

Tafsir Ibn Kathir — Modular Volume 1

Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Audited English narrative — redundant narrations removed

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Surah 1: Al-Fatihah

PDF pages 42–94

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 42–44]

The Meaning of Al-Fatihah and its: "Various Names This Surah is called Al-Fatihah, that is, the Opener of the Book, the Surah with which prayers are begun. It is also called, Umm Al-Kitab (the Mother of the Book), according to the majority of the scholars. In an authentic Hadith recorded by At-Tirmidhi, who graded it Sa hih , Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, ,"

'The prayer (i.e Al-Fatihah) is divided into two halves between Me and My servants.' When the servant says, 'All praise is due to Allah, the Lord of existence, Allah says, 'My servant has praised Me.'n Al-Fatihah was called the Salah, because reciting it is a condition for the correctness of Salah - the prayer. Al-Fatihah was also called Ash-Shifa (the Cure). It is also called Ar-Ruqyah (remedy), since in the Sahih, there is the narration of Abu Said telling the the story of the Companion who used Al-Fatihah as a remedy for the tribal chief who was poisoned. Later, the Messenger of Allah jg said to a Companion, t , Lfjl SjjJ How did you know that it is a Ruqyah?] Al-Fatihah was revealed in Makkah as Ibn Abbas, Qatadah and Abu Al- Aliyah stated. Allah said, 4u ' oi C- 1 4And indeed, We have bestowed upon you the seven Mathanty (seven repeatedly recited verses), (i.e. Surat Al-Fatihah) (15:87). ' Allah knows best. HowmanyAyatdoes Al-Fatihah contain? There is no disagreement over the view that Al-Fatihah contains seven Ayat. According to the majority of the reciters of Al-Kufah, a group of the Companions, the Tdbi'in, and a number of scholars from the successive generations, the BismiUah is a separate Ayah in its beginning. We will mention this subject again soon, if Allah wills, and in Him we trust. The Number ofWords and Letters in Al-Fatihah The scholars say that Al-Fatihah consists of twenty-five words, and that it contains one hundred and thirteen letters. Tirmidhi, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :283 . Al-Bari4 :529 . [31 That is, because this Ayah, which refers to Al-Fatihah, was itself revealed in Makkah

The Reason it is called UmmAl-Kitab

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 44–57]

In the beginning of the Book of Tafsir, in his Sahth, Al-Bukhari said; It is called Umm Al-Kitab, because the Qur an starts with it and because the prayer is started by reciting it. 111 It was also said that it is called Umm Al-Kitab, because it contains the meanings of the entire Qur an. Ibn Jarir said, The Arabs call every comprehensive matter that contains several specific areas an Umm. For instance, they call the skin that surrounds the brain, Umm Ar-Ra s. They also call the flag that gathers the ranks of the army an Umm. He also said, Makkah was called Umm Al-Qura, (the Mother of the Villages) because it is the grandest and the leader of all villages. It was also said that the earth was made starting from Makkah. 121 Further, Imam

/ toil/ teach you the greatest Surah in the Qur'an before you leave the Masjid

/ hope that I will not leave through this door until you have learned it He (Ka*b) said, The Messenger of Allah held my hand while speaking to me. Meanwhile I was slowing down fearing that he might reach the door before he finished his conversation. When we came close to the door, I said: O Messenger of Allah ! What is the Surah that you have promised to teach me? He said, ^What do you read in the prayer.

It is the seven repeated verses and the Glorious Qur'an that I was given .

It is the seven repeated verses and the Glorious Qur'an that I was given . It is the seven repeated verses and it is divided into two halves between Allah and His servant . This is the wording reported by

said, Do not do anything further until we ask the Messenger of Allah. When we went back to Al-Madina we mentioned what had happened to the Prophet The Prophet said, r~lJ ^y.^i i jti "p * + / , L\$JI AjjAj jlj> J & *Who told him that it is a Ruqyah? Divide (the sheep) and reserve a share for we. Also,

he asked for. Explaining this Hadith The last Hadith used the word Salah] prayer in reference to reciting the Qur'an, (Al-Fatihah in this case) just as Allah said in another Ayah, iAnd offer your Salah (prayer) neither aloud nor in a low voice, but jbloiv a way betioeen.} meaning, with your recitation of the Qur'an, as the Sahih. related from Ibn Abbas. 121 Also, in the last Hadith, Allah said, I have divided the prayer between Myself and My servant into two halves, a half for Me and a half for My servant. My servant shall have what he asked for. Allah next explained the division that involves reciting Al-Fatihah, demonstrating the importance of reciting the Qur'an during the prayer, which is one of the prayer's greatest pillars. Hence, the word prayer was used here although only a part of it was actually being referred to, that is, reciting the Qur'an. Similarly, the word recite was used where prayer is meant, as demonstrated by Allah's statement, iAnd recite the Qur'an in the early dawn . Verily, the recitation of the Qur'an in the early dawn is ever witnessed. in reference to the Fajr prayer. The Two Sahih's recorded that the angels of the night and the day attend this prayer.13 Reciting Al-Fatihah is required in Every Rak'ah of the Prayer All of these facts testify to the requirement that reciting the Qur'an (Al-Fatihah) in the prayer is required, and there is a consensus between the scholars on this ruling. The Hadith that we mentioned also testifies to this fact, for the Prophet said, Muslim 1 :296 , and An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 5:11,12. Fath Al-Bari 8 :257 ,3' Fath Al-Bari 8:251 and Muslim 1 :439.

There is no prayer for whoever does not recite the Opening of the Book.nW Also, the Sahih's of Ibn Khuzaymah and Ibn Hibban recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, ojTjiil Lfj \% 'j 5^Li> i V 6 The prayer during which Umm Al-Qur'dn is not recited is invalid.# There are many other Hadiths on this subject. Therefore, reciting the Opening of the Book, during the prayer by the Imam and those praying behind him, is required in every prayer, and in every Rak'ah. The Tafsir of Ist'adha (seeking Refuge) Allah said, f t _ r - .ff * Jrj >

Al-Fatihah (Part-1) with things they utter. And say: "My Lord! I seek refuge with You from the whisperings (suggestions) of the Shayatin (devils) And I seek refuge with You, My Lord! lest they

should come near me."} (23:96-98) and, *!* > *" ci ij'Jc. /CAij 4Li> tsff IjU (S? jf^ at ^Cc-k. ri y^bc. ji "\$i l^"lj Ly iiJLa jl 4 k jLiili LJJ\ '1 & ~Zk LcJi iRepel (an evil) zvith one zohiclt is better, then verily he zvith zvhom there zvas enmity betzween you, (zvill become) as though he zvas a close friend. But none is granted it except those zvho are patient and none is granted it except the owner of the great portion (ofhappiness in the Hereafter, i.e. Paradise and of a high moral character) in this zvorld. And if an evil zvhisper from Shaytdn tries to turn you axvay (O Muhammad sg) (from doing good), then seek refuge in Allah. Verily, He is the Hearing, the Kmnving.} (41:34-36) These are the only three Ayat that carry this meaning. Allah commanded that we be lenient human enemy, so that his soft nature might make him an ally and a supporter. He also commanded that we seek refuge from the Satanic enemy, because the devil does not relent in his enmity if we treat him with kindness and leniency. The devil only seeks the destruction of the Son of Adam due to the vicious enmity and hatred he has always had towards man s father, Adam. Allah said, A # 3 tr V Sc a Children of Adam! Let not Shaytdn deceive you, as he got your parents [Adam and Hazvwd (Eve)] out of Paradise} (7:27), iSurely, Shaytdn is an enemy to you, so take (treat) him as an enemy. He only invites his Hizb (fblloivers) that they may become the dwellers of the blazing Fire (35:6) and, JXj jji djJ at "YCyf ilojjj

By Your might, then I will surely, mislead them all. Except Your chosen servants among them (i.e. faithful, obedient, true believers ofIslamic Monotheism).

stand up in prayer at night, he would start his prayer with the Takbir (saying Allahu Akbai Allah is Greater) and would then supplicate, y'l ij ,hjJr JUu 3 bjtij J^Sji All praise is due to You, O Allah, and also the thanks. Blessed be Your Name, Exalted be Your sovereignty, and there is no deity worthy ofworship except You ." He would then say thrice, "iiil VI V" "There is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah, He would then say, jv^'Jl Cri 3j -t seek refuge with Allah, the Hearing, the Knowing, from the cursed Satan, from his coercion, lures to arrogance and poems J. The four collectors of the Sunan recorded this Hadith, which

There are many other Hadthihs about seeking refuge with Allah. One can find this subject in the books on supplication and the virtues of righteous, good deeds. Is the Isti'adhah (seeking Refuge) required? The majority of the scholars state that reciting the Isti'adhah (in the prayer and when reciting the Qur an) is recommended and not required, and therefore, not reciting it does not constitute a sin. However, Ar-Razi recorded that Ata bin Abi Rabah said that the Isti'adhah is required in the prayer and when one reads the Qur an. In support of Ata s statement, Ar- Razi relied upon the apparent meaning of the Ayah, iThen seek refuge.} He said that the Ayah contains a command that requires implementation. Also, the Prophet 5(3 always said the Isti'adhah. In addition, the Isti'adhah wards off the evil of Satan, which is neccessaiy, the rule is that the means needed to implement a requirement of the religion is itself also required. And when one says, 1 seek refuge with Allah from the cursed devil. Then this will suffice. Virtues ofthe Isti'adhah The Isti'adhah cleanses the mouth from the foul speech that it has indulged in. It also purifies the mouth and prepares it to recite the speech of Allah. Further, the Isti'adhah entails seeking Allah s help and acknowledging His ability to do everything. The Isti'adhah also affirms the servant s meekness, weakness and inability to face the enemy of his inner evil, whom Allah alone. Who created this enemy, is able to repel and defeat. This enemy does not accept kindness, unlike the human enemy. There are three Ayat in the Qur an that affirm this fact. Also, Allah said, tSjC^ iVerily, My

servants (i.e. the true believers of Islamic Monotheism) you have no authority over them. And sufficient is your Lord as a Guardian .} (17 :65). We should state here that the believers, whom the human enemies kill, become martyrs, while those who fall victim to the inner enemy - Satan - become bandits. Further, the believers who are defeated by the apparent enemy - disbelievers - gain a reward, while those defeated by the inner enemy earn a sin and become misguided. Since Satan sees man where man cannot see him, it is befitting that the believers seek refuge from Satan with Whom Satan cannot see. The Isti'adhah is a form of drawing closer to Allah and seeking refuge with Him from the evil of every evil creature.

What does Isti'adhah mean?

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 57–58]

Isti'adhah means, I seek refuge with Allah from the cursed Satan so that he is prevented from affecting my religious or worldly affairs, or hindering me from adhering to what I was commanded, or luring me into what I was prohibited from. Indeed, only Allah is able to prevent the evil of Satan from touching the son of Adam. This is why Allah allowed us to be lenient and kind with the human devil, so that his soft nature might cause him to refrain from the evil he is indulging in. However, Allah required us to seek refuge with Him from the evil of Satan, because he neither accepts bribes nor does kindness affect him, for he is pure evil. Thus, only He Who created Satan is able to stop his evil. This meaning is reiterated in only three Ayat in the Qur'an. Allah said in Surat Al-Araf, iShoio forgiveness, enjoin what is good, and turn away from the foolish (i.e. don't punish them).} (7:199) This is about dealing with human beings. He then said in the same Surah, t* Si iAnd if an evil whisper comes to you from Shaytan, then seek refuge with Allah. Verily, He is Hearing, Knowing (7: 200).} Allah also said in Surat Al-Mu minun, f" - < > >' . . - > " ,/ / ^ >> " t - " < ? - ;} .y I /'if

ARepel evil zoith that which is better. We are Best-Acquainted with the things they utter. And say: "My Lord! I seek refuge with You from the whisperings (suggestions) of the Shayatin (devils). And I seek refuge with You, My Lord! lest they should come near me." (23 :96-98).\$ Further, Allah said in Surat As-Sajdah, jX tj'Jx. fZj IjU u? 11 Vj j> Cj "iff 4 .T" , .>-4*!' jit AThe good deed and the evil deed cannot be equal. Repel (the evil) with one which is better, tlten verily he, between whom and you there was enmity, (will become) as though he was a close friend. But none is granted it (the above quality) except those who are patient and none is granted it except the owner of the great portion (of happiness in the Hereafter, i.e. Paradise and of a high moral character) in this world. And if an evil whisper from Shaytdn tries to turn you away (from doing good), then seek refuge in Allah. Verily, He is the Hearing, the Knowing (41:34-36).

Why the Devil is called Shaytan

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 58–67]

In the Arabic language, Shaytdn is derived from Shatana, which means the far thing. Hence, the Shaytdn has a different nature than mankind, and his sinful ways are far away from every type of righteousness. It was also said that Shaytdn is derived from Shata, (literally burned), because it was

created from fire. Some scholars said that both meanings are correct, although they state that the first meaning is more plausible. Further, Siyawayh (the renowned Arab linguistic) said, The Arabs say, So-and-so has Tashaytan, when he commits the act of the devils. If Shaytdn was derived from Shata, they would have said, Tashayyata (rather than Tashaytan). Hence, Shaytdn is derived from the word that means, far away. This is why they call those who are rebellious (or mischievous) from among the Jinns and mankind a Shaytan . Allah said, i-vv -

\$And so We have appointed for every Prophet enemies - Shayatin (devils) among mankind and Jinn, inspiring one another with adorned speech as a delusion (or by way of deception)} (6:112). In addition, the Musnad by Imam

4And indeed We have adorned the nearest heaven with lamps, and We have made such lamps Rujuman (as missiles) to drive away the Shayatin (devils)} (67:5). Allah also said, "3l V gC \kL-j gfi, Gjili tJ}\ ft) \$? ijflrfef irt Zyjp #Vf ft iVerily, We have adorned the near heaven with the stars (for beauty). And to guard against every rebellious devil. They cannot listen to the higher group (angels) for they are pelted from every side. Outcast, and theirs is a constant (or painful) torment. Except such as snatch away something by stealing, and they are pursued by a flaming fire of piercing brightness} (37:6-10). Further, Allah said. f in u iAnd indeed, We have put the big stars in the heaven and We beautified it for the beholders. And We have guarded it (near heaven) from every Shaytan Rajim (outcast Shaytdn). Except him (devil) wlv steals the hearing then he is pursued by a clear flamingfire>(15:16-18). There are several similar Ayat. It was also said that Rajim means, the person who throws or bombards things, because the devil throws doubts and evil thoughts in people s hearts. The first meaning is more popular and accurate. Bismillah is the FirstAyah ofAl-Fatihah The Companions started the Book of Allah with Bismillah: 4,1. In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.} The scholars also agree that Bismillah is a part of an Ayah

in Surat An-Naml {chapter 27). They disagree over whether it is a separate Ayah before every Surah, or if it is an Ayah, or a part of an Ayah, included in every Surah where the Bismillah appears in its beginning. Ad-Daraqutni also recorded a Hadith from Abu Hurayrah from the Prophet jig that supports this Hadith by Ibn Khuzaymah. Also, similar statements were attributed to Ali, Ibn Abbas and others. The opinion that Bismillah is an Ayah of every Surah, except Al-Bara ah (chapter 9), was attributed to (the Companions) Ibn Abbas, Ibn Umar, Ibn Az-Zubayr, Abu Hurayrah and Ali. This opinion was also attributed to the Tabi'in: Ata , Tawus, Said bin Jubayr, Makhul and Az-Zuhri. This is also the view of Abdullah bin Al-Mubarak, Ash-Shafil, Ahmad bin Hanbal, (in one report from him) Ishaq bin Rahwayh and Abu Ubayd Al-Qasim bin Salam. On the other hand, Malik, Abu Hanifah and their followers said that Bismillah is not an Ayah in Al- Fatihah or any other Surah. Dawud said that it is a separate Ayah in the beginning of every Surah, not part of the Surah itself, and this opinion was also attributed to Ahmad bin Hanbal. Basmalah aloud in the Prayer As for Basmalah aloud during the prayer, those who did not agree that it is a part of Al-Fatihah, state that the Basmalah should not be aloud. The scholars who stated that Bismillah is a part of every Surah (except chapter 9) had different opinions; some of them, such as Ash-Shafil, said that one should recite Bismillah with Al-Fatihah aloud. This is also the opinion of many among the Companions, the Tabi'in and the Imams of Muslims from the Salaf and the later generations. For instance, this is the opinion of Abu Hurayrah, Ibn Umar, Ibn Abbas, Mu'awiyah,

*Umar and Ali - according to Ibn Abdul- Barr and Al-Bayhaqi. Also, the Four Khalifahs - as Al-Khatib reported - were said to have held this view although the report from them is contradicted. The Tabi'in scholars who gave this Tafsir include Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Abu Qilabah, Az- Zuhri, Ali bin Al- Hasan, his son Muhammad, Said bin Al- Musayyib, Ata , TawQs, Mujahid, Salim, Muhammad bin Kali ' Ad-Daraqutni 1 :303 and 306

Al-Qurazi, Abu Bakr bin Muhammad bin Amr bin Hazm, Abu Wa il, Ibn Sirin, Muhammad bin Al- Munkadir, Ali bin Abdullah bin Abbas, his son Muhammad, Nafi the freed slave of Ibn Umar, Zayd bin Aslam, Umar bin Abdul-Azlz, Al-Azraq bin Qays, Habib bin Abi Thabit, Abu Ash-Sha'tha , Makhul and Abdullah bin Ma'qil bin Muqarrin. Also, Al-Bayhaqi added Abdullah bin Safwan, and Muhammad bin Al-Hanafiyyah to this list. In addition, Ibn Abdul-Barr added Amr bin Dinar. The proof that these scholars relied on is that, since Bismilldh is a part of Al-Fatihah, it should be recited aloud like the rest of Al-Fatihah. Also,

Sahth^ Furthermore, Imam Abu Abdullah Ash-Shafil and Al- Hakim in his Mustadrak, recorded that Mu'awiyah led the prayer in Al-Madinah and did not recite the Bismillah. The Muhajirin who were present at that prayer criticized that. When Mu'awiyah led the following prayer, he recited the Bismillah aloud. The Hadiths mentioned above provide sufficient proof for the opinion that the Bismillah is recited aloud. As for the opposing evidences and the scientific analysis of the narrations mentioned their weaknesses or otherwise it is not our desire to discuss this subject at this time. Other scholars stated that the Bismillah should not be recited aloud in the prayer, and this is the established practice of the Four Khalifahs, as well as Abdullah bin Mughaffal and several scholars among the Tdbi'in and later generations. It is also the Madhhab (view) of Abu Hanlfah, Ath-Thawri and

63Surah 1 , Al-Fatihah (Part-1) whether in the beginning or the end of the recitation. Similar is recorded in the Sunan books from Abdullah bin Mughaffal, may Allah be pleased with him.¹² These are the opinions held by the respected Imams, and their statements are similar in that they agree that the prayer of those who recite Al-Fatihah aloud or in secret is correct. All the favor is from Allah. The Virtue of Al- Fatihah Imam

large as a house. Rather, say, 'Bismillah/ because Satan then becomes as small as a fly. u 1 ' 1 This is the blessing of reciting Bismillah. Basmalah is recommended before performing any Deed Basmalah (reciting Bismillah is recommended before starting any action or deed. For instance, Basmalah is recommended before starting a Khutbah (speech). The Basmalah is also recommended before one enters the place where he wants to relieve himself, there is a Hadith concerning this practice.' 2 ' Further, Basmalah is recommended at the beginning of ablution, for Imam

// anyone of you before having sexual relations with his wife says, 'In the Name of Allah. O Alldl! Protect us from Satan and also protect what you grant us (meaning the coming offspring) from Satan,' and if it is destined that they should have a child then, Satan zoill never be able to harm that child, it1 ' 1

The Meaning of Allah Allah is the Name of the. Lord, the Exalted. It is said that Allah is the Greatest Name of Allah, because it is referred to when describing Allah by the various attributes. For instance, Allah said, & ft 'ft JfS\ jli y, V}, l J. V & f>) & f'ffX fjxti wfS\ ft \ ill y \nVi 'jj Uj\$ o&R & f> iii Ai %

He is Allah, beside Whom there is no other deity (none has the right to be worshipped but He) the Knower of the unseen and the seen. He is the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. He is Allah, beside Whom there is no other deity, the King, the Holy, the One free from all defects, the Giver of security, the Watcher over His creatures, the Almighty, the Compeller, the Supreme. Glory be to Allah! (High is He) above all that they associate as partners with Him. He is Allah, the Creator, the Inventor of all things, the Best of all forms. To Him belong the Best Names. All that is in the heavens and the earth glorify Him. And He is the Almighty, the Wise (59:22-24). Hence, Allah mentioned several of His Names as Attributes for His Name Allah. Similarly, Allah said, And (all) the Most Beautiful Names belong to Allah, so call on Him by them (7:180), and, *Allah* is the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful (FathAl-Bari 9:136, Muslim 2:1058).

66 Tafsir Ibn Kathir i. Say (O Muhammad sg.): "Invoke Allah or invoke the Most Gracious (Al-Rahman), by whatever name you invoke Him (it is the same), for to Him belong the Best Names."

The Meaning of Ar-Rahman Ar-Rahim - the Most

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 67–80]

Gracious, the Most Merciful Ar-Rahman and Ar-Rahim are two names derived from Ar-Rahmah (the mercy), but Rahman has more meanings that pertain to mercy than Ar-Rahim. There is a statement by Ibn Jarir that indicates that there is a consensus on this meaning. Further, Al-Qurtubi said, The proof that these names are derived (from Ar-Rahmah), is what

Al-Fatihah (Part-1) and Nadim, as Abu Ubayd has stated. Abu Ali Al-Farisi said, Ar-Rahman, which is exclusively for Allah, is a name that encompasses every type of mercy that Allah has. Ar-Rahim is what effects the believers, for Allah said, And He is ever Rahim (merciful) to the believers. (33:43) Also, Ibn Abbas said - about Ar-Rahman and Ar-Rahim, They are two soft names, one of them is softer than the other (meaning it carries more implications of mercy). Ibn Jarir said; As-Surri bin Yahya At-Tamimi narrated to me that Uthman bin Zufar related that Al-Azrami said about Ar-Rahman and Ar-Rahim, He is Ar-Rahman with all creation and Ar-Rahim with the believers. Hence. Allah's statements, Then He rose over (Istawa) the Throne (in a manner that suits His majesty), Ar-Rahman (25:59), and, Ar-Rahman (Allah) rose over (Istawa) the (Mighty) Throne (in a manner that suits His majesty). (20:5) Allah thus mentioned the Istawa - rising over the Throne - along with His Name Ar-Rahman, to indicate that His mercy encompasses all of His creation. Allah also said, And He is ever Rahim (merciful) to the believers, thus encompassing the believers with His Name Ar-Rahim. They said, This testifies to the fact that Ar-Rahman carries a broader scope of meanings pertaining to the mercy of Allah with His creation in both lives. Meanwhile, Ar-Rahim is exclusively for the believers. Yet, we should mention that there is a supplication that reads, "The Rahman and the Rahim of this life and the Hereafter" 111 Tafsir Al-Qurtubi 1:105. [2] At-Tabari 1:127.

Al-Fatihah (Part-1) (merciful) (9:128). Allah has also described some of His creation using some of His other Names. For instance, Allah said, Verily, We have created man from Nutfah (drops) of mixed semen (sexual discharge of man and woman), in order to try him, so We made him hearer (Sami') and seer (Basir) (76:2). In conclusion, there are several of Allah's Names that are used as names for others

besides Allah. Further, some of Allah's Names are exclusive for Allah alone, such as Allah, Ar-Rahman, Al-Khaliq (the Creator), Ar-Raziq (the Sustainer), and so forth. Hence, Allah started the Tasmiyah (meaning, In the Name of Allah, Most Gracious Most Merciful) with His Name, Allah, and described Himself as Ar-Rahman, (Most Gracious) which is softer and more general than Ar-Rahim. The most honorable Names are mentioned first, just as Allah did here. A Hadith narrated by Umm Salamah stated that the recitation of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was slow and clear, letter by letter, *ygfi . p * ~^}* i. . /u iln the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. All the praises and thanks be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists. The Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. The Owner of the Day of Recompense} (1:1-4). And this is how a group of scholars recite it. Others connected the recitation of the Tasmiyah to Al-Hamd. *4l0laJhiji <_ "j fu j1^S\}* 42. Al-Hamd be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.} The Meaning of Al-Hamd Abu Jafar bin Jarir said, The meaning of *4fa 1^}*

iAl-Hamdu Lilldh (all praise and thanks be to Allah) is: all thanks are due purely to Allah, alone, not any of the objects that are being worshipped instead of Him, nor any of His creation. These thanks are due to Allah's innumerable favors and bounties, that only He knows the amount of. Allah's bounties include creating the tools that help the creation worship Him, the physical bodies with which they are able to implement His commands, the sustenance that He provides them in this life, and the comfortable life He has granted them, without anything or anyone compelling Him to do so. Allah also warned His creation and alerted them about the means and methods with which they can earn eternal dwelling in the residence of everlasting happiness. All thanks and praise are due to Allah for these favors from beginning to end. Further, Ibn Jarir commented on the Ayah, iAl-Hamdu Lilldh}, that it means, A praise that Allah praised Himself with, indicating to His servants that they too should praise Him, as if Allah had said, Say: All thanks and praise is due to Allah. It was said that the statement, *4A11* praise and thanks be to Allah}, entails praising Allah by mentioning His most beautiful Names and most honorable Attributes. When one proclaims, All thanks are due to Allah, he will be thanking Him for His favors and bounties. 12 The Difference between Praise and Thanks Hamd is more general, in that it is a statement of praise for one's characteristics, or for what he has done. Thanks are given for what was done, not merely for characteristics. The Statements of the Salaf about Al-Hamd Hafis mentioned that Umar said to Ali, We know *La ilaha illallah*, *Subhan Allah* and *Allahu Akbar*. What about Al-Hamdu Lilldh? Ali said, A statement that Allah liked for At-Tabari 1:135. At-Tabari 1 :137.

Himself, was pleased with for Himself and He likes that it be repeated. 111 Also, Ibn Abbas said, Al-Hamdu Lillah is the statement of appreciation. When the servant says Al-Hamdu Lillah, Allah says, My servant has praised Me. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this HadithP The Virtues of Al-Hamd Imam

72 * Tafsir Ibn Kathir said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, *(J ^"J -uAll tID i IS : Jj jlle Ijl* jji> l3j 'J 'JUi ail Jj lu" IfjL^xj IjjJj j*Ii jllsijL oJLajo . . M1UI : oXp JU LL 1 4)1 JU i vials V JjLzS Jli A* Ijlp o\ ^j ^ -U^Jl jjj ! Jli ajI iljj U !^IS !Sl Jiil: Jj- , X* Jli as Uds-I :L\$ Jii jiii .dujLL ijI^J 8 . If> A servant of Allah once said, 'O Allah! Yours is the Hamd that is suitable for the grace of Your Face and the greatness of Your Supreme Authority. The two angels were confused as to how to write these words. They ascended to Allah and said, 'O our Lord! A servant has just uttered a statement and we are unsure how to record it for him.' Allah said while having more knowledge in what His servant has said, What did My servant say? They said, 'He said, 'O Allah! Yours is the Hamd that is suitable for the grace of*

Your Face and the greatness of Your Supreme Authority.' Allah said to them, Write it as My servant has said it, until he meets Me and often I shall reward him for it.) Al before Hamd encompasses all Types of Thanks and Appreciation for Allah The letters Alif and Lam before the word Hamd serve to encompass all types of thanks and appreciation for Allah, the Exalted. A Hadith stated. idp jl hsLf iiiS ilUjl dij , ^s juJl ill ^liis oils' "O Allah! All of Al-Hamd is due to You, You own all the ownership, all types of good are in Your Hand and all affairs belong to YouM2 111 Ibn Majah 2:1249.TarghJb wat-Tarhib 2 :253

Al-Fdihali (Part-1) The Meaning of Ar-Rabb, the Lord Ar-Rabb is the owner who has full authority over his property. Ar-Rabb, linguistically means, the master or the one who has the authority to lead. All of these meanings are correct for Allah. When it is alone, the word Rabb is used only for Allah. As for other than Allah, it can be used to say Rabb Ad-Dar, the master of such and such object. Further, it was reported that Ar-Rabb is Allah's Greatest Name. The Meaning of Al-'Alamin Al- Alamin is plural for Alam, which encompasses everything in existence except Allah. The word Alam is itself a plural word, having no singular form. The Alamin are different creations that exist in the heavens and the earth, on land and at sea. Every generation of creation is called an Alam. Al- Farra' and Abu TJBayd said, Alam includes all that has a mind, the Jinns, mankind, the angels and the devils, but not the animals. Also, Zayd bin Aslam and Abu Muhaysin said, Alam includes all that Allah has created with a soul. Further, Qatadah said about, iThe Lord of the 'Alamin}, Every type of creation is an Alam. Az-Zajaj also said, Alam encompasses everything that Allah created, in this life and in the Hereafter. Al-Qurtubi commented, This is the correct meaning, that the Alam encompasses everything that Allah created in both worlds. Similarly, Allah said, o' iFir'awn (Pharaoh) said: "And what is the Lord of the 'Alamin?" Musa (Moses) said: "The Lord of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them, if you seek to be convinced with certainty"} (26 :23-24). Why is the Creation called Alam? Alam is derived from Alamah, that is because it is a sign testifying to the existence of its Creator and to His Oneness. m Al-Qurtubi 1 :139

-4 >' 43. Ar-Rahman (the Most Gracious), Ar-Rahim (the Most Merciful)}. Allah said next, 4Ar-Rahmdn (the Most Gracious), Ar-Raliim (the Most Merciful)} We explained these Names in the Basmalah. Al-Qurtubi said, Allah has described Himself by Ar-Rahman, Ar-Rahim after saying the Lord of the Alamin , so His statement here includes a warning, and then an encouragement. Similarly, Allah said, jVj ,if.l Gi tji li^} iDeclare (O Muhammad unto My servants, that truly, I am the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful. And that My torment is indeed the most painful torment.) (15:49-50)* Allah said, iSurely, your Lord is swift in retribution, and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} (6:165) Hence, Rabb contains a warning while Ar-Rahman Ar-Rahim encourages. Further,

Al-Fdihah (Part-1 but this does not negate His sovereignty over all other things. For Allah mentioned that He is the Lord of existence, including this earthly life and the Hereafter. Allah only mentioned the Day of Recompense here because on that Day, no one except Him will be able to claim ownership of anything whatsoever. On that Day, no one will be allowed to speak without His permission. Similarly, Allah said, rA . J'b j 4 U~" iSoiU'j [ji: fj.} iThe Day that Ar-Ruh (Jibril (Gabriel) or another angel) and the angels will stand forth in rows, they will not speak except him whom the Most Gracious (Allah) allows, and he will speak what is right.} (78:38), 4) ^} iAnd all voices will be humbled for the Most

Gracious (Allah), and nothing shall you hear but the voice of their footsteps.} (20:108), and, - x> s' ".! > ' J- ot } iOti the Day when it comes, no person shall speak except by His (Allah s) leave. Some among them will be wretched and (others) blessed} (11:105). Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas commented, Allah says, On that Day, no one owns anything that they used to own in the world. The Meaning of Yawm Ad-Din Ibn Abbas said, Yawm Ad-Din is the Day of Recompense for the creatures, meaning the Day of Judgment. On that Day, Allah will reckon the creation for their deeds, evil for evil, good for good, except for those whom He pardons. In addition, several other Companions, Tabi'in and scholars of the Salaf, said similarly, for this meaning is apparent and clear from the Ayah. Allah is Al-Malik (King or Owner) Allah is the True Owner (Malik) (of everything and everyone). Allah said, 111 Ibn Abi Hfitim 1:19.

J./M QX>^% 4He is Allah, beside Whom Ld ildha ilia Huwa, the King, the Holy, the One free from all defects> (59:23). Also, the Two Sahihs recorded Abu Hurayrah saying that

4l V) ilJU l 4IIL JLz Jf-j r- The most despicable name to Allah is a person who calls himself the king of kings, while there are no owners except Am. Also the Two Sahihs recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ^jt\ itllLeJl ui : JjZ Cm

iWhen He made Prophets among you, and made you kings^ (5:20). Also, the Two Sahihs recorded, j4" Jusf like kings reclining on their thrones a ' The Meaning of Ad-Din Ad-Din means the reckoning, the reward or punishment. Similarly, Allah said, iOn that Day Allah will pay them the (Dinahum) recompense (of their deeds) in full> (24:25), and, 4offJ iLi^ iShall we indeed (be raised up) to receive reward or punishment (according to our deeds)?} (37:53). A Hadith stated. The wise person is he who reckons himself and works for (his life) after death. d meaning, he holds himself accountable. Also, Umar said, Hold yourself accountable before you are held accountable, weigh yourselves before you are weighed, and be prepared for the biggest gathering before He Whose knowledge encompasses your deeds, jy'j} iThat Day shall you be brought to Judgement, not a secret of yours will be hidden} (69:18). j){ te\} 45. You we worship, and You we askJbr help.} (1:5) The Linguistic and Religious Meaning of *Ibadah Linguistically, Ibadah means subdued. For instance, a road * Fath Al-Bari 6 :89 and Muslim 3:1518. 121 Ibn Majah 2:1423.

78 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir is described as Mu'abbadah, meaning, paved . In religious terminology, Ibadah implies the utmost love, humility and fear. The Merit of stating the Object of the Action before the Doer of the Act, and the Merit of these Negations You... , means, we worship You alone and none else, and rely on You alone and none else. This is the perfect form of obedience and the entire religion is implied by these two ideas. Some of the Salaf said, Al-Fatihah is the secret of the Qur'an, while these words are the secret of Al-Fatihah, JO 45. You we worship, and You we ask for help from.} The first part is a declaration of innocence from Shirk (polytheism), while the second negates having any power or strength, displaying the recognition that all affairs are controlled by Allah alone. This meaning is reiterated in various instances in the Qur'an. For instance, Allah said, / / C // /y 4So I worship Him (O Muhammad sg) and put your trust in Him. And your Lord is not unaware of what you (people) do.} (11:123), i&f . iL'i : &J \$ ji> iSay: "He is the Most Gracious (Allah), in Him we believe, and in Him we put our trust."} (67:29), 4(He alone is) the Lord of the east and the west; Ld ildha ilia Huwa (none has the right to be worshipped but He). So take Him alone as Wakil (Disposer of your affairs)}, (73:9), and. i

jjujj jLo 4You we worship, and You we askfor helpfrom}. We should mention that in this Ayah, the type of speech here changes from the third person to direct speech by using the Kaf in the statement Iyyaka (You). This is because after the servant praised and thanked Allah, he stands before Him,

addressing Him directly; }You we worship, and You we askfor helpfrom}. Al-Fatihah indicates the Necessity of praising Allah. It is required in every Prayer.

The beginning of Surat Al-Fatihah contains Allah's praise for

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 80–84]

Tliere is tw valid prayerfor whoever does not recite Al-Fatiliah of the BooleV Also, it is recorded in Sahih Muslim that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, J if?j u-i xJxi : JU; li)i J^a;

80 Tafctr Ibn Kathir Allah says, My servant lias praised Me.'When the servant says, 1 iThe Most Gracious, the Most Merciful}, Allah says, My servant has praised Me.' When the servant says, iThe Owner of the Day of Recompense}, Allah says, 'My servant has glorified Me.' If the servant says, i iltjjj Jl-jo Jjljt^ iYoti we worship, and You we ask for help}, Allah says, 'This is between Me and My servant, and My servant shall have what he asked.' If the servant says, if v; iGuide us to the straight path. The path of those on whom You have bestoived Your grace, not (that) of those who have earned Your anger, nor of those who went astray}, Allah says, This is forMy servant, andMy servant shall have what he asked/i Tawhid Al-Uluhiyyah Ad-Dahhak narrated that Ibn Abbas said, iX~^ iYou we worship} means, It isYouwhomwe single out, Whomwe fearandWhomwe hope in, You alone, our Lord, and none else. Tawhid Ar-Rububiyyah icss }And You we ask for help from}, to obey you and in all of our affairs. Further, Qatadah said that the Ayah, i: M\} 1 :297. ,2) Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :19.

Al-Fdtihah (Part-1) 4You we worship, and You we askfor helpfrom} Contains Allah s command to us to perform sincere worship for Him and to seek His aid concerning all ofour affairs. Allah mentioned, 4Juju jLjJ4 4You we worship} before, 44?~ 4And You we ask for help from}, because the objective here is the worship, while Allah s help is the tool to implement this objective. Certainly, one first takes care of the most important aspects and then what is less important, and Allah knows best. Allah called His Prophet^ an Abd Allah called His Messenger jg an Abd (servant) when He mentioned sending down His Book, the Prophet s involvement in inviting to Him, and when mentioning the Isra (overnight journey from Makkah to Jerusalem and then to heaven), and these are the Prophet s most honorable missions. Allah said, 4' * '6- ' k 4AU praise and thanks be to Alldlt, Who has sent down to His servant (Mulmmad the Book (the Qur an)) (18:1), 4 JLt Cl f^i} 4And when the servant of Allah (Muhammad is) stood up invoking Him (his Lord - Allah in prayer)}, (72:19) and, 4^J *;jJJu Isfj Cjjft J*CL.} 4Clorified (and Exalted) be He (Allah) (above all that they associate with Him) Who took His servant (Muhammad %) for a journey by night} (17:1). Encouraging the Performance of the Acts of Worship duringTimes ofDistress Allah also recommended that His Prophet sg resort to acts of worship during times when he felt distressed because of the 111 Ibid. 1 :20

they associate with You)! Truly, / have been of the wrongdoers) (21:87). Further, one may praise Him without mentioning what he needs. The Meaning ofGuidance mentioned in the Surah The guidance mentioned in the Surah implies being directed and guided to success. Allah said, ' "')' iCuide us to the

straight path) meaning guide, direct, lead and grant us the correct guidance. Also, 'ojwJi iAnd shown him the two ways (good and evil?) (90:10), means, *We explained to him the paths of good and evil. Also, Allah said, 4He (Allah) chose him (as an intimate friend) and guided him to a straight path) (16:121), and, iAnd lead them on to the zuay offlaming Fire (Hell)) (37:23). Similarly, Allah said, iAnd verily, you (O Muhammad sg) are indeed guiding (mankind) to the straight path) (42:52), and, 4u4l \$ *^ jSQ) iAll praise and thanks be to Allah, Who has guided us to this) (7:43), meaning, guided us and directed us and qualified us for this end - Paradise.

The Meaning of As-Sirat Al-Mustaqim, the Straight

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 84–94]

Path. As for the meaning of As-Sirat Al-Mustaqim, Imam Abu Ja far

Al-Fdthah (Part-1) The Faithful ask for and abide by Guidance If someone asks, Why does the believer ask Allah for guidance during every prayer and at other times, while he is already properly guided? Has he not already acquired guidance? The answer to these questions is that if it were not a fact that the believer needs to keep asking for guidance day and night, Allah would not have directed him to invoke Him to acquire the guidance. The servant needs Allah the Exalted every hour of his life to help him remain firm on the path of guidance and to make him even more firm and persistent on it. The servant does not have the power to benefit or harm himself, except by Allah s permission. Therefore, Allah directed the servant to invoke Him constantly, so that He provides him with His aid and with firmness and success. Indeed, the happy person is he whom Allah guides to ask of Him. This is especially the case if a person urgently needs Allah s help day or night. Allah said, IS ^ jit (jLjli i gftjj I {) } 43? u;& 40 you who believe! Believe in Allah, and His Messenger (Muhammad %g), and the Book (the Qur'an) which He has sent down to His Messenger, and the Scripture which He sent down to those before (him)) (4:16). Therefore, in this Ayah Allah commanded the believers to believe, and this command is not redundant since what is sought here is firmness and continuity of performing the deeds that help one remain on the path of faith. Also, Allah commanded His believing servants to proclaim, 4; 4. iiA he k'JM Q Aj h * * < } iOur Lord! Let not our hearts deviate (from the truth) after You have guided us, and grant us mercy from You. Truly, You are the Bestower.} (3:8). Hence, iGuide us to the straight way} means, Make us firm on the path of guidance and do not allow us to deviate from it.

V) p+sc j*. jv^Ac e-jit Cjl/jj"" 47. 77ie way 0/ those upon whom You have bestowed Your grace, not (that) of those who earned Your anger, nor of those who went astray}. We mentioned the Hadith in which the servant proclaims, iGuide us to the straight way and Allah says, This is for My servant, and My servant shall acquire what he asks for. Allah s statement. iThe way of those upon whom You have bestowed Your grace defines the path. Those upon whom Allah has bestowed His grace are those mentioned in Surat An-Nisa (chapter 4), when Allah said, / .'- 7 * /V * i iAnd whoever obeys Allah and the Messenger (Muhammad \$&), then they will be in the company of those on whom Allah has bestowed His grace, the Prophets, the Siddiqin (the truly faithful), the martyrs, and the righteous. And how excellent these companions are! Such is the bounty from Allah, and Allah is sufficient to know (4:69-70). Allah s statement, jCc-} iNot (the way) of those who earned Your anger, nor of those who went astray } meaning guide us to the straight path, the path of those upon whom you have bestowed

Your grace, that is, the people of guidance, sincerity and obedience to Allah and His Messengers. They are the people who adhere to Allah's commandments and refrain from committing what He has prohibited. But, help us to avoid the path of those whom Allah is angry with, whose intentions are corrupt, who know the truth, yet deviate from it. Also, help us avoid the path of those

Al-Fdthah (Part-1) who were led astray, who lost the true knowledge and, as a result, are wandering in misguidance, unable to find the correct path. Allah asserted that the two paths He described here are both misguided when He repeated the negation not. These two paths are the paths of the Christians and Jews, a fact that the believer should beware of so that he avoids them. The path of the believers is knowledge of the truth and abiding by it. In comparison, the Jews abandoned practicing the religion, while the Christians lost the true knowledge. This is why anger descended upon the Jews, while being described as led astray is more appropriate of the Christians. Those who know, but avoid implementing the truth, deserve the anger, unlike those who are ignorant. The Christians want to seek the true knowledge, but are unable to find it because they did not seek it from its proper resources. This is why they were led astray. We should also mention that both the Christians and the Jews have earned the anger and are led astray, but the anger is one of the attributes more particular of the Jews. Allah said about the Jews, ii' iii iThose (Jews) who incurred the curse of Allah and His wrath (5:60). The attribute that the Christians deserve most is that of being led astray, just as Allah said about them, 4^J' j* =. tfeS; JJj iWho wait astray before and who misled many, and strayed (themselves) from the right path} (5:77). There are several Hadiths and reports from the Salaf on this subject. Imam

Prophet jg came back, there was a man next to him, I think that he was Ali, who said to her, Ask him for a means of transportation. She asked the Prophet jg, and he ordered that she be given an animal. Adi then said, Later on, she came to me and said, He (Muhammad jg) has done a favor that your father (who was a generous man) would never have done. So and-so person came to him and he granted him his favor, and so-and-so came to him and he granted him his favor. So I went to the Prophet sg and found that some women and children were gathering with him, so close that I knew that he was not a king like Kisra (King of Persia) or Caesar. He said, O Adi! What made you run away, so that La ilaha illalldh is not proclaimed? Is there a deity worthy of worship except Allah? What made you run away, so that AUa.hu Akbar (AllAh is the Greater) is not proclaimed? Is there anything Greater than Allah? I proclaimed my Islam and I saw his face radiate with pleasure and he said: J ^ .1 i 1 c. Ljj .1^W 1 Those who have earned the anger are the Jews and those who are led astray are the Christians This HacLUh was also collected by At-Tirmidhi who said that it is Hasan Gharib . (1 Also, when Zayd bin Amr bin Nufayl went with some of his friends - before Islam - to Ash-Sham seeking the true religion, the Jews said to him, You will not become a Jew unless you carry a share of the anger of Allah that we have earned. He said, I am seeking to escape Allah's anger. Also, the Christians said to him, If you become one of us you will carry a share in Allah's discontent. He said, I cannot bear it. So he remained in his pure nature and avoided worshipping the idols and the polytheistic practices. He became neither a Jew, nor Christian. As for his companions, they became Christians because they found it more pure than Judaism. Waraqah bin Nawfal was among these people until Allah guided him by the hand of His Prophet g, when he was sent as Prophet, and Waraqah believed in the revelation that was sent to the Prophet may Allah be pleased with him. *** Ahmad 4:378, and Tuhfat At-Ahwadhi 8:289.

The Summary of Al-Fatihah The honorable Surah Al-Fatihah contains seven Ayat including the praise and thanks of Allah, glorifying Him and praising Him by mentioning His most Beautiful Names and most high Attributes. It also mentions the Hereafter, which is

the Day of Resurrection, and directs Allah's servants to ask of Him, invoking Him and declaring that all power and strength comes from Him. It also calls to the sincerity of the worship of Allah alone, singling Him out in His divinity, believing in His perfection, being free from the need of any partners, having no rivals nor equals. Al-Fatihah directs the believers to invoke Allah to guide them to the straight path, which is the true religion, and to help them remain on that path in this life, and to pass over the actual Sirat (bridge over hell that everyone must pass over) on the Day of Judgment. On that Day, the believers will be directed to the gardens of comfort in the company of the Prophets, the truthful ones, the martyrs and the righteous. Al-Fatihah also encourages performing good deeds, so that the believers will be in the company of the good-doers on the Day of Resurrection. The Surah also warns against following the paths of misguidance, so that one does not end up being gathered with those who indulge in sin, on

the Day of Resurrection, including those who have earned the anger and those who were led astray. The Bounties are because of Allah, not the Deviations Allah said, 'The way of those upon whom you have bestowed Your grace', when He mentioned His favor. On mentioning anger, Allah said, 'Not (that) of those who earned Your anger without mentioning the subject, although it is He Who has sent down the anger on them, just as Allah stated in another Ayah, 'if you have seen those (hypocrites) who take as friends a people upon whom is the wrath of Allah (i.e.

90 Tafsir Ibtt Kathtr Jews)?' (58:14). Also, Allah relates the misguidance of those who indulged in it, although they were justly misguided according to Allah's appointed destiny. For instance, Allah said, 'He whom Allah guides, he is the rightly-guided; but he whom He sends astray, for him you will find no Waif (guiding friend) to lead him (to the right path)' (18:17) and, 'Whomsoever Allah sends astray, none can guide him; and He lets them wander blindly in their transgression' (7:186). These and several other Ayat testify to the fact that Allah alone is the One Who guides and misguides, contrary to the belief of the Qadariyyah sect, who claimed that the servants choose and create their own destiny. They rely on some unclear Ayat avoiding what is clear and contradicts their desires. Theirs, is the method of the people who follow their lust, desire and wickedness. An authentic Hadith narrated, 'When you see those who follow what is not so clear in it (the Qur'an), then they are those whom Allah has mentioned (refer to 3:7). Hence, avoid them.' The Prophet (ﷺ) was referring to Allah's statement, 'to those who are given the book, We have sent down the Qur'an as for those in whose hearts there is a deviation (from the truth) they follow that which is not entirely clear thereof, seeking Al-Fitnah (polytheism and trials), and seeking for its hidden meanings' (3:7). Verily, no innovator in the religion could ever rely on any authentic evidence in the Qur'an that testifies to his innovation. The Qur'an came to distinguish between truth and falsehood, and guidance and misguidance. The Qur'an does Al-Bdri8:57.

Al-Fatihah (Part-1) not contain any discrepancies or contradictions, because it is a revelation from the Most Wise, Worthy of all praise. Saying Amin It is recommended to say Amin after finishing the

recitation of Al-Fatihah. Amin means, O Allah! Accept our invocation. The evidence that saying Amin is recommended is contained in what Imams

1They will not envy us for anything more than they envy us for Friday which we have been guided to, while they were led astray from it, and for the Qiblah which we were guided to, while they were led astray from it, and for our saying Amin behind the Imam .n Also,

Surah 2: Al-Baqarah (Part 1 of 4)

PDF pages 95–803

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 95–103]

Opening Tafsirof SuratAl-Baqarah (Chapter 2)

The Virtues of SuratAl-Baqarah In Musnad

Everything has a hump (or, high peek), ami Al-Baqarah is the high peek of the Qur'an . Whoever recites Al-Baqarah at night in his house, that Shaytan toill not enter that house for three nights. Whoever recites it during a day in his house, then Shaytan will not enter that housefor three days .

|> . > i ' <_p cs? i>* JS , ^-;?->* v j^ * (iLearn Al-Qur'an and recite it, for the example of whoever learns the Qur'an, recites it and adheres to it, is the example of a bag that is full ofmusk whose scent fills the air. The example of whoever learns the Qur'an and then sleeps (i.e . lazy) while the Qur'an is in his memory, is the example of a bag that has musk, but is closed tight.

This is the narration reported by Imam Abu Ubayd Al-Qasim bin Salam in his book Fada il Al-Qur an. Virtues of SuratAl-Baqarahand SuratAl *Imran Imam Ahmad said that Abu Nu'aym narrated to them that Bishr bin Muhajir said that Abdullah bin Buraydah narrated to him from his father, I was sitting with the Prophet and I heard him say, 'jj UJU-i S'JLJl \ 8Learn Surat Al-Baqarah, because in learning it there is blessing, in ignoring it there is sorrow, and the sorceresses cannot memorize itj He jg kept silent for a while and then said, fji jlj jA> -j* L jiS j\ jliiUJ- j*

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) companion, the Qur'an, which has brought you thirst during the heat and made you stay up during the night. Every merchant has his certain trade. But, this Day, you are behind all types of trade. Kingship will then be given to him in his right hand, eternal life in his left hand and the croion of grace ivill be placed on his head. His parents will also be granted tivo garments that the people of this life could never afford. They ivill say, 'Why were we granted these garments?' It ivill be said, 'Because your son was carrying the Qur'an.' It ivill be said (to the reader of the Qur'an), 'Read and ascend through the levels of Paradise. He will go on ascending as long as he recites, whether reciting sloivly or quicklyj 111

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) the Qur an. Some of the scholars said that it contains a thousand news incidents, a thousand commands and a thousand prohibitions. Those who count said that the number of Al-Baqarah s Ayat is two hundred and eighty-seven, and its words are six thousand two hundred and twenty-one words. Further, its letters are twenty-five thousand five hundred. Allah knows best. Ibn Jurayj narrated that Ata said that Ibn Abbas said, Surat Al-Baqarah was revealed in Al-Madlnah. 111 Also, Khasif said from Mujahid that Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr said; Surat Al-Baqarah was revealed in Al-Madlnah. 12* Several Imams and scholars of Tafsir issued similar statements, and there is no

difference of opinion over this as we have stated. The Two Sahihs recorded that Ibn Mas'Ud kept the Ka'bah on his left side and Mina on his right side and threw seven pebbles (at the Jamrah) and said, The one to whom Surat Al- Baqarah was revealed (i.e. the Prophet performed Rami (the Hajj rite of throwing pebbles) similarly. The Two Sahihs recorded this HadithS3 Further, Ibn Marduwyah reported a Hadith of Shu'bah from Aqll bin Talhah from TJtbah bin Marthad; The Prophet saw that his Companions were not in the first lines and he said, "rXJl 0jyl* U" O Companions of Surat Al-Baqarah . " I Think that this incident occurred during the battle of Hunayn when the Companions retreated. Then, the Prophet jg commanded Al- Abbas (his uncle) to yell out, OUwii Ul "0 Companions of the tree/" meaning the Companions who participated in the pledge of Ar-Ridwan (under the tree). In another narration, Al- Abbas cried, O Companions of Surat Al-BaqarahV encouraging them to come back, so they returned from every direction. Also, during the battle of Al-Yamamah, against the army of Musaylimah the Liar, the Companions * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 1 :47. 121 Ibid. Al-B&ri3 :678 , Muslim 2 :942

first retreated because of the huge number of soldiers in Musaylimah s army. The Muhajirun and the Ansar called out for each other, saying; O people of Surat Al-Baqarah\ Allah then gave them victory over their enemy, may Allah be pleased with all of the companions of all the Messengers of Allah 4i &p 4 i . ilti the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful 41. AlifLam Mim}. The Discussion ofthe Individual Letters The individual letters in the beginning of some Surahs are among those things whose knowledge Allah has kept only for Himself. This was reported from Abu Bakr, Umar, Uthman, Ali and Ibn Mas'ud. It was said that these letters are the names of some of the Surahs. It was also said that they are the beginnings that Allah chose to start the Surahs of the Qur an with. Khaslf stated that Mujahid said, The beginnings of the Surahs, such as Qaf, Sad, Ta Sin Mim and AlifLam Ra, are just some letters of the alphabet. Some linguists also stated that they are letters of the alphabet and that Allah simply did not cite the entire alphabet of twenty-eight letters. For instance, they said, one might say, My son recites Alif, Ba, Ta, Tha... he means the entire alphabet although he stops before mentioning the rest of it. This opinion was mentioned by Ibn Jarir. The Letters at the Beginning ofSurahs Ifone removes the repetitive letters, then the number of letters mentioned at the beginning of the Surahs is fourteen: Alif, Lam, Mim, Sad, Ra, Kdf, Ha, Yd, Ayn, Ta, Sin, Ha, Qaf, Nun. So glorious is He Who made everything subtly reflect His wisdom. Moreover, the scholars said, There is no doubt that Allah did not reveal these letters for jest and play. Some ignorant 111 Al-Majma' 6:180.Tabari 1 : 208

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) people said that some of the Qur an does not mean anything, (meaning, such as these letters) thus committing a major mistake. On the contrary, these letters carry a specific meaning. Further, if we find an authentic narration leading to the Prophet sg that explains these letters, we will embrace the Prophet s statement. Otherwise, we will stop where we were made to stop and will proclaim, 4 l Of A. 4We believe in it; all of it (clear and unclear verses) isfrom our Lord" (3 :7). The scholars did not agree on one opinion or explanation

regarding this subject. Therefore, whoever thinks that one

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 103–114]

scholar's opinion is correct, he is obliged to follow it, otherwise it is better to refrain from making any judgment on this matter. Allah knows best. These Letters testify to the Miraculous Qur'an. The wisdom behind mentioning these letters in the beginning of the Surahs, regardless of the exact meanings of these letters, is that they testify to the miracle of the Qur'an. Indeed, the servants are unable to produce something like the Qur'an, although it is comprised of the same letters with which they speak to each other. This opinion was mentioned by Ar-Razi in his Tafsir who related it to Al-Mubarrid and several other scholars. Al-Qurtubi also related this opinion to Al-Farra and Qutrub. Az-Zamakhshari agreed with this opinion in his book, Al-Kashshaf. In addition, the Imam and scholar Abu Al- Abbas Ibn Taymiyyah and our Shaykh Al-Hafiz Abu Al-Hajjaj Al-Mizzi agreed with this opinion. Al-Mizzi told me that it is also the opinion of Shaykh Al-Islam Ibn Taymiyyah. Az-Zamakhshari said that these letters, Were not all mentioned once in the beginning of the Qur'an. Rather, they were repeated so that the challenge (against the creation) is more daring. Similarly, several stories were mentioned repeatedly in the Qur'an, and also the challenge was repeated in various areas (i.e., to produce something like the Qur'an). Sometimes, one letter at a time was mentioned, such as Sad, Nun and Qaf. Sometimes two letters were mentioned, such as

Tafsir Ibtt Kathir 4Ha Mutt} (44:1) Sometimes, three letters were mentioned, such as, 4f;:^} iAlifLam Mim (2 :1)} and four letters, such as, 4 AlifLdtn Mim Ra} (13:1), and iAlifLam Mini Sad} (7:1). Sometimes, five letters were mentioned, such as, 4KafHa Yd Ayn Sad} (19:1), and; 4Ha Mutt. 'Ayn Sin Qaf} (42:1-2). This is because the words that are used in speech are usually comprised of one, two, three, four, or five letters. Every Surah that begins with these letters demonstrates the Qur'an's miracle and magnificence, and this fact is known by those well-versed in such matters. The count of these Surahs is twenty-nine. For instance, Allah said, U t * *+ S iAlif Lam Mim} This is the Book (the Qur'an), wherein there is no doubt (2:1-2), 4&Q&2 *JS 4 '4 v 'if iAlifLam Mim. Allah! La ilahd ilia Huwa (mme has file right to be worshipped but He), Al-Hayyul-Qayyum (the Ever Living, the One Who sustains and protects all that exists). It is He Who has sent down the Book (the Qur'an) to you (Multammad with truth, confirming what came before it.) (3:1-3), and, 44 cfZ- 4 jZ Jb'i If J \} iAlifLam Mim Sad. (This is the) Book (the Qur'an) sent down

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) unto you (O Muhammad jg), so let not your breast be narrow therefrom} (7:1-2). Also, Allah said, i*-ifj jjLi V >> iAlif Lam Ra. (This is) a Book which We have revealed unto you (O Muhammad 4g) in order that you might lead mankind out of darkness (of disbelief and polytheism) into the light (of belief in the Oneness of Allah and Islamic Monotheism) by their Lord's leave (14:1), iAlif Lam Mim. The revelation of the Book (this Qur'an) in which there is no doubt, is from the Lord of the Alamin (mankind, Jinn and all that exists)!} (32:1-2), 4^\$ ci iHa Mim. A revelation from (Allah) the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful} (41:1-2), and, iHa Mim. 'Ain Sin Qdf. Likewise Allah, the Almighty, the W/se sends revelation to you (O Muhammad sg) as (He sent revelation to) those before you.} (42:1-3). There are several other Ayat that testify to what we have mentioned above, and Allah knows best. i2. That is Book in which there is no Rayb, guidance for the Muttaqin}. There is no Doubt in the Qur'an The Book, is the Qur'an, and Rayb means doubt. As-Suddi said that Abu Malik and Abu Salih narrated from Ibn Abbas, and Murrah Al-Hamadani narrated from Ibn Mas'ud and several other Companions of the Messenger of Allah that, i*i Cfj ^} Hn which there is no Rayb}, means about which there is no

doubt. 111 Abu Ad-Darda , Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Malik, Nail' Ata , Abu Al-Aliyah, Ar-Rabl bin Anas, Muqatil bin Hayyan, As-Suddi, Qatadah and Ismail bin Abi Khalid said similarly. In addition, Ibn Abi Hatim said, I do not know of any disagreement over this explanation. [2i The meaning of this is that the Book, the Qur an, is without a doubt revealed from Allah. Similarly, Allah said in Surat As- Sajdah, iAlif Lam Mm}. The revelation of the Book (this Qur an) in which there is no doubt, is from the Lord of all that exists) (32:1-2). Some scholars stated that this Ayah - 2:2 - contains a prohibition meaning, Do not doubt the Qur an. Furthermore, some of the reciters of the Qur an pause upon reading, 4there is no doubt} and they then continue; iin which there is guidanceefar the Muttaqin (the pious and righteous persons)}. However, it is better to pause at, ill iin which there is no doubt} because in this case, i-e>} iguidance} becomes an attribute of the Qur an and carries a better meaning than, / A ' i(SJL.t, jj} iin which there is guidance}. Guidance is granted to ThoseWho have Taqwa. Hidayah - correct guidance - is only granted to those who have Taqwa - fear of Allah. Allah said, At-Tabari 1 :228. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :3 1

jij wi i ^ >-l-A 4-Uj? i>* -iijJj! c *- 4Sfli/: It is for those who believe, a guide and a healing. And as far those ivho disbelieve, there is heaviness (deafness) in their ears, and it (the Qur'an) is blindness for them. They are those who are calledfrom a place far azoay (so they neither listen nor understand)) (41:44), and, AT I, U / i * I / y " " "* W"/x ' /> / \ Wi? send down of the Qur'an that which is a healing and a mercy to those who believe (in Islamic Monotheism and act on it), and it increases the Zdlimin (wrongdoers) in nothing but loss) (17:82). This is a sample of the numerous Ayat indicating that the believers, in particular, benefit from the Qur an. That is because the Qur an is itself a form of guidance, but the guidance in it is only granted to the righteous, just as Allah said, Cj Ski j j* i-WjA fS^CC- J3 J-U)' (\$k) iO mankind! There has come to you a good advice from your Lord (i.e. the Qur'an, enjoining all that is good and forbidding all that is evil), and a healing for that (disease of ignorance, doubt, hypocrisy and differences) which is in your breasts, - a guidance and a mercy (explaining lawful and unlawful things) for the believers) (10:57). Ibn Abbas and Ibn Mas ud and other Companions of the Messenger of Allah jg said, iguidance for the Muttaqm (the pious and righteous persons), means, a light for those who have Taqwa. The Meaning ofAl-Muttaqin Ibn Abbas said about.

^guidance for the Muttaqin} that it means, They are the believers who avoid Shirk with Allah and who work in His obedience. Ibn Abbas also said that Al-Muttaqin means, Those who fear Allah s punishment, which would result if they abandoned the true guidance that they recognize and know. They also hope in Allah s mercy by believing in what He revealed. Further, Qatadah said that, iAl-Muttaqin}, are those whom Allah has described in His statement; cgjity iWho believe in the Ghayb and perform the Salah (2:3), and the following Ayat. Ibn Jarir stated that the Ayah (2:2) includes all of these meanings that the scholars have mentioned, and this is the correct view. Also, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah narrated that Atiyah As-Sa di said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, *The servant will not acquire the status of the Muttaqin until he abandons what is harmless out offear of falling into that which is harmfulV At-Tirmidhi then said Hasan Gharib. There areTwo Types of Hidayah (Guidance) Huda here means the faith that resides in the heart, and only Allah is able to create it in the heart of the servants. Allah said, If vA} 4Verily, you (O Muhammad jfe) guide not whom you like} (28:56), 4Not upon you (Muhammad jg) is their guidance (2:272), m TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7 :147 , and Ibn Majah 2 : 1409

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1 4/S (ill* iit } ^Whomsoever Allah sends astray, none can guide him} (7:186), and, /, / * / * " K ' < t. > " ' cHr^ . v^ - J Hi & T } He whom Allah guides, he is the rightly guided; but he whom He sends astray, for him you will find no Walt (guiding friend) to lead him (to the right path)) (18:17). Huda also means to explain the truth, give direction and lead to it. Allah, the Exalted, said, d\ ^- 5 (Off} iAttd verily, you (O Muhammad sfe) are indeed guiding (mankind) to the straight path (i.e. Allah's religion of Islamic Monotheism)) (42:52), iYou are only a wamer, and to every people there is a guide} (13:7), and, itOi \$& %} } And as for Thamiid, We showed and made clear to them the path of truth (Islamic Monotheism) through Our Messenger (i.e. showed them the way of success), but they preferred blindness to guidance} (41:17). testifying to this meaning. Also, Allah said, iAnd shown him the two ways (good and evil).} (90:10) This is the view of the scholars who said that the two ways refer to the paths of righteousness and evil, which is also the correct explanation. And Allah knows best. Meaning of Taqwa The root meaning of Taqwa is to avoid what one dislikes. It was reported that Umar bin Al-Khattab asked Ubayy bin Ka*b about Taqwa. Ubayy said, Have you ever walked on a path

no Tafsir Ibn Kathir that has thorns on it? Umar said, Yes. Ubayy said, What did you do then? He said, I rolled up my sleeves and struggled. Ubayy said, That is Taqwa." 43. Those Who have faith in the Ghayb}. The Meaning of iman Abu Ja'far Ar-Razi said that Al- Ala bin Al-Musayyib bin Rafi narrated from Abu Ishaq that Abu Al-Ahwas said that Abdullah said, Iman is to trust. . 1 11 Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, iivho have faith means they trust.121 Also, Ma mar said that Az- Zuhri said, Iman is the deeds. 131 In addition, Abu JaYar Ar- Razi said that Ar-RabT bin Anas said that, They have faith , means, they fear (Allah),.4) Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari) commented, The preferred view is that they be described as having faith in the Unseen by the tongue, deed and creed. In this case, fear of Allah is included in the general meaning of /man, which necessitates following deeds of the tongue by implementation. Hence, Iman is a general term that includes affirming and believing in Allah, His Books and His Messengers, and realizing this affirmation through adhering to the implications of what the tongue utters and affirms. Linguistically, in the absolute sense, Iman merely means trust, and it is used to mean that sometimes in the Qur an, for instance, Allah the Exalted said, 4&p} it 4He trusts (yu'minu) in Allah , and trusts (yu mittu) in the believers.} (9:61) Prophet Yusuf's brothers said to their father, At-Tabari 1 :235. Ibid. (31 Ibid. 4| Ibid.

4Buf yot/ u/ never believe us even when we speak the truth> (12:17). Further, the word Iman is sometimes mentioned along with deeds, such as Allah said, 4o i ii \JlSj ip: IM 4\} iSave those who believe (in Islamic Monotheism) and do righteous deeds (95:6). However, when iman is used in an unrestricted manner, it includes beliefs, deeds, and statements of the tongue. We should state here that Iman increases and decreases. There are many narrations and Hadlths on this subject, and we discussed them in the beginning of our explanation of Sahih Al-Bukhari, all favors are from Allah. Some scholars explained that iman means Khashyah (fear of Allah). For instance, Allah said; 4Verily, those who fear their Lord unseen (i.e. they do not see Him, nor His punishment in the Hereafter)) (67:12), and, iWho feared the Most Gracious (Allah) in the Ghayb (unseen) and brought a heart turned in repentance (to Him and absolutely free from every kind of polytheism)) (50:33). Fear is the core of Iman and knowledge, just as Allah the Exalted said, ilt is only those who have knowledge among His servants that fear Allah} (35:28). The Meaning of Al-Ghayb As for the meaning of Ghayb here, the Salaf have

different explanations of it, all of which are correct, indicating the same '*' See the Tafstroi Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :35

general meaning. For instance, Abu Ja'far Ar-Razi quoted Ar- Rabi bin Anas, reporting from Abu Al-Aliyah about Allah's statement, i(Those who) have faith in the Ghayb}, They believe in Allah, His angels, Books, Messengers, the Last Day, His Paradise, Fire and in the meeting with Him. They also believe in life after death and in Resurrection. All of this is the Ghayb. Qatadah bin Di'amah said similarly. Said bin Mansur reported from Abdur-Rahman bin Yazid who said, We were sitting with Abdullah bin Mas'ud when we mentioned the Companions of the Prophet jg and their deeds being superior to our deeds. Abdullah said, The matter of Muhammad was clear for those who saw him. By He other than Whom there is no God, no person will ever acquire a better type of faith than believing in Al-Ghayb.' He then recited, iAlif Lam Man. This is the Book, wherein there is no doubt, a guidance for the Muttaqin. Those who believe in the Ghayb}, until. 4the successful}. Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Marduwah and Al- Hakim, in his Mustadrak, [3] recorded this Hadith.

Al-Bagharalt (1 - 24) (Part-1) said, ^ ^ ir! fj* r" "Yes, those who will come after you , who will believe in me although they did not see me." This Hadith has another route collected by Abu Bakr bin Marduwah in his Tafsir, from Salih bin Jubayr who said: Abu Jumu'ah Al-Ansari, the Companion of the Messenger of Allah jg, came to Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem) to perform the prayer. Raja bin Haywah was with us, so when Abu Jumu'ah finished, we went out to greet him. When he was about to leave, he said, You have a gift and a right. I will narrate a Hadith for you that I heard from the Messenger of Allah. We said, Do so, and may Allah grant you mercy. He said, We were with the Messenger of Allah, ten people including Mu'adh bin Jabal. We said, "O Messenger of Allah! Are there people who will acquire greater rewards than us? We believed in Allah and followed you. He jfe said, j: lyt p&OSi ife tri t ij-i L"j jjJUjoj j ijy'f iff. ly w ' What prevents you from doing so, while the Messenger of Allah is among you, bringing you the revelation from heaven? There are people who will come after you and who will be given a book between two covers (the Qur'an), and they will believe in it and implement its commands. They have a greater reward than you, even hoice as much.* / >..* i' ' 'n<\\ 4And perform Salah, and spend out of what we have provided for them} Meaning of Iqamat As-Salah Ibn Abbas said that, 4:106. ' Ibn Asakir 6 :368

114 Tafsir Ibn Kathir i. And perform the Salah\$, means, Perform the prayer with all of the obligations that accompany it. 1 11 Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said, Iqamat As-Saldh means to complete the bowings, prostrations, recitation, humbleness and attendance for the prayer. ' Qatadah said, Iqamat As-Saldh means to preserve punctuality, and the ablution, bowings, and prostrations of the prayer. '3 Muqatil bin Hayyan said Iqamat As-Saldh means "To preserve punctuality for it, as well as completing ones purity for it, and completing the bowings, prostrations, recitation of the Qur an, Tashahhud and blessings for the Prophet jg. This is Iqamat As-Saldh. 4 '

The Meaning of "Spending" in this Ayah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 114–118]

Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, 'And spend out of what We have provided for them means, The Zakat due on their wealth.'⁵ As-Suddi said that Abu Malik and Abu Salih narrated from Ibn Abbas, as well as Murrah from Ibn Mas'ud and other Companions of the Messenger of Allah s, that, 'And spend out of what We have provided for them means, A man's spending on his family. This was before the obligation of Zakat was revealed.'⁶ Juwaybir narrated from Ad-Dahhak, General spending (in charity) was a means of drawing nearer to Allah, according to one's discretion and capability. Until the obligation of charity was revealed in the seven Ayat of Surat Baqarah (chapter 9), were revealed. These abrogated the previous case.⁷ At-Tabari 1 :241 Ibid. 'Ibn Abi Hatim 1:37. 'Ibid. At-Tabari 1 :243 6| Ibid. 'Ibid.

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) In many instances, Allah mentioned prayer and spending wealth together. Prayer is a right of Allah as well as a form of worshipping Him. It includes singling Him out for one's devotion, praising Him, glorifying Him, supplicating to Him, invoking Him, and it displays one's dependence upon Him. Spending is form of kindness towards creatures by giving them what will benefit them, and those people most deserving of this charity are the relatives, the wife, the servants and then the rest of the people. So all types of required charity and required spending are included in Allah's saying, 'And spend out of what we have provided for them'. The Two Sahih recorded that Ibn Umar said that the Messenger of Allah said, 'Islam is built upon five (pillars): Testifying that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah and that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah, establishing the prayer, giving Zakat, fasting Ramadan and Hajj to the House. There are many other Hadiths on this subject. The Meaning of Salah In the Arabic language, the basic meaning of Salah is supplication. In religious terminology, Salah is used to refer to the acts of bowing and prostration, the remaining specified acts associated with it, specified at certain times, with those known conditions, and the characteristics, and requirements that are well-known about it. 'And who have faith in what is revealed to you and in what was revealed before you, and in the Hereafter they are certain.' Ibn Abbas said that. * Fath Al-Bari 1 :64 and Muslim 1 :45.

116 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4 And who have faith in what is revealed to you and in what was revealed before you means, They believe in what Allah sent you with, and in what the previous Messengers were sent with, they do not distinguish between (believing) them, nor do they reject what they brought from their Lord. 4 And in the Hereafter they are certain^ that is the resurrection, the standing (on the Day of Resurrection), Paradise, the Fire, the reckoning and the Scale that weighs the deeds (the Afzdn). * The Hereafter is so named because it comes after this earthly life. Attributes of the Believers The people described here (2:4) are those whom Allah described in the preceding Ayah, 4 Those who have faith in the Ghayb and perform Salat, and spend out of what we have provided for them.) Mujahid once stated, Four Ayat at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah describe the believers, two describe the disbelievers, and thirteen describe the hypocrites. * The four Ayat mentioned in this statement are general and include every believer, whether an Arab, non-Arab, or a person of a previous Scripture, whether they are Jinns or humans. All of these attributes complement each other and require the existence of the other attributes. For instance, it is not possible that one believes in the Unseen, performs the prayer and gives Zakat without believing in what the Messenger of Allah and the previous Messengers were sent with. The same with certainty in the Hereafter, this is not correct without that, for Allah has commanded the believers, 'And who have faith in what is revealed to you and in what was revealed before you, and in the Hereafter they are certain.' At-Tabari 1 :244. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :39. At-Tabari 1 :239.

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) 40 you who believe! Believe in Allah, and His Messenger, and the Book (the Qur'an) which He has revealed to the Messenger, and the Book which He sent down to those before (him)} (4:136), and, (L'C I+li \JSL iS^ If 41-S (%^ t!4l4 iAnd argue not with the People of the Book, unless it be in (a way) that is better, except with such of them as do wrong; and say (to them): "We believe in that which has been revealed to us and revealed to you; our Hah (God) and your Hah (God) is One (i.e. Allah)" (29:46), ip* Li, \iJj Ciy ti \$&} 40 you who have been given the Book (Jews and Christians)! Believe in what We have revealed (to Muhammad ig) confirming what is (already) with you} (4:47), and, oi 4 %M# & &p fo iSay (O Muhammad \$&) : "O People of the Book (Jews and Christians)! You have nothing until you act according to the Tawrdlt (Torah), the Injil (Gospel), and what has (now) been revealed to you from your Lord (the Qur'an)." (5:68). Also, Allah the Exalted described the believers; xi . > i 4 >!r J oi iThe Messenger (Muhammad believes in what has been revealed to him from his Lord, and (so do) the believers. Each one believes in Allah, His Angels, His Books, and His Messengers. (They say,) "We make no distinction between any ofHis Messengers"} (2:285), and, ipr?P r> !y^i Jij A- jj i iAnd those who believe in Allah and His Messengers and make no distinction between any of them (Messengers)} (4:152),

This is a sample of the Ayat that indicate that the true believers all believe in Allah, His Messengers and His Books. The faithful among the People of the Book, have a special significance here, since they believe in their Books and in all of the details related to that, so when such people embrace Islam and sincerely believe in the details of the religion, then they will get two rewards. As for the others, they can only believe in the previous religious teachings in a general way. For instance, the Prophet stated. Jit lil" yOl Jjifj 01 Jjif the People of the Book narrate to you, neither reject nor affirm what they say. Rather, say, We believe in what was revealed to ns and what was revealed to i/om.) However, the faith that many Arabs have in the religion of Islam as it was revealed to Muhammad sjfcj might be more complete, encompassing and firmer than the faith of the People of the Book who embraced Islam. Therefore, if the believers in Islam among the People of the Book gain two rewards, other Muslims who have firmer Islamic faith might gain an equal reward that compares to the two the People of the Book gain (upon embracing Islam). And Allah knows best. 45. They are on guidance from their Lord, and they are the successful. Guidance and Success are awarded to the Believers Allah said, iThey are} refers to those who believe in the Unseen, establish the prayer, spend from what Allah has granted them, believe in

what Allah has revealed to the Messenger and the Messengers

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 118–125]

before him, believe in the Hereafter with certainty, and prepare the necessary requirements for the Hereafter by performing I 1 * Abu D&wud 4 :59.

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) good deeds and avoiding the prohibitions. Allah then said, iiSJj* &} 4On guidance} meaning, they are (following) a light, guidance, and have insight from Allah, 4And they are the successfid} meaning, in this world and the Hereafter. They shall have what they seek and be saved from the evil that they tried to avoid. Therefore, they will have rewards, eternal life in Paradise, and safety from the torment that Allah has prepared for rJj -&&& r iM# ^ z f i" it > s.' a 't ' \" oX*~.juj

0_)"Jrr His enemies. 46. Verily, those who disbelieve, it is the same to them whether you warn them or do not warn them, they will not believe.} Allah said, 4& l\} 4Verily, those who disbelieve} meaning, covered the truth and hid it. Since Allah has written that they would do so, it does not matter if you (O Muhammad jg) warn them or not, they would still have disbelieved in what you were sent with. Similarly, Allah said, 'M ti ~

iTruly, those against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment (10:96-97). About the rebellious People of the Book, Allah said, m, \J4 u p; Ca^Ji iAnd even if you were to bring to the People of the Book (Jews and Christians) all the Ayat, they would not follozo your Qiblah (prayer direction)} (2:5). These Ayat indicate that whomever Allah has written to be miserable, they shall never find anyone to guide them to happiness, and whomever Allah directs to misguidance, he shall never find anyone to guide him. So do not pity them - O Muhammad ^ - deliver the Message to them. Certainly, whoever among them accepts the Message, then he shall gain the best rewards. As for those who turn away in rejection, do not feel sad for them or concerned about them, for gif 01} iYour duty is only to convey (the Message) and on Us is the reckoning} (13:40), and, iBut you are only a wamer. And Allah is a Wakil (Disposer of affairs, Trustee, Guardian) over all things} (11:12). Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said about Allah s statement, iVerily, those who disbelieve, it is the same to them whether you (O Muhammad warn them or do not warn them, they will not believe} That the Messenger of Allah jg was eager for all the people to believe and follow the guidance he was sent with. Allah informed him that none would believe except for those whom He decreed happiness for in the first place, and none would stray except those who Allah has decreed to do so in the first

place."m 4 v HJae. >\js. j^Jj &s J& Si* ^\L) 47. Allah has set a seal on their hearts and on their hearing, and on their eyes there is a covering. Theirs will be a great torment Meaning of Khatama As-Suddi said that, 4Kluttama Allah means, Allah has sealed. Qatadah said that this Ayah means, Shaytan controlled them when they obeyed him. Therefore, Allah sealed their hearts, hearing and sight, and they could neither see the guidance nor hear, comprehend or understand. 13 * Ibn Jurayj said that Mujahid said, iAllah has set a seal on their hearts), A stamp. It occurs when sin resides in the heart and surrounds it from all sides, and this submersion of the heart in sin constitutes a stamp, meaning a seal. 141 Ibn Jurayj also said that the seal is placed on the heart and the hearing. [S * In addition, Ibn Jurayj said, that Abdullah bin Kathxr narrated that Mujahid said, The stain is not as bad as the stamp, the stamp is not as bad as the lock which is the worst type. 16 * Al-A mash said, Mujahid demonstrated with his hand while saying, They used to say that the heart is just like this - meaning the open palm. When the servant commits a sin, a part of the heart will be rolled up - and he rolled up his index finger. When the servant commits another sin, a part of the heart will be rolled up - and he rolled up another finger, until he rolled up all of his fingers. Then he At-Tabari 1:252. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :44 |3i Ibid. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 44 At-Tabari 1 :259 161 Ibid.

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) authentic Hadith from the Messenger of Allah sg stated. Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, \j 3 yj. viols Ci klJji lil jit Jt> jiJu oSlj Slj j\j)i 4-Y iy^ pr_>^ j* o'j j> When the believer commits a sin, a black dot will be engraved on his heart. If he repents, refrains and regrets, his heart loill be polished again. If he commits more errors, the dots will increase

until they cover his heart. This is the Ran (stain) that Allah described, 4 iy^ rrjli &% j!%} iNay! But on their hearts is the Ran (stain) which they used to earn}" (83:14).

they do not see."I 1 ' The Hypocrites We mentioned that four Ayat in the beginning of Surat Al- Baqarah described the believers. The two last Ayat (2:6-7) describe the disbelievers. Afterwards, Allah begins to describe the hypocrites who show belief and hide disbelief. Since the matter of the hypocrites is vague and many people do not realize their true reality, Allah mentioned their description in detail. Each of the characteristics that Allah used to described them with is a type of hypocrisy itself. Allah revealed Surat Bara ah (chapter 9) and Surat Al-Munafiqun (chapter 63) about the hypocrites. He also mentioned the hypocrites in Surat An- Nur (24) and other Surahs, so that their description would be known and their ways and errors could be avoided. Allah said, Al"b djAj & &JT is&& 13 \pa 48. And of mankind, there are some who say: "We believe in Allah and the Last Day" while in fact they do not believe}. 49. They try to deceive Allah and those who believe, while they only deceive themselves, and perceive (it) not!} Meaning ofNifaq Nifaq means to show conformity - or agreement - and to conceal evil. Nifaq has several types: Nifaq in the creed that causes its people to reside in Hell for eternity, and Nifaq in deed, which is one of the major sins, as we will explain soon, Allah willing. Ibn Jurayj said of the hypocrite that, His actual deeds are different from what he publicizes, what he conceals is different from what he utters, his entrance and presence are not the same as his exit and absence. The Beginning ofHypocrisy The revelations about the characteristics of the hypocrites were revealed in Al-Madlnah, this is because there were no A(1 :266.Tabari 1 :270.

hypocrites in Makkah. Rather the opposite was the situation in Makkah, since some people were forced to pretend that they were disbelievers, while their hearts concealed their faith. Afterwards, the Messenger of Allah jg migrated to Al-Madinah, where the Ansar from the tribes of Aws and Khazraj resided. They used to worship idols during the pre-Islamic period of ignorance, just as the rest of the Arab idolators. Three Jewish tribes resided in Al-Madinah, Banu Qaynuqa'-allies of Al- Khazraj, Banu An-Nadlr and Banu Qurayzah-allies of the Aws. Many members of the Aws and Khazraj tribes embraced Islam. However, only a few Jews embraced Islam, such as Abdullah bin Salam. During the early stage in Al-Madinah, there weren t any hypocrites because the Muslims were not strong enough to be feared yet. On the contrary, the Messenger of Allah jg conducted peace treaties with the Jews and several other Arab tribes around Al-Madinah. Soon after, the battle of Badr occurred and Allah gave victory to Islam and its people. Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul was a leader in Al-Madinah. He was Al-Khazraj s chief, and during the period of Jahiliyyah he was the master of both tribes - Aws and Khazraj. They were about to appoint him their king when the Message reached Al- Madlnah, and many in Al-Madinah embraced Islam. Ibn Salul s heart was filled with hatred against Islam and its people. When

the battle of Badr took place, he said, “Allah’s religion has

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 125–128]

become apparent. So he pretended to be Muslim, along with many of those who were just like him, as well as many among the People of the Book. It was then that hypocrisy began in Al- Madinah and among the surrounding nomad tribes. As for the Emigrants, none of them were hypocrites, since they emigrated willingly (seeking the pleasure of Allah). Rather, when a Muslim would emigrate from

Makkah, he would be forced to abandon all of his wealth, offspring and land; he would do so seeking Allah's reward in the Hereafter. The Tafsir of Ayah 2:8 Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Ibn Abbas said that, ⁴ "And of mankind, there are some who say: 'We believe in Allah and the Last Day' while in fact they do not believe."

126 Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr This refers to the hypocrites among the Aws and Khazraj and those who behaved as they did. This is how Abu Al- Aliyah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and As- Suddi explained this Ayah. Allah revealed the characteristics of the hypocrites, so that the believers would not be deceived by their outer appearance, thus saving the believers from a great evil. Otherwise, the believers might think that the hypocrites were believers, when in reality they are disbelievers. To consider the sinners as righteous people is extremely dangerous, Allah said, "And of mankind, there are some who say: 'We believe in Allah and the Last Day' while in fact they do not believe" meaning, they utter these false statements only with their tongues, just as Allah said, "When the hypocrites come to you (O Muhammad), they say: 'We bear witness that you are indeed the Messenger of Allah.' Allah knows that you are indeed His Messenger" (63:1). This Ayah means that the hypocrites utter these statements only when they meet you, not because they actually believe what they are saying. The hypocrites emphasize their belief in Allah and the Last Day with their words, when that is not the case in reality. Therefore, Allah stated that the hypocrites lie in their testimony of creed, when He said, "And Allah bears witness that the hypocrites are indeed liars." (63:1), and, "While in fact they believe not" Allah said, *At-Tabari* 1:269

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) "They try to deceive Allah and those who believe". The hypocrites show belief outwardly while concealing disbelief. They think that by doing this, they will mislead Allah, or that the statements they utter will help them with Allah, and this is an indication of their total ignorance. They think that such behavior will deceive Allah, just as it might deceive some of the believers. Similarly, Allah said, "On the Day when Allah will resurrect them all together; then they will swear to Him as they swear to you. And they think that they have something (to stand upon). Verily, they are liars!" (58:18). Hence, Allah refuted their way by saying, "While they only deceive themselves, and perceive (it) not!" Allah stated that the hypocrites only deceive themselves by this behavior, although they are unaware of this fact. Allah also said, "Verily, the hypocrites try to deceive Allah, but it is He Who deceives them" (4:142). Also, Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Ibn Jurayj commented on Allah's statement, "Verily, the hypocrites seek to deceive Allah, but it is He Who deceives them", The hypocrites pronounce, There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah seeking to ensure the sanctity of their blood and money, all the while concealing disbelief. '11 Said said that Qatadah said, *Ibn Abi Hatim* 1:46.

The Meaning of 'Disease' in this Ayah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 128–174]

As-Suddi narrated from Abu Malik and (also) from Abu Salih, from Ibn Abbas, and (also) Murrah Al-Hamdani from Ibn Mas'ud and other Companions that this Ayah, "In their hearts is a disease" means, doubt, and, "And Allah has increased their disease" also means doubt. 2 Mujahid, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Abu Al- Aliyah, Ar-Rabi bin Anas and Qatadah also said similarly. *

Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented on, {In their hearts is a disease}, A disease in the religion, not a physical disease. They are the hypocrites and the disease is the 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:47. | 2) At-Tabari 1 :280 3 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :48

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) doubt that they brought to Islam. 4And Allah has increased their disease^ meaning, increased them in shameful behavior. 111 He also recited, ^ j 0; tp: cty 4As /or Z/iouse zo/jo believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice. But as for those in whose hearts is a disease, it will add disgrace to their disgrace.} (9:124-125) and commented, Evil to their evil and deviation to their deviation. This statement by Abdur-Rahman is true, and it constitutes a punishment that is compatible to the sin, just as the earlier scholars stated. Similarly, Allah said, \ ^ iWhile as for those who accept guidance. He increases their guidance and grants them their piety} (47:17). Allah said next, 4Because they used to tell lies}. The hypocrites have two characteristics, they lie and they deny the Unseen. The scholars who stated that the Prophet knew the hypocrites of his time have only the Hadith of Hudhayfah bin Al-Yaman as evidence. In it the Prophet jg gave him the names of fourteen hypocrites during the battle of Tabuk. These hypocrites plotted to assassinate the Prophet sg during the night on a hill in that area. They planned to excite the Prophet's camel, so that she would throw him down the hill. Allah informed the Prophet sfe about their plot, and the Prophet Sfe told Hudhayfah their names. As for the other hypocrites, Allah said about them, >\ .I .."if i * > ':/ , " " ^ > / " /.< Tabari 1 :280.

"I was given the choice (to pray for him or not), so I chose. " In another narration, the Prophet j|| said, 2/ I knew that by asking (Allah to forgive Ibn Saliil) more than seventy times that He would forgive him, then I would do f/wf.n cyt j 'jJL ii 't ^ j i; 422. And ivhen it is said to them: "Do not make mischief on the earth," they say: "We are only peacemakers } 412. Verily, they are the ones who make mischief, but they perceive not.} Meaning of Mischief In his Tafsir, As-Suddi said that Ibn Abbas and Ibn MasYid commented, 4> Ci\ ijju jfjVl 4 'ji-ji v isjAnd when it is said to them : "Do not make mischief on the earth," they say: "We are only peacemakers."} "They are the hypocrites. As for, 4j?W 4WL4 4"Do not make mischief on the earth }, that is disbelief and acts of disobedience. I Abu JaYar said that Ar-Rabl bin Anas said that Abu AI- Aliyah said that Allah s statement, 4 (! Jj 4And ivhen it is said to them: "Do not make mischief on the earth, }, means, Do not commit acts of disobedience on the earth. Their mischief is disobeying Allah, because whoever Al-Bari 8 :184, Muslim 4 :2141Tabari 1 :288.

disobeys Allah on the earth, or commands that Allah be disobeyed, he has committed mischief on the earth. Peace on both the earth and in the heavens is ensured (and earned) through obedience (to Allah). 1,(11 Ar-Rabl bin Anas and Qatadah said similarly 2(Types of Mischief that the Hypocrites commit Ibn Jarir said, The hypocrites commit mischief on earth by disobeying their Lord on it and continuing in the prohibited acts. They also abandon what Allah made obligatory and doubt His religion, even though He does not accept a deed from anyone except with faith in His religion and certainty of its truth. The hypocrites also lie to the believers by saying contrary to the doubt and hesitation their hearts harbor. They give as much aid as they can, against Allah s loyal friends, and support those who deny Allah, His Books and His Messengers. This is how the hypocrites commit mischief on earth, while thinking that they are doing righteous work on earth. 131 The statement by Ibn Jarir is true, taking the disbelievers as friends is one of the categories of mischief on the earth. Allah said, Jf\ ^ tUi jz Mjl iAnd those who disbelieve are allies of one another, if you do not do this (help each other), there will be turmoil and

oppression on the earth, and great mischief.> (8:73), In this way Allah severed the loyalty between the believers and the disbelievers. Similarly, Allah said, Pi 40 you who believe! Do not take disbelievers as Awliyid' (protectors or helpers or friends) instead of believers. Do you (1(Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :50. (2(Ibn Abi Hatim 1:51. 3| At-Tabari 1 :289

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) wish to offer Allah a manifest proof against yourselves?) (4:144). Allah then said, iVerily, the hypocrites will be in the lowest depth of the Fire; no helper will you findfor them) (4:145). Since the outward appearance of the hypocrite displays belief, he confuses the true believers. Hence, the deceitful behavior of the hypocrites is an act of mischief, because they deceive the believers by claiming what they do not believe in, and because they give support and loyalty to the disbelievers against the believers. If the hypocrite remains a disbeliever (rather than pretending to be Muslim), the evil that results from him would be less. Even better, if the hypocrite becomes sincere with Allah and makes the statements that he utters conform to his deeds, he will gain success. Allah said, 4And when it is said to them : "Do not make mischiefon the earth, they say: ,r \Ne are only peacemakers.) meaning, We seek to be friends with both parties, the believers and the disbelievers, and to have peace with both parties. Similarly, Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas said, 4And when it is said to them: "Do not make mischiefon the earth, they say: "Wc are only peacemakers") means, We seek to make amends between the believers and the People of the Book. Allah said, ^ jU\$W) iVerily, they are the ones who make mischief, but they perceive not.). This Ayah means that the hypocrites behavior, and their claim that it is for peace, is itself mischief, although in their ignorance, they do not see it to be mischief. m Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :52.

jtf\$ gas XT J/i u XS \&i\$ Ji vsjj> 4\$&ES 4 j3j 413. And when it is said to them: Believe as the people believe," They say: "Shall we believe as the fools have believed? Verily, they are the fools, but they do not know.} Allah said that if the hypocrites are told, 4ote> li US' \ .\}*} i Believe as the people believe, }, meaning, Believe just as the believers believe in Allah, His angels, His Books, His Messengers, Resurrection after death, Paradise and Hellfire, etc. And obey Allah and His Messenger by heeding the commandments and avoiding the prohibitions. Yet the hypocrites answer by saying, 4'S\$2i\ IT '\$ } i Shall we believe as the fools have believed? } they meant (may Allah curse the hypocrites) the Companions of the Messenger of Allah sg. This is the same Tafsir given by Abu Al- Aliyah and As-Suddi in his Tafsir, with a chain of narration to Ibn Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and other Companions.¹¹¹ This is also the Tafsir of Ar-Rabl bin Anas and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam^{J21} The hypocrites said, Us and them having the same status, following the same path, while they are fools?! The fool is the ignorant, simple-minded person who has little knowledge in areas of benefit and harm. This is why, according to the majority of the scholars, Allah used the term foolish to include children, when He said, 4&" -S3 ^ ajiiii lyjj }And do not give your property, which Allah has made a means ofsupportfor you, to the foolish} (4:5). Allah answered the hypocrites in all of these instances. For instance, Allah said here, & v' 1 :293.Tabari 1 :294

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) iVerily, they are the fools}. Allah thus affirmed that the hypocrites are indeed the fools, yet, A&} iBut they know not}. Since they are so thoroughly ignorant, the hypocrites are unaware of their degree of deviation and ignorance, and such situation is more dangerous, a severer case of blindness, and further from the truth than one who is aware. & ijS. iSfc ! ": 414. And when they

meet those who believe, they say: "We believe," but when they are alone with their Shayatin (devils), they say: "Truly, we are with you; verily, we were but mocking."} 415. Allah mocks at them and leaves them increasing in their deviation to wander blindly.} The Hypocrites* Cunning and Deceit Allah said that when the hypocrites meet the believers, they proclaim their faith and pretend to be believers, loyalists and friends. They do this to misdirect, mislead and deceive the believers. The hypocrites also want to have a share of the benefits and gains that the believers might possibly acquire. Yet, 4 ii!> 4But when they are alone with their Shayatin}, meaning, if they are alone with their devils, such as their leaders and masters among the rabbis of the Jews, hypocrites and idolaters. Human and Jinn Devils Ibn Jarir said, The devils of every creation are the mischievous among them. There are both human devils and Jinn devils. Allah said,

136 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir 4And so We have appointed for every Prophet enemies - Shayṭān (devils) among mankind and Jinn, inspiring one another with adorned speech as a delusion (or by way of deception)} (6:112).

The Meaning of Mocking Allah said, iThey say: "Truly, we are with you"}. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas said that the Ayah means, We are with you, as} iVerily, we were but mocking}, meaning, we only mock people (the believers) and deceive them."111 Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said that the Ayah, i.e., a\} iVerily, we were but mocking}, means, We (meaning the hypocrites) were mocking the Companions of Muhammad. 121 Also, Ar-Rabi bin Anas and Qatadah said similarly. 131 Allah's statement. 4 4 re iifra &} iAllah mocks at them and leaves them increasing in their deviation to wander blindly} answers the hypocrites and punishes them for their behavior. Ibn Jarir commented, Allah mentioned what He will do to them on the Day of Resurrection, when He said, 40n the Day when the hypocrites - men and women - will say to the believers: "Wait for us! Let us get something from your light!" It will be said: "Go back to your rear! Then seek a At-Jabari 1 :300. Ibid. Ibid.

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) light!" So a wall will be put up between them, with a gate therein. Inside it will be mercy, and outside it will be torment.\$ (57:13), and, iAnd let not the disbelievers think that Our postponing of their punishment is good for them. We postpone the punishment only so that they may increase in sinfulness.} (3:178). He then said, This, and its like, is Allah's mockery of the hypocrites and the people of Shirk. The Hypocrites suffering for their Plots Allah stated that He will punish the hypocrites for their mockery, using the same terms to describe both the deed and its punishment, although the meaning is different. Similarly, Allah said, iTie recompense for an offense is an offense equal to it; but whoever forgives and makes reconciliation, his reward is with Allah} (42:40), and, iThen whoever transgresses (the prohibition) against you, transgress likewise against him} (2:194). The first act is an act of injustice, while the second act is an act of justice. So both actions carry the same name, while being different in reality. This is how the scholars explain deceit, cunning and mocking when attributed to Allah in the Qur'an. Surely, Allah exacts revenge for certain evil acts with a punishment that is similar in nature to the act itself. We should affirm here that Allah does not do these things out of joyful play, according to the consensus of the scholars, but as a just form of punishment for certain evil acts. Meaning of Leavethemincreasingintheirdeviationto wander blindly Allah said,

iAlldh mocks at them and leaves them increasing in their deviation to wander blindly). As-Suddi reported that Ibn Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and several other Companions of the Messenger of Allah jg said

that. and leaves them increasing^ means, He gives them respite. 111 Also, Mujahid said, He (causes their deviation) to increase. 12 Allah said; *وَلَا يَخَفُ ۚ فَاُفٍّ لَهُمْ وَلَهُمْ فِي السَّاعَةِ النَّارُ ۚ وَلَوْ رَدُّوهُ إِلَىٰ الْحَيٰۤاتِ لَعُدُّوْهُم مِّثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ ۚ فَلَهُمْ فِي السَّاعَةِ النَّارُ ۚ وَلَوْ رَدُّوهُ إِلَىٰ الْحَيٰۤاتِ لَعُدُّوْهُم مِّثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ ۚ فَلَهُمْ فِي السَّاعَةِ النَّارُ ۚ* (23:55-56). Ibn Jarir commented, The correct meaning of this Ayah is We give them increase from the view of giving them respite and leaving them in their deviation and rebellion. Similarly, Allah said, *وَلَا يَخَفُ ۚ فَاُفٍّ لَهُمْ وَلَهُمْ فِي السَّاعَةِ النَّارُ ۚ وَلَوْ رَدُّوهُ إِلَىٰ الْحَيٰۤاتِ لَعُدُّوْهُم مِّثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ ۚ فَلَهُمْ فِي السَّاعَةِ النَّارُ ۚ* (6:10). Tughyan used in this Ayah means to transgress the limits, just as Allah said in another Ayah, *وَلَوْ رَدُّوهُ إِلَىٰ الْحَيٰۤاتِ لَعُدُّوْهُم مِّثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ ۚ فَلَهُمْ فِي السَّاعَةِ النَّارُ ۚ* (69:11). Also, Ibn Jarir said that the term *Amah*, in the Ayah means, deviation . He also said about Allah's statement, Tabari 1:311. 121 IbnAbiyatim 1:57. Tabari 1 :307

4in their deviation to wander In the misguidance and disbelief that has encompassed them, causing them to be confused and unable to find a way out of it. This is because Allah has stamped their hearts, sealed them, and blinded their vision. Therefore, they do not recognize guidance or find the way out of their deviation. 1 o is it SSXst Sj 426. These are they who have purchased error with guidance, so their commerce was profitless. And they were not guided.} In his Tafsir, As-Suddi reported that Ibn Abbas and Ibn Mas'ud commented on; }These are they who have purchased error with guidance} saying it means, They pursued misguidance and abandoned guidance. Mujahid said, They believed and then disbelieved, while Qatadah said, They preferred deviation to guidance. Qatadah's statement is similar in meaning to Allah's statement about Thamud, its # \$ iAnd as for Thamud, We granted them guidance, but they preferred blindness to guidance} (41:17). In summary, the statements that we have mentioned from the scholars of Tafsir indicate that the hypocrites deviate from the true guidance and prefer misguidance, substituting wickedness in place of righteousness. This meaning explains Allah's statement, *وَلَا يَخَفُ ۚ فَاُفٍّ لَهُمْ وَلَهُمْ فِي السَّاعَةِ النَّارُ ۚ وَلَوْ رَدُّوهُ إِلَىٰ الْحَيٰۤاتِ لَعُدُّوْهُم مِّثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ ۚ فَلَهُمْ فِي السَّاعَةِ النَّارُ ۚ* (23:55-56), meaning, they exchanged guidance to buy misguidance. This meaning includes those who first believed, then later disbelieved, whom Allah described, *لَمَّا أَلَّاتَابَارِ ۚ* 1 :309.

p if * pr\ iThat is because they believed, and then disbelieved; therefore their hearts are sealed (63:3). The Ayah also includes those who preferred deviation over guidance. The hypocrites fall into several categories. This is why Allah said, *وَلَا يَخَفُ ۚ فَاُفٍّ لَهُمْ وَلَهُمْ فِي السَّاعَةِ النَّارُ ۚ وَلَوْ رَدُّوهُ إِلَىٰ الْحَيٰۤاتِ لَعُدُّوْهُم مِّثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ ۚ فَلَهُمْ فِي السَّاعَةِ النَّارُ ۚ* (23:55-56), meaning their trade did not succeed nor were they righteous or rightly guided throughout all this. In addition, Ibn Jarir narrated that Qatadah commented on the Ayah, *وَلَا يَخَفُ ۚ فَاُفٍّ لَهُمْ وَلَهُمْ فِي السَّاعَةِ النَّارُ ۚ وَلَوْ رَدُّوهُ إِلَىٰ الْحَيٰۤاتِ لَعُدُّوْهُم مِّثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ ۚ فَلَهُمْ فِي السَّاعَةِ النَّارُ ۚ* So their commerce was profitless. And they were not guided>, By Allah! I have seen them leaving guidance for deviation, leaving the Jama'ah (the community of the believers) for the sects, leaving safety for fear, and the Sunnah for innovation. * Ibn Abi Hatim also reported other similar statements. j 3f CSS^ U ijCtf US feL'.i jSS' At-Tabari 1:316. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :60

ii&te . Their likeness is as the likeness of one who kindled a fire; then, when it illuminated all around him, Allah removed their light and left them in darkness. (So) they could not see}. 418. They are deaf, dumb, and blind, so they return not (to the right path).} The Example of the Hypocrites Allah likened the hypocrites when they bought deviation with guidance, thus acquiring utter blindness, to the example of a person who started a fire. When the fire was lit, and illumintated the surrounding area, the person

benefited from it and felt safe. Then the fire was suddenly extinguished. Therefore, total darkness covered this person, and he became unable to see anything or find his way out of it. Further, this person could not hear or speak and became so blind that even if there were light, he would not be able to see. This is why he cannot return to the state that he was in before this happened to him. Such is the case with the hypocrites who preferred misguidance over guidance, deviation over righteousness. This parable indicates that the hypocrites first believed, then disbelieved, just as Allah stated in other parts of the Qur'an. Allah's statement, {Allah removed their light} means, Allah removed what benefits them, and this is the light, and He left them with what harms them, that is, the darkness and smoke. Allah said, {And left them in darkness}, that is their doubts, disbelief and hypocrisy. {So they could not see} meaning, they are unable to find the correct path or find its direction. In addition, they are, {deaf} and thus cannot hear the guidance,

{dumb} and cannot utter the words that might benefit them, and blind in total darkness and deviation. Similarly, Allah said, {Verily, it is not the eyes that grow blind, but it is the hearts which are in the breasts that grow blind (22:46)} and this why they cannot get back to the state of guidance that they were in, since they sold it for misguidance. *ijs" iX" <!) * * ^>\ 4~&Jd iat JLi jJJ |i,i j^Lfci 429. Or like a rainstorm in the sky, bringing darkness, thunder, and lightning. They thrust their fingers in their ears to keep out the stunning thunderclap Jbr Jear of death. But Allah ever encompasses the disbelievers. } 420. The lightning almost snatches away their sight, whenever it flashes for them, they walk therein, and when darkness covers them, they stand still. And if Allah willed. He could have taken away their hearing and their sight. Certainly, Allah has power over all things.} Another Parable of the Hypocrites This is another parable which Allah gave about the hypocrites who sometimes know the truth and doubt it at other times. When they suffer from doubt, confusion and disbelief, their hearts are, {Like a Sayyib}, meaning, "The rain", as Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn Abbas, and several other Companions have confirmed it as well as in At-Tabari 1 :334.

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) Abu Al- Aliyah, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ata , Al-Hasan Al- Basri, Qatadah, Atiyah Al- Awfi, Ata Al-Khurasani, As-Suddi and Ar-Rabi bin Anas. Ad-Dahhak said It is the clouds. However, the most accepted opinion is that it means the rain that comes down during, {darkness} meaning, here, the doubts, disbelief and hypocrisy. {thunder that shocks the hearts with fear. The hypocrites are usually full of fear and anxiety, just as Allah described them, {They think that every cry is against them} (63:4), and, { (Uj) tyj } j' iLi'jLk {They swear by Allah that they are truly of you while they are not of you, but they are a people who are afraid. Should they find refuge, or caves, or a place of concealment, they would turn straightway thereto in a swift rush} (9:56-57). {The lightning}, is in reference to the light of faith that is sometimes felt in the hearts of the hypocrites, J-Ao- VJ* i ' {They thrust their fingers in their ears to keep out the stunning thunderclap for fear of death. But Allah ever encompasses the disbelievers}, meaning, their cautiousness does not benefit them because they are bound by Allah's all-encompassing will and decision. Similarly, Allah said, i** .y> \K1r * .1? / "r; > pri'jj j? ^ UP imj ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :66. I2! Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :67.

jS isj {On the Day you shall see the believing men and the believing women - their light running forward before them and by their right hands. Glad tidings for you this Day! Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise)} (57:12), and, i f* /*

commented on, iTheir Light will run forward before them}, They will pass on the Sirat. according to their deeds. The light that some people have will be as big as a mountain, while the light of others will be as big as a date tree. The people who will have the least light are those whose index fingers will sometimes be lit and extinguished at other times. 11 Ibn Abi Hatim also reported that Ibn Abbas said, Every person among the people of Tawhid (Islamic Monotheism) will gain a light on the Day of Resurrection. As for the hypocrite, his light will be extinguished. When the believers witness the hypocrite's light being extinguished, they will feel anxious. Hence, they will supplicate, iOur Lord! Keep perfect our Light for us^. 12 * Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim said, On the Day of Resurrection, everyone who has embraced the faith will be given a light. When they arrive at the Sirat, the light of the hypocrites will be extinguished. When the believers see this, they will feel anxious and supplicate, iOur Lord! Keep perfect our Light for us\$. Types of Believers and Types of Disbelievers Consequently, there are several types of people. There are the believers whom the first four Ayat (2:2-5) in Surat Al-Baqarah describe. There are the disbelievers who were described in the next two Ayat. And there are two categories of hypocrites: the complete hypocrites who were mentioned in the parable of the fire, and the hesitant hypocrites, whose light of faith is sometimes lit and sometimes extinguished. The parable of the rain was revealed about this category, which is not as evil as the first category. Jabari 23:3179. 121 Al-Hakim 2:495.

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) lamp, a sealed heart with a knot tied around its seal, a heart that is turned upside down and a wrapped heart. As for the polished heart, it is the heart of the believer and the lamp is the light of faith. The sealed heart is the heart of the disbeliever. The heart that is turned upside down is the heart of the pure hypocrite, because he had knowledge but denied it. As for the wrapped heart, it is a heart that contains belief and hypocrisy. The example of faith in this heart, is the example of the herb that is sustained by pure water. The example of hypocrisy in it, is the example of an ulcer that thrives on puss and blood. Whichever of the two substances has the upper hand, it will have the upper hand on that heart*. This Hadith has a Jayid Hasan (good) chain of narration. Allah said, if He *** * > **jl iif sti iAnd if Allah willed, He would have taken away their hearing and their sight. Certainly, Allah has power over all things}. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah's statement, ^& i*i> iAnd if Allah willed. He would have taken away their hearing and their sight}, Because they abandoned the truth after they had knowledge in it. & if iCertainly, Allah has power over all things}. Ibn Abbas said, Allah is able to punish or pardon His servants as He wills. Ibn Jarir commented, Allah only described Himself with the ability to do everything in this Ayah as a warning to the hypocrites of His control over everything, and to inform them that His ability completely encompasses them and that He is able to take away their hearing and sight. Ibn Jarir and several other scholars of Tafsir stated that these two parables are about the same kind of hypocrite. So [1 Ahmad 3:17. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :76 At-Jabari 1 :361

the or mentioned in, 40r like a rainstorm froth ' rky} means and , just as the Ayah, 4 < ^ g %f 4And obey neither a c>- : isbeliever among them}. Therefore, or in the Ayah inclu.i-)ice of using either example for the hypocrites. Also, M Qv. i said that or means, To show compatibility of the two ch res, just as when one says, Sit with Al-Hasai. or Ibn Sirin. According to the view of Az- Zamakhshari, 'so it means each of these persons is the same as the other, so you may sit with either one of them. The meaning of or thus becomes either. Allah gave these two examples of the hypocrites, because they both

perfectly describe them. I (Ibn Kathir) say, these descriptions are related to the type of hypocrite, because there is a difference between them as we stated. For instance, Allah mentioned these types in Surat Bara ah (chapter 9) when He repealed the statement, And among them three times, describing their types, characteristics, statements and deeds. So the two examples mentioned here describe two types of hypocrites whose characteristics are similar. For instance Allah gave two examples in Surat An-Nur, one for the advocates of disbelief and one for the followers of disbelief, He said, 4As for those who disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert} (24:39), until, '}} 4Or (the state of a disbeliever) is like the darkness in a vast deep sea} (24:40). The first example is of the advocates of disbelief who have complex ignorance, while the second is about the followers who have simple ignorance. Allah knows best. &4 * j. -Si P&4 pz

"jl iJUiat ill . O mankind! Worship your Lord (Allah), Who created you and those who were before you so that you may acquire Taqwd.i ill. WJw has made the earth a resting place for you, and the sky as a canopy, and sent down water (rain) from the sky and brought forth therewith fruits as a provision for you. Then do not set up rivals unto Allah (in worship) while you know (that He alone has the right to be worshipped) Tawhid Al-Uluhiyyah Allah next mentioned His Oneness in divinity and stated that He has favored His servants by bringing them to life after they did not exist. He also surrounded them with blessings, both hidden and apparent. He made the earth a resting place for them, just like the bed, stable with the firm mountains. iAnd the sky as a canopy^ meaning, a ceiling . Similarly, Allah said in another Ayah, iAnd We have made the heaven a roof, safe and well-guarded. Yet they turn away from its signs (i.e. sun, moon, winds, clouds)i (21:32). i'&> "IU' iAnd sends down for you water (rain) from the sky> meaning, through the clouds, when they need the rain. Hence, Allah caused the various types of vegetation and fruits to grow as a means of sustenance for people and their cattle. Allah reiterated this bounty in various parts of the Qur an. There is another Ayah that is similar to this Ayah (2:22), that is, Allah s statement, psz i&fr^ " J&5 ^6 ^ n -jU. 'AS4JC3 p=45a 'ig ilt is He Wlw has made for you the earth as a dwelling place

To take an equal with Allah, while He alone created you.

jf; l_r -"j - ^j5j jl Jf^t Jr'j'J 2)1 j!' J-r* A ji lS ^j yg of J.jljj) of Jci'r-!^ jitj j& Jiil of oUIS i_r_L^ oj*f jj ifcj p^LUI of jj ^j ,>! u; : jiii ji liij -*jlj ji , j Ji'r-! 4Ai ji ^**j ^ ji J^JJ.1 2il jl :JU pi tAf 2)1 .uAi kjjlil js. jJ ! " *. -i> bA *l Ji- ji : j+ijf jf; pll~ ji ^- j*P jij J^e-i ji oUK ^yp* 'jj} ". Ji 'V- l5^' J"-j J4 j^i I llli Ijjii Vj s- jf j i p^jfi L g 3: " 41* iS^jiJ J**i wJ*i _ji e^AJaJ^ ^y"p J" P^j " Vj "jJ-pU 2)1 jp c vLUJL? _yp lj.iT.lj yS 'oli iljjb jj j aJLp A>*jJ 4 ^jJ l j.yq'.i 1 j^i ?J -p" (4^ Ji 4 Ji 1'j~p < ** Jtj 4Ui j4 jli fliiJl ^yAj .^iLLJl ^j J, jui xj. 4il ^LiJl ^ jp jLjJl tj j yjj2 tyji' Jj. j\ j-uJi pif jij jiis JjJj 'Jj jli jr^P *~- 2 (* i J "f of j42 j* :j4J 4E, jij j-jj iui j*; jp 2 /ju^p .ii iu " > __ t i , t ^ - j? 'JjN j-2j-'-4*i' j-2 llwr>- UJi>- ojji ^ Iplj- "2)l ^Si^ jLS' lil jUaJbl ayV//"/i commanded Yahya bin Zakariya to implement five commands and to order the Children of Israel to impletnent them, but Yaltyd was slow in carrying out these commands. Isa said to Yahya, 'You were ordered to implement five commands and to order the Children of Israel to implement them. So either order, or I will do it. Yahya said, 'My brother! I fear that ifyou do it before me, I will be punished or the earth will be shaken under my feet. Hence, Yahya bin Zakariya called the Otildren of Israel to Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem), until they filled the Masjid. He sat on the balcony,

thanked Allah and praised him and then said, 'Allah ordered me to implement five commandments and that I should order you to adhere to them. The first is that you worship Allah alone and

ul ill dfoj li yi* ^ Ifij ^ l^piU ijt pj (C

slogans of Jahiliyah (the pre-Islamic period of ignorance) he will be among those kneeling in (Hellfire) ."

They said: O Messenger of Allah! If he prays and fasts? He said, "Even if he prays, fasts and claims to be Muslim. So call the Muslims with their own words that Allah has called them: 'The Muslims, the believing slaves of Allah. This is a Hasan Hadith, it contains the statement, Allah has created and sustains you, so worship Him and do not associate anything with Him in worship. This statement is relevant in the Ayat (2:2-22) we are discussing here and supports singling Allah in worship, without partners. Signs of Allah's Existence Several scholars of Tafsir, like Ar-Razi and others, used these Ayat as an argument for the existence of the Creator, and it is a most worthy method of argument. Indeed, whoever ponders over the things that exist, the higher and lower creatures, their various shapes, colors, behavior, benefits and ecological roles, then he will realize the ability, wisdom, knowledge, perfection and majesty of their Creator. Once a Bedouin was asked about the evidence to Allah's existence, he responded, All praise is due to Allah! The camel's dung testifies to the existence of the camel, and the track testifies to the fact that someone was walking. A sky that holds the giant stars, a land that has fairways and a sea that has waves, does not all of this testify that the Most Kind, Most Knowledgeable exists? 121 Hence, whoever gazes at the sky in its immensity, its expanse, and the various kinds of planets in it, some of which appear stationary in the sky - whoever gazes at the seas that surround the land from all sides, and the mountains that were placed on the earth to stabilize it, so that whoever lives on land, whatever their shape and color, are able to live and thrive - whoever reads Allah's statement, 'Layla' - |! Ahmad 4:130. 121 Ar-Razi 2:91.

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) Our servant's meaning, Muhammad (ﷺ), 4} then produce a Surah (chapter)} meaning, similar to what he brought to you. Hence, if you claim that what he was sent with did not come from Allah, then produce something similar to what he has brought to you, using the help of anyone you wish instead of Allah. However, you will not be able to succeed in this quest. Ibn Abbas said that, 'your witnesses' means Aids. 111 Also, As-Suddi reported that Abu Malik said the Ayah means, 'Your partners, meaning, some other people to help you in that. Meaning then go and seek the help of your deities to support and aid you. 121 Also, Mujahid said that, 'and call your witnesses' means, 'People, meaning, wise and eloquent men who will provide the testimony that you seek. The Challenge Allah challenged the disbelievers in various parts of the Qur'an. For instance, Allah said in Surat Al-Qasas (28:49), 'We have sent you (O Muhammad) a Book from Allah, which is a better guide than these two (the Tawrah (Torah) and the Qur'an), that I may follow it, if you are truthful'. Also, Allah said in Surat Al-Isra (17:88), 'If mankind and the Jinn were together to produce the like of this Qur'an, they could not produce the like thereof, even At-Tabari 1:376. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:84 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:85

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) is the Tafsir of Umar, Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn Abbas, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and the majority of the scholars. And he gave preference to this view and mentioned the fact that Allah has challenged the disbelievers as individuals and as groups, whether literate or illiterate, thus making the challenge truly complete. This type of challenge is more daring than simply challenging the disbelievers

who might not be literate or knowledgeable. This is why Allah said, iBring you then ten forged Surahs (chapters) like it> (11:13), and, iThey could not produce the like thereof^ (17:88). Therefore, this is a general challenge to the Arab disbelievers, the most eloquent among all nations. Allah challenged the Arab disbelievers both in Makkah and Al-Madlnah several times, especially since they had tremendous hatred and enmity for the Prophet ig and his religion. Yet, they were unable to succeed in answering the challenge, and this is why Allah said, iBut ifyou do it not, and you can never do it), indicating that they will never be able to answer the challenge. This is another miracle, in that, Allah clearly stated without doubt that the Qur an will never be opposed or challenged by anything similar to it, for eternity. This is a true statement that has not been changed until the present and shall never change. How can anyone be able to produce something like the Qur an, when the Qur an is the Word of Allah Who created everything? How can the words of the created ever be similar to the Words of the Creator? Examples ofthe Miracle ofthe Qur an Whoever reads through the Qur an will realize that it contains various levels of superiority through both the apparent and hidden meanings that it mentions. Allah said, ^ j. iii 2 i:

iAlifLam Ra. (This is) a Book, the verses wltereof are perfect (in every sphere of knowledge, etc.), and then explained in detailfrom One (Allah), Who is Wise and well-acquainted (with all things)} (11:1) So the expressions in the Qur an are perfect and its meanings are explained. Further, every word and meaning in the Qur an is eloquent and cannot be surpassed. The Qur an also mentioned the stories of the people of the past; and these accounts and stories occurred exactly as the Qur an stated. Also, the Qur an commanded every type of righteousness and forbade every type of evil, just as Allah stated, \iJLg c*Cj iAnd the Word ofyour Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice} (6:115). meaning, true in the stories it narrates and just in its Laws. The Qur an is true, just and full of guidance. It does not contain exaggerations, lies or falsehood, unlike Arabic and other types of poems that contained lies. These poems, conform with the popular statement, The most eloquent speech is the one that contains the most lies! Sometimes, one would find a long poem that mainly contains descriptions of women, horses or alcohol. Or, the poem might contain praise or the description of a certain person, horse, camel, war, incident, fear, lion, or other types of items and objects. Such praise or descriptions do not bring any benefit, except shed light on the poet s ability to clearly and eloquently describe such items. Yet, one will only be able to find one or two sentences in many long poems that elaborate on the main theme of the poem, while the rest of the poem contains insignificant descriptions and repetitions. As for the Qur an, it is entirely eloquent in the most perfect manner, as those who have knowledge in such matters and understand Arabic methods of speech and expressions concur. When one reads through the stories in the Qur an, he will find them fruitful, whether they were in extended or short forms, repeated or not. The more these stories are repeated, the more fruitful and beautiful they become. The Qur an does not become old when one repeats reciting it, nor do the scholars ever get bored with it. When the Qur an mentions the subject

Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) of warning and promises, it presents truths that would make solid, firm mountains shake, so what about the comprehending, understanding hearts? When the Qur an promises, it opens the hearts and the ears, making them eager to attain the abode of peace - Paradise - and to be the neighbors of the Throne of the Most Beneficent. For instance, on the subject of promises and encouragement, the Qur an said, Uj "J " . j " cit\$ No person knmos ivhat is kept hidden for them of joy as a rewardfor what they used to do} (32:17), and, ""/y l^t V 4(There will be) therein all that inner

selves could desire, and all that eyes could delight in and you will abide therein forever} (43:71). On the subject of warning and discouragement; *viC f-> o' }* 4Do you then feel secure that He will not cause a side of the land to swallow you up} (17:68), and, *O' tU-J' r ' 4f ';* *jjU OyUJt \ -* 4Do you feel secure that He, *Wlw* is over the heaven (Allah), will not cause the earth to sink with you, and then it should quake? Or do you feel secure that He, Who is over the heaven (Allah), will not send against you a violent whirlwind? Then you shall know how (terrible) has been My warning} (67:16-17). On the subject of threats, the Qur'an said, *4So We punished each (of them) for his sins*} (29:40). Also, on the subject of soft advice, the Qur'an said,

iTell Me, (even) if We do let them enjoy for years. And afterwards comes to them that (punishment) - which they had been promised. All that with which they used to enjoy shall not avail them (26:205-207). There are many other examples of the eloquence, beauty, and benefits of the Qur'an. When the Qur'an is discussing Laws, commandments and prohibitions, it commands every type of righteous, good, pleasing and beneficial act. It also forbids every type of evil, disliked and amoral act. Ibn Mas'ud and other scholars of the Salaf said, When you hear what Allah said in the Qur'an, such as, *i\p\;pS iO you who believe!*}, then listen with full attention, for it either contains a type of righteousness that Allah is enjoining, or an evil that He is forbidding. For instance, Allah said, *iHe (Muhammad s&)* commands them for Al-Ma'ruf (i.e. Islamic Monotheism and all that Islam has ordained); and forbids them from Al-Munkar (i.e. disbelief, polytheism of all kinds, and all that Islam has forbidden); he allows them as lawful At-Tayyibdt (i.e. all good and lawful things), and prohibits them as unlawful Al-Khaba'ith (i.e. all evil and unlawful things), he releases them from their heavy burdens and from the fetters (bindings) that were upon them} (7:157). When the Ayat mention Resurrection and the horrors that will occur on that Day, and Paradise and the Fire and the joys and safe refuge that Allah prepared for His loyal friends, or torment and Hell for His enemies, these Ayat contain glad tidings or warnings. The Ayat then call to perform good deeds and avoid evil deeds, making the life of this world less favorable and the Hereafter more favorable. They also establish the correct methods and guide to Allah's straight path and just legislation, all the while ridding the hearts of the evil of the cursed devil.

I Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) The Qur'an is the Greatest Miracle given to the Prophet The Two Sahih records that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet said, L^jly JI d-? ^ ^IjVI yt -Jj VI frll-jS/ j to <*Uxl I IajU fs ,j I jl 4ul oL>-jl I ^JU I 0\S "Even/ Prophet was given a miracle, the type of which brings mankind to faith. What I was given is a revelation that Alldh sent dmvn to me. Yet, I hope that I zwill have the most folioiuing on the Day of Resurrection This is the wording narrated by Muslim. The Prophet stated that among the Prophets he was given a revelation, meaning, he was especially entrusted with the miraculous Qur'an that challenged mankind to produce something similar to it. As for the rest of the divinely revealed Books, they were not miraculous according to many scholars. Allah knows best. The Prophet jg was also aided with innumerable signs and indications that testify to the truth of his prophethood and what he was sent with, all thanks and praise is due to Allah. Meaning of Stones Allah said, iThen fear the Fire (Hell) whose fuel is men and stones, prepared for the disbelievers> (2:24). Fuel is wood, or similar substances, used to start and feed a fire. Similarly, Allah said, 'y^j iAnd as for the Qdsitun (disbelievers wlv deviated from the right path), they shall be firewood for Hell^ (72:15), and, y.AS. a~f"- s oi \aj +Z=K>\f Ijj t U cifi Al-Bari 8 :619 and Muslim 1 :134*

164 Tafstr Ibn Kathir {Certainly you (disbelievers) and that which you are worshipping nmo besides Allah, are (but) fuel for Hell! (Surely) you enter it. Had these (idols) been dliyah (gods), they would not have entered there (Hell), and all of them will abide therein" (21:98-99). The stones mentioned here are the giant, rotten, black, sulfuric stones that become the hottest when heated, may Allah save us from this evil end. It was also reported that the stones mentioned here are the idols and rivals that were worshipped instead of Allah, just as Allah said, y " y ' s 4 oi Vj 4Certainly you (disbelievers) and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) fuel far Hell!} (21:28). Allah s statement, ipreparedfor the disbelievers It appears most obvious that it refers to the Fire that is fueled by men and stones, and it also may refer to the stones themselves. There is no contradiction between these two views, because they are dependent upon each other. Prepared means, it is kept and will surely touch those who disbelieve in Allah and His Messenger Ibn Ishaq narrated that Muhammad said that *Ikrimah or Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn Abbas said, ipreparedfar the disbelievers}, For those who embrace the disbelief that you (disbelievers) have embraced. ' Jahannam (Hellfle) existsnow Many of the Imams of the Sunnah used this Ayah to prove that the Fire exists now. This is because Allah said, Tabari 1:383.

Also, there is a Hadith recorded from Ibn Mas*ud that the Companions heard the sound of a falling object. When they asked about it, the Messenger of Allah sfe said,

166 Tafstr Ibn Kathir there is disagreement that I ' ' know of on this fact between the scholars ^x "> f i- i. > - rLsfc*. of old and new. Before he beeam Muslim. Amr bin Al-'As met .*<' s x ' \ ' Musaylimah the Liar who asked him, What has recently S , x - \ -i Musaylimah the Liar who asked him, what has recently / , . been revealed to your aiiBUiU^ > =UijjL^jJ fellow (meaning >\ .-Nll'i'v," Muhammad s) in Amr said, Xjr-Sj^'-^tf ^ dn" , J ->*)' A short, yet eloquent < >\--" -l 't Surah. He asked, iW^oy' ah' What is it? He said, J &tf Si Al-'Asr (the time). aotfi'T Musaylimah J thought for a while and said, A similar Surah was also revealed to me. Amr asked, What is it? He said, O Wabr, O Wabr (i.e. a wild cat), you are but two ears and a chest, and the rest of you is unworthy and thin. Amr said, By Allah! You know that I know that you are lying. lU= j&Vf <& 3 iju j VJX j& JZ> l\$ j ti 15 J-5 Oi ufj' 'Ly Ar j ^ l^V ^ t!*; (L*j . And give glad tidings to those who believe and do righteous good deeds, tluit for them will be Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise). Every time they will be provided with a fruit therefrom, they will say: This is what we were provided with before, and they ivill be given things in

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) resemblance (i.e. in the same form but different in taste) and they shall have therein Azwajun Mutahharatun (purified mates or wives), and they will abide therein forever Rewards of Righteous Believers After mentioning the torment that Allah has prepared for His miserable enemies who disbelieve in Him and in His Messengers, He mentions the condition of His happy, loyal friends who believe in Him and in His Messengers, adhere to the faith and perform the good deeds. This is the reason why the Qur an was called Mathani, based on the correct opinion of the scholars. We will elaborate upon this subject later. Mathani means to mention faith and then disbelief, or vice versa. Or, Allah mentions the miserable and then the happy, or vice versa. As for mentioning similar things, it is called Tashabbuh, as we will come to know, Allah willing. Allah said, iAnd give glad tidings to those who believe and do righteous good deeds, that for them will be Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise)^. Consequently, Allah stated that Paradise has rivers that run beneath it, meaning, underneath its trees and rooms. From Hadiths it is learned that the rivers of Paradise do not run in valleys, and that

the banks of Al-Kawthar (the Prophet's lake in Paradise) are made of domes of hollow pearls, the sand of Paradise is made of scented musk while its stones are made from pearls and jewels. We ask Allah to grant Paradise to us, for verily, He is the Most Beneficent, Most Gracious. Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, *Jv 1 *- ...1 1 Q. ^jA* "The rivers of Paradise spring from beneath hills, or mountains of musk . ,1! He also reported from Masruq that Abdullah said, The rivers of Paradise spring from beneath mountains of musk. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :87. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 88

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) The Wives of the People of Paradise are Pure Allah said. and they shall have therein Azwajun Mutahharatun}. Ibn Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, Purified from filth and impurity. 1 11 Also, Mujahid said, From menstruation, relieving the call of nature, urine, spit, semen and pregnancies. 121 Also, Qatadah said, Purified from impurity and sin." In another narration, he said, From menstruation and pregnancies. 131 Further, Ata , Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, Abu Salih, Atiyah and As-Suddi were reported to have said similarly. Allah's statement, and they will abide therein forever^ meaning ultimate happiness, for the believers will enjoy everlasting delight, safe from death and disruption of their bliss, for it never ends or ceases. We ask Allah to make us among these believers, for He is the Most Generous, Most Kind and Most merciful. ** IXfj iii i'j' 'iC iri ^ jiilf oyiajc, jiy "Aj iif Vi jyJaOJ -A.j.'j .4 JILu 426 . Verily, Allah is not ashamed to set forth a parable even of a mosquito or so much more when it is bigger (or less when it is smaller) than it. And as for those who believe, they know that it is the truth from their Lord, but as for those who disbelieve, they say : "What did Allah intend by this parable?" By it He misleads many, and many He guides thereby. And He misleads thereby only the Fdsiqin (the rebellious, disobedient to Tabari 1 :295. At-Tabari 1 :396. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:91. 141 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :92

Allah). 427. Those who break Allah's covenant after ratifying it, and sever what Allah has ordered to be joined and do mischief on earth, it is they who are the losers.) In his Tafsir, As-Suddi reported that Ibn Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud, and some Companions said; When Allah gave these two examples of the hypocrites meaning Allah's statements, -^) iTheir likeness is as the likeness of one who kindled a fire), and, }) iOr like a rainstorm from the sky), The hypocrites said, Allah's far more exalted than for Him to make such examples. So Allah revealed these Ayat (2:26-27) up to: iWlto are the losers)".111 Said said that Qatadah said, Allah does not shy away from the truth when He mentions a matter as a parable, whether this matter is significant or not. When Allah mentioned the flies and the spider in His Book, the people of misguidance said, *Why did Allah mention these things. So Allah revealed; 4Verily, Allah is not ashamed to set forth a parable even of a mosquito or so much more when it is bigger (or less when it is smaller) than A Parable about the Life of This World Abu Ja'far Ar-Razi reported that Ar-Rabl bin Anas commented on this Ayah (2:26); This is an example that Allah has given for the life of this world. The mosquito lives as long as it needs food, but when it gets fat, it dies. This is also the example of people whom Allah mentioned in the Qur'an: when At-Tabari 1 :398. At-Tabari 1 :399.

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) they acquire (and collect the delights of) the life of this world, Allah then takes them away. Afterwards, he recited, 4", *y. A 1 4So, when they forgot (the warning) with which they had been reminded, We opened for them the gates of every (pleasant) thing) (6:44)' In this Ayah (2:26) Allah stated that He does not shy away or hesitate in making an example or parable of anything,

whether the example involves a significant or an insignificant matter. Allah's statement, (Or so much more when it is bigger than it) Fama fawqaha means, something bigger than the mosquito, which is one of the most insignificant and tiniest of creatures. Muslim narrated that Aishah said that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said, (No Muslim is harmed by a thorn, Fama fawqaha (or something larger), but a good deed will be written for him and an evil deed will be erased from his record.) [2] So Allah has informed us that there is no matter that is too small that is exempt from being used as an example, even if it was as insignificant as a mosquito or a spider. Allah said, O mankind! A similitude has been coined, so listen to it (carefully): Verily, those on whom you call besides Allah, cannot create (even) a fly, even though they combine together for the purpose. And if the fly snatches away a thing from Tabari 1:398. ' Muslim 4:1991.

them, they will have no power to release it from the fly. So weak are (both) the seeker and the sought.} (22:73), (O) the likeness of those who take (false deities as) Awliya' (protectors, helpers) other than Allah is the likeness of a spider who builds (for itself) a house; but verily, the frailest (weakest) of houses is the spider's house - if they but knew.} (29:41), and, a (likeness of) a tree, whose root is firmly fixed, and its branches (reach) to the sky (i.e. very high). Giving its fruit at all times, by the leave of its Lord, and Allah sets forth parables for mankind in order that they may remember. And the parable of an evil ivory is that of an evil tree uprooted from the surface of earth, having no stability. Allah will keep firm those who believe, with the word that stands firm in life of this world (i.e. they will keep on worshipping Allah alone and none else), and in the Hereafter. And Allah will cause the Zalimin (polytheists and wrongdoers) to go astray those and Allah does what He wills.} (14:24-27). Allah said, (Two men - a believer and a disbeliever); a servant under the possession of another, he has no power of any sort} (16:75). He then said, (And Allah puts forward the

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) (Allah puts forward (another) example of two men, one of them dumb, who has no power over anything, and he is a burden on his master; whichever way he directs him, he brings no good. Is such a man equal to one who commands justice?) (16:76). Also, Allah said, (He sets forth for you a parable from your own selves: Do you have partners among those whom your right hands possess (i.e. your servants) to share as equals in the wealth we have bestowed on you?) (30:28). Mujahid commented on Allah's statement, (Verily, Allah is not ashamed to set forth a parable even of a mosquito or so much more when it is bigger than it.) The believers believe in these parables, whether they involve large matters or small, because they know that they are the truth from their Lord, and Allah guides the believers by these parables. In his Tafsir, As-Suddi reported that Ibn Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and other people among the Companions said, (By it He misleads many), Meaning the hypocrites. Allah guides the believers with these parables, and the straying of the hypocrites increases when they reject the parables that Allah mentioned for them which they know are true. This is how Allah misleads them. (And He guides thereby) meaning, with the parables, (many) from among the people of faith and conviction. Allah (ﷻ) Ibn Abi Hatim 1:93. Tabari 1:408.

adds guidance to their guidance, and faith to their faith, because they firmly believe in what they know to be true, that is, the parables that Allah has mentioned. This is guidance that Allah grants them; 4 -jjif j j4 4And He misleads thereby only the Fasiqin (the rebellious, disobedient to Allah)}, meaning, the hypocrites. The Arabs say that the date has Fasaqat, when it comes out of its skin, and they call the mouse a Fuwaysiqah, because it leaves its den to cause mischief. The Two Sahihs recorded 'A islah saying that the Messenger of Allah said, SjUilj J j> jiiUl Five animals are Fawasiq, and they must be killed during Ihram and otherwise: the crow, the kite, the scorpion, the mouse and the rabid dog ."li Fasiq, includes the disbeliever and the disobedient. However, the Fisq of the disbeliever is worse, and this is the type of Fasiq that the Ayah is describing here, because Allah described them as, / \ 'J*' / \ t X' < > t m t S * > * ' \ j' *** U ojjOsAj .Aa,1. .4 jl"u j* aUi jjl f> fw;^jf JLiit ^Vf 4 iThose who break Allah's covenant after ratifying it, and sever

what Allah has ordered to be joined and do mischief on earth, it

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 174–203]

is they who are the losers.} These are the characteristics of the disbelievers and they contradict the qualities of the believers. Similarly, Allah said in Surat Ar-Ra d, _>* yy xa S~ S. J aii ii' tj y jLfl m Fath Al-Bari 6 :408 and Muslim 2 :856

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) iShall he then, who knows that what has been revealed unto you (O Muhammad sg) from your Lord is the truth, be like him who is blind? But it is only the men of understanding that pay heed. Those who fulfill the covenant of Allah and break not the Mithdq (bond, treaty, covenant). And those who join that which Alldh has commanded to be joined (i.e. they are good to their relatives and do not sever the bond of kinship), and fear their Lord, and dread the terrible reckoning.} (13:19-21)^ until, . ' > A \ tC' 'A ^ l" t 't ^ o' La ^jyOUij Aaj j* aA\ J-fC- ft) ilif ft. j i\ iAnd those who break the covenant of Allah, after its ratification, and sever that which Alldh has commanded to be joined (i.e. they sever the bond of kinship and are not good to their relatives), and work mischief in the land, on them is the curse (i.e. they will be far away from Allah's mercy), and for them is the unhappy (evil) home (i.e. Hell).} (13:25) The covenant that these deviant people broke is Allah's covenant with His creation, that is, to obey Him and avoid the sins that He prohibited. This covenant was reiterated in Allah's Books and by the words of His Messengers. Ignoring this covenant constitutes breaking it. It was said that the Ayah (2:27) is about the disbelievers and the hypocrites among the People of the Book. In this case, the covenant that they broke is the pledge that Allah took from them in the Tawrah to follow Muhammad jg when he is sent as a Prophet, and to believe in him, and in what he was sent with. Breaking Allah's covenant in this case occurred when the People of the Book rejected the Prophet after they knew the truth about him, and they hid this truth from people, even though they swore to Allah that they would do otherwise. Allah informed us that they threw the covenant behind their backs and sold it for a miserable price. It was also reported that the Ayah (2:27) refers to all disbelievers, idol worshippers and hypocrites. Allah took their pledge to believe in His Oneness, showing them the signs that testify to His Lordship. He also took a covenant from them to obey His commands and refrain from His prohibitions,

176 Tafsir Ibn Kathir knowing that His Messengers would bring proofs and miracles that none among the creation could ever produce. These miracles testified to the truth of Allah's Messengers. The covenant was broken when the disbelievers denied what was proven to them to be authentic and rejected Allah's Prophets and Books, although they knew that they were the truth. This Tafsir was reported from Muqatil bin Hayyan, and it is very good. It is also the view that Az-Zamakhshari held. Allah's statement next, *And sever what Allah has ordered to be joined* is in reference to keeping the relations with the relatives, as Qatadah asserted. This Ayah is similar to Allah's statement, *Would you then, if you were given the authority, do mischief in the land, and sever your ties of kinship?* (47:22) Ibn Jarir At-Tabari preferred this opinion. However, it has been said that the meaning of the Ayah (2:27) here is more general. Hence, everything that Allah has commanded to nurture, and the people severed, is included in its meaning.

The Meaning of Loss Muqatil bin Hayyan commented on Allah's statement, *It is they who are the losers* In the Hereafter. 121 Similarly, Allah said, *On them is the curse (i.e. they will be far away from Allah's mercy), and for them is the unhappy (evil) home (i.e. Hell)* (13:25). Also, Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said, Every characteristic that Allah describes those other than the people of Islam - such as being losers - then it refers to disbelief. m At-Tabari 1 :416. 12* Ibn Abi Hatim 1:101

Al-Baqarah (25 -49) (Part-1) However, when they are attributed to the people of Islam, then these terms refer to sin. Ibn Jarir commented on Allah's statement, *It is they who are the losers,* Losers is plural for loser, this word refers to whoever decreased his own share of Allah's mercy by disobeying Him, just as the merchant loses in his trade by sustaining capital loss. Such is the case with the hypocrite and the disbeliever who lose their share of the mercy that Allah has in store for His servants on the Day of Resurrection. And that is when the disbeliever and the hypocrite most desperately need Allah's mercy. / > JxS) i] TA 428. Hmv can you disbelieve in Allah seeing that you were dead and He gave you life? Then He zoill give you death, then again zoill bring you to life (on the Day of Resurrection) and then unto Him you will return. Allah testifies to the fact that He exists and that He is the Creator and the Sustainer Who has full authority over His servants, 4Hozo can you disbelieve in Allah?) How can anyone deny Allah's existence or worship others with Him while; 4You were dead and He gave you life) meaning, He brought them from the state of non-existence to life. Similarly, Allah said, Tabari 1 : 417. 121 Ibid.

4Were they created by nothing? Or were they themselves the creators? Or did they create the heavens and the earth? Nay, but they have no firm belief} (52:35-36) and, jijJ' Ss" S-H' & iHas there not been over man a period of time, when he was not a thing worth mentioning?} (76:1). There are many other Ayat on this subject. Ibn Jarir reported from Ata that Ibn Abbas said that, iSyl pi^-gj} iSeeing that you were dead and He gave you life} means, You did not exist beforehand. You were nothing until Allah created you; He will bring death to you and then bring you back to life during Resurrection. Ibn Abbas then said, This is similar to Allah's statement; I biil i4> lja} iThey will say : Our Lord! You have made us to die twice and You have given us life twice."} (40:1 1) 11 }29. He it is Wlto created for you all that is on earth. Then He Istawd ila the heaven and made them seven heavens and He is the Knower of everything.} Evidence of Allah's Ability After Allah mentioned the proofs of His creating them, and

what they can witness in themselves as proof of that, He mentioned another proof that they can witness, that is, the creation of the heavens and earth. Allah said, *gi&p 21 Spt p Vip 4 u p 3L \$} J. 4He it is Who created for you all that is on earth . Then He Istawd ila the heaven and made them seven heavens}* meaning, He turned Al-Tabari 1 :419.

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) towards the heaven, *4And made them^* meaning, that He made the heaven, seven heavens. Allah said, *4And made them seven heavens and He is the Knower ofeverything^* meaning, His knowledge encompasses all His creation, just as He said in another Ayah, *iShould not He Who has created know? }* (67:14). The Beginning ofthe Creation This Ayah (2:29) is explained in detail in Surat As-Sajdah where Allah said; *z iii'i wJ ,i! jj&j jUy' j yjVi ju jjji 'r* -> > fey ui ^ ife bls jl WjL uii jijybj a Jli oU-j J'k ^ if Gjji zLlii (Ijj U^ .d jf j uyjj ^ yld* r-> ^ ,f , j 'n'^ 'i/ (O Muhammad jg) :* "Do you verily disbelieve in Him Wlto created the earth in two Days? And you set up rivals (in worship) ivith Him? That is the Lord of all that exists. He placed therein (i.e. the earth) firm mountainsfrom above it, and He blessed it, and measured therein its sustenance (for its dwellers) in four Days equal (i.e. all these four days' were equal in the length of time) for all those who ask (about its creation). Then He Istawd ild the heaven when it ivas smoke, and said to it and to the earth : "Come both ofyou willingly or unwillingly." They both said: We come willingly. Then He finished them (as) seven heavens in two Days and He made in each heaven its affair. And We adorned the nearest (lowest) heaven with lamps (stars) to be an adornment as well as to guard (from the devils by using them as missiles against the devils). Such is the decree of the Almighty, the Knower (41:9- 12).

180 Tafsir Ibn Kathir These Ayat indicate that Allah started creation by creating earth, then He made heaven into seven heavens. This is how building usually starts, with the lower floors first and then the top floors, as the scholars of Tafsir reiterated, as we will come to know, Allah willing. Allah also said, *3Cif; Tv ,1^ .r)\ UU> Ail ^ ,n UIU iiU j jai i*Are you more difficult to create or is the heaven that He constructed? He raised its height, and has perfected it. Its night He covers with darkness and its forenoon He brings out (with light). And the earth, after that, He spread it out. And brought forth therefrom its water and its pasture. And the mountains He has fixedfirmly. (To be) a provision and benefitfor you and your cattle} (79:27-33). It is said that Then in the Ayah (2:29) relates only to the order of reciting the information being given, it does not relate to the order that the events being mentioned took place, this was reported from Ibn Abbas by Ali bin Abi Talhah. The Earth was created before Heaven Mujahid commented on Allah s statement, *Jf'il 4 U p. jjfo ' }* *4He it is Who createdfor you all that is on earth Allah created the earth before heaven, and when He created the earth, smoke burst out of it. This is why Allah said, 4 -> () fIA 2Sj?-'* ^} i*Then He Istawa ild (turned towards) the heaven when it was smoke.} (41:11) *jj- iAnd made them seven heavens}* means, one above the other, while the seven earths means, one below the other. At-Tabari 1 :437.Tabari 1 :436.

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1 This Ayah testifies to the fact that the earth was created before heaven, as Allah has indicated in the Ayat in Surat As- Sajdah. Spreading the Earth out alter the Heavens were created Sahih Al-Bukhari records that when Ibn Abbas was question about this matter, he said that the earth was created before heaven, and the earth was spread out only after the creation of the heaven. Several Tafsir scholars of old and recent times also said similarly, as we have elaborated on in the Tafsir of Surat An-Nazi'at (chapter 79). The result of that discussion is that the word Daha (translated above as

spread) is mentioned and explained in Allah's statement, *وَالْأَرْضَ بَنَدًا* (79:30-32) Therefore, Doha means that the earth's treasures were brought to its surface after finishing the job of creating FathAl-Bari 8:417.

whatever will reside on earth and heaven. When the earth became Doha, the water burst out to its surface and the various types, colors, shapes and kinds of plants grew. The stars started rotating along with the planets that rotate around them. And Allah knows best. *وَالْأَرْضَ بَنَدًا* (79:30-32) And (remember) when your Lord said to the angels: "Verily, I am going to place (mankind) generations after generations on earth." They said: "Will You place therein those who will make mischief therein and shed blood, while we glorify You with praises and tlmnks and sanctify You." He (Allah) said: "I know that which you do not know. } Adamand His Children inhabited the Earth, Generation after Generation Allah reiterated His favor on the Children of Adam when He stated that He mentioned them in the highest of heights before He created them. Allah said, *وَالْأَرْضَ بَنَدًا* (79:30-32) (remember) when your Lord said to the angels.} This Ayah means, O Muhammad sgl Mention to your people what Allah said to the angels, *وَالْأَرْضَ بَنَدًا* (79:30-32) Meaning people reproducing generation after generation, century alter centuiy, just as Allah said, *وَالْأَرْضَ بَنَدًا* (79:30-32) And it is He Who has made you (Khald'if) generations coming after getterations, replacing each other on the earth} (6:165), *وَالْأَرْضَ بَنَدًا* (79:30-32) And makes you (Khulafd') inheritors of the earth} (27:62), *وَالْأَرْضَ بَنَدًا* (79:30-32) }

mSurah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) iAnd if it were Our will, We would have (destroyed you (mankind all, and) made angels to replace you (Yakhlufun) on the earth> (43:60) and, *وَالْأَرْضَ بَنَدًا* (79:30-32) after them succeeded an (evil) generation (Khalf)} (7:169). It appears that Allah was not refering to Adam specifically as Khalifah, otherwise he would not have allowed the angels statement, *وَالْأَرْضَ بَنَدًا* (79:30-32) You place therein those who will make mischief therein and shed blood}. The angels meant that this type of creature usually commits the atrocities they mentioned. The angels knew of this fact, according to their understanding of human nature, for Allah stated that He would create man from clay. Or, the angels understood this fact from the word Khalifah, which also means the person who judges disputes that occur between people, forbidding them from injustice and sin, as Al-Qurtubi said. The statement the angels uttered was not a form of disputing with Allah's, nor out of envy for the Children of Adam, as some mistakenly thought. Allah has described them as those who do not precede Him in speaking, meaning that they do not ask Allah anything without His permission. When Allah informed them that He was going to create a creation on the earth, and they had knowledge that this creation would commit mischief on it, as Qatadah mentioned, they said, *وَالْأَرْضَ بَنَدًا* (79:30-32) Will You place therein those who will make mischief therein and shed blood?} This is only a question for the sake of learning about the wisdom of that, as if they said, Our Lord! What is the wisdom of creating such creatures since they will cause trouble in the earth and spill blood? ^ If the wisdom behind this action is m At-Tabari 1 :464.

77ie deeds of the night are elevated to Allah before the morning, and the deeds of the morning before the night falls .

Stira/i 2 . Al-Baaarah (25 - 49) (Part-1 185 41 knoio that which you do not know.} is, I have a specific wisdom in creating them, which you do not have knowledge of. It was also said that it is in answer to, IjA)} iWhile we glorify You with praises and thanks and sanctify You after which Allah said, 41 knoio that which you do not knoio}. Meaning, I know that Iblis is not as you are, although he is among you. Others said, ,j-Jju > r "4Will You place therein those who will make mischief therein and shed blood, - while we glorify you ivith praises and thanks and sanctify You.} is their request that they should be allowed to inhabit the earth, instead of the Children of Adam. So Allah said to them, 41 know that which you do not know} if your inhabiting the heavens is better, or worse for you. Ar-Razi as well as others said this. Allah knows best. The Obligation of appointing a Khalifah and some related Issues Al-Qurtubi, as well as other scholars, said that this Ayah (2:30) proves the obligation of appointing a Khalifah to pass judgements on matters of dispute between people, to aid the oppressed against the oppressor, to implement the Islamic penal code and to forbid evil. There are many other tasks that can only be fulfilled by appointing the Imam, and what is necessary in performing an obligation, is an obligation itself. We should state here that Imamah occurs by either naming a successor, as a group among Ahl As-Sunnah scholars said occurred - by the Prophet ^ - in the case of Abu Bakr, or hinting to a successor. Or, the current Khalifah names a certain person as Khalifah after him, as Abu Bakr did with Umar. Or, the Khalifah might leave the matter in the hands of

432. And He taught Adam all the names (of everything), then He showed them to the angels and said, "Tell Me the names of these ifyou are truthful. } 432. They (angels) said: "Glory is to You, we have no knowledge except what you have taught us. Verily, You are the Knower, the Wise. } 433. He said: O Adam! Inform them of their names," and when he had informed them of their names. He said : "Did I not tell you that l know the Ghayb (unseen) in the heavens and the earth, and 1 kttoiu what you reveal and what you have been concealing?"} The Virtue ofAdam over the Angels Allah stated the virtue ofAdam above the angels, because He taught Adam, rather than them, the names of everything. This occurred after they prostrated to him. This discussion precedes that event here, only to show the importance of his position, and the absence of the angels knowledge about creating the Khalifah when they asked about it. So Allah informed the angels that He knows what they do not know, and then He mentioned this to show them Adam s superiority over them in knowledge. Allah said, 4'+ ' p; } iAnd He taught Adam all the names (ofeverything)}. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah; 4^ t V' pi (fej) iAnd He taught Adam all the names (ofeverything)} Meaning, the names that people use, such as human, animal, sky, earth, land, sea, horse, donkey, and so forth, including the names of the other species. Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn m At-Tabari 1 :458

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) all mankind, Allah created you with His Own Hand, ordered the angels to prostrate for you and taught you the names of everything. Will you not intercede for us with your Lord, so that he relieve us from this gathering place? On that Adam will reply, 7 cannot do what you have asked'. He will have remembered his error and will be embarrassed, saying, Go to Nuh, for he is the first ofAllah's Messengers whom Allah sent to the people of the earth.' They will go to Nuh and ask him. He will say, 7 cannot do what you have asked.' He will recall asking Allah what he was not to know, and will also be embarrassed. He will say, 'Go to Khalil Ar-Rahman.' They will go to Ibrahim and he will also say, 7 cannot do what you have asked. He will say, Go to Musa, a servant to whom Allah spoke directly and gave the Tawrdh.' Musa will say, 7 cannot do what you have asked. He zoill

remember that he killed a person without justification and will be embarrassed before his Lord. He will say, 'Go to Tsā, Allah's servant and Messenger and His Word and a spirit of His.' They will go to 'Isa and he will say, 'I will not do what you asked. Go to Muhammad, a servant whose previous and latter errors were forgiven.' They will come to me, and I will go to Allah and seek His permission and He will give me His permission. When I gaze at my Lord, I will prostrate myself and Allah will allow me to remain like that as much as He will. Then I will be addressed, 'O Muhammad! Raise your head; ask, for you will be given what you ask, and intercede, for your intercession will be accepted.' I will raise my head and thank and praise Allah with such praise as He will inspire me. I will intercede and He will grant me a quantity of people that He will admit into Paradise. I will go back to Hell, and when I see my Lord, I will intercede and He will allow me a quantity that He will admit into Paradise. I will do that for a third and then a fourth time. I will say, There are no more people left in Hell except those whom the Qur'an has incarcerated and have thus acquired eternity in Hell. This Hadith was collected by Muslim, An-Nawawi, and others. * Allah's Word and spirit; the meaning here is that Allah created him with a word, "Be" and he was, and that he is a spirit from the spirits that Allah created, as Ibn Kathir discusses later. Fath Al-Bari 8:10. 12]

The reason why we mentioned this Hadith here is the Prophet's statement, -: "They will go to Adam and say, 'O Adam! You are the father of all mankind, and Allah created you with His Own Hand, ordered the angels to prostrate for you, and taught you the names of everything'." This part of the Hadith testifies to the fact that Allah taught Adam the names of all creatures. This is why Allah said, 'Then He showed them to the angels' meaning, the objects or creations. Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma'mar said that Qatadah said, Allah paraded the objects before the angels. And said,

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) honor and glorify Me. However, since you do not know the names of the objects I paraded before you, then you have even less knowledge of what will occur on the earth that does not exist yet. They (angels) said: "Glory is to You, we have no knowledge except what you have taught us. Verily, it is You, the Most Wise." Here the angels are praising Allah's holiness, and perfection above every kind of deficiency, affirming that no creature could ever acquire any part of Allah's knowledge, except by His permission, nor could anyone know anything except what Allah teaches them. This is why they said, "Glory is to You, we have no knowledge except what you have taught us. Verily You are the Knower, the Most Wise" meaning, Allah is knowledgeable of everything, Most Wise about His creation, and He makes the wisest decisions, and He teaches and deprives whom He wills from knowledge. Verily, Allah's wisdom and justice in all matters is perfect. Adam's Virtue of Knowledge is demonstrated Allah said, 'Inform them of their names,' and when he had informed them of their names, He said: "Did I not tell you that I know the Ghayb (unseen) in the heavens and the earth, and I know what you reveal and what you have been concealing?" Zayd bin Aslam said, You are Jibril, you are Mikail, you are Israfil, until he mentioned the name of the crow. Mujahid said that Allah's statement, in Ibn Abi Hatim 1:118.

He said: "O Adam! Inform them of their names," The name of the pigeon, the crow and everything. Statements of a similar meaning were reported from Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, and Qatadah. When Adam's virtue over the angels became apparent, as he mentioned the names that Allah

taught him, Allah said to the angels, j <~ - - xs\ 4Did I not tell you that / know the Chayb (unseen) in the heavens and the earth, and I know what you reveal and what you have been concealing?} This means, Did I not state that I know the seen and unseen matters. Similarly, Allah said, yf oij^ iAnd if you (O Muhammad jg) speak (the invocation) aloud, then verily, He knows the secret and tint which is yet more hidden^ (20:7). Also, Allah said about the hoopoe, that it said to Sulayman; HAs Shaytan (Satan) has barred them from Allah's way] so they do not prostrate before Allah, Wlw brings to light what is hidden in the heavens and the earth, and knows what you conceal and what you reveal. Allah, La ilaha ilia Huwa (none has the right to be worshipped but He), the Lord of the Supreme Throne!} (27:25-26). They also have comments other than what we have said about the meaning of Allah's statement, 4SJ& pr c; 4And I know what you reveal and what you have been concealing}. ^ Ibn Abi Hatim 1:119. Ibid.

It is reported from Ad-Dahhak that Ibn Abbas said that, 4And I know what you reveal and what you have been concealing^ means, I know the secrets, just as I know the apparent things, such as, what Iblis concealed in his heart of arrogance and pride. Abu Ja'far Ar-Razi narrated that Ar-Rabi bin Anas said that, 4oJS4p ojij l* jXetjAnd I know what you reveal and what you have been concealing} means, The apparent part of what they said was: Do you create in it that which would commit mischief and shed blood? The hidden meaning was: We have more knowledge and honor than any creation our Lord would create. But they came to know that Allah favored Adam above them regarding knowledge and honor. 4 ri , St Gjfw (3% 1 bii } 434. And (remember) when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves before Adam. And they prostrated except Iblis (Shaytan), he refused and was proud and was one of the disbelievers (disobedient to Allah).} Honoring Adam when the Angels prostrated before Him This Ayah mentions the great honor that Allah granted Adam, and Allah reminded Adam's offspring of this fact. Allah commanded the angels to prostrate before Adam, as this Ayah and many Hadiths testify, such as the Hadith about the intercession that we discussed. There is a Hadith about the supplication of Musa, O my Lord! Show me Adam who caused us and himself to be thrown out of Paradise. When Musa met Adam, he said to him, Are you Adam whom Allah created with His Own Hands, blew life into and commanded the angels to prostrate before? '2Jabari 1 :498. Abu DSud 5:28.

194 Tafsir Ibtal Kathir Iblis was among Those ordered to prostrate before Adam, although He was not an Angel When Allah commanded the angels to prostrate before Adam, Iblis was included in this command. Although Iblis was not an angel, he was trying - and pretending - to imitate the angels behavior and deeds, and this is why he was also included in the command to the angels to prostrate before Adam. Satan was criticized for defying that command, as we will explain with detail, Allah willing, when we mention the Tafsir of Allah's statement, & J-4 4Except Iblis (Satan). He was one of the Jinn; he disobeyed the command of his Lord> (18:50) Similarly, Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas said, Before he undertook the path of sin, Iblis was with the angels and was called Azazil. He was among the residents of the earth and was one of the most active worshippers and knowledgeable persons among the angels. This fact caused him to be arrogant. Iblis was from a genus called Jinn. The Prostration was before Adam but the Obedience was to Allah Qatadah commented on Allah's statement, Gii iAnd (remember) when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves before Adam .")> The obedience was for Allah and the prostration was before Adam. Allah honored Adam and commanded the angels to prostrate before him. 121 Some people said that this prostration was just a prostration of greeting, peace and honor, hence Allah's statement, Cji (ri j V-K jlij iir*~J it JJ 1,1 At-Tabari 1 :502. At-Tabari 1 :512.

lii Ar-Razi agreed with this view. Also, Qatadah said about Allah's statement, *And they prostrated except Iblis (Shaytan), he refused and was proud and was one of the disbelievers (disobedient to Allah).* Iblis, the enemy of Allah, envied Adam because Allah honored Adam. He said, I was created from fire, and he was created from clay. Therefore, the first error ever committed was arrogance, for the enemy of Allah was too arrogant to prostrate before Adam. 121 I - Ibn Kathir - say, the following is recorded in the Sahih, In in JuL jsJ b's ji Jji-Ju

4Verily, You are the Knower, the Wise .} Then Adam fell asleep, as the People of the Book and other scholars such as Ibn Abbas have stated, Allah took one of Adam's left ribs and made flesh grow in its place, while Adam was asleep and unaware. Allah then created Adam's wife, Hawwa, from his rib and made her a woman, so that she could be a comfort for him. When Adam woke up and saw Hawwa next to him, it was claimed, he said, My flesh and blood, my wife. Hence, Adam reclined with Hawwa. When Allah married Adam to Hawwa and gave him comfort, Allah said to him directly. *And it is said to Adam! Dwell you and your wife in the Paradise and eat both of you freely with pleasure and delight, of things therein wherever you will, but come not near this tree or you both will be of the Zolim (wrongdoers).* . ^ Allah tests Adam Allah's statement to Adam, *but come not near this tree* is a test for Adam. There are conflicting opinions over the nature of the tree mentioned here. Some said that it was the grape tree, barley, date tree, fig tree, and so forth. Some said that it was a certain tree, and whoever eats from it will be relieved of the call of nature. It was also said that it was a tree from which the angels eat so that they live for eternity. Imam Abu Ja'far bin Jarir said, The correct opinion is that Allah forbade Adam and his wife from eating from a certain tree in Paradise, but they ate from it. We do not know which tree that was, because Allah has not mentioned anything in the Qur'an or the authentic Sunnah about the nature of this tree. It was in At-Tabari 1 :514.

said that it was barley, grape, or a fig tree. It is possible that it was one of those trees. Yet, this is knowledge that does not bring any benefit, just as being ignorant in its nature does no harm. Allah knows best. ' This is similar to what Ar-Razi stated in his Tafsir, and this is the correct opinion. Allah's statement, *Then the Shaytan made them slip therefrom* either refers to Paradise, and in this case, it means that Shaytan led Adam and Hawwa away from it, as Asim bin Abi An-Najid recited it.' ' It is also possible that this Ayah refers to the forbidden tree. In this case, the Ayah would mean, as Al-Hasan and Qatadah stated, He tripped them. '3 ' In this case, *Then the Shaytan made them slip therefrom* means, Because of the tree, just as Allah said, *It turned aside therefrom* (i.e. from Muhammad jg and the Qur'an) is he who is turned aside (by the decree and preordainment of Allah)} (51:9) meaning, the deviant person becomes turned aside - or slips - from the truth because of so and so reason. This is why then Allah said, *And got them out from that in which they were* meaning, the clothes, spacious dwelling and comfortable sustenance. Tabari 1 :520. 2| Ibn Abi Hatim 1:128. 3| Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :128, 129.

} meaning, dwelling, sustenance and limited life, until the commencement of the Day of Resurrection Adam was very Tall Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Ubayy bin Ka'b said that the Messenger of Allah 3g said, *the snake was sent down to Asbahan.* This was reported by Ibn Abi HatimJ ' Also,

Adam repents and supplicates to Allah It was reported that the above Ayah is explained by Allah's statement, S; J G j jfc Cxi 437. They said: "Our Lord! We have wronged ourselves. If You forgive us not, and bestow not upon us Your mercy, we shall certainly be of the losers") (7:23) as Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Al- Aliyah, Ar-RabT bin Anas, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi, Khalid bin Ma'dan, Ata Al-Khurasani and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam have stated . As-Suddi said that Ibn Abbas commented on, iy# Vi 4Then Adam receivedfrom his Lord Words) Adam said, O Lord! Did You not created me with Your Own Hands? He said, Yes. He said, And blow life into me? He said, Yes. He said, And when I sneezed, You said, May Allah grant you His mercy. Does not Your mercy precede Your anger? He was told, Yes. Adam said, And You destined me to commit this evil act? He was told, Yes. He said, If I repent, will You send me back to Paradise? Allah said, Yes. [21 Similar is reported from Al- Awfi, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Mahad, and Ibn Abbas .

J mm v ' ' * > - 1~- ' mm \j p-j^- lS'j^a C- Xsrk 'Lj\y~**j CP-\S i_yjS2^lj ^ lllli ^ dyuS^Sj}UiL4 rn^l! d.l^fe*jt" ajL^lU ^^'. Ij-. ^.* -'j Af > ^*>/'/i i *^i-'* ., Tafefr Ibn Kathir K returns to Him in repentance. This meaning is similar to Allah's statements, z ^ ii 3 tpj:& 4 nQ % P iAnd whoever does evil or wrongs himselfo (4:110) and sSj jzfr iAnd whosoever repents and does righteous good deeds" (25:71). The Ayat mentioned above, testify to the fact that Allah forgives the sins of whoever repents, demonstrating His kindness and mercy towards His creation and servants. There is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah, the Most Forgiving, the Most Merciful. (U 'fj ftic. i_i>- & iJI'Ia iSXk^ pdbj lili iLfr (. LJS^ i tA~,oj4li t^i jii 4-AA t*UJl tiiG [flsj, \fj& lj "fg.ityjZ iKnow they not that Allah accepts repentance from His servants (9:104), (4lL jl itjX jlZ i38. We said: "Get down all of you from this place (the Paradise), then whenever there comes to you Hudan (guidance) from Me, and whoever follows My guidance, there shall be no fear on than, nor shall they grieve.> 439. But those who disbelieve and belie Our Ayat (proofs, evidences, verses, lessons, signs, revelations, etc.) - such are the dwellers of the Fire. They shall abide therein forever."^

203Siirah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) Allah stated that when He sent Adam, Hawwa , and Shaytan to earth from Paradise, He warned them that He will reveal Books and send Prophets and Messengers to them, i.e., to their offspring. Abu Al- Aliyah said, UAI-Huda, refers to the Prophets, Messengers, the clear signs and plain explanation. iAnd whoever follows My guidance^ meaning, whoever accepts

what is contained in My Books and what I send the Messengers

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 203–209]

with, iThere shall be nofear on them regarding the Hereafter, j*at inor shall they grieve} regarding the life of this world. Similarly, in Surat Ta Ha, Allah said, * iuigP ciit ty% jflpZ CJr L jli> / , ' v> " " * / . "TP aLLa 4He (Allah) said: Get you down (from the Paradise to the earth), both ofyou, together, some ofyou are an enemy to some others. Then if there comes to you guidance from Me, then whoever follows My guidance, he shall neither go astray, nor shall he be distressed.} (20:123) Ibn Abbas commented, He will not be misguided in this life or miserable in the Hereafter. The Ayah, >> t 'S. i iBut whosoever turns away from My Reminder (i.e. neither believes in this Qur'an nor acts on its teachings) verily, for him is a life of hardship, and We shall raise him up blind on the Day of Resurrection .}

(20:124) is similar to what Allah stated here, ^ tV cl.rl - slyjj'j Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :139. 121 AMabari 18:389.

204 Tafsrr Ibn Katlur iBnt those who disbelieve and belie Our Aydt - such are the dwellers of the Fire. They shall abide therein forever}, meaning, they will remain in Hell for eternity and will not find away out of it. (jf>\S jjl Xi * ijkjtj \jpri \$40 4ft ijB % 4 \$ i'jjfe ^ ti tiiai ^ i^iij 4#^). O Children of Israel! Remember My favor which I bestowed upon you, and fulfill (your obligations to) My covenant (with you) so that I fulfill (My obligations to) your covenant (with Me), andfear none but Me.} 442. And believe in what I have sent down (this Qur an), confirming that which is with you (the Tawrah and the Injtl), and be not the first to disbelieve therein, and buy not with My verses (the Tawrah and the Injil) a small price (i.e. getting a small gain by selling My verses), andfearMe andMe alone.} Encouraging the Children ofIsrael to embrace Islam Allah commanded the Children of Israel to embrace Islam and to follow Muhammad jg. He also reminded them with the example of their father Israel, Allah s Prophet Ya'qub, as if saying, O children of the pious, righteous servant of Allah who obeyed Allah! Be like your father, following the truth. This statement is similar to one s saying, O you son of that generous man! Do this or that or, O son of the brave man, engage the strong fighters, or O son of the scholar, seek the knowledge, and so forth. Similarly, Allah said. 40 offspring of those whom We carried (in the ship) with Niih (Noah)! Verily, he was a grateful servant} (17:3). Israel is ProphetYa'qub (Jacob) Israel is Prophet Ya'qab, for

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) Do you know that Israel is Jacob?* They said, Yes, by Allah. He said, "O Allah! Be zoifness." |1!

206 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir Reminding the Children of Israel of Allah s Covenant withThem Allah s statement, iAnd fulfill (your obligations to) My covenant (with you) so that I fulfill (My obligations to) your covenant (with Me),} means, My covenant that I took from you concerning Prophet Muhammad sfe, when he is sent to you, so that I grant you what I promised you ifyou believe in him and follow him. I will then remove the chains and restrictions that were placed around your necks, because of the errors that you committed. 111 Also, Al-Hasan Al-Basri|21 said, The covenant is in reference to Allah s statement, j) iit Jtljj J^c. jLJi. b_Lo_) Sie&l ij-bt : 'm -v ***> <" i sis. t tv ^ tjo 4jipVt^^ tip iln indeed, Allah took the covenant from the Children of Israel (Jews), and We appointed twelve leaders among them. And Allah said: I am ivith you if you perfonn As-Saldh and give Zakdh and believe in My Messengers; honor and assist them, and lend a good loan to Allah, verily, I will expiate your sins and admit you to Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise)} (5:12). Other scholars said, The covenant is what Allah took from them in the Tawrah, in that. He will send a great Prophet - meaning Muhammad aS - from among the offspring of Ismail, who will be obeyed by all peoples. Therefore, whoever obeys him, then Allah will forgive his sins, enter him into Paradise and award him two rewards. We should mention here that Ar- Razi mentioned several cases of information brought by the earlier Prophets regarding the coming of Muhammad Further, Abu Al- Aliyah said that, m At-Jabari 1 : 555& 557. At-Jabari 1 :109.

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) 4And fulfill (your obligations to) My covenant (with you)} means, His covenant with His servants is to embrace Islam and to adhere to it. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said, I fulfill My obligations to you means, 1 (Allah) will be pleased with you and admit you into Paradise.

121 As-Suddi, Ad- Dahhak, Abu Al- Aliyah and Ar-Rabl' bin Anas said similarly. Ibn Abbas said that Allah's statement, 4And fear Me and Me alone.} means, Fear the torment that I might exert on you, just as I did with your fathers, like the mutation, etc. !31 This Ayah contains encouragement, followed by warning. Allah first called the Children of Israel, using encouragement, then He warned them, so that they might return to the Truth, follow the Messenger jg, heed the Qur'an's prohibitions and commands and believe in its content. Surely, Allah guides whom He wills to the straight path. Allah said next, 4And believe in what I have sent down, confirming that which is with you (the Tawrah and the Injil)} meaning, the Qur'an that Allah sent down to Muhammad ag, the unlettered Arab Prophet, as bringer of glad tidings, a Warner and a Light. The Qur'an contains the Truth from Allah and affirms what was revealed beforehand in the Tawrah and the Injil (the Gospel). Abu Al- Aliyah said that Allah's statement, 4And believe in what I have sent down (this Qur'an), confirming that which is with you (the Tawrah and the Injil)} means, O People of the Book! Believe in what I sent down that conforms to what you have. This is because they find the description of Muhammad jg recorded in the Tawrah and the At-Jabari 1 :558. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :143. !3 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :144.

2M Tafstr Ibn Kathir Injil. Similar statements were attributed to Mujahid, Ar-Rabl bin Anas and Qatadah. Allah said, 4-a j/fc Jj* "jj} 4and be not the first to disbelieve therein}. Ibn Abbas commented, Do not become the first to disbelieve in the Qur'an (or Muhammad jg), while you have more knowledge in it than other people. 121 Abu Al- Aliyah commented, Do not become the first to disbelieve in Muhammad, meaning from among the People of the Book, after you hear that he was sent as a Prophet. * Similar statements were attributed to Al-Hasan, As-Suddi and Ar-Rabl bin Anas. * Ibn Jarir stated that the Ayah (disbelieve therein 2:41) refers to the Qur'an, mentioned earlier in the Ayah, iin what I have sent down (this Qur'an),} Both statements are correct because they are inter-related. For instance, whoever disbelieves in the Qur'an will have disbelieved in Muhammad's, and whoever disbelieves in Muhammad will have disbelieved in the Qur'an. Allah's statement, ft Jjfa 4thefirst to disbelieve therein} means, do not become the first among the Children of Israel to disbelieve in it, for there were people from Quraysh and the Arabs in general who rejected Muhammad's before the People of the Book disbelieved in him. We should state here that the Ayah is talking about the Children of Israel in specific, because the Jews in Al-Madlnah were the first among the Children of Israel to be addressed by the Qur'an. Hence, their disbelief in the Qur'an means that they were the first among the People of the Book to disbelieve in it. *** Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :145. 121 Ibid. Ibid. 141 Ibid.

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) Allah's statement, 04 O' iand buy not with My verses a small price,} means, Do not substitute faith in My Ayat and belief in My Prophet with the life of this world and its lusts which are minute and bound to end. Allah said, iand have Taqwa of Me and Me alone}. Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Talq bin Habib said, Taqwa is to work in Allah's obedience, on a light from Allah, hoping in Allah's mercy, and to avoid Allah's disobedience, on a light from Allah, fearing Allah's punishment. 1 11 Allah's statement, OPi (fj} iandfearMe andMe alone} means, that Allah warns the People of the Book against intentionally hiding the truth and spreading the opposite of it, as well as, against defying the Messenger jg. ijyi iyiv> iji-jVj yj} 442. And mix not truth with falsehood, nor conceal the truth while you know (the truth).} i43. And perform As-Salatl, and give Zakdh, and bozo down along with Ar-Raki'in .}

The Prohibition of hiding the Truth and distorting It

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 209–249]

with Falsehood Allah forbade the Jews from intentionally distorting the truth with falsehood and from hiding the truth and spreading falsehood, iAnd mix not truth with falsehood, nor conceal the truth while you know (the truth)}. So Allah forbade them from two things; He ordered them to make the truth known, as well as explaining it. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas mentioned the Ayah, i0t J&' IjjE iAtid mix not truth with falsehood} and said; Do not mix the truth with falsehood and the facts with lies. Qatadah said that, <-3**j * 'j }Atid mix not truth with falsehood} means, Do not mix Judaism and Christianity with Islam, iwhile you know (the truth).} that the religion of Allah is Islam, and that Judaism and Christianity are innovations that did not come from Allah. 121 It was reported that Al-Hasan Al-Basri said similarly.131 Also, Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Ibn Abbas said that, inor conceal the truth while you know (the truth).} means, Do not hide the knowledge that you have of My Messengerandwhathe was sent with. His description, whichyou know about, canbe found written in the Books thatyou have. 141 It is possible that it means, ..although you know the tremendous harm that this evil will cause people, misguiding them and leading them to the Fire, because they will follow the falsehood that you mixed with the truth in your claims. jyfcj *jW }ji*~Aj} iAnd perform As-Salat and give Zakah, and bow down along with Ar-Rdki'in.} At-Tabari 1 :569. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :147. 131 Ibid. 141 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:148.

Slira!i 2. Al-Bnqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) 211 Muqatil said, Allah s statement to the People of the Book, iAtid perform As-Saldhy commands them to perform the prayer behind the Prophet sg, iand give Zakdh commands them to pay the Zakah to the Prophet and iand bcnv dozen along zoith Ar-Raki'fn commands them to bow down with those who bow down among the Ummah of Muhammad jfe. Allah therefore commands the People of the Book to be with, and among the Ummah of Muhammad In addition, Allah s statement, iAnd bow dozen along with Ar-Raki'in) means, And be among the believers performing the best deeds they perform, such as, and foremost, the prayer. Many scholars said that this Ayah (2:43) is proof for the obligation of performing the prayer in congregation (for men only). I will explain this ruling in detail in Kitab Al-Ahkam Al-Kabir, Allah willing. v^SJ' ojiii jjC J-U)' oJyQ^ i44. Enjoin you Al-Birr (piety and righteousness and every act of obedience to Allah) on the people and you forget (to practise it) yourselves, while you recite the Scripture (TawraJt))! Have you then no sense? The Condemnation of commanding Others to observe Righteousness while ignoring Righteousness Allah said, How is it, O People of the Book, that you command people to perform Al-Birr, which encompasses all types of righteousness, yet forget yourselves and do not heed what you call others to? And you read Allah s Book (the m Al-Kashaf 1 :133.

Tawrah) and know what it promises to those who do not fulfill Allah s commandments. iHave you then no sense?} of what you are doing to yourselves, so that you might become aware ofyour slumber and restore your sight from blindness? Abdur-Razzdq said that Ma'mar stated that Qatadah commented on Allah s statement, iEnjoin you Al-Birr (piety and righteousness and every act of obedience to Allah) on the people and you forget (to practise it) yourselves,} The Children of Israel used to command people to

obey Allah, fear Him and perform Al-Birr. Yet, they contradicted these orders, so Allah reminded them of this fact. As-Suddi said similarly. Ibn Jurayj said that the Ayah iEnjoin you Al-Birr on the people Is about the People of the Book and the hypocrites. They used to command people to pray and fast. However, they did not practice what they commanded others. Allah reminded them of this behavior. So whoever commands people to do righteousness, let him be among the first of them to implement that command. 121 Also, Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Ibn Abbas said that, j} 4And you forget yourselves,} means, You forget to practice it yourselves, iWhile you recite the Scripture (Tawrah)! Have you then no sense?} You forbid the people from rejecting the prophethood and the 111 Abdur-Razzaq 1 :44.Tabari 2 :8

covenant that you have mentioned with you in the Tawrah, while you yourselves have forgotten it, meaning that you have forgotten the covenant that I made with you that you will accept My Messenger. You have breached My covenant, and rejected what you know is in My Book. Therefore, Allah admonished the Jews for this behavior and alerted them to the wrongs that they were perpetrating against themselves by ordering righteousness, yet refraining themselves from righteousness. We should state that Allah is not criticizing the People of the Book for ordering righteousness, because enjoining good is a part of righteousness and is an obligation for the scholars. However, the scholar is himself required to heed, and adhere to, what he invites others to. For instance, Prophet Shu'ayb said, Cj i&J c - W it Z j; 3 '4 %} 41 wish not, in contradiction to you, to do that which I forbid you. I only desire reform to the best of my power. And my guidance cannot come except from Allah, in Him I trust and unto Him I repent} (11:88). Therefore, enjoining righteousness and performing righteousness are both required. Neither category is rendered not necessary by the practice of the other, according to the most correct view of the scholars among the Salaf (predecessors) and the Khalaf.'21 Imam Ahmad reported that Abu Wa il said, While I was riding behind Usamah, he was asked, Why not advise Uthman? He said, *Do you think that if 1 advise him I should allow you to hear it? 1 advise him in secret, and I will not start something that I would hate to be the first to start. I will not say to a man, *You are the best man, even if he was my leader, after what I heard from the Messenger of Allah j&. They said, What did he say? He said, T heard him say, A-list (jixis jlill t, "L 2:7. ^ The scholars who came after the first three generations of Islam

Jl jjJj A-jT 'Jj L_jjytliL C-iS : J ,jP A man will be brought on the Day of Resurrection and thrown in the Fire. His intestines will fall out and he will continue circling pulling them behind him, just as the donkey goes around the pole. The people of the Fire will go to that man and ask him, 'What happened to you? Did you not used to command us to do righteous acts and forbid us from committing evil?' He will say, 'Yes. I used to enjoin righteousness, but refrained from performing righteousness, and I used to forbid you to perform from evil while 1 myself did it This Hadith was also recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim. Also, Ibrahim An-Nakha*i said, I hesitate in advising people because of three Ayat. A'f^ Jf. AEnjoin you Al-Birr on the people and you forget (to practise it) yourselves}.

^ Art prli . And seek help in patience and As-Saltdt (the prayer) and truly, it is extremely heavy and hard except for Al-Khdshi'in .} (They are those) who are certain that they are going to meet their Lord, and that unto Him they are going to return .} The Support that comes with Patience and Prayer Allah commanded His servants to use patience and prayer to acquire the good of this life and the Hereafter.

Muqatil bin Hayyan said that this Ayah means, Utilize patience and the obligatory prayer in seeking the Hereafter. As for patience (here), they say that it means fasting. 111 There are similar texts reported from Mujahid. Al-Qurtubi and other scholars commented, This is why Ramadan is called the month of patience,"121 as is mentioned in the Hadith literature. It was also said that patience in the Ayah means, refraining from evil, and this is why patience was mentioned along with practicing acts of worship, especially and foremost, the prayer. Also, Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Umar bin Al-Khattab said, There are two types of patience: good patience when the disaster strikes, and a better patience while avoiding the prohibitions of Allah. Ibn Abi Hatim said that Al-Hasan Al-Basri was reported to have said similarly.131 Allah then said, iAnd As-Salah (the prayer).} The prayer is one of the best means of assistance for firmly adhering to Allah's orders, just as Allah said; 2 ykiJi J T\ j) Z 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :154. Al-Qurtubi 1 :372 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :155.

iRecite (O Muhammad jgj what has been revealed to you of the Book (the Qur'an), and perform As-Saldh. Verily, As-Saldh (the prayer) prevents from Al-Fahshd' (i.e. great sins of every kind), and Al-Munkar and the remembrance of (praising) of (you by) Allah is greater indeed (29:45). The personal pronoun in the Ayah, 4 1P 4And truly, it is extremely heavy and hard^ refers to prayer, as Mujahid is reported to have said, and it was also the choice of Ibn Jarir. It is possible that the pronoun might be referring to the advice - to observe patience and the prayer - mentioned in the same Ayah. Similarly, Allah said about Qarun (Korah), Vj jj J*. Jif L>\y pji iBut those who had been given (religious) knowledge said: "Woe to you! The reward of Allah (in the Hereafter) is better for those who believe and do righteous good deeds, and this, none shall attain except As-Sabirun (the patient)."> (28:80). Also, Allah said, /CK ij'Jc ifjJ' Ijji J is jS Sy-'i jp. vi \ % iThe good deed and the evil deed cannot be equal. Repel (the evil) with one which is better than verily he, between whom and you there was enmity, (will become) as though he was a close friend. But none is granted it (the above quality) except those who are patient - and none is granted it except the owner of the great portion (of happiness in the Hereafter and) in this world. (41:34-35) meaning, this advice is only implemented by those who are patient and the fortunate. In any case, Allah's statement here means, prayer is heavy and burdensome, iexcept for Al-Khashi'in .\$.>

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) Ibn Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on this Ayah, They (Al-Khashi'in) are those who believe in what Allah has revealed. ' Allah's statement, iThey are those who are certain that they are going to meet their Lord, and that unto Him they are going to return . continues the subject that was started in the previous Ayah. Therefore, the prayer, or the advice to observe it is heavy, 4except for Al-Khashi'in. (They are those) xoho are certain (Yazunnuna) that they are going to meet their Lord,} meaning, they know that they will be gathered and face their Lord on the Day of Resurrection, \ iand that unto Him they are going to return .} meaning, their affairs are all subject to His will and He justly decides what He wills. Since they are certain that they will be returned to Allah and be reckoned, it is easy for them to perform the acts of obedience and refrain from the prohibitions. Ibn Jarir commented on Allah's statement; 4Yazunnuna that they are going to meet their Lord} Ibn Jarir said; The Arabs call certainty as well as doubt, Zann. There are similar instances in the Arabic language where a subject as well as its opposite share the same name. For instance, Allah said, i&sQy jL)' \1jf} iAnd the Mujrimiin (criminals, polytheists, sinners), shall see the Fire and Zannu

(apprehend) that they have to fall therein}:53). It is recorded in the Sahih that on the Day of Resurrection, IM At-Tabari 2:16.

218 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Allah will say to a servant, Have I not allowed you to marry, honored you, made the horses and camels subservient to you and allowed you to become a chief and a master? He will say, Yes. Allah will say, Did you have Zann (think) that you will meet Me? He will say, No. Allah will say, This Day, I will forget you, just as you forgot Me. ^ If Allah wills, we will further elaborate on this subject when we explain Allah s statement, ijiiey haveforgotten Allah, so He has forgotten them (9:67). 447. O Children of Israel! Remember My favor which I bestowed upon you and that I preferred you over the Alamin (nations)} Reminding the Children of Israel that They were preferred above the Other Nations Allah reminds the Children of Israel of the favors that He granted their fathers and grandfathers, how He showed preference to them by sending them Messengers from among them and revealing Books to them, more so than any of the other previous nations. Similarly, Allah said, 4And We chose them (the Children of Israel) over the 'Alamin, (nations) with knowledge.} (44:32) and, fdl ' i 3%. i; r - JU" k&'j* J v* J jy i.K'j&X && p b p&j 4And (remember) when Miisd (Moses) said to his people: "O my people! Retnember thefavor ofAllah to you : when He made Prophets among you, made you kings, honored you above the 'Alamin (nations)."} (5:20). Abu JaYar Ar-Razi reported that Ar-Rabl bin Anas said that 4:2279.

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) Abu Al- Aliyah said that Allah s statement, iand that l preferred you over the 'Alamin> means, The kingship, Messengers and Books that were granted to them, instead of granting such to the other kingdoms that existed during their time, for every period there is a nation.)1 ' It was also reported that Mujahid, Ar-Rabl bin Anas, Qatadah and Ismail bin Abi Khalid said similarly. 121 The Ummah of Muhammad jg is Better than the Children of Israel This is the only way the Ayah can be understood, because this Ummah is better than theirs, as Allah said; j j3 &xl jjj 4You are the best of people ever raised up for mankind; you enjoin good and forbid evil, and you believe in Allah. And had the People of the Book (Jews and Christians) believed, it would have been betterfar them> (3:1 10). Also, the Musnad and Sunan Collections of Hadith recorded that Mu awiyah bin Haydah Al-Qushayri said that the Messenger of Allah said, pi Ji- lfrjVj U Jfa -J\ Vow (Muslims) are the seventieth nation, but you are the best and most honored ofthem according to Allah. "|3 There are many Hadiths on this subject, and they will be mentioned when we discuss Allah s statement, pi > iYou are the best of peoples ever raised up for mankind (3:110). p% 3s ft \$ tiii ft& ij i ft At-Tabari 2 :24 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:158. Ahmad 5 :3 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :352 , and Ibn Majah 2 :1433

448. And fear a Day (of Judgement) when a person shall not avail another, nor will intercession be accepted from him, nor will compensation be taken from him, nor will they be helped.} After Allah reminded the Children of Israel of the favors that He has granted them, He warned them about the duration of the torment which He will punish them with on the Day of Resurrection. He said, y. \$Andfear a Day} meaning, the Day of Resurrection, iWhen a person shall not avail another} meaning, on that Day, no person shall be ofany help to another. Similarly, Allah said, iAnd no bearer ofburdens shall bear another's burden} (35:18) & W*. rri iEvery man that Day will have enough to make him careless of others.} (80:37) and. o* & is pS 8 J-ti 40 mankind! Have Taqwd of your Lord (by keeping your duty to Him and avoiding all evil), and fear a Day when no father can avail aught for his son, nor a

son avail aught for his father} (31:33). This indeed should serve as a great warning that both the father and the son will not be of help to each other on that Day. Neither Intercession, Ransom, or Assistance will be accepted on behalf of the Disbelievers Allah said,

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) inor will intercession be accepted from him} meaning, from the disbelievers. Similarly, Allah said, 4So no intercession of intercessors will be of any use to them} (74:48) and described the people of the Fire saying, # 0 &} iNow we have no intercessors. Nor a close friend (to help us)} (26:100-101). Allah's statement here (2:48) ite^Q y,} inor will compensation be taken from him} means, that Allah does not accept the disbelievers to ransom themselves. Similarly, Allah said, t\$ i Vg <\$ l{ } iVerily, those who disbelieved, and died while they were disbelievers, the (whole) earth full of gold will not be accepted from anyone of them even if they offered it as a ransom (3:91) Ji i b >*" . /iS-iJ ijgjR j. d J \fjzj==> cyji iVerily, those who disbelieve, if they had all that is in the earth, and as much again therewith to ransom themselves from the torment on the Day of Resurrection, it would never be accepted of them, and theirs would be a painful torment> (5:36) iQi ii-jj V ijjc jkas> j_)2 ^ff} iAnd even if he offers every ransom, it will not be accepted from him} (6:70) and, iSo this Day no ransom shall be taken from you (hypocrites), nor of those who disbelieved. Your abode is the Fire. That is your Mawla (friend - proper place)} (57:15).

Allah stated that if the people do not believe in His Messenger jg and follow what He sent him with, then when they meet Him on the Day of Resurrection, after remaining on the path of disbelief, their family lineage and/or the intercession of their masters will not help them at all. It will not be accepted of them, even if they paid the earth's fill of gold as ransom. Similarly, Allah said, \ * ""*_* ij-? * a*T 4Before a Day comes when there will be no bargaining, nor friendship, twr intercession} (2:254) and, 4on which there will be neither mutual bargaining nor befriending (19:31). Allah's statement next, inor will they be helped.} means, no person shall get angry - or anxious - on their behalf and offer them any help, or try to save them from Allah's punishment. As stated earlier on that Day, neither the relative, nor persons of authority will feel pity for the disbelievers, nor will any ransom be accepted for them. Consequently, they will receive no help from others and they will be helpless themselves. Allah said, 4 vj %} iWhile He (Allah) grants refuge (or protection), but none grants refuge from Him} (23:88) 4So on that Day none will punish as He will punish. And none will bind (the wicked, disbelievers and polytheists) as He will bind} (89:25-26) jrT fj? > if- 4"What is the matter with you? Why do you not help one another (as you used to do in the world)? Nay, but that Day they shall surrender} (37:25-26) and,

Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) iThen why did those whom they had taken for dliyah (gods) besides Allah, as a way of approach (to Allah) not help them? Nay, but they vanished completely from them> (46:28). Also, Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said that Allah's statement, v j3 4"What is the matter with you? Why do you not help one another?"} (37:25) means, This Day, you shall not have a refuge from Us. Not this Day. 1 11 Ibn Jarir said that Allah's statement, a inuigii V, ^j;-fe5 piuj4 p-4=Llj1 Cgty 3^ i]j *' ,Zt " " 'C\ 'A t > |i . *. - ^JKfa > ^pS L"Jp {jp Jfcil I^ssCXp(s.ill"J f]p ^ Ojilkapj - flit iTyJLbUj \$&jj inor will they be helped.} meaning, on that Day, they shall neither be helped by any helper, nor shall anyone intercede on their behalf. No repeal or ransom will be accepted for them, all courtesy towards them will have ceased, along with any helpful intercession. No type of help or cooperation will

be available for them on that Day. The judgment will, on that Day, be up to the Most Great, the Most Just, against whom no intercessor or helper can ever assist. He will then award the evil deed its kind and will multiply the good deeds. This is similar to Allah's statement, IM At-Tabari 2 :36

But stop them, verily, they are to be questioned. "What is the matter with you? Why do you not help one another?" Nay, but that Day they shall surrender (37:24-26).¹¹¹ And (remember) when We delivered you from Fir'awn's (Pharaoh) people, who were afflicting you with a horrible torment, killing your sons and sparing your women, and therein was a mighty trial from your Lord 450. And (remember) when We separated the sea for you and saved you and drowned Fir'awn's (Pharaoh) people while you were watching. The Children of Israel were saved from Pharaoh and His Army Who drowned Allah said to the Children of Israel, Remember My favor on you 4"3" if * > * ffcyjr-i J' 4 And (remember) when We delivered you from Fir'awn's (Pharaoh) people, who were afflicting you with a horrible torment, \$ meaning, I - Allah - saved you from them and delivered you from their hands in the company of Musa, after they subjected you to horrible torture. This favor came after the cursed Pharaoh had a dream in which he saw a fire emerge from Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem), and then the fire entered the houses of the Copts in Egypt, with the exception of the Children of Israel. Its purport was that his kingship would be toppled by a man among the Children of Israel. It was also said that some of Pharaoh's entourage said that the Children of Israel were expecting a man among them to arise who would establish a state for them. We will mention the Hadith on this subject |i| At-Tabari 2 :35

Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) when we explain Surat Ta Ha (20), Allah willing. After the dream, Pharaoh ordered that every newborn male among the Children of Israel be killed and that the girls be left alone. He also commanded that the Children of Israel be given tasks of hard labor and assigned the most humiliating jobs. The torment here refers to killing the male infants. In Surat Ibrahim (14) this meaning is clearly mentioned, jppj ppAP> iWho were afflicting you with horrible torment, and were slaughtering your sons and letting your women live.} (14:6). We will explain this Ayah in the beginning of Surat Al-Qasas (28), Allah willing, and our reliance and trust are with Him.

The meaning of, iP-APt iwho toere afflicting you} is, They humiliated you, as Abu Ubaydah stated. It was also said that it means, They used to exaggerate in tormenting you according to Al-Qurtubi. As for Allah saying, 4cpP iAPPpU spi;} i killing your sons and sparing your women} that explains His statement, 4y'Ju!" yppAPi iwho were afflicting you with horrible torment} then it explains the meaning of the favor He gave them, as mentioned in His statement, i p pA\p jAn iRemember My favor which I bestowed upon you}. As for what Allah said in Surat Ibrahim, iP pA. pAP'vi iAnd remind them of the annals of Allah} (14:5) meaning, the favors and blessing He granted them, He then said, iWho were afflicting you with horrible torment, and were

226 Tafstr Ibn Kathir slaughtering your sons and letting your women live.} (14:6) So Allah mentioned saving their children from being slaughtered in order to remind them of the many favors that He granted them. We should state here that Pharaoh (Fir'awn) is a title that was given to every disbelieving king who ruled Egypt, whether from the Amallq (Canaanites) or otherwise, just as Caesar (Qaysar) is the title of the disbelieving kings who ruled Rome and Damascus. Also, Khosrau (Kisra) is the title of the kings who ruled Persia, while Tubb'a is the title of the kings of Yemen, and the kings of Abyssinia

(Ethiopia) were called Negus (An-Najashi). Allah said, *And therein was a mighty trial from your Lord.* Ibn Jarir commented that this part of the Ayah means, Our saving your fathers from the torment that they suffered by the hand of Pharaoh, is a great blessing from your Lord. ! * We should mention that in the blessing there is a test, the same as with hardship, for Allah said, *And We shall make a trial of you with evil and with good* (21:35) and, *And We tried them with good (blessings) and evil (calamities) in order that they might turn (to obey Allah.)* (7:168). Allah's statement next, *And (remember) when We separated the sea for you and saved you and drowned Fir'aun's (Pharaoh) people while you were watching* means, After We saved you from Fir'aun and you escaped with Musa; Fir'aun went out in your pursuit and We parted (il At-Tabari 2 :48

Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) the sea for you. Allah mentioned this story in detail, as we will come to know, Allah willing. One of the shortest references to this story is Allah's statement, *And saved you* meaning, We saved you from them, drowning them while you watched, bringing relief to your hearts and humiliation to your enemy. Fasting the Day of Ashura It was reported that the day the Children of Israel were saved from Fir'aun was called the day of Ashura. Imam Ahmad reported that Ibn Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah came to Al-Madina and found that the Jews were fasting the day of Ashura. He asked them, What is this day that you fast? They said, This is a good day during which Allah saved the Children of Israel from their enemy, and Musa used to fast this day. The Messenger of Allah *s*fe said, "I have more right to Musa than you *luive.o* So the Messenger of Allah *j*fe fasted that day and ordered that it be fasted. This Hadith was collected by Al-Bukhari, Muslim, An-Nasa'i and Ibn Majah. [1] *t < f f* "j ' / * /w ^ s ^ aIJ 3T OJ filial uiij'i -W Cjt 451.* And (remember) when We appointed for Miisd (Moses) forty nights, and (in his absence) you took the calf (for ivorship), and you were Zalimun (polytheists and wrongdoers) .> 452. Then after that We forgave you so that you might be grateful.} 453. And (remember) *ivhen* We gave Musa the Scripture (the Tawrdlt)) and the criterion (of right and wrong) so that you Ahmad 1 :291, Fath Al-Bari 4 :287, Muslim 2 :796, An-Nasa'i in At-Kubrd 2 :157, and Ibn Majah 1 :553.

228 Tafstr Ibn Kathir may be guided aright.} The Children of Israel worshipped the Calf Allah then said, Remember My favor on you when I forgave you for worshipping the calf. This happened after Musa went to the meeting place with his Lord at the end of that period which was forty days. These forty days were mentioned in Surat Al-A'raf when Allah said, *And We appointed for Musa thirty nights and added (to the period) ten (more)* (7:142). It was said that these days were during the month of Dhul- Qa'dah plus the first ten days in Dhul-Hijjah, after the Children of Israel were delivered from Fir'aun and they safely crossed the sea. Allah's statement, *iss Lyi iAnd (remember) when We gave Musa the Scripture* means, the Tawrah, *iXM*} *iAnd the criterion* that is that which differentiates between truth and falsehood, guidance and deviation. *fa*} *iSo that you may be guided aright*}, after escaping the sea, as another Ayah in Surat Al-A'raf clearly stated, *And indeed We gave Musa - after We *Imd* destroyed the generations of old - the Scripture (the Tawrah) as an enlightenment for mankind, and a guidance and a mercy, that they might remember (or receive admonition)* (28:43). *dl IjSji* j*")' ffi&A syi -**_>) >\f*} *ji ft* (Mfa tfS 454. And (remember) when Musa said to his people: "O my

Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1 people! Verily, you have wronged yourselves by worshipping the calf. So turn in repentance to your Creator and kill yourselves (the innocent kill the wrongdoers among you),

that will be better for you with your Creator." Then He accepted your repentance. Truly, He is the One Who accepts repentance, the Most Merciful. } The Children of Israel kill each other in Repentance This was the repentance required from the Children of Israel for worshipping the calf. Commenting on Allah's statement; iAnd (remember) when Musa said to his people: O my people! Verily, you have wronged yourselves by worshipping the calf...}, Al- Hasan Al-Basri said, When their hearts thought of worshipping the calf, AAii \Hj-j p ijls ijii Ji Ijljj Jai- iAnd when they regretted and saw that they had gone astray, they (repented and) said : "If our Lord does not have mercy upon us and forgive us"} (7:149). This is when Musa said to them. pm pi iO my people! Verily, you have wronged yourselves by worshipping the calf...}.' Abu Al- Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr and Ar-Rabi bin Anas commented on. iSo turn in repentance to your Bari'} that it means, To your Creator. 121 Allah's statement, iTo your Bari' (Creator)} alerts the Children of Israel to the enormity of their error and means, Repent to He Who created you after you associated others with Him in worship.

saying, Allah told the Children of Israel that their repentance would be to slay by the sword every person they meet, be he father or son. They should not care whom they kill. Those were guilty whom Musa and Harun were not aware of their guilt, they admitted their sin and did as they were ordered. So Allah forgave both the killer and the one killed. * This is part of the HacLith about the trials that we will mention in Surat Ta Ha, (20) Allah willing. Ibn Jarir narrated that Ibn Abbas said, Musa said to his people, k4-# ji ft yC i*p pi -p2u\ ijSS 4" So turn in repentance to your Creator and kill each other (the innocent kill the wrongdoers among you), that will be better for you with your Creator. Then He accepted your repentance. Truly, He is the One Who accepts repentance, the Most Merciful.} Allah ordered Musa to command his people to kill each other. He ordered those who worshipped the calf to sit down and those who did not worship the calf to stand holding knives in their hands. When they started killing them, a great darkness suddenly overcame them. After the darkness lifted, they had killed seventy thousand of them. Those who were killed among them were forgiven, and those who remained alive were also forgiven. And (remember) when you said: "O Musa! We shall never believe in you until we see Allah plainly. But you were seized with a bolt of lightning while you were looking}. Then We raised you up after your death, so that you might be grateful.} 111 An-Nasab in Al-Kubra 6 :404 , At-Tabari 18 :306, and Ibn Abi Hatim At-Tabari 2:73.

Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) The Best among the Children of Israel ask to see Allah; their subsequent Death and Resurrection Allah said, Remember My favor on you for resurrecting you after you were seized with lightning when you asked to see Me directly, which neither you nor anyone else can bear or attain. This was said by Ibn Jurayj. Ibn Abbas said that the Ayah iAnd (remember) when you said: "O Miisa ! We shall never believe in you until we see Allah plainly/> means, Publicly , 111 So that we gaze at Allah. 121 Also, Tirmidhi bin Ruwaym said that Allah's statement, iWhile you were looking means, Some of them were struck with lightning while others were watching. 131 Allah resurrected those, and struck the others with lightning. As-Suddi commented on, iBut you were seized with a bolt of lightning saying; They died, and Musa stood up crying and supplicating to Allah, O Lord! What should I say to the Children of Israel when I go back to them after You destroyed the best of them, it ill& C & it ci*. if it had been Your will, You could have destroyed them and me before; would You destroy us for the deeds of the foolish ones among us?y Allah revealed to Musa that these seventy men were among those who worshipped the calf. Afterwards, Allah brought them back to life one man at a time, while the rest

of them were watching how Allah was bringing them back to life. That is why Allah said, *Then We raised you up after your death, so that you might be grateful*. At-Tabari 2 :81 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :170. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:172.

Ar-Rabi bin Anas said, Death was their punishment, and they were resurrected after they died so they could finish out their lives. Qatadah said similarly.[^] Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented on this Ayah, *Musa returned from meeting with his Lord carrying the Tablets on which He wrote the Tawrah. He found that they had worshipped the calf in his absence. Consequently, he commanded them to kill themselves, and they complied, and Allah forgave them. He said to them, These Tablets have Allah's Book, containing what He commanded you and what He forbade for you. They said, Should we believe this statement because you said it? By Allah, we will not believe until we see Allah in the open, until He shows us Himself and says: This is My Book, therefore, adhere to it. Why does He not talk to us as He talked to you, O, Musa? Then he (Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd) recited Allah's statement, *We shall never believe in you until we see Allah plainly* and said, So Allah's wrath fell upon them, a thunderbolt struck them, and they all died. Then Allah brought them back to life after He killed them. Then he (Abdur-Rahman) recited Allah's statement, *Then We raised you up after your death, so that you might be grateful*}, and said, Musa said to them, Take the Book of Allah. They said, No. He said, What is the matter with you? They said, The problem is that we died and came back to life. He said, Take the Book of Allah. They said, No. So Allah sent some angels who made the mountain topple over them. 131 This shows that the Children of Israel were required to fulfill the commandments after they were brought back to life. However, Al-Mawardi said that there are two opinions about this matter. The first opinion is that since the Children of Israel were brought back to life, they were required to fulfill the commandments. The second opinion states that they were required to adhere to the commandments, so that no responsible adult is free of such responsibilities. Al-Qurtubi said that this is what is correct, because, he said, although the Children of Israel witnessed these tremendous calamities and incidents, that did not mean that they were not responsible for fulfilling the commandments any more. Rather they are responsible for that, and this is clear. Allah knows best. (i u oi [fX* cSjtil) cP! Uj [di\ V?& i57. And We shaded you with clouds and sent down on you Al-Manna and the quail, (saying): "Eat of the good lawful things We have provided for you, (but they rebelled). And they did not wrong Us but they wronged themselves. The Shade, the Manna and the Quail After Allah mentioned the calamities that He saved the Children of Israel from, He mentioned the favors that He granted them, saying, *And We shaded you with clouds*}. This Ayah mentions the white clouds that provided shade for the Children of Israel, protecting them from the sun's heat during their years of wandering. In the Hadith about the trials,*

Israel witnessed these miracles, they were compelled to believe, so they did not have to fulfill the commandments. The second opinion states that they were required to adhere to the commandments, so that no responsible adult is free of such responsibilities. Al-Qurtubi said that this is what is correct, because, he said, although the Children of Israel witnessed these tremendous calamities and incidents, that did not mean that they were not responsible for fulfilling the commandments any more. Rather they are responsible for that, and this is clear. Allah knows best. (i u oi [fX* cSjtil) cP! Uj [di\ V?& i57. And We shaded you with clouds and sent down on you Al-Manna and the quail, (saying): "Eat of the good lawful things We have provided for you, (but they rebelled). And they did not wrong Us but they wronged themselves. The Shade, the Manna and the Quail After Allah mentioned the calamities that He saved the Children of Israel from, He mentioned the favors that He granted them, saying, *And We shaded you with clouds*}. This Ayah mentions the white clouds that provided shade for the Children of Israel, protecting them from the sun's heat during their years of wandering. In the Hadith about the trials,

sun. 1 11 Ibn Jarir said that several scholars said that the type of cloud the Ayah mentioned, was cooler and better than the type we know. 121 Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah's statement, *And sent down on you Al-Manna*>, The manna used to descend to them to the trees, and they used to eat whatever they wished of it. Also, Qatadah said, The manna, which was whiter than milk and sweeter than honey, used to rain down on the Children of Israel, just as the snow falls, from

dawn until sunrise. One of them would collect enough for that particular day, for if it remained more than that, it would spoil. On the sixth day, Friday, one would collect enough for the sixth and the seventh day, which was the Sabbath during which one would not leave home to seek his livelihood, or for anything else. All this occurred in the wilderness. 131 The type of manna that we know provides sufficient food when eaten alone, because it is nutritious and sweet. When manna is mixed with water, it becomes a sweet drink. It also changes composition when mixed with other types of food. However, this is not the only type. The evidence to this fact is that

Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) Allah jg said, ,j* j*^Jl ^ja "ILi t\$jj & lj* o^AJUIt The 'Ajwah (pressed, dried date) is from Paradise and it cures poison, Al-Kam'ah (truffles) is a form of manna, and its liquid heals the eye."*

4 Eat of the provision of your Lord, and be grateful to Him (34 :15). Yet, the Children of Israel rebelled, disbelieved and committed injustice against themselves, even though they saw the clear signs, tremendous miracles and extraordinary events.

The Virtue of Muhammad's Companions over the Companions of all Other Prophets Here it is important to point out the virtue of Muhammad's Companions over the companions of the other Prophets. This includes firmness in the religion, patience and the lack of arrogance, may Allah be pleased with them. Although the Companions accompanied the Prophet jg in his travels and battles, such as during the battle of Tabuk, in intense heat and hardship, they did not ask for a miracle, though this was easy for the Prophet^ by Allah's leave. And when the Companions became hungry, they merely asked the Prophet jg - to invoke Allah - for an increase in the amount of food. They collected whatever food they had and brought it to the Prophet sg, and he asked Allah to bless it, told each of them to take some food, and they filled every pot they had. Also, when they needed rain, the Prophet jg asked Allah to send down rain, and a rain cloud came. They drank, gave water to their camels and filled their water skins. When they looked around, they found that the cloud had only rained on their camp. This is the best example of those who were willing to accept Allah's decision and follow the Messenger of Allah sg. Ijljj lijkl ijijij Ijly j&Li Gii sjfc ji- Jjk-j j 4L. 4 iyf VLj !i-W b*-' 458. And (remember) when We said: "Enter this town (Jerusalem) and eat bountifully therein with pleasure and delight wherever you wish, and enter the gate in prostration (or bowing with humility) and say: 'Forgive us,' and We shall forgive you your sins and shall increase (reward) for the good-doers 459. But those who did wrong changed the word from Hurt which had been told to them for another, so We sent upon the wrongdoers Rijz (a punishment) from the heaven because of

Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) their rebellion.} The Jews were Rebellious instead of Appreciative when They gained Victory Allah admonished the Jews for avoiding Jihad and not entering the holy land as they had been ordered to do when they came from Egypt with MOsa. They were also commanded to fight the disbelieving Amallq (Canaanites) dwelling in the holy land at that time. But they did not want to fight, because they were weak and exhausted. Allah punished them by causing them to become lost, and to continue wandering, as Allah has stated in Surat Al-Ma'idah (5). The correct opinion about the meaning of, the holy land mentioned here is that it was Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem), as As-Suddi, Ar-Rabl bin Anas, 1 Qatadah and Abu Muslim Al-Asfahani, as well as others have stated. Musa said, (Jcl J jlT jrj? yi. * ' r JyLLii yicrS iiiUu SU i JitoiSiL>{^piSsj J [y\ ="j ' liU i 4l4y jft& Jf s^saf AVr t 3 iO

people! Enter the holy land which Allah has assigned to you and turn not back (in flight).} (5:2 1) However, some scholars said that the holy land is Jericho, Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 18 1 121 Ar-Razi 3:82.

(Ariha) and this opinion was mentioned from Ibn Abbas and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd. After the years of wandering ended forty years later, in the company of Yuwsha* (Joshua) bin Nun, Allah allowed the Children of Israel to conquer the holy land on the eve of a Friday. On that day, the sun was kept from setting for a little more time, until victory was achieved. When the Children of Israel conquered the holy land, they were commanded to enter its gate while, 4prostrating^ in appreciation to Allah for making them victorious, triumphant, returning them to their land and saving them from being lost and wandering. Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said that, iattd enter the gate Sujjadan} means, While bowing . 11 ' Ibn Jarir reported Ibn Abbas saying, iand enter the gate in prostration} means, Through a small door while bowing. Al-Hakim narrated it, and Ibn Abi Hatim added, And they went through the door backwards! Al-Hasan Al- Basri said that they were ordered to prostrate on their faces when they entered the city, but Ar-Razi discounted this explanation. It was also said that the Sujud mentioned here means, submissiveness , for actually entering while prostrating is not possible. Khaslf said that Ikrimah said that Ibn Abbas said, The door mentioned here was facing the Qiblah. Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, As-Suddi, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak said that the door is the door of Hittah in Ilyya , which is Jerusalem. Ar-Razi also reported that some of them said that it was a door in the direction of the Qiblah . Khaslf said that Ikrimah said that Ibn Abbas said that the Children of Israel entered the door sideways. As-Suddi said that Abu Said Al-Azdy said that Abu Al-Kanud said that Abdullah bin Mas*ud said that they were (i At-Tabari 2:113.

Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) commanded to, 4&Si ^qi j&%} ienter the gate in prostration (or bowing with humility)} but instead, they entered while their heads were raised in defiance. Allah said next, 4*^ lAA"^\ iand say: 'Hittah'}. Ibn Abbas commented, Seek Allah s forgiveness. 121 Al-Hasan and Qatadah said that it means, Say, Relieve us from our errors. ' iand We shall forgive you your sins and shall increase (reward) far the good-doers Here is the reward for fulfilling Allah s commandment. This Ayah means, If you implement what We commanded you, We will forgive your sins and multiply your good deeds. In summai, upon achieving victory, the Children of Israel were commanded to submit to Allah in tongue and deed and, to admit to their sins and seek forgiveness for them, to be grateful to Allah for the blessings He gave them, hastening to do the deeds that Allah loves, as He said, {4 4 u-UJ' iWhen there comes the help ofAllah (to you, O Muhammad jfe against your enemies) and the conquest (of Makkahj. And you see that the people enter Alldlt s religion (Islam) in croivds. So glorify the praises of your Lord, and ask His forgiveness. Verily, He is the One Wlw accepts the repentance.} (110). Allah said, 4^i> Jj if *Ai y&} iBut those who did wrong changed the word from that which had been told to themfar another}. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :183. ' Ibid. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :185.

Al-Bagaralt (50 - 74) (Part-1) Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said, Every word in Allah s Book that says Rijz means, a punishment. |1 Mujahid, Abu Malik, As-Suddi, Al-Hasan and Qatadah were reported to have said that Rijz means Torment. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Sa d bin Malik, Usamah bin Zayd and Khuzaymah bin Thabit said that the Messenger of Allah said, jLS ^r* fi . j Ojf-Uail uThe plague is a Rijz, a punishment with which Allah punished those before yo". This is also how

? Tafsir Ibn Katir gushed forth therefrom twelve springs. Each (group of) people knew its own place for water. "Eat and drink of that which Allah has provided and do not act corruptly, making mischief on the earth. Twelve Springs gush forth Allah said, Remember My favor on you when I answered the supplication of your Prophet, Moses, when he asked Me to provide you with water. I made the water available for you, making it gush out through a stone. Twelve springs burst out of that stone, a designated spring for each of your tribes. You eat from the manna and the quails and drink from the water that I provided for you, without any effort or hardship for you. So worship the One Who did this for you. 44- * - ^ U i V i .) 4 And do not act corruptly, making mischief on the earth) meaning, Do not return the favor by committing acts of disobedience that cause favors to disappear. Ibn Abbas said that the Children of Israel, Had a square stone that Moses was commanded to strike with his staff and, as a result, twelve springs burst out of that stone, three on each side. Each tribe was, therefore, designated a certain spring, and they used to drink from their springs. They never had to travel from their area, they would find the same bounty in the same manner they had in the first area. 111 This narration is part of the long Hadith that

Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1 i.e. there gushed forth out of it twelve springs} (7:160), describing what first occurred when the water begins to gush out. In the Ayah in Surat Al-Baqarah, Allah described what happened later on, meaning when the water burst out in full force. Allah knows best. G U & j f * i J u i - j L r i i j i ' J V i C + U ; 461 . And (remember) when you said, "O Musa ! We cannot endure one kind of food. So invoke your Lord for us to bring forth for us of what the earth grows, its herbs, its cucumber its Film, its lentils and its onions." He said, "Would you exchange that which is better for that which is lower? Go you down to any town and you shall find what you want!"} The Children of Israel preferred foods inferior to Manna and Quails Allah said, And remember My favor on you when I sent down the manna and quails to you, a good, pure, beneficial, easily acquired food. And remember your ungratefulness for what We granted you. Remember how you asked Musa to exchange this type of food for an inferior type that consists of vegetation, and so forth. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said about the Children of Israel, They were bored and impatient with the type of food they were provided. They also remembered the life they used to live, when their diet consisted of lentils, onions, garlic and herbs." They said, 40 Musa ! We cannot endure one kind of food. So invoke your Lord for us to bring forth for us of what the earth grows, its herbs, its cucumbers, its Film, its lentils and its onions}. They said, - i & Z & } 40 the kind of food} meaning, the manna and quails, because they ate the same food day after day. The Ayah mentioned

lentils, onions and herbs, which are all known types of foods. As for the Fum, Ibn Mas'ud read it, Thum (garlic). Also, Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Al-Hasan said about the Ayah, 4 Its Fum}, Ibn Abbas said that Fum means, garlic. He also said that the expression, Fumu-lanna means, bake for us , according to the languages of old. Ibn Jarir commented, If this is true, then Fum is one of the words whose pronunciation were altered, the letter fa was replaced by the letter tha , since they are similar in sound. * And Allah knows best. Others said that Fum is wheat, the kind used for bread. Al-Bukhari said, Some of them said that Fum includes all grains or seeds that are eaten. Allah's statement, 4 % > 24 4 He said, "Would you exchange that which is better for that which is lower?"} criticized the Jews for asking for inferior foods, although they were living an easy life, eating tasty, beneficial and pure food. Allah's statement, 4 Go you down to any Misr} means, any city , as Ibn Abbas said. ' Ibn Jarir also reported that Abu Al- Aliyah and Ar-Rabi bin Anas said that the Ayah refers to Misr, the Egypt of Fir'aun. * The

Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) that Allah revealed the following Ayah afterwards, *And whoever seeks religion other than Islam, it will never be accepted of him, and in the Hereafter he will be one of the losers*> (3:85). This statement by Ibn Abbas indicates that Allah does not accept any deed or work from anyone, unless it conforms to the Law of Muhammad *that is, after Allah sent Muhammad Sfe. Before that, every person who followed the guidance of his own Prophet was on the correct path, following the correct guidance and was saved.*

Why the Jews were called ‘Yahud’

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 249]

The Jews are the followers of Prophet Musa, who used to refer to the Tawrah for judgment. Yahud is a word that means, repenting , just as Musa said, *Certainly we have Hudna to You*> meaning, we repent to You. This indicates that they were first called Yahud, because they repented and, because they were kind to each other. It was also said that they were called Yahud in reference to Yahuda (Judah) the eldest son of Prophet Ya'qub. Abu Amr bin Al- Ala said that they were called Yahud, because they swayed when they read the Tawrah.

Why the Christians were called ‘Nasara’

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 249–261]

When Isa was sent, the Children of Israel were required to follow and obey him. The followers of Isa and his companions are called An-Nasdra, because they gave aid and support to each other. They are also called Ansar (helpers), as Isa said, *-iJli jii 4"Who will be my helpers in Allah's cause?"* Al-Haivariyyun said : *"We are the helpers ofAllah.">(61:14)* It was said that they were called Nasara , because they inhabited a land called An-Nasirah (Nazareth), as Qatadah, Ibn

250 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Jurayj and Ibn Abbas were reported to have said , *11 Allah knows best. Nasara is certainly plural for Nasran. When Allah sent Muhammad as the Last and Final Prophet and Messenger to all of the Children of Adam, mankind was required to believe in him, obey him and refrain from what he prohibited them; those who do this are true believers. The Ummah of Muhammad was called Mu minin (believers), because of the depth of their faith and certainty, and because they believe in all of the previous Prophets and matters of the Unseen. The Sabi un or Sabians There is a difference of opinion over the identity of the Sabians. Sufyan Ath-Thawri said that Layth bin Abu Sulaym said that Mujahid said that, The Sabians are between the Majus, the Jews and the Christians. They do not have a specific religion. Similar is reported from Ibn Abi Najlh . Similar statements were attributed to Ata and Said bin Jubayr. They (others) say that the Sabians are a sect among the People of the Book who used to read the Zabur (Psalms), others say that they are a people who worshipped the angels or the stars. It appears that the closest opinion to the truth, and Allah knows best, is Mujahid s statement and those who agree with him like Wahb bin Munabbih, that the Sabians are neither Jews nor Christians nor MajOs nor polytheists. Rather, they did not have a specific religion that they followed and enforced, because they remained living according to their Fitrah (instinctual nature). This is why the idolators used .to call whoever embraced Islam a Sabi , meaning, that he abandoned all religions that existed on the earth. Some scholars stated that the Sabians are those who never received a message by any Prophet. And*

Allah knows best. pi jJ> C \g% pZK Z \jSL 'jjd pi G& pi jJa Jdli Sjli liij'i a oi i it 111 Ar-Razi 3 :97 At-Tabari 2 :146 * Ibid. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :199-200.

163. And (O Children of Israel, remember) when We took your covenant and We raised above you the Mount (saying) : "Hold fast to that which We have given you, and remember that which is therein so that you may acquire Taqwa" 164. Then after that you turned away. Had it not been for the grace and mercy of Allah upon you, indeed you would have been among the losers Taking the Covenant from the Jews Allah reminded the Children of Israel of the pledges, covenants and promises that He took from them to believe in Him alone, without a partner, and follow His Messengers. Allah stated that when He took their pledge from them, He raised the mountain above their heads, so that they affirm the pledge that they gave Allah and abide by it with sincerity and seriousness. Hence, Allah's statement, u !#0 St fsst t !4i" as jaas%&&s#S !f" idj iAtid (remember) when We raised the mountain over them as if it had been a canopy, and they thought that it was going to fall on them . (We said) : "Hold firmly to what We have given you (Tawrah), and remember that which is therein (act on its commandments), so that you may fear Allah and obey Him. % (7:171). The mount mentioned here is At-TQr, just as it was explained in Surat Al-A'raf according to the Tafsir of Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ata , Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabi bin Anas and others. 1 11 This is more obvious. There is another report from Ibn Abbas saying; The Tur is a type of mountain that vegetation grows on, if no vegetation grows on it, it is not called Tur. And in the Hadith about the trials, Ibn Abbas said; When they (the Jews) refused to obey, Allah raised the ^ Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :203 121 Ibid.

252 Tafsir Ibn Kathir mountain above their heads so that they would listen. Al-Hasan said that Allah's statement, iHold fast to that which We have given you means, the Tawrah. Mujahid said that the Ayah commanded, Strictly adhere to it." * Abu Al- Aliyah and Ar-Rabi said that, in c \g%} iand remember that which is therein means, Read the Tawrah and implement it. * Allah's statement, -Iji ft iThen after that you turned away. Had it not been for the grace of Allah> means, Yet, after the firm pledge that you gave, you still deviated and broke your pledge ; iHad it not been for the grace and mercy of Allah upon you}, meaning, by forgiving you and by sending the Prophets and Messengers to you, 4Indeed you would have been among the losers meaning, in this life and the Hereafter due to their breach of the covenant. \yT-l \$ Oft 4 p* \Sx3 cji f, f& cfj 1 465. And indeed you knew those amongst you who transgressed in the matter of the Sabbath (i.e. Saturday). We said to titan: "Be you monkeys, despised and rejected."} 466. SoWe made this punishment an example for those in front of it and those behind it, and a lesson for Al-Muttaqin (the pious.) *** An-Nasab in Al-Kubra6 :396 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :204 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :205. * Ibid.

Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) The Jews breach the Sanctity of the Sabbath Allah said, iAnd indeed you knew}. This Ayah means, O Jews! Remember that Allah sent His torment on the village that disobeyed Him and broke their pledge and their covenant to observe the sanctity of the Sabbath. They began using deceitful means to avoid honoring the Sabbath by placing nets, ropes and artificial pools of water for the purpose of fishing before the Sabbath. When the fish came in abundance on Saturday as usual, they were caught in the ropes and nets for the rest of Saturday. During the night, the Jews collected the fish after the Sabbath ended. When they did that, Allah changed them from humans into monkeys, the animals having the form closest to humans. Their evil deeds and deceit appeared lawful on the surface,

but they were in reality wicked. This is why their punishment was compatible with their crime. This story is explained in detail in Surat Al-A'raf, where Allah said (7:163), H V-V if 4 "/"; " * < 'jib iSIJL iAnd ask them (O Muhammad about the town that was by the sea; when they transgressed in the matter of the Sabbath (i.e. Saturday): when their fish came to them openly on the Sabbath day, and did not come to them on the day they had no Sabbath. Thus We made a trial of them, for they used to rebel (disobey Allah).}(7: 163) In his Tafsir, Al- Awfi reported from Ibn Abbas that he said, iWc said to tltem : "Be you monkeys, despised and rejected"} means, Allah changed their bodies into those of monkeys and swines. The young people turned into monkeys while the old people turned into swine. * Shayban An-Nahwi reported that hi Ibn Abi H&tim 1 :210

254 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Qatadah commented on. 4We said to them: "Be you monkeys, despised and rejected"}, These people were turned into howling monkeys with tails, after being men and women. 111 The Monkeys and Swine that exist now are not the Descendants ofThose thatwere transformed Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said, Those who violated the sanctity of the Sabbath were turned into monkeys, then they perished without offspring. 12' Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said, Allah turned them into monkeys because of their sins. They only lived on the earth for three days, for no transformed person ever lives more than three days. They did not eat, drink or have offspring. Allah transformed their shapes into monkeys, and He does what He wills, with whom He wills and He changes the shape of whomever He wills. On the other hand, Allah created the monkeys, swines and the rest of the creation in the six days (of creation) that He mentioned in His Book. '3 ' Allah s statement, <\$ } ^So We made this punishment an example} means, Allah made the people of this village, who violated the sanctity of the Sabbath, ii&} ian example} via the way they were punished. Similarly, Allah said about Pharaoh, 4So Allah, seized him with punishing example for his last and first transgression} (79:25). Allah s statement, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :209 121 Ibid.Jabari 2:167.

U) IfOj OJJ ifor those in front of it and those behind it} meaning, for the other villages. Ibn Abbas commented, Meaning, *We made this village an example for the villages around it by the manner in which We punished its people. Similarly, Allah said, V .o>"*y (***> 4And indeed We have destroyed towns (populations) round about you, and We have (repeatedly) shown (them) the Ayat (proofs, evidences, verses, lessons, signs, revelations, etc.) in various ways that they might return (to the truth and believe in the Oneness ofAllah - Islamic Monotheism^).(46:27) Therefore, Allah made them an example for those who lived during their time as well as a reminder for those to come, by preserving their story. This is why Allah said, iand a_ lesson for Ai-Muttaqin (the pious)}}, meaning, a reminder. This Ayah means, The torment and punishment that this village suffered was a result of indulging in Allah s prohibitions and their deceit. Hence, those who have Taqwd should be aware of their evil behavior, so that what occurred to this village does not befall them as well. Also, Imam Abu Abdullah bin Battah reported that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger ofAllah jg said, kIJSSjl U l yyfj'j V Do not commit what the Jews committed, breaching what Allah has forbidden, by resorting to the lowest types of deceitV This Hadith has a good [Jayid) chain of narration. Allah knowsjaest. j&L \)jA ijlli \ju IItjj c>\ Is'J* JLj 3)j} 467. And (remember) when Musa said to his people: "Verily, m Irwa Al-Gham 5:375.

Allah commands you that you slaughter a cow.: "I take Allah's refuge from being among Al-Jdhilin (the ignorant or the foolish)."

knows best.' * t>: \$ J>: & js u *. "> ca f-^ ^pVii^iU'Ss'i^I^ ^ ^ ^ ^ " ' *' / * >'. .? j"-r ,r^ . ^ %f w* *-> v
- "****^ r '{- -^f-t -"i- -" * H^y tr* -* - Juo C~3 * fcy _^UUU.^SJ uJ^J}+ > ^ ^ " s ^ iCJ U fal ij\i ^tJ"j3i
j*viiijJ lj .. , , , , / . ? , ^r-ffv > v-< dSi'i'i.-' ?r v-N)i'- ^ A" ot ji u u C5- 4lJi Lijj OjC5^<^U^tii.^JL^C5l^
^ jv jf, jg j'gji jj 3ji ^ ?j a_.Li4_o \ \$i v i 2 ijb\p ^/ ^ip^iir^jiSij\$ yi\ jfcs ^(_5 > 'jJ^ dj <\$6#. They said, ~-
- - =*J "Call upon your Lord for us that He may make plain to us what it is!" He said, "He says, 'Verily,
it is a cow neither too old nor too young, but (it is) between the two conditions', so do what you are
commanded."} 469. They said, "Call upon your Lord for us to make plain to us its colour." He said, "He
says, 'It is a ycllmo cow, bright in its colour, pleasing the beholders.' "\$> 470. They said, "Call upon
your Lord for us to make plain to us what it is. Verily, to us all cows are alike. And surely, if Allah wills,
we will be guided/> 471. He (Musa) said, "He says, 'It is a cow neither trained to At-Tabari 2 : 183 .

258 Tafstr Ibn Katfur till tlte soil nor water the fields, sound, having no blemish in it. " They said, "Now
you have brought the truth." So they slaughtered it though they ivere near to not doing it.} The
Stubbornness ofthe Jews regarding the Cow; Allah made the Matter difficult forThem Allah mentioned
the stubbornness of the Children of Israel and the many unnecessary questions they asked their
Messengers. This is why when they were stubborn, Allah made the decisions difficult for them. Had
they slaughtered a cow, any cow, it would have been sufficient for them, as Ibn Abbas and Ubaydah
have said. Instead, they made the matter difficult, and this is why Allah made it even more difficult for
them. They said, 4c icj Q fe\} iCall upon your Lord for us that He may make plain to us what it is!},
meaning, What is this cow and what is its description? Musa said, 4He says, 'Verily, it is a cmv neither
too old nor too young }, meaning, that it is neither old nor below the age of breeding. This is the
opinion of Abu Al- Aliyah, As-Suddi, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Atiyah Al- Awfi, Ata , Al-Khurasani, Wahb bin
Munabbih, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ibn Abbas. Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn Abbas said
that, 4But (it is) between the two conditions} means, Neither old nor young. Rather, she was at the age
when the cow is strongest and fittest. 121 In his Tafsir Al- Awfi reported from Ibn Abbas that, 4bright in
its colour} A deep yellowish white. 131 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:216. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :217. 131 Ibn
Abi Hatim 1 :22 1

Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) As-Suddi said, ipleasing the beholder meaning, that it pleases those who
see it. This is also the opinion of Abu Al- Aliyah, Qatadah and Ar-Rabl bin Anas. 2 Furthermore, Wahb
bin Munabbih said, Ifyou look at the cow s skin, you will think that the sun s rays radiate through its
skin. 3 ' The modern version of the Tawrah mentions that the cow in the Ayah was red, but this is an
error. Or, it might be that the cow was so yellow that it appeared blackish or reddish in color. Allah s
knows best. itS iVcrily, to us all cows are alike}* this means, that since cows are plentiful, then
describe this cow for us further, \$Atid surely, ifAllah zvills} and ifyou further describe it to us, iwe xuill
be guided uj 1 'ij Jjb 'J JI iHe says, 'It is a emu neither trained to till the soil nor water the fields'
meaning, it is not used in farming, or for watering purposes. Rather, it is honorable and fair looking.
Abdur- Razzaq said that Ma mar said that Qatadah said that, isound} means, The cow does not suffer
from any defects. This is also the opinion ofAbu Al- Aliyah and Ar-Rabl . Mujahid also said that the
Ayah means the cow is free from defects. Further, Ata Al-Khurasani said that the Ayah means that its

legs and body are free of physical defects. 6 " Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :222. Ibid. At-Tabari 2 :202 At-Tabari 2:214. At-Tabari 2 :225. At-Tabari 2:226.

Also, Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Ayah, 4d^J^i 'j Cj llyi iSo they slaughtered it though they were near to not doing it} means, They did not want to slaughter it. This means that even after all the questions and answers about the cow s description, the Jews were still reluctant to slaughter the cow. This part of the Qur an criticized the Jews for their behavior, because their only goal was to be stubborn, and this is why they nearly did not slaughter the cow. Also, Ubaydah, Mujahid, Wahb bin Munabbih, Abu Al- Aliyah and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, The Jews bought the cow with a large amount of money. There is a difference of opinion over this. Iliii U l ii yT'.i 4ff?jyili JjJi iit t/J 472. And (remember) when you killed a man and disagreed among yourselves as to the crime. But Allah brought forth that which you were Taktumun .} 473. So We said: "Strike him (the dead man) with a piece of it (the cow). Thus Allah brings the dead to life and shows you His Ayat (proofs, evidences, etc.) so that you may understand.} Bringing the murdered Man back to Life Al-Bukhari said that, 4^ (wij'ili} 4And disagreed among yourselves as to the crime means, Disputed. This is also the Tafsir of Mujahid. Ata Al-Khurasani and Ad- Dahhak said, Disputed about this matter. 141 Also, Ibn Jurayj said that, Jabari 2:219. Jabari 2:221. Al-Bari 6 :506 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :229

itri 2M iAud (remember) when you killed a man and disagreed among yourselves as to the crime means, some of them said, You killed him, while the others said, No you killed him. 1 11 This is also

the Tafsir of 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin AslamJ21 Mujahid

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 261–269]

said that, 4'oJ&p M 4But Allah brought forth that which you were Taktumun means, what you were hiding. 131 Allah said, 4So We said: "Strike him (the dead man) with a piece of it (the cow)" } meaning, any part of the cow will produce the miracle (if they struck the dead man with it). We were not told which part of the cow they used, as this matter does not benefit us either in matters of life or religion. Otherwise, Allah would have made it clear for us. Instead, Allah made this matter vague, so this is why we should leave it vague. Allah s statement, iTltus Allah brings the dead to life^ means, They struck him with it, and he came back to life. This Ayah demonstrates Allah s ability in bringing the dead back to life. Allah made this incident proof against the Jews that the Resurrection shall occur, and ended their disputing and stubbornness over the dead person. Allah mentioned His bringing the dead back to life in five instances in Surat Al-Baqarah. First Allah said, 4j ? 4Then We raised you up after your death}- He then mentioned the story about the cow. Allah also mentioned the story of those who escaped death in their land, while they were numbering in Tabari 2 :225 At-Tabari 2:225. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :229

the thousands. He also mentioned the story of the Prophet who passed by a village that was destroyed, the story of Abraham and the four birds, and the land that comes back to life after it has died. All these incidents and stories alert us to the fact that bodies shall again become whole, after they were rotten. The proof of Resurrection is also reiterated in Allah s statement, eft L"j ft ftftj ft % n a* Hf, Jt 9:\$&i dS \$3 kJfl 4And a sign for them is the dead land We give it life, and We bring forth from it grains, so that they eat thereof. And We have made therein gardens of date palms and grapes, and We have caused

springs of water to gush forth therein . So that they may eat of the fruit thereof - and their hands made it not. Will they not then give thanks?) (36:33-35). JAA iJ YAf of jI ijUi.s' ft I? fojjb ftli y) ft (Y~-*~ Si -1ft tJ ft a'j ft jftj 3ft 1-J ft v\j ft 474. T/ie/i after that your hearts were hardened and became as stones or even worse in hardness. And indeed, there are stones out of which rivers gush forth, and indeed, there are of them (stones) which split asunder so that ivaterfloios from them, and indeed, there are of them (stones) which fall down for fear of Allah. And Allah is not unaware ofwhat you do.) The Harshness oftheJews Allah criticized the Children of Israel because they witnessed the tremendous signs and the Ayat of Allah, including bringing the dead back to life, yet, i# ft * y) iThen after that your hearts were hardened). So their hearts were like stones that never become soft. This is why Allah forbade the believers from imitating the Jews when He said,

yj 'ij j ' Jt 4> '- j ^i==yJ c? '>*' # >*&(iHa\$ not the time come for the hearts of those who believe (in the Oneness of Allah - Islamic Monotheism) to be affected by Allah's Reminder (this Qur'an), and that which has been revealed of the truth, lest they become as those who received the Scripture (the Tawrah) and the Injtl (Gospel)) before (i.e. Jeivs and Christians), and the term was prolonged for them and so their hearts were hardened? And many of them were Fdsiquon (the rebellious, the disobedient to Allah)} (57:16). In his Tafsir, Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said, When the dead man was struck with a part of the cow, he stood up and became more alive them he ever was. He was asked, Who killed you? He said, My nephews killed me. He then died again. His nephews said, after Allah took his life away, By Allah! We did not kill him and denied the truth while they knew it. Allah said, Vj j% iAnd became as stones or even worse in hardness And by the passage of time, the hearts of the Children of Israel were unlikely to accept any admonishment, even after the miracles and signs they withnessed. Their hearts became harder than stones, with no hope of ever softening. Sometimes, springs and rivers burst out of stones, some stones split and water comes out of them, even if there are no springs or rivers around them, sometimes stones fall down from mountaintops out of their fear of Allah. Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Ibn Abbas said that, ^ u!j itU* C* gfhA 6}j A+At' CJ YAAAf St YSA ^ U iAnd indeed, there are stones out of which rivers gush forth, and indeed, there are of them (stones) which split asunder so that water floivs from them, and indeed, there are of them (stones) which fall m At-Jabari 2 : 234

down for fear of Allah}, means, Some stones are softer than your hearts, they acknowledge the truth that you are being called to, lli ill Cj} iAnd Allalt is not unaware ofwhat you Solid Inanimate Objects possess a certain Degree of Awareness Some claimed that the Ayat mentioned the stones being humble as a metaphor. However, Ar-Razi, Al-Qurtubi and other Imams said that there is no need for this explanation, because Allah creates this characteristic - humbleness - in stones. For instance, Allah said, iTruly, We did offer Al-Amdnah (the trust) to the heavens and the earth, and the mountains, but they declined to bear it and were afraid of it (i.e. afraid ofAllah's torment)} (33:72), 4ti iThe seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him (17:44), iAnd the stars and the trees both prostrate themselves (to Allah)} (55:6), 4Have they not observed things that Allah has created: (how) their shadows incline} (16:48), iThey both said: We come willingly."} (41:11), iHad We sent down this Qur an on a mountain} (59:21), and. m Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :233

Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) 4And they will say to their skins,: "Why do you testify against us? They will say: Allah has caused us to speak."

266 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4To cut off all excuses or to warn} (77:6). Some other scholars said that or here means, rather . Hence, the meaning becomes, As hard as stones. Rather, harder. For instance, Allah said, *li.1 jl il 'M i* f x * 4A section of them fear men as they fear Allah or even more) (4:77), *'iv . \$ iijl iiL* 4And We sent him to a hundred thousand (people) or even more} (37:147), and, **T o&** 4And so as at a distance of two bows' length or (even) nearer (53:9). Some other scholars said that this Ayah means their hearts are only of two types, as hard as stone or harder than stone. Further, Ibn Jarir commented that this Tafsir means that some of their hearts are as hard as stone and some hearts are harder than stone.¹¹¹ Ibn Jarir said that he favored this last Tafsir, although the others are plausible. I - Ibn Kathir - say that the last Tafsir is similar to Allah's statement, *s&L \ 2 i* Their likeness is as the likeness of one who kindled a fire (2:17), and then His statement, *ll oi jr4 i* Or like a rainstorm from the sky} (2:19). It is also similar to Allah's statement, *r&A \ j k=> jMj}* 4As for those who disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert} (24:39), and then His statement, 4 4Jabari 2 :236.

Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) iOr (the state of a disbeliever) is like the darkness in a vast deep sea) (24:40). This then means that some of them are like the first example, and some others are like the second example. Allah knows best. *+1& fSj& ^ #P J j* (44*% \\\J r.\$ y* UM\$ "J4i (46 & t w yy.j&L <& pj * fete p& & 2 c* 475. Do you (faithful believers) covet that they will believe in your religion in spite of the fact that a party of them (Jewish rabbis) used to hear the Word of Allah (the Tawrah), then they used to change it knowingly after they understood it?) 476. And when they (Jews) meet those who believe (Muslims), they say, "We believe," but when they meet one another in private, they say, "Shall you (Jews) tell them (Muslims) what Allah has revealed to you that they (Muslims) may argue with you (Jews) about it before your Lord?" Have you (Jews) then no understanding?) 477. Know they (Jews) not that Allah knows what they conceal and what they reveal?) There was little hope that the Jews who lived during the time of the Prophet jfe could have believed Allah said, *4'jJ2&\)* 4Do you covet) O believers, *ip & 4* That they will believe in your religion) meaning, that these people would obey you? They are the deviant sect of Jews whose fathers witnessed the clear signs but their hearts became hard afterwards. Allah said next,

in spite of the fact that a party of them (Jewish rabbis) used to hear the Word of Allah (the Tawrah), then they used to change it} meaning, distort its meaning, iafter they understood it}. They understood well, yet they used to defy the truth, iknowingly}, being fully aware of their erroneous interpretations and corruption. This statement is similar to Allah's statement, iSo, because of their violation of their covenant, We cursed them and made their hearts grow hard. They change the words from their (right) places (5:13). Qatadah commented that Allah's statement; *dC/ #>, 1/ t K . + V" U lx}* AThen they used to change it knowingly after they understood it} They are the Jews who used to hear Allah's Words and then alter them after they understood and comprehended them. Also, Mujahid said, Those who used to alter it and conceal its *J \y iiBjigP L IXA- 1 j pJ !Aj J 'j b ' Jr 1 ^*j I* Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :236

Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) truths; they were their scholars. * Also, Ibn Wahb said that Ibn Zayd commented, *./# i-i if ' <<- ' >/ / V* 4used to hear the Word of Allah (the Tawrah), then they used to change it} They altered the Tawrah that Allah revealed to them, making it say that the lawful is

unlawful and the prohibited is allowed, and that what is right is false and that what is false is right. So when a person seeking the truth comes to them with a bribe, they judge his case by the Book of Allah, but when a person comes to them seeking to do evil with a bribe, they take out the other (distorted) book, in which it is stated that he is in the right. When someone comes to them who is not seeking

what is right, nor offering them bribe, then they enjoin

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 269–285]

righteousness on him. This is why Allah said to them, iEnjoin you Al-Birr (piety and righteousness and every act of obedience to Allah) on the people and you forget (to practise it) yourselves, while you recite the Scripture (the Tawrdh)! Have you then no sense?} (2:44) [21 The Jews knew the Truth of the Prophet but disbelieved inHim Allah said next, d) f I 4And when they (Jews) meet tlwse who believe (Muslims), they say, "We believe", but when they meet one another in private..}. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas commented, i&\: \$6 \JS\> _ > \ij,} 4And when they (Jews) meet those who believe (Muslims), they say, "We believe"} They believe that Muhammad sfe is the Messenger of Allah, But he was only sent for you (Arabs) 131 However, when they meet each other they say, Do not conveyTabari 2:245.Tabari 2:246.Tabari 2 :250

270 Tafstr Ibn Kathir the news about this Prophet to the Arabs, because you used to ask Allah to grant you victory over them when he came, but he was sent to them (not to you). Allah then revealed, ^ uj ? d) VL lijj &l" Ijlli \ySXt jji \fo lij 4A"rf when they (Jews) meet those who believe (

Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) iThat Allah knows what they conceal}, What they concealed refers to when they were alone with each other away from the Companions of Muhammad jg. Then they would forbid each other from conveying the news that Allah revealed to them in their Book to the Companions of Muhammad jg, fearing that the Companions would use this news (about the truth of Muhammad jg) against them before their Lord. iAnd what they reveal?} meaning, when they said to the Companions ofMuhammad jg, i&\'.} 4We believe}, as Abu Al- Aliyah, Ar-Rabl' and Qatadah stated. bM ,U & U\$ % O0, (4^ Jeii . And f/iere are among than (Jews) 'Ummyyun (unlettered) people, who know not the Book, but they trust upon Amdni (false desires) and they but guess.} 479. Then woe to those who write the book with their own hands and then say, "This isfrom Allah," to purchase with it a little price! Woe to than for what their hands have written and woe to them for that they earn thereby.}

The Meaning of UmmV Allah said, iAnd there are among them Ummyyun people} meaning, among the People of the Book, as Mujahid stated. Ummyyun, is plural for Ummi, that is, a person who does not write, as Abu Al- Aliyah, Ar-RabT, Qatadah, Ibrahim An-Nakhal and others said. This meaning is clarified by Allah s statement, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :240. 121 Ibid.

\$Who know not the Booty meaning, are they not aware ofwhat is in it.' Ummi was one of the descriptions of the Prophet because he was unlettered. For instance, Allah said, 4Neither did you (O Muhammad read any book before it (this Qur an) nor did you write any book (whatsoever) with your right hand. In that case, indeed, the followers offalsehood might have doubted} (29:48). Also, the Prophet said, lislaj lisci Jl UjB We are an Ummi nation, neither writing nor calculating. The (lunar) month is like this, this and this (i.e. thirty or twenty- nine days .""2 This liadlth stated that Muslims do

not need to rely on books, or calculations to decide the timings of their acts of worship. Allah also said, 4 4 44 Jty iHe it is Who sent among the Ummyym ones a Messenger (Muhammad \$fe)from among themselves} (62:2). The Explanation of Amani Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said that Allah's statement, i'Oit.) 4But they trust upon Amani} means, It is just a false statement that they utter with their tongues. It was also said that Amani means Visiles and hopes . Mujahid commented, Allah described the Ummyyin as not understanding any of the Book that Allah sent down to Musa, yet they create lies and * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :241 2| Path Al-Bari 4:151. At-Tabari 2 :261

131 Woe unto Those Criminals among the Jews Allah said, L

means this life and all that it contains. Allah's statement, iWoe to them for what their hands have written and woe to them for that they earn thereby^ means, Woe to them because of what they have written with their own hands, the lies, falsehood and alterations. Woe to them because of the property that they unjustly acquired. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas commented, iWoe to them}, Means the torment will be theirs because of the lies that they wrote with their own hands, iOjLJZ lij^ jj, 4And woe to them for that they earn thereby}, which they unjustly acquired from people, be they commoners or otherwise. ii' Jii 'x+l -if jcc Jrjcl ji jl^Slf l: J J 4 i' *f l; . rJi- i& 480. And they (Jews) say, "The Fire shall not touch us but far afew numbered days." Say (O Muhammad jg to them): "Have you taken a covenant from Allah, so that Allah will not break His covenant? Or is it that you say of Allah what you know not? } The Jews hope They will only remain in the Fire for a Few Days Allah mentioned the claim of the Jews, that the Fire will only touch them for a few days, and then they will be saved from it. Allah refuted this claim by saying, -if JC* Jriitfl j"Say (O Mulmmmad jg to them) : "Have you taken a covenant from 1,1 Ibn Abi HAtim 1 :247. At-Jabari 2:273.

Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) Allah?'\$. Hence, the Ayah proclaims, ifyou had a promise from Allah for that, then Allah will never break His promise. However, such promise never existed. Rather, what you say, about Allah, you have no knowledge of and you thus utter a lie about Him. Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said about the Ayah, 4And they (Jews) say, The Fire shall not touch us but for a feiu numbered days The Jews said, The Fire will only touch us for forty days. I' 1 Others added that this was the period during which the Jews worshipped the calf. Also, Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr bin Marduwah reported Abu Hurayrah saying, 4)\ Jlii i. aLt \$? taj j- ?&' JUi - f I 'j* jli If J ^ jyj jj\ ! JIS IjJIS illL iiS j|3 t' U : I_ j| ^ i'B jtJl jii Jj-^j ^ Jlii iLi ILS cJ^p 4il_> lyU^~U ail J_^j pjJ JUS IfJ jif '3rri 4^ j_j& JJ j"-(J Jii jJ .aijjl V JVU2. alljl ajia :Jli Ul IS : l_pli jiSolLi ji Cits' jl HjJlii p SJL>- Lilt :JIS :llii ' ; J ^ ' , , _ ' , _ - . ILj (jjj fVfjtv Khaybar was conquered, a roasted poisoned sheep was presented to the Prophet -fe as a gift (by the Jews). The Messenger ofAllah jfe ordered, Assemble before me all the Jews who were here.' The Jews were summoned and the Prophet jg said (to them), Who is your father? They replied, So-and-so. He said, You have lied; your father is so-and-so. They said, You have uttered the truth. He said, "Will you now tell me the truth, if I ask you about something? They replied, Yes, O (il At-Jabari 2 :276

276 Tafsir ton Kathir Abul-Qasim; and ifwe should tell a lie, you will know our lie as you have about our fathers.' On that he asked, Who are the people of the (Hell) Fire?' They said. We shall remain in the (Hell) Fire for a short period, and after that you will replace us in it. The Prophet gg said, May you be cursed and humiliated in it! By AllAh, we shall never replace you in it.' Tlten he asked, Will you tell me the truth if I ask you a question?' They said, 'Yes, O Abul-Qasim.' He asked, 'Have you poisoned this

sheep?' They said, 'Yes.' He asked, 'What made you do so?' They said, 'We wanted to know if you were a liar, in which case we would get rid of you, and if you were a Prophet then the poison would not harm i/ow.'n Imam

Oi 'ij ** '*jr* y"P jifcjSUt > *>" c.1 4 <* < ^ ^ << , M/ / .</ * if > Crf >*J l>* y Ot s^r"J W' JJ LJJ 4i"l UJJ 4""C!/ij Ojiiiu iX*j> ilt will not be in accordance with your desires (Muslims), nor those of the People of the Scripture (Jews and Qiristians), whosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof, and he will not find any protector or helper besides Allah. And whoever does righteous good deeds, male or female, and is a (true) believer [in the Oneness of Allah (Muslim)], such will enter Paradise and not the least injustice, even the size of a Naqira (speck on the back of a date stone), will be done to them) {4:123-124). Also, Abu Hurayrah, Abu Wa il, Ata , and Al-Hasan said that, i 4A)id his sin has surrounded him) means, His Shirk (polytheism) has surrounded him. 111 Also, Al-A mash reported from Abu Razin that Ar-Rabl bin Khuthaym said, 4And his sin has surrounded him), Whoever dies before repenting from his wrongs. As-Suddi and Abu Razin said similarly. Abu Al- Aliyah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ar-Rabi bin Anas said that, 4Attd his sin has surrounded him) refers to major sins. * All of these statements carry similar meanings, and Allah knows best. When Small Sins gather, They bring about Destruction Here we should mention the Hadith that Imam Ahmad [1 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1:252. (2 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :252. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :253 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :253

recorded, in which Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah jg said,: "77iis is lte example of people who set up camp on a flat land, and then their servants came. One of them collected some wood and another man collected some wood until they collected a great deal. They then started a fire and cooked what they put on Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas said that, 4Ami those who believe and do righteous good deeds, they are dwellers of Paradise, they will dwell therein forever Whoever believes in what you (Jews) did not believe in and implements what you refrained from implementing of Muhammad s religion, shall acquire Paradise for eternity. Allah stated that the recompense for good or evil works shall remain with its people for eternity. 12 \$ & lS}j C/j)9Vj Si' OjiLw"

you, ivhile you are backsliders.} The Covenant that Allah took from the Children of Israel Allah reminded the Children of Israel of the commandments that He gave them, and the covenants that He took from them to abide by those commands, and how they intentionally and knowingly turned away from all of that. Allah commanded them to worship Him and to associate none with Him in worship, just as He has commanded all of His creatures, for this is why Allah created them. Allah said. "0 V iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you (O Muhammad s&) but We revealed to him (saying) : La ilaha ilia Ana [none has the right to be worshipped but I (Allah)], so worship Me (alone and none else)} (21:25), and, Si' iil 4 X&f} iAnd verily, We have sent among every Ummah (community, nation) a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah (alone), and avoid the Tdghilt (allfalse deities,)} (16:36). This is the highest and most important right, that is, Allah s right that He be worshipped alone without partners. After that comes the right of the creatures, foremost, the right of the parents. Allah usually mentions the rights of the parents along with His rights. For instance, Allah said, iXJd (j[AJjjJ J jk=d\oty iGive thanks to Me and to your parents. Unto Me is the final destination} (31:14). Also, Allah said.

iAnd your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him. And that you be dutiful to your parents} (17:23), until, iAnd give to the kinsman his due and to the MiskTn (poor) and to the wayfarer} (17:26).

Abu Dharr said that the FathAl-Bari 6:5, and Muslim 1 :89. 2| IbnAbiHatim 1:258.

Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) Prophet jgj said, p jtj U"i jyL Do "of belittle anyform of righteousness, and even ifyou did not find any good deed except meeting your brother with a smiling face, then do so . This Hadith was also collected by Muslim in his Sahih and At-Tirmidhi, who graded it SahihJ Allah commands the servants to say good words to people, after He commanded them to be kind to them, thereby mentioning two categories of manners: good speech and good actions. He then emphasized the command to worship Him and the command to do good, ordaining the prayer and the Zakah, iand perform As-Salah and give Zakah\$. Allah informed us that the People of the Book, except for a few among them, ignored these orders, that is, they knowingly and intentionally abandoned them. Allah ordered this Ummah similarly in Surat An-Nisa when He said, ijT4% s& \j52Xfr J K jCSfo &2X jj A'S U *&k 4Worship Allah and join none with Him (in worship); and do good to parents, kinsfolk, orphans, Al-Masdkin (the poor), the neighbor who is near ofkin, the neighbor who is a stranger, the companion by your side, the wayfarer (you meet), and tlwse (servants) whom your right hands possess. Verily, Allah does not like such as are proud and boastful^ (4:36). Of these orders, this Ummah has practiced what no other nation before it has, and all praise is due to Allah. } pA-i as ^ f &A * P&A \$ & rO/Zi oi j&i &j* oyrffoj p ^ m Ahmad 5 : 173 , Muslim 4 :2026 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 5 :526

J maz 'r " 'oJrjZ'j'jp&i ilj ^ *-" f-' -> V ^ " V"^\ I*p oj' uiijji'j jf oi pi A. '< \$'s> sy s * > , "T- i -- -xL\c. {r^\.yttjp-s_ju j b-C&jC^W&* \$ ojl 4 iijjtj ^- CJV?^ J&its^ ffriL&l2*Jftg Jippi "ia ^ii jf^v ("*& y tfyi' (Syfc p'A & 'fit r > ; l_ ^ '* ijfULyJ' ii tf> tli ^aiL. iyJiS2j 2^ r^i < *" ,/ -'.ff r& u 5li y jt 4 Aii\ Uj 4 if, ytuit iJi cySjj iMpJLjU Li-C* L^ *^ Uj!" ij/if Ijjif n* J&4 Su th% (7/iis) you ratified and (to this) you bore witness. i . >* > > <- p* JJ . And (remember) when VJe took your covenant (saying): Shed not the blood of your (people), nor turn out your own people from their dwellings. Then, 485. After this, it is you xoho kill one another and drive out a party of you from their homes, assist (their enemies) against them, in sin and transgression. And if they come to you as captives, you ransom them, although their expulsion was forbidden to you . Then do you believe in a part of the Book and reject the rest? Then what is the recompense of those who do so among you, except disgrace in the life of this world, and on the Day of Resurrection they shall be consigned to the most grievous torment. And Allah is not unaware ofwhat you do.) 486. Tlwse are they who have bought the life of this world at the price of the Hereafter. Their torment shall not be lightened nor shall they be helped.}

Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) The Terms ofthe Covenant and their Breach of It Allah criticized the Jews who lived in Al-Madlnah during the time of the Messenger of Allah jg. They used to suffer, because of the armed conflicts between the tribes of Al-Madlnah, Aws and Khazraj. Before Islam, the Aws and Khazraj worshipped idols, and many battles took place between them. There were three Jewish tribes in Al-Madlnah at that time, Banu Qaynuqa and Banu An-Nadlr, the allies of the Khazraj, and Banu Qurayzah, who used to be the allies of the Aws. When war erupted between Aws and Khazraj, their Jewish allies would assist them. The Jew would kill his Arab enemy, and sometimes they also killed Jews who were the allies of the other Arab tribe, although the Jews were prohibited from killing each other according to clear religious texts in their Books. They would also drive each other from their

homes and loot whatever furniture and money they could. When the war ended, the victorious Jews would release the prisoners from the defeated party, according to the rulings of the Tawrah. This is why Allah said, {Then do you believe in a part of the Scripture and reject the rest?} Allah said, {If you tip your heels and turn out your own people from their dwellings, nor expel one another from their homes, nor participate in fighting against them. Allah mentioned the word *your own here, just as He said in another Ayah. {So turn in repentance to your Creator and kill yourselves, that will be better for you with your Creator (2:54) because the followers of one religion are just like one soul. Also, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said,

284 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Jj 1 1j L yU* J ^pljLJ jyafr "C. 77ie example of the believers in their kindness, mercy and sympathy to each other is the example of one body, when an organ of it falls ill, the rest of the body rushes to its aid in fever and sleeplessness.^ Allah's statement, > --Y "j --.I TJJ-V * -' ""j fJj*' pT {Then, (this) you ratified and (to this) you bore witness.} means, You testified that you know of the covenant Jind that you were witnesses to it. {Xj \uufi byffe-j Si p, \ iAfter this, it is you who kill one another and drive out a party of you from their homes}. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar reported that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, {After this, it is you who kill one another and drive out a party of you from their homes} Allah mentioned what they were doing, and that in the Tawrah He had prohibited them from shedding each other's blood, and required them to free their prisoners. Now they were divided into two camps in Al-Madlnah, Banu Qaynuqa*, who were the allies of the Khazraj, and An-Nadir and Qurayzah, who were the allies of the Aws. When fighting erupted between Aws and Khazraj, Banu Qaynuqa* would fight along with the Khazraj, while Banu An-Nadir and Qurayzah would fight along with the Aws. Each Jewish camp would fight against their Jewish brethren from the other camp. They would shed each other's blood, although they had the Tawrah with them, and they knew their rights and dues. Meanwhile, the Aws and Khazraj were polytheists who worshipped idols. They did not know about Paradise, the Fire, Resurrection, Divine Books the lawful and prohibited. When the war would end, the Jews would ransom their prisoners and implement 4:1999. 121 Ibn Abi H&tim 1 :261

the Tawrah. Consequently, Banu Qaynuqa' would ransom their prisoners who were captured by the Aws, while Banu An-Nadir and Qurayzah would ransom their prisoners who were captured by the Khazraj. They would also ask for blood money. During these wars, they would kill whomever (Jews or Arabs) they could, while helping the polytheists against their brethren. Therefore, Allah reminded them of this when He said, {Then do you believe in a part of the Scripture and reject the rest? ^ This Ayah means, Do you ransom them according to the rulings of the Tawrah, yet kill them while the Tawrah forbade you from killing them and from expelling them from their homes? The Tawrah also commanded that you should not aid the polytheists and those who associate with Allah in the worship against your brethren. You do all this to acquire the life of this world. I was informed that the behavior of the Jews

Surah 2: Al-Baqarah (Part 2 of 4)

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regarding the Aws and Khazraj was the reason behind

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 285–313]

revealing these Ayat. These noble Ayat criticized the Jews for implementing the Tawrah sometimes and defying it at other times, although they believed in the Tawrah and knew what they were doing was wrong. This is why they should not be trusted to preserve or convey the Tawrah. Further, they should not be believed when it comes to the description of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, his coming, his expulsion from his land, and his Hijrah, and the rest of the information that the previous Prophets informed them about him, all of which they hid. The Jews, may they suffer the curse of Allah, hid all of these facts among themselves, and this is why Allah said. {Then what is the recompense of those who do so among you, except disgrace in the life of this world}, because they defied Allah's Law and commandments, {And on the Day of Resurrection they shall be consigned to the most grievous torment} as punishment for defying the Book of Allah

Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1 4 Verily, We did reveal the Tawrah (to Musa), therein was guidance and light, by which the Prophets, who submitted themselves to Allah's will, judged for the Jews. And the rabbis and the priests (too judged for the Jews by the Tawrah after those Prophets), for to them was entrusted the protection of Allah's Book, and they were witnesses thereto} (5:44). This is why Allah said here, {And Qaffayna him with Messengers}. As-Suddi said that Abu Malik said that Qaffayna means, Succeeded, while others said, Followed". Both meanings are plausible, since Allah said, {Then We sent Our Messengers in succession} (23:44). Thereafter, Allah sent the last Prophet among the Children of Israel, Isa the son of Mary, who was sent with some laws that differed with some in the Tawrah. This is why Allah also sent miracles to support Isa. These included bringing the dead back to life, forming the shape of birds from clay and blowing into them, after which they became living birds by Allah's leave, healing the sick and foretelling the Unseen, as Ibn Abbas stated. 121 Allah also aided him with Rah Al-Qudus, and that refers to Jibril. All of these signs testified to the truthfulness of Isa and what he was sent with. Yet, the Children of Israel became more defiant and envious of him and did not want to differ with even one part of the Tawrah, as Allah said about Isa, {And to make lawful to you part of what was forbidden to you, and I have come to you with a proof from your Lord} (3:50). Hence, the Children of Israel treated the Prophets in the worst manner, rejecting some of them and killing some of them. All of this occurred because the Prophets used to 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 268. 121 Ibid.

command the Jews with what differed from their desires and opinions. The Prophets also upheld the rulings of the Tawrah that the Jews had changed, and this is why it was difficult for them to believe in these Prophets. Therefore, they rejected the Prophets and killed some of them. Allah said, {And they rejected what you yourselves desired not, you

grew arrogant? Some you disbelieved and some you kill}. Jibril is Ruh Al-Qudus The proof that Jibril is the Ruh Al-Qudus is the statement of Ibn Mas'ud in explanation of this Ayah. ' This is also the view of Ibn Abbas, Muhammad bin Ka'b, Ismail bin Khalid, As-Suddi, Ar-Rabl bin Anas, Atiyah Al- Awfi and Qatadah.'2' Additionally, Allah said. iWhich the trustworthy Ruh (Jibril) has brought down. Upon your heart (O Muhammad jfej that you may be (one) of the wamers (26:193-194).

Ir-** '-.T''' IP J-Asll JJ jJ 'Z J " " "_jiyi^)i \jZ\i uRuli Al-Qudus infontied me that no soul shall die until it finishes its set provisions and term limit. Therefore, have Tacnod of Allah and seek your sustenance in the most suitable ivayj' 1] The Jews tried to kill the Prophet #, Az-Zamakhshari commented on Allah s statement, iSome you disbelieved and some you kill}, Allah did not say killed here, because the Jews would still try to kill the Prophet in the future, using poison and magic. During the illness that preceded his death, the Prophet jg said. jljl Ijigj jL>- "isi kiJlj U "/ kept feeling the effect of what I ate (from the poisoned sheep) during the day of Klmybar, until now, when it is the time that the aorta ivill be cut off(meaning when death is near)fo2^ This Hadith was collected by Al-Bukhari and others 3 i88. And they say, "Our hearts are Ghulf." Nay, Allah has cursed them for their disbelief, so little is that which they believe.} Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas said that, 4h& ejs \)6j} 4And they say, "Our hearts are Ghulf. }, means, Our hearts are screened. * Mujahid also said that, 4ht \)&j} See As-Sunnah 14 :304 ,2* Ibn Adi 3:1239. 3 * Path Al-Bari 7 :737Tabari 2 :326

dSQ Tafsir Ibn Kathir iAtid theu say, "Our hearts are Ghulf. }, means, They are covered. ' Ikrimah said, There is a stamp on them. 12 ' Abu Al- Aliyah said, They do not comprehend. '3 ' Mujahid and Qatadah said that Ibn Abbas read the Ayah in a way that means, Our hearts contain every type of knowledge and do not need the knowledge that you (O Muhammad) have. '4 ' This is the opinion of Ata and Ibn Abbas. 4Nay, Allah has cursed them for their disbelief" meaning, Allah expelled them and deprived them of every type of righteousness. Qatadah said that the Ayah, iSo little is that which they believe.} means, Only a few of them believe. '5 ' Allah s statement, ib& vj iAtid they say, "Our hearts are Ghidf."} is similar to His statement, XS, iAtid they say: "Our hearts are under coverings (screened) from that to which you invite us} (41:5). This is why Allah said here, iNay, Allah has cursed them for their disbelief, so little is that which they believe.} meaning, It is not as they claim. Rather, their hearts are cursed and stamped, just as Allah said in Surat An-Nisa (4:155), 111 Ibid. ' Ibn Abi flatim 1 :274. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 273. ' Al-Qurtubi. 151 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :274.

Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) iAtid of their saying : "Our hearts are wrapped (with coverings, i.e. we do not understand what the Messengers say)" - nay, Allah has set a seal upon their hearts because of their disbelief, so they believe not but a little.} There is a difference of opinion regarding the meaning of Allah s statement, 4So little is that which they believe.} and His statement, & %} 4So they believe not except a feiv}. Some scholars said that the Ayat indicate that a few of them would believe, or that their faith is minute, because they believe in Resurrection and in Allah s reward and punishment that Musa foretold. Yet, this faith will not benefit them since it is overshadowed by their disbelief in what Muhammad jg brought them. Some scholars said that the Jews did not actually believe in anything and that Allah said, 4&S e ij&} 4So little is that which they believe}, meaning, they do not believe. This meaning is similar to the Arabic expression, Hardly have I seen anything like this, meaning, I have never seen anything like this. itjfo <_ oyuilJ J-3 \yij HJ *x\ JCt oi 4 -a-* l ^ llii ijJiS 4S9. And when

there came to them (the Jews), a Book (this Qur'an) from Allah confirming what is with them (the Tawrah) and the Injil (Gospel), although aforetime they had invoked Allah (for the coming of Muhammad ﷺ) in order to gain victory over those who disbelieved, then when there came to them that which they had recognised, they disbelieved in it. So let the curse of Allah be on the disbelievers.} The Jews were awaiting the Prophet's coming, but they disbelieved in Him when He was sent. Allah said,

292 Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr J 1 t (3 J 13! 4lw: "Book from Allah} meaning, the Qur'an that Allah sent down to Muhammad, Uj 4confirming what is with them} meaning, the Tawrah. Further, Allah said, j? *m i& sj although aforetime they had invoked Allah (for coming of Muhammad ﷺ) in order to gain victory over those who disbelieved} meaning, before this Messenger came to them, they used to ask Allah to aid them by his arrival, against their polytheistic enemies in war. They used to say to the polytheists, A Prophet shall be sent just before the end of this world and we, along with him, shall exterminate you, just as the nations of Ad and Iram were exterminated."

Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) and describe him to us, Salam bin Mushkim from Bani An-Nadlir replied, He did not bring anything that we recognize. He is not the Prophet we told you about. Allah then revealed this Ayah about their statement, q && \$And when there came to them (the Jews), a Book (this Qur'an) from Allah confirming what is with them (the Tawrah) and the Injil (Gospel)} Abu Al-Aliyah said, The Jews used to ask Allah to send Muhammad ﷺ so that they would gain victory over the Arab disbelievers. They used to say, O Allah! Send the Prophet that we read about - in the Tawrah - so that we can torment and kill the disbelievers alongside him. When Allah sent Muhammad ﷺ and they saw that he was not one of them, they rejected him and envied the Arabs, even though they knew that he was the Messenger of Allah. Hence, Allah said, Jo Jill iLJi **_> "i==" 'jijlfc l5 tU" ^> iThen when there came to them that which they had recognized, they disbelieved in it. So let the curse of Allah be on the disbelievers}. ^ -4 J* at jl lli; iit JjJ IjytAso J p |.Jl'A \S>} 490. How bad is i/iaf/or which they have sold their own selves, that they should disbelieve in that which Allah has revealed (the Qur'an), grudging that Allah should reveal of His grace unto whom He wills of His servants. So they have drawn on themselves wrath upon wrath. And for the disbelievers, there is disgracing torment.} Mujahid said, 4How bad is that for which they have sold their own selves}, The Tabari 2:333. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 276.

Jews sold the truth for falsehood and hid the truth about Muhammad ﷺ. 1 ' 1 As-Suddi said that the Ayah, i^\ ijXif l 2L> iHoiv bad is that for which they have sold their own selves} means, The Jews sold themselves. * * meaning, what is worse is what they chose for themselves by disbelieving in what Allah revealed to Muhammad ﷺ instead of believing, aiding and supporting him. This behavior of theirs is the result of their injustice, envy and hatred, igmdging that Allah should reveal of His grace unto whom He wills of His servants}. There is no envy worse than this. Therefore, iLZk ijJu.ym 4So they have drawn on themselves wrath upon wrath}. Ibn Abbas commented on this Ayah, Allah became angry with them because they ignored some of the Tawrah and disbelieved in the Prophet that He sent to them. 131 I (Ibn Kathir) say that the meaning of, }And they drew on themselves} is that they deserved and acquired multiplied anger. Also, Abu Al-Aliyah said, Allah became angry with them, because of their disbelief in the Injil and Isa and He became angry with them again, because they disbelieved in Muhammad ﷺ and the Qur'an. 14 * Similar was said by Ikrimah and Qatadah. 15 * Allah said, 4And for the disbelievers,

there is disgracing torment}. Since their disbelief was a result of their transgression and envy, which was caused by arrogance, they were punished with disgrace At-Jabari 2:340. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :277. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :279 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :278 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :279

77ie arrogant people will be gathered on the Day of Resurrection in the size of ants, but in the shape of men. Everything shall be above them, because of the humiliation placed on them, until they enter a prison in Jahannam called Baiulas where the fire will surround them from above. They shall drink from the puss of the people of the Fire. jhj f*[fj Uj V.. jb Cj jllli ill' Jrf t*J j-i 4i3 |*Mj *t*-j Si p will ll! 491. And when it is said to them (the Jews),

^ Tafstr Ibn Kathtr Although The Jews denied the Truth, They claimed to be Believers! Allah said, iAnd when it is said to them}, meaning, the Jews and the People of the Book, 'Sj\ TL iBelieve in what Allah has sent down> to Muhammad \$fe, believe in and follow him, itS jj il^ \)&} iThey say, "We believe in what was sent down to us."4 meaning, it is enough for us to believe in what was revealed to us in the Tawrah and the Injll, and this is the path that we choose, iffij &>} iAnd they disbelieve in that which came after it}. ifaci<&&\%} iwhile it is the truth confirming what is with them} meaning, while knowing that what was revealed to Muhammad jg, i S 4it is the truth confirming what is with them}. This means that since what was sent to Muhammad jg conforms to what was revealed to the People of the Book, then this fact constitutes a proof against them. Similarly, Allah said, 4(***li? af&} iThose to whom We gave the Scripture (Jews and Christians) recognize him (Muhammad as they recognize their sons} (2:146). Allah said next. i^ji 4 J5 *\$ 'oM } 4"Why then have you killed the Prophets of Allah aforetime, if you indeed have been believers?". This means, If your claim that you believe in what was

Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) revealed to you is true, then why did you kill the Prophets who came to you affirming the Tawrah s Law, although you knew they were true Prophets? You killed them simply out of transgression, stubbornness and injustice with Allah s Messengers. Therefore, you only follow your lusts, opinions and desires. Similarly, Allah said, &JS f'JSUpH a# LL pK(M} 41\$ it that whenever there came to you a Messenger with what you yourselves desired not, you grew arrogant? Some you disbelieved and some you killed. } Also, As-Suddi said, In this Ayah, Allah chastised the People of the Book, ; V * '* -y f{ X > > . 'iv C)[Ji "*">> sLi' lli 4Say (O Muhammad 5g to them) : "Why then have you killed the Prophets of Allah aforetime, if you indeed have been believers?". pkzaifc. jjij} 4And indeed Musa came to you with clear proofs} meaning, with clear signs and clear proofs that he was the Messenger of Allah and that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah. The clear signs -or miracles- mentioned here are the flood, the locusts, the lice, the frogs, the blood, the staff and the hand. Musa s miracles also include parting the sea, shading the Jews with clouds, the manna and quails, the gushing stone, etc. 4&J\ p} 4yet you worshipped the calf} meaning, as a deity instead of Allah, during the time of Musa. Allah s statement, iafter he left} after Musa went to Mount Tur to speak to Allah. Similarly, Allah said, 4And the people of Musa made in his absence, out of their m Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 281

ornaments, the image of a calf (for worship). It had a sound (as if it was mooing)} (7:148). iatid you were Zdlimun meaning, you were unjust in this behavior of worshipping the calf, although you knew that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah. Similarly, Allah said, a J*r") Wj I i/ iAnd wheti they regretted and saw that they had gone astray, they (repented and) said: "If our Lord have not mercy

upon us and forgive us, we shall certainly be of the losers"} (7:149). IjJLj }yu t* ixi. jylill dlijj tJo-t ij} pSSiL) i* J} ti*\$ 493. And (remember) when We took your covenant and We raised above you the Mount (saying), "Hold firmly to what We have given you and hear (Our Word)." They said, "We have heard and disobeyed." And their hearts absorbed (the worship of) the calf because of their disbelief. Say : "Worst indeed is that which your faith enjoins on you if you are believers. } The Jews rebel after Allah took Their Covenant and raised the Mountain above Their Heads Allah reminded the Jews of their errors, breaking His covenant, transgression and defiance, when He raised Mount Tur above them so that they would believe and agree to the terms of the covenant. Yet, they broke it soon afterwards, tiL- \j\\$} iThey said, "We have heard and disobeyed. } We have mentioned the Tafsir of this subject before. Abdur-Razzaq said that Ma'mar narrated that Qatadah said that, iAnd their hearts absorbed (the worship of) the calf} means, They

Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) absorbed its love, until its love resided in their hearts. | This is also the opinion of Abu Al- Aliyah and Ar-Rabl* bin Anas. 121 Allah s statement, 4Say ; "Worst indeed is that which your faith enjoins on you if you are believers."} means, Worse yet is the manner in which you behaved in the past and even now, disbelieving in Allah s Ayat and defying the Prophets. You also disbelieved in Muhammad which is the worst of your deeds and the harshest sin that you committed. You disbelieved in the Final Messenger and the master of all Prophets and Messengers, the one who was sent to all mankind. How can you then claim that you believe, while committing the evil of breaking Allah s covenant, disbelieving in Allah s Ayat and worshipping the calf instead of Allah?" ', ojjl ujU)' jjj j* Xt 0*/\$' j'oJ' 1 o! lii(j jr^i Jj &>,* > \$ c, Jjt % \&\) . & osvSit 494. Say to (them) : "If the abode of the Hereafter with Allah is indeed for you especially and not for others of mankind, then long for death if you are truthful."} 495. But they will never long for it because of what their hands have sent before them (i.e. what they have done). And Allah is Aware of the Zalimin .} 496. And verily, you will find them (the Jeios) the greediest of mankind for life and (even greedier) than those who ascribe partners to Allah . One of them toishes that he could be given a life of a thousand years. But the grant of such life will not save him even a little from (due) punishment. And Allah is Seer of what they do.} 'Abdur-Razzaq 1:52. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :283

If the home of the Hereafter with Allah is indeed for you especially and not for others, of mankind, then long for death if you are truthful.

O i/om Jews! If you pretend that you are friends of Allah, to the exclusion of (all) other mankind, then long for death if you are truthfid.

them): "Verily, the death from which you flee will surely meet you, then you iwill be sent back to (Allah) the Knoiver of the unseen and the seen, and He will tell you what you used to do."} (62:6-8). So they claimed that they are Allah s sons and loved ones and said, Only those who are Christian or Jews shall enter Paradise. Therefore, they were called to invoke Allah to destroy the lying group, be it them or the Muslims. When the Jews declined, every one was sure of their wrong, for had they been sure of their claims, then they would have accepted the proposal. Their lies were thus exposed after they declined the offer to invoke the curse. Similarly, the Messenger of Allah jfe called a delegation of Najran s Christians to curse after he refuted them in a debate in which they demonstrated stubbornness and defiance. Allah said, at -iliC t* juL *_> j* oIJJ JLj fC-A) iThen whoever disputes with you

concerning him ('Isa) after (all this) knowledge that has come to you (i.e. 'Isd) being a servant of Allah, and having no share in divinity), say (O Muhammad jg) ; "Come, let us call our sons and your sons, our women and your women, ourselves and yourselves - then we pray and invoke (sincerely) the curse of Allah upon those who lie/" (3:61). When the Christians heard this challenge, some of them said to each other, By Allah! If you do such with this Prophet, none of you will have an eye that blinks. This is when they resorted to peace and gave the Jizyah (tax) in disgrace. The Prophet jg accepted the Jizyah from them and sent Abu Ubaydah bin Al-Jarrah with them as a trustee. Similar to this meaning is Allah's command to His Prophet gg to proclaim to the polytheists: iSay (O Muhammad jg) whoever is in error, the Most Gracious (Allah) will prolong him (in it). (19:75) meaning, Whoever among us has deviated, may Allah increase

Al-Bagarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) and prolong his deviation. We will mention this subject later, Allah willing. The Mubalahah (invocation to Allah to destroy the liars) was called a wish here, because every just person wishes that Allah destroy the unjust opponent who is debating with him, especially when the just person has a clear, apparent proof for the truth he is calling to. Also, the Mubalahah involves invoking Allah for death of the unjust group, because to disbelievers, life is the biggest prize, especially when they know the evil destination they will meet after death. Disbelievers wish They could live longer This is why Allah said next, iBut they will never long for it because of what their hands have done before them (i.e.what they have done). And Allah is Aware of the Zulumin. And verily, you will find among (the jews) the greediest of mankind for life meaning, greedy to live longer, because they know their evil end, and the only reward they will have with Allah is total loss. This life is a prison for the believer and Paradise for the disbeliever. Therefore, the People of the Book wish they could delay the Hereafter, as much as possible. However, they shall certainly meet what they are trying to avoid, even if they are more eager to delay the Hereafter than the polytheists who do not have a divine book. Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Ibn Abbas commented on, 4^4 St 4 But the grant of such life will not save him even a little from (due) punishment. \$ Long life shall not save them from torment. Certainly, the polytheists do not believe in resurrection after death, and they would love to enjoy a long life. The Jews know the humiliation they will suffer in the Hereafter for knowingly ignoring the truth. 111 Also, Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, The Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :288.

Jews are most eager for this life. They wish they could live for a thousand years. However, living for a thousand years will not save them from torment, just as Iblis - Satan - long life did not benefit him, due to being a disbeliever. Li j ^j i Atid Allah is Seer of what they do.} meaning, Allah knows what His servants are doing, whether good or evil, and will compensate each of them accordingly. Aj-b L"j Li Jil jiU i!ti" Je (Jj J Ijji & 'j-1* Cr* ,v 0!HS 497. Say (O Muhammad sg) : "Whoever is an enemy to Jibril (Gabriel) (let him die in his fury), for indeed he has brought it (this Qur'an) down to your heart by Allah's permission, confirming what came before it (i.e. the Tawrah and the Injil) and guidance and glad tidings for the believers}. 498. "Whoever is an enemy to Allah, His Angels, His Messengers, Jibril and Mikail, then verily, Allah is an enemy to the disbelievers."} The Jews are the Enemies of Jibril Imam Abu Ja'far bin Jarir At-Tabari said, The scholars of Tafsir agree that this Ayah (2: 97-98) was revealed in response to the Jews who claimed that Jibril (Gabriel) is an enemy of the Jews and that Mikail (Michael) is their friend. 121 Al-Bukhari said, Allah said, iWhoever is an enemy of Jibril (let him die in his fury)}. Ikrimah said, Jibr, Mik and Israfil all mean, worshipper, while Il means, Allah .

Anas bin Malik said, When Abdullah bin Salam heard of the arrival of the Prophet ﷺ in Al-Madinah, he was working on his land. He came to the Prophet ﷺ and said, I am going to ask you about three things which nobody knows except Allah. Tabari 2:376. Tabari 2:377.

On that Abdullah bin Salam said, I testify that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah and you are the Messenger of Allah. Abdullah bin Salam further said, O Allah's Messenger! The Jews are liars, and if they should come to know about my conversion to Islam before you ask them (about me), they will tell a lie about me. The Jews came to Allah's Messenger ﷺ, and Abdullah went inside the house. Allah's Messenger ﷺ asked (the Jews),

another chain of narration.' Some people say that il means worshipper while whatever word that is added to it becomes Allah's Name, because 'Il is a constant in such conjunction. This is similar to the names Abdullah, Abdur-Rahman, Abdul-Malik, Abdul-Quddus, Abdus-Salam, Abdul-Kafi, Abdul-Jalil, and so forth. Hence, Abd is constant in these compound names, while the remainder differs from name to name. This is the same case with Jibril, Mika'il, Azrael, Israfil, and so forth. Allah knows best. Choosing Some Angels to believe in over Others is Disbelieflike choosing Some Prophets over Others Allah said. [^]fil\ JU" Jc jyy /Cji C& ^Whoever is an enemy to Jibril (Gabriel) (let him die in his fury), for indeed he has brought it (this Qur'an) down to your heart by Allah's permission, meaning, whoever becomes an enemy of Jibril, let him know that he is Ruh Al-Qudus who brought down the Glorious Dhikr (Qur'an) to your heart from Allah by His leave. Hence, he is a messenger from Allah. Whoever takes a messenger as an enemy, will have taken all the messengers as enemies. Further, whoever believes in one messenger, is required to believe in all of the messengers. Whoever rejects one messenger, he has rejected all of the messengers. Similarly, Allah said, oty 4-JJ MS' [jV? o' -ijj jit / * * * - ^Verily, those who disbelieve in Allah and His Messengers and wish to make distinction between Allah and His Messengers (by believing in Allah and disbelieving in His Messengers) saying, "We believe in some but reject others/> (4:150) Allah decreed that they are disbelievers, because they believe in some Prophets and reject others. This is the same [i] Sahih Al-Bukhari 3329, 3911, 3938, and Muslim 315.

Al-Baqarah (75 - WO) (Part-1 with those who take Jibril as an enemy, because Jibril did not choose missions on his own, but by the command of his Lord, iAnd we (angels) descend not except by the command of your Lord> (19:64), and, iAnd truly, this (the Qur'an) is a revelation from the Lord of all that exists. Which the trustivorthy Riih (Jibril) has brought doivn. Upon your heart (O Muhammad ﷺ) that you may be (one) of the wamers} (26:192-194). Al-Bukhari reported that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, iai LJj y #Allah said, 'Whoever takes a friend of Mine as an enemy, tvill have started a war with Mt'J Therefore, Allah became angry with those who took Jibril as an enemy. Allah said, Ci Ui-ii jib Jiii 'f,j /du JpJwJ 'jj* ifo} iWhocver is an enemy to Jibril (Gabriel) (let him die in his fury), for indeed he has brought it (this Qur'an) down to your heart by Allah's permission, confirming what came before it} meaning, the previous Books, * 'V' iand guidance and glad tidings for the believers meaning, as guidance to their hearts and bringer of the good news of Paradise, which is exclusively for the believers. Similarly, Allah said, iSay : "It is for those who believe, a guide and a healing."} (41:44), and, Al-Bari 1 1 :348

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1 and earth and Knower of the seen and the unseen! You judge between Your servants regarding what they differ in, so direct me to the truth which they differ on, by Your leave. Verily, You guide whom You will to the straight path. Allah's statement, it then verily, Allah is an enemy to the disbelievers} informed the disbelievers that whoever takes a friend of Allah as an enemy, then he has taken Allah as an enemy, and whoever treats Allah as an enemy, then he shall be Allah's enemy. Indeed, whoever is an enemy of Allah then he will lose in this life and the Hereafter, as stated earlier; Jii J jSli- "Whoever takes a friend of Mine as an enemy, I shall wage war on &m ^ v\$8 & J44 & "S iTjj i(-S & 12 tfZa 5 &5j ujZ& \$ ijLdii ijS2 c v Uj Jp- jjji tj o-Uif Ojli ojyjjj l* l/i cji ij - Uj[jji CjULtf jp*i*j *i' jib -a, ^ bj "P' jib ^ ij 2 u * iU-yi a Ji u cp' ipti Jaij ,4iib IJjSJ; \pa j) 4 :<^Lz \}t 499. And indeed We have sent down to you manifest Ayat and none disbelieve in them but Fdsiqun (those who rebel against Allah's command).} 4100. Is it not (the case) that every time they make a covenant, some 1 :534 Al-Bari 1 1 :348.

320 Tafstr Ibn Kathir party among them throw it aside? Nay! (the truth is :) most of them believe not.} 4202. And when there came to them a Messenger from Allah (i.e. Muhammad confirming what was with them, a party of those who were given the Scripture threw away the Book of Allah behind their backs as if they did not know!) 4202. They followed what the Shaydtn (devils) gave out (falsely of the magic) in the lifetime of Sulayman (Solomon). Sulayman did not disbelieve, but the Shaydtn (devils) disbelieved teaching men magic and such things that came down at Babylon to the two angels, Hdriit and Mdrut, but neither of these two (angels) taught anyone (such things) till they had said, "We are for trial, so disbelieve not (by learning this magic from us)." And from these (angels) people learn that by which they cause separation between man and his wife, but they could not thus harm anyone except by Allah's leave. And they learn that which harms them and profits them not. And indeed they knew that the buyers of it (magic) would have no share in the Hereafter. And how bad indeed was that for which they sold their own selves, if they but knew.} 4103. And if they had believed and guarded themselves from evil and kept their duty to Allah, far better would have been the reward from their Lord, if they but knew!} maA u m" ^=uLJ \ JljAUj [/ CSpijib Cjt CiyXtCjJ -i' \pc 'jlfiytXX'j i ydAi \ jiLjt \yXXj\ifX>\ - - '< * 'j J^O'

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) Proofs of Muhammad's Prophethood Imam Abu Ja'far bin Jarir said that Allah's statement, g W i And indeed We have sent down to you manifest Ayafy means, We have sent to you, O Muhammad, clear signs that testify to your prophethood. These Ayat are contained in the Book of Allah (Qur'an) which narrates the secrets of the knowledge that the Jews possess, which they hid, and the stories of their earlier generations. The Book of Allah also mentions the texts in the Books of the Jews that are known to only the rabbis and scholars, and the sections where they altered and distorted the rulings of the Tawrah. Since Allah mentioned all of this in His Book revealed to His Prophet Muhammad jg, then this fact alone should be enough evidence for those who are truthful with themselves and who wish to avoid bringing themselves to destruction due to envy and transgression. Further human instinct testifies to the truth that Muhammad sg was sent with and the clear signs that he brought which he did not learn or acquire from mankind. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said that, 4^ p.i W i And indeed We have sent down to you manifest Aydfy means, You recite and convey this Book to them day and night, although you are an Ummi (unlettered) who never read a book. Yet, you inform them of what they have (in their own Books). Allah stated that this fact should serve as an example, a

clear sign and a proof against them, if they but knew. The Jews break Their Covenants When the Messenger of Allah ^{sg} was sent and Allah reminded the Jews of the covenant that they had with Him, especially concerning Muhammad ^{jg}, Malik bin As-Sayf said, By Allah! Allah never made a covenant with us about Muhammad, nor did He take a pledge from us at all. Allah then revealed, m At-Tabari 2 : 397

41s it not (the case) that every time they make a covenant, some party among them throw it aside?}li] Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that Allah s statement, iNay! (the truth is :) most of them believe not means, There is not a promise that they make, but they break it and abandon it. They make a promise today and break it tomorrow. 121 The Jews abandoned the Book of Allah and practiced Magic As-Suddi commented on, a, 3 if Si 4And when there came to them a Messenger from Allah (i.e. Muhammad confirming what was with thanK When Muhammad ^{jg} came to them, they wanted to contradict and dispute with him using the Tawrah. However, the Tawrah and the Qur an affirmed each other. So the Jews gave up on using the Torah, and took to the Book of Asaf,¹³ ' and the magic of Harut and Marut, which indeed did not conform to the Qur an. Hence Allah s statement, \$As if they did not know!}. Also, Qatadah said that Allah s statement, 46jt& V ^As if they did not knowfy means, They knew the truth but abandoned it, hid it and denied the fact that they even had it. > At-Tabari 2 :400 > Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 295. ^ Lisan Al-Arab lists Asaf as the name of the Book revealed to the Prophet Sulaym&n, peace be upon him. See also the explanation that follows Tabari 2 :404 |s| Ibid.

Al-Baaarah (101 - 124) (Part-1 Magic existed before Sulayman (Solomon) As-Suddi said that Allah s statement, \ja c iThey jblozoed what the Shayatin (devils) gave out (falsely of the magic) in the lifetime ofSulayman} means, During the time of Prophet Solomon. Beforehand, the devils used to ascend to heaven and eavesdrop on the conversations of the angels about what will occur on the earth

regarding death, other incidents or unseen matters. They

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 313–335]

would convey this news to the soothsayers, and the soothsayers would in turn convey the news to the people. The people would believe what the soothsayers told them as being true. When the soothsayers trusted the devils, the devils started to lie to them and added other words to the true news that they heard, to the extent of adding seventy false words to each true word. The people recorded these words in some books. Soon after, the Children of Israel said that the Jinns know matters of the Unseen. When Solomon was sent as a Prophet, he collected these books in a box and buried it under his throne; any devil that dared get near the box was burned. Solomon said, will not hear of anyone who says that the devils know the Unseen, but I will cut off his head. When Solomon died and the scholars who knew the truth about Solomon perished, there came another generation. To them, the devil materialized in the shape of a human and said to some of the Children of Israel, Should I lead you to a treasure that you will never be able to use up? They said. Yes. He said, T)ig under this throne, and he went with them and showed them Solomon s throne. They said to him, Come closer. He said, No. I will wait for you here, and ifyou do not find the treasure then kill me. They dug and found the buried books, and Satan said to them, Solomon only controlled the humans, devils and birds with this magic. Thereafter, the news that Solomon was a sorcerer spread among the people, and the Children of Israel adopted these books.

When Muhammad came, they disputed with him relying on these books. Hence Allah's statement, "Lidi Uj"

iSulayman did not disbelieve, but the Shayatfn (devils) disbelieved}. The Story of Harut and Marut, and the Explanation that They were Angels Allah said, Ji. Uj ejyyk JAi Jp J>' 4Awf swell filings that came down at Babylon to the two angels, Harut and Marut, but neither of these two (angels) taught anyone (such things) till they had said, "We are for trial, so disbelieve not (by learning this magic from us)." And from these (angels) people learn that by which they cause separation between man and his wife}. There is a difference of opinion regarding this story. It was said that this Ayah denies that anything was sent down to the two angels, as Al-Qurtubi stated and then referred to the Ayah, iSulayman did not disbelieve} saying, The negation applies in both cases. Allah then said, 4cf =dl)' Jc Jjli tj iBut the Shaydtin (devils) disbelieved, teaching men magic and such things fluff came down at Babylon to the turn angels}. The Jews claimed that Gabriel and Michael brought magic down to the two angels, but Allah refuted this false claim. ' Also, Ibn Jarir reported, that Al-'Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said about Allah's statement, Jt Jy\ LJ" iAnd such things that came down at Babylon to the two angels} Allah did not send magic down. ' Also, Ibn Jarir narrated that Ar-Rabi bin Anas said about, Tabari 2:405. * Al-Qurtubi 2 :50 3| At-Tabari 2:419.

(> jjii tj)> si/c/i things that came down to the two angels>, Allah did not send magic down to them. 1 11 Ibn Janr commented, This is the correct explanation for this Ayah. {They followed what the Shaydtin (devils) gave out (falsely) in the lifetime of Sulayman. \$ meaning, magic. However, neither did Solomon disbelieve nor did Allah send magic with the two angels. The devils, on the other hand, disbelieved and taught magic to the people of the Babylon of Harut and Marut. Ibn Janr continued; If someone asks about explaining this Ayah in this manner, we say that, vilii& iThey followed what the Slstaydtiti (devils) gave out (falsely) in the lifetime of Sulayman means, magic. Solomon neither disbelieved nor did Allah send magic with the two angels. However, the devils disbelieved and taught magic to the people in the Babylon of Harut and Marut, meaning Gabriel and Michael, for Jewish sorcerers claimed that Allah sent magic by the words of Gabriel and Michael to Solomon, son of David. Allah denied this false claim and stated to His Prophet Muhammad jg that Gabriel and Michael were not sent with magic. Allah also exonerated Solomon from practicing magic, which the devils taught to the people of Babylon by the hands of two men, Harut and Marut. Hence, Harut and Marut were two ordinary men (not angels or Gabriel or Michael). 121 These were the words of At-Tabari, and this explanation is not plausible. Many among the Salaf, said that Harut and Marut were angels who came down from heaven to earth and did what they did as the Ayah stated. To conform this opinion with the fact that the angels are immune from error, we say that Allah had eternal knowledge what these angels would do, just as He At-Tabari 2:419. 121 Ibid.

had eternal knowledge that Iblls would do as he did, while Allah referred to him being among the angels, 4And (remember) when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves before Adam." And they prostrated except Iblis (Satan), he refused^ (20 :116) and so forth. However, what Harut and Marut did was less evil than what Iblls, may Allah curse him, did. Al-Qurtubi reported this opinion from Ali, Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn Abbas, Ibn Umar, Ka*b Al-Ahbar, As-Suddi and Al-Kalbi. Learning Magic is Kufr Allah said, ^ Vilii (ft Cil Vyj aJ iBut neither of these two (angels) taught anyone (such things) till they had said, "We

are for trial, so disbelieve not (by learning this magic from us).} Abu Ja'far Ar-Razi said that Ar-Rabi bin Anas said that Qays bin Abbad said that Ibn Abbas said, When someone came to the angels to learn magic, they would discourage him and say to him, *We are only a test, so do not fall into disbelief. They had knowledge of what is good and evil and what constitutes belief or disbelief, and they thus knew that magic is a form of disbelief. When the person who came to learn magic still insisted on learning it, they commanded him to go to such and such place, where if he went, Satan would meet him and teach him magic. When this man would learn magic, the light (of faith) would depart him, and he would see it shining (and flying away) in the sky. He would then proclaim, O my sorrow! Woe unto me! What should I do?. ' Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that this Ayah means, The angels were sent with magic, so that the people whom Allah willed would be tried and tested. Allah made them promise that they would not teach anyone until first proclaiming, We are a test * * Al-Qurtubi 2 :51 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1:312.

Surah 2, Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) 317 for you, do not fall into disbelief.)1 ' It was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Also, Qatadah said, Allah took their covenant to not teach anyone magic until they said, We are a test. Therefore, do not fall in disbelief. 121 Also, As-Suddi said, When a man would come to the two angels they would advise him, Do not fall into disbelief. We are a test. When the man would ignore their advice, they would say, Go to that pile of ashes and urinate on it. When he would urinate on the ashes, a light, meaning the light of faith, would depart from him and would shine until it entered heaven. Then something black that appeared to be smoke would descend and enter his ears and the rest of his body, and this is Allah's anger. When he told the angels what happened, they would teach him magic. So Allah's statement, iBut neither of these two (angels) taught anyone (such things) till they had said, "We are for trial, so disbelieve not (by learning this magic from us) ,'^3 Sunayd said that Hajjaj said that Ibn Jurayj commented on this Ayah (2:102), No one dares practice magic except a disbeliever. As for the Fitnah, it involves trials and freedom of choice. 14 ' The scholars who stated that learning magic is disbelief relied on this Ayah for evidence. They also mentioned the Hadith that Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar recorded from Abdullah, which states, 1Whoever came to a soothsayer or a sorcerer and believed in what he said, will have disbelieved in what Allah revealed to Muhammad This Hadith has an authentic chain of narration and there are other Hadiths which support it. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:310 At-Jabari 2 :443 At-Tabari 2:443. 141 Ibid. ,S| Kashaf Al-Astar 2 :443

Causing a Separation between the Spouses is One of the Effects of Magic Allah said, 4And from these (angels) people learn that by which they cause separation between man and his wife,} This means, The people learned magic from Harut and Marut and indulged in evil acts that included separating spouses, even though spouses are close to, and intimately associate with each other. This is the devil's work.

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) iBut they could not thus harm anyone except by Allah's leave}. Sufyan Ath-Thawri commented, Except by Allah's appointed term. ' Further, Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that, ii, iBut they could not thus harm anyone except by Allah's leave means, Allah allows magicians to adversely affect whomever He wills and saves whomever He wills from them. Sorcerers never bring harm to anyone except by Allah's leave. Allah's statement, 4*^ . ^ of rzmj And they learn that which harms them and profits them not.} means, it harms their religion and does not have a benefit compared to its harm. && 4 \$ ^ SJdj} 4And indeed they knew that the buyers of it (magic) would have no (Khalaq) share in the Hereafter.} meaning, The Jews who preferred magic over following the

Messenger of Allah knew that those who commit the same error shall have no Khalaq in the Hereafter. Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and As-Suddi stated that no Khalaq means, *no share. Allah then said, 4And hmo bad indeed was that for which they sold their own selves, if they but kneiv. And if they had believed and guarded themselves from evil and kept their duty to Allah, far better would have been the reward from their Lord, if they but knew!}. Allah stated, 4And hoxx bad} meaning, what they preferred, magic, instead of faith and following the Messenger, if they but comprehend the * ! * Ibn Abi Hatim 1:312. Ibn Abi Hatim 1:311. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :314.

advice. 4jf*~ jSjA"d if they had believed and guarded thetnselvesfrom evil and kept their duty to Allah, far better would have been the reward from their Lord,} meaning, Had they believed in Allah and His Messenger aS and avoided the prohibitions, then Allah s reward for these good deeds would have been better for them than what they chose and preferred for themselves. Similarly, Allah said, ' j*. L>y i \yf Jfij} 4> 'il iBut those who had been given (religious) knowledge said: 'Woe to you! The reward of Allah (in the Hereafter) is better for those who believe and do righteous good deeds, and this none shall attain except As-Sabirun (the patient in following the truth)."} (28:80). oi^ % d % ji ii'j *t S if liif} if yt-4104. O you who believe! Say not (to the Messenger s&j Raind but say Unzumd (make us understand) and hear. And for tlte disbelievers there is a painful torment.} 4105. Neither those who disbelieve among the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) nor Al-Mushrikin (the idolaters) like that there should be sent down unto you any good from your Lord. But Allah chooses for His mercy whom He wills. And Allah is the Owner ofgreat bounty.} Manners in Speech Allah forbade His believing servants from imitating the behavior and deeds of the disbelievers. The Jews used to use devious words that hide what they really meant. May Allah s curse be upon them. When they wanted to say, hear us, they would use the word Rd ind, which is an insult (in Hebrew, but means hear us in Arabic). Allah said,

it would have been better for them, and more proper; but Allah cursed them for tlteir disbelief, so they believe not except a feiv\$ (4:46). Also, the Hadiths stated that when they would greet Muslims, they would say, As-Samu alaykum, meaning, death be to you . This is why we were commanded to answer them by saying, Wa alaykum, meaning, and to you too , then our supplication against them shall be answered, rather than theirs against us. Allah forbade the believers from imitating the disbelievers in tongue or deed. Allah said, 'i \p\ : /j!' iO you who believe! Say not (to the Messenger Rd'ind but say Unzurnd (make us understand) and hear. And for the disbelievers there is a painful torment (2:104). Also, Imam Ahmad narrated that Ibn Umar said that the Messenger of Allah sB said, vlb^i 't lli-j v_4ll3L ii-lUl CUjI Ute- jU ./illj aJLSI

322 Tafeir Ibn Kathir whoever imitates a people, he is one of //lem. Abu Dawud narrated that the Prophet jg said, J*' "Whoever imitates a people is one of them. These Hadiths indicate, along with their threats and warnings, that we are not allowed to imitate the disbelievers in their statements, deeds, clothes, feasts, acts ofworship, etc., whatever actions ofthe disbelievers thatwere not legislated for us. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, 4Say not (to the Messenger j||) Ra'ina} They used to say to the Prophet jg, Ar'ina samak (which is an insult). * Ibn Abu Hatim said that it was reported that Abu Al-'Aliyah, Abu Malik, Ar-Rabl bin Anas, Atiyah Al- Awfi and Qatadah said similarly. ' Further, Mujahicl said, T not say Ra'ina' means, Do not dispute . 151 Mujahid said in another narration, Do not say, *We hear from you, and you hear from us. Also, Ata said, Do not say, iRa'ina},

which was a dialect that the Ansar used and which was forbidden from use by Allah. 16 Also, As-Suddi said, Rifa'ah bin Zayd, a Jewish man from the tribe of Qaynuqa*, used to come to the Prophet and say to him, Hear, Ghayr Musma in (let you hear nothing). The Muslims used to think that the Prophets are greeted and honored with this type of speech, and this is why some of them used to say, Hear, let you hear nothing, and so on, as mentioned in Surat An-Nisa. Thereafter, Allah forbade the believers from uttering the word Ra'ina. Abdur-Rahman bin (I * Ahmad 2:50. * Abu Dawud 4 :314. * At-Tabari 2 :461 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :317. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :318. * Ibid. * At-Tabari 2:462.

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) Zayd bin Aslam also said similarly. The extreme Enmity that the Disbelievers and the People of the Book have against Muslims Allah said next (2:105), if /~ if SjS J ^ ^ v Si ^ M> iNeither those who disbelieve among the People of the Scripture (Jeu and Christians) nor Al-Mushrikfn (the idolaters), like that there should be sent down unto you any good from your Lord}. Allah described the deep enmity that the disbelieving polytheists and People of the Scripture, whom Allah warned against imitating, have against the believers, so that Muslims should sever all friendship with them. Also, Allah mentioned what He granted the believers of the perfect Law that He legislated for their Prophet Muhammad jg. Allah said, iBut Allah chooses for His mercy whom He wills. And Allah is the Owner of great bounty^ (2:105). t,L ofe '.4.-1 : jl ol. jwj C tlj if\$ if Lj ojuVlj lilii \$ iit fui jiii J/ji 4106. Whatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh (We abrogate) or Nunsihd (cause to be forgotten), We bring a better one or similar to it. Kncnv you not that Allah is Able to do all things?} 4W7. Know you not that it is Allah to Whom belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth? And besides Allah you have neither any Wall (protector or guardian) nor any helper.} The Meaning of Naskh Ibn Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said that, [i] Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :965

bt -* 4Whatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh} means, Whatever an Ayah We abrogate. Also, Ibn Jurayj said that Mujahid said that, ^#5'* bt Whatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh> means, Whatever an Ayah We erase. Also, Ibn Abi Najlh said that Mujahid said that, b\ 4Whatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh} means, We keep the words, but change the meaning. He related these words to the companions of Abdullah bin Mas'ud.131 Ibn Abi Hatim said that similar statements were mentioned by Abu Al- Aliyah and Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi. Also As-Suddi said that, bi ^ iWhatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh} means, We erase it. Further, Ibn Abi Hatim said that it means, Erase and Tabari 2 :473 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:321. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :322. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 322 151 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :322. at bt \bj () y'1' 1liiii " *> s*s ' > * ,<.t-s / - / ><{ A " *X<

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) raise it, such as erasing the following wordings (from the Qur an), The married adulterer and the married adulteress: stone them to death, and, *If the son of Adam had two valleys of gold, he would seek a third. " Ibn Jarir stated that, 4#5'* hi ^ ^Whatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh) means, Whatever ruling we repeal in an Ayah by making the allowed unlawful and the unlawful allowed. The Nasakh only occurs with commandments, prohibitions, permissions, and so forth. As for stories, they do not undergo Nasakh. The word, *Nasakh literally means, to copy a book . The meaning of Nasakh in the case of commandments is removing the commandment and replacing it by another. And whether the Nasakh involves the wordings, the ruling or both, it is still called Nasakh. Allah said next, ior Nunsiha (cause it to be forgotten)). *Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said that, ^ &" hi 4Whatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh or Nunsiha) means, Whatever Ayah We repeal

or uphold without change. * Also, Mujahid said that the companions of Ibn Mas'ud (who read this word Nansa ha) said that it means, We uphold its wording and change its ruling. * Further, *Ubayd bin T'Jayr, Mujahid and Ata said, Nansa'ha. means, We delay it (i.e., do not abrogate it). * Further, Atiyyah Al- Awfi said that the Ayah means, We delay repealing it." * This is the same Tafsir provided by As- Suddi and Ar-Rabi bin Anas. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :324. * At-Tabari 1 :472 * At-Tabari 2:476. * At-Tabari 2:473. * At-Tabari 2:477. * Ibid. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :326

327Siirah 2. Al-Bacjarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) Wall (protector or guardian) nor any helper Allah directed His servants to the fact that He alone is the Owner of His creatures and that He does with them as He wills. Indeed, His is the supreme authority and all creation is His, and just as He created them as He wills, He brings happiness to whom He wills, misery to whom He wills, health to whom He wills and ailment to whom He wills. He also brings success to whom He wills and failure to whom He wills. He judges between His servants as He wills, allows what He wills and disallows what He wills. He decides what He wills, there is no opponent for His judgment, and no one can question Him about what He does, while they shall be questioned. He tests His servants and their obedience to His Messengers by the Naskh. He commands a matter containing a benefit which He knows of, and then He out of His wisdom, prohibits it. Hence, perfect obedience is realized by adhering to His commands, following His Messengers, believing in what ever they convey, implementing their commands and avoiding what they prohibit. The statements of Allah here contain tremendous benefit, prove that the Jews are disbelievers and refute their claim that Naskh does not occur, may Allah curse the Jews. In ignorance and arrogance they claimed that the sound mind stipulates that Naskh does not occur. Some of them falsely claimed that there are divine texts that dismiss the possibility that Naskh occurred. Imam Abu JaTar bin Jarir said, The Ayah means, Do you not know, O Muhammad, that I alone own the heavens and the earth and that I decide whatever I will in them? I forbid whatever I will, change and repeal whatever I will of My previous rulings, whenever I will. I also uphold whatever I will. Ibn Jarir then said, Although Allah directed His statement indicating His greatness towards His Prophet zg He also rejected the lies of the Jews who denied that the rulings of the Torah could undergo Naskh. The Jews also denied the prophethood of Jesus and Muhammad, because of their dislike for what they brought from Allah, such as changing some rulings of the Torah, as Allah commanded. Allah thus proclaimed to the Jews that He owns the heavens and earth

328 Tafsir Ibt' Kathir and also all authority in them. Further, the subjects in Allah s kingdom are His creation, and they are required to hear and obey His commands and prohibitions. Allah has full authority to command the creation as He wills, forbidding them from what He wills, abrogate what He wills, uphold what He wills, and decide whatever commandments and prohibitions He wills. 111 I (Ibn Kathir) say that the Jews dismissal of the occurrence of the Naskh is only a case of their disbelief and rebellion. The sound mind does not deny that there could be a Naskh in Allah s commandments, for He decides what He wills, just as He does what He wills. Further, Naskh occurred in previous Books and Law. For instance, Allah allowed Adam to marry his daughters to his sons and then later forbade this practice. Allah also allowed Nuh to eat from all kinds of animals after they left the ark, then prohibited eating some types of foods. Further, marrying two sisters to one man was allowed for Israel and his children, but Allah prohibited this practice later in the Torah. Allah commanded Abraham to slaughter his son, then repealed that command before it was implemented. Also, Allah commanded the Children

of Israel to kill those who worshipped the calf and then repealed that command, so that the Children of Israel were not all exterminated. There are many other instances that the Jews admit have occurred, yet they ignore them. Also, it is a well-known fact that their Books foretold about Muhammad jg and contained the command to follow him. These texts, in their Books, indicate that the Jews were required to follow the Prophet Muhammad sg and that no good deed would be accepted from them, unless it conformed to Muhammad s Law. The Prophet jg brought another Book, - the Qur an -, which is the last revelation from Allah. s X4 at i3~' (S 3 Oil 4108. Or do you want to ask your Messenger (Muhammad as Musa (Moses) was asked before (i.e. show us openly our Lord)? And he who changes faith for disbelief, verily, he has At-Tabari 2 :488

gone astray from the right way.} The Prohibition of Unnecessary Questions In this Ayah, Allah forbade the believers from asking the Prophet jg numerous questions about matters that did not occur yet. Similarly, Allah said, Iji 4 j], i 3 v \p: ip4^ iO you who believe! Ask not about things which, if made plain to you, may cause you trouble. But if you ask about them while the Qur an is being revealed, they will be made plain to you} (5:101). This Ayah means, If you ask about a matter after it is revealed, it shall be duly explained to you. Therefore, do not ask about matters that have not occurred yet, for they might become prohibited, due to your questions. This is why the Sahah narrated. 77ie greatest criminal among the

iLeave me as I leave you; those before you were only destroyed because of their excessive questioning and disputing with their Prophets. Therefore, when I command you with a matter, adhere to it as much as you can, and when I forbid from something, avoid it." The Prophet ag only said this after he told the Companions that Allah has ordered them to perform Hajj. A man asked, Every year, O Messenger of Allah? The Prophet jg did not answer him, but he repeated his question three times. Then the Prophet jgg said, 'J&~. I ui \$J fai .it aNo. Had I said yes, it would have been ordained, and you would not have been able to implement tfV This is why Anas bin Malik said, We were forbidden from asking the Messenger of Allah jg about things. So we were delighted when a bedouin man would come and ask him while we listened. 121 Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Muhammad bin Abi Muhammad told him that Ikrimah or Said said that Ibn Abbas said that RafT bin Huraymilah or Wahb bin Zayd said, O Muhammad! Bring us a Book sent down from heaven and which we could read, and make some rivers flow for us, then we will follow you and believe in you. Allah sent down the answer to this challenge, j'4 m ill iOr do you want to ask your Messenger (Muhammad as Musa was asked before (i.e. show us openly our Lord)? And he who changes faith for disbelief, verily, he has gone astray from the right way^)^ Allah criticized those who ask the Messenger of Allah jg about a certain matter just for the purpose of being difficult, just as the Children of Israel asked Musa out of stubbornness, Muslim 2:975. 1 :4Tabari 2:490.

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) rejection and rebellion. Allah said. 4-^-? 4And he who changes faith for disbelief} meaning, whoever prefers disbelief to faith, iTjl iverily, he has gone astray from the right way} meaning, he has strayed from the straight path, to the path of ignorance and misguidance. This is the case of those who deviated from accepting the Prophets and obeying them and those who kept asking their Prophets unnecessary questions in defiance and disbelief, just as Allah said, aii c.'lmt jwi' J! il iHave you not seen those who have changed the blessings of Allah into disbelief (by denying Prophet

Muhammad ^{sg} and his Message of Islam), and caused their people to dwell in the house of destruction? Hell, in which they will burn and what an evil place to settle in!} (14:28-29). Abu Al- Aliyah commented, They exchanged comfort for hardship. 111 xj> -ja -jJu bi 4-j^ CJt ^S} & iii lit qt gf- iyutifj dri ^ b* ^ ijii id Uj ij'o ijfcatt 4 v4 Cj -i' 6) 4109. Many of the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) wish that they could turn you away as disbelievers after you have believed, out of envy from their own selves, even after the truth (that Muhammad ^{sg} is Allah's Messenger) has become manifest unto them. But forgive and overlook, till Allah brings His command. Verily, Allah is able to do all things.} 4110. And perform the Salah and give the Zakah, and whatever 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :330.

332 Tafstr Ibn Kathir of good you send forth for yourselves before you, you shall find it with Allah. Certainly, Allah is the Seer of what you do.}

The Prohibition of following the Ways of the People of the Book Allah warned His believing servants against following the ways of the People of Book, who publicly and secretly harbor enmity and hatred for the believers, and who envy the believers, while they recognize the virtue of the believers and their Prophet ^{ig}. Allah also commanded His believing servants to forgive them and to be patient with them, until Allah delivers His aid and victory to them. Allah commanded the believers to perform the prayer perfectly, to pay the Zakah and He encouraged them to preserve the practice of these righteous deeds. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abdullah bin Ka*b bin Malik said that Ka*b bin Al-Ashraf, who was a Jew and a poet, used to criticize the Prophet ^{ig} in his poems, so Allah revealed, iMany of the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) wish that they could turn you away..} regarding his matter. 11 Also, Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said, An unlettered Messenger came to the People of the Scriptures confirming what they have in their own Books about the Messengers and the Ayat of Allah. He also believes in all of this, just as they believe in it. Yet, they rejected the Prophet out of disbelief, envy and transgression. This is why Allah said, \$ } iout of envy from their mvn selves, even after the truth (that Muhammad ^{sg} is Allah's Messenger) has become manifest unto them}. Allah said that after He illuminated the truth for them, such that they were not ignorant of any of it, yet their envy made them deny the Prophet ^{ig}. Thus Allah criticized, chastised and !i| Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :331

333Sura 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) denounced them. Allah legislated the characteristics that His Prophet and the believers should adhere to: belief, faith and accepting what Allah revealed to them and to those before them out of His generosity and tremendous kindness. Ar-Rabl bin Anas said that, ifrom their own selves} means, of their making. 12 Also, Abu Al- Aliyah said that, jt+i IS ieven after the truth (that Muhammad ^{ig} is Allah's Messenger) has become manifest unto them > means, After it became clear that Muhammad ^{ig} is the Messenger of Allah whom they find written of in the Torah and the Injill. They denied him in disbelief and transgression because he was not one of them. 31 Qatadah and Ar-Rabl bin Anas said similarly.14 Allah said, iBut forgive and overlook, till Allah brings His command.} this is similar to His saying; os U iAnd you shall certainly hear much that will grieve you from those who received the Scripture before you (Jews and Christians) and from tlxose who ascribe partners to Allah (3:186). Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said that Allah's statement, iBut forgive and overlook, till Allah brings His command.} was abrogated by the Ayah, At-Tabari 2:502. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :332. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :335. 141 Ibid.

4Then kill the Mushrikin wherever you find them) (9:5), and, ^/d against those who believe not in Allah, nor in the Last Day) (9:29) until, j) iAndfeel themselves subdued) (9:29). Allah s pardon for the disbelievers was repealed. Abu Al- Aliyah, Ar-Rabi* bin Anas, Qatadah and As-Suddi said similarly: It was abrogated by the Ayah of the sword." (Mentioned above). The Ayah, iil &~) itill Allah brings His command.) gives further support for this view, Ibn Abi Hatim recorded Usamah bin Zayd saying that the Messenger of Allah and his Companions used to forgive the disbelievers and the People of the Book, just as Allah commanded in His statement, HA l\ & oh& i &) 4But forgive and overlook, till Allah brings His command. Verily, Allah is able to do all things). The Messenger of Allah 3g used to forgive them and was patient with them as Allah ordered him, until Allah allowed fighting them. Then Allah destroyed those who He decreed to be killed among the strong men of Quraysh, by the Prophet s forces.¹³¹ The chain of narration for this text is Sahih, but I did not see its wordings in the six collections of Hadith, although the basis of it is in the Two Sahihs, narrated from Usamah bin Zayd.¹⁴¹ Ibn Abi Hfitim 1:334. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :335 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :333 Fath Al-Bari 8 :87 , and Muslim 3 : 1422

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) The Encouragement to perform Good Deeds Allah said, i%\ lie ij'4 jZ. m 1 "to !>.j SjpfcSIT 4And perform the Salah and give the Zakah, and whatever of good you send forth for yourselves before you, you shall find it with Allah}. Allah encouraged the believers to busy themselves in performing deeds that would bring them benefit and reward on

the Day of Resurrection, such as prayer and paying Zakah.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 335–359]

This way, they will gain Allah s aid in this life and on a Day when the witnesses testify, 4: ijt jj+jj pjJZ UA0 1 ' } 4The Day when their excuses will be of no profit to the Zdlimin (wrongdoers). Theirs will be the curse, and theirs will be the evil abode (i.e. painful torment in Hell-fire)} (40:52). This is why Allah said, 4Certainly , Allah sees what you do}, meaning, that He is never unaware of the deeds of any person, nor will these deeds be lost by Him. Whether deeds are righteous or evil, Allah will award each according to what he or she deserves based on their deeds. \j& ji d&i if ^ Jij ij tj} o f* A fffj if oj vJUj ff ij+ii cJI"j (f 'ij VJ -fj oyOZt tfjt JIS Jil'jST ofx jJLj "; Isflji 4 ."r . Ll-> < 4121. And they say, ",None shall enter Paradise unless he be a Jezo or a Christian. These are their own desires. Say (O Muhammad jg), "Produce your Burhdn ifyou are truthful. } 4122. Yes! But whoever submits his face (himself) to Allah (i.e. follows Allah's religion of Islamic Monotheism) and he is a Multsin then his reward is with his Lord (Allah), on such shall

be no fear, nor shall they grieve. 4223. The Jews said that the Christians follow nothing (i.e. are not on the right religion); and the Christians said that the Jews fallow (i.e. are not on the right religion) ; though they both recite the Scripture. Like unto their word, said those (the pagans) who know not. Allah will judge between them on the Day of Resurre- tion about that wherein they have been differing.} The Hopes of the People ofthe Book Allah made the confusion of the Jews and the Christians clear, since they claim that no one will enter Paradise, unless he is a Jew or a Christian. Similarly, Allah mentioned their claims in Surat Al-Md idah: 4We are the children ofAllah and His loved ones (5:18). Allah refuted this false claim and informed them that they will be punished because of their sins.

Previously we mentioned their claim that the Fire would not touch them for more than a few days, after which they would be put in Paradise. Allah rebuked this claim, and He said about this baseless claim, *mm 'A liKP J (^* uJfij J\ S QjJl^ (jjft (1) SjV f (" J? :'- J **\Ap t ljp j&i ' >. ' ivirijlT'A \cIjji*

{These are their man desires}. Abu Al-'Aliyah commented, These are wishes that they wished Allah would answer, without basis. * Similar was stated by Qatadah and Ar-RabT bin Anas.¹² * Allah then said, *4Sm/^* meaning, Say O Muhammad: *4"Produce your Burhati ..."* meaning, Your proof , as Abu Al- 'Aliyah, Mujahid, As-Suddi and Ar-RabI' bin Anas stated.¹³¹ Qatadah said that the Ayah means, Bring the evidence that supports your statement, if you are truthful in your claim. ¹⁴¹ Allah then said, *k o*&}* iYes! But whoever subtnits hisface (himself) to Allah (i.e.follows Allah's religion ofIslamicMonotheism) and he is aMuhsin} meaning, Whoever performs deeds in sincerity, for Allah alone without partners. In a similar statement, Allah said, *4^* c^j k ty}* ⁴So if they dispute with you (Muhamtnad say: "I have submitted myself to Allah (in Islam), and (so have) those who follow me. } (3:20) Abu Al-'Aliyah and Ar-RabI' said that, *4k jfcJ ik&}* ⁴Yes! But whoever submits his face (himself) to Allah} means, Whoever is sincere with Allah. *sl Ibn Abi Hatim 1:336. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :336. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :337 141 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:337. 151 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :337*

This Hadith was recorded by Muslim. ¹²¹ Therefore, the good deeds of the priests and rabbis will not be accepted, even if they are sincerely for Allah alone, because these deeds do not conform with the method of the Messenger who was sent for all mankind. Allah said regarding such cases, *tii ylt U \Ujij}* iAnd We shall turn to whatever deeds they (disbelievers, polytheists, sinners) did, and We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust.} (25:23) *Jj*) ififij}* ⁴As for those who disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert. The thirsty one thinks it to be water, until he comes up to it, he finds it to be nothing.} (24:39) and. *1 / / / * > ' , / / * < f ^ T * , ; * } * ^ vIv'AST' v^*

³³⁹Siirah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) They will enter in the hot blazing Fire. They will be given to drink from a boiling spring} (88:2-5). When the deed conforms to the Shari'ah outwardly, but the person did not perform it sincerely for Allah alone, the deed will also be rejected, as in the case of the hypocrites and those who do their deeds to show off. Similarly, Allah said, *Oji' JLS ijili lilj Si' 6)^ -fa .ii* iVerily, the hypocrites seek to deceive Alldlt, but it is He Who deceives them. And when they stand up for As-Salah (the prayer), they stand with laziness to be seen by people, and they do not remember Allah but little.} (4:142) and, iSo woe unto those performers of Saldh (prayers) (hypocrites). Those who delay their Saldh (from their stated fixed times). Those who do good deeds only to be seen (of men). And withhold Al-Md'tin (small kindnesses)} (107:4-7). This is why Allah said, *ifj 4/ i Vj W-w* .Ay ' }* \f~Jm of & } ⁴So whoever hopes for the meeting with his Lord, let him work righteousness and associate none as a partner in the worship of his Lord} (18:110). He also said in this Ayah, *yj A pli' O* dr!?* iYes, but whoever submits his face (himself) to Allah (follows Allah's religion ofIslamic Monotheism) and he is a Multsin}. Allah s statement, iShall have their reward with their Lord, on them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve} guaranteed them the rewards and safety from what they fear and should avoid.

iThere shall be no fear on them} in the future, *4t>&. 'is}* inor shall they grieve} about what they abandoned in the past. Moreover, Said bin Jubayr said, in**& 'At "iThere shall be no fear on them} in the Hereafter, and *4"&. j* lit* inor shall they grieve} about their imminent death. The Jews and

Christians dispute among themselves out of Disbelief and Stubbornness Allah said, p-*J }& }li- iS^d.I' lyJUj^ iThe Jews said that the Christians follow nothing (i.e. are not on the right religion); and the Christians said that the Jews follow nothing (i.e. are not on the right religion); though they both recite the Scripture.} Allah explained the disputes, hatred and stubbornness that the People of the Book have towards each other. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas said, When a delegation of Christians from Najran came to the Messenger of Allah jfe, the Jewish rabbis came and began arguing with them before the Messenger of Allah 5^ . Rafi bin Huraymilah said, *You do not follow anything, and he reiterated his disbelief in Jesus and the Injll. Then a Christian man from Najran s delegation said to the Jews, Rather, you do not follow anything, and he reiterated his rejection of Musa s prophethood and his disbelief in the Torah. So Allah revealed the Ayah, m Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :338

jiiij & iji yJSJ JJ- -X, It *jif }The Jews said that the Christians follow nothing (i.e. are not on the right religion); and the Christians said that the Jews follow nothing (i.e. are not on the right religion); though they both recite the Scripture.y^ Allah made it clear that each party read the affirmation of what they claimed to reject in their Book. Consequently, the Jews disbelieve in Jesus, even though they have the Torah in which Allah took their Covenant by the tongue of Moses to believe in Jesus. Also, the Gospel contains Jesus assertion that Moses prophethood and the Torah came from Allah. Yet, each party disbelieved in what the other party had. Allah said, y j ; Y 4Like unto their word, said those who know not} thus exposing the ignorance displayed by the Jews and the Christians concerning their statements that we mentioned. There is a difference of opinion regarding the meaning of Allah s statement, iwho know not} For instance, Ar-Rabl bin Anas and Qatadah said that, i&t, V IS jli iLike unto their word, said tlwse said those who know not means, The Christians said similar statements to the Jews. 121 Ibn Jurayj asked Ata Who are those who know not? Ata said, Nations that existed before the Jews and the Christians and before the Torah and the Gospel. 131 Also, As- Suddi said that, l 1 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 339. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :341 ,3] Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :340

They said, Whoever killed our fathers at Badr, shall never enter it while there is one of us alive. Allah s statement. iand strive for their ruin) means those who prevent whoever maintain the Masjids with Allah s remembrance and who visit Allah s House to perform Hajj and C/mrah. 1 1 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said that the Quraysh prevented the Prophet from praying at the Ka'bah in Al-Masjid Al-Haram, so Allah revealed, ^ 'ti

Masjids?} After Allah chastised the Jews and Christians, He also criticized the idolaters who expelled the Messenger of Allah jg and his Companions from Makkah, preventing them from praying in Al-Masjid Al-Haram, which they kept exclusively for their idols and polytheism. Allah said, 'i ^ & 'Jl 4Awd why should not Allah punish them tohile they hinder (men) from Al-Masjid Al-Haram, and they are not its guardians? None can be its guardians except Al-Muttaqiin (the pious), but most of them know not.} (8:34) jjfi 'irixjpU 4ii ip { -* c? fyfi C^* Cr* ^ v*- - ^t r* jj >+* *- uJ lA^d J wA*; it> J''j "jpLsll ^ >-3! ilt is not for the Mushrikin (polytheists), to maintain the Masjids of Allah while they witness against their own selves of disbelief. The works of such are in vain and in Fire shall they abide. The Masjids of Allah shall be maintained only by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day; perform the SalSh, and give the Zakdh and fear none but Allah. It is they who are on true guidance.} (9:17-18) and, JWY Vjlj isxlb J^U' j* j&yiiy 1 p*} > < to \ ? r's '4 ^ \ * r: " ? z* "T">' 1 jvAjiUi iy jJ Oj-ty ILi C&

i T 03 t&5 ji Scs j iThey are the ones who disbelieved and hindered you from Al- Masjid-Al-Haram (at Makkah) and detained the sacrificial Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :341

345Silruli 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) animals, from reaching their place of sacrifice. Had there not been believing men and believing women whom you did not know, that you may kill them and on whose account a sin would have been committed by you without (your) knowledge, that Allah might bring into His mercy whom He wills - if they (the believers and the disbelievers) had been apart, We verily, would have punished those of them who disbelieved with painful torment (48:25). Therefore, Allah said here, jij *jS="jli Ji.j ffefj j s-Vi -"j"***' \$ iThe Masjids of Allah shall be maintained only by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day; perform the Saldh, and give the Zakdh andfear none but Allah}. Therefore, if those believers who follow the virtues mentioned in the Ayah were prevented from attending the Masjid, then what cause for destruction is worse than this? Maintaining the Masjids not only means beautifying them, but it involves remembering Allah, establishing His Shari'ah in the Masjids and purifying them from the filth of Shirk. The Good News that Islam shall prevail Allah said next, VI ZJLZ c? (3 u JiJf\} ilt was not fitting that such should themselves enter them (Allah's Masjids) except in fear}. This Ayah means, Do not allow them - the disbelievers - to enter the Masjids, except to satisfy the terms of an armistice or a treaty. When the Messenger of Allah ^ conquered Makkah in 9 H, he commanded that someone announce at Mina, After the current year, no idolaters shall perform Hajj, and no naked persons shall perform Tawafaround the House, except for those who have a treaty. In this case, the treaty will be carried to the end of its term. ' This Ayah supports the Ayah, m Path Al-Bari 3 : 565

^ i;p:%52 1 ip: you who believe! (in Allah's Oneness and in His Messenger Muhammad ss)/ Verily, the Mushrikun (idolators) are Najasun (impure). So let them not come near Al-Masjid-Al-Haram (at Makkah) after this year} (9:28). It was also said that this Ayah (2:114) carries the good news for the

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) This Hadith is HasanJ ill ^L- jit if-j jiii Ulifc vjS} 4115. And to Allah belong the east and the west, so wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face of Allah (and He is High above, over His Throne). Surely, Allah is Sufficient (for His creatures' needs), Knowing. Facing the Qiblah (Direction ofthe Prayer) This ruling brought comfort to the Messenger of Allah jg and his Companions, who were driven out of Makkah and had to depart from the area of Al-Masjid Al-Haram. In Makkah, the Messenger of Allah 2g used to pray in the direction of Bayt Al-Maqdis, while the Ka'bah was between him and the Qiblah. When the Messenger jg migrated to Al-Madinah, he faced Bayt Al-Maqdis for sixteen or seventeen months, and then Allah directed him to face Al-Ka'bah in prayer. This is why Allah said, ^ ^V 4And to Allah belong the east and the west, so wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face of Allah (and He is High above, over His Throne)). Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said, The first part of the Qur an that was abrogated was about the Qiblah. When the Messenger of Allah migrated to Al-Madinah, which was inhabited by the Jews, he was at first commanded to face Bayt Al-Maqdis. The Jews were happy, and the Messenger of Allah jg faced Bayt Al-Maqdis for some ten months. However, the Messenger of Allah sg liked to face the Qiblah of Ibrahim [Al- Ka'bah at Makkah], and he used to look to the sky and supplicate. So Allah revealed, 4 j Jr jiVerily, We have seen the turning ofyour (Mulumumd's) face towards the heaven) until, fasrj m Ahmad 4:181

itum yourfaces (in prayer) in that direction} (2:144). The Jews were disturbed by this development and said, What made them change the direction of the Qiblah that they used to face? Allah revealed, 4Say (O Muhammad si) : "To Allah belong both, east and the west"} and, 4So wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face ofAllah (and He is High above, over His Throne)}. 1 Ikrimah said that Ibn Abbas said, 4#ai iyy ' &} <(So wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face ofAllah (and He is High above, over His Throne)) means, Allah s direction is wherever you face, east or west. Mujahid said that, 4So wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face ofAllah (and He is High above, over His Throne)) means, Wherever you may be, you have a Qiblah to face, that is, Al-Ka bah. ^ However, it was said that Allah sent down this Ayah before the order to face the Ka'bah. Ibn Jarir said, Others said that this Ayah was revealed to the Messenger of Allah si permitting the one praying voluntary prayers to face wherever they wish in the east or west, while traveling, when in fear and when facing the enemy. For instance, Ibn TJmar used to face whatever direction his animal was headed and proclaim that the Messenger ofAllah Si did the same, explaining the Ayah, At-Jabari 2:527. 121 Ibn Abi Hfitim 1 :347. 131 Ibn Abi Hfitim 1 :345. At-Tabari 2:530.

i%\ p i# CSifc> iSo wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face ofAllah}. 11 ' That Hadtth was also collected by

iSurely, Allah is Sufficient (for His creatures' needs), Knowing> is that AllMi encompasses all His Creation by providing them with sufficient needs and by His generosity and favor. His statement, 4%^} 4Knowing means He is knowledgeable of their deeds and nothing escapes His watch, nor is He unaware of anything. Rather, His knowledge encompasses everything. jfj? }!y jejV'j Ojxi!' 4 ^ \$ Ji 'jJj - a' & \$ 4>*i C 1* 'ijj tjCiVf) *' 4116. And they (Jews, Christians and pagans) say: Allah has begotten a son (children or offspring). Glory is to Him (Exalted is He above all that they associate with Him). Nay, to Him belongs all that is in the heavens and on earth, and all are Qdnitun to Him.} 4117. The Originator of the heavens and the earth. When He decrees a matter, He only says to it: "Be!" - and it is.} Refuting the Claim that Allah has begotten a Son This and the following Ayat refute the Christians, may Allah curse them, and their like among the Jews and the Arab idolators, who claimed that the angels are Allah s daughters. Allah refuted all of them in their claim that He had begotten a son. Allah said, 4%^} 4Glory is to Him.} meaning, He is holier and more perfect than such claim; ijiffij 4 u HI At-Tabari 2 : 537

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) 4Nay, to Him belongs all that is in the heavens and on earth,} meaning, the truth is not as the disbelievers claimed, rather, Allah s is the kingdom of the heavens and earth and whatever and whoever is in, on and between them. Allah is the Supreme Authority in the heavens and earth, and He is the Creator, Provider and Sustainer Who decides all the affairs of the creation as He wills. All creatures are Allah s servants and are owned by Him. Therefore, how could one of them be His son? The son of any being is bom out of two comparable beings. Allah has no equal or rival sharing His grace and greatness, so how can He have a son when He has no wife? Allah said, /j 1 Jj %)d j/2 3 Jfjfo) jiff} \$He is the Originator of the heavens and the earth . How can He have children when He has no wife? He created all things and He is the Knoioer ofeverything} (6:101). A&ai Oj llli j&z JLaS Xie\ ^ oi ! m \$:p& \$\$&% oy^jf 4 * %=> 4 : : "& iAnd they say "The Most Gracious (Allah) has begotten a son (offspring or children) " Indeed you have brought forth (said) a terrible evil thing. Whereby the

heavens are almost torn, and the earth is split asunder, and the mountains fall in ruins. That they ascribe a son (or offspring or children) to the Most Gracious (Allah). But it is not suitable for (the majesty of) the Most Gracious (Allah) that He should beget a son (or offspring or children). There is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Gracious (Allah) as a servant. Verily, He knows each one of them, and has counted them a full counting. And everyone of them will come to Him alone on the Day of Resurrection (without any helper, or protector or defender)} (19:88-95), and, \$&& ;J3J, p;

He is Allah (the) One, Allah the Samad (the Self- Sufficient, upon whom all depend), He begets not, nor was He begotten, and there is none comparable to Him.

353Sura 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-1) Ibn Abi Hatim said that Abu Said Al-Ashaj informed them that Asbat informed them from Mutarrif, from Atiyah, from Ibn Abbas who said that, iQdntin} (2:238) means, they pray to Him.' ' Ikrimah and Abu Malik also said that, \$and all are Qdnitiin to Him.} means, bound to Him in servitude to Him. * Said bin Jubayr said that Qanitun is sincerity. 131 Ar-Rabl bin Anas said that, iall are Qdnitiin to Him.} means, Standing up - before Him - on the Day of Resurrection. 141 Also, As-Suddi said that, \$ \$} iatid all are Qdnitiin to Him.} means, Obedient on the Day of Resurrection. that Mujahid said that, Khaslf said iand all are Qdnitiin to Him.} means, Obedient. He says, *Be a human and he becomes a human. He also said, (Allah says,) *Be a donkey and it becomes a donkey. Also, Ibn Abi Najlh said that Mujahid said that, {and all are Qdnitiin to Him.} 1,1 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :349. 121 Ibid. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :350. 141 Ibid.Jabari 2 :538 161 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:349.

means, obedient. Mujahid also said, The obedience of the disbeliever occurs when his shadow prostrates, while he hates that. ' Mujahid s statement, which Ibn Jarir preferred, combines all the meanings, and that is that Qunut means obedience and submission to Allah. There are two categories of Qunut legislated and destined, for Allah said, }And unto Allah (alone) falls in prostration whoever is in the heavens and the earth, willingly or unwillingly, and so do their shadows in the mornings and in the (late) afternoons} (13:15). The Meaning ofBadV Allah said, 4The Badf (Originator) of the heavens and the earth.} which means, He created them when nothing resembling them existed. Mujahid and As-Suddi said that this is the linguistic meaning, for all new matters are called Bid.'ah.

for He is the Owner of everything that is in the heavens and earth. All testify to His Oneness and to their submissiveness to Him. He is their Creator and Maker. Without created precedence, He shaped the creatures in their current shapes. Allah also bears witness to His servants that Jesus, who some claimed to be Allah s son, is among those who testify to His Oneness. Allah stated that He created the heavens and earth out of nothing and without precedent. Likewise, He created Jesus, the Messiah, with His power and without a father. ' This explanation from Ibn Janr, may Allah have mercy upon him, is very good and correct. Allah said, 4oJ^* if \$ J 4When He decrees a matter, He only says to it : "Be!" - and it is.} thus, demonstrating His perfectly complete ability and tremendous authority; if He decides a matter. He merely orders it to, Be and it comes into existence. Similarly, Allah said, 4 fffff ^ff /J Jyj J lili.\$ iij 4 Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, "Be!" - and it is.} (36:82), 4 if ^ f iVerily, Our Word unto a thing when We intend it, is only that We say unto it: "Be!" - and it is.} (16:40) and, 4And Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye} (54:50) So Allah informed us that He created Jesus by merely saying, Be! and he was, as Allah willed: 44 'r* if \$ 3b A y'J is 4Verily, the likeness of Isa (Jesus) before Allah is the likeness of m At-Tabari 2 :550.

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1 Messengers of Allah had received." Allah blows best with whom to place His Message. Humiliation and disgrace from Allah and a severe torment will overtake the criminals (polytheists and sinners) for that which they used to plot.) (6:124) and iAnd they say: "We shall not believe in you (O Muhammad \$), until you cause a spring to gush forth from the earth for us} until, w ^ j-" 4j iSay (O Mulmmmad : "Glorified (and Exalted) be my Lord [(Allah) above all that evil they (polytheists) associate with Him]! Am I anything but a man, sent as a Messenger?"} (17:90-93) and, iCj& ') \LS VJJ UU) . V 1\$ iAnd those who expect not a meeting with Us (i.e. those who deny the Day ofResurrection and the life of the Hereafter) said "Why are not the angels sent down to us, orwhy do we not see our Lord? } (25:21) and, yJX* U" J iNay, everyone of them desires tluit he should be given pages spread out} (74:52). There are many other Ayat that testify to the disbelief of the Arab idolators, their transgression, stubbornness, and that they asked unnecessary questions out of disbelief and arrogance. The statements of the Arab idolators followed the statements of the nations of the People of the Two Scriptures and other religions before them. Allah said, iThe People of the Scripture (Jews) ask you to cause a book to descend upon them from heaven. Indeed, they asked Musa (Moses) for even greater than that, when they said : "Show us

truth (Islam), a bringer ofglad tidings (for those who believe in what you brought, that they will enter Paradise) and a wamer (for those who disbelieve in what you brought, that they will enter the Hellfire) . And you will not be asked about the dwellers of the blazing Fire.} Allah s statement; iAnd you will not be asked about the dwellers of the blazing Fire.} means, We shall not ask you about the disbelief of those who rejected you. Similarly, Allah said, itids t&j gjr til} iYour duty is only to convey (the Message) and on Us is the reckoning.} (13:40) 0 3 Oil J(li) 4So remind them (O Mufwnmad jg) - you arc only one who reminds. You are not a dictator over them.}(88:21-22) and, iWe knoiv best what they say. And you (O Muhammad jg) are not the one to force them (to belief). But warn by the Qur'an; him who fearsMy threat} (50:45). There are many other similar Ayat. The Description ofthe Prophet in the Tawrah Imam

the description of the Messenger of Allah sg in the Torah.” He

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 359–376]

said, Yes, by Allah, he is described by the Torah with the same characteristics that he is described with in the Qur an with: O Prophet! We have sent you as a witness, a bringer of good news, a wamer, and as safe refuge for the unlettered people. You are My servant and Messenger. I have called you the Mutawakkil (who depends and relies on Allah for each and everything). You are not harsh, nor hard, nor obnoxious in the bazaars. He does not reward the evil deed with an evil deed.

360 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir Rather, he forgives and pardons. Allah will not bring his life to an end, until he straightens the wicked s religion by his hands so that the people proclaim: There is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah. By his hands, Allah will open blind eyes, deaf ears and sealed hearts. 111 This was recorded by Al-Bukhari only. 12 ' kii \$ M& ji pL g Sj J^i it;& &} Ji\$ Sj & o; Jit jjillyil 4 ^ ibljli j- j .* jjljJ vjujJl jCjii 4120. Never will the Jews nor the Christians be pleased with you (O Muhammad jg) till you follow their religion. Say:"Verily, the guidance ofAllah (i.e. Islamic Monotheism) that is the (only) guidance. And if you (O Mulymimad jg) were to follozv their (Jews and Christians) desires after

what you have received of Knowledge (i.e. the Qur'an), then you would have against Allah neither any Wall (protector or guardian) nor any helper.} 4121. Those to whom we gave the Book recite it as it should be recited (Yatlunahu Haqqa Tilawatihi) they are the ones who believe therein. And whoso disbelieve in it, those are they who are the losers.} Ibn Jarir said, Allah said, (f Sr&& % &L } 4Never ivill the Jews nor the Christians be pleased with you (O Muhammad sg) till you follow their religion.} meaning, The Jews and the Christians will never be happy with you, O Muhammad! Therefore, do not seek what pleases or appeases them, and stick to what pleases Allah by calling them to the truth that Allah sent you with. Allah s statement, iktti ;im \$} 4Say: "Verily, the guidance ofAllah (i.e. Islamic Monotheism) that is the (only) guidance } 1,1 Ahmad 2:174. Fath Al-Bari4 :402 , 8 :449 , and Al-AdabAl-Mufrad 72

Al-Baqarah (101 - 224) (Part-1 means, Say, O Muhammad jg, the guidance of Allah that He sent me with is the true guidance, meaning the straight, perfect and comprehensive religion. Qatadah said that Allah s statement, (fi) iSay : "Verily, the guidance of Allah (i.e. Islamic Monotheism) that is the (only) guidance} is, A true argument that Allah taught Muhammad % and his Companions and which they used against the people of misguidance 121 Qatadah said, We were told that the .*) ji(^ S ^ S ^== {jC&LjtijJU^UaU "IS Messenger ofAllah used to say, ,_f>- j^iJU y> ^ ij^ J* J'j3 "-d)l ^jU "There will always be a group ofmy Ummah fighting upon the truth, having the upper hand, not harmed by their opponents, until the decree ofAllah (the Last Hour) comes. "[31 This Hadith was collected in the Sahth and narrated from Abdullah bin Amr. Tabari 2:562. I2 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :356 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :355. 1924.

362 Tafstr Ibn Kathtr "5" d 4And ifyou (O Muhammad jg) were to follow their (Jews and Christians) desires after what you have received of Knowledge (i.e. the Qur'an), then you would have against Allah neither any Walt (protector or guardian) nor any helper This Ayah carries a stem warning for the Muslim Ummah against imitating the ways and methods of the Jews and Christians, after they have acquired knowledge of the Qur an and Sunnah, may Allah grant us refuge from this behavior. Although the speech in this Ayah was directed at the Messenger ag, the ruling ofwhich applies to his entire Ummah. The Meaning ofCorrect Tilawah Allah said, 4Those to whom We gave the Book. Yatliinahu Haqqan Tildwatih.} Abdur-Razzaq said ag from Ma mar, from Qatadah, They are the Jews and Christians. This is the opinion of Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam, and it was also chosen by Ibn Jarir. Said reported from Qatadah, They are the Companions of the Messenger of Allah ag. Abu Al-Aliyah said that Ibn Mas*ud said, By He in Whose Hand is my soul! The right Tilawah is allowing what it makes lawful, prohibiting what it makes unlawful, reciting it as it was revealed by Allah, not changing the words from their places, and not interpreting it with other than its actual interpretation. As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik from Ibn Abbas who said about this Ayah (2:121): They make lawful what it allows and they prohibit what it makes unlawful, and they do not alter its wordings." TJmar bin Al-Khattab said, They are those who when they recite an Ayah that mentions mercy, they ask Allah for it, and when they recite an Ayah that mentions torment, they seek refuge with Allah from it. * This meaning was attributed to AMabari 2:567. At-Jabari 2:567. * Al-Qurtubi 2 :95

Al-Bacjarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) the Prophet 3g, for when he used to recite sin Ayah of mercy, he invoked Allah for mercy, and when he recited an Ayah of torment, he sought refuge from it with Allah.

Allah's statement, ^ it they are the ones who believe therein) explains the Ayah, iThose to whom We gave the Book. Yatliinahu Haqqa Tilawatih). These Ayat mean, Those among the People of the Book who perfectly adhered to the Books that were revealed to the previous Prophets, will believe in what I have sent you with, O Muhammad! Allah said in another Ayah, ;td i/ only they had acted according to the Tawrdh, the Itijil, and what has (now) been sent down to them from their Lord (the Qur'an), they would surely, have gotten provision from above them and from underneath their feet.) (5:66). The Ayah, iSay (O Muhammad jg) "O People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians)! You have nothing (as regards guidance) till you act according to the Tawrdh, the Injil, and what has (now) been sent down to you from your Lord (the Qur'an).) means, If you adhere to the Torah and the Gospel in the correct manner, believe in them as you should, and believe in the news they carry about Muhammad's prophethood, his description and the command to follow, aid and support him, then this will direct you to adhere to truth and righteousness in this life and the Hereafter. In another Ayah, Allah said, 111 Ibn Majah 429

364 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir 4 isil OJJfi L\$fy 4 i >\ii'. iThose who follow the Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write (i.e. Muhammad jg) whom they find written with them in the Tawrah and the Injil.) (7:157) and, . (**?' SJ' oj 'y^y S y ** j"jr i *>> > >-* "V/'WJ o" b*; 4^ > Ijj* ^Sfli/ fO Muhammad to them): "Believe in it (the Qur'an) or do not believe (in it). Verily, those who were given knowledge before it, when it is recited to them, fall down on their faces in humble prostration. And they say: "Glory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise of our Lord must be fulfilled (17:107-108). These Ayat indicate that what Allah promised for Muhammad ag will certainly occur. Allah also said, *) *#i *'^ pj-k drl^ + ' ' >*" t >'A \ 'JL/fr*# w ,J" iji Or, Cl LLY AtLjl iTlwse to whom We gave the Scripture (i.e. the Tawrah and the Itijil) before it, they believe in it (the Qur'an). And when it is recited to them, they say: "We believe in it. Verily, it is the truth from our Lord. Indeed even before it we have been from those who submit themselves to Allah in Islam as Muslims. These will be given their reward twice over, because they are patient, and repel evil with good, and spend (in charity) out of what We have provided them.) (28:52-54) and, tear viz 3 u*%& &t u& i, ii tFC 4gif iAnd say to those who were given the Scripture (Jews and Christians) and to those who are illiterates (Arab pagans) : "Do you (also) submit yourselves (to Allah in Islam)?" If they do, they are rightly guided; but if they turn away, your duty is only to convey the Message; and Allah is the Seer of (His)

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1 servants (3:20), Allah said, 4And whoever disbelieves in it (the Qur'an), those are they who are the losers}, just as He said in another Ayah, Ji 4But those of the sects (Jews, Christians and all the other non-

them. They should not envy their cousins, the Arabs, for what Allah has given them, the Final Messenger of Allah being an Arab. Envy should not incite them to oppose or deny the Prophet or refrain from following him, may Allah's peace and blessings be upon him until the Day of Judgment. Jlj iri-j \S 4 JC y 4124. And (remember) when the Lord of Ibrahim (Abraham) tried him with (certain) commands, which he fulfilled. He (Allah) said (to him), "Verily, I am going to make you an Imam (a leader) for mankind (to follow you). (Ibrahim) said, "And of my offspring (to make leaders)." (Allah) said, "My covenant (prophethood) includes not Zalimin (polytheists and wrongdoers) . " } Ibrahim Al-Khalfl was an Imam for the People Allah is informing us of the honor of Ibrahim Al-KhaM, who He made an Imam for the people, and a model to be imitated, because of the way he conducted himself and

adhered to Tawhid. This honor was given to Prophet Ibrahim when he adhered to Allah's decisions and prohibitions. This is why Allah said, *And (remember) when the Lord of Ibrahim (i.e., Allah) tried him with (certain) commands*. This Ayah means, O Muhammad! Remind the idolaters and the People of the Scriptures, who pretend to be followers of the religion of Ibrahim, while in reality they do not follow it, while you, O Muhammad, and your followers are the true followers of his religion; remind them of the commands and prohibitions that Allah tested Ibrahim with, which he fulfilled, indicating that Ibrahim implemented all of Allah's orders. Allah said in another Ayah,

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) *And of Ibrahim (Abraham) who fulfilled (or conveyed) all that (Allah ordered him to do or convey)* (53:37) meaning, he was truthful and he was obedient to Allah's legislation. Also, Allah said, *Verily, Ibrahim was an Ummah (or a nation), obedient to Allah, Hanif (i.e. to worship none but Allah), and he was not one of those who were Al-Mushrikin (polytheists), (He was) thankful for His (Allah's) favors. He (Allah) chose him and guided him to a straight path. And We gave him good in this world, and in the Hereafter he shall be of the righteous. Then, We have sent the revelation to you (O Muhammad) saying "Follow the religion of Ibrahim Hanif (Islamic Monotheism - to worship none but Allah) and he was not of the Mushrikin.* (16:120-123) *Can you see the straight path which I have chosen for him? Ibrahim was neither a Jew nor a Christian, but he was a true Muslim Hanifan (Islamic Monotheism - to worship none but Allah alone) and he was not of Al-Mushrikin. Verily, among mankind who have the best claim to Ibrahim are those who followed him, and this Prophet (Muhammad) and those who have believed (Muslims). And Allah is the Wali (Protector and Helper) of the believers* (3:67-68). Allah said,

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) *And (remember) when the Lord of Ibrahim (Abraham) (i.e., Allah) tried him with (certain) commands* means, Allah tested him with Taharah (purity, ablution): five on the head and five on the body. As for the head, they are cutting the mustache, rinsing the mouth, inhaling and discarding water, using Siwak and parting the hair. As for the body, they are trimming the nails, shaving the pubic hair, circumcision and plucking under the arm and washing with water after answering the call of nature. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim said, A similar statement was also reported from Said bin Al-Musayyib, Mujahid, Ash-Sha'bi, An-Nakhal, Abu Salih, Abu Al-Jald, and so forth. 121 There is a similar statement that Imam

Muslim. 111 Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas said, The words that Allah tested Ibrahim with, and that he implemented were: abandoning his (disbelieving) people when Allah commanded him to do so, disputing with Nimrod (king of Babylon) about Allah, being patient when he was thrown in the fire (although this was extremely traumatic) migrating from his homeland when Allah commanded him to do so, patience with the monetary and material demands of hosting guests by Allah's command, and Allah's order for him to slaughter his son. When Allah tested Ibrahim with these words, and he was ready for the major test, Allah said to him, *Submit (be a Muslim)!* He said, I have submitted myself (as a Muslim) to the Lord of all that exists. (2:131) although this meant defying and being apart from the people. 121 The Unjust do not qualify for Allah's Promise Allah said that Ibrahim said, *and*

cm} iAnd ofmy offspring (to make leaders)} and Allah replied, iMy covenant (prophethood) includes not Zalimin (polytheists and wrongdoers)}. When Allah made Ibrahim an Imam (Leader for the faithful), he asked Allah that Imams thereafter be chosen from his offspring. Allah accepted his supplication, but told him that there will be unjust people among his offspring and they will not benefit from Allah s promise. Thus, they will neither become Imams nor be imitated (for they will not be righteous). The proof that Ibrahim s supplication to Allah was accepted is that Allah said in Surat Al-Ankabut (29:27), Fath Al-Bari 10:347 and Muslim 1 :222. ^ Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :360.

372 Tafstr Ibn Kathir to their homes, and then visit it again. Also, Abu Ja'far Ar- Razi narrated from Ar-Rabi* bin Anas from Abu Al- Aliyah who said that, 5 o-M c^f oz ii;> iAnd (remember) when We made the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah) a place of resortfor mankind and a place ofsafety} means, Safe from enemies and armed conflict. During the time of Jahiliyyah, the people were often victims of raids and kidnapping, while the people in the area surrounding it (Al Masjid Al-Haram) were safe and not subject to kidnapping. '11 Also, Mujahid, Ata , As-Suddi, Qatadah and Ar-Rabi bin Anas were reported to have said that the Ayah (2:125) means, Whoever enters it shall be safe. '21 This Ayah indicates that Allah honored the Sacred House, which Allah made as a safe refuge and safe haven. Therefore, the souls are eager, but never bored, to conduct short visits to the House, even every year. This is because Allah accepted the supplication of His Khalil, Ibrahim, when he asked Allah to make the hearts of people eager to visit the House. Ibrahim said (14:40), iOur Lord! And accept my invocation}. Allah described the House as a safe resort and refuge, for those who visit it are safe, even if they had committed acts of evil. This honor comes from the honor of the person who built it first, Khalil Ar-Rahman, just as Allah said, V o' olj' iAnd (remember) when We showed Ibrahim the site of the (Sacred) House (the Ka'bah at Makkah) (saying) : "Associate not anything (in worship) with Me..." (22:26) and, 2% cl & At-Tabari 3 :29 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :370.

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1 iVerily, thefirst House (ofworship) appointedfor mankind was that at Bakkah (Makkah), full of blessing, and a guidance for Al-'Alamin (mankind and Jinn). In it are manifest signs (for example), the Maqam (place) of Ibrahim; whosoever enters it, he attains security (3 : 96-97). The last honorable Ayah emphasized the honor of Ibrahim s Maqam, and the instruction to pray next to it, iAnd take you (people) the Maqam (place) of Ibrahim as a place ofprayer TheMaqam ofIbrahim Sufyan Ath-Thawri reported that Sa'id bin Jubayr commented on the Ayah, iAnd take you (people) the Maqam (place) ofIbrahim as a place ofprayer" The stone (Maqam) is the standing place of Ibrahim, Allah s Prophet, and a mercy from Allah. Ibrahim stood on the stone, while Ismail was handing him the stones (constructing the Ka bah). ^ As-Suddi said, The Maqam of Ibrahim is a stone which Ismail s wife put under Ibrahim s feet when washing his head ."121 Al-Qurtubi mentioned this, but he considered it unauthentic, although others gave it preference, Ar-Razi reported it in his Tafsir from Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Qatadah, and Ar-Rabl bin Anas . Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Jabir, describing the Hajj (pilgrimage) of the Prophet jg said, When the Prophet jfe performed Tawaf Umar asked him, Is this the Maqam of our father? He said, Yes. Umar said, Should we take it a place of prayer? So Allah revealed, Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :371 At-Tabari 3:35. t3 ' Ar-Razi 4 :45

Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) Hadith that

from the Ka'bah's wall during his reign. Umar is one of the two men, whom the Messenger of Allah described when he said, "Imitate the two men who will come after me: Abu Bakr and 'Umar." [1] Umar was also the person whom the Qur'an agreed with

regarding praying next to Maqam of Ibrahim. This is why none

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 376–380]

among the Companions rejected it when he moved it. Abdur-Razzaq reported from Ibn Jurayj from Ata, Umar bin Al-Khattab moved the Maqam back. Also, Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Mujahid said that Umar was the first person who moved the Maqam back to where it is now standing. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr,

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) 4127. And (remember) when Ibrahim and (his son) Isma'il were raising the foundations of the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah), (saying), "Our Lord! Accept (this service) from us. Verily, You are the Hearer, the Knower." } 4128. "Our Lord! And make us submissive unto You and of our offspring a nation submissive unto You, and show us our Manasik, and accept our repentance. Truly, You are the One Who accepts repentance, the Most Merciful." } The Command to purify the House Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that, 4 And We gave Our Ahd (command) to Ibrahim and Isma'il } means, Allah ordered them to purify it from all filth and impurities, of which none should ever touch it. 11 ' Also, Ibn Jurayj said, I said to Ata, What is Allah's Ahd? He said, *His command. Also, Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, } 4 that they should purify My House (the Ka'bah) for those who are circumambulating it, or staying (1 tikaf) } ^ imu " Vi ZZJSj ijl LJj! Jjjj ^j&i JJIs ^,ijj 4-i; i (jp\$ Qwllj 'Ojcull J1S y*> gullpO 1*" J, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :373.

Purify it from the idols. Further, Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr said that, 4 *i M& i purify My House for those who are circumambulating it } means, From the idols, sexual activity, false witness and sins of all kinds. Allah said, if for those who are performing Tawaf (circumambulating) it }. The Tawaf around the House is a well-established ritual, Said bin Jubayr said that, if for those who are circumambulating it } means, strangers (he means who do not live in Makkah), while; if for staying (1'tikaf) } is about those who live in the area of the Sacred House. Also, Qatadah and Ar-Rabi bin Anas said that Tikaf is in reference to those who live in the area of the House, just as Said bin Jubayr stated. 21 Allah said, if for bowing or prostrating themselves (there, in prayer) } Ibn Abbas said, when it is a place of prayer it includes those who are described as bowing and prostrating themselves. 3 Also, Ata and Qatadah offered the same Tafsir.^ Purifying all Masjids is required according to this Ayah and according to Allah's statement, i-g&M jii'L % cp.& 3%4 & m Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :375. Ibid. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :376. Ibid.

My Lord, make this city (Makkah) a place of security and provide its people with fruits, such of them as believe in Allah and the Last Day.

There are several other Hadiths that indicate that Allah made Makkah a sacred area before He created the heavens and earth. The Two Sahih recorded Abdullah bin Abbas saying that the Messenger of Allah (s) said, 4) 1 jqs < 'jj*jSllj OI^Lt.1 1 ^yi)1 jJbl I-1a j| E } P iri J JP. pJ Jp pH P JP. p P pi lajfoj 'ij taJL yLi 'jj *syi Xj|*j 'i illiJl (l J ' Vt'V P'P" Ji v'i :ji) J U" :>&3i Jia "U^U ^ ^ iikJ l Allah has made

this city a sanctuary (sacred place) the Day He created the heavens and earth . Therefore, it is a sanctuary until

the Day of Resurrection because Allah made it a sanctuary. It

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 380–436]

was not legal for anyone to fight in it before me, and it was legal for me for a few hours of one day. Therefore, it is a sanctuary until the Day of Resurrection, because Allah made it a sanctuary. None is allowed to uproot its thorny shrubs, or to chase its game, or to pick up something that has fallen, except by a person who announces it publicly, nor should any of its trees be cut. Al- Abbas said, O Messenger of Allah! Except the lemon-grass, for our goldsmiths and for our graves. The Prophet added, "Except lemon-grass. This is the wording of

5; J 1 ' d.j j jj Yj to wlglj 01 Or? i*ti L\$J Oil UJlj i^iU jjU JUj tlj-'A Oi^ ill OJ :ljJ" wliil -IalIJI *J~Jj ^p-iS/L lfi>"y>- ojU 8Allah, not the people, made Makkah a sanctuary, so any person who has belief in Allah and the Last Day, should neither shed blood in it nor should he cut down its trees. If anybody argues that fighting in it is permissible on the basis that Allah's Messenger fought in Makkah, say to him, Allah allowed His Messenger and did not allow you.' Allah allowed me only for a few hours on that day (of the Conquest), and today its sanctity is valid as it was before. So, those who are present should inform those who are absent (concerning this fact). Abu Shurayh was asked, What did Amr reply? He said, (Amr said) O Abu Shurayh! I know better than you about this, the Sacred House does not give protection to a sinner, a murderer or a thief. This Hadith was collected by Al-Bukhari and Muslim.¹¹¹ After this, there is no contradiction between the Hadiths that stated that Allah made Makkah a sanctuary when He created the heavens and earth and the Hadiths that Ibrahim made it a sanctuary, since Ibrahim conveyed Allah's decree that Makkah is a sanctuary, before he built the House. Similarly, the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) was written as the Final Prophet when Adam was still clay. Yet, Ibrahim said, O Our Lord! Send amongst them a Messenger of their own (2:129). Allah accepted Ibrahim's supplication, although He had full knowledge beforehand that it will occur by His decree. To further elaborate on this subject, we should mention the Hadith about what the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said when he was asked, O Messenger of Allah! Tell us about how your prophethood started. He said, >^ jJ iy-il Al-Bari 4 :50, and Muslim 2 :987.

the supplication of my father Ibrahim, the good news of Jesus, the son of Mary, and my mother saw a light that radiated from her which illuminated the castles of Ash-Sham (Syria).*

O My Lord, make this city (Makkah) a place of security} meaning, make this a safe city. This occurred before the Ka'bah was built. Allah said in Surat Ibrahim, -43' l-ilb yj Jli ilj} iAnd (remember) when Ibrahim said, "My Lord! Make this city (Makkah) one of peace and security..." (14:35) as here, Ibrahim supplicated a second time after the House was built and its people lived around it, after Ishaq who was thirteen years Ismail's junior was born. This is why at the end of his supplication, Ibrahim said here, &^ , i' iAll the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has given me in old age Isma'il (Ishmael) and Ishaq (Isaac). Verily, my Lord is indeed the Hearer of invocations} (14:39). Allah said next, o' ex ft*' y'je- d) i"...and provide its people with fruits, such of them as believe in Allah and the Last Day." He (Allah)

answered: "As for him who disbelieves, I shall leave him in contentment for a while, then I shall compel him to the torment of the Fire, and worst indeed is that destination!"} Ibn Jarir said that Ubayy bin KaTa commented on. iHe answered: "As for him who disbelieves, I shall leave him in contentment for a while, then I shall compel him to the torment of the Fire, and worst indeed is that destination!"} These are Allah's Words (meaning not Ibrahim's) This is also the Tafsir of Mujahid and Ikrimah. Furthermore, Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah's statement, Tabari 3:53. At-Tabari 3:54.

fT~i i** J 4">^' Oi itib W* '-i? 'j!' j**-' 4 -'^ Lord, make this city (Makkah) a place of security and provide its people with fruits, such of them as believe in Allah and the Last Day.\$ Ibrahim asked Allah to grant sustenance for the believers only. However, Allah revealed, I will also provide for the disbelievers, just as I shall provide for the believers. Would I create something and not sustain and provide for? I shall allow the disbelievers little delight, and then force them to the torment of the Fire, and what an evil destination. Ibn Abbas then recited, & Cj% .i ij tfji li 40n each these as well as those We bestow from the bounties of your Lord. And the bounties of your Lord can never be forbidden> (17:20). This was recorded by Ibn Marduwyah, who also recorded similar statements from Ikrimah and Mujahid. Similarly, Allah said, C4i JLi % 4 > V Sj' 4 ljl t =3C f jil A , iVerily, those who invent a lie against Allah will never be successful. (A brief) enjoyment in this world! And then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve.\$ (10:69-70), J.U pic -till ol j-j? cl) (Is 4jB 4And whoever disbelieves, let not his disbelief grieve you (O Muliammad To Us is their return, and We shall inform them what they have done. Verily, Allah is the Knower of what is in the breasts (of men). We let them enjoy for a little while, then in the end We shall oblige them to (enter) a great torment (31:23-24) and, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:377.

j lili irl Liuj j\ "^jj} J = o}J l".> U/~y& rt'-X^b 'XZX-dk lj& gl"*J / ^ i^ ^ ^ ^ ^ -J # ^ X X ^rs , (j\l*A) cibj JCij * LijJ' U *ijj> 4A"d were it that mankind would have become of one community (all disbelievers desiring worldly life only). We would have provided for those who disbelieve in the Most Gracious (Allah), silver roofs for their houses, and elevators whereby they ascend. And for their houses, doors (of silver), and thrones (of silver) on which they could recline. And adornments of gold. Yet all this would have been nothing but an enjoyment of this world. And the Hereafter with your Lord is (only) for the Muttaqin (the pious).} (43:33-35). Allah said next, jiiii d) 4Then I shall compel him to the torment of the Fire, and worst indeed is that destination!} meaning, After the delight that the disbeliever enjoyed in this life, I will make his destination torment in the Fire, and what an evil destination. This Ayah indicates that Allah gives the disbelievers respite and then seizes them in a manner compatible to His greatness and ability. This Ayah is similar to Allah's statement, 4 ilHi CAj Li hi/ \$fo=T)} iAnd many a township did I give respite while it was given to wrongdoing. Then (in the end) I seized it (with punishment) And to Me is the (final) return (of all)} (22:48). Also, the Two Sahihs recorded, Xj jt **** ifo- fX H-\ No one is more patient than Allah when hearing abuse. They attribute a son to Him, while He grants them sustenance and health ."}11 The Sahih. also recorded, (1 ' FathAl-Bari 13:372, and Muslim 4:2160.

386 Tafsir Tbt Kathir j*J aJL"4 lit ^J . " pJUaJLj 3)1 jl Allah gives respite to the unjust person, until when He seizes him; He never lets go of him ."}11 He then recited Allah's statement, IS&&& iSuch is the punishment of your Lord when He punishes the (population of) towns while they are doing wrong.

Verily, His punishment is painful (and) severe (11:102) Building the Kaltah and asking Allah to accept This Deed Allah said, j Ot J-t'jiill A*fj S jV Ai4 IJc- w^J \ j& kill -clL-.1 iixJj'i JAJ iitt ijlLli (Ij 4And (remember) when Ibrahim (Abraham) and (his son) Ismd'il (Ishmael) were raising the foundations of the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah), (saying), "Our Lord! Accept (this service) from us. Verily, You are the Hearer, the Knou. Our Lord! And make us submissive unto You and of our offspring a nation submissive unto You, and shoiv us our Mandsik and accept our repentance. Trtdy, You are the One Who accepts repentance, the Most Merciful."4 Allah said, O Muhammad! Remind your people when Ibrahim and Ismail built the House and raised its foundations while saying, 4jjj\ %& c# iOur Lord! Accept (this service) from us. Verily, You are the Hearer, the Knower."^ Al-Qurtxibi mentioned that Ubayy and Ibn Mas*ud used to recite the Ayah this way, (il Fath Al-Bari 8 :205

> j //^ f | ^ # , tj,"* ^ , /j "# ^^'.J i C-ii J J r-W cm *tj r.ii 4Anrf (remember) when Ibrahim and Ohs son) Istnd'il were raising the foundations of the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah), Saying, "Our Lord! Accept (this service) from us. Verily, You are the Hearer, the Knower."} {^ What further testifies to this statement (which adds saying to the Ayah) by Ubayy and Ibn Maslad, is what came afterwards, iOur Lord! And make us submissive unto You and of our offspring a nation submissive unto You}. The Prophets Ibrahim and Ismail were performing a good deed, yet they asked Allah to accept this good deed from them. Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Wuhayb bin Al-Ward recited, iAnd (remember) when Ibrahim and Ohs son) Ismd'il were raising the foundations of the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah), (saying), "Our Lord! Accept (this service)from us"} and cried and said, O Khalil of Ar-Rahman[You raise the foundations of the House of Ar-Rahman (Allah), yet you are afraid that He will not accept it from you? This is the behavior of the sincere believers, whom Allah described in His statement, t oyy iAnd those who give that which they give} (23:60) meaning, they give away voluntary charity, and perform the acts of worship yet, iwith their hearts full offear} (23:60) 111 Al-Qurtubi 2:126. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :384

388 Tafair Ibn KatHir afraid that these good deeds might not be accepted of them. There is an authentic Hadith narrated by A ishaah on this subject, which we will mention later, Allah willing.

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) of Allah jg said, This is why the people make the trip between As-Safa and Al-Marwah (during Hajjand Umrah)." When she reached Al-Marwah, she heard a voice and said, Shush, to herself. She tried to hear the voice again and when she did, she said, 1 have heard you. Do you have relief? She found the angel digging with his heel (or his wing) where Zamzam now exists, and the water gushed out. Ismail s mother was astonished and started digging, using her hand to transfer water to the water-skin. Ibn Abbas said that the Prophet jg then said, May Allah grant His mercy to the mother of Ismail, had she left the water, (flow naturally without her intervention), it would have been flowing on the surface of the earth. Ismail s mother started drinking the water and her milk increased for her child. The angel (Gabriel) said to her, Do not fear abandonment. There shall be a House for Allah built here by this boy and his father. Allah does not abandon His people. During that time, the area of the House was raised above ground level and the floods used to reach its right and left sides. Afterwards some people of the tribe of Jurhum, passing through Kada , made camp at the bottom of the valley. They saw some birds, they were astonished, and said, Birds can only be found at a place where there is water. We did not notice before that this valley had water. They sent a scout or two who

searched the area, found the water, and returned to inform them about it. Then they all went to Ismail's mother, next to the water, and said, O Mother of Ismail! Will you allow us to be with you (or dwell with you)? She said, Yes. But you will have no exclusive right to the water here. They said, We agree. Ibn Abbas said that the Prophet (ﷺ) said, At that time, Ismail's mother liked to have human company. And thus they stayed there and sent for their relatives to join them. Later on, her boy reached the age of puberty and married a lady from them, for Ismail learned Arabic from them, and they liked the way he was raised. Ismail's mother died after that. Then an idea occurred to Abraham to visit his dependents. So he left (to Makkah). When he arrived, he did not find Ismail, so he asked his wife about him. She said, *He has

390 Tafsir Urn Kathir gone out hunting. When he asked her about their living conditions, she complained to him that they live in misery and poverty. Abraham said (to her), When your husband comes, convey my greeting and tell him to change the threshold of his gate. When Ismail came, he sensed that they had a visitor and asked his wife, Did we have a visitor? She said, Yes. An old man came to visit us and asked me about you, and I told him where you were. He also asked about our condition, and I told him that we live in hardship and poverty. Ismail said, Did he ask you to do anything? She said, Yes. He asked me to convey his greeting and that you should change the threshold of your gate. Ismail said to her, He was my father and you are the threshold, so go to your family (i.e. you are divorced). So he divorced her and married another woman. Again Ibrahim thought of visiting his dependents whom he had left (at Makkah). Ibrahim came to Ismail's house, but did not find Ismail and asked his wife, Where is Ismail? Ismail's wife replied, He has gone out hunting. He asked her about their condition, and she said that they have a good life and praised Allah. Ibrahim asked, What is your food and what is your drink? She replied, Our food is meat and our drink is water. He said, O Allah! Bless their meat and their drink. The Prophet (ﷺ) said, They did not have crops then, otherwise Ibrahim would have invoked Allah to bless that too. Those who do not live in Makkah cannot bear eating a diet only containing meat and water. Ibrahim said, When Ismail comes back, convey my greeting to him and ask him to keep the threshold of his gate. When Ismail came back, he asked, Has anyone visited us. She said, Yes. A good looking old man, and she praised Ibrahim, And he asked me about our livelihood and I told him that we live in good conditions. He asked, Did he ask you to convey any message? She said, 'Yes. He conveyed his greeting to you and said that you should keep the threshold of your gate. Ismail said, That was my father, and you are the threshold; he commanded me to keep you. Ibrahim then came back visiting and found Ismail behind the Zamzam well, next to a tree, mending his arrows. When he saw Ibrahim, he stood up and they greeted each other, just as

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) the father and son greet each other. Ibrahim said, O Ismail, Your Lord has ordered me to do something. He said, Obey your Lord. He asked Ismail, Will you help me? He said, Yes, I will help you. Ibrahim said, Allah has commanded me to build a house for Him there, and he pointed to an area that was above ground level. So, both of them rose and started to raise the foundations of the House. Abraham started building (the Ka'bah), while Ismail continued handing him the stones. Both of them were saying, O our Lord ! Accept (this service) from us, Verily, You are the Hearing, the Knowing. (2.127). m Hence, they were building the House, part by part, going around it and saying, ijMii % j% # iOur Lord! Accept (this service) from us. Verily, You are the Hearer, the Ktmver The StoryofrebuildingtheHousebyQurayshbefore the Messenger ofAllahg was sent as Prophet

In his Sirah, Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar said, When the Messenger of Allah m reached thirty-five years of age, the Quraysh gathered to rebuild the Ka'bah, this included covering it with a roof. However, they were weary of demolishing it. During that time, the Ka'bah was barely above a man s shoulder, so they wanted to raise its height and build a ceiling on top. Some people had stolen the Ka'bah s treasure beforehand, which used to be in a well in the middle of the Ka'bah. The treasure was later found with a man called, Duwayk, a freed servant of Bani Mulayh bin Amr, from the tribe of Khuza'ah. The Quraysh cut off his hand as punishment. Some people claimed that those who actually stole the treasure left it with Duwayk. Afterwards, the sea brought a ship that belonged to a Roman merchant to the shores of Jeddah, where it washed-up. So they collected the ship s wood to use it for the Ka'bah s ceiling; a Coptic carpenter in Makkah prepared what they needed for the job. When they decided to begin the demolition process to rebuildAl-Bari 6:456.

392 Tafstr Ibn Katlnr the House, Abu Wahb bin Amr bin A idh bin Abd bin Imran bin Makhzum took a stone from the Ka'bah, the stone slipped from his hand and went back to where it had been. He said, O people of Quraysh! Do not spend on rebuilding the House, except from what was earned from pure sources. No money earned from a prostitute, usury or injustice should be included. Ibn Ishaq commented here that the people also attribute these words to Al-Walid bin Al-Mughirah bin Abdullah bin Amr bin Makhzum. Ibn Ishaq continued, The Quraysh began to organize their efforts to rebuild the Ka'bah, each subtribe taking the responsibility of rebuilding a designated part of it. However, they were still weary about bringing down the Ka'bah. Al-Walid bin Al-Mughirah said, will start to bring it down. He held an ax and stood by the Ka'bah and said, O Allah! No harm is meant. O Allah! We only seek to do a good service. He then started to chop the House s stones. The people waited that night and said, *We will wait and see. If something strikes him, we will not bring it down and instead rebuid it the way it was. If nothing happens to him, then Allah will have agreed to what we are doing. The next morning, Al- Walld went to work on the Ka'bah, and the people started bringing the Ka'bah down with him. When they reached the foundations that Ibrahim built, they uncovered green stones that were above each other, just like a pile of spears. Ibn Ishaq then said that some people told him, A man from Quraysh, who was helping rebuild the Ka'bah, placed the shovel between two of these stones to pull them up; when one of the stones was moved, all of Makkah shook, so they did not dig up these stones. 12 The Dispute regarding Who should place the Black Stone in Its Place Ibn Ishaq said, The tribes of Quraysh collected stones to rebuild the House, each tribe collecting on their own. They started rebuilding it, until the rebuilding of the Ka'bah reached the point where the Black Stone was to be placed in ** Ibn Hisham 1 :204. * Ibn Hisham 1 :207

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) its designated site. A dispute erupted between the various tribes of Quraysh, each seeking the honor of placing the Black Stone for their own tribe. The dispute almost led to violence between the leaders of Quraysh in the area of the Sacred House. Banu Abd Ad-Dar and Banu Adi bin Ka'b bin Lu ay, gave their mutual pledge to fight until death. However, five or four days later, Abu Umayyah bin Al-Mughlrah bin Abdullah bin Amr bin Makhzum, the oldest man from Quraysh then intervened at the right moment. Abu Umayyah suggested that Quraysh should appoint the first man to enter the House from its entrance to be a mediator between them. They agreed. The Messenger - Muhammad sg - was the first person to enter the House. When the various leaders of Quraysh realized who the first one was, they all proclaimed, This is Al-Amin (the Honest one). We all

accept him; This is Muhammad. When the Prophet ﷺ reached the area where the leaders were gathering and they informed him about their dispute, he asked them to bring a garment and place it on the ground. He placed the Black Stone on it. He then requested that each of the leaders of Quraysh hold the garment from one side and all participate in lifting the Black Stone, moving it to its designated area. Next, the Prophet ﷺ carried the Black Stone by himself and placed it in its designated position and built around it. The Quraysh used to call the Messenger of Allah Al-Amin even before the revelation came to him. Ibn Az-Zubayr rebuilds Al-Ka'bah the way the Prophet wished Ibn Ishaq said, During the time of the Prophet ﷺ, the Ka'bah was eighteen cubits high and was covered with Egyptian linen, and they with a striped garment. Al-Hajjaj bin Yusuf was the first person to cover it with silk. The Ka'bah remained the same way the Quraysh rebuilt it, until it was burned during the reign of Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr, after the year 60 H, at the end of the reign of Yazid bin Mu'awiyah. During that time, Ibn Az-Zubayr was besieged at Makkah. When it was burned, Ibn Az-Zubayr brought the Ka'bah down and built it upon the foundations of Ibrahim, including the Hijr m Ibn Hisham 1 :21 1

in it. He also made an eastern door and a western door in the Ka'bah and placed them on ground level. He had heard his aunt A'ishah, the Mother of the believers, narrate that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ had wished that. The Ka'bah remained like this throughout his reign, until Al-Hajjaj killed Ibn Az-Zubayr and then rebuilt it the way it was before, by the order of Abdul-Malik bin Marwan.

from Al-Hijr and would have made a door for it that people could enter from, and another door that they could exit from. Ibn Az-Zubayr said, can spend on this job, and I do not fear the people. So he added five cubits from the Hijr, which looked like a rear part for the House that people could clearly see. He then built the House and made it eighteen cubits high. He thought that the House was still short and added ten cubits in the front and built two doors in it, one as an entrance and another as an exit. When Ibn Az-Zubayr was killed, Al-Hajjaj wrote to Abdul-Malik bin Marwan asking him about the House and told him that Ibn Az-Zubayr made a rear section for the House. Abdul-Malik wrote back, *We do not agree with Ibn Az-Zubayr's actions. As for the Ka'bah's height, leave it as it is. As for what he added from the Hijr, bring it down, and build the House as it was before and close the door. Therefore, Al-Hajjaj brought down the House and rebuilt it as it was. * In his Sunan,

Abdul-Malik then said, *You heard A'ishah say this Hadith? He said, Yes. Abdul-Malik said, I wish I left it as it was. ! An Ethiopian will destroy the Kabbah just before the Last Hour The Two Sahih's recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, The Ka'bah will be destroyed by Dhus-Sawiqatayn (literally, a person with two lean legs) from Ethiopia .

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) recorded this Hadith ft^ Imam

' This supplication by Ibrahim and Ismail is similar to what Allah informed us of about His believing servants, 4;v.:CC\ i And those who say : 'Our Lord! Bestow on us from our wives and our offspring the comfort of our eyes, and make us leaders of the Muttaqin} (25:74). This type of supplication is allowed, because loving to have offspring who worship Allah alone without partners is a sign of complete love of Allah. This is why when Allah said to Ibrahim, JtttC ^} i Verily, I am going to make you an Imam (a leader) for mankind (to follow you)} Ibrahim said, JC 1 JU tjffj* Lrt-j} i And of my offspring (to make leaders).

The Meaning of Manasik Said bin Mansur said that Attab bin Bashir informed us from Khaslf, from Mujahid who said, The Prophet Ibrahim supplicated, and show us our Manasik^ Jibril then came down, took him to the House and said, Raise its foundations. Ibrahim raised the House's foundations and completed the building. Jibril held Ibrahim's hand, led him to As-Safa and said, This is among the rituals of Allah. He then took him to Al-Marwah and said, And this is among the rituals of Allah. He then took him to Mina until when they reached the Aqabah, they found Iblls standing next to a tree. Jibril said, Say Takbir (Allah is the Great) and throw (pebbles) at him. Ibrahim said the Takbir and threw (pebbles at) Iblls. Iblls moved to the middle Jamrah, and when Jibril and Ibrahim passed by him, Jibril said to Ibrahim, Say Takbir and throw at him. Ibrahim threw at him and said Takbir. The devious Iblls sought to add some evil acts to the rituals of Hajj, but he was unable to succeed. Jibril took Ibrahim's hand and led him to Al-Mash'ar Al-Haram and Arafat and said to him, Have you Arafta (known, learned) what I showed you? thrice. Ibrahim said, Yes I did. ,1, Similar statements were reported from Abu Mijlaz and Qatadah.12' yti cSM 4129. "Our Lord! Send amongst them a Messenger of their oivtt, who shall recite unto them Your verses and instruct them in the Book (this Qur'an), and purify them. Verily, You are the Mighty, the Wise."4 Ibrahim's Supplication that Allah sends the Prophet Allah mentioned Ibrahim's supplication for the benefit of the people of the Sacred Area (to grant them security and Said Bin Man?Qr 2 :615. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :387.

The supplication of my father Ibrahim and the glad tidings brought forth by Jesus the son of Mary,

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) '{till pAj* u"*J j3 jil uThere will always be a group of my Ummah zoho will be on the truth, undeterred by those who fail or oppose them, until the command of Allah comes while they are on this. Al-Bukhari added in his Sahih, "And they loill reside in Ash- S/lflmV 1 The Meaning of Al-Kitab wal-Hikmah Allah said, iatid instruct them in the Book} meaning, Al-Qur'an, iand Al-Hikmah} meaning, the Sunnah, as Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Abu Malik asserted.12 It was also said that Al-Hikmah\ means comprehension in the religion, and both meanings are correct. Ali bin Abi Talhah said, that Ibn Abbas said that, iand purify them} means, With the obedience of Allah. 3 iVerily, You are the Mighty, the W/se^ . This Ayah stated that Allah is able to do anything, and nothing escapes His ability. He is Wise in His decisions, His actions, and He puts everything in its rightful place due to His perfect knowledge, wisdom and justice. jfi' ^ *i'j liill q "v..lw>' Ju)j ^ yi O*- J*j} f is**} } 3'J 3 i ft i " lAyCi C"SI iw>' "j)' JjyuoJ fjb il30. And who turns away from the religion of Ibrahim (i.e. Fath Al-Bari 6 :73 1 and Muslim 2 : 1524 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :390. 3 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :391

Islamic Monotheism) except him who fools himself? Truly, We chose him in this world and verily, in the Hereafter he will be among the righteous}. 4131. When his Lord said to him, Submit (i.e. be a Muslim)!" He said, I have submitted myself (as a Muslim) to the Lord of the 'Alamin (mankind, Jinn and all that exists). } 4132. And this (submission to Allah, Islam) was enjoined by Ibrahim (Abraham) upon his sons and by Ya'qub (Jacob) (saying), O my sons! Allah has chosen for you the (true) religion, then die not except as Muslims. } Only the Fools deviate from Ibrahim's Religion Allah refuted the disbelievers innovations of associating others with Allah in defiance of the religion of Ibrahim, the leader of the upright. Ibrahim always singled out Allah in worship, with sincerity, and he did not call upon others besides Allah. He did not commit Shirk, even for an instant. He disowned every other deity

that was being worshipped instead of Allah and defied all his people in this regard. Prophet Ibrahim said, s + } * " 31 "iXp> uj 4^-i} 4%\^ ft Zj 40 my people! I am indeed free from all that you join as partners (in worship with Allah). Verily, I have turned myface towards Him Who has created the heavens and the earth Hanifa (Islamic Monotheism), and I am not of Al-Mushriktn .} (6:78- 79). Also, Allah said, vffoi lijji ^ ^ ,cj i, tL 4And (remember) when Ibrahim said to his father and his people: "Verily, I am innocent of what you worship. "Except Him (i.e. I worship none but Allah alone) Who did create me; and verily, He will guide me } (43 :26-27),

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) 4And Ibrahim's invoking (of Allah) for his father's forgiveness was only because of a promise he (Ibrahim) had made to him (his father). But when it became clear to him (Ibrahim) that he Otis father) was an enemy of Allah, he dissociated himselffrom him. Verily, Ibrahim was Awivah (one ivho invokes Allah with humility, glorifies Hitti and remembers Him much) and was forbearing} (9:114), and, 4 Verify, Ibrahim ivas an Ummah (a leader having all the good qualities, or a nation), obedient to Allah, Hanif (i.e. to worship none but Allah), and he was not one of those who were Al- Mushrikin. (He was) thankful for His (Allah's) favors. He (Allah) chose him (as an intonate friend) and guided him to a straight path. And We gave him good in this world, and in the Hereafter he shall be of the righteous.} (16:120-122). This is why Allah said here, ii ^j} 4And who turns away from the religion of Ibrahim}, meaning, abandons his path, way and method Li; J. -jt} 4except him who fools himself} meaning, who commits injustice against himself by deviating from the truth, to wickedness. Such a person will be defying the path of he who was chosen in this life to be a true Imam, from the time he was young, until Allah chose him to be His Khalil, and who shall be among the successful in the Last Life. Is there anything more insane than deviating from this path and following the path of misguidance and deviation instead? Is there more injustice than this? Allah said, 4^L JjJili dJ,} iVerily, joining others in worship with Alldlt is a great Zulm (wrong) indeed} (31:13). Abu Al- Aliyah and Qatadah said, This Ayah (2:130) was revealed about the Jews who invented a practice that did not

come from Allah and that defied the religion of Ibrahim. ^ Allah s statement. -1 itX cs ^ & dp "*; st c} %% fee sS^ ^ ^ ilbrahim was neither a Jew nor a Christian, but he was a true Muslim Hanifo (to worship none but Allah alone) and he was not ofAl-Mushrikin . Verily, among mankind who have the best claim to Ibrahim are those who followed him, and this Prophet (Muhammad jg) and those who have believed (Muslims). And Allah is the Walt (Protector and Helper) of the believers.} (3:67-68), testifies to this fact. Allah said next, 4lf^cjj S> cJJJ Jis , 4j \$ Ju iWhen his Lord said to him, ",Submit (i.e. be a Muslim)!" He said, "I have submitted myself (as a Muslim) to the Lord of the Alamin (mankind, Jinn and all that exists). } This Ayah indicates that Allah commanded Ibrahim to be sincere with Him and to abide and submit to Him; Ibrahim perfectly adhered to Allah s command. Allah s statement, 4And this (submission to Allah, Islam) xvas enjoined by Ibrahim upon his sons and by Ya'qiiib} means, Ibrahim commanded his offspring to follow this religion, that is, Islam, for Allah. Or, the Ayah might be referring to Ibrahim s words, 4I have submitted myself (as a Muslim) to the Lord of the 'Alamitt (mankind, Jinn and all that exists)}. This means that these Prophets loved these words somuch that they preserved them until the time of death and advised their children toadhere tothem afterthem. Similarly, Allah said, ^ Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :392.

-l Ao jtJ -I }But We gave her (Sarah) glad tidings of Isldiq (Isaac), and after Ishaq, of Ya'qub (Jacob)} (11:71). Also, if Jacob was not alive then, there would be no use here in mentioning him specifically among Isaac s children. Also, Allah said in Surat Al- Ankabut, iro* j liLiy JjyUjj S**-0(^rkt)} 4And We bestowed on him (Ibrahim), Ishaq and Ya'qub, and We ordained among his offspring prophethood and the Book.} (29:27), and, ^ &a^} }And We bestowed upon him Ishaq, and (a grandson) Ya'qub} (21:72), thus, indicating that this occurred during Ibrahim s lifetime. Also, Jacob built Bayt Al-Maqdis, as earlier books testified. The Two Sahihs recorded that Abu Dharr said, I said, O Messenger of Allah! Which Masjid was built first? He said, uAl-Masjid Al-Haram (Al-Ka'bah) .

i(Saying), O my sons! Allah has chosen for you the (true) religion, then die not except as Muslims meaning, perform righteous deeds during your lifetime find remain on this path, so that Allah will endow you with the favor of dying upon it. Usually, one dies upon the path that he lived on and is resurrected according to what he died on. Allah, the Most Generous, helps those who seek to do good deeds to remain on the righteous path. This by no means contradicts the authentic Hadith that says, VI I f'J Ci Ojfi t, d"dl j^l uj j0i jaI jii, jud Sp . jilji jii jul j^d 4,1431 4 Jj&l Jinj 1 I dd ji I I , Vl 4 i) to "M"n might perform the works of the people of Paradise until only a span of outstretched arms or a cubit separates him from it, then the Book (destiny) takes precedence, and he performs the works of the people of the Fire and thus enters it. Also, man might perform the works of the people of the Fire until only a span of outstretched arms or a cubit separates him from the Fire, but the Book takes precedence and he performs the works of the people of Paradise and thus enters it .t Allah said, (92:5-10), r-A Lr;'. GSto- 4As for him who gives (in charity) and keeps his duty to Allah and fears Him. And believes in Al-Husna. We will make smooth for him the path of ease (goodness). But he who is a greedy miser and thinks himself self-sufficient. And belies Al- Husna (none has the right to be worshipped except Allah). We will make smooth for him the path for evil}, Ijlli ifjJu 03-Lid U JIS 4 Jlii i) iil 'njt,oyli * \$ if- ' CW S-ef 'A'o . "-1 TVI" '. Al-Bari 6:105.

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) [yi" U* Vj U c..\ . U C+J cJ . j5 4233. Or were you witnesses when death approached Ya'qub (Jacob)? When he said unto his sons, "What will you worship after me?" They said, We shall worship your Allah (God - Allah) the Ildh of your fathers, Ibrahim (Abraham), Isma'H (Ishtnael), Ishaq (Isaac), One Halt, and to Him we submit (in Islam)}. 4134. That was a nation who has passed away. They shall receive the reward of what they earned and you of what you earn. And you will not be asked of what they used to do.} Ya'qub s Will and Testament to His Children upon His Death This Ayah contains Allah s criticism of the Arab pagans among the offspring of Ismail as well as the disbelievers among the Children of Israel Jacob the son of Isaac, the son of Ibrahim. When death came to Jacob, he advised his children to worship Allah alone without partners. He said to them, 4 What will you worship after me?" They said, We shall worship your Ildh (God - Allah) the Ildh of your fathers, Ibrahim, Ismd'il, Isfiaq," } Mentioning Ismail here is a figure of speech, because Ismail is Jacob s uncle. An-Nahas said that the Arabs call the uncle a father, as Al-Qurtubi mentioned^ This Ayah is used as evidence that the grandfather is called a father and inherits, rather than the brothers (i.e. when his son dies), as Abu Bakr asserted, according to Al-Bukhari who narrated Abu Bakr s statement from Ibn Abbas and Ibn Az- Zubayr. Al-Bukhari then commented that there are no opposing opinions regarding this subject.¹²¹ This is also the opinion of A ishaah the Mother of the believers, Al-Hasan Al- Basri, Tawus and Ata , Malik, Ash-Shafi and Ahmad said that ¹¹¹ Al-Qurtubi 2:138. ¹²¹ PathAl-B&ri 12:19.

408 Tafstr Ibn Kathtr the inheritance is divided between the grandfather and the brothers. It was reported that this was also the opinion of Umar, Uthman, Ali, bin Mas*ud, Zayd bin Thabit and several scholars among the Salafand later generations. The statement, 40ne Hah (God)} means, We single Him out in divinity and do not associate anything or anyone with Him. 4And to Him we submit}, in obedience meaning, obedient and submissiveness. Similarly, Allah said, iWItile to Him submitted all creatures in the heavens and the earth, willingly or unwillingly. And to Him shall they all be returned} (3:83). Indeed, Islam is the religion of all the Prophets, even if their respective laws differed. Allah said, \$ VI% V \$ 4And We did not send any Messenger before you (O Muljammad jgj [but We revealed to him (saying) : La ilaha ilia Ana [none has the right to be ivorshipped but I (Allah)], so ivorship Me (alone and none else)} (21:25). There are many other Ayat - and Hadlths - on this subject. For instance, the Prophet jg said, aL-lj lij ivjl jlx. ^We, the Proplwts, are brothers with different mothers, but the same religion Allah said, js &i} 4That was a nation who has passed away} meaning, existed before your time, m Ahmad 2 :319.

4 l2 3) U } iThey shall receive the reward ofwhat they earned and you of what you earn}. This Ayah proclaims, Your relationship to the Prophets or righteous people among your ancestors will not benefit you, unless you perform good deeds that bring about you religious benefit. They have their deeds and you have yours, 4And you will not be asked ofwhat they used to do}." This is why a Hadith proclaims, w 4j *JlLp 4j Uaj ^Whoever was slowed on account of his deeds will not get any faster on account ofhisfamily lineage. u it iL^ && % s: ji te yjk. wj} 4135. And they say, "Be Jews or Christians, then you will be guided." Say (to them O Muhammad j&), "Nay, (toe follow) only the religion of Ibrahim, Hanif (Islamic Monotheism), and he was not ofAl-Mushrikin (those wlv worshipped others along with Allah.) Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas said that Abdullah bin Suriya Al-A*war said to the Messenger of Allah, The guidance is only what we (Jews) follow. Therefore, follow us, O Muhammad, and you will be rightly guided. Also, the Christians said similarly, so Allah revealed, 4 L> 'Sji 4And thou say, "Be Jews or Christians, then you will be guided."}'2^ Allah s statement, % S. 4 : 2074 IbnAbiHatim 1:397.

4Say (to them O Muhammad sg), Nay, (we follow) only the religion of Ibrahim, Hanifo means, We do not need the Judaism or Christianity that you call us to, rather, i(we follow) only the religion of Ibrahim, Hanifo meaning, on the straight path, as Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi and Isa bin Jariyah stated. 111 Also, Abu Qilabah said, The ilanif is what the Messengers, from beginning to end, believed in. 121 ty Jrf&b \$ fcj 4136. Say (O Muslims) : "We believe in Allah and that which has been sent down to us and that which has been sent down to Ibrahim (Abraham), Ismd'il (Ishmael), Ishaq (Isaac), Ya'qub (Jacob), and to Al-Asbat (the offspring of the twelve sons of Ya'qub), and that which has been given to Musa (Moses) and 'Isa (Jesus), and that which has been given to the Prophetsfrom their Lord. We make no distinction between any of them, and to Him we have submitted (in Islam) . mm ^ t \ o vy. bt jjid -*" 4jili Js (JjA-le- js ds '->>#> Ijj^XLJ-V'3 cAf * # vJj* uj * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :397. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :397

412 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Rak dt before Fq/r. Abu Al- Aliyah, Ar-Rabi and Qatadah said, Al-Asbat are the twelve sons of Jacob, and each one of them had an Ummah of people from his descendants. This is why they were called Al- Asbat. 2 Al-Khal'l bin Ahmad and others said, Al-Asbat among the Children of Israel are just like the tribes among the Children of Ismail. This means that the Asbat are the various

tribes of the Children of Israel, among whom Allah sent several Prophets. Moses said to the Children of Israel, *fd ' i ij # iRemember the favor of Allah to you : when He made Prophets among you, made you kings* } (5:20). Also, Allah said, *4U-^ \ji iAnd We divided them into twelve tribes* } (7:160). Al-Qurtubi said, Sibt is the group of people or a tribe all belonging to the same ancestors. Qatadah said, Allah commanded the believers to believe in Him and in all His Books and Messengers. Also, Sulayman bin Habib said, We were commanded to believe in the (original) Torah and Injll, but not to implement them. *5 jbj 4l)l J j pA UJi jjs .i, It 4137*. So if they believe in the like of that which you believe then they are rightly guided; but if they turn away, then they are only in opposition. So Allah will suffice for you against them. And He is the Hearer, the Knower.} 4133. [Our Sibghah (religion) is] the Sibghah of Allah (Islam) and which Sibghah can be better than Alldh's? And we are His worshippers.} ** Muslim 1 :502 , Abu Dawud 2 :46 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :339 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :399. 131 Al-Qurtubi 2:141. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :400 > Ibid.

Al-Baaarah (125 - 149) (Part-1 Allah said, if they, the disbelievers among the People of the Book and other disbelievers, believe in all of Allah s Books and Messengers and do not differentiate between any of them, *4 \xi\ 4then they are rightly guided meaning, they would acquire the truth and be directed to it. 4but if they turn away from truth to falsehood after proof had been presented to them, 4 ^ (1\$) 4then they are only in opposition*. So Allah will suffice you against them) meaning, Allah will aid the believers against them, *4And He is the Hearer, the Kncrwer Allah said, 4The Sibghah of Allah*). Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas commented, The religion of Allah. ' This Tafsir was also reported of Mujahid, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Ikrimah, Ibrahim, Al- Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Abdullah bin Kathlr, Atiyah Al- Awfi, Ar-Rabl bin Anas, As-Suddi and other scholars. The Ayah, *4Allah s Fitrah (i.c. Allah's Islamic Monotheism)) (30:30) directs Muslims to, Hold to it."* 2&P& pj uj M j ejzs) ji j' Ijj* \jfc Q Sjyj IA Sih # " ^ Zr oU jS0 s-s & }pp Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :402. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :403

4139. Say (O Muhammad jfe to the Jews and CJtristians), "Dispute you with us about Allah while He is our Lord and your Lord? And we are to be rewarded for our deeds and you for your deeds. And we are sincere to Him (i.e. we worship Him alone and none else, and we obey His orders). } 4140. Or say you tlmt Ibrahim, Ismail, Ishaq, Ya'qub and Al- Asbdt, were Jews or Christians? Say, "Do you know better or does Allah? And who is more unjust than he who conceals the testimony he has from Allah? And Allah is not unaware of what you do."} 4141. That loas a nation zoho has passed away. They shall receive the reward of what they earned, and you of what you earn. And you will not be asked ofwhat they used to do.} Allah directed His Prophet to pre-empt the arguments with the idolators: *4\$ 4 \$} 4Say (0 Muliammad ag to the Jews and Christians), "Dispute you xvith us about Allah* } meaning, Do you dispute with us regarding the Oneness of Allah, obedience and submission to Him and in avoiding His prohibitions, *WJ Jr*JT 4whilc He is our Lord and your Lord?*} meaning, He has full control over us and you, and deserves the worship alone without partners. *4fiuf\ fij T3j> 4And we are to be rewarded for our deeds and you for your deeds.* } meaning, we disown you and what you worship, just as you disown us. Allah said in another Ayah, *4And if they belie you, say : "For me are my deeds and for you are your deeds! You are innocent of what I do, and I am innocent ofzvhat you do! }* (10:41), and,

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) *4\$*o if they dispute with you (Muhammad sg) say: "I have submitted myself to Allah (in Islam), and (so have) those who follozo me" (3:20). Allah said about Ibrahim, j js

His people disputed with him. He said: Do you dispute with me concerning Allah") (6:80), and, 4 I? j) ^4 i/oh ho/ looked at him toho disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord (Allah?) (2:258). He said in this honorable Ayah, 4And we are to be rewarded for our deeds azid you for your deeds. And we are sincere to Him .) meaning, We disown you just as you disown us, 4 ;i 4And we are sincere to Him), in worship and submission. Allah then criticized them in the claim that Ibrahim, the Prophets who came after him and the Asbat were following their religion, whether Judaism or Christianity. Allah said, f pk 4Say, Do you know better or does Allah?" meaning, Allah has the best knowledge and He stated that they were neither Jews, nor Christians. Similarly, Allah said in the Ayah, ilbrahim was neither a Jezv nor a Christian, but he zvas a true Muslim Hanifa (to worship none but Allah alone) and he zvas iwt of Al-Mushrikfn) (3:67) and the following Ayat. Allah also said, 4And who is more unjust than he who conceals the testimony he has from Allah?) (2:140). Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, They used to recite the Book of Allah He sent to them that stated that the true religion is Islam and that Muhammad jg is the Messenger

of Allah. Their Book also stated that Ibrahim, Ismail, Ishaq, Ya'qub and the tribes were neither Jews, nor Christians. They testified to these facts, yet hid them from the people. Allah s statement, ii' iAnd Allah is not unaware of what you do\$, is a threat and a warning that His knowledge encompasses eveiy one s deeds, and He shall award each accordingly. Allah then said, Is iil iThat was a nation who has passed away meaning, existed before you, i)zt a irr c iThey shall receive the reward of what they earned, and you ofwhat you eam.\$ meaning, they bear their deeds while you bear yours, iAnd you will not be asked of what they used to do)> meaning, the fact that you are their relatives will not suffice, unless you imitate their good deeds. Further, do not be deceived by the fact that you are their descendants, unless you imitate them in obeying Allah s orders and following His Messengers who were sent as wamers and bearers of good news. Indeed, whoever disbelieves in even one Prophet, will have disbelieved in all the Messengers, especially if one disbelieves in the master and Final Messenger from Allah, the Lord of the worlds, to all mankind and the Jinns. May Allah s peace and blessings be on Muhammad sg and the rest ofAllah s Prophets.

Jjill -oj j* Lf. J'f- jSs^? dl (> tJt: jfcK; d}Sg ^ u^j isi Jic Utj. L) l-i- 4 *- e * jtfa, ir V*t *+?. 4>*v y> VJUp *# o^j ^waJ o^" C*J i jjh ijij ojldlt^ <<,[fts&i 4142. The fools (idolator hypocrites, and Jews) among the people will say: "What has turned them (Muslims) from their Qiblah [prayer direction (towards Jerusalem)] to which they used to face in prayer Say (O Muhammad sg): "To Allah belong both, east and the west. He guides whom He wills to the straight way."} 4143 . Thus We have made you [true Muslims real believers of Islamic Monotheism, true followers of Prophet Muhammad M and his Sunnah (legal ways)], a Wasat (just and the best) nation, that you be witnesses over mankind and the Messenger (Muhammad 3g) be a witness over you. And We made the Qiblah which you used to face, only to test those who followed the Messenger (Muhammad from those who would turn on their heels (i.e., disobey the Messenger). Indeed it was great (heavy, difficult) except for those whom Allah guided. And y mm tt -asp ^ LfrXk- \jjfo==ai jpsili-dil'jSj oA^l\fi)i< ,1 Sifaj4Si\iSZk c Ji_U (jip JjioiilUj o1 ti _y"jl ujL"." _)U!c- dUli ijijjUAjC ^ [j*p-* jt yja*} 0 ;JitlriU

4 Verily, We have seen the turning ofyour (Muhammad's) face toioards the heaven. Surely, We shall turn you to a Qiblah (prayer direction) that shall please you, so turn yourface in the direction ofAl-Masjid

Al-Hardm (at Makkah).} (2:144) A man from among the Muslims then said, We wish we could know about those among us who died before the Qiblah was changed (i.e., towards Makkah) and also about our own prayers, that we had performed towards Bayt Al-Maqdis. Allah then revealed: 4And Allah would never make your faith (prayers) to be lost.\$ (2:143) The fools among the people, meaning the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians), said, What made them change the former Qiblah that they used to face? Allah then revealed: 4The fools (idolators, hypocrites, and Jeios) among the people will say... until the end of the Ayah.]] Ali bin Abu Talhah related that Ibn Abbas said: When Allah s Messenger jg migrated to Al-Madlnah, Allah commanded him to face Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem). The Jews were delighted then. Allah s Messenger jfe faced Jerusalem for over ten months. However, he liked (to offer prayer in the direction of) Prophet Ibrahim s Qiblah (the Ka'bah in Makkah) and used to supplicate to Allah and kept looking up to the sky (awaiting Allah s command in this regard). Allah then revealed: 4&& 4turn yourfaces (in prayer) in that direction meaning, its direction. The Jews did not like this change and said, What made them change the Qiblah that they used to face (meaning Jerusalem)? Allah revealed: Al-Qurtubi 3:133.

iSay (O Muhammad : "To Allah belong both, east and the west. He guides whom He wills to the straight way There are several other Ahadith on this subject. In summary, Allah s Messenger sg was commanded to face Bayt Al-Maqdis (during the prayer) and he used to offer prayer towards it in Makkah between the two comers (of Ka'bah), so that the Ka bah would be between him and Bayt Al-Maqdis8. When the Prophet jg migrated to Al-Madinah, this practice was no longer possible; then Allah commanded him to offer prayer towards Bayt Al-Maqdis, as Ibn Abbas and the majority of the scholars have stated. Al-Bukhari reported in his Sahih that the news (of the change of Qiblah) was conveyed to some of the Ansar while they were performing the Asr (Afternoon) prayer towards Bayt Al-Maqdis, upon hearing that, they immediately changed their direction and faced the Ka'bah . It is reported in the Sahihayn (Al-Bukhari & Muslim) that Ibn Umar narrated: While the people were in Quba (Mosque) performing the Fajr (Dawn) prayer, a man came and said, A (part of the) Qur an was revealed tonight to Allah s Messenger jg and he was commanded to face the Ka'bah. Therefore, face the Ka'bah. They were facing Ash-Sham, so they turned towards the Ka bahP These Hadiths prove that the Nasikh (a Text that abrogates a previous Text) only applies after one acquires knowledge of it, even if the Nasikh had already been revealed and announced. This is why the Companions mentioned above were not commanded to repeat the previous Asr, Maghrib and Isha prayers (although they had prayed them towards Jerusalem after Allah had changed the Qiblah). Allah knows best. When the change of Qiblah (to Ka'bah in Makkah) occurred, those inflicted with hypocrisy and mistrust, and the disbelieving Jews, both were led astray from the right guidance and fell into confusion. They said: 9?&* & u 3:138. I2 ' Al-Bukhari no. 399. These people were from the tribe of Banu Salamah Fath Al-B&ri 8 :24 , and Muslim 1 :375

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-2) iWhat has turned them (Muslims) from their Qiblah to which they used toface in prayer. ^ They asked, What is the matter with these people (Muslims) who one time face this direction (Jerusalem), and then face that direction (Makkah)? Allah answered their questions when He stated: iSay (O Muliammad jg); "To Allah belong both, east and the west meaning, the command, the decision and the authority are for Allah Alone. Hence: 4 ...so wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face of Allah (and He is High above, over His Throne).} (2:115), and: 4?*^ J** ie jf

It is not Al-Birr (piety, righteousness) that you turn your faces towards east and (or) west (in prayers); but Al-Birr is the one who believes in Allah.} (2:177) This statement means, the best act is to adhere to Allah's commands. Hence, wherever He commands us to face, we should face. Also, since obedience requires implementing Allah's commands, if He commands us every day to face different places, we are His servants and under His disposal, and we face whatever He orders us to face. Certainly, Allah's care and kindness towards His servant and Messenger, Muhammad (ﷺ), and certainly, his Ummah (Muslim nation) is profoundly great. Allah has guided them to the Qiblah of (Prophet) Ibrahim - Allah's Khalil (intimate friend). He has commanded them to face the Ka'bah, the most honorable house (of worship) on the face of the earth, which was built by Ibrahim Al-Khalil in the Name of Allah, the One without a partner. This is why Allah said afterwards:

"O Muhammad (ﷺ) : "To Allah belong both, east and the west. He guides whom He wills to the straight way) Imam Ahmad reported that A'ishah (the Prophet's wife) said that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said about the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians): "They do not envy us for a matter more than they envy us for Jumu'ah (Friday) to which Allah has guided us and from which they were led astray; for the (true) Qiblah to which Allah has directed us and from which they were led astray ; and for our saying 'Amin' behind the Imam (leader of the prayer) ." * The Virtues of Muhammad's Nation Allah said: "Thus We have made you [true Muslims], a Wasat (just) (and the best) nation, that you be witnesses over mankind and the Messenger (Muhammad ﷺ) be a witness over you.) Allah stated that He has changed our Qiblah to the Qiblah of Ibrahim and chose it for us so that He makes us the best nation ever. Hence, we will be the witnesses over the nations on the Day of Resurrection, for all of them will then agree concerning our virtue. The word Wasat in the Ayah means the best and the most honored. Therefore, saying that (the Prophet's tribe) Quraysh is in the Wasat regarding Arab tribes and their areas, means the best. Similarly, saying that Allah's Messenger was in the Wasat of his people, means he was from the best subtribe. Also, 'Asr, the prayer that is described as Wusfa (a variation of the word Wasat), means the best prayer, as the authentic collections of Ahadith reported. Since Allah made this Ummah (Muslim nation) the Wasaf, He has endowed her with the most complete legislation, the best m Ahmad 6 :134.

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-2) Manhaj (way, method, etc.,) and the clearest Madhhab (methodology, mannerism, etc). Allah said: "We have chosen you (to convey His Message of Islamic Monotheism to mankind), and has not laid upon you in religion any hardship : it is the religion of your father Ibrahim . It is He (Allah) Who has named you

424 Tafsir Ibtidai Imam Ahmad also reported that Abu Said Khudri narrated: Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: "The Prophet would come on the Day of Resurrection with two or more people (his only following!), and his people would also be summoned and asked, 'Has he (their Prophet) conveyed (the Message) to you?' They would say, No. He would be asked, 'Have you conveyed (the Message) to your people?' He would say, 'Yes.' He would be asked. Who testifies for you? He would say, 'Muhammad and his Ummah.' Muhammad and his Ummah would then be summoned and asked, 'Has he conveyed (the Message) to his people?' They would say, 'Yes.' They would be asked, 'What told you that?' They would

say, 'Our Prophet (Muhammad) came to us and told us that the Messengers have conveyed (their Messages) Hence Allah's statement: 'Thus We have made you a Wasat nation. He said, (meaning) the Adi, (he then continued reciting the Ayah): 'O you who believe, We have made you, a just (and the best) nation, that you be witnesses over mankind and the Messenger (Muhammad) be a witness over you.' Furthermore, Imam Ahmad reported that Abul-Aswad narrated: I came to Al-Madinah and found that an epidemic had broken out that caused many fatalities. I sat next to Ahmad 3 :58.

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-2) Umar bin Al-Khattab once when a funeral procession started and the people praised the dead person. Umar said, Wajabat (it will be recorded as such), Wajabati Then another funeral was brought forth and the people criticized the dead person. Again, Umar said, Wajabat. Abul-Aswad asked, What is Wajabat, O Leader of the faithful? He said, I said just like Allah's Messenger had said: 'The Messenger of Allah is like the Qiblah, if you turn towards him, you are facing the Qiblah.'

meaning, reverts from his religion. [Allah then said:] 'Indeed it was great (heavy, difficult)' The Ayah indicates that changing the Qiblah from Bayt Al-Maqdis to the Ka'bah is heavy on the heart, except for whomever Allah has rightly guided their hearts, who believe in the truth of the Messenger with certainty and that whatever he was sent with is the truth without doubt. It is they who believe that Allah does what He wills, decides what He wills, commands His servants with what He wills, abrogates any of His commands that He wills, and that He has the perfect wisdom and the unequivocal proof in all this. (The attitude of the believers in this respect is) unlike those who have a disease in their hearts, to whom whenever a matter occurs, it causes doubts, just as this same matter adds faith and certainty to the believers. Similarly, Allah said: 'And whenever there comes down a Surah (chapter from the Qur'an), some of them (hypocrites) say: Which of you has had his faith increased by it?' As for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice. But as for those in whose hearts is a disease (of doubt, disbelief and hypocrisy), it will add doubt and disbelief to their doubt and disbelief; and they die while they are disbelievers.' (9:124, 125) and: 'We send down of the Qur'an that which is a healing and a mercy to those who believe, and it increases the wrongdoers in nothing but loss.' (17:82) Certainly, those who remained faithful to the Messenger, obeyed him and faced whatever Allah commanded them, without doubt or hesitation, were the leaders of the Companions. Some scholars stated that the Early Migrants

427 Siirah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-2) (who migrated with the Prophet from Makkah to Al-Madinah) and Ansar (the residents of Al-Madinah who gave aid and refuge to both the Prophet and the Migrants) were those who offered prayers towards the two Qiblah (Bayt Al-Maqdis and then the Ka'bah).

And Allah would never make your faith to be lost entails: Your (prayer towards) the first Qiblah and your believing your Prophet and obeying him by facing the second Qiblah; He will grant you the rewards for all these acts. Indeed, Truly, Allah is full of kindness, the Most Merciful towards mankind. Furthermore, it is reported in the Sahih that Allah's Messenger saw a woman among the captives who was separated from her child. Whenever she found a boy (infant) among the captives, she would hold him close to her chest, as she was looking for her boy. When she found her child, she embraced him and gave him her breast to nurse. Allah's Messenger said: 'Do you think that this woman would willingly throw her son in the

fire?" They said, No, O Messenger of Allah! He said, By Allah! Allah is more merciful with His servants than this woman with her son." (21 jy * "" Jjt I4 .Yt' j m iSsm iff c;& faz pijZ ij> 2% u ixj gai iif lij il44. Verily, We have seen the turning of your (Muhammad's) face towards the heaven . Surely, We shall turn you to a Qiblah (prayer direction) that slmll please you, so turn your face in the direction of Al-Masjid Al-Hardm (at Makkah). And wheresoever you people are, turn your faces (in prayer) in that direction. Certainly, the people who were given the Scripture (i.e., Jews 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :99. Muslim 4:2109.

Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-2) and Christians) know well that, that (your turning towards the direction of the Ka'bah at Makkah in prayers) is the truth from their Lord. And Allah is not unaware of what they do}. The First Abrogation in the Qur'an was about the Qiblah Ali bin Abu Talhah related that Ibn Abbas narrated: The first abrogated part in the Qur'an was about the Qiblah. When Allah's Messenger jg; migrated to Al-Madinah, the majority of its people were Jews, and Allah commanded him to face Bayt Al-Maqdis. The Jews were delighted then. Allah's Messenger jg faced it for ten and some months, but he liked to face the Qiblah of Ibrahim (Ka'bah in Makkah). He used to supplicate to Allah and look up to the sky (awaiting Allah's command). Allah then revealed: 4 AfLj & lift i Verily, We have seen the turning of your (Muhammad's) face towards the heaven}, until, itum your faces (in prayer) in that direction. } The Jews did not like this ruling and said: Ai i#\$pi *& i What has turned them (Muslims) from their Qiblah (prayer direction) to which they used to face in prayer." Say (O Muhammad), "To Allah belong both, east and the zvest."} (2: 142) Allah said: 'jlyCp} i...so wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face of Allah} (2:115), and: } And We made the Qiblah (prayer direction towards Jerusalem) 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :103.

zohicli you used to face, only to test those who fbllozved the Messenger (Muhammad \$g) from those ivho would turn on their heels (i.e., disobey the Messenger).} (2:143) Is the Qiblah the Ka'bah itself for its General Direction? Al-Hakim related that Ali bin Abu Talib said: 4 ...so turn your face in the direction of Al-Masjid Al-Hardm (at Makkah).} means its direction. 11 ' Al-Hakim then commented that the chain of this narration is authentic and that they (i.e., Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not include it in their collections. This ruling concerning the Qiblah is also the opinion of Abu Al- Aliyah, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah, Ar- Rabl bin Anas and others.'2' Allah's Statement: 4 And wheresoever you people are, turn your faces (in prayer) in that direction \$ is a command from Allah to face the Ka'bah from wherever one is on the earth: the east, west, north or south. The exception is of the voluntary prayer {Nafl) while one is traveling, for one is allowed to offer it in any direction his body is facing, while his heart is intending the Ka'bah. Also, when the battle is raging, one is allowed to offer prayer, however he is able. Also, included are those who are not sure of the direction and offer prayer in the wrong direction, thinking that it is the direction of the Qiblah, because Allah does not burden a soul beyond what it can bear. The Jews had Knowledge that the (Muslim) Qiblah would later be changed Allah stated that: "" Al-Mustadrak 2 :269 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:107-109.

431 Siirah 2 . Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-2) ^Certainly, the people who were given the Scripture (i.e., Jews and the Christians) know well that, that (your turning towards the direction of the Ka'bah at Makkah in prayers) is the truth from their Lord. } This Ayah means: The Jews, who did not like that you change your Qiblah from Bayt Al-Maqdis, already knew that Allah will command you (O Muhammad)

to face the Ka'bah. The Jews read in their Books their Prophets' description of Allah's Messenger and his Ummah, and that Allah has endowed and honored him with the complete and honorable legislation. Yet, the People of the Book deny these facts because of their envy, disbelief and rebellion. This is why Allah threatened them when He said: *And Allah is not unaware of what they do.* And even if you were to bring to the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) all the Ayat (proofs, evidences, verses, lessons, signs, revelations, etc.), they would not follow your Qiblah (prayer direction), nor are you going to follow their Qiblah. And they will not follow each other's Qiblah. Verily, if you follow their desires after that which you have received of knowledge (from Allah), then indeed you will be one of the wrongdoers. The Stubbornness and Disbelief of the Jews Allah describes the Jews' disbelief, stubbornness and defiance of what they know of the truth of Allah's Messenger, that if the Prophet brought forward every proof to the truth of what he was sent with, they will never obey him or abandon following their desires. In another instance, Allah said:

Those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment. (10:96, 97) This is why Allah said here: *And even if you were to bring to the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) all the Ayat (proofs, evidences, verses, lessons, signs, revelations, etc.), they would not follow your Qiblah (prayer direction).* Allah's statement: *nor are you going to follow their Qiblah*, indicates the vigor with which Allah's Messenger implements what Allah commanded him. Allah's statement also indicates that as much as the Jews adhere to their opinions and desires, the Prophet adheres by Allah's commands, obeying Him and following what pleases Him, and that he would never adhere to their desires in any case. Hence, praying towards Bayt Al-Maqdis was not because it was the Qiblah of the Jews, but because Allah had commanded it. Allah then warns those who knowingly defy the truth, because the proof against those who know is stronger than against other people. This is why Allah said to His Messenger and his Ummah:

Those to whom We gave the Scripture (Jews and Christians) recognize him (Muhammad or the Ka'bah at Makkah) as they recognize their sons. But verily, a party of them conceal the truth while they know it - [i.e., the qualities of Muhammad which are written in the Torah and the Injil]. This is the truth from your Lord. So be you not one of those who doubt. The Jews know that the Prophet's message is True, but they hide the Truth. Allah states that the scholars of the People of the Scripture know the truth of what Allah's Messenger was sent with, just as one of them knows his own child, which is a parable that the Arabs use to describe what is very apparent. Similarly, in a Hadith, Allah's Messenger said to a man who had a youngster with him: *This is your son*

own son? He replied, Yes, and even more. The Honest One descended from heaven on the Honest One on the earth with his (i.e., Muhammad's) description and I recognized him, although I do not know anything about his mother's story. Allah states next that although they had knowledge and certainty in the Prophet's message, they still: *hide the truth.* The Ayah indicates that they hide the truth from the people, about the Prophet, that they find in their Books, while they know it. Allah then strengthens the resolve of His Prophet and the believers and affirms that what the Prophet came with is the truth

without doubt, saying: Cri {ft 4(Tltis is) the truth from your Lord. So be you not one of those who doubt.} S jfc* ot: ij,jG u 4? 4148. For every nation there is a direction to which they face (in their prayers). So hasten to wards all that is good. Wheresoever you may be, Allah will bring you together (on the Day of Resurrection). Truly, Allah is able to do all things.} Every Nation has a Qiblah Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said: 4For every nation there is a direction to which they face (in their prayers)} This talks about followers of the various religions. Hence, every nation and tribe has its own Qiblah that they choose, Al-Qurtubi 2 :163

Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) while Allah s appointed Qiblah is what the believers face. I' 1 Abul-Aliyah said, The Jew has a direction to which he faces (in the prayer). The Christian has a direction to which he faces. Allah has guided you, O (Muslim) Ummah, to a Qiblah which is the true Qiblah, This statement was also related to Mujahid, Ata Ad-Dahhak, Ar-RabT bin Anas, As-Suddi, and others. 31 This last Ayah is similar to what Allah said: z 4\$3 # jduea iit sl 4To each among you, We have prescribed a law and a clear way. If Allah had willed, He would have made you one nation, but that (He) may test you in what He has given you; so compete in good deeds. The return of you (all) is to Allah.} (5:48) In the Ayah (2:148), Allah said: A.'j.f* ;isr jf& 5) 'A-i- Jilt iyjZS U '\$} 4Wheresoever you may be, Allah will bring you together (on the Day of Resurrection). Truly, Allah is able to do all things.} meaning: He is able to gather you from the earth even if your bodies and flesh disintegrated and scattered. L"j litJ j"li j.\yd* jji cJLJ u ~"-j i J' ^ . 'a.ojtlju J" i&z * tik ysi ^ . And from wheresoever you start forth (for prayers), turn your face in the direction of Al-Masjid Al-Hardm (at Makkah), that is indeed the truth from your Lord. And Allah is not unaware of what you do.} 4150. And from wheresoever you start forth (for prayers), turn At-Jabari 3:193. 2 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:121-122.

your face in the direction of Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah), and wheresoever you are , turn your faces towards it (when you pray) so that men may have no argument against you except those of them that are wrongdoers, so fear them not, but fear Me! - And so that I may complete My blessings on you and that you may be guided.)

Why was changing the Qiblah mentioned thrice?

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 436–447]

This is a third command from Allah to face Al-Masjid Al- Haram (the Sacred Mosque) from every part of the world (during prayer). It was said that Allah mentioned this ruling again here because it is connected to whatever is before and whatever is after it. Hence, Allah first said: y^ / / / # J ^ # t ^ v i Verily, We have seen the turning of your (Muhammad's) face to wards the heaven. Surely, We shall turn you to a Qiblah (prayer direction) that shall please you) (2:144), until: *(lie. Jiytf Uj p-fcd OylLd wACii iCertainly, the people who were given the Scripture (i.e., feius and the Christians) knozv well that, that (your turning towards the direction of the Ka'bah at Makkah in prayers) is the truth from their Lord. And Allah is not unaware of what they do.) (2:144) Allah mentioned in these Ayat His fulfillment of the Prophet s wish and ordered him to face the Qiblah that he liked and is pleased with. In the second command, Allah said: tit eUj ^ A A*-* e.- jti) / ">"* . 'S iAnd from wheresoever you start forth (for prayers), turn your face in the direction of Al-Masid Al-Haram that is indeed the truth from your Lord.

And Allah is not unaware of what you do.) Therefore, Allah states here that changing the Qiblah is also the truth from Him, thus upgrading the subject more than in the first Ayah, in which Allah agreed to what His Prophet

had wished for. Thus Allah states that this is also the truth from Him that He likes and is pleased with. In the third command, Allah refutes the Jewish assertion that the Prophet M faced their Qiblah, as they knew in their Books that the Prophet gg will later on be commanded to face the Qiblah of Ibrahim, the Ka'bah. The Arab disbelievers had no more argument concerning the Prophet s Qiblah after Allah commanded the Prophet gg to face the Qiblah of Ibrahim, which is more respected and honored, rather than the Qiblah of the Jews. The Arabs used to honor the Ka'bah and liked the fact that the Messenger gs was commanded to face it. The Wisdom behind abrogating the Previous Qiblah Allah said: \$...so that men may have no argument against you ^ Therefore, the People of the Book knew from the description of the Muslim Ummah that they would be ordered to face the Ka'bah. If the Muslims did not fit this description, the Jews would have used this fact against the Muslims. If the Muslims had remained on the Qiblah of Bayt Al-Maqdis, which was also the Qiblah of the Jews, this fact could have been used as the basis of argument by the Jews against other people. Allah s Statement: irk iAi 4 . . .except those of them that are wrongdoers, indicates the Mushrikin (polytheists) of Quraysh. The reasoning of these unjust persons was the unsound statement: This man (Muhammad) claims that he follows the religion of Ibrahim! Hence, if his facing Bayt Al-Maqdis was a part of the religion of Ibrahim, why did he change it? The answer to this question is that Allah has chosen His Prophet gg to face Bayt Al-Maqdis first for certain wisdom, and he obeyed Allah

regarding this command. Then, Allah changed the Qiblah to the Qiblah of Ibrahim, which is the Ka'bah, and he also obeyed Allah in this command. He, obeys Allah in all cases and never engages in the defiance of Allah even for an instant, and his Ummah imitates him in this.

Allah said: 4...so fear them not, but fear Me!} meaning: Do not fear the doubts that the unjust, stubborn persons raise and fear Me Alone. Indeed, Allah Alone deserves to be feared. Allah said: 4&&& 4...so that I may complete My blessings on you.} This Ayah relates to Allah s statement: j & jjUjj, h,} .so that men may have no argument against you}, meaning: I will perfect My bounty on you by legislating for you to face the Ka bah, so that the (Islamic) Shari ah (law) is complete in every respect. Allah said: 4c2fc2 -fJ&j} .that you may be guided.}, meaning: To be directed and guided to what the nations have been led astray from. We have guided you to it and preferred you with it. This is why this Ummah is the best and most honored nation ever. 4 1 S&5S %P 4151. Similarly (to complete My blessings on you). We have sent among you a Messenger (Muhammad ig) of your own, reciting to you Our verses (the Qur'an) and purifying you, and teaching you the Book (the Qur an) and the Hikmah (i.e., Sunnah, Islamic laws and Fiqh - jurisprudence), and teaching you that which you did not know.} 4152. Therefore remember Me (by praying, glorifying). I will remember you, and be grateful to Me (for My countless favors on you) and never be ungrateful to Me.}

Muhammad's Prophecy is a Great Bounty from Allah Allah reminds His believing servants with what He has endowed them with by sending Muhammad as a Messenger to them, reciting to them Allah s clear Ayat and purifying and cleansing them from the worst types of behavior, the ills of the souls and the acts of JdhUiyyah (pre-Islamic era). The Messenger 3 also takes them away from the darkness (of

disbelief) to the light (of faith) and teaches them the Book, the Qur'an, and the Hikmah (i.e., the wisdom), which is his Sunnah. He also teaches them what they knew not. During the time of Jadhuyyah, they used to utter foolish statements. Later on, and with the blessing of the Prophet's Message and the goodness of his prophecy, they were elevated to the status of the Awliya (loyal friends of Allah) and the rank of the scholars. Hence, they acquired the deepest knowledge among the people, the most pious hearts, and the most truthful tongues. Allah said: 'aM i j >' * f. - Scuiifi .U ill ilIndeed, Allah conferred a great favor on the believers when He sent among them a Messenger (Muhammad from among themselves, reciting unto them His verses (the Qur'an), and purifying them (from sins).} (3:164) Allah also criticized those who did not give this bounty its due consideration, when He said: 4 r J,* \$ illi ijlje j) J fi\} iHave you not seen those who have changed the favors of Allah into disbelief (by denying Prophet Muhammad and his Message of Islam), and caused their people to dwell in the house of destruction?} (14:28) Ibn Abbas commented, Allah's favor means Muhammad. Therefore, Allah has commanded the believers to affirm this favor and to appreciate it by thanking and remembering Him: ^Therefore, remember Me. I will remember you, and be grateful to Me, and never be ungrateful to Me.} Al-Bukhari no . 3977.

Mujahid said that Allah's statement: 4Similarly (to complete My favor on you), We have sent among you a Messenger (Muhammad O) of your own,\$ means: Therefore, remember Me in gratitude to My favor. Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented about Allah's statement: ipn 4Therefore remember Me. I will remember you Remember Me regarding what I have commanded you and I will remember you regarding what I have compelled Myself to do for your benefit (i.e., His rewards and forgiveness). '2' An authentic Hadith states: VI' - i- r* J - ^ri CAJ uAllah the Exalted said, 'Whoever mentions Me to himself, then I will mention him to Myself; and whoever mentions Me in a gathering, I will mention him in a better gathering , " 13 ' Imam Ahmad reported that Anas narrated that Allah's Messenger said: 0) Jt J Je'J 3* "" jlj - J~>- J -Jli A ~ iSsiyim Irt J J A?] jlj tlpU aJuu o^o Iplji Je jlj ilpljj the Exalted said, O son of Adam! If you mention Me to yourself, I will mention you to Myself. If you mention Me in a gathering, I will mention you in a gathering of the angels (or said in a better gathering). If you draw closer to Me by a hand span, I will draw closer to you by forearm's length. If you draw closer to Me by a forearm's length, I will draw closer to you by an arm's length . And if you come to Me walking, I will come Tabari 3:210. (2 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :141 Al-Bari 13:395.

Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) J mm T t 'jv"j 'o? j^h^ jJj j oy"-j Hj'jauUHjSfiiluiip^.'tCA (j f j'j \$.^SjiaJJ4jj jloill -lf+i -? ~\ . *-f C i- ..-'."if" iT-r -"i to you runnings. Its chain is Sahih, it was recorded by Al- Bukhari. 111 Allah said: % J 4...and be grateful to Me (for My countless favors on you) and never be ungrateful to Me.} In this Ayah, Allah commands that He be thanked and appreciated, and promises even more rewards for thanking Him. Allah said in another Ayah: od f\$3j 'fi&iff j^j =zC. 4V\, %& u'i jj 4And (remember) token your Lord proclaimed : "If you give thanks (by accepting faith and worshipping none but Allah), I will give you more (of My blessings); but if you are thankless (i.e., disbelievers), verily, My punishment is indeed severe. Abu Raja Al- Utaridi said: Imran bin Husayn came by us once wearing a nice silken garment that we never saw him wear before or afterwards. He said, Allah's Messenger jg said: JJ '-kij (_"!* J>\ i&fi "5 jji ilAj lit ^Ju\ t.xJ. Jit : Ja Those whom Allah has favored with a bounty, then Allah likes 3 :138 , Path Al-Bdri 13 :52 1

442 Tafsir Ibn Kathir to see the effect of His bounty on His creation ", or he said, on His servant - according to Ruh (one of the narrators of the Hadith)ff\ jSj! JJ ijJjii 'ij yrjitjcSli ^ IA^ !A*** ^ Lj ^ :53j" L .Jit _LJk ' ij 4153. O you who believe! Seek help in patience and As-Saldh (the prayer). Truly, Allah is with As-Sabirin (the patient).} 4154. And say not of those who are killed in the way of Allah, "They are dead." Nay, they are living, but you perceive (it) not.} The Virtue of Patience and Prayer After Allah commanded that He be appreciated, He ordained patience and prayer. It is a fact that the servant is either enjoying a bounty that he should be thankful for, or suffering a calamity that he should meet with patience. A Hadith states: 015 yojj oiii oi :*J \ js- N) *tAt" ^ t-j \fj- ois oLii olj d oAmazing is the believer, for whatever Allah decrees for him, it is better for him! If he is tested with a bounty, he is grateful for it and this is better for him; and if he is afflicted with a hardship, he is patient with it and this is better for him. Allah has stated that the best tools to help ease the effects of the afflictions are patience and prayer. Earlier we mentioned Allah's statement: i? -*\1And seek help in patience and As-Saldh (the prayer) and truly, it is extremely heavy and hard except for Al-Khdshi'in [i.e., the true believers in Allah]} (2:45) There are several types of Sabr patience: one for avoiding the prohibitions and sins, one for acts of worship and obedience. The second type carries more rewards than the first I 1 * Ahmad 4 :438. > Muslim 4:2292.

Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) type. There is a third type of patience required in the face of the afflictions and hardships, which is mandatory, like repentance. Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, Sabr has two parts: patience for the sake of Allah concerning what He is pleased with (i.e., acts of worship and obedience), even if it is hard on the heart and the body, and patience when avoiding what He dislikes, even if it is desired. Those who acquire these qualities will be among the patient persons whom Allah shall greet (when they meet Him in the Hereafter; refer to Surat Al- Ahzab 33:44), Allah willing. 111 The Life enjoyed by Martyrs Allah's statement: 4 ^ j* kyl y' Ssf CA iAnd say not of those who are killed in the way of Allah, "They are dead. Nay, they are living indicates that the martyrs are alive and receiving their sustenance. Muslim reported in his Sahih * C tj~a>- Jb il jj\ jl liU :JUi Aijj e JjJl Si |JL".{ iaxJ U LllixP I jSj J lijj Ij : I flii ?jyw Ijlj Ul# tJia ... ^ Ij I/: ojs tij - s Ais jii jiL~i j ;\21 uijji jijji ^J\ . a : J'jL*- fs? Jyl* ;S1)1 tjJi "T7ie sow/s O/ f/ie martyrs are inside green birds and move about in Paradise wherever they wish. Then, they take refuge in lamps that are hanging under the Throne (of Allah). Your Lord looked at them and asked them, "What do you wish for?" They said, 'What more could we wish for while You have favored us with what You have not favored any other of your creation? He repeated the question again. When they realize that they will be asked (until they answer), they said, We wish that You send (M Ibn Abi Hatim 1:144.

surely, We shall try you till We test those who strive hard (for the cause of Allah) and As-Sabirin (the patient), and We shall test your facts (i.e., the one who is a liar, and the one who is truthful).} (47:31) Hence, He tests them with the bounty sometimes and sometimes with the afflictions of fear and hunger. Allah said in another Ayah J-Q 111 4So Allah made it taste extreme of hunger (famine) and fear.} (16:112) The frightened and the hungry persons show the effects of the affliction outwardly and this is why Allah has used here the word Libas (cover or clothes) of fear and hunger. In the Ayat above, Allah used the words: iwith something of fear, hunger,} meaning, a little of each. Then (Allah said), Sj oftj} iloss of wealth, } meaning, some of the wealth will be destroyed, ij*%} Olives} meaning, losing friends, relatives and loved ones to death, iattd fruits,} meaning, the gardens and the farms will not produce the

usual or expected amounts. This is why Allah said next: ⁴but give glad tidings to As-Sdbirfn (the patient). } He then explained whom He meant by the patient whom He praised:

446 Tafstr Ibt Kathir 5 4 j&} 4W7io, when afflicted with calamity, say: "Truly, to Allah we belong and truly, to Him we shall return . " } meaning, those who recite this statement to comfort themselves in the face of their loss, know that they belong to Allah and that He does what He wills with His servants. They also know that nothing and no deed, even if it was the weight of an atom, will be lost with Allah on the Day of Resurrection. These facts thus compel them to admit that they are Allah s servants and that their return will be to Him in the Hereafter. This is why Allah said: ... y . A* ", A_r-i\ Lit iThey are those on whom are the Salawat (i.e., who are blessed and will be forgiven) from their Lord, and (they are those who) receive His mercy,> meaning, Allah s praise and mercy will be with them. Said bin Jubayr added, Meaning, safety from the torment. iand it is they who are the guided ones . TJmar bin Al-Khattab commented: What righteous things, and what a great heights. iThey are those on whom are the Salawat from their Lord, and (they are those who) receive His mercy} are the two righteous things. iattd it is they who are the guided ones} are the heights. The heights means more rewards, and these people will be awarded their rewards and more. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:158. 121 Al-Hakim 2:270.

The Virtue of asserting that We all belong to Allah,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 447–448]

during Afflictions There are several Ahadith that mention the rewards of admitting that the return is to Allah by saying: #21 fyj k fy) i"Truly, to Allah we belong and truly, to Him we shall return.'y when afflictions strike. For instance, Imam Ahmad reported that Umm Salamah narrated: Once, Abu Salamah came back after he was with Allah s Messenger jg and said: I heard Allah s Messenger jg recite a statement that made me delighted. He said: \j^-\ Aj iIlJS Jii Slj 1 1\$-; ijl es? 4No Muslim is struck with an affliction and then says Istirja when the affliction strikes, and then says : 'O Allah! Rezoard me for my loss and give me what is better than it/ but Allah will do just that. Umm Salamah said: So I memorized these words. When Abu Salamah died I said Istitja.' and said: O Allah! Compensate me for my loss and give me what is better than it. I then thought about it and said, Who is better than Abu Salamah? When my Iddah (the period of time before the widow or divorced woman can remarry) finished, Allah s Messenger sg asked for permission to see me while I was dyeing a skin that I had. I washed my hands, gave him permission to enter and handed him a pillow, and he sat on it. He then asked me for marriage and when he finished his speech, I said, O Messenger of Allah! It is not because I do not want you, but I am very jealous and I fear that you might experience some wrong mannerism from me for which Allah would punish me. I am old and have children. He said: yLJ\ U Ulj J y, Ail 14-A-jj 1 Sjj! Iy y'ffs U tab JUU* JU*JI jyi !j niLLil ^.ill -lii

448 Tafsir Ibn Kathir "As for the jealousy that you mentioned, Allah the Exalted will remove it from you As for your being old as you mentioned, I lurve suffered what you have suffered. And for your having children, they are my children too." She said, I have surrendered to Allah s Messenger. Allah s Messenger sg married her and Umm Salamah said later, Allah compensated me with who is better than Abu Salamah: Allah s Messenger Muslim reported a shorter version of this HadithJ21 4fo'j-fo 'fofo iit oji Cto- fefo Jij 11. Verily, As-Safd and Al-Marwah131 are of the symbols of Allah. So it is not a sin on

him who performs Hajj or Umrah (pilgrimage) of the House to perform Tawaf between them. And whoever does good voluntarily, then verily, Allah is All- Recognizer, All-Knower

Surah 2: Al-Baqarah (Part 3 of 4)

PDF pages 95–803

The Meaning of “it is not a sin” in the Ayah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 448–485]

Imam Ahmad reported that Urwah said that he asked A'ishah about what Allah stated: *Verily, As-Safa and Al-Marwah (two mountains in Makkah) are of the symbols of Allah. So it is not a sin on him who performs Hajj or 'Umrah (pilgrimage) of the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah) to perform the going (Tawaf) between them (As-Safa and Al-Marwah). By Allah! It is not a sin if someone did not perform Tawaf around them.* A'ishah said, Worst is that which you said, O my nephew! If this is the meaning of it, it should have read, *It is not a sin!* Ahmad 4:27, 2:633. The names of the two small mountains that the pilgrims walk and run between during the rites of 'Umrah.

Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) is not a sin if one did not perform Tawaf around them. Rather, the Ayah was revealed regarding the Ansar, who before Islam, used to assume Ihlal (or Ihram for Hajj) in the area of Mushallah for their idol Manat that they used to worship. Those who assumed Ihlal for Manat, used to hesitate to perform Tawaf (going) between Mounts As-Safa and Al-Marwah. So they (during the Islamic era) asked Allah's Messenger about it, saying, O Messenger of Allah! During the time of Jahiliyyah, we used to hesitate to perform Tawaf between As-Safa and Al-Marwah. Allah then revealed: *Verily, As-Safa and Al-Marwah are of the symbols of Allah. So it is not a sin on him who performs Hajj or 'Umrah of the House to perform the going (Tawaf) between them.* A'ishah then said, Allah's Messenger has made it the Sunnah to perform Tawaf between them (As-Safa and Al-Marwah), and thus, no one should abandon performing Tawaf between them. This Hadith is reported in the Sahihayn. In another narration, Imam Az-Zuhri reported that Urwah said: Later on I (Urwah) told Abu Bakr bin Abdur-Rahman bin Al-Harith bin Hisham (of A'ishah's statement) and he said, I have not heard of such information. However, I heard learned men saying that all the people, except those whom A'ishah mentioned, said, Our Tawaf between these two hills is a practice of Jahiliyyah. Some others among the Ansar said, We were commanded to perform Tawaf of the Ka'bah, but not between As-Safa and Al-Marwah. So Allah revealed: *Verily, As-Safa and Al-Marwah are of the symbols of Allah.* Abu Bakr bin Abdur-Rahman then said, It seems that this verse was revealed concerning the two groups. Al-Bukhari collected a similar narration by Anas. Ash-Shahi said, Isaf (an idol) was on As-Safa while Na'ilah *** Ahmad 6:144. Path Al-Bari 3:581, and Muslim 2:929

(an idol) was on Al-Marwah, and they used to touch (or kiss) them. After Islam came, they were hesitant about performing Tawaf between them. Thereafter, the Ayah (2:158 above) was revealed. The Wisdom behind legislating Sa'at between As-Safa and Al-Marwah

Al-Baqarah (150 - 374) (Part-2) Damm. 1 1 Allah has stated that Tawaf between As-Safa and Al-Marwah is among the symbols of Allah, meaning, among the acts that Allah legislated during the Hajj for Prophet Ibrahim. Earlier we mentioned the Hadith by Ibn Abbas that the origin of Tawaf comes

from the Tawaf of Hajar (Prophet Ibrahim's wife), between As-Safa and Al-Marwah seeking water for her son (Isma'il) Ibrahim had left them in Makkah, where there was no habitation for her. When Hajar feared that her son would die, she stood up and begged Allah for His help and kept going back and forth in that blessed area between As-Safa and Al-Marwah. She was humble, fearful, frightened and meek before Allah. Allah answered her prayers, relieved her of her loneliness, ended her dilemma and made the well of Zamzam bring forth its water for her, which is: OaJij . -"As "A tasty (or nutritional) food and a remedy for the illness ." Therefore, whoever performs Sa't between As-Safa and Al-Marwah should remember his meekness, humbleness and need for Allah to guide his heart, lead his affairs to success and forgive his sins. He should also want Allah to eliminate his shortcomings and errors and to guide him to the straight path. He should ask Allah to keep him firm on this path until he meets death, and to change his situation from that of sin and errors to that of perfection and being forgiven, the same providence which was provided to Hajar. Allah then states: fcp&& 4And whoever does good voluntarily. \$ It was said that the Ayah describes performing Tawaf more than seven times, it was also said that it refers to voluntary Umrah or Hajj. It was also said that it means volunteering to do good works in general, as Ar-Razi has stated. The third opinion was attributed to Al-Hasan Al-Basri.^ Allah knows best. A form of expiation in which an animal is slaughtered in Makkah and distributed among the poor Ar-Razi 4 :146.

Allah states: ^iJc \$12 if6...then verily, Allah is All-Recognizer, All-Knower.) meaning, Allah's reward is immense for the little deed, and He knows about the sufficiency of the reward. Hence, He will not award insufficient rewards to anyone. Indeed: ftS 25! os 'f "\-l I." iSurely, Allah wrongs not even of the weight of an atom, but if there is any good (done), He doubles it, and gives from Him a great reward.) (4:40) Itj . 4\$ dLdjts l/X4> i>; \$j(^ 'it <*(^ \)Cj \ z\$ % v\$" btj 4'faj'^{\$ f "5lj j+r oirt V ujLitf} 4159. Verily, those who conceal the clear proofs, evidences and the guidance, which We have sent down, after We have made it clear for the People in the Book, they are the ones cursed by Allah and cursed by the cursers.) 4160. Except those who repent and do righteous deeds, and openly declare (the truth which they concealed). These, I will accept their repentance. And I am the One Who accepts repentance, the Most Merciful.) 4161. Verily, those who disbelieve, and die while they are disbelievers, it is they on whom is the curse of Allah and of the angels and of mankind, combined.) 4162. They will abide therein (under the curse in Hell), their punishment will neither be lightened nor will they be reprieved). The Eternal Curse for Those Who hide Religious Commandments These Ayat sternly warn against those who hide the clear signs that the Messengers were sent with which guide to the correct path and beneficial guidance for the hearts, after Allah

Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) has made such aspects clear for His servants through the Books that He revealed to His Messengers. Abu Al-'Aliyah said that these Ayat, were revealed about the People of the Scripture who hid the description of Muhammad jg. Allah then states that everything curses such people for this evil act. Certainly, just as everything asks for forgiveness for the scholar, even the fish in the sea and the bird in the air, then those who hide knowledge are cursed by Allah and by the cursers. A Hadith in the Musnad, narrated through several chains of narrators, that strengthens the overall judgment of the Hadith, states that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah's Messenger jg said: IrJ pi* If Jr- "Whoever was asked about knowledge that one has, but he hid it, then a bridle made of fire will be tied around his mouth on

the Day of Resurrection It is also recorded by Al-Bukhari that Abu Hurayrah said, If it was not for an Ayah in Allah's Book, I would not have narrated a Hadith for anyone: iVerily, those who conceal the clear proofs, evidences and the guidance, which We have sent down,} [3] Mujahid said, When the earth is struck by drought, the animals say, This is because of the sinners among the Children of Adam. May Allah curse the sinners among the Children of Adam. Abu Al- Aliyah, Ar-Rabl bin Anas and Qatadah said that iand cursed by the cursers} means that the angels and the believers will curse them. 5 **' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :170. 2:495. Al-Bari 1 :258. 4| Ibn Abi Hatim 1:175. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1:174.

Moreover, a Hadith states that everything, including the fish in the sea, asks for forgiveness for the scholars. The Ayah (2:159 above) states that those who hide the knowledge will be cursed, (in this life and) on the Day of Resurrection, by Allah, the angels, all humanity, and those who curse (including the animals) each in its own distinct way. Allah knows best. From this punishment, Allah excluded all who repent to Him: ijtf ^Except those who repent and do righteous deeds, and openly declare (the truth which they concealed). This Ayah refers to those who regret what they have been doing and correct their behavior and, thus, explain to the people what they have been hiding. 4.Art)' 4\$' tits iThese, I will accept their repentance. And I am the One Wlw accepts repentance, the Most Merciful. \$ This Ayah also indicates that those who used to call to innovation, or even disbelief, and repent to Allah, then Allah will forgive them. Allah afterwards states that those who disbelieve in Him and remain in this state until they die, then: iit is they on whom is the curse ofAllah and of the angels and of mankind, combined. They will abide therein (under the curse in Hell). Therefore, they will suffer the eternal curse until the Day of Resurrection and after that in the fire of Jahannam, where, itheir punishment ivill neither be lightened Hence, the torment will not be decreased for them, i will they be reprieved. ^ The torment will not be changed or tempered for even an hour. Rather, it is continuous and eternal. We seek refuge

with Allah from this evil end. Cursing the Disbelievers is allowed There is no disagreement that it is lawful to curse the disbelievers. Umar bin Al-Khattab and the Imams after him used to curse the disbelievers in their Qunut (a type of supplication) during the prayer and otherwise. As for cursing a specific disbeliever, some scholars stated that it is not allowed to curse him, because we do not know how Allah will make his end. Others said that it is allowed to curse individual disbelievers. For proof, they mention the story about the man who was brought to be punished repeatedly for drinking (alcohol), a man said, May Allah curse him! He is being brought repeatedly (to be flogged for drinking). Allah's Messenger jg said: Do not curse him, for he loves Allah and His Messengers. 111 This Hadith indicates that it is allowed to curse those who do not love Allah and His Messenger sg. Allah knows best. 244 V is4 4163. And your Hah (Cod) is One Halt (God - Allah), La ildha ilia Huiua (there is none who has the right to be worshipped but He), the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.) In this Ayah, Allah mentions that He is the only deity, and that He has no partners or equals. He is Allah, the One and Only, the Sustainer, and there is no deity worthy of worship except Him. He is the Most Gracious Ar-Rahman, the Most Merciful Ar-Rahlm. We explained the meanings of these two Names in the beginning of Surat Al-Fatihah. Shahr bin Hawshab reported that Asma bint Yazid bin As-Sakan narrated that Allah's Messenger jg said: jzy*&&j 4*^'^^ |s "Allah's Greatest Name is contained in these tzvo Ayah: f'nV; &&\$44V is4 Abdur-Razzdq 7 :381 , similar with Al-Bukhari, no. 6780.

456 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4Ami your Ildh (God) is One Ildh (God - Al- lah), La ilalta ilia Huwa (there is none who has the right to be wor- shipped but He), the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.) and: jji ji v sif ; 4Alif-Ldm-Mim . Allah! La ilaha ilia Huwa (none has the right to be wor- shipped but He), Al- Haiyul-Qaiyum (the Ever Living, the One Who sustains and pro- tects all that exists).} (3:1, 2) m Then Allah mentions some of the proof that He is alone as the deity, that He is the One who created the heavens and the earth and all of the various creatures between them, all of which testify to His Oneness. Allah said: J ami 1 jJij *X" {j 'J ilA; oj& ills jib i^ j 1 1 0 4> iil dll jiSAIj \$ chi W -/4 4-^' 4 oi t,j vLj .Tf j* is! 3\$ 4264. Verily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in the alternation of night and day, and the ships which sail through the sea with that which is of use to mankind, and the water (rain) which Allah sends down from the sky and makes Abu DAwud 2 :168.

Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) the earth alive therewith after its death, and the moving (living) creatures of all kinds that He has scattered therein, and in the veering ofwinds and clouds which are held between the sky and the earth, are indeed Aydt (proofs, evidences, signs, etc.) for people ofunderstanding.} The Proofs for Tawhid Allah said: ^Verily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth... } Therefore, the sky, with its height, intricate design, vastness, the heavenly objects in orbit, and this earth, with its density, its lowlands, mountains, seas, deserts, valleys, and other structures, and beneficial things that it has. Allah continues: . . .and in the alternation ofnight and day.} This (the night) comes and then goes followed by the other (the day) which does not delay for even an instant, just as Allah said: ^ \$%A&& J iip v} \$It is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit.} (36:40) Sometimes, the day grows shorter and the night longer, and sometimes vice versa, one takes from the length of the other. Similarly Allah said: ip 4 'JAA 4 aSp e4y> iAllah merges the night into the day, and He merges the day into the night} (57 :6) meaning, He extends the length of one from the other and vice versa. Allah then continues: . . .and the ships which sail through the sea with that which is ofuse to mankind,} Shaping the sea in this manner, so that it is able to carry

458 Tafstr Ibn Kathir ships from one shore to another, so people benefit from what the other region has, and export what they have to them and vice versa. Allah then continues: 4'iLr* -*.*) ji oi ill and the water (rain) which Allah sends down from the sky and makes the earth alive therewith after its death}, which is similar to Allah s statement: 4.TT,U>^=t -cJ> ui iLil p> 4And a sign for them is the dead land. We give it life, and We bring forth from it grains, so that they eat thereof.} (36:33), until: iwhich they know not.} (36:36) Allah continues: iand the moving (living) creatures of all kinds that He has scattered therein,} meaning, in various shapes, colors, uses and sizes, whether small or large. Allah knows all that, sustains it, and nothing is concealed from Him. Similarly, Allah said: 4 j&j if"jy S yi ^:V(^ iSL^ tj} iAnd no moving (living) creature is there on earth but its provision is due from Allah. And He knows its dwelling place and its deposit (in the uterus or grave) . All is in a Clear Book (Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz the Book of Decrees with Allah).} (11 :6) 'jiSZ>} 4 . . .and in the veering ofwinds ... } Sometimes, the wind brings mercy and sometimes torment. Sometimes it brings the good news of the clouds that follow it, sometimes it leads the clouds, herding them, scattering them or directing them. Sometimes, the wind comes from the north

Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) (the northern wind), and sometimes from the south, sometimes from the east, and striking the front of the Ka'bah, sometimes from the west, striking its back. There are many books about the wind rain, stars and the regulations related to them, but here is not the place to elaborate on that, and Allah knows best. Allah continues: ﴿...and clouds which are held between the sky and the earth,﴾ The clouds run between the sky and the earth to wherever Allah wills of lands and areas. Allah said next: ﴿...are indeed Ayat for people of understanding,﴾ meaning, all these things are clear signs that testify to Allah's Oneness. Similarly, Allah said: ﴿...Verily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in the alternation of night and day, there are indeed signs for men of understanding. Those who remember Allah (always, and in prayers) standing, sitting, and lying down on their sides, and think deeply about the creation of the heavens and the earth, (saying): "Our Lord! You have not created (all) this without purpose, glory to You! (Exalted are You above all that they associate with You as partners). Give us salvation from the torment of the Fire."﴾ (3:190, 191) ili. ﴿...﴾ J4.1 XfoW c^i'j "ai "T^ ^'-*i\$ ujii ai tr ixi ill olj &,"* "yj' ul i) sii 4S j!j . 'Sij ^ u \i4 n t&d & a*? i cr (3 i sit

460 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4165. And of mankind are some who take (for worship) others besides Allah as rivals (to Allah). They love them as they love Allah. But those who believe, love Allah more (than anything else). If only, those who do wrong could see, when they will see the torment, that all power belongs to Allah and that Allah is severe in punishment.} 4166. When those who were followed disown (declare themselves innocent of) those who followed (than), and they see the torment, then all their relations will be cut off from them}. 4167. And those who followed will say : "If only we had one more chance to return (to the worldly life), we would disown (declare ourselves as innocent from) than as they have disowned (declared themselves as innocent from) us." Thus Allah will show them their deeds as regrets for them . And they will never get out of the Fire.} The Condition of the Polytheists in this Life and the Hereafter In these Ayat, Allah mentions the condition of the polytheists in this life and their destination in the Hereafter. They appointed equals and rivals with Allah, worshipping them along with Allah and loving them, just as they love Allah. However, Allah is the only deity worthy of worship, Who has neither rival nor opponent nor partner. It is reported in the Sahihayn that Abdullah bin Mas'ud said: I said, O Messenger of Allah! What is the greatest sin? He said: "To appoint a rival to Allah while He Alone has created Allah said: ﴿...﴾ 4But those who believe, love Allah more (than anything else)} Because these believers love Allah, know His greatness, revere Him, believe in His Oneness, then they do not associate Fath Al-Bari 8 :3 and Muslim 1 :90,

Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) anything or anyone with Him in the worship. Rather, they worship Him Alone, depend on Him and they seek help from Him for each and every need. Then, Allah warns those who commit Shirk, if only, those who do wrong could see, when they will see the torment, that all power belongs to Allah.} if these people knew what they will face and the terrible punishment they are to suffer because of their disbelief and Shirk (polytheism), then they would shun the deviation that they live by. Allah mentions their false beliefs in their idols, and that those they followed will declare their innocence of them. Allah said: ﴿...﴾ When those who were followed disown (declare themselves innocent of) those who followed (them).} the angels, whom they used to claim that they worshipped, declare their innocence of them in the Hereafter, saying: ﴿...﴾ We declare our innocence (from them) before You. It was not us they worshipped.} (28:63), and: ﴿...﴾ JL'.> it \ X, ' . i -iT [' ** . * C.i\ 4

'Glorified be You! You are our Walt (Lord) instead of them. Nay, but they used to worship the Jinn; most of them were believers in them. } (34:4) The Jinn will also disown the disbelievers who worshipped them, and they will reject that worship. Allah said: k *. ^ y k yk ce !> J-t S-k yfa iAtid who is more astray than one who calls on (invokes) besides Allah, such as will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, and who are (even) unaware of their calls (invocations) to them? And when mankind are gathered (on the

Day of Resurrection), they (false deities) will become their enemies and xoill deny their worshipping> (46:5, 6) Allah said: , /y /> Kf, n*~ iAnd they have taken (for worship) alihah (gods) besides Allah, that they might give them honor, power and glory (and also protect them from Allah' punishment). Nay, but they (the so- called gods) zoill deny their worship of them, and become opponents to them (on the Day of Resurrection) (19:81, 82) Prophet Ibrahim said to his people: i (4 ~>y" bijj' JJ*' o/i iri p5==*i Jill' till) p-'SaJi.i > ' 4You have taken (for worship) idols instead of Allah. The love between you is only in the life of this world, but on the Day of Resurrection, you shall disown each other, and curse each other, and your abode will be the Fire, and you shall have no helper. (29:25) Allah said: 4y4 4\$ d) f-ry iy i[Isj Jljf Ciftt il/ ~A g;jK jfc Jij^J iy.. T *.t ' 'Ju / , p35i, ^ , " V V- / * 'it' x V/ . , y 1/{ _> . > crtijt J\5j ^pcA4/^ Jf) i[^ \yu^a^>\ > > ' > - csj> l&t 4But if you could see when the Zdlimiin (polytheists and wrongdoers) xoill be made to stand before their Lord, how they xoill cast the (blaming) word one to another! Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant : "Had it not been for you, we should certainly have been believers!" And those who were arrogant will say to those who were deemed xoeak: Did we keep you back from guidance after it had come to you? Nay, but you were Mujrimin (polytheists, sinners, disbelievers, criminals)." Those who were deetned xoeak will say

Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) to those who were arrogant : Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day, when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him!" And each of them (parties) will conceal their own regrets (for disobeying Allah during this worldly life), when they behold the torment. And We shall put iron collars round the necks of those who disbelieved. Are they requited aught except what they used to do?} (34:31-33) Allah said: U 4 & 4 4&\$ os 4 41 tj 4And Shaytdn (Satan) will say when the matter has been decided: Verily , Allah promised you a promise of truth. And I too promised you, but I betrayed you. I had no authority over you except that I called you, and you responded to me. So blame me not, but blame yourselves. I cannot help you, nor can you help me. I deny your former act in associating me (Satan) as a partner with Allah (by obeying me in the life of the world). Verily, there is a painful torment for the Zdlimxn (polytheists and wrongdoers).} (14:22) Allah then said: i...and they see the torment, then all their relations will be cut off from than.} meaning, when they see Allah s torment, their power and means of salvation are all cut off, and they will have no way of making amends, nor will they find a way of escape from the Fire. Ata reported that Ibn Abbas said about: 444-^' jj-fj)} it then all their relations will be cut off from than.} meaning the friendship. Mujahid reported a similar statement in another narration by Ibn Abu Najlh. m At-Jabari 3 :290

464 Tafsir Ibt Kathir Allah said: cr fa 3 G \ i \p\$\\ sif those who followed will say: "If only we had one more chance to return (to the worldly life), we would disown (declare ourselves as innocent from) them as they have disowned (declared themselves as innocent from) us.'f This Ayah means: If we only had a chance to go back to the life so that we could disown them (their idols, leaders, etc.) shun their worship,

ignore them and worship Allah Alone instead. But they utter a lie in this regard, because if they were given the chance to go back, they would only return to what they were prohibited from doing, just as Allah said. This is why Allah said: iii iThus Allah will show them their deeds as regretsfor them.)" meaning, their works will vanish and disappear. Similarly, Allah said: 4And We shall turn to whatever deeds they (disbelievers, polytheists, sinners) did, and We shall make such deeds as scatteredfloating particles of dust> (25:23) Allah also said: iThe parable of those who disbelieved in their Lord is that their works are as ashes, on which the wind blows furiously on a stormy day (14:18), and: 4&&& 1* iLi J? yjfr 4As for those who disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert. The thirsty one thinks it to be water .> (24:39) This is why Allah said at the end of the Ayah 2:167 above iAnd they zoitl never get out of the Fire.>

ji p ft tjliS -Si qp ^,Vt 4 li# 4 .'j'-Ujit" 7 l> ,jt Ijlyj Jj fePt ift . UV.CJ. O mankind! Eat of that which is lawful and good on the earth, and follow not the footsteps of Shaytan (Satan). Verily, he is to you an open enemy.4 4169. He (Satan) commands you only what is evil and Faltsha (sinful), and that you should say about Allah what you know not.\$ The Order to eat the Lawful Things, and the Prohibition offollowing the Footsteps ofShaytan After Allah stated that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him and that He Alone created the creation, He stated that He is the Sustainer for all His creation, and He mentioned a favor that He granted them; He has allowed them to eat any of the pure lawful things on the earth that do not cause harm to the body or the mind. He also forbade them from following the footsteps of Shaytan, meaning his ways and methods with which he misguides his followers, like prohibiting the Bahirah (a she-camel whose milk was spared for the idols and nobody was allowed to milk it), or Sa ibah (a she-camel let loose for free pasture for the idols and nothing was allowed to be carried on it), or a Wasilah (a she-camel set free for idols because it has given birth to a she-camel at its first delivery and then again gives birth to a she-camel at its second delivery), and all of the other things that Shaytan made attractive to them during the time of Jahiliyyah.

Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) adultery and so forth. He commands you to commit what is even worse, that is, saying about Allah without knowledge. So this includes every innovator and disbeliever. t Si, t jj)U "i titi; si> ;Taji &S Sfi v Vi S 4170. Whoi it is said to them : ",Folloio what Al- lah has sent down." They say: "Nay! We shall follow what we found our fathers following." (Would they do that!) even though their fathers did not understand anything nor were they guided?} 4172. And the example of those who disbelieve is as that ofhim who shouts to those (flock of sheep) that hear nothing but calls and cries. (They are) deaf, dumb and blind. So they do not understand The Polytheist imitates Other Polytheists Allah states that if the disbelievers and polytheists are called to follow what Allah has revealed to His Messenger and abandon the practices of misguidance and ignorance that they indulge in, they will say, Rather. We shall follow what we found our fathers following, meaning, worshipping the idols and the false deities. Allah criticized their reasoning: 'Yu' * s.' t Si ijl ISill U \jjj ojjL j S+S iTijilc.j tc ^/4^o6i JJ# JSj j ViocySSsYjYSXj.f* 'Si Ijf^ V 'aji uVjSty's (w) _LJJ jS*aS 1Jl ifjl 1 ^

aw# -m 4(Would they do that!) even though theirfathers}, meaning, those whom they follow and whose practices they imitate, and: i'ojX-Z%)) i . . .did not understand anything nor were they guided?} meaning, they had no sound understanding or guidance. Ibn Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas said that this was revealed about a group of Jews whom Allah s Messenger jg called to Islam, but they refused,

saying, Rather, we shall follow what we found our forefathers following. So Allah revealed this Ayah (2:170) above."111 The Disbeliever is just like an Animal Allah then made a parable of the disbelievers, just as He said in another Ayah: 4 For those who believe not in the Hereafter is an evil description.} (16:60) Similarly, Allah said here (2:171 above) &} } And the example of those who disbelieve. . . } meaning, in their injustice, misguidance and ignorance, they are just like wandering animals, not understanding what they are told; if the shepherd heralds them or calls them to what benefits them, they would not understand what is actually being said to them, for they only hear unintelligible sounds. This is what is reported from Ibn Abbas, Abu Al- Aliyah, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ata , Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ata Al- Khurasani and Ar-RabT bin Anas. 121 5p}Tabari 3:305. 121 Ibn Abi HStim 1 :225-228.

Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) iThey are deaf, dumb, and blind.} means, they are deaf, as they do not hear the truth; mute, as they do not utter it; and blind, as they do not see or recognize its path and way. 4So they do not understand.} means, they do not comprehend or understand anything. 4 a UfciS c +Q Oi \pa \$ \ , 4)"l jyii 'ti f 5J ^ " > gi? jjfc 4172. O you who believe (in the Oneness of Allah - Islamic Monotheism)! Eat of the lawful things that We have provided you with, and be grateful to Allah, if it is indeed He Whom you worship}. 4173. He has forbidden you only the Maitah (dead animals), and blood, and the flesh of swine, and that which is slaughtered as a sacrifice for other than Allah. But if one is forced by necessity without willful disobedience nor transgressing due limits, then there is no sin on him. Truly, Allah is Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful.} The Command to eat Pure Things and the Explanation of the Prohibited Things Allah commands His believing servants to eat from the pure things that He has created for them and to thank Him for it, if they are truly His servants. Eating from pure sources is a cause for the acceptance of supplications and acts of worship, just as eating from impure sources prevents the acceptance of supplications and acts of worship, as mentioned in a Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad, that Abu Hurayrah said that Allah's Messenger |{g said: it 'jA 2 013 i 2)1 ty l\$" o m 1

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*Its water is pure and its dead are permissible Ash-Shafit, Ahmad, Ibn Majah, and Ad-Daraqutni reported that Ibn Umar said that the Prophet jg said: JUULj 1S3I; dLLDI cdHij o&U 0 lWe have been allowed two dead things and two bloody things fish and locusts; and liver and spleen>.^ We will mention this subject again in Surat Al-Ma'idah (chapter 5 in the Qur'an), In sha Allah (if Allah wills). Issue: According to Ash-Shafit and other scholars, milk and eggs that are inside dead unslaughtered animals are not pure, because they are part of the dead animal. In one narration from him, Malik said that they are pure themselves, but become impure because of their location. Similarly, there is a difference of opinion over the cheeses (made with the milk) of dead animals. The popular view of the scholars is that it is impure, although they mentioned the fact that the Companions ate from the cheeses

made by the Magians (fire worshippers). Hence, Al-Qurtubi commented: Since only a small part of the dead animal is mixed with it, then it is permissible, because a minute amount of impurity does not matter if it is mixed with a large amount of liquid. ,3) Ibn Majah reported that Salman said that Allah's Messenger was asked about butter, cheese and fur. He said: * - L j U ^ -ui J^l Li J iUJln Mi. U, tThe allowed is what Allah has allowed in His Book and the prohibited is what Allah has prohibited in His Book. What He has not mentioned is a part of what He has pardoned .s4 Allah has prohibited eating the meat of swine, whether *** Ahmad 5:365, Al-Muwatta 1:22, Abu Dawud 1:64, Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi 1 : 224, An-Nasa i 1 :50, and Ibn Majah 1 :136. Tarttb Musnad Ash-Shafi'i 2 :173 , Ahmad 2 :97 , Ibn Majah 2 :1073 Ad-Daraqutni 4 :272 131 Al-Qurtubi 2:221. Ibn Majah 2:1117.

472 Tafsir Ibn Kathir slaughtered or not, and this includes its fat, either because it is implied, or because the term Lahm includes that, or by analogy. Similarly prohibited are offerings to other than Allah, that is what was slaughtered in a name other than His, be it for monuments, idols, divination, or the other practices of the time of JahUyyah. Al-Qurtubi mentioned that A isha was asked about what non-Muslims slaughter for their feasts and then offer some of it as gifts for Muslims. She said, Do not eat from what has been slaughtered for that day, (or feast) but eat from their vegetables. The Prohibited is Allowed in Cases of Emergency Then Allah permitted eating these things when needed for survival or when there are no permissible types of food available. Allah said: iBut if one is forced by necessity without willful disobedience nor transgressing due limits meaning, without transgression or overstepping the limits, i...then there is no sin on him.)> meaning, if one eats such items, for, *"" iTruly, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. Mujahid said, If one is forced by necessity without willful disobedience nor transgressing the set limits. For example, if he didn't, then he would have to resort to highway robbery, rising against the rulers, or some other kinds of disobedience to Allah, then the permission applies to him. If one does so transgressing the limits, or continually, or out of disobedience to Allah, then the permission does not apply to him even if he is in dire need. The same was reported from Said bin Jubayr. Said and Muqatil bin Hayyan are reported to have said that without willful disobedience means, Without believing that it 1,1 Al-Qurtubi 2:224.

Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2 is permissible. 11 ' It was reported that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah: 4 ...without willful disobedience nor transgressing^ saying, Without willful disobedience means eating the dead animal and not continuing to do so. Qatadah said: 4without willful disobedience^ Without transgressing by eating from the dead animals, that is when the lawful is available. '2' Issue: When one in dire straits finds both dead animals, and foods belong to other people which he could get without risking the loss of his hands or causing harm, then it is not allowed for him to eat the dead animals. Ibn Majah reported that Abbad bin Shurahbil Al-Ghubari said, One year we suffered from famine. I came to Al-Madlnah and entered a garden. I took some grain that I cleaned, and ate, then I left some of it in my garment. The owner of the garden came, roughed me up and took possession of my garment. I then went to Allah's Messenger and told him what had happened. He said to the man: "Yom have not fed him when he was hungry - or he said starving - nor have you taught him if he was ignorant . The Prophet jg commanded him to return Abbad's garment to him, and to offer him a Wasq (around 180 kilograms) - or a half Wasq - of food'3' This has a sufficiently strong chain of narrators and there are many other witnessing narrations to support it, such as the Hadith that Amr bin Shu'ayb

narrated from his father that his grandfather said: Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) was asked about the hanging clusters of dates. He said: 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :236. Tabari 3:324. '3| Ibn Majah 2:770.

at?iere is no hann for whoever takes some of it in his mouth for a necessity without putting it in his garment ."[1 ' Muqatil bin Hayyan commented on: jjii "'i' 6} U . . .then there is no sin on him. Truly, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. For what is eaten out of necessity. ' SaTd bin Jubayr said, Allah is pardoning for what has been eaten of the unlawful, and Merciful in that He allowed the prohibited during times of necessity. '3 ' Masrtiq said, Whoever is in dire need, but does not eat or drink until he dies, he will enter the Fire. ' This indicates that eating dead animals for those who are in need of it for survival is not only permissible but required. Vi itij* & ii In Vi jjiiSv iii&&& t&k% :viii it 'y=,jVJt Je. Lj vitJcilij oijt kilpJjl 4 ^ VyiiFljl 4 tjkhit ;/Jji 4"it i-'-feil' Jj-j ii' C liM'i 4174. Verily, those who conceal what Allah has sent down of the Book, and purchase a small gain therewith (of worldly things), they eat into their bellies nothing but fire. Allah will not speak to them on the Day of Resurrection, nor purify them, and theirs will be a painful torment}. 4175. Those are they who have purchased error at the price of guidance, and torment at the price of forgiveness . So how bold they are (for evil deeds which will push them) to the Fire}. 4176. That is because Allah has sent down the Book (the Qur'an) in truth. And verily, those who disputed as regards the Book are far away in opposition}. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:510. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1:240. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :240 ' Al-Bayhaqi in AsSunan Al-Kubra 9 :357

Criticizing the Jews for concealing what Allah revealed Allah said: t t[} iVerily, those who conceal what Allah has sent down of the Book.} Meaning the Jews who concealed their Book's descriptions of Muhammad (ﷺ), all of which testify to his truth as a Messenger and a Prophet. They concealed this information so that they would not lose authority and the position that they had with the Arabs, where they would bring them gifts, and honor them. The cursed Jews feared that if they announced what they know about Muhammad (ﷺ), then the people would abandon them and follow him. So they hid the truth so that they may retain the little that they were getting, and they sold their souls for this little profit. They preferred the little that they gained over guidance and following the truth, believing in the Messenger (ﷺ) and having faith in what Allah was sent him with. Therefore, they have profited failure and loss in this life and the Hereafter. As for this world, Allah made the truth about His Messenger (ﷺ) known anyway, by the clear signs and the unequivocal proofs. Thereafter, those whom the Jews feared would follow the Prophet (ﷺ), believed in him and followed him anyway, and so they became his supporters against them. Thus, the Jews earned anger on top of the wrath that they already had earned before, and Allah criticized them again many times in His Book. For instance, Allah said in this Ayah (2:174 above): Q . A J. jir iVerily, those who conceal what Allah has sent down of the Book, and purchase a small gain therewith (of worldly things).} meaning, the joys and delights of this earthly life. Allah said: ^ ijft u 3J\$} i-. they eat into their bellies nothing but fire.} meaning, whatever they eat in return for hiding the truth, will turn into a raging fire in their stomachs on the Day of Resurrection. Similarly, Allah said:

4^ \$ o 1\$ {Verily, those who unjustly eat up the property of orphans, they eat up only fire into their bellies, and they will be burnt in the blazing Fire!} (4:10) Also, reported in an authentic Hadith is that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: tp^r j\l J yr'M4 IS\ L'X j\ JS l; uTt those who eat or drink in golden or silver plates are filling their stomachs with the fire of Jaltannam (Hell)M li Allah said: {j~^ }y. \$Allah will not

speak to them on the Day of Resurrection, nor purify them, and theirs will be a painful torment.} This is because Allah is furious with them for concealing the truth. They thus deserve Allah's anger, so Allah will not look at them or purify them, meaning that He will not praise them but will cause them to taste a severe torment. Then, Allah said about them: US)'& BM {Those are they who have purchased error for guidance.} Hence, they opposed the guidance, that is, not announcing the Prophet's description they find in their Books, the news about his prophecy and the good news of his coming which the previous Prophets proclaimed, as well as following and believing in him. Instead, they preferred misguidance by denying him, rejecting him and concealing his descriptions that were mentioned in their Books. Allah said: { . . .and torment at the price of forgiveness,} meaning, they preferred torment over forgiveness due to the I 1 ' Sahih Al-Bukhtui no . 5634, and Muslim no. 2065.

Al-Baaarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) sins they have committed. Allah then said: 4So how bold they are (for evil deeds which will push them) to the Fire> Allah states that they will suffer such severe, painful torment that those who see them will be amazed at how they could bear the tremendous punishment, torture and pain that they will suffer. We seek refuge with Allah from this evil end. Allah's Statement: imm tv aap 'j Wyo'jj A !~ =r^gjj \j jj'_) 4JLJ c-{j <- > JLJ' i&Ali oUljtj 1 Stei f& ** ** " ^ tSA-fi-l,^"4UayJ (iil j (ji "A> djl j - -1 gpoyiij . *? r< . -t 255 i\$ \$ > 41"uW (JCyW UJuc iThat is because Allah has sent down the Book (the Qur'an) in truth. means, they deserve this painful torment because Allah has revealed Books to His Messenger Muhammad s, and the Prophets before him, and these revelations bring about truth and expose falsehood. Yet, they took Allah's signs for mockery. Their Books ordered them to announce the truth and to spread the knowledge, but instead, they defied the knowledge and rejected it. This Final Messenger Muhammad jg called them to Allah, commanded them to work righteousness and forbade them from committing evil. Yet, they rejected, denied and defied him and hid the truth that they knew about him. They, thus, mocked the Ayat that Allah revealed to His

Messengers, and this is why they deserved the torment and the punishment. This is why Allah said here (2:176): iThat is because Allah has sent down the Book (the Qur'an) in truth. And verily, those who disputed about the Book are far away in opposition.} jit 'jf l ij y JrAy o' jJ' \$\$} yj) {jSf.llJlj iii JLi jlij JtjJ' Ijl *JtiM " J 1' ^Wcj*-" iiUJjij glil ^Vif Jy^y u 4177 . It is not Birr that you turn your faces towards east and (or) west; but Birr is the one who believes in Allah, the Last Day, the Angels, the Book, the Prophets and gives his ioealth, in spite of love for it, to the kinsfolk, to the orphans, and to Al- Masdkfn (the poor), and to the wayfarer, and to those who ask, and to set servants free, performs As-Saldh (Iqdmata-Saldh) and gives the Zakdh, and who fulfill their covenant when they make it, and ivho are patient in extreme poverty and ailment (disease) and at the time offighting (during the battles). Such are the people of the truth and they are Al-Muttaqun (the pious).} Al-Birr (Piety, Righteousness) This Ayah contains many great wisdoms, encompassing rulings and correct beliefs. As for the explanation of this Ayah, Allah first commanded the believers to face Bayt Al-Maqdis, and then to face the Ka'bah during the prayer. This change was difficult for some of the People of the Book, and even for some Muslims. Then Allah sent revelation which clarified the wisdom behind this command, that is, obedience to Allah, adhering to His commands, facing wherever He commands facing, and implementing whatever He legislates, that is the objective. This is Birr, Taqwa and complete faith. Facing the east or the west does not necessitate righteousness or obedience, unless it is legislated by Allah. This is why Allah said:

,>'* o* jj' !\$> Ar &i bb> o' </f is not Birr that you h/m your faces towards east and (or) west (in prayers); but Birr is the one who believes in Allah and the Last Day,} Similarly, Allah said about the sacrifices: 4It is neither their meat nor their blood that reaches Allah, but it is the piety from you that reaches Him.} (22:37) Abu Al- Aliyah said, The Jews used to face the west for their Qiblah, while the Christians used to face the east for their Qiblah. So Allah said: Jj \jy o' jii 411 is not Birr that you turn your faces towards east and (or) west (in prayers)} (2:177) meaning, this is faith, and its essence requires implementation. Similar was reported from Al-Hasan and Ar- Rabi bin AnasJ Ath-Thawri recited: ibut Birr is the one who believes in Alldlt,} and said that what follows are the types of Birr. He has said the truth. Certainly, those who acquire the qualities mentioned in the Ayah will have indeed embraced all aspects of Islam and implemented all types of righteousness; believing in Allah, that He is the only God worthy of worship, and believing in the angels the emissaries between Allah and His Messengers. The Books are the Divinely revealed Books from Allah to the Prophets, which were finalized by the most honorable Book (the Qur an). The Qur an supercedes all previous Books, it mentions all types of righteousness, and the way to happiness in this life and the Hereafter. The Qur an abrogates all previous Books and testifies to all of Allah s Prophets, from the first Prophet to the Final Prophet, Muhammad, may Allah s l1 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :251 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :253

3il -fidu - l(Jj t-jy i <!f <\$ Oy^vf} 4And they give food, inspite of their love for it, to the Miskin (the poor), the orphan, and the captive (saying) :

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) than anyone else to one s charity, as the Hadith supports: ^j \ t ?j 4jXu? *jwl l j t aSjIJ? ^lp 4jXu2.ll 8 iL ^Sadaqah (i.e., charity) given to the poor is a charity, while the Sadaqah given to the relatives is both Sadaqah and Silah (nurturing relations), for they are the most deserving of you and your kindness and charih/ . 11 Allah has commanded kindness to the relatives in many places in the Qur an. 4to the orphans} The orphans are children who have none to look after them, having lost their fathers while they are still young, weak and unable to find their own sustenance since they have not reached the age of work and adolescence. Abdur- Razzaq reported that Ali said that the Prophet jg said: <*\$!> iand to Al-Masakin} The Mishin is the person who does not have enough food, clothing, or he has no dwelling. So the Miskin should be granted the provisions to sustain him enough so that he can acquire his needs. In the Sahthayn it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that Allah s Messenger jg said: tjtuiUij a j, ^jji . tijiaii ^ . ti JLkui 3 v'j i ^sizJ i jfij The Miskin is not the person who roams around, and whose need is met by one or two dates or one or two bites. Rather, the Miskin is he who does not have what is sufficient, and to whom the people do not pay attention and, thus, do not give him from the charity. iand to the wayfarer} is the needy traveler who runs out of money and should, thus, be granted whatever amount that Ahmad 4 :214. Fath Al-B&ri3 :399 , and Muslim 2:719.

helps him to go back to his land. Such is the case with whoever intends to go on a permissible journey, he is given what he needs for his journey and back. The guests are included in this category. Ali bin Abu Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, Ibn As-Sabil (wayfarer) is the guest who is hosted by Muslims. ' 11 Furthermore, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Abu JaTar Al-Baqir, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Az-Zuhri, Ar- Rabl bin Anas and Muqatil bin Hayyan said similarly.'2' iZ&xfr iattd to those who ask> refers to those who beg people and are thus given a part of the Zakah and general charity.

and to set servants free} These are the servants who seek to free themselves, but cannot find enough money to buy their freedom. We will mention several of these categories and types under the Tafsir of the Ayah on Sadaqah in Surat Bara'ah [chapter 9 in the Qur'an], In sha Allah. Allah's statement: *Al-Muttaqin As-Salah (Iqdamat-As-Salath)* means those who pray on time and give the prayer its due right; the bowing, prostration, and the necessary attention and humbleness required by Allah. Allah's statement: *and gives the Zakah* means the required charity {Zakah} due on one's money, as Said bin Jubayr and Muqatil bin Hayyan have stated.¹³ ' Allah's statement: *and who fulfill their covenant when they make it,* } 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :259. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :260 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :264

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) is similar to: '*... & . u *'' * cyl'r iTitose zoho fulfill the covenant of Allah and break not the Mithdaq (bond, treaty, covenant).* } (13:20) The opposite of this characteristic is hypocrisy. As found in a Hadith: *t . aL>- jpi 1i)^ t bl : v^^Aj aJU 77ie signs of a hypocrite are three: if he speaks, he lies; if he promises, he breaks his promise; and if he is entrusted, he breaches the trust.* In another version: *lilji jJL(JL*U lilj iJLijS lil 11 Ifhe speaks, he lies; if he vows, he breaks his vow; and if he disputes, he is a liar.* Allah's statement: *4 ...and who are patient in extreme poverty and ailment (disease) and at the time of fighting (during the battles).* } means, during the time of meekness and ailment. *s& } 4 .. .and at the time of fighting (during the battles).* } means on the battlefield while facing the enemy, as Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn Abbas, Abu Al- Aliyah, Murrah Al-Hamdani, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi bin Anas, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Abu Malik¹³ ' Ad-Dahhak and others have stated. 141 And calling them the patient here, is a form of praise, because of the importance of patience in these circumstances, and the suffering and difficulties that accompany them. And in Muslim 1 :78. 121 Ibid. [3] Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :270-271 Tabari 3:355.

Allah knows best, it is He Whom help is sought from, and upon Him we rely. Allah's statement: *S S * +* ** < J V j'jll italjiy i* Such are the people of the truth means, whoever acquires these qualities, these are truthful in their faith. This is because they have achieved faith in the heart and realized it in deed and upon the tongue. So they are the truthful, *iatui* they are Al-Muttaqin (the pious). because they avoided the prohibitions and performed the acts of obedience. *S3 aty &VS & } \$ >; 4 && sr* o; " jj s>_ o; /J 4^ j;* - 4 , va* . Xj> J * xJ dsxii .* O you who believe! Al-Qisas (the Law of equality) is prescribed for you in case of murder: the free for the free, the slave for the slave, and the female for the female. But if the killer is forgiven by the brother (or the relatives) of the killed (against blood money), then it should be sought in a good manner, and paid to him respectfully. *Ttis* is an alleviation and a mercy from your Lord. So after this, whoever transgresses the limits (i.e. kills the killer after taking the blood money), he shall have a painful torment. } 4179. And there is (a saving of) life for you in Al-Qisas (the Law of equality in punishment), O men of understanding, that you may acquire Taqwa. } The Command and the Wisdom behind the Law of Equality Allah states: O believers! The Law of equality has been ordained on you (for cases of murder), the free for the free, the slave for the slave and the female for the female. Therefore, do

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) not transgress the set limits, as others before you transgressed them, and thus changed what Allah has ordained for them.

The reason behind this statement is that (the Jewish tribe of)

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 485–502]

Banu An-Nadlr invaded Qurayzah (another Jewish tribe) during the time of JahUiyyah (before Islam) and defeated them. Hence, (they made it a law that) when a person from Nadir kills a person from Quraizah, he is not killed in retaliation, but only pays a hundred IVasq of dates. However, when a person from Quraizah kills a Nadir man, he would be killed for him. If Nadir wanted (to forfeit the execution of the murderer and instead require him) to pay a ransom, the Quraizah man pays two hundred Wasq of dates [double the amount Nadir pays in Diyah (blood money)]. So Allah commanded that justice be observed regarding the penal code, and that the path of the misguided and mischievous persons be avoided, who in disbelief and transgression, defy and alter what Allah has commanded them. Allah said: # ys fcii 4 Al-Qisds (the Law of equality in punishment) is prescribed for you in case of murder: the free for the free, the slave for the slave, and thefemalefor thefemale.} Allah s statement: ivii 35 iff" 4the free for the free, the slave for the slave, and the female for thefemale.} was abrogated by the statement {life for life) (5:45). However, the majority of scholars agree that the Muslim is not killed for a disbeliever whom he kills. Al- Bukhari reported that Ali narrated that Allah s Messenger sgj; said: (J- 4 ifek y iThe Muslim is not killed for the disbeliever (whom he kills),a'21 No opinion that opposes this ruling could stand correct, nor is there an authentic Hadith to contradict it. However, Abu I 1 * A camel load, sixty Sa , approximately 165 liters. ^ SahOi Al-Bukharino . 111.

Hanifah thought that the Muslim could be killed for a disbeliever, following the general meaning of the Ayah (5:45) in Surat Al-Ma idah (chapter 5 in the Qur an). The Four Imams (Abu Hanifah, Malik, Shafil and Ahmad) and the majority of scholars stated that the group is killed for one person whom they murder. Umar said, about a boy who was killed by seven men, If all the residents of San a (capital of Yemen today) collaborated on killing him, I would kill them all. No opposing opinion was known by the Companions during that time which constitutes a near Ijma' (consensus). There is an opinion attributed to Imam Ahmad that a group of people is not killed for one person whom they kill, and that only one person is killed for one person. Ibn Al-Mundhir also attributed this opinion to Mu'adh, Ibn Az-Zubayr, Abdul-Malik bin Marwan, Az-Zuhri, Ibn Sirin and Habib bin Abu Thabit. Allah s statement: iBut if the killer is forgiven by the brother (or the relatives) of the killed (against blood money), then it should be sought in a good manner, and paid to him respectfully refers to accepting blood money (by the relatives of the victim in return for pardoning the killer) in cases of intentional murder. This opinion is attributed to Abu Al- Aliyah, Abu Sha'tha , Mujahid, Sa'Id bin Jubayr, Ata Al-Hasan, 11 Qatadah¹² ' and Muqatil bin Hayyan.¹³¹ Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said: 4 it} tie iBut if the killer is forgiven by the brother (or the relatives) of the killed (against blood moneyfo means the killer is pardoned by his brother (i.e., the relative of the victim) and accepting the Diyah after capital punishment becomes due (against the killer), this is the Afw (pardon mentioned in the Ayah). 141 Allah s statement: 111 Ibn Abi flatim 1 : 278-279. At-Tabari 3 :368. Ibn AbiHatim 1:279. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :280.

4 ...then it should be sought in a good manner,} means, when the relative agrees to take the blood money, he should collect his rightful dues with kindness: di 4 and paid to him respectfully.} means, the killer should accept the terms of settlement without causing further harm or resisting the payment. Allah s statement: 4This is an alleviation and a mercyfrom your Lord.} means the legislation that allows you

to accept the blood money for intentional murder is an alleviation and a mercy from your Lord. It lightens what was required from those who were before you, either applying capital punishment or forgiving. Sa'id bin Mansur reported that Ibn Abbas said, The Children of Israel were required to apply the Law of equality in murder cases and were not allowed to offer pardons (in return for blood money). Allah said to this Ummah (the

This is an alleviation from your Lord^ Allah had mercy on this Ummah by giving them the Diah which was not allowed for any nation before it. The People of the Torah (Jews) were allowed to either apply the penal code (for murder, i.e., execution) or to pardon the killer, but they were not allowed to take blood money. The People of the Injil (the Gospel - the Christians) were required to pardon (the killer, but no Diah was legislated). This Ummah (Muslims) is allowed to apply the penal code (execution) or to pardon and accept the blood money. Similar was reported from Said bin Jubayr, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Ar-Rabi' bin Anas. Allah's statement: 4.*-^ Jjo i!(jCii j, 4S0 after this lohever transgresses the limits, he shall have a painful torment.} means, those who kill in retaliation after taking the Diah or accepting it, they will suffer a painful and severe torment from Allah. The same was reported from Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ata Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas, As-Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan.' The Benefits and Wisdom of the Law of Equality Allah's statement: 4And there is life for you in Al-Qisas legislating the Law of equality, i.e., killing the murderer, carries great benefits for you. This way, the sanctity of life will be preserved because the killer will refrain from killing, as he will be certain that if he kills, he would be killed. Hence life will be preserved. In previous Books, there is a statement that killing stops further killing! This meaning came in much clearer and eloquent terms in the Qur'an: iw- 4P& [1! Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :274-275. ,2) Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :278-279.

muz TA mm .{' f-v-r j?f5* " --f?. ?.-fr _r" ! <&. ov> 0 / ^ WSsJ'J.s *'l{ ""***>{* . >\ \ * *' \^bi^bj C^^yyScfcS ^L)^ j)^jL lJk"~*-Ly^ -X-^J 1 *r r ^ *" >^:r O?oJ_ L-va^^U^==3(lraJ 4" X^=cJj;Lj \ ijj^y;^i\ pLcolj^pjJJ' a_jfrjt o^iv_w_j i(jli (_jC'ti5aL_At 1_): >;^-. "i.Araf there is (a saving of) life for you in Al- Qisas (the Law of equal- ity in punishment) .> Abu Al- Aliyah said, Allah made the Law of equality a life . Hence, how many a man who thought about killing, but this Law prevented him from killing for fear that he will be killed in turn. Similar statements were reported from Mujahid, Sa'id bin Jubayr, Abu Malik, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas and Muqatil bin Hayyan. Allah's statement: ^ ^Vf dM iO men of understanding, that you may acquire Taqwd.\$ means, O you who have sound minds, comprehension and understanding! Perhaps by this you will be compelled to refrain from transgressing the prohibitions of Allah and what He considers sinful. Taqwa (mentioned in the Ayah) is a word that means doing all acts of obedience and refraining from all prohibitions. CwyV'j Lj" Aj oj. 'ij ii' uj Uf& ,<*!', /klr> CjZ IL. jjA* Alii aAc pti tlij j! l_aj* a j* {j)^ . (1| Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :290-292

490 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 4#. It is prescribed for you, when death approaches any of you, if he leaves wealth, that he makes a bequest to parents and next of kin, according to reasonable manners. (This is) a duty upon Al-Muttaqin (the pious) 4181 . Then whoever changes it after hearing it, the sin shall be on those who make the change. Tndy, Allah is All-Hearer, All- Knower.} 4182. But he who fears from a testator some unjust act or wrongdoing, and thereupon he makes peace between the parties concerned, there shall be no sin on him. Certainly, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful Including Parents and Relatives in the Will was later abrogated This Ayah contains the command to include parents and relatives in the

Al-Bagarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) 4...if he leaves wealth, that he makes a bequest to parents and next of kin.} He then said, This Ayah was abrogated. This was recorded by Said bin Mansur and

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) means, whoever changed the will and testament or altered it by addition or deletion, including hiding the will as is obvious, then the sin shall be on those who make the change.} Ibn Abbas and others said, The dead person's reward will be preserved for him by Allah, while the sin is acquired by those who change the will. 111 ipya iTruly, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knower.} means, Allah knows what the dead person has bequeathed and what the beneficiaries (or others) have changed in the will. Allah's statement: 4&1 j\ l_j ' >} 4But he who fears from, a testator some unjust act or wrongdoing,} Ibn Abbas, Abu Al- Aliyah, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas and As-Suddi said, Error. 121 These errors include such cases as when the inheritor indirectly acquires more than his fair share, such as by being allocated that a certain item mentioned in the legacy be sold to him. Or, the testator might include his daughter's son in the legacy to increase his daughter's share in the inheritance, and so forth. Such errors might occur out of the kindness of the heart without thinking about the consequences of these actions, or by sinful intention. In such cases, the executive of the will and testament is allowed to correct the errors and to replace the unjust items in the will with a better solution, so that both the Islamic law and what the dead person had wished for are respected and observed. This act would not constitute an alteration in the will and this is why Allah mentioned it specifically, so that it is excluded from the prohibition (that prohibits altering the will and testament) mentioned in the m At-Tabari 3:397. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :310-31 1

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whoever does good of his own accord, it is better for him. And that you fast is better. *Abdur-Razzaq* 9 : 88.

Al-Ba'arah (175 - 200) (Part-2) far you if only you know the Order to Fast In an address to the believers of this Ummah, Allah ordered them to fast, that is, to abstain from food, drink and sexual activity with the intention of doing so sincerely for Allah the Exalted alone. This is because fasting purifies the souls and cleanses them from the evil that might mix with them and their ill behavior. Allah mentioned that He has ordained fasting for

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) (for every day).} It means those who find it difficult (to fast). Formerly, those who wished, fasted and those who wished, did not but fed a poor person instead. Allah then said: iBut whoever does good of his own accord} meaning whoever fed an extra poor person, u'j fi it is better for him. And that you fast is better for you} Later the Ayah: 'j i\ feL whoever of you sights (the crescent on the first night of) the month (of Ramadan, i.e., is present at his home), he must observe Sawm (fasting) that month} (2:185) was revealed and this abrogated the previous Ayah (2:184). The Fidyah (Expiation) for breaking the Fast is for the Old and the Ailing *Al-Bukhari* reported that *Ata* heard *Ibn Abbas* recite: /kjjLlu 4And as for those who can fast with difficulty, (e.g., an old man), they have (a choice either to fast or) to feed a Miskin (poor person) (for every day).} *Ibn Abbas* then commented, (This Ayah) was not abrogated, it is for the old man and the old woman who are able to fast with difficulty, but choose instead to feed a poor person for every day (they do not fast). '2 ' Others reported that *Said bin Jubayr* mentioned this from *Ibn Abbas*. So the abrogation here applies to the healthy person, who is not traveling and who has to fast, as Allah said: 4*I\i *Al-Bari* 8 :28 *Al-Bari* 8:28.

498 *Tafsir Ibn Kathir* 4So whoever of you sights (the crescent on the first night of) the month (of Ramadan, i.e., is present at his home), he must observe Sawm (fasting) that month> (2:185) As for the old man (and woman) who cannot fast, he is allowed to abstain from fasting and does not have to fast another day instead, because he is not likely to improve and be able to fast other days. So he is required to pay a Fidyah for every day missed. This is the opinion of *Ibn Abbas* and several others among the Salaf who read the Ayah: 4And as for those who can fast with difficulty, (e.g., an old man)} to mean those who find it difficult to fast' * as *Ibn Mas'ud* stated. This is also the opinion of *Al-Bukhari* who said, As for the old man (person) who cannot fast, (he should do like) *Anas* who, for one or two years after he became old fed some bread and meat to a poor person for each day he did not fast. This point, which *Al-Bukhari* attributed to *Anas* without a chain of narrators, was collected with a continuous chain of narrators by *Abu Ya'la Mawsuli* in his *Musnad*, that *Ayyub bin Abu Tamimah* said; *Anas* could no longer fast. So he made a plate of Thand (broth, bread and meat) and invited thirty poor persons and fed them. * The same ruling applies for the pregnant and breast-feeding women if they fear for themselves or their children or fetuses. In this case, they pay the Fidyah and do not have to fast other days in place of the days that they missed. J "Ij J* CTJ jIJClj Xji c: # ^j; -;ij: ^ lj, %^ =" a 4185. The month of Ramadan in which was revealed the Qur'an, a guidance for mankind and clear proofs for the m *At-Tabari* 3:431. * *Fath Al-Bari* 8:179. * *Musnad Abu Ya'la* 7:204.

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) guidance and the criterion (between right and wrong). So whoever of you sights (the crescent on the first night of) the month (of Ramadan, i.e., is present at his home), he must observe Sazom (fasting) that month, and whoever is ill or on a journey, the same number [of days

which one did not observe Sawm (fasting) must be made up] from other days. Allah intends for you ease, and He does not want to make things difficult for you. (He wants that you) must complete the same number (of days), and that you must magnify Allah [i.e., to say Takbir (Allahu Akbar: Allah is the Most Great)] for having guided you so that you may be grateful to Him.} The Virtue of Ramadan and the Revelation of the Qur'an in it. Allah praised the month of Ramadan out of the other months by choosing it to send down the Glorious Qur'an, just as He did for all of the Divine Books He revealed to the Prophets. Imam Ahmad reported Wathilah bin Al-Asqa that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: "The Suhuf (Pages) of Ibrahim were revealed during the first night of Ramadan. The Torah was revealed during the sixth night of Ramadan. The Injil was revealed during the thirteenth night of Ramadan. Allah revealed the Qur'an on the twenty-fourth night of Ramadan." The Virtues of the Qur'an Allah said: "A guidance for mankind and clear proof for the guidance and the criterion (between right and wrong)." Here Allah praised the Qur'an, which He revealed as Ahmad 4:107.

guidance for the hearts of those who believe in it and adhere to its commands. Allah said: "And clear proofs meaning, as clear and unambiguous signs and unequivocal proof for those who understand them. These proofs testify to the truth of the Qur'an, its guidance, the opposite of misguidance, and how it guides to the straight path, the opposite of the wrong path, and the distinction between the truth and falsehood, and the permissible and the prohibited. The Obligation of Fasting Ramadan Allah said: "So whoever of you sights (the crescent on the first night of) the month (of Ramadan, i.e., is present at his home), he must observe Sawm (fasting) that month." This Ayah requires the healthy persons who witness the beginning of the month, while residing in their land, to fast the month. This Ayah abrogated the Ayah that allows a choice of fasting or paying the Fidyah. When Allah ordered fasting, He again mentioned the permission for the ill person and the traveler to break the fast and to fast other days instead as compensation. Allah said: "...and whoever is ill or on a journey, the same number [of days which one did not observe Sawm (fasting) must be made up] from other days." This Ayah indicates that ill persons who are unable to fast or fear harm by fasting, and the traveler, are all allowed to break the fast. When one does not fast in this case, he is obliged to fast other days instead. Allah said: "Allah intends for you ease, and He does not want to make things difficult for you."

Those who did not fast have done good, and there is no harm for those who fasted. In another Hadith, the Prophet (ﷺ) said:

Some scholars say that the two actions are the same, as A'ishah narrated that Hamzah bin Amr Al-Aslami said, O Messenger of Allah! I fast a lot, should I fast while traveling?

Fast if you wish or do not fast if you wish. This Hadith is in the Two Sahibs. It was reported that if the fast becomes difficult (while traveling), then breaking the fast is better. Jabir said that Allah's Messenger saw a man who was being shaded (by other people while traveling). The Prophet (ﷺ) asked about him and he was told that man was fasting. The Prophet (ﷺ) said: .

what is required then is to merely make up for missed days.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 502–512]

This is why Allah said: /1 *'{ mm X \ 4>' a* ...the same number (should be made up)from other days.} Base and not Hardship Allah then said: 4Allah intends far you ease, and He does not want to make things difficultfar you .} 1 1] Fath Al-Bari 4:211, and Muslim 2 :789 Al-Bari 4 :216, and Muslim 2 : 786.

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 Imam

4...and that you must magnify Allah [i.e., to say Takbir (Allahu Akbar: Allah is the Most Great)]forhaving guided you means: So that you remember Allah upon finishing the act of worship. This is similar to Allah s statement: 4So when you have accomplished your Mandsik, (rituals) remember Allah as you remember your forefathers or with far more remembrance (2:200) and: i -IT jJS" IjSZfj j yUrt 4...Then when the (Jumu'ah) Saldh (prayer) is ended, you may disperse through the land, and seek the bounty of Allah (by working), and remember Allah much, that you may be successful. (62:10) and: 4 -- and glorify the praises ofyour Lord, before the rising of the sun and before (its) setting. And during a part of the night, glorify His praises, and after the prayers.> (50:39, 40) This is why the Sunnah encouraged Tasbih (saying Subhan Allah, i.e., all praise is due to Allah), Tahmid (saying Al-Hamdu Lillah, i.e., all the thanks are due to Allah) and Takbir (saying Allahu Akbar, i.e., Allah is the Most Great) after the compulsory prayers. Ibn Abbas said, We used to know that Allah s Messenger jfe has finished the prayer by the Takbir. 01 Similarly, several scholars have stated that reciting Takbir the during Id-ul-Fitrwas specified by the Ayah that states: isi ljuj =cJj jLjll (He wants that you) must complete the same number (of days), and that you must magnify Allah [i.e., to say Takbir (Allahu Akbar: Allah is the Most Great)] for having guided m Sahih Al-Bukharino . 842

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 Allah s statement: i...so that you may be grateful to Him.) means: If you adhere to what Allah commanded you, obeying Him by performing the obligations, abandoning the prohibitions and abiding by the set limits, then perhaps you will be among the grateful. il86. And when My servants ask you (O Muhammad jg concerning Me, then ansiver them), I am indeed near (to them by My knowledge). I respond to the invocations of the supplicant when he calls on Me (without any mediator or intercessor). So let them obey Me and believe in Me, so that they may be led aright.} Allah hears the Servant s Supplication Imam Ahmad reported that Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari said, We were in the company of Allah s Messenger during a battle. Whenever we climbed a high place, went up a hill or went down a valley, we used to say, Allah is the Most Great, raising our voices. The Prophet came by us and said: ujj iQu ij jUii bji-x i 'ji. 1 l'i ^ sWb 3* Cri J! 4O * (jail jj Oji-Xi '*H V4% v ?&ji it ^ xj. "0 people! Be merciful to yourselves (i.e., don t raise your voices), for you are not calling a deafor an absent one, but One Who is All-Hearer, All-Seer. The One Whom you call is closer to one ofyou than the neck ofhis animal. O 'Abdullah bin Qais (Abu Musa s name) should I teach you a statement that is a treasure of Paradise : 'La hawla wa la quwwata ilia billdh (there is no power or strength exceptfrom Allah).'111 " (i) Ahmad 4 :402

j jiJU sL>J*LLjO One s supplication will be accepted as long as he does become get hash/ and say, 7 have supplicated but it has not been acceptedfrom we.

V, ti*in&'cffi 1p^&c-J <&P > a (J==i~Ji>\ =S 4^'^^ -^i ^ ^ .jgflV&K j difcj^tl^tfyu jli JitJJji rl&J r^'^ \ JilijJl*!!^j^LoJ^t} to;l3Jy.1 jjilJ**lj^jjo;^I'i*^Vij?3li^V , -3 {" " ; _illt._L-'5^it^C^j-l^-l^J Tafsir 7b"

KflOirr Resurrection, and the doors of heaven will be opened far it, and Allah says, 'By My grace! / ti>"7/ certainly grant it far you, even if after a while. 'I ' &j ,U"J 5 Q Ji ihsC>\ (*i" o4 J'Q v , =J^ [y j> iAiJr? opt !& S [&P& C^=> u * jgflm *k & JU A _fZ& &)S~& 4^ Z&4 % 44' Ol ftt J ; 4 o-sr ^ ;,r ojua **a;& * g. 4fcd^& 4187. It is made lawful far you to luwe sexual relations with your wives on the night of As-Siyam (fasting). They are Libas [i.e., body-cover, or screen] far you and you are Libas for them. Allah knows that you used to deceive yourselves, so He turned to you (accepted your repentance) and forgave you So now luwe sexual relations with them and seek that which Allah has ordained for you (offspring), and eat and drink until the white thread (light) of dawn appears to you distinct from the black thread (darkness of night), then complete your fast till the nightfall. And do not have sexual relations with them (your 3:544, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7 :229, and Ibn Mfijah 1 :557

wives) while you are in I'tikaf in the Masjids. These are the limits (set) by Allah, so approach them not. Thus does Allah make clear His Ayat to mankind that they may acquire Taqwd.} Eating, Drinking and Sexual Intercourse are allowed during the Nights of Ramadan These Ayat contain a relief from Allah for the Muslims by ending the practice that was observed in the early years of Islam. At that time, Muslims were allowed to eat, drink and have sexual intercourse only until the Isha. (Night) prayer, unless one sleeps before the Isha prayer. Those who slept before Isha or offered the Isha prayer, were not allowed to drink, eat or sexual intervourse sex until the next night. The Muslims found that to be difficult for them. The Ayat used the word Rafath to indicate sexual intercourse, according to Ibn Abbas, Ata and Mujahid. Similar Tafsir was offered by Said bin Jubayr, Tawus, Salim bin Abdullah, Amr bin Dinar, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Az-Zuhri, Ad-Dahhak, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, As-Suddi, Ata Al-Khurasani and Muqatil bin Hayyan. Allah said: ilti sq pjp sq iThey are Libds [i.e., body-cover, or screen] for you and you are Libdsfor them.} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan said that this Ayah means, Your wives are a resort for you and you for them. Ar-Rabl bin Anas said, They are your cover and you are their cover. In short, the wife and the husband are intimate and have sexual intercourse with each other, and this is why they were permitted to have sexual activity during the nights of Ramadan, so that matters are made easier for them. Abu Ishaq reported that Al-Bara bin Azib said, When the Companions of Allah s Messenger jg observed fast but would sleep before breaking their fast, they would continue fasting Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :367-371 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :370. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:371.

iVtfe AAlldh knows that you used to deceive yourselves, so He turned to you (accepted your repentance) and forgave you. So noio have sexual relations with them}" This is the same narration that Al- Awfi related from Ibn Abbas . 1 Allah said: ip if a A --and seek that which Allah has ordained far you (offspring),} Abu Hurayrah, Ibn Abbas, Anas, Shurayh Al-Qadi, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Ata , Ar-Rabl bin Anas, As-Suddi, Zayd bin Aslam, Hakam bin Utbah, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Al- Hasan Al-Basri, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, and others said that this Ayah refers to having offspring . Qatadah said that the Ayah means, Seek the permission that Allah has allowed for you. Said narrated that Qatadah said, ip if u Aand seek that which Allah has ordainedfar you,} Time for Suhur Allah said: Oi # 2>' Of & it l; I^ifj \jt& i . .and eat and drink until the white thread (light) of dawn appears to you distinct from the black thread (darkness of night), then complete yourfast till the nightfall.} Allah has allowed eating and drinking, along with having sexual intercourse, as we have stated, during any part of the night until the light of dawn is distinguished from the darkness of the night. Allah has described that time as

distinguishing the white thread from the black thread. He At-Tabari 3 :496-498. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 377-378, and At-Tabari 3 :506-507.

then made it clearer when He said: iofdawn.} As stated in a Hadith that Imam Abu Abdullah

What is the white thread from the black thread? Are they

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 512–523]

m FathAl-Bari 8:31. 121 Ibid. 131 Ibid.

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 actual threads? He said: jdt Siji j: i : jti p o>:' M uiif "VoHr Qafd is wide ifyou see the two threads. Rather, they are the blackness of the night and the whiteness of the daylight Suhur^ is recommended Allah allowed eating and drinking until dawn, it represents proof that Suhur is encouraged, since it is a Rukhsah (concession or allowance) and Allah likes that the Rukhsah is accepted and implemented. The authentic Sunnah indicates that eating the Suhur is encouraged. It is reported in the Two Sahihs that Anas narrated that Allah s Messenger said: Eat the Suhur, for there is a blessing in Suhur . Muslim reported that Amr bin Al- As narrated that Allah s Messenger said: !l iis l ~ej li U jl> uTlie distinction between our fast and the fast of the People of the Book is the meal ofSuhur. Imam Ahmad reported that Abu Said narrated that Allah s Messenger jg said: iu I jli jl jij itjf-Jj 'fi SJt ? 1 ifi- 0 "Suhur is a blessed meal. Hence, do not abandon it, even ifone just takes a sip of water. Indeed, Allah and His angels send Saldh (blessings) upon those who eat Suhur. ",5) There are several other Hadiths that encourage taking the m Ibid. Al-Bari 4 :165 and Muslim 2 :770. Muslim 2:771. Ahmad 3 :44 ^ Predawn meal taken before fasting.

Suhur, even if it only consists of a sip of water. It is preferred that Suhur be delayed until the time of dawn. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Anas bin Malik narrated that Zayd bin Thabit said, We had Suhur with Allah s Messenger jg and then went on to pray. Anas asked, How much time was there between the Adhan (call to prayer) and the Suhur?' He said, The time that fifty Ayat take (to recite). Imam

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 for he does not call the Adhan until daion.^ ^ This is the wording collected by

The people will retain goodness as long as they hasten in breaking thefastfo 1 ^ Imam

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 iAttd do not Itave sexual relations with them (your wives) while you are in I'tikdf in the Masjids meaning, Do not touch your .wives as long as you are in I'tikdf, whether you were in the mosque or outside of it . ' It is also the opinion of Mujahid, Qatadah and several other scholars, that the

It is reported in the Two Sahihs that Safiyyah, the daughter of Huyal, went to Allah s Messenger si to visit him in the mosque while he was in I'tikaf. She had a talk with him for a while, then she got up in order to return home. The Prophet \$g accompanied her back home, as it was night. Her house was at Usamah bin Zayd s house on the edge of Al-Madlnah. While they were walking, two Ansari men met them and passed by them in a hurry, for they were shy to bother the Prophet jg while he was walking with his wife. He told them: J? I^jJ i USU-'-j Do not run away! She is (my wife) Safiyyah bint Huyai.v

Both of them said, All praise is due to Allah, (How dare we think of any evil) O Allah s Messenger! The Prophet sg said (to them): : JIS j\ *Shaytan reaches everywhere in the human body, that the blood reaches. I was afraid lest Shaytan might suggest an evil thought in your minds .o' 11 Imam Ash-Shafit commented, Allah s Messenger jg sought to teach his Ummah to instantly eliminate any evil thought, so that they do not fall into the prohibited. They (the two Ansari men) had more fear of Allah than to think evil of the Prophet 3g. Allah knows best. The Ayah (2:187) prohibits sexual intercourse and anything like kissing or embracing that might lead to it during I'tikaf. As for having the wife helping the husband, it is allowed. It is reported in the Two Sahllis that A islah said, Allah s Messenger jg would bring his head near me (in her room) and I would comb his hair, while I was on my menses. He would enter the room only to attend to what a man needs. |2 Allah s statement: Fath Al-Bari4 :326 and Muslim 4:1712. FathAl-Bari4 :320 and Muslim 1 :244

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) iThese are the limits (set) by Allah} means, This is what We have explained, ordained, specified, allowed and prohibited for fasting. We also mentioned the fast s objectives, what is permitted during it, and what is required of it. These are the set limits that Allah has legislated and explained, so do not come near them or transgress them. Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, (Allah s set limits mentioned in the Ayah) mean these four limits (and he then recited): }It is made lawful for you to have sexual relations with your wives on the night ofAs-Siydm (fasting).} and he recited up to: 4^ % foi& ' } ithen complete your Sawm (fast) till the nightfall.} My father and other s used to say similarly and recite the same Ayah to us. Allah said: }Thus does Allah make clear His Aydt to mankind} meaning, Just as He explains the fast and its rulings. He also explains the other rulings by the words of His servant and Messenger, Muhammad j . Allah continues: 4to mankind that they may attain Taqwq.} meaning, So that they know how to acquire the true guidance and how to worship (Allah). Similarly, Allah said: ill ub Jpl j*, kl' c)f_ oil. I.J ge. Jjv! y,} ilt is He Who sends down manifest Aydt to His servant (Muhammad jg) that He may bring you out from (types of) darkness into the light. And verily, Allah is to you full of kindness, Most Merciful.} (57:9)

oi '-J* I4J Jiiill jJSIT j^Jyl ijKt5 4:j 5#s o-vilf 4188. And eat up not one another s property unjustly (in any illegal way, e.g., stealing, robbing, deceiving), nor give bribery to the rulers (judges before presenting your cases) tltat you may knowingly eat up a part of the property ofothers sinfully.> Bribery is prohibited and is a Sin Ali bin Abu Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, This [Ayah 2:188] is about the indebted person when there is no evidence of the loan. So he denies taking the loan and the case goes to the authorities, even though he knows that it is not his money and that he is a sinner, consuming what is not allowed for him. ! ' This opinion was also reported from Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As- Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayan and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. They all stated, Do not dispute when you know that you are being unjust. ,21 The Judge s Ruling does not allow the Prohibited or prohibit the Lawful It is reported in the Two Sahihs that Umm Salamah narrated that Allah s Messenger said: oi (* -***; j*-; Ui) Via j\ IfL-Alb ijU ja aJ A" til t_r ! "/ am only human! You people present your cases to me, and as some of you may be more eloquent and persuasive in presenting his argument, I might issue a judgment in his benefit. So, if I give a Muslim's right to another, I am really giving him a piece offire; so he should not take tfV3 The Ayah and the Hadith prove that the judgment of the At-Tabari 3:550. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :393-394, and At-Tabari 3 :550-551 [31 Fath Al-Bari 13 :190 , and Muslim 3 :1373

Al-Bagharalt (175 authorities in any case does not change the reality of the truth. Hence, the ruling does not allow what is in fact prohibited or prohibit what is in fact allowed. It is only applicable in that case. So if the ruling agrees with the truth, then there is no harm in this case. Otherwise, the judge will acquire his reward, while the cheater will acquire the evil burden. This is why Allah said: Jyl oi ijxxx pyl %} y'i's. iAtid eat up not one another's property unjustly, nor give bribery to the rulers (judges before presenting your cases) that you may knowingly eat up a part of the property of others sinfully.) meaning, While you know the falsehood of what you claim. Qatadah said, O son of Adam! Know that the judge's ruling does not allow you what is prohibited or prohibit you from

what is allowed. The judge only rules according to his best

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 523–527]

judgment and according to the testimony of the witnesses. The judge is only human and is bound to make mistakes. Know that if the judge erroneously rules in some one's favor, then that person will still encounter the dispute when the disputing parties meet Allah on the Day of Resurrection. Then, the unjust person will be judged swiftly and precisely with that which will surpass whatever he acquired by the erroneous judgment he received in the life of this world. 'j "jL Jjj(JliJ Ji 3* \$\$} ifll \jluXj \$ St : Cr* j l&J Ji y.\ 4189. They ask you (O Muhammad) about the crescents. Say: "These are signs to mark fixed periods of time for mankind and for the pilgrimage." It is not Al-Birr (piety, righteousness, etc.) that you enter the houses from the back, but Al-Birr is from Taqwd. So enter houses through their proper doors, and have Taqwa of Allah that you may be successful.) At-Tabari 3 :550

The CrescentMoons Al- Awfl related that Ibn Abbas said, The people asked Allah's Messenger 2 about the crescent moons. Thereafter, this Ayah was revealed: iThey ask you (O Muhammad) about the crescents. Say, These are signs to mark fixed periods of time for mankind...) so that they mark their acts of worship, the Iddah (the period of time a divorced woman or a widow is required to wait before remarrying) of their women and the time of their Hajj (pilgrimage to Makkah). 1 ' 1 Abdur-Razzaq reported that Ibn Tjmar narrated that Allah's Messenger said: p-* Jill J*?- a ijiii Allah has made the crescents signs to mark fixed periods of time for mankind. Hence, fast on seeing it (the crescent for Ramadan) and break the fast on seeing it (the crescent for Shawwal). If it (the crescent) was obscure to you then count thirty days (mark that month as thirty days)ji2] This Hadlth was also collected by

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) Jahiliyyah, they used to enter the house from the back upon assuming the Hiram. Thereafter, Allah revealed (the following Ayah): hi.' \$5 cA\$m ot \$5 oL ilt is not Al-Birr (piety, righteousness, etc.) that you enter the houses from the back but Al-Birr is from Taqwa. So enter houses through their proper doors.

J mm* r mm 1' > ' * > t ?* * > A'.M l *" -f- -f- < :""("">"!" * //> ,-v' / />!*> y *" i l pA^C\$d 4.^ / <' V/.< #/ > . i- ' a" j .cJJoys-3 J VJ^J ^;jjA -4)i"oji l_y "-jA^k. As^e^!^\$ 4"IS) iiii! -^.(^i>* ^ vS-| .*> Y-f ?"!< ,f **. .{< 'I J**' fy 1** ^ 'jf<' jtt ,*v\j^iSj' l**r~U jji* i"" rt <* ' oAy oJS- H tj- & J'jm "& Ij^uf jji 4 !*^' . And fight in the way of Allah those who fight you, but transgress not the limits. Truly, Allah likes not the transgressors.) And kill them wherever you find them, and turn them out from where they have turned you out. And Al-Fitnah is worse than killing. And fight not with them at Al-Masjid Al-

Haram (the sanctuary at Makkah), unless they (first fight you there. But if they attack you, then kill them. Such is the recompense of the disbelievers.) 4192. But if they cease, then Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) 4193. And fight them until there is no more Fitnah (disbelief and worshipping of others along with Allah) and the religion (all and every kind of worship) is for Allah (Alone). But if they cease, let there be no transgression except against Az-Zalim (the polytheists and wrongdoers.) The Command to fight Those Who fight Muslims and killing Them wherever They are found Abu Jafar Ar-Razi said that Ar-Rabi bin Anas said that Abu Aliyah commented on what Allah said: 4 Ji& u&\$ 4 'fo&f}

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) 4 And fight in the way of Allah those who fight you,} Abu Aliyah said, This was the first Ayah about fighting that was revealed in Al-Madina. Ever since it was revealed, Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) used to fight only those who fought him and avoid non-combatants. Later, Surat Bara'ah (chapter 9 in the Qur'an) was revealed. Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said similarly, then he said that this was later abrogated by the Ayah: , 4 then kill them wherever you find them} (9:5). However, this statement is not plausible, because Allah's statement: . . . u-a\} 4 . . . those who fight you} applies only to fighting the enemies who are engaged in fighting Islam and its people. So the Ayah means, Fight those who fight you , just as Allah said (in another Ayah): 4 . . and fight against the Mushrikin collectively as they fight against you collectively> ' (9:36) This is why Allah said later in the Ayah: .. # > (- > \ 4 And kill them wherever you find them, and turn them out from where they have turned you out.} meaning, Your energy should be spent on fighting them, just as their energy is spent on fighting you, and on expelling them from the areas from which they have expelled you, as a law of equality in punishment.

The Prohibition of mutilating the Dead and stealing

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 527–529]

from the captured Goods Allah said: Tabari 3:561. Tabari 3:562.

but transgress not the limits. Truly, Allah likes not the transgressors This Ayah means, Fight for the sake of Allah and do not be transgressors, such as, by committing prohibitions. Al-Hasan Al-Basri stated that transgression (indicated by the Ayah), includes mutilating the dead, theft (from the captured goods), killing women, children and old people who do not participate in warfare, killing priests and residents of houses of worship, burning down trees and killing animals without real benefit. This is also the opinion of Ibn Abbas, Umar bin Abdul-'Aziz, Muqatil bin Hayyan and others.

529 Siirah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and Ar-Rabi bin Anas said that what Allah said: 'at Makkah And Al-Fitnah is worse than killing.} Shirk (polytheism) is worse than killing. Fighting in the Sacred Area is prohibited, except in Self- Defense Allah said: Sij> i And fight not with them at Al-Masjid Al-Haram (the sanctuary at Makkah)} It is reported in the Two Sahih's that the Prophet (ﷺ) said: JjJl 4)1 tf3 ol^*"Ul fjJ 4)1 IJL" oJB 4 y^> (\ j*~ "j-6 tjjJj i j* 'jl J (J jLJj liiQJl ^y_ j j V t'y, ^ (jiu ^l (j) : I_jJjh "i)l j "Allah has made this city a sanctuary since the day He created the heavens and the earth. So, it is a sanctuary by Allah's decree till the Day of Resurrection. Fighting in it

was made legal for me only for an hour in the daytime. So, it (i.e., Makkah) is a sanctuary, by Allah's decree, from now on until

the Day of Resurrection. Its trees should not be cut, and its

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 529–604]

grass should not be uprooted. If anyone mentions the fighting in it that occurred by Allah's Messenger, then say that Allah allowed His Messenger, but did not allow you." [1] In this Hadith, Allah's Messenger just mentions fighting the people of Makkah when he conquered it by force, leading to some deaths among the polytheists in the area of the Khandamah. This occurred after the Prophet just proclaimed: if you see the flag of Allah in the land of the disbelievers, then fight them. Al-Bari 6 :327 and Muslim 2 :986-987

530 Tafsir Ibn Kathir "Whoever closed his door is safe. Whoever entered the (Sacred) Mosque is safe. Whoever entered the house of Abu Sufyan is also safe." Allah said: 4...unless they (first) fight you there. But if they attack you, then kill them. Such is the recompense of the disbelievers.} Allah states: Do not fight them in the area of the Sacred Mosque unless they start fighting you in it. In this case, you are allowed to fight them and kill them to stop their aggression. Hence, Allah's Messenger took the pledge from his Companions under the tree (in the area of Al-Hudaybiyyah) to fight (the polytheists), after the tribes of Quraysh and their allies, Thaqif and other groups, collaborated against the Muslims (to stop them from entering Makkah to visit the Sacred House). Then, Allah stopped the fighting before it started between them and said: 4And He it is Who has withheld their hands from you and your hands from them in the midst of Makkah, after He had made you victors over them .} (48:24) and: O you who believe! If you did not know, that you may kill them and on whose account a sin would have been committed by you without (your) knowledge, that Allah might bring into His mercy whom He wills if they (the believers and the disbelievers) had been apart, We verily, would have punished those of them who disbelieved with painful torment.} (48:25) Allah's statement: & you 2 :292

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) iBut if they cease, then Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful .} which means, If they (polytheists) cease fighting you in the Sacred Area, and come to Islam and repent, then Allah will forgive them their sins, even if they had before killed Muslims in Allah's Sacred Area. Indeed, Allah's forgiveness encompasses every sin, whatever its enormity, when the sinner repents it. The Order to fight until there is no more Fitnah Allah then commanded fighting the disbelievers when He said: you & } i...until there is no more Fitnah} meaning, Shirk. This is the opinion of Ibn Abbas, Abu Al- Aliyah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi , Muqatil bin Hayyan, As-Suddi and Zayd bin Aslam. 1 Allah's statement: i . . .and the religion (all and every kind of worship) is for Allah (Alone).} means, So that the religion of Allah becomes dominant above all other religions. It is reported in the Two Sahih's that Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari said: "The Prophet was asked, O Allah's Messenger! A man fights out of bravery, and another fights to show off, which of them fights in the cause of Allah? The Prophet said: " The one who fights so that Allah's Word is superior, then he fights in Allah's cause. in addition, it is reported in the Two Sahih's: .Jill V) ii) you I fight for Allah, > & ! ^ > > ! " 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 415-416. in Fath Al-Bari 13 :450 and Muslim 3:1513.

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) Allah . Under Allah's statement: iAndfight them until there is no more Fitnah}

4 i ojG v 4A"rffight them until there is no more Fittah (disbelief)?} He said, That we did during the time of Allah s Messenger when Islam was still weak and (the Muslim) man used to face trials in his religion, such as killing or torture. When Islam became stronger (and apparent), there was no more Fitnah. He asked, What do you say about Ali and TJthman? He said, As for Uthman, Allah has forgiven him. However, you hated the fact that Allah had forgiven him! As for Ali, he is the cousin of Allah s Messenger jg and his son-in-law. He then pointed with his hand, saying, This is where his house is located (meaning, so close to the Prophet s house just as Ali was so close to the Prophet himself). dSJ u jjXii u 4 > Sil CjS ijiStlj ill iy'j 4194. Tlte sacred month is for the sacred month, and for the prohibited things, there is the Law of equality (Qisds). Then whoever transgresses against you, you transgress likewise against him. And fear Allah, and know that Allah is with Al- Muttaqm.} Fightingduringthe SacredMonths is prohibited, except in Self-Defense Ibn Abbas, Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi, Qatadah, Miqsam, Ar- Rabl bin Anas and Ata said, Allah s Messenger sg went for Umrah on the sixth year of Hijrah. Then, the idolators prevented him from entering the Sacred House (the Ka'bah in Makkah) along with the Muslims who came with him. This incident occurred during the sacred month of Dhul-Qa dah. The idolators agreed to allow them to enter the House the next year. Hence, the Prophet entered the House the following year, along with the Muslims who accompanied him, and Allah permitted him to avenge the idolators' treatment of him, when He said: m Fath Al-Bari 8 :32

/Ji jfoi jffo \$The sacred month is for the sacred month, and for the prohibited things, there is the Law ofequality (Qisas).^ Imam

against hint.} ordains justice even with the polytheists. Allah also said in another Ayah: ti I^Ui u? 4And i/ 1/om punish, then punish them with the like of that with which you were afflicted.} (16:126) Allah s statement: ija' 'ijtlclj iAndfear Allah, and know that Allah is luith Al-Muttaqm (the pious)} (2:194) commands that Allah be obeyed and feared out of Taqwa. The Ayah informs us that Allah is with those who have Taqwa by His aid and support in this life and the Hereafter. il95. And spend in the cause of Allah and do not throw yourselves into destruction, and do good. Truly, Alldlt loves Al-Mulisimn (those who do good).} TheCommand to spend in the Cause ofAllah

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 this Ayah (2:195) better, for it was revealed about us, the Companions of Allah s Messenger sg who participated in Jihad with him and aided and supported him. When Islam became strong, we, the Ansar, met and said to each other, Allah has honored us by being the Companions of His Prophet jg and in supporting him until Islam became victorious and its following increased. We had before ignored the needs of our families, estates and children. Warfare has ceased, so let us go back to our families and children and attend to them. So this Ayah was revealed about us: 4 Aty' J! [y^ Vi 4 4 4.And spend in the cause of Allah and do not throw yourselves into destruction the destruction refers to staying with our families and estates and abandoning Jihad . This was recorded by Abu Dawud, At- Tirmidhi, An-Nasal, Abd bin Humayd in his Tafsir, Ibn Abu Hatim, Ibn Jarir, Ibn Marduwyah, Al-Hafiz Abu Yala in his Musnad, Ibn Hibban and Al-Hakim. * At-Tirmidhi said; "Hasan, Sahih, Gharib ' Al-Hakim said, "It meets the criteria of the Two Shaykhs (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) but they did not record it. Abu Dawud s version mentions that Aslam Abu Imran said, We were at (the siege

of) Constantinople. Then, Tjqbah bin Amr was leading the Egyptian forces, while the Syrian forces were led by Fadalah bin Tjbayd. Later on, a huge column of Roman (Byzantine) soldiers departed the city, and we stood in lines against them. A Muslim man raided the Roman lines until he broke through them and came back to us. The people shouted, All praise is due to Allah! He is sending himself to certain demise. Abu Ayyub said, O people! You explain this Ayah the wrong way. It was revealed about us, the Ansar when Allah gave victory to His religion and its following increased. We said to each other, It would be better for us now if we return to our estates and attend to them. Then m Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:311, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:299, Ibn Abi Hatim 1:424, At-Tabari 3:590, Ibn Hibban 7:105, and Al-Hakim ' That is, almost the level of Sahih.

Allah revealed this Ayah (2:195) ."111 Abu Bakr bin Aiyash reported that Abu Ishaq As-Subai'y related that a man said to Al-Bara bin Azib, If I raided the enemy lines alone and they kill me, would I be throwing myself to certain demise? He said, No. Allah said to His Messenger <_i>S 'J ' Jju {Then fight (O Muhammad jg) in the cause of Allah, you are not tasked (held responsible) exceptfor yourself. (4:84) That Ayah (2:195) is about (refraining from) spending. Ibn Marduwyah reported this Hadlth, as well as Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak who said; "It meets the criteria of the Two Shaykhs (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) but they did not record it. Ath-Thawri and Qays bin Ar-Rabi related it from Al-Bara . but added: {You are not tasked Qield responsible) except for yourself (4:84) Destruction refers to the man who sins and refrains from repenting, thus throwing himself to destruction. Ibn Abbas said: j! &A A I&& {And spend in the cause of Allah and do not throw yourselves into destruction This is not about fighting. But about refraining from spending for the sake of Allah, in which case, one will be throwing his self into destruction." The Ayah (2:195) includes the order to spend in Allah s cause, in the various areas and ways that involve obedience and drawing closer to Allah. It especially applies to spending in fighting the enemies and on what strengthens the Muslims against the enemy. Allah states that those who refrain from spending in this regard will face utter and certain demise and destruction, meaning those who acquire this habit. Allah Abu Dawud 3:27.

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 commands that one should acquire Ihsan (excellence in the religion), as it is the highest part of the acts of obedience. Allah said: 44 if k iatid do good. Truly, Allah loves Al-Muhsinin (those who do good).) % & \ja % -faj \$ % %% gii i \fo\j) jtj jf ? J? i-.fi; o' Jif 1; J) 'fok *H #*r-> gti ^ jS; jf. ipii 3^ ji ' 5 ff" jl iii (jijlj ijii lilij jtjjl' > - 4296. And complete Hajj and Umrah for Allah. But ifyou are prevented, then sacrifice a Hady that you can afford, and do not shave your heads until the Hady reaches the place of sacrifice. And whosoever of you is ill or has an ailment on his scalp (necessitating shaving), he must pay a Fidyah (ransom) of either fasting or giving Sadaqah or a sacrifice. Then if you are in safety and whosoever performs the 'Umrah (in the months of Hajj), before (performing) the Hajj, he must slaughter a Hady such as he can afford, but ifhe cannot (afford it), he should fast for three days during Hajj and seven days after his return, making ten days in all. This is for him whose family is not present at Al-Masjid Al-Haram (i.e., non-resident of Makkah). And fear Allalt much and know tlmt Allah is severe in punishment.) TheCommand to complete Hajjand Umrah After Allah mentioned the rulings for fasting and Jihad, he explained the rituals by commanding the Muslims to complete Hajj and Umrah, meaning, to finish the rituals of Hajj and Umrah after one starts them. This is why Allah said afterwards: iBut ifyou are prevented)

meaning, if your way to the House is obstructed, and you are prevented from finishing it. This is why the scholars agree that starting the acts of Hajj and Umrah requires one to finish them. As for Makhul, he said, Complete, means to start them from the Miqat (areas the Prophet ﷺ designated to assume Ihram from). Abdur-Razzaq said that Az-Zuhri said: We were told that Tjmar commented on: gas 4And complete Hajj and 'Umrah for Allah.} Complete Hajj and Umrah means performing each of them separately, and to perform Umrah outside of the months of Hajj, for Allah the Exalted says: 4The Hajj (pilgrimage) is (in) the well-known (lunar year) months.} m As-Suddi said, P'J g 4And complete Hajj and Umrah for Allah.} means, Maintain the performance of Hajj and Umrah. Ibn Abbas was reported to have said, Hajj is Arafat, while Umrah is Tawaf."14 Al-A mash related that Ibrahim said that Alqamah commented on Allah's statement: i AZ& &j} 4And complete Hajj and Umrah for Allah.} Abdullah (Ibn Mas'ud) recited it this way: Complete Hajj and Umrah to the House, so that one does not exceed the area of the House during the Umrah'. Ibrahim then said, I mentioned this statement to Said bin Jubayr and he said; Ibn Abbas also said that. 151 Sufyan reported that Ibrahim said 111 Ibn Abi HStim 1 :437. 121 Ibid.Tabari4:12. 141 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :439. At-Tabari4:7.

that Alqamah said (regarding the Ayah 2:196), Perform the Hajj and Umrah to the House. ' Ath-Thawri reported that Ibrahim read (the Ayah), Perform the Hajj and Umrah to the House. If One is prevented while in Route, He slaughters the Sacrifice, shaves his Head and ends Ihram Allah's statement: iBut if you are prevented, sacrifice a Hady (animals for sacrifice) such as you can afford,} was revealed in the sixth year of Hijrah, the year of the treaty of Al-Hudaybiyyah when the polytheists prevented Allah's Messenger ﷺ from reaching the House. Allah revealed Surat Al-Fath (chapter 48 in the Qur'an) then, and allowed the Muslims to slaughter any Hady (animals for sacrifice) they had. They had seventy camels with them for that purpose. They were also permitted to shave their heads and end their Ihram. When the Prophet ﷺ commanded them to shave their heads and end the state of Ihram, they did not obey him, as they were awaiting that order to be abrogated. When they saw that the Prophet ﷺ went out after shaving his head, they imitated him. Some of them did not shave, but only shortened their hair. This is why

the Prophet ﷺ said: "i)l May Allah award His mercy to those who shaved They said, What about those who shortened the hair? He said in the third time, And to those who shortened. |2) Every seven among them shared one camel for their sacrifice. They were one thousand and four hundred Companions and were camping in the area of Al-Hudaybiyyah, outside the Sacred Area. It was also reported that they were within the boundaries of the Sacred Area. Allah knows best. Being prevented from the House (Hast) includes more than just being sick, fearing an enemy or getting lost on the way to 111 Ibid. 2:946.

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) Abdur-Razzaq reported that Ibn Abbas said about what Allah said: i&ii G" .sacrifice a Hady such as you can afford As much as one could afford. Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said, If one can afford it, then camels, otherwise cows, or sheep. * Hisham bin Urwah quoted his father: v, 4^' Si Gp 4...sacrifice a Hady (animal, i.e., a sheep, a cow, or a camel) such as you can afford} Depending on the price. The proof that sacrificing only a sheep is allowed in the case of being prevented from continuing the rites, is that Allah has required sacrificing whatever is available as a Hady, and the Hady is any type of cattle; be it camels, cows or sheep. This is the opinion of Ibn Abbas

the cousin of Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) and the scholar of Tafsir. It is reported in the Two Sahih's that Aishah, the Mother of the believers, said, The Prophet (ﷺ) once offered some sheep as Hady. Allah's statement: 'Ujj 4...and do not shave your heads until the Hady reaches the place of sacrifice. is a continuation of His statement: 4.A * / *\$> ji' 4And complete, the Hajj and Umrah for Allah. and is not dependent upon: 4t0su'j&t fad 4But if you are prevented, then sacrifice a Hady ** Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :451 At-Tabari 4 :30 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :452 * Path Al-Bari 3 :639 and Muslim 2 :958

/ matted my hair and I have garlanded my Hady (animals for sacrifice), so I will not finish my Ihram till I offer the sacrifice .

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) N : cJJ i IJla JAj jl^JI jf Ui: "/ newer thought that your ailment (or struggle) had reached to such an extent as I see. Can you afford a sheep (for sacrifice)?' I replied in the negative ."

546 Tafstr Ibn Kathir: "but there is no difference between them over the Hady. So Allah said, G gfJ jl p ty} iThen if you are in safety and whosoever performs the 'Umrah (in the months of Hajj), before (performing) the Hajj (i.e., Hajj At-Tamattu and Al-Qiran), he must slaughter a Hady such as he can afford,} means let him sacrifice whatever Hady is available to him, the least of which is a sheep. One is also allowed to sacrifice a cow because the Prophet (ﷺ) slaughtered cows on behalf of his wives. Al-Awza! reported that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) slaughtered cows on behalf of his wives when they were performing Tamattu' 1 ^ This was reported by Abu Bakr bin Marduwyah. This last Hadlth proves that Tamattu' is legislated. It is reported in the Two Sahdhs that Imran bin Husayn said, We performed Hajj At-Tamattu' in the lifetime of Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) and then the Qur'an was revealed (regarding Hajj At- Tamattu). Nothing was revealed to forbid it, nor did he (the Prophet) forbid it until he died. And somebody said what he wished (regarding Hajj At-Tamattu) according to his own opinion."

Al-Bagaralt (175 - 200) (Part-2) Umar. It is reported in an authentic narration that Umar used to discourage the people from performing Tamattu . He used to say, If we refer to Allah's Book, we should complete it, meaning: iU * a& Ji p& 4 .. .whosoever performs the 'Urnral (in tlte months of Hajj), before (performing) the Hajj, he must slaughter a Hady such as he can afford,\$ However Umar did not say that Tamattu' is unlawful. He only prevented them so that the people would increase their trips to the House for Hajj (during the months of Hajj) and Vmrah (throughout the year), as he himself has stated. Whoever performs Tamattu should fastTen Days ifHe does not have aHady Allah said: 4 '(/u. Jij; iji p 4 4.. but ifhe cannot (afford it), he should fast three days during the Hajj and seven days after his return (to his home), making ten days in all> This Ayah means: Those who do not find a Hady, let them fast three days during the Hajj season. Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said, If one does not have a Hady, he should fast three days during Hajj, before 'Arafah day. If the day of Arafah was the third day, then his fast is complete. He should also fast seven days when he gets back home. 1 ' 1 Abu Ishaq reported from Wabarrah from Ibn Umar who said, One fasts one day before the day of Tarwiyah, the day of Tarwiyah (eighth day of Dhul-Hijjah) and then Arafah day (the ninth day of the month of Dhul-Hijjah). The same state ment was reported by Ja'far bin Muhammad from his father from Ali.13 If one did not fast these three days or at least some of them before Id day (the tenth day of Dhul-Hijjah), he is allowed to At-Tabari 4 :97Tabari 4:95. At-Tabari 4 :94

fast during the Tashriq days (11-12-13th day of Dhul-Hijjah). A'ishah and Ibn Umar said, Fasting the days of Tashriq was only allowed for those who did not find the Hady as Al-Bukhari has reported. Sufyan related that Ja'far bin Muhammad narrated that his father said that Ali said, "Whoever did not fast the three days during the Hajj, should fast them during the days of Tashriq." This is also the position taken by Tjibayd bin Tjmayr Al-Laythi, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Tjrwah bin Az-Zubayr, referring to the general meaning of Allah's statement: 4\$ 1 . . .fast three days during the Hajj . As for what Muslim reported that Qutaybah Al-Hudhali said that Allah's Messenger said: p hj AS\ id Jijls I ;d" ' * * " - ' days of Tashriq are days of eating and drinking and remembering Allah the Exalted ." This narration is general in meaning while what A'ishah and Ibn Umar narrated is specific. Allah said: .and seven days after his return .} There are two opinions regarding the meaning of this Ayah. First, it means when you return to the camping areas . The second, upon going back home. Abdur-Razzaq reported that Salim narrated that he heard Ibn Umar saying: i...but if he cannot (afford it), he should fast three days during the Hajj and seven days after his return,} means when he goes back to his family. ,31 The same opinion was reported from Said bin Jubayr, Abu Al-Aliyah, Mujahid, Ata , Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Imam Az-Zuhri and Ar-At-Tabari 4 :98-99 2:800. ,3 I Tafsir Abdur-Razzaq 1 :76.

Rab' bin Anas.' Al-Bukhari reported that Salim bin Abdullah narrated that Ibn Umar said, During the Farewell Hajj of Allah's Messenger Sg, he performed Tamattu' with Umrah and Hajj. He drove a Hady along with him from Dhul-Hulayfah. Allah's Messenger Jg started by assuming Ihram for 'Umrah, and then for Hajj. And the people, too, performed the Umrah and Hajj along with the Prophet sg. Some of them brought the Hady and drove it along with them, while the others did not. So, when the Prophet Jg arrived at Makkah, he said to the people: Isj '*** Cr?*- J*- Jt V JfcJ (*J jSw j! lij IjJA JL jU .utff ^Whoever among you has driven the Hady, should not finish his Ihram till he completes his Hajj. And whoever among you has not (driven) the Hady with him, he should perform Tawaf of the Ka'bah and between As-Safd and Al-Marwah. Then, he should shave or cut his hair short and finish his Ihram, and should later assume Ihram far Hajj; [but he must offer a Hady (sacrifice)]. And if anyone cannot afford a Hady, he should fast far three days during the Hajj and seven days when he returns home." He then mentioned the rest of the Hadith, which is reported in the Two SahXhsP1 Allah said: it# Xju-4 ...making ten days in all> to emphasize the ruling we mentioned above. This method is common in the Arabic language, for they would say, I have seen with my eyes, heard with my ears and written with my hand, to emphasize such facts. Similarly, Allah said: Ibn Abi Hatim 2:498. ' Fath Al-Bari 3 :630 and Muslim 2 :901

550 Tafsir Ibit Kaihir 4...nor a bird that flies with its two wings" (6:38) and: 4...nor did you write any book (whatsoever) with your right hand) (29:48) and: iAnd We appointed for Musa thirty nights and added (to the period) ten (more), and he completed the term, appointed by his Lord, offorty nights.) (7:142) It was also said that the meaning of ten days in all emphasizes the order to fast for ten days, not less than that. The Residents of Makkah do not perform Tamattu Allah said: 4^/^ jW iThis is for him whose family is not present at Al-Masjid Al-Haram (i.e., non-resident of Makkah).) Tltis Ayah concerns the residents of the area of the Haram, for they do not perform Tamattu Abdur-Razzaq reported that Tawus said, Tamattu is for the people, those whose families are not residing in the Haram area (Makkah), not for the residents of Makkah. Hence Allah's Statement: i/jti iThis is for him whose family is not present at Al-Masjid Al-Hardm (i.e., non-resident of Makkah) Abdur-Razzaq then said, I was also

told that Ibn Abbas said similar to TawQs. Allah said: i . .and fear Allah) meaning, in what He has commanded you and what He prohibited for you. He then said: ji jLj \$ 3 \pi\ i...and know that Allah is severe in punishment) m At-Tabari 4:111.

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) J mm n aiap < . '< '" \$ -4Vt4jk *is!A^Ji0 5 SiW Vi for those who defy His command and commit what He has prohibited. o*-" j*-' juJ'y * gi1 dfj g"J' 4 J'i-t vj - - -* jS> >> < ,* / .5 SS^i (j-j) \jLUJ .) Jr? ~ *r . [V tr 4&) Uju jAj* ^ \jX*..a\ }fy J*-)j- ^v^dVi Jjti pjftj 4297. 77w Hajj (pilgrimage) is (in) the well-known months. So whosoever intends to perform Hajj therein (by assuming Ihram), then he should not have sexual relations (with his wife), nor commit sin, nor dispute unjustly during the Hajj. And whatever good you do, Allah brows it. And take provisions for the journey, but the best provision is At-Taqua (piety, righteousness). So fear Me, O men of understanding!} When does Ihram for Hajj start Allah said: ii \$The Hajj is (in) the well-known months.} This Ayah indicates that Ihram for Hajj only occurs during the months of Hajj. This was reported from Ibn Abbas , Jabir, Ata , Tawus and Mujahid. The proof for this is Allah s HI At-Tabari 4 : 1 15.

552 Tlfebr Ibn Kathir statement that Hajj occurs during known, specific months, which indicates that Hajj is not allowed before that, just as the prayer has a fixed time (before which one's prayer is not accepted). Ash-Shafil recorded that Ibn Abbas said, No person should assume Ihram for Hajj before the months of the Hajj, for Allah said: \$The Hajj is (in) the well-known months Ibn Khuzaymah reported that Ibn Abbas said, No Ihram for Hajj should be assumed, except during the months of Hajj for among the Sunnah of Hajj is that one assume Ihram for it during the Hajj months. This is an authentic narration and the Companion s statement that such and such is among the Sunnah is considered as a Hadith of the Prophet jg, according to the majority of the scholars. This is especially the case when it is Ibn Abbas who issued this statement, as he is the Tarjuman (translator, interpreter, explainer) of the Qur an. There is a Hadith about this subject too. Ibn Marduwyah related that Jabir narrated that the Prophet jg said: Jt V) fj oi aNo one should assume Ihram for Hajj, but during the months ofHajj.* The chain of narrators for this Hadith is reasonable. Ash- Shafit and Al-Bayhaqi recorded this Hadith from Ibn Jurayj who related that Abu Az-Zubayr said that he heard Jabir bin Abdullah being asked, Does one assume Ihram for Hajj before the months of the Hajp He said, No. This narration is more reliable than the narration that we mentioned from the Prophet jg. In short, this statement is the opinion of the Companion, supported by Ibn Abbas statement that it is a part of the Sunnah not to assume Ihram for Hajj before the Al-Umm 2 :132 . Ibn Khuzaymah 4 :162 . Al-MusannaflbnAbi Shaybah, and Tafsir Abdur-Razzaq. ^ Al-Umm 2 :132 , and Al-Bayhaqi 4 :343 .

months of the Hajj. Allah knows best. The Months ofHajj Allah said: 4...the well-known months.}

554 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir In this case, one will only be hastening for one and a half days. Allah then said: iSo whosoever intends (Farada) to perform Hajj therein (by assuming Ihram),} meaning that one's assuming the Ihram requires a Hajj, for the person is required to complete the rituals of Hajj after assuming Ihram. Ibn Jarir said that Al- Awfi said, The scholars agree that (Farada) intends mentioned in the Ayah means it is a requirement and an obligation. 111 Ali bin Abu Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said: iSo whosoever intends to perform Hajj therein (by assuming Ihram), refers to those who assume Ihram for Hajj and Umrah . Ata said, 'Intends', means, assumes the Ihram." Similar statements were attributed

to Ibrahim, Ad-Dahhak and others. 2 ^ Prohibition of Rafath (Sexual Intercourse) during Hajj Allah said: iHe should not have Rafath^ This Ayah means that those who assume the Ihram for Hajj or Umrah are required to avoid the Rafath, meaning, sexual intercourse. Allah s statement here is similar to His statement: ilt is made lawful for you to have Rafath (sexual relations) with your wives on the night of the fast.> (2:187) Whatever might lead to sexual intercourse, such as embracing, kissing and talking to women about similar Tabari 4:120-121. At-Tabari 4:123.

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) subjects, is not allowed. Ibn Jarir reported that Nafi narrated that Abdullah bin Umar said, Rafath means sexual intercourse or mentioning this subject with the tongue, by either men or women. 111 Ata bin Abu Rabah said that Rafath means sexual intercourse and foul speech.121 This is also the opinion of Amr bin Dinar. Ata also said that they used to even prevent talking (or hinting) about this subject.131 Tawtis said that Rafath includes one s saying, When I end the Ihram I will have sex with you. This is also the same explanation offered by Abu Al- Aliyah regarding Rafath. Ali bin Abu Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said, Rafath means having sex with the wife, kissing, fondling and saying foul words to her, and similar acts. 151 Ibn Abbas and Ibn Umar said that Rafath means to have sex with women. 161 This is also the opinion of Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Mujahid, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Abu Al- Aliyah who narrated it from Ata and MakhQL, Ata Al- Khurasani, Ata bin Yasar, Atiyah, Ibrahim, Ar-Rabi , Az- Zuhri, As-Suddi, Malik bin Anas, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Abdul-Karim bin Malik, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak, and others. The Prohibition of Fusuq during HaJJ Allah said: 4...nor commit sin Miqsam and several other scholars related that Ibn Abbas said, "It is disobedience." This is also the opinion of Ata, Mujahid, Tawus, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Muhammad bin KaT), Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Az-Zuhri, Ar-Rabl* bin Anas, Ata bin Yasar, Ata Al-Khurasani and Muqatil bin Hayyan.171 Ibn Wahb reported that Nafi narrated that Abdullah bin m At-Tabari 4:126.Tabari 4:127. At-Tabari 4:128. Ibid. 151 Al-Tabari 4:129. 161 Ibid. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 : 497-500

Umar said, Fusuq [or sin mentioned in the Ayah (2:197)] refers to committing what Allah has forbidden in the Sacred Area. 111 Several others said that Fusuq means cursing others, they based this on the authentic Hadith: ,4^Jl "Cursing the

mother gave birth to him The Prohibition of arguing during Hajj Allah said: 4 fo-t 4nor should there be Jiddl during Hajj} meaning, disputes and arguments. Ibn Jarir related that Abdullah bin MasUd said that what Allah said: 4 . -nor dispute unjustly during the Hajj.} means to argue with your companion (or fellow) until you make him angry. This is similar to the the opinion that Miqsam and Ad-Dahhak related to Ibn Abbas.121 This is also the same meaning reported from Abu Al- Aliyah, Ata , Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Jabir bin Zayd, Ata Al- Khurasani, MakhQL, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Amr bin Dinar, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabi bin Anas, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Ata bin Yasar, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Az-Zuhri. The Encouragement for Righteous Deeds and to bring Provisions for Hajj Allah said: aILju jji \Zj} 4And whatever good you do, Allah blows it.} After Allah prohibited evil in deed and tongue, He encouraged righteous, good deeds, stating that He is knowledgeable of the good that they do, and He will reward them with the best awards on the Day of Resurrection. Allah said next: 0 4And take provisions (zbith you) for the journey, but the best Fath Al-Bari 4 :25 and Muslim 2 :983 . At-Tabari 4:141. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :503-505 :

provision is At-Taqla (piety, righteousness) .)" Al-Bukhari and Abu Dawud reported that Ibn Abbas said, The people of Yemen used to go to Hajj without taking enough supplies with them. They used to say, *We are those who have Tawakkul (reliance on Allah). Allah revealed this Ayah: iAnd take provisions (with you) for the journey, but the best provision is At-Taqla (piety, righteousness).^ Ibn Jarir and Ibn Marduyah narrated that Ibn Tjmar said, When people assumed Ihram, they would throw away whatever provisions they had and would acquire other types of provisions. Allah revealed: il&l' 0> iAnd take a provisions (with you) for the journey, but the best provision is At-Taqla (piety, righteousness).} Allah forbade them from this practice and required them to take flour and Sawiq (a type of food usually eaten with dates) with them. 121 The Provisions ofthe Hereafter Allah said: &% djfr .but the best provision is At-Taqla (piety, righteousness).} When Allah required mankind to supply themselves with what sustains them for the journeys of this life, He directed them to the necessary provisions for the Hereafter: Taqla. Allah said in another Ayah T tSjB' o-Uj .and as an adornment; and the raiment of Taqla, that is better.} (7:26) Allah mentioned the material covering and then He Fath Al-Bari 3 :449 , Abu Dawud 2 :309. At-Jabari 4:156.

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) mentioned the spiritual covering, which includes humbleness, obedience and Taqla. He also stated that the latter provision is better and more beneficial than the former. iSofear Me, O men ofunderstanding!} meaning: Fear My torment, punishment, and affliction for those who defy Me and do not adhere to My commands, O people of reason and understanding. . i - ".*. 0i 0^ oi V l'i of feZi p =s=c\s. \"< ' I'ir t .. Ax I ", il98. There is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your lord (during pilgrimage by trading). Then when you leave 'Arafat, remember Allah (by glorifying His praises, i.e., prayers and invocations) at the Mash ar-il-Haram. And remember Him (by invoking Allah for all good) as He has guided you, and verily you were before, of those who were astray}. Commercial Transactions during Hajj

iThere is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord (during pilgrimage by trading).} This is also the explanation of Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Mansur bin Al-Mu tamir, Qatadah, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Ar-Rab! bin Anas and others. Ibn Jarir reported that Abu Umaymah said that when Ibn Umar was asked about conducting trade during the Hajj, he recited the Ayah: iThere is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord (during pilgrimage by trading).} This Hadith is related to Ibn Umar with a strong chain of narrators. This Hadith is also related to the Prophet \$gg, as Ahmad reported that Abu Umamah At-Taymi said, I asked Ibn Umar, *We buy (and sell during the Hajj), so do we still have a valid Hajp He said, Do you not perform Tawaf around the House, stand at Arafat, throw the pebbles and shave your heads? I said, Yes. Ibn Umar said, A man came to the Prophet^ and asked him about what you asked me, and the Prophet did not answer him until Jibril came down with this Ayah: t. ^ i iThere is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord (during pilgrimage by trading).} The Prophet 3g summoned the man and said: You are pilgrims**. i Ibn Jarir narrated that Abu Salih said to Umar, O Leader of the faithful! Did you conduct trade transactions during the Hajp He said, Was their livelihood except during Hajp'W Standing at Arafat Allah said: it iil(j.\ .. TiU>^> Abu Dawud 2:350. At-Tabari 4:165. 2:155. A*-Tabari 4:168.

Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 iTheti when you leave 'Arafat, remember Allah (by glorifying His praises, i.e., prayers and invocations) at the Mash'ar-il- Haramf Arafat is the place where one stands during the Hajj and it is a pillar of the rituals of Hajj Imam

This Hadith was collected by Imam Ahmad and the compilers of the Sunan, and At-Tirmidhi graded it Sahib. ' It was reported that the mount was called Arafat because, as Abdur- Razzaq reported that Ali bin Abu Talib said, Allah sent Jibril to Prophet Ibrahim and he performed Hajj for him (to teach him its rituals). When Ibrahim reached Arafat he said, 1 have Araftu (I know this place). He had come to that area before. Thereafter, it was called Arafat. '2 ' Ibn Al-Mubarak said that Ata said, It was called Arafat because Jibril used to teach Ibrahim the rituals of Hajj. Ibrahim would say, 1 have Araftu, I have Araftu. It was thereafter called Arafat. Similar statements were attributed to Ibn Abbas³ ' , Ibn TJmar and Abu Mijlaz.⁴ ' Allah knows best. Arafat is also called Al-Mash ar Al-Haram, Al-Mash ar Al- Aqsa and Ilal, while the mount that is in the middle of Arafat is called Jabal Ar-Rahmah (Mount of Mercy). The Time to leave Arafat and Al-Muzdalifah Ibn Abu Hatim reported that Ibn Abbas said, During the time of JahUiyyah, the people used to stand at Arafat. When the sun would be on top of the mountains, just as the turban is on top of a man s head, they would move on. Allah s Messenger jg delayed moving from Arafat until sunset. '5 ' Ibn Marduwyah related this Hadith and added, He then stood at Al-Muzdalifah and offered the Fajr (Dawn) prayer at an early time. When the light of dawn broke, he moved on. This Hadith has a Hasan chain of narrators. The long Hadith that Jabir bin Abdullah narrated, which Muslim collected, stated, The Prophet jg kept standing there (meaning at Arafat) until sunset, when the yeUow light had somewhat gone and the disc of the sun had disappeared. Then, the Prophet \$g made Usamah sit behind him, and in order to keep her under control, puUed the nose string of Al-Qaswa so hard, that its head touched the saddle. He gestured with his right hand and '*' Ahmad 4:261, Abu D&wud 2:486, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 3:633, An- Nasal 5:264, and Ibn Majah 2:1004. Abdur-Razzaq 5 :96 At-Jabari 4:173-174. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :519 Ibn Abi Hatim 2:517.

Al-Baqarah Cl75 - 200) (Part-2) said, "Proceed calmly people, calmly!" Whenever he happened to pass over an elevated tract of sand, he lightly loosened the nose string of his camel till she climbed up and this is how they reached Al-Muzdalifah. There, he led the Maghrib (Evening) and Isha (Night) prayers with one Adhan and two Iqamah (which announces the imminent start of the acts of the prayer) and did not glorify Allah in between them (i.e., he did not perform voluntary Rak'ah). Allah s Messenger jg then laid down till dawn and offered the Fajr (Dawn) prayer with Adhan and Iqamah, when the morning light was clear. He again mounted Al-Qaswa , and when he came to Al-Mash ar Al-Haram, he faced towards Qiblah, supplicated to Allah, glorifying Him and saying, La ilaha illalldh, and he continued standing until the daylight was very clear. He then went quickly before the sun rose. It is reported in the Two Sahihs that Usamah bin Zayd was asked, How was the Prophet s pace when he moved? He said, Slow, unless he found space, then he would go a little faster. 2' Al-Mash arAl-Haram Abdur-Razzaq reported that Ibn Umar said that all of Al- Muzdalifah is Al-Mash'ar Al-Haram.¹³ It was reported that Ibn Umar was asked about Allah s statement: i* at 4...remember Allah (by glorifying His praises, i.e., prayers and invocations) at the Mash ar-il-Haram. \$ He said, It is the Mount and the surrounding area. It was reported that Al-Mash ar Al-Haram is what is between the two Mounts (refer to the following Hadith), as Ibn Abbas, Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Mujahid, As-Suddi, Ar-Rabl bin Anas, Al- Hasan and Qatadah have stated. 5 Imam

Jr Ibn Kathir " jZ Z&yfi o* *T ^> j " "A// 0/ 'Arafat is a place of standing, and keep away from 'Uranah . All of Al-Muzdalifah is a place for standing, and keep away from the bottom of Muhassir. All of the areas of Makkah are a place for sacrifice, and all of the days of Tashreeq are days of sacrifice. Allah then said: 'O you who believe! Remember Allah (by invoking Allah for all good) as He has guided you.' This Ayah reminds Muslims of Allah's bounty on them that He has directed and taught them the rituals of Hajj according to the guidance of Prophet Ibrahim Al-Khalil. This is why Allah said: '...and verily, you were, before, of those who were astray.' It was said that this Ayah refers to the condition before the guidance or the Quran or the Messenger all of which are correct meanings. 4199. Then depart from the place whence all the people depart and ask Allah for His forgiveness. Truly, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most-Merciful. The Order to stand on Arafat and to depart from it 4 This Ayah contains Allah's order to those who stand at Arafat to also move on to Al-Muzdalifah, so that they remember Allah at Al-Mash'ar Al-Haram. Allah commands the Muslim to stand with the rest of the pilgrims at Arafat, unlike Quraysh who (before Islam) used to remain in the sanctuary, near Al-Muzdalifah, saying that they are the people of Allah's Town and Ahmad 4 :82

Al-Baqarali (175 - 200) (Part-2) the servants of His House. Al-Bukhari reported that A'ishah said, Quraysh and their allies, who used to be called Al-Mudhar, used to stay in Al-Muzdalifah while the rest of the Arabs would stand at Arafat. When Islam came, Allah commanded His Prophet ﷺ to stand at Arafat and then proceed from there. Hence Allah's statement: '...from the place whence all the people depart. This was also said by Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ata, Qatadah and As-Suddi and others. 131 Ibn Jarir chose this opinion and said that there is Ijma (a consensus among the scholars) for it. Imam Ahmad reported that Jubayr bin Mut'im said, My camel was lost and I went out in search of it on the day of Arafah, and I saw the Prophet ﷺ standing in Arafat. I said to myself, 'By Allah he is from the Hums. What has brought him here?' 14 This Hadith is also reported in the Sahih al-Bukhari. Al-Bukhari reported that Ibn Abbas said that depart mentioned in the Ayah refers to proceeding from Al-Muzdalifah to Mina to stone the pillars. Allah knows best. Asking Allah for His Forgiveness Allah said: '...and ask Allah for His forgiveness. Truly, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most-Merciful.' Allah frequently orders remembrance of Him after acts of worship are finished. Muslim reported that Allah's Messenger ﷺ used to ask Allah for His forgiveness thrice after the prayer. Literally, strictly religious, Quraysh were called so, as they used to say, We are the people of Allah, we do not go out of the sanctuary. Al-Bari 8 :35 At-Jabari 4:186-187. * Ahmad 4 :80 * Fath Al-Bari 3 :602, and Muslim 2 :894 [6] Fath Al-Bari 8 :35

is finished. 11 ' It is reported in the Two Sahih's that the Prophet ﷺ encouraged Tasbeeh (saying Subhan Allah, i.e., Glorified is Allah), Tahmud (saying Al-Hamdu Lillah, i.e., praise be to Allah) and Takbir (saying Allahu Akbar, i.e., Allah is the Most Great) thirty-three times each (after prayer). 2' Ibn Mardawayh collected the Hadith that Al-Bukhari reported from Shaddad bin Aws, who stated that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said: 'Whoever says: O Allah! You are my Lord, there is no deity worthy of worship except You. You have created me and I am Your servant. I am on Your covenant, as much as I can be, and awaiting Your promise. I seek refuge with You from the evil that I have committed. I admit Your favor on me and admit my faults. So forgive me, for none except You

forgives the sins.' Whoever said these words at night and died that same night will enter Paradise. Whoever said it during the day and died will enter Paradise .'''3 ' Furthermore, it is reported in the Two Sahths that 'Abdullah bin Amr said that Abu Bakr said, O Messenger of Allah! Teach me an invocation so that I may invoke (Allah) with it in my prayer. He told me to say: J oil MJ 4-jJili jk Mj \ys Uit Jj : ji" j^ll jJl JJUJ tloyy ji vAllahumma innt zalamtu nafsi zulman kathiran, wa la yaghfirudh-dhunuba ilia Anta faghfirli maghfiratan min 'indika, war-hamni innaka Antal-Ghafur-ur-Rahim (O Allah! I have done great injustice to myself and none except You forgives Muslim 1 :414. Al-Bari2 :378 and Muslim 1 :417. ' Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :100

sins, so please forgive me and be merciful to me as You are the Forgiver, the Merciful).^ There are many other Hadiths on this subject. -fffjif iii l_jji==oS l> O' >-<-U 0? Art?* ' i ^ '- J ClIK JjIj ;> JbJji f;jdii^ &S && 4 tsr. eg Q r *Mt 'j--^ ^ . So ivhen you have accomplished your Mandsik, remember Allah as you remember your forefathers or with far more remembrance. But of mankind there are some who say: "Our Lord! Give us (Your bounties) in this world!" and for such there will be no portion in the Hereafter.} 4202 . And of than there are some who say : "Our Lord! Give us in this world that which is good and in the Hereafter that which is good, and save usfrom the torment of the Fire!"} 4202 . For than there will be allotted a share for what they have earned. And Allah is swift at reckoning.} The Order for Remembrance of Allah and seeking Good in this Lifeand the Hereafteruponcompletingthe Rites otHajj Allah commands that He be remembered after the rituals are performed. 4ft=*X %\$} 4...as you ranember yourforefathers} Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn Abbas said, During the time of Jdhiliyyah, people used to stand during the {Hay) season, and one of them would say, My father used to feed (the poor), help others (end their disputes, with his money), pay the Diah (i.e., blood money), and so forth. The only Dhikr that they had was that they would remember the deeds of their fathers. Allah then revealed to Muhammad jg: *** Fath Al-Bari 13 :484 and Muslim 4 :2078

mentioned. Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn Abbas said, Some bedouins used to come to the standing area (Arafat) and supplicate saying, O Allah! Make it a rainy year, a fertile year and a year of good child bearing. They would not mention any of the affairs of the Hereafter. Thus, Allah revealed about them: 4^i Ji , \ ^ tjiU tij jjij jS ^* } }But of mankind there are some who say : "Our Lord! Give us (Your bounties) in this world!" and for such there will be no portion in the Hereafter. The believers who came after them used to say: 4jU!" v'ic cij iOur Lord! Give us in this world that which is good and in the Hereafter that which is good, and save us from the torment of the Fire!"} Next, Allah revealed: iFor them there will be allotted a share for what they have earned. And Allah is swift at reckoning.} Hence, Allah praised those who ask for the affairs of both this life and the Hereafter. He said: 4S^> 4And of them there are some who say : "Our Lord! Give us in this world that which is good and in the Hereafter that which is good, and save usfrom the torment of the Fire! } The supplication mentioned and praised in the Ayah includes all good aspects of this life and seeks refuge from all types of evil. The good of this life concerns every material request of well-being, spacious dwelling, pleasing mates, sufficient provision, beneficial knowledge, good profession or deeds, comfortable means of transportation and good praise, all of which the scholars of Tafsir have mentioned regarding this subject. All of these are but a part of the good that is sought in this life.

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2 Ad-Diyli: 5! 'fc jr^ If) (^!^ ui fdj "The days of Mina (Tashriq) are three. Those who hasten in two days then there is no sin in it, and those who delay (i.e., remain in Mind for a third day) then there is no sin in it. a Ibn Jarir reported that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah's Messenger jg said: ""l Ji'j pjd, jtji-H fd" lThe days of Tashriq are days of eating and remembering Allah. Ibn Jarir reported that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah's Messenger^ sent Abdullah bin Hudhafah to Mina proclaiming: " > js-i fd ";i\$ i .i* t yy^ " * * ' ' Do not fast these days (i.e., Tashriq days), for they are days of eating, drinking and remembering Allah the Exalted and Most Honored . 12 The Appointed Days Miqsam said that Ibn Abbas said that the Appointed Days are the days of Tashriq, four days: the day of the Sacrifice (10th of Dhul-Hijjah) and three days after that. This opinion was also reported of Ibn Umar, Ibn Az-Zubayr, Abu Musa, Ata , Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Malik, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Yahya bin Abu Kathir, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Az-Zuhri, Ar-Rabi bin Anas, Ad-Dahhak, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ata Al-Khurasani, Malik bin Anas, and others. * In addition, the apparent meaning of the following Ayah supports this opinion: 4But whosoever hastens to leave in hoo days, there is no sin on ^ Abu Dawud 2 :485 At-Tabari 4:211.Tabari 4:213. 141 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :547-549.

574 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir him and whosoever stays on, there is no sin on him.} So the Ayah hints to the three days after the day of Sacrifice. Allah's statement: -j '.it \f^=,%} iAnd remember Allah during the Appointed Days directs remembering Allah upon slaughtering the animals, after the prayers, and by Dhikr (supplication) in general. It also includes Takbir and remembering Allah while throwing the pebbles every day during the Tashriq days. A Hadith that Abu Dawud and several others collected states: 4ii /i jUJi ^ uTaiuaf around the House, Sa'f between As-Safd and Al- Marwah and throwing the pebbles were legislated so that Allah is remembered in Dhikr. When mentioning the first procession (refer to 2:199) and the second procession of the people upon the end of the Hajj season, when they start to return to their areas, after they had gathered during the rituals and at the standing places, Allah said, iand obey Allah (fear Him), and know that you will surely be gathered unto Him.} Similarly, Allah said: iAnd it is He Wlw has created you on the earth, and to Him you shall be gathered back.} (23:79) cr v 'j J~A-, JfjVi j iA-* dy 'j*_> m Abu Dawud 2 :447

, he is led by arrogance to (more) crime. So etough for him is Hell, and worst indeed is that place to rest!} 4207. And of tankind is he who would sell himself, seeking the pleasure of Allah. And Allah is full of kindness to (His) servants.} The Characteristics of the Hypocrites As-Suddi said that these Ayat were revealed about Al- Akhnas bin Shariq Ath-Thaqafi who came to Allah's Messenger jg and announced his Islam although his heart concealed otherwise. Ibn Abbas narrated that these Ayat were revealed about some of the hypocrites who criticized Khubayb and his companions who were killed during the Rajl incident. 12 ' Thereafter, Allah sent down His condemnation of the hypocrites and His praise for Khubayb and his companions: 4

Mujahid, Ar-Rabl bin Anas and several others, and it is correct. Ibn Jarir related that Al-Qurazi said that Nawf Al-Bikali, who used to read (previous Divine) Books said, I find the description of some members of this Ummah in the previously revealed Books of Allah: they (hypocrites) are people who use the religion to gain material benefit. Their tongues are sweeter than honey, but their hearts are more bitter than Sabir (a bitter plant, aloe). They show the people the appearance of sheep while their hearts hide the viciousness of wolves. Allah said, They dare challenge Me, but they are deceived by Me. I

swear by Myself that I will send a Fitnah (trial, calamity) on them that will make the wise man bewildered. I contemplated about these statements and found them in the Qur'an describing the hypocrites: *Atid of mankind there is he whose speech may please you (O Muhammad j&), in this worldly life, and he calls Allah to witness as to that which is in his heart,*[^] This statement by Al-Qurazi is Hasan Sahih. Allah said: *4 . . .and he calls Allah to witness as to that which is in his heart,*} This Ayah indicates that such people pretend to be Muslims, but defy Allah by the disbelief and hypocrisy that their hearts conceal. Similarly Allah said: *Si J.Q1 Si iThey may hide (their crimes) from men, but they cannot hide (them)from Allah.*} (4:108) This Tafsir was reported from Ibn Abbas * by Ibn Ishaq. It was also said that the Ayah means that when such people announce their Islam, they swear by Allah that what is in their hearts is the same of what their tongues are Tabari 4:232. Tabari 4:230.

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) pronouncing. This is also a correct meaning for the Ayah that was chosen by Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. It is also the choice of Ibn Jarir who related it to Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid. Allah knows best. Allah said: *jit iYet he is the most Aladd of the opponents.*} (2:204) The Ayah used the word Aladd here, which literally means wicked (here it means quarrelsome). A variation of the word Ludda was also used in another Ayah: *iSo that you (Muhammad) warn with it (the Qur'an) a Ludda people.*} (19:97) Hence, a hypocrite lies, alters the truth when he quarrels and does not care for the truth. Rather, he deviates from the truth, deceives and becomes most quarrelsome. It is reported in Sahih that Allah's Messenger said: *lilj t jjj- juU- lij- iCjYS tAi- IS) jSILJL SSL "77ie signs of a hypocrite are three : Whenever he speaks, he tells a lie. Whenever he promises, he always breaks it (his promise). If you have a dispute with him, he is most quarrelsome.** Imam Bukhari reported that A'ishah narrated that the Prophet said: *jJ'ifl j&l J _ra.ijf j)8 The most hated person to Allah is he who is Aladd and Khasim (meaning most quarrelsome).** Allah then said: At-Tabari 4 :233 Al-Bari 1:111. Al-B&ri 8:36.

AAAnd when he turns away (from you O Muhammad), he struggles in the land to make mischief therein and to destroy the crops and the cattle, and Allah likes not mischief. ^ This Ayah indicates that such persons are deviant in the tongue, evil in the deeds, their words are fabricated, their belief is wicked and their works are immoral. The Ayah used the (Arabic word) Sa'a (literally. Tries or intends). This word was also used to describe Pharaoh: *if# a" pijj L"1 JUi rr 4 - ^A 4 A* Then he turned his back, Yas'a (striving hard against Allah) Then he gathered Ohs people) and cried aloud saying, *T am your lord, most high.* So Allah, seized him with a punishing example for his last and first transgression. Verily, in this is an instructive admonition for whosoever Jears Allah. (79:22-26) [Sa'a was also used in the Ayah]: *4^ S' J' ot 'H you who believe (Muslims)! When the call is proclaimed for the Salah (prayer) on the day of Friday (Jumu'ah prayer), As'aiu come to the remembrance of Allah.*} (62:9) This Ayah means, (when the call to the Friday prayer is announced) intend and then proceed to attend the Friday prayer. We should mention that hastening to the mosque is condemned by the Sunnah (as this is another meaning for the word Sa'a): *Ujjlj jUib UjJt ISLsji iii" i* When you come to attend the prayer, do not come in a Sa't (haste). Rather, come to it while walking at ease and in peace (or grace). |1 The hypocrite has no motive in this life but to cause mischief and to destroy the crops and the offspring, including what the animals produce and what the people depend on for their livelihood. Mujahid said, If the hypocrite strives for mischief m Muslim 1 :420

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) in the land, Allah prevents the rain from falling and thus the crops and the offspring perish. The Ayah continues: it 44 v &f} i...and Allah likes not mischief. that is, Allah does not like those who possess these characteristics, or those who act like this. Rejecting Advice is Characteristic of the Hypocrites Allah said: iAnd when it is said to him, "Fear Allah", he is led by arrogance to (more) crime.} This Ayah indicates that when the hypocrite, who deviates in his speech and deeds, is advised and commanded to fear Allah, refrain from his evil deeds and adhere to the truth, he refuses and becomes angry and outraged, as he is used to doing evil. This Ayah is similar to what Allah said: *" *. , yrj 4 it &T # <& iAnd when Our clear verses are recited to them, you will notice a denial on the faces of the disbelievers! They are nearly ready to attack with violence those who recite Our verses to them. Say: "Shall I tell you of something worse than that? The Fire (of Hell) which Allah has promised to those who disbelieved, and it is indeed that destination!} (22:72) This is why in this Ayah, Allah said: JliJ enough for him is Hell, and worst indeed is that place to rest} meaning, the Fire is enough punishment for the hypocrite. The Sincere Believer prefers pleasing Allah Allah said:

\$And of mankind is he who would sell himself, seeking the pleasure of Allah.} After Allah described the evil characteristics of the hypocrites, He mentioned the good qualities of the believers. Allah said: 2 Jy-ii iAnd of mankind is he who would sell himself, seeking the pleasure of Allah.} Ibn Abbas, Anas, Said bin Musayyib, Abu Uthman An-Nahdi, Ikrimah and several other scholars said that this Ayah was revealed about Suhayb bin Sinan Ar-Rumi. When Suhayb became a Muslim in Makkah and intended to migrate (to Al-Madinah), the people (Quraysh) prevented him from migrating with his money. They said that if he forfeits his property, he is free to migrate. He abandoned his money and preferred to migrate, and Allah revealed this Ayah about him. Umar bin al-Khattab and several other Companions met Suhayb close to the outskirts of Al-Madinah at Al-Harrah (flat lands with black stones). They said to him, The trade has indeed been successful. He answered them, You too, may Allah never allow your trade to fail. What is the matter? Umar told him that Allah has revealed this Ayah (2:207) about him. It was also reported that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said, The trade has been successful, O Suhayb! 1 ^

The meaning of the Ayah (2:207) includes every Mujahid in the way of Allah. Allah said in another Ayah: a feat & ' & 33 \ u*- 4 Verily, Allah has purchased of the believers their lives and their properties for (the price) that theirs shall be the Paradise. They fight in Allah's cause, so they kill (others) and are killed. It is a promise in truth which is binding on Him in the Tawrah and the Injil and the Qur'an . And who is truer to his covenant in At-Tabari 4 :248

than Allah? Then rejoice in the bargain which you have concluded. That is the supreme success.} (9:1 1 1) When Hisham bin Amr penetrated the lines of the enemy, some people criticized him. Umar bin al-Khattab and Abu Hurayrah refuted them and recited this Ayah: dy-ii CT ojdLf CZ?j} iAnd of mankind is he who would sell himself, seeking the pleasure of Allah .And Allah is full of kindness to (His) servants.} ft if \J4l 4 Jjfoi l s; {&>} U? sS SJ SiS 4208. O you who believe! Enter Islam perfectly, and follow not the footsteps of Shaytan (Satan). Verily, he is to you a plain enemy.} 4209. Then if you slide back after the clear signs (Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, and this Qur'an and Islam) have come to you, then know that Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise}. Entering Islam in its Entirety is obligated Allah commands His servants who believe in Him and have faith in His Messenger to implement all of Islam's legislation and law, to adhere to all of its commandments, as much as they can, and to refrain from all of its prohibitions. Al-

Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said, and also Mujahid, Tawtis, Ad- Dahhak, Ikrimah, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd said that Allah's statement: 4j-3 j ijuofEnter Silm} means Islam.¹¹¹ Allah's statement: 4i_ "\ =} 4 . . . perfectly} means, in its entirety. This is the Tafsir of Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Abu Al- Aliyah, Ikrimah, Ar-RabT bin Anas, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak.¹² At-Jabari 4 : 252 , Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :584-585 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :586-588.

Al-Bagarah (201 - 224) (Part-2 4 Verily, he is to you an open enemy. Allah said: U & [/i -J 4Then ifyou slide back after the clear signs have come to you} meaning, if you deviate from the Truth after clear proofs have been established against you, 4-. then know that Allah is All-Mighty} in His punishment, and no one can escape His vengeance or defeat Him. 4All-Wise} in His decisions, actions and rulings. Hence Abu Al- Aliyah, Qatadah and Ar-RabT bin Anas said, He is Mighty in His vengeance, Wise in His decision. JI> (faij J* jit ij "iif J 4210. Do they then wait for anything other than that Allah should come to them over the shadows of the clouds and the angels? (Then) the case would be already judged. And to Allah return all matters (for decision).} Do not delay embracing the Faith 4D0 they then wait for anything other than that Allah should come to them over the shadows of the clouds and the angels?) on the Day of Resurrection to judge the early and the latter creations. Allah shall then reward each according to his or her deeds; and whoever does good shall see it, and whoever does evil shall see it. This is why Allah said: 4&\& fS& & } 4(Then) the case would be already judged. And to Allah return all matters (for decision).} *** Ibn Abi yatim 2 :591

584 Tafstr IbtT Kathir mu" rr mm J J^4*..^* > \$' ^ Jj "Zj ili~?(3 " j Cj*L>-L" _Xj*jy* .Jjt ijJT jUS*vOo a "" _y,"_Si_ji \ ^ Similarly, Allah said: & JoVl Ji t' H %> dS Jfcif; J& ;% ; fc *; / -V t <" M " ty** " tiv jOfI i \ i cjl^s -^ ** l -" ">-^#.UU ^|"A l Aii^j i j\^ aJs L*j |\} -j: *: L^" - ^j SjKs3"S6yi^, ' ? \i' \ > -; -i- ' <-? *. 4jjlj^i ,4_ "z \ ^y_uj > u_> J"-yyjj \$0 #4\$vsX^ :ii" ;n *: /-v-1-V-^"" y^s.^ Z1 * # ^ "Z . J Z^, {ftp> . Afz^j 4"O^i j Crj 5&^ f . z*z jV- 4xNay! When the earth is ground to powder. And your Lord comes with the angels in rows. And Hell will be brought near that Day. On that Day will man remember, but how will that remembrance (then) avail him?) (89:21-23) and: 3# %) 3& \$& '&) *t 4Do they then wait for anything other than that the angels should come to them, or that your Lord (Allah) should come, or that some of the signs of your Lord should come (i.e., portents of the Hour, e.g., rising of the sun from the west!) (6:158) Abu Jafar Razi reported that Abu Al- Aliyah narrated that: 12'j oj ij "lit jt4 Jf, ol "Sfy oj; \$j,) iDo they then wait for anything other than that Allah should come to them over the shadows of the clouds and the angels?) means, the angels will descend on the shadows of clouds, while Allah comes as He wills.' ' Some of the reciters read it, m At-Jabari 4 :264

Do they then wait for anything other than that Allah should come to them and also the angels over the shadows of the clouds. This is similar to Allah's other statement: <: "& \$\$\$2 4And (remember) the Day when the heaven shall be rent asunder with clouds, and the angels will be sent down, with a grand descending.> (25:25) ill' oji it t* Si JrJl Lr'J Cji -Hre'* di'Zr\ Xjf. ijSJI 05 Oj LijH L/jj) jf Ju J..*.. / v x >> / ^ . -'if"tf -"/ *> i iy* (3jjJ, AUy ^_y > 4211. Ask the Children of Israel how many clear Ayat (proofs, evidences, verses, lessons, signs, revelations, etc.) We gave them. And whoever changes Allah's favor after it has come to him, [e.g., renounces the religion of Allah (Islam) and accepts Kufr (disbelief)] then surely, Allah is severe in punishment 4212. Beautified is the life of this world for those who disbelieve, and they mock at those who believe. But those who have Taqwa, will be above them on the

Day of Resurrection. And Allah gives (of His bounty, blessings, favors, and honors on the Day of Resurrection) to whom He wills without limit. The Punishment for changing Allah's Favor and mocking the Believers Allah mentioned that the Children of Israel, were witnesses to many clear signs that attest to the truth of Moses regarding what he was sent with for them. They witnessed his hand (when it became lit with light), his parting the sea, his striking the rock (and water flowed from the rock), the clouds that shaded them during the intense heat, the manna and the quails, and so forth. These signs attested to the existence of the Creator and the truth of Moses by whose hand these signs appeared. Yet, so many among them changed Allah's favor, by preferring disbelief to faith and by ignoring Allah's favors,

JL.X^* iii jli 4j"Xk> -* Jju j* fIS Xmw Jxj &j} 4And whoever changes Allah's favor after it had come to him, then surely, Allah is severe in punishment. Similarly, Allah said about the disbelievers of Quraysh: -j'1 1 \$ iddo jilJ j) > jjj C iHave you not seen those who have changed the blessings of Allah into disbelief, and caused their people to dwell in the house of destruction? Hell, in which they will burn, - and what an evil place to settle in!} (14:28, 29) Then Allah states that He has made the life of this world beautiful for the disbelievers who are satisfied with it, who collect wealth, but refrain from spending it on what they have been commanded, which could earn them Allah's pleasure. Instead, they ridicule the believers who ignore this life and who spend whatever they earn on what pleases their Lord. The believers spend seeking Allah's Face, and this is why they have gained the ultimate happiness and the best share on the Day of the Return. Therefore, they will be exalted above the disbelievers at the Gathering Place, when they are gathered, during the resurrection and in their final destination. The believers will reside in the highest grades in the utmost highs, while the disbelievers will reside in the lowest of lows (in the Fire). This is why Allah said: iAnd Allah gives to whom He wills without limit.} This Ayah indicates that Allah gives sustenance to whomever He wills of His servants without count or limit in this and the Hereafter. A Hadith has stated (that Allah said): O son of Adam! Spend (in Allah's cause) and 1 (Alldlt) will spend on i/om.s111 I 1 * Al-Humaydi 2 :459

The Prophet jg said: w*i) J.yl\& 'jXc% j*. ji!u "0 Bilal! Spend and do not fear deprivation from the Owner of the Throne ."11 Allah said: J > > .*> />< J43 jcP- Oj 3 4...and whatsoever you spend of anything (in Allah's cause), He will replace it.} (34:39) In addition, it is reported in the Sahih (that the Prophet jg said): (>-(11' : LLa.i"-l ^ ovj "UJJI ^ j'Jyj -LLo jit "UL ISLOi ui :^ML .lit "Every day two angels come down from heavens and one of them says, 'O Allah! Compensate every person who spends in Your cause,' and the other (angel) says, 'O Allah! Destroy every miser .'"|21 Also in the Sahih: C- : l l"j iC-itti oisi U Ml jJUU vlil (JLa j^j vlilJi ic o~s. .'o' Uj ic-lLli "Tlie son of Adam says, My money, my money!" Yet, what is your money except that which you eat and use up, wear and tear, and spend in charity and thus keep (in your record). Other than that, it will go away and will be left for the people (the inheritors) In addition, Imam Ahmad reported that the Prophet jg said: **J L^jj < aj Jli M JU_j t jIS M fjA jIS DjJlt aThe Dunya (life of this world) is the residence of those who have no residence, the wealth of those who have no wealth, and it is harvested by those who have no sense of reason. *14] AMabarani 10:192. ,2) Fath Al-Bari 3 :357 4 :2273 ,41 Ahmad 6:71.

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) Allah's statement: ^Mankind was one community} means; "They all had the guidance. Then: 4)1 i^vi They disputed and Allah sent Prophets. The first to be sent was Nuh."

Abdur-Razzaq reported that Abu Hurayrah commented on: 44% " I 2JQ iThen Allah by His leave guided those who believed to the truth of that wherein they differed.} saying that the Prophet jg said: j*' J"j Vyi-i Jjl O 5 \y> >.\ IXJ 4)1 UJlfi oU-j 0 ; ULi Ijji li*j u lii iij 4)1 Ulo^i o ^jil tJL^i n&u&j ji joj; "We are f/ie /asf (nation), but the first (foremost) on the Day of Resurrection We are thefirst people to enter Paradise, although they (Jews and Christians) have been given the Book before us and we after them. Allah has guided us to the truth wherever they disputed over it. This is the day (Friday) that they disputed about, Allah guided us to it. So, the peoplefollow us, as tomorrow is for the Jews and the day after is for the Christians. "|2) Ibn Wahb related that Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that his father said about the Ayah: ,>)' ce *j ijUi-t Q i "I* oji' 4)t iThen Allah by His leave guided those who believed to the truth of that wherein they differed.} They disputed about the day of Congregation (Friday). The l1 ' Abdur-Razzaq 1 :82. Abdur-Razzaq 1 :82

Jews made it Saturday while the Christians chose Sunday. Allah guided the Ummah of Muhammad jg to Friday. They also disputed about the true Qiblah. The Christians faced the east while the Jews faced Bayt Al-Maqdis. Allah guided the Ummah ofMuhammad sg to the true Qiblah (Ka bah in Makkah). They also disputed about the prayer, as some ofthem bow down, but do not prostrate, while others prostrate, but do not bow down. Some of them pray while talking and some while walking. Allah guided the Ummah of Muhammad jg to the truth. They also disputed about the fast; some of them fast during a part of the day, while others fast from certain types of foods. Allah guided the Ummah ofMuhammad sg to the truth. They also disputed about Ibrahim. The Jews said, He was a Jew, while the Christians considered him Christian. Allah has made him a Haniyfan Musliman. Allah has guided the Ummah of Muhammad sg to the truth. They also disputed about Isa. The Jews rejected him and accused his mother of a grave sin, while the Christians made him a god and the son of God. Allah made him by His Word and a spirit from (those He created) Him. Allah guided the Ummah ofMuhammad jg to the truth. Allah then said: 44% by His leave} meaning, By His knowledge of them and by what He has directed and guided them to, according to Ibn Jarir.,2 ' Also: \$And Allah guides whom He wills} means from among His creation. (Allah said:) fa .to the straight way} meaning, He commands the decision and the clear proof. Al-Bukhari and Muslim reported that A isha narrated that when Allah s Messenger jg used to wake up at night to pray, he would say: m At-Tabari 4:284.Tabari 4 :286

^ ui4 ' * l Ar4^**i "-> l"j italic- ^ ("^* C"JI lojljJLSl} "p.; ..4 "UJ^ t5^ kiU[nilta^ J"Jl "0 Af/d/i, f/ie Lord of (angels) JibrH, Mika'U and lsrdfil, Creator of the heavens and earth and Knower of the seen and the unseen. You judge between Your servants regarding wlwt they have disputed in, so guide me to what have been the subject ofdispute of the truth by Your leave. Indeed, You guide whom You will to the straight path, u A Du a reads: tAtaC Ji UjIJ liljjlj 1 15^- Ujl "uujj&h d^ij , di. u_ ii O Allah! Show us the truth as truth, and bestow adherence to it on us. Show us the evil as evil, and make us stay awayfrom it, and do not confuse us regarding the reality ofevil so that we will not be led astray by it, and make us leaders far the believers .d ' \$2 jKtf" ! U\$& tSc tjStJG J ft iffCtj\$ 'J* a sr^^^ iiscu& ,214. Or think you that you will enter Paradise without such (trials) as came to those who passed away before you? They were afflicted with severe poverty and ailments and were so shaken that even the Messenger and those who believed along with him said, "When (will come) the help of Allah? Yes! Certainly, the help ofAllah is near!} Victory onlycomes after succeeding in the Trials Allah said: 4'i^ ijSiJc jt ?.:jL 40r think you that you will enter Paradise} ^ Muslim 1 :534 121 TakhrijAl-Ihya 3:1418.

l; js 4 ...without such (trials) as came to those who passed away before you? They were afflicted with severe poverty and ailments} meaning, illnesses, pain, disasters and hardships. Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn Abbas, Abu Al- Aliyah, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Murrah Al-Hamdani, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-RabT, As- Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan said that iAl-Ba'sd'} means poverty.' Ibn Abbas said that \$...and Ad-Darra'} means ailments. 4and were so shaken} for fear of the enemy, and were tested, and put to a tremendous trial. An authentic Hadith narrated that Khabbab bin Al-Aratt said, We said, O Messenger of Allah! Why do you not invoke Allah to support us? Why do you not supplicate to Allah for us? He said: 4_-l3 jIS jIS j* jI , * x (' ^ __ , ~ 1 IT , ..l C- \ \ ; La .Li l la l* aL LjLajJ lAUj .1 1/ . ji- JIjI The saw would be placed on the middle of the head of one of those who were before you (believers) and he would be sawn until his feet, and he would be combed with iron combs between his skin and bones, yet that would not make him change his religion .

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) iBij Allah! This matter (religion) will spread (or expand) by Allah until the traveler leaves San'a' to Hadramawt (both in Yemen, but at a great distance from each other) fearing only Allah and then the wolf for the sake of his sheep. You are just a hasty people . i 1 And Allah said: Oi *i"& Jaj tSX i 3 3 i H\) 4' t (j&tj iyirf ill! jJyii iAlif-Ldm-Mvn . Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested? And We indeed tested those who were before than. And Allah will certainly make (it) known (the truth of) those who are true, and iwill certainly make (it) known (the falsehood of) those who are liars.) (29:1-3) The Companions experienced tremendous trials during the battle of Al-Ahzab (the Confederates). Allah said: % pi& S6 ps * fit h) j>; \$:":<&. \$ 4(2 & sjisj tilAy tay UoV (try1* ? ttjb 4W/ie?i they came upon you from above you and from below you, and when the eyes grew wild and the hearts reached to the throats, and you were harboring doubts about Allah. There, the believers were tried and shaken with a mighty shaking. And whai the hypocrites and those in whose hearts is a disease (of doubts) said: "Allah and His Messenger promised us nothing but delusion!") (33:10-12) When Heraclius asked Abu Sufyan, Did you fight him (Prophet Muhammad)? He said, Yes. Heraclius said, What was the outcome of warfare between you? Abu Sufyan said, Sometimes we lose and sometimes he loses. He said, Such is the case with Prophets, they are tested, but the final victory is theirs. ,2! Allah s statement: Al-Bari 6:716. Al-Bari9:25.

594 Tafsir Ibtt Kathtr j2> i...without (such) (trials) as came to those who passed away before you} meaning, their way of life. Similarly, Allah said: iThen We destroyed men stronger (in power) than these - and the example of the ancients has passed away (before them)} (43:8) and: 4\$ jy*& '>*' jMj Sf-f jj* ifo ^ . . .were so shaken that even the Messenger and those who believed along with him said, "When (will come) the help of Allah."} They pleaded (to Allah) for victory against their enemies and invoked Him for aid and deliverance from their hardships and trials. Allah said: 4*r?j\$ 61 Vty 4Yes! Certainly, the help of Allah is near!} Allah said: iVerily, along with every hardship is relief. Verily, along with every hardship is relief.} (94:5, 6) So just as there is hardship, its equal of relief will soon arrive. This is why Allah said: r}& ol vty 4Yes! Certainly, the help of Allah is near!} 4 ii 6^" _/"- ert jL"55 i215. They ask you (O Muhammad jg) what they should spend. Say: "Whatever you spend of good must be for parents and kindred and orphans and Al-Masakin (the poor) and the wayfarer, and whatever you do of good deeds, truly, Allah

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) rJj rt am# ^ knows it well jajJcPj[_3' o^fv^s-L-;c ViS*- ^ '->-4^-J 'j^ *j&\ Zj^te^jzzLfZcj &\ \$ i-sr Who deserves the Nafaqah (Spending or Charity) Muqatil bin Hayyan said that this Ayah was revealed about the voluntary charity. 111 The Ayah means, They ask you (O Muhammad \$yg) how they should spend, as Ibn Abbas and Mujahid have stated. So, Allah explained it for them, saying: S'A'Ab* j& IA, b 5)j o&^b t&f) otj/V'j ii& iSay: "Whatever you spend of good must be for parents and kindred and orphans and Al-Masakin and the wayfarer,"} meaning, spend it on these categories or areas. Similarly, a Hadith states (that those who deserve one s generosity the most, Eire): ailuil h&\ J iiu'ij itiiJ brij vluf "Your mother, father, sister, brother, the closest and then the farthest (relatives) .",2i Maymun bin Mihran once recited this Ayah (2:215) and commented, These are the areas of spending. Allah did not mention among them the drums, pipe, wooden pictures, or the 111 Ibn AbiHatim 2:619. l2] Al-Hakim 3:611.

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) required to march forth, then march forth .a111 Allah s statement: 4...though you dislike it} means, Fighting is difficult and heavy on your hearts. Indeed, fighting is as the Ayah describes it, as it includes being killed, wounded, striving against the enemies and enduring the hardship of travel. Allah then said: !#5 J &*>} 4 . .and it may be that you dislike a thing which is good for you meaning, fighting is followed by victory, dominance over the enemy, taking over their lands, money and offspring. Allah continues: 4 and that you like a thing which is badfor you .} This Ayah is general in meaning. Hence, one might covet something, yet in reality it is not good or beneficial for him, such as refraining from joining the Jihad, for it might lead to the enemy taking over the land and the government. Then, Allah said: X p 'if# 4Alldh knows, but you do not know.} meaning, He has better knowledge than you ofhow things will turn out to be in the end, and of what benefits you in this earthly life and the Hereafter. Hence, obey Him and adhere to His commands, so that you may acquire the true guidance. * if u* JLij jS JWSi jio Jla pp x; jiif S, if ie iij \$ r Pi> & >*' / V * // \ , * jlllf iLijlj } ^% Qif 4 ^ liljdjl if 4 ijffl Sr'jFj \pXi olAl-Bari4:56.

598 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4 .N\,j ?;) Jji* "Ji'j "UI - ~-j 4217. They ask you concerning fighting in the Sacred Months. Say, "Fighting therein is a great (transgression) but a greater (transgression) with Allah is to prevent mankindfrom following the way ofAllah, to disbelieve in Him, to prevent access to Al- Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah), and to drive out its inhabitants, and Al-Fitnah is worse than killing." And they will never cease fighting you until they turn you back from your religion (Islamic Monotheism) if they can. And whosoever ofyou turns back from his religion and dies as a disbeliever, then his deeds will be lost in this life and in the Hereafter, and they will be the dwellers of the Fire. They will abide therein forever.} 4218. Verily, those who have believed, and those who have emigrated (for Allah's religion) and have striven hard in the way of Allah, all these hope for Allah s mercy. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most-Merciful.} The Nahhlah Military Maneuvers, and the Ruling on Fighting during the SacredMonths Ibn Abu Hatim reported that Jundub bin Abdullah said: Allah s Messenger jg assembled a group of men under the command ofAbu Ubaydah bin Jarrah. When he was about to march, he started crying for the thought of missing Allah s Messenger j . Consequently, the Messenger jg relieved Abu Ubaydah from command, appointed Abdullah bin Jahsh instead, gave him some written instructions and commanded him not to read the instructions until he reached such and such area. He also said to Abdullah: "Do not compel any of your men to continue marching with you thereafter . When Abdullah read the instructions, he recited Istitjd [saying, Trulyl to Allah we belong and truly, to Him we shall

return ; and refer to (2:156)] and said, I hear and obey Allah and His Messenger. He then told his companions the story and read the instructions to them, and two men went back while the rest remained. Soon after, they found Ibn Hadrami

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) (one of the disbelievers of Quraysh) and killed him not knowing that that day was in Rajab or Jumadi (where Rajab is the Sacred Month). The polytheists said to the Muslims, You have committed murder in the Sacred Month. Allah then revealed: i~2, 3vSi ji J15 iThey ask you concerning fighting in the Sacred Months. Say, "Fighting therein is a great (transgression)..."^ Abdul-Malik bin Hisham, who compiled the Sirah (life story of the Prophet j), related that Ziyad bin Abdullah Bakka i said that Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar Al-Madani wrote in his book on the Sirah, Allah s Messenger jg sent Abdullah bin Jahsh bin Riyab Al-Asadi in Rajab, after he (the Prophet jg) came back from the first battle of Badr. The Prophet sent eight people with him, all from among the Muhajirun and none from the Ansar. He also gave him some written instructions and ordered him not to read them until he marched for two days. Abdullah should then read the instructions and march to implement them, but should not force any of those who were with him to accompany him. The companions of Abdullah bin Jahsh were all from the Muhajirun, from the tribe of Banu Abd Shams bin Abd Manaf, there was Abu Hudhayfah bin TJtbah bin Rabi'ah bin Abd Shams bin Abd Manaf. From their allies, there was Abdullah bin Jahsh, who was the commander of the army unit, and TJkkashah bin Mihsan from the tribe of Banu Asad bin Khuzaymah. From the tribe of Banu Nawfal bin Abd Manaf, there was TJtbah bin Ghazwan bin Jabir, one of their allies. From the tribe of Banu Zuhrah bin Kilab, there was Sa d bin Abu Waqqas. From Banu KaTa, there were their allies: Adi bin Amr bin Ar-RabPah not from the tribe of Ibn Wa il; Wfiqid bin Abdullah bin Abd Manaf bin Ann bin Thalabah bin Yarbu' from Banu Tamlm; and Khalid bin Bukair from the tribe of Banu Sa d bin Layth, Suhayl bin Bayda from Banu Al-Harith bin Fihri was also among them. When Abdullah bin Jahsh marched for two days, he opened and read the I 1 * Ibn Abi H tim 2 :628.

600 Tafsir Ibtisami Kathir (Prophet s) instructions, When you read these instructions, march until you set camp at Nakhlah between Makkah and At-Ta'if. There, watch the movements of the caravan of Quraysh and collect news about them for us. When Abdullah bin Jahsh read the document, he said, I hear and obey. He then said to his companions, Allah s Messenger % has commanded me to march forth to Nakhlah to watch the movements of the caravan of Quraysh and to inform him about their news. He has prohibited me from forcing any of you (to go with me). So, those who seek martyrdom, they should march with me. Those who dislike the idea of martyrdom, let them turn back. Surely, I will implement the command of Allah s Messenger s&. He and his companions continued without any of them turning back. Abdullah entered the Hijaz area (western Arabia) until he reached an area called Buhran, close to Furu'. There, Sa d bin Abu Waqqas and Utbah bin Ghazwan lost the camel that they were riding in turns, and they went back to search for it while Abdullah bin Jahsh and the rest of his companions continued until they reached Nakhlah. Then, a caravan belonging to the Quraysh passed by carrying raisins, food stuff and some trade items for the Quraysh. Amr bin Hadrami, whose name was Abdullah bin Abbas, was in the caravan, as well as Uthman bin Abdullah bin Al-Mughirah and his brother Nawfal bin Abdullah from the tribe of Makhzum, and Al-Hakam bin Kaysan, a freed slave of Hisham bin Al-Mughirah. When they saw the Companions they were frightened, but when they saw Ukkashah bin Mihsan their fears subsided, since his head was shaved. They said, These people seek the Umrah, so

there is no need to fear them. The Companions conferred among themselves. That day was the last day in the (sacred) month of Rajab. They said to each other, By Allah! If you let them pass, they will soon enter the Sacred Area and take refuge in it from you. If you kill them, you will kill them during the Sacred Month. They at first hesitated and did not like to attack them. They then began encouraging themselves and decided to kill whomever they could among the disbelievers and to confiscate whatever they had. Hence, Waqid bin Abdullah At-Tamimi shot an arrow at Amr bin Al-Hadrami and killed him. Uthman bin Abdullah

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) and Al-Hakam bin Kaysan gave themselves up, while Nawfal bin Abdullah was able to outrun them in flight. Later on, Abdullah bin Jahsh and his companions went back to Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) in Al-Madinah with the caravan and the two prisoners. Ibn Ishaq went on: I was told that some members of the family of Abdullah bin Jahsh said that Abdullah said to his companions: Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) will have one-fifth of what we have confiscated. This occurred before Allah required one-fifth for His Messenger from the war booty. So, Abdullah designated one-fifth of the caravan for Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) and divided the rest among his companions. Ibn Ishaq also stated that at first, when the Sariyah came back to Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) he said to them: *Jill ja' Li J* have not commanded you to conduct warfare during the Sacred Month. He left the caravan and the two prisoners alone and did not take any share of the war booty. When Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) did that, the soldiers from the attack were concerned and felt that they were destroyed, and their Muslim brethren criticized them for what they did. The Quraysh said that Muhammad (ﷺ) and his Companions violated the sanctity of the Sacred Month and shed blood, confiscated property and took prisoners during it. Those who refuted them among the Muslims who remained in Makkah replied that the Muslims had done that during the month of Shalsan (which is not a sacred month). Meanwhile, the Jews were pleased about what happened to Allah's Messenger (ﷺ). They said, Amr bin Hadrami was killed by Waqid bin Abdullah: 'Amr, means the war has started, Hadrami means the war has come, as for Waqid (bin Abdullah): the war has raged (using some of the literal meanings of these names to support their fortune-telling!). But, Allah made all that turn against them. The people continued talking about this matter, then Allah revealed to His Messenger (ﷺ): *ip\ tejM ^ c!&&*

iThey ask you concerning fighting in the Sacred Months. Say, "Fighting therein is a great (transgression) but a greater (transgression) with Allah is to prevent mankind from following the way of Allah, to disbelieve in Him, to prevent access to Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah), and to drive out its inhabitants, and Al-Fitnah is worse than killing. This Ayah means, If you had killed during the Sacred Month, they {disbelievers of Quraysh} have hindered you from the path of Allah and disbelieved in it. They also prevented you from entering the Sacred Mosque, and expelled you from it, while you are its people, 4 ...a greater (transgression) with Allah} than killing whom you killed among them. Also: 4...and Al-Fitnah is worse than killing .} means, trying to force the Muslims to revert from their religion and re-embrace Kufr after they had believed, is worse with Allah than killing. Allah said: 4And they will never cease fighting you until they turn you back from your religion (Islamic Monotheism) if they can.} So, they will go on fighting you with unrelenting viciousness. Ibn Ishaq went on: When the Qur'an touched this subject and Allah brought relief to the Muslims instead of the sadness that had befallen them, Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) took possession of the caravan and the two prisoners. The Quraysh offered to ransom the two prisoners, Uthman bin Abdullah and Hakam bin Kaysan. Allah's

Messenger jg said: mt'i' I - "l* * ' . ' * " i- tCvl JI Ne will not accept your ransom until our two companions return safely . meaning Sa d bin Abu Waqqas and TJtbah bin Ghazwan, For we fear for their safety with you. If you kill them, we will kill your people. Later on, Sa d and TJtbah returned safely and

i&nu" ro tSatgu v ^i^r%Qli' Cr?-i o\Jjj- 34\$p^^sfp^lS^Uk ^jXj^LSj | | t j y f j J f ~ g " ^ \ i U 3 \ j l \ i j s 1 _ J ^ \ , j c j | i j - g i ^ y > 3 J & t y y > & p f \$ p Z . \ \$ \ z & y & i ^ i r j L t * j s ^ _) 1 i j S ^ o e . * ^ j | |) * !) > < > U J \ f f o ~ ~ a i * j _ p C S t A l l a h s Messenger jg accepted the Quraysh s ransom for their prisoners. As for Al-Hakam bin Kaysan, he became Muslim and his Islam strengthened. He remained with Allah s Messenger jg until he was martyred during the incident at Bir Ma Onah (when the Prophet jg sent seventy Companions to Najd to teach them Islam, but Banu Sulaim killed them all except two). As for Uthman bin Abdullah, he went back to Makkah and died there as a disbeliever. Ibn Ishaq went on: When Abdullah bin Jahsh and his companions were relieved from their depressing thoughts after the Qur an was revealed about this subject, they sought the reward of the fighters (in Allah s way). They said, O Messenger of Allah! We wish that this incident be considered a battle for us, so that we gain the rewards of the Mujahidin. Then, Allah revealed: ^^ S j 4 \&1 l r. & j y 4 Verily, those who have believed, and those who have emigrated (for Allah's religion) and have striven hard in the way of Allah, all these hope for Allah s mercy. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.}

604 Tafsir Ibt Kathir Hence, Allah has greatly elevated their hopes of gaining what they had wished for. ssM Pi 3 P < Ji 5 "iC v JM {pi js Sss ^ gif 40oi ^U3 sSf s" 'if its& p3f Oi jLT^% pJ4 jij \$ 4219. They ask you (O Muhammad jg) concerning alcoholic drink and gambling. Say: "In them is a great sin, and (some) benefits far men, but the sin of them is greater than their benefit." And they ask you what they ought to spend. Say: "That which is (spare) beyond your needs." Thus Allah makes clear to you His Laws in order that you may give thought. 4220. In (to) this worldly life and in the Hereafter. And they ask you concerning orphans. Say: "The best thing is to work honestly in their property, and if you mix your affairs with theirs, then they are your brothers. And Allah knows (the one) who means mischief (e.g., to swallow their property) from (the one) who means good (e.g., to save their property). And if Allah had wished, He could have put you into difficulties. Truly, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise."} The Gradual Prohibition of Khamr (Alcoholic Drink) Imam

regarding Al-Khamr.n Then, this Ayah that is in Surat An-

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 604–605]

Nisa was revealed: |i| Ibn Hishfim 2 1252-255 .

iO you who believe! Approach not As-Salah (the prayer) when you are in a drutiketi state.} (4:43) Then, when the prayer was called for, a person used to herald on behalf of Allah s Messenger jg, No drunk person should attend the prayer. Umar was summoned again and the Ayah was recited to him. Yet, he still said, O Allah! Give us a clear ruling regarding Al-Khamr. Then, the Ayah that is in

Surat Al-Ma'idah was revealed, Umar was again summoned

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 605–618]

and the Ayah was recited to him. When he reached: {And so, will you not then abstain?} (5:91) he said, We did abstain, we did abstain. This is also the narration that Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasai collected in their books.¹² Ali bin Al-Madlani and At-Tirmidhi said that the chain of narrators for this Hadith is sound and authentic. We will mention this Hadith again along with what Imam Ahmad collected by Abu Hurayrah Allah's saying in Surat Al-Ma'idah: 4 {Intoxicants and gambling, and Al-Ansdb,¹³¹ and Al-Azlam¹⁴¹ are an abomination of Satan's handiwork. So avoid (strictly all) that (abomination) in order that you may be successful.} (5:90) Allah said: {They ask you (O Muhammad ﷺ) concerning alcoholic drinks and gambling.} As for Al-Khamr, Umar bin al-Khattab, the Leader of the faithful, used to say, It includes all what intoxicates the mind. We will also mention this statement in the explanation 1:531. ' Abu Dawud 4 :79 , Tuhfatul-Ahwadhi 8 :415 , An-Nasai 8 : 287 * Altars upon which animals were sacrificed for other than Allah * Arrows used for divination

606 Tahir Ibn Kathir of Surat Al-Ma'idah, along with the topic of gambling. Allah said: {Say : In them is a great sin, and (some) benefits for men.} As for the harm that the Khamr and gambling cause, it affects the religion. As for their benefit, it is material, including benefit for the body, digesting the food, getting rid of the excrements, sharpening the mind, bringing about a joyous sensation and financially benefiting from their sale. Also, (their benefit includes) earnings through gambling that one uses to spend on his family and on himself. Yet, these benefits are outweighed by the clear harm that they cause which affects the mind and the religion. This is why Allah said: 4...but the sin of them is greater than their benefit. This Ayah was the beginning of the process of prohibiting Khamr, not explicitly, but it only implied this meaning. So when this Ayah was recited to Umar, he still said, O Allah! Give us a clear ruling regarding Al-Khamr." Soon after, Allah sent down a clear prohibition of Khamr in Surat Al-Ma'idah: {O you who believe! Intoxicants (all kinds of alcoholic drinks), and gambling, and Al-Ansdb, and Al-Azlam are an abomination of Shaytan's handiwork. So avoid (strictly all) that (abomination) in order that you may be successful. Shaytan wants only to excite enmity and hatred between you with intoxicants (alcoholic drinks) and gambling, and hinder you from the remembrance of Allah and from As-Salat (the prayer). So, will you not then abstain?} (5 :90 , 9 We will mention this subject, by the will of Allah, when we Ahmad 2:351. [21 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :636.

Al-Bacmrah (201 - 224) (Part-2) explain Surat Al-Ma'idah. Ibn 'Umar, Ash-Sha'bi, Mujahid, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi bin Anas and Abdur-Rahman bin Aslam stated that the first Ayah revealed about Khamr was: {They ask you about Khamr and gambling. Say : "In them there is great sin."} (2:219) Then, the Ayah in Surat An-Nisa was revealed (on this subject) and then the Ayah in Surat Al-Ma'idah which prohibited Khamr. {Spend whatever One could spare of his Money on Charity Allah said: {And they ask you what they ought to spend. Say: "That which is (spare) beyond your needs."} Al-Hakam said that Miqdam said that Ibn Abbas said that this Ayah means, whatever you can spare above the needs of your family. This is also the opinion of Ibn Umar, Mujahid, Ata , Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Muhammad bin Ka'b, Al- Hasan, Qatadah, Al-Qasim, Salim, Ata Al-Khurasani and Ar- Rabi bin Anas.¹²¹ Ibn Jarir related that Abu Hurayrah said that a man said, O Messenger of Allah! I have a Dinar (a currency). The Prophet ﷺ said: "Spend it on yourself." He said, I have another Dinar. He said: "Spend it on your wife." He said, I have another Dinar. He said: At-Jabari 4:331-336. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :656-657.

uSpend it on your offspring ." He said, I have another Dinar." He said: "You have better knowledge (meaning how and where to spend it in charity)Jll]

regarding the commandments and His promises and warnings, so that you might give thought in this life and the Hereafter. Ali bin Abu Talhah said that Ibn Abbas commented, Meaning about the imminent demise and the brevity of this life, and the imminent commencement of the Hereafter and its continuity. ^ 'I Maintaining the Orphan s Property Allah said: j* j&J ijlij fii'y-li Jlj "Jf js 4And they ask you concerning orphans. Say: "Tire best thing is to work honestly in their property, and ifyou mix your affairs with theirs, then they are your brothers. And Alldlt knows him who means mischief (e.g., to swallow their property) from him who means good (e.g., to save their property). And if Allah had wished. He could have put you into difficulties.} Ibn Jartr reported that Ibn Abbas said, When the Ayat 4And come not near to the orphan's property, except to improve it.} (6:152) and i\} iVerily, those wlv unjustly eat up the property of orphans, they eat up only fire into their bellies, and they will be burnt in the blazing Fire!} (4: 10) were revealed, those who took care of some orphans, separated their food and drink from the orphans food and drink. When some of the orphans food and drink remained, they would keep it for them until they eat it or otherwise get spoiled. This situation was difficult for them and they mentioned this subject to Allah s Messenger fg. Ill At-Jabari 4 :348

^pj4 % & &\ * ^ iAnd they ask you concerning orphans. Say: "The best thing is to work honestly in their property, and if you mix your affairs with theirs, then they are your brothers.} Hence, they joined their food and drink with the food and drink of the orphans. 1 11 This Hadith was also collected by Abu Dawud, An-Nasal and Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak.m Several others said similarly about the circumstances surrounding the revelation of the Ayah (2:220), including Mujahid, Ata , Ash-Shahi, Ibn Abu Layla, Qatadah and others among the Salaf and those after them. Ibn Jarir reported that A ishaah said, I dislike that an orphan s money be under my care, unless I mix my food with his food and my drink with his drink. Allah said: iSay: The best thing is to ivork honestly in their property.} meaning, on the one hand (i.e., this is required in any case). Allah then said: i...and if you mix your affairs with theirs, then they are your brothers.} meaning, there is no harm if you mix your food and drink with their food and drink, since they are your brothers in the religion. This is why Allah said afterwards: iAnd Allah knows (the otic) who means mischief (e.g., to swallow their property) from (the one) who means good (e.g., to save their property).} meaning, He knows those whose intent is to cause mischief or righteousness. He also said:Tabari 4 :350 121 Abu Dawud 3 :291 , An-Nasal 6 :256 and Al-Hakim 2 : 103.Tabari 4 :350-353Tabari 4 : :355

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2 iif jl ill its f'ff iAnd if Allah had wished, He could have put you into difficulties. Truly, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise> meaning, if Allah wills, He will make this matter difficult for you. But, He made it easy for you, and allowed you to mix your affairs with the orphans affairs in a way that is better. Similarly, Allah said: *' JI iAnd come not near to the orphan's properh/, except to improve it.? (6 :152 Allah has thus allowed spending from the orphan s estate by its executor, in reasonable proportions, on the condition that he has the intention to compensate the orphan later on, when he can afford it. We will mention about it in detail in Surat An- Nisa by Allah s will. JI ^ fcxdS jJJ j;% Uy -Oj i as 4 ijtJSi'j Ji ijf-j, ffx i221. And do not marry Al-Mushrikdt (idolatresses) till they believe (worship Allah Alone). And indeed a slave woman who believes is better than a (free) Mushrikah

(idolatress), even though she pleases you. And give not (your daughters) in marriage to Al-Mushrikfn till they believe (in Allah Alone) and verily, a believing servant is better than a (free) Mushrik (idolator), even though he pleases you. Those (Mushrikin) invite you to the Fire, but Allah invites (you) to Paradise and forgiveness by His leave, and makes His Ayat (proofs, evidences, verses, lessons, signs, revelations, etc.) Hear to mankind that they may remember. }> The Prohibition of marrying MushrikMen andWomen Allah prohibited the believers from marrying Mushrik women who worship idols. Although the meaning is general and includes every Mushrik woman from among the idol worshippers and the People of the Scripture, Allah excluded

the People of the Scripture from this ruling. Allah stated: Jt* uw 'i) OJ ^ (Lawful to you in marriage) are chaste women from those who were given the Scripture (Jeios and Christians) before your time when you have given their due dowry, desiring chastity (i.e., taking them in legal wedlock) not committing illegal sexual intercourse.} (5:5) Ali bin Abu Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said about what Allah said: } Attd do not marry Al-Mushrikdt (female idolators) till they believe (worship Allah Alone).} Allah has excluded the women of the People of the Scripture. 1 11 This is also the explanation of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Makhul, Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, Zayd bin Aslam and Ar-Rabl bin Anas and others.12 * Some scholars said that the Ayah is exclusively talking about idol worshippers and not the People of the Scripture, and this meaning is similar to the first meaning we mentioned. Allah knows best. Abu JaYar bin Jarir (At-Tabari) said, after mentioning that there is Ijma that marrying women from the People of the Scripture is allowed, "TJmar disliked this practice so that the Muslims do not refrain from marrying Muslim women, or for similar reasons. An authentic chain of narrators stated that Shaqlq said: Once Hudhayfah married a Jewish woman and TJmar wrote to him, Divorce her." He wrote back, Do you claim that she is not allowed for me so that I divorce her? He said, No. But, I fear that you might marry the whores from among them. Ibn Jarir related that Zayd bin Wahb said that TJmar bin Khattab said, The Muslim man marries the Christian woman, but the Christian man does not marry the Muslim woman. This Hadith has a stronger, authentic chain of narrators than the previous Hadith. Tabari 4:362. * Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :669-67 1 * At-Tabari 4 :366 * See Al-Tabari 4 :366

Ibn Abu Hatim * said that Ibn Umar disliked marrying the women from the People of the Scripture. He relied on his own explanation for the Ayah: iAnd do not marry Al-Mushrikdt (female idolators) till they believe (worship Allah Alone).

till they believe (in Allah Alone).} meaning, do not marry Mushrik men to believing women. This statement is similar to Allah s statement: iThey are not lawful (wives) for them, nor are they lawful (husbands) for them.} (60:10) Next, Allah said: 4 ...and verily, a believing servant is better than a (free) Mushrik (idolator), even though he pleases you.} This Ayah indicates that a believing man, even an Abyssinian servant, is better than a Mushrik man, even if he was a rich master. 4~M iThose (Al-Mushrikin) invite you to the Fire} meaning, associating and mingling with the disbelievers makes one love this life and prefer it over the Hereafter, leading to the severest repercussions. Allah said: .but Allah invites (you) to Paradise and forgiveness by His leave} meaning, by His Law, commandments and prohibitions. Allah said: tpy* P)} .and makes His Aydt clear to mankind that they may remember.} offe jij 'jj J*~-i"*)' 4 if Ji jJpi L4- h be ^ \$ p? \$P Ij. 4222 . They ask you concerning menstruation . Say : "That is an Adhd, therefore, keep away from women during menses and go

Al-Baarah (201 - 224) (Part-2 not in unto them till they are purified. And when they have purified themselves, then go in unto them as Allah has ordained for you. Truly, Allah loves those who turn unto Him in repentance and loves those who purify themselves.) 4223. Your wives are a tilth for you, so go to your tilth, when or how you will, and send (good deeds, or ask Allah to bestow upon you pious offspring) for your own selves beforehand. And fear Allah, and know that you are to meet Him (in the Hereafter), and give good tidings to the believers (O Muhammad &).} Sexual Intercourse with Menstruating Women is prohibited Imam

616 Tafsir Ibtidhi Kathir Muslim also reported this Hadith. Allah said: 4 'Alili 4 .. therefore, keep away from women during menses meaning, avoid the sexual organ. The Prophet said: 'Do anything you wish except having sexual intercourse.' This is why most of the scholars said that it is allowed to fondle the wife, except for having sexual intercourse (when she is having her menses). Abu Dawud reported that Ilkrimah related to one of the Prophet's wives that she said that whenever the Prophet wanted to fondle (one of his wives) during her menses, he would cover her sexual organ with something.'21 Abu Ja'far bin Jarir related that Masruq went to A'ishah and greeted her, and A'ishah greeted him in return. Masruq said, I wish to ask you about a matter, but I am shy. She replied, I am your mother and you are my son. He said, What can the man enjoy of his wife when she is having her menses? She said, Everything except her sexual organ. 13' This is also the opinion of Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and Ikrimah. One is allowed to sleep next to his wife and to eat with her (when she is having her menses). A'ishah said, Allah's Messenger used to ask me to wash his hair while I was having the menses. He would lay on my lap and read the Qur'an while I was having the period. '4' It is also reported in the Sahih that A'ishah said, While having the menses, I used to eat from a piece of meat and give it to the Prophet who would eat from the same place I ate from. I used to have sips of a drink and would then give the cup to the Prophet who would place his mouth where I placed my mouth. '5' It is also reported in the Two Sahih's that Maymunah bint Muslim 1 :246. ' Abu Dawud 1 :286. Tabari 4:378. Al-Bari 1 :479 ' Muslim 1 :245.

Al-Baarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) Al-Harith Al-Hilaliyah said, Whenever the Prophet wanted to fondle any of his wives during the periods (menses), he used to ask her to wear an Izar (a sheet covering the lower-half of the body). These are the wordings collected by Al-Bukhari. Similar was reported from A'ishah. In addition, Imam Ahmad, Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah reported that Abdullah bin Sa'd Al-Ansari asked Allah's Messenger, What am I allowed of my wife while she is having her menses? He said, What is above the Izar (a sheet covering the lower-half of the body). 131 Hence, Allah's statement: 4...and go not in unto them till they are purified. explains His statement: 4...therefore, keep away from women during menses> Allah prohibited having sexual intercourse with the wife during menstruation, indicating that sexual intercourse is allowed otherwise. Allah's statement: 4And when they have purified themselves, then go in unto them as Allah has ordained for you indicates that men should have sexual intercourse with their wives after they take a bath. The scholars agree that the woman is obliged to take a bath, or to perform Tayammum with sand, if she is unable to use water, before she is allowed to have sexual intercourse with her husband, after the monthly period ends. Ibn Abbas said: "till they are purified^ means from blood, and, 111 Path Al-Bari 1 :483 .Muslim 1 :243. ^ Fath Al-Bari 1 :480.Muslim 1 :242. '31 Ahmad 4:342, Abu Dawud 1 :145,Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 1:415, Ibn Majah 1 :213.

iAttd when they have purified themselves} means with water. This is also the Tafsir of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Al-Layth bin Sa'd and others. Anal Sex is prohibited Allah said: .as Allah has ordainedfor you.} this refers to Al-Farj (the vagina), as Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and other scholars have stated. ' Therefore, anal sex is prohibited, as we will further emphasize afterwards, Allah willing. Abu Razln, Ikrimah and Ad-Dahhak and others said that: 1,, ^ f%} 4...then go in unto them as Allah has ordainedfor you.} means when they are pure, and not during the menses. Allah said afterwards: iTruly, Allah loves those who turn unto Him in repentance} from the sin even if it was repeated, US iand loves those who purify themselves.} meaning, those who purify themselves from the impurity and the filth that include having sexual intercourse with the wife during the menses and anal sex.

The Reason behind revealing Allah's Statement: "Your

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 618–642]

Wives are a Tilth forYou. Allah said: 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :682,683 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :684) Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :684 ,685

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) iYour wives are a tilth for you,} Ibn Abbas commented, Meaning the place of pregnancy. [Allah then said:] \$py . . .so go to your tilth, when or how you will,} meaning, wherever you wish from the front or from behind, as long as sex takes place in one valve (the female sexual organ), as the authentic Hadiths have indicated. For instance,

Al-Bagaralt (201 - 224) (Part-2) Only in one valve (the vagina) .n 11 ' This Hadith was also collected by At-Tirmidhi who said, Hasan. '21 An-Nasal reported that Ka*b bin Alqamah said that Abu An- Nadr said that he asked Nafi , The people are repeating the statement that you relate from Ibn Umar that he allowed sex with women in their rear (anus). He said, They have said a lie about me. But let me tell you what really happened. Ibn Umar was once reciting the Qur an while 1 was with him and he reached the Ayah: ^pi \%p P t/ iYour wives are a tilth for you, so go to your tilth, when or Itoio you will,} He then said, O Nafi ! Do you know the story behind this Ayah? I said, No. He said, We, the people of Quraysh, used to have sexual intercourse with our wives from the back (in the vagina). When we migrated to Al-Madlnah and married some Ansari women, we wanted to do the same with them. They disliked it and made a big issue out of it. The Ansari women had followed the practice of the Jews who have sex with their women while they lay on their sides. Then, Allah revealed: \$pl\$P iYour wives are a tilth for you, so go to your tilth, when or hmo you will This has an authentic chain of narrators. Imam Ahmad reported that Khuzaymah bin Thabit Al- Khatami narrated that Allah s Messenger jfe said: J iUJl 'i - lS% - Jijl^ iSil V "Allah does not shy from the truth - he said it thrice-, do not have anal sex with women . ""41 6:305. Al-Ahwadhi 8 :322 ' An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5:315. Ahmad 5:215.

This Hadith was collected by An-Nasal and Ibn Majah. Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal reported that Ibn Abbas narrated that Allah s Messenger jfe said: "^\jJi si^t j\ y*. Jii Jtii &Allah does not look at a man who had anal sex with another man or a woman ."[2 At-Tirmidhi said, Hasan Gharib. This is also the narration that Ibn Hibban collected in his Sahih, while Ibn Hazm stated that this is an authentic Hadith. In addition, Imam Ahmad reported that Ali bin Talaq said, Allah s Messenger ?, forbade anal

sex with women, for Allah does not shy away from truth. 13 Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi also reported this Hadith and said, Hasan . 4 Abu Muhammad Abdullah bin Abdur-Rahman Darimi reported in his Musnad that Said bin Yasar Abu Hubab said: I said to Ibn Umar, What do you say about having sex with women in the rear? He said, What does it mean? I said, Anal sex. He said, Does a Muslim do that? 5 ' This Hadith has an authentic chain of narrators and is an explicit rejection of anal sex from Ibn Umar. Abu Bakr bin Ziyad Naysaburi reported that Ismail bin Ruh said that he asked Malik bin Anas, What do you say about having sex with women in the anus? He said, You are not an Arab? Does sex occur but in the place of pregnancy? Do it only in the Farj (vagina). I said, O Abu Abdullah! They say that you allow that practice. He said, They utter a lie about me, they lie about me. This is Malik's firm stance on this subject. It is also the view of Said bin Musayyib, Abu Salamah, Ikrimah, Tawus, Ata , Said bin Jubayr, Urwah bin Az-Zubayr, Mujahid bin Jabr, Al-Hasan and other scholars of the Salaf (the Companions and the following two generations An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5:316, Ibn Majah 1 :619. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4 :329 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5:320, Sahih Ibn Hibban 6 :202 131 Ibn Hajr mentioned it in AtrafAl-Musnad 4 :384, but it is not in the published version Al-Ahwadhi 4 :274 Ad-Darimi 1 :277 no. 1143.

Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2 after them). They all, along with the majority of the scholars, harshly rebuked the practice of anal sex and many of them called this practice a Kufr. Allah said: and send for your own selves beforehand.} meaning, by performing the acts of worship while refraining from whatever Allah has prohibited for you. This is why Allah said afterwards: i}j& fUt 3 i&& \$And fear Allah, and know that you are to meet Him (in the Hereafter), meaning, He will hold you accountable for all of your deeds, 4 ...and give good tidings to the believers (O Muhammad &).} meaning, those who obey what Allah has commanded and refrain from what He has prohibited. Ibn Jarir reported that Ata said, or related it to Ibn Abbas, 4 ...and send for your oivn selves beforehand.} means, mention Allah's Name, by saying, Bismillah , before having sexual intercourse.

3 %} tjiXJj L}jy ^ j " ^sulwV ^i)L v . .>- "if" jfe*? ti >;f/ ^ V. /-"/ J_ ^AA 4ji(j f>" Cu 4i\$J . Af/f/ make not Allah's (Name) an excuse in your oaths against doing good and acting piously, and making peace among mankind. And AUdlt is All-Hearer, All-Knower (i.e., do not sivear much and if you have sworn against doing something good then give an expiation for the oath and do good).} i225. Allah will not call you to account for that which is unintentional in your oaths, but He will call you to account for that which your hearts have earned. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most- Forbearing.} sS3'&S di2-SCc il)'0^J"lsojs Oil \fS\ fj fffvj t| i3j jJ' j OJilsf *Ji(jjji- 5^ ' "lli!ij\ a rtiifjjJii-ju^p,o*jhbjX*iSteau'jJ A; - Uu^ ,a! *\$> OjilJa) 'J" O'QioUjjjr-'/_jo^ o^s " o_j^c-W- _> f p 0_y*lju jjji- The Prohibition of swearing to abandon a Good Deed Allah commands, *You should not implement your vows in Allah's Name to refrain from pious acts and severing the relations with the relatives, if you swear to abandon such causes. Allah said in another Ayah: < ii' jtM jl jjjt yi ij iyiljj iAnd let not those among you who are blessed with graces and

Al-Bagarah (225 - 252) (Part-2 wealth swear not to give (any sort of help) to their kinsmen, Al- Masakin (the poor), and those who left their homes for Allah's cause. Let them pardon and forgive. Do you not love that Allah should forgive you?) (24:22) Continuity in a sinful vow is more sinful than breaking it by expiation. Allah's Messenger sfe said: j)1 Jiip aJ *LLi gfj jS) aIIC Jill By Allah! It is more sinful to

Allah that one of you implements his vow regarding (severing the relations with) his relatives than (breaking his promise and) paying the Kaffarah that Allah has required in such cases ." This is how Muslim reported this Hadith and also Imam Ahmad . Ali bin Abu Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said that what Allah said: ill' 'Jbof iAnd make not Allah's (Name) an excuse in your oaths} meems, Do not vow to refrain from doing good works. (If you make such vow then) break it, pay the Kaffarah and do the good work. 131 This was also said by Masruq, Ash-Sha'bi, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Mujahid, Tawus, Said bin Jubayr, Ata , Ikrimah, Meikhul, Az-Zuhri, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar-Rabi bin Anas, Ad-Deihhak, Ata Al-Khurasani and As-Suddi . Supporting this view, which is the majority view, is what is reported in the Two Sahih that Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari narrated that Allah's Messenger said: Sfl 1(1; V ii)l lli iillj > j By Allah! Allah willing, I will not vow to do a thing and then 111 Expiation, refer to 5 :89. Al-Bari 12:441, Muslim 3 :1276, Ahmad 2:317. At-Tabari 4 :422 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :700-702

Whoever makes a vow and then finds what is better than his vow (should break his vow,) pay the Kaffarah and perform the better deed2] TheLaghw (Unintentional) Vows Allah said: -j 3 v> iAllah will not call you to account for that which is unintentional in your oaths,} This Ayah means, Allah does not punish or hold you accountable for the Laghw (unintentional) vows that you make. The Laghw vows are unintentional and are just like the habitual statements that the tongue repeats, without really intending them. For instance, it is reported in the Two Sahih that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah's Messenger said:

4...but He will call you to account for that which your hearts have earned. and in another Ayah: . . .for your deliberate oaths} (5:89) Abu Dawud reported under Chapter: The Laghw Vows that Ata said that Aishah said that Allah's Messenger said: nilj ('5^ y* jcW' i_j? Vililn "The Laghw in the voios includes what the man says in his house, such as, 'No, by Allah, and, 'Yes, by Allah . s' 11 Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Ibn Abbas said, The Laghw vow includes vowing while angry. !2 He also reported that Ibn Abbas said, The Laghw vow includes vowing to prohibit what Allah has allowed, and this type does not require a Kaffarah (expiation). Similar was said by Said bin Jubayr31 In addition, Abu Dawud related under Chapter: Vowing while Angry' that Said bin Musayyib said that two Ansari brothers both received inheritance and one of them asked that the inheritance be divided. His brother said, If you ask me about dividing the inheritance again, then all of what I have will be spent on the Ka'bah's door. Umar said to him, The Ka'bah does not need your money. So break your vow, pay the Kaffarah and come to terms with your brother. I heard Allah's Messenger saying: "itU: aDo not make a vow against yourself, nor to disobey the Lord, cut the relations of the womb or dispose of what you do not own ." 141 Allah said: ti pTi*#. IM Abu Dawud 3:572. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :716. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 2:715. H Abu Dawud 3:581.

628 Tafsir ton Katlhr i.. but He will call you to account for that which your hearts have earned,} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and several others said that this Ayah means swearing about a matter while knowing that he is lying. Mujahid and others said this Ayah is similar to what Allah said: 4.. but He will punish you for your deliberate oaths.} (5:89) Allah said (2:225 above): Wj} iAnd Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most-Forbearing .} meaning, He is Oft-Forgiving to His servants and Most Forbearing with them. bi 1 ,b m 3 oU^ iujl lAj rfctls ^ S.bjj^ TTV jbit ijil 4226 . Those who take an oath not to have sexual relation with

their wives must wait for four months, then if they return, veil /, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 4222'. And if they decide upon divorce, then Allah is All-Hvater, All-Knoiver.} The ilVand its Rulings Ila is a type of vow where a man swears not to sleep with his wife for a certain period, whether less or more than four montns. If the vow of Ila was for less than four months, the man has to wait for the vow s period to end and then is allowi d to have sexual intercourse with his wife. She has to be patient and she cannot ask her husband, in this case, to end his vcw before the end of its term. It is reported in the Two Sahih.r that A ishah said that Allah s Messenger swore he would stay away from with his wives for a month. He then came down after twenty-nine days saying: 'Vj -Z-tj ,4-^' "The (lunar) month is twenty-nine days ," 1 ' 1 m Fath M-Bari 8 :380 , Muslim 2 :1 1 13.

Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) Similar was narrated by Umar bin Al-Khattab and reported in the Two SahSis. If the period of Ila is for more than four months, the wife is allowed in this case to ask her husband, upon the end of the four months, to end the hd and have sexual relations with her. Otherwise, he should divorce her, by being forced to do so by the authorities if necessary, so that the wife is not harmed. Allah said: iThose who take an oath not to have sexual relations with their wives meaning, swear not to have sexual relations with the wife. This Ayah indicates that the M involves the wife and not a slave-women, as the majority of the scholars have agreed, .must waitforfour months, meaning, the husband waits for four months from the time of the vow and then ends the lid {if the vow was for four or more months) and is required to either return to his wife or divorce her. This is why Allah said next: 4 ...then if they return,} meaning, to a normal relationship, having sexual intercourse with the wife. This is the Tafsir of Ibn Abbas, Masruq, Ash- Shalii, Said bin Jubayr and Ibn Jarir.[2 4]^& at Ifr 4...verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} with any shortcomings that occurred in the rights of the wife because of the vow of Ila . Allah said: Vyj. 4And if they decide upon divorce,} ,l Path Al-Ban 4 :143 , MuslimJabari 4:466,467.

indicating that divorce does not occur by merely passing the four month mark (during the Ila). Malik reported from Nafi that Abdullah bin Umar said, If the man swears to Uol from his wife, then divorce does not occur automatically even after the four months have passed. When he stops at the four months mark, he should either divorce or return. 111 Al- Bukhari also reported this HadlthP^ Ibn Jarir reported that Suhayl bin Abu Salih said that his father said, I asked twelve Companions about the man who does Ha. with his wife. They all stated that he does not have to do anything until the four months have passed and then has to either retain or divorce her. ' Ad-Daraqutni also reported this from Suhayl.14 It is also reported from Umar, Uthman, Ali, Abu Ad-Darda , A ishah, Ibn Umar and Ibn Abbas. This is also the opinion of Said bin Musayyib, Umar bin Abdul-'AzIz, Mujahid, Tawus, Muhammad bin Ka b and Al-Qasim. kittf " J\$U% tJj i."S^ Irik ^rk <(228. And divorced women shall wait (as regards their marriage) for three menstrual periods, and it is not lawful for them to conceal wluit Allah has created in their wombs, if they believe in Allah and the Last Day. And their husbands have the better right to take them back in that period, if they wish for reconciliation. And they (women) have rights (over their husbands as regards living expenses) similar (to those of their husbands) over them (as regards obedience and respect) to what is reasonable, but men have a degree (of responsibility) over tlctetn. And Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise The *Iddah (Waiting Period) ofthe DivorcedWoman This Ayah contains a command from Allah that the divorced woman, whose marriage was consummated and who still has 111 Al-Muwatta 2 :556 Al-Bari9 :335Tabari 4:493. 4 Ad-Daraqutni4 :61 .

Al-Baqarah (22 - 252) (Part-2) menstruation periods, should wait for three (menstrual) periods (Quru after the divorce and then remarry if she wishes. The Meaning of Al-Quru Ibn Jarir related that Alqamah said: We were with Umar bin Al-Khattab when a woman came and said, My husband divorced me one or two periods ago. He then came back to me while I had prepared my water (for taking a bath], took off my clothes and closed my door. Umar asked Abdullah bin Mas'ud, What do you think? He said, I think that she is still his wife, as long as she is not allowed to resume praying (i.e., until the third period ends before he takes her back). Umar said, This is my opinion too. This is also the opinion of Abu Bakr As-Siddiq, Umar, Uthman, Ali, Abu Ad-Darda , Ubadah bin As-Samit, Anas bin Malik, Ibn Mas'ud, Mu'adh, Ubayy bin Ka'b, Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari and Ibn Abbas. Furthermore, this is the opinion of Said bin Musayyib, Alqamah, Aswad, Ibrahim, Mujahid, Ata , Tawus, Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Muhammad bin Sirin, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ash-Shati, Ar-Rabi', Muqatil bin Hayyan, As-Suddi, Makhul, Ad-Dahhak and Ata Al-Khurasani. They all stated that the Quru is the menstruation period. What testifies to this is the Hadith that Abu Dawud and An-Nasa'i reported that Fatimah bint Abu Hubaysh said that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said to her: "Do not pray during your Aqrd' (i.e. for Quru , the menstruation period). If this Hadith was authentic, it would have been a clear proof that the Quru is the menstruation period. However, one of the narrators of this Hadith, Al-Mundhir, is an unknown person (in Hadith terminology), as Abu Hatim has stated, although Ibn Hibban has mentioned Al-Mundhir in his book Ath-Thiqat. At-Tabari 4:502. Abu Dawud 1 :191 , An-Nasa'i 6:21 1

Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2 husband is eligible to take his divorced wife back. We should mention that (when this Ayah 2:228 was revealed), the ruling that made the divorce thrice and specified when the husband is ineligible to take his divorced wife back, had not been revealed yet. Previously, the man used to divorce his wife and then take her back even if he had divorced her a hundred separate times. Thereafter, Allah revealed the following Ayah (2:229) that made the divorce only thrice. So there was now a reversible divorce and an irreversible final divorce. The Rights the Spouses have over Each Other Allah said: iAnd they (women) have rights (over their husbands as regards living expenses) similar (to those of their husbands) over them (as regards obedience and respect) to what is reasonable, This Ayah indicates that the wife has certain rights on her husband, just as he has certain rights on her, and each is obliged to give the other spouse his due rights. Muslim reported that Jabir said that Allah's Messenger said: tU J l 4)1 oliL L 4)1 I li .iiJS j)i l Ajyb 3 f ut JgiP)1 iFear Allah regarding your women, for you have taken them by Allah's covenant and were allowed to enjoy with them sexually by Allah's Words. You have the right on them that they do not allow anyone you dislike to sit on your mat. If they do that, then discipline them leniently. They have the right to be speitt on and to be bought clothes in what is reasonableV Bahz bin Hakim said that Mu'awiyah bin Haydah Al- Qushayri related that his grandfather said, O Messenger of Allah! What is the right the wife of one of us has? The Prophet ﷺ said: i t v/j t IS) lit l^ *W 2 :886

J A+ To feed her when you eat, buy her clothes when you buy for yourself and to refrain from striking her on the face, cursing her or staying away from her except in the house .n*' 1 Waki related that Ibn Abbas said, I like to take care of my appearance for my wife just as I like for her to take care of her appearance for me. This is because Allah says: i*!SHt 4<&& AAnd they (women) have rights similar (to those of their husbands) over them to what is reasonable.} This statement is reported by Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abu Hatim.12 The VirtueMen have overWomen Allah said: Irfo- Abut men have a degree (of

responsibility) over them .} This Ayah indicates that men are in a more advantageous position than women physically as well as in their mannerism, status, obedience (of women to them), spending, taking care of the affairs and in general, in this life and in the Hereafter. Allah said (in another Ayah) -. AMen are the protectors and maintainers of women, because Allah has made one of them to excel the other, and because they spend (to support them)from their means.} (4:34) Allah s statement: AAnd Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise means, He is Mighty in His punishment of those who disobey Abu Dawud 2 :606. At-Jabari 4 :532, Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :750.

Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) and defy His commands. He is Wise in what He commands, destines and legislates. l, p_lr. oli iji. C-jj rS Juu 'irt fi jli X wi'f -" 'i > > * > *" -* \g(. IfwJU aU Jjffi*- AD* JJ-W U-Aj O 4229. The divorce is twice, after that either you retain her on reasonable terms or release her with kindness. And it is not lawful for you (men) to take back (from your wives) any of what you gave them (the Mahr, bridal-money given by the husband to his wife at the time of marriage), except when both parties fear that they would be unable to keep the limits ordained by Allah (e.g., to deal with each other on a fair basis). Then if you fear that they would not be able to keep the limits ordained by Allah, then there is no sin on either of them if she gives back (the Mahr or a part of it). These are the limits ordained by Allah, so do not transgress them. And whoever transgresses the limits ordained by Allah, then such are the wrongdoers> 4230. And if he has divorced her (the third time), then she is not lawful unto him thereafter until she has married another husband. Then, if the other husband divorces her, it is no sin on both of them that they reunite, provided they feel that they can keep the limits ordained by Allah. These are the limits of Allah, which He makes plain for the people who have knowledge. Divorce is Thrice This honorable Ayah abrogated the previous practice in the beginning of Islam, when the man had the right to take back his divorced wife even if he had divorced her a hundred times, as long as she was still in her Iddah (waiting period). This situation was harmful for the wife, and this is why Allah made the divorce thrice, where the husband is allowed to take back his wife after the first and the second divorce (as long as she is still in her Iddah). The divorce becomes irrevocable after the

third divorce, as Allah said: 4T//e divorce is twice, after that, either you retain her on reasonable terms or release her with kindness. In his Sunan, Abu Dawud reported in Chapter: Taking the Wife back after the third (Divorce) is an abrogated practice," that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah. iAttd divorced women shall wait (as regards their marriage) for three menstrual periods, and it is not incumbent for them to conceal

The reason for the woman (who was divorced thrice) to marry another man must be that the man desires her and has the intention of having an extended married life with her. These are the legal goals and aims behind marriage. If the

reason behind the second marriage was to make the woman

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 642–647]

eligible for her ex-husband again, then this is the Tahtil that the Hadthhs have cursed and criticized. In addition, when the

reason behind this marriage (if it was Tahiti) is announced in the contract, it would make the contract invalid according to the majority of the scholars. Imam Ahmad reported that Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, Allah's Messenger ﷺ cursed the one who does Tahiti, the one in whose favor it is done, those who eat RibA (usury) and those who feed it (pay the usury). Tirmidhi and An-Nasat reported this Hadith[^] and At-Tirmidhi said, This Hadith is Hasan." He said, This is what is acted upon according to people of knowledge among the Companions, amongwhom are 6:34 Al-Bari 10 :518, Muslim 2 :1057, An-Nasal 6 :146. 6 :62 1:448. Ahmad 1 :448 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi4 :268 , An-Nasal 6 :149

Umar, Uthman and Ibn Umar. It was also the saying of the scholars of Fiqh among the Tabi in (second generation of Islam). And it has been reported from Ali, Ibn Mas'ud and Ibn Abbas . In his Mustadrak, Al-Hakim reported that Nafi said: A man came to Ibn Umar and asked him about a man who divorced his wife three times. Then, his brother married her to make Tahiti for his brother, without the brother knowing this fact. He then asked, Is she allowed for the first (husband)? He said, No, unless it is a marriage that involves desire. We used to consider this an act of adultery during the time of Allah s Messenger ﷺ. Al-Hakim said, This Hadith has a Sahth chain although they (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not record it. The wording of this Hadith indicates that the ruling came from the Prophet Abu Bakr bin Abu Shaybah, Al-Jawzjani, Harb Al- Kirmani and Abu Bakr Al-Athram said that Qablsah bin Jabir said that Umar said, If the participants to Tahiti are brought to me, I will have them stoned. |2 When does a Woman who was divorced Three Times become Eligible for Her First Husband Allah said: iAnd if he has divorced her> meaning, the second husband after he had complete sexual relations with her, iit is no siti on both of them that they reunite^ meaning, the wife and her first husband, 4^ JJ-W- 1.-ai ol iprovided they feel that they can keep the limits ordained by Allah. meaning, they live together honorably. Mujahid said, If they are convinced that the aim behind their marriage is honorable. ' Next, Allah said: jjii- 1,1 Al-Hakim 2:199. I2 * Ibn Abi Shaybah 4 :294Tabari 4:598.

644 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ~mibi w mm jl JC~iU cA?"^~4J Ji*ubb f*r'-s^ JJ^Ju^cAjfZr VjJAMitoilslj Jus dJJ i J" ^ i"b' (J-SijJj^U* -j J4^'->^ CiySa^ L? Udj's'Jo^ O^jl.Ac.V34i'ijiJ^'-3-I^V ^ iTIiese are the limits of Allah,} His commandments and legislation, (He makes plain fs& ifor the people who have knowledge.} 1&\ j& i \$ \ f&> \if} ter *w &&& 6fe SJs4 % jjli" JUS ilM'i l)Xolj Vjyt o ll tjJjii *!?!j illi \$% 3 li'ifj *&*\$ S5 3 'A i>% i lS "# * "\$& . And when you have divorced women and they have fulfilled the term of their prescribed period, either take them back on a reasonable basis or set them free on a reasonable basis. But do not take them back to hurt them, and whoever does that, then he has wronged himself. And treat not the verses (Laws) of Allah in jest, but remember Allah's favors on you (i.e., Islam), and that which He has sent down to you of the Book (i.e., the Qur'an) and Al-Hikmah (the Prophet's Sunnah - legal ways - Islamic jurisprudence) whereby He instructs you . And fear Allah, and know that Allah is All-Aware ofeverything}. BeingKind to the Divorced Wife This is a command from Allah to men that when one of them divorces his wife with a reversible divorce, he should

Al-Baoarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) treat her kindly. So when her term of Iddah (waiting period) nears its end, he either takes her back in a way that is better, including having witnesses that he has taken her back, and he lives with her with kindness. Or, he should release her after her Iddah finishes and then kindly asks her to depart from his house, without disputing, fighting with her or using foul words. Allah then said: i\X2 \$But do not take them back to hurt them,} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Masruq, Al-Hasan,

Qatadah, Ad- Dahhak, Ar-Rabl and Muqatil bin Hayyan said that a man used to divorce his wife, and when her Iddah came near its end, he would take her back to harm her and to stop her from marrying someone else. He then divorced her and she would begin her Iddah and when her Iddah term neared its end, he would take her back again, so that the term of Iddah would be prolonged for her. After that, Allah prohibited this practice. ' Allah has also threatened those who indulge in such practices, when He said; ii jXb Jd* idS i and whoever does that, then he has wronged himself.} meaning, by defying Allah s commandments. Allah then said: iAnd treat not the verses (Laws) ofAllah in a jest,} Ibn Jarir said that Abu Musa (Al-Ash'ari) narrated that Allah s Messenger jg once became angry at the Ash'ari tribe. Abu Musa went to him and said, O Messenger of Allah! Are you angry with the Ash'ariyyin? The Prophet jg said: One of you says, 'I divorced her' -then says- 'I took her back!' This is not the appropriate way Muslims conduct divorce. 1,1 Ibn Abi Hatim 2:772-774.

Al-Baqarah (22 - 252) (Part-2) none of your secret or public affairs ever escapes His knowledge, and He will treat you accordingly. >'n j&&* & m pi Sf Ayfij^ ^ *" JI*j" illl'i 4 ; c . And when you have divorced women and they have fulfilled the term of their prescribed period, do not prevent them from marrying their (former) husbands, if they mutually agree on reasonable basis. This (instruction) is an admonition for him among you who believes in Allah and the Last Day. That is more virtuous and purer for you. Allah knows and you know not.} The Wall (Guardian) of the Divorced Woman should not prevent Her from going back to Her Husband Ali bin Abu Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, This Ayah was revealed about the man who divorces his wife once or twice and her 'Iddah finishes. He later thinks about taking her back in marriage and the woman also wishes that, yet, her family prevents her from remarrying him. Hence, Allah prohibited her family from preventing her. Masruq, Ibrahim An-Nakha'i, Az-Zuhri and Ad-Dahhak stated that this is the

the meaning of Allah's statement:

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 663–669]

-iy \)JS o' i . . .except that you speak an honorable saying.} He said, He says to her Wali, Do not give her away (in marriage) until you inform me first . This statement was narrated by Ibn Abu Hatim. 3 Allah then said: kAac. AAnd do not be determined on the marriage bond until the term prescribed is fulfilled.> meaning, do not make marriage contracts before the 'Iddah finishes. Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ash-Shaln, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi bin Anas, Abu Malik, Zayd bin Aslam, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Az-Zuhri, Ata Al-Khurasani, As-Suddi, Ath-Thawri and Ad- Dahhak said that: iuntil the term prescribed is fulfilled.} means, Do not consummate the marriage before the Iddah term finishes. * The scholars agree that marriage contracts during the Iddah are invalid. Allah then said: iUxk -4 u pz& AAnd know that Allah knows what is in your minds, so fear Him.} warning the men against the ideas they conceal in their hearts about women, directing them to think good about them rather 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2:824. * At-Tabari 5:114. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :826. [4 * Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :828,829

4~J. jjUli \ j 4a\ 4237 . And if you divorce them before you have touched (had a sexual relation with) them, and you have appointed for them their due (dowry), then pay half of that, unless they (the women) agree to remit it, or he (the husband), in whose hands is the marriage tie, agrees to remit it. And to remit is nearer to At-Taqwa (piety, righteousness). And do not forget liberality between yourselves .

Truly, Allah is All-Seer of what you do.} The Wife gets half of her Mahr if she is divorced before the Marriage is consummated. This honorable Ayah is not a continuation of the Mut'ah (gift) that was mentioned in the previous Ayah (i.e., divorce before the marriage is consummated). This Ayah (2:237) requires the husband to relinquish half of the appointed Mahr if he divorces his wife before the marriage is consummated. If it was discussing any other type of gift, then it would have been mentioned that way, especially when this Ayah follows the previous Ayah related to this subject. Allah knows best. Giving away half of the bridal-money in this case is the agreed practice according to the scholars. So, the husband pays half of the appointed Mahr if he divorces his wife before consummating the marriage. Allah then said: 4unless they (the women) agree to remit it,} meaning, the wife forfeits the dowry and relieves the husband from further financial responsibility. As-Suddi said that Abu Salih mentioned that Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement: J%} unless they (the women) agree to remit it,} Unless the wife forfeits her right. 11 ' Furthermore, Imam Abu 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :839

it was reported that Shurayh, Said bin Musayyib, Ikrimah, Mujahid, Ash-ShaTsi, Al-Hasan, Nafi , Qatadah, Jabir bin Zayd, Ata Al-Khurasani, Ad-Dahhak, Az-Zuhri, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ibn Sinn, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas and As-Suddi said similarly. Allah then said: fy i...or he (the husband), in whose hands is the marriage tie, agrees to remit it.) Ibn Abu Hatim reported that Amr bin Shu ayb said that his grandfather narrated that the Prophet sg said: siie- *The husband is he wlv has the marriage he."121 Ibn Marduwyah also reported this Hadith, and it is the view chosen by Ibn Jarir. The Hadith states that the husband is the person who really holds the marriage tie in his hand, as it is up to him to go on with the marriage or end it. On the other hand, the Wali of the wife is not allowed to give away any of her rightful dues without her permission, especially the dowry. Allah then stated: 1 -4-i^)And to remit it is nearer to At-Taqiya (piety, righteousness.) Ibn Jarir said, Some scholars said that this statement is directed at both men and women. Ibn Abbas stud: iAnd to remit it is nearer to At-Taqwd (piety, righteousness.) indicates that the one who forgives, is nearer to At-Taqwa (piety). A similar statement was made by Ash-Sha*bi and several other scholars. Mujahid, An-Nakha i, Ad-Dahhak, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar- 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :840-842 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :842Jabari 5:162.

Rabl bin Anas and Thawri stated that liberality mentioned in the Ayah refers to the woman giving away her half Mahr, or the man giving away the full Afahr. This is why Allah said here: & ipi 1;} iAnd do not forget liberality between yourselves.} meaning, kindness (or generosity), as Said has stated. 121 Allah said: iTruly, Allah is All- Seer of what you do.} meaning, none of your affairs ever escapes His perfect Watch, and He will reward each according to his deeds. v rn'vA ** mm JJ y*fiy \ J ^Aiijltpi==d jC-AAij ?f} jSL^sat jJ-U! "*" sf} JaJS Jajialj9 , wa-ii 0jtf==> 4 'jijSo li t3r "jji Tj^S 4238. Guard strictly (five obligatory) As-Salawdt (the prayers) especially the Middle Salah. And stand before Allah with obedience.} 4239. And if you fear (an enemy), (perform Salah) on foot or riding. And when you are in safety, then remember Allah (pray) in the manner He has taught you, which you kneio not m At-Tabari 5:165,166.Tabari 5:166.

(before).} Allah commands that the prayer should be performed properly and on time. It is reported in the Two Sahihs that Ibn Mas'Qd said, I asked the Prophet j^, Which deed is the dearest (to Allah)? He replied: *To offer the prayers at their fixed times. I asked, What is the next (in goodness)? He replied: Mil Jr-J *To participate in Jihad (religions fighting) in Allah's cause.*" I again asked, What is the next

(in goodness)? He replied: *oiJJ y* "To be good and dutiful to your parents ." Abdullah then added, The Prophet ^ told me these words, and had I asked more, the Prophet jfe would have told me more. 111 The Middle Prayer Furthermore, Allah has specifically mentioned the Middle prayer, which is the Asr prayer according to the majority of the scholars among the Companions, as At-Tirmidhi and Al-Baghawi have stated. Al-Qadi Al-Mawardi added that the majority of the scholars of the Tabi'in also held this view. Al- Hafiz Abu TJmar bin Abdul-Barr said that this is also the opinion of the majority of the scholars of the Athar (i.e., the Hadith and the statements of the Salaf). In addition, Abu Muhammad bin Atiyah said that this is the Tafsir (of the Middle prayer) of the majority of scholars. Al-Hafiz Abu Muhammad Abdul-Mu min bin Khalaf Ad-Dumyati stated in his book on the Middle prayer that it is the Asr prayer and mentioned that this is the Tafsir of Umar, Ali, Ibn Mas'ud, Abu Ayyub, Abdullah bin Amr, Samurah bin Jundub, Abu Hurayrah, Abu Said, Hafsah, Umm Habibah, Umm Salamah, Ibn Abbas and A isha. This is also the Tafsir of TJbaydah, Al-BOri2:12, MusUm 1 :90

sank1mBwr" hJ225 - 252) (Part21 MuqSl, Ubayd bin Abu Maiyam, and others. The Proof that the Asr Prayer is the Middle Prayer Confederates): _ , ,, yi^ *i*.>* *> iW"y .Ttev (fc disbelievers} ImsM us from performing pr^r.the Mr prayer, may AM. fill Iherr hearts and houses with fire " (He performed the Asr prayer between Maghrib and /sha Muslta and

the battle of Al-Ahzdb, when the Mushnks prevented Mlah s

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 669–671]

Messenger sg and his Companions from performing the A prayer has been narrated by several other Companions We only mentioned the narrations that stated that the Middle prayer is the -Asr prayer. Furthermore, wordings for this HadUh from Ibn Mas'ud and Al-Bara bin Azib In addition, Imam Ahmad reported that Samurah bin Jundub said that Allah s Messenger said: iThe Middle prayer is the 'Asr prayer. 15] In another narration, Allah s Messenger\$ mentioned: hi Ahmad 1:113. PI Muslim 1 : 437 , An-Nasal 6 :303 ' Muslim 1 :437 ,438 I5I Ahmad 5 :22

lafsir Ibn Kathir fc' MdM^LTlnitS fta/lfTfthf ^l.f% another Mn-ation, Allah's Messenger"Ud: ^ prayer" to // is the 'Asr prayerj al^^TCrp M T^"h WaS th" b* S SS"?=afesSSaS OjJiiJl S^U> Ja^jl iii! The Middle prayer is the 'Asr prayer "(4i MtlLTsS that Ibn MasM " " Allah's V i'Lc The 'Asr prayer is the Middle prayer . tv^eS rm Mu , the '1 statet* tha 'his Hadlth is of a IJasan, Sahih wordings are to Ws * his p^rttr;,ts? s^ "" M" rp^rttrr ^r^ (^s f the authentic Hachth, Allah's Messenger j# emphasized the aTrLsr^ the^^^"" z ,1J Ahmad 5:8. * Atimad 5 :7 i4 i TuWat Al-Ah.wad.hi 8 :328 Ibn Hibban 3 :12 1 Tu^fatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :329 Muslim 1 :437.

JUf yj UjtSo yjl*}\ o^iLi AIj li "Whoever misses the 'Asr prayer will be like who has lost his family and money ." [1 It is reported in the Sahih that Buraydah bin Al-Husayb said that the Prophet said: On a cloudy day, perform the (Asr) prayer early, for whoever misses the 'Asr prayer, will have his (good) deeds annulled ."

Surah 2: Al-Baqarah (Part 4 of 4)

PDF pages 95–803

The Prohibition of speaking during the Prayer

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 671–682]

Allah said: *And stand before Allah with obedience.* meaning, with humbleness and humility before Him (i.e., during the prayer). This command indicates that it is not allowed to speak during the prayer, as speaking contradicts the nature of the prayer. This is why the Prophet ﷺ refused to answer Ibn Mas'ud when he greeted him while he was praying and said afterwards: "The prayer makes one sufficiently busy" (i.e., by the various actions of the body, tongue and heart involved during the prayer.) Muslim reported that the Prophet said to Mu'awiyah bin Hakam As-Sulami when he spoke during the prayer: "The ordinary speech people indulge in is not appropriate during the prayer. The prayer involves only Tasbih (praising Allah), Takbir (saying Allahu Akbar, i.e., Allah is the Most Great) and remembering Allah. Imam Ahmad reported that Zayd bin Arqam said, One used to address his friend about various affairs during the prayer. Then when this Ayah was revealed: *And stand before Allah with obedience.* we were ordered to refrain from speaking. 12* The Group (i.e., the Hadith collections), except Ibn Majah, reported this Hadith. The Fear Prayer Allah said: *And if you fear (an enemy), (perform Salah) on foot or riding. And when you are in safety, then remember Allah (pray) in the manner He has taught you, which you knew not (before).* After Allah commanded His servants to perform the prayer perfectly and emphasized this commandment. He mentioned the situation where the person might not be able to perform the prayer perfectly, during battle and combat. Allah said: *And if you fear (an enemy), perform Salah on foot or riding.* meaning, pray in the appropriate manner under these circumstances, whether on foot or riding and whether facing the Qiblah or otherwise. Imam Malik reported that Nafi related that Ibn Umar used to describe the Fear prayer when he was asked about it and would then add, If there is intense fear, pray on foot, riding, facing the Qiblah and otherwise. Nafi commented, I think that he related that to the Prophet ﷺ. 1:381. * Ahmad 4:368. * Fath Al-Bari 3:88, Muslim 1 :383, Abu Dawud 1 :583, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :330 , An-Nasal 3:18. * Al-Muwatta' 1:184.

Great) and remembering Allah. Imam Ahmad reported that Zayd bin Arqam said, One used to address his friend about various affairs during the prayer. Then when this Ayah was revealed: *And stand before Allah with obedience.* we were ordered to refrain from speaking. 12* The Group (i.e., the Hadith collections), except Ibn Majah, reported this Hadith. The Fear Prayer Allah said: *And if you fear (an enemy), (perform Salah) on foot or riding. And when you are in safety, then remember Allah (pray) in the manner He has taught you, which you knew not (before).* After Allah commanded His servants to perform the prayer perfectly and emphasized this commandment. He mentioned the situation where the person might not be able to perform the prayer perfectly, during battle and combat. Allah said: *And if you fear (an enemy), perform Salah on foot or riding.* meaning, pray in the appropriate manner under these circumstances, whether on foot or riding and whether facing the Qiblah or otherwise. Imam Malik reported that Nafi related that Ibn Umar used to describe the Fear prayer when he was asked about it and would then add, If there is intense fear, pray on foot, riding, facing the Qiblah and otherwise. Nafi commented, I think that he related that to the Prophet ﷺ. 1:381. * Ahmad 4:368. * Fath Al-Bari 3:88, Muslim 1 :383, Abu Dawud 1 :583, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :330 , An-Nasal 3:18. * Al-Muwatta' 1:184.

Al-Baqarah (223 - 252) (Part-2) Al-Bukhari and Muslim reported the Hadith^P Muslim, Abu Dawud, An-Nasal, ibn Majah and Ibn Jarir reported that Ibn Abbas said, Allah has ordained the prayer by the words of your Prophet four (Rak'ah) while residing, two while traveling and one Rak'ah during times of fear. 1 This is also the view of Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, and others . In addition, Al-Bukhari has entitled a Chapter: Prayer while confronting the Forts and facing the Enemy . Al-Awzal said, If the victory seems near and the Muslims are unable to perform the prayer (in the normal manner), they should pray by nodding each by himself. If they are unable to nod, they should delay the prayer until fighting is finished. When they feel safe, they should pray two Rak'ah. If they are unable,

they should then pray one Rak'ah that includes two prostrations. If they are unable, then Takbir alone does not suffice, so they should delay the prayer until they are safe. This is the same view that Makhul held. Anas bin Malik said, I participated in the attack on the fort of Tostar, when the light of dawn started to become clear. Suddenly, the fighting raged and the Muslims were unable to pray until the fight of day spread. We then prayed (the Dawn prayer) with Abu Musa and we became victorious. I would not have been pleased if I were to gain in the life of this world and whatever is in it instead of that prayer. 1 This is the wording of Al-Bukhari. Prayer during the Times of Peace is performed normally Allah said: iArui when you are in safety, then remember Allah (pray)) meaning, Perform the prayer as I have commanded you by completing its bowing, prostration, standing, sitting, and with the required attention (in the heart) and supplication. Allah said: Fath Al-Bari 8 :46 , Muslim 1 :574 Muslim 1 : 478,479 , Abu Dawud 2:40, An-Nasal 3:169, Ibn Maiah 1 :339, At-Tabari 5: 247. At-Tabari 5 :240,241 Fath Al-Bari 2:503.

tiP \$ tf 2} iin the manner He has taught you, which you knew not (before). meaning, just as He has endowed you, guided you and taught you about what benefits you in this life and the Hereafter, so thank and remember Him. Similarly, Allah said after He mentioned the prayer of Fear, i6& (IT s&p & v&\ ijfcrt f# 4...but when you are free from danger, perform As-Saldh. Verily, As-Saldh (the prayer) is enjoined on the believers at fixed hours.) (4:103) We will mention the Hadiths about the prayer of Fear and its description in Surat An-Nisa while mentioning Allah's statement: iWhen you (O Messenger Muliammad sg) are among them, and lead them in As-Saldh (the prayer).} (4:102) J JI *Pj 'it&'jfo afj 'jxr Of 4 \$ i)V iif ^JQ SST j* .w* j*lii i 4240. And those of you who die and leave behind wives should bequeath for their wives a year's maintenance (and residence) without turning them out, but if they (wives) leave, there is no sin on you for that which they do of themselves, provided it is honorable (e.g., lawful marriage). And Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise.} 4242. And for divorced women, maintenance (should be provided) on reasonable (scale). This is a duty on Al-Muttaqin (the pious).} 4242. Thus Allah makes clear His Aydt (Laws) to you, in order that you may understand>

Ayah (2:240) was abrogated The majority of the scholars said that this Ayah (2:240) was abrogated by the Ayah (2:234), what Allah said: 4 . . .they (the wives) shall wait (as regards their marriage) for four months and ten days.) (2:234) For instance, Al-Bukhari reported that Ibn Az-Zubayr said: I said to TJthman bin Affan: jjiyy iAnd those of you who die and leave wives behind them) was abrogated by the other Ayah (2:234). Therefore, why did you collect it (meaning, in the Qur'an)? He said, O my nephew! I shall not change any part of the Qur'an from its place. The question that Ibn Az-Zubayr asked TJthman means: If the ruling of the Ayah (2:240) was abrogated to four months (the 'Iddah of the widow, and refer to 2:234), then what is the wisdom behind including it in the Qur'an, although its ruling has been abrogated? If the Ayah (2:240) remains (in the Qur'an) after the Ayah that abrogated it (2:234), this might imply that its ruling is still valid. TJthman, the Leader of the faithful, answered him by stating that this is a matter of the revelation, which mentioned these Ayat in this order. Therefore, I shall leave the Ayah where I found it in the Qur'an. Ibn Abu Hatim reported that Ibn Abbas said about what Allah said: iAnd those of you who die and leave behind wives should bequeath for their wives a year's maintenance (and residence) without turning them out,) The widow used to reside, and have her provisions provided in Fath Al-Bari 8:48.

used to be the Iddah, and the widow had to remain with her (deceased) husband's family (during that period, i.e., four months and ten days). Then, Allah revealed: *And those of you who die and leave behind wives should bequeath for their wives a year's maintenance (and residence) without turning them out, but if they (wives) leave, there is no sin on you for that which they do of themselves, provided it is honorable (e.g., lawful marriage).* So, Allah made the rest of the year, which is seven months and twenty days, as a will and testament for her. Consequently, if she wants, she could use her right in this will and remain in the residence (for the rest of the year). Or, if she wants, she could leave the (deceased husband's) house after the four months and ten days have passed. This is the meaning of what Allah said: *...without turning them out, but if they (wives) leave, there is no sin on you.* Therefore, the required term of 'Iddah is still unchanged (refer to 2:234). Ata quoted Ibn Abbas, This Ayah (2:240) has abrogated (the requirement that) the widow spends the Iddah with his (i.e., her deceased husband's) family. So, she spends her Iddah wherever she wants. This is the meaning of what Allah said: *...without turning them out,}.*" Ata also said: If she wants, she spends the Iddah with his family and resides there according to the will (meaning the rest of the year). If she wants, she is allowed to leave, for Allah said: *...there is no sin on you for that which they do of themselves,}.*

Ata then said: Then (the Ayah on) the inheritance (refer to 4:12) came and abrogated the residence. Hence, the widow spends her Iddah wherever she wants and does not have the right to residence any more. The statement of Ata and those who held the view that the Ayah (2:240) was abrogated by the Ayah on the inheritance (4:12), is only valid for more than the four months and ten days (required in 2:234). However, if they mean that the four months and ten days are not required from the deceased husband's estate, then this opinion is the subject of disagreement among the scholars. As proof, they said that the widow is required to remain in her (deceased) husband's house (for four months and ten days) according to what Malik reported from Zaynab bint Ka'b bin T'Jrah. She said that Fari'ah bint Malik bin Sinan, the sister of Abu Said Al-Khudri, told her that she came to Allah's Messenger[^] asking him to return to her family's residence with Banu Khudrah. Her husband had pursued some of his servants who ran away, but when he reached the area of Al-Qadum, they killed him. She said, So I asked Allah's Messenger jg if I should stay with my family in Banu Khudrah, for my (deceased) husband did not leave me a residence that he owns or Nafaqah (maintenance). Allah's Messenger jg answered in the positive. While I was in the room, Allah's Messenger jg summoned me or had someone summon me and said: *... , zWliat did you say? I repeated the story to him about my (deceased) husband. He said: "ijjA 4.GS3I^ JU 4^J Stay at your home until the term reaches its end. So I remained through the Iddah term for four months and ten days in my (deceased husband's) house. Thereafter, Uthman bin Allan sent for me during his reign and asked me about this matter and I told him what happened. He made a judgment to the same effect. This Hadlth was also collected 111 Al-Bukhari 4531,5344. 121 Al-Muwatta 2:591.*

Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) by Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah.m At- Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahih". TheNecessityoftheMut'ah (Gift) attheTime ofDivorce Allah said: *Andfor divorced women, maintenance (should be provided) on reasonable (scale). This is a duty on Al-Muttaqin (the pious) .}* Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that when Allah's statement: *...a gift of reasonable amount is a duty on the doers ofgood}* (2:236) was revealed, a man said, If I want, I will be excellent and if I do not, I will not. Thereafter, Allah revealed this Ayah: *Andfor divorced women, maintenance*

(should be provided) on reasonable (scale). This is a duty on Al-Muttaqin (the pious). The scholars who ruled that the Mut'ah (reasonable gift) at the time of divorce is required for every divorced woman, whether she had a bridal-money appointed for her or not, and whether the marriage was consummated or not, relied on this Ayah (2:241) when they issued their ruling. This is the view taken on this subject by Said bin Jubayr and several others among the Salaf and also Ibn Jarir. Hence, Allah's statement: *Jr o+i j' o^ \$ & -Zjf uj. ^ sAt jc-j "jJi i* There is no sin on you, if you divorce women while yet you have not touched (had sexual relation with) them, nor appointed Abu Dawud 2:773, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:319,390, An-Nasal 6:200, Ibn Majah 1 :654. At-Tabari 5 :264. At-Tabari 5:263.

680 Tafstr Ibn Kathir for than their due (dowry) . But bestow on them (a suitable gift), the rich according to his means, and the poor according to his means, a gift of reasonable amount is a duty on the doers of good.) (2:236) only mentions some specifics of this general ruling. Allah then said: *4**~j"* ii(^ i* Thus Allah makes clear His Ayat (Laws) to you,) meaning, what He allows, forbids, requires, His set limits, His commandments and His prohibitions are all explained and made plain and clear for you. He did not leave any matter in general terms if you needed the specifics, in order that you may understand.) meaning, understand and comprehend. *P iyji if .H? Jffii J4 Oi !&s; f; v UJm jsn ^^ if Jaju ifif \> if of l[kfj & 4 jS^iu iifj 4 jfj ,*i* 4243. Did you (O Muhammad jg) not think of those who went forth from their homes in the thousands, fearing death? Allah said to them, "Die". And that He restored them to life. Truly, Allah is full of bounty to mankind, but most men thank not.) 4244. And fight in the way of Allah and know that Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knower.) 4245. Who is he that will lend to Allah a goodly loan so that He may multiply it to him many times? And it is Allah that decreases or increases (your provisions), and unto Him you shall return.) The Stoij of the Dead People Ibn Abu Hatdm related that Ibn Abbas said that these people mentioned herein, were the residents of a village called Dawardan. Ali bin Asim said that they were from Dawardan,

Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) a village several miles away from Wasit (in Iraq). In his Tafsir, Waki bin Jarrah said that Ibn Abbas commented. *i* Did you (O Muhammad not think of those who went forth from their homes in thousands, fearing death?) that they were four thousand persons who escaped the plague (that broke out in their land). They said, We should go to a land that is free of death! When they reached a certain area, Allah said to them: *i* "Vie."} and they all died. Afterwards, one of the Prophets passed by them and supplicated to Allah to resurrect them and Allah brought them back to life. So, Allah stated: *4y' Ojli L/& j) J-" f&}* *i* Did you (O Muhammad not think of those who went forth from their homes in the thousands, fearing death?) Furthermore, several scholars among the Salaf said that these people were the residents of a city during the time of the Children of Israel. The weather in their land did not suit them and an epidemic broke out. They fled their land fearing death and took refuge in the wilderness. They later arrived at a fertile valley and they filled what is between its two sides. Then Allah sent two angels to them, one from the lower side and the other from the upper side of the valley. The angels screamed once and all the people died instantly, just as the death of one man. They were later moved to a different place, where walls and graves were built around them. They all perished, and their bodies rotted and disintegrated. Long afterwards, one of the Prophets of the Children of Israel, whose name was Hizqll (Ezekiel), passed by them and asked Allah to bring them back to life by his hand. Allah accepted his supplication and commanded him to say, O rotted bones, Allah commands you to come together. The bones of every body were brought together. Allah then commanded him to

682 Tafstr Ibn Kathir say, O bones, Allah commands you to be covered with flesh, nerves and skin. That also happened while Hizqll was watching. Allah then commanded him to say, O souls, Allah commands you to return, each to the body that it used to inhabit. They all came back to life, looked around and proclaimed, All praise is due to You (O Allah!) and there is no deity worthy of worship except You." Allah brought them back to life after they had perished long ago. We should state that bringing these people back to life is a clear proof that physical resurrection shall occur on the Day of Resurrection. This is why Allah said: iTruly, Allah is full of bounty to mankind,} meaning, in that He shows them His great signs, sound proofs and clear evidences. Yet, 'j UJ ibut most men thank not.}ll] as they do not thank Allah for what He has given them with in their worldly life and religious affairs.

The Story of the Jews Who sought a King to be

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 686–703]

appointed over Them Mujahid said that the Prophet (mentioned in the Ayah 2:246 above) is Shamwil (Samuel).¹ Wahb bin Munabbih said: The Children of Israel remained on the straight path for a period of time after Moses. They then innovated in the religion and some of them even worshipped the idols. Yet, there were always Prophets sent among them who would command them to work righteous deeds, refrain from doing evil and who would rule them according to the commands of the Torah. When they (Israelites) committed the evil that they committed, Allah caused their enemies to overwhelm them, and many fatalities fell among them as a consequence. Their enemies also captured a great number of them, and took over large areas of their land. Earlier, anyone who would fight the Israelites would lose, because they had the Torah and the Tdhiit,² which they inherited generation after generation ever since the time of Moses, who spoke to Allah directly. Yet, the Israelites kept indulging in misguidance until some king took the Tabut from them during a battle. That king also took possession of the Torah, and only a few of the Israelites who memorized it remained. The prophethood halted among their various tribes and only a pregnant woman remained of the offspring of Lavi (Levi), in whom the prophethood still appeared. Her husband had been killed, so the Israelites kept her in a house so that Allah may give her a boy, who would be their Prophet. The woman also kept invoking Allah to grant her a boy. Allah heard her pleas and gave her a boy whom she At-Tabari 5:293. The ark of the Covenant.

Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) called Shamwil meaning Allah has heard my pleas. Some people said that the boy's name was Sham'un (Simeon), which also has a similar meaning. As that boy grew, Allah raised him to be a righteous person. When he reached the age of prophethood, Allah revealed to him and commanded him to call (his people) to Him and to His TawhicL (Oneness). Shamwil called the Children of Israel (to Allah) and they asked him to appoint a king over them so that they could fight their enemies under his command. The kingship had also ended among them. Their Prophet said to them, What if Allah appoints a king over you, would you fulfill your vow to fight under his command? irr - : * SA r- 4They said, Why should we not fight in Allah's way while we have been driven out of our homes and our children?"} meaning, After our land had been confiscated and our children had been taken from us? Allah said: li Ij & 44C4 4But when fighting was ordered for them, they turned away, all except a few of them. And Allah is All-Aware of the wrongdoers meaning, only a few of them kept their

promise, but the majority abandoned Jihad and Allah has full knowledge of them. C~"> jj ill! oj .r JUj^ ix&j & Si Ju aai 4 it, d&l % ii14 (~y'j - i j* jj) Ji'j 44 4 "'jj ^ ny ;7 44 i247. And their Prophet said to them, "Indeed Allah has appointed Taliit (Saul) as a king over you." They said, "How can he be a king over us when we are fitter than him for the kingdom, and he has not been given enough wealth." He said: "Verily , Allah has chosen him above you and has increased him abundantly in knowledge and stature. And Allah grants His kingdom to whom He wills. And Allah is All-Sufficient for His

creatures' needs, All-Knower.) When the Israelites asked their Prophet to appoint a king over them, he appointed Talut (Saul), who was then a soldier. But, Talut was not a descendant of the house of kings among them, which was exclusively in the offspring of Yahudha (Judah). This is why they said: " JiJ'i i) 3\$ iHow can he be a king over us) meaning, how can he be the king for us. iwhen we are fitter than him for the kingdom, and he has not been given enough wealth?) They said that Talut was also poor and did not have the wealth that justifies him being king. Some people stated that Talut used to bring water to the people, while others stated that his profession was dyeing skins. The Jews, thus, disputed with their Prophet while they were supposed to obey him and to say good words to him. Their Prophet answered them: C. 4jll 0^ iVerily, Allah has chosen him above you) meaning, Allah chose Talut from amongst you while having better knowledge about him. Their Prophet stated, I did not choose Talut to be your king on my own. Rather, Allah has commanded that upon your request. Further: 44- ' 4 ")' 4 * la i...and has increased him abundantly in knowledge and stature.) meaning, Talut is more knowledgeable and honorable than you, and stronger and more patient during combat, and has more knowledge of warfare. In short, he has more knowledge and is stronger than you are. The king should have sufficient knowledge, be fair looking and should have a strong soul and body. He then said: 4* \$j) \$And Allah grants His kingdom to whom He wills.)

Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2 meaning, Allah Alone is the Supreme Authority Who does what He wills and no one can ask Him about His actions, while they will be asked (about their actions by Him). This is because Allah has perfect knowledge, wisdom and kindness with His creation. Allah said: }And Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All- Knower.} meaning, His favor is encompassing and He grants His mercy to whom He wills. He also knows those who deserve to be kings and those who do not deserve it. Am A ^ ^U i j i). Jll CLj ilij fj==uj / < V i < / _ 4248 . And their Prophet said to them: "Verily! Tire sign ofHis kingdom is that there shall come to you At-Tabfit, wherein is Sakinah (peace and reassurance) from your Lord and a remnant of that which Musa (Moses) and Harun (Aaron) left behind, carried by the angels. Verily, in this is a sign for you ifyou are indeed believers.} Their Prophet then proclaimed, The sign of the blessings of Talut s kingship over you is that Allah will give you back the Tabut (wooden box) that has been taken from you. Allah said: iwhereiti is Sakinahfrom your Lord meaning, peace (or grace) and reassurance. Abdur-Razzaq stated that Qatadah said: iwherein is Sakinah means grace.* * In addition, Ar-Rabl said that Sakinah means mercy. This is also the meaning given by Ibn Abbas, as Al- Awfi narrated. *** Abdur-Razzaq 1:98.

690 Tafislr Ibn Kathir Allah then said: jttj i...and a remnant of that which Musa (Moses) and Hdrun (Aaron) left behind,} Ibn Jarir related that Ibn Abbas said about this Ayah: Jl" U-j i...and a remnant of that which Miisd (Moses) and Hdrun (Aaron) left behind,} Meaning, Moses staff and the remnants of the Tablets. * This is the same Tafsir of Qatadah, As-Suddi, Ar-RabT bin Anas and Tkrimah, who

added, And also the Torah. 121 Abdur- Razzaq said that he asked Ath-Thawri about the meaning of, i...and a remnant of that which Miisd (Moses) and Hdrun (Aaron) left behind,} Ath-Thawri said, Some said that it contained a pot of manna and the remnants of the Tablets, while some others said that it contained (Moses) staff and two shoes (and refer to 20 : 12). Allah then said: "LJ-} i...carried by the angels.} Ibn Jurayj stated that Ibn Abbas said, The angels came down while carrying the Tabut between the sky and the earth, until they placed it before Talut while the people were watching. As-Suddi said, The Tabut was brought to TalQt s house, so the people believed in the prophethood of ShamTin (Simeon) and obeyed Talut The Prophet then said: At-Tabari 5:331. At-Tabari 5:331,332. At-Tabari 5:333. At-Tabari 5 :335

691Surali 2 . Al-tfaqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) i\ eiiSJP j> ogles' ; s' A\ '* ><\ ' Ua)". - _/^\a) p. ^ JiSU>~ Ki3fcStW jjl "ia 4. ' >*p g~a^ Uilllip gjj^^-^JllaJ A' s't">' \ ' t. Z\ ' ' i - ^. --:- JI) dJ?Jr= .1Z^Ai. 3-J-Jj l"J J ^;jiaUsiyw ji> 4ji)fQ^=d3 j"*' A"X-j ^f 1 ^ * jtiv , +sS *- ' ^ni - .>< 4i)lj 4)1 Jjb a / i* /-** (*^=* > iVerily, in this is a sign far you} testifying to my truth in what I was sent with, my prophethood, and my command to you to obey Talut, < #& * & \if you are indeed believers .} in Allah and the Hereafter. JS jjL jL OjJlk jdi CH*^ Cj~* iii dS', A . " " (: ' :jr cf4,} o""i**** VL/** Cr* Xs^ i-'mhj Mi ' !< :? ! ' CT<*< H * i * *\$. -o> s> ,oJC Ui J44 xi 'J ijd , i i: o LJ Xlji? (^ ^jL; <^i> jvi // cr, J uLAjdl' . Then when Talut set out with the army, he said: Verily, Allah will try you by a river. So whoever drinks thereof, he is not ofme ; and xohoever tastes it not, he is of me, except him who takes (thereof) in the hollow of his hand." Yet, they drank thereof, all, except a faro of them . So when he had crossed it (the river), he and those who believed with him, tftey said: "We have no power this day against Jdliit (Goliath) and his hosts." But those who ktmv with certainty that they were going to meet Allah, said: "Hoiv often has a small group overcome a mighty host by Allah's leave?" And Allah is with As-Sdbirin (the patient).}

Allah states that TalQt, the king of the Children of Israel, marched forth with his soldiers and the Israelites who obeyed him. His army was of eighty thousand then, according to As- Suddi, but Allah knows best. Talut said: iif -^\$ iVerily, Allah will try you meaning, He will test you with a river, which flowed between Jordan and Palestine, i.e., the Shari'ah river, according to Ibn Abbas and others.,2) He continued. iSo whoever drinks thereof, he is not ofme;} meaning, shall not accompany me today, 4'i^s. if^ ^ iand whoever tastes it not, he is of me, except him who takes (thereof) in the hollow ofhis hand meaning, there is no harm in this case. Allah then said: 4-i kpf iYet, they drank thereof, all, except a few ofthem.} Ibn Jurayj stated that Ibn Abbas commented, Whoever took some of it (the river s water) in the hollow of his hand, quenched his thirst; as for those who drank freely from it, their thirst was not quenched. Ibn Jarir reported that Al-Bara bin Azib said, We used to say that the Companions of Muhammad jg who accompanied him on the battle of Badr were more than three hundred and ten, just as many as the soldiers who crossed the river with Talut. Only those who believed crossed the river with him. 131 Al-Bukhari also reported this . This is why Allah said: Li; o Z5& 'J ijd . At-Tabari 5:339. [21 At-Tabari 5:340. At-Tabari 5:345,346,347. Al-Bari 7 :339

Al-Bacjarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) iSo when he had crossed it (the river), he and those who believed with him, they said: "We have no power this day against Jdliit (Goliath) and his hosts."} This Ayah indicates that the Israelites (who remained with Saul) thought that they were few in the face of their enemy who were many then. So, their knowledgeable scholars strengthened their resolve by stating that Allah s

promise is true and that triumph comes from Allah Alone, not from the large numbers or the adequacy of the supplies. They said to them: i"How often has a small group overcome a mighty host by Allah's leave?"And Allah is with As-Sabirin (the patient).} \L& y>\ ".j\" jijj !*&}& Vjlj ttlj jLU&J iif ^ . -'I'* wtlj Jc J Si JJ , m 1 4#< 3 St)^^ isjs 4250. And when they advanced to meet Jdliit (Goliath) and his forces, they invoked: "Our Lord! Pour forth on us patience, and set firm our feet and make us victorious over the disbelieving people."} 4251. So they routed them by Allah's leave and Dawud (David) killed Jdliit (Goliath), and Allah gave him (Ddwud) the kingdom [after the death of Tdlut and Samuel] and Al-Hikmah (prophethood), and taught him of that which He willed. And if Alldh did not check one set of people by means of another, the earth would indeed be full of mischief. But Alldh is full of bounty to the 'Alarnin (mankind, Jinn and all that exists).} 4252. These are the verses of Alldh, We recite them to you (O Muhiammad jfe) in truth, and surely, you are one of the Messengers (ofAllah.) When the faithful party, who were few under the command of Taltit, faced their enemy, who were many under the command of Jalut,

4(^> lli 'jHj^ ithey invoked: "Our Lord! Pourforth on us patience..."} meaning, send down patience on us from You. i\&63 pS} iand setfirm ourfeet meaning, against the enemy and save us from running away and from feebleness, iand make us victorious over the disbelieving people.} Allah said: 4So they routed them by Allah's leave} meaning, they defeated and overwhelmed them by Allah s aid and support. Then, iand Ddwud killed Jalut} Israelite accounts claimed that (Prophet) David killed Goliath with a slingshot that he had, which he launched at Goliath causing his death. TalCit promised that whoever killed Jalut, would marry his daughter and would share his kingship and authority. He kept his promise. Later, the kingship was transferred to Prophet Dawud in addition to being granted Prophethood by Allah. So, Allah said: 4d&l\ & fcSi 4 . . .and Allah gave him (Ddwud) the kingdom} that TalQt had and, iand Al-Hikmah} that comes with the prophethood, meaning, after Shamwil. (Allah then said:)

Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) iand taught him of that which He willed.} meaning, what He willed of the knowledge that He bestowed on (Prophet) Dawud. Next, Allah said: ;uit &* > iAnd if Allah did not check one set of people by means of another, the earth would indeed be full of mischief.} This Ayah indicates that if it were not for the fact that Allah checks one set of people with another, such as when Talut and the bravery of Dawud helped the Children of Israel (against Goliath), then people would have perished. Similarly, Allah said: JiGlt \$ iFor had it not been that Allah checks one set of people by means of another, monasteries, churches, synagogues, and Masjids, wherein the Name ofAllah is mentioned much, would surely, have been pulled down.} (22:40) Allah then said: & J i jj Sit iBut Allah is full ofbounty to the 'Alamitt (mankind, Jinn and all that exists)} meaning, by His mercy and favor He fixes some of them by some others. Surely, Allah has the wisdom, the supreme authority and the clear proof against His creation in all of His actions and statements. Allah said: U && iThese are the verses of Allah, We recite them to you (O Muhammad jfe) in truth, and surely, you are one of the Messengers (ofAllah).} This Ayah states, These Ayat (verses) of Allah that We have narrated for you in truth conform to the exact manner that these stories have occurred and to the truth that still remain

in the (Divine) Books that the scholars of the Children of Israel have and know. Allah said: O Muhammad, iyou arc iotie of the Messengers (of Allah)) emphatically stating the truth of his

prophethood741 "w This is the End of Volume One with the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah, verse. 252.. Volume Two begins with Surat Al-Baqarah, verse. 253.

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A GROUP OF SCHOLARS UNDER THE SUPERVISION OF Pir Nihar" & Distributors

(ABRIDGED) Parts 3, 4 & 5 (Surat Al-Baqarah, Verse 253 to Surat An-Nisa, Verse 147)

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(ABRIDGED)VOLUME 2 Parts 3, 4 & 5 (Surat Al-Baqarah, Verse 253 to Surat An-Nisa, Verse 147)
AGROUP OF SCHOLARS UNDER THE SUPERVISION OF SHAYKH SAFIUR-RAHMAN AL-MUBARAKPURI s. Riyadh Jeddah Al-Khobar Sharjah Lahore London Houston New York

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Important Guidelines About the Authenticity of the Reports and Quotations in the Tafsir of Ibn Kathir
Reports from the Companions of the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) Reports that are attributed to the companions of Allah s Messenger are commonly used for additional explanation of the meanings of the Qur an. As for those quotes that Ibn Kathir mentions in passing, these quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as an evidence against what is known to be authentic. Additional information in this regard is found in the Introduction of Ibn Kathir.
Incomplete Chains of Narration The following is a list of common incomplete chains of narrations that Al-Hafiz Ibn Kathir often quotes. - Ali bin Abi Talhah (Al-Walibi) reported that Ibn Abbas said... - (Atiyah) Al-Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said... - Ad-Dahhak from Ibn Abbas. - As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik and Abu Salih from Ibn Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and (or) some men among the companions. - Al-Hasan Al-Basri reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ) - Az-Zuhri [Muhammad bin Shihab] reporting from or about the Prophet - Urwah bin Az-Zubayr reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). - Ikrimah reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). - Qatadah reporting from or about the

Prophet 53. All narrations coming from these chains are unauthentic according to the Sciences of Hadlth. Their meanings, however, may be correct as understood by authentic texts, and for this reason they are commonly referenced.

Reports from the Followers of the Companions and those who Followthem The following is a list of those who did not see the Prophet 3g, but they report from companions of the Prophet jg, while often they themselves are quoted for Tafsir. Reports that are attributed to them are used as additional support in understanding certain issues by Ibn Kathir. Such quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as evidence against the authentic evidence. Abu Al- Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Al-Musayib, Ata (bin Abi Rabah), Ata Al-Khurrasani, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar- Rabl bin Anas, Ash-Shabbi, Qatadah, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ad- Dahhak, Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam (Ibn Zayd), Ibn Jurayj. Other Scholars After the Companions The following are some scholars that Ibn Kathir often quotes from. Since these scholars are not well known to the average English reader, one should beware that their own statements about the Prophet jg, his companions, or circumstances surrounding the Qur an s revelation, are not to be considered as important as authentically narrated texts. Wakl , Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Ibn Atiyyah, Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari).

4* GiXi JG')' Jli ^ ^ ^ * * "JJ Alii p-6 ^ O'. X3-& C-^j-> gJW, JidS' G iif *ud jij cf-i-j!' G jGj j*-*jJu it? ' ijsa \$y & % \$ aa o* (*r4 d*"" d1 (*A j ijiddit G Is' ltd Jj) 4 1 4253. Those Messengers! We preferred some of them to others; to some of them Allah spoke (di- rectly); others He raised to degrees (of honor); and to 'Isa, the son of Maryam, We gave clear proofs and evidences, and supported him with Ruh-il-Qudus [Jibril]. If Allah had willed, succeeding generations would not have fought against each other, after clear Verses ofAllah Iwd come to them, but they differed - some of ihetn believed and others disbelieved. IfAllah had willed, they would not havefought against one another, but Allah does what He wills.) jSSlfeS ** ^tI 4i&tj* ofl<\$&(*-\$"" ^^ S", ' > '\ (' ' "t \ l*tofU 1Uji' ai A ,i -js,ss A A.^ its". GpXVIw \T.x*^^ini4: 4 Allah Honored Some ProphetsAbove Others Allah states that He has honored some Prophets to others. For instance, Allah said, 4iJ t2'*J tfj? '& iAnd indeed, We have preferred some of the Prophets above others, and to Ddwud We gave the Zabiir (Psalms)} [17:55]. In the Ayah above, Allah said,

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) argument, such as the incident mentioned in the Hadlth. The Hadith indicates that it is not up to creation to decide which Prophet is better, for this is Allah s decision. The creation is only required to submit to, obey and believe in Allah s decision. Allah s statement, S' cPs iAtid We gave 'Isa, the son ofMaryam, clear signs refers to the proofs and unequivocal evidences that testify to the truth that isa delivered to the Children of Israel, thus testifying that he was Allah s servant and His Messenger to them. 4And supported him with Rihih-il-Qudus)> meaning Allah aided Isa with Jibril, peace be upon him. Allah then said, 5j i&k \p^ a^ iSf JtS C& "S 5TJ^ iff Allah had willed, succeeding generations zoould not have fought against each other, after clear Verses of Allah had come to them, but they differed - some of them believed and others disbelieved. If Allah had willed, they ivould not have fought against one another. meaning all this happened by Allah s decree, and this is why He said next, IP 2s' iBut Allah does what He wills.) % %L% }y_ 'Sy> & Sf oj XL. irp: \$0 4254. O you who believe!

Spend of that with which We have provided for you, before a Day comes when there will be no bargaining, nor friendship, nor intercession. And it is the disbelievers who are the wrongdoers .)>

Allah commands His servants to spend for His sake, in the path of righteousness, from what He has granted them, so that they acquire and keep the reward of this righteous deed with their Lord and King. Let them rush to perform this deed in this life, it's.\$ d jJ ^before a Day comes) meaning, the Day of Resurrection, 4 'ij <&" j*~? iwhen there will be no bargaining, nor friendship, nor intercession .) This Ayah indicates that on that Day, no one will be able to bargain on behalf of himself for ransom himself with any amount, even if it was the earth's fill of gold; nor will his friendship or relation to anyone benefit him. Similarly, Allah said, Vj V Jj-uA' j iThen, when the Trumpet is blown, there will be no kinship among them that Day, nor will they ask of one another) [23:101], /9*ss s x %) iNor intercession) meaning, they will not benefit by the intercession of anyone. Allah's statement, iand it is the disbelievers who are the wrongdoers) indicates that no injustice is worse than meeting Allah on that Day while a disbeliever. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ata bin Dinar said, All thanks are due to Allah Who said, pa Sfi&ij) iand it is the disbelievers who are the wrongdoers) but did not say, And it is the wrongdoers who are the disbelievers. m Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :966

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) &Vf je 4 C 'i 'g * -v JjSK ^^ &> oi ^. Vj p t*j uy l* jU*> "ify i"X* jii; ifji' IS ,> ol r*" J*J ""***" 1lj Cj jiU' *~?S *li CLi ^ j*Jc 4," 4255. Allah! None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Ever Living, the One Who sustains and protects all that exists. Neither slumber nor sleep overtakes Him. To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. Who is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission? He knows what happens to them (His creatures) in this world, and what will happen to them in the Hereafter. And they will never compass anything of His Knowledge except that which He wills. His Kursi extends over the heavens and the earth, and He feels no fatigue in guarding and preserving them. And He is the Most High, the Most Great.} The Virtue of Ayat Al-Kursi This is Ayat Al-Kursi and tremendous virtues have been associated with it, for the authentic Hadith describes it as the greatest Ayah in the Book of Allah. Imam

include the part that starts with, By He in Whose Hand... Imam

the description of Shaytan. In this narration, Abu Hurayrah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 720–726]

said, Allah's Messenger assigned me to keep watch over the Sadaqah (charity) of Ramadan. A person snuck in and started taking handfuls of foodstuff. I caught him and said, By Allah, I will take you to Allah's Messenger. He said, Release me, for I am meek and have many dependents and am in great need. I released him, and in the morning Allah's Messenger asked 111 That is a category of the Jinn , attributed with many different characteristics by different scholars 5 :422 Tuhfat Al-Ahwardi 8 :183

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) me, What did your prisoner do yesterday, O Abu Hurayrah? I said, O Allah's Messenger! He complained of being needy and of having many dependents, so I pitied him and let him go. Allah's Messenger said, Indeed, he told you a lie and will be coming again. I believed that he would show up again, for Allah's Messenger had told me that he would return. So, I watched for him. When he (showed up and) started stealing handfuls of foodstuff, I caught hold of him again and said, I will

definitely take you to Allah's Messenger. He said, Leave me, for I am very needy and have many dependents. I promise I will not come back again. I pitied him and let him go. In the morning Allah's Messenger asked me, What did your prisoner do last night, O Abu Hurayrah! I replied, O Allah's Messenger! He complained of his great need and of too many dependents, so I took pity on him and set him free. Allah's Messenger said, Verily, he told you a lie; he will return. I waited for him attentively for the third time, and when he (came and) started stealing handfuls of the foodstuff, I caught hold of him and said, I will surely take you to Allah's Messenger as it is the third time you promised not to return, yet you returned. He said, Let me teach you some words which Allah will give you benefit from. I asked, What are they? He replied, Whenever you go to bed, recite Ayat Al-Kursi- AUahu la ilaha ilia Huwal-Hayyul-Qayyum, till you finish the whole verse. (If you do so), Allah will appoint a guard for you who will stay with you, and no Shaytan will come near you until morning. So, I released him. In the morning, Allah's Messenger asked, What did your prisoner do yesterday? I replied, O Allah's Messenger! He claimed that he would teach me some words by which Allah will grant me some benefit, so I let him go. Allah's Messenger asked, What are they? I replied, He said to me: Whenever you go to bed, recite Ayat Al-Kursi from the beginning to the end, AUahu la ilaha ilia Huwal-Hayyul-Qayyum. He further said to me: (If you do so), Allah will appoint a guard for you who will stay with you, and no Shaytan will come near you until morning. (One of the narrators) then commented that they (the Companions) were very keen to do good deeds. The Prophet said, He spoke the truth, although he is a liar. Do you know whom you were talking to, these three nights, O Abu Hurayrah? Abu Hurayrah said, No. He said, It

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) ^ ^ VI '4 v iAlldh! None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Ever Living, the One Who sustains and protects all that exists [2:255]; in Al Imran, it is in. 1 h4 v iAlif-Ldm-Mim . Allah! None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Ever Living, the One Who sustains and protects all that exists} [3:1-2], while in Ta-Ha, it is in, & </4 :j\$ iAtid (all) faces shall be humbled before (Allah), the Ever Living, the One Who sustains and protects all that exists} [20 : 1 1 |. Ayat Al-Kursi has Ten Complete Arabic Sentences Allah's statement, 4S* V] id] '*d &} iAlldh! None has the right to be worshipped but He } mentions that Allah is the One and Only Lord of all creation. Allah's statement, iAl-Hayyul-Qayyum} testifies that Allah is the Ever Living, Who never dies, Who sustains everyone and everything. All creation stands in need of Allah and totally relies on Him, while He is the Most Rich, Who stands in need of nothing created. Similarly, Allah said, i-\ iJojij fju o' j^j} iAnd among His signs is that the heaven and the earth stand by His command} [30:25]. Allah's statement, iNeither slumber nor sleep overtakes Him} means, no shortcoming, unawareness or ignorance ever

4. Allah's statement, Uj Oy. ,ji Ji U 4J^ iTo Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth} indicates that everyone is a servant for Allah, a part of His kingdom and under His power and authority. Similarly, Allah said, ^ |

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) _ iThere is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Gracious (Allah) as a servant. Verily, He knows each one of them, and has counted them a full counting. And everyone of them will come to Him alone on the Day of Resurrection (without any helper, or protector or defender)} [19:93-95]. 5. Allah's statement, <(W7jo is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission?) is similar to His statements. cA ft Sit j 4 i'1 there are many angels in the heavens,

whose intercession will avail nothing except after Allah has given leave for whom He wills and is pleased with [53:26], and, f < < y ' ^ ty+y Ky\ 4o^' A. "i }They cannot intercede except for him with whom He is pleased [21:28]. These Ayat assert Allah's greatness, pride, and grace, and that no one dares to intercede with Him on behalf of anyone else, except by His permission. Indeed, the Hadith about the intercession, states that the Prophet% said, :juj ji 4i! iti U ^e-xx o l_f\ "/ will stand under the Throne and fall in prostration, and Allah will allow me to remain in that position as much as He wills. I will thereafter be told, "Raise your head, speak and you will be heard, intercede and your intercession will be accepted" . The Prophet then said, "He will allow me a proportion of whom I will enter into Paradise."n11 6. Allah's statement, ^ Muslim 1 : 180.

He knows what happens to them (His creatures) in this world, and what will happen to them in the Hereafter^ this refers to His perfect knowledge of all creation; its past, present and future. Similarly, Allah said that the angels proclaimed; 4L> & > Jui Cj Oil. Cj L-Cl jX, j} iAnd we (angels) descend not except by the command of your Lord (O Muhammad jgj . To Him belongs what is before us and

what is behind us, and what is between those two; and your

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 726–767]

Lord is neverforgetful (19:64). 7. Allah's statement, iAnd they will never compass anything of His Knowledge except that which He wills}, asserts the fact that no one attains any part of Allah's knowledge except what Allah conveys and allows. This part of the Ayah indicates that no one ever acquires knowledge of Allah and in His Attributes, except what He conveys to them. For instance, Allah said, itic CjJi ij} iBut they will never compass anything of His knowledge (20 :110). 8. Allah said, i M ^ iHis Kursi extends over the heavens and the earth.} Wald' narrated in his Tafsir that Ibn Abbas said, Kursi is the footstool, and no one is able to give due consideration to (Allah's) Throne. ' A1-Hakim recorded this Hadith in his Mustadrafa2] from Ibn Abbas, who did not relate it to the Prophet jgj. Al-Hakim said, It is Sahih according to the criteria At-Tabarani 12:39. 121 Al-Hakim 2 :282

of the Two Sahihs, and they (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not record it. In addition, Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said, If the seven heavens and the seven earths were flattened and laid side by side, they would add up to the size of a ring in a desert, compared to the Kursi. 9. Allah said, }And He feels no fatigue in guarding and preserving them} meaning, it does not burden or cause Him fatigue to protect the heavens and earth and all that is in between them. Rather, this is an easy matter for Him. Further, Allah sustains everything, has perfect watch over everything, nothing ever escapes His knowledge and no matter is ever a secret to Him. All matters are insignificant, modest and humble before Him. He is the Most Rich, worthy of all praise. He does what He wills, and no one can ask Him about what He does, while they will be asked. He has supreme power over all things and perfect alertness concerning everything. He is the Most High, the Greatest, there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, and no Lord other than Him. 10. Allah's statement, }And He is the Most High, the Most Great} is similar to His statement, ithe Most Great, the Most High} |13:9). These and similar Ayat and authentic Hadiths about Allah's Attributes must be treated the way the Salaf (righteous ancestors) treated them by accepting their apparent meanings without equating them (with the attributes of the creation) or altering their apparent meanings. ft ill ^\$\$ fjii .- l- Ibn Abi HStim 3:981.

30 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4256. There is no compulsion in religion. Verily, the right path has become distinct from the wrong path. Whoever disbelieves in Taghiit and believes in Allah, then he has grasped the most trustworthy handhold that will never break. And Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knower.'f No Compulsion in Religion Allah said, i~0 4 ' \$[iThere is no compulsion in religion), meaning, Do not force anyone to become

""Embrace Islam." The man said, "I dislike it." The Prophet ss said, "Even if you dislike it." First, this is an authentic Hadith, with only three narrators between Imam

his character, even if he was Persian or Nabatian. 1 11 'Umar s statement that Taghut is Shaytan is very sound, for this meaning includes every type of evil that the ignorant people of Jdhiliyyah (pre Islamic era of ignorance) fell into, such as worshipping idols, referring to them for judgement, and invoking them for victory. Allah s statement, i \X (Cm i 4then he has grasped the most trustworthy handhold that will never break> means, He will have hold of the true religion with the strongest grasp. Allah equated this adherence to the firm handhold that never breaks because it is built solid and because its handle is firmly connected. This is why Allah said here, 4then he has grasped the most trustworthy handhold that will never break. Mujahid said, The most trustworthy handhold is Iman (faith). As-Suddi said that it refers to Islam. [3] Imam

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) 0 ' '5 U^: ""iji;Li c^L>*cfbbfJ\S ii^o 0 i3 4jiif.jcj.*<\$ cJlJ j^ajlfl,AjUjjij^cSjL; 4itAjUlil45_^Jk"

j j' JI oXiiii Si i^i* tj 4^ U&\ ji vji & l &\ {257. Allah is the Walt (Protector or Guardian) of those who believe. He brings them out from darknesses into light. But as for those who disbelieve, their Awliya (supporters and helpers) are Taghiit (false deities and false leaders), they bring them out from light into darknesses. Those are the dwellers of the Fire, and they will abide therein forever. Allah stated that whoever follows what pleases Him, He will guide him to the paths of peace, that is Islam, or Paradise. Verily, Allah delivers His believing servants from the darkness of disbelief, doubt and hesitation, to the light of the plain, clear, explained, easy and unequivocal truth. He also stated that Shaytan is the supporter of the disbelievers who beautifies the paths of ignorance and misguidance that they follow, thus causing them to deviate from the true path into disbelief and wickedness. iThose are the dwellers of the Fire, and they will abide therein forever This is why Allah mentioned the light in the singular while mentioned the darkness in the plural, because truth is one, while disbelief comes as several types, all of which are false! Similarly, Allah said, Mr- cf fM p. =ail2 (Xi-ij {And verily, this is my straight path, so follow it, and follow not (other) paths, for they will separate you away from His path. This He has ordained for you that you may have Taqwa} [6.153J t ji*. {And originated the darknesses and the lights [6:1], and,

ciwJi } 4to the right and to the left} [16:48]. There are many other Ayat on the subject that mention the truth in the singular and falsehood in the plural, because of falsehood s many divisions and branches. , Sjji it *it J 4 C? J] J"3 oti dyilif o? ur*-^ rl 36 \$ Jo T-\./n iJX{m V iljlj 4258. Have you not looked at him who disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord (Allah), because Allah had given him the kingdom? When Ibrdftim said (to him): "My Lord is He Who gives life and causes death." He said, "I give life and cause death." Ibrahim said, "Verily, Alldlt brings the sun from the east; then bring it you from the

west." So the disbeliever was utterly defeated. And Allah guides not the people, who are wrongdoers.} The Debate Between Ibrahim Al-KhalQandKingNimrod The king who disputed with Ibrahim was King Nimrod, son of Canaan, son of Kush, son of Sam, son of Noah, as Mujahid stated. It was also said that he was Nimrod, son of Falikh, son of Abir, son of Shalikh, son of Arfakhshand, son of Sam, son of Noah. Mujahid said, The kings who ruled the eastern and western parts of the world Eire four, two believers and two disbelievers. As for the two believing kings, they were Sulayman bin Dawud and Dhul-Qamayn. As for the two disbelieving kings, they were Nimrod and Nebuchadnezzar. Allah knows best. Allah said, 4Have you not looked} meaning, With your heart, O Muhammad! Tabari 5 :433

iat him who disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord} meaning, about the existence of Allah. Nimrod denied the existence of a god other than himself, as he claimed, just as Fir awn said later to his people, 4' (1-^=0 o lir- L} il know not that you have a god other than me} [28:38]. What made Nimrod commit this transgression, utter disbelief and arrant rebellion was his tyranny and the fact that he ruled for a long time. This is why the Ayah continued, id S\ & iji; \$} 4Because Allah had given him the kingdom.} It appears that Nimrod asked Ibrahim to produce proof that Allah exists. Ibrahim replied, df} iMy Lord is He Wlw gives life and causes death} meaning, The proof of Allah s existence is the creations that exist after they were nothing and perish after they had existed. This only proves the existence of the Creator, Who does what He wills, for these things could not have occurred on their own without a Creator who created them, and He is the Lord that I call to for worship, Alone without a partner. This is when Nimrod said, . t. J '\$} il give life and cause death.} Qatadah, Muhammad bin Ishaq and As-Suddi said that he meant, Two men who deserved execution were to be brought before me, and I would command that one of them be killed, and he would be killed. I would command that the second man be pardoned, and he would be pardoned. This is how I bring life and death. However, it appears that since Nimrod did not deny the existence of a Creator, his statement did not mean what Qatadah said it meant. This explanation does not provide an answer to what Ibrahim said. Nimrod arrogantly and defiantly claimed that he was the creator and pretended lil At-Jabari 5 :433,436,437

Al-Bagaralt (Part-3) that it was he who brings life and death. Later on, Firawn imitated him and announced, 41 know not that you have a god other than me> [28:38]. This is why Ibrahim said to Nimrod, St^ St a~^ iVerily, Allah brings the sun from the east; then bring it you from the west.} This Ayah means, You claim that it is you who brings life and death. He who brings life and death controls the existence and creates whatever is in it, including controlling its planets and their movements. For instance, the sun rises eveiyday from the east. Therefore, if you were god, as you claimed,^ bringing life and death, then bring the sun from the west. Since the king was aware of his weakness, inadequacy and that he was not able to reply to Ibrahim s request, he was idle, silent and unable to comment. Therefore, the proof was established against him. Allfih said, iAnd Allah guides not the people, who are wrongdoers meaning, Allah deprives the unjust people of any valid proof or argument. Furthermore, their false proof and arguments are annulled by their Lord, and they have earned His anger and will suffer severe torment. The meaning that we provided is better than the meaning that some philosophers offered, claiming that Ibrahim used the second argument because it was clearer than the first one. Rather, our explanation asserts that Ibrahim refuted both claims of Nimrod, all praise is due to Allah. As-Suddi stated that the debate between Ibrahim and Nimrod occurred after Ibrahim was thrown in the fire, for Ibrahim did not meet the king before that day.

3 & p \QxSJ u*= 4dJi4, jj&j -OH fly- 3~=- (jjc iLl oi jU*t jc 4259. Or like the one who passed by a town in ruin up to its roofs. He said : "How will Allah ever bring it to life after its death? So Allah caused him to die for a hundred years, then raised him up (again). He said: "How long did you remain (dead)?" He (the man) said: "(Perhaps) I remained (dead) a day or part of a day. He said : "Nay, you have remained (dead) for a hundred years, look at your food and your drink, they show no change; and look at your donkey! And thus We have made of you a sign for the people. Look at the bones, how We bring them together and clothe them with flesh." When this was clearly shown to him, he said, "I know (now) that Allah is able to do all things.")

The Story of Uzayr Allah's statement, 4Mi&4 jj2\$) iHave you not looked at him 10I10 disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord) means, Have you seen anyone like the person who disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord? Then, Allah connected the Ayah, Jo ' } He 4% iOr like the one who passed by a town in ruin up to its roofs) to the Ayah above by using or . Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ali bin Abi Talib said that the Ayah [2:259] meant Uzayr * Ibn Jarir^ also reported it, and this explanation was also reported by Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi Hatim from Ibn Abbas, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Sulayman bin Buraydah J3 I 1 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :1009. At-Tabari 5 :439 f3| At-Tabari 5:439,440, Ibn Abi Hatim 3:1009-1010.

39Surat 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) Mujahid bin Jabr said that the Ayah refers to a man from the Children of Israel, and the village was Jerusalem, after Nebuchadnezzar destroyed it and killed its people. 4in ruin\$ means, it became empty of people. Allah's statement, iup fo its roofs indicates that the roofs and walls (of the village) fell to the ground. TJzayr stood contemplating about what had happened to that city, after a great civilization used to inhabit it. He said, 4 W iOh! How will Allah ever bring it to life after its death?} because of the utter destruction he saw and the implausibility of its returning to what it used to be. Allah said, p 21, iii 5SCfc> Allah caused him to die for a hundred years, then raised him up (again).} The city was rebuilt seventy years after the man (TJzayr) died, and its inhabitants increased and the Children of Israel moved back to it. When Allah resurrected TJzayr after he died, the first organ that He resurrected were his eyes, so that he could witness what Allah does with him, how He brings life back to his body. When his resurrection was complete, Allah said to him, meaning through the angel, 4^je j'1 3* How long did you remain (dead)? He (the man) said: (Perhaps) I remained (dead) a day or part of a day. } The scholars said that since the man died in the early part of the day and Allah resurrected him in the latter part of the day, when he saw that the sun was still apparent, he thought that it was the sun of that very day. He said, P JJiS iSl* S. ^ j'")1 4 Or part of a day." He said: "Nay, you have remained (dead) for a hundred years, look at your food and your drink, they

show no change. He had grapes, figs and juice, and he found them as he left them; neither did the juice spoil nor the figs become bitter nor the grapes rot. iAnd look at your donkey!*, How Allah brings it back to life while you are watching. 'iZ\ dj&cjS iAnd thus We have made of you a sign for the people that Resurrection occurs. >,CUt 3} J-&V iLook at the bones, how We Nunshizuha meaning, collect them and put them back together. In his Mustadrak,

Al-Baarah (Part-3 who blew life in the donkeys nostrils, and the donkey started to bray by Allah's leave. All this occurred while TJzayr was watching, and this is when he proclaimed, ^=> ii' \$ jUtl \$He said, "I know (now) that Allah is able to do all things,"} meaning, I know that, and I did witness it with

my own eyes. Therefore, I am the most knowledgeable in this matter among the people of my time. *oi y pj J ' c ti* J-v-' iU^ & 4260.* And (remember) when Ibrahim said, "My Lord! Show me how You give life to the dead." He (Allah) said: Do you not believe? He (Ibrahim) said: "Yes (I believe), but to be stronger in faith. He said: "Take four birds, then cause them to incline towards you (then slaughter them, cut them into pieces), and then put a portion of them on every hill, and call them, they will come to you in haste. And know that Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise."} At-Tabari 5 :468 J15 t. a!. =="(jjt i- 'J* j i3\ S \$ \$ ^ , ^- ip^ J*\$3c \J" i r/>-' .v. < f T" ". >~Z* a <#sSi eft r,;aujjs-iiir,iiii=ii: ..-j. o^vai irtjl jjj t_#5i i-jlW i&b \$ jr * ill J deij LIL- &ut _ f*>-

icause them to incline towards you> means, cut them to pieces. This is the explanation of Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Malik, Abu Al-Aswad Ad-Dlli, Wahb bin Munabbih, Al-Hasan and As-SuddiJ Therefore, Ibrahim caught four birds, slaughtered them, removed the feathers, tore the birds to pieces and mixed the pieces together. He then placed parts of these mixed pieces on four or seven hills. Ibn Abbas said, Ibrahim kept the heads of these birds in his hand. Next, Allah commanded Ibrahim to call the birds to him, and he did as Allah commanded him. Ibrahim witnessed the feathers, blood and flesh of these birds fly to each other, and the parts flew each to their bodies, until every bird came back to life and came walking at a fast pace towards Ibrahim, so that the example that Ibrahim was witnessing would become more impressive. Each bird came to collect its head from Ibrahim s hand, and if he gave the bird another head the bird refused to accept it. When Ibrahim gave each bird its own head, the head was placed on its body by Allah s leave and power. 121 This is why Allah said, jcp 3 4And know that Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise and no one can overwhelm or resist Him. Whatever Allah wills, occurs without hindrance, because He is the All-Mighty, Supreme above all things, and He is Wise in His statements, actions, legislation and decrees. Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Ma'mar said that Ayyub said that Ibn Abbas commented on what Ibrahim said, 3&& ibut to be stronger in Faith), To me, there is no Ayah in the Qur an that brings more hope than this Ayah. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Muhammad bin Al-Munkadir said that Abdullah bin Abbas met Abdullah bin Amr bin Al- As and Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :1039,1040. Al-Qurtubi 3:300. At-Jabari 5 :489

said to him, Which Ayah in the Qur an carries more hope for you? Ibn Amr said, 4Say: "O Ibddi (My servants) who have transgressed against themselves (by committing evil deeds and sins)! Despair not.} [39:53]. Ibn Abbas said, But I say that it is Allah s statement, ** " " ^fX .1 *** */## * >* < , . - y * Jif pb' 3^ ufO jjc i}^ iAnd (remember) when Ibrahim said, "My Lord! Show me how You give life to the dead." He (Allah) said: Do you not believe?" He (Ibrahim) said: "Yes (I believe)...} Allah accepted Ibrahim s affirmation when he merely said, Yes. This Ayah refers to the doubts that attack the heart and the thoughts that Shaytan inspires.

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) Said bin Jubayr commented, Meaning spending in Allah s obedience. 1 11 Makhul said that the Ayah means, Spending on Jihad, on horse stalls, weapons and so forth. The parable in the Ayah is more impressive on the heart than merely mentioning the number seven hundred. This Ayah indicates that Allah grows the good deeds for its doers, just as He grows the plant for whoever sows it in fertile land. The Sunnah also mentions that the deeds are multiplied up to seven hundred folds. For instance, Imam

46 Tafstr Ibn Kathir folds, to as much as Allah wills. Allah said, "Except the fast, for it is for Me and I will reward for it. One abandons his food and desire in My sake. The fasting person has two times of happiness : when he breaks his fast and when he meets his Lord. Verily, the odor that comes from the mouth of whoever fasts is more pure to Allah than the scent of musk. Fasting is a shield (against sinning), fasting is a shield [1]

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) all needs) and He is Most Forbearing.} \$264. O you who believe! Do not render in vain your Sadaqah (charity) by reminders of your generosity or by injury, like him who spends his wealth to be seen of men, and he does not believe in Allah, nor in the Last Day. His likeness is the likeness of a smooth rock on which is a little dust; on it falls heavy rain which leaves it bare. They are not able to do anything with what they have earned. And Allah does not guide the disbelieving people.} To Remind About Charity Given is Forbidden Allah praises those who spend from their money in His cause, and then refrain from reminding those who received the charity of that fact, whether these hints take the form of words or actions. Allah's statement, 4or with injury}, indicates that they do not cause harm to those whom they gave the charity to, for this harm will only annul the charity. Allah next promised them the best rewards for this good deed, V&> ** |*A*' 4their reward is with their Lord}, indicating that Allah Himself will reward them for these righteous actions. Further, 4on them shall be no fear} regarding the horrors of the Day of Resurrection, 4^'yjk (U 4nor shall they grieve} regarding the offspring that they leave behind and the adornment and delights of this world. They will not feel sorry for this, because they will acquire what is far better for them. Allah then said, 4Kind words} meaning, compassionate words and a

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) Hike him who spends his wealth to be seen of men} meaning, Do not nullify your acts of charity by following them with reminders and harm, just like the charity of those who give it to show off to people. The boasting person pretends to give away charity for Allah's sake, but in reality seeks to gain people's praise and the reputation of being kind or generous, or other material gains of this life. All the while, he does not think about Allah or gaining His pleasure and generous rewards, and this is why Allah said, iya a iand he does not believe in Allah, nor in the Last Day.} Allah next set the example of whoever gives charity to show off. Ad-Dahhak commented that the example fits one who follows his acts of charity with reminders or harm. 111 Allah said, iofcgZ &Z} 4His likeness is the likeness of Safivdn} where Safwan, from is Safwanah, meaning the smooth rocks, vi/ #4^ ion which is little dust; on it falls a Wabil} meaning, heavy rain, H'ZZ t>} iwhich leaves it bare.} This Ayah means that heavy rain left the Safivan completely barren of dust. Such is the case with Allah's action regarding the work of those who show off, as their deeds are bound to vanish and disappear, even though people think that these deeds are as plentiful as specks of dust. So Allah said. iThey are not able to do anything with what they have earned. And Allah does not guide the disbelieving people. } iXj-t (* Sit&}Tabari 5:527.

J mm 10 s\$m Jj'jl*"t} i*-iL.j JJa3jjj\j\^L^oJ^N^J^i->^?t4i^==^ CiliS s'*" t'-5- if " OJjJ^io(" - =>-1 jjjl {njil _j^zjj jU"juUj &&% &%fl"dj ~r- t> ^ \$4.1 as i\$ i^a -L-jUl (jl Il^o-lc^ ** ^ A#-wJi^,'_)4i\j%^a3j oya_*> djiltj Jt'j T -" (^ oji ifj5i!LU 4S-W? 4265. And the parable of those who spend their wealth seeking Allah's pleasure while they in their own selves are sure and certain that Allah will reward them (for their spending in His cause), is that of a gar- den on a height; heavy rain

falls on it and it doubles its yield of harvest. And if it does not receive heavy rain, light rain suffices it. And Allah is All-Seer (knows well) of what you do.} This is the example of the believers who give away charity seeking only Allah's pleasure, (while they in their own selves are sure and certain) meaning, they are certain that Allah shall reward them for these righteous acts with the best rewards. Similarly, in a Hadith collected by Al-Bukhari and Muslim, the Messenger of Allah said, n IjLll>-ij liLiIjI j\JlAj Lao ^Whoever fasts Ramadan with faith and expectation ..." meaning, believing that Allah commanded the fast, all the while awaiting His reward for fasting it. m Path Al-Bari 4 :300

Allah's statement, iis that of a garden on a Rabwah means, the example of a garden on a height above the ground, as the majority of scholars have stated. Ibn Abbas and Ad-Dahhak added that it also has flowing rivers. 11 Allah's statement, fWabil falls on it} means, heavy rain as we stated, So it produces its, iyield of harvest} meaning, fruits or produce, 4doubles}, as compared to other gardens. iS& Jtb } And if it does not receive Wdbil, a Tall suffices it.} Ad-Dahhak said that the Tali is light rain. 2 * The Ayah indicates that the garden on the Rabwah is always fertile, for if heavy rain does not fall on it, light rain will suffice for it. Such is the case regarding the believer's good deeds, for they never become barren. Rather, Allah accepts the believer's righteous deeds and increases them, each according to his deeds. This is why Allah said next, oj" "> '< \$)} iAnd Allah is All-Seer of what you do} meaning, none of His servants' deeds ever escapes His perfect watch. y vpj' jfc -m At-Tabari 5:539.Tabari 5:539.

4266. Would any of you wish to have a garden with date palms and vines, with rivers flowing underneath, and all kinds of fruits for him therein, while he is stricken with old age, and his children are weak (not able to look after themselves), then it is struck with a fiery whirlwind, so that it is burnt? Thus does Allah make clear His Aydt to you that you may give thought.} The Example of Evil Deeds Nullifying Good Deeds

is fiery, so that it is burnt} meaning, its fruits were burnt and its trees were destroyed. Therefore, what will his condition be like? Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Al-Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said, Allah has set a good parable, and all His parables are good. He said, a %}} 4Wo"W any 0/you wish to have a garden with date palms and vines, with rivers flowing underneath, and all kinds of fruits for him therein.} But he lost all this in his old age, i'J&f^} iwhile he is stricken with old age} while his offspring and children are weak just before the end of his life. Then a lightning storm came and destroyed his garden. Then he did not have the strength to grow another garden, nor did his offspring offer enough help. This is the condition of the disbeliever on the Day of Resurrection when he returns to Allah, for he will not have any good deeds to provide an excuse - or refuge - for him, just as the man in the parable had no strength to replant the garden. The disbeliever will not find anything to resort to for help, just as the offspring of the man in the parable did not provide him with help. So he will be deprived of his reward when he most needs it, just as the man in the parable was deprived of Allah's garden when he most needed it, when he became old and his offspring weak. 111 In his Mustadrak,

This is why Allah said, i'o&Z p t Sg 3 ?} iThus Allah makes clear to you His Laws in order that you may give thought> meaning, comprehend and understand the parables and their intended implications. Similarly, Allah said. ": ofy. dJbify 4And these similitudes We put forward for mankind; but none will understand them except those who have knowledge (of Allah and His signs)} [29:43]. % *p u *q; j. \&\ rp: 'a# [ff JLi C)1 fjleij 4-j iP-Z J ~V> *% SjLu ii. SiJi tjit'f. os- uj^ oji tis: >:9^ % ijijt uj 4267. O

you who believe! Spend of the good things which you have (legally) earned, and of that which We have produced from the earth for you, and do not aim at that which is bad to spend from it, (though) you would not accept it save if you close your eyes and tolerate therein. And know that Allah is Rich (free of all needs), and worthy of all praise.} 4268. Shaytan threatens you with poverty and orders you to commit Fahshd (evil deeds) whereas Allah promises you forgiveness from Himself and bounty, and Allah is All- Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All-Knower.} 4269. He grants Hikmah to whom He wills, and he, to whom Hikmah is granted, is indeed granted abundant good. But none remember (will receive admonition) except men of understanding.} The Encouragement to Spend Honest Money for Allah's Sake Allah commands His believing servants to spend in charity, as Ibn Abbas stated, from the pure, honest money that they

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) earned and from the fruits and vegetables that He has grown for them in the land. Ibn Abbas said, Allah commanded them to spend from the purest, finest and best types of their money and prohibited spending from evil and dishonest money, because Allah is pure and good and only accepts that which is pure and good. This is why Allah said, and do not aim at that which is bad* meaning, filthy (impure) money, Ji i" * I" * "*" . * V oy&l K-tf 4to spend from it, (though) you would not accept it) meaning, If you were given this type, you would not take it, except if you tolerate the deficiency in it. Verily, Allah is far Richer than you. He is in no need of this money, so do not give, for His sake, what you would dislike for yourselves. It was reported that, , %) and do not aim at that which is bad to spend from it) means, Do not spend from the dishonest, impure money instead of the honest, pure money. Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Bara bin Azib commented on Allah's statement, 40 you who believe! Spend of the good things which you have (legally) earned, and of that which We have produced from the earth for you, and do not aim at that which is bad to spend from it,) that it was revealed about the Ansar. When the season for harvesting date-trees would start, the Ansar would collect ripe- date branches from their gardens and hang them on a rope erected between two pillars in the Masjid of the Messenger of Allah. The poor emigrant Companions would eat from these dates. However, some of them (Ansar) would also add lesser type of dates in between ripe-date branches, thinking they are

allowed to do so. Allah revealed this Ayah about those who did this, 44^ IJX %) and do not aim at that which is bad to spend from Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, A 'VI *&% ^j) iyou would not accept it save if you close your eyes and tolerate therein) means, If you had a right on someone who would pay you less than what you gave them, you would not agree until you require more from them to make up the difference. This is why Allah said, J%) isave if you close your eyes and tolerate therein) meaning, How do you agree for Me what you do not agree for yourselves, while I have a right to the best and most precious of your possessions? Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir recorded this Hadith and Ibn Jarir added, And this is the meaning of Allah's statement, 4By no means shall you attain Al-Birr, unless you spend of that which you love) [4:92] Allah said next, 4JL & % \fj^ 4And know that Allah is Rich (free of all needs), and worthy of all praise) meaning, Although Allah commanded you to give away the purest of your money in charity. He is far Richer from needing your charity, but the purpose is that the distance between the rich and the poor becomes less. Similarly, Allah said, Tabari 5:559. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :1088 , At-Tabari 5 :565

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) ipi 3c S.5 %V&& j & at is neither their meat nor their blood that reaches Allah, but it is piety from you that reaches Him> [22:37], Allah is Rich and free of needing anything from any of His creatures, while all of His creatures stand in need of Him. Allah's bounty encompassing, and what He has never ends. Therefore, whoever gives away good and pure things in charity, let him know that Allah is the Most Rich, His favor is enormous and He is Most Generous, Most Compassionate; and He shall reward him for his charity and multiply it many times. So who would lend to He Who is neither poor nor unjust, Who is worthy of all praise in all His actions, statements, and decisions, of Whom there is neither a deity worthy of worship except Him, nor a Lord other than Him? Shaytan's Doubts Concerning Spending in Charity Allah said, y,% to;m && 'jx f y 4 Shaytan threatens you with poverty and orders you to commit Fahsha'; whereas Allah promises you forgiveness from Himself and bounty, and Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All-Knower Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah jg said. v-jOSCj i. jUa.Jjl ill uO illj .MU* jjn if iiJ * J I JjUalljl I# -J J*J JU tjill jf* <,\ "Shaytan has an effect on the son of Adam, and the angel also has an effect. As for the effect of Shaytan, it is by his threatening with evil repercussions and rejecting the truth. As for the effect of the angel, it is by his promise of a good end and believing in the truth. Whoever finds the latter, let him know that it is coming from Allah and let him thank Allah for it. Whoever finds the former, let him seek refuge - with Allah -

from Shaytan . The Prophet then recited, fit; * ,i-% pi {Shaytan threatens you with poverty and orders you to commit Fahsha'; whereas Allah promises you forgiveness from Himself and bounty^ (1 This is the narration that At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasab collected in the book of Tafsir in their Sunan collections . Allah said, \$ pSa {Shaytan threatens you with povertyf, so that you hold on to whatever you have and refrain from spending it in Allah's pleasure. iAnd orders you to commit Fahsha>, meaning, Shaytan forbids you from spending in charity because of the false fear of becoming poor, and he encourages evil deeds, sins, indulging in what is prohibited, and immoral conduct. Allah said, {Whereas Allah promises you forgiveness from Himself instead of ie evil that Shaytan enjoins on you, \nd Bounty^ as opposed to the poverty that Shaytan frightens you with, {And Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All- Ktiower.f he Meaning of Al-Hikmah \llah said, 4* a%} Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :1090 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :332, An-Nasab in Al-Kubra 6 :305.

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) - > 1 4dLjU (Jjji "_4olUj 'll1M .J.ilxju r'i > > x . \La "i 1 ^ j>- =LLC. 7aSvj |>- ==Ljji- iHe grants Hikmah to whom He wills. Ali bin Abi Jahlah reported that Ibn Abbas said, That is knowledge of the Qur'an. For instance, the abrogating and the abrogated, what is plain and clear and

what is not as plain and clear, what it allows, and what it does not allow, and its parables. 111 Imam

60 Tafair Ibn Katliir understanding.} means, Those who will benefit from the advice are those who have sound minds and good comprehension with which they understand the words (of advice and reminder) and their implications. o; iii-X "i \ djf* j oi j' oi 5.# ^ StW Ji-f * 'Xfj 1^=0^ X*- 4270. And whatever you spend far spendings (e.g., in Sadaqah) or whatever vow you make, be sure Allah knows it all. And far the wrongdoers there are no helpers. 4271. If you disclose your Sadaqdt (almsgiving), it is well; but if you conceal them and give them to the poor, that is better for you. (Allah) will expiate you some of your sins. And Allah is Well-Acquainted with what you do.} Allah states that He has perfect knowledge of the good deeds performed by all of His creation, such as charity and various vows, and

He rewards tremendously for these deeds, provided they are performed seeking His Face and His promise. Allah also warns those who do not work in his obedience, but instead disobey His command, reject His revelation and worship others besides Him: 4jfa j 4Andfar the wrongdoers there are no helpers .} meaning, who will save them from Allah s anger and torment on the Day of Resurrection. The Virtue of Disclosing or Concealing Charity Allah said, 4ji ciixSli 14-5 4Ifyou disclose your Sadaqdt, it is well meaning, It is well ifyou make known the charity that you give away. Allah s statement, 4But if you conceal them and give them to the poor, that is

He who utters aloud Qur'dnic recitation is just like he who discloses charity acts. He who conceals Qur'dnic recitation is just like he who conceals charity acts . The Ayah indicates that it is better that acts of charity be concealed, as reiterated by the Hadith that the Two Sahihs recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Aliah jg said, ^ I*-*'-?- 1 jil ^ UUi O'jJjj ijill ou ai -jf> Jfjj go;> O lii yj olii :jUi olj ;i^ll J4-jj jUi; 7 tUUaU jixA jxk: lAllah will give shade to seven on the Day when there will be no shade but His. (They are:) a just ruler, a youth who has been brought up in the worship of Allah, two persons who love each other only for Allah's sake who meet and part in Allah's cause only, a man whose heart is attached to the Masjids from the time he departs the Masjid until he returns to it, a person who remembers Allah in seclusion and his eyes are then flooded with tears, a man who refuses the call of a charming woman of noble birth for illicit intercourse with her and says, 7 fear Allah, Lord of the worlds', and a man who gives charitable gifts so secretly that his left hand does not know what his right hand has given .

Allah s statement, irt i (Allah) will expiate you some of your sins> means, in return for giving away charity, especially if it was concealed. Therefore, you will gain goodness by your rank being raised, and your sins being forgiven. Allah s statement, 4if- A ^'. iAtid Allah is Well-Acquainted with what you do means, No good deed that you perform escapes His knowledge, and He shall reward for it. yy. AA' Ji-a -S' vA 4 ljj_ ^ 'Z ;ti' j^Lssar ^>;Vf * *i' -A*- 0; iyi - o -UJf * > jy- v5 f-jjj AiA -' * ^y*i A- 'i 4272. Not upon you (Muhammad jfe) is their guidance, but Allah guides whom He wills. And whatever you spend in good, it is for yourselves, when you spend not except seeking Allah's Face. And whatever you spend in good, it will be repaid to you in full, and you shall not be wronged.) i273. (Charity is) for Fuqard (the poor), who in Allah s cause are restricted (from travel), and cannot move about in the land (for trade or work). The one who knows them not, thinks that they are rich because of their modesty. You may know them by their mark, they do not beg of people at all. And whatever you spend in good, surely Allah knows it well.) 4274. Tlwse who spend their zwealth (in Allah s cause) by night and day, in secret and in public, they shall have their reward with their Lord. On them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve.)

Al-Baqarah (Part-1) Giving Charity to Polytheists Abu Abdur-Rahman

He went out with his charity and (unknowingly) gave it to an adulteress. The next morning the people said that alms were given to an adulteress. The man said, O Allah! All the praises are far You. (I gave my alms) to an adulteress. Tonight, I shall give alms again.

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) make him take a lesson and spend his wealth that Allah has given him. As for the thief, it might make him abstain from stealing ."o Who Deserves Charity Allah said, Charity is) for the poor, ivho in Allah's cause are restricted (from travel meaning, the migrants who migrated to Allah and

His Messenger, resided in Al-Madinah and did not have resources that sufficiently provided them with their needs, 3} iAnd cannot Darbdti (move about) in the land} meaning, They cannot travel in the land to seek means of livelihood. Allah said in other instances [using a variation of the word Darban i't&4 ot lir-uS ' 4*- 0-4 c]OV' 4 iAnd when you (Muslims) travel in the land, there is no sin on you ifyou shorten the Salali (the prayer)} [4:101], and, ot Jfjji J OJj* fL* 'bflS* J iHe knows that there will be some among you sick, others traveling through the land, seeking ofAllah's bounty, yet others fighting in Allah's cause} [73:20]. Allah then said, iJ&\ lysZ} iThe one who knows them not, thinks that they are rich because of their modesty} meaning, those who do not know their situation think that they are well-off, because they are modest in their clothes and m Fath At-Bari 3 :340 , Muslim 2 :709

SahVis recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said to Sa d bin Abi Waqqas: ^ -s 0 s" ^ ' * jZ Lj, y dLiy ii~ji ddSjl 4 P-j ij? </ J**" cT "Yow will nof spent/ charity ivith which you seek Allah's Face, but you will ascend a higher degree and status be- cause of it, including what you put in your wife s mouth. i Imam

Al-Baqarali (Part-3) obedience. We previously explained the Ayah, ithere shall be nofear on them nor shall they grieve.} u slss & (S v* && v 5M~i; 'H> jj ,*:r Ikjtf fjij iif J"* ** 'j** (Hp\, ^ jCS> >"f Ji uJJ^j C&L U \$ 4275. Those loho eat Riba will not stand (on the Day of Resurrection) except like the standing of a person beaten by Shaytan leading him to insanity. That is because they say: "Trading is only like Riba, ivhereas Allah has permitted trading and forbidden Riba. So whosoever receives an admonition from his Lord and stops eating Riba, shall not be punished for the past; his case is for Allah (to judge); but whoever returns (to Riba), such are the dwellers of the Fire - they will Abide therein. The Punishment for Dealing with Riba (Interest and Usury) After Allah mentioned the righteous believers who give charity, pay Zakah and spend on their relatives and families at various times and conditions, He then mentioned those who deal in usury and illegally acquire people s money, using various evil methods and wicked ways. Allah describes the condition of these people when they are resurrected from their graves and brought back to life on the Day of Resurrection: iThose who eat Riba will not stand (on the Day of Resurrection) except like the standing of a person beaten by Shaytan leading him to insanity.} This Ayah means, on the Day of Resurrection, these people will get up from their graves just as the person afflicted by insanity or possessed by a demon would. Ibn Abbas said, On

the Day of Resurrection, those who consume Riba will be

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 767–775]

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) Allah allow this, but did not allow that, they asked in defiance ofAllah's commandments. Allah s statement, iWhereas Allah has permitted trading andforbidden Riba} might be a continuation of the answer to the disbelievers claim, who uttered it, although they knew that Allah decided that ruling on trade is different from that of Riba. Indeed, Allah is the Most Knowledgeable, Most Wise, Whose decision is never resisted. Allah is never asked about what He does, while they will be asked. He is knowledgeable of the true reality of all things and the benefits they carry. He knows what benefits His servants, so He allows it for them, and what harms them, so He forbids them from it. He is more merciful with them than the mother with her own infant. Thereafter, Allah said, 4/*' J* V* Jji .juj J* ikgj iSo whosoever receives an admonition from his Lord and stops eating Riba, shall not be

punished for the past; his case is for Allah (to judge),} meaning, those who have knowledge that Allah made usury unlawful, and refrain from indulging in it as soon as they acquire this knowledge, then Allah will forgive their previous dealings in Riba, Cf- lit & } iAllah has forgiven what is past.} On the day Makkah was conquered the Prophet jg said, *All cases of Riba during the time of Jdhiliyyah (pre-Islamic period of ignorance) is annulled and under my feet, and the first Riba I annul is the Riba of Al-'Abbs (the Prophet's uncle). We should mention that the Prophet jg did not require the |i| Abu Dawud 3 :628

return of the interest that they gained on their Riba during the time of Jahiliyyah. Rather, he pardoned the cases of Riba, that occurred in the past, just as Allah said,)' ij-A) -it- ?&} ishall not be punished for the past; his case is for Allah (to judge).} Said bin Jubayr and As-Suddi said that, ishall not be punished for the past refers to the Riba one consumed before it was prohibited. 1 11 Allah then said, iBut whoever returns meaning, deals in Riba after gaining knowledge that Allah prohibited it, then that warrants punishment, and in this case, the proof will have been established against such person. This is why Allah said, isuch are the dwellers of the Fire - they will abide therein forever.}

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) for some of its produce, was prohibited. Muzabanah, trading fresh dates still on trees with dried dates already on the ground, was prohibited. Muhaqalah, which refers to trading produce not yet harvested, with crops already harvested, was also prohibited. These were prohibited to eradicate the possibility that Riba might be involved, for the quality and equity of such items are only known after they become dry. The subject of Riba is a difficult subject for many scholars. We should mention that the Leader of the Faithful, Umar bin Al-Khattab, said, I wished that the Messenger of Allah sg had made three matters clearer for us, so that we could refer to his decision: the grandfather (regarding inheriting from his grandchildren), the Kalalah (those who leave neither descendants nor ascendants as heirs) and some types of Riba. ^ Umar was referring to the types of transactions where it is not clear whether they involve Riba or not. The Shari'ah supports the rule that for any matter that is unlawful, then the means to it are also unlawful, because whatever results in the unlawful is unlawful, in the same way that whenever an obligation will not be complete except with something, then that something is itself an obligation. The Two Sahih recorded that An-Nu'man bin Bashir said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, I t Jiii olj cjln j. ^ J, ly J S-f iii-ii br- uBoth lawful and unlawful things are evident, but in between there are matters that are not clear. So whoever saves himself from these unclear matters, he saves his religion and his honor. And whoever indulges in these unclear matters, he will have fallen into the prohibitions, just like a shepherd who grazes (his animals) near a private pasture, at any moment he is liable to enter it. The Sunan records that Al-Hasan bin Ali said that he heard the Messenger of Allah sfe say, Fath Al-Bari 10 :48 , Muslim 4 :2322 Al-Bari 1 : 153 , Muslim 3:1219.

V U Jj iL^; U jS" Leave that which makes you doubt for that which does not make you doubt . (1

Al-Raqarah (Part-3) "May Allah curse whoever consumes Riba, whoever pays Riba, the two who are witnesses to it, and the scribe who records it.*" They say they only have witnesses and a scribe to write the Riba, contract when they want it to appear to be a legitimate agreement, but it is still invalid because the ruling is applied to the agreement itself, not the form that it appears in. Verily, deeds are judged by their intentions. * >< 'y'. <.* <*\SZ\\ tj)? . will destroy Riba and will give increase for Sadaqdt. And

Allah likes not the disbelievers, sinners .} . Truly, those who believe, and do deeds of righteousness, and perform the Saldh and give Zakdh, they will have their reward with their Lord. On them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve. Allah Does Not Bless Riba Allah states that He destroys Riba, either by removing this money from those who eat it, or by depriving them of the blessing, and thus the benefit of their money. Because of their Riba, Allah will torment them in this life and punish them for it on the Day of Resurrection. Allah said, \$^ d&il jj sfA -i iSay: "Not equal are Al-Khabith (evil things) and At-Tayyib (good things), even though the abundance of Al-Khabith may please you"} (5:100) .A cl /Wf-njy iAnd put the wicked (disbelievers and doers of evil deeds) one over another, heap them together and cast them into Hell} [8:37], and, 3:1219.

76 Tafstr Ibn Kathlr Xi ljjj> (jjlj: "{And that which you give in gift (to others), in order that it may increase (your wealth by expecting to get a better one in return) from other people's property, has no increase with Allah} (30:39). Ibn Jarir said that Allah s statement, 4!S' I lit K"

ip\ 'if# 4-And Allah likes not the disbelievers, sinners indicates that Allah does not like he who has a disbelieving heart, who is a sinner in tongue and action. There is a connection between the beginning of the Ayah on Riba and

what Allah ended it with. Those who consume Riba are not

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 775–791]

satisfied with the permissible and pure resources that Allah provided them. Instead, they try to illegally acquire people s money by relying on evil methods. This demonstrates their lack of appreciation for the bounty that Allah provides. PraisingThoseWho Thank Allah Allah praised those who believe in His Lordship, obey His commands, thank Him and appreciate Him. They are those who are kind to His creation, establish prayer and give charity due on their money. Allah informed them of the honor that He has prepared for them and that they will be safe from the repercussions of the Day of Resurrection. Allah said, jU is is iTruly, those who believe, and do deeds of righteousness, and perform the Salah and give Zakah, they will have their reward with their Lord. On them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve.} p S'*. Si Jy. !# '*' ij SjZliu V |^=qy1 J-/ *j "if oi jl jA j -" dl AA-* // * jj ol) sl ^ jj, 4278. O yoM w/io believe! Have Taqwa of Allah and give up what retnainsfrom Riba, ifyou are (really) believers .} 4279. And ifyou do not do it, then take a notice ofwarfrom Allah and His Messenger but ifyou repent, you shall have your capital sums. Deal not unjustly, and you shall not be dealt

with unjustly. 1280. And if the debtor is having a hard time, then grant him time till it is easy for him to repay; but ifyou remit it by way ofcharity, that is betterfor you ifyou did but know> 1281. And have Taqwa the Day when you shall be brought back to Allah . Then every person shall be paid what he earned, and they shall not be dealt with unjustly. The Necessity of TaqwaandAvoiding Riba Allah commands His believing servants to fear Him and warns them against what would bring them closer to His anger and drive them away from His pleasure. Allah said, 4* Qejf iO you who believe! Have Taqwa ofAllah} meaning, fear Him and remember that He is watching all that you do. 45^ he jji (j iAnd give up what remains of Riba} meaning, abandon the Riba that people still owe you upon hearing this warning, < #& fUr& iifyou indeed have been believers} believing in the trade that He allowed you and

the prohibition of Riba. Zayd bin Aslam, Ibn Jurayj, Muqatil bin Hayyan and As-Suddi said that this Ayah was revealed about Bani Amr bin 'Umayr, a sub-tribe of Thaqlf, and Bani Al-Mughlah, from the tribe of Bani Makhzum, between whom were outstanding transactions of Riba leftover from time of Jahiliyyah. When Islam came and both tribes became Muslims, Thaqlf required Bani Al-Mughlah to pay the Riba of that transaction, but Bani Al-Mughlah said, We do not pay Riba in Islam. Attab bin Usayd, the Prophet's deputy in Makkah, wrote to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ about this matter. This Ayah was then revealed and the Messenger of Allah ﷺ conveyed it to Attab, 1A2 \$4 4 g c & fjsi \pa Qi} jif bt lyjfe

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) 40 you who believe! Be afraid of Allah and give up what remains (due to you) from Riba (from now onward), if you are (really) believers. And if you do not do it, then take a notice of war from Allah and His Messenger.} They said, We repent to Allah and abandon whatever is left of our Riba", and they all abandoned it This Ayah serves as a stern threat to those who continue to deal in Riba after Allah revealed this warning. Riba Constitutes War Against Allah and His Messenger Ibn Jurayj said that Ibn Abbas said that, 4then take a notice of war means, Be sure of a war from Allah and His Messenger. ' He also said, On the Day of Resurrection, those who eat Riba will be told, take up arms for war. He then recited, 4And if you do not do it, then take a notice of war from Allah and His Messenger.^ Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said about, It is if LA** of 4And if you do not do it, then take a notice of war from Allah and His Messenger,} Whoever kept dealing with Riba and did not refrain from it, then the Muslim Leader should require him to repent. If he still did not refrain from Riba, the Muslim Leader should cut off his head. Allah then said, 4But if you repent, you shall have your capital sums. Deal not unjustly} *** Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :1 140,1 141 . This story is not authentic. Jabari 6 : 26 Tabari 6:25. * At-Tabari 6:25.

by taking the Riba, %} iAnd you shall not be dealt with unjustly meaning, your original capital will not diminish. Rather, you will receive only what you lent without increase or decrease. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Amr bin Al-Ahwas said, The Messenger of Allah ﷺ gave a speech during the Farewell Hajj saying; jA Xs- \jj Lj Jj\j tj voi. :::\j j *Verily, every case of Riba from the Jahiliyyah is completely annulled. You will only take back your capital, without increase or decrease. The first Riba that 1 annul is the Riba of AWWabbin bin 'Abdul-Muttalib, all of it is annulledJ111 Being Kind to Debtors Who Face Financial Difficulties Allah said, jy iyii Jj YJ-Ya d! jS-* j TA*. iAnd if the debtor is having a hard time, then grant him time till it is easy for him to repay; but if you remit it by way of charity, that is better for you if you did but know.} Allah commands creditors to be patient with debtors who are having a hard time financially, 3 , j } iAnd if the debtor is having a hard time (has no money), then grant him time till it is easy for him to repay.} During the time of Jahiliyyah, when the debt came to term, the creditor would say to the debtor, Either pay now or interest will be added to the debt. Allah encouraged creditors to give debtors respite regarding their debts and promised all that is good, and a great reward Ibn Abi Hatim 3:1147.

Al-Baqarah (Part-3J from Him for this righteous deed, jUS jj, jf- iBut if you remit it by way of charity, that is better for you if you did but know meaning, if you forfeit your debts and cancel them completely. Imam

Allah further advised His servants, by reminding them that this life will soon end and all the wealth in it will vanish. He also reminded them that the Hereafter will surely come, when the Return to Him will occur, and that He will hold His creation accountable for what they did, rewarding them or punishing them accordingly. Allah also warned them against His torment, Ji "/ Ik t * s u o? * \$ r i And have Taqwd for the Day when you shall be brought back to Allah. Thai every person shall be paid what he earned, and they shall not be dealt with unjustly.} It was reported that this was the last Ayah revealed from the Glorious Qur an.

This is the same narration reported by Ad-Dahhak and Al- Awfi from Ibn Abbas. dl \$2 4 t C \$ > iS ifit ^a2ij la i^=> ;J J vt v; JJ^iX jl U~".> ji , ' *Jx- <^jj' o'? oji ii* J-iJj V> ' jlilj jiJ (jU ^=OWj <_ Ot : r J-iili ijj eP;l-l" _)* j~J J (ff i 1 W J'i - 4=-^ j^oJ oi oJS/ ,;-; v)^t*j J-4>" .)\$ di !=. 3 ;jL&5 d 2 vj i u' lit it 'JJ i i>"C j/i o' "it ttf'tr' 1x04 fy*J &* jX}'i / jS\$ -i; 4 Ijl+itj -jt & 4\$ =CZ \2j& tis-1 "**** jlssutju) iil i_"i-j'j (" =u AOli Ijiiij jlj jL_*i YJ ^ ,W ^ If. . O t/OH zy/iu believe! When you contract a debt far a fixed period, lorile it doion. Let a scribe ivrite it doivn in justice between you. Let not the scribe refuse to ivrite, as Allah has taught him, so let him ivrite. Let him (the debtor) who incurs the liability dictate, and he must have Taqivd of Allah, his Lord, and diminish not anything of what he awes. But if the debtor is ofpoor understanding, or weak, or is unable to dictate for himself, then let his guardian dictate in justice. And get two witnesses out of your own men. And if there are not two men (available), then a man and two women, such as you agree far ivitnesses, so that if one of them (two women) errs, the other can remind her. And the witnesses should not refuse when they are called (far evidence). You should not become weary to write it (your contract), whether it be small or big, far its fixed term, that is more just ivith Allah; more solid as evidence, and more convenient to prevent doubts among yourselves, save when it is a present trade which you carry out on the spot among yourselves, then there is no sin on you if you do not write it down. But take witnesses whenever you make a commercial contract. Let neither scribe nor witness suffer any harm, but if m At-Tabari 6 :40.

* ' Whoever pays money in advance (jbr dates to be delivered later) should pay it Jbr known specified measure and weight (of the dates) for a specified date .

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) ^Whoever kept knowledge to himself will be restrained by a bridle made offire on the Day ofResurrectionV Mujahid and Ata said that if asked to do so, The scribe is required to record. Allah s statement, iS 4 ilet him (the debtor) who incurs the liability dictate, and he must have Taqwa ofAllah, his Lord> indicates that the debtor should dictate to the scribe what he owes, so let him fear Allah, 4And diminish not anything ofwhat he owes,}' meaning, not hide any portion ofwhat he owes. 4But if the debtor is ofpoor understanding} and is not allowed to decide on such matters, because he used to waste money, for instance, 40r weak}, such as being too young or insane, 40r is unable to dictate for himself} because of a disease, or ignorance about such matters, 4then let his guardian dictate in justice.} Witnesses Should Attend the Dictation ofContracts Allah said, 4And get two witnesses out ofyour own men} requiring witnesses to attend the dictation of contracts to m At-Tabarani 5:11.

further preserve the contents, &&p ofr 4Attd if there are not tioo men (available), then a man and two women } this requirement is only for contracts that directly or indirectly involve money. Allah requires that two women take the place of one man as witness, because of the woman s shortcomings, as the Prophet jg described.

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) witnesses. Further, Allah's statement, *And if one of them errs, the other can remind her; and the witnesses should not refuse when they are called*, means, when people are called to be witnesses, they should agree, as Qatadah and Ar-Rabi bin Anas stated. Similarly, Allah said, *Let not the scribe refuse to write as Allah has taught him, so let him write.* Some say that this Ayah indicates that agreeing to become a witness is Fard Kifayah (required on at least a part of the Muslim Ummah). However, the majority of the scholars say that the Ayah, *And the witnesses should not refuse when they are called* is referring to testifying to what the witnesses actually witnessed,' thus befitting their description of being witnesses. Therefore, when the witness is called to testify to what he witnessed, he is required to give testimony, unless this obligation was already fulfilled, in which case such testimony becomes Fard Kifayah. Mujahid and Abu Mijlaz said, If you are called to be a witness, then you have the choice to agree. If you witnessed and were called to testify, then come forward. It was reported that Ibn Abbas and Al-At-Tabari 6:68. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 3:1181, At-Tabari 6:71.

the obligation includes both cases, agreeing to be a witness and testifying to what one witnessed. Allah's statement, *You should not become weary to write it (your contract), whether it be small or large, for its fixed term* perfects this direction from Allah by commanding that the debt be written, whether the amount is large or small. Allah said, *You should not become weary* meaning, do not be discouraged against writing transactions and their terms, whether the amount involved is large or small. Allah's statement, *that is more just with Allah; more solid as evidence, and more convenient to prevent doubts among yourselves* means, writing transactions that will be fulfilled at a later date is more just with Allah meaning better and more convenient in order to preserve the terms of the contract. Therefore, recording such agreements helps the witnesses, when they see their handwriting - or signatures - later on and thus remember what they witnessed, for it is possible that the witnesses might forget what they witnessed. *And more convenient to prevent doubts among yourselves* meaning, this helps repel any doubt. Since if you need to refer to the contract that you wrote and the doubt will end. Allah's statement, *save when it is a present trade which you carry out on the spot among yourselves, then there is no sin on you if you do not write it down* indicates that if the transaction will be fulfilled immediately, then there is no harm if it is not recorded.

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) As for requiring witnesses to be present in trading transactions, Allah said, *But take witnesses whenever you make a commercial contract. However, this command was abrogated by, {Then if one of you entrusts the other, let the one who is entrusted discharge his trust (faithfully).}* Or, it could be that having witnesses in such cases is only recommended and not obligatory, as evident from the Hadith that Khuzaymah bin Thabit Al-Ansari narrated which Imam Ahmad collected. Umarah bin Khuzaymah Al-Ansari said that his uncle, who was among the Prophet's Companions, told him that the Prophet ﷺ was making a deal for a horse with a bedouin man. The Prophet ﷺ asked the bedouin to follow him so that he could pay him the price of the horse. The Prophet ﷺ went ahead of the bedouin. The bedouin met several men who tried to buy his horse, not knowing if the Prophet ﷺ was actually determined to buy it. Some people offered more money for the horse than the Prophet ﷺ had. The bedouin man said to the Prophet ﷺ , If you want to buy this horse, then buy it or

I will sell it to someone else. When he heard the bedouin man's words, the Prophet ﷺ stood up and said, Have I not bought that horse from you? The bedouin said, By Allah! I have not sold it to you. The Prophet ﷺ said, Rather, I did buy it from you. The people gathered around the Prophet ﷺ and the Bedouin while they were disputing, and the bedouin said, Bring forth a witness who testifies that I sold you the horse. Meanwhile, the Muslims who came said to the bedouin, Woe to you! The Prophet only says the truth. When Khuzaymah bin Thabit came and heard the dispute between the Prophet ﷺ and the bedouin who was saying, Bring forth a witness who testifies that I sold you the horse, Khuzaymah said, I bear witness that you sold him the horse. The Prophet ﷺ said to Khuzaymah, What is the basis of your testimony? Khuzaymah said, That I entrusted you, O Messenger of Allah! Therefore, the Messenger ﷺ made Khuzaymah's testimony

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) *jr 1 Y> IS / -f-' * > }, o!j' / i ^ / ^ y .^r A** J| v/. y. i / c jl^ Lva*j 0^ ^ s' tit \ * t*"-! yA \a \ ^-=^> ftjQ o 3'4^' (^ o_ji_ 'jJ-HOij l^jV'(4^*J ^-: SpA0ff^dp\pp^<^ C-k i\$TU c-o ^L"LgJ j,1 X}> Ky j -j'a^'-zzW^ylj\) ^C-U j>_..rt'>iU 4>* ' Messenger, He will give you a double portion of His mercy, and He will give you a light by which you shall walk (straight)} [57:28]. Allah said; 4And Allah is the All-Knower of everything} stating that Allah has perfect knowledge in all matters and in their benefits or repercussions, and nothing escapes His perfect watch, for His knowledge encompasses everything in existence. ft f- &m 0{S V s ft' ',s.& ! > " 0^ u-*jt '-* rylu> y; \h\ \j&^ fc -it pj pf 4' gE pA. A i%% Z 2 f ifcH . And if you are on a journey and cannot find a scribe, then let there be a pledge taken (mortgaging), then if one of you entrusts the other, let the one who is entrusted discharge his trust, and let him have Taqwa of Allah, his Lord. And conceal not the evidence, for he who hides it, surely, his heart is sinful And Allah is All-Knower of what you do.}*

What is the 'Mortgaging' Mentioned in the Ayah?

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 791–803]

iAttd if you are on a journey} meaning, traveling and some of you borrowed some money to be paid at a later date, i&x p;} iand cannot find a scribe who would record the debt for you. Ibn Abbas said, And even if they find a scribe, but did not find paper, ink or pen. Then, 0 let there be a pledge taken (mortgaging)} given to the creditor in lieu of writing the transaction. The Two Sahih's recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ died while his shield was mortgaged with a Jew in return for thirty Wasq (approximately 180 kg) of barley, which the Prophet ﷺ bought on credit as provisions for his household. In another narration, the Hadith stated that this Jew was among the Jews of Al-Madinah.' Allah said, jll ffifi 4then if one of you entrusts the other, let the one who is entrusted discharge his trust (faithfully) .} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded, with a sound chain of narration, that Abu Saïd Al-Khudri said, This Ayah abrogated what came before it (i.e. that which required recording the transaction and having witnesses present). '2 Ash-Sha'bi said, If you trust each other, then there is no harm if you do not write the loan or have witnesses present. Allah's statement, 4And let him have Taqwa of Allah means, the debtor. Imam

nThe hand (of the debtor) will carry the burden of what it took until it gives it back. b111 Allah's statement, iAttd conceal not the evidence> means, do not hide it or refuse to announce it. Ibn Abbas and other scholars said, False testimony is one of the worst of the major sins, and such is the case with

hiding the true testimony. This is why Allah said, 4For he who hides it, surely, his heart is sinful As-Suddi commented, Meaning he is a sinner in his heart. This is similar to Allah's statement, -J4 4U ^ iWe shall not hide testimony of Allah, for then indeed we should be of the sinful (5:106]. Allah said, f if- fS lyb ojj ol 4\ fez "% Up if f oj, otpVb 4 o "*" & Si' ijj yow who believe! Stand out firmly for justice, as witnesses to Allah, even though it be against yourselves, or your parents, or your kin, be he rich or poor, Allah is a better Protector to both (than you). So follow not the lusts (of your hearts), lest you avoid justice; and if you distort your witness or refuse to give it, verily, Allah is Ever Well-Acquainted with what you do> [4:135] and in this Ayah (2:283) He said, 5:13, Abu Dawud 3:822, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:482, An- Nasal in Al-Kubru 3 :41 1 , Ibn Majah 2 :802Jabari 6:100.

iUf 'o&z tL% p: "i3j k^hi ^y \$And conceal not the evidence, for he who hides it, surely, his heart is sinful. And Allah is All-Knower of what you do.y ' 4* f p=Lp\ ii u ijlj jij 4 Cj oJ2 l' 4 li /A_J * A^TCB* ">' J *t li jV" _J *L j /vJ 4284. To Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth, and whether you disclose what is in yourselves or conceal it, Allah will call you to account for it. Then He forgives whom He wills and punishes whom He wills. And Allah is able to do all things. Would the Servants be Accountable for What They Conceal in Their Hearts? Allah states that His is the kingship of the heavens and earth and of what and whoever is on or between them, that He has perfect watch over them. No apparent matter or secret that the heart conceals is ever a secret to Him, however minor it is. Allah also states that He will hold His servants accountable for what they do and what they conceal in their hearts. In similar statements, Allah said, (-y ^X j ="& iSay (O Multammad : "Whether you hide what is in your breasts or reveal it, Allah knows it, and He knows what is in the heavens and what is in the earth. And Allah is able to do all things [3:29], and, iHe knows the secret and that which is yet more hidden. There are many other Ayat on this subject. In this Ayah [2:284], Allah states that He has knowledge of what the hearts conceal, and consequently, He will hold the creation accountable for whatever is in their hearts. This is why when this Ayah was revealed, it was hard on the Companions, since out of their strong faith and conviction, they were afraid that

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) such reckoning would diminish their good deeds. Imam

o). V C.j e. ' U ^c-j C4^ U \-|J * -j l jj iil - f'j 4&LZ } \$Allah burdens not a person beyond his scope. He gets reiuard far that (good) which he has earned, and he is punisliedfar that (evil) which he has earned. Our Lord! Punish us not if we forget orfall into error."} until the end.

Say , 'We hear and toe obey They said, We hear and we obey. Thereafter, this Ayah abrogated the previous Ayah, iThe Messenger believes in what has been sent doivn to him from his Lord , and (so do) the believers. Each one believes in Allah}, until, c licr c^ tjcj vi iii iif i v> iAIIdh burdens not a person beyond his scope. He gets reivard for that (good) which he has earned, and he is punishedfor that (evil) which he has earned.} Therefore, they were pardoned what happens in their hearts, and were held accountable only for their actions. The Group recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, j\ ^ i: - . l

IfMy servant intmds to commit an evil deed, do not record it as such for him, and if he commits it, write it for him as one evil deed. If he intends to perform a good deed, but did not perform it, then write it for him as one good deed, and ifhe performs it, write it for him as ten good deeds .

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) The Hadith on the Virtue of These Two Ayat, May Allah Benefit Us by Them

202 Tafsir Ibn Kathir been given and which no Prophet before you was given: the Opener of the Book (Al-Fatihah) and the last Ayat in Surat Al-Baqarah. You will not read a letter of them, but you will be granted its benefit. This Hadith was collected by Muslim and An-Nasa'i, 111 and this is the wording collected by An-Nasa'i. The Tafsir of the Last Two Ayat of Surat Al-Baqarah Allah said, it is > i - 'aV j & i Each one believes in Allah, His Angels, His Books, and His Messengers. (They say,) "We make no distinction between one another of His Messengers." > Therefore, each of the believers believes that Allah is the One and Only and the Sustainer, there is no deity worthy of worship except Him and there is no Lord except Him. The believers also believe in all Allah's Prophets and Messengers, in the Books that were revealed from heaven to the Messengers and Prophets, who are indeed the servants of Allah. Further, the believers do not differentiate between any of the Prophets, such as, believing in some of them and rejecting others. Rather, all of Allah's Prophets and Messengers are, to the believers, truthful, righteous, and they were each guided to the path of righteousness, even when some of them bring what abrogates the Law of some others by Allah's leave. Later on, the Law of Muhammad, the Final Prophet and Messenger from Allah, abrogated all the laws of the Prophets before him. So the Last Hour will commence while Muhammad's Law remains the only valid Law, and all the while a group of his Ummah will always be on the path of truth, apparent and dominant. Allah's statement, 4 Lutlj LILL i And they say, "I've heard, and we obey" means, we heard Your statement, O our Lord, comprehended and implemented it, and adhered to its implications. 4(We seek) Your forgiveness, our Lord^ contains a plea and Muslim 1:554, An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 5:12.

Al-Baqarah (Part-3) supplication for Allah's forgiveness, mercy and kindness. Allah's statement, 4^j -fy C_i 'it v} i Allah burdens not a person beyond his scope means, Allah does not ask a soul what is beyond its ability. This only demonstrates Allah's kindness, compassion and generosity towards His creation. This Ayah is the Ayah that abrogated the Ayah that worried the Companions, that is, Allah's statement, 4 A- A "4 U 'jjI; 4And ivltether you disclose what is in yourselves or conceal it, Allah zoill call you to accountfor it.} This indicates that although Allah will question His servants and judge them, He will only punish for what one is able to protect himself from. As for what one cannot protect himself from, such as what one says to himself - or passing thoughts - they will not be punished for that. We should state here that to dislike the evil thoughts that cross one's mind is a part of faith. Allah said next, 4iZ% <^} 4He gets reioardfor that ivltich he has earned} of good, 4 ty&j} 4And he is punished for that which he has earned} of evil, that is, concerning the acts that one is responsible for. Allah then said, [mentioning what the believers said] while directing His servants to supplicate to Him, all the while promising them that He will answer their supplication: 4"Our Lord! Push us not ifweforget or fall into error,"} meaning, If we forgot an obligation or fell into a prohibition, or made an error while ignorant of its ruling. We mentioned the Hadith by Abu Hurayrah, that Muslim collected, wherein Allah said, I shall (accept your supplication). There is also the Hadith by Ibn Abbas that Allah said, I did (accept your hi Muslim 1:115.

supplication). 1 4^* ij^- /oi^" ViJ* J-io Yj 4Our Lord! Lay not on us a burden like that which You did lay on those before us (fews and Christians),} means, Even if we were able to perform them, do not require us to perform the difficult deeds as You required the previous nations before us, such as the

burdens that were placed on them. You sent Your Prophet Muhammad ^{sg}, the Prophet of mercy, to abrogate these burdens through the Law that You revealed to him, the Hanifi (Islamic Monotheism), easy religion.

i'Ck JI&\ iPardon us meaning, between us and You regarding what You know of our shortcomings and errors. iAnd grant us forgiveness \$> concerning what is between us and Your servants. So do not expose our errors and evil deeds to them. iHave mercy on us} in what will come thereafter. Therefore, do not allow us to fall into another error. They say that those who commit error need three things: Allah's forgiveness for what is between Him and them, that He conceals these errors from His other servants, and thus does not expose them before the servants, and that He grants them immunity from further error. We mentioned before that Allah answered these pleas, I shall, in one narration and, I did, in another narration. ^Yow are our Mawld^ meaning. You are our supporter and helper, our trust is in You, You are sought for each and every type of help and our total reliance is on You. There is no power or strength except from You. sji iAnd give us victory over the disbelieving people^ those who rejected Your religion, denied Your Oneness, refused the Message of Your Prophet jg, worshipped other than You and associated others in Your worship. Give us victory and make us prevail above them in this and the Hereafter. Allah said, I shall, in one narration, and, I did, in the Hadith that

Surah 3: Al-Imran (Part 1 of 2)

PDF pages 804–1062

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 804–814]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Al-Imran (Chapter 3) Surah Al-Imran was revealed in Al-Madinah, as evident by the fact that the first eighty-three Ayat in it relate to the delegation from Najran that arrived in Al-Madinah on the ninth year of Hijrah (632 CE). We will elaborate on this subject when we explain the Ayah about the Mubahalah [3:61] in this Surah, Allah willing. We should also state that we mentioned the virtues of Surah Al-Imran along with the virtues of Surat Al-Baqara in the beginning of the

Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah. g. c# 0 gJi 1S ii Jig I ill j* iJj V at MJ oUyi' ifii Ji irt .i f . " ' >{ ' " < "?!> < ' JJ **!> V'- </n t/ie Name o/Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful} 41. Alif-Lam-Mim .} 42. Allah! None has the right to be worshipped but He, the

2OS Tafsir Ibn Kathir Ever Living, the One Wfzo sustains and protects all that exists.} 43. It is He Who has sent down the Book to you zoith truth, confirming what came before it. And He sent down the Tawrdh and the Injil,} 44. Aforetime, as a guidance to mankind. And He sent down the criterion. Truly, those who disbelieve in the Ayat of Allah, for them there is a severe torment; and Allah is All-Mighty, All-Able of Retribution .} We mentioned the Hadith in the Tafsir of Ayat Al-Kursi [2:255] that mentions that Allah's Greatest Name is contained in these two Ayat, tfii *} [H 4Alldt! None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Ever Living, the One Wlw sustains and protects all that exists and, 4 . (iP V ! ; 4Alif-Ldm-Mim . Allah! None has the right to be zoorshipped but He, the Ever Living, the One Wlto sustains and protects all that exists.} We also explained the Tafsir of, 4^} 4Alif-Lam-Mim} in the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah, and the meaning of, 'fi Vt, "V 4Alldh! La ilaha ilia Huwa, Al-Hayyul-Qayyum in the Tafsir of Ayat Al-Kursi. Allah's statement, 4&& C&J' %} 4It is He Who has sent down the Book to you with truth,} means, revealed the Qur'an to you, O Muhammad, in truth, meaning there is no doubt or suspicion that it is revealed from Allah. Verily, Allah revealed the Qur'an with His knowledge, and the angels testify to this fact, Allah is sufficient as a Witness. Allah's statement,

^Aj 4Confirming what came before it)> means, from the previous divinely revealed Books, sent to the servants and Prophets of Allah. These Books testify to the truth of the Qur'an, and the Qur'an also testifies to the truth these Books contained, including the news and glad tidings of Muhammad's prophethood and the revelation of the Glorious Qur'an. Allah said, 4And He sent dawn the Tawrah> to Musa (Musa) son of Imran, 4And the Inji!\$, to Isa, son of Mary, 4& Jit ^Aforetime} meaning, before the Qur'an was revealed, 4As a guidance to mankind> in their time. it&sm 4And He sent down the criterion which is the distinction between misguidance, falsehood and deviation on one hand, and guidance, truth and piety on the other hand. This is because of the indications, signs, plain evidences and clear proofs that it contains, and because of its explanations, clarifications, etc. Allah's statement, \xf& 0Truly, those

who disbelieve in the Aydt of Allah> means they denied, refused and unjustly rejected them, 4For them there is a severe torment} on the Day of Resurrection,

no Tafsir Ibtī Katlur 4!df iAnd Allah is All-Mighty meaning, His grandeur is invincible and His sovereignty is infinite. i.All-Able of Retribution .} from those who reject His Ayat and defy His honorable Messengers and great Prophets. -iVyV' j yS& ji a j Vj Jfjii 4 V ' 4 i VI V itS U?" . Truly, nothing is hidden from Allah, in the earth or in the heaven.} A6. He it is Who shapes you in the ivontbs as He ivills. None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Almighty, the All- Wise.} Allah states that He has perfect knowledge in the heavens and earth and that nothing in them is hidden from His watch. ioff j ifjil iHe it is Who shapes you in the wombs as He wills.} meaning, He creates you in the wombs as He wills, whether male or female, handsome or otherwise, happy or miserable. ^ s> 3> Vf 4La ilaha ilia Huwa (none has the right to be worshipped but He), the Almightjhj, the All-Wise.} meaning, He is the Creator and thus is the only deity worthy of worship, without partners, and His is the perfect might, wisdom and decision. This Ayah refers to the fact that Isa, son of Mary, is a created servant, just as Allah created the rest of mankind. Allah created 'Isa in the womb (of his mother) and shaped him as He willed. Therefore, how could Isa be divine, as the Christians, may Allah s curses descend on them, claim? 'Isa was created in the womb and his creation changed from stage to stage, just as Allah said, iHe creates you in the ivontbs of your mothers, creation after

creation in three veils of darkness .} [39:6]. j iji fife ft J s\ }\ i44 2& If Z&i . jf ~A\ \$} 5i' VJ r-ft <,4^ lOcifj iLiili i t iL *ii5 6 *^ijjj "i l2j ,y.yill'^i ijlll V] xj- cA S "-ii *"" oj!>*i AJ' 4 4J-UJ) U#j , C^l i-*y jJ U > *J JUy iJjli 4: y/AzftX ftL \$ s"f^ IsiZZ'f 47. It is He Who has sent down to you the Book. In it are verses that are entirely clear, they are the foundations of the Book; and others not entirely clear. So as for those in whose hearts there is a deviation (from the truth) they follow (only) that which is not entirely clear thereof, seeking Al-Fitnah, and seeking its Ta ioil, but none knows its Ta'zvil except Allalt. And those who are firmly grounded in knowledge say : "We believe in it; all of it is from our Lord." And none receive admonition except men of understanding .} (They say) : "Our Lord! Let not our hearts deviate (from the truth) after You have guided us, and grant us mercy from You. Truly, You are the Bestower."} 49. "Our Lord! Verily, it is You Who will gather mankind together on the Day about which there is no doubt. Verily, Allah never breaks His Promise."} The Mutashabihatand MuhkamatAyat Allah states that in the Qur an, there are Ayat that are Muhkam, entirely clear and plain, and these are the foundations of the Book which are plain for everyone. And there are Ayat in the Qur an that are Mutashabihat not entirely clear for many, or some people. So those who refer to the Muhkam Ayat to understand the Mutashabih Ayat, will have acquired the correct guidance, and vice versa. This is why Allah said, 44&\ % Ik} 4They are the foundations of the Book}, meaning, they are the basis of the Qur an, and should be referred to for clarification, when warranted,

112 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4And others not entirely clear as they have several meanings, some that agree with the Muhkam and some that carry other literal indications, although these meaning might not be desired. The Muhkam are the Aydt that explain the abrogating rulings, the allowed, prohibited, laws, limits, obligations and rulings that should be believed in and implemented. As for the Mutashabihat Ayat they include the abrogated Ayat, parables, oaths, and what should be believed in, but not implemented. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar commented on, cSX. iL} ihi it are verses that are entirely

clear} as Containing proof of the Lord, immunity for the servants and a refutation of opponents and of falsehood. They cannot be changed or altered from what they were meant for. He also said, As for the unclear Ayat, they can (but must not) be altered and changed, and this is a test from Allah to the servants, just as He tested them with the allowed and prohibited things. So these Ayat must not be altered to imply a false meaning or be distorted from the truth. Therefore, Allah said, iSo as for those in whose hearts there is a deviation} meaning, those who are misguided and deviate from truth to falsehood, 4-lit they follow that which is not entirely clear thereof} meaning, they refer to the Mutashabih, because they are able to alter its meanings to conform with their false interpretation since the wordings of the Mutashabihat encompass such a wide area of meanings. As for the Muhkam Ayat, they cannot be altered because they are clear and, thus, constitute unequivocal proof against the misguided people. This is why Allah said, filial &#} ^seeking Al-Fitnah} meaning, they seek to misguide their following by pretending to prove their innovation by relying on

the Qur'an - the Mutashabih of it - but, this is proof against and not for them. For instance, Christians might claim that [Isa is divine because] the Qur'an states that he is Ruhullah and His Word, which He gave to Mary, all the while ignoring Allah's statements, 4& C2S&% ji 4He [Isa] was not more than a servant. We granted Our favor to him.} [43:59], and, iVerily, the likeness of 'Isa before Allah is the likeness of Adam. He created him from dust, then (He) said to him: "Be! and he was.} [3:59]. There are other Ayat that clearly assert that Isa is but one of Allah's creatures and that he is the servant and Messenger of Allah, among other Messengers. Allah's statement, 4 ifeilj} 4And seeking for its Ta'wil,} to alter them as they desire. Imam

0 Allah! Bestow on him knowledge in the religion and teach him the Ta'wil (interpretation) Ta'wil has two meanings in the Qur'an, the true reality of things, and what they will turn out to be. For instance, Allah said, ijA 4 iAnd he said :

116 Tafslr Ibn Kathir meaning, that is, explaining and describing, such as what Allah said, 4(They said): Inform us of the Ta'wil of this"} meaning its explanation, then pausing after reciting, AAttd those who are firmly grounded in knowledge is warranted. This is because the scholars have general knowledge in, and understand what they were addressed with, even though they do not have knowledge of the true reality of things. Therefore, Allah's statement, 4- &'* '&} isay: "We believe in it } describes the conduct of the scholars. Similarly, Allah said, liS Jiy fcj} AAnd your Lord comes, and the angels, in rows.} [89:22] means, your Lord will come, and the angels will come in rows. Allah's statement that the knowledgeable people proclaim, &' Sjjju} }We believe in it} means, they believe in the Mutashabih. iall of it is from our Lord} meaning, both the Muhkam and the Mutashabih are true and authentic, and each one of them testifies to the truth of the other. This is because they both are from Allah and nothing that comes from Allah is ever met by contradiction or discrepancy. Allah said, 4 biL'U *j ijji "il xx. j* f'} "\$ } }Do they not then consider the Qur'an carefully? Had it been from other than Allah, they would surely have found therein many a contradiction .} (4:82). Allah said in his Ayah [3:7], / ****# # J j ij i b

Al 'Imran (Part-3) iAtid none receive admonition except men of understanding .} meaning, those who have good minds and sound comprehension, understand, contemplate and comprehend the meaning in the correct manner. Further, Ibn Al-Mundhir recorded in his Tafslr that Nafi bin Yazid said, Those

firmly grounded in knowledge are those who are modest for Allah's sake, humbly seek His pleasure, and do not exaggerate

regarding those above them, or belittle those below them.”

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 814–860]

'r-' ^ / * *. .A .vUjJl tAlil dl)j] U yjk) JOu Lyi i

118 Tafoir Ibtī Kathir J m&m up J'*. 1^ > _'t *A\ ^jiAu\^-4> \s&\Ljj'l^j* /jj!jOy^j CA^ss-ii Op jL^'o-'V clll.'^Jtr J& You are the Bestower.'V The Ayah continues, yjj cs^i c?^- t4s"r} Cjj 4M'jlj\4l ' 1)S-^~ ^jyi d& ;g *'L^V^4^u^Ch\$^uVl v/ *" r ' > * /r>/ x?>/ " <' - ^ ^ ,f - -f t^> ".Y\j-p ys->' mI-aJj (*=="J^j^i jl 3j^k"jr^yj v 'L\$lk(jjdy"3 jU- jC Ajlj , JM .- 7 - i Our Lord! Verily, it is You Who will gather mankind together on the Day about which there is no doubt } meaning, they say in their supplication: O our Lord! You will gather Your creation on the Day of Return, judge between them and decide over what they disputed about. Thereafter, You will reward or punish each according to the deeds they did in this life. jyj (*i ")' cA "-*-<\$ Y> >+!y! -^ J byS* /^"" -* ^ >"*" { -?? ** ,?fo ' ' . 'j (f:ji ,-k ad' jOO y-4^.* ja JI* wiA .. . < > \jU> . Verily, those who disbelieve, neither their properties nor their offspring will avail them whatsoever against Allah ; and it is they who will be fuel of the Fire.} ill. Like the behavior of the people of Fir'awn and those before them; they belied Our Aydt. So Allah punished them for their sins. And Allah is severe in punishment.} Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :84 , At-Tabari 6 :2 13

On the Day of Resurrection, No Wealth or Offspring Shall Avail Allah states that the disbelievers shall be fuel for the Fire, 4 * AiJill p-rJ-i if Day luhcn their excuses zoill be of tto profit to wrongdoers . Theirs will be the curse, and theirs will be the evil abode (i.e. painful torment in Hell-fire.) [40:52]. Further, what they were granted in this life of wealth and offspring shall not avail them with Allah, or save them from His punishment and severe torment. Similarly, Allah said. 4 IJt (4 -44. 'J T Ojjtp ,4-^' ^So let not their wealth nor their children amaze you; in reality Allah's plan is to punish them with these things in the life of this world, and that their souls shall depart (die) while they are disbelievers.) [9:55], and, ZWe& tS 4* &% iLet not the free disposal (and affluence) of the disbelievers throughout the land deceive you. A brief enjoyment ; then, their ultimate abode is Hell; and worst indeed is that place for rest.) [3:196, 197]. Allah said in this Ayah [3:10], k) iVerily, those who disbelieve) meaning, disbelieved in Allah's Ayat, denied His Messengers, defied His Books and did not benefit from His revelation to His Prophets, iNeither their properties nor their offspring will avail them whatsoever against Allah; and it is they who will be fuel of the Fire.) meaning, they will be the wood with which the Fire is kindled and fed. Similarly, Allah said,

-7 > ' i"- 'Si 1. J* iJJ-U_-*o Uj 4Certainly you (disbelievers) and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) fuel for Hell!} [21:98]. Allah said next, 4o i Ji iLike the Da b of the people of Fir'awn .} Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said that the Ayah means, Like the behavior of the people of Fir'awn. This is the same Tafsir of Ikrimah, Mujahid, Abu Malik, Ad-Dahhak, and others. Other scholars said that the Ayah means, Like the practice, conduct, likeness of the people of Fir'awn. These meanings are all plausible, for the Da b means practice, behavior, tradition and habit. The Ayah

indicates that the disbelievers will not benefit from their wealth or offspring. Rather, they will perish and be punished. This is the same end the people of Fir'aun and the previous nations met, those who rejected the Messengers, the Ayat, and proofs of Allah that they were sent with. And Allah is severe in punishment. } meaning, His punishment is severe and His torment is painful. None can escape Allah's grasp, nor does anything escape His knowledge. Allah does what He wills and prevails over all things, it is He to Whom everything is humbled and there is no deity worthy of worship, nor any Lord except Him. } "T " ^ . t, if / 4 Sf.j . CyVi . ys\ "js-J ili i i>* < !> 422. Say to those who disbelieve: "You will be defeated and gathered together to Hell, and worst indeed is that place of rest. } Tabari 6:224. ,2) Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :92

Al 'Imran (Part-3) il3. There has already been a sign for you in the two armies that met. One was fighting in the cause of Allah, and as for the other, in disbelief. They saw them with their own eyes twice their number. And Allah supports with His aid whom He wills. Verily, in this is a lesson for those who understand Threatening the Jews With Defeat and Encouraging Them to Learn a Lesson From the Battle of Badr Allah commanded the Prophet Muhammad to proclaim to the disbelievers, 4You will be defeated^ in this life, 4And gathered together^ on the Day of Resurrection, ^& 4to Hell, and worst indeed is that place of rest4 Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar recorded that Asim bin Umar bin Qatadah said that when the Messenger of Allah jg gained victory in the battle of Badr and went back to Al-Madina, he gathered the Jews in the marketplace of Bani Qaynuqa . Therefore, Allah said, iThere has already been a sign for you meaning, O Jews, who said what you said! You have an Ayah, meaning proof, that Allah will make His religion prevail, award victory to His Messenger, make His Word apparent and His religion the highest. 4In the two armies^ meaning, two camps, 4that met in combat (in Badr)

iOne was fighting in the Cause of Allah the Muslims, iAnd as for the other, in disbelief} meaning, the idolators of Quraysh at Badr. Allah's statement, iThey saw them with their own eyes twice their number } means, the idolators thought that the Muslims were twice as many as they were, for Allah made this illusion a factor in the victory that Islam had over them. It was said that the meaning of Allah's statement, iThey saw them with their own eyes twice their number} is that the Muslims saw twice as many idolators as they were, yet Allah gave them victory over the disbelievers. Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, When we looked at the disbelievers' forces, we found that they were twice as many as we were. When we looked at them again, we thought they did not have one man more than we had. So Allah's statement. iAnd (remember) when you met, He showed them to you as few in your eyes and He made you appear as few in their eyes.} [8:44] / When the two camps saw each other, the Muslims thought that the idolators were twice as many as they were, so that they would trust in Allah and seek His help. The idolators thought that the believers were twice as many as they were, so that they would feel fear, horror, fright and despair. When the two camps stood in lines and met in battle, Allah made each camp look smaller in the eyes of the other camp, so that they would be encouraged to fight each other, so that Allah might accomplish a matter already ordained.} [8:42] m At-Tabari 6 :234

meaning, so that the truth and falsehood are distinguishable, and thus the word of faith prevails over disbelief and deviation, so that the believers prevail and the disbelievers are humiliated. In a similar statement, Allah said; 4And Allah has already made you victorious at Badr, when you were a weak

little force} [3:123], In this Ayah [3:13] Allah said, 4 '&} 4And Allah supports with His victory whom He zfills. Verily, in this is a lesson for those who understand.} meaning, this should be an example for those who have intelligence and sound comprehension. They should contemplate about Allah s wisdom, decisions and decree, that He gives victory to His believing servants in this life and on the Day the witnesses stand up to testify. rU % Qilf }%Zi\ % iduft 'Sfy j-Vfi (vfeO'j a? yl~ ^ i . * A3- 414. Beautified for men is the love of things they covet; women, children, Qanatir Al-Muqantarah of gold and silver, branded beautiful horses (Musawwatnah) , cattle and fertile land. This is the pleasure of the present world's life; but Allah has the excellent return zoith Hint.} 415. Say: "Shall / inform you of things far better than those? For those who have Taqwd there are Cardens (Paradise) with their Lord, underneath which rivers flow. Therein (is their) eternal (home) and Azzvdjun Mutahharatun (purified mates or zvives). And Allah zwill be pleased zoith them. And Allah is All- Seer of the servants. }

124 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The True Value of This Earthly Life Allah mentions the delights that He put in this life for people, such as women and children, and He started with women, because (he test with them is more tempting. For instance, the SahOi recorded that the Messenger sg said, (Jt>- ^Jlaj y to "/ did not leave behind me a test more tempting to men than women. n When one enjoys women for the purpose of having children and preserving his chastity, then he is encouraged to do so. There are many Hadiths that encourage getting married, such as, ;.U> ' ojj " Verily, the best members of this Ummah are those who have the most wives{ He jg also said, UjjJU "This life is a delight, and the best of its delight is a righteous wife {3]

The Prophet jg said in another Hadith, "/ was made to like women and perfume, and the comfort of my eye is the prayer. A ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said, Nothing was more beloved to the Messenger of Allah than women, except horses," and in another narration, ...than horses except women. The desire to have children is sometimes for the purpose of pride and boasting, and as such, is a temptation. When the purpose for having children is to reproduce and increase the |l * FathAl-B&ri9:41. * Fath Al-Bari9:15. That is , a maximum of four at the same time Muslim 2:1090. An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5 :280 [S] An-Nasal 6:217, 7:61.

Al 'Imran (Part-3 Ummah of Muhammad sg with those who worship Allah alone without partners, then it is encouraged and praised. A Hadtth states, "Marry the Wadud (kind) and Waliid (fertile) woman, for I ivill compare your numbers to the rest of the nations on the Day of ResurrectionV The desire of wealth sometimes results out of arrogance, and the desire to dominate the weak and control the poor, and this conduct is prohibited. Sometimes, the want for more money is for the purpose of spending it on acts of worship, being kind to the family, the relatives, and spending on various acts of righteousness and obedience; this behavior is praised and encouraged in the religion. Scholars of Tafsir have conflicting opinions about the amount of the Qintar, all of which indicate that the Qintar is a large amount of money, as Ad-Dahhak and other scholars said. Abu Hurayrah said The Qintar is twelve thousand Uwqiyah, each Uwqiyah is better than what is between the heavens and earth. [This was recorded by Ibn Jarir]. The desire to have horses can be one of three types. Sometimes, owners of horses collect them to be used in the cause of Allah, and when warranted, they use their horses in battle. This type of owner shall be rewarded for this good action. Another type collects horses to boast, and out of enmity to the people of Islam, and this type earns a burden for his behavior. Another type collects horses to fulfill

their needs and to collect their offspring, and they do not forget Allah's right due on their horses. This is why in this case, these horses provide a shield of sufficiency for their owner, as evident by a Hadith that we will mention, Allah willing, when we explain Allah's statement. {And make ready against them all you can of power, including steeds of war.} [8:60]. Abu Dawud, An-Nasa'i, and Ibn Hibban 6:134. Tabari 6:250 Tabari 6:244.

126 Tafsir Ibn Kathir As for the Musawwamah horses, Ibn Abbas said that they are the branded, beautiful horses. This is the same explanation of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Abdur-Rahman bin Abdullah bin Abza, As-Suddi, Ar-Rabi bin Anas and Abu Sinan and others. 2 Makhul said the Musawwamah refers to the horse with a white spotted face, and the horse with white feet. 3 Imam

Al 'Imran (Part-3) 4 But Allah has the excellent return with Hun? meaning, the best destination and reward. The Reward of the Those Who Have Taqwa is Better Than All Joys of This World This is why Allah said, 4 Say : ", Shall I inform you of things far better than those?" This Ayah means, Say, O Muhammad, to the people, Should I tell you about what is better than the delights and joys of this life that will soon perish? Allah informed them of what is better when He said, 4 jik VI l+ne SyC J-fJ ix \ j&\ itfff} 4 For those who have Taqwa there are Gardens (Paradise) with their Lord, underneath which rivers flow^ meaning, rivers run throughout it. These rivers carry various types of drinks: honey, milk, wine and water such that no eye has ever seen, no ear has ever heard, and no heart has ever imagined, 4 Therein (is their) eternal (home)} meaning, they shall remain in it forever and ever and will not want to be removed from it. 4 j' 4 And Azwdjun Mutahlmratun (purified mates or wives)} meaning, from filth, dirt, harm, menstruation, post birth bleeding, and other things that affect women in this world. 4 And Allah will be pleased with them} meaning, Allah's pleasure will descend on them and He shall never be angry with them after that. This is why Allah said in Surah Bara'ah, o'j-svj} 4 But the pleasure of Allah is greater} [9:72], meaning, greater than the eternal delight that He has granted them. Allah then .ad.

*)'C J i And Allah is All-Seer of the (His) servants and, He gives each provisions according to what they deserve. kjj LJ ijf jUif i!6. Those who say: Our Lord! We have indeed believed, so for- give us our sins and save us from the punish- ment of the Fire/y il7. (They are) the patient, the true believ- ers, and obedient ivith sincere devotion in wor- ship to Allah . Those who spend [in good] and those who pray and beg Allah's pardon in the last hours of the nighty The Supplication and Description of Al-Muttaqin Allah describes the Muttaqin, His pious servants, whom He promised tremendous rewards, id& ts; ojiji ^jy i Those who say: "Our Lord! We Iwve indeed believed' in You, Your Book and Your Messenger. 4.S0 forgive us our sins because of our faith in You and in what You legislated for us. Therefore, forgive us our errors and

Al 'Imran (Part-3) shortcomings, with Your bounty and mercy, fej} iatid save us from the punishment of the Fire.} Allah then said, 4Lf &i} 4 (They are) those who are patient while performing acts of obedience and abandoning the prohibitions. ithose who are true} concerning their proclamation of faith, by performing the difficult deeds. ianci obedient meaning, they submit and obey Allah, Owse who spend} from their wealth on all the acts of obedience they were commanded, being kind to kith and kin, helping the needy, and comforting the destitute. &fL3's} iand those who pray and beg Allah's pardon in the last hours of the night} and this testifies to the virtue of seeking Allah's forgiveness in the latter part

of the night. It was reported that when Ya'qub said to his children, 41 ivill ask my Lord for forgiveness for you} [12:98] he waited until the latter part of the night to say his supplication. Furthermore, the Two Sahihs, the Musnad and Sunan collections recorded through several Companions that the Messenger of Allah said, 'irrT j. I I ">' ju^La JA ji ?j ji J;U ja ji :JyZ

iRVuqi [e, STS: l unisnw ^gg: Z UP8'1V MWd \z\ iet: z pBUiqv set: I qBfeN uqi EZl -9 Vjqnx-iv Ui J.BSBN-UV IZ>= 6 ?ypom/y -JV jo/qnj, 'if Z pnMBQ nqy \Z9 - uiqsnw [: 1 W8-JV Ml* |,] fpsRiu paptmqns aavq / : /ivs noR ipioi aindsip Raip ft os 0Z\$ i'Sutuoyaa m ifrns st 1/pnv 'R/auns imp ifvpy fo jvRy dip ui sanatpqstp jaoaoi/oi puy uiaip o) aiuaa pvq a2pa\ (iwu uaffv Rujvau fo)tto jdaaxa uaffip }ou pip (suvpsuiQ puv saiaI) a.mjduas sip uaat8 auaa oi{m asoip 'uippi si ippy ipioi uoi8tpA aip 'R}iu \$1> i'3S!M-UV 3tU 'RjifinuiV sip 3H piq paddtqsjooi aq oj p(8u aip sin/ auop aapsnf ui uopvaua sip suwfumu (sRooip ap) !(sup o) ssaiprn Jvaq osjv) a8papiou 8uta.vi{ asotp puv sp8uv aip puv 'ap)tiq paddii{SAO(n aq Of p{8u aip svq auou)Vip ssaipim suvaq t{vpy g/> nfi iTpr i U\ n *f " w IT? f \$?, '? W" fi'l !r.5FT 5fp; fl rr r\ \r\$ tri ^ ^r' if jfP j?T ? ifpv "r?^r:f: ^ ^ if ite, " jt-t ^ (f- && V 15 & 15 u t sts < fffi iff sb f.%^f ijf^ (el-uiijBH iqv uqi Aq papaya sb/w ipipop siqx UMBp [pun SSdUaAlSjOJ SJH 9up[33S pUB qB[[V O; 3upB3l[ddnS JJBJS p[nOM JBUia uqi ,, sa^ ptBS ,JIBM J] PUB (l ;q3U 3ip JO JJBd J3JJBj aq; JI SI i.xjBN On >{SB p[noM PUB jqSiu oqj 3uunp Asad o; posn jBuifl, uiq qpnnpqv, |e|(1 PJBd jobbj aqj 3uunp (A[uo) ji uuojjad pjno/w aq (ajt[siq ui) jajB[uaqx iq3iu aq; jo sued ja;;B[pus aipprai aq; pJBd ;sjij aq; 3uunp JIJM pauuojjad^ qB[[v jo jaSuassaw aqi* 'PP88 qBMs!" l^q; papjooaj sqn/og omx aaiSucfRvui l jvip os 'ssauaaISwf Ryq Kupaas auoRuv auaij sj iuopvaoai siq oj puodsau Rmu j jvip os 'ay/ ayoaij oj auoRuv ajaip si psanbau siq uiij juvuS Rvui j }vip os 'ay/ ^/sb oj auoRuv auaij s/ 'SuiRvs uacwaif jsarno/ aip oj spuaasap 'jouadns sip 'passajg aip 'pjoq uno suwuij p fo puitp }sv{ aip uaiion 'iq8tu Ruaajn 0 luqj utsfvx

to Allah, and (so have) those zohofollow me." And say to those who were given the Scripture (Jews and Christians) and to those who are illiterate (Arab pagans): "Do you (also) submit yourselves?" If they do, they are rightly guided; but if they turn aumy, your duty is only to convey the Message; and Allah sees the servants.} The Testimony ofTawhid Allah bears witness, and verily, Allah is sufficient as a Witness, and He is the Most Truthful and Just Witness there is; His statement is the absolute truth, Vi v g\} ithat La ilaha ilia Huwa} meaning. He Alone is the Lord and God of all creation; everyone and everything are His servants, creation and in need of Him. Allah is the Most Rich, Free from needing anyone or anything. Allah said in another Ayah, "3jji\$ 'C &\$} iBut Allah bears witness to that which He has sent dotvn (the Qur'an) unto xjou (O Muhammad jg)} [4: 166J. Allah then mentioned the testimony of His angels and those who have knowledge after he mentioned His own testimony, 'j* vi 'A[v iSt 'if iAlldh bears witness that none has the right to be worshipped but He), and the angels, and those having knowledge (also bear witness to this)}. This Ayah emphasizes the great virtue of those who have knowledge. ^ jiLjj\j (iJi^ i(He) maintains His creation in justice in all that He does, Vi % V> iNone has the right to be worshipped but He} thus emphasizing this fact, iX&i^}

ithe Almighty, the All-Wise. fr the Mighty that does not submit to weakness due to His might and greatness, the Wise in all His statements, actions, legislation and decrees. The Religion with Allah is Islam Allah said, ^ k> \$Truly, the religion with Allah is Isl dm.fr Allah states that there is no religion accepted with Him from any person, except Islam. Islam includes obeying all of the Messengers until

Muhammad jg who finalized their commission, thus closing all paths to Allah except through Muhammad jg\$. Therefore, after Allah sent Muhammad s , whoever meets Allah following a path other than Muhammad s, it will not be accepted of him. In another Ayah, Allah said, A~" iyjf frAnd whoever seeks a religion other than Islam, it will never be accepted ofhimfr [3:85]. In this Ayah [3:19], Allah said, asserting that the only religion accepted with Him is Islam, frTruly, the religion with Allah is Islm.fr Allah then states that those who were given the Scripture beforehand divided in the religion after Allah sent the Messengers and revealed the Books to them providing them the necessary proofs to not do so. Allah said, tZ \ iZ o; iyjl frThose who were given the Scripture (Jews and Christians) did not differ except out of rivalry, after knowledge had come to them.fr meaning, some of them wronged others. Therefore, they differed over the truth, out of envy, hatred and enmity for each other. This hatred made some of them defy those whom they hated even if they were correct. Allah then said,

4And whoever disbelieves in the Ayat ofAllah} meaning, whoever rejects what Allah sent down in His Book, 4then surely, Allah is Swift in reckoning.} Allah will punish him for his rejection, reckon him for his denial, and torment him for defying His Book. Thereafter, Allah said. 4So if they dispute with you (Muhammad so if they argue with you about Tawhid, & iSv-j Cm Jiiy 4Say: "I have submitted myself to Allah (in Islam), and (so have) those whofollow me") meaning, Say, 1 have made my worship sincere for Allah Alone without partners, rivals, offspring or companion, iand those who follmo me} who followed my religion and embraced my creed. In another Ayah, Allah said, Cr*J ilk "" 4Say (O Muhammad sg): This is my way; I invite unto Allah with sure knowledge, I and whosoever follows me..."} [12:108]. Islam is the Religion ofMankindand the Prophet^Was Sent to all Mankind Allah commanded His servant and Messenger, Muhammad Si" to ca21 the People of the Two Scriptures and the unlettered idolaters to his religion, way, Law and all that Allah sent him with. Allah said. J& IjiSif [yl-J jji iyjl Jij} 4And say to those who were given the Scripture (Jews and Christians) and to those who are illiterates (Arab pagans) : "Do

you (also) submit yourselves?: "If they do, they are rightly guided; but if they turn away, your duty is only to convey the Message. ^ meaning, their reckoning is with Allah and their return and final destination is to Him. It is He Who guides whom He wills and allows whom He wills to stray, and He has the perfect wisdom and the unequivocal proof for all of this. This is why Allah said, 4^ dj) iAnd Allah sees the servants.) for He has perfect knowledge ofwho deserves to be guided and who does not deserve to be guided. Verily, i-i J Vf 4He cannot be questioned for what He does, while they will be questioned.) [21:23] because of His perfect wisdom and mercy. This and similar Ayat are clear proofs that the Message of Muhammad jg is universal to all creation, as it is well established in the religion, according to the various texts of the Book and Sunnah. For instance, Allah said, iSay (O Muhammad : O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger ofAllah."

y fjA jS- 1 V l 0jJj (jjjjl: "JO) ji? tJ, Lj\ jjj By He in Whose Hand is my soul! No member of this Ummah, no Jew or Christian, hears of me but dies without believing in what I was sent with, but will be among the people of the Fire ."

They also killed many Prophets when they conveyed to them

what Allah legislated for them, without cause or criminal behavior committed by these Prophets, for they only called them to the truth, iAini kill those men who order just dealings thus, demonstrating the worst type of arrogance. Indeed,

the Prophet said, L o P) *,L ; tKibr (arrogance) is refusing the truth and degrading people"(11 This is why when they rejected the truth and acted arrogantly towards the creation, Allah punished them with humiliation and disgrace in this life, and humiliating torment in the Hereafter. Allah said, # amm er m ^ ijis. y. /y * / ("> y^- y -i > I ^ > ifj 'ojiaOi 0 f6 ~; J- a j3^ JLwillUil iJb <. < TA </ *. ,7 . .ss n announce to them a painful torment} meaning, painful and humiliating, y Slfj s j yJ*tiLcS -jjLi- iThey are those whose works will be lost in this world and in the Hereafter, and they will have no helpers.}. m Muslim 1 :93

i* Is ZZ'fXi fS & V& ^S\ 4i &1^ J> 3 j j\$J> O'jjjJU 6\$ jl5)> tills j 'jtt t&i i Tr.,SA^i (**" > u^ jAa *~> vsj *H * K^i^i i =. i; 4.,;^ V ,US 423 . Have you not seen those who have been given a portion of the Scripture? They are being invited to the Book of Allah to settle their dispute, then a party of them turned away, and they are averse.> 424. This is because they say: "The Fire shall not touch us but for a number of days. And that which they used to invent in their religion has deceived them.} 425. How (will it be) when We gather them together on the Day about which there is no doubt (i.e. the Day of Resurrection). And each person will be paid in full what he has earned? And they will not be dealt with unjustly.} Chastising the People of the Book for Not Referring to the Book ofAllah forJudgment Allah criticizes the Jews and Christians who claim to follow their Books, the Tawrah and the Injll, because when they are called to refer to these Books where Allah commanded them to follow Muhammad jg, they turn away with aversion. This censure and criticism from Allah was all because of their defiance and rejection. Allah said next, 4# -ii idsi j iju iTltis is because they say : The Fire shall not touch us but for a number ofdays."} meaning, what made them dare to challenge and defy the truth is their false claim that Allah will only punish them for seven days in the Fire, a day for every one thousand years in this life. We mentioned this subject in the Tafsir of Surat Al- Baqarah. Allah then said,

\$And that which they used to invent regarding their religion has deceived them.} meaning, what caused them to remain on their false creed is that they deceived themselves, believing that the Fire will onlytouch them for a few days for their errors. However, it is they who have invented this notion, and Allah did not grant them authority to support this claim. Allah said, while threatening and warning them, iHow (will it be) when We gather them together on the Day about which there is no doubt (i.e. the Day ofResurrection).} meaning, what will their condition be like after they have uttered this lie about Allah, rejected His Messengers and killed His Prophets and their scholars who enjoined righteousness and forbade evil? Allah will ask them about all this and punish them for what they have done. This is why Allah said, ViJ V \ j2S3} iHow (will it be) when We gather them together on the Day about which there is no doubt.} meaning, there is no doubt that this Day will come, i< V li j =" Sljj} iAnd each person will be paid in full what he has earned? And they will not be dealt with unjustly.}. j-w gjoj -iGif d&is jji \ (in J,} &* & ^ur\$& VCii ^ jj45 i jf* iLiS OipJ Ifii cGl' gfjj ll j}\$\ fcpiuj 126. Say: "O Allah! Possessor of the power, You give power to whom You will, and You take powerfrom whom You will, and You endue with honor whom You will, and You humiliate whom You will. In Your Hand is the good. Verily, You are able to do all things.} 127. You make the night to enter into the day, and You

make the day to enter into the night, You bring the living out of the dead, and You bring the dead out of the living. And You give

Al 'Imran (Part-3) wealth and sustenance to whom You will, without limit .} Encouraging Gratitude Allah said, iSay} O Muhammad sH, while praising your Lord, thanking Him, relying in all matters upon Him and trusting in Him. Sij .Lility 40 Allah! Possessor of the power} meaning, all sovereignty is Yours, 4You give power to whom You will, and You take powerfrom whom You will, and You endue with honor whom You will, and You humiliate whom You will.} meaning, You are the Giver, You are the Taker, it is Your will that occurs and whatever You do not will, does not occur. This Ayah encourages thanking Allah for the favors He granted His Messenger jg and his Ummah. Allah transferred the prophethood from the Children of Israel to the Arab, Qurashi, Makkan, unlettered Prophet, the Final and Last of all Prophets and the Messenger of Allah jg to all mankind and Jinn. Allah endowed the Prophet jg with the best of qualities from the prophets before him. Allah also granted him extra qualities that no other Prophet or Messenger before him was endowed with, such as granting him (more) knowledge of Allah and His Law, knowledge of more of the matters of the past and the future, such as what will occur in the Hereafter. Allah allowed Muhammad s Ummah to reach the eastern and western parts of the world and gave dominance to his religion and Law over all other religions and laws. May Allah s peace and blessings be on the Prophet jg until the Day of Judgment, and as long as the day and night succeed each other. This is why Allah said, 4 isf J+bi } iSay: "O Allah! Possessor of the power,"} meaning, You decide what You will concerning Your creation and You do what you will. Allah refutes those who thought that they could decide for Allah,

o? J~-J& <}*/\$ 'i* Jj ijj i\$lij} iAnd they say: Why is not this Qur'an sent down to some great man of the two towns (Makkah and Ta'if)?"} [43:3 lj. Allah refuted them by saying, i&> cSC Jji-i' \$} ils it they who would portion out the Mercy of your Lord?} [43:32], meaning, We decide for Our creation what We will, without resistance or hindrance by anyone. We have the perfect wisdom and the unequivocal proof in all of this, and We give the prophethood to whom We will. Similarly, Allah said, viX iAlldh knows best with whom to place His Message> and, (i! 4See hozo We prefer one above another (in this world)) [17:21] Allah said, 4 glpj jiQil 4 4You make the night enter into the day, and You make the day enter into the night} meaning, You take from the length of one of them and add it to the shortness of the other, so that they become equal, and take from the length of one of them and add it to the other so that they are not equal. This occurs throughout the seasons of the year: spring, summer, fall and winter. Allah s statement, iYou bring the living out of the dead, and You bring the dead out of the living.} means, You bring out the seed from the plant: and the plant from the seed; the date from its seed and the date s seed from the date; the faithful from the disbeliever and the disbeliever from the faithful; the chicken from the egg and the egg from the chicken, etc.

Al 'Imran (Part-3) 4y^i- JpJ *& 0* &j iAtid You give wealth and sustenance to whom You will, without limit. meaning, You give whomever You will innumerable amounts of wealth while depriving others from it, out of wisdom, and justice. j ' IjA j'J i" Cri \$-4^ Z-V. > /-if * < ' >' ; -4 428. Lef not the believers take the disbelievers as friends instead of the believers, and whoever does that, will never be helped by Allah in any way, unless you indeed fear a danger from them And Allah loams you against Himself, and to Allah is the final return .} The Prohibition ofSupporting the Disbelievers Allah prohibited His

believing servants from becoming supporters of the disbelievers, or to take them as comrades with whom they develop friendships, rather than the believers. Allah warned against such behavior when He said, 4\$ iAnd whoever does that, will never be helped by Allah in any way meaning, whoever commits this act that Allah has prohibited, then Allah will discard him. Similarly, Allah said, jElj' Y ni' 40 you who believe! Take not My enemies and your enemies as friends, shozving affection toioards them}, until, ;\P jS ji i b 4Atid whosoever of you does that, then indeed he has gone astrayfrom the straight path.} [60:1]. Allah said. ijjiJi Y '>*' cyM ^

- Tafsir Ibn Kathir iO you who believe! Take not forfriends disbelievers instead of believers. Do you wish to offer Allah a manifest proof against yourselves?) [4:144], and. Q? ;yj' jj jl ijijrii V [ySll S.ji' you who believe! Take not the Jews and the Christians as friends, they are but friends of each other. And ivhoever befriends than, then surely, he is one ofthem.) [5:51], Allah said, after mentioning the fact that the faithful believers gave their support to the faithful believers among the Muhajirfn, Ansar and Bedouins, 3' O cJfJVI .jUC VI i\3)\ iAnd those who disbelieve are allies ofone another, (and) ifyou do not behave the same, there will be Fitnah and oppression on the earth, and a great mischiefand corruption.) [8:73]. Allah said next, ioi oi VJ^ iunless you indeedfear a dangerfrom than) meaning, except those believers who in some areas or times fear for their safety from the disbelievers. In this case, such believers are allowed to show friendship to the disbelievers outwardly, but never inwardly. For instance,

. " /V" / 'll- Ljl.mVjfOtf 4^f ^&" ^Anrf to AZ/a/j is the final return^ meaning, the return is to Him and He will reward or punish each person according to their deeds. jt 4 t" b*^" o[ji)> & iiC 614 {; 4 " *sziT *? fJ* ;Jjr ip3 ^ /> "y 4 > yy- 0; u 19* J^=> yy-* u* '1 wj J/ x y-' .< 1JU^> iJU! *-4 tJ 3 " >- .<<(.- ^:r)! U*J ! ;< *> "0l |" ="jJ~i) 4 429. Say: "Whether you hide what is in your breasts or reveal it, Allah knows it, and He knows what is in the heavens and what is in the earth. And Allah is able to do all things") 430. On the Day when every person will be confronted with the good he has done, and all the evil he has done, he will wish that there were a great distance between him and his evil. And Allah warns you against Himselfand Allah is full ofkindness with the servants .) Allah KnowsWhat the Hearts Conceal Allah tells His servants that He knows the secrets and apparent matters and that nothing concerning them escapes His observation. Rather, His knowledge encompasses them in all conditions, time frames, days and instances. His knowledge encompasses all that is in heaven and earth, and nothing not

even the weight of an atom, or what is smaller than that in the earth, seas and mountains, escapes His observation. Indeed, 4And Allah is able to do all things.} and His ability encompasses everything. This Ayah alerts Allah s servants that they should fear Him enough to not commit what He prohibits and dislikes, for He has perfect knowledge in all they do and is able to punish them promptly. And He gives respite to some of them, then He punishes them, and He is Swift and Mighty in taking account. This is why Allah said afterwards. Jr Uj ^S* 'd jJb -L5 fy} iOn the Day when every person will be confronted with all the good he has done,} meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, Allah brings the good and evil deeds before the servant, just as He said, fj j n that Day man will be informed ofwhat he sent forward, and what he left behind.} [75:13). When the servant sees his good deeds, he becomes happy and delighted. When he sees the evil deeds he committed, he becomes sad and angry. Then he will wish that

he could disown his evil work and that a long distance separated it from him. He will also say to the devil who used to accompany him in this life, and who used to encourage him to do evil; 4"Would that between me and you were the distance of the two easts" - a horrible companion (indeed)!} [43:38], Allah then said, while threatening and warning, 4And Allah warns you against Himself} meaning, He warns you against His punishment. Allah then said, while bringing hope to His servants, so that they do not despair from His mercy or feel hopeless of His kindness.

4And Allah is full of kindness with the servants> Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, Allah is so kind with them that He warns them against Himself. Others commented,^ He is merciful with His creation and likes for them to remain on His straight path and chosen religion, and to follow His honorable Messenger. *> J*X Jtjfy iif oj ii. -5 4(U ou L4455 -il idj.1 431 . Say (O Muhammad sg to mankind): "If you (really) love Allah, then follow me (i.e. Muhammad), Allah will love you and forgive you your sins. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.y 432. Say : "Obey Allah and the Messenger." But if they turn away, then Allah does not like the disbelievers> Allah's Love is Attained by Following the Messenger^ This honorable Ayah judges against those who claim to love Allah, yet do not follow the way of Muhammad sg. Such people are not true in their claim until they follow the Shari'ah (Law) of Muhammad jg and his religion in all his statements, actions and conditions. It is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah 2g said, }j UjA oWhoever commits an act that does not conform with our matter (religion), then it will be rejected o/"m." This is why Allah said here, 4Say (O Muhammad jg to mankind) : "If you (really) love Allah, then follow me, Allah will love you... } meaning, what you will earn is much more than what you At-Tabari 6 :202 Fath Al-Bari 5 :355

Si 'r***? %i3 rT.Cfl^J' J* o>- - J'o Vyj f"U 1 ,*ru f .* f ' .?-/ 4 ./ ^ .n ,- 433. Allah chose Adam, Nuh (Noah), the family of Ibrahim and the family of 'Imran above the nations 434. Offspring, one of the other, and Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knower> The Chosen Ones Among the People of the Earth Allah states that He has chosen these households over the people of the earth. For instance, Allah chose Adam, created him with His Hand and blew life into him. Allah commanded the angels to prostrate before Adam, taught him the names of everything and allowed him to dwell in Paradise, but then sent him down from it out of His wisdom. Allah chose Nuh and made him the first Messenger to the people of the earth, when the people worshipped idols and associated others with Allah in worship. Allah avenged the way Nuh was treated, for he kept calling his people day and night, in public and in secret, for a very long time. However, his calling them only made them shun him more, and this is when Nuh supplicated against them. So Allah caused them to drown, and none among them was saved, except those who followed the religion that Allah sent to Nuh. Allah also chose the household of Ibrahim, including the master of all mankind, and the Final Prophet, Muhammad, peace be upon him. Allah also chose the household of 'Imran, the father of Maryam bint 'Imran, the mother of Isa, peace be upon them. So Isa is from the offspring of Ibrahim, as we will mention in the Tafsir of Surat Al-An'am, Allah willing, and our trust is in Him. ^ U OjX ^ Cjj o cJli V& U*&%\$ Xfri # eft a Ss ifri}}') iff) 'As ff (Remember) when the wife of 'Imran said : "O my Lord! I have vowed to You what is in my womb to be dedicated for Your services, so accept this from me. Verily, You are the All-Hearer, the All-Knowing."4

Al-'Imran (Part-3) the newly born the day it is born, as is apparent from the Ayah, which is also a part of the law of those who were before us. Further, the Sunnah of the Messenger of Allah jg mentioned that

the Prophet Jg said, (*r?'3?|J r^; J jjj This night, a son was bom for me and I called him by my father's name, Ibrahim ."

/ saw John and 'isa, who are maternal cousins .s'11 We should state that ,in general terms, what Ibn Ishaq said is plausible, and in this case, Maryam was under the care of her maternal aunt. The Two Sahlhs recorded that the Messenger of Allah Jg decided that Amarah, the daughter of Hamzah, be raised by her maternal aunt, the wife of JaYar bin Abi Talib, saying, 77ie maternal aunt is just like the mother.

umij&s ii.> >; , C. AJ > JJ Js_ *Ai_ iAj) UA A. pj_aijAjaSCjIJ' AtJl!l i-b^A.._'.U > -#./ ." {*>' . * '<' -V <> , >^ t \$iisc jj 4fl 5 *^S "y *Aii 4S//e said, This isfrom Allah." Verily, Allah provides sustenance to whom He wills, without limit.} JU AJJ ^jA-a"} li-i . AU A^ <;-? 'fiA , " "oj> -y*jJ J; 4 >--" yj TA^JwJl Y&\ ili ^ iijt && jj^i; 'i> it wi^jf j ' jj Sp ,T' . 'j >J d_ oy* C\$1 y; vH- u l> JV^=J ! iuj U 4"f AtjfjS l/ zS" viijj Vi AiiU Vi *i^i> jli i_ "i* v)-*^ Jii 4 &jij ^ii gzs <,< ,a>" < > ':' * - ""\ c .i- \"" p^J/ -" +C>\i' ' m' \$Z'SS^i \S ""*S> "t ^ cry>& 'o?3?JAI 'jW-J pyo: meaning, where did you get these fruits from? <+ JC ji lilliS. Af that time Zakariyyd invoked his Lord, saying: "O my Lord! Grant mefrom You, a good offspring. You are indeed the All-Hearer of invocation. } 439. Then the angels called him, while he was standing in prayer in the Mihrdb, (saying): "Allah gives you glad tidings ofYahya, believing in the Wordfrom Allah, and Sayyidan, and Hasuran, a Prophet, from among the righteous. } 440. He said: O my Lord! Hoio can I have a son when I am very old, and my wife is barren?" (Allah) said: "Thus Allah does what He wills. }

442. He said: "O my Lord! Make a sign for me. (Allah) said: Your sign is that you shall not speak to the people for three days except by signals. And remember your Lord much, and glorify (Him) in the afternoon and in the morning. The Supplication of Zakariyya, and the Good News of Yahya s Birth When Zakariyya saw that Allah provided sustenance for Maryam by giving her the fruits of winter in summer and the fruits of summer in winter, he was eager to have a child of his own. By then, Zakariyya had become an old man, his bones feeble and his head full of gray hair. His wife was an old women who was barren. Yet, he still supplicated to Allah and called Him in secret, 40 my Lord! Grant mefrom Ladunka,} from You, iU 4A good offspring^ meaning, a righteous offspring, iYou are indeed the All-Hearer of invocation Allah said, iThen the angels called him, while he was standing in prayer in the Mihrdb,} meaning, the angels spoke to him directly while he was secluded, standing in prayer at his place of worship. Allah told us about the good news that the angels delivered to Zakariyya, 4^ iAllah gives you glad tidings ofYaliya of a child from your offspring, his name is Yahya. Qatadah and other scholars said that he was called Yahya (literally, lie lives) because Allah filled his life with faith. m Ibn Abi Hatim 2:235.

254 Tafslr Ibn Knthir Allah said next, 4U * &* } ibelievittg in the Word from Allah} Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, and also Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ikrimah, Mujahid, Abu Ash-Shatha, As-Suddi, Ar-Rabl bin Anas, Ad-Dahhak, and several others said that the Ayah, 4i^ Si bl t} ^believing in the Word from Allah means, Believing in Isa, son ofMaryam. Abu Al- Aliyah, Ar-Rabl bin Anas, Qatadah and Said bin Jubayr said that Allah s statement, 4f Z',} iAnd Sayyidan means, a wise man. 121 Ibn Abbas, Ath-Thawri and Ad-Dahhak said that Sayyidan means, The noble, wise and pious man. 131 Said bin Al-Musayyib said that Sayyid is the scholar and Faqth, Atiyah said that Sayyid is the man noble in behavior and piety. Ikrimah said that it refers to a person who is not overcome by anger, while Ibn Zayd

said that it refers to the noble man. Mujahid said that Sayyidan means, honored by Allah. Allah's statement, 4And Hasuran does not mean he refrains from sexual relations with women, but that he is immune from illegal sexual relations. This does not mean that he does not marry women and have legal sexual relations with them, for Zakariyya said in his supplication for the benefit of Yahya, 4 Ji 4 iGrant me from You, a good offspring}, meaning, grant me a son who will have offspring, and Allah knows best. Allah's statement, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :235-237. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :238 At-Tabari 6:375.376.

4A Prophet, from among the righteous} delivers more good news of sending Yahya as Prophet after the good news that he will be born. This good news was even better than the news of Yahya's birth. In a similar statement, Allah said to the mother of Musa, 4^A-dftfr A-4-J VJ1> 4Verily, We shall bring him back to you, and shall make him one of the Messengers.} [28:7] When Zakariyya heard the good news, he started contemplating about having children at his age. He said, 436 4^=3' >*" (Ai j* *'-*"0 my Lord! How can I have a son when I am very old, and my wife is barren? (He) said...} meaning the angel said, 4 u <*&} 4 Thus Allah does what He wills. } meaning, this is Allah's matter, He is so Mighty that nothing escapes His power, nor is anything beyond His ability. 4*j 3""^ V-He said : 0 my Lord! Make a sign for me } meaning make a sign that alerts me that the child will come, 4'> *j Y) .Ay ilib 4' 36(Alldh) said: "Your sign is that you shall not speak to the people for three days except by signals. } meaning, you will not be able to speak except with signals, although you are not mute. In another Ayah, Allah said, 4 frju UH} 4For three nights, though having no bodily defect.} [19:10] Allah then commanded Zakariyya to supplicate, thank and praise Him often in that condition, iMt> 0 te- 3M} 4And remember your Lord much and glorify (Him) in the

O Maryam! Verily, Allah has chosen you, purified you, and chosen you above the women of the nations.

men achieved perfection, but among women, only Maryam the daughter of 'Imran and Asfah, the wife of Fir'aivn, achieved perfection . " The Six - with the exception of

4Nay, to Him belongs all that is in the heavens and on earth, and all surrender with obedience (Qdnitiin) to Him .> [2:116] Allah next said to His Messenger jg after He mentioned Maryam's story, iThis is a part of the news of the Ghayb which We reveal and narrate to you (O Muhammad jfe), 4You were not with them, when they cast lots with their pens as to which of them should be charged with the care of Maryam; nor were you with them when they disputed . meaning, You were not present, O Muhammad, when this occurred, so you cannot narrate what happened to the people as an eye witness. Rather, Allah disclosed these facts to you as if you were a witness, when they conducted a lottery to choose the custodian of Maryam, seeking the reward of this good deed. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ikrimah said, Maryam's mother left with Maryam, carrying her in her infant cloth, and took her to the rabbis from the offspring of Aaron, the brother of Musa. They were responsible for taking care of Bayt Al-Maqdis (the Masjid) at that time, just as there were those who took care of the Ka'bah. Maryam's mother said to them, Take this child whom I vowed [to serve the Masjid], I have set her free, since she is my daughter, for no menstruating woman should enter the Masjid, and I shall not take her back home. They said, She is the daughter of our Imam, as Imran used to lead them in prayer, who took care of our sacrificial rituals. Zakanyya said, Give her to me, for her maternal aunt is my wife. They said, Our hearts cannot bear that you take her, for she is the daughter of our Imam. So they conducted a lottery with the pens

with which they wrote the Tawrah, and Zakariyya won the lottery and took Maryam into his care. . Ikrunah, As-Suddi, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi bin Anas, and several m At-Jabari 6:351. [a] Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :266

Jr fZ*>\ S, >' >' >. >' ci'sVxU &4 ^ ^~*y ^~j4o|p Cf Oj*-k\j"&'ij j(s ^ &i: jj. others 11 said that the rabbis went into the Jordan river and conducted a lottery there, deciding to throw their pens into the river. The pen that remained afloat and idle would indicate that its owner would take care of Maryam. When they threw their pens into the river, the water took all the pens under, except Zakariyya s pen, which remained afloat in its place. Zakariyya was also their master, chief, scholar, Imam and Prophet, may Allah s peace and blessings be on him and the rest of the Prophets. 4 l+j-j j) J-uz _!' i* ' r!/rW "i' ^>" ('rtr*-i oJS . j-fj 4 < * (4^=4j tijili t2|> 0^ lit lt C it # =, 3s 5i? %' 4 & 41 J: ;i& 445. (Remember) when the angels said: "O Maryam! Verily, Allah gives you the glad tidings of a Word from Him, his name will be Al-Masili, 'Isa, the son of Maryam, held in honor in this world and in the Hereafter, and he will be one of those ivho are near to Allah "> 111 Ibn Abi HAtim 2 :267,268.

446. "He will speak to the people, in the cradle and in manhood, and he will be one of the righteous . 447. She said: "O my Lord! How shall I have a son when no man has touched me." He said: "So (it will be) for Allah creates what He wills. When He has decreed something, He says to it only: 'Be!' - and it is.") Delivering the Good News to Maryam of Isa s Birth This Ayah contains the glad tidings the angels brought to Maryam that she would give birth to a mighty son who will have a great future. Allah said, 4*A ArrH ul cJL" 4(Remember) ivheti the angels said: "O Maryam! Verily, Alldlt gives you the glad tidings of a Word from Him, a son who will come into existence with a word from Allah, Be , and he was. This is the meaning of Allah s statement (about Yahya) 4Believing in the Word from Allah. [3:39], according to the majority of the scholars. 4His name will be Al-Masih, 'Isa, the son of Maryam) and he will be known by this name in this life, especially by the believers. Isa was called Al-Masih (the Messiah) because when he touched (Mash) those afflicted with an illness, they would be healed by Allah s leave. Allah s statement, 4'Isd, the son of Maryam relates Isa to his mother, because he did not have a father. ojj JjjSb W-J' 4 4Held in honor in this world and in the Hereafter, and will be one of those who are near to Allah.) meaning, he will be a leader and honored by Allah in this life,

No infant spoke in the cradle except three, 'Isd, the boy during the time of Jurayj, and another toy.

4 *^ jJj 4 jf ^j 4"0 my Lord! How shall I have a son when no man has touched me."} Mary said, How can I have a son while I did not marry, nor intend to marry, nor am I an indecent woman, may Allah forbid? The angel conveyed to Maryam, Allah s answer, 4 'if iSo (it will be) for Allah creates what He wills. He is Mighty in power and nothing escapes His ability. Allah used the word create here instead of the word does as in the tale about Zakariyya [3:40], to eradicate any evil thought concerning Isa. Allah next emphasized this fact when He said, Jr ii iWheti He has decreed something, He says to it only: "Be! - and it is.} meaning, what Allah wills, comes into existence instantly and without delay. In another Ayah, Allah said, t iAnd Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye.} [54:50], meaning, We only issue the command once, and it comes into existence instantly, as fast as, and faster than, a blink of the eye. -' zip 41 w LxZj} 'jfi jjjllj JS \ * ojijlf ji fCjii j Oj \5 Uj pSliJj Jf OiU jjjf ^jjv5 4jjaVl J; \j "I)f 4) liiifj .w o ^ ijS *iU'i 4 'jUS oj /?*"! tfjf ,>* |^="3 tfc* ".4 1^=4j5 6[448. And He will teach him the Book and Al-Hikmah, and the Tawrah and tlie Ittijl.} 449. And will make him a Messenger to the Children of Israel

163 Sitrah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-3) (saying) : "I have come to you with a sign from your Lord, that I design for you out of clay, a figure like that of a bird, and breathe into it, and it becomes a bird by Allah's leave; and I heal the blind, and the leper, and I bring the dead to life by Allah's leave. And I inform you of what you eat, and what you store in your houses. Surely, therein is a sign for you, if you believe." } 450. "(And I have come) confirming that which was before me of the Tawrah, and to make lawful to you part of what was forbidden to you, and I have come to you with a proof from your Lord. So have Taqwa of Allah and obey me. } 451. Truly, Allah is my Lord and your Lord, so worship Him (Alone). This is the straight path." }

The Description of 'Isa and the Miracles He Performed

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 860–862]

Allah states that the good news brought to Maryam about Isa was even better because Allah would teach him, ⁴the Book and Al-Hikmah}. It appears that the Book the Ayah mentioned here refers to writing. We explained the meaning of Al-Hikmah in the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah. ⁴the Tawrah and the Injil}. The Tawrah is the Book that Allah sent down to Musa, son of Imran, while the Injil is what Allah sent down to Isa, son of Maryam, peace be upon them, and Isa memorized both Books. Allah's statement, Zip d'. ⁴And will make him a Messenger to the Children of Israel} means, that Allah will send Isa as a Messenger to the Children of Israel, proclaiming to them, > ..S ⁴¹ have come to you with a sign from your Lord, I design for you out of clay, a figure like that of a bird, and breathe into it, and it becomes a bird by Allah's leave}.

These are the miracles that Isa performed; he used to make the shape of a bird from clay and blow into it, and it became a bird by Allah's leave. Allah made this a miracle for Isa to testify that He had sent him. i s}j} iAnd I heal him who is Akmah^ meaning, a person who was born blind, which perfects this miracle and makes the challenge more daring. iAnd the leper} which is a known disease, / f , -S \ Up LfJ? iAnd I bring the dead to life by Allah's leave}. Many scholars stated that Allah sent every Prophet with a miracle suitable to his time. For instance, in the time of Musa, magic was the trade of the time, and magicians held a high position. So Allah sent Musa with a miracle that captured the eyes and bewildered every magician. When the magicians realized that Musa's miracle came from the Almighty, Most Great, they embraced Islam and became pious believers. As for Isa, he was sent during a time when medicine and knowledge in physics were advancing. Isa brought them the types of miracles that could not be performed, except by one sent by Allah. How can any physician bring life to clay, cure blindness and leprosy and bring back to life those entrapped in the grave? Muhammad jg was sent during the time of eloquent people and proficient poets. He brought them a Book from Allah; if mankind and the Jinn tried to imitate ten chapters, or even one chapter of it, they will utterly fail in this task, even if they tried to do it by collective cooperation. This is because the Qur'an is the Word of Allah and is nothing like that of the creatures. Isa's statement. iAnd I inform you of what you eat, and what you store in your houses} means, I tell you about what one of you has just eaten and

Al 'Imran (Part-3) what he is keeping in his house for tomorrow. iSurely, therein}, all these miracles, ⁴is a sign for you} testifying to the truth of what I was sent to you with, }If you believe. And I have come confirming that which was before me of the Tawrah,} affirming the Tawrah and upholding it, jji j >

fk=o &%>} iand to make lawful to you part of what was forbidden to you.} This part of the Ayah indicates that Isa abrogated some of the Laws of the Tawrah and informed the Jews of the truth

regarding some issues that they used to dispute about. In

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 862–864]

another Ayah; uylbji JaM ^SJ CA iAnd in order to make clear to you some of the (points) in which you differ} [43:63], Isa said next, iAnd I have come to you with a proof from your Lord.} Containing affirmation and evidence to the truth of what I am conveying to you. i tjxjfc . if) i>[.if JjXJlj <&1 iSo have Taqwa of Allah and obey me. Truly, Allah is my Lord and your Lord, so worship Him (Alone).} for I and you are equal in our servitude, submission and humbleness to Him, i" S-U i&} iThis is the straight path.}

266 Tafstr Ibn Kathir ?ri 22 -0-)> >' 3^ Jli (jtiit b 1 it da: C* tsa* c\$.m * / j ^ /*<*&{ Liiisoli Jj^h Lx"uJj cJjft U^=^j - ii& & 452 . Then when Tsd came to know of their disbelief, he said: "Wfw will be my helpers in Allah's cause? Al-Ha- wdriyyun said: We are the helpers of Allah; we believe in Allah, and bear witness that we are Muslims."} 453. "Our Lord! We believe in what You have sent down, and we follow the Messenger [Isa]; so write us down among those who bear witness. } And they (disbelievers) plotted and Allah planned too. And Allah is the Best of those who plot} The Disciples Give Their Support to Isa Allah said, 4Then when Tsd came to know}, meaning, Isa felt that they were adamant in disbelief and continuing in misguidance. He said to them, 4Who will be my helper in Allah's cause?} Mujahid commented,

Who will give me asylum so that / can convey the Speech of my Lord, for the Quraush have prevented me from conveying the Speech of my Lord.

the battle of Al-Ahzab, Az-Zubayr came forward, and again,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 864–872]

when the Prophet jg asked for fighters a second time. The Prophet sg said, ' Every Prophet has a Hawari, and Az-Zubayr is my Hawari^ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said about, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 3:290. 3 :322 * Al Bidayah wan-Nihayah 5 :140 Al-Bari 6 :63 , Muslim 4:1879.

iso zwrite us down among those who bear witness} Meaning among the Ummah of Muhammad. 111 This Hadith has a good chain of narration. The Jews Plot to Kill Isa Allah states that the Children of Israel tried to kill Isa by conspiring to defame him and crucify him. They complained about him to the king who was a disbeliever. They claimed that Isa was a man who misguided people, discouraged them from obeying the king, caused division, and separated between man and his own son. They also said other lies about Isa, which they will carry on their necks, including accusing him of being an illegitimate son. The king became furious and sent his men to capture Isa to torture and crucify him. When they surrounded Isa's home and he thought that they would surely capture him, Allah saved him from them, raising him up from the house to heaven. Allah put the image of Isa on a man who was in the house; when the unjust people went in the house while it was still dark, they thought that he was Isa. They captured that man, humiliated and crucified him. They also placed thorns on his head . However, Allah

deceived these people. He saved and raised His Prophet from them, leaving them in disarray in the darkness of their transgression, thinking that they had successfully achieved their goal. Allah made their hearts hard, and defiant of the truth, disgracing them in such disgrace that it will remain with them until the Day of Resurrection. This is why Allah said, if 'j ii' iAnd they plotted, and Allah planned too. And Allah is the Best of those who plot.} ^ Some of this story is based on a report from Ibn Abbas which appears in the explanation of Surat An-Nisa no. 156. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :294

ji Gj 4 iff Cfc 'iyiliio *_j 4-4 i ijL^j i sr. ^ji1/jjf lS'j 4 x isi" o f"i .> .llx^t. tjc. 455. And (remember) when Allah said: O 'Isa! I will take you and raise you to Myself and purify [save] you from those who disbelieve, and I will make those who follow you superior to those who disbelieve till the Day of Resurrection . Then you will return to Me and I will judge between you in the matters in which you used to dispute." 456. "/Vs to those who disbelieve, I will punish them with severe torment in this world and in the Hereafter, and they zwill have no helpers."} 457. And as for those who believe and do righteous good deeds, Allah will pay them their reward in full. And AllSh does not like the lorongdoers . 458 . This is wlwt We recite to you of the verses and the Wise Reminder.} Meaning of Take You Allah said, "3< 41 will take you and raise you to Myself} while you are asleep. Allah said in a similar Ayat, 4It is He Who takes your souls by night (when you are asleep).} [6:60], and, &+& 4^ J jvJIM (> 4It is Allah Who takes away the souls at the time of their death, and those that die not during their sleep.} [39:42]. The Messenger of Allah used to recite the following words when he would awaken; 0 GJtj t iiiUl G JOW CG>-I AM JU JI

- but they killed him not, nor crucified him, but it appeared that way to them} until, XirthS < - -/'-If

iAnd purify [save] youfrom those who disbelieve} by raising you to heaven, #^ Si I#r Sir ij> iji? Sir / wif make those who follaio you superior to those who disbelieve , till the Day ofResurrection This is what happened. When Allah raised Isa to heaven, his followers divided into sects and groups. Some of them believed in what Allah sent Isa as, a servant of Allah, His Messenger, and the son of His female-servant. However, some of them went to the extreme over Isa, believing that he was the son of Allah. Some of them said that *Isa was Allah Himself, while others said that he was one of a Trinity. Allah mentioned these false creeds in the Qur an and refuted them. The Christians remained like this until the third century CE, when a Greek king called, Constantine, became a Christian for the purpose of destroying Christianity. Constantine was either a philosopher, or he was just plain ignorant. Constantine changed the religion of isa by adding to it and deleting from it. He established the rituals of Christianity and the so-called Great Trust, which is in fact the Great Treacheiy. He also allowed them to eat the meat of swine, changed the direction of the prayer that Isa established to the east, built churches for Isa, and added ten days to the fast as compensation for a sin that he committed, as claimed. So the religion of Isa became the religion of Constantine, who built more than twelve thousand churches, temples and monasteries for the Christians as well as the city that bears his name, Constantinople (Istanbul). Throughout this time, the Christians had the upper hand and dominated the Jews. Allah aided them against the Jews because they used to be closer to the truth than the Jews, even though both groups were and still are disbelievers, may Allah s curse descend on them. When Allah sent Muhammad Us, those who believed in him also believed in Allah, His Angels, Books and Messengers in the correct

manner. So they were the true followers of every Prophet who came to earth. They believed in the unlettered Prophet *sg*, the Final Messenger and the master of all mankind,

who called them to believe in the truth in its entirety. This is why they had more right to every Prophet than his own nation, especially those who claim to follow their Prophet's way and religion, yet change and alter his religion. Furthermore, Allah abrogated all the laws that were sent down to the Prophets with the Law He sent Muhammad *fg* with, which consists of the true religion that shall never change or be altered until the commencement of the Last Hour. Muhammad's religion shall always be dominant and victorious over all other religions. This is why Allah allowed Muslims to conquer the eastern and western parts of the world and the kingdoms of the earth. Furthermore, all countries submitted to them; they demolished Kisra (king of Persia) and destroyed the Czar, ridding them of their treasures and spending these treasures for Allah's sake. All this occurred just as their Prophet *fg* told them it would, when he conveyed Allah's statement, *Ljr=> j .Li i \J C cyft iif J ^ t; ; p. \$ >&> p oj dUp iAlldh* has promised those among you who believe and do righteous good deeds, that He will certainly grant them succession in the land, as He granted it to those before them, and that He will grant them the authority to practice their religion which He has chosen for them. And He will surely give them in exchange a safe security after their fear (provided) they worship Me and do not associate anything with Me.\$ [24:55). Therefore, Muslims are the true believers in Isa. The Muslims then acquired Ash-Sham from the Christians, causing them to evacuate to Asia Minor, to their fortified city in Constantinople. The Muslims will be above them until the Day of Resurrection. Indeed, he, Muhammad *sfe*, who is truthful and who received the true news, has conveyed to Muslims that they will conquer Constantinople in the future, and seize its treasures. *** This occurred after *ibn Kathlr*'s time.

Threatening the Disbelievers with Torment in This Life and the Hereafter Allah said, *\ij J 4 C/jJ' C*fc " w -" 4r> .ikf-i Ji >-+! 4And / w/ make those zwho follow you superior to those who disbelieve till the Day of Resurrection . Then you will return to Me and I will judge between you in the matters in which you used to dispute. As to those who disbelieve, I will punish them with a severe torment in this world and in the Hereafter, and they will have no helpers. This is what Allah did to the Jews who disbelieved in isa and the Christians who went to the extreme over him. Allah tormented them in this life; they were killed, captured, and lost their wealth and kingdoms. Their torment in the Hereafter is even worse and more severe, Vi oj iAnd they have no Wdq (defender or protector) against Allah} [13 :34], s 4^^ 'Ji "' > iyit* j fi iAnd as for those who believe and do righteous good deeds, Allah ivill pay them their reward in full} in this life, with victory and domination, and in the Hereafter, with Paradise and high grades, i4i y ^j} iAnd Allah does not like the wrongdoers.} Allah then said, o # Sj #>} iThis is what We recite to you of the verses and the Wise Reminder.} meaning, What We narrated to you, O Muhammd, regarding Isa, his birth and his life, is what Allah conveyed and revealed*

m oA to you, sent down J 3 \ C LJ^j otaijS_yjli \1> '_"1^j.-M i_>!_yL" 'j3_yu|i LSuu yaUj-vujWi \$ ^iii^ from the Al-Lawh Al- M a h f u z (The Preserved Tablet). So there is no doubt in it. Similarly, Allah said in Surah Maryam-, , 4j ^ f-A cj) JAi l> ,'.HvLitA*i AJ i j)l (jhJI < J , y -J> dr5 o' (jo 4& G 1 fil i^m jr \$ iSuch is 'Isa, son of Maryam. (It is) a state- ment of truth, about which they doubt (or dispute). It befits not Allah that He should beget a son . Glorified be He. When He decrees a thing, He only says to it: "Be!" and it is. } iS*J' f jfZj jf 'A JU i y'J cri - fS'" ,(i' if ,\rt* ji 9 jft2 jia fi *~" & ji ."

'SiH)' Vi "i&j oi JI _*l' oii) fi M'j L^jJj ficly* iTaijj jSYG^J tTitH.1 j^jj* "" -iv'j *>>' V^ fj) Oi i")' .j IJca o(" ojjisa)' 4 w . jf-j-.-iili %Ac ' 5U 'j3jj 459. Verily, the likeness of 'Isa before Allah is the likeness of Adam. He created him from dust, then said to him: "Be!" and he was.} 460. (This is) the truth from your Lord, so be not of those who doubt.} 461 . Then whoever disputes with you concerning him after the

Al 'Imran (Part-3) knowledge that has come to you, say: "Come, let us call our sons and your sons, our women and your women, ourselves and yourselves, then we pray and we invoke Allah's curse upon the liars."} 462. Verily, this is the true narrative, and there is no god except Allah. And indeed, Allah is the Almighty, the All- Wise.} 463 . And if they turn away, then surely, Allah is All-Aware of those who do mischief.} The Similarities Between the Creation of Adam and the Creation of 'Isa Allah said, iVerily, the likeness of Isa before Allah}

regarding Allah's ability, since He created him without a

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 872–887]

father, 4is the likeness of Adam}, for Allah created Adam without a father or a mother. Rather, 4#3 \$ i ft J-i '-fj ot 4He created him from dust, then (He) said to him : "Be! and he was.} Therefore, He Who created Adam without a father or a mother is able to create Isa, as well, without a father. If the claim is made that Isa is Allah s son because he was created without a father, then the same claim befits Adam even more. However, since such a claim regarding Adam is obviously false, then making the same claim about Isa is even more false. Furthermore, by mentioning these facts, Allah emphasizes His ability, by creating Adam without a male or female, Hawa from a male without a female, and Isa from a mother without a father, compared to His creating the rest of creation from male and female. This is why Allah said in Surah Maryam,

4oz& ij'* ;a&} iAttd We made him a sign for mankind} [19:21]. Allah said in this Ayah, i : *& 3 \$5 i(This is) the truth from your Lord, so be not of those who doubt.} meaning, this is the only true story about Isa, and what is beyond truth save falsehood? Allah next commands His Messenger to call those who defy the truth, regarding Isa, to the Mubalahah (the curse). The Challenge to theMubalahah b.tjj fit 'jjbi jii jfjf U frt [jA liU-t fCt} iTheit whoever disputes with you concerning him after the knowledge that has come to you, say: "Come, let us call our sons and your sons, our women and your women, ourselves and yourselves"} for the Mubalahah, ^then we pray}, supplicate, d* vlwJ iand we invoke Allah's curse upon the liars} among the two of us.

The reason for the call to Mubalahah and the revelation of the Ayat from the beginning of this Surah until here, is that a delegation from the Christians of Najran (in Yemen) came to Al-Madinah to argue about Isa, claiming that he was divine and the son of Allah. Allah sent down the beginning of this Surah until here, to refute their claims, as Imam Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar and other scholars stated. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar said in his famous Sirah, The delegation of Christians from Najran came to the Messenger of Allah The delegation consisted of sixty horsemen, including fourteen of their chiefs who make

decisions. These men were Al- Aqib, also known as Abdul- Masfih, As-Sayyid, also known as Al- Ayham, Abu Harithah bin Alqamah, of (the family of) Bakr bin Wa'il and Uways bin Al- Harith. They also included, Zayd, Qays, Yazid, Nablh, Khuwaylid, Amr, Khalid, Abdullah and Yuhannas. Three of these men were chiefs of this delegation, Al- Aqib, their leader and to whom they referred for advice and decision; As-Sayyid, their scholar and leader in journeys and social gatherings; and Abu Harithah bin Alqamah, their patriarch, priest and religious leader. Abu Harithah was an Arab man from (the family of) Bakr bin Wa'il, but when he embraced Christianity, the Romans and their kings honored him and built churches for him (or in his honor). They also supported him financially and gave him servants, because they knew how firm his faith in their religion was. Abu Harithah knew the description of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ from what he read in earlier divine Books. However, his otherwise ignorance led him to insist on remaining a Christian, because he was honored and had a high position with the Christians. Ibn Ishaq said, Muhammad bin Ja'far bin Az-Zubayr said that, The (Najran) delegation came to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ in Al-Madlnah, entered his Masjid wearing robes and garments, after the Prophet ﷺ had prayed the Asr prayer. They accompanied a caravan of camels led by Bani Al-Harith bin Kah. The Companions of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ who saw them said that they never saw a delegation like them after that... Then Abu Harithah bin Alqamah and Al- Aqib Abdul- Masfih or As-Sayyid Al- Ayham spoke to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, and they were Christians like the king (Roman King). However, they disagreed about Isa; some of them said, He is Allah, while some said, He is the son of Allah, and some others said, He is one of a trinity. Allah is far from what they attribute to Him. Indeed, these are the creeds of the Christians. They claim that Isa is God, since he brought the dead back to life, healed blindness, leprosy and various illnesses, told about matters of the future, created the shape of birds and blew life into them, bringing them to life. However, all these miracles occurred by 111 Ibn Hisham 2:222.

178 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Allah's leave, so that Isa would be a sign from Allah for people. They also claim that Isa is the son of Allah, since he did not have a father and he spoke when he was in the cradle, a miracle which had not occurred by any among the Children of Adam before him, so they claim. They also claim that Isa is one of a trinity, because Allah would say, *We did, command, create and demand. They said, If Allah were one, he would have said, I did, command, create and decide. This is why they claim that Isa and Allah are one (Trinity). Allah is far from what they attribute to Him, and we should mention that the Qur'an refuted all these false Christian claims. Ibn Ishaq continued, When these Ayyid came to the Messenger from Allah ﷺ, thus judging between him and the People of the Book, Allah also commanded the Prophet ﷺ to call them to the Mubalahah if they still refused the truth. The Prophet ﷺ called them to the Mubalahah. They said, O Abu Al- Qasim! Let us think about this matter and get back to you with our decision to what we want to do. They left the Prophet ﷺ and conferred with Al- Aqib, to whom they referred to for advice. They said to him, O Abdul-Masih! What is your advice? He said, By Allah, O Christian fellows! You know that Muhammad is a Messenger and that he brought you the final word regarding your fellow (Isa). You also know that no Prophet conducted Mubalahah with any people, and the old persons among them remained safe and the young people grew up. Indeed, it will be the end of you if you do it. If you have already decided that you will remain in your religion and your creed regarding your fellow (Isa), then conduct a treaty with the man (Muhammad) and go back to your land. They came to the Prophet ﷺ and said, O Abu Al-Qasim! We decided that we cannot do Mubalahah

with you and that you remain on your religion, while we remain on our religion. However, send with us a man from your Companions whom you are pleased with to judge between us regarding our monetary disputes, for you are acceptable to us in this regard.

Verily, I will send a trusted man with you, a truly trustworthy man. The Companions of the Messenger of Allah all felt eager to be that man. The Messenger said,

180 Tafsir Ibn Kathir when they returned Al-Bukhan,

if4^=* & *#2 Ji0 ji> ^Say : "O people of the Scripture! Come to a word"} Word - in Arabic - also means a complete sentence, as evident from this Ayah. Allah described this word as being one, it is the same between us and you}, an honest and righteous word that is fair to both parties. Allah then explained this word, i'k^.. **_. 'jj y\t Zll it that we worship none but Allah (Alone), and that we associate no partners with Him,} we worship neither a statue, cross, idol, Taghut (false gods), fire or anything else. Rather, we worship Allah Alone without partners, and this is the message of all of Allah's Messengers. Allah said, ^ t' *S/ 1 Jd] Jo"" O] z&y yj. Jj-y dji* & Z',} iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him (saying) : "None has the right to be worshipped but I (Allah)], so worship Me (Alone and none else)." [21:25] and, Vj-J Ail J.=" j, jjJj} iAnd verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid (or keep away from) Taghut (all false deities). } [16:36]. Allah said next, i flit 05> liljl L*uu bwvuj JitLj Vj> i"and that none of us shall take others as lords besides Allah." Ibn Jurayj commented, We do not obey each other in disobedience to Allah. id 4\$ iThen, if they turn away, say: "Bear witness that we are Muslims. }

182 Tafsir Ibn Kathir if they abandon this fair call, then let them know that you will remain in Islam as Allah has legislated for you. We should mention that the letter that the Prophet sent to Heraclius reads, In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. From Muhammad, the Messenger of Allah, to Heraclius, Leader of the Romans: peace be upon those who follow the true guidance. Embrace Islam and you will acquire safety, embrace Islam and Allah will grant you a double reward. However, if you turn away from it, then you will carry the burden of the peasants, and, people of the Scripture: Come to a word that is the same between us and you, that we worship none but Allah (Alone), and that we associate no partners with Him, and that none of us shall take others as lords besides Allah." Then, if they turn away, say: "Bear witness that we are Muslims." Muhammad bin Ishaq and other scholars said that the beginning of Surah Al Imran, and more than eighty verses thereafter; were revealed about the delegation of Najran. Az-Zuhri stated that the people of Najran were the first people to pay the Jizyah (tax money paid to the Muslim State). However, there is no disagreement that the Ayah that ordained the Jizyah [9:29] was revealed after the Fath (conquering Makkah, and therefore, after the delegation of Najran came to Al-Madina). So, how can this Ayah [3:64] be contained in the Prophet's letter to Heraclius before the victory of Makkah, and how can we harmonize between the statements of Muhammad bin Ishaq and Az-Zuhri? The answer is that the delegation of Najran came before Al-Hudaybiyyah (before the victory of Makkah), and what they paid was in lieu of the Mubalahah, not as Jizyah. The Ayah about the Jizyah was later revealed, and its ruling supported what occurred with the Najran people. In support of this opinion, we should mention that in another instance, the ruling on dividing the booty into one-fifth (for the Prophet) and four-fifths (for

the fighters) agreed with the practice of Abdullah bin Jahsh during the raid that he led before Badr. An Ayah later on upheld the way Abdullah

divided the booty. Therefore, it is possible that the Prophet sfe wrote this statement (Say, O People of the Scripture...) in his letter to Heraclius before the Ayah was revealed. Later on, the Qur an agreed with the Prophet s statement, word by word. It is also a fact that the Qur an was revealed in agreement with what Umar said regarding the captured disbelievers at Badr, the Hijab (Muslim woman code of dress), refraining from performing prayer for the hypocrites, and regarding his statements: 4And take you the Maqdm (place) of Ibrahim as a place of prayer.} [2:125], and, x/ \ Cs^r ilt may be if he divorced you (all) that his Lord will give him instead ofyou, wives belter than you.} [66:5]. % pe pQ 2Z& uj-l: cjS* f 'J7> d V Cfifj iff' ly-f' i/fd oi^ t*J 4 kij <*" 465. O people of the Scripture! Why do you dispute about Ibrahim, while the Tawrah and the Injil were not revealed till after him? Have you then no sense?} 466. Verily, you are those who have disputed about that of which you have knoioledge. Why do you then dispute concerning that of which you have no knowledge? It is Allah Wlw knows, and you know not.} 467 . Ibrahim ivas neither a Jew nor a Christian, but he was a true Muslim Hanifa and he was not of the Mushrikin } 468. Verily, among mankind who have the best claim to Ibrahim are those who followed him, and this Prophet and those who have believed. And Allah is the Wali (Protector and Helper) of the believers

184 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir Disputing with the Jews and Christians About the Religion ofIbrahim Allah censures the Jews and Christians for their dispute with Muslims over Ibrahim Al-Khalil and the claim each group made that he was one of them. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar reported that Ibn Abbas said, The Christians of Najran and Jewish rabbis gathered before the Messenger of Allah sfe, and disputed in front of him. The rabbis said, Ibrahim was certainly Jewish. The Christians said, Certainly, Ibrahim was Christian. So Allah sent down, 40 people of the Scripture (Jews and Christians)! Why do you dispute about Ibrahim,} meaning, *How is it that you, Jews, claim that Ibrahim was Jew, although he lived before Allah sent down the Tawrah to Musa? How is it that you, Christians, claim that Ibrahim was Christian, although Christianity came after his time? This is why Allah said, iHave you then no sense?} Allah then said, k *i (" S4 \$ pi ti iVerily, you are those who have disputed about that of which you have knowledge. Why do you then dispute concerning that ofwhich you have no knowledge?} This Ayah criticizes those who argue and dispute without knowledge, just as the Jews and Christians did concerning Ibrahim. Had they disputed about their religions, which they had knowledge of, and about the Law that was legislated for them until Muhammad was sent, it would have been better for them. Rather, they disputed about what they had no knowledge of, so Allah criticized them for this behavior. Allah commanded them to refer what they have no knowledge of to He Who knows the seen and unseen matters and Who knows [At-Tabari 6 :490

185Siirah 3. Al Imran (Part-3 the true reality of all things. This is why Allah said, ill is Allah Who knows, and you knoio not.} Allah said, /*/ "A <.) ilbrdhim was neither a Jezv nor a Christian, but he was a true

'LW\ e JDSUBW u?q P1.BS m 4,/ssaufm waq nob aptfcn 'i{P}lvf ivby ai{ } ui aoatpqsip nob op bi{M pjttfduas aip fo a\doaj o OzV 4)ou aapajad baip pitv 'sanjasuatp fdaaxa auobnv bvjjsv pvaj jou \vip baip jng bvjpv nob pva\ o; tjsoi auniduag aig fo apioag aig fo bpvd y jpr*": :^ V if if* f ^ *? ! fj v iet f,

f. H jit"? rrr if f^ C5^ a^ f ft# * isEl ?*fi^ ?rfi rrr >(&f \$jss vff. -S -f- ^ f?ir' 5\V" ? i*f* it\$:r' rrv^c ifwP
firr*' <*n^(n< "A "-*> 'Jr* /r :r: irsr d ir^ *Kf l!5r d SJ57 ?^ if HE# 2a f fit "^ & 4-F S c* if^r
siaSuassajM sih ui SAdipq oqm asoqj ns jo JOpajOJD aqU si M?[iv sueau 4 sjaoaipq aip fo (uadpiq
puv jopaiouj) Jim 3lll st iffUV P"V i%% itffft juauiajejs s,qenv (I I 4" mi{ paowjjof oipi asoiiji aw
unifvuqj 0) wtvf fsaq ai{ } aavij oipi pitt)fUVUl Suouw bjU3^ > Wll"yi ttqi uisfvx ^% iff*\$ \$ ^ tans vo
swaas ^

Al Imran (Part-3) 471. "O People of the Scripture! Why do you mix truth with falsehood and conceal the truth while you know?" 472. And a party of the People of the Scripture say: "Believe in the morning in that which is revealed to the believers, and reject it at the end of the day, so that they may turn back." 473. And believe no one except the one who follows your religion." Say (O Prophet): Verily, right guidance is the guidance of Allah." (And they say:) "Do not believe that anyone can receive like that which you have received, otherwise they would engage you in argument before your Lord." Say: "All the bounty is in the Hand of Allah; He grants to whom He wills. And Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All-Knower." 474. He selects for His Mercy whom He wills and Allah is the Owner of great bounty.} The Envy the Jews Feel Towards Muslims; Their Wicked Plots Against Muslims Allah states that the Jews envy the faithful and wish they could misguide them. Allah states that the punishment of this behavior will fall back upon them, while they are unaware. Allah criticizes them, 40 People of the Scripture! : Why do you disbelieve in the Ayat of Allah, while you bear witness.} You know for certain that Allah's Ayat are true and authentic, 40 People of the Scripture: Why do you mix truth with falsehood and conceal the truth while you know? } by hiding what is in your Books about the description of Muhammad *sg*, while you know what you do. *ft 4fec 4* And a party of the People of the Scripture say : "Believe in the morning in that which is revealed to the believers, and reject it

at the end of the day,} This is a wicked plan from the People of the Book to deceive Muslims who are weak in the religion. They decided that they would pretend to be believers in the beginning of the day, by attending the dawn prayer with the Muslims. However, when the day ended, they would revert to their old religion so that the ignorant people would say, They reverted to their old religion because they uncovered some shortcomings in the Islamic religion. This is why they said next. ^so that they may turn back Ibn Abi Najih said that Mujahid commented about this Ayah, which refers to the Jews, They attended the dawn prayer with the Prophet and disbelieved in the end of the day in order to misguide the people. This way, people would think that they have uncovered shortcomings in the religion that they briefly followed. 111 C?-* o-i 4" And believe no one except the one who follows your religion." 4 They said, do not trust anyone with your secret knowledge, except those who follow your religion. Therefore, they say, do not expose your knowledge to Muslims in order to prevent them from believing in it and, thus, use it as proof against you. Allah replied, *jty 4* Say: (O Prophet) "Verily, right guidance is the guidance of Allah."} Allah guides the hearts of the faithful to the perfect faith through the clear Ayat, plain proofs and unequivocal evidence that He has sent down to His servant and Messenger Muhammad This occurs, O you Jews, even though you hide the description of Muhammad *jfe*. the unlettered Prophet whom you find in your Books that you received from the earlier Prophets. Allah's statement; *j' V k jil uj\ city m At-Tabari 6 :508*

4(And they say:) "Do not believe that anyone can receive like that which you have received, otherwise they would engage you in argument before your Lord."} They say, Do not disclose the knowledge that you have to the Muslims, to prevent them from learning it and thus becoming your equals. They will be even better because they will believe in it or will use it against you as evidence with your Lord, and thus establish Allah's proof against you in this life and the Hereafter. Allah said, 4*^ o' <-i\$. k 4Say : "All the bounty is in the Hand of Allah ; He grants to whom He wills.} meaning, all affairs are under His control, and He gives and takes. Verily, Allah gives faith, knowledge and sound comprehension to whomever He wills. He also misguides whomever He wills by blinding his sight, mind, seeding his heart, hearing and stamping his eyes closed. Allah has the perfect wisdom and the unequivocal proofs. j's% si*& y%} 4And Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures needs, All- Knower. He selects for His mercy whom He wills and Allah is the Owner of great bounty.} meaning, He has endowed you, O believers, with tremendous virtue, in that He honored your Prophet Muhammad's over all other prophets, and by directing you to the best Sharfah there is. 'i J&Jt ol JUi i.Sjj yllii iLt ol J-cv* ossf&ft 4 U 4 ,vl,Jvilisf v-i4 tif jlij 475. Among the People of the Scripture is he who, if entrusted with a Qintar (a great amount of wealth), will readily pay it back; and among them there is he who, if entrusted with a single silver coin, will not repay it unless you constantly stand demanding, because they say: There is no blame on us to betray and take the properties of the illiterates (Arabs)." But

190 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr they tell a lie against Allah while they know it.} i76. Yes, whoever fulfills his pledge and fears Allah much; verily, then Allah loves the Muttaqîn (the pious).} How Trustworthy Are the Jews? Allah states that there are deceitful people among the Jews. He also warns the faithful against being deceived by them, because some of them, if entrusted with a Qintar (a great amount)} of money, iioill readily pay it back;} This Ayah indicates that this type would likewise give what is less than a Qintar, as is obvious. However, 4 * xii k ^ o) b* jkki'i} iand among them there is he who, if entrusted with a single silver coin, will not repay it unless you constantly stand demanding,} and insisting on acquiring your rightful property. If this is what he would do with one Dinar, then what about what is more than a Dinar? We mentioned the meaning of Qintar in

the beginning of this Surah, while the value of Dinar is well

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 887–935]

known. Allah's statement, 4J : */" 4because they say : "There is no blame on us to betray and take the properties of the illiterates (Arabs). } means, what made them reject the truth (or what they owed) is that they said, There is no harm in our religion if we eat up the property of the unlettered ones, the Arabs, for Allah has allowed it for us. Allah replied, 4^jJU \$ jk Ykj}} iBut they tell a lie against Allah while they know it.} for they invented this lie and word of misguidance. Rather, Allah would not allow this money for them unless they had a right to it.

Al Imran (Part-3) Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Sa'sa'ah bin Yazîd said that a man asked Ibn Abbas, During battle, we capture some property belonging to Ahl Adh-Dhimmah such as chickens and sheep. Ibn Abbas said, What do you do in this case? The man said, We say that there is no sin (if we confiscate them) in this case. He said, That is what the People of the Book said, Aj^ SsfVf 4 } iTIt is no blame on us to betray and take the properties of the illiterates (Arabs).} Verily, if they pay the Jizyah, then you

are not allowed their property, except when they willingly give it up. Allah then said, AYes, whoever fulfills his pledge and fears Allah much,} fulfills his promise and fears Allah among you, O People of the Book, regarding the covenant Allah took from you to believe in Muhammad sg when he is sent, just as He took the same covenant from all Prophets and their nations. Whoever avoids Allah s prohibitions, obeys Him and adheres to the Shari'ah that He sent with His Final Messenger sg and the master of all mankind. 4 > iverily, then Allah loves the Muttaqin.} Yj 4 (* ^ ^ uIj jif ojjs <'w U} ^V&& % '4\ 477. Verily, those who purchase a small gain at the cost of Allah's covenant and their oaths, they shall have no portion in the Hereafter (Paradise). Neither will Allah speak to them nor look at them on the Day of Resurrection , nor will He purify them, and tlmj shall have a paitifid torment.} Jews and Christians living under Muslim control. Tafsir Abdur-Razzaq 1 :123.

192 Tafstr Ibn Kathir There is No Share in the Hereafter forThoseWho Break Allah s Covenant Allah states that whoever prefers the small things of this short, soon to end life, instead of fulfilling what they have promised Allah by following Muhammad 53, announcing his description [from their books] to people and affirming his truth, then. Ax>-*?' 4\$& -5 ithey shall have no portion in the Hereafter.\$ They will not have a share or part in the Hereafter s rewards, AY'-xY fji (^ 'ix} ANeither will Allah speak to them nor look at them on the Day ofResurrection } with His mercy. This Ayah indicates that Allah will not speak words of kindness nor look at them with any mercy, Anor will He purify them} from sins and impurities. Rather, He will order them to the Fire, iU Aand they shall have a painful torment.} There are several Hadiths on the subject of this Ayah, some of which follow. The First Hadith Imam

Al 'Imran (Part-3) statement thrice, "The Musbil (man whose clothes reach beloio the ankles), he who swears while lying so as to sell his merchandize and the one who gives charity and reminds people ofit)."" W This was also recorded by

Al 'Imran (Part-3) p*\$3 ' ^f^pjkd\$,22&l \$ ZppZfi < +.& -&!tet30# 0 j"E&aijs Ojy"- li' |JL-Lit74l A- itil gjjtgu Imam (

196 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir They attribute their own lies to Allah, even though they know that they have lied and invented falsehood. Therefore, Allah said, & zgx jSf& iattd they speak a lie against Allah while they know it.} Mujahid, Ash-ShaTji, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ar-RabI' bin Anas said that, iwho distort the Book with their tongues,} means, They alter them (Allah s Words).

4>;\$A2^ HS jSCiv. |& JS. It is not (possible) for any human being to whom Allah has given the Book and Al-Hukm and prophcthood to say to the people: "Be my ivorshippers rather than Allah s." On the contrary (he would say): "Be you Rabbaniyyun , because you are teaching the Book, and you are studying it."} 480. Nor would he order you to take angels and Prophets for lords. Would he order you to disbelieve after you have submitted to Allah s will?} No Prophet Ever Called People to Worship him or to Worship OtherThan Allah This Ayah [3:79] means, it is not for a person whom Allah has given the Book, knowledge in the Law and prophethood to proclaim to the people, Worship me instead of Allah, meaning, along with Allah. If this is not the right of a Prophet or a Messenger, then indeed, it is not the right of anyone else to issue such a claim. This criticism refers to the ignorant rabbis, priests and teachers of misguidance, unlike the Messengers and their sincere knowledgeable followers who implement their knowledge; for they only command what Allah commands them, as their honorable

Messengers conveyed to them. They also forbid what Allah forbade for them, by the words of His honorable Messengers. The Messengers, may Allah's peace and blessings be on all of them, are the emissaries between Allah and His creation, conveying Allah's Message and Trust. The messengers indeed fulfilled their mission, gave sincere advice to creation and conveyed the truth to them. Allah's statement, if Si 40n the contrary (he would say), "Be you Rabbaniyyun, because you are teaching the Book, and you are studying it."} means, the Messenger recommends the people to be Rabbaniyyun. Ibn Abbas, Abu Razln and several others said that Rabbaniyyun means, Wise, learned, and forbearing. 111 Ibn Abi HStim 2 :365

Ad-Dahhak commented concerning Allah's statement. i&jl^ ^ c,} 4because you are teaching the Book, and you are studying it. } Whoever learns the Qur'an deserves to become a Faqih (learned). 4j - & } iand you are studying it}, preserving its words. Allah then said, \$0 Z&s (& at pjK, Tj} iNor would he order you to take angels and Prophetsfor lords.} The Prophet does not command worshipping other than Allah, whether a sent Messenger or an angel. & H-M iWould he order you to disbelieve after you have submitted to Allah's will?} meaning, he would not do that, for whoever calls to worshipping other than Allah, will have called to Kufr. The Prophets only call to Iman which commands worshipping Allah Alone without partners. Allah said in other Ayat, 4 Tt 0 V) 4) V Joi VII iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you (O Muhammad jg) but We revealed to him (saying) : "None has the right to be worshipped but I, so worship Me .} (21:25], 4% &\ SV& ^ I * } * ^ V iAnd verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid Tdghiit (all false deities). } (16:36], and, i+JJ. oji Of Of Of j j} iAnd ask those of Our Messengers whom We sent before you: "Did We ever appoint gods to be worshipped besides the Most Gracious (Allah)? } [43:45] Allah said concerning the angels,

iSj* jX <?yr oi pri & 4And if any of them should say : "Verily, I am a god besides Him (Allah)," such a one We should recompense with Hell. Thus We recompense the wrongdoers (21:29). 481. And (remember) when Allah took the covenant of the Prophets, saying: "Take whatever I gave you from the Book and Hikmah, and afterwards there will come to you a Messenger confirming what is with you; you must, then, believe in him and help him." Allah said: "Do you agree (to it) and will you take up Isri?" They said: "We agree." He said: "Then bear witness; and I am with you among the witnesses.'y 482. Then whoever turns away after this, they are the rebelliously Taking a Pledge From the Prophets to Believe in Our Prophet,Muhammadm Allah states that He took a pledge from every Prophet whom He sent from Adam until Isa, that when Allah gives them the Book and the Hikmah, thus acquiring whatever high grades they deserve, then a Messenger came afterwards, they would believe in and support him. Even though Allah has given the Prophets the knowledge and the prophethood, this fact should not make them refrain from following and supporting the Prophet who comes after them. This is why Allah, the Most High, Most Honored, said 4f ?J Oi ft 4And (remember) when Allah took the covenant of the Prophets, saying: "Take whatever I gave you from the Book and Hikmah.'y

meaning, if I give you the Book and the Hikmah, afterwards there will come to you a Messenger confirming what is with you; you must, then, believe in him and help him." Allah said, "Do you agree (to it) and will you take up Isri? } Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ar-Rabl , Qatadah and As-Suddi said that 7sr means, My covenant. t Muhammad bin Ishaq said that, ^Isri} means, The responsibility of My covenant

that you took, * meaning, the ratified pledge that you gave Me. iTley said: ,r We agree." He said: "Then bear witness; and I am with you among the witnesses." then whoever turns away after this, } from fulfilling this pledge and covenant, ithey are the rebellious.} Ali bin Abi Talib and his cousin Abdullah bin Abbas said, Allah never sent a Prophet but after taking his pledge that if Muhammad jg were sent in his lifetime, he would believe in and support him. Allah commanded each Prophet to take a pledge from his nation that if Muhammad were sent in their time, they would believe in and support him. Tawus, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Qatadah said, Allah took the pledge from the Prophets that they would believe in each other , and this statement does not contradict what Ali and Ibn Abbas stated. Therefore, Muhammad is the Final Prophet jg until the Day of Resurrection. He is the greatest Imam, who if he existed in Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :373 ,374. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :273Tabari 6:555.

any time period, deserves to be obeyed, rather than all other Prophets. This is why Muhammad jg led the Prophets in prayer during the night of Isra when they gathered in Bayt Al- Maqdis (Jerusalem). He is the intercessor on the Day of Gathering, when the Lord comes to judge between His servants. This is Al-Maqam Al- Mahmud (the praised station) [refer to 17:79) that only Muhammad deserves, a responsibility which the mighty Prophets and Messengers will decline to assume. However, Muhammad 2g will carry the task of intercession, may Allah s peace and blessings be on him. g)g)i n V " js y u?i a ds- -- " "4 J yy ' . gr* '>'> - "z> .-f < * , f *Ui' / -ft>> > jjili l5 j ouie, 0;J'J), {jj viU'S 4-d}j yjdl' 4 !> ^L*~i J>' f-if&l it* ty Uj Jit l i"L j" j-^ri C5i H oi Jj 1 ty 4'V- Vb -Oy "JS - ---A*? . '-> "<';> tf ,< ,< ";! "r "< > . > > <- Cl? j _y"J J-i jU t-j (^L. jf. gj Cj*j * {*> 4"fUzP\$ 483. Do they seek other than the religion of Allah, while to Him submitted all creatures in the heavens and the earth, willingly or unwillingly. And to Him shall they all be returned. 484. Say : "We believe in Allah and in what has been sent

down to us, and what was sent down to Ibrahim, Ismd'tl, Ishaq, Ya'qub and Al-Asbdt, and what was given to Musa, 'Isa and the Prophets from their Lord. We make no distinction between one another among them and to Him (Allah) we have submitted.") 485. And whoever seeks a religion other than Islam, it will never be accepted ofhim, and in the Hereafter he will be one of the losers.) The Only Valid Religion To Allah is Islam Allah rebukes those who prefer a religion other than the religion that He sent His Books and Messengers with, which is the worship of Allah Alone without partners, to Whom, 4submitted all creatures in the heavens and the earth,) Willingly, or not. Allah said in other Ayat, 4^Jj uj jV'j 4 -w> Zif) 4And unto Allah (Alone) falls in prostration whoever is in the heavens and the earth, willingly or unwillingly.) [13:15], and, k JPB owif m & * #& u ! iHave they not observed things that Allah has created : (how) their shadows incline to the right and to the left, making prostration unto Allah, and they are lowly? And to Allah prostrate all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth, of the moving creatures and the angels, and they are not proud. They fear their Lord above them, and they do what tley are commanded) [16:48-50). Therefore, the faithful believer submits to Allah in heart and body, while the disbeliever unwillingly submits to Him in body only, since he is under Allah s power, irresistible control and mighty kingship that cannot be repelled or resisted. Wakf reported that Mujahid said that the Ayah,

4'a^==, j 4 ^ T^ij iWhile to Him submitted all creatures in the heavens and the earth , willingly or unwillingly}, is similar to the Ayah, iAnd verily, if you ask them : "Who created the heavens and the

earth?" Surely, they will say: "Allah"}ll [39 :38). He also reported that Ibn Abbas said about, > if'si'b i&S i>* tAj} iwhile to Him submitted all creatures in the heavens and the earth, willingly or unwillingly.} When He took the covenant from them. 121 iAnd to Him shall they all be returned} on the Day of Return, when He will reward or punish each person according to his or her deeds. Allah then said, its 3j Z'j% dft \$} iSay : "We believe in Allah and in what has been sent down to us} the Qur an, iSSf iUSlj &\$ ~tj} iand what was sent down to Ibrahim, Ismai'l, Ishaq, Ya'qub} the scriptures and revelation, i S%} iand the Asbdt,} the Asbat are the twelve tribes who originated from the twelve children of Israel (Ya'qub). t'j,} iand what was given to Musa, 'Isa} the Tawrah and the Injfl, 1,1 At-Jabari 6 :565Tabari 6:565. Refer to 7:172-173.

oi iand the Prophetsfrom their Lord.} and this encompasses all of Allah s Prophets. 4-*^ -P^ o> y} iWe make no distinction between one another among them we believe in all of them, 4And to Him (Allah) we have submitted (in Islam)} Therefore, faithful Muslims believe in every Prophet whom Allah has sent and in every Book He revealed, and never disbelieve in any of them. Rather, they believe in what was revealed by Allah, and in every Prophet sent by Allah. Allah said next. 4a--2 S-i*i ii1* Vti (A-W cyj} 4And whoever seeks a religion other than Islam, it will never be accepted ofhim,} whoever seeks other than what Allah has legislated, it will not be accepted from him, 0? j j} 4and in the Hereafter he will be one of the losers.} As the Prophet jfe said in an authentic Hadith, "Sj i "Whoever commits an action that does not conform to our matter (religion) then it is rejected".ll) * ^r j"- o' 'j Uy "at y ' jwUiii i > y 'iifj 'Jj m,oj_ ^j (ii yj i'joJ' --ii* y av .jv"1"^ . OJA* oj' oJ" 'yJ-Jj OiJ'j Juu iyt Fath Al-Bari 5 :355

486. How shall Allah guide a people who disbelieved after their beliefand after they bore witness that the Messenger is true and after clear proofs came to them? And Allah guides not the people zoho are wrongdoers 487. They are those whose recompense is that on them (rests) tlte curse ofAllah, of the angels and of all mankind. 488. They will abide therein. Neither will their torment be lightened nor will it be delayed or postponed.) 489. Except for those who repent after that and do righteous deeds. Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) Allah Does Not Guide People Who Disbelieve After they Believed, Unless They Repent Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Abbas said, A man from the Ansar embraced Islam, but later reverted and joined the polytheists. He later on became sorry and sent his people to, Ask the Messenger of Allah for me, if I can repent. Then, 4(*r-*^V ill 4Hmo shall Allah guide a people who disbelieved after their belief) until, js*- *>>' 4 Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) was revealed and his people sent word to him and he re- embraced Islam. ,11 This is the wording recorded by An-Nasa i, Al-Hakim and Ibn Hibban . 121 Al-Hakim said, Its chain is Sahih and they did not record it. Allah s statement, 4Menu shall Allah guide a people who disbelieved after their beliefand after they bore witness that the Messenger is true and after clear proofs came to thetn? m At-Tabari 6 :572 121 An-Nasa i in Al-Kubra 6 :31 1 , Al Hakim 4 :366 , Ibn Hibban 6 :323

means, the proofs and evidences were established, testifying to the truth of what the Messenger was sent with. The truth was thus explained to them, but they reverted to the darkness of polytheism. Therefore, how can such people deserve guidance after they willingly leapt into utter blindness? This is why Allah said, i&M y%} iAnd Allah guides not the people who are wrongdoers.} He then said, iThey are those whose recompense is that on them (rests) the curse ofAllah, of the angels and ofall mankind.} Allah curses them and His creation also curses them. iTley will abide therein in the curse, iNeither will

their torment be lightened nor loill it be delayed or postponed.} for, the torment will not be lessened, not even for an hour. After that, Allah said, t < T.ik ill 1.h -S' iExcept for those who repent after that and do righteous deeds. Verily, Alldlt is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} This Ayah indicates Allah s kindness, graciousness, compassion, mercy and favor on His creatures when they repent to Him, for He forgives them in this case. > & & j 2 & k\$ & ^ *\$2\$ M& k 490. Verily, those who disbelieved after their belief and then went on increasing in their disbelief never will their repentance be accepted. And they are those who are astray.}

Al 'Imran (Part-3 491. Verily, those who disbelieved, and died while they were disbelievers, the (whole) earth full of gold will not be accepted from anyone of them if they offered it as a ransom . For them is a painful torment and they will have no helpers.} Neither Repentance ofthe DisbelieverUpon Death, Nor HisRansomingHimselfontheDayofResurrection Shall be Accepted Allah threatens and warns those who revert to disbelief after they believed and who thereafter insist on disbelief until death. He states that in this case, no repentance shall be accepted from them upon their death. Similarly, Allah said, til O&dli SjcLZ , c^,} 4And of no effect is the repentance of those who continue to do evil deeds until death faces one ofthem> (4:18). This is why Allah said. 4never will their repentance be accepted. And they are those who went astray.} to those who abandon the path of truth for the path of wickedness. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar recorded that Ibn Abbas said that some people embraced Islam, reverted to disbelief, became Muslims again, then reverted from Islam. They sent their people inquiring about this matter and they asked the Messenger of Allah jg. On that, this Ayah was revealed, 4# &S j&M W Sj k> 4Verily, those who disbelieved after their belief and then went on increasing in their disbelief never will their repentance be accepted}. The chain of narration is satisfactory. Thereafter, Allah said. JS C3S Ad-DurrAl-Manthur2:258.

208 Tafsir Ibtî Kathir , & s* + 4Verily, those who disbelieved, and died while they were disbelievers, the (ivhole) earth full of gold will not be accepted from anyone of them even if they offered it as a ransom.} Those who die while disbelievers, shall have no good deed ever accepted from them, even if they spent the earth s fill of gold in what was perceived to be an act of obedience. The Prophet was asked about Abdullah bin Jud'an, who used to be generous to guests, helpful to the indebted and who gave food (to the poor); will all that benefit him? The Prophet jjg said, fy- u!! :} 'J y*""ll J* Ujj ^Lsj ^_5 AjJ "No, for not even one day during his life did he pronounce, O my Lord! Forgive my sins on the Day ofJudgment Similarly, if the disbeliever gave the earth s full of gold as ransom, it will not be accepted from him. Allah said, yj yj> .nor shall compensation be accepted from him, nor shall intercession be ofuse to him>[2:123], and .0n which there will be neither mutual bargaining nor befriending.} (14:31], and, it .4, \jj3Sj LLL JILj &J; 4 u & ') sii if} 4IP * j .**) 1 kj'je 4tor/71/, those who disbelieve, if they had all that is in the earth, and as much again therewith to ransom themselves thereby from the torment on the Day of Resurrection, it would never be accepted of them, and theirs would be a painful tonnent} [5:36]. This is why Allah said here, Si Sg uM k pi Muslim 1 :196.

Al Imran (Part-3) iVerily, those who disbelieved, and died while they were disbelievers, the (whole) earth full of gold will not be accepted from anyone of them if they offered it as a ransom The implication of this Ayah is that the disbeliever shall never avoid the torment of Allah, even if he spent

the earth's fill of gold, or if he ransoms himself with the earth's fill of gold, - all of its mountains, hills, sand, dust, valleys, forests, land and sea. Imam

{For them is a painful torment and they will have no helpers.} for they shall not have anyone who will save them from the torment of Allah or rescue them from His painful punishment. & Ji Oy 4 %& 492. By no means shall you attain Al-Birr, unless you spend of that which you love; and whatever of good you spend, Allah knows it well.} Al-Birr is Spending from the Best of One's Wealth In his Tafsir, Wak! reported, that Amr bin Maymun said that msi&z it sgjp -j?j i S,, . ' < SX S>' r\ f OIjW4J Cg^Ua)ji Jlfj DjL*a - "'ff'J i'u'l' \S 'v'A'. ' 'sHf?' ob-acr*j>;A^S Z \$ { > I i Sfl'Sif*' S' ,.' vXWtAi'.f- 4% ijbr no means shall you attain Al-Birr} is in reference to attaining Paradise.¹¹ Imam Ahmad reported that Anas bin Malik said, Abu Talhah had more property than any other among the Ansar in Al-Madlnah, and the most beloved of his property to him was Bayruha garden, which was in front of the (Messenger's) Masjid. Sometimes, Allah's Messenger jg used to go to the garden and drink its fresh water. Anas added, When these verses were revealed, m At-Tabari : 6:587.

Well-done! It is profitable property, it is profitable property. I have heard what you have said, and I think it would be proper if you gave it to your kith and kin .

& 4^ Jt J6 J'tD-'l t*: "#t li-O ji ^ ' Ojtdilt j^i Jijjli viO i Jji J,j ji ar i.& 493. All food was lawful to the Children of Israel, except what Israel made unlawful for himself before the Tawrdh was revealed. Say:"

Was not the best food to him camel meat and the best drink camel milk? They said, "Yes, by Allah. The Messenger sg said, O Allah, be Witness against them. The Prophet jg then said, I ask you by Allah, other than Whom there is no deity (worthy of worship), Who sent down the Tawrah to Musa, do you not know that man's discharge is thick and white and woman's is yellow and thin? If any of these fluids becomes dominant, the offspring will take its sex and resemblance by Allah's leave. Hence, if the man's is more than the woman's, the child will be male, by Allah's leave. If the woman's discharge is more than the man's, then the child will be female, by Allah's leave. They said, Yes. He said, O Allah, be Witness against them. He then said, I ask you by He Who sent down the Tawrah to Musa, do you not know that the eyes of this unlettered Prophet sleep, but his heart does not sleep? They said, , by Allah! He said, O Allah, be Witness. They said, Tell us now about your Wali among the angels, for this is when we either follow or shun you. He said, My Wali (who brings down the revelation from Allah) is Jibril, and Allah never sent a Prophet, but Jibril is his Wali. They said, We then shun you. Had you a Wali other than Jibril, we would have followed you. On that, Allah, the Exalted revealed, ASay: "Whoever is an enemy to fibril..." [2:97]. 111 Allah's statement, Jji! J Ji} ibefore the Tawrah was revealed [3:93], means, Israel forbade that for himself before the Tawrah was revealed. There are two objectives behind revealing this segment of the Ayah. First, he forbade himself the most delightful things for Allah's sake. This practice was allowed during his period of Law, and is, thus, suitable that it is mentioned after Allah's statement, X' 4 A0 j} ABy no means shall you attain Al-Birr, unless you spend of Ahmad 1 :287.

that which you love (3:92). What we are allowed in our Law is to spend in Allah's obedience from what we like and covet [but not to prohibit what Allah has allowed]. Allah said in other Ayat, iAnd gives his wealth, in spite of love for it,) [2:177], and; 4 V- J* Jj^j) iAnd they give food, in spite of their love for it,) [76:8]. The second reason is that after Allah refuted the false Christian beliefs and allegations about Isa

and his mother. Allah started refuting the Jews here, may Allah curse them, by stating that the abrogation of the Law, that they denied occurs, already occurred in their Law. For instance, Allah has stated in their Book, the Tawrah, that when Nuh departed from the ark, Allah allowed him to eat the meat of all types of animals. Afterwards, Israhil forbade the meat and milk of camels for himself, and his children imitated this practice after him. The Tawrah later on prohibited this type of food, and added several more types of prohibitions. Allah allowed Adam to marry his daughters to his sons, and this practice was later forbidden. The Law of Ibrahim allowed the man to take female servants as companions along with his wife, as Ibrahim did when he took Hajar, while he was married to Sarah. Later on, the Tawrah prohibited this practice. It was previously allowed to take two sisters as wives at the same time, as Ya'qub married two sisters at the same time. Later on, this practice was prohibited in the Tawrah. All these examples are in the Tawrah and constitute a Naskh (abrogation) of the Law. Therefore, let the Jews consider what Allah legislated for Isa and if such legislation falls under the category of abrogation or not. Why do they not then follow Isa in this regard? Rather, the Jews defied and rebelled against Isa and against the correct religion that Allah sent Muhammad SS with. This is why Allah said,

iAll food was lawful to the Children of Israel, except what Isrd'tl made unlawful for himself before the Tawrdh was revealed} [3:93] meaning, before the Tawrah was revealed, all types of foods were allowed, except what Isratl prohibited for himself. Allah then said, Cl }Say: "Bring here the Tawrdh and recite it, if you are truthful."}, for the Tawrah affirms what we are stating here. Allah said next, iThen after that, whosoever shall invent a lie against Allah, then these it is that are the wrongdoers.} [3:94], in reference to those who lie about Allah and claim that He made the Sabbath and the Tawrah eternal. They are those who claim that Allah did not send another Prophet calling to Allah with the proofs and evidences, although evidence indicates that abrogation, as we have described, occurred before in the Tawrah, it then these it is that are the wrongdoers.} Allah then said, t \$} iSay, "Allah has spoken the truth; } [3:95] meaning, O Muhammad, say that Allah has said the truth in what He conveyed and legislated in the Qur an, ^follow the religion of Ibrahim the Hanif, and he was not of the idolators."} [3:95]. Therefore, follow the religion of Ibrahim that Allah legislated in the Qur an. Indeed, this is the truth, there is no doubt in it, and the perfect way, and no Prophet has brought a more complete, clear, plain and perfect way than he did. Allah said in other Ayat,

S- Cj u O. 4* J?>" J! 4; ^ j*>:*CSay ; "Truly, my Lord has guided me to a straight path, a right religion, the religion of Ibrahim, the Hanif, and he was not of the idolaters."} [6:161] and, * Sf Cj % o\ te\ p} iThen, We have sent the revelation to you (saying): ",Follow the religion of Ibrahim, the Hanif, and he was not of the idolaters .} 116:123]. fLU C Kt if 1.,caJijJ t jW* y~ . 0]^ 'Ly.^ cJj' gp pjilil' Je- fki tyi*^ fa-* jLfJil cfi is? 496. Verily, the first House (of worship) appointed for mankind was that at Bakkah (Makkah), full of blessing, and a guidance for Al-'Alamin (mankind and Jinn). 497. In it are manifest signs (for example), the Maqdm (station) of Ibrahim; whosoever enters it, he attains security. And Hajj to the House is a duty that mankind owes to Allah, for those who are able to undertake the journey ; and whoever disbelieves, then Allah stands not in need of any of the Alamin.} The JKa'bah is the First House of Worship Allah said, fi y* Jj' h\} iVerily, the first House appointed for mankind} for all people, for their acts of worship and religious rituals. They go around the House (in Tawaf), pray in its vicinity

and remain in its area in 1 tikaf. iwas that at Bakkah,} meaning, the Ka'bah that was built by Ibrahim Al-Khalll, whose religion the Jews and Christians claim

they follow. However, they do not perform Hajj to the house that Ibrahim built by Allah s command, and to which he invited the people to perform Hajj. Allah said next, 4full of blessing), sanctified, iand a guidance for Al-'Alamfn .} Imam

218 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir The Station of Ibrahim Allah s statement, c4' 4In it are manifest signs} [3:97], means, clear signs that Ibrahim built the Kahah and that Allah has honored and blessed it. Allah then said, A P& ithe Maqam (station) of Ibrahim} When the building [the Ka'bah] was raised, Ibrahim stood on; the Maqam so that he could raise the walls higher, while his son Ismail was handing the stones to him. We should mention that the Maqam used to be situated right next to the House. Later, and during his reign, Umar bin Al-Khattab moved the Maqam farther to the east, so that those who go around the House in Tawaf are able to perform it easily, without disturbing those who pray next to the Maqam after finishing their Tawaf. Allah commanded us to pray next to the Maqam; iAnd take you (people) the Maqam (station) of Ibrahim as a place of prayer} [2:125]. We mentioned the Hadiths about this subject before, and sill the thanks are due to Allah. Al- Awfi said that, Ibn Abbas commented on Allah s statement, \+sfyl cy* lj^ iln it are manifest signs, the Maqam of Ibrahim;} Such as the Maqam and Al-Mash'ar [Al-Ifar&m]." 111 Mujahid said, The impression of Ibrahim s feet remains on the Maqam as a clear sign. 121 It was reported that Umar bin Abdul- Aziz, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan and others said similarly. ,3 At-Tabari 7 :26. Af-Tabari 7 :27 131 Ibn AbiHatim 2:412 ,413.

0 Ojj' C iSo let them worship (Allah) the Lord of this House (the Ka'bah). (He) Who has fed them against hunger, and lias made them safe from fear) [106:3-4]. It is not allowed for anyone to hunt in the Haram or to drive game out of its den to be hunted, or cut the trees in its vicinity, or pick its grass, as the Hadlths of the Prophet jg and the statements of the Companions testify. The Two Sahihs recorded (this being the wording of Muslim) that Ibn Abbas said, On the day of the conquest of Makkah, the Messenger of Allah sg said, ' There is no more Hijrah (migration to Makkah), only jihad and good intention. If you were mobilized, then march forth . He also said on the day of the conquest of Makkah, Jr! Sf[J J>

Except lemongrass The Two Sahihs also recorded that Abu Shurayh Al- Adawi said that he said to Amr bin Said while he was sending the troops to Makkah (to fight Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr), O Commander! Allow me to tell you what Allah s Messenger said on the day following the conquest of Makkah. My ears heard it and my heart memorized it thoroughly, and I saw the Prophet jg with my own eyes when he, after glorifying and praising Allah, said, j\ 3il ; {jji isfi'i jfon pj ^ !s *U)I Jlii j JL>-i l 0

Abu Shurayh was asked, What did 'Amr reply? He said that Amr said, O Abu Shurayh! I know better than you in this respect; Makkah does not give protection to a sinner, a murderer or a thief. Jabir bin Abdullah said, I heard the Messenger of Allah jg saying,

This Ayah established the obligation of performing Hajj. There are many Hadiths that mention it as one of the pillars and fundamentals of Islam, and this is agreed upon by the

(with supplication to Allah) and bloody (with sacrifice). Another man asked, What is the ability to undertake the journey, O Messenger of Allah? He said, Having provision and a means of transportation. 111 This is the narration that

O People of the Scripture (Jeivs and Christians)! Why do you stop those who have believed, from the path of Allah, seeking to make it seem crooked, while you (yourselves) are witnesses? And Allah is not unaware of what you do.

p s=". AJ AUivl^jU 4Ul> m lC^J ^ f*-4/^}d tpjl\yj\c SjXi ^ *^> V |y>^ ie Day whereon neither wealth nor sons will avail> [26:88]. LAc-i o), 0j\$ 'j3^ jyl' ,jj '-:S/ -M m frl p& & pr3&& JSj l. 4J^*j j\$ yL \)fi/ + Ji < * -UJ 4it . O you io/jo believe! If you obey a group of those who were given the Scripture (Jexvs and Christians), they would (indeed) ren- der you disbelievers after you have believed!} ilOl. And how would you disbelieve, while unto you are recited the verses of Allah, and among you is His Messenger? And whoever depends upon Allah, then he is indeed guided to the right path.} jLJlj*gjA>-jii&f-\&Sfk'4P t i'">> -i ' ** fi-'t'V /CV,ir j&j ~ fjjpCyydo^jSL o i_jIbJl i^s_jjj flip Warning Muslims Against Imitating People of the Scriptures Allah warns His believing servants against obeying the People of the Book, who envy the believers for the favor that Allah gave them by sending His Messenger jg. Similarly, Allah said, t yjiT jJ" j &OK \$ 4 "j-h-s^ ^Many o/ fte Peop/e of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) wish that they could turn you away as disbelievers after you

have believed, out of their mvn envy} [2:109]. In this Ayah [3:100], Allah said, M f&J. lA*' 6.' Sj 4If you obey a group of those who were given the Scripture (Jeivs and Christians) , they would (indeed) render you disbelievers after you have believed!}, then said, 4And how would you disbelieve, while unto you are recited the verses of Allah, and among you is His Messenger?}, meaning, disbelief is far from touching you, since the Ayat of Allah are being sent down on His Messenger 5g day and night, and he recites and conveys them to you. Similarly, Allah said, r 4 iii jg; % -u * &w 4And what is the matter with you that you believe not in Allah! While the Messenger invites you to believe in your Lord; and He has indeed taken your covenant, if you are real believers} [57:8]. A Hadith states that one day, the Prophet said to his Companions, V Czs'jt : JI" .a VJI :iyu "?UU4 ^)1 4 y Jfi ^ j 1 'jA-'j ^Ul :lU C ij JjL}; i JCSf :JU ,j :l^li * -j Hi o VULqjI i"Who among the faithful believers do you consider has the most amazing faith? They said, The angels." He said, "Why would they not believe, since they are with their Lord? They mentioned the Prophets, and the Prophet jg said, "Why ivoud they not believe while the revelation is sent down to them?" They said, "Then, we are." He said, "Why would not you believe when I am among you? They asked, "Who has the most amazing faith? The Prophet said, "A people who will

Al 'Imran (Part-4) come after you and who will find only books that they will believe in. Allah said next, (sA Al -i"C 4And whoever depends upon Allah, then he is itdeed guided to the right path [3:101] for trusting and relying on Allah are the basis of achieving the right guidance and staying away from the path of wickedness. They also represent the tool to acquiring guidance and truth and achieving the righteous aims. it?. ij fA Jilt cAt iyjuu "jj ii_JL .#& '<& 'it * ^ ^ viSf s*)% pi ^ i. ft.S/xj \$& 4102. O you who believe! Have Tacpoa of Allah as is His due, and die not except as (true)

[3:106] on the Day of Resurrection. This is when the faces of followers of the Sunnah and the Jama'ah will radiate with whiteness, and the faces of followers of Bid.'ah (innovation) and division will be darkened, as has been reported from Ibn Abbas . Allah said, m f'P&& SSp Sj' 4As for those whose faces will become black (to them will be said): Did you reject faith after accepting it?") Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, They are the hypocrites. 121 prc \},Z) iThcn taste the torment (in Hell) for rejectingfaith,) and this description befits every disbeliever. i - " " if .' / .< .>> >> ^ y jib jy Wjf iAnd for those whose faces will become white, they will be in Allah s mercy (Paradise), therein they shall dwell forever.) in Paradise, where they will reside for eternity and shall never desire to be removed. Abu Isa

236 Tafsir Ibn Kathir *-> yw {S.r iOn the Day (i.e. the Day of Resurrection) when some faces will become white and some faces will become black;} until the end of the Ayah. I said to Abu Umamah, Did you hear this from the Messenger of Allah? He said, If I only heard it from the Messenger of Allah once, twice, thrice, four times, or seven times, I would not have narrated it to you.

for His is the decision concerning the affairs of this life and the Hereafter, and His is the Supreme Authority in this life and the Hereafter. if- Jr 3 \$;:S jK&Js f i\$ < (& ^ & " p , \$M cis % P-j& t#\$ c 4-s^ a\$N Sjars jf % ^ i . . f 4110. You are the best of peoples ever raised up for mankind; you enjoin Al-Ma'ruf (all that Islam has ordained) and forbid Al-Munkar (all that Islam has forbidden), and you believe in Allah. And had the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) believed, it would have been better for them; among them are some who have faith, but most of them are Fdsiqun (rebellious) .} 4111. They will do you no harm, barring a trifling annoyance; and if they fight against you, they will show you their backs, and they will not be helped. 4 4112. They are stricken with humility wherever they may be, except when under a covenant (of protection) from Allah, and a covenant from men; they have drawn on themselves the wrath of Allah, and destitution is put over them. This is because they disbelieved in the Aydt of Allah and killed the Prophets without right. This is because they disobeyed (Allah) and used to transgress (the limits set by Allah).} Virtues of the Ummah of Muhammad the Best Nation Ever Allah states that the Ummah of Muhammad is the best nation ever, 4o0, 4You are the best of peoples ever raised up for mankind [3:1 10].

Ayah, (You, Muslims, are) the best nation of people for the people, you bring them tied in chains on their necks (capture them in war) and they later embrace Islam. 111 Similar was said by Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Atiyah Al- Awfi, Ikrimah, Ata and Ar-Rabi bin Anas that, * ji- jijj) iYou are the best of peoples ever raised up for mankind;) means, the best of peoples for the people.¹²

The meaning of the Ayah is that the Ummah of Muhammad

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 935–956]

is the most righteous and beneficial nation for mankind. Hence Allah s description of them, 4 -it J- o/ ffe) 4you ettjoin Al-Ma'rif and forbid Al-Munkar and believe in Allah) (3:110).

The Messenger of Allah said, ncftl if jS-\ L2 jU U vi_u{ : "a/ was given what no other Prophet before me was given. We said, O Messenger of Allah! What is it? He said, Jl y'ijh C-iapij y\$ i j~>- '14^"

Another Hadith that Establishes the Virtues of the Ummah of Muhammad in this Life and the Hereafter. Imam

"77ie people of Paradise are one hundred and twenty rows, this Umrnah takes up eighty of them .k* 1 Imam

These and other Hadiths conform to the meaning of the Ayah, cf oi iil 'ji- ^Lt) iYou are the best of peoples ever raised up for mankind; you enjoin Al-Ma'ruf (all that Islam has ordained) and forbid Al-Munkar (all that Islam has forbidden), and you believe in Allah). Therefore, whoever among this Ummah acquires these qualities, will have a share in this praise. Qatadah said, We were told that Umar bin Al-Khattab recited this Ayah [3:110] during a Hajj that he performed, when he saw that the people were rushing. He then said, Whoever likes to be among this [praised] Ummah, let him fulfill the condition that Allah set in this Ayah. " Ibn Jarir * recorded this. Those from this Ummah who do not acquire these qualities will be just like the People of the Scriptures whom Allah criticized, when He said, iThey did not forbid one another from the Munkar which they committed...) [5:79]. This is the reason why, sifter Allah praised the Muslim Ummah with the qualities that He mentioned, He criticized the People of the Scriptures and chastised them, saying. iAnd had the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) believed) [3:110], in what was sent down to Muhammad jsg. izfjx plus ^ &m) 4it would have been betterfor than ; among them are some who havefaith, but most ofthem are Fdsiqiin (rebellious.) Therefore only a few of them believe in Allah and in what was sent down to you and to them. The majority of them follow deviation, disbelief, sin and rebellion. (i| At-Tabari 7 :102

Al 'Imran (Part-4) The Good News that Muslims will Dominate the People ofthe Book While delivering the good news to His believing servants that victory and dominance will be theirs against the disbelieving, atheistic People of the Scriptures, Allah then said, V p fefeZ 43 ZJ&%)They will do you no harm, barring a trifling annoyance; and if they fight against you, they will show you their backs, and they will not be helped .> (3:1 1 1] This is what occurred, for at the battle of Khaybar, Allah brought humiliation and disgrace to the Jews. Before that, the Jews in Al-Madlnah, the tribes of Qaynuqa', Nadir and Qurayzah, were also humiliated by Allah. Such was the case with the Christians in the area of Ash-Sham later on, when the Companions defeated them in many battles and took over the leadership of Ash-Sham forever. There shall always be a group of Muslims in Ash-Sham area until Isa, son of Maryam, descends while they are like this [on the truth, apparent and victorious]. Isa will at that time rule according to the Law of Muhammad break the cross, kill the swine, banish the Jizyah and only accept Islam from the people. Allah said next. uj Jjjji jtji- c-f. ilndignity is put over them wherever they may be, except when under a covenant (of protection) from Allah, and a covenant from men;) meaning, Allah has placed humiliation and disgrace on them wherever they may be, and they will never be safe, iexcept when under a covenantfrom Allah,) under the Dhimmah (covenant of protection) from Allah that requires them to pay the Jizyah (tax, to Muslims,) and makes them subservient to Islamic Law.)and a covenant from men;) meaning, covenant from men,

such as pledges of protection and safety offered to them by Muslim men and women, and even a slave, according to one of the sayings of the scholars. Ibn Abbas said that, iJ* \$ \$ Si 4except when under a covenant from Allah, and a covenant from men;} refers to a covenant of protection from Allah and a pledge of safety from people.111 Similar was said by Mujahid, ikrimah, Ata , Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ar-Rabl bin Anas. 121 Allah s statement, 4* ' Cii i<%} ithey have drawn on themselves the wrath ofAllah,} means, they earned Allah s anger, which they deserved, *\$. zj/i} iatid

destitution is put over them}, meaning they deserve it by decree and legislatively. Allah said next, 4This is because they disbelieved in the Ayat of Allah and killed the Prophets without right.} meaning, what drove them to this was their arrogance, transgression and envy, earning them humiliation, degradation and disgrace throughout this life and the Hereafter. Allah said, 4This is because they disobeyed and used to transgress (the limits set by Allah).} meaning, what lured them to disbelieve in Allah's Ayat and kill His Messengers, is the fact that they often disobeyed Allah's commands, committed His prohibitions and transgressed His set limits. We seek refuge from this behavior, and Allah Alone is sought for each and every type of help. Tabari 7:112. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :480,481

Al Imran (Part-4) cmm k> sim '*ss / ^ ^ " / S * * JA ^ / ^ / GilJi^S'^jjJL^ StfjSfc ^ &:v2 is #is;3 f<" "< * **?. . 4 *- ' - } f -i tf ;'; > < . ^{ x "5 , "A-0 \jA^JUJ aJo;j'-^ -l^ujOi. iij^ /i."-*"n12j all^' >- ,t> - L-*^ V * r*' *t i -7i *T |^}J ^-dc- 4A1 ' _) x"- ,i.^4jii <}s~yj P ! J #" yl*I" 0_y^l 4i> *J*' jii I Eli \ ,;&> & &\$& o 4 5 j Si)" > < -ff *r * Wst' }jt =*i > ^ j; 'j*-*" 0^ ^ ,^niljl ^L..Ui ^ p j 1ST ^ir ,U jQt 4 Jutf; ojlXu L. Ji. ."" ,ojj^S- 0j3' jyjJ' ,*j> 4 .>* !>_}* c-.IJ yj ^ gy dj ^i;li^ ipi ^ #3; # 4^;oA 4123. No/ all of them are alike ; a party o/ //ie People of the Scripture stand for the right, they recite the verses of Allah during the hours of the night, prostrating themselves in prayer.} 4224. They believe in Allah and the Last Day; they enjoin Al- Ma'riif and forbid Al-Munkar ; and they hasten in (all) good works; and they are among the righteous. 4225. And whatever good they do, nothing will be rejected of them; for Allah knows well the Muttaqfn (the pious).} 4116. Surely, those who disbelieve, neither their properties nor their offspring will avail them against Allah. They are the dwellers of the Fire, therein they will abide.}

iThey believe in Allah and the Last Day; they enjoin Al-Ma'ruf and forbid Al-Munkar; and they hasten in (all) good works; and they are among the righteous^ [3:1 14]. This is the same type of people mentioned at the end of the Surah; if e; if tiM a ja i!& iAnd there are, certainly, among the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians), those who believe in Allah and in that which has been revealed to you, and in that which has been revealed to them, humbling themselves before Allah.} [3:199]. Allah said here, & jf ji Cj} iAnd whatever good they do, nothing will be rejected of them;} [3:115] meaning, their good deeds will not be lost with Allah. Rather, He will award them the best rewards, %} ifor Allah knows well the Muttaqin (the pious).} for no deed performed by any person ever escapes His knowledge, nor is any reward for those who do good deeds ever lost with Him. Allah mentions the disbelieving polytheists: i kL fa ^ J} i neither their properties nor their offspring will avail them against Allah} [3:116]. meaning, nothing can avert Allah's torment and punishment from striking them, iThey are the dwellers of the Fire, therein they will abide.} The Parable of What the Disbelievers Spend in This Life Allah gave a parable for what the disbelievers spend in this life, as Mujahid, Al-Hasan and As-Suddi said. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :493

tjji go Cull _"jci 4 iiy^t U <\$77ie likeness of what they spend in this world is the likeness of a wind of Sir a frigid wind, as Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al- Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabf bin Anas and others have said. 1 Ata said that Sir, means, cold and snow. Ibn Abbas and Mujahid are also reported to have said that Sir means, fire . ' * This latter meaning does not contradict the meanings we mentioned above, because extreme cold weather, especially when accompanied by snow, burns plants and produce, and has the same effect fire has on such growth. 4 ZJOijfc \Jjii Zjj- ilt struck the harvest of a people who did wrong against themselves and destroyed ify [3 : 1 17] by burning. This Ayah mentions

a calamity that strikes produce that is ready to harvest, destroying it by burning and depriving its owner of it when he needs it the most. Such is the case with the disbelievers, for Allah destroys the rewards for their good deeds in this life, just as He destroyed the produce of the sinner because of his sins. Both types did not build their work on firm foundations. iAnd Allah wronged them not, but they wronged themselves.> oi; a \$4 c& 4a 4 &/, # &L -a 01 p&Z (Ujjii jp j " * \$ lj& ffcaj oA& fiU % *Vi1 pa~i ol y'i 'Pa 'fy j^ hi JjbVl Iyat- 4 iy^jj ijj} oij ^ aa a? pa of) pa - 41?:sp afa.an i\ hz 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 : 494,495. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :496 * Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :495.

Al 'Imran (Part-4 ill8. O you who believe! Take not as (your) Bitanah (advisors, helpers) those other than your own, since they will not fail to do their best to corrupt you. They desire to harm you severely. Hatred has already appeared from their mouths, but what their breasts conceal is far worse. Indeed We have made plain to you the Ayat ifyou understand . > \$119. Lo! You are the ones who love them but they love you not, and you believe in all the Scriptures. And when they meet you, they say, "We believe." But when they are alone, they bite their Anamil at you in rage. Say: "Perish in your rage. Certainly, Allalt knows what is in the breasts (all the secrets)."4 4120. If a good befalls you, it grieves them, but if some evil overtakes you, they rejoice at it. But if you remain patient and have Taqioa, not the least harm will their cunning do to you. Surely, Allah surrounds all that they do.

The Prohibition of Taking Advisors From Among the Disbelievers Allah forbids His believing servants from taking the hypocrites as advisors, so that the hypocrites do not have the opportunity to expose the secrets of the believers and their plans against their enemies. The hypocrites try their very best to confuse, oppose and harm the believers any way they can, and by using any wicked, evil means at their disposal. They wish the very worst and difficult conditions for the believers. Allah said, oi Take not as (your) Bitanah those other than your own} [3 :118], in reference to taking followers of other religions as consultants and advisors, for advisors of a certain person have access to his most secret affairs.

"Alldh has not sent any Prophet nor was there any Khalifah but they have two types of advisors, one that commands him with righteousness and advises it, and another that commands him with evil and advises him with it. Only those whom Allah gives immunity are immune .d' Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Ibn Abi Ad-Dahqanah said, Umar bin Al-Khattab was told, There is young man here from the people of Hlrah (in Iraq, who were Christians) who is a proficient scribe. Why do you not appoint him as a scribe? Umar said, 1 would then be taking advisors from among the disbelievers. ' This Ayah and the stoiy about TJmar testify to the fact that Muslims are not allowed to use Ahl Adh- Dhimmah to be scribes in matters that affect the affairs of Muslims and expose their secrets, for they might convey these secrets to combatant disbelievers. This is why Allah said, isince they will not fail to do their best to corrupt you . They desire to harm you severely .)" Allah then said, fall jJiK^ ILjJj JLS\$ iHatred has already appearedfrom their mouths, but what their breasts conceal isfar worse. meaning, enmity appears on their faces and in what they sometimes utter, as well as, the enmity they have against Islam and its people in their hearts. Since this fact is apparent to every person who has sound comprehension, therefore, 4Indeed We have made plain to you the Aydt if you understand.} Allah said next, 40/ You are the ones who love them but they love you not}. Fath Al-Bdri 13 :201 , An-Nasal 7 :158 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 2:500.

Al 'Imran (Part-4) meaning, O believers! You like the hypocrites because you think they are believers, for they pretend to be so, but they do not like you publicly or secretly. iAtid you believe in all the Scriptures} meaning, you have no doubt in any part of Allah s Book, while the hypocrites have deep doubts, confusion and reservations about it. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas said that, iJ Jil iand you believe in all the Scriptures,} means, you believe in your Book, their Book, and the previous Books, while the hypocrites disbelieve in your Book, and this is why they deserve that you dislike them instead of them disliking you. Ibn Jarir collected this statement. tji tjg. fit; t; \%\$\$ tit> iAnd when they meet you, they say, "We believe." But when they are alone, they bite their Anamil at you in rage .} The word Anamil, means the tips of the fingers, as Qatadah stated. This is the behavior of the hypocrites who pretend to be believers and kind when they are with the believers, all the while concealing the opposite in their hearts in every respect. This is the exact situation that Allah describes, St JjbV' (SSit. ' yjxC- ijU. ti^j^> iBut zohen they are alone, they bite their Andtnil at you in rage and rage is extreme anger and fury. Allah said to them, iSay: "Perish in your rage. Certainly, Allah knows what is in the breasts (all the secrets)."} for no matter how much you envy the believers and feel rage , 1] At-Tabari 7:149.Tabari 7:153.

At Imran (Part-4) ou&ifc- i' uj *u\ iyL>i 4J31 . *r " 2'-i?~; tt-'t > < -'> :.> juy- iljCaj , \$2\$jp4j'io^v s 6jk* l3 i JJ J-jj 4'y' jujli-iy\fc-Ji 'j / > , f. ->/ / , " ,</ X- -irr- _/ j'(l uj /T jO jU-lJ'4k aU _j@ ^Jc k;\$ kii iykijlkakiikCilip^ii_=ij 'iijkC \a Allah then mentions

the story of Uhud, the defeat that He tested the believers with, His distinguishing the believers from the hypocrites and their patience. \iyZ ik (si CjjM. i\ND> c il ^CU. t i; kfj Stik J , *- 4jil y-U- j-***> -ulj 'T 5/ j ij ki ijiiii 4121 . A/id (remember) when you left your household in the morn- ing to post the believers at their stations for the battle (of Uhud). And Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knoiver.} 4222. When two parties from among you were about to lose heart, but Allah was their Wall (Supporter and Protector). And in Allah should the believers put their trust. 4223. And Allah has already made you victorious at Badr, when you were a zveak little force. So have Taqwd of Allah that you may be grateful .> The Battle ofUhud According to the majority of scholars, these Aydt are describing the battle of Uhud, as Ibn Abbas, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others said.

The battle of Uhud Tnfsir Ibn Katftir year of Hijrah. Allah knows best. Of the month of Shawwal, and Allah Kno srsx tssss Makkan leaders and t e ^ ^ "Spend this money on Badr to demand from A fy spent the money from fightingMuhammad! C0nsequeny,^y^P biiized^ forces the caravan on warfare P around the city). They tad^theA^tohtoto^w^J marched unta ^gathered three thousa Madinah. The Messenger of Allah camped near Uhud facing - he fmished with it, he jg led the Friday prayer an from Bani An-Najjar performed the funeral prayer f ^ asked the

The Messenger of Allah sg marched with a thousand of his Companions. When they reached the Shawt area, Abdullah bin Ubayy went back to Al-Madinah with a third of the army, claiming he was angry the Prophet sg did not listen to his advice. He and his supporters said, Ifwe knew that you would fight today, we would have accompanied you. However, we do not think that you will fight today. The Messenger of Allah jg marched until he reached the hillside in the area of Uhud, where they camped in the valley with Mount Uhud behind them. The Messenger ofAllah sg said, *J iLi)L c **U jL>-t N "No one startsfighting until I issue the command to fight The Messenger0 prepared his forces for battle, and

his army was seven hundred men. He appointed Abdullah bin Jubayr, from Bani Amr bin Awf, to lead the archers who were fifty men. The Prophet ﷺ said to them, "Keep the horsemen away from us, and be aware that we might be attacked from your direction. If victory was for or against us, remain in your positions. And even if you see us being picked up by birds, do not abandon your positions." The Prophet ﷺ wore two protective shields and gave the flag to Mus'ab bin Umayr of Bani Abd Ad-Dar. The Prophet ﷺ also allowed some young men to participate in fighting, but not others, whom he allowed to participate in the battle of Al-Khandaq two years later. The Quraysh mobilized their forces of three thousand men with two hundred horsemen on each flank. They appointed Khalid bin Al-Walid to lead the right side of the horsemen and Ikrimah Ibn Abi Jahl on the left side. They also gave their grand flag to the tribe of Bani Abd Ad-Dar. Allah willing, we will mention the details of this battle later on, if Allah wills. Allah said here, "And (remember) when you left your household in the morning to post the believers at their stations for the battle" [3:121],

designating them to various positions, dividing the army to the left and right sides and placing them wherever you command them. And Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knower. He hears what you say and knows what you conceal in your hearts. Allah said next, "When two parties from among you were about to lose heart," [3:122].

The day of Badr is known as Yawm Al-Furqan [the Day of the Clarification], by which Allah gave victory and dominance to Islam and its people and disgraced and destroyed Shirk, even though the Muslims were few. The Muslims numbered Fath Al-Bari 8:63 I2 * Muslim 4:1948.

Al-'Imran (Part-4) three hundred and thirteen men, with two horses and seventy camels. The rest were foot soldiers without enough supplies for the battle. The enemy army consisted of nine hundred to a thousand men, having enough shields and supplies, battle-ready horses and even various adornments. However, Allah gave victory to His Messenger ﷺ, supported His revelation, and illuminated success on the faces of the Prophet ﷺ and his following. Allah also brought disgrace to Shayatan and his army. This is why Allah reminded His believing servants and pious party of this favor, "All! (1) Attd Allah has already made you victorious at Badr, when you were a weak little force, when you were few then. This Ayah reminds them that victory is only from Allah, not because of a large army and adequate supplies. This is why Allah said in another Ayah, "and on the day of Hunayn (battle) when you rejoiced at your great number, but it availed you naught [9:25], until. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful" [9:27]. Badr is an area between Makkah and Al-Madinah and is known by the well that bears its name, which in turn was so named after Badr bin An-Narayn, the person who dug the well. So have Taqzvd of Allah that you may be grateful." [3:123], means, fulfill the obligations of His obedience. & o;p: pj 'fP. i P-P-i \$ PdA >[{} 'Pf&i & pi i-Hi pj 'pp 'i* [Ujy iA fiPj /p o! xs. & 'Jj jpd Cj pji vpAj 'p izA* " <" 4 Cj cJpS\ 4 C Aii Af. pP. j' p- i" i-

J4 jj* >;Vf . (Remember) when you said to the believers, "Is it not enough for you that your Lord should help you with three thousand angels set down?" 4125. "But, if you hold on to patience and have Taqwd, and the enemy comes rushing at you; your Lord will help you with five thousand angels having marks (of distinction). } 4126. Allah made it not but as a message of good news for you and as an assurance to your hearts. And there is no victory except from Allah, the All-Mighty, the All-Wise.}

4127. That He might cut off a part of those who disbelieve, or expose them to infamy, so that they retire frustrated.} 4128. Not for you is the decision; whether He turns in mercy to (pardon) them or punishes them; verily, they are the wrongdoers.} 4129. And to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. He forgives whom He wills, and punishes whom He wills. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} The Support of the Angels The scholars of Tafsir differ over whether the promise contained in these Ayat referred to the battle of Badr or Uhud. The First View There are two opinions about this, one of them saying that Allah's statement, (Remember) when you said to the believers [3:124], is related to His statement, (And Allah has already made you victorious at Badr) [3:123]. This was reported from Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Amr Ash-Sha'bi, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas and several others, ' Ibn Jarir also agreed *** Ibn Abi Hatim no. 519-521

with this opinion. Abbad bin Mansur said that Al-Hasan said that Allah's statement, (Remember) when you said to the believers, "Is it not enough for you that your Lord should help you with three thousand angels?" [3:124], is about the battle of Badr; ' Ibn Abi Hatim also recorded this statement. Ibn Abi Hatim then reported that Amr Ash-Sha'bi said, On

the day of Badr, the Muslims received information that Kurz

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 956-960]

bin Jabir (a prominent tribe chief) was aiding the idolators, and this news was hard on them, so Allah revealed; (Is it not enough for you that your Lord (Allah) should help you with three thousand angels sent down?), until, (having marks (of distinction)) [3:124,125]. The news of the defeat of the idolators [at Badr] reached Kurz and he did not reinforce them, and thus, Allah did not reinforce the Muslims with the five (thousands of angels). [2] ' As for Ar-Rabi' bin Anas, he said, Allah supported the Muslims with one thousand (angels), then the number reached three thousand, then five thousand. ' If one asks, according to this opinion, how can we combine between this Ayah and Allah's statement about Badr, (Remember) when you sought help of your Lord and He answered you (saying): "I will help you with a thousand angels, each behind the other (following one another) in succession." [8:9], until, (And Allah will certainly send down the angels in succession) At-Jabari 7:174. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :520. Tabari 7 :178.

4 Verily! Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise? We say that the one thousand mentioned here does not contradict the three thousand mentioned in the above Ayah [3:124], The word in succession means they follow each other and thus indicates that thousands more will follow them. The two Ayat above [8:9 and 3:124] are similar in meaning and it appears that they both were about the battle of Badr, because the angels did fight in the battle of Badr, as the evidence indicates. Allah knows best. Allah's statement, (But if you hold on to patience and have Taqwa,) [3:125] means, if you observe patience while fighting the enemy, all the while fearing Me and obeying My command. Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi' and As-Suddi said that Allah's statement, (And they will come rushing) means, they (angels) will rush to you instantaneously. 111 Al-Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said that the Ayah means, All at once. It is also said that it means, before their anger subsides (against the disbelievers). 121 The Second View The second opinion stipulates that the promise mentioned here [concerning the angels participating in battle] is related to Allah's statement, (And (remember) when you left your household in the morning to post the believers at their stations for the battle) of Uhud. However, we

should add, the angels did not come to the aid of Muslims at Uhud, because Allah made it conditional, 4/^. 4But if you hold on to patience and have Taqwa} [3:125]. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :523,524. AMabari 7:182.

The Muslims were not patient at Uhud. Rather, they ran away and, consequently, did not receive the support of even one angel. Allah's statement, iyour Lord will help you with five thousand angels having marks}, of distinction. Abu Ishaq As-Subay'i said; from Harithah bin Mudarrib said that Ali bin Abi Talib said, The angels were distinguished by wearing white wool at Badr. 111 The angels also had special markings distinguishing their horses. Allah said, if.p\$ 504,p tsA V> & Cj} iAllah made it not but as a message of good news for you and as an assurance to your hearts^ [3:126]. This Ayah means, Allah sent down angels and told you about their descent to encourage you and to comfort and reassure your hearts. You should know that victory only comes from Allah and that if He willed, He would have defeated your enemy without you having to fight them. For instance, Allah said after commanding the believers to fight, 5 Jb 5 y** o'?*-; J^iV "ii 4Qf*^ ^ Qpti iBut if it had been Allah's will, He Himself could certainly have punished them (without you). But (He lets you fight) in order to test some of you with others. But those who are killed in the way of Allah, He will never let their deeds be lost. He will guide them and set right their state. And admit them to Paradise which He has made known to them} [47:4-6]. This is why Allah said here, & X* j. % Cj 4 pjb p & A VI 'if & Cj} Ibn Abi Hatim 2:525.

iAllah made it not but as a message of good news for you and as an assurance to your hearts. And there is no victory except from Allah, the All-Mighty, the All-Wise} [3:126]. This Ayah means, Allah is the Almighty Whose power can never be undermined, and He has the perfect wisdom in His decrees and in all His decisions. Allah said, Sj' Si^ iThat He might cut off a part of those who disbelieve,} [3:127] meaning, out of His wisdom, He commands you to perform Jihad and to fight. Allah then mentions the various consequences of performing Jihad against the disbelievers. For instance, Allah said, iThat He might cut off a part...} meaning, to cause a part of a nation to perish, 4rr-p. \$ sj' Si^ iof those who disbelieve, or expose them to infamy,} by disgracing them and forcing them to return with only their rage, having failed in their aim to harm you. This is why Allah said next, ior expose them to infamy, so that they retire} to go back to their land, iZiJL} ifrustrated} without achieving their aims. Allah then mentions a statement that testifies that the decision in this life and the Hereafter is for Him Alone without partners, fit j.& fl} iNot for you is the decision} [3:128] meaning, The matter is all in My Hand. Allah also said, 4\$!4> iSj fy}

iyour duty is only to convey/ (the Message) and on Us is the reckoning .} (13:40], and, iNot upon you is their guidance, but Allah guides whom He wills.} [2:272], and, 4 o* cSJ-n >>* i-SJ-r V iVerily, you guide not whom you like, but Allah guides whom He wills} [28:56] Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Allah's statement, M > o?Nof /or yo" is the decision;}, means, No part of the decision

regarding My servants is yours, except what I command

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 960–973]

you. ' ' Allah then mentions the rest of the consequences of Jihad, in?* jfa iwltogether He pardons them} concerning the acts of disbelief that they commit, thus delivering them from misguidance to the

guidance. to ior punishes than;} in this life and the Hereafter because of their disbelief and errors, verily, they are the wrongdoers}, and thus, they deserve such a fate.

iNot far you is the decision This was also recorded by An- Nasal . Imam

(persons), mentioning some Arab tribes. Thereafter, Allah revealed, \$Notfor you is the decision .^ (11

266 Tafsir Ibn Kathir ^ Tv gjjp And to Allah belongs Hr^ dl yyA^Si' ciolliojjJ/fyij .-,^^ & i";pfj / , < *irr - < " ^ , * / .- /.t- i i-" "-x r >- ,<," , ".< " j#5si {j J ~y"J>-t&^ k-Z'tp'-j&JS fbV^:j 4 "t \$ 4He forgives whom He wills, and punishes whom He wills.} for His is the decision and none can resist His decision. Allah is never asked about what He does, while they will be asked, jj* ^bf iand Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful .} %f,jyX"i 'ii \Jil\j tLCii \fkJt -5 \p?. (\$ } # '\$,&&&& \$ & & \$ 'M \$5 Wv^u1j CjjA OyU-lJt W^t* #2 ii)Ar** d[ij*> y 44^ >"; 4ii <*' ijilu jl "'i)T?.,^j Xm y 'jL"i d* U/-*i (> "X j-A" u4> 4 'K^oUi"! ' f*-*ai ^- Ar^'" X* Ji 'Sf* ?-&> A, 4130. O t/ow who believe! Do not consume Riba doubled and multiplied, but fear Allah that you may be successful.} 4131. And fear the Fire, which is prepared for the all that is in the heavens and all that is in the Earth.} [3: 129], everything is indeed the property of Allah and all are servants in His Hand. i 0-4

disbelievers .) . And obey and the Messenger that you may obtain mercy . 4133. And march forth in the way (which leads to) forgiveness from your Lord, and for Paradise as wide as the heavens and the earth, preparedfor the Muttaqin (the pious.) 4134. Those who spend (in Allah's cause) in prosperity and in adversity, who repress anger, and who pardon men; verily, Allah loves the Muhsimn (the good-doers.) 4135. And those who, when they have committed Fahishah (immoral sin) or wronged themselves with evil, remember Allah and ask forgiveness for their sins ; and none can forgive sins but Allah, and do not persist in what (wrong) they have done, while they know.) 4236. For such, the reward is forgiveness from their Lord, and Gardens with rivers flowing underneath (Paradise), wherein they shall abide forever. Hoio excellent is this reward for the doers (ofgood.) Interest (R&d) is Prohibited Allah prohibits His believing servants from dealing in Riba and from requiring interest on their capital, just as they used to do during the time of Jahiliyyah. For instance, when the time to pay a loan comes, the creditor would say to the debtor, Either pay now, or the loan will incur interest. If the debtor asks for deferment of the loan, the creditor would require interest and this would occur year after year until the little capital becomes multiplied many times. Allah also commands His servants to have Taqwa of Him so that they may achieve success in this life and the Hereafter. Allah also threatens them with the Fire and warns them against it, saying, 43ri.TLtyT*} p Jj-jl'S iAnd fear the Fire, which is prepared for the disbelievers. And obey Allah and the Messenger that you may obtain mercy.) [3:131,1321.

268 Tafsir Ibt Kathir TheEncouragment toDo Good forwhich Paradise is the Result Allah encourages His servants to perform righteous deeds and to rush to accomplish the acts of obedience. Allah said, iAnd march forth iti the way (which leads to) forgiveness from your lord, and for Paradise as wide as the heavens and the earth, preparedfor the Muttaqin (the pious)} [3:133]. Just as the Fire was prepared for the disbelievers. It was reported that the meaning of Allah s statement. ias wide as the heavens and the earth} draws the attention to the spaciousness of Paradise. For instance, Allah said in another Ayah, while describing the couches of Paradise, ilined with silk brocade} (55:54], so what about their outer covering? It was also said that Paradise is as wide as its length, because it is a dome under the Throne.

The width and length of a dome or a circle are the same in distance. This is supported by what is found in the Sahih; . . . > . r) jtjff *When you ask Allah for Paradise, ask Him for Al-Firdaws which is the highest and best part of Paradise. From it originate the rivers of Paradise, and above it is the Throne of the Most Beneficent (Allah) J This Ayah [3:133 above] is similar to Allah's statement in Surat Al-Hadid. jU-jf frfo &> cA Jl m Path Al-Bari 6:14.

When the night comes, it overtakes everything, so where is the day? The man said, Where Allah wants it to be. The Prophet jg said, tfeje. ! j&I Jjljj

iThose who spend (in Allah's cause) in prosperity and in adversity> (3:134), in hard times and easy times, while active (or enthusiastic) and otherwise, healthy or ill, and in all conditions, just as Allah said in another Ayah, iThose who spend their wealth (in Allah's cause) by night and day, in secret and in public> (2:274) These believers are never distracted from obeying Allah, spending on what pleases Him, being kind to His servants and their relatives, and other acts of righteousness. Allah said, iwho repress anger, and who pardon men;} [3:134] for when they are angry, they control their anger and do act upon it. Rather, they even forgive those who hurt them. Imam

hill, while the deeds of the Fire are easy to find in the lowlands. The happy person is he who is saved from the tests. Verily, there is no dose of anything better to Allah than a dose of rage that the servant controls, and whenever the servant of Allah controls it, he will be internally filled with faith . [1 ' This Hadith was recorded by Imam

Tafsir Ibn Kalbir²⁷² iand who pardon menfy They forgive those who treat them with injustice. Therefore, they do not hold any ill feelings about anyone in their hearts, and this is the most excellent conduct in this regard. This is why Allah said, J ii verily, Allah loves the Muhsinitt (the good-doersfy. This good conduct is a type of Ihscin [excellence in the religion]. There is a Hadith that reads, if " 4jUj y I swear regarding three matters: no charity shall ever decrease the wealth; whenever one forgives people, then Allah will magnify his honor; and he who is humblefor Allah, then Allah will raise his rank.*[li Allah said. 4And those who, when they have committed Fahishah or wronged themselves with evil, remember Allah and ask forgivenessfor their sins [3:135]. Therefore, if they commit an error they follow it with repentance and ask forgiveness. Imam

Li L ^JuaJ A man once committed an error and said, 'O Lord! I committed an error, so forgive me.' Allah said, 'My servant committed an error and knew that he has a Lord Who forgives or punishesfor the error. I haveforgivenMy servant.' The man committed another error and said, 'O Lord! I committed an error, so forgive me.' Allah said, 'My servant knew that he has a Lord Who forgives or punishes for the sin . I have forgiven My servant. The man committed another error and said, 'O Lord! I committed an error, so forgive me.' Allah said, 'My servant knew that he has a Lord Who forgives or punishes for the error. I have forgiven my servant.' He then committed another error and said, 'O Lord! I committed an error, so forgive me. Allah said, 'My servant knew that he has a Lord Wlw forgives or punishes for the error. Bear witness that I have forgiven My servant, so let him do whatever he likes. 'n similar narration was collected in the SahihP Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Anas bin Malik said, I was told that when the Ayah, i jl i tfs til iAnd those who, when they have committed Fdhishah or wronged themselves with evil, remember Allah and ask forgivenessfor their sins,} was revealed, Iblis (Shayatan) cried. '3|

Allah's statement, "And none can forgive sins but Allah", means that none except Allah forgives sins. Allah said, "And do not persist in what (wrong) they have done, while they know", 2:296. Al-Bari 13:474. Abdul-Razzaq 1:133.

275L/m mi " i r underneath (Paradise)} carrying all kinds of drinks, 4Q. iwherein they shall abide forever and ever, 4How excellent is this reward for the doers Allah praises Paradise in this part of the Ayah. Ji' jt SjBfi \? % i; *&*> Jb X. flSV' liljj id Xii 0^ JjWJOLii} 44 ^ l;s ip; St^ (j&\ iif Ju CJj il"J' 1j3o-j3 jl "*">' (jlijJ iii tjSij J Jj ^ p~ j>-j T-^" jijj 4137. Many similar ways (and mishaps of life) were faced [by nations (believers and disbelievers) that have passed away] before you, so travel through the earth, and see what was the end of those who denied. } 4138. This is a plain statement for mankind, a guidance and instruction for the Muttaqin. } 4139. So do not become weak, nor be sad, and you will be triumphant if you are indeed believers. } 4140. If a wound has touched you, be sure a similar wound has touched the others. And so are the days, that We give to men by turns, that Allah may know (test) those who believe, and that He may take martyrs from among you. And Allah likes not the wrongdoers. } 4141. And that Allah may test those who believe and destroy the disbelievers.}. 4142. Do you think that you will enter Paradise before Allah knows (tests) those of you who performed Jihad and knows (tests) those who are patient?} 4143. You did indeed wish for death before you met it. Now

276 Tafsir Ibn Kathir you have seen it openly with your own eyes.} The Wisdom Behind the Losses Muslims Suffered During Uhud Allah states to His believing servants who suffered losses in

the battle of Uhud, including seventy dead,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 973–1011]

oli- ji} iMany similar ways (and mishaps of life) were faced before you}, for the previous nations who followed their Prophets before you, they too suffered losses. However, the good end was theirs, and the ultimate defeat was for the disbelievers. This is why Allah said, ^so travel through the earth, and see what was the end of those who denied}. Allah said next, iThis is a plain statement for mankind}, meaning, the Qur'an explains the true reality of things and narrates how the previous nations suffered by the hands of their enemies. iAnd a guidance and instruction} for the Qur'an contains the news of the past, and, 4guidance for your hearts, }and instruction for the Muttaqin} to discourage committing the prohibited and forbidden matters. Allah comforts the believers by saying, }So do not become weak}, because of what you suffered,

' opì\ p^j i^ inor be sad, and you will be triumphant if you are indeed believers}. for surely, the ultimate victory and triumph will be yours, O believers. ;pp Ji SZgpzz& ilf a wound has touched you, be sure a similar wound has touched the others [3:140]. Therefore, the Ayah says, if you suffered injuries and some of you were killed, then your enemies also suffered injuries and fatalities. iAnd so are the days, that We give to men by turns} , and at times - out of wisdom - We allow the enemy to overcome you, although the final good end will be yours. J8pip iand that Allah may know (test) those who believe,} meaning, So that We find out who would be patient while fighting the enemies, according to Ibn Abbas. i-yppspp iand that He may take martyrs from among you} those who would be killed in Allah's cause and gladly offer their lives seeking His pleasure. ip: pi& AfpMU %} iAnd Allah likes not the

wrongdoers. And that Allah may test those who believe} [3:140,141], by forgiving them their sins if they have any. Otherwise, Allah will raise their grades according to the losses they suffered. Allah's statement, and destroy the disbelievers}, for it is their conduct that if they gain the upper hand, they transgress and commit aggression.

However, this conduct only leads to ultimate destruction, extermination, perishing and dying out. Allah then said, Oj ijU- Si 4Do you think that you will enter Paradise before Allah knows (tests) those of you who will perform Jihad and (also) knows (tests) those who are the patient?) [3:142]. The Ayah asks, do you think that you will enter Paradise without being tested with warfare and hardships? Allah said in Surat Al-Baqarah, itlb' f-f * (Oi 'jU-i fty 40r think you that you will enter Paradise without such (trials) as came to those who passed away before you? They were afflicted with severe poverty and ailments and were so shaken... [2:214]. Allah said, 4Alif Lam Mim . Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe, and will not be tested?) [29:1,2], This is why He said here, 4D0 you think that you will enter Paradise before Allah knows (tests) those of you who will perform Jihad and (also) knows (tests) those who are the patient?) [3:142] meaning, you will not earn Paradise until you are tested and thus Allah knows who among you are the ones who struggle and fight in His cause and are patient in the face of the enemy. Allah said, 4 fb iYou did indeed wish for death (martyrdom) before you met it. Now you have seen it openly with your own eyes) [3:143]. The Ayah proclaims, O believers! Before today, you wished

Do not to wish to encounter the enemy, and ask Allah for your well-being. However, if you do encounter them, then observe patience and know that Paradise is under the shade of swords .

Our Lord! Forgive us our sins and our transgressions, establish our feet firmly, and give us victory over the disbelieving folk.

iMuhammad is no more than a Messenger, and indeed (many) Messengers have passed away before him}, was revealed. This story was collected by Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi in Dala il An-NubuwwahJ Allah said next, while chastising those who became weak, jje. jt OIs y iff he dies or is killed, will you then turn back on your heels?}, become disbelievers, iAnd he who turns back on his heels, not the least harm will he do to Allah; and Allah will give reward to those who are grateful}, those who obeyed Allah, defended His religion and followed His Messenger jg whether he was alive or dead. The Sahih, Musnad and Sunan collections gathered various chains of narration stating that Abu Bakr recited this Ayah when the Messenger of Allah died.

282 Tafsir Ibtisami iMuhammad is no more than a Messenger and indeed (many) Messengers have passed away before him . If he dies or is killed, will you then turn back on your heels? And he who turns back on his heels, not the least harm will he do to Allah ; and Allah will reward the grateful.} The narrator added, By Allah, it was as if the people never knew that Allah had revealed this verse before until Abu Bakr recited it, and then whoever heard it, started reciting it. Said bin Al-Musayyib said that Umar said, By Allah! When I heard Abu Bakr recite this Ayah, my feet could not hold me, and I fell to the ground. Allah said, C>% " Oj i c jf iAnd no person can ever die except by Allah's leave and at an appointed term.} [3:145] meaning, no one dies except by Allah's decision, after he has finished the term that Allah has destined for him. This is why Allah said. iat an appointed term} which is similar to His

statements, 4 iAnd no aged man is granted a length of life nor is a part cut off from his life, but it is in a Book} [35:1 1], and, 'Jj3 4' 4He it is W?!o has created you from clay, and then has decreed a (stated) term (for you to die) . And there is with Him another determined term (for you to be resurrected)} [6:2]. This Ayah [3:145] encourages cowards to participate in battle; for doing so, or avoiding battle neither decreases, nor increases the life term. Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that, Habib bin Suhban said that a Muslim man, Hujr bin Adi, said in a battle, What prevents you from crossing this river (the Euphrates) to the enemy?Al-Bari 7 :751 .

J jt =" Uj^ iAnd no person can ever die except by Allah's leave and at an appointed term\$>? He then crossed the river riding his horse, and when he did, the Muslims followed him. When the enemy saw them, they started shouting, Diwan (Persian; crazy), and they ran away. Allah said next. / 1^, m *) // t/, # xyi y-* V-M 4And whoever desires a reioard in the world, We shall give him of it; and whoever desires a reward in the Hereafter, We shall give him thereof Therefore, the Ayah proclaims, whoever works for the sake of this life, will only earn what Allah decides he will earn. However, he will not have a share in the Hereafter. Whoever works for the sake of the Hereafter, Allah will give him a share in the Hereafter, along with what He decides for him in this life. In similar statements, Allah said, c* c## 14&& te* a 4 & 24 & iWhosoever desires (by his deeds) the reward of the Hereafter, We give him increase in his reward, and whosoever desires the reivard of this world (by his deeds), We give him thereof (what is decreed for him), and he has no portion in the Hereafter. [42:20], and, W Uq Y 4 n- 1 uil*- jS iCj u Cfj yj uijj. of" * > ' ri-t.p " I-'-" " < >-4;- ,>>* _>* > L* J *^2 4W7iom. r desires the quick-passing (transitory enjoymetit of this world). We readily grant him what We will far whom We like. Then, afterwards, We have appointed far him Hell; he will 111 IbnAbiHStim 2:584.

bum therein disgraced and despised. And whoever desires the Hereafter and strives for it, with the necessary effort due for it while he is a believer, then such are the ones whose striving shall be appreciated} [17:18-19]. In this Ayah [3:145], Allah said, 4And We shall reward the grateful.} meaning. We shall award them with Our favor and mercy in this life and the Hereafter, according to the degree of their appreciation [of Allah] and their good deeds. Allah then comforts the believers because of what they suffered in Uhud, *-9\$,*-" yH Crt iAnd many a Prophet fought and along with him many Ribbiyyiin. } It was said that this Ayah means that many Prophets and their companions were killed in earlier times, as is the view chosen by Ibn Jarir. It was also said that the Ayah means that many Prophets witnessed their companions death before their eyes. However, Ibn Ishaq mentioned another explanation in his Strah, saying that this Ayah means, Many a Prophet was killed, and he had many companions whose resolve did not weaken after their Prophet died, and they did not become feeble in the face of the enemy. What they suffered in Jihad in Allah s cause and for the sake of their religion did not make them lose heart. This is patience, iand Allah loves the patient.} As-Suhayli agreed with this explanation and defended it vigorously. This view is supported by Allah saying; sfa LZ} 4And along with him many Ribbiy](iin}. In his book about the battles, Al-Amawi mentioned only this explanation for the Ayah. Sufyan Ath-Thawri reported that, Ibn Mas ud said that,

d AHafc loves the patient. And they said nothing but:

[3:146-147], and this was the statement that they kept repeating. Therefore, 4ulit iSo Allah gave them the reward of this world} victory, triumph and the good end, 4ie\$' '-f'y iand the excellent reioard of the

Hereafter} added to the gains in this life, iAtid Allah loves the good-doers}. t&X. \$ \$> ol 4 off- - 4 J_a4 |4 C 4lL i> ==rii lij .AjiLj dl-c-j *i' p4a > i~C -d)j jtt!' t* (^* t 4-1 Li -r-^ r^y^j ji_5 i_J> ji p =li;4 t2j)i i>* p-^ 'Jj 4-ii ji iilfj tit AjJj ij.j-3 y^ B. _J^ (j^ & 4 yf.oj " "~ tlj " iifj p *-a t" "Vj fr-sxjX* t* jt 4249. 0 yow u)/io believe! If you obey those who disbelieve, they will send you back on your heels, and you will turn back as losers.}

il50. Nay, Allah is your protector, and He is the best of helpers.} 4157. We shall cast terror into the hearts of those zvho disbelieve, because they joined others in zuorship with Allah, for ivhich He sent no authority; their abode will be the Fire and hmv evil is the abode of the ivrongdoers.> 4152. And Allah did indeed fulfill His promise to you when you were killing them (your enemy) with His permission; until Fashiltum and fell to disputing about the order, and disobeyed after He showed you what you love. Among you arc some that desire this world and some that desire the Hereafter. Then He made you flee from them, that He might test you. But surely, Heforgave you, and Allah is Most Gracious to the believers. il53. (And remember) when you ran away without even casting a side glance at anyone, and the Messenger was in your rear calling you back. There did Allah give you one distress after another by way of requital, to teach you not to grieve for that ivhich had escaped you, nor for what struck you. And Allah is Well-Aware of all that you do.} The Prohibition ofObeying the Disbelievers; the Cause ofDefeat atUhud Allah warns His believing servants against obeying the disbelievers and hypocrites, because such obedience leads to utter destruction in this life and the Hereafter. This is why Allah said, if ilf you obey those who disbelieve, they will send you back on your heels, and you will turn back (from faith) as losers [3:149]. Allah also commands the believers to obey Him, take Him as their protector, seek His aid and trust in Him. Allah said, ^ J*- _>*) ill 4Mo/, Allah is your protector, and He is the best ofhelpers Allah next conveys the good news that He will put tear of t Muslims, and feelings of subordination to the Muslims in the

hearts of their disbelieving enemies, because of their Ku.fr and Shirk. And Allah has prepared torment and punishment for them in the Hereafter. Allah said, p Mi 4 iWe shall cast terror into the hearts of those who disbelieve, because they joined others in worship with Allah, for which He sent no authority; their abode will be the Fire and how evil is the abode of the wrongdoers}. In addition, the Two Sahihs recorded that Jabir bin Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah said, l oa Oj*At I *L iN 1 jS-^ I ^ C.-Lp .apU-Lh o.Lp?J 'LhJLa oJL>-j 'oU ^ilii .ILJj Liu- w)i J! ,yji 01 "/ was groen five things that no other Prophet before me was given. 1 was aided with fear the distance of one month, the earth was made a Masjid and clean place for me, I was allowed war booty, I was given the Intercession, and Prophets used to be sent to their people, but I was salt to all mankind particularlyV 1 Allah said, 4t"jLpj ill' |ii==oi J^Sij} iAttd Allah did indeed fulfill His promise to you} [3:152], in the beginning of the day of Uhud, iwhen you were killing them}, slaying your enemies, 44:*> iwith His permission}, for He allowed you to do that against them, mi Fath Al-Bari 1 :519 , Muslim 1 :370.

Al Imran (Part-4) iuntil when you Fashiltum}. Ibn Jurayj said that Ibn Abbas said that Fashiltum means, lost courage . iand fell to disputing about the order, and disobeyed such as the mistake made by the archers, iafter He showed you what you love}, that is, victory over the disbelievers, iAmong you are some that desire this world referring to those who sought to collect the booty when they saw the enemy being defeated, iand some that desire the Hereafter. Then He made you flee from them, that He might

test you}. This Ayah means, Allah gave them the upper hand to try and test you, O believers, but surely, He forgave you}. He forgave the error you committed, because, and Allah knows best, the idolators were many and well supplied, while

Messenger jg commanded me not to allow you to abandon your position. They refused to listen, and when they left their position, Muslims were defeated and seventy of them were killed. Abu Sufyan shouted, Is Muhammad present among these people? The Prophet jg said, Do not answer him. Then he asked, Is the son of Abu Quhafah (Abu Bakr) present among these people? The Prophet jg said, Do not answer him. He asked again. Is the son of Al-Khattab (Umar) present among these people? As for these (men), they have been killed, for had they been alive, they would have answered me. Umar could not control himself and said (to Abu Sufyan), *You lie, O enemy of Allah! The cause of your misery is still present. Abu Sufyan said, O Hubal, be high! On that the Prophet sg said (to his Companions), Answer him back. They said, What shall we say? He said, Say, Allah is Higher and more Sublime. Abu Sufyan said, We have the (idol) Al-*Uzza, and you have no Uzza. The Prophet jg said, Answer him back. They asked, What shall we say? He said, Say, Allah is our protector and you have no protector. Abu Sufyan said, Our victory today is vengeance for yours in the battle of Badr, and in war (the victory) is always undecided and is shared in turns by the belligerents. You will find some of your killed men mutilated, but I did not urge my men to do so, yet I do not feel sorry for their deed. Only Al-Bukhari collected this Hadith using this chain of narration.' Muhammad bin Ishaq said that, Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr narrated that Az-Zubayr bin Al- Awwam said, By Allah! I saw the female servants and female companions of Hind (Abu Sufyan s wife) when they uncovered their legs and gave flight. At that time, there was no big or small effort separating us from capturing them. However, the archers went down the mount when the enemy gave flight from the battlefield, seeking to collect the booty. They uncovered our back lines to the horsemen of the disbelievers, who took the chance and attacked us from behind. Then a person shouted, Muhammad has been killed. So we pulled back, and the disbelievers followed us, after we had killed those who carried their flag, and none of them dared to come close the flag, until then. ' (1 > Fath Al-Bari 7 :405

Muhammad bin Ishaq said next, The flag of the disbelievers was left on the ground until Amrah bint Alqamah Al- Harithiyah picked it up and gave it to the Quraysh who held it. Allah said, iThen He made you flee from them, that He might test you} [3:152].

that, Tus'iduna, means, go up the mountain . 4without even casting a side glance at anyone meaning, you did not glance at anyone else due to shock, fear and fright. iand the Messenger ivas in your rear calling you back}, for you left him behind you, while he was calling you to stop fleeing from the enemy and to return and fight. As-Suddi said, When the disbelievers attacked

111 Said bin Al-Musayyib said, I heard Sa d bin Abi Waqqas saying, The Messenger of Allah jg gave me arrows from his quiver on the day of Uhud and said, Shoot, may I sacrifice my father and mother for you.

It is recorded in the Two Sahih that when he was asked about the injuries the Messenger jg sustained [in Uhud], Sahl bin Sa d said, The face of Allah s Messenger jg was injured, his front tooth was broken and his helmet was smashed on his head. Therefore, Fatimah, the daughter of Allah s Messenger jg washed

off the blood while Ali was pouring water on her hand. When Fatimah saw that the bleeding increased more by the water, she took a mat, burnt it, and placed the ashes in the wound of the Prophet ^{sg} and the blood stopped oozing out. Allah said next, ^{AThere} did Allah give you one distress after another} [3:153), He gave you grief over your grief. Ibn Abbas said, The first grief was because of the defeat, especially when it was rumored that Muhammad ^{sg} was killed. The second grief was when the idolators went up the mount and The Messenger of Allah ^{sg} said, O Allah! It is not for them to rise above us. 111 Abdur-Rahman bin Awf said, The first distress was because of the defeat and the second when a rumor started that Muhammad ^{sg} was killed, which to them, was worse than defeat. Ibn Marduwyah recorded both of these. Mujahid and Qatadah said, The first distress was when they heard that Muhammad ^{sg} was killed and the second when they suffered casualties and injury." It has also been reported that Qatadah and Ar-RabT bin Anas said that it was the opposite [order]. As- Suddi said that the first distress was because of the victory and booty that they missed and the second because of the enemy rising above them (on the mount). Allah said, ^{iby way of requital to teach you not to grieve for that which had escaped you}}, for that you missed the booty and triumph over your enemy. ^{inor for what struck you}}, of injury and fatalities, as Ibn Abbas, Abdur-Rahman bin Awf, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and As-Suddi 111 This narration is not authentic.

cmm v< m" j<* pr-~^ ^-hQj p\$#&G&k {& \>- -I' ' - 'H ' stated. 1 11 Allah said next, ^{4And Allah is Well- Aware of all that you do.}} all praise is due to Him, and thanks, there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, the Most High, Most Honored. !lrJ (* Jj*' S-^tl& \Li ' \ ?' l"P_ui (V,'. a> JJ \$ \$\$ % & Si ^ \$ si\ h ji \-J. Jt fSj\ ', { ti . ' -":' i V U (Vt o' -J by^r. ft Q 3? i> 3) 25 5j /j\ S> 4 is jt jss si' S3 a i jllf 'jly v>'ij S 1* S ?^> 4#2X & t\ fa i3 i3S t^r d^ d> *> >/ >> . "it<^fi""ifl- J;, / " <A^> jtt' e/ i't" <<' >>'. r't *^*A ^ _ Jj-nl^a lL^ A"- A.Ji " d ,>-> 4254. Then after the distress, He sent down security far you. Slumber overtook a party of you, while another party was thinking about themselves and thought wrongly of Allah - the thought of ignorance. They said, "Have we any part in the affair?" Say: "Indeed the affair belongs wholly to Allah." They hide within themselves what they dare not reveal to you, saying : "If we had anything to do with the affair, none of us IbnAbiHatim 2:613.

would have been killed here." Say: "Even ifyou had remained in your homes, those for zvhorn death was decreed would certainly have gone forth to the place of their death," but that Allah might test what is in your breasts; and to purify that which was in your hearts (sins), and Allah is All-Knower of zohat is in the breasts 4155. Tlwse of you who turned back on the day the two hosts met, Shaytan only caused them to err because of sotne of ivhat they had earned. But Allah, indeed, has forgiven them. Surely, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Forbearing . Slumber Overcame the Believers; the Fear that the Hypocrites Suffered Allah reminds His servants of His favor when He sent down on them tranquillity and slumber that overcame them while they were carrying their weapons and feeling distress and grief. In this case, slumber is a favor and carries meanings of calmness and safety. For instance, Allah said in Surat Al-Anfal about the battle of Badr, ^{4(Remember)} luhen He covered you with a slumber as a securityfrom Him^ [8 : 11]. A1-Bukhari recorded that Anas said that, Abu Talhah said, I was among those who were overcome by slumber during the battle of Uhud. My sword fell from my hand several times and I would pick it up, then it would fall and I would pick it up again. [11

said, I was among those who were overcome by slumber. ,1! The second group mentioned in the Ayah were the hypocrites who only thought about themselves, for they are the most cowardly people and those least likely to support the truth, ^ jf- 4and thought wrongly of Allah - the thought of ignorance} [3: 154], for they are liars and people who have doubts and evil thoughts about Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored. Allah said, iTIteti after the distress, He sent dmon security for you. Slumber overtook a party ofyou}, the people of faith, certainty, firmness and reliance (on Allah) who are certain that Allah shall give victory to His Messenger jfe and fulfill his objective. {While another party was thinking about themselves}, and they were not overcome by slumber because of their worry, fright and fear, iand thought wrongly ofAllah - the thought of ignorance}. Similarly, Allah said in another statement, i A C& J J \$.} {Nay, but you thought that the Messenger and the believers would never return to theirfamilies} [48:12]. This group thought that the idolators achieved ultimate victory, when their forces took the upper hand in battle, and that Islam and its people would perish. This is typical of people of doubt and hesitation, in the event of a hardship, they fall into such evil thoughts. Allah then described them that, " An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :349.

ithey said in this situation, 4 Have we any part in the affair?: ") although they tried to conceal this thought from the Messenger of Allah jgj. Ibn Ishaq recorded that Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr said that Az-Zubayr said, I was with the Messenger of Allah jgg when fear intensified and Allah sent sleep to us (during the battle of Uhud). At that time, every man among us (except the hypocrites) was nodding off. By Allah! As if in a dream, I heard the words of Mu'attib bin Qushayr, If we had anything to do with the affair, none of us would have been killed here. I memorized these words of his, which Allah mentioned later on, 4&cget# S; cix)s;"

will certainly come to pass, and there is no escaping it. Allah s statement, 4that Allah might test what is in your breasts; and to purify that which teas in your hearts,} means, so that He tests you with whatever befell you, to distinguish good from evil and the deeds and statements of the believers from those of the hypocrites, ^j} iand Allah is All-Knower ofwhat is in the breasts}, and what the hearts conceal. Some ofthe Believers Give Flight on the Day ofUhud Allah then said, \ &3S gp, " l\} iThose of you who turned back on the day the two hosts met, Shaytdn only caused them to err because of some of w!wl they Iwd earned} [3:155], because of some of their previous errors. Indeed, some of the Salaf said, The reward of the good deed includes being directed to another good deed that follows it, while the retribution of sin includes committing another sin that follows it. Allah then said, lit S f} ibut Allah, indeed, hasforgiven them}, their giving flight, isurely, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Forbearing} He forgives sins, pardons and exonerates His creatures. Imam

il56. O you who believe! Be not like those who disbelieve and who say to their brethren when they travel through the earth or go out to fight : "If they had stayed with us, they would not have died or been killed," so that Allah may make it a cause of regret in their hearts. It is Allah that gives life and causes death. And Allah is All-Seer ofwhat you do.} 4157. And if you are killed or die in the way of Allah, forgiveness and mercy from Allah are far better than all that they amass.} 4158. And whether you die or are killed, verily, unto Allah you shall be gathered.} Prohibiting the Ideas of the Disbelievers about Death and Predestination Allah forbids His believing servants from the disbelievers false creed, seen in their statement about those who died in battle and during travel; Had they abandoned these trips,

they would not have met their demise. Allah said. irtP-z ye^ s 40 you who believe! Be not like those who disbelieve Oiypocrites) and who say to their brethren}, about their dead brethren, 4when they travel through the earth} for the purpose of trading and otherwise, 4or go out to fight}, participating in battles, 4*x* 's? 4"If they had stayed with us,"} in our area, Cj 4"they would not have died or been killed,"} they would not have died while traveling or been killed in battle. Allah s statement,

iso that Allah may make it a cause of regret in their hearts.} means, Allah creates this evil thought in their hearts so that their sadness and the grief they feel for their loss would increase. Allah refuted them by saying, fit- &* ilt is Allah that gives life and causes death. for the creation is under Allah s power, and the decision is His Alone. No one lives or dies except by Allah s leave, and no one s life is increased or decreased except by His decree. 4XJ o JSC iAnd Allah is All-Seer ofwhat you do,} for His knowledge and vision encompasses all His creation and none of their affairs ever escapes Him. Allah s statement, ri^ jy*- au* ot j' Sir** j CJ^JT iAnd ifyou are killed or die in theway ofAllah, forgiveness and mercyfromAllah arefarbetter than all that theyamass.} [3 : 157), indicating that death and martyrdom in Allah s cause Eire a means of earning Allah s mercy, forgiveness Eind pleasure. This, indeed, is better than remaining in this life with its short lived delights. Furthermore, whoever dies or is killed will return to Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, and He will reward him if he has done good deeds, or will punish him for his evil deeds. Allah sEud, iAnd whether you die or are killed, verily, unto Allah you shall be gathered.} [3 :158). fr* Oj oiSll l i cJZ jjj \ll} i>[44 it k ^ pjp.j p. j & fc P%, Ob'p C& * it fe f ff. *^ Jiii 0^ Uj JjfyP i*t oj i' oy"y gjjt i>*it 'J pj \5 ^_aj ^i==

JiJ Cj %>\j Zi\ JuP i-> (U Jij ^ ijS 1# hi& H ^L\$" ujJ 33 os ly^" *Ij 4159. And by (be mercy o/A//db, you dea/f with them gently. And had you been severe and harsh-hearted, they would have broken away from about you; so pardon them, and ask forgiveness for them ; and consult them in the affairs. Then when you have taken a decision, put your trust in Allah, certainly, Allah loves those who put their trust (in Him).} 4160. If Allah helps you, none can overcome you; and if He forsakes you, who is there after Him that can help you? And in Allah (Alone) let believers put their trust.} 4161 . It is not for any Prophet to illegally take a part of the booty, and whosoever deceives his companions over the booty, he shall bring forth on the Day of Resurrection that which he took. Then every person shall be paid in full what he has earned, and they shall not be dealt with unjustly.} 4162. Is then one who follows (seeks) the pleasure ofAllah like the one who draws on himself the wrath of Allah? His abode is Hell, and worse indeed is that destination!} 4163. They are in varying grades with Allah, and Allah is All- Seer ofwhat they do.} 4164. Indeed, Allah conferred a great favor on the believers when He sent among them a Messenger from among themselves, reciting unto than His verses (the Qur an), and purifying them, and instructing them (in) the Book (the Qur'an) and Al-Hikmah [the wisdom and the Sunrtah], while before that they had been in manifest error.} Among the Qualities ofOur ProphetMuhammad^ are Mercy and Kindness Allah addresses His Messenger and reminds him and the believers of the favor that He has made his heart and words soft for his Ummah, those who follow his command and refrain from what he prohibits.

iAnd by the mercy of AlWt, you dealt with them gently} [3:159], meaning, who would have made you this kind, if it was not Allah s mercy for you and them. Qatadah said that, J 4\$ ' Cfr iAnd by the mercy ofAllah, you dealt with them gently} means, With Allah s mercy you became this kind. Al-Hasan Al-

Basri said that this, indeed, is the description of the behavior that Allah sent Muhammad ﷺ with. This Ayah is similar to Allah's statement, *O Verily, there has come unto you a Messenger from among yourselves. It grieves him that you should receive any injury or difficulty. He is anxious over you (to be rightly guided, to repent to Allah); for the believers (he is) full of pity, kind, and merciful* [9:128]. Allah said next, *And had you been severe and harsh-hearted, they would have broken away from about you; The severe person is he who utters harsh words, and, harsh-hearted is the person whose heart is hard. Had this been the Prophet's behavior, They would have scattered from around you. However, Allah gathered them and made you kind and soft with them, so that their hearts congregate around you.*" Abdullah bin Amr said that he read the description of the Messenger of Allah in previous Books, He is not severe, harsh, obscene in the marketplace or dealing evil for evil. Rather, he forgives and pardons. The Order for Consultation and to Abide by it Allah said, (i| Path Al-Bari 8 : 449

4 (&4&J p> 4So pardon them, and ask (Allah's) forgiveness for them; and consult them in the affairs.} The Messenger of Allah used to ask his Companions for advice about various matters, to comfort their hearts, and so they actively implement the decision they reach. For instance, before the battle of Badr, the Prophet ﷺ asked his Companions for if Muslims should intercept the caravan (led by Abu Sufyan). They said, O Messenger of Allah! If you wish to cross the sea, we would follow you in it, and if you march forth to Barkul-Ghimad we would march with you. We would never say what the Children of Israel said to Musa, So go, you and your Lord, and fight you two, we are sitting right here. Rather, we say march forth and we shall march forth with you; and before you, and to your right and left shall we fight. The Prophet ﷺ also asked them for their opinion about where they should set up camp at Badr. Al-Mundhir bin Amr suggested to camp close to the enemy, for he wished to acquire martyrdom. Concerning the battle of Uhud, the Messenger ﷺ asked the Companions if they should fortify themselves in Al-Madinah or go out to meet the enemy, and the majority of them requested that they go out to meet the enemy, and he did. He also took their advice on the day of Khandaq (the Trench) about conducting a peace treaty with some of the tribes of Al-Ahzab (the Confederates), in return for giving them one-third of the fruits of Al-Madinah. However, Sa'd bin Tadjbadah and Sa'd bin Mu'adh rejected this offer and the Prophet ﷺ went ahead with their advice. The Prophet ﷺ also asked them if they should attack the idolaters on the Day of Hudaibiyyah, and Abu Bakr disagreed, saying, We did not come here to fight anyone. Rather, we came to perform Umrah. The Prophet ﷺ agreed. On the day of Ifk, (i.e. the false accusation), the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said to them, O Muslims! Give me your advice about some men who falsely accused my wife (A'ishah). By Allah! I never knew of any evil to come from my wife. And they accused whom? They accused he from whom I only knew righteous conduct, by Allah! The Prophet ﷺ asked Ali and Usamah about divorcing A'ishah. In summary, the Prophet ﷺ used to take his Companions advice for battles and other important events.

; *The one whom advice is sought from is to be entrusted" This was recorded by Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, and An-Nasai who graded it *tsahih*. Trust in Allah After Taking the Decision Allah's statement, *When you have taken a decision, put your trust in Allah, means, if you conduct the required consultation and you then make a decision, trust in Allah over your decision, in fact, certainly, Allah loves those who put their trust (in Him)*. Allah's statement, *And Allah helps you, none can overcome you; and if He forsakes you, who is there after*

Him that can help you? And in Allah (Alone) let believers put their trust}, is similar to His statement that we mentioned earlier, 4*^ jff JI x* Cf} 4And there is no victory except from Allah the Almighty, the All-Wise} [3:126]. Allah next commands the believers to trust in Him, 4*&\$ &&} 4And in Allah (Alone) let believers put their trust}. Treachery with the Spoils of War was not a Trait of the Prophet^ Allah said, Abu Dawud 5 :345 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :109

43^ o' iff,& ilt is not far any Prophet to illegally take a part of the booty, Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Al-Hasan said that the Ayah means, It is not for a Prophet to breach the trust. * Ibn Jarir recorded that, Ibn Abbas said that, this Ayah, j* Iff,& ilt is not far any Prophet to illegally take a part of the booty was revealed in connection with a red robe that was missing from the spoils of war of Badr. Some people said that the Messenger of Allah 3 g might have taken it. When this rumor circulated, Allah sent down, 4^^' fy. I>*J 0* Iff, ilt is not far any Prophet to illegally take a part of the booty, and whosoever is deceitful with the booty, he shall bring forth on the Day of Resurrection that which he took. This was also recorded by

' ui la>-)j* l^JL^i - jljl ji f>: ill ir *The worst Ghulul (i.e. stealing) with Allah is a yard of land, that is, when you find two neighbors in a land or home and one of them illegally acquires a yard of his neighbor's land. When he does, he will be tied with it from the seven earths until the Day of Resurrection ."[11 Imam

recorded that Mu'adh bin Jabal said, The Messenger of Allah sent me to Yemen, but when I started on the journey, he sent for me to come back and said, "Do you know why I summoned you back? Do not take anything without my permission, for if you do, it will be Ghulul. and whosoever deceives his companions over the booty, he shall bring forth on the Day of Resurrection that which he took}. (This is why I summoned you, so now go and fulfill your mission

flurah 3 . Al Imran (Part-41 311 4/s then one who follows (seeks) the pleasure of Allah like the one who draws on himself the wrath of Allah? His abode is Hell, and worse indeed is that destination!) [3:162], This refers to those seeking what pleases Allah by obeying His legislation, thus earning His pleasure and tremendous rewards, while being saved from His severe torment. This type of person is not similar to one who earns Allah's anger, has no means of escaping it and who will reside in Jahannam on the Day of Resurrection, and what an evil destination it is. There are many similar statements in the Qur'an, such as, 4 ^ J* j. Jidi 4 ~q\ jZ jj\} i Shall he then who knows that what has been revealed unto you (O Muhammad jg) from your Lord is the truth be like him who is blind?} [13:19], and, 4C% g (Cij ieMj \} 41s he whom We have promised an excellent promise (Paradise) which he will find true, like him whom We have made to enjoy the luxuries of the life of (this) world?} [28:61]. Allah then said, iTThey are in varying grades with Allah,} [3:163] meaning, the people of righteousness and the people of evil are in grades, as Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Muhammad bin Ishaq said. Abu TJBaydah and Al-Kisa i said that this Ayah refers to degrees, meaning there are various degrees and dwellings in Paradise, as well as, various degrees and dwellings in the Fire. In another Ayah, Allah said, 4For all there will be degrees (or ranks) according to what they did} [6:132]. Next, Allah said, I 1 * Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :646, At-Tabari 7 : 367.

and Allah is All-Seer of what they do}, and He will compensate or punish them, and will never rid them of a good deed, or increase their evil deeds. Rather, each will be treated according to his deeds. The Magnificent Blessing in the Advent of Our Prophet Muhammadi Allah the Most High said: 4^ if (ip* S[Of If !&} 4Indeed Allah conferred a great favor on the believers when He sent among them a Messenger from among themselves, \$ Meaning, from their own kind, so that it is possible for them to speak with him, ask him questions, associate with him, and benefit from him. Just as Allah said: 4 \y&l if J 4And among His signs is that he created for them mates, that they may find rest in Meaning; of their own kind. And Allah said; <% "3 ta5& Pi% a n. \$ i Say "I am only a man like you . It fws been revealed to me that your God is One God" } [18:1 10). 4And We never sent before you any of the Messengers but verily, they ate food and walked in the markets [25:20). P is ^n 4And We sent not before you any but men unto whom We revealed, from among the people of townships } [12:109], and, 40 you assembly of Jinn and mankind! "Did not there come to you Messengers from among you . ..?" } [6: 130). Allah s favor is perfected when His Messenger to the people

- \ VT sm - . I t & AlA, .* ^- ' c " - "it. .t > * ' is S.Z " * i* ' , - * ' If ^l^oyj'os is from their own kind, so that they are able to talk to him and inquire about the meanings of Allah s Word. This is why Allah said, 4*^" n?*- 4reciting unto them His verses [3:164], the Qur an, iatid purifying them}, commanding them to do righteous works and forbidding them from committing evil. This is how their hearts will be purified and cleansed of the sin and evil that used to fill them when they were disbelievers and ignorant. imt&& iand instructing them (in) the Book and the Hikmah, } the Qur an and the Sunnah, 4d3 oi iwhile before that they had been}, before sending this Prophet, Muhammad jfe, ji} tin manifest error.} indulging in plain and unequivocal error and ignorance that are clear to everyone. f f i */r 4" O' ^CJu' X* j; yk j" \$ j i" tf&i (TVX^ j" tiJ

\!ss2i' Jdt ^ & & ^Li fi i j) (j!li \yZi\ jl J} ijb i - * j iy&T ji lj rn- o-\$ ^ rt?A JHt rri >^=4 r if j" ijtj Li LjpLLI 3) cr^vlt *j)S j\$ \ W5jlis2 Lt pjbt ilfj 4 ^~S"" 0 |* "ujil . (W7wf is the matter with you?) When a single disaster smites you, although you smote (your enemies) with one twice as great, you say: "From where does this come to us? Say, "It is from yourselves." And Allah has power over all things.} . And what you suffered on the day the two armies met, was by the leave of Allah, in order that He might test the believers . And that He might test the hypocrites, it was said to them : "Come, fight in the way of Alldh or defend yourselves." They said: "Had we knoion that fighting will take place, we would certainly have followed you." They were that day, nearer to disbelief than to faith, saying with their mouths what was not in their hearts. And Alldh has full knowledge of what they conceal. ^ . (They are) the ones who said about their killed brethren while they themselves sat (at home) : "If only they had listened to us, they would not have been killed." Say: "Avert death from your own selves, if you speak the truth." }

The Reason and Wisdom Behind the Defeat at Uhud

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1011–1062]

Allah said, hi& iWhen a single disaster smites you}, in reference to when the Muslims suffered seventy fatalities during the battle of Uhud, 1although you smote (your enemies) with one twice as great,} during Badr, when the Muslims killed seventy Mushriks and captured seventy others,

} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Umar bin Al-Khattab said, When Uhud occurred, a year after Badr, Muslims were punished for taking ransom from the disbelievers at Badr [in return for releasing the Mushriks whom they captured in that battle]. Thus, they suffered the loss of seventy fatalities and the Companions of the Messenger of Allah gave flight and abandoned him. The Messenger suffered a broken tooth, the helmet was smashed on his head and blood flowed onto his face. Allah then revealed, Xjj ji j

316 Tafstr Ibn Kathir and decree out of His perfect wisdom, fin order that He might test the believers.} who were patient, firm and were not shaken, (&1 J? IP / ">' ikf 4 'Ar* pi 4 And that He might test the hypocrites, it was said to them "Come, fight in the way of Alldh or defend yourselves." They said: "Had we known that fighting will take place, we would certainly have followed you."} [3:167], This refers to the Companions of Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul who went back (to Al-Madlnah) with him before the battle. Some believers followed them and encouraged them to come back and fight, saying, 4or defend}, so that the number of Muslims increases, as Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak, Abu Salih, Al- Hasan and As-Suddi stated. Al-Hasan bin Salih said that this part of the Ayah means, help by supplicating for us, while others said it means, man the posts. However, they refused, saying, fci j& \$} 4" Had we known that fighting will take place, we would certainly have followed you. } meaning, according to Mujahid, if we knew that you would fight today, we would join you, but we think you will not fight. Allah said, fjuj j&=4 i They were that day, nearer to disbelief than to faith,} This Ayah indicates that a person passes through various stages, sometimes being closer to Ku.fr and sometimes closer to faith, as evident by, rri

318 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir vr sm K , \ i 'A' * - " ; > O i '^". Lk Jli 0Uh&f^oictyli-S Sii ."iDjVSJ ijA-A} ^Ji J 1 cj;J 'oj,^ L3^C5|^.^CS1 jj{pj-^j r' (^-*" - y <-"> vf j^L. ^ ^ ijiAi ^ (C* Vj jCjUe- ?i> i , rt" V <&' o'j *j> i^Uc--l C/jjl t jju J/-50 4 si # 3d iS % P\$3 [>"*" - J"G' aj J-O' tfts j &d A# j&Sifc pi5 % &LZ * r^ * <" 'Z " (V 4U1 ^j4 4.4 4.'^ ^JU iU f," . * { ' ' Sf JH-4 .4*" * > p | . " / *;j / ry' ,1 jtf'V J-*** Jj 4"1 fift)! & *ji J&S CS1 ^ a} i 3 (Uyi2 Su 4vSfes0 4269. Tfrmfc mo2 o/ those as dead who are killed in the way of Allah. Nay, they are alive, with their Lord, and they have provision. 4270. They rejoice in what Allah has bestowed upon them of His bounty and rejoice for the sake of those who have not yet joined them, but are left behind (not yet martyred) that on them no fear shall come, nor shall they grieve.} 4272. They rejoice in a grace and a bounty from Allah, and that Allah will not waste the reward of the believers.} 4172. Those who answered (the Call of) Allah and the Messenger after being wounded; for those of them who did good deeds and feared Allah, there is a great reward.}

Allah is Sufficiettt for us, and He is the Best Disposer of affairs.

320 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir give an answer, they say, 'O Lord! We wish that our souls be returned to our bodies so that we are killed in Your cause again.' Allah knew that they did not have any other wish, so they were leftj There are several other similar narrations from Anas and Abu Said. Imam

L>-U5 Jill *j\j fjj Cr? ^ la>-f &! S U Vb JI lj\ j! ilibf : Jli .ilki-f jL. : JU

Ahmad and Ibn Jarir collected this Hadith, which has a good chain of narration. It appears that the martyrs are of different types, some of them wander in Paradise, and some remain close to this river by the door of Paradise. It is also possible that the river is where all the souls of the martyrs convene and

where they are provided with their provision day and night, and Allah knows best. Imam Ahmad narrated a Hadith that contains good news for every believer that his soul will be wandering in Paradise, as well, eating from its fruits, enjoying its delights and happiness and tasting the honor that Allah has prepared in it for him. This Hadith has a unique, authentic chain of narration that includes three of the Four Imams. Imam Ahmad narrated this Hadith from Muhammad bin Idris Ash-Shafi'i who narrated it from Malik bin Anas Al-Asbuhi, from Az-Zuhri, from Abdur-Rahman bin Ka'b bin Malik that his father said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, قَالَ "The soul of the believer becomes a bird that feeds on the trees of Paradise, until Allah sends him back to his body when He resurrects. This Hadith states that the souls of the believers are in the shape of a bird in Paradise. As for the souls of martyrs, they are inside green birds, like the stars to the rest of the believing souls. We ask Allah the Most Generous that He makes us firm on the faith. Allah's statement, قَالَ "They rejoice in what Allah has bestowed upon them" indicates that the martyrs who were killed in Allah's cause are alive with Allah, delighted because of the bounty happiness they are enjoying. They are also awaiting their brethren, who will die in Allah's cause after them, for they will be meeting them soon. These martyrs do not have fear about Ahmad 1 :266 [at-Tabari 7 :387 3 :455]

the future or sorrow for what they left behind. We ask Allah to grant us Paradise. The Two Sahihs record from Anas, the story of the seventy Ansar Companions who were murdered at Bir Ma'unah in one night. In this Hadith, Anas reported that the Prophet ﷺ used to supplicate to Allah in Qunut in prayer against those who killed them. Anas said, A part of the Qur'an was revealed about them, but was later abrogated, Convey to our people that we met Allah and He was pleased with us and made us pleased. [11 Allah said next, قَالَ "They rejoice in a grace and a bounty from Allah, and that Allah will not waste the reward of the believers [3 :171]. Muhammad bin Ishaq commented, They were delighted and pleased because of Allah's promise that was fulfilled for them, and for the tremendous rewards they earned. Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, This Ayah encompasses all the believers, martyrs and otherwise. Rarely does Allah mention a bounty and a reward that He granted to the Prophets, without following that with what He has granted the believers after them. The Battle of Hamra Al-Asad Allah said, قَالَ "Those who answered (the Call of) Allah and the Messenger after being wounded [3 :172]. This occurred on the day of Hamra Al-Asad. After the idolators defeated the Muslims (at Uhud), they started on their way back home, but soon they were concerned because they did not finish off the Muslims in Al-Madlnah, so they set out to make that battle the final one. When the Messenger of Allah got news of this, he commanded the Muslims to march to meet the disbelievers, to bring fear to their hearts and to demonstrate that the Muslims still had strength to fight. The [i] Fath Al-Bari 7 :445, Muslim 1 :468.

only allowed those who were present during Uhud to accompany him, except for Jabir bin Abdullah Al-Ansari, as we will mention. The

and they followed the pleasure of Allah. And Allah is the Owner of great bounty.} Al-Bayhaqi recorded that Ibn Abbas said about Allah's statement, قَالَ "So they returned with grace and bounty from Allah,} The Grace was that they were saved. The Bounty was that a caravan passed by, and those days were [Hajj] season days. Thus the Messenger of Allah ﷺ bought and sold and made a profit, which he divided between his Companions. 111 Allah then said, قَالَ "It is only Shaytan that suggests to you the fear

of his friends,} [3:175] meaning, Shaytan threatens you with his friends and tries to pretend they are powerful and fearsome. Allah said next, 4so fear them not, but fear Me, if you are indeed believers.} meaning, If Shaytan brings these thoughts to you, then depend on Me and seek refuge with Me. Indeed, I shall suffice you and make you prevail over them. Similarly, Allah said, is not Allah Sufficient for His servant? Yet they try to frighten you with those besides Him!} [39:36], until, iSay: "Sufficient for me is Allah; in Him those who trust must put their trust. } [39:38]. Allah said, }So fight you against the friends of Shaytan; ever feeble indeed is the plot of Shaytan.} [4:76] and Data lAn-Nubuwwah 3:318.

>{ JLi\ 4-> ^T/ury are the party of Shaytdn. Verily, it is the party of Shaytdn that will be the losers!} [58:19), / , - 0 ,, f Alldh has decreed: "Verily, it is I and My Messengers who shall be the victorious." Verily, Allah is All-Powerful, All-Mighty .} [58:21] and 4t 4* i" iVerily, Allah will help those who help His (cause). [22:40] and ifji 40 you who believe! If you help (in the cause of) Allah, He will help you} [47:7], and, sS " * ' i@h t S' i'rV . \>'s gji * pi p* pp J p-* r& i p> iVerily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe, in this world's life and on the Day when the witnesses will stand forth. The Day when their excuses will be of no profit to wrongdoers. Theirs will be the curse, and theirs will be the evil abode.} [40:51,52] (*+ J-*-. j* *"" -4y_ (12 ' y&J' 4 Slj f i ^. -it ijtJJ J i^Xii 51 4-&\$ 4 Uii -s*- 1*^ d^ wv, jLjj 4>'j jj ill' O'? U >\ OSfi 4*' lij .j* " ,jn i*' y.-*" d" Si' o'? Uj i_2U' ^ t.l.x? US* ^ ^ 'Y5, .> *.Wg- j Ailla puki fJi (jb; In Ojilal- ^ j; p L*i- 4; all' ^ ^% Aj 4176. And let not those grieve you who rush with haste to

328 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir disbelieve; verily, not the least harm will they do to Allah. It is Allah's will to give them no portion in the Hereafter. For them there is a great torment. 4177. Verily, those who purchase disbelief at the price of faith, not the least harm will they do to Allah. For them, there is a painful torment. 4178. And let not the disbelievers think that Our postponing their punishment is good for them. We postpone the punishment only so that they may increase in sinfulness. And for them is a disgraceful torment. Allah will not leave the believers in the state in which you are now, until He distinguishes the wicked from the good. Nor will Allah disclose to you the secrets of the Unseen, but Allah chooses of His Messengers whom He wills. So believe in Allah and His Messengers. And if you believe and have Taqia of Allah, then for you there is a great reward.} 4180. And let not those who are stingy with that which Allah has bestowed on them of His bounty think that it is good for them. Nay, it will be worse for them; the things that they were stingy with shall be tied to their necks like a collar on the Day of Resurrection. And Allah's is the inheritance of the heavens and the earth; and Allah is Well-Acquainted with all that you do.} Comforting the Messenger of Allah afe Allah said to His Prophet, y} 4And let not those grieve you who rush with haste to disbelieve} [3:176]. Because the Prophet's was eager for people's benefit, he would become sad when the disbelievers would resort to defiance, rebellion and stubbornness. Allah said, Do not be saddened by this behavior, 4verily, not the least harm will they do to Allah. It is Allah's will to give them no portion in the Hereafter.} for He decided with His power and wisdom that they shall not

acquire any share in the Hereafter, \$j} iFor then there is a great torment .} Allah said about the disbelievers, iif ft 'j&& U& Vfr iVerily, those who purchase disbelief at the price of faith,} by exchanging disbelief for faith, 4&i 2J#> inot the least harm will they do to Allah.} Rather, they will only harm themselves, iU 4For them, there is a painful torment.} Allah said next, ^ Ci\ j - ft^ J" i iAnd

let not the disbelievers think that Our postponing their punishment is good for them. We postpone the punishment only so that they may increase in sinfulness. And for them is a disgraceful torment} [3:178]. This statement is similar to Allah's other statements, / v - ; + ' W" \ 1 // ." < { V X V J*. ^ (j 4 Do they think that because We have given them abundant wealth and children, [that] We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not.} [23:55,56] and 4- *? V O' C-jXl J J Ojj*} iThen leave Me Alone with such as belie this Qur'an. We shall punish them gradually from directions they perceive not.} [68:44], and, (*T Qjl' j rv fk & ^ %}

Tafstr Ibn Kathir iAnd let not their wealth or their children amaze you. Allah's plan is to punish them with these things in this world, and tint their souls shall depart (die) while they are disbelievers} [9:85], Allah then said, if %} 'if& a} iAllah ioill not leave the believers in the state in which you are now, until He distinguishes the wicked from the good.} [3:179], meaning, He allows a calamity to happen, and during this calamity His friend becomes known and His enemy exposed, the patient believer recognized and the sinful hypocrite revealed. This Ayah refers to Uhud, since Allah tested the believers in that battle, thus making known the faith, endurance, patience, firmness and obedience to Allah and His Messenger that the believers had. Allah exposed the hypocrites in their defiance, reverting from Jihad, and the treachery they committed against Allah and His Messenger jte. This is why Allah said, Jiii v& 74 iSt s? *} iAllah will not leave tite believers in the state in which you are now, until He distinguishes the wicked from the good.} Mujahid commented, He distinguished between them during

the day of Uhud. 111 Qatadah said, He distinguished between them in Jihad and Hijrah. | Allah said next, {J3' & Cj} 4Nor will Allah disclose to you the secrets of the Unseen.} meaning, you do not have access to Allah's knowledge of His creation so that you can distinguish between the believer and the hypocrite, except by the signs of each type that Allah uncovers. Allah's statement, ibut Allah chooses of His Messengers whom He zoills.} is similar to another Ayah, At-Tabari 7 :424 At-Tabari 7:424.

ly, JlCo J^j ' & \ ^ lS ' j* vfs' .Y " / ~ .ijujj AjJj jy. 4(He A/o/ie is) Hie All-Knower of the Unseen, and He reveals to none His Unseen. Except to a Messenger (from mankind) lohom He has chosen, and then He makes a band of watching guards (angels) to march before him and behind him.) [72:26,271- Allah then said, jj i? \ 4So believe in Allah and His Messengers.) Obey Allah and His Messenger sfe and adhere to the law that he legislated for you, jr' 'y^b 'yj ofib 4and if you believe and fear Allah, then for you there is a great reward.) The Censure of Selfishness, and Warning Against it Allah said, 4pi 3- 3 pi ! *- y Oi pi* W i-J' OS-*: 4 And let not those who are stingy zoith that which Allah has bestowed on them of His bounty (zuealth) think that it is good for them. Nay, it will be worse for them.) [3:180] Therefore, the Ayah says that the miser should not think that collecting money will benefit him. Rather, it will harm him in his religion and worldly affairs. Allah mentions the money that the miser collected on the Day of Resurrection, 4)JLili' (y_ 'jbl C ithe things that they stingy zoith shall be tied to their necks like a collar on the Day of Resurrection .)

Whoever Allah makes wealthy and he does not pay the Zakdh due on his wealth, then (on the Day of Resurrection) his wealth will be made in the likeness of a bald-headed poisonous male snake with two black spots over the eyes. The snake will encircle his neck and bite his cheeks and proclaim, 7 am your wealth, I am your treasure . "" The Prophet then recited the Ayah, ^ J4 j? fib*-* Oi ii' i And let not

those who are stingy with that which Allah has bestowed on them of His bounty think that it is good for them. Nay, it will be looser for them, until the end. J ^

^ vt SUI? ^sn jj ;g. *sJti\j#8j 4^ O J4^'ob S^Jj&jdifiSiJs "> jj < ^u^ .a?. -' c j^\ijit^Oi^JVA^
AtS .Air-so0^ Q-^J(Ir^jttllil 'fjJ j^ij 4 \$jujis=^dS^(^==^^ '4s4C^'^^ -. jo^siyijij^A-^jolj Majah, ' and
At- Tirmidhi said, Hasan Sahih. Allah's statement, iu#%&&y*> iAnd to Allah belongs the inheritance
of the heavens and the Earth}, means, iand spend of that whereof He has made you trustees} [57:7].
Therefore, since all affairs are under Allah's control, then spend from your money so it will benefit you
on the Day of Return, o4~"t iand Allah is Well-Acquainted with all that you do.} with your intentions
and what your hearts conceal. jSBj ijtf c 4J&s && 4! l\ rjii # iit yz 'A} -Jil jj L*j oil'j A ' i _ *" "4u^(l
4"- -4 ^ (3-31 J-^e. if fyu wjjjt .w'ju_il Jli) ij iiii ^jjLj c.iira 3j ji jUl' yC-H bit J*W dJJji "AAi 0^ \nT
(4AJ . ** lbn Majah 2 :568 .

Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4181. Indeed, Allah has heard the statement of those who say: Truly, Allah is poor and we are rich!" We shall record what they have said and their killing of the Prophets unjustly, and We shall say: "Taste you the torment of the burning (Fire)." } il82. This is because of that which your hands have sent before you. And certainly, Allah is never unjust to (His) servants.} } il83. Those who said: "Verily, Allah has taken our promise not to believe in any Messenger unless he brings to us an offering which the fire (from heaven) shall devour." Say: Verily, there came to you Messengers before me, with Al-Bayindt and even with what you speak of; why then did you kill them, if you are truthful?" } il84. Then if they reject you, so were Messengers rejected before you, who came with Al-Bayinat and the Scriptures and the Book of Enlightenment.} Allah Warns the Idolators SaW bin Jubayr said that Ibn Abbas said, When Allah's statement, iWho is he that will lend to Allah a goodly loan so that He may multiply it to him many times?} [2:245] was revealed, the Jews said, O Muhammad! Has your Lord become poor so that He asks His servants to give Him a loan? Allah sent down, indeed, Allah has heard the statement of those (Jews) who say "Truly, Allah is poor and we are rich!" } [3:181]. This Hadlth was collected by Ibn Marduwyah and Ibn Abi Hatim. Allah's statement, i\ fJ iWe shall record what they have said} contains a threat and a warning that Allah followed with His statement,

A i&JVf their killing of the Prophets unjustly,} This is what they say about Allah and this is how they treat His Messengers. Allah will punish them for these deeds in the worst manner, JliJ ilt o\> UIj uB i w, ' jji* iyj*i iand We shall say: "Taste you the torment of the burning (Fire)." This is because of that which your hands have sent before you. And certainly, Allah is never unjust to (His) servants. } They will be addressed like this as a way of chastising, criticism, disgrace and humiliation. Allah said, Jj-0, - " ; iThose (Jeivs) who said: "Verily, Allah has taken our promise not to believe in any Messenger unless he brings to us an offering which the fire (from heaven) shall devour." } Allah refuted their claim that in their Books, Allah took a covenant from them to only believe in the Messenger whose miracles include fire coming down from the sky that consumes the charity offered by a member of the Messenger's nation, as Ibn Abbas and Al-Hasan stated. Allah replied. J; iSay : "Verily, there came to you Messengers before me, xvith Al-Bayindt..." } with proofs and evidence, iand even with ivhat you speak of} a fire that consumes the accepted charity, as you asked,

4why then did you kill them? Why did you meet these Prophets with denial, defiance, stubbornness and even murder, iif you are truthful>, if you follow the truth and obey the Messengers?. Allah then

comforts His Prophet Muhammad ag. '< Of/ -Ui iThen if they reject you, so were Messengers rejected before you, who came with Al-Baiyyinat and the Scripture, and the Book of Enlightenment. > meaning, do not be sad because they deny you, for you have an example in the Messengers who came before you. These Messengers were rejected although they brought clear proofs, plain evidence and unequivocal signs, iand the Zubur>, the divinely revealed Books that were sent down to the Messengers, t f&ivf \$and the Book of Enlightenment^ meaning the clarification and best explanation. if qJ-j ijS iLTi uXu -4 Kf 'Ciif { jf 5tS JS && ^ rM? oi^ ^ ^ s, 143^i^r tjga 4135. Everyone shall taste death. And only on the Day of Resurrection shall you be paid your wages in full. And whoever is moved away from the Fire and admitted to Paradise, Ite indeed is successful . The life of this world is only the enjoyment ofdeception . 4 4186. You shall certainly be tried and tested in your wealth and properties and in yourselves, and you shall certainly hear much that will grieve youfrom those who received the Scripture before you (Jews and Christians) and from those who ascribe

Al 'Imran (Part-4) partners to Allah; but if you persevere patiently, and have Taqwa, then verily, that will be a determining factor in all affairs. Every Soul Shall Taste Death Allah issues a general and encompassing statement that every living soul shall taste death. In another statement, Allah said, iWhatever is on it (the earth) will perish. And the Face of your Lord full of majesty and Itonor will remain forever} [55:26,27]. Therefore, Allah Alone is the Ever-Living Who never dies, while the Jinn, mankind and angels, including those who carry Allah s Throne, shall die. The Irresistible One and Only, will alone remain for ever and ever, remaining Last, as He was the First. This Ayah comforts all creation, since every soul that exists on the earth shall die. When the term of this life comes to an end and the sons of Adam no longer have any new generations, and thus this world ends, Allah will command that the Day of Resurrection commence. Allah will then recompense the creation for their deeds, whether minor or major, many or few, big or small. Surely, Allah will not deal unjustly with anyone, even the weight of an atom, and this is why He said, iAnd only on the Day of Resurrection shall you be paid your wages in fill [3:185]. Who Shall Gain Ultimate Victory? Allah said, iAnd whoever is moved away from the Fire and admitted to Paradise, he indeed is successful.} meaning, whoever is kept away from the Fire, saved from it and entered into Paradise, will have achieved the ultimate success.

Al 'Imran (Part-4) insignificant as when one ofyou dips his finger in the sea; let him contemplate what hisfinger will come back with .n Qatadah commented on Allah s statement, yi 'Gif Jf j} iThe life of this world is only the enjoyment ofdeception.} Life is a delight. By Allah, other than Whom there is no deity, it will soon fade away from its people. Therefore, take obedience to Allah from this delight, ifyou can. Verily, there is no power except from Allah. The Believer is Tested and Hears Grieving Statements from the Enemy Allah said, 4You shall certainly be tried and tested in your wealth and properties and in yourselves}, just as He said in another Ayah, JyVi y^ Jp ^ }& &} 4And certainly, I've shall test you with something of fear, hunger, loss ofwealth, lives andfruits} [2:155]. Therefore, the believer shall be tested, in his wealth, himself, his offspring and family. The believer shall be tested according to the degree of his faith, and when his faith is stronger, the test is larger. /< Jt A>' S-ip Ir, (fP^&j} iand you shall certainly hear much that will grieve you from those who received the Scripture before you (Jews and Christians) and from those who ascribe partners to Allah} [3:186]. Allah said to the believers upon

their arrival at Al-Madinah, before Badr, while comforting them against the harm they *** Muslim no. 2858, At-Tirmidhi no. 2324.

Al 'Imran (Part-4) Messenger of Allah ﷺ and his Companions used to forgive the Mushriks and the People of the Scriptures, just as Allah commanded them, and they used to tolerate the harm that they suffered. Allah said. *And you shall certainly hear much that will grieve you from those who received the Scripture before you (Jews and Christians) and from those who ascribe partners to Allah;* [3:186J, and,) 'J iMany of the People of the Scripture (Jews and Otristians) wish that they could turn you away as disbelievers after you have believed, out ofenvyfrom their own selves, even after the truth has become manifest unto them. Butforgive and overlook, till Allah brings His command) [2:109]. The Prophet used to implement the pardon that Allah commanded him until He gave His command (to fight the disbelievers). When the Messenger ﷺ fought at Badr, and Allah killed, by his hand, the leaders of the disbelievers from Quraysh, Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul and the Mushriks and idol worshippers who were with him said, This matter has prevailed, and they gave their pledge to the Prophet ﷺ and became Muslims. Therefore, every person who stands for truth, enjoins righteousness and forbids evil, will be harmed in some manner. In such cases, there is no cure better than being patient in Allah s cause, trusting in Him and returning to Him. 'jj o;Ull iiiii 3^ ji o' 0 Ofji C/j' CtJ "iUS l_4c .a, 4*I> * ' - itt' *kj V A, >-jJ j""+)j 'yi jjl U } y L iifj I 1 * Al-Bukhari no. 4566, Muslim no. 1798.

4187. (And remember) when Allah took a cove- nant from those who were given the Scripture (Jeios and Christians) to make it (the truth) known and clear to mankind, and not to hide it, but they threio it away behind their backs, and purchased with it some miserable gain! And indeed ivorst is that which they bought. 4188. Think not that those who rejoice in what they have done (or brought about), and love to be praised for what they have not done, think not that they are rescued from the tor- ment, and for them is a painful torment. And to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, and Allah has pmver over all things. Chastisingthe People of the Scriptures forBreakingthe Covenant and Hiding the Truth In this Ayah, Allah chastises the People of the Scriptures, from whom Allah took the covenant by the words of their Prophets, that they would believe in Muhammad ﷺ and describe him to the people, so that they would recognize and follow him when Allah sent him. However, they hid this truth and preferred the the small amounts and the material gains instead of the rewards of this life and the Hereafter that they were promised. This is a losing deal and a failing trade, indeed. These Aydt also contain a warning for the scholars not to 1; mm J5 ijfo-i Jgj /j ii 4 jfH'j ^j '.is &i. ' y' > 'i ?'

Al 'Imran (Part-4) imitate their behavior, so that they do not suffer the same fate and become like them. Therefore, the scholars are required to spread the beneficial knowledge that they have, encouraging the various righteous good deeds. They are also warned against hiding any part of their knowledge. A Hadlth states that the Prophet * said, "Whoever was asked about knowledge that he knew but did not disclose it, will be tied with a bridle made of fire on the Day of ResurrectionV 11 ChastisingThoseWho Love to be Praised forWhatThey Have not Done Allah s statement, iThink not that those who rejoice in what they have done, and love to be praisedfor what they have not done}, refers to those who show off, rejoice in what they do and claim to do what they have not done. The Two Sahihs recorded that

nils VI 4ll eJjj t j&Oi. iiiiS ^Whoever issues a false claim to acquire some type of gain, then Allah will only grant him decrease . ,2) The Sahih. also recorded; jji Z/.y l -k*i pJ U-1 He who claims to do what he has not done, is just like a person who wears too robes made of falsehood , "131 Imam

344 Tafoir Ibn Kathir tormented. Ibn Abbas said, This Ayah was revealed about the People of the Scriptures. He then recited the Ayah, oixSi iyiSo "Jj illij iyjl S.-l' J^-r* ^ }(And remember) when Allah took a covenant from those who were given the Scripture (Jews and Christians) to make it (the truth) known and clear to mankind, and not to hide it, but they threw it away behind their backs, and purchased with it some miserable gain! And indeed worst is that which they bought.} then the Ayah, j3 . 1 c-Sis : iThink not that those who rejoice in what they have done, and love to be praised for what they have not done Ibn Abbas said, The Prophet jgg asked them about something, and they hid its knowledge, giving him an incorrect answer. They parted after showing off and rejoicing in front of him because they answered him, so they pretended, and they were delighted that they hid the correct news about what he had asked them. 111 This was recorded by

Al 'Imran (Part-4) iThink not that those who rejoice in what they have done, and love to be praised for what they have not done}, to the end of the Ayah. And

created this without purpose, glory to You! Give us salvation from the torment of the Fire.} 1192 . "Our Lord! Verily, whom You admit to the Fire, indeed. You have disgraced him; and never will the wrongdoers find any helpers.} 1193. "Our Lord! Verily, we have heard the call of one calling to faith: 'Believe in your Lord,' and we have believed. Our Lord! Forgive us our sins and expiate from us our evil deeds, and make us die along with Al-Abrar (the most righteous).} 4194. "Our Lord! Grant us what You promised us through Your Messengers and disgrace us not on the Day of Resurrection, for You never break (Your) Promise."} The Proofs of Tawhld for People of Understanding, their Characteristics, Speech, and Supplications Allah said, i o-yCUi 4 S\} 4Verily, in the creation of the heavens and the Earth,} [3:190], referring to the sky in its height and spaciousness, the earth in its expanse and density, the tremendous features they have of rotating planets, seas, mountains, deserts, trees, plants, fruits, animals, metals and various beneficial colors, scents, tastes and elements. 4And in the alternation of night and day}, as one follows and takes from the length of the other. For instance, at times one of them becomes longer than the other, shorter than the other at times and equal to the other at other times, and the same is repeated again and again, and all this occurs by the decision of the Almighty, Most Wise. This is why Allah said, dji y\$} 4there are indeed signs for men of understanding}, referring to the intelligent and sound minds that contemplate about the true reality of things, unlike the deaf and mute who

Al 'Imran (Part-4) do not have sound comprehension. Allah said about the latter type, * y > *: ">' *' <' y An' * ii -v * - Ay - 1 Jtji L*j Lyle- ufJJ'J J oi u^=yf ("

348 TafsTr Ibn Kathir not in Allah except that they attribute partners unto Him} [12:105,106], Allah also praises iThose who remember Allah standing, sitting, and lying down on their sides, and think deeply about the creation of the heavens and the earth}, supplicating; i- U Gj} 4"Our Lord! You have not created this without purpose,"} You did not create all this in jest and play. Rather, You created it in truth, so that You recompense those who do evil in kind, and reward those who do righteous deeds with

what is better. The faithful believers praise Allah and deny that He does anything in jest and without purpose, saying, 4& Cf*} A "S^ory to You,"}, for You would never create anything without purpose, 4j& jS'ji \ } 4"Give us salvation from the torment of the Fire."}, meaning, O You Who created the creation in truth and justice, Who is far from any shortcomings, or doing things without purpose or with jest, save us from the torment of the Fire with Your power and strength. Direct us to perform the deeds that make You pleased with us. Guide us to righteous work from which You admit us into the delightful Paradise, and save us from Your painful torment. They next supplicate, 4ZP 'M 4 ;;} 4 Our Lord! Verily, whom You admit to the Fire, indeed. You have disgraced him;}, by humiliating and disgracing him before all people on the Day of Gathering,

4"and never will the wrongdoers find any helpers. }, on the Day of Judgment, who would save them from You. Therefore, there is no escaping whatever fate You decided for them. iLlt. <^W,} 4"Our Lord! Verily, we have heard the call of one calling to faith/% a caller who calls to faith, referring to the Messenger of Allah ^ ~//~/j. !' i'Believe in your Lord/ and we have believed}, accepted his call and followed him. 4^/y> tJ j 4"Our Lord! Forgive us our sins"}, on account of our faith and obeying Your Prophet jg 4C a -jp/} 4"Forgive us our sins"}, and cover them, 4"and expiate from us our evil deeds }, between us and You, in private, 4"and make us die along with Al-Abrdr."}, join us with the righteous people. 4ii^ u \ j} 4"Our Lord! Grant us what You promised unto us through Your Messengers } for our faith in Your Messengers, or, and this explanation is better; grant us what You promised us by the words of Your Messengers,

and disgrace us not on the Day of Resurrection,

5*^ 'jv-' Si i j \ ~ ij 4i/j"A> j ./ *- " ";*(, "i/f/ * ./#/ 7^fx' (^* J J&) ||l il^ijjlljj l&>-ppJ* jA> " "*" ** })*** "i* * ,,V^^ c/Oj-? fHp jJH " - i<&(c^l^Oj_-Ls -^: p-fc S^ *^ 'Up^ . ^p< ^^Jrt/" QJ^SSSS vi spiju V, Lord. I said, By Allah Ax' '1 ->>-" '*\ ' *t- II I love your being close to me. I also love that you worship your Lord. He used the water-skin and performed ablution, but did not use too much water. He then stood up in prayer and cried until his beard became wet. He prostrated and cried until he made the ground wet. He then laid down on his side and cried. When Bilal came to alert the Prophet M, for the Dawn prayer, he said, O Messenger of Allah! What makes you cry, while Allah has forgiven you your previous and latter sins? He ig said, haJQJI "jii ^ l^s- Jyl lij 'Cs\$ oi l_s~niL Lj !j nO Bilal! What prevents me from crying, when this night, this Ayah was revealed to me," ^p^dVt &&\$ # 4 iVerily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in the alternation of night and day, there are indeed signs for men of understanding.\$ "144 '^J JdJ "VVoe to he who recites it but does not contemplate iM. ' Mawarid Az-Zaman no . 139.

Jam C fLiva ^ fi- V ^ (t-#j > rn^s*: "rt Ai*> 'A^J j bfAj (r?^i o; b>>-ti 0-^-)U \$j %\ X? j#Vf oj ^ (^yij 4#i\$ 4195. So their Lord accepted of them (their supplication and answered them),"

Stlrah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) 353 4 i' J>- jH? 1 V4"Never ivill I allcno to be lost the work of any of you, be he male or female,\$ explains the type of answer Allah gave them, stating that no deed of any person is ever lost with Him. Rather, He will completely reward each person for his or her good deeds. Allah s statement, 41*S*You are (members) one of another means, you are all equal in relation to gaining My reward. Therefore, ithose who emigrated}, by leaving the land of Shirk and migrating to the land of

faith, leaving behind their loved ones, brethren, friends and neighbors, and were driven out from their homes}, when the Mushriks tormented them and forced them to migrate, and suffered harm in My cause}, for their only wrong, to the people, was that they believed in Allah Alone. In similar Ayat, Allah said, and have driven out the Messenger and yourselves because you believe in Allah your Lord!} [60:1], and, 4 J ijili)} 4 And they had no fault except that they believed in Allah, the Almighty, Worthy of all praise!} [85:8] . Allah's statement, 4 jLjj ^)} and who fought and were killed (in My cause),} [3:195]

Stirah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4 throughout the land deceive you.) 4197. A brief enjoyment; then their ultimate abode is Hell; and worst indeed is that place for rest.) 4198. But, for those who have Taqwa of their Lord, are Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise); therein are they to dwell, an entertainment from Allah; and that which is with Allah is the best for Al-Abrdr (the most righteous).}

Warning Against Being Deceived by This Life; the Rewards of the Righteous Believers Allah said, do not look at the disbelievers, who are enjoying various delights and joys. Soon, they will lose all this and be tied to their evil works, for verily, we are only giving them time, which deceives them, when all they have is, p+'j'- 3 4 A brief enjoyment; then their ultimate abode is Hell; and worst indeed is that place for rest. ^ This Ayah is similar to several other Ayat, such as, 42" \$!# aM^ s^L\\ Xi iNone disputes in the Ayat of Allah but those who disbelieve. So, let not their ability of going about here and there through the land deceive you!} [40:4], 4f'ojf&> tL jujliJ' JL+Li! % 4 Verily, those who invent a lie against Allah, will never be successful. (A brief) enjoyment in this world! and then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve.} [10:69,70], 4 We let them enjoy for a little while, then in the end We shall oblige them to (enter) a great torment.} [31:24], & & 4 So, give a respite to the disbelievers; deal gently with them for

V i r* er) 'Jj'I bj 3^* 1 ~5S3' j; ^j iit ' ' 1 (*#J JL*^ p-*j- "-t li\$! -^ lj . ii' Iji3i> i^iu'j.) ^y"*U .*^" ijjbj 4:k. And there are, certainly, among the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians), those who believe in Allah and in that which has been revealed to you, and in that which has been revealed to them, humbling themselves before Allah. They do not sell the verses of Allah for a small price, for them is a reward with their Lord. Surely, Allah is swift in account. 4 4200. O you who believe! Endure and be more patient, and Rabitii, and have Taqwd of Allah, so that you may be successful.} The Condition of Some of the People of the Scriptures and their Rewards Allah states that some of the People of the Book truly believe in Him and in what was sent down to Muhammad jg, along with believing in the previously revealed Books, and they are obedient to Him and humble themselves before Allah. 4 "M it iThey do not sell the verses of Allah for a small price [3:199], for they do not hide what they know of the glad tidings about the description of Muhammad sg, his Prophethood, and the description of his Ummah. Indeed, these are the best people among the People of the Book, whether they were Jews or Christians. Allah said in Surat Al-Qasas, jilt I#l UA. ijiii ^ ^ @o>*; -a (** ot 4itii ti C*> & } Those to whom We gave the Scripture before it, they believe in it (the Qur'an). And when it is recited to them, they say: 'We believe in it. Verily, it is the truth from our Lord. Indeed even before it we were Muslims. These will be given their reward twice over, because they are patient,} [28:52-54]. Allah said.

4-* '*^ % j*. jyli iThose to whom We gave the Book, recite it (follow it) as it should be recited (i.e. followed), they are the ones who believe therein.} [2:121], 4 -its is' &y o/ the people of Musa there is a

community who lead with truth and establish justice therewith.} [7:159], A " " " \$ iSt; 94c \$ _ til ^ SJ' * f,lp 4Nof all of them are alike ; a party of the people of the Scripture stand for the right, they recite the verses of Allah during the hours of the night, prostrating themselves in prayer.} [3:113], and, (jUiSii oj_y |V(i J-i Ot pM' iyy' "j-sy V _}' i * > " iCtir. " -i /- >" / l' 7,/ " <* > ^ ? > U_j o" iSay : Believe in it (the Qur'an) or do not believe (in it). Verily, those who were given knowledge before it, when it is recited to them, fall down on their faces in humble prostration." And they say: "Glory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise of our Lord must be fulfilled." And they fall down on their faces weeping and it increases their humility.} [17:107- 109], These qualities exist in some of the Jews, but only a few of them. For instance, less than ten Jewish rabbis embraced the Islamic faith, such as Abdullah bin Salam. Many among the Christians, on the other hand, embraced the Islamic faith. Allah said, 4U^ q IjUr. Sj# iVerily, you will find the strongest among men in enmity to the believers the Jews and those who commit Shirk, and you will find the nearest in love to the believers those who say: "We

Al 'Imran (Part-4) are Christians.: "A brother of yours from Ethiopia has passed, come to offer the funeral prayer."

recognized Islam. Allah gave them a double reward, for the faith that they had before Muhammad jg, and for believing in Muhammad sg (after he was sent as Prophet). Ibn Abi Hatim recorded both of these statements. The Two Sahihs record that Abu Musa said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, uThree persons iwill acquire a double reward. He mentioned among them, Ir J S' * V*^* J*" S? A person from among the People of the Book who believed in his Prophet and in me . Allah s statement, fSLS i 3M y} iThey do not sell the verses of Allah for a small price}, means, they do not hide the knowledge that they have, as the cursed ones among them have done. Rather, they share the knowledge without a price, and this is why Allah said, ifor them is a reward with their Lord, surely, Allah is Swift in account.} Mujahid commented on the verse, i(Surely, Allah is) swift in account}, He is swift in reckoning, as Ibn Abi Hatim and others have recorded from him. The Command for Patience and Ribat Allah said, 40 you who believe! Endure and be more patient, and Rdbitii} [3 :200]. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, The believers are commanded to be hi Fath Al-Bari 6 : 169 , Muslim 1 : 134

patient in the religion that Allah chose for them, Islam. They are not allowed to abandon it in times of comfort or hardship, ease or calamity, until they die as Muslims. They are also commanded to endure against their enemies, those who hid the truth about their religion. 1,1 Similar explanation given by several other scholars among the Salaf. As for Murabatah, it is to endure in acts of worship and perseverance. It also means to await prayer after prayer, as Ibn Abbas, Sahl bin Hanlf and Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi stated. Ibn Abi Hatim collected a Hadith that was also collected by Muslim and An-Nasal from Abu Hurayrah that

-Xaj i%Ui\ t UUaixJi 4j l Lw t Lk ilCfa jilii: "Should I tell you about actions with which Allah forgives sins and raises the grade? Performing perfect ablution in unfavorable conditions, the many steps one takes to the Masjid, and awaiting prayer after the prayer, for this is the Ribat, this is the Ribat, this is the Ribaf."

^ JIS jjj jls uj iat*J. jj ^Li up ii3 OijJ jj jitlll J| 14 ,ji I Let the servant of the Dinar, the servant of the Dirham and the servant of the Khamisah (of clothes) perish, as he is pleased if these things are given to

him, and if not, he is displeased. Let such a person perish and be humiliated, and if he is pierced with a thorn, let him not find anyone to take it out for him. Paradise is for him who holds the reins of his horse, striving in Allah's cause, with his hair unkempt and feet covered with dust : if he is appointed to the vanguard, he is perfectly satisfied with his post of guarding, and if he is appointed in the rearguard, he accepts his post with satisfaction; if he asks for permission he is not permitted, and if he intercedes, his intercession is not acceptedV Ibn Jarir recorded that Zayd bin Aslam said, Abu TJBaydah wrote to Umar bin Al-Khattab and mentioned to him that the Romans were mobilizing their forces. Umar wrote back, Allah will soon turn whatever hardship a believing servant suffers, to ease, and no hardship shall ever overcome two types of ease. Allah says in His Book, 40 you who believe! Endure and be more patient, and Rdbitii, and have Taqwa of Allah, so that you may be successful^ (3:200). Al-Hafiz Ibn Asakir mentioned in the biography of Abdullah bin Al-Mubarak, that Muhammad bin Ibrahim bin Abi Saklnah said, While in the area of Tarsus, Abdullah bin Al- Mubarak dictated this poem to me when I was greeting him goodbye. He sent the poem with me to Al-Fudayl bin Iyfid in the year one hundred and seventy, O he who worships in the vicinity of the Two Holy .Masjids ! If you but see us, you will realize that you are only jesting in worship. He who brings wetness to his cheek with his tears, should know that our necks are being wet by our blood. He who tires his horses 111 Al-Bukh&ri no. 2886.Tabari 7 : 503.

without purpose, know that our horses are getting tired in battle. Scent of perfume is yours, while our scent is the glimmer of spears and the stench of dust [in battle]. We were narrated about in the speech of our Prophet, an authentic statement that never lies. That the dust that erupts by Allah s horses and which fills the nostrils of a man shall never be combined with the smoke of a raging Fire. This, the Book of Allah speaks among us that the martyr is not dead, and the truth in Allah s Book cannot be denied. I met Al-Fudayl Ibn lyad in the Sacred Masjid and gave him the letter. When he read it, his eyes became tearful and he said, Abu Abdur- Rahman (Abdullah bin Al-Mubarak) has said the truth and offered sincere advice to me. He then asked me, Do you write the Hadith? I said, Yes. He said, Write this Hadith as reward for delivering the letter of Abu Abdur-Rahman to me. He then dictated, Mansur bin Al-Mutamir narrated to us that Abu Salih narrated from Abu Hurayrah that a man asked, O Messenger of Allah! Teach me a good deed that will earn me the reward of the Mujahidin in Allah s cause. The Prophet jg said, you able to pray continuously and fast without breaking thefast? The man said, O Messenger of Allah! I cannot bear it. The Prophet jg said, ^ j' J 1 ' U "ilJi osjt j l_rr ijijlji By Me in Whose Hand is my soul! Even if you were able to do it, you will not achieve the grade of the Mujahidin in Allah s cause. Did you not know that the horse of the Mujahid earns rewardsfor him as long as it lives. Allah said next, iand have Taqzoo of Allah}, concerning all your affairs and m Ahmad 5 :236

situations. For instance, the Prophet jfe said to Mu'adh when he sent him to Yemen, jLL jJUj 01=01 02JI cdlS U*> Sil Jh aHave Taqzvd of Allah wherever you may be, follcno the evil deed ivitli a good deed and it ivill erase it, and deal with people in a good manner .n11 Allah said next, 4so that you may be successful.}, in this life and the Hereafter. Ibn Jarir recorded that Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi said that, Allah s statement, 'if <\$and have Taqwa of Allah, so that you may be successful. means, Fear Me concerning what is between you and Me, so that you may acquire success when you meet Me tomorrow. 121

The Tafsir of Surah Al Imran ends here, all praise is due to Allah, and we ask Him that we die while on the path of the Qur'an and Sunnah, Amin. Al-Ahwadhi 6 : 123 Jabari 7:510.

Surah 4: An-Nisa (Part 1 of 2)

PDF pages 1063–1396

The Tafsir of Surat An-Nisa

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1063–1068]

(Chapter 4) Virtues of Surat An-Nisa A Madinan Surah Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said that Surat An-Nisa was revealed in Al-Madlnah. Ibn Marduwyah recorded similar statements from Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr and Zayd bin Thabit. In his Mustadrak,

The Command to have Taqwa, a Reminder about Creation, and Being Kind to Relatives Allah commands His creatures to have Tciqwa of Him by worshipping Him Alone without partners. He also reminds to them of His ability, in that He created them all from a single person, Adam, peace be unto him. iAnd from him He created his wife) Hawwa (Eve), who was created from Adam s left rib, from his back while he was sleeping. When Adam woke up and saw Hawwa , he liked her

and had affection for her, and she felt the same toward him. An authentic Hadith states, O-J&S 1 ^ ijlj i C~4i>- sLlJl jU gyi t\$jj ^ <*Woman was created from a rib. Verily, the most curved portion of the rib is its upper part, so, if you should try to straighten it, you will break it, but if you leave it as it is, it will remain crooked .n * Allah s statement, i'3X iAnd from them both He created many men and women;} means, Allah created from Adam and Hawwa many men and women and distributed them throughout the world in various shapes, characteristics, colors and languages. In the end, their gathering and return will be to Allah. Allah then said, ijc&j 4' & iAnd have Taqwa of Allah through Whom you demand your mutual (rights) and revere the wombs}, protect yourself from Allah by your acts of obedience to Him. Allah s statement, ithrough Whom you demand your mutual (rights)}, is in reference to when some people say, I ask you by Allah, and then by the relation of the Rahim (the womb, i.e. my relationship to you) , according to Ibrahim, Mujahid and Al- Hasan. Ad-Dahhak said; Fear Allah Whom you invoke when you conduct transactions and contracts. 131 And revere the womb by not cutting the relations of the womb, but keep and honor them, as Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabl , and others have stated. 111 Path Al-Bari 6 :4Tabari 7:519.Tabari 7:518.Tabari 7:521,522.

370 Tafoir Ibn Kathir Allah s statement, iSurely, Allah is always watching over you. means, He watches all your deeds and sees your every circumstance. In smother Ayah, Allah said; 4-^&\$& iAnd Allah is Witness over all things.} [58:6]. An authentic Hadith states, 2lt JupU "Worship Allah as if you see Him, for even though you cannot see Him, He sees you. This part of the Ayah encourages having a sense of certainty that Allah is always watching, in a complete and perfect manner. Allah mentioned that He has created mankind from a single father and a single mother, so that they feel compassion for each other and are kind to the weaker among them. In his SahSh,

ijM j 'is. p- yt iri ji jj-*' 1 "A man gave Sadaqah from his Dinar, from his Dirham, from his Sd of wheat, from his Sd' of dateso until the end of the Hadith. This narration was also collected by Ahmad

and the Sunan compilers from Ibn Mas'ud.¹²¹ *Sf %^ di && -2; Vi \$ # c &s 4^\$\$\$*&04 % rjti ifo j-fe# c \$ Is# 4:|5 fei a 15^^ a 42 .* And give unto orphans their property and do not exchange (your) bad things for (their) good ones; and devour not their substance (by adding it) to your substance. Surely, this is a great sin.} . And if you fear that you shall not be able to deal justly with the orphan girls, then marry (other) women of your choice, two or three, or four; but if you fear that you shall not be able to deal justly (with them), then only one or (the captives and the servants) that your right hands possess. That is nearer to prevent you from Ta'ulu.} 44. And give to the women (whom you marry) their Saduqat (or dowry) Nihlah (with a good heart), but if they, of their own good pleasure, remit any part of it to you, take it, and enjoy it without fear of any harm.} Protecting the Property of the Orphans Allah commands that the property of the orphans be surrendered to them in full when they reach the age of adolescence, and He forbids using or confiscating any part of it. So He said; 141 %} 2:705. 4 :358, An-Nasal 5 :75 Ibn MSjah 1 :74.

and do not exchange (your) bad things for (their) good ones;} Said bin Al-Musayyib and Az-Zuhri commented, Do not substitute a weak animal of yours for a fat animal (of the orphans). * Ibrahim An-Nakhal and Ad-Dahhak commented, Do not give something of bad quality for something of good quality. 121 As-Suddi said, One of them (caretakers of orphans) would take a fat sheep from the orphan's property and put in its place, a weak sheep of his, saying, A sheep for a sheep. He would also take a good Dirham and exchange it for a fake Dirham, saying, A Dirham for a Dirham. [3' Allah's statement, iW' & iand devour not their substance to your substance.} means, do not mix them together so that you eat up both, as Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Muqatil bin Hayyan, As-Suddi and Sufyan bin Hassin stated. Allah said, X ft} iSurely, this is a great sin.}, a major and substantial sin, according to Ibn 'Abbas. This was also reported from Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Ibn Sirin, Qatadah, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ad-Dahhak, Abu Malik, Zayd bin Aslam and Abu Sinan. The meaning above is: adding their property to your property is a grave sin and a major mistake, so avoid it.

The Prohibition of Marrying Female Orphans Without

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1068–1073]

Giving a Dowry Allah said, \$Zpi&t 4^ ii>} ,l * At-Jabari 7:525. At-Jabari 7:525. At-Jabari 7:526. At-Jabari 7:528. At-Tabari 7:530. Jabari 7:530.

4And if you fear that you shall not be able to deal justly with the orphan girls, then marry (other) women of your choice, two} Allah commands, when one of you is the caretaker of a female orphan and he fears that he might not give her a dowry that is suitable for women of her status, he should marry other women, who are plenty as Allah has not restricted him. Al-Bukhan recorded that A'ishah said, A man was taking care of a female orphan and he married her, although he did not desire to marry her. That girl's money was mixed with his, and he was keeping her portion from her. Afterwards, this Ayah was revealed about his case; if you fear that you shall not be able to deal justly} 11 '

374 Tahir Ibn Kathir iyet whom you desire to marry^ [4:127) refers to the guardian who does not desire to marry an orphan girl under his supervision because she is neither wealthy nor beautiful. The guardians were forbidden to marry their orphan girls possessing property and beauty without being just

to them, as they generally refrain from marrying them (when they are neither beautiful nor wealthy).
 111 The Permission to Marry Four Women Allah's statement, {two or three, or four}, means, marry as many women as you like, other than the orphan girls, two, three or four. We should mention that Allah's statement in (mother Ayah, {Who made the angels messengers with wings, - two or three or four} [35:1], does not mean that other angels do not have more than four wings, as there are proofs that some angels do have more wings. Yet, men are prohibited from marrying more than four wives, as the Ayah decrees, since the Ayah specifies what men are allowed of wives, as Ibn Abbas and the majority of scholars stated. If it were allowed for them to have more than four wives, the Ayah would have mentioned it. Imam

grave of Abu Righal (from ThamQd, who was saved from their fate because he was in the Sacred Area. But, when he left it, he was tormented like they were). Ash-Shafil, At-Tirmidhi, Ibn Majah, Ad-Daraqutni and Al-Bayhaqi collected this Hadith up to the Prophet's statement, Choose any four of them. Only Ahmad collected the full version of this Hadith. Therefore, had it been allowed for men to marry more than four women at the same time, the Prophet (ﷺ) would have allowed Ghllan to keep more than four of his wives since they all embraced Islam with him. When the Prophet (ﷺ) commanded him to keep just four of them and divorce the rest, this indicated that men are not allowed to keep more than four wives at a time under any circumstances. If this is the case concerning those who already had more than four wives upon embracing Islam, then this ruling applies even more so to marrying more than four. Marrying Only One Wife When One Fears He Might not Do Justice to His Wives Allah's statement, {But if you fear that you will not be able to deal justly (with them), then only one or what your right hands possess.} The Ayah commands, if you fear that you will not be able to do justice between your wives by marrying more than one, then marry only one wife, or satisfy yourself with only female captives, for it is not obligatory to treat them equally, rather it is recommended. So if one does so, that is good, and if not, there is no harm on him. In another Ayah, Allah said, {You will never be able to do perfect justice between wives even if it is your ardent desire} [4:129]. Allah said, {1 * Ahmad 2:14, Al-Umm 5:49, At-Tirmidhi no.1128, Ibn Majah no.1953, Ad-Daraqutni 3 :271 Al-Bayhaqi 7 :182.

{That is nearer to prevent you from Ta'iilu}, meaning, from doing injustice. Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Marduwyah and Abu Hatim Ibn Hibban, in his Sahih, recorded that A'ishah said that, the Prophet said that the Ayah, {Lyu Vi yjl} {That is nearer to prevent you from Ta'iilu}, means, from doing injustice.' ' However, Ibn Abi Hatim said that his father said that this Hadith to the Prophet (ﷺ) is a mistake, for it should be attributed to A'ishah not the Prophet (ﷺ). Ibn Abi Hatim reported from Ibn Abbas, A'ishah, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Abu Malik, Abu Razin, An-Nakhal, Ash-Sha'bi, Ad-Dahhak, Ata Al-Khurasani, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan that Ta'ulu means to deviate [from justice].² ' Giving the Dowry is Obligatory Ali bin Abi Talhah reported Ibn Abbas saying, Nihlah, in Allah's statement, {And give to the women (whom you marry) their Saduqat Nihlah} refers to the dowry.³ Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated from Az-Zuhri that T'irwah said that A'ishah said that Nihlah means obligatory. Muqatil, Qatadah and Ibn Jurayj said, Nihlah means obligatory Ibn Jurayj added: specified. ⁴ ' Ibn Zayd said, In Arabic, Nihlah, refers to what is necessary. So Allah is commanding: Do not marry unless you give your wife something that is her right. No person after the Prophet (ﷺ) is allowed to marry a woman except with the required dowry, nor by giving false promises about the dowry [intended]. ⁵

Therefore, the man is required "" Ibn Hibban 6:134. Tabari 7:549-551. ,3' At-Tabari 7 :553 '4) At-Tabari 7 :553 [S] At-Tabari 7:553.

to pay a dowry to his wife with a good heart, just as he gives a gift with a good heart. If the wife gives him part or all of that dowry with a good heart, her husband is allowed to take it, as it is lawful for him in this case. This is why Allah said afterwards, iBut if they, of their own pleasure, remit any part of it to you, take it, and enjoy it without fear of any harm .) # i ft&& Jf *"" jsfc* ^ppc4 'd !& tSi !&; * ^ P Stam fill; 4\$^A\$& pi^ . And give not unto the unwise your wealth which Allah has made a means of support for you, but feed and clothe them therewith, and speak to them in words of kindness and justice.) 46. And test orphans until they reach the age of marriage; if then you find sound judgment in them, release their property to them, but consume it not wastefully and hastily, fearing that they should grow up. And whoever among guardians is rich, he should take no wages, but if he is poor, let him have for himself

what is just and reasonable (according to his work) . And when

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1073–1084]

you release their property to them, take a witness in their presence; and Allah is All-Sufficient in taking account.) Holding the Property of the Unwise in Escrow Allah prohibited giving the unwise the freedom to do as they wish with wealth, which Allah has made as a means of support for people. This ruling sometimes applies because of being young, as young people are incapable of making wise decisions. It also applies in cases of insanity, erratic behavior and having a weak intellect or religious practice. It applies in cases of bankruptcy, when the debtors ask that the property of a bankrupt person is put in escrow, when his debts cannot be paid off with his money. Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn Abbas said that Allah's statement.

Stirah 4. An-Nisd' (Part-4, 379 {And test orphans^ meaning, test their intelligence, as Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, As-Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan stated.¹¹ ' until they reach the age of marriage}, the age of puberty, according to Mujahid.² The age of puberty according to the majority of scholars comes when the child has a wet dream. In his Sunan,

csj Js- ^ ^ Ji 4* Is _ -r .f * ' 4ds tj: "The pen does not record the deeds of three persons : the child until the age of puberty, the sleeping person until waking up, and the senile until sane."

considered a sign of adulthood, and the correct opinion is that it is. The Sunnah supports this view, according to a Hadith collected by Imam

ol? J^j} iAnd whoever among guardians is rich, he should take no wages,} Hence, the guardian who is rich and does not need the orphan's money, should not take any of it as wages. &&\M & ibut if he is poor, let him have for himself what is just and reasonable.} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that A'ishah said, This Ayah, 4x& u iAnd whoever among guardians is rich, he should take no wages, but if he is poor, let him have for himself what is just and reasonable.} was revealed about the guardian of the orphan and pertains to whatever work he does for the orphan's estate. 1 11

r?ry> iri J^ orphans who become c nsentin adults, in V the presence of witnesses, so that ,s- ^ / ' . s s ^ , < , none of them denies the fact that heth fact that he 4jfrii received his money. ' Allah said next, 'niff \ .M. 4- i&i ' - iand Am is AU_ ' . M\ -Sj/io^ Sufficient in taking >.'

terCSi &4> ijiji ^ 'Jt j\ ii / ^ ^ ^ ij& iL ^ ^&1 S#-V <\$ 4 Cwi f} ijSjftj^ ij& ^ tfft iS a Sj Tref r men and a sharefor women from whatA}V Parents ond those nearest in relation, whether theproperty be small or large ~ a legal share.} tstfafZf re'^ md "phm. ond me pooronpresent at the time of division, give them from the propertyand speak to them words ofkindness andjustice.} P P ty, tn theirmZdTas thZjZdZi^fZ^wZ^Zd^efr s ' * iio. Verily, those who unjustly eat up the property oforphans,they eat up only afire into their bellies, and they will be burntin the blazing Fire!} The Necessity of Surrendering the InheritanceAccording to the Portions that Allah Ordained Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah said, The idolaters used to give adult men a share of inheritance and deprive women andchildren of it. Allah revealed; &V?J 6'j}9*f -2J iViere is a sharefor menfrom what is left by parents and those nearest in relation}. Therefore, everyone is equal in Allah's decision to inherit, even though their shares vary according to the degree of then- relationship to the deceased, whether being a relative, spouse, etc. Ibn Marduwyah reported that Jabir said, Umm Kujjah came to the Messenger of Allah jg and said to him, O Messenger of Allah! I have two daughters whose father died, and they do not own anything. So Allah revealed; u/4\$ d: !LJ^>

Tnkr Ibn Kathir 384_ iV,e,e is a share formmfrom what is left by parents and those nearest in relation.y We will mention this Hadith when explaining the two Ayat about inheritance. Allah knows best.' Allah said. re present at the time of division,> those who do not have a share in the inheritance, iand the orpinms and the poor), axe also "*" u^n^dividing the inheritance, give them a share ot the mhentance. Bukhari recorded that Ibn Abbas said that the Ayah, / < - rftr ' l!', | ' .If ' "And when fhe re/nhbes mid the orphans and t^poor are present at the time of division}, was not abrogated. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Abbas said that this Ayah still applies and should be implemented . 1 Ath-Thawn said tha Ibn Abi Najih narrated from Mujahid that implementing this Ayah, Is required from those who have anything to inherit paid from whatever portions their hearts are satisfied vnth giving away. 151 Similar explanation was reported from Ibn Mas'ud, Abu Musa, Abdur-Rahman bin Abi Bakr, Abu Al- Aliyah, Ash-Shabi and Ai-Hasan . Ibn Sinn. Said bin Jubayr, Makhul, Ibrahim An-Nakhal. Ata bin Abi Rabah, Az- Zuhri and Yahya bin Ya'mar said this payment is obligatoiy. Others say that this refers to the bequeathal at the time of death. And others say that it was abrogated. Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said that this Ayah, ^ <>& 111 Abu Dawud 3 :314 . > Path Al-Bari 8 :90Tabari 8 :8.Tabari 8 :8Tabari 8:8. 6| Narrations about the cause of this Ayah s revelation are not authentic

iAnd when are present at the time ofdivision}, refers to divisions of inheritance. So, when poor relatives, who are ineligible for inheritance, orphans, and the poor attend the division of the inheritance, which is sometimes substantial, their hearts will feel eager to have a share, seeing each eligible person assuming his share; while they are desperate, yet are not given anything. Allah the Most Kind, Most Compassionate, commands that they should have a share in the inheritance as an act of kindness, charity, compassion and mercy for them. Observing Fairness in the Will Allah said, }And let those have the same fear in their minds as they would havefor their own, if they had left behind. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said that this part of the Ayah, Refers to a man who is near death and he dictates

a will and testament that harms some of the rightful inheritors. Allah commands whoever hears such will to fear Allah, and direct the dying man to do what is right and to be fair, being as eager to protect the inheritors of the dying man as he would be with his own. * Similar was reported from Mujahid and several others. The Two Sahihs record that when the Messenger of Allah visited Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas during an illness he suffered from, Sa'd said to the Messenger, O Messenger of Allah! I am wealthy and have no inheritors except a daughter. Should I give two-thirds of my property in charity? He said, No. Sa'd asked, Half? He said, No. Sa'd said, One-third? The Prophet ﷺ said; * ' > * > fl "One-third, and even one-third is too much. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ then said, iJlp ji ekij'j jji jl * * At-Tabari8:19. ' At-Jabari 8:21.

387Siirah 4. An-Nisa (art-4) The people asked, O Allah s Messenger! What are they? He said, J Vj "il fiy>- iJl i4iL d^JjU J I ^ijSj ^Jlj , -'l l Jti To join others in worship along with Allah, magic, to kill the life which Allah has forbidden except for a just cause, to consume interest, to consume an orphan's property, to turn your back to the enemy and flee from the battlefield at the time of fighting, and to accuse chaste women who never even think of anything harmful to their chastity being good believers , "m & '\$4 S&fo & Sk '4 4, Jy tl* ij oils' jji If; U M " 4 3? oU &Sif \$!5j i jz J 4 '% \$ \$ & 4>' 'j j tjr -f". j; Lr-iil' . UJ* J(7 jif tlii 412 - A//o/j commands you for your children's (inheritance) : to the male, a portion equal to that of two - females; if only daughters, two or more, their share is two thirds of the inheritance; if only one, her share is half. For parents, a sixth share of inheritance to each if the deceased left children; if no children, and the parents are the (only) heirs, the mother has a third; if the deceased left brothers or (sisters), the mother has a sixth. (The distribution in all cases is) after the payment of legacies he may have bequeathed or debts. You know not which of them, whether your parents or your children, are nearest to you in benefit, (these fixed shares) are ordained by Allah. And Allah is Ever All-Knower, All-Wise. Learning the Various Shares of the Inheritance is Encouraged This, the following, and the last honorable Ayah in this Surah contain the knowledge of Al-Fara'id, inheritance. The knowledge of Al-Fara'id is derived from these three Ayat and Fath Al-Bari 5 :462 , Muslim 1 :92.

388 Tafair Ibn Kathir from the Hadlths on this subject which explain them. Learning this knowledge is encouraged, especially the specific things mentioned in the Ayat. Ibn Uyaynah said; Knowledge of Al-Fara'id was called half of knowledge, because it effects all people.

Warning Against Transgressing the Limits for

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1093–1120]

Inheritance Meaning, the Fara'id are Allah s set limits. This includes

what Allah has allotted for the heirs, according to the degree of relation they have to the deceased, and their degree of dependency on him. Therefore, do not transgress or violate them. So Allah said; ai' jjai And whosoever obeys Allah and His Messenger,

regarding the inheritance, and does not add or decrease any of these fixed shares by use of tricks and plots. Rather, he gives each his appointed share as Allah commanded, ordained and decided, ' Abu Dawud no. 2870, At-Tirmidhi no. 2121, 2122, An-Nasal no. 3673, Ibn Majah nos. 2712 and 2713.

&y3 Wfe J4i'Sb oj iUJ4> l i i / , < < * * J ^ > > 's'?" > \ > " si *' - V-4^ * -ver-Ji All l_ ^uo ^ , ' 4: | 4-^ ft iWill be admitted to Cardens under which rivers jlmo (in Paradise), to abide therein, and is the great success. And whosoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger, and transgresses His (set) limits. He will cast him into the Fire, to abide therein and he shall have a disgraceful torment This is because he changed what Allah has ordained and disputed with His judgment. Indeed, this is the behavior of those who do not agree with what Allah has decided and divided, and this is why Allah punishes them with humiliation in the eternal, painful torment. Imam

ijjLpi p ^~ =U; o, ^T A ^ tL-T-jP' o\ =S 4JllijU^ IjftU t: " ^i 1^ -JbjcJ in his Sunan that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah j said, i\ jj\ j\ - jud Jjijll Sli i 4"

U'y o^ = o) ' 't-c- -^u)j . And those of your women who commit illegal sexual intercourse, take the evidence offour witnessesfrom among you against them ; and if they testify, confine them (i.e. women) to houses until death comes to them or Allah ordains for them some (other) way.)- . And the two persons among you who commit illegal sexual intercourse, punish than both. And if they repent and do righteous good deeds, leave them alone. Surely, Allah is Ever the One Who accepts repentance, (and He is) Most Merciful The Adulteress is Confined in her House; A Command LaterAbrogated At the begining of Islam, the ruling was that if a woman commits adulteiy as stipulated by sufficient proof, she was confined to her home, without leave, until she died. Allah said, &* " 4 i/v4 iAnd those of your women who commit illegal sexual intercourse, take the evidence offour witnessesfrom among you against them; and if they testify, confine them (i.e. women) to houses until death comes to them or Allah ordains for them some (other) way.) Some other way mentioned here is the abrogation of this ruling that came later. Ibn Abbas said, The early ruling was confinement, until Allah sent down Surat An-Nur (chapter 24) which abrogated that ruling with the ruling of flogging (for fornication) or stoning to death (for adultery). Similar was reported from Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Ata Al-Khurasani, Abu Salih, Qatadah, Zayd bin Aslam and Ad- Dahhak, and this is a matter that is agreed upon. Imam

One day, Allah sent down a revelation to him, and when the Messenger jg was relieved of its strain, he said, -d>- i -.J 1 i , . . . JL . -Jl ^ ^JJo- ^ jJI>. list oTafee/row me: Allah has made some other way for them. The married with the married, the unmarried with the unmarried. The married gets a hundred lashes and stoning to death, while the unmarried gets a hundred lashes then banishment for a year, n

they to whom Allah will forgive and Allah is Ever AU-Knower, All-Wise. 418. And ofno effect is the repentance of those who continue to do evil deeds until death faces one of them and he says : "Now I repent;" nor of those who die while they are disbelievers. For them, We have prepared a painful torment. Repentance isAccepted Until one Faces death Allah states that He accepts repentance of the servant who commits an error in ignorance and then repents, even just before he sees the angel who captures the soul, before his soul reaches his throat. Mujahid and others said, Every person who disobeys Allah by mistake, or intentionally is ignorant, until he refrains from the sin. [1 ' Qatadah said that Abu Al- Aliyah narrated that the Companions of the Messenger of Allah used to say, Every sin that the servant commits, he commits out of ignorance. 121 Abdur-Razzaq narrated that, Ma'mar said that Qatadah said that, the Companions of the Messenger of Allah ^ agreed that every sin that is committed by intention or otherwise, is committed in ignorance. 131 Ibn Jurayj said, Abdullah bin Kathir narrated

to me that Mujahid said, Every person who disobeys Allah (even willfully), is ignorant while committing the act of disobedience. Ibn Jurayj said, Ata bin Abi Rabah told me something similar. Abu Salih said that Ibn Abbas commented, It is because of one's ignorance that he commits the error. (S) Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said about the Ayah, and repent soon (afterwards)^, Until just before he (or she) looks at the angel of death. [e] Ad-Dahhak said, Every thing before death is soon [afterwards]. [7] Al-Hasan Al-Basri said about the Ayah, Tabari 8 :89 At-Tabari 8:89. Abdur-Razzaq 1 : 151 > At-Tabari 8:90. Tabari 8:90. At-Tabari 8:94. At-Tabari 8:94.

and repent soon afterwards Just before his last breath leaves his throat. 11 Ikrimah said, All of this life is soon [afterwards]. 121 Imam

So when they saw Our punishment, they said: "We believe in Allah Alone..." (40:84) Allah decided that repentance shall not be accepted from the people of the earth when the sun rises from the west, as Allah said, { V fj. } ili j^ (12 4?) * jl ,53 4T7ie day that some of the signs of your Lord do come, no good will it do to a person to believe then, if he believed not before, nor earned good through his faith.} [6:158]. Allah said, &&& sj %} inor of those who die while they are disbelievers Consequently, when the disbeliever dies while still a disbeliever and polytheist, his sorrow and repentance shall not avail him. If he were to ransom himself, even with the earth's fill of gold, it will not be accepted from him. Ibn Abbas, Abu Al- Aliyah and Ar-Rabi bin Anas said that the Ayah: inor of those who die while they are disbelievers}, was revealed about the people of Shirk. Imam

406 Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr f*JU aJLxJ yS*-i aJ Xt*y ^JLSj Uj iAllah accepts the repentance of His servant, or forgives His servant, as long as the veil does not dropj They asked, And what does the drop of the veil mean? He said, tiSjjJ J&j ^JiJl ji" oWhen the soul is removed zohile one is a polythiestV 11 Allah then said, i\J iijcil & \$} 4For them We have prepared a painful torment}, torment that is severe, eternal and enormous. : t&z % l-fo \yj JPu f \pc t#s> i' a. ,y. '> , %, T' j' 1s~* j >"i o' jV-V* u gjj gjj J ' paj Cji- W2 fr.;^ iiiiij iJ ^ ii* ijllfe *S tuij ^r j ^ ^ ^ ^ */< _ - / I I "/ >> S tx y n IUJA oj?*(J ,Aij-AA-'J liiaj j.f.ya j\^=> 1-jJ^ oi U /< ^V< n^O L. 'V 4x'5u i 419. O yoM u"/io believe! You are not permitted to inherit women against their will, nor to prevent them from marriage in order to get part of (the dowry) what you have given them, unless they commit open Fdhishah. And live with them honorably. If you dislike them, it may be that you dislike a thing and Allah brings through it a great deal of good.} 420. But if you intend to replace a wife by another and you have given one of them a Qintar, take not the least bit of it back; would you take it wrongfully without a right and (with) a manifest sin?} 421 . And how could you take it (back) while you have gone in unto each other, and they have taken from you a firm and 5:174.

strong covenant?} 422. And marry not women whom your fathers married, except if what has already passed; indeed it is as shameful and Maqtan, and an evil ifay Meaning of Inheriting Women Against Their Will

Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Muhammad bin Sirin, Said bin Jubayr, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ata Al-Khurasani, Ad-Dahhak, Abu Qilabah, Abu Salih, As-Suddi, Zayd bin Aslam and Said bin Abi Hilal said that this refers to illicit sex. Meaning that if the wife commits adultery, you are allowed to take back the dowry you gave her. You are also allowed to annoy her, until she gives back the dowry in return for a Khula ." (1 *

In Surat Al- Baqarah, Allah said, *وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ لَا يَمَسُّهُمُ أَلٌ وَلَا حُزْنٌ وَلَا يَكُن لَهُم مَالٌ وَلَا بَنُونَ وَلَهُمْ أَزْوَاجٌ مُطَهَّرَاتٌ وَيَرْضَيْنَهُمْ بِمَا أُعْطُوا وَلَا يَكُن لَهُمْ مَخَافَةٌ أَلًا وَلَا حُزْنًا وَلَا يَكُن لَهُم مَالٌ وَلَا بَنُونَ* [2:229]. Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah and Ad-Dahhak said that Fahishah refers to disobedience and defiance. ' Ibn Jarir chose the view that it is general, encompasses all these meanings, adultery, disobedience, defiance, rudeness, and so forth. Meaning that he is allowed to annoy his wife when she does any of these acts until she forfeits all or part of her rights and he then separates from her, and this [view] is good, and Allah knows best. Live With Women Honorably Allah said, *وَاكُونُوا لَهُنَّ كَمَا كُنْتُمْ لَهُمْ* by saying kind words to them, treating them kindly and making your appearance appealing for them, as much as you can, just as you like the same from them. Allah said in another Ayah, *وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ لَهُمْ أَزْوَاجٌ مُطَهَّرَاتٌ وَيَرْضَيْنَهُمْ بِمَا أُعْطُوا وَلَا يَكُن لَهُمْ مَخَافَةٌ أَلًا وَلَا حُزْنًا وَلَا يَكُن لَهُم مَالٌ وَلَا بَنُونَ* [2:228]. The Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* said, *ما أتاكم من شيء فخذوا به* At-Tabari 8:115-117. Tabari 8:117.

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّبِيُّ إِنَّا جَعَلْنَاكَ خَيْرَ الْأُمَّةِ أُخْرِجَتْ مِنَ الْغُلَامِ The best among you is he who is the best with his family. Verily, I am the best one among you with my family It was the practice of the Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* to be kind, cheerful, playful with his wives, compassionate, spending on them and laughing with them. The Messenger *ﷺ* used to race with A'ishah, the Mother of the Faithful, as a means of kindness to her. A'ishah said, The Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* raced with me and I won the race. This occurred before I gained weight, and afterwards I raced with him again, and he won that race. He said, *قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ إِنَّ الْفَتْحَ [victory] لَفِي الْوَجْهِ* [victory] When the Prophet *ﷺ* was at the home of one of his wives, sometimes all of his wives would meet there and eat together, and they would then go back to their homes. He and his wife would sleep in the same bed, he would remove his upper garment, sleeping in only his lower garment. The Prophet *ﷺ* used to talk to the wife whose night it was, after praying Isha and before he went to sleep. Allah said, *وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ لَهُمْ أَزْوَاجٌ مُطَهَّرَاتٌ وَيَرْضَيْنَهُمْ بِمَا أُعْطُوا وَلَا يَكُن لَهُمْ مَخَافَةٌ أَلًا وَلَا حُزْنًا وَلَا يَكُن لَهُم مَالٌ وَلَا بَنُونَ* [33:21]. Allah said, *وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ لَهُمْ أَزْوَاجٌ مُطَهَّرَاتٌ وَيَرْضَيْنَهُمْ بِمَا أُعْطُوا وَلَا يَكُن لَهُمْ مَخَافَةٌ أَلًا وَلَا حُزْنًا وَلَا يَكُن لَهُم مَالٌ وَلَا بَنُونَ* if indeed in the Messenger of Allah you have a good example to follow. Allah said, *وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ لَهُمْ أَزْوَاجٌ مُطَهَّرَاتٌ وَيَرْضَيْنَهُمْ بِمَا أُعْطُوا وَلَا يَكُن لَهُمْ مَخَافَةٌ أَلًا وَلَا حُزْنًا وَلَا يَكُن لَهُم مَالٌ وَلَا بَنُونَ* if you dislike them, it may be that you dislike a thing and Allah brings through it a great deal of good. Allah says that your patience, which is demonstrated by keeping wives whom you dislike, carries good rewards for you in this life and the Hereafter. Ibn Abbas commented on this Ayah, That the husband may feel compassion towards his wife and Allah gives him a child with her, and this child Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 10 :394 * Abu Dawud 3 :66

carries tremendous goodness. An authentic Hadith states, *قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ إِنَّا جَعَلْنَاكَ خَيْرَ الْأُمَّةِ أُخْرِجَتْ مِنَ الْغُلَامِ* No believing man should hale his believing wife. If he dislikes a part of her conduct, he would surely like another. The Prohibition of Taking Back the Dowry Allah said, *وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ لَهُمْ أَزْوَاجٌ مُطَهَّرَاتٌ وَيَرْضَيْنَهُمْ بِمَا أُعْطُوا وَلَا يَكُن لَهُمْ مَخَافَةٌ أَلًا وَلَا حُزْنًا وَلَا يَكُن لَهُم مَالٌ وَلَا بَنُونَ* But if you intend to replace a wife by another and you have given one of them a Qintar, take not the least bit of it back; would you take it wrongfully without a right and (with) a manifest sin? The Ayah commands: When one of you wants to divorce a wife and marry another one, he must not take any portion of the dowry he gave to the first wife, even if it were a Qintar of money. We mentioned the meaning of Qintar in the Tafsir of Surah Al Imran. This Ayah is clear in its indication that the dowry could be substantial. Umar bin Al-Khattab used to discourage giving a large dowry, but later on changed his view. Imam

Hasan Sahih . Al-Hafiz Abu Yala recorded that Masruq said, Umar bin Al- Khattab stood up on the Minbar of the Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* and said, O people! Why do you exaggerate concerning the dowry given to women? The Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* and his Companions used to pay up to four hundred Dirhams for a dowry, or less than that. Had paying more for a dowry been a part of Taqwa or an honor,

you would not have led them in this practice. Therefore, I do not want to hear about a man who pays more than four hundred Dirhams for a dowry. He then went down the Minbar, but a woman from Quraysh said to him, O Leader of the Faithful! You prohibited people from paying more than four hundred Dirhams in a dowry for women? He said, Yes. She said, Have you not heard what Allah sent down in the Qur'an? He said, Which part of it? She said, Have you not heard Allah's statement, 'And how could you take it (back) while you have gone in unto each other? how can you take back the dowry from the woman with whom you had sexual relations and she had sexual relations with you?' Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, As-Suddi and several others said that this means sexual intercourse.¹² * The Two Sahih's record that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said three times to the spouses who said the Mula'anah; ** Abu Dawud 2:582, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4 :255 , An-Nasal 6:117, Ibn Majah 1 :601 |2! At-Tabari 8:126. * Refer to Surat An-Nur 24 :6-9

UsS* lysis' us'jL^f ji Jilin *Allah knows that one of you is a liar, so would any of you repent?: "The man said, O Messenger of Allah! My money, referring to the dowry that he gave his wife. The Messenger said. ji tfcl* JUS jj tJjU Jli"

Allah prohibits marrying the women whom the father married, in honor and respect to the fathers, not allowing their children to have sexual relations with their wives after they die. A woman becomes ineligible for the son of her husband as soon as the marriage contract is conducted, and there is a consensus on this ruling. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Abbas said, During the time of Jahiliyyah, the people used to prohibit what Allah prohibits (concerning marriage), except marrying the stepmother and taking two sisters as rival wives. Allah sent down, 'And marry not women whom your fathers married,' and, 'and two sisters in wedlock at the same time' [4:23].¹¹¹ Similar was reported from Ata and Qatadah.¹¹² Therefore, the practice that the Ayah mentions is prohibited for this Ummah, being disgraced as an awful sin, Q} ^Indeed it was shameful and Maqtan, and an evil way.} Allah said in other Ayat, 'Come not near to Al-Fawdhish (shameful acts) whether committed openly or secretly' [6:151], and, 'iyf 4And come not near to unlawful sex. Verily, it is a Fdliishah and an evil way.' [17:32] In this Ayah (4:22), Allah added, '4and Maqtan}', meaning, offensive. It is a sin itself and causes the son to hate his father after he marries his wife. It is usual Tabari 8:132. Tabari 8 :132-134.

that whoever marries a woman dislikes those who married her before him. This is one reason why the Mothers of the Faithful were not allowed for anyone in marriage after the Messenger. They are indeed the Mothers of the Faithful since they married the Messenger (ﷺ), who is like the father to the believers. Rather, the Prophet's right is far greater than the right of a father, and his love comes before each person loving himself, may Allah's peace and blessings be on him. Ata bin Abi Rabah said that the Ayah, 'and Maqtan |>', means, Allah will hate him, it 4attd an evil way\$, for those who take this way. Therefore, those who commit this practice will have committed an act of reversion from the religion and deserve capital punishment and confiscation of their property, which will be given to the

guardianship, bom of your wives unto whom you have gone in - but there is no sin on you if you have not gone in unto them (to marry their daughters), - the wives of your sons who (spring) from your own

loins, and two sisters in wedlock at the same time, except for what has already passed; verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Degrees of Women Never Eligible for One to Marry This honorable Ayah is the Ayah that establishes the degrees of women relatives who are never eligible for one to marry, because of blood relations, relations established by suckling or marriage. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said, (Allah said) I have prohibited for you seven types of relatives by blood and seven by marriage. Ibn Abbas then recited the Ayah, *'M'A j\$3es 14^ iForbidden to you (for marriage) are: your mothers, your daughters, your sisters .. ,} II]*

means, just as your mother who bore you is prohibited for you in marriage, so is your mother from suckling prohibited for you.

The Mother-in-Law and Stepdaughter are Prohibited in Marriage Allah said next, *^ p 4Your wives mothers, your stcf)daughters under your guardianship, born of your tuives unto whom you have gone in - but there is no sin on you if you have not gone in unto them,} As for the mother of the wife, she becomes prohibited for marriage for her son-in-law when the marriage is conducted, whether the son-in-law has sexual relations with her daughter or not. As for the wife's daughter, she becomes prohibited for her stepfather when he has sexual relations with her mother, after the marriage contract is ratified. If the man divorces the mother before having sexual relations with her, he is allowed to marry her daughter. So Allah said; iYour stepdaughters under your guardianship, borti of your zoives unto whom you have gone in - but there is no sin on you if you have not gone in unto them,} to marry the stepdaughter. The Stepdaughter is Prohibited in Marriage Even if She Was Not Under the Guardianship of Her Stepfather Allah said, 44^ your stepdaughters under your guardianship,} The majority of scholars state that the stepdaughter is prohibited in marriage for her stepfather [who consummated his marriage to her mother] whether she was under his guardianship or not. The Two Sahih recorded that Umm Hablah said, O Messenger of Allah! Marry my sister, the daughter of Abu Sufyan (and in one narration Azzah bint Abu Sufyan). He said,*

418 Tafsir Ibtisami Katliir jV i 4*lj wJj sZ*Jld cJj jl -0y <*ihi Owi UU : oJli ^Jj" wJLJi> O^i ijft 1 oJ \j CJjP !ijlj 4 *Ok_L- l fc 4-jy <*JL* Ulj j\ Jjf ur^ v * ^ l* ^j^k>- ^ySv"" ^J Zf* ir ""Do you like that I do that?" She said, "I would not give you up for anything, but the best of whom I like to share with me in that which is righteously good, is my sister." He said, "That is not allowed for me." She said, "We were told that you want to marry the daughter of Abu Salamah." He asked, "The daughter of Umm Salamah?" She said, "Yes." He said, "Even if she was not my stepdaughter and under my guardianship, she is still not allowed for me because she is my niece from suckling, for Thuwaybah suckled me and Abu Salamah. Therefore, do not offer me to marry your daughters or sisters." In another narration from Al-Bukhari, r r* ^ v'l vHad I not married Umm Salamah, her daughter would not have been allowed for me anywayV21 Consequently, the Messenger jg stated that his marriage to Umm Salamah was the real reason behind that prohibition. Meaning of gone in unto them The Ayah continues, 4Sit 4Your wives unto whom you have gone in}, meaning, had sexual relations with them, according to Ibn Abbas and several others. 131 Prohibiting the Daughter-in-Law for Marriage Allah said, I1 ' Path Al-Bari 9 :64 and Muslim 2 :1073 FathAl-Bdri 9:62.Jabari 8:148.

CJi iThe wives of your sons who (spring) from your own loins,} Therefore, you are prohibited to marry the wives of your own sons, but not the wives of your adopted sons, as adoption was common practice

in JdhiUyyah. Allah said, & a \$& * & <&& ss ft 3:5 So when Zayd had accomplished his desire from her (i.e. divorced her), We gave her to you in marriage, so that (in future) there may be no difficulty to the believers in respect of (the marriage of) the wives of their adopted sons when the latter have no desire to keep them (i.e. they had divorced them).} [33:37] Ibn Jurayj said, I asked Ata about Allah's statement, iThe wives of your sons who (spring) from your own loins,} He said, We were told that when the Prophet jg married the ex-wife of Zayd (who was the Prophet's adopted son before Islam prohibited this practice), the idolators in Makkah criticized him. Allah sent down the Ayat I# iThe wives of your sons who (spring) from your own loins,} (ipti) pZTl Cj} inor has He made your adopted sons your real sons.} [33:4], and, ipCj 6sA ^ 'j? } iMuhammad is not the father of any of your men} [33:40], {11 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Al-Hasan bin Muhammad said, These Ayat are encompassing, IM At-Tabari 8 : 149.

4the wives of your sons}, and, iyour wives' mothers}. This is also the explanation of Tawus, Ibrahim, Az-Zuhri and Makhul. It means that these two Aydt encompass these types of women, whether the marriage was consummated or not, and there is a consensus on this ruling. A Doubt and Rebuttal Why is the wife of one's son from suckling prohibited for him for marriage - that is, if she is no longer married to his son from suckling - as the majority of scholars state, although they are not related by blood? The answer is the Prophet's statement, "Suckling prohibits what blood relations prohibit. n The Prohibition of Taking Two Sisters as Rival Wives Allah said, 3 C -ft ^ & } hi Muslim 2 :1072.

4...and two sisters in wedlock at the same time, except for what has already passed The Ayah commands: you are prohibited to take two sisters as rival wives, or riveil female-servants, except for what had happened to you during the time of Jahiliyyah, which We have forgiven and erased. Therefore, no one is allowed to take or keep two sisters as rival wives, according to the consensus of the scholars of the Companions, their followers, and the Imams of old and present. They all stated that taking two sisters as rival wives is prohibited, and that whoever embraces Islam while married to two sisters at the same time is given the choice to keep one of them and divorce the other. Imam

422 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4Also (forbidden are) women already married, except those whom your right hands possess.} The Ayah means, you are prohibited from marrying women who are already married, iexcept those whom your right hands possess} except those whom you acquire through war, for you are allowed such women after making sure they are not pregnant. Imam

iAU others are lawful^ meaning, you are allowed to marry women other than the prohibited types mentioned here, as Ata and others have stated. Allah's statement, j .Ct Jf. \$} iprovided you seek them (with a dowry) from your property, desiring chastity, not fornication,\$ meaning, you are allowed to use your money to marry up to four wives and for (the purchase of) as many female slaves as you like, all through legal means, i(desiring) chastity, not fornication .} Allah's statement, (jf-J u'f 4So zwith those among them whom you have enjoyed, give them their required due,} means, to enjoy them sexually, surrender to them their rightful dowry as compensation. In other Ayat, Allah said, 4And how could you take it (back) while you have gone in unto each other}, \yC3} 4And give to the women (whom you marry) their dowry with a good heart}, and, 0'j CU o' 'jj} 4And it is not lawful for you (men) to take back (from your wives) any of what (dowry) you gave them} Prohibiting the Mut'ah of Marriage Mujahid stated that, e . y- z> >.s< c> >"* ' *f in-t *. * Uif At-Tabari 8 : 172

424 Tafsir Ibn Kathir iSo with those among them whom you have enjoyed, give them their required due,} was revealed about the Mut'ah marriage. A Mut'ah marriage is a marriage that ends upon a predetermined date. In the Two Sahths, it is recorded that the Leader of the Faithful Ali bin Abi Talib said, The Messenger of Allah sg prohibited Mut'ah marriage and eating the meat of domesticated donkeys on the day of Khaybar (battle). In addition, in his Sahth,

The meaning of these Ayat is: Ifyou have stipulated a dowry

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1120–1131]

for her, and she later forfeits it, either totally or partially, then this bears no harm on you or her in this case. Ibn Jarir said, Al-Hadrami said that some men would designate a certain dowry, but then fall into financial difficulties. Therefore, Allah At-Jabari 8:176 Fath Al-Bari9 :590 , Muslim 2 :1027 Muslim 2:1025

said that there is no harm on you, O people, concerning your mutual agreement after the requirement (has been determined). 111 meaning, if she gives up part of the dowry, then you men are allowed to accept that. Allah s statement, tLic oS* ii' 4Surely, Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise is suitable here, after Allah mentioned these prohibitions. 0% U Ja*> jj pCifJ IjSj oijjIS' Ji i p.< 1 ."A . <* . '> . t~\~! <>*\ 0}* \J XkJaA JJ mA j\C- tyrfbA *J c lt ^ ^ .;AS3t t.ss* e5 *y* jst ot> 425 . And whoever ofyou have not the means wherewith to wed free believing women, they may wed believing girlsfrom among those whom your right hands possess, and Allah has full knowledge about your faith, you are one from another. Wed them with the permission of their own folk (guardians) and give them their due in a good manner; they should be chaste, not fornicators, nor promiscuous. And after they have been taken in wedlock, if they commit Fdliishah, their punishment is half that for free (unmarried) women . This is for him among you who is afraid of being harmed in his religion or in his body; but it is better for you that you practice self-restraint, and Allah is Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful.) Marrying a Female Slave, if One Cannot Marry a Free Woman Allah said, those who do not have, 4the means), financial capability, 4Wherewith to wedfree believing women) m At-Tabari 8 :180

meaning, free faithful, chaste women. ui ^ c5Cju U iThey may wed believing girls from among those whom your right hands possess,} meaning, they are allowed to wed believing slave girls[1] owned by the believers. iand Allah has full knowledge about your faith; you are one from another.} Allah knows the true reality and secrets of all things, but you people know only the apparent things. Allah then said. iWed them with the permission of their own folk indicating that the owner is responsible for the slave girl, and consequently, she cannot marry without his permission. The owner is also responsible for his male slave and they cannot wed without his permission. A Hadith states, j (j)t ^yy^J. lbl> "Any male slave who marries without permission from his master, is a fornicator."|21 When the owner of the female slave is a female, those who are allowed to give away the free woman in marriage, with her permission, become responsible for giving away her female slave in marriage, as well. A Hadith states that "77ie woman does not give away another woman, or herself in marriage, for only the adulteress gives herself away in marriage. "|31 Allah s statement, Recently converted captives ofwar. 121 Abu Dawud 2 :563 Ibn Majah 1 :606

An-Nisa (Part-5) iAttd give them their due in a good manner;} meaning, pay them their dowry with a good heart, and do not keep any of it, belittling the matter due to the fact that they are owned slaves. Allah s statement, i^cJ^} ithey should be chaste^ means, they are honorable women who do not commit adultery, and this is why Allah said, 4not fornicators} referring to dishonorable women, who do not refrain from illicit sexual relations with those who ask. Ibn Abbas said that the fornicating women are the whores, who do not object to having relations with whomever seeks it, while, u.1 %} inor promiscuous.} refers to taking boyfriends. ' Similar was said by Abu Hurayrah, Mujahid, Ash-Shalsi, Ad-Dahhak, Ata Al-Khurasani, Yahya bin Abi Kathir, Muqatil bin Hayyan and As-Suddi.'2 ' The Slave Girl s Punishment for Adultery is Halfthat of a Free UnmarriedWoman Allah said, # / j *i ""/ / \ iAnd after they have been taken in wedlock, if they commit Fdhishah, their punishment is half of that for free (unmarried) women.} this is about the slave women who got married, as indicated by the Ayah; p 3i"j1 cSIU l! ^ J fyd. Ij ^ iAf} iAnd whoever ofyou have not the means wherewith to wed free believing women, they may wed believing girls from amongTabari 8 :193Jabari 8:194

lr^ zwm AV 8SW3 J"J C, XjifoSj t iJLiJo^JiT ^ lL-"-j o^ui '5[ij^optafe; \a-j j^j""^/\s="^olf^-\vaSjj\ i sfMW 'Ih'^-j J^=.j^ li ic. those whom your right hands possess,> Therefore, since the honorable Ayah is about believing slave girls, then, il^A%} }And after they have been taken in wedlock, } refers to when they (believing slave girls) get married, as Ibn Abbas and others have said. 11 ' Allah s statement, CfCkMS\ J* U " -*jfe iUiar 4their punishment is half of that for free (un- married) women.> indicates that the type of punishment prescribed here is the one that can be reduced to half, lashes in this case, not stoning to death, and Allah knows best. Allah s statement, oxji oA 4This is for him among you who is afraid of being harmed in his religion or in his body;} indicates that marrying slave girls, providing one satisfies the required conditions, is for those who fear for their chastity and find it hard to be patient and refrain from sex. In this difficult circumstance, one is allowed to marry a slave girl. However, it is better to refrain from marrying slave girls and to observe m At-Tabari 8 :202

patience, for otherwise, the offspring will become slaves to the girl s master. Allah said, < ">.< .t'ko'jf ibut it is better for you that you practice self-restraint, and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. 14 tg; pe-g j. pbtizP cs'A & + " > ** A? > > ' *-> - < ' ' " t'fJLj^ Aji\ " .**->?*J* y^_ j' *a'j .r / / y. | X ^ " * y / "'i f " I .,./ . ^ ^ ,^v p^o-c- o' ;ivyU-kc. . A//fl/j wishes to make clear (what is lawful and what is unlawful) to you, and to show you the ways of those before you, and accept your repentance, and Allah is All-Knower, All- Wise. 427. Allah wishes to accept your repentance, but those who follow their lusts, wish that you (believers) should deviate tremendously away (from the right path)} 428. Allah wishes to lighten (the burden) for you; and man was created weak.} Allah explains to the believers what He has allowed and prohibited for them in this and other Surahs, 4And to show you the ways of those before you,} meaning their righteous ways and how to adhere to the commandments that He likes and is pleased with. 4and accept your repentance} from sin and error, 41&. 14%} 4and Allah is All-Knower, All-Wise.} in His commands, decrees, actions and statements. Allah s statement, 4d_Ur. [Pi J 4but those who follow their lusts, wish that you (believers) should deviate tremendously awayfrom the right path))

indicates that the followers of Shaytan among the Jews, Christians and the adulterous, wish that you would take the horrendous path of falsehood instead of the truth. 4^ J& iAllah wishes to lighten (the burden) for you"} His legislation, orders, what He prohibits and what He decrees for you. This is why

Allah has allowed free men to marry slave girls under certain conditions, as Mujahid and others have stated. 4and man was created weak.} and this is why it is suitable in his case that the commands are made easy for him, because of his weakness and feebleness. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Tawus said that, gy# & ',} iand man was created iveak}, Concerning women .121 Wakf said, Man s mind leaves when women are involved. ^ oi Vi \-fkJ6 v \frX jli . lii yj Jf"} 0 *r Jc -ii'i Ijt Lj'jjii 4 tL.? &S yCk=, 429. O you who believe! Eat not up your property among yourselves unjustly except it be a trade amongst you, by mutual consent. And do not kill yourselves (nor kill one another). Surely, Allah is Most Merciful to you.} 430. And whoever commits that through aggression and injustice, We shall cast him into the Fire, and that is easy for Allah.} 431. Ifyou avoid the great sins which you are forbidden to do. We shall remit from you your (small) sins, and admit you to a At-Jabari 8:215 At-Tabari 8:216

Noble Entrance (i.e. Paradise).} Prohibiting Unlawfully Banned Money Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, prohibits His believing servants from illegally acquiring each other s property using various dishonest methods such as Riba, gambling and other wicked methods that appear to be legal, but Allah knows that, in reality, those involved seek to deal in interest. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Abbas commented on a man who buys a garment, saying that if he likes it he will keep it, or he will return it along with an extra Dirham, This is what Allah meant, when He said, Qfc %} iEat not up your property among yourselves unjustly." }^ Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, When Allah sent down, V \ \$x \$ > }0 you who believe! Eat not up your property among yourselves unjustly} some Muslims said, Allah has forbidden us from eating up each other s property unjustly, and food is our best property. Therefore, none among us is allowed to eat from anyone else s food. After that Allah sent down, iThere is no restriction on the blind} (until the end of the Ayah). (24:61]. Qatadah said similarly. Allah s statement, oj?y o iexcept it be a trade amongst you, by mutual consent.} means, do not revert to illegal ways and means to acquire money. However, there is no harm in commercial transactions that transpire between the buyer and the seller with mutual consent, so that money is legally earned from these in At-Tabari 8 :217

transactions. Mujahid said that, 4except it be a trade amongst you, by mutual consent . \$> means, By selling and buying, or giving someone a gift. Ibn Jarir recorded this statement. The Option to Buy or Sell Before Parting, is Part of Mutual Consent in Trading Mutual agreement in various transactions is attained when both parties have the right to uphold or dissolve the agreement before they part. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said, juu judu ' The seller and the buyer retain the (right to change their mind) as long as they have not parted."12 '

the Prophet jg sent him for the battle ofDhat As-Salasil, I had a wet dream during a very cold night and feared that if I bathed, I would die. So I performed Tayammum (with pure earth) and led my company in the Dawn prayer. When I went back to the Messenger of Allah jg, 1 mentioned what had happened to me and he said, c-jij JLUvJsL oljfff !jflZ- "0 Amr! Have you led your people in prayer while you were in a state ofsexual impurity?" I said, O Messenger of Allah! I had a wet dream on a very cold night and feared that if I bathed I would perish, and I remembered Allah s statement, iAnd do not kill yourselves. Surely, Allah is Most Merciful to you>. So I performed Tayammum and prayed. The Messenger of Allah sg smiled and did not say anything. This is the narration reported by Abu Dawud. Ibn Marduyah mentioned this honorable Ayah and then reported that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah

S& said, f c f irT ^ V. tjj i oJj ji) 1 t ^ < #Jj aI .j IjIUV4 ^ i lif ijIL* ijJu. 8 tjbI lx-j IjiL. IjJl^> "Whoever kills himself with an iron tool, then his tool will be in his hand and he will keep stabbing himself with it in the Fire of Jahannam, forever and ever. Whoever kills himself with poison, then his poison will be in his hand and he will keep taking it in the Fire of Jahannam forever and ever. Wlwever kills himself by throwing himself from a mountain, will keep falling in the Fire of Jahannam forever and ever." This Hadith was also collected in the Two Sahihs. Abu Qilabah said that Thabit bin Ad-Dahhak said that the Messenger of Allah sg said,

434 Tafstr Ibn Kathfr (Ji V-'JL* j/j-i-; ,i W/ioraer Ar/7/s himself with an instrument, will be punished with it on the Day of Resurrection . This Hadith was collected by the Group. This is why Allah said, li jii JIji JIiT J^j} i And whoever commits that through aggression and injustice, ^ meaning, whoever commits what Allah has forbidden for him transgression and injustice - while knowing that it is forbidden for him, yet he still dares to commit it, AWe shall cast him into the Fire,}. This Ayah carries a stern warning and a truthful promise. Therefore, every sane person should beware of it, those who hear the speech with full comprehension. Minor Sins Willbe Pardoned if One Refrains from Major Sins Allah said. 4f Oyj* & ilfyou avoid the great sins which you are forbidden to do, We shall remit from you your (small) sins,} meaning, if you avoid the major evil deeds that you were prohibited We will forgive you the minor evil deeds and will admit you into Paradise. This is why Allah said. i and admit you to a Noble Entrance (i.e. Paradise).} There are several Hadlths on the subject of this honorable Ayah. Imam

t U Sjlls jIS "/ know what the day of Jumu'ah is. Anyone who takes a bath and cleans himself as much as he can and then proceeds for the Friday prayer and remains quiet until the Imam finishes the prayer, all his sins in between the present and the next Friday will be forgiven, as long as major sins were avoided .

What are the Seven Destructive Sins?

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1131–1171]

In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, "Avoid the seven great destructive sins. The people inquired, O Allah s Messenger! What are they? He said. ojij j i ,: H JIi To join others in worship along with Allah, to kill the life which Allah has forbidden except for a just cause, magic, to consume Riba, to consume an orphan's wealth, to turn aioay from the enemy and flee from the battlefield when the battle begins, and to accuse chaste women, who never even think of anything that would tarnish their chastity and are good believers, n 1 ' 1 Another Hadith that mentions False Witness Imam

An-Nisa' (Part-5) To make a rival for Allah while He Alone created yo: "I said, Then? He said, ^ iljJj 01 To kill your offspring far fear that he might share your food with youJ I said, Then? He said,"

438 Tafsir Ibti Kathir vAmong the worst of the major sins is for a man to curse his own parents .: "They said, How can one curse his own parents? He said, dJJj"

made a pledge (brotherhood), give them their due portion (by wills). Truly, Allah is Ever a Witness over all things.} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Salih, Qatadah, Zayd bin Aslam, As-Suddi, Ad-Dahhak, Muqatil bin Hayyan, and others said that Allah s statement, i And to everyone, We have

appointed Mawali} means, Heirs. * Ibn Abbas was also reported to have said that Mawali refers to relatives. Ibn Jarir commented, The Arabs call the cousin a Mawla." Ibn Jarir continued, Allah's statement, of that (property) left by parents and relatives.} means, from what he inherited from his parents and family members. Therefore, the meaning of the Ayah becomes: To all of you, O people, We appointed relatives (such as children) who will later inherit what you inherited from your own parents and relatives. Allah's statement, T pñlri? 4To those also with whom you have made a pledge (brotherhood), give them their due portion .} means, Those with whom you have a pledge of brotherhood, give them their share of inheritance, thus fulfilling the ratified pledges that you gave them. Allah has witnessed all of you when you gave these pledges and promises. This practice was followed in the beginning of Islam, but was later on abrogated when

4To those also with whom you have made a pledge (brotherhood)\$ When the emigrants came to Al-Madinah, the emigrant would inherit from the Ansari, while the latter's relatives would not inherit from him because of the bond of brotherhood which the Prophet ﷺ established between them (the emigrants and the Ansar). When the verse, 4And to everyone We have appointed Mawdli^ was revealed, it cancelled (the pledge of brotherhood regarding inheritance). Then he said, The verse, aagis&s At iSStga s- " < . . ^ } - ' t <> > > -(.< s'*.# < >>\ " < A< -tf Is -r As*.*.' ij[jj 1EJ ' 2 Cjtf)1^= .-T tfe'-. '*i<// . t. a - ..". .>, \ * -i' - '?' (, p-ayli* p<-=i "l >-- o-jH 4To those also with whom you have made a pledge (brotherhood), give them their due portion. remained valid for cases of co-operation and mutual advice, while the matter of inheritance was excluded and it became permissible to assign something in one's will to the person who had the right of inheriting before. m Fath. Al-Bari 8 :96

&& &&& & iii tL liji i^l5 O b** \$ 0j: "l^j^j 4Si 434. Men are the protectors and maintainers of women, because Allah has made one of them to excel the other, and because they spend (to support them) from their means. Therefore the righteous women are Qanitat, and guard in the husband's absence what Allah orders them to guard. As to those women on whose part you see ill conduct, admonish them, and abandon them in their beds, and beat them, but if they return to obedience, do not seek a means against them. Surely, Allah is Ever Most High, Most Gracious. Allah said, if\$ iMen are the protectors and maintainers of women,} meaning, the man is responsible for the woman, and he is her maintainer, caretaker and leader who disciplines her if she deviates. 4because Allah has made one of them to excel the other,} meaning, because men excel over women and are better than them for certain tasks. This is why prophethood was exclusive of men, as well as other important positions of leadership. The Prophet said, pp tjJJ fji 4^ jJ"

expenditures and various expenses that Allah ordained in His Book and the Sunnah of His Messenger for men to spend on women. For these reasons it is suitable that he is appointed her maintainer, just as Allah said, 4 l r& 4But men have a degree (of responsibility) over them}. Qualities of the Righteous Wife Allah said, ^Therefore, the righteous} women, 4l s} 4are Qanitdt}, obedient to their husbands, as Ibn Abbas and others stated.111 iand guard in the husband's absence} As-Suddi and others said that it means she protects her honor and her husband's property when he is absent, and Allah's statement, izvhat Allah orders them to guard. means, the protected [husband] is the one whom Allah protects. Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, lil_) tkлке-IM lij tLldl "77ie best woman is she who when you look at her, she pleases you, when you command her she obeys you,

and when you are absent, she protects her honor and your property . Then, the Messenger of Allah jg recited the Ayah, At-Tabari 8 :294Tabari 8 :295

444 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir iMett are the protectors and maintainers of women,} until its end.111 Imam

i&'iUi c*ii cjU Kivj ui iii: "/// the man asks his wife to come to his bed and she declines, the angels zoill keep cursing her until the morning ."

446 Tafsfr Ibti Kalhir ibeat them} means, if advice and ignoring her in the bed do not produce the desired results, you are allowed to discipline the wife, without severe beating.

An-Nisd' (Part-5 iSurely, Allah is Ever Most High, Most Great.> reminds men that if they transgress against their wives without justification, then Allah, the Ever Most High, Most Great, is their Protector, and He will exert revenge on those who transgress against their wives and deal with them unjustly. 435 . If you fear a breach between the tzuo, appoint (two) arbitrators, one from his family and the other from tier s; if they both wish for peace, Allfih will cause their reconciliation . Indeed Allah is Ever All-Knower, Well-Acquainted with all things Appointing Two Arbitrators When the Possibility of Estrangement Between Husband and Wife Occurs Allah first mentioned the case of rebellion on the part of the wife. He then mentioned the case of estrangement and alienation between the two spouses. Allah said. a; tSS-j [f, IjLuU CjJl tg ilf you fear a breach between the hoo, appoint (two) arbitrators, one from his family>. The Fuqaha (scholars of Fiqh) say that when estrangement occurs between the husband and wife, the judge refers them to a trusted person who examines their case in order to stop any wrongs committed between them. If the matter continues or worsens, the judge sends a trustworthy person from the woman s family and a trustworthy person from the man s family to meet with them and examine their case to determine whether it is best for them to part or to remain together. Allah gives preference to staying together, and this is why Allah said. iif they both wish for peace, Allah will cause their reconciliation Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, Allah commands that a righteous man from the husband s side of the family and the wife s side of the family are appointed, so

that they find out who among the spouses is in the wrong. If the man is in the wrong, they prevent him from his wife, and he pays some restitution. If the wife is in the wrong, she remains with her husband, and he does not pay any restitution. If the arbitrators decide that the marriage should remain intact or be dissolved, then their decision is upheld. If they decide that the marriage remains intact, but one of the spouses disagrees while the other agrees, and one of them dies, then the one who agreed inherits from the other, while the spouse who did not agree does not inherit from the spouse who agreed. This was collected by Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir. Shaykh Abu TJmar bin Abdul-Barr said, The scholars agree that when the two arbitrators disagree, then the opinion that dissolves the marriage will not be adopted. They also agree that the decision of the arbitrators is binding, even if the two spouses did not appoint them as agents. This is the case if it is decided that they should stay together, but they disagree whether it is binding or not when they decide for separation. Then he mentioned that the majority holds the view that the decision is still binding, even if they did not appoint them to make any decision. v 4^~^' si j'i'j 436. Worship Allah and join none with Him in worship, and do good to parents, kinsfolk, orphans, the poor, the neighbor who is near of kin, the neighbor who is a stranger, the companion by your side, the wayfarer (you meet), and those (slaves) whom your right hands possess. Verily, Allah does not like such

as are proud and boastful The Order to Worship Allah Alone and to Be Dutiful to Parents Allah orders that He be worshipped Alone without partners, m At-Tabari 8 :325

because He Alone is the Creator and Sustainer Who sends His favors and bounties on His creation in all situations and instances. Therefore He deserves to be singled out, without associating anything or anyone from His creation with Him in worship. Indeed, the Prophet jg said to Mu'adh, 4il^ U Do you know what Allah's right on His servants is?" Mu'adh replied, Allah and His Messenger know better. He said, lip -u {JjSi% That they should worship Him and should not ivorship any others with Him . The Prophet then said, 'i ji Ijj 4)1 {Jj. U Do you know what the right of the servants on Allah is if they do this? He should not punish themM 1 ^ Allah then commands the servants to be dutiful to their parents, for Allah made parents the reason for the servants to come to existence, after they did not exist. Allah joins the order to worship Him with being dutiful to parents in many places. For example, He said, iA&j J 4give tlumks to Me and to your parents}, and. 4And your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him. And that you be dutiful to your parents}. After Allah ordained being dutiful to parents, He ordained kind treatment of relatives, males and females. A Hadith states, J' _ ^ t ^ j, j-SLLJI n.V^iu Charity given to the poor is Sadaqah, while charity given to m Fath Al-Bari 13 :359

relatives is both Sadaqah and Sildh (keeping the relations)." Allah then said, Aorphans}, because they lost their caretakers who would spend on them. So Allah commands that the orphans be treated with kindness and compassion. Allah then said, AAl-Masakin (the poor)} who have various needs and cannot find what sustains these needs. Therefore, Allah commands they should be helped in acquiring their needs in a sufficient manner that will end their inadequacy. We will further elaborate on the matter of the destitute and the poor in Surah Bara h (9:60). The Right ofthe Neighbor Allah said, Athe neighbor who is near of kin, the neighbor who is a stranger} Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said that, 44J--"S' < > jii'j Athe neighbor who is near of kin} means, The neighbor who is also a relative , while, AA\$AX AThe neighbor who is a stranger} means, Who is not a relative. It was also reported that Tkrimah, Mujahid, Maymun bin Mihran, Ad-Dahhak, Zayd bin Aslam, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Qatadah said similarly. Mujahid was also reported to have said that Allah s statement, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 3 :324 * At-Jabari 8 :335 * At-Jabari 8 :338 * At-Tabari 8 :335-336

4the neighbor who is a stranger> means, The companion during travel. ' 11 There are many Hadiths that command kind treatment to the neighbors, and we will mention some of them here with Allah s help. The First Hadith Imam

To kill your offspring for fear that he might share your food with you . " I said, Then? He said, *J X>-ob To commit adultery with your neighbor's wife, d The Fifth Hadith Imam

Qiixj? til] jft *>!-->"ul UJ i4*Jlu> till Jj . " * "uf HTiflf i/om /eed yourself is a Sadaqah (charity) for you, what you feed your children is Sadaqah far you, what you feed your wife is Sadaqah far you and what you feed your servant is Sadaqahfor i/ow.s' 11

ot ==> 4^ . Y Saf 6^ i Verily, Allah does not like such as are proud and boastful. meaning, one who is proud and arrogant, insolent and boasts to others. He thinks that he is better than other people, thus thinking high of himself, even though he is insignificant to Allah and hated by people. Mujahid said that Allah s statement, -5 'if lei- iVcrily, Allah does not like such as are proud^ meansarrogant, while,

iboaftufy means boasting about what he has, while he does not thank Allah. * This Ayah indicates that such a person boasts with people about the bounty that Allah has given him, but he is actually ungrateful to Allah for this bounty. Ibn Jarir recorded that Abdullah bin Waqid Abu Raja Al- Harawi said, You will find that those who are mean are also proud and boasting. He then recited, iand those (slaves) whom your right hands possess, J rmm Ae mm Oc 4ijJ ctljoiJ " 5^* LA-r' At-Tabari 8 :350

You will find that he who is undutiful (to parents) is also arrogant, and deprived. He then recited, 1> fa jfay 4And dutiful to my mother, and made me not arrogant, deprivedty Once a man asked the Prophet, O Messenger of Allah, advise me. The Prophet jfe said, * >~ Y 2tl o\j 4aL"mJI fa jlJVj Jllil ijij'ijl Jlli)} did!" Avoid lengthening the dress (below the ankles), far this practice is from arrogance. Verily, Allah does not like arrogance.s 11 ii-*** OJ 0>^SO) . ""j-LUL o Yj o;\ jijtj ClJit tjcf-lj i*-** jl fafr *jl*j rKfaj * j faj i) , ii? jSj ijil j-p'jj li* 'jiilfj J "it 437. 77iose who are stingy and encourage people to be stingy and hide what Allah has bestowed upon than of His bounties. And We have prepared far the disbelievers a disgraceful tormentty 438. And (also) those who spend of their wealth to be seen of men, and believe not in Allah and the Last Day, and whoever takes Shaytan as an intonate; then what a dreadful intimate he hasty 439 . And what loss have they if they had believed in Allah and in the Last Day, and they spend out of what Allah has given them for sustenamce? And Allah is Ever All-Knorwer ofthemty The Censure ofStingy Behavior Allah chastises the stingy behavior of those who refuse to spend their money for what Allah ordered them, such as being kind to parents and compassionate to relatives, orphans, the poor, the relative who is also a neighbor, the companion Ahmad 5 :64

during travel, the needy wayfarer, the slaves and servants. Such people do not give Allah s right from their wealth, and they assist in the spread of stingy behavior. The Messenger of Allah said, jiy!' * disease is more serious than being stingy? He also said, "Beware of being stingy , for it destroyed those who were before you, as it encouraged them to cut their relations and they did, and it encouraged them to commit sin and they did.* Allah said, Ji iii jr^=*f)} iand hide what Allah has bestowed upon them of His bounties,} Therefore, the miser is ungrateful for Allah s favor, for its effect does not appear on him, whether in his food, clothes or what he gives. Similarly, Allah said, M -if k iVerily, man is ungrateful to his Lord. And to that he bears witness.} by his manners and conduct, js ' And verily, he is violetit in the love ofwealth.} Allah said, ui '1 Vi hide what Allah has bestowed upon than of His bounties} and this is why He threatened them, Al-Adab Al-Mufrad 83 Abu Dawud 2 :324

An-Nisa' (Part-5) generous.' And it was said..." meaning you acquired your reward in the life, and this is indeed what you sought with your action.111 This is why Allah said, iand believe not in Allah and the Last Day,) meaning, it is Shaytan who lured them to commit this evil action, instead of performing the good deed as it should be performed. Shaytan encouraged, excited and lured them by making the evil appear good, iCJ& i 4And whoever takes Shaytan as an intimate; then what a dreadful intimate he has!) Allah then said, 'y dj jfh i'yf'i i&i j* \iZ\$) 4And what loss have they if they had believed in Allah and in the Last Day, and they spend out ofwhat Allah has given them for sustenance?) This Ayah means, what harm would it cause them if they believe in Allah, go on the righteous path, replace showing off with sincerity, have faith in Allah, and await His promise in the Hereafter, for those who do good and spend what He has given them on what He likes and is pleased with. Allah s statement: i\i ^a&) 4And Allah is Ever All-Knower ofthem.) means, He has perfect knowledge of their intentions, whether good or evil.

Indeed, Allah knows those who deserve success, and He grants them success and guidance, directing them to perform righteous actions that will earn them His pleasure. He also knows those who deserve failure and expulsion from His great mercy, which amounts to utter failure in this life and the Hereafter for them, we seek refuge in Allah from this evil end. (il An-Nasfil 6 :24

Yes. He is in a shallow area in Hell-fire, and were it not for me, he would have been in the deepest depths of the Fire.

Allah rewards the good deed with a million deeds.* Abu Hurayrah said, By Allah! I heard the Messenger of Allah 5g saying, JL tSypi 3)1 jj

464 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr Messenger of Allah said to me, Recite to me. I said, O Messenger of Allah! Should I recite (the Qur'an) to you, while it was revealed to you? He said, Yes, for I like to hear it from other people. I recited Surat An-Nisa until I reached this Ayah, *fifin'- ^ (f Cri 'M 4How (will it be) then, when INe bring from each nation a witness and We bring you (O Muhammad) as a witness against these people?}* He then said, Stop now. I found that his eyes were tearful. ^ Allah s statement, *by&, Yj jtjt iSyZ j! iy X^yfr) mu- 40n that day those who disbelieved and disobeyed the Messenger will wish that they were buried in the earth, but they will never be able to hide a singlefactfrom Allah. means, they will wish that the earth would open up and swallow them because of the horror of the gathering place and the disgrace, dishonor and humiliation they will suffer on that Day. This is similar to Allah s statement, X Cwju t, 4The Day when man will see that (the deeds) which his hands have sentforth}* Allah then said, *4^& OjSfc\$}* *ibut they will never be able to hide a singlefactfrom Allah.}* indicating that they will admit to everything they did and will not hide any of it. Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, A man came to Ibn Abbas and said to him, There are things that confuse me in the Qur'an. Ibn Abbas said, What things do you have doubts about in the Qur'an? He said, *Not doubts, but rather confusing things. Ibn Abbas said. Tell me what caused you confusion. He said, I hear Allah s statement, m Path Al-Bari 8:712

M 1# i% J3 i ijhere will then be no test for them but to say : "By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others in worship with Allah."4 but He also says, & hf&i 'iff 4but they will never be able to hide a singlefact front Allah. They have indeed hid something. Ibn Abbas said, As for Allah s statement, free 4There will then be no test for them but to say: "By Allah, our Lord, we were not those ivho joined others in worship with Allah. "4, vwhen they see that on the Day of Resurrection that Allah does n('it forgive, except for the people of Islam, and that He forgives sins, no matter how big they are, except Shirk, then the Musi r^cs lie. They will say, ifffzZ tef U Cp fjfj4 4"By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others in worship with Allah."4, hoping that Allah will forgive them. However, Allah will then seal their mouths > and their hands and feet will disclose what they used to Then, 4@& 4 'oJ&% fa dff) cni' ff4 ithose who disbelieved and disobeyed the Messenger will wish that they weft buried in the earth, but they will never be able to hide a single factfrom Allah.4 ll] iSjf- tsjfd. ffj vpdzf ijJJju v \fp.4 jl jJGji jt S P f j-ju* p o\j \j\ps ^ -St Si ^ & ia| pL rqi' Abdur-Razzaq 1

V* os 443 . O you who believe! Do not approach Salah while you are in a drunken state until you know what you are saying, nor while Junub (sexually impure), except while passing through, until you bathe (your entire body), and if you are ill , or on a journey, or one of you comes from the Gha'it (toilet), or

from Lamastum (touching) women, but you do not find water, then perform Tayammum with clean earth, rubbing your faces and hands. Truly, Allah is Ever Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving.⁴ The Prohibition of Approaching Prayer When Drunk or Junub Allah forbade His believing servants from praying while drunk, for one does not know the meaning of what he is saying in that state, and He forbade them from attending the Masjids while sexually impure, except when one is just passing through the Masjid from one door to another. This Ayah was revealed before alcohol consumption was completely prohibited, as evident by the Hadith that we mentioned Surat Al-Baqarah when we explained Allah's statement, "They ask you about alcoholic drink and gambling. In that Hadith, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, recited this Ayah to Umar, who said, O Allah! Explain the ruling about Khamr (intoxicants) for us in a plain manner. When this Ayah [4:43] was revealed, the Prophet recited it to Umar, who said, O Allah! Explain the ruling about Khamr (intoxicants) for us in a plain manner. After that, they would not drink alcohol close to the time of prayer. When Allah's statement, "O you who believe! Alcoholic drinks, gambling, Al-Ansab, and Al-Azlam [11] are an abomination of Shayatan's handiwork. So avoid that in order that you may be successful. [5:90], until, [11] Al-Ansab are stone altars used for the sacrifice of animals other than Allah. Al-Azlam refers to a type of arrows used for divination

Surah 4, At-Nisā' (Part-5) "So, will you not then abstain?" [5:91] was revealed, Umar said, We abstain, we abstain. In another narration, when the Ayah in Siirat An-Nisa was revealed, "O you who believe! Do not approach Salah while you are in a drunken state until you know what you are saying," at the time of prayer, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ would have someone proclaim; Let not any drunk approach the prayer. This is the wording collected by

Another Reason Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Ali bin Abi Talib said, Abdur-Rahman bin Awf made some food to which he invited us and served some alcohol to drink. When we became intoxicated, and the time for prayer came, they asked someone to lead us in prayer. He recited Say, O disbelievers! I do not worship that which you worship, but we worship that which you worship [refer to the correct wording of the Surah: 109]. Allah then revealed, "O you who believe! Do not approach Salah when you are in a drunken state until you know what you are saying." This is the narration collected by Ibn Abi Hatim and At-Tirmidhi, who said Hasan [Gharib] Sahih. Allah's statement, "until you know what you are saying" is the best description for when one is intoxicated, that is, when he does not know the meaning of what he is saying. When a person is drunk, he makes obvious mistakes in the recitation and will not be able to be humble during the prayer. Imam

some of the narrations of this Hadith, the Messenger ﷺ said, "I ask Allah for forgiveness, but instead I curse myself." For he might want to ask for forgiveness, but instead curses himself. Allah said, "Nor while you are sexually impure, except while passing through, until you bathe (your entire body)," Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said that Allah's statement, "Nor while you are sexually impure, except while passing through, until you bathe (your entire body)," means, Do not enter the Masjid when you are Junub, unless you are just passing by, in which case, you pass through without sitting down. Ibn Abi Hatim said that similar is reported from Abdullah bin Mas'ud, Anas, Abu Ubaydah, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Abu Ad-Duha, Ata, Mujahid, Masruq, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Zayd bin Aslam, Abu Malik, Amr bin Dinar, Al-Hakam bin Utaybah, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Yahya bin Said Al-Ansari, Ibn Shihab and Qatadah. *

Ibn Jarir recorded that Yazid bin Abi Habib commented on Allah's statement, *vi cJi -j'j}* inor while Junub (sexually impure), except while passing through,} when some men from the Ansar, whose doors literally opened into the Masjid, were sexually impure, and they did not have water, their only way to get water was to pass through the Masjid. So, Allah sent down, Al-Bari 1 :375 Jabari 8 :382 Tabari 8:381-384

470 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir <"or while Juttub (sexually impure), except while passing through,}. 111 What supports this statement by Yazid bin Abi Habib, may Allah have mercy upon him, is

An-Nisd' (Part-5 Description of Tayammum Allah said, \$ rq* p 3 ft i >*- iand if you are ill , or on a journey, or one of you comes from the Gha'it (toilet), or from Ldmastum (touching) women, but you do not find water, then perform Tayammum with clean earth, rubbing your face and hands. Truly, Allah is Ever Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving.} As for the type of illness which would allow Tayammum, it is an illness that one fears would be aggravated by using water, which could be detrimental to a part of the body, or when doing so would prolong an illness. Some scholars said that any type of illness warrants Tayammum, because of the general indications of the Ayah. As for travelling on a journey, it is known, regardless of its length. Allah then said, u pi S3 ft} ior comes from the Gha'it}. The Gha it is, literally, the flat land ,1 and this part of the Ayah refers to the minor impurity. Allah then said, 3 ft} ior you Ldmastum women}, which was recited Lamastum and Ldmastum, referring to sexual intercourse. For instance, Allah said in another Ayah, 4, fSj u Jq b> eft ft 45 oj j } 4 And if you divorce them before you have touched them, and you have appointed unto them the dowry, then pay half of that} [2:237], and. p a ftp* 'ft iSi XftX ft\ } 40 you who believe! When you marry believing women, and m That is , where one goes to relieve oneself.

then divorce them before you have touched them, no 'iddah (period of waiting) have you to count in respect of than^ [33 :49]. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said that Allah's statement, }or Lamastum women^ refers to sexual intercourse. It was reported that Ali, Ubayy bin Kala, Mujahid, Tawus, Al-Hasan, Tjbayd bin Umayr, Said bin Jubayr, Ash-Shalii, Qatadah and Muqatil bin Hayyan said similarly. Allah said, X \j4 ibut you do not find water, then perform Tayammum with clean earth,} In the Two Sahih, it is recorded that Imran bin Husayn said, vIUu U j *Ai Ij* : Jlii ^ (** Jig)1 J _^j jj j b *,_jb 1S J>-y! c-Ui 3' j , "Allah's Messenger saw a person sitting away from the people and not praying with them. He asked him, 'O so-and-so! What prevented you from offering the prayer with the people, are not you

oiUJl JU lil J were given preference over people in three things. Our lines (in prayer) were arranged in rows to resemble the rows of the angels, all of the earth was made a Masjid for us, and its dust was made clean for us when there is no water. "(1 The Messenger sg mentioned the favor of making dust a purifier for us, and if there were any other substance to replace it for Tayammum, he would have mentioned it. Imam

An-Nisa' (Part-5) AT mm '*lud6 ' >"* I ' ' .1f"- Oj!jiiJ 2^a"1 o^f*^ '0.}?>*; 1) oj Allah said in this Ayah, k jfetc&& grubbing your faces and hands. Truly , Allah is Ever Oft-Pardoning Oft-Forgiving .)> meaning, a part of His pardoning and forgiving is that He allows you to use Tayammum and to pray after using it when there is no water, to make things easy for you. This Ayah sanctifies the position of

the prayer, it being too sacred than to be performed in a defecient manner, like in a state of drunkenness, until one becomes aware of what he is saying, or sexually impure, until he bathes (GhusQ, or after answering the call of nature, until he performs ablution. There are exceptions when one is ill or when there is no water. In this case, Allah allows us to use Tayammum, out of His mercy and kindness for His servants, and to facilitate them, all praise is due to Allah. laj 1-)J-5{j^ jA ill) jIUjCjl OJjb Ju jVylJo jl * \ Kf' -J * \ - V/ # 0yytojOjaIla) Ca ~ \$ SL^i lyLC- JliI? iil

The Reason behind allowing Tayammum

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1171–1173]

what A ishaah has done! She has made Allah s Messenger and the people stay where there is no source ofwater and they have no water with them. Abu Bakr came while Allah s Messenger jg was sleeping with his head on my thigh. He said to me, "You have detained Allah s Messenger and the people where there is no source of water and they have no water with them. So he admonished me and said what Allah wished him to say and hit me on my flank with his hand. Nothing prevented me from moving (because of pain) but the position of Allah s Messenger on my thigh. Allah s Messenger jg got up when dawn broke and there was no water. So Allah revealed the verses of Tayammum, and they all performed Tayammum. Usayd bin Hudayr said, O the family of Abu Bakr! This is not the first blessing of yours. Then the camel on which I was riding was moved from its place and the necklace was found beneath it.

and more proper ; but Allah has cursed them for their disbelief, so they believe not except a feiv.\$ Chastising theJews forChoosing Misguidance, Altering Allah s Words, and Mocking Islam Allah states that the Jews, may Allah s continued curse fall on them until the Day of Resurrection, have purchased the wrong path instead of guidance, and ignored what Allah sent down to His Messenger Muhammad g . They also ignored the knowledge that they inherited from previous Prophets, about

the description of Muhammad 5S5 , so that they may have a

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1173–1183]

small amount of the delights of this life. iand wishing that you should go astrayfrom the right path> for they would like that you disbelieve in what was sent down to you, O believers, and that you abandon the guidance and beneficial knowledge that you have. \$Allah has full knowledge ofyour enemies> meaning, Allah has better knowledge of your enemies, and He warns you against them. iand Allah is sufficient as a Wali (Protector), and Allah is Sufficient as a Helper He is a Sufficient Protector for those who seek refuge with Him and a Sufficient Supporter for those who seek His help. Allah then said, 4 u ithere are some who displace wordsfrom (their) right places } meaning, they intentionally and falsely alter the meanings of the Words of Allah and explain them in a different manner than what Allah meant, 4And say 'We hear your word and disobey^ saying, We hear what you say, O Muhammad, but we do not

obey you in it, as Mujahid and Ibn Zayd explained. 111 This is the implied meaning of the Ayah, and it demonstrates the Jews disbelief, stubbornness and disregard for Allah s Book after they understood it,

all the while aware of the sin and punishment that this behavior will earn for them. Allah's statement, 4And "Hear and let you hear nothing. means, hear our words, may you never hear anything, as Ad-Dahhak reported from Ibn Abbas. 121 This is the Jews way of mocking and jesting, may Allah's curse descend on them. 4And Ra'ina, zoith a twist of their tongues and as a mockery of the religion meaning, they pretend to say, Hear us, when they say, Ra'ina (an insult in Hebrew, but in Arabic it means Listen to us.). Yet, their true aim is to curse the Prophet jg. We mentioned this subject when we explained Allah's statement, i&A ijSJj y \p\ 40 you who believe! Say not Ra'ina but say Utizurnd (make us understand)>. Therefore, Allah said about them, while they pretend to say other than what they truly mean, 4l"J' 4 ^ iWith a twist of their tongues and as a mockery of the religion> because of their cursing the Prophet afe. Allah then said, * a m gs as; y 4And if only they had said : "We hear and obey", and "Do make us understand," it zvould have been better for them, and more proper; but Allah has cursed them for their disbelief, so At-Tabari 8 :433 At-Tabari 8 :434

they believe not except a feiv .> meaning, their hearts are cast away from the path of righteousness and therefore, no beneficial part of faith enters it. Earlier, when we explained, 4y & tfjS 4so little is that which they believe which means they do not have beneficial faith. 'J ^ j:t sig ^ CT^ i ui" yj' joii j jj u **i As~i & yyy 447. O you who have been given the Scripture (Jews and Christians)! Believe in what We have revealed confirming what is ivith you, before We efface faces and turn them backwards or curse them as We cursed the people of the Sabbath. And the commandment of Allah is always executed 448. Verily, Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with Him (in worship), but Heforgives except that to whom He wills; and whoever sets up partners with Allah in worship, he has indeed invented a tremendous sin. Calling the People of the Book to Embrace the Faith, Warningthem Against Doing Otherwise Allah commands the People of the Scriptures to believe in what He has sent down to His servant and Messenger, Muhammad jg, the Glorious Book that conforms to the good news that they already have about Muhammad He also warns them, 4before We efface faces and turn them backwards> Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said that effacing here refers to blindness, 4and turn them backioards meaning. We put their faces on

their backs, and make them walk backwards, since their eyes will be in their backs. 111 Similar was said by Qatadah and Atiyah Al- Awfi. 121 This makes the punishment even more severe, and it is a parable that Allah set for ignoring the truth, preferring the wrong way and turning away from the plain path for the paths of misguidance. Therefore, such people walk backwards. Similarly, some said that Allah's statement, (*-f> iuil pf&d 3 Lu>- 4 Verily, We have put on their necks iron collars reaching to the chins, so that their heads are raised up. And We have put a barrier before them that is a parable that Allah gave for their deviation and hindrance from guidance. Ka*b Al-Ahbar Embraces Islam Upon Hearing thisAyah [4:47] It was reported that Kab Al-Ahbar became

An-Nisd' (Part-5) feeling sad, Ujjj 0--.W> J Jj U lix^i Gy G ijl*. 'A> yo" who have been given the Scripture (Jews and Christians)! Believe in what We have revealed confirming what is with you, before We effacefaces and turn them backwards}. Ka*b said, believe, O Lord! I embraced Islam, O Lord! for He feared that this might be struck by this threat. He then went back to his family in Yemen and returned with them all as Muslims. 111 Allah's statement, & TS3 CT #SB }X 4or curse them as We cursed the people of the Sabbath.} refers to those who breached the sanctity of the Sabbath, using

deceit, for the purpose of doing more work. Allah changed these people into apes and swine, as we will come to know in the explanation of Surat Al-Araf (7). Allah's statement, "And the commandment of Allah is always executed." means, when He commands something, then no one can dispute or resist His command. Allah Does not Forgive Shirk, Except After Repenting From it Allah said that He, if forgives not that partners should be set up with Him (in worship), meaning, He does not forgive a servant if he meets Him while he is associating partners with Him, 6ji C fuij} m At-Tabari 8 :446

and whoever sets up partners with Allah in worship, he has indeed invented a tremendous sin it is similar to His statement, i^ Fath Al-Bari 10 :294 and Muslim 1 :95 ' Kashf Al-Astar 4 :84 ^ asstii

a'. jLjl 449. Have you not seen those who claim sanctity for themselves? Nay, but Allah sanctifies whom He wills, and they will not be dealt with injustice even equal to the extent of a Fatil.} 450. Look, how they invent a lie against Allah, and enough is that as a manifest sin.} 451 . Have you not seen those who were given a portion of the Scripture? They believe in Jibt and Tdghut and say to those who disbelieve,

said, This Ayah was revealed concerning their statement, iWe are the children of Allah and His loved ones} and their statement, ofA S\ Sitr % J} iNone shall enter Paradise unless he be a Jew or a Christian}. * This is why Allah said, 4'<&. J* -it 4Nay, but Allah sanctifies whom He wills,} meaning, the decision in this matter is with Allah Alone, because He has perfect knowledge of the true reality and secrets of all things. Allah then said, 4U oA& \$And they will not be dealt with injustice even equal to the extent of a Fatil,} meaning, He does no injustice with anyone's compensation in any part of his reward, even if it was the weight of a Fatil Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ata , Al-Hasan, Qatadah and others among the Salaf said that Fatil means, The scaly thread in the long slit of the date-stone. 12* Allah said, 4'rffR ^Jif jc OJLMJ J3T \$a\} iLook, how they invent a lie against Allah,} claiming purity for themselves, their claim that they are Allah's children and His loved ones, their statement; 4%jZ ji ISA ofA S[ssyf j} iNone shall enter Paradise unless he be a Jew or a Christian} their statement; ip&S % Jdlf i j j}Tabari 8 :453 ,2* At-Tabari 8 :458,459

486 Tafsir Ibt Kathir iThe Fire shall not touch us but for a number of days} and their reliance on the righteous deeds of their forefathers. Allah has decreed that the good actions of the fathers do not help the children, when He said, U cjjf U LfJ oii- iil \$f} iTfjat was a nation who has passed away. They shall receive the reward of what they earned and you of what you earn}. Allah then said, and enough is that as a manifest sin.} meaning, these lies and fabrications of theirs are sufficient. Allah's statement, Si lib' ditM jl ffi} iHave you not seen those who were given a portion of the Scripture? They believe in Jibt and Tdghiit}. Muhammad bin Ishaq said from Hassan bin Fa'id that Umar bin Al-Khat{ab said, Jibt is sorcery and Tdghiit is the Shaytan. 111 Abu Nasr Ismail bin Hammad Al-Jawhari, the renowned scholar, said in his book As-Sihah, aAl-Jibt means idol, soothsayer and sorcerer. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Jabir bin Abdullah was asked about Taghut, and he said, They are soothsayers upon whom the devils descend. 121 Mujahid said Tdghiit is a devil in the shape of man, and they refer to him for judgment. 131 Imam Malik said, Taghut is every object that is worshipped instead of Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored. Disbelievers Are not Better Guided Than Believers Allah said, 4%^ i\$ Si Sfr& uii and say to those who disbelieve, "These people are better guided on the way," than the believers.} At-Jabari 8 :462 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :994 3| At-Tabari 8 :462

An-Nisd' (Part-5) preferring the disbelievers over

the battle of Al-Ahzab,121 forcing the Prophet jfe and his

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1183–1205]

Companions to dig a defensive tunnel around Al-Madlnah. But, Allah saved the Muslims from their evil, 4And Allah drove back those who disbelieved in their rage, they gained no advantage (booty). Allah sufficed for the believers in the fighting. And Allah is Ever All-Strong, All-Mighhfi. t 1 * Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :994, and At-Tabari 5 :133 121 See SuratAl-Ahzab (33)

t* J* Cyilj ."! js ,44 " 4Ch_> (cKift ^* -ii* ji ' 4 4. .L" ,ji i^uj .j, J^\\, 453 . Or have they a share in the dominion? Then in that case they would not give mankind even a Naqir.} 454. Or do they envy men for what Allah has given them of His bounty? Then, We have already given thefamily ofIbrahim the Book and Al-Hikmah, and conferred upon them a great kingdom. Of them were (some) who believed in it, and of them iver (some) who rejected it; and enough is Hellfor burning (them). The Envy and Miserly Conduct ofthe Jews Allah asked the Jews if they have a share in the dominion. That is merely a statement ofrebuke, since they do not have any share in the dominion. Allah then described them as misers, 4'P? tPlilf 5yjj V \ 4Then in that case they would not give mankind even a Naqir.} Meaning, if they had a share in the sovereignty and dominion, they would not give anyone anything, especially Muhammad jfc, even if it was the speck on the back of a date- stone, which is the meaning of Naqir according to Ibn Abbas and the majority of the scholars. This Ayah is similar to another ofAllah s statements, 4Say : ",Ifyou possessed the treasure of the mercy ofmy Lord, then you would surely withhold it out offear ofspending it.} meaning, for fear that what you have might end, although there is no such possibility here. This only demonstrates their greedy and stingy nature. This is why Allah said, hpPym 4And man is ever Qatiir\$ meaning Bakhil (stingy). Allah then said,

An-Nisd' (Part-5) 40r do they envy menfor what Allah has given them ofHis Bounty?} referring to their envy of the Prophet for the great prophethood that Allah entrusted him with. Their envy made them reject him, because he was an Arab and not from the Children of Israel. At-Tabarani recorded that Ibn Abbas said that, 40r do they envy men^ means, We are the worthy people, rather than the rest ofthe people. |11 Allah said, 4Jhen, We have already given the family of Ibrahim the Book and Al-Hikmah, and conferred upon them a great kingdom .} meaning, We gave the prophethood to the tribes of the Children of Israel, who are among the offspring of Ibrahim and sent down the Books to them. These Prophets ruled the Jews with the prophetic tradition, and We made kings among them. Yet, 4-* Ir ("r^ iOf them were (some) who believed in it;} referring to Allah s favor and bounty (Prophets, Books, kingship). . iand ofthem were (some) who rejected it} by disbelieving in it, ignoring it, and hindering the people from its path, although this bounty was from and for them, the Children of Israel. They disputed with their own Prophets; so what about you, O Muhammad s&, especially since you are not from the Children of Israel? Mujahid said, 40fthem were (some) who believed in [him],} Muhammad jg, Ay i a- [1 * At-Tabarani 1 1 :146

iand ofthem were (some) who rejected [him].) ^ Therefore, O Muhammad, the rejection of you because of their disbelief is even more severe and they are even further from the truth that you brought them.

This is why Allah threatened them, and enough is Hell for bunting (them).), meaning, the Fire is a just punishment for them because of their disbelief, rebellion and defiance of Allah's Books and Messengers. LA be* (**"jS*- Os' ijii ppUai jfit VI? tj 6,1 Ijj Qje j; J/? 456. Surely, those who disbelieved in Our Ayat, We shall burn them in Fire. As often as their skins are roasted through, We shall change them for other skins that they may taste the punishment. Truly, Allah is Ever Most Powerful, All-Wise.) 457. But those who believe and do deeds of righteousness, We shall admit them to Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise), abiding therein forever. Therein they shall have Azwajun Mutahharatun (purified mates), and We shall admit them to shades, wide and ever deepening.) The Punishment of Those Who Disbelieve in Allah's Books and Messengers Allah describes the torment in the Fire of Jahannam for those who disbelieve in His Ayat and hinder from the path of His Messengers. Allah said, iSurely, those who disbelieved in Our Ayat ,) meaning, We will place them in the Fire which will encompass every part of their bodies. Allah then states that their punishment and torment are everlasting, Tabari 8:482, meaning the personal pronoun Ha was understood by him to be him rather than it .

il&\ iy/xi 's ^Si; pisjtWe s/ia/Z burn them in Fire. As often as their skins are roasted through, We shall change them for other skins that they may taste the punishment}. Al-A mash said that Ibn Umar said, When their skin are burned, they will be given another skin in replacement, and this skin will be as white as paper. 11 This was collected by Ibn Abi Hatim, who also recorded that Al-Hasan said, 4A\$ often as their skins are roasted through,} Their skin will be roasted through, seventy thousand times every day. Husayn said; Fudayl added that Hisham said that Al-Hasan also said that, 4As often as their skins are roasted through, means, Whenever the Fire has roasted them through and consumed their flesh, they will be told, Go back as you were before, and they will. 12' The Wealth of the Righteous; Paradise and its Joy Allah said, 4Q it#. y*T\ \pabM iBut those who believe and do deeds of righteousness, We shall admit them to Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise), abiding therein forever.} describing the destination of the happy ones in the gardens of Eden, beneath which rivers flow in all of its areas, spaces and corners, wherever they desire and wish. They will reside in it for eternity, and they will not be transferred or removed from it, nor would they want to move from it. Allah said, i*Z At-Tabari 8 :484 121 Al-Tabari 8 :485

iTherein they shall have Azwajun Mutahharatun (purified mates), free of menstruation, postnatal bleeding, filth, bad manners and shortcomings. Ibn Abbas said that the Ayah means, They are purified of filth and foul things. 11 ' Similar was said by Ata , Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, An-Nakhal, Abu Salih, Atiyah, and As-Suddi.'2 Mujahid said that they are, free of urine, menstruation, spit, mucous and pregnancies. Allah's statement, &} AAnd We shall admit them to shades, wide and ever deepening (Paradise).} means, wide, extensive, pure and elegant shade. Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet jg said, i'fiJ : giki; v au 4kj 444)1 Vjklj &jjj jj. There is a tree in Paradise, that if a rider travels under its shade for a hundred years, he will not cross it. It is the Tree of Everlasting Life. n' ^ - r ^ -v / M">; ol ol 458. Verily, Allah commands that you should render back the trusts to those, to whom they are due; and that when you judge between men, you judge with justice. Verily, how excellent is the teaching which He (Allah) gives you! Truly, Allah is Ever All-Hearer, All-Seer.} The Command to Return the Trusts to Whomever They Are Due Allah commands that the trusts be returned to their rightful

owners. Al-Hasan narrated that Samurah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "Return the trust to those who entrusted you, and do not betray those who betrayed you." Imam

Verily, Allah commands that you should render back the trusts to those, to whom they are due}. May I sacrifice my father and mother for him, I never heard him recite this Ayah before that." It is popular that this is

the reason behind revealing the Ayah (4:58). Yet, the application of the Ayah is general, and this is why Ibn Abbas and Muhammad bin Al-Hanafiyyah said, This Ayah is for the righteous and wicked, meaning it is a command that encompasses everyone. The Order to Be Just Allah said, and that when you judge between men, you judge with justice.} commanding justice when judging between people. Muhammad bin Ka'b, Zayd bin Aslam and Shahr bin Hawshab said; This Ayah was revealed about those in authority, meaning those who judge between people. A Hadith states, "Allah is with the judge as long as he does not commit injustice, for when he does, Allah will make him reliant on himself." A statement goes, One day of justice equals forty years of worship. Allah said, Verily, how excellent is the teaching which He (Allah) gives you! At-Tabari 8:492, as well as others. The narrations, about the revelation of the Ayah, and the statement of Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, are not authentic. There is, however a narration supporting the remainder of the information with Al-Bukhari, no. At-Tabari 8:490 Ibn Majah 2:775 ^ Al-Kanz 6:12

meaning, His commands to return the trusts to their owners, to judge between people with justice, and all of His complete, perfect and great commandments and laws. Allah's statement, Truly, Allah is Ever All-Hearer, All-Seer.} means, He hears your statements and knows your actions. And app 4% A ! & * ltd Sit <# } 4f?t%\z %& jSi jt 4 &.% \$ 459. O you who believe! Obey Allah and obey the Messenger, and those of you who are in authority. If you differ in anything among yourselves, refer it to Allah and His Messenger, if you believe in Allah and in the Last Day. That is better and more suitable for final determination.} The Necessity of Obeying the Rulers in Obedience to Allah

from the Fire to Allah's Messenger. Therefore, do not rush until you go back to Allah's Messenger, and if he commands you to enter it, then enter it. When they went back to Allah's Messenger ﷺ, they told him what had happened, and the Messenger ﷺ said, "If you entered it, you would never have departed from it. Obedience is only in righteousness, n 11 This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahths.

498 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir j Uilji uli" "Obedience is only in righteousness." [The Necessity of Referring to the Qur'an and Sunnah for Judgment Allah said, Ji w? a i(And) if you differ in anything amongst yourselves, refer it to Allah and His Messenger}. Mujahid and several others among the Salaf said that the Ayah means, (Refer) to the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger. This is a command from Allah that whatever areas the people dispute about, whether major or minor areas of the religion, they are required to refer to the Qur'an and Sunnah for judgment concerning these disputes. In another Ayah, Allah said, J amm AA OyOliM dills 'j"Jiltj ^to \$6, Si ijil ls ^J 4\$ iba3 jj -piU. 4-And in whatsoever you differ, the decision thereof is with Allah}. Therefore, whatever the Book and Sunnah decide and testify to the truth of, then it, is the plain truth. What is beyond truth, save falsehood? This is why Allah said, Ai-Bdri 13:130 At-Jabari 8:504

< if you believe in Allah and in the Last Day.} meaning, refer the disputes and conflicts that arise between you to the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger for judgment. Allah's statement, p o'> if you believe in Allah and in the Last Day.} indicates that those who do not refer to the Book and Sunnah for judgment in their disputes, are not believers in Allah or the Last Day. Allah said, iThat is better} meaning, referring to the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger for judgment in various disputes is better, iand more suitable for final determination.} meaning, Has a better end and destination, as As-Suddi and several others have stated * while Mujahid said, Carries a better reward. ot OULi jll Lj "iU[tL *>- "" ji+it olrjl' p} ol 4 LOS3 cJ VJ ^ Sjli. ^ jis^^ p te f^ P Hi** tL* f.rSjii ii f j }1 jJjCUS il^i tSX,1 oi A^ i60. Have you not seen those (hypocrites) who claim that they believe in that which has been sent down to you, and that which was sent down before you, and they wish to go for judgment (in their disputes) to the Taghut while they have been Tabari 8 :506 At-Tabari 8 :506

ordered to reject them. But Shaytan wishes to lead them far astray 461 . And when it is said to them : "Come to what Allah has sent down and to the Messenger," you see the hypocrites turn away from you with aversion. 462. How then, when a catastrophe befalls them because of what their hands have sent forth, they come to you swearing by Allah, 'We meant no more than goodwill and conciliation!'" 463. They (hypocrites) are those of whom Allah knows what is in their hearts; so turn aside from them (do not punish them) but admonish them, and speak to them an effective word to reach their inner selves.} Referring to Other than the Qur'an and Sunnah for Judgment is Characteristic of Non-Muslims Allah chastises those who claim to believe in what Allah has sent down to His Messenger jg and to the earlier Prophets, yet they refer to other than the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger jg for judgment in various disputes. It was reported that the reason behind revealing this Ayah was that a man from the Ansar and a Jew had a dispute, and the Jew said, Let us refer to Muhammad to judge between us. However, the Muslim man said, Let us refer to Kah bin Al- Ashraf (a Jew) to judge between us. It was also reported that the Ayah was revealed about some hypocrites who pretended to be Muslims, yet they sought to refer to the judgment of Jahiliyyah. Other reasons were also reported behind the revelation of the Ayah. However, the Ayah has a general meaning, as it chastises all those who refrain from referring to the Qur'an and Sunnah for judgment and prefer the judgment of whatever they chose of falsehood, which befits the description of Taghut here. This is why Allah said, 4and they wish to go for judgment to the Taghut until the end of the Ayah. Allah's statement, 4tum away from you with aversion

means, they turn away from you in arrogance, just as Allah described the polytheists, ivzc& c ft s.\$&3 iWhen it is said to them: "Follow what Allah has sent down. They say : "Nay! We shall follow what we found our fathers following This is different from the conduct of the faithful believers, whom Allah describes as, ij j ft \$ ji iSj c&gx 'sf& iThe only saying of the faithful believers, when they are called, to Allah and His Messenger, to judge between them, is that they say: "We hear and we obey Chastising the Hypocrites Chastising the hypocrites, Allah said, 4How then, when a catastrophe befalls them because of what their hands have sent forth,)> meaning, how about it if they feel compelled to join you because of disasters that they suffer due to their sins, then they will be in need of you. iThey come to you swearing by Allah, "We meant no more than goodtoill and conciliation! \$ apologizing and swearing that they only sought goodwill and reconciliation when they referred to other than the Prophet for judgment, not that they believe in such alternative judgment, as they claim. Allah describes these people to us

further in His statement, * X . . s' > *i . r .y. v 4And you see those in whose hearts there is a disease (of hypocrisy), they hurry to their friendship, saying: We fear"4, until.

iThen they will become regretful for what they have been keeping as a secret in themselves}. At-Tabarani recorded that Ibn Abbas said, Abu Barzah Al- Aslami used to be a soothsayer who judged between the Jews in their disputes. When some Muslims came to him to judge between them, Allah sent down, x* Jjil Uj U [Av i l*-*' iHave you not seen those (hypocrites) who claim that they believe in that which has been sent down to you, and that which was sent down before you}, until, i"We meant no more than goodwill and conciliation/"V Allah then said, 4 6& p-*i iThey (hypocrites) are those ofwhom Allah knows what is in their hearts;} These people are hypocrites, and Allah knows what is in their hearts and will punish them accordingly, for nothing escapes Allah s watch. Consequently, O Muhammad! Let Allah be sufficient for you in this regard, because He has perfect knowledge of their apparent and hidden affairs. This is why Allah said, iso turn asidefrom them (do not punish them)} meaning, do not punish them because of what is in their hearts. ibut admonish them} means, advise them against the hypocrisy and evil that reside in their hearts, i'A-k iand speak to them an effective word to reach their inner m At-Tabarani 1 1 :373

An-Nisd' (Part-5) selves} advise them, between you and them, using effective words that might benefit them. 'i&ZX \Z& it ljS& Upfi it IjZZXUte -4 'A-#- ^ i&a, Jilit 464. We se"f mo Messenger, but to be obeyed by Allah s leave. If they, when they were unjust to themselves, had come to you and begged Allah's forgiveness, and the Messenger had begged forgiveness for them, indeed, they would havefound Allah All- Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 465. But no, by your Lord, they can have no faith, until they make you judge in all disputes between them, and find in themselves no resistance against your decisions, and accept (them) with full submission.} The Necessity ofObeying the Messenger^ Allah said, ifpQ vt " Z'f} 4We sent no Messenger, but to be obeyed} meaning, obeying the Prophet was ordained for those to whom Allah sends the Prophet. Allah s statement, iby Allah's leave} means, None shall obey, except by My leave, according to Mujahid. * This Ayah indicates that the Prophets are only obeyed by whomever Allah directs to obedience. In another Ayah, Allah said, iAnd Allah did indeed fulfill His promise to you when you were killing them (your enemy) with His permission } (I) At-Tabari 8:516

meaning, by His command, decree, will and because He granted you superiority over them. Allah s statement, }Ifthey (hypocrites), when they had been unjust to themselves,} directs the sinners and evildoers, when they commit errors and mistakes, to come to the Messenger so that they ask Allah for forgiveness in his presence and ask him to supplicate to Allah to forgive them. If they do this, Allah will forgive them and award them His mercy and pardon. This is why Allah said, tS'ji V-*rr)} 4they would havefound Allah All-Forgiving (One Whoforgives and accepts repentance), Most Merciful}. One DoesnotBecome a BelieverUnlessHe Refersto the Messenger forJudgment and Submits to his Decisions Allah said, ii*- But no, by your Lord, they can have no faith, until they make you judge in all disputes between them,} Allah swears by His Glorious, Most Honorable Self, that no one shall attain faith until he refers to the Messenger jg for judgment in all matters. Thereafter, whatever the Messenger sg commands, is the plain truth that must be submitted to inwardly and outwardly. Allah said, 4L& CJ-4 iand find in themselves no resistance against your decisions, and accept (them) with full

submission.} meaning: they adhere to your judgment, and thus do not feel any hesitation over your decision, and they submit to it inwardly and outwardly. They submit to the Prophet's decision with total submission without any rejection, denial or dispute.

aaaijg aa :%s p ^s, iri 'j'pSsl , a~i V _jLl3 (ji jjjj l" ll A J ^_J 4j\jjaj^ "V^"4 v , ^ ^ ^ ^-3UJ^ul-aJ'j 11J^ii Ij Ovi^uiMj ^ j-^* jj;S ^ \Ljjibjj1 ,#2jfa j6?l^j3\$St ^'02l^?3S^o0j f | 'ju^i ^ > ;Ujl J-d jj !;j Ij Jil" J! O Zubayr! Irrigate (your garden) first, and then let the water flow to your neighbor ." The Ansari became angry and said, O Allah's Messenger! Is it because he is your cousin? On that, the face of Allah's Messenger jg changed color (because of anger) and said,)s+Ss -4 * * r2< 4j&jij d_jjik_33 3<_JjojlJjjLi rtJJJ-J-j L*-'tUJl 1_r^"-l !^j U r JI ct^ J 5- "iijU. ;di j-;f "Irrigate (your garden), O Zubayr, and then withhold the water until it reaches the xuals (sur- rounding the palms). Then, release the zuater to your neighbor." So, Allah's Messenger jg gave Az-Zubayr his full right when the Ansari made him angry. Before that, Allah's Messenger jg had given a generous judgment, beneficial for Az-Zubayr and the Ansari. Az-Zubayr said, I think the following verse was revealed concerning that case, -s" &- ^ Qjj iBut no, by your Lord, they can have no faith, until they make you (O Muhammad g) judge in all disputes between them.y |1 > m Path Al-Bari 8 :103

,if ijjj /iV jJj J-siuJl oi pr^ y'- Ar. ^ <(66. And if We had ordered them (saying),

467. And indeed We would then have bestowed upon them a great reward from Ourselves.} 468. And indeed We would have guided them to the straight way.} 469. And whoever obeys Allah and the Messenger, then they will be in the company of those on whom Allah has bestowed His grace, of the Prophets, the Siddiqin, the martyrs, and the righteous. And how excellent these companions are!} 470. Such is the bounty from Allah, and Allah is sufficient as All-Knower.} Most People Disobey What They Are Ordered Allah states that even if the people were commanded to commit what they were prohibited from doing, most of them would not submit to this command, for their wicked nature is such that they dispute orders. Allah has complete knowledge of what has not occurred, and how it would be if and when it did occur. This is why Allah said, Q*it 4 ucT \$; } 4And if We had ordered them (saying), "Kill yourselves (i.e. the innocent ones kill the guilty ones) } until the end of the Ayah. This is why Allah said, ijLi fi } 4but if they had done what they were told,} meaning, if they do what they were commanded and refrain from what they were prohibited, 4 4 - S&} 4it would have been better for them,} than disobeying the command and committing the prohibition, 4and would have strengthened their conviction}, stronger Tasdiq (conviction of faith), according to As-Suddi.

weak and I heard him saying, tT-yijj Si (^: "*">' (t*S^ Sj' g} 4 i f/ie company of those on whom Allah has bestowed His grace, the Prophets, the true believers (Siddiqin), the martyrs and the righteous} I knew then that he was being given the choice. recorded this Hadith.l2] This Hadith explains the meaning of another Hadith; the Prophet ss said before his death; JkVi jJ J [J]"

The Reason Behind Revealing this Honorable Ayah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1205–1223]

Ibn Jarir recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, An Ansari man came to the Messenger of Allah sg while feeling sad. The Prophet said to him, Why do I see you sad? He said, O Allah's Prophet! I was

contemplating about something. The Prophet sg said, What is it? The Ansari said, We come to you day and night, looking at your face and sitting by you. Tomorrow, you will be raised with the Prophets, and we will not be able to see you. The Prophet jg did not say anything, but later Jibril came down to him with this Ayah, $\text{Si}^* | ! \text{Si i}^* \text{"" Syi' i}$ And whoever obeys Allah and the Messenger then they will be in the company of those on whom Allah has bestowed His grace, of the Prophets}, and the Prophet sent the good news to the Ansari man. ' This Hadith was narrated in Mursal form ' from Masruq, Ikrimah, Amir Ash-Shalji, Qatadah and Ar-Rabx bin Anas. This is the version with the best chain of narrators. Abu Bakr bin Marduwyah recorded it with a different chain from A ishah, Al-Bari 8 : 103 4:1893 4:1894 At-Tabari 8 :534 * The chain of narration is missing the name of the Companion

Whoever dies in f/iis state will be with the Prophets, the truthful and martyrs on the Day of Resurrection, as long as - and he raised his finger - he is not disobedient to his parents, n 111 Only

512 Tafstr Ibt Kathfr forth (on an expedition) in parties, or go forth all together. 472. There is certainly among you he who would linger behind. If a misfortune befalls you, he says, "Indeed Allah has favored me in that I was not present among them."} 473. But if a bounty comes to you from Allah, he would surely say - as if there had never been ties of affection between you and him, "Oh! I wish I had been with them; then I would have achieved a great success."} 474. So fight those who trade the life of this world with the Hereafter, in the cause of Allah, and whoever fights in the cause of Allah, and is killed or gets victory, We shall bestow on him a great reward. The Necessity of Taking Necessary Precautions Against the Enemy Allah commands His faithful servants to take precautions against their enemies, by being prepared with the necessary weapons and supplies, and increasing the number of troops fighting in His cause. 4in parties} means, group after group, party after party, and expedition after expedition. Ali bin Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said that, 4and either go forth in parties} means, In groups, expedition after expedition, 4 $\wedge \sim = r \text{ l}$ } 4or go forth all together}, means, all of you. 121 Similar was reported from Mujahid, Ikrimah, As-Suddi, Qatadah, Ad- * There is a difference of opinion over the statement translated here as; those who trade the life of this world with the Hereafter. It could mean ; sold the life of this world for the sake of the Hereafter , or; purchased the life of this world at the expense of the Hereafter. So it is either an order for those of conviction to fight, or an order to those whose hearts waver in faith, who are quoted in the previous Ayah, to fight with sincerity, not for wordly matters. Most of the commentators see it as the first example. At-Jabari 8 :537

Dahhak, Ata Al-Khurrasani, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Khusayf Al-Jazari. Refraining from Joining Jihad is a Sign of Hypocrites Allah said, iThere is certainly among you he who ivould linger behind.} Mujahid and others said that this Ayah was revealed about the hypocrites.'2 Muqatil bin Hayyan said that, ^linger behind means, stays behind and does not join Jihad. It is also possible that this person himself lingers behind, while luring others away from joining Jihad. For instance, Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul, may Allah curse him, used to linger behind and lure other people to do the same and refrain from joining Jihad, as Ibn Jurayj and Ibn Jarir stated. This is why Allah said about the hypocrite, that when he lingers behind from Jihad, then: }If a misfortune befalls you} death, martyrdom, or - by Allah s wisdom - being defeated by the enemy, 4'V M2& * k& ti} ihe says, "Indeed Allah has favored me that I was not present among them. } meaning, since I did not join them in battle. Because he considers this one of Allah s favors on him, unaware of the reward that he might have gained from enduring war or martyrdom, if he

was killed. iBut ifa bounty comes to youfrom Allah} such as victory, triumph and booty, m At-Jabari 8 : 537-538 At-Tabari 8 :538

J tmm K3 X " 2j, Ji\ajlaly&r l4j J tJ!'j jii LJ bl,j iiijJ l)tgb\U'i) f } ' / '<' X ^ *. . * **{ 1 C)^J6 j j\j Att' y4wijUJ * L/WaUjl 1 o 40j 4 -..^f i.^-V- ir r 'r^r-r^arr-i:".*: Qlp&%\$ &%u 5 * - .-> . -t . \"< ,. / 1 *, V'-r""ljly)A^|,4^o!j^ L^jll{^jjL: >-b^!Ua 'b bjJj-b * ft > lJ-ji ^j^bllbbi^jljtiL-ij,^ ;: #3 ^ otr i*")/"// T "> <(/ie womW surely say - as 1 / f/iere had never been ties of affection be- tween you and him,} meaning, as if he was not a follower of your religion, 5\$^ 'S> 4" Oh! I wish I had been with them ; then I would have achieved a great success. } by being assigned a share of the booty and taking possession of that share. This is his ultimate aim and objective. The Encouragement to Participation in Jihad Allah then said, 4Sofight} the believer with an aversion (to fighting), Q' s J< 'M d> ithose who trade the life of this world with the Hereafter} referring to those sell their religion for the meager goods of the world, and they only do this because of their disbelief and lack of faith. Allah then said; 0 *i y SyIIi Syf- 4 j~ij J*j} 4And whoever fights in the cause ofAllah, and is killed or gets

An-Nisd' (Part-5) victory, We shall bestow on him a great reward.} meaning, whoever fights in the cause of Allah, whether he was killed or triumphant, he will earn an immense compensation and a great reward with Allah. The Two Sahihs recorded, jj ji illy; j| tjL-i JiaUtly ill I r* JA JI* U ' Allah has guaranteed the Mujahid in His cause that He will either bring death to him, admitting into Paradise; or, He will help him return safely to his home with whatever reward and booty he gained. jjii o'jyb 'j jif 4 v vi & j4-l" 'rl> j* u i+ul jt atjl j\p3 4 vjf*iij jit 4 6y~4 (jLX 4|' a? < 2if # Si. And what is wrong with you that you fight not in the cause of Allah, and for those weak, ill-treated and oppressed among men, women, and children, whose cry is: "Our Lord! Rescue us from this town whose people are oppressors; and raise for us from You one who will protect, and raise for us from You one who will help. } i76. Those who believe, fight in the cause of Allah, and those who disbelieve, fight in the cause of the Taghut. So fight against the friends of Shaytan ; ever feeble indeed is the plot of Shaytan.} Encouraging Jihad to Defend the Oppressed Allah encouraged His believing servants to perform Jihad in His cause and to strive hard to save the oppressed Muslims in Makkah, men, women and children who were restless because of having to remain there. This is why Allah said, * iii 14^ J\$} " Fath Al-Bari 6 :253 and Muslim 3 :1496

izvhose cry is: Our Lord! Rescue usfrom this town}, referring to Makkah. In a similar Ayah, Allah said, ' O? ot jff)} iAtid many a toion, stronger than your town which has driven you out} Allah then describes this town, izvhose people are oppressors; and raise for us from You one who zoill protect, and raisefor us from You one who will help} meaning, send protectors and helpers for us.

i77. Have you not seen those who were told to hold back their hands (from fighting) and perform Saldh and give Zakdh, but when the fighting was ordained for them, behold! a section of them fear men as theyfear Allalt or even more. They say: Our Lord! Why have You ordainedfor us fighting? Would that You granted us respite for a short period?" Say: "Short is the enjoyment of this world. The Hereafter is (far) better for him xoho fears Allah, and you shall not be dealt with unjustly even equal to the Fatil.} 478. "Wheresoever you may be, death will overtake you even if you are in fortresses built up strong and high! And if some good reaches them, they say, This isfrom Allah," but ifsome evil befalls them, they say, "This is from you." Say: "All things arefrom Allah," so what is wrong with these people that they

fail to understand any word?} 479. Whatever of good reaches you, is from Allah, but whatever of evil befalls you, is from yourself. And We have sent you as a Messenger to mankind, and Allah is sufficient as a Witness.} The Wish that the Order for Jihad be Delayed In the beginning of Islam, Muslims in Makkah were commanded to perform the prayer and pay some charity, so as to comfort the poor among them. They were also commanded to be forgiving and forbearing with the idolators and to observe patience with them at the time. However, they were eager and anticipating the time when they would be allowed to fight, so that they could punish their enemies. The situation at that time did not permit armed conflict for many reasons. For instance, Muslims were few at the time, compared to then- numerous enemies. The Muslims city was a sacred one and the most honored area on the earth, and this is why the command to fight was not revealed in Makkah. Later on when the Muslims controlled a town of their own, Al-Madinah, and had strength, power and support, Jihad was then legislated. Yet, when the command to fight was revealed, just as Muslims wished, some of them became weary and were very fearful of

Why is not a Surah sent down (for us)? But when a decisive is sent down, and fighting is mentioned Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said that Abdur- Rahman bin Awf and several of his companions came to the Prophet ﷺ while in Makkah and said, O Allah's Prophet! We were mighty when we were pagans, but when we embraced the faith, we became weak. The Prophet said,

him than this life. If M%} i and you shall not be dealt with unjustly even equal to the Fatil .} for your good deeds. Rather, you will earn your full rewards for them. This promise directs the focus of believers away from this life and makes them eager for the Hereafter, all the while encouraging them to fight in Jihad. There is No Escaping Death Allah said, $\text{iv\&\wedge j\wedge ii 3P\&m \wedge}$ Wheresoever you may be, death will overtake you even if you are in fortresses built up strong and high!} meaning, you shall certainly die and none of you shall ever escape death. Allah said, $\text{iWhatsoever is on it (the earth) will perish}$, $\text{\wedge js\> iEvryone shall taste death}$, and, $\text{jiii tj\> iAtid W/c}$ granted not to any human being immortality before you}. Therefore, every soul shall taste death and nothing can save any person from it, whether he performed Jihad or not. Everyone has an appointed time, and a limited term of life. In the illness that preceded his death, Khalid bin Al-Walld said, while in his bed, I participated in so and so number of battles, and every part of my body sustained an injury due to a stab or a shot. Yet here I am, I die in my bed! Let not the eyes of the cowards ever taste sleep. Allah's statement, $\text{gw 4 ieven ifyou are in fortresses built up strong and high!}$

An-Nisa' (Part-5) Allah's statement that all things are from Him means, everything occurs by the decision and decree of Allah, and His decision shall come to pass for both the righteous and the wicked, the faithful and the disbelievers. Allah then said while addressing His Messenger ﷺ , but refering to mankind in general. $\text{iWhatever ofgood reaches you, isfrom Allah\>}$ meaning, of Allah's bounty, favor, kindness and mercy. $\text{iu i' Zj\> iBut whatever of evil befalls you, is from yourself.}$, meaning because of you and due to your actions. Similarly, Allah said, $\text{4 J > O* lA'SU eLj (yi Zj\> iAnd whatever of misfortune befalls you, it is because of what your hands have earned. And He pardons much.}$ As-Suddi, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ibn Jurayj and Ibn Zayd said that, ifrom yourself means, because of your errors. Qatadah said that, iFrom yourself means, as punishment for you, O son of Adam, because of your sins. Allah said, $\text{iAnd We have sent you as a Messenger to mankind,}$ so that you convey to

them Allah's commandments, what He likes and is pleased with, and what He dislikes and refuses. & Allah is sufficient as a Witness.} that He has sent you. He is also Witness over you and them, having full knowledge in what you convey to them and the disbelief and rebellion with which they respond to the truth.

but when they leave you, a section of them spends all night in planning other than what you say. But Allah records their nightly (plots). So turn aside from them (do not punish them), and put your trust in Allah. And Allah is Ever All-Sufficient as a Disposer of affairs.} Obeying the Messenger is Obeying Allah Allah states that whoever obeys His servant and Messenger, Muhammad obeys Allah; and whoever disobeys him, disobeys Allah. Verily, whatever the Messenger says is not of his own desire, but a revelation inspired to him. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, & If you obey me, you obey Allah; and if you disobey me, you disobey Allah. !!

Whoever obeys me, obeys Allah; and whoever disobeys me, disobeys Allah. Whoever obeys the Amir (leader, ruler), obeys me; and whoever disobeys the Amir, disobeys me. " This Hadith was recorded in the Two Sahih. Allah's statement. fSt, Uj d_>> j} 4But he who turns away, then We have not sent you as a watcher over them.} means, do not worry about him. Your job is only to convey, and whoever obeys you, he will acquire happiness and success and you will gain a similar reward to that he earns. As for the one who turns away from you, he will gain failure and loss and you will not carry a burden because of what he does. A Hadith states, M. ! V vWhoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, will acquire guidance; and whoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger, will only harm himself. 3,31 The Foolishness of the Hypocrites Allah said, iThey say: We are obedient/'}. Allah states that the hypocrites pretend to be loyal and obedient. 4but when they leave you}, meaning, when they depart and are no longer with you, ("ri iijC 4a section of them spends all night in planning other than what 1 :252 I2 ' PathAl-Bari 6 :135 and Muslim 3 :1466 Muslim 2 :594

524 Tafsir Ibtisami Kathir you say}. They plot at night among themselves for other than what they pretend when they are with you. Allah said, 4But Allah records their nightly (plots).} meaning, He has full knowledge of their plots and records it through His command to His scribes, the angels who are responsible for recording the actions of the servants. This is a threat from Allah, stating that He knows what the hypocrites try to hide, their plotting in the night to defy the Messenger and oppose him, even though they pretend to be loyal and obedient to him. Allah will certainly punish them for this conduct. In a similar Ayah, Allah said, ilx iThey (Hypocrites) say: "We have believed in Allah and in the Messenger, and we obey,"} until the end of the Ayah. Allah's statement, iSo turn aside from them} means, pardon them, be forbearing with them, do not punish them, do not expose them to the people and do not fear them. \$'3 '&'\$*} and put your trust in Allah. And Allah is Ever All-Sufficient as a Disposer of affairs.} meaning, He is sufficient as Protector, Supporter and Helper for those who rely on Him and return to Him. A* d X* -jt <\$} VI \$ js vij% \$ LXS 482 . Do they not then consider the Qur'an carefully? Had it been from other than Allah, they would surely have found therein contradictions in abundance}.

483. When there comes to them some matter touching (public) safety or fear, they make it known (among the people); if only they had referred it to the Messenger or to those charged with authority among them, the proper investigators would have understood it from them (directly). Had it not been for

the grace and mercy of Allah upon you, you would have followed Shaytan, except a few of you.} The Qur'an is True Allah commands them to contemplate about the Qur'an and forbids them from ignoring it, or ignoring its wise meanings and eloquent words. Allah states that there are no inconsistencies, contradictions, conflicting statements or discrepancies in the Qur'an, because it is a revelation from the Most-Wise, Worthy of all praise. Therefore, the Qur'an is the truth coming from the Truth, Allah. This is why Allah said in another Ayah, 4Do they not then think deeply in the Qur'an, or are their hearts locked up (from understanding it)?} Allah then said, 4^ Jf- -Pi Cri O Sf 4Had it been from other than Allah,} meaning, had it been fraudulent and made up, as the ignorant idolators and . hypocrites assert in their hearts, {>=%\$} 4they would surely, have found therein contradictions}, discrepancies and inconsistencies, 4(jifo=o} 4in abundance}. However, this Qur'an is free of shortcomings, and therefore, it is from Allah. Similarly, Allah describes those who are firmly grounded in knowledge, 4 # 4We believe in it, all of it is from our Lord.>(3:7) meaning, the Muhkam sections (entirely clear) and the

Mutashabih sections (not entirely clear) of the Qur'an are all true. So they understand the not entirely clear from the clear, and thus gain guidance. As for those in whose heart is the disease of hypocrisy, they understand the Muhkam from the Mutashabih; thus only gaining misguidance. Allah praised those who have knowledge and criticized the wicked. Imam

An-Nisid' (Part-5) disagreements over the Boo/c. "''*

The Prohibition of Disclosing Unreliable and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1223–1230]

Uninvestigated News Allah said When there comes to them some matter touching (public) safety or fear, they make it known (among the people) chastising those who indulge in things before being sure of their truth, disclosing them, making them known and spreading their news, even though such news might not be true at all. In the introduction to his Sahih, Imam

the Messenger of Allah divorced his wives, he came from his house, entered the Masjid and found the people talking about this news. He could not wait and went to the Prophet to ask him about what had truly happened, asking him, Have you divorced your wives? The Prophet said, No. Umar said, I said, Allahu Akbar and mentioned the rest of the Hadith. In the narration that Muslim collected, Umar said, I asked, Have you divorced them? He said, No. So, I stood by the door of the Masjid and shouted with the loudest voice, The Messenger of Allah did not divorce his wives. Then, this Ayah was revealed, ^ lij vot^j J (HJ0_} 1 1>; IL"J 1jCJLs j* ^ ^S"f ;4qjiq ooKvi A^'V' \ >' '\". * " iqs^ //i 4Wheti there comes to them some matter touching (public) safety or fear, they make it known (among the people), if only they had referred it to the Messenger or to those charged with authority among them, the proper investigators would have understood it from them (directly).} So I properly investigated that matter. 111 m Fath Al-Bari 9 :187 and Muslim 2 : 1 105

This Ayah refers to proper investigation, or extraction of matters from their proper resources. Allah's statement, H4 *> iyou would have followed Shaytan except a few of you.} refers to the believers, as Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas.111 cpt vJiS2 o1 ii' - "> 'Jl 'j ji' J_IS ^ Ail a; fi?r |Td^- ''ij ^ "illf jlj 1^ SX. ""'..* *iil ^ ' -A".Cir* Jc^ cl* Si' 6^ Xfyjj 3,1* j IjJO juwii y v vi'f ** ff ^ i <* *f *'' ^ . ''/ *

iv < 4#4. 77ien fight in the cause of Allah, you are not tasked (held responsible) except for yourself, and incite the believers (to fight along with you), it may be that Allah will restrain the evil might of the disbelievers. And Allah is Stronger in might and Stronger in punishing.} 485. Whosoever intercedes for a good cause, will have the reward thereof; and whosoever intercedes for an evil cause, will have a share in its burden. And Allah is Ever All-Able to do everything.} 486. When you are greeted with a greeting, greet in return with what is better than it, or (at least) return it equally. Certainly, Allah is Ever a Careful Account Taker of all things.} 487. Allah! None has the right to be worshipped but He. Surely, He will gather you together on the Day of Resurrection about which there is no doubt. And who is truer in statement than Allah?} Allah Commands His Messenger^ to Perform Jihad Allah commands His servant and Messenger, Muhammad sfe, to himself fight in Jihad and not to be concerned about those who do not join Jihad. Hence Allah s statement, m At-Tabari 8 :575

4[*] iyou are not tasked (held responsible exceptfor yourself,\$ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Ishaq said, I asked Al- Bara bin Azib about a man who meets a hundred enemies and still fights them, would he be one of those referred to in Allah s statement, iAnd do not throw yourselves into destruction (by not spending your wealth in the cause of Allah)}? He said, Allah said to His Prophet, ij&Z 'i jii 4 iThen fight in the cause of Allah, you are not tasked (held responsible) except for yourself, and incite the believers (to fight along with you)}. Imam

An-Nisd (Part-5) "Stand up and march forth to a Paradise, as wide as the heavens and Earth .a There are many Hadiths that encourage Jihad.

religion and Muhammad as the Prophet, then he would rightfully acquire Paradise ." Abu Said liked these words and said, O Allah s Messenger! Repeat them for me. The Prophet jg repeated his words, then said. ^ U ji j *And (there is) another deed far which Allah raises the servant a hundred grades in Paradise, between each two grades is the distance beoheen heaven and Earth. Abu Said said, What is it, O Allah s Messenger ? He said, "Jihad in Allah's cause.* This Hadith was collected by Muslim. Allah s statement, & jX Jfc J lit J } iit may be that Allah zuill restrain the evil might of the disbelievers.> means, by your encouraging them to fight, their resolve will be strengthened to meet the enemy in battle, to defend Islam and its people and to endure and be patient against the enemy. Allah s statement, xiVj JISI 4And Allah is Stronger in might and Stronger in punishing.} means, He is able over them in this life and the Hereafter, just as He said in another Ayah, 'k.JfC. ijD jCij pfa. *i' iGi 4But if it had been Allah's will, He Himself could certainly have punished them (without you). But (He lets you fight) in order to test some ofyou with others} (47:4). 3:1501

Intercede and you will gain a reward of it. Yet, Allah shall decide whatever He wills by the words of His Prophet .

r*r60 iWhen you are greeted with a greeting, greet in return with

what is better than it, or (at least) return it equally

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1230–1239]

J ' rrr, fTT.J r f-T ^ h -s> '\$&c. ^LS.J ill iti JJj i^u jl o' pijjii j^/*ti- &i \%&\$ fi \$\$s 4 4 ^ Ji i;t c;^ f^t; af^ s.>>s^ ^ i4i iis^ ^ &i 5 #& ;J 4:*\ J iiOi^ -ia G &&1; 4SS. Then what is the matter with you that

you are divided into two parties about the hypocrites? Allah has cast them back because of what they have earned. Do you want to guide him whom Allah has made to go astray? And he whom Allah has made to go astray, you will never find for him a way.} 489. They wish that you reject faith, as they have rejected, and thus that you all become equal (like one another). So take not Awliyid' from them, till they emigrate in the way of Allah. But if they turn back, take (Iwld of) them and kill them wherever you find them, and take neither Awliyid nor helpers from them.} 490. Except those who join a group, between you and whom there is a treaty (of peace), or those who approach you with their breasts restraining from fighting you as well as fighting their own people. Had Allah willed, indeed He would have given them power over you, and they would have fought you. So, if they withdraw from you, and fight not against you, and offer you peace, then Allah has made no way for you against them.} 491. You will find others that wish to lure security from you and security from their people. Every time they are sent back to Fitnah, they yield thereto. If they withdraw not from you, nor offer you peace, nor restrain their hands, take (Itold of) them and kill them wherever you Thaqiftumiihum . In their case, We have provided you with a clear warrant against them.}

Censuring the Companions for Disagreeing over the Hypocrites who Returned to Al-Madinah Before Uhud Allah criticizes the believers for disagreeing over the hypocrites. There are conflicting opinions over the reason behind revealing this Ayah. Imam

Ati-Nisd' (Part-5) 4So take not Awliyid' from them, till they emigrate in the way of Allah. But if they turn back,} if they abandon Hijrah, as Al- Awfi reported from Ibn Abbas. As-Suddi said that this part of the Ayah means, If they make their disbelief public. Combatants and Noncombatants Allah excluded some people; iExcept those who join a group, between you and whom there is a treaty (of peace), } meaning, except those who join and take refuge with a people with whom you have a pact of peace, or people of Dhimmah, then treat them as you treat the people with whom you have peace. This is the saying of As-Suddi, Ibn Zayd and Ibn Jarir. 121 In his Sahih,

540 Tafsir Ibn Kathir hesitation in their hearts because of their aversion to fighting the Muslims. They do not have the heart to fight with the Muslims against their own people. Therefore, they are neither with nor against Muslims. 4Had Allah willed, indeed He would have given them power over you, and they would have fought you .} meaning, it is from Allah's mercy that He has stopped them from fighting you. 4p\ \ figg fi)%\ \$} 4So, if they withdraw from you, and fight not against you, and offer you peace, meaning, they revert to peace. i then Allah has opened no way for you against them}, you do not have the right to kill them, as long as they take this position. This was the position of Banu Hashim (the tribe of the Prophet 5), such as Al- Abbas, who accompanied the idolaters in the battle of Badr, for they joined the battle with great hesitation. This is why the Prophet commanded that Al- Abbas not be killed, but only captured. Allah's statement, 4You will find others that wish to have security from you and security from their people.} refers to a type of people who on the surface appear to be like the type we just mentioned. However, the intention of each type is different, for the latter are hypocrites. They pretend to be Muslims with the Prophet and his Companions, so that they could attain safety with the Muslims for their blood, property and families. However, they support the idolaters in secret and worship what they worship, so that they are at peace with them also. These people have secretly sided

with the idolaters, just as Allah described them, 4i rji^ i*. i0 4But when they are alone with their ShayaHn, they say : "Truly, we

are with you. }. In this Ayah, Allah said, iP 3l 'jij ^ iEvery time they are sent back to Fitnah, they yield thereto.} meaning, they dwell in Fitnah. As-Suddi said that the Fitnah mentioned here refers to ShirfcJ * Ibn Jarir recorded that Mujahid said that the Ayah was revealed about a group from Makkah who used to go to the Prophet jg [in Al-Madlnah] pretending to be Muslims. However, when they went back to Quraysh, they reverted to worshipping idols. They wanted to be at peace with both sides. Allah commanded they should be fought against, unless they withdraw from combat and resort to peaceJ2 * This is why Allah said, ftp \$4 41f they withdraw notfrom you, nor offer you peace} meaning, revert to peaceful and complacent behavior, ip 'jpi} 4nor restrain their hands} refrain from fighting you, i: '-s 'A - \S\< ITabari 9 :28 At-Tabari 9 :27

i X} 4take (hold of) them}, capture them, iand kill than ivherever you Thaqtumuhum .}, wherever you find them, 4In their case, We have provided you with a clear warrant against them}, meaning an unequivocal and plain warrant. >-A> bl** - o*j J otj-l ^s} >"j f& 'yxc. ja 'yiiSu jl 'fy 5^ idiJ ijij pL.ji ^ ^ oi5 ^ ^ -4^ Cr*J :ty Cfe ;i li.1j 3;^& 4^5^^ "Sit oi *?<" - ST-r 492. It is notfor a believer to kill a believer except by mistake; and whosoever kills a believer by mistake, he must set free a believing slave and submit compensation (blood money) to the deceased's family unless they ranit it. If the deceased belonged to a people at war with you and he was a believer, thefreeing of a believing slave (is prescribed) ; and if he belonged to a people with whom you have a treaty of mutual alliance, then compensation (blood money) must be paid to his family, and a believing slave must be freed. And ivhoso finds this beyond his means, he must fastfor two consecutive months in order to seek repentance from Allah. And Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All- Wise.} 493. And whoever kills a believer intentionally, his recompense is Hell to abide therein; and the wrath and the curse of Allah are upon him, and a great punishment is preparedfor him.} The Ruling Concerning Killing a Believer by Mistake Allah states that the believer is not allowed to kill his believing brother under any circumstances. In the Two Sahths,

jjUJl ojJ j The blood of a Muslim who testifies that there is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah and that I am the Messenger of Allah, is sacred, except in three instances. (They are :) life for life, the married adulterer, and whoever reverts from the religion and abandons the Jamd'ah (community of the faithful believers)V When one commits any of these three offenses, it is not up to ordinary citizens to kill him or her, because this is the responsibility of the Muslim Leader or his deputy. Allah said, 4&L iexcept by mistake There is a difference of opinion concerning

the reason behind revealing this part of the Ayah. Mujahid and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1239–1243]

others said that it was revealed about Ayyash bin Abi RabTah, Abu Jahl s half brother, from his mother s side, Asma bint Makhrabah. Ayyash killed a man called Al-Harith bin Yazid Al- Amiri, out of revenge for torturing him and his brother because of their Islam. That man later embraced Islam and performed Hijrah, but Ayyash did not know this fact. On the Day of the Makkan conquest, Ayyash saw that man

and thought that he was still a disbeliever, so he attacked and killed him. Later, Allah sent down this Ayah: "Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that this Ayah was revealed about Abu Ad-Darda because he killed a man after he embraced the faith, just as Abu Ad-Darda held the sword above him. When this matter was conveyed to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, Abu Ad-Darda said, He only said that to avert death. The Prophet said to him, "4-li je- C-iLi ^ Fath. Al-Bari 12 :209 and Muslim 3 :1302 At-Tabari 9 :32

Have you opened his heart? The basis for this story is in the Sahih, but it is not about Abu Ad-Darda . Allah said, and whoever kills a believer by mistake, he must set free a believing slave and submit compensation (blood money) to the deceased's family} thus, ordaining two requirements for murder by mistake. The first requirement is the Kaffarah (fine) for the great sin that has been committed, even if it was a mistake. The Kaffarah is to free a

The Prophet ﷺ said, C l 5'g.l I "I7ien free fier."12 ' This is an authentic chain of narration, and not knowing the name of the Ansari Companion does not lessen its authenticity. Allah's statement, At-Jabari 9 :34 3:451

and submit compensation (blood money) to the deceased's family is the second obligation which involves the killer and the family of the deceased, who will receive blood money as compensation for their loss. The compensation is only obligatory for the one who possesses one of five; as Imam

it - Sc. iil ^ iji ?> 4to seek repentance from Allah. And Allah is Ever All- Knowing, All-Wise .} means, this is how the one who kills by mistake can repent, he fasts two consecutive months if he does not find a slave to free. IIX dM} iAnd Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise}, we mentioned the explanation of this before.

Warning Against Intentional Murder

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1243–1255]

Come, I will recite what your Lord has prohibited you from: Join not anything in worship with Him.} [6:151]. There are many Ayat and Hadiths that prohibit murder. In the Two Sahih's, it is recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, iBlood offenses are the first disputes to be judged between the people on the Day of Resurrection .

}And those who invoke not any other god along with Allah}, until, 4Except those who repent and believe, and do righteous deeds}. The Ayah we just mentioned should not be considered abrogated or only applicable to the disbelievers [who become Muslim], for this contradicts the general, encompassing indications of the Ayah and requires evidence to support it. Allah knows best. Allah said, 4?'i ij~j Oi i" * V I iSay: "O My servants who have transgressed against themselves! Despair not of the mercy of Allah}. This Ayah is general, covering all types of sins, including Kufr, Shirk, doubt, hypocrisy, murder, sin, and so forth. Therefore, everyone who repents sincerely from any of these errors, then Allah will forgive him. Allah said, a c *X& d #5 -t& l\} 4 Verily, Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with Him (in worship), but He forgives except that (anything else) to whom He wills}. This Ayah is general and includes every sin except Shirk, and it has been mentioned in this Surah, both after this Ayah and before it, in order to encourage hope in Allah, and Allah knows best. It

is confirmed in the Two Sahihs, that an Israeli killed one hundred people then he asked a scholar, Is it possible for me to repent? So he replied, What is there that would prevent you from repentance? So he told him to go to another land where Allah was worshipped. He began to emigrate to it but died on the way, and the angel of mercy was the one to take him. ' Although this Hadith is about an Israeli, it is even more suitable for the Muslim community that their repentance be accepted. Indeed, Allah relieved Muslims (i) Fath Al-Bari6 :59 1 and Muslim 4 :2 1 18

from the burdens and restrictions that were placed on the Jews, and He sent our Prophet jg with the easy Hanifiyyah way (Islamic Monotheism). As for the honorable Ayah, o*jf 4And whoever kills a believer intentionally}, Abu Hurayrah and several among the Salaf said that this is his punishment, if Allah decides to punish him. And this is the case with every threat that is issued for eveiy sin. For instance, there could be good deeds that this person has done that would prevent him from being punished for that, and Allah knows best. Even if the murderer inevitably enters the Fire - as Ibn Abbas stated because his repentance was not accepted, or he did not have good deeds to save him, he will not remain there for eternity, but only for a long time. There are Mutawatir Hadiths stating that the Messenger of Allah sg said, 9 1 'j*. v3 tAA ij ' Whoever has the least speck of faith in his heart shall ultimately depart the Fire, s' 1 0 -A \\$/> % jt j k A Ayclf \it,ji SJJ & 'if if J4 tk pl^= 494. O you who believe! When you go (to fight) in the cause of Allah, verify (the truth), and say not to anyone who greets you : You are not a believer; seeking the perishable goods of the worldly life. There is much more benefit with Allah. Even as he is now, so were you yourselves before, till Allah conferred on you His Favors, therefore, be cautious in discrimination. Allah is Ever Well-Aware ofwhat you do.} Greetingwith the Salam is a Sign ofIslam Imam

said, A man from Bani Sulaym, who was tending a flock of sheep, passed by some of the Companions of the Prophet sg and said Salam to them. They said (to each other), He only said Salam to protect himself from us. Then they attacked him and killed him. They brought his sheep to the Prophet jg, and this Ayahwas revealed, 4! " 40 you who believe!}, until the end of the Ai/ah.

Al-Harith bin Rab*I and Muhallam bin Juthamah bin Qays. We continued on until we reached the area of Idam, where Amr bin Al-Adbat Al-Ashjal passed by us on his camel. When he passed by us he said Salam to us, and we did not attack him. Because of some previous problems with him, Muhallam bin Juthamah killed him and took his camel. When we went back to the Messenger of Allahm and told him what had happened, a part of the Qur an was revealed about us, 4 6i ip: 40 you who believe! When you go (to fight) in the cause of Allah}, until, 4Well-Aware}. Only

Allah, they said, O Messenger of Allah! Al-Miqdad killed a man who testified that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah. He said, % iJil iij V c-iat U oIjjLJI Sitl ill "Summon Al-Miqdad before me. 0 Miqdad! Did you kill a man who proclaimed, There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah?" What woidd you do when you face, There is no deity worthy ofivorship except Allah tomorrow?" Allah then revealed; ^== -1], jll j fZfj \jS\ j&at 4r z {St At- "J\ JLij* IlijJ' \y~\ 40 you who believe! When you go (to fight) in the cause of Allah, verify (the truth), and say not to anyone ivho greets you : You are not a believer; seeking the perishable goods of the worldly life. There are much more profits and booties with Allah. Even as he is now, so were you yourselves before till Allah conferred on you His Favors, therefore, be cautious in discrimination The Messenger of Allah jg said to Al-Miqdad, 1 azILsj

jLiS ^ ifro fJA <!X wJLLLJI "He was a believing man who hid his faith among disbelieving people, and he announced his faith to you, but you killed him, although you used to hide your faith before, in MakkahX^ Allah s statement, 4 4)1 4There is much more benefit with Allah. means, better than what you desired of worldly possessions which made you kill the one who greeted you with the Salam m Majma'Az-Zawa id 7 :9

smm imm // _ * / ^ * . / | * " | < * # i / ^ ^ < * < I ^ i y O y I > j (Uy ~ : ^ g, L ^ - . 3 * ' i _ i ^ cl) - i ^ i > - J \$ \$ K # j // { f , < i J / > > " - ' < < , ! " and pronounced his faith to you. Yet, you ignored all this and accused him of hypocrisy, to acquire the gains of this life. However, the pure wealth with Allah is far better than what you acquired. Allah s statement, A3 " pLfe- ^SS> 4 ^ SCl ill ^ so were yow yourselves before, till Allah con- ferred on you His Favors .) means, beforehand, you used to be in the same situation like this person who hid his faith from his people. We mentioned the relevant Hadiths above. Allah said, / . 5 ** - > ? j - " 4And remember when you were few and were reckoned weak in the land}. Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Said bin Jubayr commented about Allah s statement, 4A3 j : ^ iso were you yourselves before > , You used to hide your faith, just as this shepherd hid his faith. Allah said, i \ % Z) *** Abdur-RazzHq 1 :170

4therefore, be cautious in discrimination}, then said, 4Allah is Ever Well-Aware of what you do.} and this part of the Ayah contains a threat and a warning, as Said bin Jubayr stated. 4 Ji ojijisi' isf2 y} .i* '4** > * \ // < , > / IJf { .tz . " . t f " l " l ^ J / , - , * , < i . f A * % i f s . V // // * z / * ^ ^ * . 1 / 1 . ^ / " f z Jff z / > ! ? ^ . v U ^ yti- ittl o " > * (_ / " 495. Not e ^ wa / are f / iose 0 / the believers who sit (at home), except those who are disabled, and those who strive hard and fight in the cause of Allah with their wealth and their lives. Allah has preferred in grades those who strive hard and fight with their wealth and their lives above those who sit (at home). Unto each, Allah has promised good (Paradise), but Allah has preferred those who strive hard and fight, above those who sit (at home), by a huge reward.} 496. Degrees of (higher) grades from Him, and forgiveness and mercy. And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful .} The Mujahid and those Who Do not Join Jihad are Not the Same, [and Jihad is Ford. Kifayah) li]

those who sit (at home), by a huge reward. Degrees of (higher) grades from Him}, above the believers who sit at home without a disability hindering them. This is the wording recorded by

There are a hundred grades in Paradise that Allah has prepared for the Mujahidin in His cause, between each two grades is the distance between heaven and Earth. ij5u JiVi 4 ^ fjltt ^ JUi jCJijj) 'jf # if^ a 4# ; j'd ^ Jf- -wi ^ 4j- * i - * LkjS ji > ' 0 ^ fix j; jyi iz. j Ijfi ij

An-Nisd' (Part-5) who cannot devise a plan, nor are they able to direct their way > 499. These are they whom Allah is likely to forgive them, and Allah is Ever Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving 4100. He who emigrates in the cause of Allah, will find on earth many dwelling places and plenty to live by. And whosoever leaves his home as an emigrant unto Allah and His Messenger, and death overtakes him, his reward is then surely incumbent upon Allah. And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful

The Prohibition of Residing Among the Disbelievers

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1255–1263]

We were weak and oppressed on the earth) meaning, we are unable to leave the land or move about in the earth, Afa& j4 'Jz fH AThey (angels) say:

way), meaning, they do not find the way to emigrate, as Mujahid, Ikrimah and As-Suddi stated . Allah s statement, jMJU 1 iThese are they whom Allah is likely to forgive them,) means, pardon them for not migrating, and here, likely means He shall, iatid Allah is Ever Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving).

4He who emigrates in the cause of Allah, will find on earth many dwelling places and plenty to live by.} this encourages the believers to perform Hijrah and abandon the idolaters, for wherever the believer emigrates, he will find a safe refuge to resort to. Mujahid said that, 4& many dwelling places means, he will find a way out of what he dislikes. Allah s statement, iand plenty to live by.} refers to provision. Qatadah also said that, 4...will find on earth many dwelling places and plenty to live by> means, Allah will take him from misguidance to guidance and from poverty to richness. * Allah s statement, \$ J!. && 4And whosoever leaves his home as an emigrant unto Allah and His Messenger, and death overtakes him, his reward is then surely, incumbent upon Allah. ^ means, whoever starts emigrating and dies on the way, he will acquire the reward of those who emigrate for Allah. The Two Sahihs, along with the Musnad and Sunan compilers, recorded that TJmar bin Al-Khattab said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, aj CjIS iC JI^pS/I Lwt si^il j\ 1 l di Cols' j*J JU"1 J! jlj JJ ". Il -Il 11 III . I "77ie reward of deeds depends upon the intentions, and every person will be rewarded according to what he has intended. So, whoever emigrated to Allah and His Messenger, then his tM At-Tabari 9:121

emigration is for Allah and His Messenger. And whoever emigrated for worldly benefits or for a woman to marry, his emigration is for what he emigrated for. ",1J This Hadith is general, it applies to Hijrah as well as every other deed. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that a man killed ninety-nine people and completed the number one hundred when he killed a worshipper. He then asked a scholar if he has a chance to repent. The scholar said, What prevents you from repentance? The scholar told the killer to emigrate from his land to another land where Allah is worshipped. When he left his land and started on the migration to the other land, death overtook him on the way. The angels of mercy and the angels of torment disputed about the man, whereas the former said that he went out in repentance, while the latter said that he did not arrive at his destination. They were commanded to measure the distance between the two lands and to whichever land he is closer to, he will be considered part of that land. Allah commanded that the righteous land to move closer and the land of evil to move farther. The angels found that he died closer to the land that he intended to emigrate to by a hand- span, and thus the angels of mercy captured his soul. In another narration, when death came to that man, he moved his chest towards the righteous village that he emigrated to. i:k.&# \tfr kgs k rtf 4101. And when you Darabtum in the land, there is no sin on you if you shorten the Salah if you fear that the disbelievers may put you in trial, verily, the disbelievers are ever unto you open enemies.} SalatALQasr, Shortening the Prayer Allah said, 4 *fci Al-B&ri 1 :164, Muslim 3 :1515, Abu Dawud 2 :651 , Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi 5 :283, An-Nasaf 7 :713, Ibn Majah 2 :1413, Ahmad 1 :25 Al-B&ri 6 :59 1 and Muslim 4:2118

564 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4And when you Darabtum in the land , meaning if you travel in the land. In another Ayah, Allah said, j-lu& 4 y^i 1 4He knows that there will be some among you sick, others Yadribiina (traveling) through the land, seeking of Allah's bounty...} [73:20]. Allah s statement. Si lx-"" Ji te. f\$} ithere is no sin on you if you shorten the Saldh (prayer)} by reducing (the units of the prayer) from four to two. Allah s statement, & <\$ jp& 4if you fear that the disbelievers may put you in trial

(attack you)), refers to the typical type of fear prevalent when this Ayah was revealed. In the beginning of Islam, and after the Hijrah,

arms and your baggage, to attack you in a single rush, but there is no sin on you if you put away your arms because of the inconvenience of rain or because you are ill, but take every precaution for yourselves. Verily, Allah has prepared a humiliating torment for the disbelievers.} The Description of The Fear Prayer The Fear prayer has different forms, for the enemy is sometimes in the direction of the Qiblah and sometimes in another direction. The Fear prayer consists sometimes of four Rak'ahs, three Rak'ahs, as for Maghrib, and sometimes two Rak'ah like Fajr and prayer during travel. The Fear prayer is sometimes prayed in congregation, but when the battle is raging, congregational prayer may not be possible. In this case, they pray each by himself, facing the Qiblah or otherwise, riding or on foot. In this situation, they are allowed to walk and fight, all the while performing the acts of the prayer. Some scholars said that in the latter case, they pray only one Rak'ah, for Ibn 'Abbas narrated, By the words of your Prophet si, Allah has ordained the prayer of four Rak'ah while residing, two Rak'ah during travel, and one Rak'ah during fear.

The Reason behind Revealing this Ayah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1263–1292]

well known place near Makkah), when the idolators met us under the command of Khalid bin Al-Walid, and they were between us and the Qiblah. The Messenger of Allah jg led us in Zuhr prayer, and the idolators said, They were busy with something during which we had a chance to attack them. They then said, Next, there will come a prayer (Asr) that is dearer to them than their children and themselves. However, Jibril came down with these Ayat between the prayers of Zuhrand Asr, ji+J o-jti vLJT iWhen you (O Messenger Muhammad sis) are among than, and lead than in Saldh (prayer)}. When the time for prayer came, the Messenger of Allah sfe commanded

An-Nisd' (Part-5) had prayed the first Rak'ah left and guarded their brothers. The second party joined him and performed bowing and prostration with him. All the people were in prayer, but they were guarding one another during the prayer. 111 Imam

Iyuiu J jf ,^Im ^^ ^ i>" (.^-=C^t- jj_i- ift , >.{ j-'er b^j 4B"f there is no sin on you if you put away your arms because of the inconvenience of rain or because you are ill, but take every precaution for yourselves } meaning, so that when necessary, you will be able to get to your weapons easily, 4 it l\} 4Verily , Allah has prepared a humiliating torment for the disbelievers}. fc <>& < * it tj .SS ;j&f if 58&& v c if * a.#; ^^ ij <(103. When you have finished the Salah, remember Allah standing, sitting down, and on your sides, but when you are free from danger, perform the Salah. Verily, Salah is kitdban on the believers at fixed hours.} 4104. And don't be weak in the pursuit of the enemy ; if you are suffering (hardships) then surely they (too) are suffering (hardships) as you are suffering, but you have a hope from Allah (for the reward, i.e. Paradise) that for which they hope not; and Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise.} The Order for Ample Remembrance Alter the Fear Prayer Allah commands Dhikr after finishing the Fear prayer, in particular, even though such Dhikr is encouraged after finishing other types of prayer in general. In the case of Fear prayer, Dhikr is encouraged even more because the pillars

of the prayer are diminished since they move about while performing it, etc., unlike other prayers. Allah said about the Sacred Months, 4'^=>^ tri ^

Stirah 4. An-Nisd' (Part-5) 571 iso wrong not yourselves therein}, even though injustice is prohibited all year long. However, injustice is particularly outlawed during the Sacred Months due to their sanctity and honor. So Allah s statement, & & 'it iWhen you have finished Saldh, remember Allah standing, sitting down, and on your sides,} means, in all conditions, t \lj} iBut when you are freefrom danger perform the Saldh.} when you are safe, tranquil and fear subsides, \ &} iperfortn the Saldh} by performing it as you were commanded; fulfilling its obligations, with humbleness, completing the bowing and prostration positions etc. Allah s statement, iVerily, the Saldh is Kitaban on the believers atfixed hours.} means, enjoined, as Ibn 'Abbas stated.111 Ibn Abbas also said, The prayer has a fixed time, just as the case with Hajj. W Similar is reported from Mujahid, Salim bin Abdullah, Ali bin Al-Husayn, Muhammad bin Ali, Al-Hasan, Muqatil. As-Suddi and Atiyah Al-'Awfi. The Encouragement to Pursue the Enemy Despite Injuries Allah s statement, iAnd don't be weak in the pursuit of the enemy;} means, do not weaken your resolve in pursuit of your enemy. At-Tabari 9:169 At-Tabari 9:169Tabari 9:167, 168

J asaij si ?ss"m \$ -"-J'j o \$Q) 2ii\$.Sy*^*\$ \$ />. - <- " *^<'1 >-':< iir-'-li* " tjyj=-4ai li^jlJuki-il* <^ t*Jiy"-L_A&au'oKji & J^z^c& Z Z &\$S Rather, pursue them vigorously, fight them and be wary of them. oj-& i>/2 oi^ iff you are suffering then surely they are suf- fering as you are suffering,} meaning, just as you suffer from injuries and death, the same happens to the enemy. In another Ayah, Allah said, i' *'.' - W.i .{ ' " iV U * ^ iA~~i jy-> iff you suffer a harm, be sure a similar harm Itas struck the others}. Allah then said, V -i' Ss ibut you have a hope from Allah that for which they hope not;} meaning, you and they are equal regarding the injuries and pain that you suffer from. However, you hope for Allah s reward, victory and aid, just as He has promised you in His Book and by the words of his Messenger j/s. Surely, Allah s promise is true. On the other hand, your enemies do not have hope for any of this. So, it is you, not they, who should be eager to fight so that you establish the Word of Allah and raise it high. CLi? iif

Sitralt 4. An-Nisa (Part-5) 573 iAnd Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise. means, He is most knowledgeable and wise in all what He decides, decrees, wills and acts on concerning various worldly and religious ordainments, and He is worthy of praise in all conditions. Js iif \ iui \) Cfjff JC- SS" iit 'Ji o-iSif Si sAiEJi ' v.Q 65. sf "'? & Si^ SM fV " \ ' *,1 Vifi /.*' o / < K s> * >" '> * -*> ' oy -^M u_" auj jbj Jyu ^ *-* aii1 j " ^ ^ . .x*' If ">?'/ r<> ^ . *. > pr^ cr*- * LwjJ' ^ ej >\ 1 U.^ in;^ "o k J* f' +7 jl\ 4105. Surely, We have sent down to you (0 Mulmnmad 0) the Book in truth tluit you might judge between men by that which Allah has shown you, so be not a pleader for the treacherous.4 4106. And seek the forgiveness of Allah, certainly, Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. 4107. And argue not on behalf of those who deceive themselves. Verily, Allah does not like anyone who is a betrayer, sinner. 4108. They may hide (their crimes) from men, but they cannot hide (them) from Allah; for He is with them (by His knowledge), when they plot by night in words that He does not approve. And Allah ever encompasses what they do.) 4109. Lo! You are those who have argued for them in the life of this world, but who will argue for them on the Day of Resurrection against Allah, or who will then be their defender?) The Necessity of Referring to What Allah has Revealed forJudgement Allah says to His

Messenger, Muhammad (ﷺ) 4:24 Surely, We have sent down to you the Book in truth) meaning, it truly came from Allah and its narrations and

Since you said that, then go and divide the inheritance, and try to be just in your division. Then draw lots, and each one of you should forgive his brother thereafter (regardless of who got the best share). 111 Allah's statement, it is that they may hide (their crimes) from men, but they cannot hide (them) from Allah; } chastises the hypocrites because they hide their evil works from the people so that they will not criticize them. Yet, the hypocrites disclose this evil with Allah, Who has perfect watch over their secrets and knows what is in their hearts. This is why Allah said, (And He is with them by His knowledge), when they plot by night in words that He does not approve. And Allah ever encompasses what they do } threatening and warning them. Allah then said, (You are those who have argued for them in the life of this world,) meaning, suppose these people gain the verdict from the rulers in their favor in this life, since the rulers judge according to what is apparent to them. However, what will their condition be on the Day of Resurrection before Allah, Who knows the secret and what is even more hidden? Who will be his advocate on that Day? Verily, none will support them that Day. Hence, Allah's statement, } or who will then be their defender? } Ahmad 6 :320

by- JA 3:104 (And whoever does evil or wrongs himself but afterwards seeks Allah's forgiveness, he will find Allah Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) 111. And whoever earns sin, he earns it only against himself. And Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise. } 4:112. And whoever earns a fault or a sin and then blames it on someone innocent, he has indeed burdened himself with falsehood and a manifest sin. } 4:113. Had not the grace of Allah and His mercy been upon you, a party of them would certainly have made a decision to mislead you, but they mislead none except their own selves, and no harm can they do to you in the least. Allah has sent down to you the Book, and the Hikmah, and taught you that which you knew not. And ever great is the grace of Allah unto you. } The Encouragement to Seek Allah's Forgiveness, and Warning those who Falsely Accuse Innocent People Allah emphasizes His generosity and kindness, in that He forgives whoever repents to Him from whatever evil they commit. Allah said, (And whoever does evil or wrongs himself but afterwards seeks Allah's forgiveness, he will find Allah Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas commented about this Ayah, Allah informs His servants of His forgiveness, forbearing generosity and expansive mercy. So whoever commits a sin, whether minor or major,

Jesus (ﷺ) by 1:1 (But afterwards seeks Allah's forgiveness, he will find Allah Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful . even if his sins were greater than the heavens, the earth and the mountains. Imam

(And whoever does evil or wrongs himself but afterwards seeks Allah's forgiveness, he will find Allah Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) meaning, this occurs due to His knowledge, wisdom, fairness and mercy. } 4:104 and taught you that which you knew not. }, before this revelation was

sent down to you. Similarly, Allah said, j. 'Ljj JBi uXi SlliQ} 433' & sji3 C \J\ 4And thus We have sent to you (O Muham- mad sg) a Rult (a revelation, and a mercy) of Our command. You ktteio not what is the Book } 4Stu jt VI 3#ji dX)\ yfc & j5 ?3 Cj} 4And you xoere not expecting that the Book (this Qur'an) would be sent down to you, but it is a mercyfrom your Lord}. So Allah said; 4tLJi& ."& Jtj r^L&'i} 4And ever great is the grace ofAllah unto you (O Multammad #5)K

^ Cj'A.-j /j "- 4114. There is no good in most of their secret talks save (in) him who orders Sadaqah, or goodness, or conciliation between mankind; and he who does this, seeking the good pleasure of Allah, We shall give him a great reward. 4115. And whoever contradicts and opposes the Messenger after the right path has been shown clearly to him, and follows other than the believers' way, We shall keep him in the path he has chosen, and bum him in Hell - what an evil destination!} Righteous Najwd, Secret Talk Allah said, cA 4 JA- 4There is no good in most of their secret talks} meaning, what the people say to each other. Vo* - (4save him who orders Sadaqah (charity), or goodness, or reconciliation between mankind;} meaning, except for this type of talk. Imam

580 Tafsir ton Kathir Messenger of Allah said, l a 1^ ipL-kil i>-jS^ jJiiL Yin: "Should I tell you what is better than the grade of fasting, praying and Sadaqah?"

been made clear, apparent and plain to him. Allah s statement, iand follows other than the believers' way,} refers to a type of conduct that is closely related to contradicting the Messenger j". This contradiction could be in the form of contradicting a text (from the Qur an or Sunnah) or contradicting what the Ummah of Muhammad jg has agreed on. The U m m a h of Muhammad jgg is immune from error when they all agree on something, a miracle that serves to increase their honor, due to the greatness of their Prophet. There are many authentic Hadtths on this subject. Allah warned against the evil of contradicting the Prophet jg and his Ummah, when He said, rmm &sm \ oty&iis 'j'j---> i>*J fj| p ""if-' ft t s "(< . / UdJ^) _& Jucj ij 4ji\JS j^ Uaurf k If. 3' i^LujuLaj ll.'aU) OiU.j jyl j j_y ll 4VVe shall keep him in the path he has chosen, and bum him in Hell - what an evil destination!} meaning, when one goes on this wicked path, We will punish him by making the evil path appear good in his heart, and will beautify it for him so that he is tempted further. For instance, Allah said. t ' " ** ** .< / * \ Oj v_jjS2

An-Nisd (Part-5) 4117. They invoke nothing but female deities besides Him (Allah), and they invoke nothing but Shaytan, a persistent rebel!} 4118. Allah cursed him. And he [Shaytan] said: "I will take an appointed portion ofyour servants."} 4119. "Verily, I will mislead them, and surely, I will arouse in them false desires; and certainly, I will order them to slit the ears of cattle, and indeed I will order them to change the nature created by Allah." And whoever takes Shaytan as a Wali instead ofAllah, has surely suffered a manifest loss.} 4120. He [Shaytan] makes promises to them, and arouses in them false desires; and Shaytan's promises are nothing but deceptions.} 4121. The dwelling ofsuch (people) is Hell, and they will find no way ofescapefrom it.} 4122. And those who believe and do righteous good deeds, We shall admit them to the Gardens under which rivers flcno (i.e. in Paradise) to dioell therein forever. Allah's promise is the truth; and whose words can be truer than those ofAllah?} Shirk Shall not be Forgiven, in Reality the Idolators Worship Shaytan We talked about Allah s statement, 4Verily, Allah forgives not (the sin of) setting up partners (in toorship) with Him, but He forgives whom He wills, sins other than that,} before and mentioned the relevant Hadiths in the beginning of this Surah.. Allah s

statement, 4'ju^I vii jji -it)) 4and whoever sets up partners in worship xvith Allah, has indeed strayedfar away.} means, he will have taken otherthan the true path, deviated from guidance and righteousness, destroyed himselfin this lifeand the Hereafter,and lostcontentment in this lifeand the Hereafter. Juwaybir said that Ad-Dahhak said about Allah s statement,

4&{ V Jt AThey invoke nothing butfemale deities besides Him (Allah), The idolators claimed that the angels are Allah s daughters , saying, *We only worship them so that they bring us closer to Allah. So they took the angels as gods, made the shapes of girls and decided, These (idols) resemble the daughters of Allah (i.e., the angels), Whom we worship. This is similar to Allah s statements, 4; ;*>\$ cJ AHave you theti considered Al-Lat and Al-'Uzzd>' i^~j} AAnd they make the angels who themselves are servants of the Most Gracious (Allah) females and, AAnd they have invented a kinship between Him and the Jinn}. Allah s statement, Aand they invoke nothing but Shaytan, a persistent rebel!} means, Shaytan has commanded them to do this and made it seem fair and beautiful in their eyes. Consequently, they are worshipping Shaytan in reality, just as Allah said in another Ayah, ADid I not command you, O Children of Adam, that you should not worship Shaytan} Allah said that, on the Day of Resurrection, the angels shall proclaim about the idolators who worshipped them in this life: A'.> A rn f .. ^ AHay, but they used to worship the Jinn; most of them wereJabari 9 :209 ' Two ofthe most popular idols during that time

An-Nisa' (Part-5) believers in them}. Allah s statement, ZJ} iAlldh cursed him}, means, He expelled him and banished him from His mercy and His grace. 4/ will take an appointed portion ofyour servants} means, a fixed and known share. Muqatil bin Hayyan commented, From every one thousand, nine hundred and ninety-nine will go to the Fire and one to Paradise. }Verily, 1 will mislead them} from the true path, iand surely, I will arouse in them false desires;} tempting them to feign repentance, arousing false hopes in them, encouraging them to delay and procrastinate with righteous deeds, deceiving them. iand certainly, I will order them to slit the ears of cattle,} meaning, slitting their ears to designate them as Bahirah, 1^ Sa ibah, and a Wasilah,^ ' as Qatadah and As-Suddi stated. iAnd indeed I will order them to change the nature created by Allah.} A camel whose milk was spared for the idols and nobody was allowed to milk it A camel let loose for free pasture for their idols and nothing was allowed to be carried on it. 131 A camel set free for idols because it has given birth to a female camel at its first delivery, and then again gives birth to a female camel at its second deliveryTabari 9:214

means tattooing, according to Al-Hasan bin Abi Al-Hasan Al- Basri. In his Sahth,

Cj gsz, jMJ dSi ^ -44i; 4And Shaytan zoill say when the matter has been decided: Verily , Allah promised you a promise of truth. And I too promised you, but I betrayed you. I had no authority over you), until, 4%) i'i*\$ S/Aiti jI) 4Verily , there is a painful torment for the wrongdoers. Allah s statement, 4of such (people)) refers to those who like and prefer what Shaytan is promising and assuring them of. 4The dwelling of such (people) is Hell}, as their destination and abode on the Day of Resurrection, 4IU4& 5/4 4and they will find no way of escape from it .), meaning, they will not be able to avoid, avert, evade or elude the Hellfire. The Reward ofRighteous Believers Allah then mentions the condition of the content righteous believers and the perfect honor they will earn in the end. Allah said, IrAnd those ivho believe and do righteous good deeds,) meaning, their hearts were truthful and their limbs obedient with the righteous acts they were commanded, all the while abandoning the evil they

were prohibited from doing. 0; y-Jf -y 4\Ne shall admit them to Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise)) meaning, they will think of where they want these rivers to

flow and they will flow there, 4to dwell therein forever}, without end or being removed from it. tr 4 jOli iTf} {Allah's promise is the truth}, meaning, this is a true promise from Allah, and verily, Allah's promise shall come to pass. Allah then said, k oiil 2^ {and whose words can be truer than those of Allah?} meaning, none is more truthful in statement and narration than Allah. There is no deity worthy of worship, or Lord except Him. The Messenger of Allah jg used to proclaim in his speech, jZ.j ,4_uAJ I JjLii jI" "The most truthful speech is Allah's Speech, and the best guidance is the guidance of Muhammad. The worst matters are the newly invented (in religion), every newly invented matter is an innovation, and every innovation is a heresy, and every heresy is in the Fire j Mi* yj ck \$ Ce jL . rM , 'n 'jwii LJj *a> o/i k h4-j (ill 1; {^} jij , "< '* % iliji ytjj^ O'jU-JI j L> > li? jjifj U-j- ilj j-Jj _j>: 4123. /f will not be in accordance with your desires, nor those of the People of the Scripture, whosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof, and he will not find any protector or helper besides Allah .} {124. And whoever does righteous good deeds, male or female, and is a believer, such will enter Paradise and not the least injustice, even to the size of a Naqir, will be done to them.} {125. And who can be better in religion than one who submits

his face (himself) to Allah; and he is a Muhsin (a doer of good). And follows the religion of Ibrahim the Hanif (Monotheist). And Allah did take Ibrahim as a Khalil (an intimate friend)!} 4126. And to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. And Allah is Ever Encompassing all things .} Success is Only Achieved by Performing Righteous Deeds, not Wishful Thinking Qatadah said, We were told that the Muslims and the People of the Scriptures mentioned their own virtues to each other. People of the Scriptures said, Our Prophet came before your Prophet and our Book before your Book. Therefore, we should have more right to Allah than you have. Muslims said, Rather, we have more right to Allah than you, our Prophet is the Final Prophet and our Book supersedes all the Books before it. Allah sent down, it will not be in accordance with your desires (Muslims), nor those of the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians), whosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof}, A A*-' iU Ai 2A -* ief} 4And who can be better in religion than one who submits his face (himself) to Allah; and he is a Muhsin.} Allah then supported the argument of the Muslims against their opponents of the other religions. Similar statements were attributed to As-Suddi, Masruq, Ad-Dahhak and Abu Salih. * Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas commented on this Ayah [4:123], The followers of various religions disputed, the people of the Tawrah said, Our Book is the best Book and our Prophet (Musa) is the best Prophet. The people of the Injil said similarly, the people of Islam said, There is no religion except Islam, our Book has abrogated every other Book, our Prophet is the Final Prophet, and you were commanded to believe in Tabari 9 :229 * At-Tabari 9:229-231

590 Tafcir Ibn Kathir your Books and adhere to our Book. Allah judged between them, saying. j*. '*>- it will not be in accordance with your desires, nor those of the People of the Scripture, whosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof} . ,1) This Ayah indicates that the religion is not accepted on account of wishful thinking or mere hopes. Rather, the accepted religion relies on what resides in the heart and which is made truthful through actions. It is not true that when one utters a claim to something, he attains it merely on account of his claim. It is not true that every person who claims to be

on the truth is considered as such, merely on account of his words, until his claim gains merit with proof from Allah. Hence Allah's statement, ' > it will not be in accordance with your desires, nor those of the People of the Scripture, whosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof}, meaning safety will not be acquired by you or them just by wishful thinking. Rather, the key is in obeying Allah and following what He has legislated through the words of His honorable Messengers. This is why Allah said afterwards, iwhosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof, > Similarly, Allah said, "J> A JI_M v tJA fc*- jUu J^j} iSo whosoever does good equal to the weight of an atom, shall see it. And whosoever does evil equal to the weight of an atom, shall see it.} and it was reported that when these Ayat were revealed, they became hard on many Companions. HI At-Tabari 9 :230

Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that A ishaah said, I said, O Messenger of Allah! I know the hardest Ayah in the Qur an. He said, What is it, O A ishaah! 1 said, i-HA SZ^ ^whoever works evil, iwill have the recompense thereof,} He said, Z&\ Jj. JuJl L-J.. U is what strikes the believing servant, even the problems that bother him. a ' * Ibn Jarir and

repents and Allah forgives him. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded itJ Allah then said, 10 ;> 3 y 3 Ji \fz\ ly* jliS iAnd whoever does righteous good deeds, male or female, and is a believer}. Allah mentions the recompense for evil actions and that He will surely inflict its punishment on the servant, either in this life, which is better for him, or in the Hereafter, we seek refuge with Allah from this end. We also beg Allah for our well-being in this life and the Hereafter and for His forgiveness, mercy and pardon. Allah then mentions His kindness, generosity and mercy in accepting the good deeds from His servants, whether male or female, with the condition that they embrace the faith. He also stated that He will admit the believers into Paradise and will not withhold any of their righteous deeds, even the weight of a Naqir - speck on the back of a date-stone. Earlier, we discussed the FatH - the scallish thread in the long slit of a date-stone, and both of these, along with the Qitmir - the thin membrane over the date-stone were mentioned in the Qur an. Allah then said, 4^, lA-i &A IfdA [ff} iAnd who can be better in religion than one who submits his face to Allah.} meaning, performs the good actions in sincerity for his Lord with faith and awaiting the reward with Allah, iand he is a Muhsin} following the correct guidance that Allah legislated in the religion of truth which He sent His Messenger Sg with. These are the two conditions, in the absence of which no deed will be accepted from anyone; sincerity and correctness. The work is sincere when it is performed for Allah alone and it becomes correct when it conforms to the SharVah. So, the m At-Tabari 9 :239

deed becomes outwardly correct with following the Sunnah and inwardly correct with sincerity. When any deed lacks either of these two conditions, the deed becomes null and void. For instance, when one lacks the pillar of sincerity in his work, he becomes a hypocrite who shows off for people. Whoever does not follow the Shari'ah, he becomes an ignorant, wicked person. When one combines both pillars, his actions will be the deeds of the faithful believers whose best deeds are accepted from them and their errors erased. Consequently, Allah said, s-a'jX 3&J 4And follows the religion of Ibrahim the Hanif (Monotheist).} referring to Muhammad jg and his following, until the Day of Resurrection. Allah said, UUj yjj ' Jjl djfr 4Verily, among mankind who have the best claim to Ibrahim are those who followed him, and this Prophet}, and, j Jb'i 4Then, We have sent the Revelation to you (saying): ",Follow the religion of Ibrahim the Hanif (Monotheist) and he was not of the Mushrikin}. The Hanif, intentionally

and with knowledge, avoids Shirk, he goes attentively to the truth, allowing no one to hinder him or stop him from it. Ibrahim is Allah's Khalil. Allah's statement, 4/4-4 And Allah did take Ibrahim as a Khalil (an intimate friend)! encourages following Ibrahim Al-Khalil, because he was and still is an Imam whose conduct is followed and imitated. Indeed, Ibrahim reached the ultimate closeness to Allah that the servants seek, for he attained the grade of Khalil, which is the highest grade of love. He acquired all this due to his obedience to His Lord, just as Allah has described him,

And of Ibrahim, the one who fulfilled (certain) commands, which he fulfilled, and, T 4 jsj L1 A iVerily, Ibrahim was an Ummah, obedient to Allah, a Hanif, and he was not one of the Mushrikin}.

Allah has chosen me as His Khalil, just as He has chosen Ibrahim as His Khalil. n' 11 Allah's statement, 4 4 4 U 4-A/id to AZ/a/i belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth means, everything and everyone are His property, servants and creation, and He has full authority over all of this. There is no one who can avert Allah's decision or question His judgment. He is never asked about what He does due to His might, ability, fairness, wisdom, compassion and mercy. Allah's statement, ill iAnd Allah is Ever Encompassing all things.} means, His knowledge encompasses everything and nothing concerning His servants is ever hidden from Him. Nothing, even the weight of an atom, ever escapes His observation in the heavens and earth, nor anything smaller or bigger than that. xr?- 1 * jU jf- ^ Uj idaJ , ,h 4227. They ask your legal instruction concerning women. Say "Allah instructs you about them, and about what is recited unto you in the Book concerning the orphan girls whom you give not iwhat tthey deserve and yet whom you desire to marry, and the children who are iveak and oppressed, and that you stand firm for justice to orphans. And whatever good you do, Allah is Ever All-Aware of it The Ruling Concerning Female Orphans

ill Ji 4 i&fjelij} iThey ask your instruction concerning women. Say, "Allah instructs you about them...} until, ol&h} iwhom you desire to marry...} It is about the man who is taking care of a female orphan, being her caretaker and inheritor. Her money is joined with his money to such an extent, that she shares with him even the branch of a date that he has. So he likes (for material gain) to marry her himself, and hates to marry her to another man who would have a share in his money, on account of her share in his money. Therefore, he refuses to let her marry anyone else. So, this Ayah was revealed. I also recorded it. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that A'ishah said, The people asked Allah's Messenger (about orphan girls), so Allah revealed, 4 (^=4* Cj Sis iThey ask your instruction concerning women. Say, "Allah instructs you about them and about what is recited unto you in the Book..." ^

What is meant by Allah's saying, 'And about what is recited

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1292–1300]

unto you in the Book is the former verse which said, if you fear that you shall not be able to deal justly with the orphan girls, then marry (other) women of your choice.} ^ A'ishah said, "Allah's statement, iwhom you desire to marry...} also refers to the desire of the guardian not to marry an orphan girl under his supervision when she lacks property or beauty. The guardians were Fath Al-Bari 8:1 14 4:1423 At-Tabari 9 :258

An-Nisa (Part-5) forbidden to marry their orphan girls possessing property and beauty without being just to them, as they generally refrain from marrying them (when they are neither beautiful nor wealthy). 11 The basis of this is recorded in Two Sahihs. Consequently, when a man is the caretaker of a female orphan, he might like to marry her himself. In this case, Allah commands him to give her a suitable dowry that other women of her status get. If he does not want to do that, then let him marry other women, for Allah has made this matter easy for Muslims. Sometimes, the caretaker does not desire to marry the orphan under his care, because she is not attractive to his eye. In this case, Allah forbids the caretaker from preventing the female orphan from marrying another man for fear that her husband would share in the money that is mutually shared between the caretaker and the girl. Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said, During the time of Jahiliyyah, the caretaker of a female orphan would cover her with his rope, and when he did that, no man would marry her. If she was beautiful and he desired to marry her, he married her and took control of her wealth. If she was not beautiful, he did not allow her to marry until she died, and when she died he inherited her money. Allah prohibited and outlawed this practice. He also said about Allah's statement, and the children who are weak and oppressed that during the time of Jahiliyyah, they used to deny young children and females a share of inheritance. So Allah's statement, you give not what they deserve> thus prohibiting this practice and designating a fixed share for each, Fath Al-Bari 9 :6 and Muslim 4:2313 At-Tabari 9 :264

598 Tafstr Ibn Kathir t > ' j3^ C-i "V"t , o^j ^ait^J? < wt 4^& fk> 4To the male, a portion equal to that of two females..} whether they were young or old, as Said bin Jubayr and others stated. Said bin Jubayr said about Allah's statement, and that you stand firm for justice to orphans.} Just as when she is beautiful and wealthy you would want to marry her and have her for yourself, so when she is not wealthy or beautiful, marry her and have her for yourself. ' Allah's statement, 4If Aft t)ji -A*- Oi 4And whatever good you do, Allah is Ever All-Aware of it.} encourages performing the good deeds and fulfilling the commandments, and states that Allah is knowledgeable of all of this and He will reward for it in the best and most perfect manner. ifJLa tlfu jaj.ni ol If 5r. Vi jt 'jjii t+U) calf- 0!j^ Hj ii' ijiLj) iy- fw!' "jp- ait I y*L*aio^J JC3 jtp| ^i.6^ aittjSjt^ , j 0 o^litjU aitj^aSj 1 oy.fJ aJJj JC^ajLaJilt^' |vrt| V^audi^aaitolSj "j^ tjLjjit4 9 :255Tabari 9 :255

'* ' ill iyJ jj jrj IjkjjSi ^ *i'i * ; ofj :&z. & iSf "ssr OJj 4228. And i/ a woman fears cruelty or desertion on her husband's part, there is no sin on them both if they make terms of peace between themselves; and making peace is better. And human souls are swayed by greed. But if you do good and have Taqwd, verily, Allah is Ever Well-Acquainted with what you do.} 4229. You will never be able to do perfect justice between wives even if it is your ardent desire, so do not incline too much to one of them so as to leave the other hanging. And if you do justice, and do all that is right and have Taqwd, then Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 4230. But if they separate (by divorce), Allah will provide abundance for everyone of them from His bounty. And Allah is Ever All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All-Wise.} The Ruling Concerning Desertion on the Part of the Husband Allah states, and thus legislates accordingly, that sometimes, the man inclines away from his wife, sometimes towards her and sometimes he parts with her. In the first case, when the wife fears that her husband is steering away from her or deserting her, she is allowed to forfeit all or part of her rights, such as provisions, clothing, dwelling, and so forth, and the husband is allowed to accept such concessions from her. Hence, there is no harm if she offers such concessions, and if her husband accepts them. This is why Allah said, 4 ii I^ir

64 } Zjji yi} there is no sin on them both if they make terms of peace between themselves;} He then said, 4% iattd making peace is better than divorce. Allah s statement,

600 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir j3&Vf 4A;id human souls are swayed by greed .} means, coming to peaceful terms, even when it involves forfeiting some rights, is better than parting.

Surah 4, An-Nisa' (Part-5) 601 4And making peace is better}. Ali bin Abi Talhah related that Ibn Abbas said that the Ayah refers to, When the husband gives his wife the choice between staying with him or leaving him, as this is better than the husband preferring other wives to her. 11 ' However, the apparent wording of the Ayah refers to the settlement where the wife forfeits some of the rights she has over her husband, with the husband agreeing to this concession, and that this settlement is better than divorce. For instance, the Prophet jfe kept Sawdah bint Zam'ah as his wife after she offered to forfeit her day for A isha. By keeping her among his wives, his Ummah may follow this kind of settlement. Since settlement and peace are better with Allah than parting, Allah said, iand making peace is better}. Divorce is not preferred with Allah. The meaning ofAllah s statement, iBut if you do good and have Taqioa, verily, Allah is Ever Well-Acquainted with what you do} if you are patient with the wife you dislike and treat her as other wives are treated, then Allah knows what you do and will reward you for it perfectly. Allah s statement, 4 o'*. ^Yok will never be able to do perfect justice between wives even if it is your ardent desire,} means, O people! You will never be able to be perfectly just between wives in every respect. Even when one divides the nights justly between wives, there will still be various degrees concerning love, desire and sexual intimacy, as Ibn Abbas, *Ubaydah As-Salmani, Mujahid, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Ad- Dahhak bin Muzahim stated.'2 ' Imam

you have power over, while fearing Allah in all conditions, then Allah will forgive you the favoritism that you showed to some ofyour wives. Allah then said, 4 j u_. j ii' jSj .ajJu. j. iBut if they separate (divorce), Allah will provide abundance for everyone of them from His bounty. And Allah is Ever All-Sufficientfor His creatures' needs, All-Wise. } This is the third case between husband and wife, in which divorce occurs. Allah states that if the spouses separate by divorce, then Allah will suffice them by giving him a better wife and her a better husband. The meaning of, U j ii' J&j} 4And Allah is Ever All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All- Wise.} is: His favor is tremendous, His bounty is enormous and He is All-Wise in all His actions, decisions and commandments. Jt v2?') iyj jiJj ,jyV' 4 4 iuf 0 4 Cj j U) IjyS2 \$ IS oi it 4 4 c ij -V-t X"1/4* otj jlllli -ft \$ Cj1> 4, to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. And verily, We have recommended to the People of the Scripture before you, and to you that you have Taqwd of Allah. But ifyou disbelieve, then unto Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth, and Allah is Ever Rich (free ofany needs), Worthy of all praise.} 4232. And to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. And Allah is Ever All-Sufficient as Disposer ofaffairs 4233. IfHe ivills. He can take you away, O people, and bring others. And Allah is Ever All-Potent over that.} 4234. Whoever desires the rewards of this life, then with Allali is the reward of this worldly life and of the Hereafter. And

Allah is Ever All-Hearer, All-Seer.} The Necessity ofTaqwa ofAllah Allah states that He is the Owner of the heavens and earth and that He is the Supreme Authority over them. Hence Allah s statement, iffy p-g " \$ sj \$s; 4And verily, We have recommended to the People of the Scripture before you, and to you } meaning, We have recommended to you what We recommended to the People of Scriptures;

The meaning of Allah's statement,

Jr wvm ' imm 'C ;> <{/{ ^ At % Lvi-iiS iJtS' ^See /iow We prefer one above another (in this world)}. So Allah said here, (m.*Z iill iAnd Allah is Ever All- Hearer, All-Seer.) V& '& (rk 0) j\$J ik '^ri if-M & \$ & dz 4 !yLij tii djl "ili Ijjii i o !\$ J 5^ i H& Sit S . O you who believe! Stand out firmly for justice, as witnesses to Allah, even though it be against yourselves, or your parents, or your kin, be he rich or poor, Allah is a better Protector to both. So follow not the lusts, lest you may avoid justice; and ifyou Talwu or Tu'ridii, it, verily, Allah is Ever Well-Acquainted with what you do.) ^.n^' i j~ "h* ij* (*' OLS^V'j j JJ Allb {fji I j "jis Sil J0% . ^Jif' jiui*"Qj^O'yiSCL '^ . .a <' If? sr-' " " W'k.' ' - l|p ; .%,<. f^ . c *r . i "i-i>* y-isui Commanding Justice and Conveying the Witness for Allah Allah commands His believing servants to stand up for justice and fairness and not to deviate from it, right or left. They should not fear the blame of anyone or allow anyone to prevent them from doing something for the sake of Allah. They are also required to help, support and aid each other for Allah s sake.

Allah's statement, *ik ias witnesses to Allah* is similar to His statement, *iAnd establish the testimony for Allah*). Testimony should be delivered precisely, for the sake of Allah, thus making the testimony correct, truly just, and free of alterations, changes or deletions. This is why Allah said, *& %) ieven though it be against yourselves,)* meaning, give correct testimony, and say the truth when you are asked about it, even if harm will effect you as a consequence. Indeed, Allah shall make a way out and give relief for those who obey Him in every matter. Allah's statement, *ior your parents, or your kin,)* means, even if you have to testify against your parents and kin, do not compromise for their sake. Rather, give the correct and just witness even if they are harmed in the process, for the truth presides above everyone and is preferred to everyone. Allah's statement, ** *\$ 5* fei 3* ti JS o[) ibe he rich or poor, Allah is a better Protector to both.)* means, do not favor someone (in your testimony) because he is rich, or feel pity for him because he is poor, for Allah is their caretaker, a better Protector of them than you, and has better knowledge of what is good for them. Allah's statement, *iSofollow not the lusts, lest you may avoid justice;)* means, let not desire, lust or the hatred you have against others, lure you him njustice in your affairs. Rather, stand r justice in all situations.

Allah said; *ih'jh y *il& 4A/id* let not the enmity and hatred of others make you avoid justice. Be just: that is nearer to piety} when the Prophet jg sent Abdullah bin Rawahah to collect the tax on the fruits and produce of the Jews of Khaybar, they offered him a bribe so that he would go easy on them. He said; By Allah! I have come to you from the dearest of the creation to me (Muhammad), and you are more hated by me than an equivalent number of apes and swine. However, my love for him (the Prophet jg) and hatred for you shall not prevent me from being just with you. On that, they said, This (justice) is the basis which the heavens and earth were created. We will mention this Hadith later in Surat Al-Ma'idah (chapter 5) Allah willing. Allah's statement afterwards, *iand ifyou Talwu or Tu'ridu}* means, Distort your testimony and change it, according to Mujahid and several others among the Salaf. 1 1 Talwu, includes distortion and intentional lying. For instance, Allah said, *iAnd verily, among them is a party who Yalwuna (distort) the Book with their tongues (as they read)}*. Tu'ridu, includes hiding and withholding the testimony. Allah said, *iWho hides it, surely, his heart is sinful}*

The Prophet jg said, *ij i ,;.H j~>- ' The best witness is he who discloses his testimony before being m* At-Tabari 9 :308

An-Nisa (Part-5) asked to do so .s' 11 Allah then warned, *"i Hj Sit 4Verily, Allah is Ever Well-Acquainted with what you do.\$ and will reward or punish you accordingly. 4' .a&&4 4' .,44s& 'A -ui 4"* 4'j i&L J&. j*j j;4 il36. O you who believe! Believe in Allah, and His Messenger, and the Book (the Qur'an) which He has sent down to His Messenger, and the Scripture which He sent down to those before; and whosoever disbelieves in Allah, His Angels, His Books, His Messengers, and the Last Day, tthen indeed he has strayedfar away The Order to Have Faith after Believing Allah commands His faithful servants to adhere to all the elements of faith, its branches, pillars and cornerstones. This is not stated as mere redundancy, but from the view of completing faith and the continual maintenance of it. For instance, the believer proclaims in every prayer, *iGuide us to the straight way which means, make us aware of the straight path and increase us in guidance and strengthen us on it. In this Ayah [4:136], Allah commands the believers to believe in Him and in His Messenger, just as He said elsewhere, iO*

you who believe! Have Taqwa of Allah, and believe in His Messenger, Allah's statement, in Muslim 3 : 1344

that the Book which He has sent down to His Messenger, refers to the Qur'an, while, and the Scripture which He sent down to those before (him);} refers to the previously revealed divine Books. Allah then said, And whoever disbelieves in Allah, His Angels, His Books, His Messengers, and the Last Day, then indeed he has strayed far away.} meaning, he will have deviated from the correct guidance and strayed far away from its path. \$ 'M St& Z\$WS 2 \& 1 2 5\$ VjX '\$ ti C/yi } \ oj-ijJj uAl jAT^Oj V'j* at ajiiijf 1?J ,^aaau* J> -"j *u Oy Crv- 9J-= , Uj' t > >' .>*' i '< t'-s, (,r, < 'r't - ^ jJjJu All* O' 4 'itpli-ir 4 "" ol ""J ^J. oJA 4137. Verily, those who believe, then disbelieve, then believe (again), and (again) disbelieve, and go on increasing in disbelief; Allah will not forgive them, nor guide them on the (right) way.} 4138. Give to the hypocrites the tidings that there is for them a painful torment.} 4139. Those who take disbelievers for friends instead of believers, do they seek honor with them? Verily, then to Allah belongs all honor}. 4140. And it has already been revealed to you in the Book that when you hear the verses of Allah being denied and mocked at, then sit not with them, until they engage in talk other than that; certainly in that case you would be like them. Surely, Allah will collect the hypocrites and disbelievers all together in Hell.}

Characteristics of the Hypocrites and Their Destination Allah states that whoever embraces the faith, reverts from it, embraces it again, reverts from it and remains on disbelief and increases in it until death, then he will never have a chance to gain accepted repentance after death. Nor will Allah forgive him, or deliver him from his plight to the path of correct guidance. This is why Allah said. > p& ft iAllah i will not forgive them, nor guide them on the (right) way). Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that his father said that Ahmad bin Abdah related that Hafsa bin Jamil said that Samak said that Ikrimah reported that Ibn Abbas commented; Witt A) and go on increasing in disbelief), They remain on disbelief until they die. Mujahid said similarly.111 Allah then said, i^fXj C&A% Jfr iGive to the hypocrites the tidings that there is for them a painful torment.) Hence, the hypocrites have this characteristic, for they believe, then disbelieve, and this is why their hearts become sealed. Allah describes the hypocrites as taking the disbelievers as friends instead of the believers, meaning they are the disbelievers supporters in reality, for they give them their loyalty and friendship in secret. They also say to disbelievers when they are alone with them, We are with you, we only mock the believers by pretending to follow their religion. Allah said, while chastising them for being friends with the disbelievers, mfa^AA) do they seek honor, with them?) Allah then states that honor, power and glory is for Him Alone without partners, and for those whom Allah grants such in At-Tabari 9:315

qualities to. Allah said, it# j.} iWltosoever desires honor, then to Allah belong all honor}, and, y C0? yi4j 'O-") iBut honor belongs to Allah, and to His Messenger, and to the believers, but the hypocrites know not}. The statement that honor is Allah's Alone, is meant to encourage the servants to adhere to their servitude to Allah and to be among His faithful servants who will gain victory in this life and when the Witnesses stand up to testify on the Day of Resurrection. Allah's statement, ** * **j iAnd it has already been revealed to you in the Book that when you hear the verses of Allah being denied and mocked at, then sit not with them, until they engage in talk other than that; certainly in that case you would be like them . } The Ayah means, if you still commit this prohibition after being aware of its

prohibition, sitting with them where Allah's Ayat are rejected, mocked at and denied, and you sanction such conduct, then you have participated with them in what they are doing. So Allah said, i(But if you stayed with them) certainly in that case you would be like them.} concerning the burden they will earn. What has already been revealed in the Book - as the Ayah says - is the Ayah in Surat Al-An'am, which was revealed in Makkah, J& S Ay; Si' cffj } And when you see those who engage in false conversation about Our verses (of the Qur'an) by mocking at them, stay away from them}.

Muqatil bin Hayyan said that this Ayah [4:140] abrogated the Ayah in Surat Al-An'am, referring to the part that says here, i(But if you stayed with them) certainly in that case you would be like them}, and Allah's statement in Al-An'am, iTlws ivho fear Allah, keep their duty to Him and avoid evil, are not responsible for them (the disbelievers) in any case, but (their duty) is to remind them, that they may have Taqiva}. Allah's statement, U l _ .1 * * t ' . A * a , \ * - l'Z.'iu"V jjjoJi\ \OJ ^ . Uii ^ 'J3*^S)l liLi(lili J jy^ .yS^~^k2ijliJlJ[_ |w| 1%_y~ \j^S"ltu pi Jfcj 4 rp- 4 j.j&Mj o"i^' cj'i- ' i Surely, Allah will collect the hypocrites and disbelievers all together in Hell> means, just as the hypocrites participate in the Kufr of disbelievers, Allah will join them all together to reside in the Fire for eternity, dwelling in torment, punishment, enchained, restrained and in drinking boiling water. ji" ofj j\$2u J JJ1 IjHZj J* jCi if* oli

4342. Those who wait and watch about you; if you gain a victory from Allah, they say: "Were we not with you?" But if the disbelievers gain a success, they say (to them): "Did we not gain mastery over you and did we not protect you from the believers?" Allah will judge between you (all) on the Day of Resurrection . And never will Allah grant to the disbelievers a way (to triumph) over the believers.} Hypocrites Wait and Watch what Happens to Muslims Allah states that the hypocrites watch and await the harm that occurs to the believers, awaiting the time when the Muslim circumstances and religion are dissolved and the state of Kufr takes over. vt A if you gain a victory from Allah triumph, aid and booty, jS jff \$&} A they say, "Were we not with you?"} hying to come closer to the believers with this statement. However, A But if the disbelievers gain a success,} by gaining victory over the believers sometimes, just as occurred during Uhud, for surely, the Messengers were tested, but the final victory is theirs. 4Sc-p'{ s: & 4 they say (to them), "Did we not gain mastery over you and did we not protect you from the believers?"} meaning, did we not help you in secret and try our best to confuse the believers and weaken their resolve, until you gained victory over them? This statement of the hypocrites is an attempt to strengthen relations with the disbelievers, because they pretend to be friends with both parties so that they will be safe from their harm, due to their weak faith and

lack of certainty. Allah said, iAllah will judge between you (all) on the Day of Resurrection> meaning, by what He knows about you, O hypocrites. Therefore, do not be deceived by being shaded under the protection of Islamic Law in this life, which is such only out of Allah's wisdom. Surely, on the Day of Resurrection, your pretending shall not benefit you, because on that Day, the secrets of the souls will be disclosed and the contents of the hearts will be collected. Allah said, iAnd never will Allah grant to the disbelievers a way (to triumph) over the believers}. Abdur-Razzaq recorded that YasT Al-Kindi said, A man came to Ali bin Abi Talib and said, What about this Ayah, iAnd never will Allah grant to the disbelievers a way (to triumph) over the believers.} Ali said, Come closer, come closer. Allah will judge between you on the Day of Resurrection, and He will not grant victory for the disbelievers over the believers. ' Ibn Jurayj recorded that Ata Al-Khurasani said that Ibn Abbas said that, iAnd never will

They are often absent from the prayers that they can hide away from, such as the Isha prayer and the Dawn prayer that are prayed in darkness. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah said, *U[^]i b jyjju fj I Jit yJr'j 'y\ jU ifUS 'J>\ ji fj jhSjS&& 'sA a*The heaviest prayers on the hypocrites are the 'Isha' and Dawn prayers. If they know their rewards, they will attend them even if they have to crawl. I was about to order someone to pronounce the Adh[^]dn for the prayer, then order someone to lead the prayer for the people, that order some men to collect fire- wood (fuel) ; then I would bum the houses around men w[^]lw did not attend the (compulsory congregational) prayerJl2] In another narration, the Prophet jg said, j\ U-w 1iff-Al-B&ri 11:343 Al-Bari 2 :53 and Muslim 1 :451

j0L By Him, in Wltose Hand my soul is, if anyone of litem had known that he would get a bone covered with good meat or two (small) pieces of meat between two ribs, he would have turned up for the prayer, and had it not been that the houses have ivomett and children in them, I ivould burn their homes around them. Allah s statement, US iAnd they do not remember Allah but little means, during the prayer they do not feel humbleness or pay attention to what they are reciting. Rather, during their prayer, they are inattentive, jesting and avoid the good that they are meant to receive from prayer. Imam Malik reported that Al- Ala bin Abdur-Rahman said that Anas bin Malik said that the Messenger of Allah jjj said, o-jLi* Jib Jib tJilLJl V%j> Jibs

means that the hypocrites are swaying between faith and disbelief. So they are neither with believers inwardly or outwardly nor with disbelievers inwardly or outwardly. Rather, they are with the believers outwardly and with the disbelievers inwardly. Some of them would suffer fits of doubt, leaning towards these sometimes and towards those sometimes, piA 'j)j \zk} {Whenever it flashes for them, they walk therein, and zvhen darkness covers them, they stand still}. Mujahid said; {(They are) sioaying betveen this and that, belonging neither to these The Companions ofMuhammad jfc;, Jt^ {nor to those}: the Jews. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Umar said that the Prophet jte, said, aThe example of the hypocrite is the example of the sheep wandering between two herds, sometimes she goes to one of them, and sometimes the other, confused over whom she should follozv."

Ati-Nisa' (Part-5) the right path)) because, ^Whomsoever Allah sends astray, none can guide him}. So the hypocrites whom Allah has led astray from the paths of safety will never find a guide to direct them, nor someone to save them. There is none who can resist Allah s decision, and He is not asked about what He does, while they all will be asked. 4144. O you who believe! Do not take disbelievers as friends instead of believers. Do you wish to offer Allah a manifest Sultan against yourselves?} 4145. Verily, the hyprocrites will be in the lowest depth (grade) of the Fire; no helper will you findfor them.} 4146. Except those who repent, do righteous good deeds, depend on Allah, and purify their religion for Allah, then they will be with the believers. And Allah will grant the believers a great reioard.} 4147. Why should Allah punish you ifyou have thanked (Him) and have believed in Him. And Allah is Ever All-Appreciative (ofgood), All-Knowing.}

The Prohibition of Wilayah with the Disbelievers

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1317–1327]

Allah forbids His believing servants from taking the disbelievers as friends instead of the believers. This includes being friends and associates of the disbelievers, advising them, being intimate with them and exposing the secrets of the believers to them. In another Ayah, Allah said, ﴿لَا يَجْعَلُونَ لِلدِّينِ حُكْمًا وَلَا لِحُكْمِ اللَّهِ﴾ - "They do not make for the religion a law, nor for the law of Allah" (Al-Baqara: 175). This is a clear prohibition against taking disbelievers as friends or associates.

Let not the believers take the disbelievers as friends instead of the believers, and whoever does that, will never be helped by Allah in any way, except if you indeed fear a danger from them. And Allah warns you against Himself meaning, He warns you against His punishment if you fall into what He has prohibited. This is why Allah said here, ﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَتَّخِذُوا لِلدِّينِ حُكْمًا وَلَا لِحُكْمِ اللَّهِ﴾ meaning, proof against you that warrants receiving His torment. Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Ibn Abbas commented; {manifest Sultan}, The word Sultan in the Qur'an means proof. There is an authentic chain of narration for this statement, which is also the saying of Mujahid, al-As-Suddi and An-Nadr bin Arabi. The Hypocrites and the Friends of Disbelievers are in the Lowest Depth of the Fire, Unless they Repent Allah then states that, ﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَتَّخِذُوا لِلدِّينِ حُكْمًا وَلَا لِحُكْمِ اللَّهِ﴾ Verily, the hypocrites will be in the lowest depths of the Fire; } on the Day of Resurrection due to their tremendous Kufr. Al-Walibi [Ali bin Abi Talhah] said that Ibn Abbas said, {in the lowest depths (grade) of the Fire;} means, in the bottom of the Fire. Other scholars said that the Fire has ever lower depths just as Paradise had ever higher grades. Ibn Jarir recorded that Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that, in At-Tabari 9 :339

ip 'jt 4 P 4 cs& i Verily, the hypocrites will be in the lowest depths (grade) of the Fire}, Inside coffins of Fire that surround them, for they are closed and sealed in them. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that when Ibn Mas'ud was asked about the hypocrites, he said, They will be placed in coffins made of fire and they will be closed in them in the lowest depth of the Fire. \$ Pr && ino helper will you find for them.} to save them from their misery and painful torment. Allah then states that whoever among the hypocrites repents in this life, Allah will accept his repentance and sorrow, if his repentance were sincere and he then follows it by performing righteous deeds, all the while depending on his Lord. Allah said, {Except those who repent (from hypocrisy), do righteous good deeds, depend on Allah, and purify their religion for Allah} replacing showing off with sincerity, so that their good deeds will benefit them, even if they were minute. ik&P c? it then they zoill be with the believers.} on the Day of Resurrection, iilf yjj iAnd Allah tvill grant to the believers a great reivard.} Allah then states that He is too Rich to need anyone and that He only punishes the servants because of their sins, i pX'3 i&pZ } iWhy should Allah punish you if you have thanked (Him) and have believed in Him.} Ill At-Tabari 9 :339

624 Tafsir Ibtisami by correcting your actions and having faith in Allah and His Messenger, Jilt iArtd Allah is Ever All-Appreciative (of good), All-Knowing. Allah appreciates those who appreciate Him, and has knowledge of those whose hearts believe in Him, and He will give them perfect reward.

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TAFSIR (ABRIDGED) Parts 6, 7 & 8 (Surat An-Nisa, Verse 148 to the end of Surat Al-An am)

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Important Guidelines About the Authenticity of the Reports and Quotations in the Tafsir of Ibn Kathir Reports from the Companions of the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) Reports that are attributed to the companions of Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) are commonly used for additional explanation of the meanings of the Qur'an. As for those quotes that Ibn Kathir mentions in passing, these quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as an evidence against what is known to be authentic. Additional information in this regard is found in the Introduction of Ibn Kathir. Incomplete Chains of Narration The following is a list of common incomplete chains of narrations that Al-Hafiz Ibn Kathir often quotes. - Ali bin Abi Talhah (Al-Walibi) reported that Ibn Abbas said... - (Atiyah) Al-Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said... - Ad-Dahhak from Ibn Abbas. - As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik and Abu Salih from Ibn Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and (or) some men among the companions. - Al-Hasan Al-Basri reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). - Az-Zuhri [Muhammad bin Shihab] reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). - Urwah bin Az-Zubayr reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). - Ikrimah reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). - Qatadah reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). All narrations coming from these chains are unauthentic according to the Sciences of Hadith. Their meanings, however, may be correct as understood by authentic texts, and for this reason they are commonly referenced.

Reports from the Followers of the Companions and those who Follow them The following is a list of those who did not see the Prophet (ﷺ), but they report from companions of the Prophet (ﷺ), while often they themselves are quoted for Tafsir. Reports that are attributed to them are used as additional support in understanding certain issues by Ibn Kathir. Such quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as evidence against the authentic evidence. Abu Al-Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Al-Musayib, Ata' bin Abi Rabah, Ata' Al-Khurasani,

Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar-RabT bin Anas, Ash-ShaTjbi, Qatadah, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam (Ibn Zayd), Ibn Jurayj. Other Scholars After the Companions The following are some scholars that Ibn Kathir often quotes from. Since these scholars are not well known to the average English reader, one should beware that their own statements about the Prophet 2g, his companions, or circumstances surrounding the Qur'an's revelation, are not to be considered as important as authentically narrated texts. WakT, Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Ibn Atiyyah, Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari).

J \ T jU'i W3X&? > > - i ^ 'J-VUu 0_pdLLJl (jCi I \$hi <<'v.'" Si-"" s!*^" 44 *** ' 6 J* o; ji C^~ ijxjS ^cjt '*s? Sil iji , ijk jil *jiit 4f:y X 4148. Allah does not like that the evil should be uttered in public except by him who has been wronged. And Allah is Ever All-Hearer, All-Knower.} 4149. Whether you disclose a good deed or conceal it, or pardon an evil, verily, Allah is Ever Pardoning, All-Powerful.} The Permission to Utter Evil in Public, For One Who Was Wronged Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, ifi* U 4Alldh does not like that the evil should be uttered in public Allah does not like that any one should invoke Him against anyone else, unless one was wronged. In this case, Allah allows one to invoke Him against whoever wronged him. Hence Allah's statement, 4except by him who has been wronged.} Yet, it is better for one if he observes patience. 111 Al-Hasan .xj-li " ^pr ^ 'j3& Lrij& ^Ts*y jac\4 A ./ > , / ^ '{.*<< > '*A\ UjutCJal ^ y^ *ir in At-Tabari 9 :344

Throne praise Him saying, All praise is due to You for Your forbearing even though You have perfect knowledge (in all evil committed). Some of them supplicate, All praise is due to You for Your forgiving even though You have perfect ability (to punish). An authentic Hadith states, ii Ijaj < Yj Ijlp lilt SO Y_> i JU U1 "No charity shall ever decrease wealth, and Allah will only increase the honor of a servant who pardons, and he who is humble for Allah's sake, then Allah will elevate his grade eJ);i os-; Ji uj'Vj. .u-1 ojj lyyi jjJj iySIS ULJtc- 6jCa\> \i . 'jy*\$ (*r" 4150. Verily, those who disbelieve in Allah and His Messengers and wish to make distinction between Allah and His Messengers saying, "We believe in some but reject others," and wish to adopt a way in between 4151. They are in truth disbelievers. And We have prepared for the disbelievers a humiliating torment.} 4152 . And those who believe in Allah and His Messengers and make no distinction between any of them (Messengers), We shall give them their rewards; and Allah is Ever Forgiving, Most Merciful .} Believing in Some Prophets and Rejecting Others is Pure Kufr Allah threatens those who disbelieve in Him and in His Messengers, such as the Jews and Christians, who differentiate between Allah and His Messengers regarding faith. They believe in some Prophets and reject others, following their desires, lusts and the practices of their forefathers. They do not follow any proof for such distinction, because there is no such proof. Rather, they follow their lusts and prejudices. I 1 * Muslim 4 :2001 .

An-Nisa' (150 - 151) (Part-6) at least, they would have strived hard to acquire knowledge of the truth of the other Messenger. Allah said, iAttd We have prepared for the disbelievers a humiliating torment.} This is just punishment for belittling the Prophets whom they disbelieved in, by ignoring what the Prophet brought to them from Allah, and because they are interested in the insignificant possessions of this world. Or, their behavior could be the result of their disbelief in the Prophet after they were aware of his truth, just as the Jewish rabbis did during the time of Muhammad, the Messenger of Allah jg. The Jews envied the Messenger because of the great prophethood that Allah gave him, and as a

consequence, they denied the Messenger, defied him, became his enemies and fought against him. Allah sent humiliation upon them in this life, that shall be followed by disgrace in the Hereafter, 4\$ fol' i-ff ZJ.j7y} 4And they were covered with humiliation and misery, and they drew on themselves the wrath of Allah.} in this life and the Hereafter. Allah s statement, ' ' 4And those who believe in Allah and His Messengers and make no distinction between any of them,} This refers to the Ummah of Muhammad who believe in every Book that Allah has revealed and in every Prophet whom Allah has sent. Allah said, 4The Messenger believes in what has been revealed to him from his Lord, and (so do) the believers. All of them believe in Allah.} (2 :285). Allah then states that He has prepared great rewards for them, tremendous favor and a handsome bounty,

}We shall give them their rewards;} because of their faith in Allah and His Messengers, -111 il&J^ iand Allah is Ever Forgiving, Most Merciful.} for their sin, if they have any. to&& jfc3'm \$ ol jil 6 s j"lt lj2" 2 \$5& f 0 U"j Ciiij fry to O'-J' 4* il\$ 6*-; ^ea 4 lj5S V biiij 4\$yw pL 4253. The People of the Scripture (Jews) ask you to cause a book to descend upon them from heaven. Indeed, they asked Musa for even greater than that, when they said: "Show us Allah in public, but they were struck with a bolt of lightning for their wickedness. Then they worshipped the calf even after Al-Bayyinah had come to them. (Even) so We forgave them. And We gave Musa a clear proof of authority.} il54. And for their covenant, We raised over them the mount and (on the other occasion) We said: Enter the gate prostrating (or bowing) with humility; and We commanded them: Transgress not on the Sabbath (Saturday)." And We took from them a firm covenant.} The Stubbornness of the Jews Muhammad bin Rah Al-Qurazi, As-Suddi and Qatadah said that the Jews asked the Messenger of Allah to cause a book to come down to them from heaven, just as the Tawrah was sent down to Musa. Ibn Jurayj said that the Jews asked the Messenger to cause books to come down to them addressed to so-and-so among them, testifying to the truth of what he was sent with.¹² The Jews only asked for this because of their stubbornness, defiance, rejection and disbelief. The disbelievers of Quraysh also asked for similar things from the Prophet, as is mentioned in Surat Al-Isra , At-Tabari 9:356, 357. Jabari 9:357.

^ u s*^ j*-^ j 4Ah</ they say: "We shall not believe in you, until you cause a spring to gush forth from the earth for us;} (17:90) Allah said, itq & \)t& } ilindeed, they asked Musa for even greater than that, when they said, "Show us Allah in public," but they were struck with a bolt of lightning for their wickedness.} injustice, transgression, defiance and rebellion. This part was explained in Surat Al-Baqarah, j dj jifc \j p- 3" \Sj , * jtj> cJ *Ij} ^And (remember) when you said: "O Musa! We shall never believe in you until we see Allah plainly." But you were struck by a bolt of lightning while you were looking. Then We raised you up after your death, so that you might be grateful.} (2:55,56) Allah s statement, e&U iiS"2} iTheti they worshipped the calf even after Al-Bayyinah had come to them.} meaning, after they witnessed the tremendous miracles and unequivocal proofs at the hand of Musa in Egypt. They also witnessed the demise of their enemy, Fir awn and his soldiers, when they all drowned in the sea. Yet soon after, when they passed by a people who were worshipping idols, they said to MUsa, ihy -ft u 4Make for us a god as they have gods.} Allah explains the story of the Jews worshipping the calf in Surat Al-A raf (7) and Surah Ta Ha (20) after MQsa went to meet with his Lord. When Musa returned, Allah decreed that in order for the Jews to earn accepted repentance, then those

An-Nisd' (155 - 159) (Part-6 r. Jj ' ,r sot V.meaning, We commanded them to honor the Sabbath and honor what Allah prohibited them on that day. 'i^ujlj^ giftC)j?5 3\$Ql %&} \$**& 4&* & . fit 4And We took from them a firm covenant. meaning, strong covenant. They rebelled, transgressed and committed what Allah prohibited by using deceit and trickery, as is mentioned in Surat Al-A'raf (7), \$ if 4^i\ ;> . 4And ask them about the tenon that was by the sea.) "H &J" 'jfifs Cf jZ> '*C V' filij 4"i (**& J*i:~ (vp? 1' 'A'fi & fijfj fijfcfi ^\$4 ofiS. 0* ^ zf C&j y^~+ Cj ijki Iij ^sii Jjij 0;i (ili* Vil i^JILLa i# C5 tfit& ^ v .*jck&j* yasa sj Sp \$4 '4 A ^? v^* ie oij v /f oft i \ iai ilij j; 4^ * "!' fjp -}** Hi 4155. Because of their breaking the covenant, and their rejecting the Aydt of Allah, and their killing the Prophets unjustly, and their saying: "Our hearts are Ghulf, nay, Allah has set a seal upon their hearts because of their disbelief, so they believe not but a little.)

4156. And because of their disbelief and uttering against Maryam a grave false charge .} 4157. And because of their saying, "We killed Al-Masdi 'Isa, son of Maryam, the Messenger of Allah," but they killed him not, nor crucified him, but it appeared as that to them, and those who differ therein are full of doubts. They have no (certain) knowledge, they folloio nothing but conjecture. For surely; they killed him not.} 4158. But Allah raised him up unto Himself. And Allah is Ever All-Powerful, All-Wise.} 4159. And there is none of the People of the Scripture, but must believe in him, before his death. And on the Day of Resurrection, he will be a witness against them.} The Crimes of the Jews The sins mentioned here are among the many sins that the Jews committed, which caused them to be cursed and removed far away from right guidance. The Jews broke the promises and vows that Allah took from them, and also rejected Allah s Ayat, meaning His signs and proofs, and the miracles that they witnessed at the hands of their Prophets. Allah said, 4and their killing the Prophets unjustly,} because their many crimes and offenses against the Prophets of Allah, for they killed many Prophets, may Allah s peace be upon them Their saying: 4k& VJL} 4"Our hearts are Ghulf,"} meaning, wrapped with covering, according to Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ilcrimah, As-Suddi and Qatadah. This is similar to the what the idolators said, 4*\$l 4=^ a iSyis \$&)} m At-Tabari 9 :364

iAnd they say: "Our hearts are under coverings (screened from that to which you invite us.}" Allah said, ^ if inay, Allah has set a seal upon their hearts because of their disbelief,} It is as if they had given an excuse that their hearts do not understand what the Prophet says since their hearts are wrapped with coverings, so they claim. Allah said that their hearts are sealed because of their disbelief, as we mentioned before in the explanation of Surat Al-Baqarah. Allah then said, -ji iso they believe not but a little.} for their hearts became accustomed to Kufr, transgression and weak faith. The Evil Accusation the Jews Uttered Against Maryam and Their Claim that They Killed Isa Allah said, iAnd because of their (Jews) disbelief and uttering against Maryam a grave false charge.} Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas stated that the Jews accused Maryam of fornication.' ' This is also the saying of As- Suddi, Juwaybir, Muhammad bin Ishaq and several others. |2 This meaning is also apparent in the Ayah, as the Jews accused Maryam and her son of grave accusations: They accused her of fornication and claimed that Isa was an illegitimate son. Some of them even claimed that she was menstruating while fornicating. May Allah s continued curse be upon them until the Day of Resurrection. The Jews also said.Tabari 9:367. ' At-Tabari 9 :367

the house, and Isa was made to sleep and ascended to heaven while asleep. Allah said, it),\ J^ iAnd (remember) when Allah said: "O 'Isa! I will take you and raise you to Myself."} When Isa ascended, those who were in the house came out. When those surrounding the house saw the man who looked like Isa, they thought that he was Isa. So they took him at night, crucified him and placed a crown of thorns on his head. The Jews then boasted that they killed Isa and some Christians accepted their false claim, due to their ignorance and lack of reason. As for those who were in the house with Isa, they witnessed his ascension to heaven, while the rest thought that the Jews killed Isa by crucifixion. They even said that Maiyam sat under the corpse of the crucified man and cried, and they say that the dead man spoke to her. All this was a test from Allah for His servants out of His wisdom. Allah explained this matter in the Glorious Qur'an which He sent to His honorable Messenger, whom He supported with miracles and clear, unequivocal evidence. Allah is the Most Truthful, and He is the Lord of the worlds Who knows the secrets, what the hearts conceal, the hidden matters in heaven and earth, what has occurred, what will occur, and what would occur if it was decreed. He said. &4M ibut they killed him not, nor crucified him, but it appeared as tlwt to them,} referring to the person whom the Jews thought was Isa. This is why Allah said afterwards, IQj hu*A ck&J" \$ iand those who differ therein are full of doubts. They have no (certain) knowledge, they follow nothing but conjecture.} referring to the Jews who claimed to kill Isa and the ignorant Christians who believed them. Indeed they are all in confusion, misguidance and bewilderment. This is why Allah said, its, Cj}

iFor surely; they killed him not.} meaning they are not sure that Isa was the one whom they killed. Rather, they are in doubt and confusion over this matter. iBut Allah raised him up unto Himself. And Allah is Ever All- Powerful,} meaning, He is the Almighty, and He is never weak, nor will those who seek refuge in Him ever be subjected to disgrace, 4C&}.} 4All-Wise.} in all that He decides and ordains for His creatures. Indeed, Allah's is the clearest wisdom, unequivocal proof and the most glorious authority. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said, Just before Allah raised Isa to the heavens, Isa went to his companions, who were twelve inside the house. When he arrived, his hair was dripping water and he said, There are those among you who will disbelieve in me twelve times after he had believed in me. He then asked, Who volunteers that his image appear as mine, and be killed in my place. He will be with me (in Paradise)? One of the youngest ones among them volunteered and Isa asked him to sit down. Isa again asked for a volunteer, and the young man kept volunteering and Isa asking him to sit down. Then the young man volunteered again and Isa said, *You will be that man, and the resemblance of Isa was cast over that man while Isa ascended to heaven from a hole in the house. When the Jews came looking for Isa, they found that young man and crucified him. Some of Isa's followers disbelieved in him twelve times after they had believed in him. They then divided into three groups. One group, Al-Ya qQbiyyah (Jacobites), said, Allah remained with us as long as He willed and then ascended to heaven. Another group, An-Nasturiyyah (Nestorians), said, The son of Allah was with us as long as he willed and Allah took him to heaven. Another group, Muslims, said, The servant and Messenger of Allah remained with us as long as Allah willed, and Allah then took him to Him. The two disbelieving groups cooperated against the Muslim group and they killed them. Ever since that happened, Islam was then veiled until Allah

sent Muhammad jg. ' This statement has an authentic chain of narration leading to Ibn Abbas, and

30 TafsTr Ibn Kathir Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, r-> ^ ^ ~ai_> *^fc! ^ Cri (4^ 'jr5 AijwiJl j_jS5 "By Him in Whose Hands my soul is, the son of Maryam ('Isa) will shortly descend among you as a just ruler, and will break the cross, kill the pig and abolish the JizyahJ Then there will be an abundance of wealth and nobody will accept charitable gifts any more. At that time, one prostration will be better far them than this Ufa and all that is in itj Abu Hurayrah then said, Read ifyou will, f 3 A \$ ly Jlj} iAnd there is none of the People of the Scripture, but must believe in him, before his death. And on the Day of Resurrection, he will be a witness against them.}

Hurayrah said that the Prophet said, lo^Ajill J ' Ji (*Jy* jj' ,_* jf 44 * ^rCi J^ ^ J1**- t'isa, son of Maryam, will descend and will kill the pig, break the cross, lead the prayer in congregation and give away wealth until it is no longer accepted by anyone. He will also abolish the Jizyah and go to Ar-Rawlid from where he will go to perform Hajj, 'Umrah or both. Abu Hurayrah then recited, 4*a>* CA*jy 1JJ, A iAnd there is none of the People of the Scripture, but must believe in him, before his death.} Hanzalah said, Abu Hurayrah added, 'Will believe in Isa before Isa dies, but I do not know if this was a part of the Prophet s Hadith or if it was something that Abu Hurayrah said on his own. ! Ibn Abi Hatim also recorded this Hadith. Another Hadith

t/lj p-(riiJ 40^AiJ 3^! ty-s :aA^ ^^ p iSf ij^u J4 4-4 pJ 3 4^ oU 4 oi# ^idij Ji i^U.'ijl JJ 3r4i' 4)*J1 *iJ 34ji*^' J^d3 tv^-Jjall JjJ C? J 4l juft 4 4l jLjl AjUj J &| ill^j c* jUJi3 ^ j^vi >- Ji ^jSii ,_Jp ciVi jUiijiji 4 SL^J 4^-A^iu N Ol^AJU jC-lJl 4 -W-Lj 4 t^ljJJtj 4 Xl\ j_ J' 4^ (J--43 ,^ j*- "The Prophets are paternal brothers; their mothers are different, but their religion is one. I, more than any of mankind, have more right to 'Isa, son of Maryam, for there was no Prophet between him and I. He will descend, and ifyou see him, knmv him. He is a well-built man, (the color of his skin) between red and white. He will descend while wearing two long, light yelloio gartnents. His head appears to be dripping water, even though no moisture touched it. He will break the cross, kill the pig, and banish the Jizyah and will call the people to Islam. During his time, Allah will destroy all religions except Islam and Allah will destroy Al-Masili Ad-Dajjdl (the False Messiah). Safety will then fill the earth, so much so that the lions will mingle with camels, tigers with cattle and wolves with sheep. Children will play with snakes, and they will not ham them. 'Isa will remain forty years and then will die, and

fc ^ ajj i 'y : c)^i " |"^Jj aJ \1* JJ Xs* ! J-iii aIJj v !xl " j.lg- V sIJJ li-*J I c A^Ialla^i J^xIIaj t !-Xj l N v^JLli! i4ii! p-SllLi- Ji jj :jUalli ! M p4 jji*i j*-a Lilli fLJl! !j*U- iJl^U JiJ a^j ^y-j* ttri^ "Jj*-i o^A^liJl w*"i ! JUaU j iciAL\$! *\$j>)& c frLU ! ^J> ^JLJl ujl 115 "!! i^I)! jjj> - * - . "*" * >: ^ k . *?' , l oJLj OJ l "77ie (Lasf,) Hour will not start until the Romans occupy Al- A'mdq or Ddbiq.111 An army, comprised of the best of the people of the earth then, will come from Al-Madinah and challenge them. When they camp face to face, the Romans will say, 'Let us fight those who captured some of us.' The Muslims will say, 'Nay! By Allah, we will never let you get to our brothers.' They ivill fight them. A third of the (Muslim) army will flee in defeat, and those are the ones whom Allah will never forgive. Another third will be killed, and those are the best martyrs before Allah. The last third will be victorious, and this third will never be stricken with Fitnah, and they will capture Constantinople (Istanbul). While they are dividing war booty, after hanging their swords on olive trees, Shaytan will shout among them, saying, 'Al-Masili (Ad-Dajjdl) has cornered your people'. They will leave to meet Ad-Dajjdl in Ash-Sham. Tins will be a false warning, and when they reach Ash-Sham, Ad- Dajjdl will then appear. When the

Muslims are arranging their lines for battle and the prayer is called for, 'Isa, son of Maryam, will descend and - lead them in prayer. When the enemy of Allah (the False Messiah) sees him, he will dissolve just as salt dissolves in water, and if any of him were left, he would continue dissolving until he died. Allah will kill him with the hand of 'Isa and will show the Muslims his blood on his spear. Two cities close to Aleppo in Syria 4:2221.

I N 1 "/ ear of/ier f/ian Ad-Dajjal for you! If he appears while I am still among you, I will be his adversary on your behalf. If he appears while I am not among you, each one will depend on himself and Allah will be the Helper of every Muslim after me. He is young, with very curly hair and his eye is smashed. I thought that he looked like Abdul-Uzzd bin Qatan. Whoever lives long and meets Ad-Dajjal, then let him recite the beginnings of Surat Al-Kahf. He will appear on a pass between Ash-Sham (Syria) and Al-Irdq. He will wreak havoc to the right and left. O Servants of Allah! Holdfast ." We said, O Messenger of Allah! How long will he stay on earth? He said, <**** {y.j fjt) Forty days : One day as long as a year, one day as long as a month and one day as long as a week. The rest of his days will be as long as one of your ordinary days ." We said, O Messenger of Allah! As for the day that is like a year, will the prayers of one day suffice for it? He said, "J Ijjiil No. Count far its due measure We said, O Messenger of Allah, how will his speed be on earth? He said, id 14J 'pAjt-Xi pi JjIp 44iJlS" cJl\ s u J iiLJii j i>^i jiisji i" \ f _f- z i , , , ; , " i * " ^ lij^i > , sj i s ii > ' * " , < . " >> \ \ * - Vj i Ull3> bill a- Ip j* fjt I l ^ l U.vtli i kiJUwaJj diS li-fl.) 0? J- iij-' ojllUl Xp Jj4" if*

An-Nisd' (155 - 159) (Part-6) just like swarms of bees. He will summon a man full of youth and will strike him with the sword once and will cut him into two pieces (and will separate between them like) the distance (between the hunter and) the game. He will call the dead man and he will come, and his face will be radiant with pleasure and laughter. Afterwards (while all this is happening with Ad- Dajjal), Allah will send Al-Masili (Isa), son of Maryam down. He will descend close to the white minaret to the east of Damascus. He will be wearing garments lightly colored with saffron and his hands will be placed on the wings of two angels. Whenever he lowers his head droplets fall. Whenever he raises his head, precious stones that look like pearls fall. No disbeliever can survive Isa's breath, which reaches the distance of his sight. He will pursue Ad-Dajjal and will follow him to the doors of (the Palestinian city of) Ludd where he will kill him . A group of people who, by Allah's help, resisted and survived Ad-Dajjal, will pass by Isa and he will anoint their faces and inform them about their grades in Paradise. Shortly afterwards, while this is happening with Isa, Allah will reveal to him, 7 raised a people of My creation that no one can fight. Therefore, gather My servants to At-Tur (the mountain of Musa in Sinai).' Then, Allah will raise Gog and Magog and they will swiftly swarm from every mound. Their front forces will reach Lake Tabariah (Sea of Galilee) and will drink all its water. The last of their forces will say as they pass by the lake, 'This lake once had water!' Meanwhile, 'Isa, Allah's Prophet, will be cornered along with his companions until the head of a bull will be more precious to them than a hundred Dinars to you today. 'Isa, Allah's Prophet, and his companions will invoke Allah for help and Allah will send An-Naghaf (a worm) into the necks of Gog and Magog! The morning will come, and they will all be dead as if it was the death of one soul. Afterwards, 'Isa, the Prophet of Allah, will come down with his companions to the low grounds (from Mount At-Tur). They will find that no space of a hand-span on the earth was free of their fat and rot (rotten corpses). Isa, the Prophet of Allah, and his

companions will seek Allah in supplication . Allah will send birds as large as the necks of camels. They will carry them (the corpses of Gog and Magog) and will throw them wherever Allah wills.

Afterwards, Allah will send rain that no house made of mud or animal hair will be saved from, and it will cleanse the earth until it is as clean as a mirror. The earth will be commanded (by Allah), 'Produce your fruits and regain your blessing.' Then, the group will eat from a pomegranate and will take shelter under the shade of its skin. Milk will be blessed, so much so that the milk-producing camel will yield large amounts that suffice for a large group of people. Meanwhile, Allah will send a pure wind that will overcome

An-Nisid' (155 - 159) (Part-6 Allah), or he said, There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah. I almost decided to never narrate anything to anyone. I only said, Soon, you will witness tremendous incidents, the House (the Ka*bah) will be destroyed by fire, and such and such things will occur. He then said, The Messenger of Allah said, *ixtiJ 3^ ^ji t, ^ j> JttoJl ^j>^} aJL* i J>. i'/j* ' ^y> , ililp jt *HJ iii Jr>: p "jfe J&\& j4 ^ !ii Ikx: p jf- hi& J!^ t=rj 'J a'& Jj it 4S* xS 'jt a>-I ji j! hzJxj VI - jLlL ji - (*V^- L_> jlkJI ii>- ^llil jljJ< ^j Oil : Jli " ' vl :jJd jiklii^ jt4 .ijsn jjjsi; v'j v ^uui Jli iui J> ,Uj olijVl ;Sl^ jUjiii ? Ujll Ui :jJJa fj3 ^ jytai\ j*Jjjj jxJv :Jli i *LJ ,j^>- k. jAj ^ Jjij : Jli - jLh Jli ji - jk i\s \% - 5i,i Jji: :ju jl - lii J^ji p ft? p- iij>-f jw i oJlii - iidjl jlli; 1 : (d - Oj Jx-i uAd-Dajjal will appear in my nation and will remain for forty. (The narrator doubts whether it is forty days, months, or years).Then, Allah will send down Isa, son of Maryam, looking just like 'Urwah bin Mas'ud and he will seek Ad-Dajjal and will kill him. People will remain for seven years with no enmity between any two. Allah will send a cool wind from As- Sham that will leave no man on the face of the earth who has even the weight of an atom of good or faith, but will capture (his soul) . Even if one of you takes refuge in the middle of a mountain, it will find him and capture (his soul). Afterwards, only the most evil people will remain. They will be as light as birds, with the comprehension of beasts. They will not know or enjoin righteousness or forbid or know evil. Shaytan will appear*

to them and will say to them, 'Woidd you follow me.' They will say, What do you command usV He will command them to worship the idols. Meanwhile, their provision will come to them in abundance and their life will be good. Then the Trumpet will be blown and every person who hears it, will lower one side of his head and raise the other side (trying to hear that distant sound). The first man who will hear the Trumpet is someone who is preparing the zoater pool for his camels, and he and the people will swoon away. Allah will send down heavy rain and the bodies of people will grow with it. The Trumpet will be blown in again and the people will be resurrected and looking all about, staring. It will be said to them, O people! Come to your Lord,' iBut stop them, verily, they are to be questioned tJLL* i tJLJl slll-ii ;JU t i" _Jj "It will then be said, 'Bring forth the share of the Fire.' It will be asked, 'How many?' It will be said, From every one thousand, nine hundred and ninety-nine. That Day is when, the children will turn grey-headed and, if 4The Day when the Shin slml be laid bare

The Description of 'Isa, upon him be Peace

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1362–1379]

As mentioned earlier, Abdur-Rahman bin Adam narrated that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet said, OJj fa.A* j j's Muslim 4 :2258.

An-Nisd' (155 - 159) (Part-6 nlfyou see Isa, know him. He is a well-built man, (the color of his skin) between red and white. He will descend while wearing light yellow garments. His head looks like it is dripping water, even though no moisture touched ff.ii111 In the Hadith that An-Nawwas bin Sam'an narrated, Ij JliP V 4j*ij lilj t'Jai U"U" lil t jl? V ^g ... lj (OU V1 ^Mwb 7TLJJ J9U ^I^J nHe will descend close to the white minaret to the east of Damascus. He will be wearing two garments lightly colored with saffron, having his hands on the wings of two angels. Whenever he lowers his head, drops will fall off of it. Whenever he raises his head, precious [ewels like pearls will fall off of it. No disbeliever can survive 'Isa's breath, and his breath reaches the distance ofhis sight.

in his right eye. He looked exactly as Ibn Qatan, and he was leaning on the shoulder of a man while circling the House. I asked. Who is this man?' I was told, 'He is Al-Masih Ad- Dajjdl.' ["

4Almighty, the All-Wise.} 0* p^ ol"-1 'r^t. ijil* vi/ili ji C'j^k rt^lj 52" 'jr A* ijil ji ^*J ^iU}. J^i tc o i>; cijljji'j |^ jsf 4 jj^' 'j^ (T^ M 4>>\$H} -iyjii'j *ji^' 4:%> } . For the wrongdoing of the Jews, We made unlawful for them certain good foods which had been lawful for them-and for their hindering manyfrom Allah's way;} 4161. And their taking of Riba though they were forbidden from taking it, and their devouring men's substance wrongfully. And We have prepared for the disbelievers among them a painful torment.} 4162. But those among them who are well-grounded in knowledge, and the believers, believe in what has been sent down to you and what was sent down before you; and those who perform the Saldh, and give Zakah and believe in Allah and in the Last Day, it is they to whom We shall give a great reward.} Some Foods Were Made Unlawful for the Jews Because oftheir Injustice and Wrongdoing Allah states that because of the injustice and transgression of the Jews, demonstrated by committing major sins, He prohibited some of the lawful, pure things which were previously allowed for them. This prohibition could be only that of decree, meaning that Allah allowed the Jews to falsely interpret their Book and change and alter the information about what was allowed for them. They thus, out of exaggeration and extremism in the religion, prohibited some things for themselves. It could also mean that in the Tawrah, Allah prohibited things that were allowed for them before. Allah said, 4)> oi 'i-r** if- (j-* - 1* Jits-l xjr{ 4 =" y}

An-Nisa (160 - 162) (Part-6) 4AU food was lawful to the Onldren of Israel, except what Isrd'il made unlawful for himself before the Tawrah was revealed.} We mentioned this Ayah before, which means that all types of food were allowed for the Children of Israel before the Tawrah was revealed, except the camel s meat and milk that Israll prohibited for himself. Later, Allah prohibited many things in the Tawrah. Allah said in Surat Al-An'am (chapter 6), foo S} J^=" 'jjUji u yt^ s< 4And unto those who are Jews, Weforbade every (animal) with undivided hoof, and We forbade them the fat of the ox and the sheep except what adheres to their backs or their entrails, or is mixed up with a bone. Thus We recompensed them for their rebellion. And verily. We are Truthful.} This means, We prohibited these things for them because they deserved it due to their transgression, injustice, defying their Messenger and disputing with him. So Alldh said; o*- oil* /jit fms 4For the wrongdoing of the Jews, We made unlawful to them certain good foods which had been lawful to thetn, and for their hindering manyfrom Allah s way.} This Ayah states that they hindered themselves and others from following the truth, and

this is the behavior that they brought from the past to the present. This is why they were and still are the enemies of the Messengers, killing many of the Prophets. They also denied Muhammad and Isa, peace be upon them. Allah said, 4& ij % ij l' 4And their taking of Riba' though they were forbidden from taking it,} Allah prohibited them from taking Riba , yet they did so

46 Tafoir Ibn Kathir using various kinds of tricks, ploys and cons, thus devouring people s property unjustly. Allah said, i'C Q C'j* (*r iAnd We have prepared for the disbelievers among them a painful torment Allah then said, 'i i&y iBut those among them who are well-grounded in knowledge...} firm in the religion and full of beneficial knowledge. We mentioned this subject when we explained Surah Al Imran (3). The Ayah; iand the believers...} refers to the well-grounded in knowledge; o-* Uj kiUj L ibelieve in what has been sent down to you and what was sent down before you;} Ibn Abbfs said, This Ayah was revealed concerning Abdullah bin Salam, Thalabah bin Sa yah, Zayd bin Sa*yah and Asad bin TJbayd who embraced Islam and believed what Allah sent Muhammad jg with. Allah said, iand give Zakdh,} This could be referring to the obligatory charity due on one s wealth and property, or those who purify themselves, or both. Allah knows best. 4&" iand believe in Allah and in the Last Day,} They believe that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah, believe in Resurrection after death and the reward or punishment for the good or evil deeds. Allah s statement, ilt is they,} thosewhom the Ayah described above,

An-Nisd' (163 - 165) (Part-6) mxm ' fs < rV my' y.my yy my "--f JOJ^A) >- "'- ~-y, > j*%5, />< "- - vi""ja jj dll^Jtaj ^-va (4 0tejs&s&tfs by> Jb-' 1^o whom We s/ia// give a great reward.} means Paradise. xr jQl txjt q *i^ ai gy dl Xji -*.5?Sl 2k XLXjlj ic.V(s ' >" S>. >' / !</ / . OJj^J VJi'j Cs-iZJ #<\$ t3" oj ii& * *\$& ^tUc. p|^iV> jU ilijj jl" ifplii^sO y iill & teX k& m iU \$ ofjii \$& "# 'M m Verily, We have sent the revelation to you as We sent the revelation to Nuh and the Prophets after him; We (also) sent the revelation to Ibrahim, Ismd'il, Ishaq, Ya'qub, and Al-Asbdt, (the offspring of the twelve sons of Ya'qub) 'Isa, Ayyub, Yunus, Hdrun, and Sulaymdn ; and to Ddwud We gave the Zabiir.} And Messengers We have mentioned to you before, and Messengers We have not mentioned to you, and to Musa Allah spoke directly.} Messengers as bearers of good news and warning, in order that mankind should have no plea against Allah after the (coming of) Messengers. And Allah is Ever All-Powerful, All- Wise.}

Yasa (Elisha), Zakariya (Zachariya), Yahya (John) and Isa (Jesus), and their leader, Muhammad sg. Several scholars of Tafsir also listed Dhul-Kifl among the Prophets. Allah s statement, iand Messengers We have not mentioned to you,} means, there are other Prophets whom We did not mention to you in the Qur an. The Virtue ofMusa Allah said, ii' fej} iand to Musa Allah spoke directly.} This is an honor to Musa, and this is why he is called the Kalim, he whom Allah spoke to directly. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr bin Marduwyah recorded that Abdul-Jabbar bin Abdullah said, A man came to Abu Bakr bin Ayyash and said, 1 heard a man recite (this Ayah this way): llASS "and to Allah, Musa spoke directly." Abu Bakr said, Only a disbeliever would recite it like this. Al- A*mash recited it with Yahya bin Withab, who recited it with Abu Abdur-Rahman As-Sulami who recited it with Ali bin Abi Talib who recited with the Messenger of Allah sg, iL Z=Ci iit %i} iand to Musa Allah spoke directly.} "[n Abu Bakr bin Abi Ayyash was so angry with the man who recited the Ayah differently, because he altered its words and meanings. That person was from the group of Mu'tazilah who denied that Allah spoke to Musa or

that He speaks to any of His creation. We were told that some of the Mu'tazilah once recited the Ayah that way, so one teacher present said to him, O son of a stinking woman! What would you do concerning I 1 * At-Tabarani in Al-Awsat: 3325.

Allah's statement, i&& C&j& it as} 4And when Musa came at the time and place appointed by Us, and his Lord spoke to him,} [7:143]? The Shaykh meant that the later Ayah cannot be altered or changed. TheReasonBehind Sendingthe Prophets is to Establish the Proof Allah said, .Messengers as bearers ofgood news as well as ofwarning,} meaning, the Prophets bring good news to those who obey Allah and practice the good things that please Him. They also warn against His punishment and torment for those who defy His commandments. Allah said next, iii o'?'> j"> vX j&i ujBJ SjS yii} 4in order that mankind should have no plea against Allah after the Messengers. And Allah is Ever All-Powerful, All-Wise.} Allah sent down His Books and sent His Messengers with good news and warnings. He explained what He likes and is pleased with and what He dislikes and is displeased with. This way, no one will have an excuse with Allah. Allah said in other Ayat, Jt ui x&i Vjj \ja \$ i\ &} 1 -i -s 4And ifWe had destroyed them with a torment before this, they would surely have said: "Our Lord! Ifonly You had sent us a Messenger, we should certainly havefollowed Your Ayat, before we were humiliated and disgraced."} and. iLiji Cj 4And if (We had) not (sent you to the people of Makkah) in case a calamity should seize them for (the deeds) that their hands have sentforth.}

k^^ JL>-1 Nj illiJ ^TJ 3* i 1 * cr! iJl r-4 -iu> J

for you. But if you disbelieve, then certainly to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and the earth. And Allah is Ever All- Knowing, All-Wise.> Allah's statement i& ^ Verily, We have inspired you emphasized the Prophet's prophethood and refuted the idolaters and People of the Scripture who denied him. Allah said, \$ vl it j> iBut Allah bears witness to that which He has sent down unto you," meaning, even if they deny, defy and disbelieve in you, O Muhammad, Allah testifies that you are His Messenger to whom He sent down His Book, the Glorious Qur'an that, lb U ii'A. y.b ife iFalsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it, (it is) sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy ofall praise. Allah then said, i-i+n-m 4He has sent it down with His knowledge, The knowledge of His that He willed His servants to have access to. Knowledge about the clear signs of guidance and truth, what Allah likes and is pleased with, what He dislikes and is displeased with, and knowledge of the Unseen, such as the past and the future. This also includes knowledge about His honorable attributes that no sent Messenger or illustrious angel can even know without Allah's leave. Similarly, Allah said, 4And they will never compass anything of His knowledge except that which He wills. and,

An-Nisd' (166 - 170) (Part-6 4but they will never compass anything ofHis knowledge.) Allah's statement. iand the angels bear witness.) to the truth of what you came with and what was revealed and sent down to you, along with Allah's testimony to the same, 4And Allah is All-Sufficient as a Witness.) Allah said. 4 'x_'J -6 "j"l 0* rfj' 6',^ iVerily, those who disbelieve and prevent (others)from the path ofAllah, they have certainly strayedfar away.) For they are disbelievers themselves and do not follow the truth. They strive hard to prevent people from following and embracing Allah's path. Therefore, they have defied the truth, deviated, and strayed far away from it. Allah also mentions His judgment against those who disbelieve in His Ayat, Book and Messenger, those who wrong themselves by their disbelief and hindering others from His path, committing sins and violating His prohibitions. Allah

states that He will not forgive them; 4&J* r+i-Q, inor will He guide them to a way (that is, ofgood).) 4% > 4Except the way of Hell, to dwell therein forever...) and this is the exception. Allah then said, PJ *M mankind! Verily, there has come to you the Messenger with the truth from your Lord, so believe in him, it is better for you.) This Ayah means, Muhammad jg has come to you with guidance, the religion of truth and clear proof from Allah. Therefore, believe in what he has brought you and follow him, for this is better for you. Allah then said, 4cj?J\$J 4 A 'j/52 o\o)

J assniss ' ' j^I_jL3o"5 > 'Jjtibj ill ^\lfUj1T4l4^= 4J"t 8Ej"S" Si *But *f you disbelieve, then certainly to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and the earth.} Allah is far too rich than to need you or your faith, and no harm could ever affect Him because of your disbelief. Allah said in another Ayah, ~irAJ ^ Q 6j*^Sjj 0uSJ&&\$&\${ &\$&& j*j jivl ty JBj^ iff) 2i\ LLj. J\ j iAnd Musa said: "If you disbelieve, you and all on earth together, then verily, Allah is Rich (Free of all needs), Owner of all praise. } Allah said here, "Oi 4\$ >%) iAnd Allah is Ever All-Knowing,} He knows those who deserve to be guided, and He will guide them. He also knows those who deserve deviation, and He leads them to it, iAll-Wise} in His statements, actions, legislation and all that He decrees. Ci\ jhIif \$" jc ijiji-j Vj 'fz=c- 4 IjLi "5 jiV*^ " > ! Jo? Ji, '-fuil ^ iA> i?i6 4 C jS& JS j 1 %i&Q Jfej . I#J % IJ^s ^ \$> !*iVf 4 c;

An-Nisa (171) (Part-6 4171. O People of the Scripture! Do not exceed the limits in your religion, nor say ofAllah except the truth. Al-Masih 'Isa, son ofMaryam, was (no more than) a Messenger of Allah and His Word, which He bestowed on Maryam and a spirit from [created by] Him; so believe in Allah and His Messengers. Say not: "Three! Cease! (it is) better for you. For Allah is (the only) One God, hallowed be He above having a son. To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. And Allah is All-Sufficient as a Disposer of affairs.} Prohibiting the People of the Book From Going to Extremes in Religion Allah forbids the People of the Scriptures from going to extremes in religion, which is a common trait of theirs, especially among the Christians. The Christians exaggerated over Isa until they elevated him above the grade that Allah gave him. They elevated him from the rank of prophethood to being a god, whom they worshipped just as they worshipped Allah. They exaggerated even more in the case of those who they claim were his followers, claiming that they were inspired, thus following every word they uttered whether true or false, be it guidance or misguidance, truth or lies. This is why Allah said, 4They took their rabbis and their monks to be their lords besides Allah.} Imam

0 people/ Say what you have to say, but do not allow Shaytan to trick you. I am Muhammad bin 'Abdullah, Allah's servant and Messenger. By Allah! I do not like that you elevate me above the rank that Allah has granted me.

ot . JS J^S vi c^f j^="t iAl-Masili [Isa], son of Maryam, was no more than a Messenger; many were the Messengers that passed aivay before him. His mother [Maryam] was a Siddfqah. They both ate food.} And Allah said, \$ '& JVS y'> Jt \$ XJr Ji 4Verily, the likeness of 'Isa before Allah is the likeness of Adam. He created himfrom dust, then (He) said to him: "Be!" - and he was.} i_.lt t+Lfj Jf 4And she who guarded her chastity, We breathed into her (garment) and We made her and her son ['Isa] a sign for all that exits.} (21 :91) ~Csf Jf* -*!1 (y'OAnd Maryam, the daughter of 'Imran who guarded her chastity,} and Allah said concerning the Messiah, 4& 2* j& Vi ji 5[] 4He ['Isa] ivas not more than a servant. We granted Ourfavor to him.}

The Meaning of “His Word and a spirit from Him”

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1379–1382]

Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma'mar said that Qatadah said that the Ayah, 'And His Word, which He bestowed on Maryam and a spirit from [created by] Him; } means, He said,

and he was. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that

(171) (Part-6) is in the earth ; it is all from Him.} meaning, from His creation, from Him does not mean that it is a part of Him, as the Christians claim, may Allah's continued curses be upon them. Saying that something is from Allah, such as the spirit of Allah, the she-camel of Allah or the House of Allah, is meant to honor such items. Allah said, 'This is the she-camel of Allah...' and, 'I will sanctify My House for those who circumambulate it.' An authentic Hadith states, 'I will enter on my Lord in His Horned All these examples are meant to honor such items when they are attributed to Allah in this manner. Allah said, 'So believe in Allah and His Messengers.' believe that Allah is One and Alone and that He does not have a son or wife. Know and be certain that Isa is the servant and Messenger of Allah. Allah said after that, 'I say not: "Three!"' do not elevate Isa and his mother to be gods with Allah. Allah is far holier than what they attribute to Him. In Surat Al-Maidah (chapter 5), Allah said, 'Surely, disbelievers are those who said : "Allah is the third of the three. But there is none who has the right to be worshipped but One God.' Allah said by the end of the same Surah, 'Who is like Him?' *** Al-Bukhari 13:246, from the lengthy Hadith about the intercession

And (remember) when Allah will say (on the Day of Resurrection): "O son of Maryam! Did you say unto men : 'Worship me'?" and in its beginning, 'Surely, in disbelief are they who say that Allah is the Messiah, son of Maryam.) The Christians, may Allah curse them, have no limit to their disbelief because of their ignorance, so their deviant statements and their misguidance grows. Some of them believe that Isa is Allah, some believe that he is one in a trinity and some believe that he is the son of Allah. Their beliefs and creeds are numerous and contradict each other, prompting some people to say that if ten Christians meet, they would end up with eleven sects! The Christian Sects Said bin Batriq, the Patriarch of Alexandria and a famous Christian scholar, mentioned in the year four hundred after the Hijrah, that a Christian Council convened during the reign of Constantine, who built the city that bears his name. In this Council, the Christians came up with what they called the Great Trust, which in reality is the Great Treachery. There were more than two thousand patriarchs in this Council, and they were in such disarray that they divided into many sects, where some sects had twenty, fifty or a hundred members, etc.! When the king saw that there were more than three hundred Patriarchs who had the same idea, he agreed with them and adopted their creed. Constantine who was a deviant philosopher - gave his support to this sect for which, as an honor, churches were built and doctrines were taught to young children, who were baptized on this creed, and books were written about it. Meanwhile, the king oppressed all other sects. Another Council produced the sect known as the Jacobites, while the Nestorians were formed in a third Council. These three sects agreed that Isa was divine, but disputed

regarding the manner in which Isa's divinity was related to his

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1382–1391]

humanity; were they in unity or did Allah incarnate in Isa! All three of these sects accuse each other of heresy and, we

believe that all three of them are disbelievers. Allah said, iCease! (it is) better for you.} meaning, it will be better for you. A&& iit (\$ iFor Allah is (the only) One God, hallowed be He above having a son .) and He is holier than such claim. 4To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. And Allah is All-Sufficient as a Disposer of affairs,) for all are creatures, property and servants under His control and disposal, and He is the Disposer of the affairs. Therefore, how can He have a wife or a son among them, i% %& U oy-Ji y:) 4He is the originator of the heavens and the earth. How can He have children.) and \ jje? ijiuJ] iAnd they say: "The Most Gracious (Allah) has begotten a son. Indeed you have brought forth (said) a terrible evil thing." Up to His saying, ^Alone.) If- < ,*j Z3Li\ Vj & fo* ol ji) tl_jt Cjlji > \ "V> ii/SLitj iyScU tilj " oj (<* * ." (**->. o; (*V 4172. Al-Masih will never be too proud to be a servant of Allah, nor the angels who are the near (to Allah). And

62 Tafstr Ibn Kathir whosoever rejects His worship and is proud, then He will gather them all together unto Himself.} il73. So, as for those who believed and did deeds of righteousness, He will give them their (due) rewards - and more out of His bounty. But as for those who refused His worship and were proud, He will punish them with a painful tortnent. And they will not find for themselves besides Allah any protector or helper.} The Prophets and Angels Are Never too Proud to Worship Allah Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said that, proud , means insolent. Qatadah said that, iAl-Masih will never be too proud to be a servant ofAllah nor the angels who are near (to Allah). [they] will never be arrogant,' Allah then said. 4U: 4l 5J 4And whosoever rejects His worship and is proud, then He will gather them all together unto Himself.} on the Day of Resurrection. Then, Allah will judge between them with His justjudgment that is never unjust or wrong. 4 &-^ai cA (** "&.> r+A-y? (&} 4So, as for those who believed and did deeds of righteousness, He will give their (due) rewards, and more out ofHis bounty.} Allah will award them their full rewards for their righteous actions and will give them more of His bounty, kindness, ample mercy and favor. Cufr V%} 4But asfor those who refused His worship and were proud,} out of arrogance, they refused to obey and worship Him, 4C^% 6j& oJ> oi\$ 0/4 [il At-Tabari 9 :424

An-Nisd' (174 - 175) (Part-6 4He will punish them with a painful torment. And they will notfindfar themselves besides Allah any protector or helper.} In another Ayah, Allah said, ojiiip iw&C 4Verily! Those who scorn My worship, they will surely enter Hell in humiliation,} degradation, disgrace and dishonor, for they were arrogant and rebellious. ip: ft & P\ ff\$ && pc % <&} 4 i4\ -j pJ 4 f&P* |yPA'ip 4174. O mankind! Verily, there has come to you a convincing proof from your Lord; and We sent down to you a manifest light.} 4175. So, as far those who believed in Allah and held fast to [depend on] Him, He will admit them to His mercy and grace (i.e. Paradise), and guide them to Himselfby a straight path.} TheDescriptionoftheRevelationthatCameFromAllah Allah informs all people that a plain, unequivocal proof has come to them from Him. One that eradicates all possibility of having an excuse, or falling prey to evil doubts. Allah said, & Pi iand We sent down to you a manifest light.} that directs

to the Truth. Ibn Jurayj and others said, It is the Qur an. 111 i.H ipp;p ip: ft*> 4So, as far those who believed in Allah and held fast to [depend on] Him,) by worshipping Him and relying on Him for each and every thing. Ibn Jurayj said that this part of the Ayah means, They believe in Allah and hold fast to the Qur an. Tabari 9:428. At-Tabari 9 :429

j jfc 4 4He will admit them to His mercy and grace,) meaning, He will grant them His mercy and admit them into Paradise, and will increase and multiply their rewards and their ranks, as a favor and bounty from Him. iand guide them to Himself by a straight path.) and a clear way that has no wickedness in it or deviation. This, indeed, is the description of the believers in this life and the Hereafter, as they are on the straight and safe path in matters of action and creed. In the Hereafter, they are on the straight path of Allah that leads to the gardens of Paradise. 'J vmm \ . i v ". A c jiil \jjl I I3JCLjo6i jil ^pijUdf ll IojsullyLjlj oJj a ,j\$; 'i; ji & ifcr o> to a s" i ^A \$ as ar4% a jz q^;%% uju & iitj j^ iit\$ gtoa& ^^ Ai E *IJr 4176. They ask you for a legal verdict. Say: "Allah directs (thus) about Al-Kalalah. If it is a man that dies leaving a sister, but no child, she shall have half the inheritance, and [in her case] he will be her heir ifshe has no children . If there are two sisters, they shall have two-thirds of the inheritance; if there are

brothers and sisters, the male will have twice the share of the female. (Thus) does Allah make clear to you (His Law) lest you go astray. And Allah is the All-Knower ofeverything."} This is the Last Ayah Ever Revealed, the Ruling on Al- Kalalah

is on it (the earth) will perish. And the Face of your Lordfull ofmajesty and honor will remain forever.} Allah said here, ^leaving no child,} referring to the person who has neither children, nor parents. What testifies to this, is that Allah said afterwards, C+li JLi-1 iLeaving a sister, she shall have half the inheritance.} Had there been a surviving ascendant, the sister would not have inherited anything, and there is a consensus on this point. Therefore, this Ayah is referring to the man who dies leaving behind neither descendants nor ascendants, as is apparent for those who contemplate its meaning. This is because when there is a surviving parent, the sister does not inherit anything, let alone half of the inheritance. Ibn Jarir and others mentioned that Ibn Abbas and Ibn Az- Zubayr used to judge that if a person dies and leaves behind a daughter and a sister, the sister does not inherit anything. They would recite, &JUa lilx% % & Ifctf o\} ilf it is a man that dies, leaving a sister, but no child, she shall have half the inheritance.} They said that if one leaves behind a daughter, then he has left behind a child. Therefore the sister does not get anything. The majority of scholars disagreed with them, saying the daughter gets one half and the sister the other half, relying on other evidence. This Ayah (4:176 above) gives the sister half of the inheritance in the case that it specifies. As for giving the sister half in other cases,

68 Tafcir Ibn Katfur said, Abu Musa Al-Ash ari was asked about the case when there was a daughter, grand-daughter and sister to inherit. He said, The daughter gets one-half and the sister one-half. Go and ask Ibn Mas'ud, although I think he is going to agree with me. So Ibn Mas*ud was asked and was told about Abu Musa s answer, and Ibn Mas*ud commented, I would have deviated then and would not have become among those who are rightly guided. I will give a judgment similar to the judgment given by the Prophet jg. The daughter gets one-half, the grand-daughter gets one-sixth, and these two shares will add up to two-thirds. Whatever is left will be for the sister. We went back to Abu Musa and

conveyed to him Ibn Mas'ud's answer and he said, "Do not ask me (for legal verdicts) as long as this scholar is still among you. 111 Allah then said, 'And she will be her heir if she has no children.' This Ayah means, the brother inherits all of that his sister leaves behind if she has no surviving offspring or parents. If she has a surviving parent, her brother would not inherit anything. If there is someone who gets a fixed share in the inheritance, such as a husband or half brother from the mother's side, they take their share and the rest goes to the brother. It is recorded in the Two Sahih's that Ibn Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said, 'Give the Fard (share) to its people, and whatever is left is the share of the nearest male relative.' Allah said, 'If there are two sisters, they shall have two-thirds of the inheritance;' meaning, if the person who dies in Kalalah has two sisters, they get two-thirds of the inheritance. More than two sisters

share in the two-thirds. From this Ayah, the scholars took the ruling regarding the two daughters, or more, that they share in the two-thirds, just as the share of the sisters (two or more) was taken from the Ayah about the daughters, 'If there are only daughters, two or more, their share is two-thirds of the inheritance.' (4:11). Allah said, 'If there are brothers and sisters, the male will have twice the share of the female.' This is the share that the male relatives (sons, grandsons, brothers) regularly get, that is, twice as much as the female gets. Allah said, 'Thus does Allah make clear to you...' His Law and set limits, clarifying His legislation, 'Lest you go astray.' from the truth after this explanation, 'And Allah is the All-Knower of everything.' Allah has perfect knowledge in the consequences of everything and in the benefit that each matter carries for His servants. He also knows what each of the relatives deserves from the inheritance, according to the degree of relation he or she has with the deceased. Ibn Jarir recorded that Tariq bin Shihab said that Umar gathered the Companions of the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) once and said, 'I will give a ruling concerning the Kalalah that even women will talk about it in their bedrooms. A snake then appeared in the house and the gathering had to disperse. Umar commented, 'Had Allah willed this (Umar's verdict

regarding the Kalalah) to happen, it would have happened."

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1391–1393]

The chain of narration for this story is authentic.

The Tafsil of Surat Al-Ma'idah (Chapter - 5)

The Virtues of Surat Al-Ma'idah When It was Revealed

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1393–1396]

'O you who believe! Fulfill (your) obligations. Lawful to you (for food) are all the beasts of cattle except that which will be announced to you (herein), game (also) being unlawful when you assume Ihram. Verily, Allah commands that which He wills.' 42 . O you who believe! Violate not the sanctity of the symbols of Allah, nor of the Sacred Month, nor of the Hady brought for sacrifice, nor the garlands, nor

the people coming to the Sacred House (Makkah), seeking the bounty and good pleasure of their Lord. But when you finish the Ihrdm, then hunt, and let not the hatred of some people in (once) stopping you from Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah) lead you to transgression. Help you one another in Al-Birr and At-Taqwa, but do not help one another in sin and transgression. And have Taqwd of Alldlt. Verily, Allah is severe in punishment.} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that a mein came to Abdullah bin Mas*ud and said to him, Advise me. He said, When you hear Allah s statement, <*ip: <# } \$0 you who believe!} then pay full attention, for it is a righteous matter thatHe is ordaining or an evil thing thatHe is forbidding. Khaythamah said, Everything in the Qur an that reads, 40 you who believe!} reads in the Tawrah, O you who are in need. Allah said,

4Fulfill (your) obligations.} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and others said that obligations here means treaties. ' Ibn Jarir mentioned that there is a consensus for this view. Ibn Jarir also said that it means treaties, such as the alliances that they used to conduct.'2 ' Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented: 4 Iijl you who believe! Fulfill (your) obligations.} Refers to the covenants, meaning, what Allah permitted, prohibited, ordained and set limits for in the Qur an. Therefore, do not commit treachery or break the covenants. Allah emphasized this command when He said, 4And those who break the covenant of Allah, after its ratification, and sever that which Allah has commanded to be joined,} until, iM > iunhappy (evil) home (i.e. Hell).}^ Ad-Dahhak said that, 4;m 4Fulfill your obligations.} Refers to what Allah has permitted and what He has prohibited. Allah has taken the covenant from those who proclaim their faith in the Prophet jg and the Book to fulfill the obligations that He has ordered for them in the permissible and the impermissible. Explaining the Lawful and the Unlawful Beasts Allah said, At-Tabari 9:450.Tabari 9 :449 ' At-Tabari 9 :452

iLawful to you (forfood) are all the beasts of cattle} camels, cows and sheep, as Al-Hasan, Qatadah and several others stated. ' Ibn Jarir said that this Tafsir conforms to the meaning of (beasts of cattle) that the Arabs had. We should mention that Ibn Umar, Ibn Abbas and others relied on this Ayah as evidence to allow eating the meat of the fetus if it is found dead in the belly of its slaughtered mother. ' There is a Hadith to the same effect collected in the Sunan of

Surah 5: Al-Maidah (Part 1 of 2)

PDF pages 1397–1630

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1397–1402]

Opening !' -"ir vif' .Hj .* j'" -5} p^" ^ off zj Kj&Vj 4Forbidden to you (for food) are : Al-Maytah (the dead animals), blood, the flesh of swine, and what has been slaughtered as a sacrifice for others than Allah, and that which has been killed by strangling, or by a violent blow, or by a headlong fall, or by the goring of horns - and that xohich has been (partly) eaten by a wild animal .\${5:3}, for although the animals mentioned in this Ayah are types of permissible cattle (except for swine), they become impermissible under the circumstances that the Ayah (5:3) specifies. This is why Allah said afterwards, Je jui l*j U iUnless you are able to slaughter it (before its death) and that which is sacrificed (slaughtered) on An-Nusub (stone altars)\$ as the latter type is not permissible, because it can no longer be slaughtered properly. Hence, Allah s statement, & C -3) ft iLawful to you are all the beasts of cattle except that which will be announced to you,\$ means, except the specific circumstances that prohibit some of these which will be announced to you. Allah said, <)j- jpr 44P\$ igrame (also) being unlawful when you assume Ihrdm.\$ Some scholars said that the general meaning of cattle includes domesticated cattle, such as camels, cows and sheep, and wild cattle, such as gazzelle, wild cattle and wild donkeys. Allah made the exceptions mentioned above (dead animals blood, flesh of swine etc.), and prohibited hunting wild beasts while in the state of Ihr&m. It was also reported that the meaning here is, We have allowed for you all types of cattle in all circumstances, except what We excluded herewith for the one hunting game while in the state of Ihr&m. Allah said,

76 Tafsfr Ibn Kathtr &%%& J&i >))But ifone is forced by necessity, without willful disobedience, and not transgressing, then, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) This Ayah means, We allowed eating the meat of dead animals, when one is forced by necessity, under the condition that one is not transgressing the limits or overstepping them. Here, Allah states, Just as We allowed the meat of cattle in all conditions and circumstances, then do not hunt game when in the state of Ihrdm, for this is the decision of Allah, Who is the Most Wise in all that He commands and forbids. So Allah said; cpc a iVerily, Allah commands that which He wills.) The Necessity of Observing the Sanctity of the Sacred Area and the Sacred Months Allah continues, 40 you who believe! Violate not the sanctity of Sha'd ir Allah (the symbols ofAllah),) Ibn Abbas said, Sha'd ir Allah means the rituals of Hey/. Mujahid said, As-Safa and Al-Marwah, and the sacrificial animal are the symbols of Allah. * It was also stated that Sha a ir Allah is what He prohibited. Therefore, it means, do not violate what Allah prohibited. Allah said afterwards, "?CJf *^ inor of the Sacred Month,) for you are required to respect and honor the Sacred Month and to refrain from what Allah forbade during it, such as fighting. This also lays emphasis on avoiding sins during that time. As Allah said; At-Tabari 9 :463 At-Tabari 9 :463

They ask you concerning fighting in the Sacred Month. Say, "Fighting therein is a great (transgression) and, Verily, the number of months with Allah is twelve months (in a year)."

Al-Ma'idah (1 - 2) (Part-6 The Necessity of Preserving the Sanctity and Safety of those who Intend to Travel to the Sacred House Allah said, "O you who are coming to the Sacred House (Makkah), seeking the bounty and good pleasure of their Lord." The Ayah commands: Do not fight people who are heading towards the Sacred House of Allah, which if anyone enters it, he must be granted safe refuge. Likewise, those who are heading towards the Sacred House seeking the bounty and good pleasure of Allah, must not be stopped, prevented, or frightened away from entering the Sacred House. Mujahid, Ata, Abu Al-Aliyah, Mutarrif bin Abdullah, Abdullah bin Ubayd bin TMayr, Ar-Rabf bin Anas, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Qatadah and several others said that, "seeking the bounty of their Lord." refers to trading. A similar discussion preceded concerning the Ayah; "There is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord (during pilgrimage by trading)." Allah said; "and pleasure." Ibn Abbas said that the word pleasure in the Ayah refers to, seeking Allah's pleasure by their Hajj. Ikrimah, As-Suddi and Ibn Jarir mentioned that this Ayah was revealed concerning Al-Hutam bin Hind Al-Bakri, who had raided the cattle belonging to the people of Al-Madlnah. The following year, he wanted to perform 'Umrah to the House of Allah and some of the Companions wanted to attack him on his way to M At-Tabari 9 :480-481

so Tafstr Ibn Kathir the House. Allah revealed, "O you who are coming to the Sacred House (Makkah), seeking the bounty and good pleasure of their Lord." [I HuntingGame is Permissible After Ihram] Allah said, "But when you finish the Ihram, then hunt." When you end your Ihram, it is permitted for you to hunt game, which was prohibited for you during Ihram. Although this Ayah contains a command that takes effect after the end of a state of prohibition (during Ihram in this case), the Ayah, in fact, brings back the ruling that was previously in effect. If the previous ruling was an obligation, the new command will uphold that obligation, and such is the case with recommended and permissible matters. There are many Ayat that deny that the ruling in such cases is always an obligation. Such is also the case against those who say that it is always merely allowed. What we mentioned here is the correct opinion that employs the available evidence, and Allah knows best. Justice is Always Necessary Allah said, "and let not the hatred of some people in (once) stopping you from Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah) lead you to transgression (and hostility on your part)."

The meaning of this Ayah is apparent, as it commands: Let

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1402–1429]

not the hatred for some people, who prevented you from reaching the Sacred House in the year of Hudaibiyyah, make you transgress Allah's Law and commit injustice against them in retaliation. Rather, rule as Allah has commanded you, being At-Tabari 9:472,475. The narrations about the cause of revelation for this Ayah are not authentic

Al-Mu'tah (1-2) (Part-6) just with every one. We will explain a similar Ayah later on, "And let not the enmity and hatred of others make you avoid justice. Be just: that is nearer to piety which

86 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Therefore, the animals on which a name other than Allah was mentioned upon slaughtering it, is impermissible, because Allah made it necessary to mention His Glorious Name upon slaughtering the animals, which He created. Whoever does not do so, mentioning other than Allah's Name, such as the name of an idol, a false deity or a monument, when slaughtering, he makes this meat unlawful, according to the consensus. Allah's statement, and that which has been killed by strangling...^ either intentionally or by mistake, such as when an animal moves while restrained and dies by strangulation because of its struggling, this animal is also unlawful to eat. or by a violent blow .. .> This refers to the animal that is hit with a heavy object until it dies. Ibn Abbas and several others said it is the animal that is hit with a staff until it dies. ' Qatadah said, The people of Jahiliyyah used to strike the animal with sticks and when it died, they would eat it. 121 It is recorded in the Sahih. that Adi bin Hatim said, I asked, O Allah's Messenger! I use the Mi'radf31 for hunting and catch game with it. He replied, dst xij j*j jLil jL_j i -uSo L Ijl qIfthegame is hit by its sharp edge, eat it. But, if it is hit by its broad side, do not eat it, far it has been beaten to death. Therefore, the Prophet jg made a distinction between killing the animal with the sharp edge of an arrow or a hunting stick, and rendered it lawful, and what is killed by the broad side of an object, and rendered it unlawful because it was beaten to death. There is a consensus among the scholars of Fiqh on this subject. Tabari 9:496. Tabari 9:496. * A sharp-edged piece of wood or a piece of wood provided with a piece of iron used for hunting. Al-B&ri9:518.

As for the animal that falls headlong from a high place and dies as a result, it is also prohibited. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that an animal that dies by a headlong fall, Is that which falls from a mountain. 111 Qatadah said that it is the animal that falls in a well. * As- Suddi said that it is the animal that falls from a mountain or in a well.131 As for the animal that dies by being gorged by another animal, it is also prohibited, even if the horn opens a flesh wound and it bleeds to death from its neck. Allah's statement, 4and that which has been (partly) eaten by a wild animal,} refers to the animal that was attacked by a lion, leopard, tiger, wolf or dog, then the wild beast eats a part of it and it dies because of that. This type is also prohibited, even if the animal bled to death from its neck. There is also a consensus on this ruling. During the time of Jahiliyyah, the people used to eat the sheep, camel, or cow that were partly eaten by a wild animal. Allah prohibited this practice for the believers. Allah's statement, iunless you are able to slaughter it,} before it dies, due to the causes mentioned above. This part of the Ayah is connected to, XYJXtj iand that which has been killed by strangling, or by a violent blow, or by a headlong fall, or by the goring of horns - and that which has been (partly) eaten by a wild animal.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah's statement. m At-Tabari 9:498. Tabari 9:498. Al-Tabari 9:498.

iunless you are able to slaughter it,} Unless you are able to slaughter the animal in the cases mentioned in the Ayah while it is still alive, then eat it, for it was properly slaughtered. 11 ' Similar was reported from Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and As-Suddi.'2 Ibn Jarir recorded that 'Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, said, If you are able to slaughter the animal that has been hit by a violent blow, or by a headlong fall, or by the gorging of horns while it still moves a foot or a leg, then eat from its meat. '3 ' Similar was reported from Tawus, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ubayd bin Umayr, Ad-Dahhak and several others, that if the animal that is being slaughtered still moves, thus demonstrating that it is still alive while slaughtering, then it is lawful.'4 The Two Sahih recorded that Rafi bin Khadij said, I asked, O

Allah's Messenger! We fear that we may meet our enemy tomorrow and we have no knives, could we slaughter the animals with reeds? The Prophet said, *Ja'la li ifjIt I lit jilaJI 1^ i pJajO Ul* Vow can use what makes blood flow and you can eat what is slaughtered with the Name of Allah. But do not use teeth or claws (in slaughtering). I will tell you why, as for teeth, they are bones, and claws are used by Ethiopians for slaughtering. Allah said next, *C> iand* that which is sacrificed on An-Nusub.} Nusub were stone altars that were erected around the Ka'bah, as Mujahid and Ibn Jurayj stated.⁶ Ibn Jurayj said, There were three hundred and sixty Nusub [around the Ka'bah] (At-Tabari 9:502. At-Tabari 9:504, 507. ³ At-Tabari 9:503. ⁴ At-Tabari 9 :504 ' Fath Al-Bari 9 :554 , Muslim 3 : 1558 At-Tabari 9 :508

Al-Maidah (3) (Part-6) Ka'bah that the Arabs used to slaughter in front of, during the time of Jahiliyyah. They used to sprinkle the animals that came to the Ka'bah with the blood of slaughtered animals, whose meat they cut to pieces and placed on the altars. Allah forbade this practice for the believers. He also forbade them from eating the meat of animals that were slaughtered in the vicinity of the Ka'bah, even if Allah's Name was mentioned on these animals when they were slaughtered, because it is a type of Shirk that Allah and His Messenger have forbidden. The Prohibition of Using Al-Azlam for Decision Making Allah said, *i(Forbidden)* also is to make decisions with Al-Azlam} The Ayah commands, O believers! You are forbidden to use Al-Azlam (arrows) for decision making, which was a practice of the Arabs during the time of Jahiliyyah. They would use three arrows, one with the word *Do* written on it, another that says *Do not* , while the third does not say anything. Some of them would write on the first arrow, *My Lord commanded me*, and, *My Lord forbade me*, on the second arrow and they would not write anything on the third arrow. If the blank arrow was picked, the person would keep trying until the arrow that says *do* or *do not* was picked, and the person would implement the command that he picked. Ibn Abbas said that the Azlam were arrows that they used to seek decisions through. * Muhammad bin Ishaq and others said that the major idol of the tribe of Quraysh was Hubal, which was erected on the tip of a well inside the Ka'bah, where gifts were presented and where the treasure of the Ka'bah was kept. There, they also had seven arrows that they would use to seek a decision concerning matters of dispute. Whatever the chosen arrow would tell them, they would abide by it! Al- Bukhari recorded that when the Prophet *ja* entered Al- m At-Tabari 9 :508 At-Tabari 9:515. ' At-Tabari 9:513. ' Fath Al-Bari 6 :446

90 Tafstr Ibtika Kathir Ka'bah (after Makkah was conquered), he found pictures of Ibrahim and Ismail in it holding the Azlam in their hands. The Prophet commented, *Ixl Ifi l"; .aT.. J Ufii IyJs- jLa*) "May Allah fight them (the idolaters)! They know that they never used the Azlam to make decisions . Mujahid commented on Allah's statement. *i(Forbidden)* also is to make decisions with Al-Azlam These were arrows that the Arabs used, and dice that the Persians and Romans used in gambling. 111 This statement by Mujahid, that these arrows were used in gambling, is doubtful unless we say that they used the arrows for gambling sometimes and for decisions other times, and Allah knows best. We should also state that Allah mentioned Azlam and gambling in His statement before the end of the Surah (5:90, 91), *pi PM& "% 4015 jar gx iii <\$& " ^ ps 4 SO pz& J Oi iO* you who believe! Intoxicants (all kinds of alcoholic drinks), and gambling, and Al-Ansdb, and Al-Azlam are an abomination of Shaytan's handiwork. So avoid that in order that you may be successful. Shaytan wants only to excite enmity and hatred between you with intoxicants (alcoholic drinks) and gambling, and hinder you from the remembrance of Allah and from the Salah (the prayer). So, will you not then abstain?} In this Ayah,

Allah said, (Forbidden) also is to make decisions with Al-Azldm, (all) that is Fisq.b meaning, all these practices constitute disobedience, sin, misguidance, ignorance and, above all, Shirk. m At-Tabari 9:512.

d(j sJr- " " -rsis Hir VtpTthey seek. . couectors of Sunan m Ahmad, Al-Bukhari and uThe Prophet SK used to 1",a rd rfia Jabir bin Abdullah smd, t0 guide one to how to make fetdchurah us (hc samhs of rtght action), in aii matters, as "c Qur an. He sa.d, ,i;, ySi\^ o'^ S J -- w-iJ " :JU j\ - t*/ V^ , .-iiu - . . , "tu aj J djt; J r-iJ hT- - ' , . . ; ... A . a o" 4^ * * * ' . _ *r > cr1. " ..,at Svs: r^ ilf anyone of you thinks and m-> (cr two Rak'ah prayer other tha , Yowr knowledge, the prayer) V .[fjy2 great bounty , for You are from Your ability and I askfa Jo, ^^^ k capable and I am not Youjun f,lis matter (and one the Unseen. O Allah! If You for my religion, should mention the matter or J ; /Or my P^scnj mid my livelihood and the Hereafiero ^ mt. f0 have later needs) then ordam it for " ; kmm> that tins - "- ivith it.' ,l '] , J At-Tirmidhi ,. r-r,uptred by Ahmad, anu This is the wording collecte 3 58 Abu oawud 2:187, TW Zadhil^t "- M9i h :440

Shaytan and the Disbelievers Do Not Will Ever FollowThem ^Tafsir [blatter Hope that

itpfp4*;&&Apip i3i iThis day, I have perfected your religion for you, completed My favor upon you, and have chosen for you Islam as your religion.} This, indeed, is the biggest favor from Allah to this Ummah, for He has completed their religion for them, and they, thus, do not need any other religion or any other Prophet except Muhammad jfc. This is why Allah made Muhammad jg the Final Prophet and sent him to all humans and Jinn. Therefore, the permissible is what he allows, the impermissible is what he prohibits, the Law is what he legislates and everything that he conveys is true and authentic and does not contain lies or contradictions. Allah said; uJu.pip il%) iAnd the Word ofyour Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice,} meaning, it is true in what it conveys and just in what it commands and forbids. When Allah completed the religion for

religion is being perfected for us. Now it is perfect, nothing is perfect, but it is bound to deteriorate. The Prophet gg said, "Yom have said the truthy ' What supports the meaning of this Hadith is the authentic Hadith, iltiP IjO* ^ Aslant was strange in its beginning and will return strange once more. Therefore, Tiiba121 for the strangersV31 Imam

' Sufyan (one of the narrators) doubted if Friday was mentioned in this narration. Sufyan s confusion was either because he was unsure if his teacher included this statement in the Hadth or not. Otherwise, if it was because he doubted that the particular day during the Farewell Hajj was a Friday, it would be a mistake that could not and should not have come from someone like Sufyan Ath-Thawri. The fact that it was a Friday, is agreed on by the scholars of Sirah and Fiqh. There are numerous Hadiths that support this fact that are definitely authentic and of the Mutawati^ type. This Hadith was also reported from TJmar through various chains of narration. PermittingtheDeadAnimals in Conditions ofNecessity Allah said, iBut as for him xvho is forced by severe hunger, with no inclination to sin (such can eat these above mentioned animals), then surely, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Therefore, when one is forced to take any of the impermissible things that Allah mentioned to meet a necessity, he is allowed and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful with him. Allah is well aware of His servant s needs during dire straits, and He will forgive and pardon His servant in this case. In the Musnad and the Sahth of Ibn

Hibban, it is recorded that Ibn Tjmar said that Messenger of Allah jg said. M Vjz us utf a 2)1 jj> *Allah likes that His Rukhsah (allowance) be used, just as He dislikes that disobedience to Him is committed .

96 Tafstr Ibn Kathir wait three days before eating the meat of dead animals, as many unlettered

you are At-Tayyibat (the good things). And those Jawarih (beasts and birds of prey) which you have trained as hounds, training and teaching them (to catch) in the manner as directed to you by Allah; so eat of what they catch for you, but pronounce the Name of Allah over it, and have Taqwa of Allah. Verily, Allah is swift in reckoning Clarifying the Lawful In the previous Ayah Allah mentioned the prohibited types of food, the impure and unclean things, harmful for those who eat them, either to their bodies, religion or both, except out of necessity, c^ ft U ftS2 iwhile He has explained to you in detail what is forbidden to you, except under compulsion of necessity After that, Allah said, ft jJ j" p. jJ Tili iTheu ask you what is lawful for them. Say, "Lawful unto you are At-Tayyibat. In Surat Al-A'rdf Allah describes Muhammad jag allowing the good things and prohibiting the filthy things. Muqatil said, At-Tayyibat includes everything Muslims are allowed and the various types of legally earned provision. Az-Zuhri was once asked about drinking urine for medicinal purposes and he said that it is not a type of Tayyibat. Ibn Abi Hatim also narrated this statement. Using Jawarih^ to Hunt Game is Permissible Allah said, \$And those Jawarih (beasts and birds of prey) which you have trained as hounds ...\$ That is, lawful for you are the animals slaughtered in Allah s Name, and the good things for sustenance. [The game you m Hunting animal

catch) with the Jawarih are also lawful for you. This refers to trained dogs and falcons, as is the opinion of the majority of the Companions, their followers, and the Imams. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said that, *P ik 4And those Jawarih (beasts and birds of prey) which you have trained as hounds... refers to trained hunting dogs, falcons and all types of birds and beasts that are trained to hunt, including dogs, wild cats, falcons, and so forthJ ' Ibn Abi Hatim collected this and said, Similar was reported from Khaythamah, Tawus, Mujahid, Makhul and Yahya bin Abi Kathir. ' Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Tjmar said, You are permitted the animal that the trained birds, such as falcons, hunt for you if you catch it (before it eats from it). Otherwise, do not eat from it. 13 I say, the majority of scholars say that hunting with trained birds is just like hunting with trained dogs, because bird s of prey catch the game with their claws, just like dogs. Therefore, there is no difference between the two. Ibn Jarir recorded that Adi bin Hatim said that he asked the Messenger of Allah jg about the game that the falcon hunts and the Messenger sg said, j j killii- ilLj! U ^Whatever it catches for you, eat from it." These carnivores that are trained to catch game are called Jawarih in Arabic, a word that is derived from Jarh, meaning, what one earns. The Arabs would say, So-and-so has Jaraha something good for his family, meaning, he has earned them something good. The Arabs would say, So-and-so does not have a Jarih for him, meaning, a caretaker. Allah also said, 4And He knows what you have done during the day. At-Jabari 9 : 548 At-Jabari 9:547-548. At-Tabari 9 :549Tabari 9:550.

meaning, the good or evil you have Allah s statement, earned or committed. itrained as hounds,) those Jawarih that have been trained to hunt as hounds with their claws or talons. Therefore, if the game is killed by the weight of its blow, not with its claws, then we are not allowed to eat from the game. Allah said, pi & 4training than in the manner as directed to you by Allah,) as when the beast is sent, it goes after the game, and when it catches it, it keeps it until its owner arrives and does not catch it to eat it

itself. This is why Allah said here, *il&Up !#Gp 'J2S Jk 4so eat ofwhat they catch for you, but pronounce the Name of Allah over it,*) When the beast is trained, and it catches the game for its ownerwho mentioned Allah s Name when he sent the beast after the game, then this game is allowed according to the consensus of scholars, even if it was killed. There are Hadiths in the Sunnah that support this statement. The Two Sahihs recorded that Adi bin Hatim said, I said, O Allah s Messenger! I send huntingdogs and mention Allah s Name. He replied, *4)1 cj'Sij jJULJl ciijl lil" '//, with mentioning Allah's Name, you let loose your tamed dog after a game and it catches it, you may eat what it catches ."* I said, Even if it kills the game? He replied, *"p 'Ps l}* P vLk 14^ i ^ ' ip o!j 'J Even if it kills the game, unless another dog joins the hunt, for you mentioned Allah's Name when sending your dog, but not the other dog ."* I said, I also use the Mi'rad and catch game with it. He replied,

*// you send your hunting dog, then mention Allah s Name and whatever it catchesfor you and you find alive, slaughter it. If you catch the game dead and the dog did not eat from it, then eat from it, for the dog has caused its slaughter to be fulfilled.** In yet another narration of two Sahths, the Prophet sfe said, *stLLal 1)j j jl bjst*

Mention Allah s Name, eat with your right hand and eatfrom the part of the plate that is in front ofyou.

from the believers and chaste womenfrom those who were given the Scripture before your time when you have given them their due, desiring chastity, not illegal sexual intercourse, nor taking them as girlfriends (or lovers). And whosoever rejects faith, then fruitless is his work; and in the Hereafter he will be among the losers Permittingthe SlaughteredAnimals ofthe People ofthe Book After Allah mentioned the filthy things that He prohibited for His believing servants and the good things that He allowed for them, He said next, *fi iMade lawful to you this day are At-Tayyibat .*\$> Allah then mentioned the ruling concerning the slaughtered animals of the People of the Book, the Jews and Christians, *Jr Z/& f \$Thefood of the People of the Scripture is lawful to you..)*? meaning, their slaughtered animals, as Ibn Abbas, Abu Umamah, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Ata , Al-Hasan, Makhul, Ibrahim An-Nakha I, As-Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan stated.¹¹ ' This ruling, that the slaughtered animals of the People of the Book are permissible for

Al-Md'idah (5) (Part-6 before it is divided. The scholars of the Hanafi, the Shafil and the Hanbali Madhhabs rely on this Hadith to allow eating parts of the slaughtered animals of the Jews that they prohibit for themselves, such as the fat. They used this Hadith as evidence against the scholars of the Maliki Madhhab who disagreed with this ruling. A better proof is the Hadith recorded in the Sahth that the people of Khaybar gave the Prophet jg a gift of a roasted leg of sheep, which they poisoned. The Prophet jg used to like eating the leg of the sheep and he took a bite from it, but it told the Prophet jg that it was poisoned, so he discarded that bite. The bite that the Prophet jg took effected the palate of his mouth, while Bishr bin Al-Bara bin Ma'rur died from eating from that sheep. The Prophet jg had the Jewish woman, Zaynab, who poisoned the sheep, killed. Therefore, the Prophet jg and his Companions wanted to eat from that sheep and did not ask the Jews if they removed what the Jews believed was prohibited for them, such as its fat. ¹¹¹ Allah s statement, *J*pas iand your food is lawful to them.}* means, you are allowed to feed them from your slaughtered animals. Therefore, this part of the Ayah is not to inform the People of the Scriptures that they are allowed to eat our food - unless we consider it information for us about the ruling that they have - i.e, that they are allowed all types of foods over

which Allah's Name was mentioned, whether slaughtered according to their religion or otherwise. The first explanation is more plausible. So it means: you are allowed to feed them from your slaughtered animals just as you are allowed to eat from theirs, as equal compensation and fair treatment. The Prophet ﷺ gave his robe to Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salfil, who was wrapped with it when he died. They say that he did that because Abdullah had given his robe to Al- Abbas when Al- Abbas came to Al- Madinah. As for the Hadith, *Do not befriend but a believer, nor should other than a Taqi* 111 Path Al-Bari 7 :569

(pious person) eat your food. This is to encourage such behavior, and Allah knows best. The Permission to Marry Chaste Women From the People of the Scriptures Allah said, (Lawful to you in marriage) are chaste women from the believers. The Ayah states: you are allowed to marry free, chaste believing women. This Ayah is talking about women who do not commit fornication, as evident by the word chaste. Allah said in another Ayah, O believers, Desiring chastity not committing illegal sexual intercourse, nor taking them as boyfriends (lovers). [4:25] Abdullah Ibn Umar used to advise against marrying Christian women saying, I do not know of a worse case of Shirk than her saying that Isa is her lord, while Allah said, And do not marry idolatresses till they believe. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Malik Al-Ghifari said that Ibn Abbas said that when this Ayah was revealed, And do not marry idolatresses till they believe, the people did not marry the pagan women. When the following Ayah was revealed, (Lawful to you in marriage) are chaste women from the believers and chaste women from those who were given the Scripture before your time) IM Abu Dawud 5 : 167. Abdullah bin Ubayy was known as a hypocrite

they married women from the People of the Book. Some of the Companions married Christian women and did not see any problem in this, relying on the honorable Ayah, (Lawful to you in marriage) are chaste women from those who were given the Scripture before your time. Therefore, they made this Ayah an exception to the Ayah in Surat Al-Baqarah, And do not marry the idolatresses till they believe, considering the latter Ayah to include the People of the Book in its general meaning. Otherwise, there is no contradiction here, since the People of the Book were mentioned alone when mentioning the rest of the idolators. Allah said, Those who disbelieve from among the People of the Scripture and the idolators, were not going to leave (their disbelief) until there came to them clear evidence. and, And say to those who were given the Scripture and to those who are illiterates: "Do you (also) submit yourselves?" If they do, they are rightly guided. Allah said next, When you have given them their due. This refers to the Mahr, so just as these women are chaste and honorable, then give them their Mahr with a good heart. We should mention here that Jabir bin Abdullah, Amir Ash- Shalji, Ibrahim An-Nakhal and Al-Hasan Al-Basri stated that when a man marries a woman and she commits illegal sexual intercourse before the marriage is consummated, the marriage is annulled. In this case, she gives back the Mahr that he paid

It is said, Allah said, Desiring chastity, not illegal sexual intercourse, nor taking them as girl- friends (or lovers). And just as women must be chaste and avoid illegal sexual activity, such is the case with men, who must also be chaste and honorable. Therefore, Allah said, ...not illegal sexual intercourse' as adulterous people do, those who do not avoid sin, nor reject adultery with

whomever offers it to them. tSJicl %} 4nor taking them as girl-friends (or lovers),} meaning those who have mistresses and girlfriends who commit illegal sexual intercourse with them, as we mentioned in the explanation of Surat An-Nisa . *P~ a P.&p& lA^s j* dS onto dpTci) - 33f at p;:A \ &r3 ii*i ! 3 it fj!4 pi&Mpu it ; 53 it it it t^b gi-* - l jt iif i _> _^ U Uj J^ojtj IjtlG tli m At-Tabari 9 :585-586.

> > i6. O you who believe! When you stand (intend) to offer the Saldh (the prayer), then wash your faces and your hands (fbreartns) up to the elbows, rub (by passing wet hands over) your heads, and (wash) yourfeet up to the ankles. Ifyou are in a state of janaba, purify yourselves (bathe your whole body). But ifyou are ill or on a journey or any ofyou comesfrom the Ghd it (toilet) or you have touched women and you find no water, then perform Tayammum with clean earth and rub therewith your faces and hands. Allah does not want to place you in difficulty, but He wants to purify you, and to complete His Favor to you that you may be thankful.} The Order to PerformWudu Allah said, Si^ iWhen you standfor (intend to offer) the Saldh,} Allah commanded performing Wudu for the prayer. This is a command of obligation in the case of impurity, and in the case of purity, it is merely a recommendation. It was said that in

the beginning of Islam, Muslims had to perform Wudu' for

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1429–1446]

every prayer, but later on, this ruling was abrogated. Imam

208 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Fadl bin Al-Mubashshir said, I saw Jabir bin Abdullah perform several prayers with only one Wudu . When he would answer the call of nature, he performed Wudu and wiped the top of his Khuffs with his wet hand. I said, O Abu Abdullah! Do you do this according to your own opinion? He said, Rather, I saw the Prophet j do the same thing. So, I do what I saw the Messenger of Allah jg doing. 111

Actions are judged by their intentions, and each person will earn what he intendedJ121 It is also recommended before washing the face that one mentions Allah s Name for the Wudu . A Hadith that was narrated by several Companions states that the Prophet m *said,)1 jU.1 Ji:p i

110 Tafsir Ibn Kathir It is also recommended that one washes his hands before he puts his hands in the vessel of water, especially after one wakes up from sleep, for the Two Sahlhs recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, jti vlbl IfL ji JI* ^ ay ly! JailLU lit // one of you wakes up from his sleep, let him not put his hand in the pot until he washes it thrice, for one of you does not know where his hand spent the nightJ [1 ' The face according to the scholars of Fiqh starts where the hair line on the head starts, regardless of one s lack or abundance of hair, until the end of the cheeks and chin, and from ear to ear. Passingthe Fingersthroughthe BeardWhilePerforming Wudu Imam

it. Allah said, i\$ffS Jl iand your hands (forearms) up to (Ila) the elbows...} meaning, including the elbows. Allah said in another Ayah [using ila], its& of % %} , 4And devour not their substance to (Ila) your substance (by adding or including it in yourproperty) . Surely, this is a great sin.} It is recommended that those who perform Wudu should wash a part of the upper arm with the elbow.

Wudu ?" Abdullah bin Zayd said, Yes. He then asked for a pot of water. He poured from it on his hands and washed them twice, then he rinsed his mouth and washed his nose [with water] thrice [by putting water in it and blowing it out]. He washed his face thrice and after that he washed his forearms up to the elbows twice. He then passed his wet hands over his head from its front to its back and vice versa, beginning from the front and taking them to the back of his head up to the nape of the neck and then brought them to the front again from where he had started. He next washed his feet. * A similar description of the Wudu of the Messenger of Allah was performed by Ali in the Hadith by Abdu Khayr. *

it from Tjthman, under the description of Wudu , and in it, that he wiped his head one time. The Necessity of Washing the Feet Allah said, iattd your feet up to ankles.} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas stated that the Ayah refers to washing (the feet).¹² Abdullah bin Mas*ud, TJrwah, Ata , Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Mujahid, Ibrahim, Ad-Dahhak, As- Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Az-Zuhri and Ibrahim At-Taymi said similarly. ¹³¹ This clearly indicates the necessity of washing the feet, just as the Salaf have said, and not only wiping over the top of the bare foot. The Hadiths that Indicate the Necessity of Washing the Feet We mentioned the Hadiths by the two Leaders of the Faithful, Uthman and Ali, and also by Ibn Abbas, Mu'awiyah, Abdullah bin Zayd bin Asim and Al-Miqdad bin Ma'dlkarib, that the Messenger of Allah jgg washed his feet for Wudu , either once, twice or thrice. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abdullah bin Amr said, The Messenger of Allah jg was once late during a trip we were taking, and he caught up with us when the time remaining for the Asr prayer was short. We were still performing Wudu (in a rush) and we were wiping our feet. He shouted at the top of his voice, "Perform Wudu thoroughly. Save your heels from the Fire,"¹⁴¹ The same narration was also collected in the Two Sahihs Abu Dawud 1:80,82. Tabari 10:55. At-Tabari 10:54-57. Fath Al-Bari 1 :319, Muslim 1 :214.

ilrf Ji-J Perform Wudii' thoroughly. Save your heels from the Fire^{M21} Abdullah bin Al-Harith bin Jaz said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jfi saying, jtJl v-jUpSU Jj Save your heels and the bottom of the feet from the Fire^J It was recorded by Al-Bayhaqi and

ordered him) to repeat the prayer. ^{1 11} This Hadith has a strong, reasonably good chain of narrators. Allah knows best. The Necessity of Washing Between the Fingers In the Hadith that Humran narrated, Uthman washed between his fingers when he was describing the Wudu of the Prophet sg.' ' The collectors of the Sunan recorded that Laqlt bin Sabrah said, I said, O Messenger of Allah! Tell me about Wudu . The Messenger% replied, "Perform Wudu' thoroughly, wash between the fingers and exaggerate in rinsing your nose, unless you are fasting." Wiping Over the Khuffs' ' is an Established Sunnah Imam

this Hadith because Jarir embraced Islam after Surat Al- M& idah was revealed. ¹¹¹ This is the wording collected by

until the end of the Ayah. Usayd bin Al-Hudayr said, O the family of Abu Bakr! Allah has blessed the people because of you. Therefore, you are only a blessing for the people. *' Allah said, i&Z 6i ilf bjt& 4Allah does not want to place you in difficulty,} This is why He made things easy and lenient for you. This is why He allowed you to use Tayammum when you are ill and when you do not find water, to make things comfortable for you and as mercy for you. Allah made Tayammum in place of Wudu , and

Allah made it the same as ablution with water for the one who it is legitimate for, except for certain things, as we mentioned before. For example; Tayammum only involves one strike with the hand on the sand and wiping the face and hands. Allah said, ibut He wants to purify you, and to complete His favor on you that you may be thankful.} for His bounties on you, such as His easy, kind, merciful, comfortable and lenient legislation. Supplicating to Allah after Wudu The Sunnah encourages supplicating to Allah after Wudu and states that those who do so are among those who seek to purify themselves, as the Ayah above states. Imam Ahmad, Muslim and the collectors of Sunan narrated that TjQbah bin Amir said, We were on watch, guarding camels, and when my turn to guard came, I took the camels back at night. I found that the Messenger of Allah ag was giving a speech to the people. I heard these words from that speech: Ui ULfelp y \0tyij y~>i j"j " y li uAny Muslim zoho performs Wudu' properly, then stands up and prays a two Rak'ah prayer with full attention in his heart ** Fath Al-Bari 8:121.

andface , will earn Paradise ." I said. What a good statement this is! A person who was close by said, The statement he said before it is even better. When I looked, I found that it was Umar, who said, 1 saw that you just came. The Prophet said, 7J i5j 7 jl :JjZ *"Li J>-X liljUiJl J Vj i "J oJL* jfj When any of you performs Wudu' properly and says, 7 bear witness that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah and that Muhammad is His servant and Messenger', the eight doors of Paradise will be opened for him so that he can enter from any door he wishes . This is the wording collected by Muslim.12

The Virtue of Wild* Malik recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, M iy- Ji if/=33 jf AliJt 1 j* It W M jf .uil l JI fS I.UJI Jot yif\ jl jUJl " oljb yt liij J** j j! "UJl "4>-j l iWhen the

ijLL/ijl jLl JJ " L)U u Sui fs\ 4i ij jii oUJi} fjiJO j5 oJ-^aJ Ij v i\--a j j * >- . f * - 4 >. > # ^ , jl wJU ^Purity is half of faith and Al-Hamdu Lillah (all the thanks are due to Allah) fills the Mizdn (the Scale). And Subhdn Allah and Allahu Akbar (all praise is due to Allah, and Allah is the Most Great) fills what is between the heaven and earth. As-Sawm (the fast) is a Junnah (a shield), Sabr (patience) is a light, Sadaqah (charity) is evidence (offaith) and the Qur an is proffor, or against you. Every person goes out in the morning and ends up selling hitnself, he either frees his soul or destroys

Wj p& ^ ill, A !yj' ' Qk 'yfi/xlil v'i JL At Sj. 'At 'At ! % &Sij AXt A tjUl ij\$& tel fifyz% te4\ v*Aj (A o/i!i ljLr j ! * ^it At ilj. ^X. At Xj. #4 ^^ ^ & -~*i*t ^Sol[tjJi jj jl lj5^ (*^==Cle. jit Hu i^fit ! '* -X/Jt 4 At j*j iit tjijtJ . A/ remember Allah's favor to you and His covenant with which He bound you when you said: "We hear and we obey." And have Taqwa of Allah. Verily, Allah is All-Knower of that which is in the breasts .} . O you who believe! Stand out firmly for Allah as just witnesses ; and let not the enmity and hatred of others make you avoid justice. Be just, that is nearer to Taqwa; and have Taqwa of Allah. Verily, Allah is Well-Acquainted with what you do i9. Allah has promised those who believe and do deeds of righteousness, that for them there is forgiveness and a great reward (i.e. Paradise).} 110. And they who disbelieve and deny Our Ayat are those who will be the dwellers of the Hell-fire.} 111. O you who believe! Remember thefavor of Allah unto you xohen some people desired (made a plan) to stretch out their hands against you, but (Allah) held back their handsfrom you. So have Taqwa of Allah. And in Allldt let the believers put their trust.} Reminding the Believers of the Bounty of the Message and Islam Allah reminds His believing servants of His bounty by legislating this glorious religion and sending them this honorable Messenger. He also reminds them of the covenant and pledges that He took

from them to follow the Messenger support and aid him, implement his Law and convey it on his behalf, while accepting it themselves. Allah said.

4And remember Allah's favor upon you and His covenant with which He bound you when you said, We hear and we obey This is the pledge that they used to give to the Messenger of Allah when they embraced Islam. They used to say, We gave our pledge of obedience to the Messenger of Allah jfe to hear and obey, in times when we are active and otherwise, even if we were passed on for rights, and not to dispute leadership with its rightful people. Allah also said, & !*& X V4 v # 4And what is the matter with you that you believe not in Allah! Wltile the Messenger invites you to believe in your Lord; and He has indeed taken your covenant, if you are real believers.} It was also said that this Ayah (5:7) reminds the Jews of the pledges and promises Allah took from them to follow Muhammad sg and adhere to his Law, as Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas stated. Allah then said, 4'ii i 4And have Taqiva ofAllah.} in all times and situations. Allah says that He knows the secrets and thoughts that the hearts conceal, ijuid if 5 Verily, Allah is All-Knower of the secrets of (your) breasts.} The Necessity ofObserving Justice Allah said, 4A ! you who believe! Stand outfirmlyfor Allah...} meaning, in truth for the sake of Allah, not for the sake of people or for fame,

4 /wsf witnesses} observing justice and not transgression. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that An-Nu'man bin Bashir said, My father gave me a gift, but Amrah bint Rawahah, my mother, said that she would not agree to it unless he made Allah's Messenger^ as a witness to it. So, my father went to Allah's Messenger jg to ask him to be a witness to his giving me the gift. Allah's Messenger sg asked, oJU; dJj jsU "'Have you given the like of it to everyone of your offspring?" He replied in the negative. Allah's Messenger jg said, ijJjlc-Ij iui i^au vHave Taqwd ofAllah and treat your children equally. " And said; 'Syr 'Ji -4-ii V J| '/' shall not be witness to injustice." My father then returned and took back his gift. Allah said; 4Lta- jjc oi&CS "^j} iand let not the enmity and hatred of others make you avoid justice.} The Ayah commands: Do not be carried away by your hatred for some people to avoid observing justice with them. Rather, be just with every one, whether a friend or an enemy. This is why Allah said, iBe just: tlmt is nearer to Taqwd} this is better than if you abandon justice in this case. Although Allah said that observing justice is nearer to Taqwa , there is not any other course of action to take, therefore nearer here means *is . Allah said in another Ayah, Fath Al-Bari 5 :250 , Muslim 3 :1242

2} iThe dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairer of places for repose .i Some of the female Companions said to Umar, You are more rough and crude than the Messenger of Allah jg, meaning, you are rough, not that the Prophet jg is rough at all. Allah said next, 'if Si 'if !#(>) iand have Taqiua of Allah. Verily, Allah is Well-Acquainted with what you do.\$ and consequently, He will reward or punish you according to your actions, whether good or evil. Hence Allah's statement afterwards, iAllah has promised those who believe and do deeds of righteousness, that for them there is forgiveness > for their sins, iand a great reward which is Paradise, that is part of Allah's mercy for His servants. They will not earn Paradise on account of their good actions, but rather on account of His mercy and favor, even though they will qualify to earn this mercy on account of their good actions. Allah has made these actions the cause and path that lead to His mercy, favor, pardon and acceptance. Therefore, all this is from Allah Alone and all thanks are due to Him. Allah said next, iAnd they who disbelieve and deny our Aydt are those who will be the dwellers of the Hell-fire. This only

demonstrates Allah's perfect justice, wisdom and judgment, He is never wrong, for He is the Most Wise, Most Just and Most Able.

Among Allah's Favors is that He Prevented the Disbelievers from Fighting the

The story of this bedouin man, whose name is Ghawrath bin

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1446–1472]

Al-Harith, is mentioned in the Sahih. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar, Mujahid and Ikrimah said that this Ayah was revealed about Bani An-Nadir, who plotted to drop a stone on the head of the Messenger sg when he came to them for help to pay the blood money of two persons Abdur-Razziq 1 : 185. * Al-Bukhari nos: 4135, 4136, 4139.

whom Muslims killed. 11 The Jews left the execution of this plot to Amr bin Jihash bin Ka'b and ordered him to throw a stone on the Prophet from above, when he came to them and sat under the wall. Allah told His Prophet 53 about their plot, and he went back to Al-Madinah and his Companions followed him later on. Allah sent down this Ayah concerning this matter. Allah's statement, {And in Allah let the believers put their trust.} and those who do so, then Allah shall suffice for them and shall protect them from the evil plots of the people. Thereafter, Allah commanded His Messenger to expel Bani An-Nadir, and he laid siege to their area and forced them to evacuate Al-Madinah. Jes; i i&i c>: ^ p&z 14 j[5St ,T" >- s'..* ' ' < UJ Jill Xji) ,A t X" . "i ' if / *Z+ -" \ m ^ The Prophet \$g had a treaty with the Jews to help him pay the Diyah, when warranted.

k&& ^%U V ^ Jy%4 ! ll" 'U ifc^ tSi tfo ^Sfeji 44 * i&g tayt *ssK year ^r t 4 - 'f, H_> . Indeed, Allah took the covenant from the Children of Israel (Jeios), and We appointed twelve leaders among them. And Allah said : "I am with you if you perform the Saldh and give the Zakdh and believe in My Messengers; honor and assist them, and lend to Allah a good loan, verily, I will remit your sins and admit you to Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise). But if any of you after this, disbelieved, he has indeed gone astray from the straight way. } il3. So, because of their breach of their covenant, We cursed them and made their hearts grow hard. They changed the words from their (right) places and luwe abandoned a good part of the Message that was sent to them. And you will not cease to discover deceit in them, except a few of them. But forgive them and overlook (their misdeeds). Verily, Allah loves the doers of good.} 414. And from those who call themselves Christians, We took their covenant, but they have abandoned a good part of the Message that was sent to them. So We planted amongst them enmity and hatred till the Day of Resurrection; and Allah will inform them of what they used to do.} Cursing the People of the Book for Breaking the Covenant Allah commanded His believing servants to fulfill the promises and pledges that He took from them and which they gave His servant and Messenger, Muhammad, peace be upon him. Allah also commanded them to stand for the truth and give correct testimony. He also reminded them of the obvious and subtle favors of the truth and guidance that He granted them. Next, Allah informed them of the pledges and promises that He took from the People of the Book, who were before them, the Jews and Christians. When they broke these promises and covenants, Allah cursed them as a consequence

Al-Ma'idah (12 - 14) (Part-6) and expelled them from His grace and mercy. He also sealed their hearts from receiving guidance and the religion of truth, beneficial knowledge and righteous actions. Allah said, &j} 4Indeed Allah took the covenant from the Children of Israel and We appointed twelve leaders among them.} These twelve people were leaders who gave the pledge to Allah to listen and obey Allah, His Messenger and His Book on behalf of their tribes. Muhammad bin Ishaq and Ibn Abbas said that this occurred when Musa went to fight the mighty enemy (in Palestine), and Allah commanded him to choose a leader from every tribe. The Leaders of Ansar on the Night of Aqabah Likewise, when the Messenger of Allah 3H took the pledge from the Ansar in the Aqabah area, there were twelve leaders from the Ansar. There were three men from the tribe of Aws: Usayd bin Al-Hudayr, Sa'd bin Khaythamah and Rifa'ah bin Abdul-Mundhir, or Abu Al-Haytham bin At-Tayhan. There were nine people from the tribe of Khazraj: Abu Umamah As ad bin Zurarah, Sa'd bin Ar-RabT, Abdullah bin Rawahah, RafT bin Malik bin Al- Ajlan, Al-Bara bin Ma'rur, TJbadah bin As-Samit, Sa'd bin Ubadah, Abdullah bin Amr bin Haram and Al- Mundhir bin Umar bin Khunays. Ka*b bin Malik mentioned these men in his poem, as recorded by Ibn Ishaq.12* On that night, these men were the leaders or representatives of their tribes by the command of the Prophet They gave the pledge and promise of allegiance and obedience to the Prophet 3 on behalf of their people. Allah said, \$And Allah said, "I am with you...} with My protection, support and aid, hg} iif you perform the Salah and give the Zakdh and believe in My [1 * At-Tabari 10:113. ,2i Ibn Hisham 2:86-87.

Messengers;} concerning what they bring you of the revelation, ihonor and assist them...} and support them on the truth, iand lend to Allah a good loan...} by spending in His cause, seeking to please Him. iverily, I will remit your sins} and errors, I will erase them, cover them, and will not punish you for them, ut &}\$&} iand admit you to Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise).} thus, protecting you from what you fear and granting you what you seek. Breaking the Covenant Allah said. iBut if any of you after this, disbelieved, he has indeed gone astray from the straight way.} Therefore, those who break this covenant, even though they pledged and vowed to keep it, yet, they broke it and denied it ever existed, they have avoided the clear path and deviated from the path of guidance to the path of misguidance. Allah then mentioned the punishment that befell those who broke His covenant and the pledge they gave Him, iSo because of their breach of their covenant, We cursed them...} Allah states, because of their breaking the promise that We took from them, We cursed them, deviated them away from the truth, and expelled them from guidance,

iand made their hearts grow hard...} and they do not heed any word of advice that they hear, because of the hardness of their hearts. && iThex/ change the words from their (right) places...} Since their comprehension became corrupt, they behaved treacherously with Allah s Ayat, altering His Book from its apparent meanings which He sent down, and distorting its indications. They attributed to Allah what He did not say, and we seek refuge with Allah from such behavior. 44i LuCiX iand have abandoned a good part of the Message that zoas sent to them.} by not implementing it and by ignoring it. Allah said next, 4 i >\$> J0 iAnd you will not cease to discover deceit in them,} such as their plots and treachery against you, O Muhammad, and your Companions. Mujahid said that this Ayah refers to their plot to kill the Messenger of Allah iBut forgive them, and overlook (their misdeeds).} This, indeed, is the ultimate victory and triumph. Some of the Salaf said, You would never treat those who disobey Allah with you better than obeying Allah with them. This way, their hearts will gather around the truth and

Allah might lead them to the right guidance. This is why Allah said, 4Verily, Allah loves the doers of good.} Therefore, forgive those who err against you. Qatadah said that this Ayah was abrogated with Allah's statement, jfyfX ait Xf y. y (11 At-Jabari 10:131.

iFight against those who believe not in Allah, nor in the Last Day^|.l1 The Christians Also Broke their Covenant with Allah and the Repercussion of this Behavior Allah said, aL. ik S iAnd from those who call themselves Christians, We took their covenant, Meaning: From those who call themselves Christians and followers of Isa, son of Maryam, while in fact they are not as they claim. We took from them the covenant and pledges that they would follow the Prophet jg, aid him, honor him and follow his footsteps. And that they would believe in every Prophet whom Allah sends to the people of the earth. They imitated the Jews and broke the promises and the pledges. This is why Allah said, ibut they have abandoned a good part of the Message that was sent to them. So We planted amongst them enmity and hatred till the Day of Resurrection Meaning: We planted enmity and hatred between them, and they will remain like this until the Day of Resurrection. Indeed, the numerous Christian sects have always been enemies and adversaries of each other, accusing each other of heresy and cursing each other. Each sect among them excommunicates the other sects and does not allow them entrance to their places of worship. The Monarchist sect accuses the Jacobite sect of heresy, and such is the case with the Nestorians and the Arians. Each sect among them will continue to accuse the other of disbelief and heresy in this life and on the Day when the Witnesses will come forth. Allah then said, t s'Tabari 10:134.

mSiirah 5. Al-Ma'idah (15 - 16) (Part-6 iand Allah ivill inform them of zuhat they used to do. warning and threatening the Christians because of their lies against Allah and His Messenger and their false claims about Allah, hallowed be He above what they say about Him. The Christians attribute a companion and a son to Allah, while He is the One and Only, the All-Sufficient, Who neither begets nor was He begotten, and there is none like unto Him. p dyi; -p-K Sj if Jdif V J > Si lSJ-" 4 H-uxJj jy-if 415. O People of the Scripture! Noiv has come to you Our Messenger explaining to you much of that which you used to hide from the Scripture and passing over much. Indeed, there has come to you from Allah a light and a plain Book.) 416. Wherewith Allah guides all those who seek His Pleasure to ways of peace, and He brings them out of darkness by His permission unto light and guides them to a straight path.) Explaining the Truth Through the Messenger and the Qur'an Allah states that He sent His Messenger Muhammad jg with the guidance and the religion of truth to all the people of the earth, the Arabs and non-Arabs, lettered and unlettered. Allah also states that He sent Muhammad sg with clear evidences and the distinction between truth and falsehood. Allah said, P& R Si 40 People of the Scripture! Now has come to you Our Messenger explaining to you much of that which you used to hide from the Scripture and passing over much.) So the Prophet explained where they altered, distorted, changed and lied about Allah. He also ignored much of what they changed, since it would not bring about any benefit if it was explained. In his Mustadrak,

C iai -- , >. :"'s ~i -"v \$'>">' i- lJj -A*>(*? U ^yXlicr- fcW lJ. il ^* ilj^^jS *,lji Abbas said, He who disbelieves in stoning (the adulterer to death) will have inadvertently disbelieved in the Qur'an, for Allah said, Jj if &&>} p vlg d^; P-H Oi 40 People of the Scripture! Now has come to you Our Messenger explaining to you much of that zohich you used to hide from the Scripture} and stoning was

among the things that they used to hide. Al-Hakim said, Its chain is Sahih, and they did not record it. Allah next mentions the Glorious Qur an that He sent down to His honorable Prophet 2g, \$J jy y& &} . > -* .> > 4?' 4Indeed, there has come to you from Allah a light and a plain Book. Wherewith Allah guides all those who seek His pleasure to ways ofpeace.} meaning, ways of safety and righteousness, till **i%iP dS\ Oi |4v*VJ Al-Hfikim 4:359.

Al-Ma'idah (17 - 18) (Part-6) iand He brings them out of darkness by His permission unto light and guides them to a straight path.} He thus saves them from destruction and explains to them the best, most clear path. Therefore, He protects them from what they fear, and brings about the best of what they long for, all the while ridding them of misguidance and directing them to the best, most righteous state of being. \$ Oi 0 js 'fzis Qg ji\$ lc*i} 4,j ULjr ^ O-J t&J of j'jf u&L& Cj cfcjVfj -iii ^ F A < A J f I . I ^ ^ X . aft ! / - >< > V a I J // 417. Surely, in disbelief are they who say that Allah is the Messiah, son of Maryam. Say: "Who then has the least power against Allah, if He were to destroy the Messiah, son of Maryam, his mother, and all those who are on the earth together? And to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them. He creates what He wills. And Allah is able to do all things.} 418. And the Jews and the Christians say: "We are the children of Allah and His loved ones." Say: "Why then does He punish you far your sins?" Nay, you are but human beings of those He has created, He forgives whom He wills and He punishes whom He wills. And to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth and all that is between them ; and to Him is the return (ofall).} The Polytheism and Disbelief of the Christians Allah states that the Christians are disbelievers because of their claim that Isa, son of Maryam, one of Allah's servants and creatures, is Allah. Allah is holier than what they attribute to Him. Allah then reminds them of His perfect ability over everything and that everything is under His complete control and power,

m 's*' & (g -4' ol j'j! o . 4if St -j l)I; S*-CL*r ofjl/' 4 4Say: "WTio then has the least power against Allah, ifHe were to destroy the Messiah, son of Maryam, his mother, and all those who are on the earth together?"j> Therefore, if Allah wills to do that, who would be able to stop Him or prevent Him from doing it? Allah then said, iAnd to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them. He creates what He wills. All things in existence are Allah s property and creation and He is able to do everything. He is never asked about what He does with His power, domain, justice and greatness so this refutes the Christian creed, may Allah s continued curses be upon them until the Day of Resurrection. Refuting the People of the Book s Claim that they are Allah s Children Allah then refutes the Christians and Jews false claims and lies, iAnd the Jews and the Christians say, "We are the children of Allah and His loved ones."} They claim: We are the followers of Allah s Prophets, who are His children, whom He takes care of. He also loves us. The People of the Book claim in their Book that Allah said to His servant Israel, You are my firstborn. But they explained this statement in an improper manner and altered its meaning. Some of the People of the Book who later became Muslims refuted this false statement saying, This statement only indicates honor and respect, as is common in their speech at that time. The Christians claim that Isa said to them, I will go back to my father and your father, meaning, my Lord and your Lord. It is a fact that the Christians did not claim that they too are Allah s sons as they claimed about Isa. Rather this statement by Isa only meant to indicate a

Al-Ma'idah (18 - 19) (Part-6) closeness with Allah. This is why when they said that they are Allah's children and loved ones, Allah refuted their claim, 4Say, "Why then does He punish you for your sins?" meaning, if you were truly as you claim, Allah's children and loved ones, then why did He prepare the Fire because of your disbelief, lies and false claims? 4Nay, you are but human beings, of those He has created, } Allah states; you are just like the rest of the children of Adam, and Allah is the Lord of all His creation, 4Heforgives whom He wills and punishes whom He wills. } Allah does what He wills, there is none who can escape His judgement, and He is swift in reckoning. 4And to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth and all that is between them; } Therefore, everything is Allah's property and under His power and control, } and to Him is the return. } In the end, the return will be to Allah and He will judge between His servants as He will, and He is the Most Just Who is never wrong in His judgment. he bb** J jA?' oi Ja" (} c _ &\$&%te % ft-& ;i% 419. O People of the Scripture! Now has come to you Our Messenger making (things) clear unto you, after a break in (the series of) Messengers, lest you say: "There came to us no bringer of glad tidings and no wamer." But now has come unto you a bringer of glad tidings and a wamer. And Allah is able to do all things. }

136 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr Allah is addressing the People of the Book - the Jews and the Christians, saying that He has sent His Messenger Muhammad s.g. to them, the Final Prophet, after whom there will be no Prophet or Messenger. Rather, He is the Final Messenger who came after a long time passed between him and Isa, son of Maryam peace be upon them. There is a difference of opinion about the length of time between Isa and Muhammad j.g. Abu Uthman An-Nahdi and Qatadah were reported to have said that this period was six hundred years. *

This Hadith refutes the opinion of Al-Qudal and others, that there was a Prophet after Isa called Khalid bin Sinan. Allah sent Muhammad j.g. after a period of time during which there was no Prophet, clear path, or unchanged religions. Idol worshipping, fire worshipping and cross worshipping flourished during this time. Therefore, the bounty of sending Muhammad j.g. was the perfect bounty at a time when he was needed the most. Evil had filled the earth by then, and tyranny and ignorance had touched all the servants, except a few of those who remained loyal to the true teachings of previous Prophets, such as some Jewish rabbis, Christian priests and Sabian monks. Imam

what 1 allowed and commanded them to associate others with Me [in worship], which I gave no permission for.' Then Allah looked at the people of the earth and disliked them all, the Arabs and non-Arabs among them, except a few from among the Children of Israel. Allah said (to me), 7 only sent you to test you and to test with you. I sent to you a Book that cannot be washed by water (it is eternal), and you will read it while asleep and while awake. Allah has also Commanded me to bum (destroy) Quraysli. So I said, O Lord! They will smash my head and leave it like a piece of bread.' He said, 7 will drive them out as they drove you out, and when you invade them We will help you. Spend on them (your companions) and We will spend on you, send an army and We will smd five armies like it (in its support). Fight with those who obey you, against those who disobey you. And the inhabitants of Paradise are three: a just, prosperous, and charitable ruler; A merciful man who has a kind heart toward every relative and every

ixtsui^ " T esm 1 L\$!"- li * ijJliQjy - _~ '-hjj ~-J jU_iJj3jiU<_ ^ -* '-."V -; '> "I,; - _ ? *Cw~tl tLA^O'rt-fl"!^' L-gJpJU QAfl .^>.-4 i I "its ?..J ^j\J i jL*j^ ill'. L* (^gX'-L'-J iiU _^j owLaJ^iIjj " ^C-

^ii3^AjyvJaJI \3j->- j_Jll5lv_-2>&"o' l> f|> ,iilii4-i-1jiS, iij ,dl -*> f. .':{. > ^-'s'> s" Ijlj ^ * * Aj-L^ij
 tjU a*_^-" "*_J and no wamer. meaning, so that you, who changed the true religion, do not make it an
 excuse and say, No Messenger came to us bringing glad tidings and warning against evil. There has
 come to you a bringer of good news and a warner, Muhammad m- 4i-ir* }lr 3^=>& iAnd Allah is able
 to do all things. Ibn Jarir said this part of the Ayah means, I am able to punish those who disobey Me
 and to reward those who obey Me. 11 ' *iyl 'J-y vjj P 1* fSS^Cj S'jti fS^i-j '2CA jli ij ', & *li 2k S'jij Vj
 Jit jJi J iJiJi iA 'j WyS &- IZ+L-li jl U]j bji Ijj j[yii .V'O, ijUiUt ^jLjl Jif C*jK ce oyi) jli ^.^SjU-'k liji
 CJL i^ .^ie t^C. 4 #53 ^ ^^ :^ i" ^ Stfji^ ytsr t5~ii sJlj Oil J~"i ijilj U (jj\ L"Ai-jS J) 0), ijq !'r ^yji ^j-iu 'j
 o; JU Jf O-b Ufj J ^ * b^fjl Lf>^ Jli ^:n'A^ijf [II At-Jabari 10:158.

420. And (remember) when Musa said to his people: "O my people! Remember the favor of Allah to
 you: when He made Prophets among you, made you kings and gave you what He had not given to any
 other among the nations (AI-'Alamm). } 421. O my people! Enter the Holy Land which Allah has
 assigned to you and turn not back; for then you will be returned as losers. } 422. They said: "O Musa!
 In it are a people of great strength, and we shall never enter it, till they leave it; when they leave, then
 we will enter."} 423. Two men of those who feared (Allah and) on whom Allah had bestowed His grace
 said: "Assault them through the gate; for when you are in, victory will be yours. And put your trust in
 Allah if you are believers indeed."} 424. They said: "O Musa! We shall never enter it as long as they are
 there. So go, you and your Lord, and fight you tivo, we are sitting right here. } 425. He [Musa] said: "O
 my Lord! I have power only over myself and my brother, so Ifruq us from the rebellious people!"} 426 .
 (Allah) said: "Therefore it is forbidden to them for forty years; in distraction they will wander through
 the land. So do not grieve for the rebellious people."} Musa Reminds His People of Allah s Favors on
 Them; The Jews Refuse to Enter the Holy Land Allah states that His servant, Messenger, to whom He
 spoke directly, Musa, the son of Imran, reminded his people that among the favors Allah granted them,
 is that He will give them all of the good of this life and the Hereafter, if they remain on the righteous
 and straight path. Allah said, 4And (remember) when Musa said to his people: "O my people!
 Remember the favor of Allah to you, when He made Prophets among you,} for whenever a Prophet
 died, another rose among them, from the time of their father Ibrahim and thereafter. There were many
 Prophets among the Children of Israel

calling to Allah and warning against His torment, until Isa was sent as the final Prophet from the
 Children of Israel. Allah then sent down the revelation to the Final Prophet and Messenger,
 Muhammad, the son of Abdullah, from the offspring of Ismail, the son of Ibrahim, peace be upon them.
 Muhammad 3S5 is the most honorable Prophet of all times. Allah said next, imade you kings^ Abdur-
 Razzaq recorded that Ibn Abbas commented: Having a servant, a wife and a house. ' * In his Mustadrak,

142 Tafair Ibn Kathir were the most honorable among the people of their time, compared to the Greek,
 Copts and the rest of mankind. Allah said in another Ayah, uuijl J* >> at s SiZrA XjA. '-:?' i'4) iAnd
 indeed We gave the Children of Israel the Scripture, and the understanding of the Scripture and its laws,
 and the Prophethood ; and provided them with good things, and preferred them above the nations
 (Al-'Alamfn)> Allah said, Jli '* l*T" ^ 'jit* ^ pS^LU% pi*J \$ 1 js X \$They said: "O Musa! Make for us
 a god as they have gods." He said: "Verily, you are an ignorant people." [Musa added:] "Verily, these
 people will be destroyed for that which they are engaged in (idol worship)." And all that they are doing

is in vain. He said: "Shall I seek for you a god other than Allah, while He has given you superiority over the nations.") Therefore, they were the best among the people of their time. The Muslim Ummah is more respected and honored before Allah, and has a more perfect legislative code and system of life, it has the most honorable Prophet, the larger kingdom, more provisions, wealth and children, a larger domain and more lasting glory than the Children of Israel. Allah said, "Thus We have made you, a just (the best) nation, that you be witnesses over mankind.") We mentioned the Mutawatir Hadiths about the honor of this Ummah and its status and honor with Allah, when we explained Allah's statement in Surah Al-Imran (3), "You are the best of peoples ever raised up for mankind...") Allah states next that Musa encouraged the Children of

Israel to perform Jihad and enter Jerusalem, which was under their control during the time of their father Ya'qub. Ya'qub and his children later moved with his children and household to Egypt during the time of Prophet Yusuf. His offspring remained in Egypt until their exodus with Musa. They found a mighty, strong people in Jerusalem who had previously taken it over. Then, Allah's Messenger, ordered the Children of Israel to enter Jerusalem and fight their enemy, and he promised them victory and triumph over the mighty people if they did so. They declined, rebelled and defied his order and were punished for forty years by being lost, wandering in the land uncertain of where they should go. This was their punishment for defying Allah's command. Allah said that Musa ordered them to enter the Holy Land, which Allah has assigned to you meaning, which Allah has promised to you by the words of your father Israel, that it is the inheritance of those among you who believe. If you turn not back in flight from Jihad. And if you do not return as losers." They said, "O Musa! In it are a people of great strength, and we shall never enter it, till they leave it; when they leave, then we will enter." Their excuse was this, in this very town you commanded us to enter and fight its people, there is a mighty, strong, vicious people who have tremendous physique and physical ability. We are unable to stand against these people or fight them. Therefore, they said, we are incapable of entering this city as long as they are still in it, but if they leave it, we will enter it. Otherwise, we cannot stand against them.

The Righteous Response of the Companions During the Battle of Badr Compare this to the better response the Companions gave to the Messenger of Allah during the battle of Badr, when he asked for their advice about fighting the Quraysh army that came to protect the caravan led by Abu Sufyan. When the

146 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Imam

and decide between us and them. Other scholars said that the Ayah means, Separate between us and them. Forbidding the Jews from Entering the Holy Land for Forty Years Allah said, "Therefore it is forbidden to them for forty years; in distraction they will wander through the land." When Musa supplicated against the Jews for refusing to fight in Jihad, Allah forbade them from entering the land for forty years. They wandered about lost in the land of At-Tih, unable to find their way out. During this time, tremendous miracles occurred, such as the clouds that shaded them and the manna and quails Allah sent down for them. Allah brought forth water springs from solid rock, and the other miracles that He aided Musa bin Imran with. During this time, the Tawrah was revealed and the Law was established for the Children of Israel and the Tabernacle of the Covenant was erected. Conquering Jerusalem Allah's

statement, iforforty years defines, \$o?jVl 4 iin distraction they will wander through the land .> When these years ended, Yuwsha' bin NQn led those who remained among them and the second generation, and laid siege to Jerusalem, conquering it on a Friday afternoon. When the sun was about to set and Yuwsha' feared that the Sabbath would begin, he said (to the sun), You are commanded and I am commanded, as well. O Allah! Make it stop setting for me. Allah made the sun stop setting until Yuwsha' bin NunTabari 10:189.

conquered Jerusalem. Next, Allah commanded Yuwsha' to order the Children of Israel to enter Jerusalem from its gate while bowing and saying Hittah, meaning, remove our sins. Yet, they changed what they were commanded and entered it while dragging themselves on their behinds and saying, Habbah (a seed) in Sha'rah (a hair). We mentioned all of this in the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas commented, . "t)f . ^ o' -Vt * ^ iTherefore it is forbidden to them for forty years; in distraction they will wander through the land They wandered in the land for forty years, during which Musa and Harun died, as well as everyone above forty years of age. When the forty years ended, Yuwsha* son of Nun assumed their leadership and later conquered Jerusalem. When Yuwsha' was reminded that the day was Friday and the sun was about to set, while they were still attacking Jerusalem, he feared that the Sabbath might begin. Therefore, he said to the sun, I am commanded and you are commanded. Allah made the sun stop setting and the Jews conquered Jerusalem and found wealth unseen before. They wanted to let the fire consume the booty, but the fire would not do that. Yuwsha' said, Some ofyou have committed theft from the booty. So he summoned the twelve leaders ofthe twelve tribes and took the pledge from them. Then, the hand of one of them became stuck to the hand of Yuwsha' and Yuwsha' said, You committed the theft, so bring it forth. So, that man brought a cow s head made of gold with two eyes made of precious stones and a set of teeth made of pearls. When Yuwsha' added it to the booty, the fire consumed it, as they were prohibited to keep the booty. There is evidence supporting all of this in the Sahih. Allah Comforts Musa Conforting MQsa, Allah said i-tfJI Jt'yill jfr J-b Su\$> 4So do not greivefor the rebellious people. A Similar version was recorded by At-Tabari 10 :193

Allah said: Do not feel sorrow or sadness over My judgment against them, for they deserve such judgment. This story chastises the Jews, exposes their defiance of Allah and His Messenger, and their refusal to obey the order for Jihad. They were weak and could not bear the thought of fighting their enemy, being patient, and enduring this way. This occurred although they had the Messenger of Allah and the one whom He spoke to among them, the best of Allah s creation that time. Their Prophet promised them triumph and victory against their enemies. They also witnessed the torment and punishment of drowning with which Allah punished their enemy Fir awn and his soldiers, so that their eyes were pleased and comforted. All this did not happen too long ago, yet they refused to perform Jihad against people who had less than a tenth of the power and strength than the people of Egypt had. Therefore, the evil works of the Jews were exposed to everyone, and the exposure was such an enormous one that the night, or the tail, can never cover its tracks. They were also blinded by their ignorance and transgression. Thus, they became hated by Allah, and they became His enemies. Yet, they claim that they are Allah s children and His loved ones! May Allah curse their faces that were transformed to the shape of swine and apes, and may Allah s curse accompany them to the raging Fire. May Allah make them abide in the Fire for eternity, and He did; all thanks are due to Him. . And recite

to them the story of the two sons of Adam in truth; when each offered a sacrifice, it was accepted from the one but not from the other. The latter said to the former: "I will surely, kill you. The former said: Verily, Allah accepts

150 Tafsir Ibn Kathir only from those who have Taqwa.) 428. "If you do stretch your hand against me to kill me, I shall never stretch my hand against you to kill you, for I fear Allah; the Lord of all that exists.") 429. "Verily, I intend to let you draw my sin on yourself as well as yours, then you will be one of the dwellers of the Fire, and that is the recompense of the wrongdoers.") 430. So the soul of the other encouraged him and made fair-seeming to him the murder of his brother; he murdered him and became one of the losers. 431. Then Allah sent a crow who scratched the ground to show him how to hide the dead body of his brother. He said: "Woe to me! Am I not even able to be as this crow and to hide the dead body of my brother?" Then he became one of those who regretted.) The Story of Habil (Abel) and Qabil (Cain) Allah describes the evil end and consequence of transgression, envy and injustice in the story of the two sons of Adam, Habil and Qabil. One of them fought against the other and killed him out of envy and transgression, because of the bounty that Allah gave his brother and because the sacrifice that he sincerely offered to Allah was accepted. The murdered brother earned forgiveness for his sins and was admitted into Paradise, while the murderer failed and earned a losing deal in both the lives. Allah said, 4 And recite to them the story of the two sons of Adam in truth;) meaning, tell these envious, unjust people, the brothers of swine and apes from the Jews and their likes among mankind,

the story of the two sons of Adam, Habil and Qabil, as many

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1472–1509]

scholars among the Salaf and later generations said. Allah's statement, 4 in truth;) means, clearly and without ambiguity, alteration,

confusion, change, addition or deletion. Allah said in other Ayat, i V i Verily, this is the true narrative [about the story of Isa,] } > 1 ~ ^ _ j " U ii U * joi narrate unto you their story with truth, } and, 4i' Jv & i Ae 4 Such is 'Isa, son of Maryam. (It is) a statement of truth.} Several scholars among the Salaf and the later generations said that Allah allowed Adam to marry his daughters to his sons because of the necessity of such action. They also said that in every pregnancy, Adam was given a twin, a male and a female, and he used to give the female of one twin, to the male of the other twin, in marriage. Habil's sister was not beautiful while Qabil's sister was beautiful, resulting in Qabil wanting her for himself, instead of his brother. Adam refused unless they both offer a sacrifice, and he whose sacrifice was accepted, would marry Qabil's sister. Habil's sacrifice was accepted, while Qabil's sacrifice was rejected, and thus what Allah told us about them occurred. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said - that during the time of Adam - The woman was not allowed in marriage for her male twin, but Adam was commanded to marry her to any of her other brothers. In each pregnancy, Adam was given a twin, a male and a female. A beautiful daughter was once born for Adam and another one that was not beautiful. So the twin brother of the ugly daughter said, Marry your sister to me and I will marry my sister to you. He said, No, for I have more right to my sister. So they both offered a sacrifice. The sacrifice of the one who offered the sheep was accepted while the sacrifice of the other [the twin brother of the beautiful

daughter), which consisted of some produce, was not accepted. So the latter killed his brother. This story has a better than good chain of narration."Tabari 10:223.

The statement, *jt iit Jlij !{ } i: "Verily, Allah accepts only from those who have Taqwa.} who fear Allah in their actions. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Ad-Darda said, If I become certain that Allah has accepted even one prayer from me, it will be better for me than this life and all that in it. This is because Allah says, L5^ iVerily, Allah accepts only from the those who have Taqwd.} The statement, vj t tjjJ i"*

Hellfire. They said, O Allah's Messenger! It is all right for the murderer, but what about the victim? Allah's Messenger *g* replied, *t- j>- jl* He surely had the intention to kill his comrade . Imam

154 Tafstr Ibn Kathfr 4"Verily, I intend to let you draw my sin on yourself as well as yours..."} means, the sin of murdering me, in addition to your previous sins. Ibn Jarir recorded this! Allah's statement, 4So the soul of the other encouraged him and made fair-seeming to him the murder of his brother; he murdered him and became one of the losers.} means, his conscience encouraged him to kill his brother by making it seem like a sensible thing to do, so he killed him, even after his brother admonished him. Ibn Jarir said, When he wanted to kill his brother, he started to twist his neck. So Shaytan took an animal and placed its head on a rock, then he took another rock, and smashed its head with it until he killed it while the son of Adam was looking. So he did the same thing to his brother. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim also recorded this. Abdullah bin Wahb said that Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that his father said, Qabll held Habll by the head to kill him, so Habll laid down for him and Qabll started twisting Habfl's head, not knowing how to kill him. Shaytan came to Qabll and said, Do you want to kill him? He said, Yes. Shaytan said, Take that stone and throw it on his head. So Qabll took the stone and threw it at his brother's head and smashed his head. Shaytan then went to Hawwa in a hurry and said to her, O Hawwa ! Qabll killed Habll. She asked him, Woe to you! What does 1011 mean? He said, He will no longer eat, drink or move. She said, And that is death? He said, *Yes it is. So she started to weep until Adam came to her while she was weeping and said. What is the matter with you? She did not answer him. He asked her two more times, but she did not answer him. So he said, *You and your daughters will inherit the practice of weeping, while I and my sons are free of it. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded it. Allah's statement.Tabari 10:215-216. 121 AMabari 4:536.

Cxi iAnd became one of the losers in this life and the Hereafter, and which loss is worse than this? Imam

J V. Si. sp a &>;> :rp yj3l Ili 4"Woe fo me! Am I not even able to be as this crow and to hide the dead body of my brother?"* Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, A crow came to the dead corpse of another crow and threw sand over it, until it hid it in the ground. He who killed his brother said, Sh c, 1 \$ > S/X 4Woe to me! Am I not even able to be as this crow and to hide the dead body of my brother?*' Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented on the statement, Si ' & iThen he became one of those who regretted. Allah made him feel sorrow after the loss that he earned. \m&i ' saga jdi 4^& _^sCSli==uijffd .it *Vf ^ j"r-) ,ij JJ4I1I '3T>*- jLLjijl ijiiJaj laL-j -^L-U'a Lr s'd'e^ ^ jL->-jj aii 0^?j3s- r The Swift Punishment for Transgression and Cutting the Relations of the Womb A Hadith states that the Prophet said,Tabari 10:225.Tabari 10:226.

jj La e UjJlJl iijyS ai 1 jf L/f " There is no sin that is more worthy of Allah hastening its punishment in this life, in addition to wltat He has in store for its offender in the Hereafter, more than transgression and cutting the relations of the ivomb.n The act of Qabll included both of these. We are Allah s and to Him is our return. 4 idi "f (Jjjj _ ju dlil jil ja /jl JajJ, jaj 6-Srf i\$3 tltl - I?; d uiC'A'^ijj^Lil jfHi 4 - 5! jL Li-ij f jl jl Ijdi cjfjV' 4 Sit OjSijU;^ 4 - i ui jV' ^ jl oi (*-4*-jl> ^ i&g 6i^ & \# i>\% -o#\ 4 girt -& 432. Because of that, We ordained for the Children of Israel that if anyone killed a person not in retaliation of murder, or (and) to spread mischief in the land - it would be as if he killed all mankind, and if anyone saved a life, it would be as if he saved the life of all mankind. And indeed, there came to them Our Messengers with Al-Bayyindt, even then after that many of than continued to exceed the limits in the land!) 433 . The recompense of those who wage war against Allah and His Messenger and do mischief in the land is only that they shall be killed or crucified, or their hands and their feet be cut off on opposite sides, or be exiled from the land. Tlwt is their disgrace in this world, and a great torment is theirs in the Hereafter.} 434. Exceptfor those who (having fled away and then) came back (as Muslims) with repentance before they fall into your power; in that case, know that Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Abu D&wud 5:208.

Human Beings Should Respect the Sanctity of Other Human Beings Allah says, because the son of Adam killed his brother in transgression and aggression, iWe ordained for the Children of Israel... meaning, We legislated for them and informed them, \L.S. JI Qi (S ujfjVi 4 fZCi j-ju lilij jii j til i4l =*> util / anyone killed a person not in retaliation of murder, or (and) to spread mischief in the land - it would be as if he killed all mankind, and if anyone saved a life, it would be as if he saved the life of all mankind.} The Ayah states, whoever kills a soul without justification - such as in retaliation for murder or for causing mischief on earth - will be as if he has killed all mankind, because there is no difference between one life and another. iand if anyone saved a life...} by preventing its blood from being shed and believing in its sanctity, then all people will have been saved from him, so, i\ JIUit til iit would be as ifhe saved the life of all mankind.} Al-A mash and others said that Abu Salih said that Abu Hurayrah said, I entered on TJthman when he was under siege in his house and said, 1 came to give you my support. Now, it is good to fight (defending you) O Leader of the Faithful! He said, O Abu Hurayrah! Does it please you that you kill all people, including me? I said, No. He said, If you kill one man, it is as ifyou killed all people. Therefore, go back with my permission for you to leave. May you receive your reward and be saved from burden. So 1 went back and did not fight. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, It is as Allah has stated, L_ ; 4-j CSI^=o ufjVf 4 yLli 31 jjaj iLi f*}

Ja-iI til \itiS iif anyone killed a person not in retaliation of murder, or (and) to spread mischief in the land - it would be as if he killed all mankind, and if anyone saved a life, it would be as if he saved the life of all mankind. Saving life in this case occurs by not killing a soul that Allah has forbidden. So this is the meaning of saving the life of all mankind, for whoever forbids killing a soul without justification, the lives of all people will be saved from him. Similar was said by Mujahid; iAnd if anyone saved a life...} means, he refrains from killing a soul. ' Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said that Allah s statement, iit would be as ifhe killed all mankind..} means, Whoever kills one soul that Allah has forbidden killing, is just like he who kills all mankind. * Said bin Jubayr said, He who allows himself to shed the blood of a Muslim, is like he who allows shedding the blood of all people. He who forbids shedding the blood of one Muslim, is like he who forbids shedding the blood of all people. In addition,

Ibn Jurayj said that Al-A'raaj said that Mujahid commented on the Ayah, it would be as if he killed all mankind,} He who kills a believing soul intentionally, Allah makes the Fire of Hell his abode, He will become angry with him, and curse him, and has prepared a tremendous punishment for him, equal to if he had killed all people, his punishment will still be the same. Ibn Jurayj said that Mujahid said that the Ayah, Tabari 10:235. 'At-Tabari 10:236. 'At-Tabari 10:233.

260 Tafsir Ibn Kathtir til iiti.1 and if anyone saved a life, it would be as if he saved the life of all mankind . means, He who does not kill anyone, then the lives of people are safe from him. 111 Warning Those who Commit Mischief Allah said, OI JS";> 4 And indeed, there came to them Our Messengers with Al-Baxjyindt,} meaning, clear evidences, signs and proofs, ufjV>' 4 IT rfjg h% ieven then after that many of them continued to exceed the limits in the land!} This Ayah chastises and criticizes those who commit the prohibitions, after knowing that they are prohibited from indulging in them. The Jews of Al-Madlnah, such as Banu Qurayzah, An-Nadlr and Qaynuqa', used to fight along with either Khazraj or Aws, when war would erupt between them during the time of Jdhiliyyah. When these wars would end, the Jews would ransom those who were captured and pay the blood money for those who were killed. Allah criticized them for this practice in Surat Al-Baqarah, oj (Xu kkA Ojrf-J Ci * pi p g'ojjpi AAj f =A\c. \Sj& d\j Cj'jSWj | Ojb+liJ 'if Uj y'iif d'. ojev. tijif 4 i) ^c, 4 rp,0 tii (remember) zuhen We took your covenant (saying) : Shed id At-Tabari 10:235.

not your (peoples) blood, nor turn out your mvn people from their dwellings. Then, (this) you ratified and (to this) you bear witness. After this, it is you luho kill one another and drive out a party of your own from their homes, assist (their enemies) against them, in sin and transgression. And if they come to you as captives, you ransom them, although their expulsion was forbidden to you. Then do you believe in a part of the Scripture and reject the rest? Then what is the recompense of those who do so among you, except disgrace in the life of this world, and on the Day of Resurrection they shall be consigned to the most grievous torment. And Allah is not unaivare of what you do.} [2:84-85] The Punishment of those Who Cause Mischief in the Land Allah said next, ijiLu jl IjLj Jfji 4 Sif , i Cc>\t) jl <- oi ^ jl iThe recompense of those xoho wage war against Allah and His Messenger and do mischief in the land is only that they shall be killed or crucified or their hands and their feet be cut offon the opposite sides, or be exiledfrom the land.} *Wage war mentioned here means, oppose and contradict, and it includes disbelief, blocking roads and spreading fear in the fairways. Mischief in the land refers to various types of evil. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ikrimah and Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that the Ayat, 4/lAu oui' Cl[} iThe recompense of those who wage war against Allah and His Messenger} until, sSf Sj> iAllah is Of-Forgiving, Most Merciful,} Were revealed about ijC idolators. Therefore, the Ayah decrees that, whoever amongthem repents before you apprehend them, then you have no right to punish them. This Ayah does not save a Muslim from punishment if he kills, causes mischief in the land or wages

war against Allah and His Messenger and then joins rank with the disbelievers, before the

Al-Md'idah (32 - 34) (Part-6) Allah said, 31 i (-t-'ij'i ^a-jj f jl ijiiLu c ithey shall be killed or crucified or their hands and their feet be cut offon the opposite sides, or be exiledfront the land.} Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said about this Ayah, He who takes up arms in

As for Allah's statement, (or be exiled from the land.) some said that it means, he is actively pursued until he is captured, and thus receives his prescribed punishment, or otherwise he escapes from the land of Islam, as Ibn Jarir recorded from Ibn Abbas, Anas bin Malik, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas, Az-Zuhri, Al-Layth bin Sa'd and Malik bin Anas. Some said that the Ayah means these people are expelled to another land, or to another state by the

'* C/4. oi J* J-iJi <<! u? wi! jt Q* Iff ^ Lipj Qi- oyLli djil^ Cii JJil jjj > -: ". a * Uf. Jj <. He who sins in this life and was punished for it, then Allah is far more just than to combine two punishments on His servant. He who commits an error in this life and Allah hides this error and pardons him, then Allah is far more generous than to punish the servant for something that He has already pardoned."

The Punishment of those who Wage War Against Allah and His Messenger is Annulled if They Repent Before their Apprehension Allah said, (Except for those who (having fled away and then) came back (as

Al-Maidah (32 - 34) (Part-6) offered the obligatory prayer, O Abu Musa! I seek your help. I am so-and-so from Murad and I waged war against Allah and His Messenger and caused mischief in the land. I repented before you had any authority over me. Abu Musa proclaimed, This is so-and-so, who had waged war against Allah and His Messenger and caused mischief in the land, and he repented before we had authority over him. Therefore, anyone who meets him, should deal with him in a better way. If he is saying the truth, then this is the path of those who say the truth. If he is saying a lie, his sins will destroy him. So the man remained idle for as long as Allah willed, but he later rose against the leaders, and Allah punished him for his sins and he was killed. Ibn Jarir recorded that Musa bin Ishaq Al-Madani said that Ali Al-Asadi waged war, blocked the roads, shed blood and plundered wealth. The leaders and the people alike, sought to capture him, but they could not do that until he came after he repented, after he heard a man reciting the Ayah, if*# & My servants who have transgressed against themselves! Despair not of the mercy of Allah, verily, Allah forgives all sins. Truly, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. So he said to that man, O servant of Allah! Recite it again. So he recited it again, and Ali put down his sword and went to Al-Madnah in repentance, arriving during the night. He washed up and went to the Masjid of the Messenger of Allah and prayed the dawn prayer. He sat next to Abu Hurayrah amidst his companions. In the morning, the people recognized him and went after him. He said, You have no way against me. I came in repentance before you had any authority over me. Abu Hurayrah said, He has said the truth, and he held his hand and went to Marwan bin Al-Hakam, who was the governor of Al-Madnah during the reign of Mu'awiyah. Abu Hurayrah said, This is Ali and he came in repentance and you do not have a way against him, nor can you have him killed. So Ali was absolved of punishment and remained on his repentance and went to the sea to perform Jihad in Allah's cause. The Muslims met the Romans in battle, and the

Commanding Taqwa, Wasilah and Jihad Allah commands His faithful servants to fear Him in Taqwa, which if mentioned along with acts of obedience, it means to refrain from the prohibitions and the prohibited matters. Allah said next, i%ra i seek the Wasilah to Him ^ Sufyan Ath-Thawri said that Talhah said that Ata said that Ibn Abbas said that Wasilah means the means of approach. ^ * Mujahid, Abu Wa'il, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Abdullah bin Kathir, As-Suddi, Ibn Zayd and others gave the same meaning for Wasilah. Qatadah said that the Ayah means, Seek the means of approach to Him by obeying Him and performing the acts that please Him. iThose whom they call upon seek a means of

access to their Lord (Allah). [17:57] Wasilah is a means of approach to achieve something, and it is also used to refer to the highest grade in Paradise, and it is the grade of the Messenger of Allah jfe, his residence and the nearest grade in Paradise to Allah's Throne.

170 Tafsir Ibu Kathir that he heard the Prophet saying, aju < \jLj> pi ijij u ji* \jijH jji iji" h^- 'fy uf- r 1 ^ iJj~* t^ji i IjLi i jllp JJ aitlX*J] - oI"- _AJ jj! jLi v V* ui jjS\ jl 15&I ill#- t/ow hear the Mu'adlidhin, repeat ivhat he says, and then ask for Saldh (blessing, mercy from Allah) for me. Verily, whoever asks for Saldh for me, then Allah will grant ten Saldh to him. Then, ask for the Wasilah for me, for it is a grade in Paradise that only one servant of Allah deserves, and I hope that I am that servant. Verily, whoever asks (Allah) for Wasilah for me, he will earn the right of my intercession ."(11 Allah said, iand strive hard in His cause as much as you can . So that you may be successful. After Allah commanded Muslims to avoid the prohibitions and to work towards obedience, He commanded them to fight against their enemies, the disbelievers and idolators who have deviated from the straight path and abandoned the correct religion. Allah encouraged the believers by reminding them of the unending success and great happiness that He prepared for them for the Day of Resurrection, which will never change or decrease for those who join Jihad in His cause. They will remain in the lofty rooms of Paradise that are safe and beautiful. Those who live in these dwellings will always be comfortable and will never be miserable, living, never dying, and their clothes will never grow thin, nor will their youth ever end. No Amount of Ransom Shall Be Accepted from the Disbelievers on the Day of the Judgment and They Will Remain in the Fire Allah then describes the painful torment and punishment that He has prepared for His disbelieving enemies for the Day Muslim 1 :288.

of Resurrection. Allah said, lx ijilsJ 4 U y r' 4>j* ~; I* #- *! -jj; <^tit Verify, those zoho disbelieve, if they had all that is in the earth, and as much again thereioith to ransom themselves thereby from the torment on the Day of Resurrection, it zvould never be accepted of them. And theirs would be a painfid torment. So if a disbeliever brought the earth s fill of gold, and twice as much as that amount on the Day of Judgment to ransom himself from Allah s torment that has surrounded him, and he is certain that he will suffer from it, it will not be accepted of him. Rather, there is no escaping the torment, and he will not be able to evade or save himself from it. Hence Allah s statement, v'js \$\$ <*&And theirs would be a painfid torment.} meaning, hurtful, 4 ^ Z& ~ ,4"&U \g J iThey will long to get out of the Fire, but never zoill they get out therefrom, and theirs will be a lasting torment.} In another Ayah, Allah said. i)Xr6^^ Cri \ iEveny time they seek to get away therefrom, in anguish, they zoill be driven back therein.} Therefore, they will still long to leave the torment because of the severity and the pain it causes. They will have no way of escaping it. The more the flames lift them to the upper part of Hell, the more the angels of punishment will strike them with iron bars and they will fall down to its depths, 4^ <{And theirs zoill be a lasting torment.} meaning, eternal and everlasting, and they will never be able to depart from it or avoid it. Anas bin Malik said that the Messenger of Allah sg said,

: oo>-j fji \yi\ U:*J JUj jOi jif r j'i ?l**i ^jSil 'r l, Si . j* :Jlia 3-i *jU' (Jl * js jUi -iiJi j*^ iiib. jj idJJS : Jil J^ili man from the people of the Fire will be brought forth and will be asked, 'O son of Adam! How did you find your dwelling? He will say, 'The worst dwelling.' He will be told, 'Would you ransom yourself with the earth's fill of gold?' He will say, 'Yes, O Lord!' Allah will say to him, 'You have lied. 1 asked you for what is less than that and you did not do it,' and he will be ordered to the Fire .

Al-Ma'idah (38 - 40) (Part-6) be met before this punishment is carried out, as we will come to know, Allah willing. There are other rulings that Islam upheld after modifying these rulings, such as that of blood money for example. When Does Cutting the Hand of the Thief Become Necessary? In is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, 3j t) 1 s-*i OilJl 3j i 3jLUl uil aMfly Allah curse the thief who steals an egg and as a result his hand is cut off, and who steals rope and as a result his hand is cut ofjff. [1]

174 Tafsir Ibn Kathir may Allah be pleased with them - and it is the view of Umar bin Abdul-'Aziz, Al-Layth bin Sa d, Al-Awza'I, and Ash-Shafil and his companions. This is also the view of Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal and Ishaq bin Rahwayh in one of the narrations from him, as well as Abu Thawr, and Dawud bin 'Ali Az-Zahari, may Allah have mercy upon them. As for Imam Abu Hanifah and his students Abu Yusuf, Muhammad and Zufar, along with Sufyan Ath-Thawri, they said that the least amount of theft that deserves cutting off the hand is ten Dirhams, whereas a Dinar was twelve Dirhams at that time. The first ruling is the correct one, that the least amount of theft is one forth of a Dinar or more. This meager amount was set as the limit for cutting the hand, so that the people would refrain from theft, and this is a wise decision to those who have sound comprehension. Hence Allah s statement, ins a recompense for that xohich both committed, a punishment by way ofexamplefrom Allah. And Allah is All-Pozverfid , All- Wise.} This is the prescribed punishment for the evil action they committed, by stealing the property of other people with their hands. Therefore, it is fitting that the tool they used to steal the people s wealth be cut off as punishment from Allah for their error. iAnd Allah is All-Powerfid,} in His torment, {All-Wise.} in His commands, what he forbids, what He legislates and what He decrees. Repentance ofthe Thief is Acceptable Allah said next, 4 r y^j oj. jJo & 11)6 {But whosoever repents after his crime and does righteous good deeds, then verily, Allah will pardon him. Verily, Allah is Oft-

Al-Ma'idah (38 - 40) (Part-6) Forgiving, Most Merciful. Therefore, whoever repents and goes back to Allah after he commits theft, then Allah will forgive him. Imam

176 Tafsir Ibt Kathir he jjg said, Do you intercede in a punishment prescribed by Allah ?" Usamah said to him, Ask Allah to forgive me, O Allah s Messenger! During that night, the Messenger of Allah stood up and gave a speech and praised Allah as He deserves to be praised. He then said, njSj: jli\ ijJ Ijj \^S - j* jjS}\ Jllaf U aju ji ii"Jl kSs- . " aJ t Ijlj "ui' Jjij aThose who were before you were destroyed because when an honorable person among them would steal, they would leave him. But, xohen a weak man among them stole, they implemented the prescribed punishment against him. By Him in Whose Hand is my soul! IfFatimah the daughter ofMuhammad stole, I will have her hand cut off. The Prophet si commanded that the hand of the woman who stole be cut off, and it was cut off. A ishah said, Her repentance was sincere afterwards, and she got married and she used to come to me so that I convey her needs to the Messenger of Allah. This is the wording that Muslim collected, and in another narration by Muslim, A ishah said, She was a woman from Makhzum who used to borrow things and deny that she took them. So the Prophet ordered that her hand be cut off. Allah then said, tit ji 4t P fit iKnow you not that to Allah (Alone) belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth!} He owns eveiything and decides what He wills for it and no one can resist His judgment, 4jjJ fj.^&%&S Al-Bari 7:619, Muslim 3 :1315. Muslim 3:1316.

you aavij oiim sjai/jo of Siuusfst('sstj Of RpaSos puv ipnui U3fsi{ 01(01 U3UI 3XV S013[3l(f fo puy l(fwj OU 30Vl(SfJV3t(JJ3l((fuq sipnoui ui3i(j ifltol "303ipq 3^, Has oipi ipns Jo noR oasixS Jsipqstp ofut \ (vj of fuxntf otfoi asm// fou \s7 (xsSuassoyq q if\$ 7X^ fX JP yt? T? if r"^! 5p vTi* ?rfi jip-f ff" ^ \fr , TfWtr> ^ /i \fcxb j7?bf! ^jr if rr \$*tj; b. t/br b, \fn jrfgr tr? a*?^^ ifrrr 17 ff jnfr?0 gr br ibbb trrbP v&v vi iib f bf rb sf*f pf ^tr Tb 5'? ITf- i*=5f7 i&tf * TPT' bb f itr.ti bs frfr f r*V iff* i<? n* r#-'r r fj' "*" jV - a j. r- if Tb] frn> if? f bb f *cp rbi b7 f(ip i<'jr,r *rri o" flc [f V <- - >* * < " J rrfjfp *o :rf*; "r AfF ibr * -yCp frksTrr-> ""* <"p nr^ ; ; rf^C nfrf-* Cf* ^ I(f>? ryfi f- ;>*** - ii- - "V ipb ? > :c? ^s*r fir if^ fbf? f jr^f" 4# 5^ jCff s8uu{ { // " op of 3(qv st ipuv puy 'Sffioi dp 11101(01 S3l(SlUttd puv S((101 3f-{ moipi saaiSxoJ 3fj\$ fc~iaO' rr-nrf^^S^ <=5^r(\~|>?r CrC -s*' ^pjVrrfS \r^?F\$r frrr*? - , < /" /<* s< teftj.cri^\$ ^{f !rc^i^i^T 4*^~ ~*~\~. ; 1 i y's zsfy r^f bi fsr SSa?8 eu ^ LLL {9-Wd) iff - If) l P!,m- lVHwvs

come to you. They change the words from their places; the\ say, "If you are given this, take it, but if you are not given this, then beware!" And whomsoever Allah wants to put in Fitnah, you can do nothing for him against Allah. Those are the ones ivhose hearts Allah does not ivanl to purify; for them there is a disgrace in this world, and in the Hereafter a great torment.} 442. They (like to) listen to falsehood, to devour Suht. So if they come to you, either judge between them, or turn away from them. Ifyou turn awayfrom them, they cannot hurt you in the least. And ifyou judge, judge with justice between them. Verily, Allah loves those who act justly.} i43. But how do they come to you for a decision rohile they have the Tawrdh, in which is the decision of Allah; yet even after that they turn axvay. For they are not believers.} 444. Verily, We did send down the Tawrdh, therein ivas guidance and light, by which the Prophets zuho submitted themselves to Allah's zoill, judged for the Jczos. And the Rabbdniyyiln and the Ahbdr, for to them was entrusted the protection of Allah's Book, and they zvere zoitnenses thereto. Therefore fear not men butfear Me and sell not My verses for a miserable price. And zvhosoever does not judge by zvhat Allah has revealed, such are the disbelievers.} Do NotFeelSadBecause ofthe Behavior oftheJewsand Hypocrites These honorable Ayat were revealed about those who rush into disbelief, deviating from the obedience of Allah, His Messenger, prefering their opinions and lusts to what Allah has legislated, crt y &'* Qfc Crify iof such who say, "We believe" with their mouths but their hearts have nofaith.} These people pretend to be faithful with their words, but their hearts are empty from faith, and they are the hypocrites. 4b*i* Si'

180 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir stoning to death, then do not accept his decision. There are several HacLlths mentioning this story. Malik reported that Nafi said that Abdullah bin TJmar said, The Jews came to Allah s Messenger sg and mentioned that a man and a woman from them committed adultery. Allah s Messenger said to them, jli, 11What dofind of the ruling about stoning in the Taivrah ?" They said, *We only find that they should be exposed and flogged. Abdullah bin Salam said, You lie. The Tawrah mentions stoning, so bring the Tawrah. They brought the Tawrah and opened it but one of them hid the verse about stoning with his hand and recited what is before and after that verse. Abdullah bin Salam said to him, Remove your hand, and he removed it, thus uncovering the verse about stoning. So they said, He (Abdullah bin Salam) has said the truth, O Muhammad! It is the verse about stoning. The Messenger of Allah sg decided that the adulterers be stoned to death and his command was carried out. I saw that man shading the woman from the stones with his body. Al-Bukhari and Muslim also

collected this Hadith and this is the wording collected by Al-Bukhari. In another narration by Al-Bukhari,

the Prophet ﷺ said to the Jews, c V -l ^ jj Li What would you do in this case?* They said, We would humiliate and expose them. The Prophet ﷺ recited, Lfc^bli iBring here the Tawrah and recite it, if you are truthful.} So they brought a man who was blind in one eye and who was respected among them and said to him, Read (from the Tawrah). So he read until he reached a certain verse and then covered it with his hand. He was told, Remove your hand, and it was the verse about stoning. So that man said, O Muhammad! This is the verse about stoning, and we had hid its knowledge among us. So the Messenger ﷺ ordered that the two adulterers be stoned, and they were stoned. m Al-Bukhari no . 4556

182 Tafstr Ibn Katlur tBring me your most knowledgeable persons So he was brought a young man... and then he mentioned the rest of the story that Malik narrated from Nafi'J These Hadiths state that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ issued a decision that conforms with the ruling in the Tawrah, not to honor the Jews in what they believe in, for the Jews were commanded to follow the Law of Muhammad ﷺ only. Rather, the Prophet did this because Allah commanded him to do so. He asked them about the ruling of stoning in the Tawrah to make them admit to what the Tawrah contains and what they collaborated to hide, deny and exclude from implementing for all that time. They had to admit to what they did, although they did it while having knowledge of the correct ruling. What made them go to the Prophet for judgement in this matter was their lusts and desires, hoping that the Prophet ﷺ would agree with their opinion, not that they believed in the correctness of his judgment. This is why they said, if you are given this,} referring to flogging, then take it, 4but if you are not given this, then beware!} and do not accept or implement it. Allah said next, ijS iiS Jyi JU djJI c XZij\ lili /) - jpjj ^ %% aiif ^p -g. iAnd whomsoever Allah wants to put in Fitnah, you can do nothing for him against Allah . Those are the ones whose hearts Allah does not want to purify; for them there is a disgrace in this world, and in the Hereafter a great torment. Tthey (like to) listen to falsehood, to devour Sulit} SuM refers to bribes, as Ibn Mas'ud and others stated.121 The 111 Abu Dawud 4:597.Tabari 10:319.

Al-Ma'idah (41 - 44) (Part-6 Ayah states that if one is like this, how can Allah cleanse his heart and accept his supplication? Allah said to His Prophet m, 4\$ 4So if they come to you ...) so that you judge between them, 4% o\j j' rr* p-4 ^either judge between them, or turn away from them. If you turn away from them, they cannot hurt you in the least.} meaning, there is no harm if you do not judge between them. This is because when they came to you to judge between them, they did not seek to follow the truth, but only what conformed to their lusts. We should mention here that Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Zayd bin Aslam, Ata Al-Khurasani, and several others said that this part of the Ayah was abrogated by Allah's statement, & Zj pi44 4And so judge among them by what Allah has revealed.) iArni if you judge, judge with justice between them.} and with fairness, even if the Jews were unjust and outcasts from the path of fairness, 4- kii iVerily, Allah loves those who act justly.} Chastising the Jews for Their Evil Lusts and Desires, While Praising the Tawrah Allah then chastises the Jews for their false ideas and deviant desires to abandon what they believe is true in their Book, and which they claim is their eternal Law that they are always commanded to adhere to. Yet, they do not adhere to the Tawrah, but they prefer other laws over it, although they believe that these other laws are not correct and do not apply m At-Tabari 10:330-332.

down the Ayat, J' ii' Jy' Hj 2 i>*JA)id ivhosoever does not judge by what Allah has revealed, such are the disbelievers,} jii iSuch are the unjust,} and, 4Swc/i are the rebellious .} about two groups among the Jews. During the time of Jahiliyyah, one of them had defeated the other. As a result, they made a treaty that they would pay blood money totaling fifty Wasaq [of gold] (each Wasaq approx. 3 kg) for every dead person from the defeated group killed by the victors, and a hundred Wasaq for every dead person the defeated group killed from the victors. This treaty remained in effect until the Prophet came to Al-Madlnah and both of these groups became subservient under the Prophet sfe. Yet, when the mighty group once suffered a casualty at the hands of the weaker group, the mighty group sent a delegation demanding the hundred Wasaq. The weaker group said, How can two groups who have the same religion, one ancestral lineage and a common land, have a Diah that for some of them is half of that of the others? We only agreed to this because you oppressed us and because we feared you. Now that Muhammad has come, we will not give you what you asked. So war was almost rekindled between them, but they agreed to seek Muhammad s judgement in their dispute. The mighty group among them said [among themselves], By Allah! Muhammad will never give you double the Diah that you pay to them compared to what they pay to you. They have said the truth anyway, for they only gave us this amount because we oppressed and overpowered them. Therefore, send someone to Muhammad who will sense what his judgement will be. If he agrees to give you what you demand, accept his judgment, and if he does not give you what you seek, do not refer to him for judgement. So they sent some hypocrites to the Messenger of Allah jg to try and find out the Messenger s judgement. When they came to the Messenger sg, Allah informed him of their

matter and of their plot. Allah sent down, iO Messenger! Let not those who hurry to fall into disbelief grieve you,) until, iSuch are the rebellious.) By Allah! It is because of their problem that Allah sent down these verses and it is they whom Allah meant. 1"

iopii o' ' r#^ \$Aiid We ordained therein for them: Lifefor life, eyefor eye'**? until the end of the Ayah, which strengthens the opinion that

the story of the Diah was behind revealing the Ayat as we

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1509–1537]

explained above. Allah knows best. Allah said, ^And whosoever does not judge by what Allah has revealed, such are the disbelievers .? Al-Bara bin Azib, Hudhayfah bin Al-Yaman, Ibn Abbas, Abu Mijlaz, Abu Raja Al- Utaridi, Ikrimah, Ubaydullah bin Abdullah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and others said that this Ayah was revealed about the People of the Book.' ' Al-Hasan Al- Basri added that this Ayah also applies to us . 121 Abdur- Razzaq said that Ath-Thawri said that Mansur said that Ibrahim said that these Ayat, Were revealed about the Children of Israel, and Allah accepted them for this Ummah." Ibn Jarir recorded this statement.'3 ' Ali bin Abi Talhah also stated that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah s statement, iAnd whosoever does not judge by what Allah has revealed, such are the disbelievers,\$ Whoever rejects what Allah has revealed, will have committed Kufr, and whoever accepts what Allah has revealed, but did not rule by it, is a Zalim (unjust) and a Fasiq (rebellious) and a sinner." Ibn Jarir recorded this statement.'4 ' Abdur-Razzaq said, Ma'mar narrated to us thatTawus said that Ibn Abbas

was asked about Allah's statement, \$&Tabari 10:347-357.Tabari 10:357.Tabari 10:356. (4> At-Tabari 4:597.

4And whosoever does not judge. He said, It is an act of Kufr.' Ibn Tawus added, It is not like those who disbelieve in Allah, His angels. His Books and His Messengers. Ath-Thawri narrated that Ibn Jurayj said that Ata said, There is Kufr and Kufr less than Kufr, Zulm and Zulm less than Zulm, Fisq and Fisq less than Fisq. ^ Waki said that Said Al-Makki said that Tawus said that, 4^fs&S\ pi ibjti ill \$ il, Xfe JJX) 4And whosoever does not judge by what Allah has revealed, such are the disbelievers,) This is not the Kufr that annuls one's religion. o% j\ 'Q^ Gg) (*^==u: J X * XxX XX IsXh pi iujti& ti 445. And We ordained therein for them "Life for life, eye for eye, nose for nose, ear for ear, tooth for tooth, and wounds equal for equal. But if anyone remits the retaliation by way of clemency, it shall be for him an expiation. And whosoever does not judge by that which Allah has revealed, such are the unjust.) This Ayah also chastises and criticizes the Jews because in the Tawrah, they have the law of a life for a life. Yet, they defied this ruling by transgression and rebellion. They used to apply this ruling when a person from Bani An-Nadlr was killed by a Qurayzah person, but this was not the case when the opposite occurred. Rather, they would revert to Diah in this case. They also defied the ruling in the Tawrah to stone the adulterer and instead came up with their own form of punishment, flogging, humiliation and parading them in public. This is why Allah said in the previous Ayah, ilfgs pi &&X iX) 4And whosoever does not judge by what Alldh has revealed, Abdur-Razzaq 1 :191 , At-Jabari 4 :595. At-Tabari 10:355.

189enroll 5. Al-Ma'idah (45) (Part-6) such are the disbelievers. because they rejected Allah's command with full intention and with transgression and rebellion. In this Ayah, Allah said, isuch are the unjust because they did not exact the oppressed his due rights from the oppressor in a matter which Allah ordered that all be treated equally and fairly. Instead, they defied that command, committed injustice and transgressed against each other. AMan is Killed for aWomanWhom He Kills Imam Abu Nasr bin As-Sabbagh stated in his book, Ash- Shamil, that the scholars agree that this Ayah [5:45] should be implemented, and the Imams agree that the man is killed for a woman whom he kills, according to the general indications of this Ayah. A Hadith that

s^S/ .dll ^s. j, it _jj j* aJJI jLp v. jl? There are some of Allah's seroants ivho, if theu take an oath by Allah, Allah fullfils .

that man said, O Messenger of Allah! I limp now. Messenger sg said, Jfaj il-Ujli t The: "/ had asked you to zvait, but you disobeyed me. Therefore, Allah cast you away and your limp has no compensation ."

192 Tafsir Ibtisami Kathir Imam

confirming the Tawrah that had come before him, and We gave him the Injil, in which was guidance and light and confirmation of the Tawrah that had come before it, a guidance 'and an admonition for those who have Taqwa.} 447. Let the people of the Injil judge by what Allah has revealed therein. And whosoever does not judge by what Allah has revealed, such are the rebellious. Allah Mentions Isa and Praises the Injil Allah said, 4and We sent...} meaning, We sent 4in their footsteps} meaning the Prophets of the Children of Israel, Oi A-i-j os LJ ^ J-u*} 4'Isa, son of Maryam, confirming the Tawrah that had come before him,} meaning, he believed in it and ruled by it. jt /I 4and We gave him the Injil,

in which was guidance and light} a guidance that directs to the truth and a light that removes the doubts and solves disputes, 4and confirmation of the Tawrah that had come before it,} meaning, he adhered to the Tawrah, except for the few instances that clarified the truth where the Children of Israel differed. Allah states in another Ayah that Isa said to the Children of Israel, 4 ...and to make lawful to you part of what was forbidden to you.} So the scholars say that the Injil abrogated some of the

Al-Ma'idah (48 - 50) (Part-6) Ayah was revealed about the Christians, and this is evident from the context of the Ayah. LfeJ, jjShJu i_ ^~ jSJ i // #5 &" ;k 3 V^= s"3i Si &Z p, il -p S; M Iis ,U;T^ jis -fc & J&i ^ST U S -'i-U ^^ =a.U "Ll Jti ill J_/1 Uj t*j Ll^jw iit ij* (3 |5cli ijJy4 iyi ii' S6)j~*i o' 5*j ojv. cA ob fri11 ois^j (T fi & ^j3i tS-^ OJ rS. And We /woe sent down to you the Book (this Qur'an) in truth, confirming the Scripture that came before it and Muhayminan over it (old Scriptures). So judge between them by what Allah has revealed, and fallow not their vain desires, diverging away from the truth that has come to you. To each among you, We have prescribed a law and a clear way. IfAllah willed, He would have made you one nation, but that (He) may test you in what He has given you; so compete in good deeds. The return of you (all) is to Allah; then He will inform you about that in which you used to differ 449. And so judge between them by what Allah has revealed and fallow not their vain desires, but beware of them lest they turn you far awayfrom some of that which Allcih has sent down to you. And if they turn away, then know that Allah's will is to punish them far some sins of theirs. And truly, most men are rebellious 450. Do they then seek the judgement of (the days of) ignorance? And who is better in judgement than Allah far a people who havefirm faith4 Praising the Qur an; the Command to Refer to the Qur an forJudgment Allah mentioned the Tawrah that He sent down to His Prophet Musa, the one whom He spoke directly to, praising it, commanding that it should be implemented, before it was

196 Tafsfr Ibn Kathtr abrogated. Allah then mentioned the Injll, praised it and commanded its people to adhere to it and follow it, as we stated. He next mentioned the Glorious Qur an that He sent down to His honorable servant and Messenger. Allah said, ig31 30 i Su[iAnd We have sent dnmvti to you the Book in truth... meaning, with the truth that, no doubt, is coming from Allah, zz Q. 4confirming the Scripture that came before ify meaning, the Divinely Revealed Books that praised the Qur an and mentioned that it would be sent down from Allah to His servant and Messenger Muhammad sg. The Qur an was revealed as was foretold in the previous Scriptures. This fact increased faith in the previous Scriptures for the sincere who have knowledge of these Scriptures, those who adhered to Allah s commands and Laws and believed in His Messengers. Allah said, o&u 'oU& j4 & 4 Cj jij 'yy kt ,/ > / i! t: /> 4Say : "Believe in it or do not believe (in it) . Verily, those who were given knowledge before it, when it is recited to them, fall down on their faces in humble prostration." And they say: "Glory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise ofour Lord must be fulfilled meaning that they say, the promise of our Lord, concerning the coming of Muhammad ^ by the words of His previous Messengers, will certainly be fulfilled. Allah s statement, iand Muhayminan over ify means entrusted over it, according to Sufyan Ath-Thawri who narrated it from Abu Ishaq from At-Tamlmi from Ibn Abbas . m Af-Tabari 10:378.

Al-Md'idah (48 - 50) (Part-6) Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, Muhaymin is, the Trustworthy . Allah says that the Qur an is trustworthy over every Divine Book that preceded it. 111 This was reported from Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Mujahid, Muhammad bin KaT), Atiyyah, Al-Hasan,

Qatadah, Ata Al-Khurasani, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd . 121 Ibn Jarir said, The Qur'an is trustworthy over the Books that preceded it. Therefore, whatever in these previous Books conforms to the Qur'an is true, and whatever disagrees with the Qur'an is false. Al-Walibi said that Ibn Abbas said that Muhayminan means, Witness .13 ' Mujahid, Qatadah and As-Suddi said the same. Al-Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said that Muhayminan means, dominant over the previous Scriptures .41 These meanings are similar, as the word Muhaymin includes them all. Consequently, the Qur'an is trustworthy, a witness, and dominant over every Scripture that preceded it. This Glorious Book, which Allah revealed as the Last and Final Book, is the most encompassing, glorious and perfect Book of all times. The Qur'an includes all the good aspects of previous Scriptures and even more, which no previous Scripture ever contained. This is why Allah made it trustworthy, a witness and dominant over all Scriptures. Allah promised that He will protect the Qur'an and swore by His Most Honorable Self, /i 'Tilt iVerily, We, it is We Who have sent down the Dhikr and surely, We will guard it (from corruption).} Allah said, iSo judge between them by what Allah has revealed.} The Ayah commands: O Muhammad! Rule between the people, Arabs and non-Arabs, lettered and unlettered, by what Allah has revealed to you in this Glorious Book and what it At-Tabari 10:379. '2| At-Tabari 10:377-380. At-Tabari 10:377. At-Tabari 10:379.

approves of for you from the Law of the previous Prophets, as Ibn Jarir said. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Ibn Abbas said, The Prophet had the choice to judge between them or to turn away from them and refer them to their own Law. Then this Ayah was revealed, \$j} iSo judge between them by what Allah has revealed, and follow not their vain desires...} and he was commanded to judge between them by our Book. .121 Allah's statement iand follow not their vain desires. . .} This means the ideas they promote, because of which they turned away from what Allah revealed to His Messengers. This is why Allah said, i'&X Si Q3 -Tj} iAnd follow not their vain desires, diverging away from the truth that has come to you.} The Ayah commands: Do not diverge from the truth that Allah has ordained for you, to the vain desires of these miserable, ignorant people. Allah's statement, CQ;j j * .p} 4To each among you, We have prescribed a law and a clear way.} itv* P*mp> 4To each among you, We have prescribed a law} Shir'at meaning, a clear path, as Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Ibn Abbas.131 4'. iif ;vl%} At-Tabari 10:382. A^~Jabari 10:332.Tabari 10:387.

Al-Ma'idah (48 - 50) (Part-6) 41/Allah willed, He would have made you one nation. This is a general proclamation to all nations informing them of Allah's mighty ability. If Allah wills, He would make all mankind follow one religion and one Law, that would never be abrogated. Allah decided that every Prophet would have his own distinct law that is later abrogated partially or totally with the law of a latter Prophet. Later on, all previous laws were abrogated by the Law that Allah sent with Muhammad gj, His servant and Messenger, whom Allah sent to the people of earth as the Final Prophet. Allah said, z 40a js; 14 iii);} 41/Allah willed, He would have made you one nation, but that (He) may test you in what He has given you This Ayah means, Allah has instituted different laws to test His servants obedience to what He legislates for them, thus, He rewards or punishes them according to their actions and what they intend. Abdullah bin Kathlr said that the Ayah, 4In what He has given you.} means, of the Book. Next, Allah encouraged rushing to perform good deeds, strive as in a race in good deeds.} which are obedience to Allah, following His Law that abrogated the laws that came before it, and believing in His Book, the Qur'an, which is the Final Book that He revealed. Allah said next, 4The return o/you (all) is to Allah;} Therefore, O people, your return and final destination is to Allah on the

Day of Resurrection, 4then He will inform you about that in which you used to differ.} Allah will inform you about the truth in which you used to

Al-Ma'idah (48 - 50) (Part-6 Therefore, the majority of humans are disobedient to their Lord, defiant of the truth and deviate away from it. Allah said in other Ayat, iAnd most people will not believe even if you desire it eagerly,} and, tjffi 0* oft iAnd if you obey most of those on the earth they will mislead you far awayfrom Allah s path.} Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas said, Ka*b bin Asad, Ibn Saluba, Abdullah bin Surya and Shas bin Qays said to each other, Let us go to Muhammad to try and misguide him from his religion. So they went to the Prophet and said, O Muhammad! You know that we are the scholars, noblemen and chiefs of the Jews. Ifwe follow you, the Jews will follow suit and will not contradict us. But, there is enmity between us and some of our people, so we will refer to you for judgement in this matter, and you should rule in our favor against them and we will believe in you. The Messenger of Allah jg refused the offer and Allah sent down these Ayat about them, iAnd so judge between them by what Allah has revealed and fallow not their vain desires, but beware of them lest they turn you far away from some of that which Allah has sent down to you.} until, ifar a people who havefirm faith.} Ibn Jarir111 and Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this Hadith. Allah continues, oi 0 0 jlgl m At-Tabari 10:393.

4Do they then seek the judgement of (the days of) ignorance? And who is better in judgement than Allah far a people who havefirm faith?} Allah criticizes those who ignore Allah s commandments, which include every type of righteous good thing and prohibit every type of evil, but they refer instead to opinions, desires and customs that people themselves invented, all of which have no basis in Allah s religion. During the time of Jahiliyyah, the people used to abide by the misguidance and ignorance that they invented by sheer opinion and lusts. The Tatar (Mongols) abided by the law that they inherited from their king Genghis Khan who wrote Al-Yasiq, for them. This book contains some rulings that were derived from various religions, such as Judaism, Christianity and Islam. Many of these rulings were derived from his own opinion and desires. Later on, these rulings became the followed law among his children, preferring them to the Law of the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger s||. Therefore, whoever does this, he is a disbeliever who deserves to be fought against, until he reverts to Allah s and His Messenger s decisions, so that no law, minor or major, is referred to except by His Law. Allah said, 4Do they then seek the judgement of (the days of) ignorance?} meaning, they desire and want this and ignore Allah s judgement, iAnd who is better in judgement than Allah far a people who havefirmfaith?} Who is more just in decision than Allah for those who comprehend Allah s Law, believe in Him, who are certain that Allah is the best among those who give decisions and that He is more merciful with His creation than the mother with her own child? Allah has perfect knowledge of everything, is able to do all things, and He is just in all matters. Al-Hafiz Abu Al-Qasim At-Tabarani recorded that Ibn Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah said, lijl

nv sum jLfr"-jitl[jt-jfto;J Iji* '* I yti <*k0 ^u:.^yu43^CiSyJt~ij ijLuc/J f teJ iA2&Ss^& 3j tj^ (& \$ JiM 3^~ je*. itSf\ >" g tThe most hated person to Allah is the

3 ijlic; -j IS \$\$\$ 40 you who believe! Take not the Jews and the Christians as friends,K ' Allah said, 4And you see those in whose hearts there is a disease...} A disease of doubt, hesitation and hypocrisy. 4ptf 4they hurry to theirfriendship,} meaning, they rush to offer them their friendship and allegiances in

secret and in public, 4saying : "We fear lest some misfortune of a disaster may befall us."} They thus offer this excuse for their friendship and allegiances to the disbelievers, saying that they fear that the disbelievers might defeat the Muslims, so they want to be in favor with the Jews and Christians, to use this favor for their benefit in that eventuality! Allah replied, jfc jl iif 4Perhaps Allah may bring a victory...} referring to the conquering ofMakkah, according to As-Suddi.'2 4or a decision according to His will} requiring the Jews and Christians to pay the Jizyah, as As-Suddi stated, 4 4Then they will become} meaning, the hypocrites who gave their friendship to the Jews and Christians, will become, 'j &4 4for what they have been keeping as a secret in themselves} of allegiances, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 4:1156. At-Jabari 10:405.

iregretful for their friendship with the Jews and Christians which did not benefit them or protect them from any harm. Rather, it was nothing but harm, as Allah exposed their true reality to His faithful servants in this life, although they tried to conceal it. When the signs that exposed their hypocrisy were compiled against them, their matter became clear to Allah s faithful servants. So the believers were amazed at these hypocrites who pretended to be believers, swearing to their faithfulness, yet their claims were all lies and deceit. This is why Allah said, ifckr X iAnd those who believe ivill say, "Are these the men ivto swore their strongest oaths by Allah that they were with you?" All that they did has been in vain, and they have become the losers / yff < ' * *+ A? < '< / {'w / ;> // * V jjjt i (*i* ^ * ti u* It*-* w/jM / * i* P "",** ^ i ^ ^ /* , // " f li ,>* J -up Vj au* J-u- j Jfc * *i* ^ Ch[luij ^ ^ f C U\$J \$ "&& oZ 454. O you who believe! Whoeverfrom among you turns back from his religion (Islam), Allah will bring a people whom He will love and they will love Him; humble towards the believers, stem towards the disbelievers, fighting in the way ofAllah, and never fearing the blame of the blamers. That is the grace of Allah which He bestows on whom He wills. And Allah is All- Sufficientfor His creatures' needs, All-Knower.> 455. Verily, your Protector is Allah, His Messenger, and the believers, those who perform the Saldh, and give Zakdh, and they bow down 456. And whosoever takes Allah, His Messenger, and those who have believed, as protectors, then the party ofAllah will be the victorious.\$

Al-Ma'idah (54 - 56) (Part-6) Threatening to Replace the Believers With Another People ifThey Revert from Islam Allah emphasizes His mighty ability and states that whoever reverts from supporting His religion and establishing His Law, then Allah will replace them with whomever is better, mightier and more righteous in Allah s religion and Law. Allah said in other Ayat, ^ ^ 'jip iAnd if you turn away, He will exchange you for some other people and they will not be your likes.} and. 2A 45 di j #} 4Do you not see that Allah has created the heavens and the earth with truth? IfHe will, He can remove you and bring (in your place) a new creation! And for Alldh that is not hard or difficult.>(14 : 19-20]. Verily this is not difficult or hard on Allah. Allah said here, i#ti VX '\$ \$ > 40 you who believe! Whoeverfrom among you turns backfrom his religion...} and turns back from the truth to falsehood, from now until the commencement of the Last Hour. Allah said next. ihumble towards the believers, stem towards the disbelievers.} These are the qualities of perfect believers, as they are humble with their believing brothers and allies, stem with their enemies and adversaries. In another Ayah, Allah said. ,iZL& %& ZJ} iMuhammad is the Messenger of Alldh. And those who are with him are severe against disbelievers, and merciful among themselves.} The Prophet jg is described as the smiling fighter, smiling to his allies and fighting his enemies. Allah s statement,

ilfj Stfm % if 4 \$>* .} iFighting in the way of Allah, and never fearing the blame of the btamers.} Nothing prevents them from obeying Allah, establishing His Law, fighting His enemies, enjoining righteousness and forbidding evil. Certainly, nothing prevents them from taking this path, neither someone who seeks to hinder them, nor one who blames or chastises them. Imam

4.5-4-*-\$>} iAtid Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All- Knower,\$> His favor is ever extending, and He has perfect knowledge of those who deserve or do not deserve His favor and bounty. Allah s statement, iVerily, your Protector is Allah, His Messenger, and the believers . ..} means, the Jews Eire not your friends. Rather, your allegiance is to Allah, His Messenger and the faithful believers. 4WS& ytrrf SfS '44 ithose who perform lire Saldh, and give the Zakdh ...} referring to the believers who have these qualities and establish the prayer, which is one of the most important pillsirs of Islam, for it includes worshipping Allah alone without partners. They pay Zakdh, which is the right of the creation and a type of help extended to the needy and the poor. As for Allah s statement, iand they bow down,} some people thought that they give the Zakdh while bowing down. If this were the case, then paying the Zakdh while bowing would be the best form of giving Zakdh. No scholar from whom religious rulings Eire tEiken says this, as much as we know. Therefore, 4&i iand they bow down,} means, they attend the prayer in congregation in Allah s Masjids and spend by way of charity on the vEirious needs ofMuslims. Allah said; }Atid whosoever takes Allah, His Messenger, and those who have believed, as protectors, then the party of Allah will be the victorious.}

Kfi&ifc ' 'A ^ similarly Allah said; UJJbj*!*) JJ|" lilj^_j J^iy 0 <^riliV ill! ll^U * V "j-,Jr^P (iji ill -""^jl - r^t P, P^S-vt. 6j "&fp pA\$k -& &Pa*^ J'- S* "% ^Jijto ;1 r^ ,;^ liilluii^ilu^ f\$| LillLtd .1111:6(22 ^ ^ J A Msr^AirL & ir. -irrn^r - ,yJ^iCi ^ f 7^ -* t-'r-'u" Iv m -r > Z"".'&\ *&&> * &si r**\$J ->-\$P=*o p v,., -s t, jUVi^jiliw5^JliJoiJjl .,1 >{. ^ "" , . , , (^c-cii ,r ouL>- p; it cp.\ "A//d/i has decreed: wJjT-'^(MT^ff - i^E Messengers who shall be 4jilUui i^uyjijlIDS //jg victorious. Verily, \$ ^ ,s All-Powerful, "it &> cyki VI ,it 4"> Ji\$! k (^Jj 4 ^ it3* Si II ^ Afwfohiu. You zed/ not find any people who believe in Allah and the Last Day, making friendship with those who oppose Allah and His Messenger, even though they were their fathers or their sons or their brothers or their kindred (people). For such He has written faith in their hearts, and strengthened them with a Ruh (proof) from Himself. And He will admit them to Gardens (Paradise) under which rivers flow to dwell therein (forever). Allah is pleased with them, and they with Him. They are the party ofAllah. Verily, it is the party ofAllah that will be the successful.} Therefore, those who accept the allegiance of Allah - His Messenger and the faithful believers - will gain success in this life and the Hereafter. Hence Allah s statement here, ZM % ip: fcz^ &; p)> iAnd whosoever takes Allah, His Messenger, and those who

have believed, as protectors, then the party of Allah will be the victorious.} M &i CjM & a; :& 13 WsS -5 Ip:\$ % fiS u/ili juSSif JJ "S|3 ^ * & \$5 bj \$35 * -"J" >-iA 457. O you who believe! Do not take as friends those who take your religion for a mockery andfun from those who received the Scriptures before you, and (nor) the disbelievers; and have Tacpoa ofAlldh ifyou indeed are true believers.} 458. And when you proclaim the call for the Saldh, they take it (but) as a mockery and fun; that is because they are a people who understand not.} The ProhibitionofBeingLoyalFriendswith Disbelievers This Ayah discourages and forbids taking the enemies of Islam and its people, such as the People of the Book and the polytheists, as friends. These disbelievers mock the most important acts that any person

could ever perform, the honorable, pure acts of Islam which include all types of good for this life and the Hereafter. They mock such acts and make them the subject of jest and play, because this is what these acts represent in their misguided minds and cold hearts. Allah said; i'M & ifrom those who received the Scriptures before you and (nor) the disbelievers. . .} This is to clarify the particular category (of disbelievers). As Allah said, 4^i 4So shun the evil of the idols...} [22:30] So some recited it Kuff&ri , making it an object of the preposition, and others recited it Kuffara , making it a predicate noun; M par ijji & g;& 'S IAS#

iTake not as friends those who take your religion for a mockery andfunfrom those who received the Scriptures before you . . .) with the meaning of nor . inor the disbelievers as friends That is, do not take these people nor those people as friends. The meaning here of Kuffar" [disbelievers] is idolators. Similarly, Ibn Jarir recorded that in the recitation of Ibn Mas ud [in place of Kuffar" he recited it: and those who commit Shirk . Allah s statement, (o&J Si' ffii) iAnd have Taqwa ofAllah ifyou indeed are true believers means, fear Allah and do not take the enemies of you and your religion as friends, if you believe in Allah s Law and religion that these people mocked and jested about. Allah said in another Ayah, ^ -li > Jji iif iuj JS iLet not the believers take the disbelievers as friends instead of the believers, and whoever does that, will never be helped by Allah in any way, except if you indeed fear a danger from them. And Allah warns you against Himself, and to Allah is thefinal return.) The Disbelievers Mock the Prayer and theAdhan Allah said, jjUJt jj Y>\}) iAnd when you proclaim the call for the Saldh, they take it (but) as a mockery andfun;) When you proclaim the Adhan for the prayer, which is the best action there is, for those who have sound minds and good m At-Tabari 10:430.

comprehension, itthey take it...) also,)as a mockery and fun; tltat is because they are a people who understand not.) the acts of worship and Allah s Law. These are the characteristics of the followers of Shaytan who, lA 'yii jliVl Iil" Jr lili Jilil i jk> #5 -A fJ uj #i tis :i# ijii3 ^Jl .li i"ILJi J>-j liji "W?ten file call for prayer is made, Shaytan takes to his heels passing wind so that he may not hear the Adhan . When the call is finished he comes back, and when the Iqdmah is pronounced, Shaytan again takes to his heels. When the Iqdmah is finished he comes back again and tries to interfere with the person and his thoughts and to say, 'Remember this and that,' which he has not thought of before the prayer, until the praying person forgets how much he has prayed. If anyone of you does not remember, then he should perform two prostrations before pronouncing the Salami This Hadith is agreed upon. Az-Zuhri said, Allah mentioned the Adhan in His Book, J UJj tjjr* UjJid J) iAnd when you proclaim the call for the Saldh, they take it (but) as a mockery and fun; that is because they are a people who understand not.) Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this statement.12 '\$j&1 j'j J>' Uj jyl ~C.j jit, d"U o' VI iL 0_, is ji Al-Bukhari nos. 608, 1222, 1231 and Muslim 1 :291 , 398. 2 Ibn Abi Hatim 4 : 1 164

(*r* ^ -T-^J 4ii\ j* A" x^ . i # dUi ^La \$^j\ J* Ji jj'i fSj'X- \i\j ^V,J^~UI *)"- jt jjj ts3 OydJ' Ju .j OjSl fS "##*& (X c#% 4 > S pi; ^it ijSis i; dir. H)' (H -rt VP *y^ S '=Xb\ t^J=X) o jjJ'j ^ oj*a4 !\$?c^g^jf ^ jU5^ #315 . Say: "O People of the Scripture! Do you criticize us for no other reason than that we believe in AllaJt, and in what has been sent down to us and in that which has been sent down before (us), and that most ofyou are rebellious? } 460. Say: "Shall I inform you of something worse than that,

regarding the recompense from Allah: those who incurred the curse of Allah and His wrath, and those of whom He transformed into monkeys and swine, and those who worshipped Tdghiit; such are worse

in rank, and for more astray from the straight path. } 461. When they come to you, they say: We believe." But in fact they enter with disbelief and they go out with the same. And Allah knows all that they were hiding.} 462. And you see many of them hurrying for sin and transgression, and eating illegal things. Evil indeed is that which they have been doing . 463. Why do not the Rabbdniyyun and the Ahbdr forbid them from uttering sinful words and from eating illegal things. Evil indeed is that which they have been performing. The People of the Book are Enraged at the Believers Because oftheir Faith in Allah Allah commands: Say, O Muhammad, to those who mock and jest about your religion from among the People of the Scriptures, 4, li L>* \Ul jyl U 4Do you criticize us for no other reason than that we believe in Allah, and in what has been sent down to us and in that which has been sent down before (us)?}

Al-Ma'idah (59 - 63) (Part-6) Do you have any criticism or cause of blame for us, other than this? This, by no means, is cause of blame or criticism. Allah said in other Aydt, jyU& A% fc Cji iAnd they had no fault except that they believed in Allah, the Almighty, Worthy ofall praise!) and, i.iiSti fifij 4 J VL iand they could not find any cause to do so except that Allah and His Messenger had enriched them ofHis bounty.)9:74] In an agreed upon Hadith, the Prophet sg said, "5il 1* jIS ji Ml J -"j"- Li *What caused Ibn Jamil to Yanqim (refuse to give Zakdh), although he was poor and Allah made him rich?"[1 Allah s statement, m%) iand that most ofyou are rebellious...) is connected to 4 o-4% 4 tj& a: \$) ithat we believe in Allah, and in that which has been sent down to us and in that which has been sent down before (us.) Therefore, the meaning of this part of the Ayah is: we also believe that most of you are rebellious and deviated from the straight path. The PeopleoftheScripturesDeserve theWorstTorment on the Day ofResurrection Allah said next, i \ JU: M cA- 'fr* > 3*Sfly; "Shall I inform you of something worse than that,

regarding the recompensefrom Allah?")

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1537–1567]

The Ayah commands the Prophet ^ to say: Shall I inform I 1 ' Fath Al-Bari 3 :388 , Muslim 2 :676 .

216 Tafsir Ibn Kathir you about a worse people with Allah on the Day of Resurrection than what you think of us? They are you, with these characteristics, 4* & ithose who incurred the curse of Allah were expelled from His mercy, iand who incurred His wrath) and anger, after which He will never be pleased with them, ithose ofwhotn He transformed into monkeys and swine,) as we mentioned in Surat Al-Baqarah (2) and as we will mention in Surat Al-A'raf (7). Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated that Ibn Mas'ud said, Allah s Messenger sg was asked if the current monkeys and swine were those whom Allah transformed. He said, oS^iSl jjj tQp 'ij 1 1 jiJ "l1 ' Jt Allah never destroyed a people by transforming them and making offspring or descendants for them. The monkeys and swine existed before that.* This was also recorded by Muslim. 121 Allah said, iThose who worshipped Taghiit...) and served them, becoming their servants. The meaning of this Ayah is: you, O People of the Scriptures, who mock our religion, which consists of Allah s Tawhid, and singling Him out in worship without others, how can you mock us while these are your characteristics? This is why Allah said, "a Mushkil Al-Athar 4 :275 Muslim 4:2051.

Al-Ma'idah (59 - 63) -6) is such are worse in rank...} than what you - People of the Scriptures - think of us Muslims, A*- }attdfar more astray from the straight path.} More in the Ayah does not mean that the other party is less astray, but it means that the People of the Scriptures are far astray. In another Ayah, Allah said, ('*V * T > -iv iThe dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose.} The Hypocrites Pretend to be Believers but Hide their Kufr Allah said, / 1 * ^ > / 'jv -1 **J .A-51 ! J"j iWhen they come to you, they say, "We believe." But in fact they enter with (an intention of) disbelief and they go out with the same.} This is the description of the hypocrites, for they pretend to be believers while their hearts hide Kufr. So Allah said; -&j } }But in fact they enter} on you, O Muhammad, iwith disbelief} in their hearts and they depart with Kufr, and this is why they do not benefit from the knowledge they hear from you, nor does the advice and reminder move them. So, } and they go out with the same} meaning, they alone, 4SJ& C %} }and Allah knows all that they were hiding.} Allah knows their secrets and what their hearts conceal, even if they pretend otherwise with His creatures, thus

pretending to be what they are not. Allah, Who has perfect knowledge of the seen and unseen, has more knowledge about the hypocrites than any of His creatures do and He will recompense them accordingly. Allah's statement, iAnd you see many of them (Jews) hurrying for sin and transgression, and eating illegal things. They hurry to devour prohibited and illegal things, still while transgressing against people, unjustly consuming their property through bribes and Riba, V? c 4Evil indeed is that which they have been doing. Indeed, horrible is that which they used to do and the transgression that they committed. Criticizing Rabbis and Learned Religious Men for Giving up on Forbidding Evil Allah said, \ % 6 kill it's 2\$ X) " 4Why do not the Rabbaniyyin and the Ahbdr forbid them from uttering sinful words and from eating illegal things. Evil indeed is that which they have been performing.> meaning why don't the Rabbaniyyun and the Ahbdr forbid them from this evil? The Rabbaniyyun are the scholars who are in positions of authority, while the Ahbdr are the regular scholars. iEvil indeed is that which they have been performing.} referring to the Rabbaniyyun, as Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas, 111 because they abandoned forbidding evil. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Abbas said, There is no Ayah in the Qur'an that has more severe admonition than this Ayah, m At-Jabari 10:450.

C 2?" :Uy ^ jU-Vfj ^WJiy do not the Rabbaniyyun and the Ahbdr forbid them from uttering sinful words and from eating illegal things. Evil indeed is that which they have been performing.} 1 ^ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Yahya bin Ya'mar said, Ali bin Abi Talib once gave a speech, which he started by praising Allah and thanking Him. He then said, O people! Those who were before you were destroyed because they committed sins and the Rabbaniyyun and Ahbar did not forbid them from evil. When they persisted in sin, they were overcome by punishment. Therefore, enjoin righteousness and forbid evil before what they suffered also strikes you. Know that enjoining righteousness and forbidding evil does not reduce the provision or shorten the term of life. ' Imam

Al-Ma'idah (64 - 66) (Part-6) and admitted them to Gardens of pleasure (in Paradise).} 466. And if only they had acted according to the Tawrah, the Injil, and what has (now) been sent down to them from their Lord (the Qur'an), they would surely have gotten provision from above them and from underneath their feet. And among them is a Muqtasid Ummah, but for most of them; evil is their work.} The Jews Say That Allah's Hand is Tied up! Allah states that the Jews, may Allah's continuous curses descend on

them until the Day of Resurrection, describe Him as a miser. Allah is far holier than what they attribute to Him. The Jews also claim that Allah is poor, while they are rich. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah's statement, "The Jews say, "Allah's Hand is tied up.") They do not mean that Allah's Hand is literally tied up. Rather, they mean that He is a miser and does not spend from what He has. Allah is far holier than what they attribute to Him. 111 Similar was reported from Mujahid, Ikrimah, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ad-Dahhak. * Allah said in another Ayah, 'ijS& Ji iii ij} iAnd let not your hand be tied (like a miser) to your neck, nor stretch it forth to its utmost reach (like a spendthrift), so that you become blameworthy and in severe poverty.} In this Ayah, Allah prohibits stinginess and extravagance, which includes unnecessary and improper expenditures. Allah describes stinginess by saying, / * " { til -jbi J"? iAnd let not your hand be tied (like a miser) to your neck.} Therefore, this is the meaning that the Jews meant, mayTabari 10:452.Tabari 10:453.

222 Tafsir Ibt Kathir Allah's curses be on them. Ikrimah said that this Ayah was revealed about Finhas, one of the Jews,111 may Allah curse him. We mentioned before that Finhas said, i"Truly, Allah is poor and we are rich!"} and that Abu Bakr smacked him. Allah has refuted what the Jews attribute to Him and cursed them in retaliation for their lies and fabrications about Him. Allah said, 4Be their hands tied up and be they accursed for what they uttered.} What Allah said occurred, for the Jews are indeed miserly, envious, cowards and tremendously humiliated. Allah said in other Ayat, ms43* 'f&1 Jr. t r. JS4 iOr have they a share in the dominion? Then in that case they would not give mankind even a Naqir. Or do they envy men for what Allah has given them of His bounty? Then, We had already given the family of Ibrahim the Book and the Hikmah, and conferred upon them a great kingdom.} and, i'fol& 4Indignity is put over them.} Allah's Hands are Widely Outstretched Allah said next, 3\$ \ si} iNay, both His Hands are widely outstretched. He spends (of His bounty) as He wills .} Allah's favors are ample, His bounty unlimited, as He owns the treasures of everything. Any good that reaches His At-Tabari 10:153.

servants is from Him alone, without partners. He has created everything that we need by night or by day, while traveling or at home and in all situations and conditions. Allah said, V j5 c U J =" Ji f 4And He gave you of all that you asked for, and if you count the blessings of Allah, never will you be able to count them. Verily, man is indeed an extreme wrongdoer, an extreme ingrate There are many other Ayat on this subject. Imam

Al-Ma'idah (64 - 66) (Part-6) fire of war, Allah extinguishes it and makes their plots turn against them. Therefore, their evil plots will return to harm them. iand they (ever) strive to make mischief on earth. And Allah does not like the mischief-makers.} It is their habit to always strive to cause mischief on the earth, and Allah does not like those with such behavior. Had the People of the Book Adhered to their Book, they Would Have Acquired the Good of this Life and the Hereafter Allah said next, iAnd if only the People of the Scripture had believed and had Tacjiod...} Consequently, had the People of the Book believed in Allah and His Messenger and avoided the sins and prohibitions that they committed; iWe would indeed have expiated for them their sins and admitted them to Gardens of pleasure (in Paradise).} meaning We would have removed the dangers from them and granted them their objectives. <(-> oi ijiul fj} iAnd if only they had acted according to the Tawrdh, the Injil, and what has (now) been sent down to them from their Lord,} meaning, the Qur'an, as Ibn Abbas and others said. 111 ithey would

surely have gotten provision from above them and from underneath theirfeet.} Had they adhered to the Books that they have with them III At-Tabari 10:463.

i O-Xc- "il gill OlAiJl [yC. ^ t'j sir-Q (*r'Qj 0; -U^ !>; iThen We gave the Book as inheritance to such ofOur servants whom We chose. Then ofthem are some who wrong themselves, and of them are some who follow a middle course, and of them are some who, by Alldlt's pertnission, are Sdbiq (foremost) in good deeds. That itself is indeed a great grace. 'Adn (Eden) Paradise (everlasting Gardens) will they enter, therein will they be adorned with bracelets ofgold and pearls, and their garments there will be of silk.>[35:32-33] i% Xi j2 i oli ut 4 Z & Jji# ^ v -it ^iSf ^ . O Messenger! Convey what has been sent down to you from your Lord. And if you do not, then you have not conveyed His Message. Allah will protect you from mankind. Verily, Allah guides not the people who disbelieve Commanding the Prophet to Convey the Message; PromisingHim Immunityand Protection Allah addresses His servant and Messenger Muhammad jg by the title Messenger and commands him to convey all that He has sent him, a command that the Prophet jg has fulfilled in the best manner. Al-Bukhan recorded that A ishah said, Whoever says to you that Muhammad hid any part of what Allah revealed to him, then he is uttering a lie. Allah said. 40 Messenger! Convey what has been sent down to you from your Lord. Al-Bukhari collected the short form of this story here, but mentioned the full narration in another part of his book. Muslim in the Book of /man,Tirmidhi, and An-Nasal in Fath Al-Bari 8: 124. Muslim1:159.

the Book of Tafsir of their Simons also collected this Hadith. In is recorded in the Two Sahihs that A ishah said, If Muhammad hid anything from the Qur an, he would have hidden this Ayah, /> /*< \ ^ > T*-- O' o - s'j ir U iti-e "-'X. 4But you did hide in yourself that which Allah will make manifest, you did fear the people while Allah had a better right that you shouldfear Him> 12 '

meaning: If you do not convey to the people what I sent to you, then you have not conveyed My Message. Meaning, the Prophet knows the consequences of this failure. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, iAnd if you do not, then you have not conveyed His Message It means, if you hide only one Ayah that was revealed to you from your Lord, then you have not conveyed His Message. Allah s statement, UO\ Si UO iAllah will protect you from mankind means, you convey My Message and I will protect, aid and support you over your enemies and will grant you victoiy over them. Therefore, do not have any fear or sadness, for none of them will be able to touch you with harm. Before this Ayah was revealed, the Prophet sgj was being guarded, as Imam

wills,} and, Li!*> -tdc L3J''^ {Your duty is only to convey and on Us is the reckoning.} *a.* &S " a? i\$V&J4 j *> ^ ^t o* uy^ ltj 1/jU t *l* jdt i + >* * .> * _<> 4t /f /. /T (i-* jj >-4?* >-* U^" . Say: "O Peop/e o/ the Scripture! You have nothing till you act according to the Tawrdh, the Injil, and what has (now) been sent down to you from your Lord (the Qur'an). Verily, the revelation that has come to you from your Lord makes many of them increase in rebellion and disbelief. So do not grieve for the people who disbelieve.} i69. Surely, those who believe, and those who are the Jews and the Sabians and the Christians, whosoever believed in Allah and the Last Day, and worked righteousness, on them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve.} There is no Salvation Except through Faith in the Qur an Allah says: O Muhammad, say, 40 People of the Scripture! You have nothing...} meaning no real religion until you adhere to and implement the Tawrdh and the Injfl. That is, until you believe in all the Books that you have that Allah revealed to the Prophets. These Books command following Muhammad and believing

in his prophecy, all the while adhering to his Law. Before, we explained Allah's statement, iVerily, the revelation that has come to you from your Lord makes many of them increase in rebellion and disbelief.}

232 Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr 4So do not grieve for the people who disbelieve>, Do not be sad or taken aback by their disbelief. Allah said next, iSurely, those who believe^ referring to Muslims, 4those who are the Jews} who were entrusted with the Tawrah, 4and the Sabians.. .} a sect from the Christians and Magians who did not follow any particular religion, as Mujahid stated. As for the Christians, they are known and were entrusted with the Injīl. The meaning here is that if each of these groups believed in Allah and the Hereafter, which is the Day of Judgement and Reckoning, and performed good actions, which to be so, must conform to Muhammad's Law, after Muhammad was sent to all mankind and the Jinns. If any of these groups held these beliefs, then they shall have no fear of what will come or sadness regarding what they lost, nor will grief ever affect them. We discussed a similar Ayah before in Surat Al-Baqarah (2:62). ^ />^ * ^ * * A - I y . JU154Jlj J iil jl {j* Lai) l* "jlJl LmL"j" 1 >- "!!? jjij Ut => "5tiy bL*lj j; ..

470. Verily, We took the covenant of the Children of Israel and sent Messengers to them. Whenever there came to them a Messenger with what they themselves desired not, a group of them they called liars, and others among them they killed. 471. They thought there will be no Fitnah (trial or punishment), so they became blind and deaf; after that Allah turned to them (with forgiveness); yet again many of them became blind and deaf. And Allah is the All-Seer of what they do.} Allah reminds that He took the covenant and pledges from the Children of Israel to hear and obey Him and His Messenger. They broke these pledges and covenants and followed their lusts and desires instead of the law, and whichever part of the law they agreed with, they took it. Otherwise, they abandoned it, if it did not conform to their desires. This is why Allah said, X ^ Vi 4Whenever there came to them a Messenger with what they themselves desired not - a group of them they called liars, and others among them they killed. They thought there will be no Fitnah (trial or punishment) so they became blind and deaf.} thinking that they would suffer no repercussions for of the evil that they committed. Consequently, they were blinded from the truth and became deaf, incapable of hearing the truth. For these reasons they were unable to be guided by it. Allah forgave that, then, 4 \f^} 4yet they became blind and deaf} again, C,^ 'if; Jg %L=} 4many of them, and Allah is the All-Seer of what they do.} He has perfect knowledge of what they do and whomever among them deserves the guidance and whomever deserves misguidance.

~i gyyJ* JSj i*' 'jStt JLS UJ jLJji alijU 4J^Jl 4iJ> f>. Juli J r* clj . . ^ a *-*< ' *^ @* oj c sii& 472 . Surely, they have disbelieved who say: Allah is the Messiah [Isa], son of Maryam." But the Messiah said: O Children of Israel! worship Allah, my Lord and your Lord" Verily, whosoever sets up partners (in worship) with Allah, then Allah has forbidden Paradise for him, and the Fire will be his abode. And for the wrongdoers there are no helpers. 473 . Surely, they have disbelieved who say: "Allah is the third of three." And there is no god but One Cod (Allah). And if they cease not from what they say, verily, a painful torment will befall on the disbelievers among them.} i74. Will they not repent to Allah and ask His forgiveness? For Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 475 . The Messiah [Isa], son of Maryam, was no more than a Messenger; many were the Messengers that passed away before him.

His mother [Maryam] was a Siddiqah. They both used to eat food. Look how We make the Ayat clear to them; yet look how they are deluded away (from the truth).} The Disbelief of the Christians; !sa Only called to Tawhid Allah states that the Christians such sects as Monarchite, Jacobite and Nestorite are disbelievers, those among them who say that Isa is Allah. Allah is far holier than what they attribute to Him. They made this claim in spite of the fact that Isa made it known that he was the servant of Allah and His Messenger. The first words that Isa uttered when he was still a baby in the cradle were, I am Abdullah (the servant of Allah). He did not say, I am Allah, or, I am the son of

Al-Ma'idah (72 - 75) (Part-6 Allah. Rather, he said. "!">' JLC 4Verily , I am a servant of Allah, He has given me the Scripture and made me a Prophet . until he said, -k tii UJ-ili i"Attid verily Allah is my Lord and your Lord. So worship Him (Alone). That is the straight path. } He also proclaimed to them when he was a man, after he was sent as a Prophet, commanding them to worship his Lord and their Lord, alone without partners, 4A *k !M;; j;& '&)> iBut the Messiah said, "O Children of Israel! worship Allah, my Lord and your Lord. Verily, whosoever sets up partners with Allah . . . \$> in worship; H\3 iliif fS % ^ i-. then Allah has forbidden Paradise for him, and the Fire will be his abode. as He will send him to the Fire and forbid Paradise for him. Allah also said; iVerily, Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with Him (in worship), but He forgives except that (anything else) to whom He wills> and, iAnd the dwellers of the Fire will call to the dwellers of Paradise; "Pour on us some water or anything that Allah has provide you with. They will say: "Allah has forbidden both to the disbelievers

Al-Ma'idah (72 - 75) (Part-6) Allah replied, 4VS % i\$! Jt^} iBut there is no god but One God.} meaning there are not many worthy of worship but there is only One God without partners, and He is the Lord of all creation and all that exists. Allah said next, while threatening and admonishing them, // I s f ^ \ i/ they cease not from what they say,} their lies and false claims, m Xk Ukk} iverily, a painful torment will befall the disbelievers among them.} in the Hereafter, shackled and tormented. Allah said next, S * i' &} iWill they not repent to Allah and ask His Forgiveness? For Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} This demonstrates Allah s generosity, kindness and mercy for His creatures, even though they committed this grave sin and invented such a lie and false allegation. Despite all of this, Allah calls them to repent so that He will forgive them, for Allah forgives those who sincerely repent to Him. Isa is Allah s Servant and His Mother is a Truthful Believer Allah said, Vi^ VL V Vi V* c-iif& iThe Messiah, son of Maryam, was no more than a Messenger; many were the Messengers that passed away before him.} Isa is just like the previous Prophets, and he is one of the servants of Allah and one of His honorable Messengers. Allah said in another Ayah, V 3j ji j\} iHe ['Isa] was not more than a servant. We granted Our favor

to him, and We made him an example for the Children of Israel. Allah said next, iHis mother was a Siddiqahfy for she believed in Allah with complete trust in Him. This is the highest rank she was given, which proves that she was not a Prophet. Allah said next, 4They both used to eat food\$ needing nourishment and to relieve the call of nature. Therefore, they are just servants like other servants, not may Allah s continued curses cover them until the Day of Resurrection. Allah said next, ^ aasms a ^ \jJc- j4 I(J-atsJ5 \ J jIS^jWly 1 ^ /> / > / < . ^ j.jlio^U.'lc-, jj _\$y^= ' 1-3- -* ^ li J ^fjfiL""^pA)j zx #Ujlp-AjaJ"ilU > ilg ^uajlSU^Li^yjlLi^LiU OJj^== l _^l) J J^Sa-O-13 gods as ignorant Christian sects claim, 4cr0\ 4Look how We make the Ayat clear to them ^ making them unequivocal and plain, 4yet

look how they are deluded away (from the truth). look at the opinions, misguided ideas, and claims they cling to, even after Our clarification and plain, unequivocal explanation. yt iifj L"3i Vj p^=t3 V C jjif v^Jji W fA 1 Vj 0"J' JI-t j i V is=Jl J_*s j" . Y'1

& ijky i^=,bk# jJi o; ijLi JLi . Say: "How do yo" worship besides Allah something which has no power either to harm or to benefit you? But it is Allah Who is the All-Hearer, All-Knower. } 477. Say: "O People of the Scripture! Exceed not the limits in your religion beyond the truth, and do not follow the vain desires of people who went astray before and who misled many, and strayed (themselves) from the right path. } The Prohibition of Shirk (Polytheism) and Exaggeration in the Religion Allah admonishes those who take up rivals with Him and worship the idols, monuments and false deities. Allah states that such false deities do not deserve any degree of Divinity. Allah said, 43*Say} O Muhammad, to those from among the Children of Adam, such as the Christians, who worship other than Allah, 4 Z% 4How do you worship besides Allah something which has no power either to harm or to benefit you?} meaning, which cannot prevent harm for you nor bring about your benefit, 4But it is Allah Who is the All-Hearer, All-Knower.} He hears what His servants say and has knowledge of all things. Therefore, how did you worship inanimate objects that do not hear, see or know anything - having no power to bring harm or benefit to themselves let alone others - instead of worshipping Allah? Allah then said, / " / j/ ">, , i > t / / / ^ , > 4Say : "O People of the Scripture! Exceed not the limits in your religion beyond the truth, }

Meaning: Do not exceed the limits concerning the truth and exaggeration in praising whom you were commanded to honor. You exaggerated in his case and elevated him from the rank of Prophet to the rank of a god. You did this with Isa, who was a Prophet, yet you claimed that he is god besides Allah. This error occurred because you followed your teachers, the advocates of misguidance who came before your time and who, 4...and who misled many, and strayed (themselves) from the right path, } deviated from the straight path, to the path of misguidance and deviation. IL eU'i S; [*y^=" -dsf} U ^ Y VA, C. u lj- ~c- ZZ C Sil 1^=* Si' ^ ^ \$ jlj A |S" iif -L> J , \$ Sgfj iujl (Ujiilf u& i tj it 47S. 77iose among the Children of Israel who disbelieved were cursed by the tongue of Dawud and 'Isa, son of Maryam. Tltat was because they disobeyed (Allah and the Messengers) and were ever transgressing (beyond the bounds).} 479. They used not to forbid one another from the evil tley committed. Vile indeed was what they used to do.} 480. You see many of them taking the disbelievers as their friends. Evil indeed is that which they have sent forward before themselves ; for tlmt (reason) Allah is wrath with them, and in torment they will abide.} 481. And had tley believed in Allah, and in the Prophet and in what has been revealed to him, never would they have taken them as friends; but many of them are rebellious.} Allah Cursed the Disbelievers Among the Children of Israel Allah states that He has cursed the disbelievers among the Children of Israel long ago, and revealed this fact to His

Dawud and Isa, son of Maryam. He cursed them because they disobeyed Allah and transgressed against His creatures. Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, They were cursed in the Tawrah, the Injll, the Zabur (Psalms) and the Furqan (Qur an). Allah then states that during their time, their habit was that, iThey used not to forbid one another from the evil they committed.} They did not forbid each other from committing sins and the prohibitions. Allah chastised them for this behavior, so that their behavior would not be imitated. Allah said, ^Li} iVile indeed was what they used to do.} Hadiths that Order

Enjoining Righteousness and Forbidding Evil There are many Hadiths that order enjoining righteousness and forbidding evil. Imam

244 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir miJj iiSBMS " XiK ./ wSWfs Ss*s" <*> i",v/ flp Ctoclxi!I^f_jj"3 liJJJii-JaJl ife&sys\$ s8j2Ec4^i^v)i".4j 5J it i_ji5(J 3 %) tin torment they will abided on the Day of Resurrection. Allah s statement, **\ |>*\|^=" SJj^ a 4l -J^l fcj^ ^iUjI ^jjl^i Alll JUtWfjicA <% 4A"d had they believed in Allah, and in the Prophet and in what has been revealed to him, never would they have taken them as friends. meaning, had they sincerely believed in Allah, His Messenger and the Qur an, they would not have committed the evil act of supporting the disbelievers in secret and being enemies with those who believe in Allah, the Prophet jg and what was revealed to him, W &. M> 4but many of them are rebellious disobedient to Allah and His Messenger and defiant of the Ayat of His revelation that He sent down. i-k-jjJj L y& v^J'j ijQi \$, iySS oflti iii ojL \$5-^ > t ; ot IjLil* ij^j 5a> G* gfjl'" d 4 J>' t- ii|S V ^hh'j UiL l*_ " V l3 l U Hil; b!_, ojljij <^ '(y, !\$fi i &&%U^ |2; GLjI 12; ^fS < i*i =; ojifj Sj - ^iVi t sfj. jl (tSCHbl

killJjl T:ViL 482 . Verily, you will find the strongest among men in enmity to the believers the Jews and those who commit Shirk, and you will find the nearest in love to the believers those who say : "We are Christians." That is because among them are priests and monks, and they are not proud.} 483. And when they listen to what has been sent down to the Messenger, you see their eyes overflowing with tears because of the truth they have recognized. They say: "Our Lord! We believe; so write us down among the witnesses."} 484. "And why should we not believe in Allah and in that which has come to us of the truth? And we wish that our Lord will admit us along with the righteous people."} 485. So because of what they said, Allah awarded them with Gardens under which rivers flow, they will abide therein forever. Such is the reward ofgood-doers .} 486. But those who disbelieved and belied Our Ayat, they shall be the dwellers ofHell.}

The Reason Behind Revealing these Ayat

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1567–1597]

Said bin Jubayr, As-Suddi and others said that these Ayat were revealed concerning a delegation that An-Najashi (King of Ethiopia) sent to the Prophet jg in order to hear his words and observe his qualities. When the delegation met with the Prophet and he recited the Qur an to them, they embraced Islam, cried and were humbled. Then they returned to An-Najashi and told him what happened. 11 Ata bin Abi Rabah commented, They were Ethiopians who embraced Islam when the Muslims who migrated to Ethiopia resided among them. Qatadah said, They were some followers of the religion of Isa, son ofMaryam, who when they saw Muslims and heard the Qur an, they became Muslims without hesitation. 12 Ibn Jarir said that these Ayat were revealed concerning some people who fit this description, whether they were from Ethiopia or otherwise. Allah said,Tabari 10:499,500.Tabari 10:501.

iVerily, you will find the strongest among men in enmity to the believers the Jews and those who commit Shirk,} This describes the Jews, since their disbelief is that of rebellion, defiance, opposing the truth, belittling other, people and degrading the scholars. This is why the Jews - may Allah s continued curses descend on them until the Day of Resurrection - killed many of their Prophets and tried to kill

the Messenger of Allah [^] several times, as well as, performing magic spells against him and poisoning him. They also incited their likes among the polytheists against the Prophet Allah's statement, and you will find the nearest in love to the believers those who say: "We are Christians."} refers to those who call themselves Christians, who follow the religion of the Messiah and the teachings of his Injil. These people are generally more tolerant of Islam and its people, because of the mercy and kindness that their hearts acquired through part of the Messiah's religion. In another Ayah, Allah said; *Vj O'j i* And We ordained in the hearts of those who followed him, compassion, mercy, and monasticism . .> [57:27]. In their book is the saying; He who strikes you on the right cheek, then turn the left cheek for him. And fighting was prohibited in their creed, and this is why Allah said, *l* intended by it should be clear to the reader. However, the remainder of the Ayah, which can be translated as ; *4*that they invented which We did not prescribe for them.} (referring to monasticism) obviously contradicts Ibn Kathir's objective here. He himself discusses this issue shortly, as well as at the end of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Hadid., as will appear later, if Allah wills.

*i*That is because among them are Qissin (priests) and Ruhban (monks), and they are not proud. This means that among them are Qissin (priests). The word Ruhban refers to one dedicated to worship. Allah said, *i*That is because among them are priests and monks, and they are not proud. This describes them with knowledge, worship and humbleness, along with following the truth and fairness. *44^' Oi gfJlf JI ^ 'j 4*And when they listen to what has been sent down to the Messenger, you see their eyes overflowing with tears because of the truth they have recognized> This refers to the good news that they have about the advent of Muhammad jfe, ics^Lii ^ \lj *i*They say: "Our Lord! We believe; so write us down among the witnesses/y who testify to the truth and believe in it. ^ CL1 J -p tit; Cj it ! y u 6> *i*"And why should we not believe in Allah and in that which has come to us of the truth? And We wish that our Lord will admit us (in Paradise) along with the righteous people '> Such sect of Christians are those mentioned in Allah's statement, *i*And there are, certainly, among the People of the Scripture, those who believe in Allah and in the Truth which has been revealed to you, and in that which has been revealed to them, humbling themselves before Allah.\$>[3:199] and, *1 UX tjlte 'pfl !*" A* j?*

*4*Those to whom We gave the Scripture before it, they believe in it (the Qur'an). And when it is recited to them, they say, "We believe in it. Verily, it is the truth from our Lord. Indeed even before it we were Muslims/wis">[28:52-53), until, *4*"We seek not the ignorant.">[28:55] This is why Allah said here, *Uj iuif)+ \$)* *4*So because of what they said, Allah awarded them...) rewarding them for embracing the faith and recognizing and believing in the truth, "*Jri > ^ ot 4*Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise), they will abide therein forever.) and they will never be removed from it, for they will dwell and remain in it forever and ever, *4*Such is the reward of good-doers) who follow the truth and obey it wherever, whenever and with whomever they find it. Allah then describes the condition of the miserable. *UMft 4*But those who disbelieved and belied Our Ayat,) defied and opposed them, *4^"& 4*they shall be the dwellers of the (Hell) Fire.) For they are the people of the Fire who will enter and reside in it (eternally). if-. *V 'ifS f#Js %P if ja C v \ X <*kft *& alf 'if f 3tjtf &- ifpZ* in 487. O you who believe! Make not unlawful the good things

/ fast and break my fast, pray and sleep, and marry women. Whoever follows my Sunnah is of me, and whoever abandons my Sunnah is not of me. Ibn Abi Hatim also collected this Hadith. Ibn Mardawayh

recorded that Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas narrated a similar Hadith. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that A islah said that some of the Companions asked the wives of the Prophet jg about the acts of worship that he performed in private. One of them said, I will not eat meat, another said, I will not many women, while the third said, I will not sleep on the bed.

Al-Ma'idah (89) (Part-7) iand have Taqwa ofAllah in Whom you believe. ,233 o^vt^ c 4=4* jCij -j 4ft # 4 4 > * > 4,4 4 f uji-jis C -k~4 j5^ * iyi j&S iit 4sT jfcg ii : 4 4-i# i&i . /W/o/i un// not punish you for what is unintentional in your oaths, but He will punish you for your deliberate oaths; for its expiation feed ten poor, on a scale of the Awsat of that with which you feed your own families; or clothe them; or free a slave. But whosoever cannot afford, then he should fast for three days. That is tlte expiation for the oaths when you have sworn. And protect your oaths. Thus Allah makes clear to you His Ayat that you may be grateful Unintentional Oaths We mentioned the subject of unintentional oaths in Surat Al-Baqarah, all praise and thanks are due to Allah, and so we do not need to repeat it here. We also mentioned that the Laghw in oaths refers to one s saying, No by Allah, or, Yes, by Allah, unintentionally. Expiation for Breaking the Oaths Allah said, ibut He will punish you for your deliberate oaths.} in reference to the oaths that you intend in your hearts, f l ifor its expiation (a deliberate oath) feed ten poor,}, who are needy, not able to find necessities of the life. Allah s statement, Si} ion a scale of the Awsat of that with which you feed your own families;} means, On the average scale of what you feed your families. -

according to Ibn Abbas, Said bin Jubayr and Ikrimah . 111 Ata Al-Khurasani commented on the Ayah, From the best ofwhat you feed your families .121 Allah s statement, a} ior clothe them,} refers to clothing each of the ten persons with what is suitable to pray in, whether the poor person was male or female. Allah knows best. Al- Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Ayah means a robe or garment for each poor person (of the ten).13' Mujahid also said that the least of clothing, referred to in the Ayah, is a garment, and the most is whatever you wish . Al-Hasan, Abu Ja'far Al-Baqir, Ata , Tawus, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Hammad bin Abi Sulayman and Abu Malik said that it means (giving each of the ten poor persons) a garment each.15* Allah s statement, ior free a slave} refers to freeing a believing slave. In the Muwatta of Malik, the Musnad of Ash-Shafil and the Sahih of

. is easier than giving > s' >'.* / * >' away clothes, and ^ jcJljp'blj-y giving away clothes is i jkj\jSW->\jii\UliVIS^Qc.^ easier than freein8 a , i . slave. If one is unable i~~ ^ '(< ' to fulfill any of these options, then he fasts 7 l , for three days for expiation, just as e jjzxiaf ,t Allah said, juillljbil' jyv'-te-43iiU i ^tf

iAnd protect your oaths ^ Do not leave your broken oaths without paying the expiation for them, according to the meaning given by Ibn Jarir. iThus Allah makes clear to you His Aydt} and explains them to you, 4that you may be grateful. fix pfts iuVe jar Gi \p: sir j* (5-Luj j iylUt ^ J SllliJi i_"J" l2) lyixU ^Jy jji ijjiitj Jy-J' }jL2)f jfcj jll Li ft*- [_cj iyjii S-rJ' Lit 44 JS5 \$ j ! j <\$? c^iJi ijU; usr c 4 490. O you who believe! Khamr, Maysir, Ansdb, and Azlam are a Rijs of Shaytan s handiwork. So avoid that in order that you may be successful.} 492 . Shaytan wants only to excite enmity and hatred between you with Khamr and Maysir, and hinder you from the remembrance ofAllah andfrom the Salah (the prayer). So, will you not then abstain?} 492. And obey Allah and obey the Messenger, and beivare. Then if you turn away, you should know that it is Our Messenger's duty to convey in the clearest way.} 493. Those

who believe and do righteous good deeds, there is no sin on them for what they ate, if they have Taqwa and believe and do righteous good deeds, and they (again) have Taqwa and believe, and then (once again) have Taqwa and perform good. And Allah loves the good-doers.} Prohibiting Khamr (Intoxicants) and Maysir (Gambling) Allah forbids His believing servants from consuming Khamr and Maysir which is gambling. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that in At-Tabari 10:560,562.

Abu Talib, the Leader of the Faithful, said that chess is of fabling.' Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Mujahid and Jawus, or, two of them, said that every type of gambling, including children's playing with (a certain type of) nuts is Maysir. Ibn Umar said that Al-Maysir means gambling and this is the same statement that Ad-Dahhak reported from Ibn Abbas, who added, They used to gamble there { dhUyyah } until Islam came. Allah then forbade them from this evil behavior. Meaning of Ansab and Azlam M-Ansa were altar stones, in whose vicinity sacrifices were offered (during the time of Jahiliyyah), according to Ibn Abbas through the words of Jubayr and 'Hasan. They also said that Af-Azla/n were arrows that they used for lotteries to make decisions, as Ibn Abi Hatim narrated. Allah said, 4A Rijs of Shaytan's handiwork} meaning, abomination of Shaytan's handiwork, according to Abu Talib bin Jubayr said that Rijs means sin (6) while Zayd bin Aslam said; An evil handiwork of Shaytan. So avoid that} avoid all of these abominations, {in order that you may be successful.} and this is a statement of encouragement. Allah said next, May such saying, through all of its routes, is not authentically attributable to him, may Allah be pleased with him ' At-Tabari 4:322,323. Tabari 4:325. Tabari 4:324. Is! At-Tabari 10:565. At-Tabari 4:330. 17 * At-Tabari 10:565.

ji' Ji o j~fA) j 'tyxji j4y_ J jiiLili i!5 }" / .*>'1 >\ *'<.* " T " J+> o*j iShaytan wants only to excite enmity and hatred between you with Khamr (intoxicants) and Maysir (gambling), and hinder you from the remembrance of Allah and from the Salat (the prayer). So, will you not then abstain?} This is a threat and a warning. Hadiths that Prohibit Khamr (Intoxicants) Imam

vi + * > s/ iThose who believe and do righteous good deeds, there is no sin on them for what they ate...> [5:93], until the end of the Ayah. The Prophet (s) said, U5 IjS? tX* > Had they been made impermissible for them, they would have abandoned them as you have abandoned them .

Khamr clear to us. Then, the Ayah in Surat Al-Ma'idah [5:91] was revealed, and Umar was summoned and it was recited to him. When he reached the part of the Ayah that reads, iSo, will you not then abstain?^[5:91], Umar said, We abstained, we abstained. 111

heralded, and Abu Talhah ordered me to see what it was about. So I found that a person was announcing that alcoholic drinks had been prohibited. Abu Talhah ordered me to go out and spill the wine. I went out and spilled it, and it flowed in the streets of Al-Madinah. Some people said, Some people were killed and wine was still in their stomachs. Later on, Allah's revelation came, iThose who believe and do righteous good deeds, there is no sin on them for what they ate...>[5:93]. Ibn Jarir recorded that Anas bin Malik said, I was serving Abu Talhah, Abu Ubaydah bin Al-Jarrah, Abu Dujanah, Mu'adh bin Jabal and Suhayl bin Bayda, until they became intoxicated from an alcoholic drink made of mixed unripe and normal dates. Then I heard someone herald, Khamr has been made illegal. So no one went in or out until we spilled the alcohol and broke its barrels. Some of us then performed ablution and others took a

shower, and we wore some perfume. We then went out to the Masjid while the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was reciting, & k Sf? js; at \-p: si; 40 you who believe! Khamr, Maysir, Ansab, and Azl^{dm} are only an abomination of Shaytan's handiwork. So avoid that...>[5:90], until, it iSo, zoill you not then abstain?: 91]. A man asked, O Allah s Messenger! What about those who died drinking it? Allah sent down the verse. $\text{i}\backslash\text{yUq}$ iff ijLi ; $\backslash\text{jx}^{\wedge}\text{i}$; & iThose who believe and do righteous good deeds, there is no sin on them for what they ate.}[5:93]. {2 ' FathAl-Bari 5:133, Muslim 3:1570. At-Tabari 10:578.

. 1_ . * i ; . I e old JS\j 4a3] tUj-plpJ l "ifea aTen matters related to Khamr were cursed. Khamr itself was cursed, whoever drinks it, its server, seller, buyer, brewer, who asks for it to be brewed, whoever carries it, whomever it is carried to and whoever consumes its priced

they were better, while Quraysh (the Muhajirin) said that they were better. So a man from the Ansar took a bone and struck Sa'd s nose with it and made a flesh wound on it. Ever since that happened, Sa'd s nose had a scar from that wound. The Ayah, $\text{ilntoxicants gambling,}$ until, 4So, will you not then abstain?} was later revealed.

a? 4v*- 44 4-4 4* P 4^ ^ j uWhoever drinks Khamr in the life of this world and does not repent from it, will be deprived of it in the Hereafter .

Khamr was prohibited, some people said, O Allah s Messenger! What about our brethren who died while still drinking Khamr? Allah sent down the Ayah j -V'dIU'l ijLij dl/jj' iThose who believe and do righteous good deeds, there is no sin on than for what they ate,} until the end of the Ayah. When the Qiblah (direction of the prayer) was changed (from Jerusalem to Makkah), some people asked, O Allah s Messenger! What about our brethren who died while still praying toward Jerusalem? Allah sent down, j} 4And Allah would never make your faith to be lost.> (2: 143)m Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that the Prophet said when the Ayah, c \i[ryiq \pc & } iThose who believe and do righteous good deeds, there is no sin on them for what they ate, if they have Taqwd, and believe...} was revealed, "p oil JJ8 '/' was told, that you are among them .b This is the narration that Muslim, At-Tirmidhi and An- Nasal¹²¹ collected. M S 'if pcs, pJ fa SS\$ St -iH if)\$X f fe> \ S pi&& * iip: iif ifk mz ssz ^ & Csp sc& .4,p j4 P& S'> j*, f- iii jCj ojJj viU'j Jj* f ;JaT y> x?^ ^ m Ahmad 1:295. f2 ' Muslim 4:1910, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:419, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra

494. O you who believe! Allah will certainly make a trial for you with something in the game that is well within reach of your hands and your lances, that Allah may test who fears Him in the unseen. Then whoever transgresses thereafter, for him there is a painful torment.} 495. O you who believe! Kill not game while you are in a state of Ihram, and whosoever of you kills it intentionally, the penalty is an offering, brought to the Ka'bah, of livestock equivalent to the one he killed, as adjudged by two just men among you; or, for expiation, he slwuld feed the poor, or its equivalent in fasting, that he may taste the heaviness (punishment) of his deed. Allah has forgiven what is past, but wlwsoever commits it again, Allah will take retribution from him. And Allah is Almighty, All-Able ofRetribution.} Prohibiting Hunting Game in the Sacred Area and During the State ofIhram [*Ali bin Abi Talhah] Al-Walibi said that Ibn Abbas said that Allah s statement, 'fiJ 4Alldh will certainly make a trial for you with something in (the matter of) the game that is well within reach ofyour hands and your lances,}[5:94], refers to, The weak and young game. Allah tests His servants with such game during their Ihram, that if they wish,

they would be able to catch it with their hands. Allah has commanded them to avoid catching it. * Mujahid said that, {well within reach of your hands} refers to the young game and chicks, while {close and your lances,} refers to mature game. * Muqatil bin Hayyan said that this Ayah was revealed during the Umrah of Tabari 10:584. * At-Tabari 10:583.

1 Therefore, Allah tests His servants with the game that comes near their camping area, for if they wish, they can catch it with their hands and spears in public and secret. This is how the obedience of those who obey Allah in public and secret becomes apparent and tested. In another Ayah, Allah said; 4, 'U sA> bj

Five are Fawdsiq, they may be killed while in Ihram or not the crow, the kite, the scorpion, the mouse and the rabid dogM Ibn Umar narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, jjiJl lOjldJlj II jAxi\j

The Penalty of Killing Game in the Sacred Area or in the State of Ihram Allah said, J1* l* '>>' j*JT \$Atid whosoever of you kills it intentionally, the penalty is [an offering of] livestock equivalent to the one he killed. Mujahid bin Jabr said, The meaning of intentionally here is that one intends to kill the game while forgetting that he is in the state of Ihram. Whoever intentionally kills the game while aware that he is in the state of Ihram, then this offense is more grave than to make an expiation, and he also loses his Ihram This statement is odd, and the view of majority is that they have to pay the expiation for killing the game whether they forgot that they are in Ihram or not. Az-Zuhri said, The Book (the Qur'an) asserts the expiation for intentional killing, and the Sunnah included those who forget, as well."121 The meaning of this statement is that the Qur'an mentioned the expiation and sin of those who intentionally kill game, -t- Cf- 4iil tti y ithat he may taste the heaviness (punishment) of his deed. Allah has forgiven what is past, but whosoever commits it again, Allah will take retribution from him.} the Sunnah that includes the rulings issued by the Prophet jg and his Companions, indicated the necessity of expiation in cases of unintentional killing of game, just as the Book legislated expiation for intentional killing. Killing game is a form of waste, which requires expiation in intentional and unintentional cases, although those who intend it have sinned, rather than those who made an honest error. Allah's statement, iJii j4 :i> iThe penalty is [an offering of] livestock equivalent to the one he killed.}Tabari 11 :8. At-Tabari 11:11.

indicates the necessity of offering an equivalent animal to the one the Muhrim killed. The Companions gave rulings that the camel, for instance, is the equivalent of the ostrich, the cow is the equivalent of wild cattle, and the goat for the deer. As for the cases when there is no equivalent for the killed animal, Ibn Abbas said that one should spend its amount in Makkah (i.e. charity), as Al-Bayhaqi recorded. Allah's statement, iAs adjudged by two just men among you;} means, two just

269Siiralt 5. Al-Md'ida}i (94 - 95) (Part-7) that is, if the Muhrim does not find an equivalent to what he killed, or the animal hunted is not comparable to anything else. Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, "L'C, 4-S& i id, VJZ i Cz) 4...an offering brought to the Ka bah, or, for expiation, he should feed the poor, or its equivalent in fasting .> If the Muhrim killed game, then his judgement is its equivalent. If he kills an antelope, he offers a sheep slaughtered in Makkah. If he cannot, then he feeds six poor people, otherwise he should fast for three days. If he kills a deer, he offers a cow. If unable, he feeds twenty poor people, or otherwise if unable, he fasts for twenty days. If

he kills an ostrich or zebra, he offers a camel, or he feeds thirty poor people, or fasts thirty days. Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir recorded this statement, and in Ibn Jarir's narration, the food measurement is a Mudd (4 handfuls of food) each that suffices for the poor. Allah's statement, "that he may taste the heaviness (punishment) of his deed." means, We have required him to pay this expiation so that he tastes the punishment of his error, "And Allah has forgiven what is past." during the time of Jdhiliyyah, provided that one becomes good in Islam and follows Allah's Law, all the while avoiding the sin. Allah then said, "but whoever commits it again, Allah will take retribution from him." meaning, whoever does this after it has been prohibited in Islam and having knowledge that it is prohibited, m At-Tabari 11:31

Allah will take retribution from him. And Allah is Almighty, All-Able of retribution.} Ibn Jurayj said, I said to Ata, What is the meaning of, "Allah has forgiven what is past." He said, Meaning, during the time of Jdhiliyyah. I asked about, "but whoever commits it again, Allah will take retribution from him." He said, Whoever commits this offense again in Islam, then Allah will take retribution from him and he also has to pay the expiation. I asked, Is there any punishment for repeating this offense that you know of? He said, No. I said, Do you think that the authorities should punish him? He said, No, for it is a sin that he committed between him and Allah. He should pay the expiation. Ibn Jarir recorded this statement. It was said that the Allah will take retribution refers to the expiation, according to Sa'ad bin Jubayr, Ata, and the majority among the earlier and later generations. They stated that when the Muhrim kills game, the expiation becomes necessary, regardless of whether it was the first, second or third offense, and whether intentional or by error. Ibn Jarir commented on Allah's statement; "And Allah is Almighty, All-Able of retribution." Allah says that He is invincible in His control, none can resist Him, prevent Him from exacting retribution from anyone, or stop Him from punishing anyone. This is because all creation is His creation and the decision is His, His is the might, and His is the control. His statement, At-Tabari 11:48. 2| At-Tabari 11:50.

All-Able of retribution.)> meaning, He punishes those who disobey Him for their disobedience of Him. Lawful to you is water game and its use for food -for the benefit of yourselves and those who travel, but forbidden is (the pursuit of) land game as long as you are in a state of Ihram. And have Taqwa of Allah to Whom you shall be gathered back. Allah has made the Ka'bah, the Sacred House, an asylum of security and benefits for mankind, and also the Sacred Month and the animals of offerings and the garlanded, that you may know that Allah has knowledge of all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth, and that Allah is the All-Knower of each and everything. At-Tabari 11:57.

As-Suddi and others. Imam Malik bin Anas recorded that Jabir bin Abdullah said, Allah's Messenger sent an army towards the east coast and appointed Abu Ubaydah bin Al-Jarrah as their commander, and the army consisted of three hundred men, including myself. We marched on until we reached a place where our food was about to finish. Abu Ubaydah ordered us to collect all the food for our journey, and it was collected in two bags of dates. Abu Ubaydah kept on giving us our daily ration in small amounts from it, until it was exhausted. The share of each of us used to be one date only. (one of the narrators

from Jabir) said, How could one date suffice for you? Jabir replied, We came to know its value when even that finished. Jabir added, When we reached the seashore, we saw a huge fish which was like a small mountain. The army ate from it for eighteen days. Then Abu Ubaydah ordered that two of its ribs be affixed in the ground. Then he ordered that a she-camel be ridden, and it passed under the two ribs (forming an arch) without touching them. 121 This Hadith was also collected in the Two Sahths)3 ^ Malik recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, A man asked Allah's Messenger, O Allah's Messenger! We go to sea and carry little water with us. If we use it for Wudu, we get thirsty, so should we use seawater for Wudu? The Messenger of Allah jg said, Its water is pure and its dead are lawful, 141 The two Imams, Ash-Shafi'i and

Hunting Land Game is Prohibited During Ihram Allah said, U ^if Aji fQ. ibut forbidden is land game as long as you are in a state of Ihram.> Therefore, hunting land game during Ihram is not allowed, and if someone who is in the state of ihram hunts, he will have to pay expiation, along with the sin he earns if he does it intentionally. If he hunts by mistake, he will have to pay the expiation and is not allowed to eat from it, because this type of game is just like dead animals, be he a Muhrim or a non- Muhrim. If someone who is not in the state of Ihram hunts and gives the food to a Muhrim, the Muhrim is not allowed to eat from its meat if it was killed for him in particular. As-Sah bin Jathth&mah said that he gave a zebra as a gift to the Prophet M in the area of Waddan or Abwa, the Prophet jg gave it back. When the Prophet saw the effect of his returning the gift on As-Sah's face, he said, uf id* ll J jj up aWe only gave it back to you because we are in a state of Ihram. This Hadith was collected in the Two Sahxhs.ll] The Prophet thought that As-Sah hunted the zebra for him, and this is why he refused to take it. Otherwise, the Muhrim is allowed to eat from the game if one who is not in Ihram hunts it. For when Abu Qatadah hunted a zebra when he was not a Muhrim and offered it to those who were in the state of Ihram, they hesitated to eat from it. They asked the Messenger of Allah jg and he said, Ji jU-1 'fh* l>\s Jin Did any of you point at it or help kill it?" They said, No. He said, m A1 Bukhari no. 1825,2573, Muslim 2:850.

Al-Ma'utah Oft) - 99) (Purl-7) I uThen cat,'> and he also ate from it. This Hadith is also in the Two Sahths with various wordings.' [Ibn Kathlr only mentioned Ayat 96 to 99 here and explained the better part of Ayah number 96, but he did not mention

the explanation of the rest of that Ayah or the other Ayat (97

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1597–1630]

to 99). This is the case in all of the copies of his Tafsir in existence, and he might have forgotten to do that, for it is less likely that all who copied this book forgot to copy only this part. So we used a summary of the Tafsir of these Ayat from the Imam of Tafsir, Ibn Jarir At-Tabari. We tried to summarize At-Tabari's eloquent words to the best of our ability, by Allah's help and leave.] iAnd have Taqiva of Allah to Whom you shall be gathered back.} Allah says, fear Allah, O people, and beware of His might, by obeying what He commands you and avoiding what He prohibits for you in these Ayat revealed to your Prophet Hg. These Ayat forbid Khamr, gambling, Al-Ansab and Al-Azlam, along with hunting land game and killing it while in the state of Ihram. To Allah will be your return and destination, and He will punish you for disobeying Him and will reward you for obeying Him. iJi \2j '(\$ szit & fc-) iAllah

has made the Ka'bah, the Sacred House, an asylum of security and benefits for mankind,} Allah says, Allah made the Ka'bah, the Sacred House, an asylum of safety for the people who have no chief to prevent the strong from transgressing against the weak, the evil from the good-doers, and the oppressors from the oppressed. iAnd also the Sacred Month and the animals of offerings and Al-Bari 9 :528 , Muslim 2 :362

276 Tafsir Ibn Kathir the garlanded.> Allah says that He made these symbols an asylum of safety for the people, just as He made the Ka'bah an asylum of safety for them, so that He distinguishes them from each other, for this is their asylum and symbol for their livelihood and religion. Allah made the Ka'bah, the Sacred Month, the Hady, the garlanded animals and people an asylum of safety for the Arabs who used to consider these symbols sacred. Thus, these symbols were just like the chief who is obeyed by his followers, and who upholds harmony and public safety. As for the Ka'bah, it includes the entire sacred boundary. Allah termed it Haram because He prohibited hunting its game and cutting its trees or grass. Similarly, the Ka'bah, the Sacred Month, the animals of offerings and the garlands were the landmarks of existing Arabs. These symbols were sacred during the time of Jahiliyyah and the people's affairs were guided and protected by them. With Islam they became the symbols of their Hajj, their rituals, and the direction of the prayer, [i.e., the Ka'bah in Makkah.] 4 US 4 Ujt 3 it that you may know that Allah has knowledge of all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth, and that Allah is the All-Knower of each and everything .> Allah says; O people, I made these symbols an asylum for you, so that you know that He Who made these symbols that benefit your life and provide you with security, also knows everything in the heavens and earth that brings about your immediate or eventual benefit. Know that He has perfect knowledge of everything and that none of your deeds or affairs ever escapes His observation; and He will count them for you so that He rewards those who do good with the same and those who do evil in kind. { J"> < r-> jj** &% yllji 4Know that Allah is severe in punishment and that Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful .> Allah says, know that your Lord, Who has perfect knowledge of whatever is in the heavens and earth, and Who is never

unaware of your deeds - public or secret - is severe in punishment for those who disobey and defy Him. He also pardons the sins of those who obey and repent to Him, more Merciful than to punish them for the sins that they repented from. 2 CS pt% gj('ll Jgjf& } iThe Messenger's duty is but to convey. And Allah knows all that you reveal and all that you conceal.} This is a warning from Allah for His servants in which He says: Our Messenger, whom We sent to you, has only to convey Our Message and then the reward for the obedience, and punishment for the disobedience is on Us. The obedience of those who accept Our Message never escapes Our knowledge, just as in the case of those who disobey and defy Our Message. We know what one of you does, demonstrates physically, announces, and utters with his tongue, and what you hide in your hearts, be it of faith, disbelief, certainty, doubt or hypocrisy. He Who is so capable, then nothing that the hearts conceal, nor any of the apparent acts of the souls in the heavens and earth could escape His knowledge. In His Hand, alone, is the reward and punishment, and He is worthy to be feared, obeyed and never disobeyed. JjbC iif ijijfi V & *\$2P '4 Cl ;'CS \p p % Uib 13 %&%&P2 4 > 1^ . \y yj\ jJ> Jt 4100. Say : "Not equal are the bad things and the good things, even though the abundance of the bad may please you So have Taqwa of Allah, O men of understanding in order that you may be successful.} 4101. O you who believe! Ask not about things which, if made plain to you, may cause you trouble. But if you ask about them while the Qur'an is being revealed, they will

be made plain to you. Allah has forgiven that, and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Forbearing.} 4102. Before you, a community asked such questions, then on that account they became disbelievers.}

Allah says to His Messenger jg, 4Say,} O Muhammad jg\$, 4 A****^ Jj Sj- > 'i} \$Not equal are the bad things and the good things, even though they may please you O human, \$the abundance of bad.} This Ayah means, the little permissible is better than the abundant evil. 4. ijiV' Taqwd ofAllah, O men ofunderstanding . . .} who have sound minds, avoid and abandon the impermissible, and let the permissible be sufficient for you, 4in order that you may be successful.} in this life and the Hereafter. Unnecessary Questioning is Disapproved of Allah said next, 4pp Xz oljO y S* Ip: &\ 40 you who believe! Ask not about things which, ifmade plain to you, may cause you trouble.} This Ayah refers to good conduct that Allah is teaching His believing servants, by forbidding them from asking about useless things. Since if they get the answers they sought, they might be troublesome for them and difficult on their ears. Al- Bukhari recorded that Anas bin Malik said, The Messenger of Allah Sg gave a speech unlike anything I heard before. In this speech, he said, "I'j\$ ij^ iSpj , pS U bjPc> ^lfyou but know what I know, you will laugh little and cry a

The companions of Allah s Messenger jg covered their faces and the sound of crying was coming out of their chests. A man asked, Who is my father? The Prophet jg said, So-and-so . This Ayah was later revealed, iAsk not about things...

"/ have never witnessed both goodness and evil like I have today. Paradise and the Fire were shown to me and I saw them before that wall. ^ This Hadith was recorded in the Two Sahihs from Said.121

to ask about things that if one has knowledge of, he would be sorry he had asked. Consequently, it is better to avoid such questions. Allah s statement, & yss iBut ifyou ask about them while the Qur'an is being revealed, they will be made plain to you.} means, if you ask about things that you are prohibited from asking about, then when the revelation about them comes to the Messenger jg, they will be made plain for you, 4%?. & Mj} iVerily! That is easyfor Allah.} Allah said next, 61} iAllah has forgiveti that,} what you did before this, iflf jy iand Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Forbearing.} Do not ask about things that do not have a ruling yet, for because of your questions, a difficult ruling may be ordained. A Hadlth states, djdLU J>-i ja Yj ' fyA. ^ If jk* "J "77ie worst criminal among the

282 Tafoir ton Kathir \mm 'To s#p:'J\ k0 \$"' ***-' ^ j&y} >> Jtf ai M" .< ff . > > i j*V , . .- c jj ' oijA Cji>***j*(Vs ^*- f < *>*- ' < i (jojIju^Aj 5JLu*i j _V- 0I4ttu 1 ^ -bUl'jJlXU'.U'.j l*r-iLjl- gi I'j-*^ A a - J^V 4)ii yu() . * * > a v v - v > * ". > 7:UjJl^ J-? J i LftjJLyAt yj "UJ#f t lijJlLu *Ai "U"if oiwj t li jl~lu jjr J "i p ijili: 1Allah, the Most Honored, has ordained some obligations, so do not ignore them; has set some limits, so do not trespass them; has pro- hibited some things, so do not commit them; and has left some things with- out rulings, out ofmercy for you, not that He for- got them, so do not ask about tfiem. Allah said next. oi f} Cifti aj)> iBefore you, a community asked such questions, then on that account they became disbelievers meaning, some people before your time asked such questions and they were given answers. They did not believe the answers, so they became disbelievers because of that. This occurred because these rulings were made plain to them, yet they did not benefit at all from that, for they asked about these things not to gain guidance, but only to mock and defy. \$ Cufiii \fjt &! fogfi 3j fcffo HI Al-Bukhari 4623 and Muslim 2856.

ijUj jIS&\$ t jl ijju; ji lilj JpO&J 4VHyiyJSp Yj V jl\$ tsiLl. #4* L> t 1 *-': "- 4103. Allah has not instituted things like Bahirah or a Sd'ibah or a Wasilah or a Ham. But those who disbelieve invent lies against Allah, and most of them have no understanding.} 4104. And when it is said to them :"

the Prophet said, i/IJ Ji 3j** y} fliSIi xSj Cli [ly Jji d)8 fijllj] o"ULol aThe first to start the practice of Sd'ibah and worshipping idols was Abu Khuzd'ah, 'Amr bin 'Amir. I saw him pulling his intestines behind him in the Fire." The Amr mentioned in the above Hadith is the son of Luhay bin Qam'ah, one of the chiefs of the tribe of Khuza'ah who were the caretakers of the House of Allah after the tribe of Jurhum, (and before the Prophet's tribe, Quraysh). He was the first to change the religion of Ibrahim (Al-KhaM in Makkah) bringing idol worshipping to the area of Hijaz (Western Arabia). He also called the foolish people to worship idols and offer sacrifices to them and started these ignorant rituals concerning the animals as well as other rituals of Jdhiliyyah. Allah said in Surat Al-An'am, % cSi k iAnd they assign to Allah a share of the tilth and cattle which He has created. ^{(3:136). As for the Bahirah, Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said, It is the female camel that has given delivery five times. After that, they looked at the fifth delivery, if it were a male, they would slaughter it and give it to the men only and not the women. If it were a female, they would cut off its ears and proclaim, This is a Bahirah (no one is allowed to milk it). 121 As-Suddi and others mentioned a similar statement.131 As for the S& ibah, Mujahid said that it is for sheep, and mentioned a similar meaning as for Bahirah. He said that it delivers six females and then a male, female or two males, and that they then would slaughter it (the newly born sheep) and feed its meat to the men, but not to the woman.' Muhammad bin Ishaq said that the S& ibah is the female [1 * Ahmad 1 :446. ' At-Tabari 11 :129. At-Tabari 11:130. At-Tabari 11 :128.

camel that delivers ten females, without giving birth to a single male between them. They would then set it free and no one was allowed to ride it, cut its wool or milk it, except for a guest. Abu Rawq said, The Sa ibah was made as such when one goes out for some of his affairs and succeeds in whatever he intended to do. So he would designate a S& ibah from his property, a female camel or another type, and would set it free for the idols (in appreciation for his success). Then, whatever this camel gave birth to was set free for the idols too. As- Suddi said, When one's affair was successful, or if he was cured from an illness, or if his wealth increased, he would set some of his wealth free for the idols. Those who would try to acquire any of the Sa ibah property were punished in this world. As for the WasOah, Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said, It is the sheep that gives birth seven times, if she gives birth to a male or a female stillborn at its seventh delivery, the men, but not the women, would eat from it. If she gave birth to a female, or a female and a male, they would set them free, proclaiming (about the male in this case). His sister Wasalat (literally, connected him to being forbidden on us). Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this statement . 111 Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma*mar said that Az-Zuhri said that Said bin Al-Musayyib said that, I'M iOr a Wastlah} It is the female camel that gives delivery to a female and then another female at its second delivery. They would call such a camel a Wasilah, proclaiming that she has Wasalat (connected) between two females without giving birth to a male between them. So they used to cut off the ears of the WasOah and let it roam free to pasture for their idols. A similar explanation was reported from Imam Malik bin Anas. Muhammad bin Ishaq said, The WasOah sheep is the ewe that gives birth to ten females in five deliveries, giving birth to two females at each delivery. This sheep would be called 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 4:1222. Abdur-Razzaq 1:196.

WasUah and would be set free. Whatever this sheep delivers afterwards, male or female, would be given to the men, but not the women, but if it delivers a stillborn, men and women would share it! As for the Ham, Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said, If a man's camel performs ten copulations, they would call him a Ham, So set him free., 1 Similar was reported from AbuRawq and Qatadah. Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said, The Ham is the male camel whose offspring gave birth to their own offspring; they would then proclaim, This camel has Hama (protected) its back. Therefore, they would not carry anything on this male camel, cut his wool, prevent him from grazing wherever he likes or drinking from any pool, even if the pool did not belong to its owner. 121 Ibn Wahb said, I heard Malik saying, As for the Ham, it is the male camel who is assigned a certain number of copulations, and when having finished what was assigned to him, would have peacock feathers placed on him and be set free. Other opinions were also mentioned to explain this Ayah. There is a Hadith on this subject that Ibn Abi Hatim collected from Abu Ishaq As-Subay i from Al-Ahwas Al- Jushami from his father Malik bin Nadlah who said, I came to the Prophet jg wearing old clothes. So he said to me, "JU -j. id "Do you have any property?t I said, Yes. He asked, aWhat type?n I said, All types; camels, sheep, horses and slaves. He said, fii vu iiM "// Allah gives you wealth, then let it show on you ." He then asked, blj iiy Do your catnels deliver calves that have full ears?* I said, Yes, At-Tabari 11:129. Ibn Abi Hatim 4 :1225 and do camels give birth but to whole calves? He said, iii jIS1 jlil j>-fe fj>- ' iiyu aDo you take the knife and cut off the ears of some of them saying, This is a Bahirah/ and tear the ears of some of them and proclaim, 'This is Sacred?'" \ said, Yes. He said, ^ M U! jil ' Then do not do that, for all the wealth that Allah has given you is allowedfor you. " Then he said; i}C Vj frJj% }&.% }j iAllah has not instituted things like Bahirah or a Sd'ibah or a Wasilah or a Ham.} As for the Bahirah, it is the animal whose ears were cut, one would not allow his wife, daughters, or any of his household to benefit from its wool, hair or milk. But, if it died, they would share it. As for the Sa ibah, they used to set it free for their idols and announce this fact in the vicinity of the idols. As for the Wasilah, it is the sheep that gives birth to six offspring. When she delivered for the seventh time, they would cut its ears and horns, saying, It has Wasalat (connected deliveries), and they would not slaughter it, hit it or prevent it from drinking from any pool. 11 This Hadith was narrated with the addition of the explanation of these words in it. In another narration for this Hadith from Abu Ishaq from Abu Al-Ahwas, Awf bin Malik used his own words (Le., he explained these words not as a part of the Hadith itself) and this is more sound. Imam

Allah s statement, 'j) ^&\ "#t jt ojdu '4 ZfSsi ifai)} ifiut those who disbelieve invent lies against Allah, and most of them have no understanding.} means, Allah did not legislate these invented rituals and He does not consider them acts of obedience. Rather, it is the idolaters who made them into rituals and acts of worship that they used to draw near to Allah. But they did not and will not help them to draw near to Him, rather, these innovations will only harm them. {3fi lTi.4 C Lula. IjJLi JI4 i# I* d! J2i jj iAnd when it is said to them: "Come to wlmt Allah has revealed and to the Messenger." Tlthey say; "Enough for us is that which wefound ourfathers following,"} meaning, if they are called to Allah s religion, Law and commandments and to avoiding what He prohibited, they say, The ways and practices that we found our fathers and forefathers following are good enough for us. Allah said, ieven though theirfathers had no knowledge whatsoever...} That is, even though their fathers did not understand or recognize the truth or find its way. Therefore, who would follow their forefathers, except those who are

even more ignorant and misguided than they were? j til V Cfjji 4105. O you who believe! Take care of yourselves . If you follow the right guidance, no hurt can come to you from those who are in error. The return of you all is to Allah, then He will inform you about (all) that you used to do.} One is Required to Reform Himself First Allah commands His believing servants to reform themselves and to do as many righteous deeds as possible. He also informs them that whoever reforms himself, he would not be

affected by the wickedness of the wicked, whether they were his relatives or otherwise. Imam

not hide the testimony of Allah, for then indeed we should be of the sinful. } 4107. If it then becomes known that these two had been guilty of sin, let two others stand forth in their places, nearest in kin from among those who claim a lawful right. Let them swear by Allah (saying): We affirm that our testimony is truer than that of both of them, and that we have not trespassed (the truth), for then indeed we should be of the wrongdoers. } 4108. That should make it closer (to the fact) that their testimony would be in its true nature and shape, or else they would fear that (other) oaths would be admitted after their oaths. And have Taqwa of Allah and listen (with obedience to Him). And Allah guides not the rebellious people.} Testimony of Two Just Witnesses for the Final Will and Testament This honorable Ayah contains a glorious ruling from Allah. Allah's statement, 4\$\$ Up ' 1\$ 40 you who believe! When death approaches any of you, and you make a bequest, then take the testimony of two...} meaning that there should be two witnesses in such cases, 4just men...} thus, describing them as just, 4of your own folk}

Al-Ma'idah (105 - 108) (Part-7) if you are traveling through the land on a journey, } and the calamity of death befalls you.} These are two conditions that permit using non-

Al-Ma'idah (105 - 108) (Part-7) honor. This is discussed in the studies of the oaths in the books of Ahk&m. Allah's statement, \s%d\ \% J HA \$>} iThat should make it closer (to the fact) that their testimony would be in its true nature and shape (and thus accepted),} means, the ruling requiring the two Dhimmis witnesses to swear, if there is a doubt that they were not truthful, might compel them to admit to the testimony in its true form. Allah's statement, feU ior else they would fear that (other) oaths would be admitted after their oaths.} means, requiring them to swear by Allah might encourage them to admit to the true testimony because they respect swearing by Allah and they glorify and revere Him. They also fear exposure if the heirs of the deceased are required to swear instead of them. In this case, the heirs would swear and earn the rightful inheritance that the two witnesses failed to declare. This is why Allah said, fe j 1} ior else they would fear that (other) oaths would be admitted W53H1& saaiEU ^Jr ^ h jlk V l j fez > > * / ^ " v* * * * "+" ;*> t T ^ / . at J/ O' OSVjri??

Al-Ma'idah (109 - 111) (Part-7) Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ath-Thawri said that Al-A mash said that Mujahid said about the Ayah, A TiC US iOn the Day when Allah will gather the Messengers together and say to them : "What was the response you received?"} They will become afraid and reply, 4U jk 4We have no knowledge .. ^ Ibn Jarir * and Ibn Abi Hatim also recorded this explanation. Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, ti 'a sc lit 4 iOn the Day when Allah will gather the Messengers together and say to them: "What was the response you received (from men to your teaching)?" They will say: "We have no knowledge, verily, only You are the Knower of all that is hidden."} They will say to the Lord, Most Honored, We have no knowledge beyond what we know, and

even that. You have more knowledge of them than us. * This response is out of respect before the Lord, Most Honored, and it means, we have no knowledge compared to Your encompassing knowledge. Therefore, our knowledge only grasped the visible behavior of these people, not the secrets of their hearts. You are the Knower of everything, Who has encompassing knowledge of all things, and our knowledge compared to Your knowledge is similar to not having any knowledge at all, for 4V X&^} ionly You are the Knower of all that is hidden.} *** Abdur-Razzaq 1:201. At-Tabari 11:210. At-Tabari 11:211.

ijj J-4V'j P4=J' - & > j-P" ^ J\lSrf %z ** iff i *r, h'x > yy . '< . r" . ""s' st ' ' , - K*. L^=*i\ Sjjj 1/y* IJj jjJaN 4i: |S ^ h PtPi & 3 Apr^ & 3% 3 s^pr ji iu #sip *i 4 up yr 3ui ^jv 4110. (Remember) when Allah will say (on the Day of Resurrection): "O 'Isa, son of Maryam! Remember My favor to you and to your mother when I supported you with Ruh - il- Qudus [Jibril] so that you spoke to the people in the cradle and in maturity; and when I taught you the Book, the Hikmah, the Tawrah and the Injil; and when you made out of the clay, as it were, the figure of a bird, by My permission, and you breathed into it, and it became a bird by My permission, and you healed those born blind, and the lepers by My permission, and when you brought forth the dead by My permission; and when I restrained the Children of Israel from you since you came unto them with clear proofs, and the disbelievers among them said: This is nothing but evident magic 4111. "And when I Awhaytu [put in the hearts of] Al- Hawariyyin to believe in Me and My Messenger, they said: We believe. And bear witness that we are Muslims." 4 Reminding Isa of the Favours that Allah Granted him Allah mentions how He blessed His servant and Messenger, Isa, son of Maryam, and the miracles and extraordinary acts He granted him. Allah said, 4Remember My favor to you^ when I created you from your mother, without male intervention, and made you a sign and clear proof of My perfect power over all things. 4And to your mother when I made you testify to her chastity and you thus absolved her from the sin that the unjust, ignorant liars accused her of,

when I supported you with Ruh - il-Qudus^ the angel Jibril, and made you a Prophet, calling to Allah in the cradle and manhood. I made you speak in the cradle, and you testified that your mother was free from any immoral behavior, and you proclaimed that you worship Me. You also conveyed the news of My Message and invited them to worship Me. so that you spoke to the people in the cradle and in maturity Meaning you called the people to Allah in childhood and in maturity. And the word Tukallim means invited, because his speaking to people while a child is nothing strange by itself. Allah's statement, iiXJSj iAnd when I taught you the Book and the Hikmah,\$ the power of writing and understanding, iand the Tawrdh which was revealed to Musa, son of Imran, who spoke to Allah directly. Allah's statement, iand when you made out of the clay, as it were, the figure of a bird, by My permission means: you shaped it in the figure of a bird by My permission, and it became a bird with My permission, after you blew into it . Then, it became a flying bird with a soul by Allah's permission. Allah said; <#h iand you healed those born blind, and the lepers by My permission, This was explained before in Surah Al Imran (chapter 3) and we do not need to repeat it here. Allah's statement,

Al-Ma'idah (112 - 115) (Part-7 mum uv .tUli 'lC'o .'cr*! |J ijuy^do-*^ /* ^ \ l t?' > 40*(^Cu * ^ ^ X* />* I 'j I * I J tii JSStajJ Ca i"j ft^VJj4jii' <^E^""^***^ ' f!-^ =^ g&iJWS\$ MIkJIjjyd 1^Kx\y*J5prJJ l And your Lord Awha (inspired) the bee, saying: "Take habitations in the mountains and in the trees and in what they erect. Then, eat of all fruits, and follow the ways of your Lord made easy (for you)."}

[16:68-69] Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented about the Hawariyyun, Allah inspired them, while As-Suddi said, He put in their hearts, and the Hawariyyun said, 4Sj4li &W} iWe believe. And bear witness that we are Muslims.} 5jj ji JU ij> ji S' j\ jLy j\ iSspofeti* j,* -=< &' IjiJi Jli .uLi)' "-vX* ty* Jjo S ' Jtt iggc^j Oi oj^j j5 jl j^L"jj Ljjj& J^=^J 5J"j t^l"j LJjV 'j LJ j -I- '-* SjJl* Sf Ujj Ja-tlll i?) ts i!5 tjji j* Jli f He 4\ iif jfi j?- "i*t" Si 'SJ 'Sf tu* /Jjj 4122. (Remember) when Al-Hawdriyun said: "O 'Isa, son of Maryam! Can your Lord send down to us a Ma'idah from heaven?" 'Isa said: "Have Taqwa of Allah, if you are indeed believers. } 4113. They said: "We wish to eat thereof and to be stronger in faith, and to know that you have indeed told us the truth and

that we ourselves be its witnesses."} }114. 'Isa, son of Maryam, said: "O Allah, our Lord! Send us from heaven a table spread (with food) that there may be for us - for the first and the last of us - a festival and a sign from You; and provide us sustenance, for You are the Best of sustainers."} 4115. Allah said: "I am going to send it down unto you, but if any of you after that disbelieves, then I will punish him with a torment such as I have not inflicted on anyone among the Alamin."} SendingDown the Ma'idah This is the story of the Ma'idah, the name of which this Surah bears, Surat Al-Ma'idah. This is also among the favors that Allah granted His servant and Messenger, Isa, accepting his request to send the Ma'idah down, and doing so as clear proof and unequivocal evidence. Allah said, 44/^ ja Si" 4(Retnember) when Al-Hawaryun said...} the disciples of Isa said, 40 'Isa, son of Maryam! Can your Lord send down to us a Ma'idah from heaven?} The Ma'idah is the table that has food on it. Some scholars said that the disciples requested this table because they were poor and deprived. So they asked Isa to supplicate to Allah to send a table of food down to them that they could eat from every day and thus be more able to perform the acts of worship. / "a a > m p* ittl ijiil JUy 4'Isa said: "Have Taqwa of Allah, if you are indeed believers."} Isa answered them by saying, Have Taqwa of Allah! And do not ask for this, for it may become a trial for you, but trust in Allah for your provisions, if you are truly believers.

4They said: "We wish to eat thereof."} we need to eat from it, iatid to be stronger in faith,\$ when we witness it descending from heaven as sustenance for us, i&Z. 3 i5pj} 4and to know that you have indeed told us the truth,} of your Message and our faith in you increases and also our knowledge, iand that we ourselves be its witnesses. testifying that it is a sign from Allah, as proof and evidence that you are a Prophet, and attesting to the truth of what you brought us, Qft ii* U Alin & & '4 % ^ i'Isa, son of Maryam, said: "O Allah, our Lord! Send us from heaven a table spread (with food) that there may be for us - for the first and the last of us - a festival..."} As-Suddi commented that the Ayah means, We will take that day on which the table was sent down as a day of celebration, that we and those who come after us would consider sacred. 111 Sufyan Ath-Thawri said that it means, A day of prayer. 121 4Jbi ty*j} iand a sign from You.} proving that You are able to do all things and to accept my supplication, so that they accept what I convey to them from You, iand provide us sustenance,} a delicious food from You that does not require any effort or hardship, Tabari 11 :225. Tabari 11 :225.

f d.\ iif JB C&j} 4"For You are the Best of sustainers." Allah said: "I am going to send it down unto you, but if any of you after that disbelieves..."} by denying this sign and defying its implication, O Isa, 4*&\ ss V Q& i then I will punish him with a torment such as I have not inflicted on anyone among the 'Alatmn .} among the people of your time. Allah said in similar Ayat, i^Zs\ lit X fci il tfe }yj} 4And on the Day when the Hour will be established (it will be said to the angels): "Cause Fir'awn's people to

enter the severest torment!"} [40:46], and, iVerily, the hypocrites will be in the lowest depths of the Fire.} [4:145] Ibn Jarir said that Abdullah bin Amr said, Those who will receive the severest torment on the Day of Resurrection are three: The hypocrites, those from the people of Al-Ma'idah who disbelieved in it, and the people of Fir'awn. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said, They said to Isa, son of Maryam, Supplicate to Allah to send down to us from heaven, a table spread with food. He also said, So the angels brought the table down containing seven fish and seven pieces of bread and placed it before them. So the last group of people ate as the first group did. 121 Ibn Jarir recorded that Ishaq bin Abdullah said that the table was sent down to Isa son of Maryam having seven pieces of bread and seven fish, and they ate from it as much as they wished. But when some of them stole food from it, saying, It might not come down tomorrow, the table ascended.131 At-Tabari 11:233.Tabari 5 :132 , Ibn Abi Hatim 4 :1246Tabari 5:134.

These statements testify that the table was sent down to the Children of Israel during the time of Isa, son of Maryam, as a result of Allah's accepting his supplication to Him. The apparent wording of this Ayah also states so, 41& 4Allah said: I am going to send it down unto you..." (5:1 15]. jfi jif o/j Ji a' i >) (L ^Ju ^ -xi* jCU ^ U Jy" o' Q Ojr** v* tit*** iil (jl oil U pllfr O^ < 1 4 U V> fe. o4j ^,Uc 0-1 llli i~*i U 'o-j ooSj jJ jj #3' &\$\$\$%> pr (*& y 4116. And (remember) when Allah will say (on the Day of Resurrection): "O 'Isa, son of Maryam! Did you say unto men : Worship me and my mother as two gods besides Allah?" He will say : "Glory be to You! It was not for me to say what I had no right (to say). Had I said such a thing. You would surely have known it. You know what is in my inner self though I do not know what is in Yours, truly. You, only You, are the Knower of all that is hidden and unseen.") 4117. "Never did I say to them ought except what You (Allah) did command me to say: Worship Allah, my Lord and your Lord.' And I was a witness over them while I dwelled amongst them, but when You took me {up}, You were the Watcher over them, and You are a Witness to all things.") ill8. "If You punish them, they are Your servants, and if You forgive them, verily You, only You are the Almighty, the All- Wise.") Isa Rejects Shirk and Affirms Tawhid Allah will also speak to His servant and Messenger, Isa son of Maryam, peace be upon him, saying to him on the Day of Resurrection in the presence of those who worshipped Isa and his mother as gods besides Allah, oi ut!j '(if> a' J^*k)

305Surat 5. Al-Ma'idah (116 - 118) -7 nothing escapes Your knowledge. Rather, I have not said these words nor did the thought even cross my mind, this why he, said, U pjl cJb U pSlfr dlyi) t* Yo" fcnoiy what is in my inner self though I do not know what is in Yours, truly, You, only You, are the Knower of all that is hidden and unseen . Never did I say to them ought except what You (Allah) did command me to say...} and convey, j; itw# 4Worship Allah, my Lord and your Lord.} I only called them to what You sent me with and commanded me to convey to them, j; it & ^Worship Allah, my Lord and your Lord} and this is what I conveyed to them, A * .S ' , A , 2 iAnd I was a witness over them while I dwelled amongst them,} I was a witness over what they did when I was amongst them, il ibut when You took me [up]. You were the Watcher over them, and You are a Witness to all things.}

}As We began the first creation, We shall repeat it.} Iri fji J&i JIjt ulj" U N liUI :Jy(i iJUJI oli JLi^i jbJi ju us jyG ih'j The first among the creation who will be covered with clothes will be Ibrahim. Some men from my Ummah will be brought and taken to the left (to the Fire) and I will yell, 'They are my followers!' It will be said, 'You do not know what they innovated after you (in religion).' So I will say

just as the righteous servant (Tsa) said, iAnd I was a witness over them while I dwelled amongst them, but when You took me [up], You were the Watcher over them, and You are a Witness to all things. If You punish them, they are Your servants, and if You forgive them, verily You, only You are the Almighty, the All-Wise.} It will further be said, 'These people kept reverting back on their heels after you left them.'o"W

Al-Ma'idah (119 - 120) (Part-7) Christians who invented a lie against Allah and His Messenger, thus making a rival, wife and son for Allah. Allah is glorified in that He is far above what they attribute to Him. So this Ayah [5:118] has tremendous value and delivers unique news. Ijj Xfj UJVf- o; iSf '\$ d >*J liil 41 jjil' \$i lie jjijj li' 4119. Allah will say: "This is a Day on which the truthful will profit from their truth : Theirs are Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise) - they shall abide therein forever. Allah is pleased with them and they with Him. That is the great success. 4120. To Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth and all that is therein, and He is able to do all things.} OnlyTruth willbe ofBenefiton theDay ofResurrection Allah answers His servant and Messenger Isa, son of Maiyam, after he disowns the disbelieving Christians who lied about Allah and His Messenger, and when Isa refers their end to the will of his Lord, 4This is a Day on which the truthful will profit from their truth.}' Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas commented, This is the Day when Tawhid will benefit those who believed in it. 4Tlteirs are Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise) - they shall abide therein forever and they will never be removed from it, 4AUah is pleased with them and they with Him.}

iBut the greatest bliss is the good pleasure ofAllah.} [9:72} We will mention the Hadiths about this Ayah [9:72] later on. Allah s statement, gif&} 4That is the great success.} means, this is the great success, other than which there is no greater success. Allah said* in another Ayat, fis gj} 4For the like of this let the workers work.} [37:61], and, jjGdi iSj i jjAndfor this let (all) those strive who want to strive.} [83:26] Allah s statement, 4To Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth and all that is therein, and He is able to do all things.} means, He created everything, owns everything, controls the affairs of everything and is able to do all things. Therefore, everything and everyone are in His domain and under His power and will. There is none like Him, nor is there rived, ancestor, son, or wife for Him, nor a lord or god besides Him. Ibn Wahb said that he heard Huyay bin Abdullah saying that Abu Abdur-Rahman Al-Habli said that Abdullah bin Amr said, The last revealed Surah was Surat Al-Ma idah. ^ m At-Tirmidhi no . 3063

Surah 6: Al-Anam (Part 1 of 2)

PDF pages 1631–1870

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1631–1634]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-An'am (Chapter - 6) Which was Revealed in Makkah ^ ilgaSB&S 'TA ^ The Virtue of Surat Al-An'am and When it Was Revealed Al-Awfi, Ikrimah and Ata said that Ibn Abbas said, Surat Al-An'am was revealed in Makkah 1 A\$- Tabarani recorded that Ibn Abbas said, All of Surat Al-An'am was revealed in Makkah at night, accompanied by seventy thousand angels, raising their voices in glorification of Allah 12 As-Suddi said that Murrah said that Abdullah said, Surat Al-An'am was revealed in the company of seventy thousand angels. 3 ag" In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 3 :243 Tabarani 12:215. 3| Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 3 :243

ofo ciikli " JU. l jK _u_2i^ /Ai J"-l> Jjii ji Cnt I c ii' ji t j&y 'ftAft-i '<&~i pbs 3?J^ jj 4 lit b*J il. All praise be to Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, and originated the darkness and the light, yet those who disbelieve hold others as equal with their Lord.} il. He it is Who has created you from clay, and then has decreed a stated term. And there is with Him another determined term, yet you doubt. i3. And He is Allah, in the heavens and the earth. He knows what you conceal and what you reveal, and He knows what you earn.\$> All Praise is Due to Allah for His Glorious Ability and Great Power Allah praises and glorifies His Most Honorable Self for creating the heavens and earth, as a dwelling for His servants, and for making the darkness and the light to benefit them in the night and the day. In this Ayah, Allah describes darkness in the plural, Zulumat [where Zulmah is singular for darkness], while describing the light in the singular, An-Nur, because An-Nur is more honored. In other Ayat, Allah said. iTo the right and to the left. [16:48] Near the end of this Surah (chapter 6), Allah also said; ^ J?>? Ui ot>^ iAnd verily, this is my straight path, so follow it, and follow no (other) ways, for they will separate you away from His way.\$ [6:153] Allah said next, iYet those who disbelieve hold others as equal with their Lord.\$ meaning, in spite of all this, some of Allah's servants disbelieve in Him and hold others as partners and rivals with Him. Some

of Allah's servants claimed a wife and a son for Allah, hallowed be He far above what they attribute to Him. Allah's statement, M y*} 4He it is Who has created you from clay,} refers to the father of mankind, Adam, from whom mankind originated, multiplied in numbers and spread about, east and west. Allah said, 4Then has decreed a stated term. And there is with Him another determined term...} His saying; iThen has decreed a stated term,} refers to death, while, 4And there is with Him another determined term... ^ refers to the Hereafter, according to Said bin Jubayr who reported this from Ibn Abbas. * Similar statements were narrated from Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Zayd bin Aslam, Atiyyah, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan and others. * Ibn Abbas and Mujahid said that, 4And then has decreed a stated term,} is the term of this earthly life, while, JL3 4And there is with Him another determined term} refers to man's extent of life until he dies as

mentioned in Allah's statement; AM JZ? C& McMaM 4It is He, Who takes your souls by night (when you are asleep), and has knowledge of all that you have done by day, m At-Tabari 11:257. * At-Tabari 11 :256-258. * At-Tabari 11 :256.

then He raises (wakes) you up again that a term appointed (life) be fulfilled.} [6:60]

The meaning of Allah's statement,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1634–1642]

AM iWith Him} is that none but Him knows when it will occur. Allah said in other Ayat, IS iThe knowledge thereof is with my Lord. None can reveal its time but He.} [7:187], and. 4They ask you about the Hour - when will be its appointed time? You have no knowledge to say anything about it. To your Lord belongs (the knowledge of) the term thereof.} [79:42-44] Allah said, 4Yet you doubt.} the coming of the (last) Hour, according to As-Suddi. ' Allah said next, 1* jfej 'f&i Jfjt jj 4 iAnd He is Allah in the heavens and the earth, He knows what you conceal and what you reveal, and He knows what you earn.} Meaning, it is He Who is called Allah, throughout the heavens and the earth, that is, it is He who is worshipped, singled out, whose divinity is believed in by the inhabitants of the heavens and the earth. They call Him Allah, and they supplicate to Him in fear and hope, except those who disbelieve among the Jinns and mankind. In another Ayah, Allah said; ^ jj sJi 4 jjJ' j*j} ilt is He Who is God in the heavens and the earth.}[43:84] meaning, He is the God of those in heaven and those on earth, m At-Tabari 1 1 :260

Al-An'dm (4 - 6) (Part-7) and He knows all affairs, public and secret. 4And He knows what you earn all the good and bad deeds that you perform. CJ jii .i.vijwJA* (ft- 1 fr^rj Jt jj _*+L" IjJ f i jyf t* (Tri **. " * (**"W OJ vi/4 bb-li (^ itHil uLjlj jiw J L v| 44. And never an Ayah comes to them from the Ayat of their Lord, but that they have been turning awayfrom it.} 45. Indeed, they rejected the truth when it came to them, but there will come to them the news of that which they used to mock at.} 46. Have they not seen how many a generation before them We have destroyed whom We had established on the earth such as We have not established you? And We poured out on them rain from the sky in abundance, and made the rivers flow under them. Yet We destroyed them for their sins, and created after them other generations. Threatening the Idolators for their Stubbornness Allah states that the rebellious, stubborn polytheists will turn away from eveiy Ayah, meaning, sign, miracle and proof that is evidence of Allah's Uniqueness and the truth of His honorable Messengers. They will not contemplate about these Ayat or care about them. Allah said, 4 *! jyf ijs3 (iiiC- 111 is.Indeed, they rejected the truth when it came to them, but there will come to them the news of that which they used to mock at.} This Ayah contains a warning and a stem threat for the disbelievers rejection of the truth, stating that the disbelievers will surely know the truth ofwhat they used to deny and taste the evil end of their behavior. Allah advises and warns the disbelievers, that they should avoid the torments and

y amm saga Li ,1 L^=tL> > "c& c& ol oil Jiil Cp ^ ijuj @Ssi ^ ui \$ & gjf _p; & j^\ ilsjiv^^ju^gg 4'x^ >} ' 'Jj\ 'J& \$ Lt?Jf^S\ vJ-j iijw i = ij . jj; @<^A d ,*^j Ct2:: i^* jk^jc t 3J~i.j* ij_^^~ ' 4-j<-t(J--4 K^i-t jS5j ^ < "& &a^ -4^ c "Jt S ^ ^ ^Vf * ^ Xft^fiJ4S0it"SI2 ^ ^ -<< . ,s >.s .,;> ; - -- 4IS^!-^jf XjU-k^jJA^PcJ^O*Qp y"-S'S* jN,'J W^> ./" " . And euen ifWe /wt 4 S#3f , > t5f < */r-' ,^ ^ .11 M- 7 ^ "uf

iL -t. 0)j jv_JlJyJ \li^'-JJ.-" ^> 47. And even if We had sent down unto you a Message written on paper so that they could touch it with their hands, the disbelievers would have said : "This is nothing but obvious magic!" } 48. And they say: "Why has not an angel been sent down to him?" Had We sent down an angel, the matter would have been judged at once, and no respite would be granted to them. } 49. And had We appointed him an angel, We indeed would have made him a man, and We would have certainly caused them confusion in a matter which they have already covered with confusion. } 410. And indeed Messengers were mocked before you, but their scoffers were surrounded by the very thing that they used to mock at. } 411 . Say: "Travel in the land and see what was the end of those who rejected truth. }

316 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir Censuring the Rebellious and their Refusal to Accept Human Messengers Allah describes the rebellion and stubbornness of the idolaters in defying the truth and arguing against it, 4And even if We had sent down unto you a Message written on paper so that they could touch it with their hands, } meaning, if they saw this Message's descent and were eye-witnesses to that, 4the disbelievers would have said : "This is nothing but obvious magic!" } This is similar to Allah's description of the disbelievers' defiance of facts and truth, j: jyy* biii \$j } 4And even if We opened to them a gate from the heaven and they were to continue ascending thereto. They would surely say: "Our eyes have been (as if) dazzled. Nay, we are a people bewitched." } [15:14-15], and, *r" ^ Ua 4And if they were to see a piece of the heaven falling down, they would say, Clouds gathered in heaps!" } [52 : 44]. 4%fc g\ 'yj \)fc } 4And they say: "Why has not an angel been sent down to him?" } to convey the Message with admonition along with him. Allah replied, 2 f & tz (0& } 4Had We sent down an angel, the matter would have been judged at once, and no respite would be granted to them. } Consequently, even if the angels descend, while the

disbelievers still had the same attitude, then the torment will surely befall them from Allah as a consequence. Allah said in other Ayat,)We send not the angels down except with the truth (i.e. for torment, etc.), and in that case, they (the disbelievers) would have no respite!) (15:8], and, iOn the Day they will see the angels, no glad tidings will there be for the criminals that day.) [25:22] Allah's statement, j. if* bwl+Uj V-"-j)And had We appointed him an angel, We indeed would have made him a man, and We would have certainly caused them confusion in a matter which they have already covered with confusion.) meaning, if We send an angel along with the human Messenger, or if We send an angel as a Messenger to mankind, he would be in the shape of a man so that they would be able to speak to him and benefit from his teachings. In this case, the angel (in the shape of a human) will also cause confusion for them, just as the confusion they caused themselves over accepting humans as Messengers! Allah said, tU dr! ^=4 4& i& iSay: "If there were on the earth, angels walking about in peace and security. We should certainly have sent down from the heaven an angel as a Messenger.") (17:95] It is a mercy from Allah to His creation that He sends every type of creation, Messengers from among their kind, so that they are able to call their people to Allah, and their people able to talk to them, ask them and benefit from them. In another Ayah, Allah said; 4 tfs lA 1A> ^ h

318 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Indeed Allah conferred a great favor on the believers when He sent among them a Messenger from among themselves, reciting unto them His verses (the Qur'an), and purifying them. } [3:164] Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said about the Ayah [6:9 above], If an angel was sent to them,

he would come in the shape of a man. This is because they will not be able to look at the angel due to light. 111 tS 4 and We would have certainly caused them confusion in a matter which they have already covered with confusion .} meaning, We would confuse them over their confusion. And Al-Walibi reported Ibn Abbas saying; We brought doubts around them. Allah s statement, 4And indeed Messengers were mocked before you, but their scoffers were surrounded by the very thing that they used to mock at.} comforts the Messenger jg concerning the denial of him by his people. The Ayah also promises the Messenger \$gl, and his believers, of Allah s victory and the good end in this life and the Hereafter. Allah said next. JLi 4 buy 4Say : "Travel in the land and see what was the end of those who rejected truth."} meaning, contemplate about yourselves and think about the afflictions Allah struck the previous nations with, those who defied His Messengers and denied them. Allah sent torment, afflictions and punishment on them in this life, as well as the painful torment in the Hereafter, while saving His Messengers and believing servants. m At-Tabari 11 :268.

He has prescribed mercy for Himself. Indeed He will gather you together on the Day of Resurrection, about which there is no doubt. Those who destroy themselves will not believe.} 413. And to Him belongs whatsoever exists in the night and the day, and He is the All-Hearing, the All-Knowing. } 414. Say:

Allah said; 4t- vw V 4% } ilndeed He will gather you together on the Day of Resurrection, about which there is no doubt.} swearing by His Most Honored Self that He will gather His servants, [] iFor appointed meeting of a known Day.} [56:50],

the Day of Resurrection that will certainly occur, and there is

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1642–1699]

no doubt for His believing servants in this fact. As for those who deny and refuse, they are in confusion and disarray. Allah s statement, iThose who destroy themselves} on the Day of Resurrection, iwill not believe.} in the Return and thus do not fear the repercussions of that Day. Allah said next, iAnd to Him belongs whatsoever exists in the night and the day.} meaning, all creatures in the heavens and earth are Allah s servants and creatures, and they are all under His authority, power and will; there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, yb\ iand He is the All-Hearing, the All-Knowing.} He hears the statements of His servants and knows their actions, secrets and what they conceal. Allah then said to His servant and Messenger Muhammad jg, whom He sent with the pure Tawhid. and the straight religion, commanding him to call the people to Allah s straight path; iSay: ",Shall I take as a guardian any other than Allah, the Creator of the heavens and the earth?"}

^jjl ? nip Vj iijy&A 'jj filid Vj k 4^yj l^ i i JLJ ! uiLs.^ j Xkj>

assiss '* ust &r>: Bp ^All thanks and praises J" J~**j 1* JjSjiiij] Jr ',,\" ?i\"fi-\" :\" ' > ' ' > '*\\,-\\} \\ Z > ' jpLi<>>)dUU^") UX"j& p^ are due to Allah Who fed us the food, gave us the drink, covered our nudity , guided us from mis- guidance, gave us sight from blindness, and honored us above many of His creatures . All praise is due to Allah, Lord of all that exists."a 1 jjt if & xi[j"ld? iSay "Verily, I am commanded to be the first of those who submit themselves to Allah as (Muslims)."} from this Ummah,

t M?^ U "> 4; 5i jsa 4 \$ /? C*Ij 4And be not you of the idolaters. Say: "I fear, if I disobey my Lord, the torment of a Mighty Day."} [6:14-15],

the Day of Resurrection, t,o -*^-M 4Who is averted from} such a torment, ion that Day, He has surely been Merciful to him} meaning, Allah will have been merciful to him, iitp K An-NasSl in Al-Kubra 6 : 82

iAnd that would be the obvious success .} Allah also said, iAnd whoever is moved away from the Fire and admitted to Paradise, he indeed is successful.} [3:185], r&i 'i /'5' j' \ 117. And if Allah touches you with harm, none can remove it but He, and if He touches you with good, then He is able to do all things.} 118. And He is the Irresistible, above His servants, and He is the All-Wise, Well-Acquainted with all things.} 119. Say: "What thing is the most great in witness? Say: Allah is Witness between you and I; this Qur'an has been revealed to me that I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach. Can you verily bear witness that besides Allah there are other gods? Say "I bear no (such) witness! Say : "Only He is God, alone, and truly I am innocent of what you join in worship with Him. } 420. Those to whom We have given the Scripture recognize him, as they recognize their own children. Those who have lost (destroyed) themselves will not believe.} 421. And who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah or rejects His Aydt? Verily, the wrongdoers shall never be successful.} Allah is the Irresistible, Able to Bring Benefit and Protect from Harm Allah states that He Alone brings benefit or harm, and that He does what He wills with His creatures, none can resist His

324 Tahir Ibn Kathir judgment or prevent what He decrees, fir: "ji iS(iAnd if Allah touches you with harm, none can remove it but He, and if He touches you with good, then He is able to do all things.} Similarly, Allah said, i'.z k % *Ji 'if u ^Whatever mercy, Allah may graht to mankind, none can withhold it, and whatever He may withhold, morn can grant it thereafter {35:2}. It is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah used to supplicate*; c (AtJi ill- 1 u U!^ 'ij UJ V JL"

Al-An'dm (17-21) (Part-7) rightful place, grants and favors whomever deserves His favor. Allah said next, ~ M -v iSay: "What thing is the most great in witness?"} or what is the greatest witness, v& fr 4Say : "Allah (the Most Great!) is Witness between you and I"} for He knows what I brought you and what you will answer me with, 0*j !2" J^j} 4this Qur'an has been revealed to me that I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach.} Therefore, this Qur'an a warmer for alj those who hear of it. In another Ayah, Allah said, ijMry J^i 4But those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place.} [11:17] Ar-Rabl bin Anas said, Those who follow the Messenger of Allah ought to call to what the Messenger of Allah called to and warn against what he warned against. Allah said next, \$1\$} 4"Can you verity bear witness..."} O idolaters, 4"that besides Allah, there are other gods?" Say, "I bear no (such) witness!"} Similarly, in another Ayah, Allah said; ' 4J Z IjiLjS \$} 4Thert if they testify, testifyhot you with them.} [6:150] Allah said next, ft 4Say: "Only He is God, alone, and truly I am innocent of what you join in worship with Him."}

422 . And on the Day when We shall gather them all together, We shall say to those who joined partners in worship (with Us) : "Where are your partners (false deities) whom you used to assert (as partners in worship with Allah)? } 423 . There will then be (left) no Fitnah for them but to say: "By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others (in worship with Allah). } 424 . Look! How they lie against

themselves! But the (lie) which they invented will disappear from them.} 425 . And of them there are some who listen to you; but We have set veils on their hearts, so they understand it not, and deafness in their ears; if they see every one of the Ayat they will not believe therein; to the point that when they come to you to argue with you, those who disbelieve say: "These are nothing but tales of the men of old. } . And they prevent others from him and they themselves keep away from him, and (by doing so) they destroy none but themselves, yet they perceive (it) not.} The Polytheists Shall be Questioned About the Shirk They Committed About the polytheists, Allah said: iAnd on the Day when We shall gather them all together,} This is on the Day of Resurrection, when He will ask them about the idols and rivals that they worshipped instead of Him. Allah will say to them, iWhere are your partners (false deities) whom you used to assert (as partners in worship with Allah)?} Allah said in Surat Al-Qasas, & iS 4And (remember) the Day when He will call to them, and say, "Where are My (so-called) partners whom you used to assert? } [28 :62].

Allah's statement. iThere will then be (left) no Fitnah for them} means, argument. Ata Al-Khurasani said that, & i iThere will then be (left) no Fitnah for them in the face of the affliction that will be placed on them, 4c SZ it \$ ijli oi ibut to say: "By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others (in worship with Allah) Allah said next, >: , " > * \ " * f.t iLook! How they lie against themselves! But the (lie) which they invented will disappear from them.} which is similar to His other statement, jjAji j) J; & ijLJ. *yii oji ft Si f} &U. '4% \b j2 oe }Then it will be said to them : "Where are (all) those whom you used to join in worship as partners. Besides Allah?" They will say, "They have vanished from us: Nay, we did not invoke (worship) anything before." Thus Allah leads astray the disbelievers.} (40:73-74) The Miserable Do Not Benefit from the Qur'an Allah's statement, ! < ip o+ ; J cjiJ J <&>} iAnd of them there are some who listen to you ; but We have set veils on their hearts, so they understand it not, and deafness in their ears; if they see every one of the Ayat they will not believe therein;} (i) At-Tabari 1 1 : 299

means, they come to you, (O Muhammad jg), so that they hear you recite the Qur'an, but its recitation does not benefit them, because Allah has set veils on their hearts, and so they do not understand the Qur'an, il j PE& iand (set) deafness in their ears;) that prevents them from hearing what benefits them. In another Ayah, Allah said; ^ Cc (jbM=" cyj' 4A"(f the example of those who disbelieve, is as that of him who shouts at one who hears nothing but calls and cries.) [2:171] Allah said next, SZ4) iif they see every one of the Ayat they will not believe therein;) meaning, they will not believe in any of the Ayat, proofs, clear evidences and signs they witness because they do not have sound comprehension or fair judgment. In another Ayah, Allah said, iif &) iHad Allah known of any good in them, He would indeed have made them listen.) [8:23] Allah said, 4v*- fy&) ito the point that when they come to you to argue with you...) using falsehood against truth, ithose who disbelieve say : "These are nothing but tales of the men of old") The disbelievers say, what you (O Muhammad jg) brought us was taken from the books of those who were before us, meaning plagiarized, jl*" > ** X"4-

330 Tatsir Ibn Kathir 4And they prevent others from him and they themselves keep away from him,} They discourage people from following the truth, believing in Muhammad and obeying the Qur'an, 4&& iand they themselves keep away from him,} They thus combine both evil acts, for they neither benefit themselves, nor let others benefit from the Prophet 3g|. Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas

said that the Ayah, 4And they prevent others from him.} means, they hinder people from believing in Muhammad jg. Muhammad bin Al-Hanafiyyah said, The disbelievers of Quraysh used to refrain from meeting Muhammad -gj and they discouraged people from coming to him. 12* Similar was reported from Qatadah, Mujahid and Ad-Dahhak and several others. 4X%Gpi%& \$} iand (by doing so) they destroy not but themselves, yet they perceive (it) not.} At-Tabari 11 :311.Tabari 1 1 :31 1 [3 > At-Tabari 11 :312. J \r\ %ostsm piAyI > ijIIS (* > :Ar- 'sc >> ^") (^ ^dr' J 'J 0 iuifi

They destroy themselves by committing this evil action, and its harm will only touch them. Yet, they do not perceive this fact! J* \$\$\$&\$ ^ Yj iji ui. ijllii je \yt) H Itj jij} jt oi tfis& # a lira& is J? * ^ \$ ij*i> H 5y \$> j ch 4^^ u, (>/ i>' 427. If you could but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They will say: Would that we were but sent back (to the world)! Then we would not deny the Aydt of our Lord, and we would be of the believers!"} 428. Nay, what they had been concealing before has become manifest to them. But if they were returned (to the world), they would certainly revert to that which they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars.} 429. And they said: "There is no (other life) but our (present) life of this world, and never shall we be resurrected."} 430. If you could but see when they will stand before their Lord! He will say: "Is not this the truth?" They will say: "Yes, by our Lord!" He will then say: "So taste you the torment because you used not to believe."} Wishes and Hopes Do Not Help One When He Sees the Torment Allah mentions the condition of the disbelievers when they are made to stand before the Fire on the Day of Resurrection and witness its chains and restraints, along with seeing the horrible, momentous conditions in the Fire with their own eyes. This is when the disbelievers will say, * sps% i"Would that we were but sent back (to the world)! Then we would not deny the Aydt of our Lord, and we would be of the believers!"} They wish that they would be sent back to the life of the world so that they could perform righteous deeds, refrain from disbelieving in the Ayat of their Lord and be among the

332 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir believers. Allah said, * tfk ca "i: j.> iNay, what they had been concealing before has become manifest to them.} meaning, the disbelief, denial and rebellion that they used to hide in their hearts will then be uncovered, even though they will try to hide this fact in this life and the Hereafter. Earlier, Allah said, ifm ije ot% J3 j %} 4There will then be (left) no trial for them but to say: "By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others in worship with Allah." Look! How they lie against themselves! But the (lie) which they invented will disappear from them.} It is also possible that the meaning here is that the disbelievers will realize the truth that they knew all along in their hearts, that is, that what the Messengers brought them in this life is true, although they used to deny his Message before their followers. Allah said that Mdsa said to Fir awn, i';& Jftfj V]\$ \$ C3X&} i"Verily, you know that these signs have clearly been sent down by none but the Lord of the heavens and the earth as eye- opening evidence."} [17:102] Allah said about Fir awn and his people, tils \jjZStj} iAnd they belied them (those Aydt) wrongfully and arrogantly, though they were themselves convinced thereof.} (27:14) to lyf Vi j;Nay, it has become manifest to them wltat they had been concealing before.} [6:28] When this occurs, and the disbelievers ask to be returned to this life, they will not do so because they truly wish to embrace the faith. Rather, they ask to be returned to this life for fear of the torment that they are witnessing before them,

as punishment for the disbelief they committed, and to try and avoid the Fire that they see before their eyes. QW3& to iBut if they were returned, they would certainly revert to that which they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars.} meaning, they lie when they say they wish to go back to this life so that they can embrace the faith. Allah states that even if they were sent back to the life of this world, they will again commit the disbelief and defiance that they were prohibited. 4And indeed they are liars.} in their statement that, Cj UJaf GiG- ^ ^ j) j ftfoJ i Q by 4"Would that we were but sent back! Then we would not deny the Aydt of our Lord, and we would be of the believers! Nay, what they had been concealing before has become manifest to them. But if they were returned, they would certainly revert to that which they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars. And they said: "There is no (other life) but our (present) life of this world, and never shall we be resurrected."} Therefore, they will revert to their old behavior and say, i to iThere is no life but our life of this world} and there is no Hereafter, & to 4and never shall we be resurrected.} Allah said, 4rtj H ?sj to 4If you could but see when they will stand before their Lord!} in front of Him, 4"Is not this the truth?"} meaning, is not Resurrection true,

skin, awful odor, wearing dirty clothes, who will enter his grave with him. When the unjust person sees him, he will say, How ugly is your face! He will reply, So was your work, it was ugly. The unjust person will say, *How foul is the odor coming from you! He will reply, Such was the case with your work, it stunk. The unjust person will say, How dirty are your clothes! He will reply, And your work too was dirty. The unjust person will ask, Who are you? He will reply, I am your deeds. So he will remain with the unjust person in his grave, and when he is resurrected on the Day of Resurrection, his companion will say to him, In the life of the world, I used to carry you because you followed desire and lust. Today, you carry me. So he will ride on the unjust person's back and lead him until he enters the Fire. So Allah said, assm \rt % Cy0djjuoJ J&j ip#0 CsJS\$ SeS r > ^ " f - Sy'S"' f. *y". Vfes"y-"Vi^ jU \ {while they will bear their burdens on their backs; and evil indeed are the burdens that they will bear} [6:31 1 Allah's statement, At-Tabari 1 1 :328

336 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr)And the life of this world is nothing but play and amusement.) means, most of it is play and amusement, iBut far better is the abode of the Hereafter for those who have Taqwd. Will you not then understand?) u t&t gss v \$ sjj>; 4' ft 4 Z) 4 vi*- 1* '& ijj 'iU* , -dIV JiJj ji' p 4 " "J lii iCi j}j illL "IU' ^ Ct jl Jfjtj tj Ui oJJji *^CTto "if4A \$ Sj M f 433. We know indeed the grief which their words cause you; it is not you that they deny, but it is the verses of Allah that the wrongdoers deny.) 434. Verily, (many) Messengers were denied before you, but with patience they bore the denial, and they were hurt, till Our help reached them, and none can alter the Words of Allah. Surely, there has reached you the information about the Messengers (before you.) 435. If their aversion is hard on you, then if you were able to seek a tunnel in the ground or a ladder to the sky, so that you may bring them a sign. And had Allah willed, He could have gathered them together upon true guidance, so be not you one of the ignorant.) 436. It is only those who listen, that will respond, but as for the dead, Allah will raise them up, then to Him they will be returned.) Comforting the Prophet^ Allah comforts the Prophet jg in his grief over his people's denial and defiance of him,

Al-An'dm (33 - 36) (Part-7) }We know indeed the grief which their words cause you ;} meaning. We know about their denial of you and your sadness and sorrow for them. Allah said in other Ayat, juii ZIZ \$>} iSo destroy not yourself in sorrow for them (35:8), and it may be that you are going to kill yourself

with grief, that they do not become believers.} [26:3], and. fife iPerhaps, you, would kill yourself in grief, over their footsteps (for their turning away from you), because they believe not in this narration.} (18:6] Allah s statement, tit is not you that they deny, but it is the verses of Allah that the wrongdoers deny.} means, they do not accuse you of being a liar, v&j. 'JQ'j} ibut it is the Verses ofAllah that the wrongdoers deny.} It is only the truth that they reject and refuse. Muhammad bin Ishaq mentioned that Az-Zuhri said that Abu Jahl, Abu Sufyan Sakhr bin Harb and Al-Akhnas bin Shurayq once came to listen to the Prophet reciting the Qur an at night, but these three men were not aware of the presence of each other. So they listened to the Prophet s recitation until the morning, and then left. They met each other on their way back and each one of them asked the others, What brought you? So they mentioned to each other the reason why they came. They vowed not to repeat this incident so that the young men of Quraysh would not hear ofwhat they did and imitate them. On the second night, each one of the three came back thinking that the other two would not come because of the vows they made to each other. In the morning, they again met each other on their way back and criticized each other, vowing not to

Hereafter is for His believing servants. Allah said in other Ayat, p pi WA 4And, verily, Our Word has gone forth of old for Our servants, the Messengers. That they verily would be made triumphant. And that Our hosts, they verily would be the victors." (37:171-173], and, * - iAllah has decreed: "Verily! It is I and My Messengers who shall be the victorious Verily, Allah is All-Powerful, Almighty (58:21] Allah said; iSurely, there has reached you the information about the Messengers (before you).\$ who were given victory and prevailed over the people who rejected them. And you (O Muhammad jg), have a good example in them. Allah said next, 4If their aversion is hard on you ,^ and you cannot be patient because of their aversion, llU' 3 Lii jl 3, hi jp? 4then if you were able to seek a tunnel in the ground or a ladder to the sky.. .\$ Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented, If you were able to seek a tunnel and bring them an Ayah, or go up a ladder in the sky and bring a better Ayah than the one I (Allah) gave them, then do that. 111 Similar was reported from Qatadah, As-Suddi and others. Allah s statement, At-Tabari 11 :338. (2> At-Tabari 11 :338.

340 To, iAnd had Allah willed. He could have gathered them together upon true guidance, so be not you one of the ignorant is similar to His statement, (4^== ufjVf 4 t*Cj 5S } And had your Lord willed, those on earth would have believed, all ofthem together Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said about Allah s statement, 4And had Allah willed, He could have gathered them together upon true guidance,} The Messenger of Allah ^ was eager that all people believe and be guided to follow him. Allah told him that only those whose happiness Allah has written in the first Dhikr will believe. |11 Allah s statement. 4It is only those who listen, that will respond,} means, only those who hear the speech, comprehend and understand it, will accept your call, O Muhammad 3g! In another Ayah, Allah said; jc JjiK Ui. jjlT Jt jjul1 ^ iThat it may give warning to him who is living, and that the Word may be justified against the disbelievers.} [36:70], Allah s statement, i. ih fSgz ibut as for the dead, Allah will raise them up, then to Him they will be returned.} refers to the disbelievers because their hearts are dead. Therefore, Allah resembled them to dead corpses as a way of mocking and belittling them, saying, M f W frv. Taban 1 1 : 340 . Meaning those He had decreed to believe

ibut as for the dead (disbelievers), Allah will raise them up, then to Him they will be returned (for their recompense.) &'j h:% J# j"b s3 Xi 5 " -/ # ui^j u ^ JjL y l" Vj JfjK 4 Jt i*j Vdiit 4 ; ti usas, i;lr si*; is a

^& 4"ni ^ V- , "u iui 1 ** rJ j'f 437. And they said: "Why is not a sign sent down to him from his lord?" Say : "Allah is certainly able to send down a sign, but most of them know not.") . There is not a moving creature on earth, nor a bird that flies with its two wings, but are Umam like you. We have neglected nothing in the Book, then unto their Lord they (all) shall be gathered . 439. Those who reject Our Aydt are deaf and dumb in darkness. Allah sends astray whom He wills and He guides on the straight path whom He wills.) The Idolaters Ask for a Miracle Allah states that the idolaters used to proclaim, Why does not (Muhammad) bring an Ayah from his Lord, meaning, a miracle of their choice! They would sometimes say, & 4"We shall not believe in you, until you cause a spring to gush forth from the ground for us." [17:90]. 43Xi * % Jg J# J,s& iv 4Say ",Allah is certainly able to send down a sign, but most of them know not.") Certainly, Allah is able to send an Ayah (sign). But, He decided out of His wisdom to delay that, because if He sends an Ayah of their liking and they still do not believe, this will hasten their punishment as with the previous nations. Allah said in other Aydt, ijiiki SiCW ifo L41"j l,; **~=* J V) j)

iAnd nothing stops Us from sending the Aydt but that the people of old denied them. And We sent the she-camel to Thamud as a clear sign, but they did her wrong. And We sent not the signs except to warn, and to make them afraid (of destruction).} (17:59), and, if We will, We could send down to them from the heaven a sign, to which they would bend their necks in humility (26:4). The Meaning of Umam Allah said, iThere is not a moving (living) creature on earth, nor a bird that flies with its two wings, but are Umam like you.} Mujahid commented, Meaning, various species that have distinct names. 111 Qatadah said, Birds are an Ummah, humans are an Ummah and the Jinns are an Ummah. ' As- Suddi said that, ipti fA%} ibut are Umam like you.} means, creations (or species).131 Allah s statement, iWe have neglected nothing in the Book,} means, the knowledge about all things is with Allah, and He never forgets any of His creatures, nor their sustenance, nor their affairs, whether these creatures live in the sea or on land. In another Ayah, Allah said; At-Tabari 11:345. At-Tabari 11:345. At-Tabari 11:345.

It was also said that the Day of Resurrection gathers them, for in another Ayah, Allah said; iAnd when the wild beasts shall be gathered together.} [81:5) Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Abu Hurayrah said about Allah s statement, i/A ft) (3) at 4 ^ ft ibut are Umam like you. We have neglected nothing in the Book, then unto their Lord they (all) shall be gathered.} All creatures will be gathered on the Day of Resurrection, the beasts, birds and all others. Allah s justice will be so perfect, that the un-homed sheep will receive retribution from the homed sheep. Allah will then command them, *Be dust! This is when the disbeliever will say, 4 &&} i

344 Tafstr Ibn Kathir The Disbelievers will be Deaf and Mute in Darkness Allah said, 4Those who reject Our Ayat are deaf and dumb in darkness.} due to their ignorance, little knowledge and minute comprehension. Their example is that of the deaf-mute who cannot hear nor speak, as well as being blinded by darkness. Therefore, how can such a person find guidance to the path or change the condition he is in? Allah said in other Ayat, 4 \$35 a a'i fe C iitSl iTheir parable is that of one who kindled a fire; then, when it illuminated all around him, Allah took away their light and left them in darkness. (So) they could not see. They are deaf, dumb, and blind, so they return not (to the right path)} [2:17- 18], and, I't *' t* I? A* ' ^ i\ V"! o Ji" ^ jy -A-Jy y. gy y* ^ C.:l.bS ot A "-* b_y au' 2 iij jaMi iOr like the darkness in a vast deep sea, overwhelmed with a great wave topped by a great wave, topped by

dark clouds, darkness, one above another, if a man stretches out his hand, he can hardly see it! And he for whom Allah has not appointed light, for him there is no light.} [24:40] This is why Allah said here, iAllah sends astray whom He wills and He guides on the straight path whom He wills.} for He does what He wills with His creatures. 0^ Sy-X yS ittll j ji\ 4Am. (& } 'ijyOfafS U jj-jjj "Ii jl JjtX I t.fac* ofax J" (jyoixCi iL-t ,v"iW. jtlfcu JpxX Soj jj jJi tixji c& i&tt *\$ sgj & j3; \%z

Al-An'dm (40 - 45) (Part-7) 5*" ? (4 j^ CIj W :":o 2 % S c/J' ffS\ Jta i ^ A iif; iJub "^s ir 440. Say; "Te/i me if Allah's torment comes upon you, or the Hour comes upon you, would you then call upon any one other than Allah? (Reply) if you are truthful!"} 441 . Nay! To Him alone you call, and, if He willed, He would remove that (distress) for which you call upon Him, and you forget at that time whatever partners you joined with Him (in worship)!} 442. Verily, We sent (Messengers) to many nations before you. And We seized them with extreme poverty and loss of health so that they might believe with humility.} 443. When Our torment reached them, why then did they not believe with humility? But their hearts became hardened, and Shaytdn made fair-seeming to them that which they used to do.} 444. So, when they forgot (the warning) with which they had been reminded, We opened to them the gates of every (pleasant) thing, until in the midst of their enjoyment in that which they were given, all of a sudden, We took them to punishment, and lo! They were plunged into destruction with deep regrets and sorrows.}

Al-An'am (40 - 45) (Part-7) That is, loss of wealth and diminished provisions, 4atid loss of health} various illnesses, diseases and pain, &} so that they might believe with humility and call Allah and supplicate to Him with humbleness and humility. Allah said; iljCZ SJ. Vj5^ iWhen Our torment reached them, why then did they not believe with humility?} Meaning: Why do they not believe and humble themselves before Us when We test them with disaster? iBut their hearts became hardened,} for their hearts are not soft or humble, iand Shaytan made fair-seeming to them that which they used to do.} J That is. Shirk, defiance and rebellion. iSo, when they forgot (the warning) with which they had been reminded,} by ignoring and turning away from it, i,^ GZ} iWe opened to them the gates of everything,} Meaning: We opened the gates of provisions for them from wherever they wished, so that We deceive them. We seek refuge with Allah from such an end. This is why Allah said, lit until in the midst of their enjoyment in that which they were given,} such as wealth, children and provisions.

ijj) p&Q} i all of a sudden, We took them to punishment and lo! They were plunged into destruction with deep regrets and sorrows.} They have no hope for any type of good thing. Al-Hasan Al- Basri said, Whomever Allah gives provision and he thinks that Allah is not testing him, has no wisdom. Whomever has little provision and thinks that Allah will not look at (provide for) him, has no wisdom. He then recited the Ayah, rjji Cf*- U 'j i U-Uy <{So, w/jen they forgot (the warning) with which they had been reminded, We opened to them the. gates 0/ ei (pleasant) thing, until in the midst of their enjoyment in that which they were given, all of a sudden, We took them to punishment, and lo! They were plunged into destruction with deep regrets and sorrows.} He added, By the Lord of the Ka'baM Allah deceived these people, when He gave them what they wished, and then they were punished. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this statement.11 k fcs& 42 pz 52 4 %<} \$} K 2\$ ^ * ps& 4%'^ 446. Say: "Tell me, if Allah took away your hearing and your sight, and sealed up your hearts, is there a god other than Allah who could restore them to you?" See how variously We - explain the Aydt, yet they turn aside.} 447. Say:

"Tell me, if the punishment of Allah comes to you suddenly, or openly, will any be destroyed except the wrongdoing people?"} m Ad-DurrAl-ManthUr 3 :270 , Ibn Abi Hatim 4 :129 1

349 Surah 6^ Al-An'dm (46 - 49) (Part-7) . And We send not the Messengers but as givers of glad tidings and as warners . So whosoever believes and does righteous good deeds, upon such shall come no fear, nor shall , grieve.} ... 449. But those who reject Our Ayat, the torment will strike them for their rebelling.} Allah said to His Messenger, say,,O Muhammad to those rebellious liars, v iTell me, if Allah took away your hearing and your sight.} rA 'ju't as He gave these senses to*you. In another Ayah, Allah said; ^ m 4' 1} 4It is He Who has created you, and endowed you with hearing, seeing.} [67:23). The Ayah above might also mean that Allah will not allow the disbelievers to benefit from these senses in religious terms. This is why He said next, 4and sealed up your hearts, .} He also said in other Ayat, \$} 4Or who owns hearing and sight?} [10:31], and, ^ J/z at \pjdj} 4And know that Allah comes in between a person and his heart.} Allah said; ik ifr 4/s there a god other than Allah who could restore them to you?} Meaning, is there anyone except Allah who is able to give you back these senses if Allah took them from you? Only Allah is able to do so, and this is why He said here,

Al-An'am (50 - 54) (Part-7 iSo whosoever believes and does righteous good deeds. meaning, whoever believes in his heart with what the Messengers were sent with and makes his works righteous by imitating them; iupon such shall come no fear,\$ concerning the future, inor shall they grieve. about what they missed in the past and left behind them in this world. Certainly, Allah will be the Wall and Protector over what they left behind. Allah said next, Jii Ij"L>. (gj ./ ,s c ^ ^ -. 's.' : , *i '-*N_ j_pJajaJ j { JJ;Qijl s^i j\$ f & G. \$T iBut those who reject Our Ayat, the torment will strike them for their rebelling The torment will strike them because of disbelieving in the Message of the Messengers, defying Allah s commands, committing what He prohibited and transgressing His set limits. \$ Si 4iP Jit t? fiS%\$ & Jit V j J '&k Sj * jit; ig&fcsS ^ u S js jj& & - "l) CjP\$ ii (iitil gji* Vj clj o; ^ J^t \2-i-4 <, * X\Sx' . * s+* < A A ,/" * .i-rflf f (Uj ^ (v- w-" ^ ^Xm> U ojA^ -p Oj f'-k

352 Tafstr Ibn Kathir uj?"r! Oi jj ojUji iiiC. IjjJ i^tlj ill Jjt iLju ^ j, il(oi '*>" (^J J~i >> /j HJff ^__iJ J* pCjJ pS2f. jlil Jii CiJ*> y^c., " '.">. ". { ' ' t s .'. ss *^,-"-j j#4* a> nf"y o* v"l* >- />!+ 450. Say: "/ don't tell you that with me are the treasures of Allah, nor (that) I know the Unseen; nor do I tell you that I am an angel. / but follow what is revealed to me. Say: "Are die blind and the one who sees equal? Will you not then consider?'y 451. And warn therewith those wlv fear that they will be gathered before their Lord, when there will be neither a protector nor an intercessor for them besides Him, so that they may have Taqwa 452. And turn not away those who invoke their Lord, morning and evening seeking His Face. You are accountable for them in nothing, and they are accountable for you in nothing, that you may turn them away, and thus become of the wrongdoersy 453. Thus We have tried some of them with others, that they might say : "Is it these (poor believers) that Allah has favored from amongst us?" Does not Allah know best those wlv are grateful?} 454. When those wlv believe in Our Ayat come to you, say: "Saldmun 'Alaykum (peace be on you); your Lord has written mercyfor Himself, so that, ifany ofyou does evil in ignorance, and thereafter repents and does righteous good deeds, then surely, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Mercifully TheMessengerNeitherhas theKey to Allah'sTreasures, NorKnows the Unseen Allah said to His Messenger 4^' os*>- 4 Jy'V J*) 4Say: "I don't tell you that with me are the treasures of Allah "" meaning, I do not own Allah s treasures or have any power over them,

jSa%} 4"or (that) I know the Unseen,} and I do not say that I know the Unseen, because its knowledge is with Allah and I only know what He conveys of it to me. inor I tell you that I am an angel.} meaning, I do not claim that I am an angel. I am only a human to whom Allah sends revelation, and He honored me with this duty and favored me with it. ih Irk dj\$& 41 but follow what is revealed to me.} and I never disobey the revelation in the least. jfZ JS \$} iSay: "Are the blind and the one who sees equal? } meaning, Is the one who is guided, following the truth, equal to the one misled? ilf&l <&} iWill you not then consider?} In another Ayah, Allah said; 4\$Vi ijji iShall he then who knows that ivhal has been revealed to you from your Lord is the truth, be like him who is blind? But it is only the men ofunderstanding that pay heed.} (13:19] Allah s statement, Vj elf S4 di J oyC* ukf *> j dj} iAnd warn therewith those who fear that they will be gathered before their Lord, when there will be neither a protector nor an intercessorfor them besides Him,} means, warn with this Qur an, O Muhammad jg, C1L 'jt pX jk\} \$Those who live in awe for fear of their Lord} [23:57], who,

354 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir {j ^ iFear their Lord, and dread the terrible reckoning.} [13:21], JI ^ o>&} 4those whofear that they will be gathered before their Lord,} on the Day of Resurrection, iwhen there will be neither a protector nor an intercessor for them besides Him,} for on that Day, they will have no relative or intercessor who can prevent His torment ifHe decides to punish them with it, 4so that they may have Taqwa.} Therefore, warn of the Day when there will be nojudge except Allah, iso that they may have Taqwa.} and thus work good deeds in this life, so that their good deeds may save them on the Day of Resurrection from Allah s torment, and so that He will grant them multiple rewards. Prohibitingthe MessengerfromTurningtheWeakAway and the Order to HonorThem 4 Allah said, f 2> ^j} 4And turn not away those who invoke their Lord, morning and evening seeking His Face.} meaning, do not turn away those who have these qualities, instead make them your companions and associates. In another Ayah, Allah said;

Al-An'am (50 - 54) (Part-7) \$And keep yourself patiently with those who call on their Lord morning and evening, seeking His Face, and let not your eyes overlook them, desiring the pomp and glitter of the life of the world; and obey not him whose heart We have made heedless of Our remembrance, one who follows his own lusts and whose affair (deeds) has been /osf.>[18:28] Allah s statement, iinvoke their Lord...} refers to those who worship Him and supplicate to Him, imorning and evening.} referring to the obligatory prayers, according to Said bin Al-Musayyib, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and Qatadah. In another Ayah, Allah said; iAnd your Lord said, "Invoke Me, I will respond (to your invocation)." [40:60], I will accept your supplication. Allah said next, " 4seeking His Face.} meaning, they seek Allah s Most Generous Face, by sincerity for Him in the acts ofworship and obedience they perform. Allah said; iYou are accountable for them in nothing, and they are accountablefor you in nothing,} This is similar to the answer Nflh gave to his people when they said, 4S&V?& Si >\$} iSltall we believe in you, when the meekest (of the people) fallow you?" [26:111]. NOh answered them, 'jir*-* j) ^r ' -5- Uj U>>

"\ 'S l_4r ' t* (&& iHad it been a good thing, they (weak and poor) would not have preceded us to it!) [46:11], and, H&1 iV& Jtt I & ^i"} iAnd when Our clear verses are recited to them, those who disbelieve say to those who believe : "Which of the two groups is best in position and station." [19:73] Allah said in reply, 4 ^ (U jj & (4 * S3iS -\$> } }And how many a generation (past nations) have We destroyed before them, who were better in wealth, goods and outward appearance?} [19:74]. Here,

Allah answered the disbelievers when they said, J# Lry "if 4 Is it these (poor believers) that Allah has favored from amongst us?" Does not Allah know best those who are grateful?} Meaning is not Allah more knowledgeable of those who thank and appreciate Him in statement, action and heart? Thus Allah directs these believers to the ways of peace, transfers them from darkness to light by His leave, and guides them to the straight path. In another Ayah, Allah said; 4As for those who strive hard for Us (Our cause), We will surely guide them to Our paths (i.e. Allah's religion). And verily, Allah is with the doers ofgood"} [29:69]. An authentic Hadlth states, Ji M Ji% J M n ai "Allah does not look at your shapes or colors, but He looks at your heart and actions. n 1 4: 1987.

Allah s statement, jii I'Zr fy} iWhen those who believe in Our Aydt come to you, say: "Salamun Alaykum" (peace be on you);} means, honor them by returning the Saldm and give them the good news of Allah s exclusive, encompassing mercy for them. So Allah said; iyour Lord has written Mercyfor Himself,} meaning, He has obliged His Most Honored Self to grant mercy, as a favor, out of His compassion and beneficence, iSo that, ifany ofyou does evil in ignorance. . .} as every person who disobeys Allah does it in ignorance, iand thereafter repents and does righteous good deeds,} by repenting from the sins that he committed, intending not to repeat the sin in the future, but to perform righteous deeds, fv j** P*} ithen surely, He is Oft-Forgiving Most Merciful.} Imam

^ J* '^jA- ^^ 'H -** (^=5, *| y^ g' J* > ' ce o"j* Ji"jj jo j 2Jf jjLillii u . u -x ="j aj o* ^ ,; .a. ~ ..ttf . . -f .1 f, /* *c . , 455. And thus do We explain the Ayat in detail, that the way of the criminals, may become manifest.} 456. Say: "I have been forbidden to worship those whom you invoke (worship) besides AUdh. Say: ",I will not follow your vain desires. If I did, I would go astray, and I would not be one of the rightly guided. } 457. Say: "I am on clear prooffrom my Lord, but you deny it. I do not have what you are hastily seeking (the torment). The decision is only for Allah, He declares the truth, and He is the best ofjudges. } 455. Say: "If I had that which you are asking for impatiently (the torment), the matter would have been settled at once between you and I, but Allah knows best the wrongdoers."} 459. And with Him are the keys of tlte Ghayb (all that is hidden), none knows them but He. And He knows whatever there is on the land and in the sea; not a leaf falls, but he knows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anythingfresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.} TheProphet^UnderstandsWhatHeConveys;Torment is in Allah s Hands Not the Prophet's Allah says, just as We mentioned the clear signs that testify and direct to the path of guidance, all the while chastising useless arguments and defiance, 4?i J"5 > iAnd thus do We explain the Ayat in detail,} that is, whatever responsible adults need explained to them, in the affairs of life and religion,

360 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir 4.3%-J ' Xk Uf Q>) iThat the way of the criminals may become manifest.) so that the path of the criminals who defy the Prophets is apparent and clear. This Ayah was also said to mean, so that you, O Muhammad jg, are aware of the path of the criminals. Allah s statement, 4oj ci &4 \$) 4Say: "I am on clear prooffrom my Lord...) means: I have a clear understanding of the Law of Allah that He has revealed to me, ibut you deny it.) meaning, but you disbelieve in the truth that came to me from Allah. 4*U '- e) 41 do not have what you are hastily seeking) meaning, the torment, 4k^ & iThe decision is only for Allah,) for the ruling of this is with Allah. If He wills, He will punish you soon in response to your wish! If He wills, He will give you respite, out of His great wisdom. This is why Allah said, iHe declares the truth, and He is the best ofjudges.) and the best in reckoning between His

servants. Allah's statement, *41^=s^tj jiVt5^ H it 4Say* : "If I had that which you are asking for impatiently (the torment), the matter would have been settled at once between you and I," means, if I have what you ask for, I will surely send down what you deserve of it, (jJUi iuij) ibut Allah knows best the wrongdoers)

Someone might ask about the meaning of this Ayah compared to the Hadith in the Two Sahihs, from Aishah, may Allah be pleased with her, that she said to the Messenger, O Allah's Messenger jg! Have you encountered a day harder than the day (of the battle) of Uhud? The Prophet sg replied, t/r41 C- vi-jJ 13 xil jJSj Irt lib <_ u i.j'isxs. j, jJtJil* J,\ t^iUa ai >^~i uf c-iiy n_JUi! jyb Ml jjiil jUi i "dijji -" -li)1 jl : Jlii ij*^Jl ^ifor tfj li)i o^tli t j" C-X-* l"J i ij11 I tllLa JjLJj iJju liilip IjJj Uj Itijj Jji jj)1 jj !jIA< 13 :Jli p kQZ. jjL-j JC siiU Jalii oi tii ii^iL ivliiJj ^ jji iJjJ drJ ^ J ^Ht ?&' Jj-'j "j3Ll>-Sll iLi ", ^ M 33)1 J^ 'J* }r lYour people have troubled me alot and the worst trouble was on the day of Aqabah when I presented myself to Ibn 'Abd Ydlil bin 'Abd Kuldl, who did not respond to my call. So I departed, overwhelmed with severe sorrow, proceeded on and could not relax until I found myself at Qam Ath-Tha'dlib where I raised my head towards the sky to see a cloud unexpectedly shading me. I looked up and saw jibril in it and he called me saying, 'Indeed Allah has heard what you said to the people and what they have responded to you. Therefore, Allah has sent the Angel of the Mountains to you so that you may order him to do whatever you wish to these people. The Angel of the Mountains called and greeted me, and then said, 'O Muhammad! verily, Allah has heard how your people responded to you and He has sent me to you so that you could order me to do what you wish. If you like, I will let Al-Akhshabayn (two mountains to the north and south of Makkah) fall on them. The Prophet said, No, but I hope that Allah will let them generate offspring who will worship Allah Alone, and will worship none besides Him.'" {1} IM FathAl-B&ri 6 :360 , Muslim 3 : 1420

362 Tafoir Ibtt Kathir This is the wording of

Al-An'dm (60 - 62) (Part-7 All-Aware} " [31:34].m Allah's statement, &\$a c iAttd He kttows whatever there is on the land and in the sea;} means, Allah's honored knowledge encompasses everything, including the creatures living in the sea and on land, and none of it, not even the weight of an atom on earth or in heaven, ever escapes His knowledge. Allah's statement, Ji Cj} inot a leaffalls, but He blows it.} means, He knows the movements of everything including inanimate things. Therefore, what about His knowledge of the living creatures, especially, those whom the Divine laws have been imposed upon such as mankind and the Jinns? In another Ayah, Allah said; Cj pz} iAllah knows the fraud of the eyes, and all that the breasts conceal.} [40:19] J \r" saiposssm .&) p'&j'Uit 0igx Ij\0 .c. yt,js < > < 'Site -is' Jr jC^ jU^> ijil y"j^ k#? &% pr u* y &\ Ml Fath Al-Bdri8:141.

364 Tafsxr Ibn Kathir Jl \%? H&& m P** SfiS. 460. It is He, Who takes your souls by night (when you are asleep), and has knowledge of all that you have done by day, then he raises (wakes) you up again, that a term appointed be fulfilled, then (in the end), unto Him will be your return. Then He will inform you of what you used to do.} 461. He is the Qdhir over His servants, and He sends guardians over you, until when death approaches one of you, Our messengers take his soul, and they never neglect their duty.} 462. Then they are returned to Allah, their Master, the Just Lord. Surely, His is the judgment and He is the swiftest in taking account.} The Servants are in Allah's Hands Before and After Death Allah states that He brings death to His servants in then- sleep at night, for sleep is minor death. Allah said in

other Ayat, 4And (remember) when Allah said: "O Isa! I will take you and raise you to Myself... } [3:55], and, t" ,j jJZ jJ ujft) ijri 4j^& dl&&S opt 4It is Allah Who takes away the souls at the time of their death, and those that die not during their sleep. He keeps those (souls) for which He has ordained death and sends the rest for a term appointed.}[39A2\, thus mentioning both minor and major death. Allah says, 4\$\ j"j} 4It is He, Wlto takes your souls by night (when you are asleep), and has knowledge of all that you have done by day,}

meaning, He knows the deeds and actions that you perform during the day. This Ayah demonstrates Allah's perfect knowledge of His creation, by day and night, and in their movements and idleness. Allah said in other Ayat, it is the same (to Him) whether any of you conceal his speech or declare it openly, whether he be hid by night or go forth freely by day.) [13:10], and - j4* otj) it is out of His mercy that He made night and day, so that you may rest therein, by night, iand that you may seek of His bounty by day. Allah said, 'J GZj jlf&) iAnd (We) have made the night as a covering. And (We) have made the day for livelihood.) [78:10-11]. Allah said here, it is He, Who takes your souls by night (when you are asleep), and has knowledge of all that you have done by day,) [6:60], Then said, it then he raises (wakes) you up again,) by day, according to Mujahid, Qatadah and As-Suddi. Allah's statement, IP &*I) it that a term appointed be fulfilled) refers to the life span of every person, m At-Tabari 5:212.

it then (in the end), unto Him will be your return. on the Day of Resurrection, p Kt ft?,p iThen He will inform you of what you used to do.} He will reward you, good for good, and evil for evil. Allah's statement, s*jt 4He is the Qahir over His servants.} The Qahir means, the one who controls everything, all are subservient to His supreme grace, greatness and majesty, iand He sends guardians over you,} angels who guard mankind. In another Ayah, Allah said; .. il 4For each (person), there are angels in succession, before and behind him. They guard him by the command of Allah.} 113:11], watching his deeds and recording them. Allah said, 4But verily, over you (are appointed angels in charge of mankind) to watch you.} [82:10], and, vib V] 02 JiiL ifrf ge, if yUUJ' Jk. 4(Remember!) that the two receivers (recording angels) receive, one sitting on the right and one on the left. Not a word does he utter, but there is a watcher by him, ready.} [50:17-18]. Allah's statement, pi& ""*&} ^until when death approaches one of you...} refers to, when one's life span comes to an end and he is dying,

iOur messengers take his soul ...^ meaning, there are angels who are responsible for this job. Ibn Abbas and several others said that the Angel of Death has angels who pull the soul from its body and when it reaches the throat, the Angel of Death captures it.¹¹ ' Allah said; iand they never neglect their duty.)> They guard the soul of the dead person and take it to wherever Allah wills, to IUiyym if he was among the righteous, and to Styth * if he was among the wicked (disbelievers, sinners, etc.), we seek refuge with Allah from this end. Allah said next, iThen they are returned to Allah, their Master, the Just Lord.> Imam

iSay: (Yes) verily, those of old, and those of later times. All will surely be gathered together for an appointed meeting of a known Day."} [56:49-50] and, jiU j}i f&Z-jAnd We shall gather them all together so as to leave not one of them behind...} [18:47] until, iAnd your Lord treats no one with injustice.} [18:49] Allah said here, P%P 3* & } it their Master, the just Lord. Surely, His is the judgement and He is the swiftest in taking account.} [6:62] Xm /*)'> jil J Jitft 2 5 \$? yjr jf &S i ^ \$ft# " \$-& i* "3i 5 463. Say: "W/io resales you from the dark recesses of the land and the sea, when you call

upon Him begging and in secret (saying) : IfHe (Allah) only saves us from these (dangers), we shall truly be grateful."} 464. Say: Allah rescues you from these (dangers) andfrom all distress, and yet you commit Shirk."} 465. Say: He has the power to send torment on you from above orfrom under your feet, or to Yalbisakum in party strife, and make you taste the violence of one another." See how variously We explain the Ayat, so that they may understand.} Allah s Compassion and Generosity, and His Power and Torment Allah mentions how He favors His servants, saving them during times of need, in the darkness of land and at sea, such as when storms strike. In such cases, they call on Allah alone, without partners, in supplication. In other Ayat, Allah said.

370 Tafsir Ibrt Kathfr ik fy) iAnd when harm strikes you at sea, those that you call upon besides Him vanishfrom you except Him.) [17:67], * eVJm Vte-j ^ ^ jjl ^ af ijs in jJ\$ ^\$ *gx fa iHe it is Who enables you to travel through the land and the sea, till when you are in the ships and they sail with them with a favorable wind, and they rejoice, then comes a stormy wind and the waves come to them from all sides, and they think that they are encircled therein, they invoke AIM, making theirfaith pure far Him alone, saying: If You deliver us from this, we shall truly be of the grateful .) [10:22], and, iff) 'ffa \$\$ & tfr Sf i ils not He (better than your gods) Wlw guides you in the darkness of the land and the sea, and Who sends the winds as heralds of glad tidings, going before His mercy? Is there any god with Allah? High Exalted be AIM above all that they associate as partners (with Him)!) [27:63]. Allfih said in this honorable Ayah, jffri jK if iSay : Who rescues you from the dark recesses of the land and the sea, when you call upon Him begging and in secret.) i.e., in public and secret, 4&4) 4(Saying): 'IfHe (Allah) only saves us...) from this distress, 4U&* U iwe shall truly be grateful.) thereafter. Allah said, ^ y

iSay: "Allah rescues you from these (dangers) and from all distress , and yet you commit Shirk."} meaning, yet you call other gods besides Him in times of comfort. Allah said; 4S"y; "He /ias the power to send torment on youfrom above or from under yourfeet, } He said this after His statement, 4&P ^And yet you commit Shirk.} Allah said next, 1Z jjUt y iSay: "He has the power to send torment on you.."}, after He saves you. Allah said in Surah Subhan (chapter 17), p fy i&z ot s# 43 p 0& \$ j(U fui V1 oyi y 4 ^ j iu4 ^ y jji' viC 3 i ,s i^ O* yt 2r* J ^ . iYour Lord is He Wlw drives the ship for you through the sea, in order that you may seek of His bounty. Truly! He is Ever Merciful towards you. And when harm strikes you upon the sea, those that you call upon besides Him vanish from you except Him. But when He brings you safely to land, you turn away (from Him). And man is ever ungrateful. Do you then feel secure that He will not cause a side of the land to swallow you up, or that He will not send against you a storm ofstones? Then, you shall find no guardian. Or do you feel secure that He will not send you back a second time to sea, and send against you a hurricane ofwind and drown you because ofyour disbelief, then you will not find any avenger therein against Us?} (17:66-69). Al-Bukhari, may Allah grant him His mercy, commented on Allah s statement,

372 Tafstr Ibn Kathir frXr}^ Ji j' J 6i&& j 3* J\$ Ji&' > " i 4SS p *#f4^ oT j& jk %z iSay : "He has the power to send torment on youfrom above or from under your feet, or to Yalbisakum in party strife, and make you taste the violence ofone another." See haw variously We explain the Ayat, so that they may understand.) Yalbisakum means, cover you with confusion , So it means to, divide into parties and sects . Jabir bin Abdullah said, "When this Ayah was revealed, 40 Jjfif 2 \$) 4Say: "He has power to send torment on youfrom above") Allah s Messenger jg said, "/ seek refuge with Your Face ." 4'0\$ at

Aprfrom under yourfeet,) he^ again said, ijf,i "/ seek refuge with Your Face ." 4c5 ! aX fk*. AjiJ 0).& 4or to cover you with confusion in party strife, and make you to taste the violence of one another.) he jg said, jt jy ;JU> uThis is less burdensome or easiery |1)

above us and He gave me that. I asked my Lord not to cover us with confusion in party strife, but He refused.^

J rnsn Kap <^ypjj^J~bt i[r*jmP liit ^ !&& (L j2\I^JJ^~i^jV '4u;k.'-'^^ 'iS\$ 0^S\y^%\ls\j^p^'. j" ' yy y J? J& t ^t <&^ ^ \$f)&& sa#^ J^iS U\$1 ti vAy* U\$) t *f . / {>^ ^ -iff' v**~ 4 O'*" rr -Uf JUUJ V* ^Jbu ll ^Ugto U os && & " 0^r4j S^; iA-i . But your people have denied it (the Qur'an) though it is the truth. Say: "I am not responsible for your affairs. } 467. For every news there is a reality and you will come to know.} 468. And when you see those who engage in false conversation about Our verses (of the Qur'an) by mocking at them, stay away from them till they turn to another topic. And if Shaytdn causes you to forget, then after the remembrance, sit not you in the company of those people who are the wrongdoers.} 469. There is no responsibility for them upon those who have Taqwa, but (their duty) is to remind them, that they may (attain) Taqwa.} The Invitation to the Truth is Guidance Without Coercion Allah said, U4"> 4But have denied it} denied the Qur'an, guidance and clear

376 Tafsir IbtI Kathir explanation that you (OMuhammad jg) have brought them. A your people} meaning, Quraysh, &%) it though it is the truth.} beyond which there is no other truth. cJ } ASay: "I am not responsible for your affairs."} meaning, I have not been appointed a guardian or watcher over you. Allah also said; 'XL i*,^ ^ J,j} 4And say: The truth is from your Lord." Then whosoever wills, let him believe, and whosoever wills, let him disbelieve.} [18:29], This means, my duty is to convey the Message and your duty is to hear and obey. Those who follow me, will acquire happiness in this life and the Hereafter. Those who defy me will become miserable in this life and the Hereafter. So Allah said; 4f r every news there is a reality...} meaning, for every news, there is a reality, in that, this news will occur, perhaps after a while, according to Ibn Abbas and others. Allah said in other Ayat, AAnd you shall certainly know the truth of it after a while } [38:88] and, fipy 4(For) each and every matter there is a decree (from Allah).} [13:38], This, indeed, is a warning and a promise that will surely occur,

4oilli 4and you will come to know.} Allah's statement, ^And when you see those who engage in false conversation about Our verses (of the Qur'an)}, by denying and mocking them.

The Prohibition of Sitting with Those Who Deny and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1699–1739]

Mock Allah's Ayat r --i~ 4 3r*&. frr^ Jy&f istay away from them till they turn to another topic.} until they talk about a subject other than the denial they were engaged in. f &J. fy} 4And if Shaytan causes you to forget...} This command includes every member of this Ummah. No one is to sit with those who deny and distort Allah's Ayat and explain them incorrectly. If one forgets and sits with such people, 4then after the remembrance sit not you} after you remember, 4in the company of those people who are the wrongdoers.}. A Hadith states, (k^Jl "My Ummah was forgiven unintentional errors, forgetfulness and what they are coerced to do. The Ayah above [6:68] is the Ayah mentioned in Allah's statement, 111 Ibn Majah 1 :659.

<*\$ tij, 4 Jy 'Si ~S\ v-s* * "> 4 !> y -" 4And if /ws already been revealed to you in the Book that when you hear the Verses ofAllah being denied and mocked at, then sit not with them, until they engage in a talk other than that; (but if you stayed with them) certainly in that case you would be like them.} [4:140], for, if you still sit with them, agreeing to what they say, you will be just like them. Allah s statement, 4* -"l Oi iyiii ZZjM iThere is no responsibility for them upon those who have Taqwa,} means, when the believers avoid sitting with wrongdoers in this case, they will be innocent of them and they will have saved themselves from their sin. Allah s statement, ibut (their duty) is to remind them, that they may avoid that.}, means, We commanded you to ignore and avoid them, so that they become aware of the error they are indulging in, that they may avoid this behavior and never repeat it again. & Q*If Xfc <&a fci & "3 jll ifi Ci J-J els' Cj ijf ^ ji ^ 'U . And /eae alone those who take their religion as play and amusement, and are deceived by the life of this world. But remind (them) with it (the Qur an) lest a soul Tubsal for that which one has earned, when he will find for himself no protector or intercessor besides Allah, and even ifhe offers every ransom, it will not be accepted from him. Such are they who are given up to destruction because of that which they have earned. For them uhll be a drink of boiling water and a painful

Al-An'dm (70) (Part-7) torment because they used to disbelieve . Allah said, 5 CJ &3& 4A"d leave alone those who take their religion as play and amusement, and are deceived by the life of this world.} The Ayah commands to leave such people, ignore them and give them respite, for soon, they will taste a tremendous torment. This is why Allah said, iBut remind with it} meaning, remind the people with this Qur an and warn them against Allah s revenge and painful torment on the Day of Resurrection. Allah said; Ct 2 3 ilest a soul Tubsalfor that which one has earned,} meaning, so that it is not Tubsal. Ad-Qahhak from Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan and As-Suddi said that Tubsal means, be submissive.¹¹¹ Al-Walibi said that Ibn Abbas said that Tubsal means, be exposed .¹²¹ Qatadah said that Tubsal means, be prevented ,¹³¹ Murrah and Ibn Zayd said that it means, be recompensed ,¹⁴¹ Al-Kalbi said, be reckoned .¹⁵¹ All these statements and expressions are similar, for they all mean exposure to destruction, being kept away from all that is good, and being restrained from attaining what is desired. Allah also said; iEvery person is restrained by what he has earned. Except those on the Right.} [74:38-39), and 'Ij hfi '-VI* Oi& At-Tabari 11 :443.Tabari 11 :444. At-Tabari 11 :443. At-Tabari 11 :443. At-Tabari 11 :444.

Al-An'dm (71 - 73) (Part-7 is He to Whom you shall be gathered> 473. It is He Who has created the heavens and the earth in truth, and on the Day He will say: "Be!" it shall become. His Word is the truth. His will be the dominion on the Day when the Sur will be blown. All-Knower of the unseen and the seen. He is the All-Wise, Well-Aware> The Parable ofThoseWhoRevertto DisbeliefAfterFaith and Good Deeds As-Suddi said, Some idolators said to some

^calling him} by his name, his father s and his grandfather s names. So he follows the devils call thinking that it is a path of guidance, but by the morning he will find himself destroyed and perhaps they eat him. The Jinns will then let him wander in a wasteland where he will die of thirst. This is the example of those who follow the false gods that are being worshipped instead of Allah, Most Honored. Ibn Jarir also recorded thisJ Allah said, ji j'A iSay: "Verily, Allah's guidance is the only guidance,"} Allah said in other instances, 4J-4 < > } }And whomsoever Allah guides, for him there will be none to

misguide him.} [39:37], and, i 1 * Z ilf you covet for their guidance, then verily Allah guides not those whom He makes to go astray. And they will have no helpers.} [17:37] Allah s statement, iAA A, 'xA&y3} iand we have been commanded to submit to the Lord of all that exists.} means, we were commanded to worship Allah in sincerity to Him alone, without partners. iAnd to perform the Salah, and have Taqwa ofHim.} meaning, we were commanded to perform the prayer and to fear Allah in all circumstances, A ttJ%} [ii At-Tabari 11:452.

Al-An'am (71 - 73) (Part-7) iand it is He to Whom you shall be gathered.} on the Day of Resurrection. ^ ^%} ilt is He Who has created the heavens and the earth in truth.} meaning, in justice, and He is their Originator and Owner Who governs their affairs and the affairs of their inhabitants. Allah said, 4and on the Day He will say: "Be!" it shall become.} Referring to the Day of Resurrection, which will come faster than the blink of an eye, when Allah says to it, Be. As-Sur; The Trumpet Allah s statement, 4 } ion the Day when the Sur will be blown.. .} refers to His statement, iand on the Day He will say: "Be!" it shall become.} as we stated above. Or, it means, i)&\ 4& Jjj\$%} iHis will be the dominion on the Day when the Sur will be blown.} Allah said in other Aydt, ij&X a jyS cfi} iWhose is the kingdom this Day? It is Allah s, the One, the Irresistible!} (40:16), and, iThe sovereignty on that Day will be the true (sovereignty), belonging to the Most Beneficent (Allah), and it will be a hard Dayfor the disbelievers.} [25:26] The Sur is the Trumpet into which the angel Isr&fil, peace be

* /i,s t- TjJa JljajSjjCullU ICJll2^ CiJCalf itig the command to blow <*s* - -, 'Csn Z>'z, 1 in if.

in manifest error. } 475. Thus did we show Ibrahim the kingdom of the heavens and the earth that he be one of those who havefaith with certainty.} 476. When the night overcame him he saw a Kawkab. He said: "This is my lord." But when it Afala, he said: "I like not those that set.}" 477. When he saw the moon rising up, he said: This is my lord. But when it set, he said: "Unless my Lord guides me, I shall surely be among the misguided people.}" 478. When he saw the sun rising up, he said: "This is my lord. This is greater." But when it Afalat, he said: "O my people! I am indeed free from all that you join as partners in worship with Allah .} 479. Verily, I have turned my face towards Him Who has created the heavens and the earth, Hanifan, and I am not of the idolators. } Ibrahim Advises his Father Ibrahim advised, discouraged and forbade his father from worshipping idols, just as Allah stated, # CCJ jji: ju \ \j} 4And (remember) when Ibrahim said to his father Azar: Do you take idols as gods?"} meaning, do you worship an idol instead of Allah? 4Verily, I see you and your people...} who follow your path, 4\$4 4in manifest error} wandering in confusion unaware of where to go. Therefore, you are in disarray and ignorance, and this fact is clear to all those who have sound reason. Allah also said,

-11, df^t & v'j ^- *i ^ \$% J J*bb^^ ft \$-S 2&\$ ic*J *Sjb vt 5^- jj ijMS *i' i " jj"-1" ;w.t. 4A"d mention in the Book (the Qur'an, the story of) Ibrahim. Verily! He was a man of truth, a Prophet. When he said to his father: "O my father! Why do you worship that which hears not, sees not and cannot avail you in anything? O my father! Verily! There has come to me ofknowledge that which came not unto you. So follow me. I will guide you to a straight path. O my father! Worship not Shaytan. Verily! Shaytan has been a rebel against the Most Beneficent (Allah). O my father! Verily! I fear lest a torment from the Most Beneficent (Allah) overtakes you, so that you become a companion of Shaytan (in the Hell- fire). He (the father) said: "Do you reject my gods, O Ibrahim? Ifyou stop not (this), I will indeed stone you. So get awayfrom me safely before l punish you. Ibrahim said: "Peace be on you! I will askforgiveness

of my Lord for you. Verily! He is unto me, Ever Most Gracious. And I shall turn away from you and from those whom you invoke besides Allah. And I shall call on my Lord; and I hope that I shall not be unanswered in my invocation to my Lord." [19:41-48] Ibrahim continued asking for forgiveness for his father for the rest of his father's life. When his father died an idolator and Ibrahim realized this fact, he stopped asking Allah for forgiveness for him and disassociated himself from him. Allah said, "And invoking for his father's forgiveness was only because of a promise he had made to him. But when it became clear to him that he was an enemy to Allah, he dissociated himself from him. Verily Ibrahim was patient in supplication and forbearing. [9:114].

It was recorded in the Sahih that Ibrahim will meet his father Azar on the Day of Resurrection and Azar will say to him, My son! This Day, I will not disobey you. Ibrahim will say, O Lord! You promised me not to disgrace me on the Day they are resurrected; and what will be more disgraceful to me than cursing and dishonoring my father? Then Allah will say, O Ibrahim! Look behind you! He will look and there he will see (that his father was changed into) a male hyena covered in dung, which will be caught by the legs and thrown in the (Hell) Fire. 111 Tawhid. Becomes Apparent to Ibrahim Allah's statement, "Thus did I've show Ibrahim the kingdom of the heavens and the earth..." [6:75], means, when he contemplated about the creation of the heaven and earth, We showed Ibrahim the proofs of Allah's Oneness over His dominion and His creation, which indicate that there is no god or Lord except Allah. Allah said in other Ayat, "Say: "Behold all that is in the heavens and the earth." [10:101], and, "I see they do not know what is before them and what is behind them, of the heaven and the earth? If We will, We sink the earth with them, or cause a piece of the sky to fall upon them. Verily, in this is a sign for every servant who turns to Allah." [34:9] Allah said next, Path Al-Bdri 6:445. There are a number of reasons explained for this incident, among them, that Ibrahim will not feel disgraced by seeing a dung-covered hyena thrown in the Fire, and that this is the true worth of his father. See the reference given for more comments

When the night overcame him, he covered him with darkness, and he saw a Kawkab a star. He said: "This is my lord" But when it set, he said, "This is not my lord." Qatadah commented, Ibrahim knew that his Lord is Eternal and never ceases. "I saw the moon rising up, he said: "This is my lord." But when it set, he said: "Unless my Lord guides me, I shall surely be among the misguided people." When he saw the sun rising up, he said: "This is my lord." This radiating, rising star is my lord, and this is greater than the star and the moon, and more so. But when it set, he said: "O my people! I am indeed free from all that you join as partners in worship with Allah. Verily, I have turned my face..." meaning, I have purified my religion and made my worship sincere, in At-Jabari 1:480

He said, "I have turned my face towards Him Who has created the heavens and the earth," Who originated them and shaped them without precedence, in Hanifan avoiding Shirk and embracing Tawhid. This is why he said next, "and I am not of the idolaters." Prophet Ibrahim Debates with his People We should note here that, in these Ayat, Ibrahim, peace be upon him, was debating with his people, explaining to them the error of their way in worshipping idols and images. In the first case with his father, Ibrahim explained to his people their error in worshipping the idols of earth, which they made in the shape of heavenly angels, so that

they intercede on their behalf with the Glorious Creator. His people thought that they are too insignificant to worship Allah directly, and this is why they turned to the worship of angels as intercessors with Allah for their provisions, gaining victory and attaining their various needs. He then explained to them the error and deviation of worshipping the seven planets, which they said were the Moon, Mercury, Venus, the Sun, Mars, Jupiter and Saturn. The brightest of these objects and the most honored to them was the Sun, the Moon then Venus. Ibrahim, may Allah's peace and blessings be on him, first proved that Venus is not worthy of being worshipped, for it is subservient to a term and course appointed that it does not defy, nor swerving right or left. Venus does not have any say in its affairs, for it is only a heavenly object that Allah created and made bright out of His wisdom. Venus rises from the east and sets in the west where it disappears from sight. This rotation is repeated the next night, and so forth. Such an object is not worthy of being a god. Ibrahim then went on to mention the Moon in the same manner in which he mentioned Venus, and then the Sun. When he proved that these three objects were not gods,

Al-An'am (80 - 83) (Part-7) Jr ossmz 'rA A r-? j l3'* i^ I ^ ^ ^ -i Z' ^ *. /f.X #/ L>-^jl^-j-XJb j^L s**-*Jy4) CwJbj >"/ >/'*' >' <> '*' } (jCy~*\ j 0J^ ^J i A *yJ 1 ti*UL 'M^A^saj U"jJ_) j^jkI* T,j S'~"+i 'h c ./ " " f/,^ " " ^ 'T^rf P^jpeWj jo^JlitijiiiU.'S -at .* i Jv^Lg fr> .H.4 ju\$A\$>^ \$< * % &&& gogtt These Ayat indicate that Ibrahim was debating with his people about the Shirk they practiced. 4&& fe li kjli3 *Jj 4jl"JL6 jij ait 4; as oi Vi - fa* > j^=. 1 uu = jj^ ="jcj yjl ^ (2 & ^=Ci1 j p C it ^*,1 ji & fa" is V *f> r<=t:- * < { iff <_1 { cl iri.pt jj) (>''' <! \$' J^ojijbd iiji Ji 4 lilijj l^IUX-Ja (**> jOlt '?' d6 -* -iijil '- Ajli < X ** > u* *- -" 4^^ iii J%> -r ? < X ox c ; 01 4>* *J> *A*y 480. His people disputed with him. He said: Do you dispute with me about Allah while He has guided me, and I fear not those whom you associate with Allah in worship. (Nothing can happen to me) except when my Lord wills something. My Lord comprehends in His knowledge all things. Will you not then remember?} 481. And how should I fear those whom you associate in worship with Allah, while you fear not that you have joined in worship with Allah things for which He has not sent down to you any Sultan.(So) which of the two parties has more right to be in security? If you but know."} 482 . It is those who believe and confuse not their belief with

392 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Zulm (wrong), for them (only) there is security and they are the guided.} 483 . And that was Our proof which We gave Ibrahim against his people. We in degrees raise whom We will. Certainly your Lord is All-Wise, All-Knowing.} Allah states that His KhalU, Prophet Ibrahim, said when his people mentioned various doubts and disputed with him about the Tawhid that he called to: it . i-l -."if V -Xjj 4ji\ J* f 4Do you dispute with me about Allah while He has guided me?}. The Ayah means, do you argue with me about Allah, other than Whom there is no god worthy of worship, while He has guided me to the Truth and made me aware of it? Therefore, how can I ever consider your misguided statements and false doubts? Ibrahim said next, ol Vi ^ ^j} iand I fear not those whom you associate with Allah in worship. (Nothing can happen to me) except when my Lord wills something.} Ibrahim said, among the proofs to the falsehood of your creed, is that these false gods that you worship do not bring about any effect, and I do not fear them or care about them. Therefore, if these gods are able to cause harm, then use them against me and do not give me respite. Ibrahim's statement, 4&~ Lp ^ ^} iexcept when my Lord wills something.} means, only Allah causes benefit or harm. 4My Lord

comprehends in His knowledge all things.} meaning, Allah's knowledge encompasses all things and nothing escapes His complete observation, *\$} iWill you not then remember?}

Al-An'am (80 - 83) (Part-7) what I explained to you, considering your idols as false gods and refraining from worshipping them? This reasoning from Prophet Ibrahim is similar to the argument that Prophet Had used against his people, Ad. Allah mentioned this incident in His Book, when He said, 'iXSj-t V' Jji I* Ai> ij* ciSS d] Wf ')->-*\$* AJ-5 i>; .4,0 lli 4 -* Jj/-? j 3j a] J* &> Ot iThey said: 0 Hud! No evidence have you brought us, and we shall not leave our gods for your (mere) saying! And we are not believers in you . All that we say is that some of our gods have seized you with evil. He said: I call Allah to witness - and bear you witness - that I am free from that which you ascribe as partners in worship with Him (Allah). So plot against me, all ofyou, and give me no respite. I put my trust in Allah, my Lord and your Lord! There is not a moving creature but He has grasp of its forelock. Verily, my Lord is on the straight path (the truth). } [11:53-56] Ibrahim's statement, t* -1 iAnd how should I fear those whom you associate. . .} means, how should I fear the idols that you worship instead of Allah, 3% ? cA JZ&p %} {while you fear not that you have joined in worship with Allah thingsfor which He has not sent down to you any Sultan.} meaning, proof, according to Ibn Abbas and others among the Salaf. 111 Allah said in similar Ayat, Si (4 {Or have they partners who have instituted for them a religion which Allah has not allowed?} [42:21], and, m At-Tabari 1 1 :491

4A ip:oM 4It is those who believe and confuse not their belief with Zulm (wrong),) it was hard on the people. They said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Who among us did not commit Zulm against himself? He said, j]Sji ju u v]Lai /dJJo ^jJi J Jjj" tit is not what you understoodfrom it. Did you not hear what the righteous servant (Luqmdn) said, 4%A >\ \$i i '(>) my son! Join not in worship others with Allah. Verily! Shirk is a great Zulm (xorong) indeed.)* [31:13]. Therefore, it is about Shirk. Allah's statement. 4+3& &,) 4And that was Our proof which We gave Ibrahim against his people.) means, We directed him to proclaim Our proof against them. Mujahid and others said that Our proof refers to. 3% p c p zid 4\$% i&Ji\$ 4And how should I fear those whom you associate in worship with Allah (though they can neither benefit nor harm), while you fear not that you have joined in worship with Allah things for which He has not sent down to you any Sultan. (So) which of the tivo parties has more right to be in security?) Allah has testified Ibrahim's statement and affirmed security and guidance, saying; 4 & j i: 4It is those who believe and confuse not their beliefwith Zulm, Ahmad 1 :444. 121 AMabari 11:505.

396 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir far them there is security and they are the guided.} Allah said, iAnd that was Our proof which We gave Ibrahim against his people. We raise in degrees whom We will.} And; jx; iCertainly your Lord is All-Wise, All-Knowing.} He is All-Wise in His statements and actions, All-Knower of those whom He guides or misguides, and whether the proof was established against them or not. Allah also said, iTruly! Those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them - until they see the painful torment.} [10:96-97] This is why Allah said here, iCertainly your Lord is All-Wise, All-Knowing.} ii-iA OJJ Jr* Jt LJjS i-jjiJoj j'lj Cf& OJ Zs*y3 "-* . > & u \$\$ & y Jdij J* dl. fZ&j rjfa/3 X ^ ^ -Lfa jjj **'4c Oi iUa a* tf. SXf, ^ "#JJ* v, ! & % u&& d& 4 ktiM c&n \$zc 4 i4* ^ JJ i+jji iif L {(\$ Jb)j! V^jiox^SC 4 > 4S4. And We bestowed upon him Ishaq and Ya'qub, each of than We guided, and before him, We guided Niih and

among his progeny Ddwud, Sulaymdn, Ayyub, Yusuf, Musa, and Hdriin. Thus do We reward the good-doers.}

485. And Zakariyyd, and Yahyd and 'Isa and Iliyas, each one of them was of the righteous . 486. And Isma'il and Al-Yasa', and Yunus and Lut, and each one of them We preferred above the 'Alamin (mankind and Jinns, of their times).} 487. And also some of their fathers and their progeny and their brethren, We chose them, and We guided them to a straight path.} 488. This is the guidance of Allah with which He guides whomsoever He wills of His servants. But if they had joined in worship others with Allah, all that they used to do would have been of no benefit to them.} 489. They are those whom We gave the Book, Al-Hukm, and prophethood. But if they disbelieve therein, then, indeed We have entrusted it to a people who are not disbelievers therein.} 490. They are those whom Allah had guided. So follow their guidance. Say : "No reward I ask of you for this (the Qur'an). It is only a reminder for the 'Alamin (mankind and Jinns)." Ibrahim Receives the News of Ishaq and Ya'qub During His Old Age Allah states that after Ibrahim became old and he, and his wife, Sarah, lost hope of having children, He gave them Ishaq. The angels came to Ibrahim on their way to the people of Prophet Lut (to destroy them) and they delivered the good news of a child to Ibrahim and his wife. Ibrahim's wife was amazed at the news, \$8 tc-i yz 0; 'A 47 U 5* 'A /& 4She said (in astonishment): "Woe unto me! Shall I bear a child while I am an old woman, and here is my husband, an old man? Verily! This is a strange thing!" They said: "Do you wonder at the decree of Allah? The mercy of Allah and His blessings be on you, O the family [of Ibrahim]. Surely, He (Allah) is All-Praiseworthy, All-Glorious."} (11:72-73) The angels also gave them the good news that Ishaq will be a

3&L Tafsir Ibn Kathir Prophet and that he will have offspring of his own. In another Ayah, Allah said; iAnd We gave him the good news of Ishaq a Prophet from the righteous.}[37:112), which perfects this good news and completes the favor. Allah said, iof Ishaq, and after him, of Ya'qub...} [11:71), meaning, this child will have another child in your lifetime, so that your eyes are comforted by him, just as your eyes will be comforted by his father. Certainly, one becomes jubilant and joyous when he becomes a grandfather, because this means that his offspring will continue to exist. It was also expected that if an elderly couple had children, due to the child's weakness, he would have no offspring. This is why Allah delivered the good news of Ishaq and of his son Ya'qub, whose name literally means multiplying and having offspring . This was a reward for Ibrahim who left his people and migrated from their land so that he could worship Allah alone. Allah compensated Ibrahim with better than his people and tribe when He gave him righteous children of his own, who would follow his religion, so that his eyes would be comforted by them. In another Ayah, Allah said; iSo when he turned away from them and from those whom they worshipped besides Allah, We gave him Ishaq and Ya'qub, and each one of them We made a Prophet.} [19:49] Allah said here, iAnd We bestowed upon him Ishaq and Ya'qub, each of them We guided,} Allah said; Ji Cjlm. li-yj} iand before him. We guided Nuh...}

Al-An'am (84 - 90) (Part-7 meaning, We guided Nuh before and gave him righteous offspring, just as We guided Ibrahim and gave him righteous children. Qualities of Nuh and Ibrahim Each of these two Prophets had special qualities. When Allah caused the people of the earth to drown, except those who believed in Nuh and accompanied him in the ark, Allah made the offspring of Nuh the dwellers of the earth thereafter. Ever since that occurred, the people of the earth were and still are the descendants of

NQh. As for Ibrahim, Allah did not send a Prophet after him but from his descendants. Allah said in other Ayat, iAnd We ordained among his (Ibrahim s) offspring prophethood and the Book.} [29:27], iAnd indeed, We sent Nuh and Ibrahim, and placed in their offspring Prophethood and the Book.} [57:26], and. !"- (ifc ty (Mi i iThose were they unto whom Allah bestowed His grace from among the Prophets, of the offspring of Adam, and of those whom We carried (in the ship) with Niih, and of the offspring of Ibrahim and Isrd il andfrom among (hose whom We guided and chose. When the verses of the Most Beneficent (Allah) were recited unto them, they fell down prostrating and weeping.} [19:58] Allah said in this honorable Ayah here, ofi} iand among his progeny...} meaning, We guided from among his offspring. "</"}

We shall worship your God, and the God of your fathers, Ibrahim, Isma'il, Ishaq, One God, and to Him we submit

?j} iattd among his progeny Dawud, Sulaymdn . . .} until, &} }and Yahyd and Isa...} Al-Hajjaj said, Yes. Yahya said, Is not Isa from the offspring of Ibrahim, although he did not have a father? Al- Hajjaj said, You have said the truth. For example, when a man leaves behind a legacy, a trust, or gift to his offspring then the children of his daughters are included. But if a man gives something to his sons , or he leaves a trust behind for them, then that would be particular to his male children and their male children. Allah s statement, rri>/> hti} iAnd also some of their fathers and their progeny and their brethren,} (6:87], mentions that some of these Prophets ascendants and descendants were also guided and chosen. So Allah said, }We chose them, and We guided than to a straight path.} Shirk Eradicates the Deeds, Even the Deeds of the Messengers Allah said next, / l / * fx"" " ** ** '>' 'Y cn j4 jjl,-. jut iSjj iThis is the guidance of Allah with which He guides whomsoever He wills ofHis servants.} meaning, this occurred to them by Allah s leave and because He directed them to guidance. Allah said; Yffc d Ip ij\$1 fj} }But if they had joined in worship others with Allah, all that Ad-DurrAl-Manthur3:311.

Al-An'dm (84 - 90) (Part-7 4Jhey...} refers to the people of Makkah, according to Ibn Abbas, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Ad-pahhak, Qatadah, As-Suddi, and others.111 ithen, indeed We have entrusted it to a people who are not disbelievers therein .} This Ayah means, if the Quraysh and the rest of the people of the earth - Arabs and non-Arabs, illiterate and the People of the Scripture - disbelieve in these bounties, then We have entrusted them to another people, the Muhajirfln and Ansar, and those who follow their lead until the Day of Resurrection, iwho are not disbelievers therein.} They will not deny any of these favors, not even one letter. Rather, they will believe in them totally, even the parts that are not so clear to some of them. We ask Allah to make us among them by His favor, generosity and kindness. Addressing His servant and Messenger, Muhammad sg, Allah said; iThey are...} the Prophets mentioned here, along with their righteous fathers, offspring and bretheren, 4til tiJjk jM} 4those whom Allah had guided.} meaning, they alone are the people ofguidance, 4So follow their guidance.} Imitate them. This command to the Messenger jjg certainly applies to his Ummah, according to what he legislates and commands them. While mentioning this Ayah,

IJj assail \r\$) y is ** * *jj-ajL*_j *Aj"Wi j1 f<_"i^! *Jj^dr43 <* / > '*.'! AX ' > >' ?,X\X ' -" , '* , jJ^ S^oAJ*Cr ^lQ^pjJJU^ JlijtljS^if 1j}y JjitUJji, ""t"" \ --^ >\r %? '/4^ > "% *** ^ < a^ < . "" " < * > ^ A ^j] .And We bestowed upon him Ishaq and Ya'qub...} until, ifj^il 4 So follow guidance. ^ He commented, He (our Prophet, Muhammad jg) was among them. In another narration, Mujahid added

that Ibn Abbas said, Your Prophet sg was among those whose guidance we were commanded to follow. ^ * Allah s statement, 4&i p& i ji" iSay : "No reward I ask ofvou for this."} means, I do not ask you for any reward for delivering the Qur an to you, nor anything else, &M \$i i" It is only a reminder for the 'Alamin (mankind and Jinns). } so they are reminded by it and guided from blindness to clarity, from misguidance to guidance, and from disbelief to faith. their i jK Cj* J* s j; y ? j* Jjil l* i) lli ij j>- iiii ijyji Cj} Fath Al-B&ri 8 : 144 . The reference is to no . 24 of Sad (38) where it is mentioned that Dawud , peace be upon him , prostrated . Since Allah ordered following what they were guided to in these Ayat of Al- An'am, then we should also prostrate at the mention of the Prophets prostrations , according to Ibn Abbas

U /iVj SM) 'jj> Cs~y it *V C5S5 4 (XfiX&jJ&c^ il \$ (Uj 54* o4*j" u{Jt> i-ij*- i>*j ^ i* j\$ 4^z & 491. They did not estimate Allah with an estimation due to Him when they said: "Nothing did Allah send down to any human being (by inspiration) ." Say : "Who then sent down the Book which Musa brought, a light and a guidance to mankind which you (the Jews) have made into (separate) papersheets, disclosing (some of it) and concealing much. And you were taught that which neither you nor your fathers knew. Say: "Allah (sent it down)." Then leave them to play in their vain discussions.} 492. And this is a blessed Book which We have sent down, confirming wlwt came before it, so that you may warn the Mother of Towns and all those around it. Those who believe in the Hereafter believe in it, and they are constant in guarding their Saldh.} The Messenger is but aHuman toWhom the Book was Revealedby Inspiration Allah says that those who rejected His Messengers did not give Allah due consideration. Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Abdullah bin Kathir said that this Ayah was revealed about the Quraysh. 1 1 It was also said that it was revealed about some Jews. 0; & " 4/1 They said: "Nothing did Allah send down to any human being (by inspiration)."} Allah also, said, 4Is it a wonder for mankind thatWe have inspired to a man from among themselves (saying): "Want mankind."} (10:2], and, m At-Tabari 11 :524.

406 Tafsir Ibt Kathir jj & % 3\$ oi^ s^fl fZr l\ && J jtff Cj} ff 4 i& > = SJf ^ vsg3 4 sr ^ And nothing prevented men from believing when the guidance came to them, except that they said: Has AllSh sent a man as Messenger?" Say: "If there were on the earth, angels walking about in peace and security, We should certainly have sent down for them from the heaven an angel as a Messenger. } (17:94-95). AllSh said here, 4JUT jj ri) "Sl Jjil U jfc ill IjjJi 477iey did not estimate Allah with an estimation due to Him when they said : "Nothing did Allah send down to any human being (by inspiration). } AllSh answered them, iU&&&*S &&#Z& iSay : "Who then sent down the Book which Musa brought, a light and a guidance to mankind?"} meaning, say, O Muhammad jg, to those who deny the concept that AllSh sent down Books by revelation, answering them specifically, iWho then sent down the Book which Musa brought?} in reference to the Tawrah that you and all others know that AllSh sent down to MQsS, son of Imran. AllSh sent the Tawrah as a light and a guidance for people, so that it could shed light on the answers to various disputes, and to guide away from the darkness of doubts. Allah s statement, o&j t " ? fi %} iwhich you have made into (separate) papersheets, disclosing (some of it) and concealing (much).} means, you made the Tawrah into separate sheets which you copied from the original and altered, changed and distorted as

Al-An'am (91 - 92) (Part-7) you wished. You then said, this is from Allah, meaning it is in the revealed Book of Allah, when in fact, it is not from Allah. This is why Allah said here, iwhich you have made into (separate) papersheets, disclosing (some of it) and concealing (much).} Allah said; iAnd you were taught that which neither you nor yourfathers knew.} meaning, Who sent down the Qur an in which Allah taught you the news of those who were before you and the news of what will come after, that neither you nor your fathers had knowledge of. Allah s statement, iSay: "Allah."} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, Meaning, Say, Allah sent it down. Allah said, rx+r- 4 (*"j> *>? {Then leave them to play in their vain discussions.} leave them to play in ignorance and misguidance until the true news comes to them from Allah. Then, they will know whether the good end is theirs or for the fearful servants of Allah. Allah said. iAnd Otis is a Book,} the Qur an, iif/R P 1"M is & &\$} iBlessed, which We have sent down, confirming which came before it, so that you may warn the Mother ofTowns} that is, Makkah, & ifiJ iand all those around it...} refering to the Arabs and the rest of the children ofAdam, Arabs and non-Arabs alike. Allah said in other Ayat,

O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger ofAllah.'> [7:158], and 4\$ oo 4

This is why Allah said, iThose who believe in the Hereafter believe in it,} meaning, those who believe in Allah and the Last Day, believe in this blessed Book, the Qur an, which We revealed to you, O Muhammad jig, & fit iand they are constant in guarding their Salah.} for they perform what Allah ordered them, offering the prayers perfectly and bn time. J, JtS j> pj Z}[J* \$ C-i^" a*-; ffi-j-iJ 4 ijjL lal l ISjj jlj <!' U jit pr Ct of f &Z dSfi '\$ \$>" }j*\$ pSSit u* jui tjg* sJ; p:& Cj / s- , >> : . 493. And who can be more unjust than he who invents a lie against Allah, or says: "I have received inspiration, whereas he is not inspired in anything; and who says, I will reveal the like ofwhat Allah has revealed." And ifyou could but see when the wrongdoers are in the agonies ofdeath, while the angels are stretching forth their hands (saying) : ",Deliver your souls! This day you shall be recompensed with the tonnent of degradation because of wluit you used to utter against Allah other than the truth. And you used to reject His Aydt with disrespect!"} 494. And truly you have come unto Us alone, as We created you the first time. You have left behind you all that which We had bestowed on you. We see not with you your intercessors whom you claimed to be your partners. Now you and they have been cut off, and all that you used to claim has vanished from you.}

suffering from the hardhips, agonies and afflictions of death, iwhile the angels are stretching forth their hands...) beating them. Allah said in other Ayat. 4Ifyou do stretch your hand against me to kill me..) [5:28]and, 4 \ \ j Z) 4And stretch forth their hands and their tongues against you with ey"7.^(60:2j Ad-Dahhak and Abu Salih said that, stretch forth their hands, means, with torment .111 In another Ayah, Allah said, Jy-i 5And if you could see when the angels take away the souls of those who disbelieve they smite their faces and their backs.}[8:50] Allah said, iwhile the angels are stretchingforth their hands) beating them, until their souls leave their bodies, saying, i"Deliver your souls!") When the disbeliever is near death, the angels will convey the good news to him of torment, vengeance, chains, restraints, Hell, boiling water and the singer ofthe Most Beneficent, Most Merciful. The soul will then scatter in the body of the disbeliever and refuse to get out of it. The angels will keep beating the disbeliever until his soul exits from his body, i(Saying): "Deliver your souls! This day you shall be recompensed with the torment of degradation because of what Al-Tabari 1 1 :539

422 Tafslr Ibrt Kathir you used to say about Allah other than the truth.) This Ayah means, today, you will be utterly humiliated because you used to invent lies against Allah and arrogantly refused to follow His Aydt and obey His Mesengers. There are many Hadlths, of Mutawati^ grade, that explain what occurs when the believers and disbelievers die, and we will mention these Hadlths when explaining Allah s statement, P-' 4 SA ip* PiJ' iif iAllah will keep firm those wlv believe, with the word that standsfirm in this world, and in the Hereafter.) [14:27] Allah said next, iAnd truly you have come unto Us alone as We created you thefirst time.) [6:94], and this statement will be said on the Day of Return. In another Ayah, Allah said, s) iAnd they will be set before your Lord in rows, (and Allah will say) : Now indeed, you have come to Us as We created you tfte first time.) [18:48], meaning, just as We started your creation, We brought you back, although you used to deny Resurrection and reject its possibility. Therefore, this is the Day of Resurrection! Allah said, iYou have left behind you all that which We had bestowed on you.) [6:94], The wealth and the money that you collected in the life of the world, you left all this behind you. It is recorded in the Sahlh that Allah s Messenger said, c-ijj jf icJliti cJs\ t; M[iuu JA Jjj pal i \ A Hadtth reported by numerous routes, having many different narrators at each level ofevery chain

^QJ iSjti'j JLi i iSj-r ^ oLiiti iThe Son ofAdam says, 'My money, my money! But, what part ofyour money do you have, other than what you eat of it and is thus spent, what you wear and tear and what you gave in chairty and thus remains (in the record of good deeds)? Other than that, you will depart and leave it to the people.'"[11 Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, On the Day of Resurrection, the Son of Adam will be brought, as if he were a golden chariot and Allah, the Most Honored, will ask, Where is what you collected? He will reply, O Lord! I collected it and left it as intact as ever. Allah will say to him, O Son of Adam! Where is what you sent forth for yourself (of righteous, good deeds), and he will realize that he did not send forth anything for himself. Al-Hasan then recited the Ayah, ftP& "s & 4And truly you have come unto Us alone as We created you the first time. You have left behind you all that which We had bestowed on you.} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this statement. Allah said; iW&p sj;pzz pi& c;} 4We see not with you your intercessors whom you claimed to be your partners.} This chastises and criticizes the disbelievers for the rivals, idols and images that they worshipped in this life, thinking they will avail them in this life and upon Resurrection, if there is Resurrection, as they thought. On the Day of Resurrection, all relationships will be cut off, misguidance will be exposed, and those whom they used to call upon as gods will disappear from them. Allah will then call them, while the rest of creation is listening, ^ S# i&i j)} iWhere are My (so-called) partners whom you used to assert?} (28:62] And, ' l * Muslim 4: 2273.

ypxspj^ ^ .yJ lbii it: iiS; ^./ ./, 'H,jC' >- > / . < !/ ?* LfrJu^j6yl^l'ji_juii o' \$^a#4? iLt-JpJOj > *^-*rr^ 'j*A? jd>,jJu ujf"jV'j f \Then, when the Trumpet is blown, there will be no kinship among them that Day, nor will they ask of one another.) [23:101], and 'tJl di' oji Jt JXJ^i Cj\) tSitf opsi 4 fp ; shall have no helper.) [29:25], and \$%*\$&)&\$& Jt j, ^s") Uj jlll' 4You have taken (for worship) idols instead of Allah, and the love be- tween you is only in the life of this world, but on

the Day of Resurrection, you shall disown each other, and curse each other, and your abode will be the Fire, and you iAnd it will be said (to them) : "Call upon your partners", and they will call upon them, but they will give no answer to them.) [28:64], and 4And the Day whereon We shall gather them all

together, then We shall say to those who committed Shirk...) [10:28] until, \jit tf fr XSj> 4And their invented false deities will vanish from them.) [10:30]

416 Tafsir Ibnt Kathir iit , J'i ji y-pf 9p' o; 5-' jvi ' o!> 2if j# 5m? & o^Jj (^ j# JSK^ ,3>> @Sj3? \$ 3 J35 2< % W23 j 3rf 3 43.4f# 495. Verily! It is Allah Who causes the seed grain and the fruit stone to split and sprout. He brings forth the living from the dead, and it is He Who brings forth the dead from the living. Such is Allah, then how are you deluded away from the truth?} i96. (He is the) Cleaver of the daybreak. He has appointed the night for resting, and the sun and the moon for reckoning. Such is the measuring of the Almighty, the All-Knowing.} 497. It is He Who has set the stars for you, so that you may guide your course with their help through the darkness of the land and the sea. We have (indeed) explained in detail Our Ayat for people who know.} Recognizing Allah Through Some of His Ayat Allah states that He causes the seed grain and the fruit stone to split and sprout in the ground, producing various types, colors, shapes, and tastes of grains and produce. The Ayah, iWho causes the seed grain and the fruit stone to split and sprout.} is explained by the next statement, U 5 iHe brings forth the living from the dead, and it is He Who brings forth the dead from the living.} meaning, He brings the living plant from the seed grain and the fruit stone, which is a lifeless and inanimate object. Allah said, iAnd a sign for them is the dead land. We gave it life, and We

Al-Ariam (95 - 97) (Part-7) brought forth from it grains, so that they eat thereof.} [36:33] until, V iL'tj c^j} ias well as of their own (human) kind (male and female), and of that which they know not.} [36:36] Allah's statement, cp' iand it is He Wlw brings forth the dead from the living.} There are similar expressions in meaning such as, He brings the egg from the chicken, and the opposite. Others said that it means, He brings the wicked offspring from the righteous parent and the opposite, and there are other possible meanings for the Ayah. Allah said, iSuch is Allah,} meaning, He Who does all this, is Allah, the One and Only without partners, i then how are you deluded away from the truth?} meaning, look how you are deluded from Truth to the falsehood of worshipping others besides Allah. Allah's statement, Jdf ^pi\ \$} i(He is the) Cleaver of the daybreak. He has appointed the night for resting,} means, He is the Creator of light and darkness. Allah said in

the beginning of the Surah,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1739–1791]

'4And originated the darkness and the light.} Indeed, Allah causes the darkness of the night to disappear and brings forth the day, thus bringing brightness to the world and light to the horizon, while dissipating darkness and "S ending the night with its depth of darkness and starting the day with its brightness and light. Allah said,

iU- 4He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly.\$ [7:54] In this Ayah, Allah reminds of His ability to create diversified things in opposites, testifying to His perfect greatness and supreme power. Allah states that He is the Cleaver of the daybreak and mentioned its opposite, when He said, 4<&& &,} 4He has appointed the night for resting,} meaning, created darkness, in order for the creation to become halt and rest during it. Allah said in other Ayat, 4By the forenoon. And by the night when it is still.} [93:1-2], 4By the night as it envelops. And by the day as it appears in brightness.} [92:1,2] and,

4And by the day as it shows up (the sun's) brightness. And by the night as it conceals it.} [91:3-4] Allah's statement, ik /\ 4...And the sun and the moon for reckoning.} means, the sun and the moon have specific orbits, according to a term appointed with magnificent precision that never changes or alters. Both the sun and the moon have distinct positions that they assume in summer and winter, effecting changes in the length of night and day. Allah said in other Ayat, 4b& 4\> 4It is He Who made the sun a shining thing and the Moon as a light and measured out stages for it.} [10:5],

4 P* ^ ^ u5^i a-*-"* V/f is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit. [36:40], And, 4xv\ J <\$T7ie sun and the moon; and the stars are subjected by His command.} [16:12] Allah's statement, i^Xi\ -j\$ s& \$> iSuch is the measuring of the Almighty, the All-Knowing.} means, all of this occurs according to the decree and due measurement of the Almighty Who is never resisted or contradicted. He is the Knower of all things and nothing ever escapes His knowledge, not even the weight of an atom on earth or in heavens. Allah often mentions the creation of the night, the day, the sun and the moon and then ends His Speech by mentioning His attributes of power and knowledge, as in this Ayah above [6:96], and in His statement. 4And a sign for them is the night, We' withdraw therefrom the day, and behold, they are in darkness. And the sun runs on its fixed course for a term . That is the decree of the Almighty, the All-Knowing.} [36:37-38] In the beginning of Surat Ha-Mim As-Sajdah, after mentioning the creation of the heavens and earth and all that is in them, Allah said: J^all J> i liU i U-J Cjif fcjj} 4And We adorned the nearest (lowest) heaven with lamps (stars) to be an adornment as well as to guard. Such is the decree of Him, the Almighty, the All-Knower.} [41:12] Allah said next,

4It is He Who has set the stars for you, so that you may guide your course with their help through the darkness of the land and the sea.} Some of the Salaf said; Whoever believes in other than three things about these stars, then he has made a mistake, and lied against Allah. Indeed Allah made them as decorations for the heavens, and to shoot at the Shayatin, and for directions in the dark recesses of the land and sea. Then, Allah said, 4We have explained in detail Our Ayat.} meaning, We made them clear and plain, ifor people who know.} who have sound minds and are able to recognize the truth and avoid falsehood. # /A 2 \$25'M ^ i^^ C4 Ss& vjf% 498. It is He Who has created you from a single person, and has given you a place of residing and a place of storage. Indeed, We have explained in detail Our revelations for people who understand.} 499. It is He Who sends down water from the sky, and with it We bring forth vegetation of all kinds, and out of it We bring forth green stalks, from which We bring forth thick clustered grain. And out of the date-palm and its sprouts come forth clusters of dates hanging low and near, and gardens of grapes, olives and pomegranates, each similar, yet different. Look at their fruits when they begin to bear, and Yan'ih. Verily! In these things there are signs for people who believe.} Allah said, 4)U5 oj" 3S 4It is He Who has created you from a single person,} (6:98)

in reference to Adam, peace be upon him. In another Ayah, Allah said; & j5 ft 3K&J ii 4' jfe !\$ 40 mankind! Have Taqwa of your Lord, Wlw created you from a single person, and from him He created his mate, and from them both He created many men and women.^[4:1] Allah said, iMustaqar and Mustawda'} Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn Abbas, Abu Abdur-Rahman As-Sulami, Qays bin Abu Hazim, Mujahid, Ata , Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Ad- Dahhak, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ata Al-Khurasani and others said that, 4Mustaqar}, in the wombs . They, or most of them, also said that, 4And Mustawda',} means, In your

father's loins. Ibn Mas'ud and several others said that, Mustaqar, means residence in this life, while, Mustawda', means the place of storage after death (the grave). Allah's statement, {Indeed, We have explained in detail Our revelations for people who understand.} refers to those who comprehend and understand Allah's Words and its meanings. AllSh said next, {It is He Who sends down water (rain) from the sky} m At-Tabari 11:565-570.

422 Tafstr Ibn Kathir in due measure, as a blessing and provision for the servants, relief and means of survival for the creatures and mercy from Allah for His creation. Allah's statement, {And with it We bring forth vegetation of all kinds,} is similar to, {And We have made from water every living thing.} [21:30] and out of it We bring forth green stalks,} green produce and trees, on which We grow seeds and fruits. {from which We bring forth thick clustered grain.} lined on top of each other in clusters, like an ear or spike of grain. {And out of the date-palm and its sprouts come forth clusters} of dates hanging low} Within reach and easy to pick. Ali bin Abi Talhah Al-Wajibi said that Ibn Abbas said that, {clusters hanging low} refers to short date trees whose branches hang low, close to the ground. This was recorded by Ibn Jarir.¹¹¹ Allah's statement {And gardens of grapes,} means. We bring forth gardens of grapes. Grapes and dates are the most precious fruits to the people of Al-Hijaz (Western Arabia), and perhaps both are the best fruits in this world. Allah has reminded His servants of His m At-Tabari 11:576.

favor in making these two fruits for them, when He said, from the fruits of date-palms and grapes, you derive strong drink and a goodly provision.} [16:67] before intoxicating drinks were prohibited, and; Ji. y~Z- -i^o} {And We have made therein gardens of date-palms and grapes.} [36:34]. Allah said, {Olives and pomegranates, each similar yet different.} The leaves are similar in shape and appearance, yet different in the shape, and taste. And the kind of fruit each plant produces is different, according to the explanation of Qatadah and several others. * Allah's statement, {Look at their fruits when they begin to bear, and Yan ih .} means, when the fruits become ripe, according to Al-Bara bin Azib, Ibn Abbas, Ad-Dahhak, Ata Al-Khurasani, As-Suddi, Qatadah and others. This Ayah means, contemplate the ability of the Creator of these fruits, Who brought them into existence after they were dry wood, and they later became grapes and dates; and similar is the case with the various colors, shapes, tastes and fragrance of whatever Allah created. Allah said. .1' u''' "1 a "A ..iff 'X. ifjr-f Jjej Ct'j^uA dfji\ jj? 4 df* sJJ6 {And in the earth are neighbouring tracts, and gardens of vines, and green crops, and date-palms, growing out, two or three from a single stem root, or otherwise, watered with the same water, yet some of them We make better than others to eat.} [13:4] Tabari 11 :578. * At-Tabari 11:582.

424 Tafsh Ibn Kathir This is why Allah said here, {In these things there are...} O people, signs...} and proofs that testify to the perfect ability, wisdom and mercy of He Who created these things, {O people, if for people who believe.} in Allah and obey His Messengers. Je jA. 14* A 4100. Yet, they join the Jinns as partners in worship with Allah, though He has created them, and they attribute, falsely without knowledge - sons and daughters to Him. Be He Glorified and Exalted above what that they attribute to Him.} Rebuking the Idolators This Ayah refutes the idolators who worshipped others besides Allah and associated the Jinns with Him in worship. Glory be to Allah above this Shirk and Kufr. If someone asks, how did the idolators worship the Jinns, although they only were idol worshippers? The answer is that in fact, they worshipped the idols by obeying the Jinns who commanded them to do so. Allah said in

other Ayat, AiSI o! J xAjji yf&fA Os /1 oi i-hZ. \$ JJA- frs\$J " bj Lj _ i- j-/~~ -i-ii ' J . >! }They invoke nothing but female deities besides Him, and they invoke nothing but Shaytan, a persistent rebel! Allah cursed him. And he [Shaytdn] said: "I will take an appointed portion of your servants. Verily, I will mislead them, and surely, I will arouse in them false desires; and certainly, I will order them to

Al-An'dm (98 - 99) (Part-7) slit the ears of cattle, and indeed I will order them to change the nature created by Allah." And whoever takes Shaytan as a protector instead of Allah, has surely suffered a manifest loss. He [Shaytan] makes promises to them, and arouses in them false desires; and Shaytan's promises are nothing but deceptions.} [4:117-120] and, bt ^ iWill you then take him (Iblis) and his offspring as protectors and helpers rather than Me?} [18:50] Ibrahim said to his father, i"O my father! Worship not Shaytan. Verily! Shaytan has been a rebel against the Most Beneficent (Allah)"} [19:44] Allah said, o!j /dl ^ sj fill Xjffi 1>* ili iDid I not ordain for you, O Children of Adam, that you should not worship Shaytdn. Verily, he is a plain enemy to you. And that you should worship Me. That is a straight path.} [36:60-61] On the Day of Resurrection, the angels will proclaim. x'." (r \?% j? |"+u> ot ^-b 4 Glorified be You! You are our Protector instead of them. Nay, but they used to worship the Jinns; most of them were believers in them.} [34:41] This is why Allah said here, }Yet, they join the Jinns as partners in worship with Allah, though He has created them.} [6:100], Alone without partners. Consequently, how is it that another deity is being worshipped along with Him? As Ibrahim said. u; &S tg&g C&& Si}

i"Worship you that which you (yourselves) carve? While Allah has created you and what you make!"} [37:95-96] Allah alone is the Creator without partners. Therefore, He Alone deserves to be worshipped without partners. Allah said next, 4fh jk 4And they Kharagu (attribute falsely) without knowledge, sons and daughters to Him.} Allah mentions the misguidance of those who were led astray and claimed a son or offspring for Him, as the Jews did with Tjzayr, the Christians with Isa and the Arab pagans with the angels whom they claimed were Allah's daughters. Allah is far holier than what the unjust, polytheist people associate with Him. The word, Kharagu, means falsely attributed, invented, claimed and lied, according to the scholars of the Salaf. Allah's statement next, 4&U. > & ' } 4Be He Glorified and Exalted above (all) that they attribute to Him.} means, He is holier than, hallowed, and Exalted above the sons, rivals, equals and partners that these ignorant, misled people attribute to Him. ti' * ' V' ' cp? J5 i J2 js% %& U ^Vf; tfcsn " |S& 4101. He is the Bad? (Originator) of the heavens and the earth. How can He have children when He has no wife? He created all things and He is the All-Knower of everything.} Meaning of BadV 4He is the Bad? of the heavens and the earth} Meaning He originated, created, invented and brought them into existence without precedence, as Mujahid and As-Suddi said. This is why the word for innovation - Bid'ah - comes AJ-Tabari 2 :540

Jr orn rn u ' from it, because it is something that did not have a precedence. \$& i; % %& S" ^J^yaj uSj f^j-J J^>- pel'll lljl j*-' " |v"| ,JJJcJj a \jS aJ_)Oj/SfT ^jia^csfesSE^Jtsjjj< }og"yr sT'-O-jjK"L^i*yj i vvl fiOllUjljia- "".(' T v ,{ if. > ' LajUUIJO ^ v'-V^ f <, 'A'~ ^ jj- 1 s*y~iy. iHow can He have children when He has no wife?> for the child is the offspring of two compatible spouses. Allah does not have an equal, none of His creatures are similar to Him, for He alone created the entire creation. Allah said; ms \$\$ & (Sufy Ju3 iAnd they say " The Most Beneficent (Allah) has begotten a son." Indeed you have brought forth (said) a terrible evil thing.> [19:88-89], until, iAnd everyone of them will come to Him

alone on the Day of Resurrection .>[19:95]. iHe created all things and He is the All-Knower of everything.> He has created everything and He is All-Knower of all things. How can He have a wife from His creation who is suitable for His majesty, when there is none like Him? How can He have a

and Sunan collections. As for this life, MasrQq narrated that A ishaah said, Whoever claims that Muhammad jg has seen his Lord, will have uttered a lie against Allah, for Allah the Most Honored, says, }No vision can grasp Him, but His grasp is over all vision.yW In the Sahih (

mustard seed, and though it be in a rock, or in the heavens or in the earth, Allah will bring it forth. Verily, Allah is Most Subtle, Well Acquainted} [31:16] tf t'j tys & sj XJ4 os ffo & (3ft * ' 4104. Verily, Basd'ir (proofs) have come to you from your Lord, so whosoever sees, will do so for (the good of) himself, and whosoever blinds himself, will do so against himself, and I am not a Hafiz over you.} 4105. Thus We explain variously the verses so that they (the disbelievers) may say: You have Darasta (studied) and that We may make the matter clear for the people who have knowledge.} The Meaning ofBasa ir Basa ir are the proofs and evidences in the Qur an and the Message of Allah s Messenger jg. The Ayah, >} 4so whosoever sees, will do so for (the good of) himself.} is similar J-s'i tfjii' *} 4So whosoever receives guidance, he does so for the good of himself, and whosoever goes astray, he does so at his own loss.} [10:108] After Allah mentioned the Basd'ir, He said, ce 4And whosoever blinds himself, will do so against himself,} meaning, he will only harm himself. Allah said, a\$ ^ Q\$} 4Verily, it is not the eyes that grow blind, but it is the hearts which are in the breasts that grow blind.} [22:46]

4And I (Muhammad) am not a Hafiz over you.} neither responsible, nor a watcher over you. Rather, I only convey, Allah guides whom He wills and misguides whom He wills. Allah said, 4^\$ 4Thus We explain variously the verses..>[6:105], meaning, just as We explained the Ay&t in this Surah, such as explaining Tawhid and that there is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah. This is how We explain the Ayat and make them plain and clear in all circumstances, to suffice the ignorance of the ignorant; and so that the idolaters and disbelievers who deny you say, O Muhammad! You have Darasta with those who were before you from among the People of the Book and learned with them . Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr and Ad-Dahhak said similarly.' ' At-Tabarani narrated that Amr bin Kaysan said that he heard Ibn Abbas saying, Darasta, means, recited, argued and debated. 12 ' This is similar to Allah s statement about the denial and rebellion of the disbelievers, LU" jStf jii pi !H "SI] Uci oj, &&&1^,1 j\$!\ j&d biiij 4Those who disbelieve say, "Tltis (the Qur'an) is nothing but a lie that he has invented, and others have helped him at it, so that they have produced an unjust wrong (thing) and a lie. And they say, "Tales of the ancients, which he has written down, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon."} [25:4-5] Allah described the chief liar of the disbelievers [Al-Walid bin Al-Mughirah Al-Makhzumi], ;* -I 'Sf - ? -.it -V.* ' V f yrf f f i&iM) >* Mr ' 45 "k "A 4 3 4Verily, he thought and plotted. So let him be cursed! How he plotted! And once more let him be cursed, how he plotted! Then m At-Tabari 12:27. ' At-Tabarani 11 :137.

he thought. Then he frowned and he looked in a bad tempered way. Then he turned back and was proud. Tlten he said, "This is nothing but magic from that of old. This is nothing but the word ofa human being!"} [74:18-25] Allah said next, 4And that We may make the matter clear for the people who have knowledge.} The Ayah means, so that We explain the matter to a people who know truth, and thus follow it, and know falsehood, and thus avoid it. Allah s wisdom is perfect, He allows the disbelievers

to stray, and He guides the people who have knowledge. Allah said in other Ayat, 4By it He misleads many, and many He guides thereby.} [2:26], and; 4That He (Allah) may make what is thrown in by Shaytan a trial for those in whose hearts is a disease and whose hearts are hardened.} [22:53] and, jkr*? 'S-*' o,)) 4And verily, Allah is the Guide of those who believe, to the straight path.} [22:54], iyjt jCil fJr\i fl*- ly til*. Cj} 30 rrp 4 'cS && i &. % hi &C ^ i] Cj 'iLS & iS+r') ' " O' Sifi '.iV; 4"" j'jI 4And We have set none but angels as guardians of the Fire, and We have fixed their number only as a trial for the disbelievers, in order that the People of the Scripture may arrive at a certainty and the believers may increase in faith, and that no doubts may be left for the People of the Scripture and the

believers, and that those in whose hearts is a disease (of hypocrisy) and the disbelievers may say, "What does Allah intend by this example? Thus Allah leads astray whom He wills and guides whom He wills. And none can know the hosts of your Lord but He.) [74:3 1J, and; iAnd We send down in the Qur'an that which is a healing and a mercy to the believers, and it increases the wrongdoers in nothing but loss.) [17:82], and, * *r " * .i.i j*j jo 4 V ip: ^JUju ot iSay, "It is for those who believe, a guide and a healing. And as for those who disbelieve, there is heaviness in their ears, and it is blindness for them. They are those who are called from a place far away.) [41:44] There are similar Ayat that testify that Allah sent down the Qur'an as guidance to those who fear Him and that He guides or misguides whom He wills by the Qur'an. e# %%-gj.if#&& % m&i jJ z 4106. Follow what has been inspired (revealed) to you from your Lord, none has the right to be worshipped but He, and turn aside from the idolaters.) 4107. Had Allah willed, they would not have taken others besides Him in worship. And We have not made you Hafiz over them nor are you set over them to dispose of their affairs.) The Command to Follow the Revelation Allah commands His Messenger and those who followed his path, 4Follow what has been inspired to you from your Lord,) meaning, follow it, obey it and act according to it. What has been revealed to you from your Lord is the Truth, no doubt,

and there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, io&ZK J^j} iand him aside from the idolaters} meaning, forgive them, be forbearing and endure their harm until Allah brings relief to you, supports you and makes you triumphant over them. Know - O Muhammad jg - that there is a wisdom behind misleading the idolaters, and that had Allah willed, He would have directed all people to guidance, (\&\ Z& XL %) iHad Allah willed, they would not have taken others besides Him in worship.} Allah s is the perfect will and wisdom in all decrees and decisions, and He is never questioned about what He does, while they all will be questioned. Allah s statement, 4And We have not made you Hafiz over them.} means, a watcher who observes their statements and deeds, \tj} iNor are you set over them to dispose of their affairs.} or to control their provision. Rather, your only job is to convey, just as Allah said, iSo remind them, you are only one who reminds. You are not a dictator over them.} (88:21-22] and, iVdS gjf Cj} iYour duty is only to convey and on Us is the reckoning.} (13:40) ii,\ j j iSj fia j"u at a! oJ" & oy- r&A r& 4108. And insult not those whom they worship besides Allah, lest they insult Allah wrongfully without knowledge. Thus We have made fair seeming to each people its own doings; then to their Lord is their return and He shall inform them of all that they used to do.}

The Prohibition of Insulting the False gods of the Disbelievers, So that they Do not Insult Allah Allah prohibits His Messenger ijg and the believers from insulting the false deities of the idolaters, although there is a clear benefit in doing so. Insulting their deities will lead to a bigger evil than its benefit, for

the idolators might retaliate by insulting the God of the believers, Allah, none has the right to be worshipped but He. Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas commented on this Ayah [6:108]; They (disbelievers) said, O Muhammad! You will stop insulting our gods, or we will insult your Lord. Thereafter, Allah prohibited the believers from insulting the disbelievers idols, iX Si3 ilest they insult Allah wrongfully without knowledge.yW Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma'mar said that Qatadah said,

"He insults a man's father, and that man insults his father, and insults his mother and that man insults his mother. i)m Allah s statement, & \$1 2 {Thus We have made fair seeming to each people its own doings;} means, as We made fair seeming to the idolators loving their idols and defending them, likewise We made fair seeming to every previous nation the misguidance they indulged in. Allah s is the most perfect proof, and the most complete wisdom in all that He wills and chooses. (* -> ithen to their Lord is their return,) gathering and final destination, iand He shall then inform them of all that they used to do.} He will compensate them for their deeds, good for good and evil for evil. Uj jcc cJffi ji *' pfe 05? 'x**r fh) iX p'A i&> o;t 6l 4109. And they swear their strongest oaths by Allah, that if there came to them a sign, they would surely believe therein. Say: "Signs are but with Allah and what will make you perceive that (even) if it came, they will not believe?"} 4110. And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away, as they refused to believe therein for the first time, and We shall leave them in their trespass to wander blindly.} Asking for Miracles and Swearing to Believe if They Come Allah states that the idolators swore their strongest oaths by Allah, Al-Bari 10:417.

438 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir 4that if there came to them a sign...} a miracle or phenomenon. 4they would surely believe therein.} affirming its truth, 4%\ i* Ci \$} 4Say: ",Signs are but with Allah."} [6:109] meaning: Say, O Muhammad si - to those who ask you for signs out of defiance, disbelief and rebellion, not out of the desire for guidance and knowledge - The matter of sending signs is for Allah. If He wills, He sends them to you, and if He wills, He ignores your request. Allah said next, 4U& V lil t# 4And what will make you perceive that (even) if it came, they will not believe?} It was said that you in make you preceive' refers to the idolaters, according to Muj&hid. In this case, the Ayah would mean, what makes you - you idolaters - preceive that you are truthful in the vows that you swore? Therefore, in this recitation, the Ayah means, the idolaters will still not believe if the sign that they asked for came. It was also said that you in, what will make you preceive , refers to the believers, meaning, what will make you preceive, O believers, that the idolaters will still not believe if the signs come. Allah also said, iSS& h 4"What prevented you (O Ibts) that you did not prostrate, when I commanded you?"} [7:12] and, 4And a ban is laid on every town (population) which We have destroyed that they shall not return (to this world again).} [21:95] These Ayat mean: What made you, O Iblls, refrain from prostrating, although I commanded you to do so, and, in the

second Ayah, that village shall not return to this world again. In the Ayah above [6:109], the meaning thus becomes: What makes you perceive, O believers, who wish eagerly for the disbelievers to believe, that if the Ayat came to them they would believe? Allah said next, ffl ."as -i* p'4 {And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away, as they refused to believe thereinfor the first time,} Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said about this Ayah, When the idolaters rejected what Allah sent down, their hearts did not settle on any one thing and they turned away from every matter (of benefit). 1 11 Mujahid said that Allah s statement, p'4 {andWe shall turn their hearts and their eyes away,} means, We prevent them

from the faith, and even if every sign came to them, they will not believe, just as We prevented them from faith the first time. Similar was said by Ikrimah and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said, Allah mentions what the servants will say before they say it and what they will do before they do it. Allah said; & JSg vj" {And none can inform you like Him Who is the All-Knower.} [35:14] and, {\$ sj&r 4 c-1it 4^ {Lest a person should say, "Alas, my grief that I was undutiful to Allah."} [39:56] until, Oi 4 3b {"Ifonly I had another chance, then I should indeed be among the doers ofgood."} [39:58]. So Allah, glory be to Him, states that if they were sent back A{- Tabari 12:44.

to life, they would not accept the guidance, l)r Q }But if they were returned, they would certainly revert to that which they were forbid- den. And indeed they are liars.} (6:28] Allah said, IT P'A 4.}v* }f 2 iAnd We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away (from gui- dance), as they refused to believe therein for the first time,} meaning: If they were sent back to this life, they would be prevented from embracing the guidance, just as We prevented them from it the first time, when they were in the life of this world. 111 Allah said, iand We shall leave them...} and abandon them, m mm % or.t . 1 , - > > - * * Aff 't'S iin their trespass...} meaning, disbelief, according to Ibn Abbas and As-Suddi. Abu Al- Aliyah, Ar-Rabi bin Anas and Qatadah said that their trespass means, their misguidance . m At-Tabari 12 :45

Al-An'dm (111) (Part-8) 4to wander blindly or playfully, according to Al-A mash. Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Abu Al- Aliyah, Ar-Rabi , Abu Malik and others commented, to wander in their disbelief. IjIT til & \$ fig 3 uy 0 %m 4111. And even ifWe had sent down unto them angels, and the dead had spoken unto them, and We had gathered together all things before them, they would not have believed, unless Allah willed, but most ofthem behave ignorantly.} Allah says: Had We accepted what the disbelievers asked for, that is - those who swore their strongest oaths by Allah that if a miracle came to them they would believe in it - had We sent down angels, to convey to them Allah s Message, in order to support the truth of the Messengers, as they asked, when they said, i'iS &\$ f} 4or you bring Allah and the angels before (us) face to face.} [17:92] 4They said: "We shall not believe until we receive the like of that which the Messengers of Allah had received."} [6:124] and, Ail f i'. yp b"UJ y Jlij 4And those who expect not a meeting with Us said : "Winy are not the angels setit down to us, or why do we not see our Lord?" Indeed they think too highly of themselves, and are scornful with great pride.} [25:21] Allah said. iand the dead had spoken unto them,} This is, to inform them of the truth of what the Messengers brought them;

they may remain pleased with it, and that they may commit what they are committing . Every Prophet Has Enemies Allah says, just as We made enemies for you, O Muhammad, who will oppose and rebel against you and become your adversaries, We also made enemies for every Prophet who came before you. Therefore, do not be saddened by this fact. Allah said in other Ayat. itik c# i&s# 345 sip {Verily, Messengers were denied before you, but with patience they bore the denial, and they were hurt...} [6:34], and, JiJ j[/*** jj! ii tiUr Jji Ji L"^ till Jli) {Nothing is said to you except what was said to the Messengers before you. Verily, your Lord is the Possessor offorgiveness, and (also) the Possessor ofpainful punishment.) [41:43] and, {Thus have We made for every Prophet an enemy among the criminals.) [25:31]. Waraqah bin Nawfal said to Allah s Messenger jg, None came with what you came with but he was the subject of enmity. Allah s statement, {Shayatin among mankind...} refers to,

{enemies...} meaning, the Prophets have enemies among the devils of mankind and the devils of the Jinns. The word, Shaytan, describes one who is dissimilar to his kind due to his or her wickedness. Indeed, only the Shaydfin, may Allah humiliate and curse them, from among mankind and the Jinns oppose the Messengers. Abdur-Razzaq said that Ma'mar Al-Bukhari no : 3

narrated that Qatadah commented on Allah s statement, iShayattn (decoils) among mankind and Jinn...} There are devils among the Jinns and devils among mankind who inspire each other. Allah s statement, Jj of" (3) (*+>"" dfjfi 4inspiring one another with adorned speech as a delusion .} means, they inspire each other with beautified, adorned speech that deceives the ignorant who hear it, c4 as ilfyour Lord had so willed, they would not have done it;} for all this occurs by Allah s decree, will and decision, that every Prophet had enemies from these devils, ->- pijJif iso leave them alone with theirfabrications.} and lies. This Ayah orders patience in the face of the harm of the wicked and to trust in Allah against their enmity, for, Allah shall suffice for you (O Muhammad) and aid you against them. Allah s statement, iAnd Tasghd to it.} means, according to Ibn Abbas, incline to it. 4the hearts of those who do not believe in the Hereafter...} their hearts, mind and hearing. As-Suddi said that this Ayah refers to the hearts of the disbelievers. 4And that they may remain pleased with it.} At-Tabari 12 :58 At-Tabari 12:59

they like and adore it. Only those who disbelieve in the Hereafter accept this evil speech, being enemies of the Prophets, etc., just as Allah said in other Ayat, 4 ik#& JC 4So, verily, you (pagans) and those whom you worship (idols). Cannot lead astray. Except those who are predestined to bum in Hell!) [37:161-163] and, 4Certainhr-yourhave different ideas. Turned aside therefrom is he lohcrfs turned aside.) [51:8-9] Allah said; 4^L>}j pi lyjlij) 4And that they may commit what they are committing.) meaning, let them earn whatever they will earn , according to Ali bin Abi Tajhah who reported this from Ibn Abbas.1,1 As- Suddi and . Ibn Zayd also commented, Let them do whatever they will do. ,2 iifj \$ 'J&\) \$ " 32 0&& c&l 43 aiCJf LJti ^ (jjl. 4114. [Say:] "Shall I seek a judge other than Allah while it is He Who has sent down unto you the Book, explained in detail." Those unto whom We gave the Scripture know that it is revealed from your Lord in truth. So be not you of those who doubt.) 4115. And the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice. None can change His Words. And He is the All- Hearer, the All-Knower.) Allah tells His Prophet jg to say to these polytheists who worship others besides Allah, m At-Tabari 12 :59Tabari 12 :60

40S. u0\$ 4Shall I seek a judge other than Allah ...^ between you and I, iwhile it is He Who has sent down unto you the Book, explained...:}m detail iand those unto whom We gave the Scripture the Jews and the Christians, 0* Jj**^ iknow that it is revealedfrom your Lord in truth.} because the previous Prophets have conveyed the good news of you coining to them. Allah s statement, UUP 4So be not you of those who doubt .^ is similar to His other statement, A&r3 ot 4^=0? 4" 0(SiS&slf^UP# 4So j/you are in doubt concerning that which We have revealed unto you, then ask those who are reading the Book before you. Verily, die truth has come to you from your Lord. So be not of those who doubt (it).} [10:94) The conditional if in this Ayah does not mean that doubt will ever occur to the Prophet gg . Allah said, 4fej iLf%^ %} 4And the Word ofyour Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice.} Qatadah commented, In truth concerning what He stated and in justice concerning what He decided. 1 11 Surely, whatever Allah says is the truth and He is Most Just in what m At-Tabari 12:63

He commands. All of Allah's statements are true, there is no doubt or cause for speculation about this fact, and all His commandments are pure justice, besides which there is no justice. All that He forbade is evil, for He only forbids what brings about evil consequences. Allah said in another Ayah, 4 sa & ^ ft 4He commands them with good; and forbids them from evil...} [7:157] until the end of the Ayah. 4None can change His Words.} meaning, none can avert Allah's judgment whether in this life or the Hereafter, iy& 4And He is the All-Hearer,} Hearing, His servants statements, 4} 4The All-Knower.} of their activities and lack of activity. Who awards each according to their deeds. (** (ijj i)y*& if 4A-SK if if J* "3} 4116. And if you obey most of those on the earth, they will mislead you far away from Allah's path. They follow nothing but conjecture, and they do nothing but lie.} 4117. Verily, your Lord! It is He Who knows best who strays from His way, and He knows best the rightly guided.} Most People are Misguided Allah states that most of the people of the earth, are misguided. Allah said in other Ayat, 4mp m 4And indeed most of the men of old went astray before them.} 137:711 and, 4w^k K'j} 4And most of mankind will not believe even if you eagerly desire >(^[12:103]

tissam uEH'fia '^=-| They are misguided, @4*r - f^O^ ^C jj 16iT4jJab_J I 'i j \ ^Li^Jtlj ojj^T*) Ojil bL">-vilJ.' ^ ^jjJL--"j \j"t 0* JtS" ,> jiiel yk^ iX^ ^f is He Who knows best who straysfrom His way.\$ and facilitates that for him, P '&> iAnd He knows best the rightly guided.> He facilitates that for them, all ofthem are facilitated for what He created them. lii \j&Jz vt j\$3 Cj p* o\ 4& \ ijsh> 1^* ojj *Jj ^jjLi>\ c vi jc^ (5 jj3 J5J fix fix ' i P J* -Xxj 81 j*> ^+AyX ||| \ojjP=X \x\ 1 -zf '-' 3 AUI^JlJ ij i_j_)\ y y *Jr" \ A yet they have doubts about their way, and they rely on wishful thinking and delusions. #W vi oAX;& 4They follow nothing but conjecture, and they do nothing but lie Thus, they fulfill Allah's decree and decision concerning them. 4118. So eat of that on which Allah's Name has been mentioned, ifyou are believers in His Aydt.\$ 4119. And why should you not eat of that on which Allah's Name has been mentioned, while He has explained to you in detail what is forbidden to you, except under compulsion of necessity? And surely, many do lead astray by their own desires through lack of knowledge. Certainly your Lord knows

best the transgressors.} AllowingWhatwas Slaughtered in the Name ofAllah This is a statement of permission from Allah, for His servants, allowing them to eat the slaughtered animals wherein His Name was mentioned when slaughtering them. It is understood from it that He has not allowed that over which Allah's Name was not mentioned when slaughtering. This was the practice of the pagans of Quraysh who used to eat dead animals and eat what was slaughtered for the idols. Allah next encourages eating from the meat of sacrificed animals on which His Name was mentioned upon slaughtering, 'p tf p& JaJ&\$ -1 yi \L. yfp iAnd why should you not eat of that on which Allah's Name has been mentioned, while He has explained to you what is forbidden to you ...} meaning, He has explained and made clear to you what He has prohibited for you in detail, 3 C iexcept under compulsion ofnecessity.} In which case, you are allowed to eat whatever you can find. Allah next mentions the ignorance of the idolators in their misguided ideas, such as eating dead animals and what was sacrificed while other than Allah's Name was mentioned when slaughtering them. Allah said, J* i) oj-i off} iAnd surely, many do lead astray by their own desires through lack of knowledge. Certainly your Lord knows best the transgressors.} He has complete knowledge of their transgression, lies and inventions. 'j'y 5jl_s2 4220. Leave sin, open and secret. Verily, those who commit sin will get due recompensefor that which they used to commit.}

Mujahid said that, b^} iLeave evil, open and secret...} refers to all kinds of sins committed in public and secret. Qatadah said that, iLeave sin, open and secret. . .} encompasses sins committed in public and secret, whether few or many. 2 In another statement, Allah said, 4Say : "(But) the things that my Lord has indeed forbidden are Al-Fawahish (evil sins) whether committed openly or secretly.} [7:33] This is why Allah said, ^jyjUj \ylt IL oyrP iVerily, those who commit sin will get due recompense for that which they used to commit.} Whether the sins they committed were public or secret, Allah will compensate them for these sins. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that An-Nawwas bin Sam'an said, I asked Allah's Messenger jg about Al-Ithm. He said, ,>&i if iijl> j?lJu- u *The sin is that which you find in your heart and you dislike that people become aware of if. JLjtljf *.N *& \$ i-t JS ^ iL Yj} 4121. Eat not of that on which Allah's Name has not been pronounced, for surely it is disobedience. And certainly, the Shayatin do inspire their friends to dispute with you, and if you 1,1 At-Tabari 12:73 Tabari 12 :72 4 : 1980

This Hadith was collected in the Two Sahths. Khadlj narrated that the Prophet jg said; rip 4 pi y fo)i y\$\\ u

a(For food) you have every bone on which Allah's Name was mentioned on slaughtering ."

Allah and one from the devil. Allah's revelation came to Muhammad jg, while the Shaytan's revelation comes to his friends. He then recited, 4And certainly, the Shaydtin do inspire their friends... We also mentioned Ikrimah's commentary on the Ayah, inspiring one another with adorned speech as a delusion.} Allah said next, 4j& i> 4to dispute with you,} Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Abbas commented; %} 4Eat not of that on which Allah's Name has not been mentioned. . .} until, 4-. -to dispute with you,} The devils inspire their loyal supporters, T)o you eat from what you kill but not from what Allah causes to die? As-Suddi said; Some idolators said to the Muslims, *You claim that you seek Allah's pleasure. Yet, you do not eat what Allah causes to die, but you eat what you slaughter? Allah said, 4and if you obey them...}, and eat dead animals, 4then you would indeed be polytheists.}13 Similar was said by Mujahid, Ad-pahhak and several others m At-Tabari 12:86 At-Tabari 12:81 [3! At-Tabari 12:81

among scholars of the SalafJ Giving Preference to Anyone's Saying Over the Legislation of Allah is Shirk Allah's statement, iand if you obey them, then you would indeed be polytheists.} means, when you turn away from Allah's command and Legislation to the saying of anyone else, preferring other than what Allah has said, then this constitutes Shirk. Allah said in another Ayah, 4\$ Oi ljXC&} iThey Qews and Christians) took their rabbis and their monks to be their lords besides Allah,}[9:31] In explanation of this Ayah,

The Parable of the Disbeliever and the Believer This is an example that Allah has given of the believer who was dead, meaning, wandering in confusion and misguidance. Then, Allah brought life to him, by bringing life to his heart with faith, guiding him to it and guiding him to obeying His Messengers, iAnd set for him a light whereby he can walk amongst men . > for he became guided to where he should go and how to remain on the correct path. The light mentioned here is the Qur'an, according to Ibn Abbas, as Al- Awfi and Ibn Abi Talhah reported from him.111 As-Suddi said that the light mentioned here is Islam.12 Both meanings are correct. iLike him who is in the darkness} of ignorance, desires and

various types of deviation, from which he can never come out?} for he is unable to find a way out from what he is in. In Musnad

And thus We have set up in every town great ones of its wicked people to plot therein. But they plot not except against themselves, and they perceive (it) not.} 4123. And when there comes to them a sign they say: "We shall not believe until we receive the like of that which the Messengers of Allah received." Allah knows best with whom to entrust His Message. Humiliation and disgrace from Allah and a severe torment will overtake the criminals for that which they used to plot.} Evil Plots of the Leaders of the Criminals and their Subsequent Demise Allah says: Just as We appointed chiefs and leaders for the criminals who call to disbelief, hinder from the path of Allah, and oppose and defy you in your town, O Muhammad. Such was also the case with the Messengers before you, who were tested with the same. But the good end was always theirs. Allah said in other Ayat, Thus have We made for every Prophet an enemy among the criminals.} [25:31] Allah said, And when We decide to destroy a town, We send a definite order to those among them who lead a life of luxury, and they transgress therein.} [17:16] meaning, We command them to obey Us, but they defy the command and as a consequence, We destroy them. It was also said that, We send a definite order, in the last Ayah means, We decree for them, as Allah stated here

to plot therein.} Ibn Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas explained the Ayah great ones of its wicked people to plot therein.} We give the leadership to these wicked ones and they commit evil in it. When they do this, We destroy them with Our torment. Mujahid and Qatadah said that in the Ayah, great ones refers to leaders. I say that this is also the meaning of Allah's statements, And We did not send a Warner to a township, but those who were given the worldly wealth and luxuries among them, said: "We believe not in what you have been sent with." And they say: "We have too much wealth and too many children and we are not going to suffer punishment.} [34:34-35] And, And similarly. We sent not a Warner before you to any town but the luxurious ones among them said: "We found our fathers following a certain way and religion, and we will indeed follow their footsteps." [43:23] Plot in the Ayah [6:123] refers to beautified speech and various actions with which the evil ones call to misguidance. Allah said about the people of Prophet Nuh, peace be upon him, I At-Tabari 12:94.

f/iey /woe plotted a mighty plot.} (71:22) Allah said, Jy-J Jj^' w'jf'V p 4 *. |* J J-i*; >* S/ i^SL:(iir j* S3 j*J i ?Sif *Jj i^T jS jlij 5 jfc H II ^ \$ 54^ i) j4j iv^ bvi a J<&\$ 1Z s 1&& uk ^Buf "/ you could see when the wrongdoers will be made to stand before their Lord, how they will cast the (blaming) word one to another! Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: Had it not been for you, we should certainly have been believers." And those who were arrogant will say to those who were deemed weak: "Did we keep you back from guidance after it had come to you? Nay, but you were criminals." Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day, when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals for Him!"} (34:31-33). Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Ibn Abi Umar said that Sufyan said, Every plot mentioned in the Qur'an refers to actions. Allah's statement, But they plot not except against themselves, and they perceive (it) not.} means, the harm of their wicked plots, as well as misguiding those whom they lead

astray, will only strike them. Allah said in other Ayat, iAnd verily, they shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own.} (29:13) and, Juu Jiji}

While they disbelieve at the mention of the Most Gracious (Allah).} [21:36], and, [tisfa

j? j- iA banner will be raised for every deceitful person from his anus on the Day of Resurrection, and it will say; 'This is the treacherous plot of so-and-so, son of so-and-so, son of so-and-so.,n The wisdom in this is that since a plot occurs in secret, and people are usually unaware of it, then on the Day of Resurrection the plot itself will become public news testifying to the actions of those who committed it. ill oij f&ilV& Gr* teMi \$ if &. fcaf 4 & Qfe-* Cf 4125. And whomsoever Allah wills to guide. He opens his t) Sm , > -f/v

breast to Islam; and whomsoever He wills to send astray, He makes his breast closed and constricted, as if he is climbing up to the sky. Thus Allah puts the wrath on those who believe not.} Allah said, 4And whomsoever Allah wills to guide. He opens his breast to Islam; He makes Islam easy for him and strengthens his resolve to embrace it, and these are good signs. Allah said in other Ayat, jj& Jf*'^ Sif Gr ils he whose breast Allah has opened to Islam, so that he is in light from His Lord (as he who is a non-Muslim)?} [39:22] and, SCiJ'b 44 \$ Igi} 4coxI,\$,U ib# iBut Allah has endeared the faith to you and has beautified it in your hearts, and has made disbelief, wickedness and disobedience hated by you. Such are they who are the rightly guided.} [49:7] Ibn Abbas commented on Allah s statement, 4And whomsoever Allah wills to guide, He opens his breast to Islam;}, Allah says that He will open his heart to Tawhid and faith in Him. This is the same as was reported from Abu Malik and several others, and it is sound. Allah s statement, 443*- 4-4 J 1fi'i} 4and whomsoever He wills to said astray, He makes his breast closed and constricted,} [i] Ad-DurrAl-Manthur3 :356

Al-An'am (125) (Part-8) refers to inability to accept guidance, thus being deprived of beneficial faith. 4...OS i//ie is climbing up to the sky.} because of the heaviness of faith on him. Said bin Jubayr commented that in this case, (Islam) finds every path in his heart impassable. 111 Al-Hakam bin Aban said that Ikrimah narrated from Ibn Abbas that he commented on: 4 CM~} 4 ...as if he is climbing up to the sky}, Just as the Son of Adam cannot climb up to the sky, Tawhid. and faith will not be able to enter his heart, until Allah decides to allow it into his heart. 121 Imam Abu Ja'far bin Jarir commented: This is a parable that Allah has given for the heart of the disbeliever, which is completely impassable and closed to faith. Allah says, the example of the disbeliever s inability to accept faith in his heart and that it is too small to accommodate it, is the example of his inability to climb up to the sky, which is beyond his capability and power. 131 He also commented on Allah s statement, iThus Allah puts the Rijs (wrath) on those who believe not.} Allah says that just as He makes the heart of whomever He decides to misguide, closed and constricted. He also appoints Shaytdn for him and for his likes, those who refused to believe in Allah and His Messenger. Consequently, Shaytdn lures and hinders them from the path of Allah. 141 Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said that, Rijs, refers to Shat/tan, while Mujahid said that it refers to all that does not contain goodness.161 Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that, 1,1 At-Tabari 12:105 121 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur3 :356Tabari 12:109 Af-Tabari 12:110Tabari 12:111Tabari 12:111

Rys, means, torment . if Jii\% \$ f'jJ'i; b 2 5c; i>- i&s> lyi?' 4^' . And f/iis is the path of your Lord leading straight. We have detailed Our Ayatfor a people who take heed.} 4127. For them will be the abode ofpeace with their Lord. And He will be their Walt because ofwhat they used to do.} After Allah mentioned the way of those who were themselves led to stray from His path and who hindered others from it, He emphasized the honor of the guidance and religion of truth that He sent His Messenger with. Allah said next, % i>- &>,} 4And this is the path ofyour Lord leading straight.} that is, Islam, that We have legislated for you, O Muhammad, by revealing this Qur an to you, is Allah s straight path. 02 1} 4We have detailed Our Ayat. ..} We have explained the Ayat and made them clear and plain, 4for a people who take heed} those who have sound comprehension and understand what Allah and His Messenger convey to them, 4f&\% } 4For them will be die abode ofpeace} Paradise, kc.} iwith their Lord.} on the Day of Resurrection. Allah described Paradise as the abode of peace , because its residents are safe due to their access to the straight path, which conforms to the way ofthe Prophets. And just as theirwaywas not wicked, they earned the abode ofpeace [which is free from all wickedness]. 4And He will be their Walt} Protector, Supporter and Helper,

^because ofwhat they used to do,} As reward for their good deeds, Allah has favored them and been generous with them, and awarded them Paradise. as; S5 ij&a ig^ && C -Ji ty 3s & p4 up T2&^ ii\$- icj Si& its 4128. And on the Day when He will gather them together (and say): "O you assembly ofJinn! Many did you mislead ofmen," and their friends among the people will say: "Our Lord! We benefited one from the other, but now we have reached our appointed term which You did appoint for us." He will say: The Fire be your dwelling place, you will dwell therein Jbrever, except as Allah may will. Certainly your Lord is All- Wise, All-Knowing."} Allah says, Mention, O Muhammad, in what you convey and warn, that, && }>)} ion the Day when He will gather them (all) together.} gather the Jinns and their loyal supporters from mankind who used to worship them in this life, seek refuge with them, obey them and inspire each other with adorned, deceitful speech. Allah will proclaim then. iO you assembly of Jinn! Many did you mislead of men,} So the Ayah; iMany did you mislead of men} refers to their misguiding and leading them astray. Allah also said; Jj J3 &\ Z&3\ \)Zc 'J JI p: jf \$t} lyj** | JjvjT jP j&j ' iDid I not command you, O Children of Adam, that you

468 Tafstr Ibn Kathir should not worship Shaytan. Verily, he is a plain enemy to you. And that you should worship Me. That is the straight path . And indeed he (Shaytan) did lead astray a great multitude ofyou. Did you not, then, understand?) [36:60-62], and iand their friends among the people will say: "Our Lord! We benefited onefrom the other . . .") The friends of the Jinns among humanity will give this answer to Allah, after Allah chastises them for being misguided by the Jinns. Al-Hasan commented, They benefited from each other when the Jinns merely commanded and mankind obeyed. Ibn Jurayj said, During the time of Jahiliyyah, a man would reach a land and proclaim, T seek refuge with the master (Jinn) of this valley, and this is how they benefited from each other. They used this as an excuse for them on the Day of Resurrection. * Therefore, the Jinns benefit from humans since humans revere the Jinns by invoking them for help. The Jinns would then proclaim, We became the masters of both mankind and the Jinns. ifo tfj' tp ibut now we have reached our appointed term which You did appointfor us.) meaning, death, according to As-Suddi. 'jQ\ Si) 4He (Allah) will say : "The Fire be your dwelling place..." where you will reside and live, you and your friends, 4you will dwell therein

forever.) and will never depart except what Allah may will. ^ Jjs i Hj Um) Jvo lltyjSj) Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 3 :357 Al-Tabari 12:116

Al-An'am (129 - 130) (Part-8) 4129. And thus We do make the wrongdoers supporters of one another, because of that which they used to earn.} The Wrongdoers Are the Supporters of Each other Ma'mar said that Qatadah commented on this Ayah, Allah makes the wrongdoers supporters for each other in the Fire by following one another into it. 111 Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented on Allah's statement, 4And thus We do make the wrongdoers supporters of one another.> It refers to the wrongdoers of the Jinns and mankind. He then recited, f -t y ' > ' "X. 4And whosoever turns away blindly from the remembrance of the Most Gracious (Allah), We appoint for him Shaytan to be a companion to him>[43:36] He said next - concerning the meaning of the Ayah; We appoint the wrongdoer of the Jinns over the wrongdoer of mankind. A poet once said, There is no hand, but Allah's Hand is above it, and no wrongdoer but will be tested by another wrongdoer.

The meaning of this honorable Ayah thus becomes: 'Just as

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1791–1809]

We made this losing group of mankind supporters of the Jinns that misguided them, We also appoint the wrongdoers over one another, destroy them by the hands of one another, and take revenge from them with one another. This is the just recompense for their injustice and transgression. *"2l \yfr .lipl J jje 'jjLjij Gjji ; il ijlu ijc 4130. O you assembly of Jinn and humans! Did not there Abdur-Razzaq 2:218Tabari 12:119

come to you Messengers from amongst you, reciting unto you My verses and warning you of the meeting of this Day of yours?" They will say: "We bear witness against ourselves." It was the life of this world that deceived them. And they will bear witness against themselves that they were disbelievers.} Chastising the Jinns and Humans after their Admission that Allah Sent Messengers to Them Allah will chastise the disbelieving Jinns and humans on the Day of Resurrection, when He asks them, while having better knowledge, if the Messengers delivered His Messages to them, i"0 you assembly of Jinn and humans! Did not there come to you Messengers from among you?"} We should note here that the Messengers are from among mankind only, not vice versa, as Mujahid, Ibn Jurayj and others from the Imams of Salaf and later generations have stated. The proof for this is that Allah said, is trA& iVerily, We have sent the revelation to you as We sent the revelation to Nuh and the Prophets after him.} [4:163], until, < Jk k ^Messengers as bearers of good news as well as of warning in order that mankind should have no plea against Allah after the (coming of) Messengers.} [4:165] Allah said, concerning the Prophet Ibrahim, iAnd We ordained among his offspring prophethood and the Book} [29:27], thus sending the prophethood and the Book exclusively through the offspring of the Prophet Ibrahim. No one has m Af-Tabari 12:122

Al-An'dm (129 - 130) (Part-8) claimed that there were Prophets from among the Jiiuis before the time of Ibrahim, but not after that. Allah said, 4 S'l 2 If Ss^ iXji 4-And We newer sent before you any o/ the Messengers but verily, they ate food and walked in the markets [25:20], and, & U iAnd We sent not before you any but men unto whom We revealed, from among the people of townships.} [12:109]

Therefore, concerning prophethood, the Jirms follow mankind in this regard and this is why Allah said about them, (g+t AA Qli 111'^ Oi < tijv. CjJj C5 l"-v" jJh OJ JA 1 4 /S *i ^ ot'J vfl ^ OV !>; 4 sOA ?>> Oi u*i(iAnd (remember) when We sent towards you a group of the Jinn, listening to die Qur'an. When they stood in the presence thereof, they said: "Listen in silence!" And when it was finished, they returned to their people, as wamers. They said: O our people! Verily, we have heard a Book sent down after Musa, confirming what came before it, it guides to the truth and to the straight way. O our people! Respond to Allah's caller, and believe in him. He (Allah) will forgive you your sins, and will save you from a painful torment (i.e. Hell-fire). And whosoever does not respond to Allah's caller, he cannot escape on earth, and there will be no helpers for him besides Allah. Those are in manifest error.} [46:29-32] A Hadith collected by At-Tirmidhi stated that the Messenger of Allah recited Surat Ar-Rahm&n, to these Jinns, in which Allah said, & sc& iWe shall attend to you, O you two classes (Jinn and men)! Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both (Jinn

472 Tafcir Ibn Kathir ts&znm '* " 4 4-3*^=a; t^Sol d4l fjlqip and men) deny?} [55:31-32] *"""" r" ^ji" i0?p^=_ i1 -> jiUjO j e-y '* - >^ <"^ jj ll All.i"U^j . ^ Allah said in this honorable Ayah, it # Z } sA: ^ & & ilSj . | ^=3Jr & ix). ijfi Ui j^CjJ 4Lit 40 yon assembly ofJinn and humans! \Did not there come to you Mes- sengers from amongst you, reciting unto you My verses and warning you of the meeting of this Day ofyours?" They will say: 'We bear witness against ourselves."} meaning, we affirm that the Messengers have conveyed Your Messages to us and warned us about the meeting with You, and that this Day will certainly occur. Allah said next, itfJ y K 1 '-i -i.-t s f > f/i/ ' * > * >- r> ""J j ^ : 1 1 & jp- *J^jfrj. 4/f was the life of this world that deceived them.} and they wasted their lives and brought destruction to themselves by rejecting the Messengers and denying their miracles. This is because they were deceived by the beauty, adornment and lusts ofthis life. irtr^& }And they will bear witness against themselves} on the Day of Resurrection, IM TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :177

ty?^} ithat they were disbelievers...} in this worldly life, rejecting what the Messengers, may Allah s peace and blessings be on them, brought them. iL: 147, JM; j J 4 .rT , ^ Laj . Tin's is because your Lord would not destroy the (populations of) towns for their wrongdoing while their people were unaware.} 4132. For all there will be degrees according to what they did. And your Lord is not unaware ofwhat they do.} Allah said, iTitis is because your Lord would not destroy the (populations of) towns far their wrongdoing while their people were unaware.} meaning: We sent the Messengers and revealed the Books to the Jinns and mankind, so that no one has an excuse that he is being punished for his wrongs although he did not receive Allah s Message. Therefore, We did not punish any of the nations, except after sending Messengers to them, so that they have no excuse. Allah said in other Ayat, & oi iAnd there never was a nation but a wamer had passed among them.} [35:24], and ia\ 'jfaj iil J^=> 4 til 4And verily, We have sent among every Umrnah a Messenger (proclaiming) : "Worship Allah, and stay awayfrom At-Tdghut (all false deities)." } [16:36], and }And We never punish until We have sent a Messenger.} [17:15], and,

^ \$k3 ' > pt qJ \\$) 4Every time a group is cast therein, its keeper will ask: "Did no warmer come to you?" They will say: "Yes, indeed a warmer did come to us, but we belied him.") [67:8-9] There are many other Ayat on this subject. At-Tabari said, Allah's statement, t 4For all there will be degrees according to what they did.) means, every person who obeys Allah or behaves disobediently, has grades

and ranks according to their works, which Allah gives them as recompense, good for good and evil for evil. I say, it is possible that Allah's statement, 4For all there will be degrees according to what they did.) refers to the disbelievers of the Jinns and mankind who will earn a place in the Fire according to their evil deeds. Allah said, 4He will say: "For each one there is double (torment)."[7:38), and, Lj > (;Uc S-ir- & i \sj 1 " Ji. x" * '?' 4Those who disbelieved and hinder (others) from the path of Allah, for them We will add torment to the torment because they used to spread corruption.) (16:88) Allah said next, o j) 4And your Lord is not unaware of what they do.) Ibn Jarir commented, All these deeds that they did, O Muhammad, they did while your Lord is aware of them, and He collects and records these deeds with Him, so that He recompenses them when they meet Him and return to Him. m At-Tabari 12:125

476 Tafsir Ibn Kathir i&Z if 4And in your place make whom He wills as your successors, who behave obediently, it (^=aLti |2T> 4As He raised you from the seed of other people.) and surely, He is able to do this, and it is easy for Him. And just as Allah has destroyed the earlier nations and brought their successors, He is able to do away with these generations and bring other people in their place. Allah has also said; Of Jit o j J*liil ifS j; III 4If He wills, He can take you away, O people, and bring others. And Allah is Ever Capable of that.) (4:133], 4O mankind! It is you who stand in need of Allah. But Allah is Rich (free of all needs). Worthy of all praise. If He willed, He could destroy you and bring about a new creation. And that is not hard for Allah.) (35:15-17J, and, 4But Allah is Rich (free of all needs), and you are poor. And if you turn away, He will exchange you for some other people and they will not be your likes.) (47:38). Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Ya qUb bin TJtbah said that he heard Aban bin TJthman saying about this Ayah, 4> U} 4As He raised you from the seed of other people.) The seed means the offspring and the children. Allah's statement, m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 3 :361

iSurely, that which you are promised, will verily, come to pass and you cannot escape. means, tell them, O Muhammad, that what they have been promised of Resurrection will surely occur, > 4and you cannot escape.) from Allah. Rather, He is able to resurrect you even after you become dust and bones. Certainly, Allah is able to do all things and nothing ever escapes His power. Allah said; 4Say: "O my people! Work according to your way, surely, I too am working and you will come to know."} This contains a stern warning and a sure promise, saying; remain on your way, if you think that you are rightly guided, for I will remain on mine. Allah said in another Ayah, k 12 ijfcf \$ Jj} 4And say to those who do not believe: "Act according to Makaanatikum, We are acting (in our way). And you wait! We (too) are waiting."} [11:121-122]. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said that, iaccording to Makaanatikum...} means, your way.11 ' f VA % jS > 2 4And you will come to know far which of us will be the (happy) end in the Hereafter. Certainly the wrongdoers will not be successful} [6:135], You will come to know if the happy end will be mine (Muhammad's) or yours (the disbelievers). Allah has indeed kept His promise and allowed Muhammad to prevail in the iT Af-Tabari 12:129

Some Acts of Shirk Allah chastises and criticizes the idolators who invented innovations, Kufr and Shirk, and called on partners and rivals with Allah among His creation, although He created every thing, all praise is due to Him. This is why Allah said, 4And they assign to Allah from that which He has created,) iof the tilth) meaning, fruits and produce, %) iand of the cattle a share) meaning a part and a section. iand they say: "This is for Allah," according to their claim, "and this is for our partners") Allah

said next, . yA A, A\ Z2) iBut the share of their "partners " reaches not Allah, while the share of Allah reaches their "partners' !) Ali bin Abi Talhah and Al-'Awfi narrated that Ibn Abbas said; When they, the enemies of Allah, would cultivate the land or collect produce, they would assign a part of it to Allah and another part to the idol. They would keep the share for the idol, whether land, produce or anything else, and preserve its division to such an extent that they would collect anything that accidentally falls from the share they assigned to Allah and add it to the share of the idol. If the water that they assigned for the idol irrigated something (a section of land, for instance) that they assigned for Allah, they would add whatever this water irrigated to the idol s share! If the land or produce that they assigned for Allah was accidentally mixed with the share that they assigned for the idol, they would say that the idol is poor. Therefore, they would add it to the share they assigned for the idol and would not return it to the share

Jr Ibn KathirE they assigned for Allah. If the water that they assigned for Allah irrigated what they assigned for the idol they would leave it (the produce) for the idol. They also made some of their other property sacred, like the Bahirah, Sa ibah, WasUah and Ham, assigning them to the idols, claiming that they do so as way of seeking a means of approach to Allah. Allah said, ill y l)i LLj ji. 4And they assign to Allah a share of the tilth and cattle which He has created... Similar was said by Mujahid, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others.'21 Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented; Every type of slaughter that they would assign for Allah, would never be eaten unless they mentioned the names of their idols when slaughtering it. Yet for what they sacrificed in the names of the idols, they would not mention Allah s Name when slaughtering it. He then recited the Ayah (6:136) until he reached, 4Evil is the way theyjudge!^ This Ayah means, evil is that which they determined, for they committed error in the division. Certainly, Allah is the Lord, Owner and Creator of all things and His is the dominion. All things are His property and under His supreme control, will and decree. There is no deity worthy of worship, or Lord, except Him. And even when the polytheists made this evil division, they did not preserve it, but cheated in it. Allah said in other Ayat, y 4And they assign daughters unto Allah - glory be to Him - and unto themselves what they desire (16:57), and 4Yet, they assign to some of His servants a share with Him. At-Tabari 12:131-132 At-Tabari 12:133Tabari 12:134

Al-An'dm (137) (Part-8) Verily, man is indeed a manifest ingrate!} [43:151, and, ils itfor you the mates and for Him thefemales? That indeed is a division most unfair!} (53:21-22). jjv uvAr ..ll c iif i; ^ i^jb; . And so to many of the idolators, their "partners" have made fair seeming the killing of their children, in order to lead than to their own destruction and cause confusion in their religion. And ifAllah Imd willed, they would not have done so. So leave them alone with theirfabrications.} Shaytan Lured the Idolators to Kill Their Children Allah says, just as the Shayatin lured the idolators to assign a share for Allah from what He created of agriculture and cattle - and a share for the idols, they also made it seem fair for them to kill their children, for fear of poverty, and burying their daughters alive, for fear of dishonor. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas that he commented; 4And so to many of the idolators, their "partners" have made fair seaning the killing of their children...} They make killing their children attractive to them. 01 Mujahid said, Idolators partners among the devils ordered them to bury their children for fear of poverty. ,2) As-Suddi said, The devils commanded them to kill their daughters so that they. Head than to tltheir own destruction}, and to,Tabari 12:136 At-Tabari 12:136.

482 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir 4 t[^]ii tcause confusion in their religion.y Allah said, 4? 3 c "if tti 4And if Allah had willed, they would not have done so.} meaning, all this occurred by Allah s leave, will and decree, but He dislikes these practices, and He has the perfect wisdom in every decree. He is never questioned about what He does, but they all will be questioned. 4So leave them alone with theirfabrications.} meaning, avoid and abandon them and what they do, for Allah will judge between you and them. 4 . \ r' <,\ ==^ a s <. ' < ' " , ' f s \$ "rj} ^==u>- i ur J ; -ib ijte- Hj C* if id 5\$J -J JBfe U&# 4138. And according to their claim, they say that such and such cattle and crops are Hijr (forbidden), and none should eat of them except those whom we allow. And (they say) there are cattle forbidden to be used for burden, and cattle on which (at slaughtering) the Name of Allah is not pronounced ; lyingTabari 12:137

Al-An'dm (138) (Part-8) against Him (Allah). He will recompense them for what they used to fabricate.} The Idolatore Forbade Certain Types ofCattle Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, Hijr refers to what they forbade, such as the Wastlah, and the like. 111 Similar was said by Mujahid, Ad-l?ahh&k, As-Suddi, Qatadah, Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and others. Qatadah commented on, iThey say that such and such cattle and crops are Hijr,} It is a prohibition that the Shayatin appointed for their wealth, and a type of exaggeration and extremism that did not come from Allah. [Abdur-Rahman] Ibn Zayd bin Aslam said that, iHijr,} refers to what the idolaters deities.131 As-Suddi said that the Ayah, designated for their iAnd none should eat of them except those whom we allow, they claimed. . . } means, They said, only those whom we choose can eat of them., and the rest are prohibited from eating them. Similar to this honorable Ayah, Allah said, j&J 'it ji Mij t'j a 5 'it jy e \$} 4Say : "Tell me, what provision Allah has sent down to you! And you have made of it lawful and unlawful." Say: Has Allah permitted you (to do so), or do you invent a lie against Allah?" [10:59], At-Tabari 12:143 At-Tabari 12:143 At-Tabari 12:143 At-Tabari 12:143

and, \$ jc iujju ij "ij fr?J 'Sj /?{t- "h >; iAllah has not instituted things like Bahirah or a Sd'ibah or a Wasilah or a Ham. But those who disbelieve invent lies against Allah, and most ofthem have no understanding.} [5:103] As-Suddi said that cattle forbidden to be used for burden were the Bahirah, Sa ibah, Wasilah and Ham, as well as cattle for which the idolators did not mention Allah s Name when slaughtering them nor when they were bom. Abu Bakr bin Ayyash said that Asim bin Abi An-Najud said, Abu Wa il said to me, Do you know the meaning of the Ayah, & ill up% G&fIC^ iAnd (they say) there are cattle forbidden to be used for burden, and cattle on which the Name of Allah is not pronounced.} I said, 140. He said, It is the Bahirah, which they would not use to for Hajj (either by riding it or carrying things on it). Mujahid also said that they were some of the camels belonging to idolators on which Allah s Name was not mentioned when riding, milking, carrying things, copulation or any other action. Hying against Him.} against Allah. The idolators indeed lied when they attributed this evil to Allah s religion and Law; He did not allow them to do that nor did He approve of it. 4He will recompense them for what they used tofabricate.} against Him, and falsely attribute to Him. o&s& SyM jjia M | *<&=& ,l * At-Tabari 12:144Jabari 12:145

4139. And they say: "What is in the bellies of such and such cattle is for our males alone, and forbidden to our females, but if it is bom dead, then all have slmres therein." He will punish them for their attribution (ofsuch false orders to Allah). Verily, He is All-Wise, All-Knower.} Abu Ishaq As-Subayl narrated that Abdullah bin Abi Al- Hudhayl reported that Ibn Abbas said that, ifyM I&JL And they say :

"What is in the bellies of such and such cattle is for our males alone... } refers to milk. Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said about this Ayah, 4And they say: "What is in the bellies of such and such cattle is for our males alone. It is about milk, which they prohibited for their females and allowed only their males to drink. When a sheep would give birth to a male sheep, they would slaughter it and feed it to their males, but not to their females. If the newly born lamb was a female, they would not slaughter it, but if it was stillborn, they would share in it (with their females)! Allah forbade this practice. * Similar was said by As-Suddi. Ash-Sha'bi said, The Bahirah milk was only given to the men. But if any cattle from the Bahirah died, both men and women would share in eating it. Similar was said by Ikrimah, Qatadah and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. Mujahid commented; 4And they say : "What is in the bellies of such and such cattle is for our males alone, and forbidden to our females.. ." } It refers to the Sa'ibah and the Bahirah." * Abu Al- Aliyah, Mujahid and Qatadah said that Allah's statement, At-Tabari 12:146 * At-Tabari 12:147 * At-Tabari 12:148 At-Tabari 12:148

4He will punish them for their attribution.} means, uttering such falsehood.' This is explained by Allah's statement. 5 LOS uij jfcSyf .U O i#S \$> 4? y 4fl Jp ojj^i uj. 4And say not concerning that which your tongues falsely utter: "This is lawful and this is forbidden." so as to invent lies against Allah. Verily, those who invent lies against Allah will never prosper.} [16 :116] Allah said, 4Verily, He is All-Wise.} in His actions, statements. Law and decree, 4All-Knower}, in the actions of His servants, whether good or evil, and He will recompense them for these deeds completely. \$ 'S^ Z} 4^-^ifai* iy&=" Uj ifee IS 4140. Indeed lost are they who have killed their children, foolishly, without knowledge, and (they) have forbidden that which Allah has provided for them, inventing a lie against Allah. They have indeed gone astray and were not guided.} All&h says that those who committed these evil acts have earned the loss of this life and the Hereafter. As for this life, they lost when they killed their children and made it difficult for themselves by prohibiting some types of their wealth, as an act of innovation that they invented on their own. As for the Hereafter, they will end up in the worst dwellings, because they used to lie about Allah and invent falsehood about Him. Allah also said, HI At-Tabari 12:152

"Verily, those who invent a lie against Allah will never be successful." (A brief) enjoyment in this world! And then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve.} [10:69-70] Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr bin Marduwyah recorded that Ibn Abbas commented, If it pleases you to know how ignorant the Arabs used to be, then recite the Ayat beyond Ayah one hundred and thirty in Surat Al-An'am, \$ jp bi-1' L. ft Jjju i!+iS fr~>- Ji} 4W-,^.*Z^ Cj 'i Indeed lost are they who have killed their children, foolishly, without knowledge, and [they] have forbidden that which Allah has provided for them, inventing a lie against Allah. They have indeed gone astray and were not guided.}

the virtues of the Quraysh .

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1809–1810]

pj gifj 12* isii% 0} it," ""A" *jl>. IyV"j j*-> I ' -t*" * iid. ^ &p&0*vA (A %&ph i* tffc- 4141. And it is He Who produces gardens Ma'rushdt and not Ma'rushdt, and date palms, and crops of different shape and taste, and olives, and pomegranates, similar, and different. Eat of their fruit when they ripen, but pay the due thereof on the day of their harvest, and waste not by extravagance. Verily, He likes not the

wasteful.} 4142. And of the cattle (are some) for burden and (some smaller) for Farsh. Eat of what Allah has provided for you, and follow not the footsteps of Shaytan. Surely, he is to you an open enemy.}

Allah Created the Produce, Seed Grains and Cattle Allah states that He created everything, including the produce, fruits and cattle that the idolators mishandled by their misguided ideas, dividing them into various designated parts, allowing some and prohibiting some. Allah said, / < ; / S-" sA'V 4And it is He Who produces gardens Ma'rushdt and not Ma'rushdt,) Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented, Ma'rushat refers to what the people trellise, while not Ma'rushdt refers to fruits (and produce) that grow wild inland and on mountains. Ata Al-Khurasani said that Ibn Abbas said, Ma'rushdt are the grapevines that are trellised, while hot Ma'rushdt refers to grapevines that are not trellised. As-Suddi said similarly. As for these fruits being similar, yet different, Ibn Jurayj said, They are similar in shape, but different in taste. ' Muhammad bin Ka*b said that the Ayah, 4Eat of their fruit when they ripen,\$ means, (Eat) from the dates and grapes they produce. 3 Allah said next, jLi. ibut pay the due thereof on the day of their harvest,) Mujahid commented, When the poor people are present (on

the day of harvest), give them some of the produce.”*4’

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1810–1870]

Abdur- Razzaq recorded that Mujahid commented on the Ayah, >- *j5""j^ ibut pay the due thereof on the day of their harvest.) When planting, one gives away handfuls (of seed grains) and on harvest, he gives away handfuls and allows them to pick Jabari 12:156 * At-Jabari 12:157 ' At-Tabari 12:157 * At-Jabari 12:163

whatever is left on the ground of the harvest. 111 Ath-Thawri said that Hammad narrated that Ibrahim An-Nakha! said, One gives away some of the hay."121 Ibn Al-Mubarak said that Shurayk said that Salim said that Sa'Id bin Jubayr commented; *JL"- 4but pay the due thereof on the day of their harvest This ruling, giving the poor the handfuls (of seed grains) and some of the hay as food for their animals, was before Zakah became obligatory. Allah has chastised those who harvest, without giving away a part of it as charity. Allah mentioned the story of the owners of the garden in Surat Nun, dlSf o? % :.'v; % y# Ib-ii if je jjaej yHjJ V Ji itiigsuZ & y# iQji&gi VJ j"i jl js fyiiyjj* & j? IJri J J#-* ill Uy, ijli je. Jjli IV, 4 jtt, ijil? j) y"l9i v'ilj > dl H) S^i- iWhen they swore to pluck the fruits of the (garden) in the morning. Without saying: "If Allah wills." Then there passed by on the (garden) a visitation (fire) from your Lord at night, Burning it while they were asleep. So the (garden) became black by the morning, like a pitch dark night (in complete ruins). Then they called out one to another as soon as the morning broke. Saying: "Go to your tilth in the morning, if you would pluck the fruits." So they departed, conversing in secret low tones (saying) . "No poor person shall enter upon you into it today." And they went in the morning with strong intention, thinking that they have power (to prevent the poor taking anything of the fruits therefrom). But when they saw the (garden), they said: "Verily, we have gone astray." (Then they Abdur-Razzaq 2:219 At-Jabari 12:165

4And eat and drink but waste not by extravagance. [7:31] In his Sahih,

Al-An'am (143 - 144) (Part-8) J m&m uv it imm ita^VU Js i** ^ ~ ^oi (Jj* ; * I ^L>-^ '^aj ZyiyO6 IS^kVf: ^irsitd \3^*^=^Tjii&gJ^= ri J yfitJ 1^S=> 4jli t jj ^ jL-> S/jslp jjl^.'y&c ijj"S/^rii-ILj cljjfjittU

J ^L^c> Illi t> Jcj flp IL^Juz^jJSJ A\$4: become the dwellers of the blazing Fire.} [35:6] and. ' S' p: - i fj^ ^i-1 iS <'>\ i '*'>', '- *.* ' . OJ tiT il ja ilp3 ^ gjf 40 Children of Adam! Let not Shaytan deceive you, as he got your parents out of Paradise, stripping them of their raiment, to show them their private parts.} [7:27] and, ijj *C /yJwiif - ; tit' .V< . > ^ JO* pSJ pj Oji OjJltU 4VV1// you then take him (Iblis) and his offspring as protectors and helpers rather than Me while they are enemies to you? What an evil is the exchange for the wrongdoers .}\18:50] There are many other Aydt on this subject. Q Ort ff fji. ji jClii j_Lji ^CsiJ uYj' 1 \$fcSlT dji. g ^ C~C3} ifffi otj o\^ Oy {CA *-& ^ c jSn fj*. ji ij^l jjJI CCjt) J-j*J 'i^=" "" j* ifjtj' cj*- u > iit f =>~Z H fjiJ* if^f. V 5#i 0] jYij o' 4243. Eight pairs: of the sheep two (male and female), and of the goats two (male and female). Say: "Has He forbidden the

ilnjbrm me with knowledge if you are truthful. meaning, tell me with sure knowledge, how and when did Allah prohibit what you claimed is prohibited, such as the Bahirah, Sa ibah, WasUah and Ham etc.? Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said, Allah s statement, <" 2f 5*&& <>; 3 ' &} iEight pairs : of the sheep two, and of the goats two. . .} these are four pairs, 4Say : "Has Heforbidden the two males or the twofemales .. ."} I (Allah) did not prohibit any of these. fCjl 3&LLi &} ior (the young) which the wombs of the twofemales enclose?} and does the womb produce but males and females? So why do you prohibit some and allow some others? ilnjbrm me with knowledge if you are truthful.} Allah is saying that all of this is allowed. ' Allah said. iOr, were you present when Allah ordered you such a thing?} mocking the idolaters innovations, and their lies that Allah made sacred what they have prohibited. iP* J-P 4"" jc i&l lfj>} iThen who does more wrong than one who invents a lie against Allah, to lead mankind astray without knowledge.} Therefore, no one is more unjust than the people described here and Xi V S"f <!>)^ iCertainly, Allah guides not the people who are wrongdoers.} The person most worthy of this condemnation is Amr bin At-Tabari 12:187

496 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir Luhay bin Qum'ah. He was the first person to change the religion of the Prophets and designate the Sa ibah, Wasdah and Ham, as mentioned in the Sahib. to jl liillJ C'J^ t j Jj ^ jjtj Ji* *{ ^ jji) j-f 1 Ijuli jl /O^ p- jl L-ji 4 vj 4145. Say: "7 find not in that which has been revealed to me anything forbidden to be eaten by one who wishes to eat it, unless it be Maytah (a dead animal) or blood poured forth, or the flesh of swine; for that surely, is unclean (Rijs), or immorally slaughtered in the name of other than Alldh. But whosoever is forced by necessity without willful disobedience, nor transgressing due limits; (for him) certainly, your Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. ForbiddenThings Allah commands His servant and Messenger, Muhammad sg, iSay\$ O Muhammad jg to those who prohibited what Allah has provided them, claiming this falsehood to be from Allah, 4&SZ 31uj t j4 41 find not in that which has been revealed to me anything forbidden to be eaten by one who wishes to eat it, This Ayah means, I do not find any animals that are prohibited, except these mentioned here. We should mention here that the prohibited things mentioned in Surat Al-Ma idah and the Hadiths on this subject amend the meaning of this Ayah. 4or blood poured .^ Qatadah commented, Poured blood was prohibited, but the meat that still has some blood in it is 111 Path Al-Bari 8:132

allowed. 111 Al-Humaydi said that Sufyan narrated to us that Amr bin Dinar narrated to us, I said to Jabir bin Abdullah, They claim that the Messenger of Allah jg prohibited the meat of donkeys during (the day of) Khaybar. He said, Al-Hakam bin Amr narrated that from the Messenger of Allah That

scholar - referring to Ibn Abbas - denied it, reciting the Ayah; cl) 1 4 S 4 Say : "I find not in that which has been revealed to me anything forbidden to be eaten by one who wishes to eat it. .

She said, Should we use the skin of a sheep that has died? Allah's Messenger jg| said, o/2 J jiiZlu C ^ jL3 'y :Jii ju uJi" "yJj; of y j^- "3 jf CJiIS Cl jl Allah only said, 4Say: I find not in that which has been revealed to me anything forbidden to be eaten by one who wishes to eat it, except Maytah (a dead animal) or blood poured forth, or the flesh of swine....) You will not be eating it if you tan its skin and benefit from it. So she had the sheep skinned, the skin was tanned and made into a water skin that she kept until it wore out. 111 Al- Bukhari and an-Nasal collected a similar Had.ith. Allah said, % -g, jC(iBut whosoever is forced by necessity without willful disobedience, nor transgressing due limits;) Therefore, whoever is forced by necessity to eat anything that Allah has forbidden in this honorable Ayah, without transgressing his limits, then for him, fyf icertainly, your Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) We mentioned the explanation of this Ayah in Surat Al- Baqarah. This honorable Ayah contradicts the idolators' innovated prohibitions for certain kinds of wealth, relying merely on their misguided ideas, such as the Bahlrah, Sa ibah, WasUah and Ham. Allah commanded His Messenger jJI to inform them that he does not find that such types of animals are prohibited in what Allah revealed to him. In this Ayah, Allah only prohibited dead animals, poured blood, the flesh of swine and what has been slaughtered for something other than Allah. Other things were not prohibited here, but rather treated as that which does not have a ruling, i.e., permissible. Therefore, how do you - idolators claim that such items are m Ahmad 1 :327 Al-B&ri 1 1 :557 and An-Nasal 7 :173

prohibited, and why did you prohibit them when Allah did not prohibit them? *-^^ fc Ju'i !X, ms jl ji ^ i7 "/ rate . And unto those a?/io are Jews, We forbade every (animal) with undivided hoof, and We forbade them the fat of the ox and the sheep except what adheres to their backs or their Hawdya, or is mixed up with a bone. Thus We recompensed them for their rebellion. And verily, We are Truthful.} FoodsthatwereProhibitedfortheJewsBecause oftheir Transgression Allah says. We forbade for the Jews every bird and animal with undivided hoof, ' such as the camel, ostrich, duck and goose. Allah said here. iand We forbade them the fat of the ox and the sheep.. .} The Jews used to forbid these types of foods saying that Isratl, or Ya'qub, used to forbid them for himself so they too forbid them. This was mentioned by As-Suddi. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said that, i&s# JiX %} iexcept what adheres to their backs} refers to the fat that clings to their backs. * Allah said next, i&fX }} 4or their Hawdya } that is, the entrails, according to Abu Jafar bin Jarir. He also said, The meaning here is, And from ox and sheep, We forbade their fat for the Jews, except the fat on their backs and what the entrails cany. Ali bin Abi Tajhah said that, Ibn *** See the comments on Surah At 'ImrGn, 3 :93 * At-Tabari 12 :202

Abbas said that the, Hawaya, are the entrails. * Similar was reported from Mujahid,'2 Said bin Jubayr and Ad-Dahhak.'3' Allah's statement, 4f&l 4....or is mixed up with a bone.) means, We allowed the Jews the fat that is mixed with bones. Ibn Jurayj commented, The fat on the rump that is mixed with the tailbone was allowed for them, and also the fat on the legs, head, eyes and what adheres to the bones. ' As-Suddi said similarly.'5 ' Allah said, iThus We recompensed them for their rebellion.) meaning, We imposed this restriction on them as recompense for their rebellion and defying Our commandments. Allah said in another Ayah, A A Si 4For the wrongdoing of the Jews, We made unlawful for them

certain good foods which had been lawful for them - and for their hindering many from Allah's way) [4:160]. Allah's statement, 4And verily. We are Truthful.) means, We were justified in the penalty We gave them. Ibn Jarir commented, We are Truthful in what We informed you of, O Muhammad; Our forbidding these foods for them, not as they claimed, that Israel merely forbade these things for himself (so they imitated him, they claimed). At-Tabari 12:203 At-Tabari 12:204 At-Tabari 12:204 At-Tabari 12:205 * At-Tabari 12:205 At-Tabari 12:206

May Allah curse the Jews! The fats were forbidden for them, so they melted the fat and sold it.* This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahih. ,1) Jabir bin Abdullah said, In the year of the victory of Makkah, I heard Allah's Messenger saying; and His Messenger have forbidden selling alcoholic drinks (intoxicants), dead animals, swine and idols. He was asked, What about the fat of dead animals? They are used to dye skins, paint ships and are used as light by the people. He said,

502 Tafstr Ibn Kathtr He jg then said, * * aj*^ (J tj&r (: '!* llJ 2ii jj S^Ji 2 J;Ui May Allah fight the Jews! When Allah forbade them the fats of animals, they melted the fat, sold it and ate its price.d The Group recorded this Hadith. ^ j*iV Jji Vj /j?U J> (^=4j JSi 0^ . // they deny you say :"

iDeclare unto My servants, that truly, I am the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful. And that My torment is indeed the most painful torment.} [15:49-50], and Wy^ ^ JThe Forgiver of sin, the Acceptor of repentance, the Severe in punishment.} [40:3] and, 142 jz iVerily, the punishment of your Lord is severe and painful. Verily, He it is Who begins and repeats. And He is Oft- Forgiving, full of love.H85:12-14]. There are many other Ayat on this subject. sis' ot 44 4)* 'ij t* "Sif 3) ijS^ itJ' U lyrjc. J* J" Ixib iy'i^ oj rd jS &Li^ \$ 0IS I4" V| i.jUS i4ii VJ [* ,ji 3 S. p % SjUii; ^ *12 Cr5 -4 4 4148. Those who committed Shirk say: "If Allah had willed, we would not have committed Shirk, nor would our fathers, and we would not have forbidden anything (against His will)." Likewise belied those who were before them, till they tasted Our wrath. Say: "Have you any knowledge (proof) that you can produce before us? Verily, you follow the Zann and you do nothing but lie."} 4149. Say: "With Allah is the perfect proof and argument; had He so willed. He would indeed have guided you all."} 4150. Say: "Bring forward your witnesses, who can testify that Allah has forbidden this." Then if they testify, do not testify with them. And do not follow the vain desires of those who belie Our Ayat, and such as believe not in the Hereafter, and they hold others as equal with their Lord.}

A False Notion and its Rebuttal Here Allah mentioned a debate with the idolators, refuting a false notion they have over their Shirk and the things that they prohibited. They said, surely, Allah has full knowledge of the Shirk we indulge in, and that we forbid some kinds of wealth. Allah is able to change this Shirk by directing us to the faith, - they claimed - and prevent us from falling into disbelief, but He did not do that. Therefore - they said Allah indicated that He willed, decided and agreed that we do all this. They said, Oi Gj*- Vj Lijtji Vj l& ;U }) A "If Allah had willed, we would not have taken partners (in worship) with Him, nor would our fathers, and we would not have forbidden anything. ")> Allah said in another Ayah, Ju e m AAnd they said : "If it had been the will of the Most Gracious (Allah), we should not have worshipped them (false deities)" [43 :20], Similar is mentioned in Surat An-Nahl. Allah said next, o; C'jS' JmL^) ALikewise belied those who were before them,) for by using and relying on this understanding, the misguided ones before them were led astray. This notion is false and ungrounded, for had it been true, Allah would not have harmed them, destroyed them, aided His

honorable Messengers over them, and made them taste His painful punishment. Af* Ji ji ASay : "Have you any knowledge...") that Allah is pleased with you and with your ways, XU Athat you can produce before us.) and make it plain, apparent and clear for us. However,

& vj iVerily, you only folloio the Zann} doubts and wishful thinking, Vi iand you do nothing but lie^ about Allah in the false claims that you utter. Allah said next, ivt*Jwr' it* \$ iijiji iii-i 4Sni/ : "With Allah is the perfect proof and argument; had He so willed,'He would indeed have guided you all."} Allah said to His Prophet jg iSay} O Muhammad, to them, i& i\ i* U i With Allah is the perfect proof and argument..."} the perfect wisdom and unequivocal proof to guide whom He wills and misguidewhom He wills. 55. yi} ihad He so willed, He would indeed have guided you all.} All of this happens accordng to His decree. His will, and His choice. So in this way, He is pleased with the believers, and angry with the disbelievers. Allah said in other Ayat, "*>' its fj} iAnd had Allah willed, He could have gathered them together (all) on true guidance,} [6:35] and 4u?& 4 '<& '45 55. jb> iAnd had your Lord willed, those on earth would have believed, all of them together.} [10:99] and, lily (jA V) iJw'ofitii V_> "JA-J iil jl Jii Si <\$4 iJt*V ic; - / your Lord had so willed. He could surely have made mankind one Ummah, but they will not cease to disagree.

506 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Except him on whom your Lord has bestowed His mercy and for that did He create them. And the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled ",Surely, I shall fill Hell with Jinns and men all together.") [11:118-119] Ad-Dahhfik said, No one has an excuse if he disobeys Allah. Surely, Allah has the perfect proof established against His servants. Allah said, P& 4Bringforward your witnesses,) produce your witnesses, iwho can testify that Allah has forbidden this.) which you have forbidden and lied and invented about Allah in this regard, iThen if they testify, do not testify with them.) because in this case, their testimony is false and untrue, ->-#/ ijitj vSi*svL cZ/M y5 4j) iAnd do not follow the vain desires of those who belie Our Aydt, and such as believe not in the Hereafter, and they hold others as equal with their Lord.) by associating others with Allah in worship and treating them as equals to Him. ~'- ~i &&& ft 'Jp5 <^=* |ife=4j sQ 'tj ^=oj/ Si rjlji >/j .ij fXlij iJLi vj , Ih^j 4 . Say : "Come, I will recite what your Lord has prohibited you from : Join not anything in worship with Him ; be kind and dutiful to your parents; kill not your children because of poverty - We provide sustenance for you and for them. Come not near to Al-Fawdhish (immoral sins) whether committed

} TenCommandments Dawud Al-Awdy narrated that, Ash-Sha bi said that, Alqamah said that Ibn Mas'Gd said, Whoever wishes to read the will and testament of the Messenger of Allah jgj on which he placed his seal, let him read these Ayat, pi\$ c&wa iSay :

508 Tafcir Ibn Kathir until the end of the Ayat. He then said, cJl? U;oJl *Sjiti 3. Jaj jil (JU oyj-ti ^yj lip li ijij 4jjp ^Lt jl)1 o^ oy- Sl yi-1 yaj ,Oyp "W/ioeyer fulfills (this pledge), then his reward will be with Allah, but whoever fell into shortcomings and Allah punishes him for it in this life, then that will be his recompense. Wlwever Allah delays (Ids reckoning) until the Hereafter, then his matter is with Allah. IfHe wills, He will punish him, and ifHe wills, He willforgive Al-Hakim said, Its chain is Sahih and they did not record it. 1 ! ' ' As for the explanation of this Ayah, Allah said to His Prophet and Messenger Muhammad jg: Say, O Muhammad, to those idolators who worshipped other than Allah, forbade what Allah provided them with and killed their children, following their opinions and the lures ofthe devils, 43*S"y^ to them 4Come} come here, come close j =4; '\$. c 41 will recite what your Lord

has prohibited you from.} meaning, I will inform you about what your Lord has forbidden for you in truth, not guessing or wishful thinking. Rather, it is revelation and an order from Him. Shirk is Forbidden 4Join not anything in worship with Him;} this Allah has ordained, for He said at the end of the Ayah, -4 &*} 111 Al-yakim 2:318

S]L N OjL* ^jA I :JU op J jp >-3j^ jp ,Jj jp : Jli jp J'o jp jp Pj-- jp jp :0^ ?Pj jp Jf3 jp Py* jp jp OJibril came to me and conveyed the good news that,

. i "J C jifc J 'i& !^ iVerily, Allah forgives not (the sin of) setting up partners (in worship) with Him, but He forgives whom He zoills, sins other than thatft [4:116]

> H X.HX-l tji (3- t And (remember) when We took a covenant from the Children of Israel, (saying) : Worship none but Allah and be dutiful and kind to parents.} [2 :83] There are several Ayat on this subject. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Ibn Mas'ud said, I asked Allah's Messenger about which deed is the best. He said, i'hZaiU *The prayer, when it is performed on time. I said, Then? He said,

512 Tafstr Ibn Kathir because the idolaters used to kill their children, obeying the lures of the devils. They used to bury their daughters alive for fear of shame, and sometimes kill their sons for fear of poverty. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, I asked the Messenger of Allah Which sin is the biggest? He said, jAj IX 4A) jl To call a rival for Allah, while He Alone created youj I said, Then what? He said, jf 4 >- iljljj jl To kill your son for fear that he might share your food I said, Then what? He said, '1X>- of To commit adultery with your neighbor's wifej Then the Messenger of Allah sg recited the Ayah, ill pj*. jll V iAnd those who invoke not any other god along with Allah, nor kill such person as Allah has forbidden, except for just cause, nor commit illegal sexual intercourse [25:68], fl Allah's statement, ^Because of Imlaq} refers to poverty, according to Ibn Abbas, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others. The Ayah means, do not kill your children because you are poor. Allah said in Surat Al-Isra , ^ \$2 iAnd do not kill your children for fear from Imlaq [17:31], that is, do not kill your children for fear that you might become poor in the future. This is why Allah said, ** Path Al-Bari 8:350 and Muslim 1 :98 At-Tabari 12:217

4We shall provide sustenance for them and for you [17:31], thus mentioning the provision of the children first, meaning, do not fear poverty because of feeding your children. Certainly, their provision is provided by Allah. Allah said, jpir . 4We provide sustenance for you and for them,} thus starting with parents, because this is the appropriate subject here and Allah knows. Allah said next, iCome not near Al-Fawahish (immoral sins) whether committed openly or secretly Allah said in a similar Ayah, CA A 2 c34\$% fr i c\$\$ y#& tioi j>; i iSay : "(But) the things that my Lord has indeed forbidden are Al-Fawahish (immoral sins) whether committed openly or secretly, sins (of all kinds), unrighteous oppression, joining partners (in worship) with Allah for which He has given no authority, and saying things about Allah of which you have no knowledge. } [7:33] We also explained this meaning in the explanation of the Ayah, i/Aj} }Leave sin, open and secret} [6:120]. The Two Sahihs recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah said, * fir* ^ \A~ * dre b None is more jealous than Allah. Tins is why He has forbidden the immoral sins committed openly or secretly .n 1 ' 1 m Fath Al-Bari 8 :146 and Muslim 4 :21 14

. The Prohibition of Unjustified Killing Allah said, 4^1 V) 'll)' ff- 4And kill not anyone whom Allah has forbidden, except for a just cause (according to Islamic law).} This part of the Ayah emphasizes this prohibition in specific, although it is included in the immoral sins committed openly and in secret. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Ibn Mas*ud said that the Messenger of Allah 5g said,

s> ' i pi^Xfu-u^j^ j^ (^**JpO y^-**j ^tS3jU? 0&&& 3O^d^J&Joi 4^J '6 #SI\$ ' '\$ *

516 Tafsir Ibt Kathir oljuJ'j ijijlj jiit ^ ^ |>-"3 JC Yj^ j li olfes j!j IjIacS jili lj[j V+a-Ij VJ^ L. ai LiKj 'll ^Ij]C 4^" "i&S "i" ^I*J 4152. "And come not near to the orphan's property, except to improve it, until he (or she) attains the age of full strength; and give full measure and full weight with justice ." - We burden not any person, but that which he can bear - "And whenever you speak, say the truth even if a near relative is concerned, and fulfill the covenant of Allah. This He commands you, that you may remember."} The Prohibition of Consuming the Orphan's Property Ata bin As-Sa ib said that Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn Abbas said, When Allah revealed, 4And come not near to the orphan's property, except to improve it.} and, 4ult 1\$ 6^ iVerily, those who unjustly eat up the property of orphans. } those who were guardians of orphans separated their food from the orphans food and their drink from their drink. When any of that food or drink remained, they used to keep it for the orphan until he or she ate it or it spoiled. This became difficult for the companions and they talked about it to the Messenger of Allah sg, and Allah sent down the Ayah, 4And they ask you about orphans. Say: The best thing is to work honestly in their property, and if you mix your affairs with theirs, then they are your brothers."} [2:220] Thereafter, they mixed their food and drink with food and drink of the orphans. Abu Dawud collected this statement. Allah's statement, 111 Abu Dawud 3 :291

%&} until he (or she) attains the age of full strength;}, refers to reaching the age of adolescence, according to Ash- Sha*bi, Malik and several others among the Salaf. 11 ' The Command to Give Full Measure and Full Weight with Justice Allah's statement, iand give full measure and full weight with justice.} is a command to establish justice while giving and taking. Allah has also warned against abandoning this commandment, when He said, j' (v*yo ; yjJ O-U');'o&4 's tfSf 4 Q& OyyCi ^ Jipjl \$j} & Vi 4 to Al-Mutaffifin . Those who, when they have to receive by measure from men, demand full measure. And when they have to give by measure or weight to (other) men, give less than due. Do they not think that they will be resurrected (for reckoning). On a Great Day? The Day when (all) mankind will stand before the Lord of all that exists?} [83:1-6]. Allah destroyed an entire nation that was accustomed to giving less in weights and measures.121 Allah said next, Vi 4We burden not any person, but that which he can bear.} that is, whoever strives while pursuing his rights and giving other peoples full rights, then there is no sin on him if he commits an honest mistake after trying his best and striving to do what is right.Tabari 12:223 121 That is, the nation of Prophet Shu ayb, see Surat Al-A raf7:85-92.

The Order for Just Testimony Allah said; i > 6S&. jlj ^ii whenever you give your word, say the truth even if a near relative is concerned.} This is similar to His statement, 40 you who believe! Stand out firmly Jbr Allah as just witnesses.} [5:8] And there is a similar Ayah in Surat An-Nisa . So Allah commands justice in action and statement, with both near relatives and distant relatives. Indeed, Allah orders justice for everyone at all times and in all situations. Fulfilling the Covenant of Allah is an Obligation Allah said next, jif J~i^} iand fulfill the Covenant of Allah.} Ibn Jarir commented, Allah commands: Fulfill Allah's commandments that He has ordered you. You will do so when you obey Him

in what He commanded, refrain from what He prohibited and abide by His Book and the Sunnah of His Messenger ﷺ. This constitutes fulfilling the covenant of Allah, 4...This He commands you, that you may remember.} Allah says here, that this is what He has ordered and commanded, and He stressed its importance for you, 4...that you may remember.}, that you may be advised and thus refrain from what you used to do before this. m At-Tabari 12:225

And verily, this is My straight path, so follow it, and follow not (other) paths, for they will separate you away from His path. This He has ordained for you that you may have Taqwa The Command to Follow Allah's Straight Path and to Avoid All Other Paths Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah's statements, ^{ft^^^} iAnd follow not (other) paths, for they will separate you away from His path.}, and, 4*j, iji/W

calls to it. He then recited, *Ar :i l." . * J:>? Oii iAnd verily, this is My straight path, so follow it, and follow not (other) paths, for they will separate you away from His path.)([6:l53Y 1]

Al-An'dm (153) (Part-8) Muhammad ﷺ left us at its lower end and its other end is in Paradise. To the right of this Path are other paths, and to the left of it are other paths, and there are men (on these paths) calling those who pass by them. Whoever goes on the other paths will end up in the Fire. Whoever takes the Straight Path, will end up in Paradise. Ibn Mas'ud then recited the Ayah; ^{ili} iAnd verily, this is My straight path, so follow it, and follow not (other) paths, for they will separate you away from His path.y Imam

Sarah 6. Al-An'dm (154 - 155) (Part-8) 523 iThen, We gave Musa the Book...} Allah often mentions the Qur'an and the Tawrah together. Allah said, W-3 liUj 2yyt u*j} iAnd before this was the Scripture of Musa as a guide and a mercy. And this is a confirming Book in the Arabic language.} [46:12]. Allah said in the beginning of this Surah, Cj> Cry -A& Sf & iU iSay : "Who then sent down the Book which Musa brought, a light and a guidance to mankind which you have made into paper sheets, disclosing (some of it) and concealing (much)?" (6:91), and iXC iAnd this is a blessed Book which we have sent down...} [6:92] Allah said about the idolaters, iBut when the truth has come to them from Us, they say: "Why is he not given the like of what was given to Musa? } [28:48]. Allah replied. IjSli) iri'L 1 Jj j* lyy^ iL j jJ\$} i"Did they not disbelieve in that which was given to Musa of old?" They say: "Two kinds of magic [the Tawrah and the Qur'an], each helping the other!" And they say : "Verily, in both we are disbelievers."} [28:48] Allah said about the Jinns that they said, Zf4t: Ui lyy jju [y Jjil i"0 our people! Verily, we have heard a Book sent down after Miisa, confirming what came before it, it guides to the truth."} [46:30]

Allah's statement, zs\$& CC} 4...complete for that which is best, and explaining all things in detail..."} means; *We made the Book that We revealed to Musa, a complete and comprehensive Book, sufficient for what he needs to complete his Law. Similarly, Allah said in another Ayah, 4}lr- Cs, g)jjVi 4 /I 4And We wrote for him on the Tablets the lesson to be drawn from all things.} (7:145] Allah's statement, 4fbr that which is best,} means: as a reward for his doing right and obeying Our commands and orders. Allah said in other Ayat, i&tof % to 4Is there any reward for good other than what is best?>[55:60], 4\X\ o-UU&C 4" jc&& 4And (remember) when the Lord of Ibrahim tried him with (certain) commands, which he fulfilled. He (Allah) said (to him), "Verily, I am going to make you an Imam for mankind."}

[2:124] and, iiA-3& r. i*tr 4And We made from among them (Children of Israel), leaders, giving guidance under Our command, when they were patient and believed with certainty in Our Ayat.} (32:24] Allah said; 4and explaining all things in detail and a guidance and a mercy} praising the Book that Allah sent down to Musa, while,

...that they might believe in the meeting with their Lord. And this is a blessed Book (the Qur'an) which We have sent down, so follow it and have Taqwa so that you may receive mercy.4 This calls to following the Qur'an. Allah encourages His servants to follow His Book (the Qur'an) and orders them to understand it, adhere to it and call to it. He also describes it as being blessed, for those who follow and implement it in this life and the Hereafter, because it is the Firm Rope of Allah. ft P 111 os 'P pi-* % ^ \y\$ \$ 0* Jlf cf-i iJij \1> tjljCjf "ji. \1&l" 4156. Lest you should say: "The Book was sent down only to two sects before us, and for our part, we were in fact unaware of what they studied."} 4157. Or lest you should say: "If only the Book had been sent down to us, we would surely have been better guided than they." So now has come unto you a clear proof from your Lord, and a guidance and a mercy. Who then does more wrong than one who rejects the Ayat of Allah and Sadafa away therefrom? We shall requite those who turn away from Our Ayat with an evil torment, because of their turning away.} The Qur'an is Allah's Proof Against His Creation Ibn Jarir commented on the Ayah, The Ayah means, this is a Book that We sent down, so that you do not say, 4 " & 4^fi Tl\} 4"The Book was sent down only to two sects before us."} This way, you will have no excuse. Allah said in another Ayah, C4[vi-i VjJ J 'tyj}

Al-An'dm (157 - 158) (Part-8) a guidance and a mercy. Allah says, there has come to you from Allah a Glorious Qur'an revealed to Muhammad jgg, the Arab Prophet. In it is

the explanation of the lawful and unlawful matters, guidance for the hearts and mercy from Allah to His servants who follow and implement it. Allah said; 41% i/" <? / / / f XV* OJUtfj 4ii\ iWho then does more wrong than one who re- jects the Ayat of Allah and Sadafa away therefrom?} This refers to the one who neither benefited from what the Messenger jg brought, nor followed what he was sent with by abandoning all other ways. Rather, he Sadafa from following the Ayat of Allah, meaning, he discouraged and hindered people from following it. This is the explanation of As-Suddi for Sadafa, while Ibn Abbas, Muj&hid and Qatadah said that Sadafa means, he turned away from it. J Kassail jL"Sfi lit iiill (w) la w .aT A i .i ti'/i'J' A *sr** *- hbjji'ij loA (*) 'oy i- 4^ fJi '*%> J"J" L>*" -Ofe ^^ ^ i5 iljjliu s? fe- -4 ipr OJ dZC 2g *\$% il58. Do they then wait for anything other than that the angels should come to them, or that your Lord should come, or that

some of the Signs of your Lord should come! The day that some of the signs of your Lord do come, no good will it do to a person to believe then, if he believed not before, nor earned good with his faith. Say: "Wait you! We (too) are waiting."} The Disbelievers Await the Commencement of the Hereafter, or Some of its Portents Allah sternly threatens the disbelievers, those who defy His Messengers, deny His Ayat and hinder from His path, 4\$, t. i " 4Do they then wait for anything other than that the angels should come to them, or that your Lord (Allah) should come...} on the Day of Resurrection, Hi y jz& 2\$ jz i} 4or that some of the signs of your Lord should come! The day that some of the signs of your Lord do come no good will it do to a person to believe then.} Before the commencement of the Day of

Resurrection, there will come signs and portents of the Last Hour that will be witnessed by the people living at that time. In a section explaining this Ayah,

Ujyu* j1L 1 IjS ' Three, if they appear, then a soul will not benefit from its faith, if it had not believed before or earned good in its faith when the sun rises from the west, Ad-Dajjal and the Beast of the earth. "(11

4t\$&& H � &h0 A saac%u&&} 4Do they then await (anything) other than the Hour, that it should come upon them suddenly? But some of its portents have already come; and when it is upon them, how can they benefit then by their reminder?} [47:18], and, jiU V* llg bjil=s"j jjwj llill .1* jjlj UJ"> & bta So a?/ien they saw Our punishment, they said : "We believe in Allah alone and reject (all) that we used to associate with Him as partners." Then their faith could not avail them when they saw Our punishment.} [40:84-85] X c f# Ji Kite 4 X fa \&\$ kt 4159. Verily, those who divide their religion and break up into sects, you have no concern with them in the least. Their affair is only with Allah, Who then will tell them what they used to do.} Criticizing Division in the Religion Mujahid, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and As-Suddi said that this Ayah was revealed about the Jews and Christians. 1 11 Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas commented, X pfi} 4Verily, those who divide their religion and break up into sects...} Before Muhammad ;g\$ was sent, the Jews and Christians disputed and divided into sects. When Muhammad^ was sent, Allah revealed to him, 4Verily, those who divide their religion and break up into sects, At-Tabari 12:269-270

you have no concern with them in the least. 1^ It is apparent that this Ayah refers to all those who defy the religion of Allah, or revert from it. Allah sent His Messenger fgl with guidance and the religion of truth so that He makes it victorious and dominant above all religions. His Law is one and does not contain any contradiction or incongruity. Therefore, those who dispute in the religion, 4...and break up into sects,) religious sects, just like those who follow the various sects, desires and misguidance - then Allah has purified His Messenger jg from their ways. In a similar Ayah, Allah said, 4 Cs*j putf Jt (4He (Allah) has ordained for you the same religion which He ordained for Null, and that which We have revealed to you.)[42:13] A Hadith reads, We, the Prophets, are half brothers but have one religion. This, indeed, is the straight path which the Messengers have brought and which commands worshipping Allah alone without partners and adhering to the Law of the last Messenger jg whom Allah sent. All other paths are types of misguidance, ignorance, sheer opinion and desires; and as such, the Messengers are free from them. Allah said here, 4 pri *) 4You have no concern with them in the least...) [6:159]. Allah s statement, 4&Z IX t iTheir affair is only with Allah, Who then will tell them what they used to do.) At-Tabari 12:269 ,21 Fath Al-Bari 6 :550

Al-An'dm (160) (Part-8 is similar to His statement, i C S|> 4^*^' fjJ > < -i; J-" iVerily, those who believe, and those who are Jews, and the Sabians, and the Christians, and the Majus, and those who worship others besides Allah; truly, Allah will judge between them on the Day of Resurrection [22:17] Allah then mentioned His kindness in His decisions and His justice on the Day of Resurrection, when He said. * ii t&k *m& it \$0 jii % ;t& 4 1'i0)Lku il60. Whoever brings a good deed shall have ten times the like thereof to his credit, and whoever brings an evil deed shall have only the recompense of the like thereof, and they will not be wronged The Good Deed is Multiplied Tenfold, While the Sin is Recompensed with the Same This Ayah explains the general Ayah ^Whoever comes with good, then he

will receive better than that>[28:84] There are several Hadiths that are in agreement with the apparent wording of this honorable Ayah. Imam

reward. The reason being that, this person did not intend to do good, nor commit evil. Some people abandon the sin because they were unable to commit it or due to laziness, after trying to commit it and seeking the means that help commit it. This person is just like the person who commits the sin. There is an authentic Hadith that states, "j&ij j jjuiii iij" *When two

4000 % 0 i K *} iWhoever brings a good deed shall have ten times the like thereof to his credit, < c 31 "Therefore, a day earns ten days ." At-Tirmidhi said; This Hadith is Hasan .! ' There are many other Hadiths and statements on this subject, but what we mentioned should be sufficient, Allah willing, and our trust is in Him. in 0 Si tlli tLj jj ..: Jp i Uj" v -jar^ ^ \$ ti; i . Say; "Truly, my Lord has guided me to a straight path, a right religion, the religion of Ibrahim, Hanifan (monotheism) and he was not of the Mushrikin."} 4162. Say: Verily , my Saldh, my sacrifice, my living, and my dying arefor Allah, the Lord of all that exists. } 4163. "He has no partner. And of this I have been commanded, and I am the first of the Muslims."} Islam is the Straight Path Allah commands His Prophet 5g, the chief of the Messengers, to convey the news of being guided to Allah s straight path. This path is neither wicked, nor deviant, 4 j &>} 4a right religion...} that is, established on firm grounds, V? tijU0 %} 4The religion of Ibrahim, Hanifan and he was not of the Mushrikin .} Allah said in similar Ayat, 40* '0 o* Si oj} Ahmad 5:146, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 3:470, An-Nasal 4:218 and Ibn Majah 1 :545

iAtid who turns away from the religion of Ibrahim except him who deludes himseip> [2:130], and, 'M ij*- 4 4And strive hard in Allah's cause as you ought to strive. He has chosen you, and has not laid upon you in religion any hardship: it is the religion ofyourfather Ibrahim.} [22:78], and, ISfTS L&j S*.- rt AX > LijJl J A-ij '*_) i* i ty li-X*- JL iVerily, Ibrahim was an Ummah (or a nation), obedient to Allah, a Hanif, and he was not one of the Mushrikin . (He was) thankfUl for His (Allah's) favors. He (Allah) chose him (as an intimate friend) and guided him to a straight path. And We gave him good in this world, and in the Hereafter he shall be of the righteous. Then, We have sent the revelation to you (saying): "Follow the religion of Ibrahim, (he was a) Hanif, and he was not of the Mushrikin } [16:120-123]. Ordering the Prophet sjg to follow the religion of Ibrahim, the HanifiyyahJ does not mean that Prophet Ibrahim reached more perfection in it than our Prophet jg. Rather, our Prophet perfectly established the religion and it was completed for him; and none before him reached this level of perfection. This is why he is the Final Prophet, the chief of all the Children of Adam who holds the station of praise and glory, the honor of intercession on the Day of Resurrection. All creation (on that Day) will seek him, even Ibrahim the friend of Allah, peace be upon him [to request the beginning ofJudgement]. Imam

ft vi 4And We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him (saying) : "None has the right to be worshipped but I, so worship Me."} [21:25) Allah informed us that Nuh said to his people, <>, 5* ^& 4 P "^ & jSiJ 4K 4Bui i/yow turn away, then no reward have I asked ofyou, my reward is onlyfrom Allah, and I have been commanded to be of the Muslims.} [10:72] Allah said, tty.j X&j jLlii ii-i ,>* * J* tn. i*" y} cJd 3tt Jd 2 tf il ^ di VJ V* C\$3' ' 6] Z ~i trf. 4And who turns away from the religion of Ibrahim except him who deludes himself? Truly, We chose him in this world and verily, in the Hereafter he will be among the righteous. When his Lord said to him, "Submit (i.e. be a Muslim)!"

raised you in ranks , some above others that He may try you in that which He has bestowed on you. Surely, your Lord is Swift in retribution, and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Allah Made Mankind Dwellers on the earth, Generation After Generation, of Various Grades, in order to Test Them Allah said, 4cfJ^^ pksdlur j} 4And it is He Who has made you generations coming after generations, replacing each other on the earth.} meaning, He made you dwell on the earth generation after generation, century after century and offspring after forefathers, according to Ibn Zayd and others. Allah also said, 4:"pj3Z. Jfsii 4 * &L S3 %} 4And if it were Our will. We would have made angels to replace you on the earth [43:60], and, 4j i \ &3L 4And makes you inheritors of the Earth, generation after generations.} [27:62], and 4Verily, I am going to place (mankind) generations after generations on earth.} [2:30], and. V, 4 iJ Cr-^} 4It may be that your Lord will destroy your enemy and make you successors on the earth, so that He may see how you act.} [7:129] Allah's statement, y /// "*" */ (*-* ! (hi? 4And He has raised you in ranks, some above others,}

546 Tafsir Ibn Kathir means. He has made you different from each other with regards to provision, conduct, qualities, evilness, shapes, color of skin, and so forth, and He has the perfect wisdom in all this. Allah said in other Ayat, L&? jy "i ilt is We Who portion out between them their livelihood in this world, and We raised some of them above others in ranks, so that some may employ others in their work.} [43:32], and, @^i-**** j\$1> y-i-Ji jf&i Jf*i& (> > LJyi JjS Jlity iSee how We prefer one above another (in this world), and verily, the Hereafter will be greater in degrees and greater in preferment.} [17:21] Allah's statement, ithat He may try you in that which He has bestowed on you.} means, so that He tests you in what He has granted you, for Allah tries the rich concerning his wealth and will ask him about how he appreciated it. He also tries the poor concerning his poverty and will ask him about his patience with it.

iSurely, your Lord is swift in retribution, and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} this is both discouragement and encouragement, by reminding the believers that Allah is swift in reckoning and punishment with those who disobey Him and defy His Messengers, 4 33%} 4And certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} for those who take Him as protector and follow His Messengers in the news and commandments they conveyed. Allah often mentions these two attributes together in the Qur'an. Allah said, 4-^UJt JjJ-J i)\f) j* oM. b-i~M b\j} 4But verily, your Lord is full of forgiveness for mankind in spite of their wrongdoing. And verily, your Lord is (also) severe in punishment} [13:6], and. iDeclare untoMy servants, that truly, I am the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful. And that My torment is indeed the most painful torment.} [15:49-50] There are similar Ayat that contain encouragement and discouragement. Sometimes Allah calls His servants to Him with encouragement, describing Paradise and making them eager for what He has with Him. Sometimes, He calls His servants with discouragement, mentioning the Fire and its torment and punishment, as well as, the Day of Resurrection and its horrors. Sometimes Allah mentions both so that each person is affected by it according to his or her qualities. We ask Allah that He makes us among those who obey what He has commanded, avoid what He has prohibited, and believe in Him as He has informed. Certainly, He is Near, hears and answers the supplication, and He is the Most Kind, Generous and Bestowing. Imam

Zj-J oJL>-lj j 4j> 4Ul jJL^ k^L^dl JL>-f ialj L" 4a>-^J l 4jj I XjP m ' Ij jlp_j Ljj >- "/// Me believer knew Allah's punishment, no one will hope in entering His Paradise. And if the disbeliever knew Allah's

mercy, no one will feel hopeless of acquiring Paradise. Allah created a hundred kinds of mercy. He sent down one of them to His creation, and they are merciful to each other on that account. With Allah, there remains ninety-nine kinds of merci/.